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Foreword

Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, by Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, is the principal work on the life and teachings of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the pioneer of a great social and religious movement that began in India about five hundred years ago and that has directly and indirectly influenced the subsequent course of religious and philosophical thinking not only in India but throughout the world. That Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's influence has spread so far is due in large part to the efforts of His Divine Grace A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupāda, the present work's translator and commentator and the founder and *ācārya* (spiritual guide) of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness.

Caitanya Mahāprabhu is thus a figure of great historical significance. However, our conventional method of historical analysis—that of seeing a man as a product of his times—fails here, for Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is a personality who transcends the limited scope of historical settings.

At a time when, in the West, man was directing his explorative spirit toward studying the structure of the physical universe and circumnavigating the world in search of new oceans and continents, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, in the East, was inaugurating and masterminding a revolution directed toward a scientific understanding of the highest knowledge of man's spiritual nature.

The chief historical sources for the life of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are the *kadacas* (diaries) kept by Murāri Gupta and Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī. Murāri Gupta, a physician and close associate of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's, recorded extensive notes on the first twenty-four years of His life, culminating in His initiation into the renounced order, *sannyāsa*. The

events of the rest of Caitanya Mahāprabhu's forty-eight years wererecorded in the diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī, another of His intimate associates.

Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta is divided into three sections, called *līlās*, a word that literally means "pastimes"-*Ādi-līlā* (the early period), *Madhya-līlā* (the middle period) and *Antya-līlā* (the final period). The notes of Murāri Gupta form the basis of the *Ādi-līlā*, and Svarūpa Dāmodara's diary provides the details for the *Madhya-* and *Antya-līlās*.

The first twelve chapters of the *Ādi-līlā* constitute the preface for the entire work. By referring to Vedic scriptural evidence, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja establishes that Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the *avatāra* (incarnation) of God for the Age of Kali-the current epoch, which began five thousand years ago and is characterized by materialism, hypocrisy and dissension. The author also proves that Caitanya Mahāprabhu is identical to Lord Kṛṣṇa and explains that He descends to liberally grant the fallen souls of this degraded age pure love of God by propagating *saṅkīrtana*-literally, "congregational glorification of God"-especially by organizing massive public chanting of the *mahā-mantra* (Great Chant for Deliverance). In addition, in the twelve-chapter preface Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja reveals the esoteric purpose of Lord Caitanya's appearance in the world, describes His co-*avatāras* and principal devotees, and summarizes His teachings. In the remaining portion of the *Ādi-līlā*, chapters thirteen through seventeen, the author briefly recounts Lord Caitanya's divine birth and His life until He accepted the renounced order. This account includes His childhood miracles, schooling, marriage and early philosophical confrontations, as well as His organization of a widespread *saṅkīrtana* movement and His civil disobedience against the repression of the Muslim government.

The *Madhya-līlā*, the longest of the three divisions, narrates in detail Lord Caitanya's extensive and eventful travels throughout India as a renounced mendicant, teacher, philosopher, spiritual preceptor and mystic. During this period of six years, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

transmits His teachings to His principles disciples. He debates and converts many of the renowned philosophers and theologians of His time, including Śāṅkarites, Buddhists and Muslims, and incorporates their many thousands of followers and disciples into His own burgeoning numbers. The author also includes in this section a dramatic account of Caitanya Mahāprabhu's miraculous activities at the giant Ratha-yātrā (Car Festival) in Jagannātha Purī, Orissa.

The *Antya-līlā* concerns the last eighteen years of Śrī Caitanya's presence, spent in semiseclusion near the famous Jagannātha temple in Purī. During these final years, During these final years, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya drifted deeper and deeper into trances of spiritual ecstasy unparalleled in all of religious and literary history, Eastern or Western. His perpetual and ever-increasing religious beatitude, graphically described in the eye-witness accounts of Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī, His constant companion during this period, clearly defy the investigative and descriptive abilities of modern psychologists and phenomenologists of religious experience.

The author of this great classic, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, born around the beginning of the sixteenth century, was a disciple of Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, a confidential follower of Caitanya Mahāprabhu's. Raghunātha dāsa, a renowned ascetic saint, heard and memorized all the activities of Caitanya Mahāprabhu told to him by Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī. After the passing away of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Svarūpa Dāmodara, Raghunātha dāsa, unable to bear the pain of separation from these objects of his complete devotion, traveled to Vṛndāvana, intending to commit suicide by jumping from Govardhana Hill. In Vṛndāvana, however, he encountered Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī, two of the most confidential disciples of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. They convinced him to to give up his planned suicide and impelled him to reveal to them the spiritually inspiring events of Lord Caitanya's later life. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī was also residing in Vṛndāvana at this time, and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī endowed him with a full comprehension of the transcendental life of Śrī

Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

By this time, contemporary and near-contemporary scholars and devotees had already written several biographical works on the life of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu. These included *Śrī Caitanya-carita*, by Murāri Gupta, *Caitanya-maṅgala*, by Locana dāsa Ṭhākura, and *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. This latter work, by Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, who was then considered the principal authority on Śrī Caitanya's life, was highly revered. While composing his important work, Vṛndāvana dāsa, fearing that it would become too voluminous, avoided elaborately describing many of the events of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's life, particularly the later ones. Anxious to hear of these later pastimes, the devotees in Vṛndāvana requested Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, whom they respected as a great saint and scholar, to compose a book narrating these episodes in detail. Upon this request, and with the permission and blessings of the Madana-mohana Deity of Vṛndāvana, he began compiling *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, which, due to its literary excellence and philosophical thoroughness, is today universally regarded as the foremost work on the life and profound teachings of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī commenced work on the text at a very advanced age and in failing health, as he vividly describes in the text itself: "I have now become too old and disturbed by invalidity. While writing, my hands tremble. I cannot remember anything, nor can I see or hear properly. Still I write, and this is a great wonder." That he completed the greatest literary gem of medieval India under such debilitating conditions is surely one of the wonders of literary history.

As mentioned above, this English translation and commentary is the work of His Divine Grace A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupāda, the world's most distinguished teacher of Indian religions and philosophical thought. Śrīla Prabhupāda's commentary is based upon two Bengali commentaries, one by his *guru*, Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī, the eminent Vedic scholar, teacher and saint who predicted, "The time will come when the people of the world will learn Bengali to read *Śrī Caitanya-*

caritāmṛta," and the other by Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī's father, Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura, who pioneered the propagation of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's teachings in the modern era.

Śrīla Prabhupada is himself a disciplic descendant of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and is the first scholar to execute systematic English translations of the major works of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's followers. His consummate Bengali and Sanskrit scholarship and intimate familiarity with the precepts of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are a fitting combination that eminently qualifies him to present this important classic to the English-speaking world. The ease and clarity with which he expounds upon difficult philosophical concepts enable even a reader totally unfamiliar with Indian religious tradition to understand and appreciate this profound and monumental work.

The entire text, with commentary, presented in nine lavishly illustrated volumes by the Bhaktivedanta Book Trust, represents a contribution of major importance to the intellectual, cultural and spiritual life of contemporary man.

-The Publishers

Editors note: Revisions in this edition are based on the transcripts of His Divine Grace A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupāda's original dictation of the translations, word meanings and purports of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Preface

There is no difference between the teachings of Lord Caitanya presented here and the teachings of Lord Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhagavad-gītā*. The teachings of Lord Caitanya are practical demonstrations of Lord Kṛṣṇa's teachings. Lord Kṛṣṇa's ultimate instruction in the *Bhagavad-gītā* is that everyone should surrender unto Him, Lord Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa promises to take

immediate charge of such a surrendered soul. The Lord, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is already in charge of the maintenance of this creation by virtue of His plenary expansion, Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, but this maintenance is not direct. However, when the Lord says that He takes charge of His pure devotee, He actually takes direct charge. A pure devotee is a soul who is forever surrendered to the Lord, just as a child is surrendered to his parents or an animal to its master. In the surrendering process, one should (1) accept things favorable for discharging devotional service, (2) reject things unfavorable, (3) always believe firmly in the Lord's protection, (4) feel exclusively dependent on the mercy of the Lord, (5) have no interest separate from the interest of the Lord, and (6) always feel oneself meek and humble.

The Lord demands that one surrender unto Him by following these six guidelines, but the unintelligent so-called scholars of the world misunderstand these demands and urge the general mass of people to reject them. At the conclusion of the Ninth Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, Lord Kṛṣṇa directly orders, "Always think of Me, become My devotee, worship Me alone, and offer obeisances unto Me alone." By so doing, the Lord says, one is sure to go to Him in His transcendental abode. But the scholarly demons misguide the masses of people by directing them to surrender not to the Personality of Godhead but rather to the impersonal, unmanifested, eternal, unborn truth. The impersonalist Māyāvādī philosophers do not accept that the ultimate aspect of the Absolute Truth is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. If one desires to understand the sun as it is, one must first face the sunshine and then the sun globe, and then, if one is able to enter into that globe, one may come face to face with the predominating deity of the sun. Due to a poor fund of knowledge, the Māyāvādī philosophers cannot go beyond the Brahman effulgence, which may be compared to the sunshine. The *Upaniṣads* confirm that one has to penetrate the dazzling effulgence of Brahman before one can see the real face of the Personality of Godhead.

Lord Caitanya therefore teaches direct worship of Lord Kṛṣṇa, who appeared as the foster child of the King of Vraja. He also teaches that the

place known as Vṛndāvana is as good as Lord Kṛṣṇa because, Lord Kṛṣṇa being the Absolute Truth, there is no difference between Him and His name, qualities, form, pastimes, entourage and paraphernalia. That is the absolute nature of the Personality of Godhead. Lord Caitanya also teaches that the highest mode of worship in the highest perfectional stage is the method practiced by the damsels of Vraja. These damsels (*gopīs*, or cowherd girls) simply loved Kṛṣṇa without any motive for material or spiritual gain. Lord Caitanya also teaches that *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is the spotless narration of transcendental knowledge and that the highest goal in human life is to develop unalloyed love for Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Lord Caitanya's teachings are identical to those given by Lord Kapila, the original propounder of *sāṅkhya-yoga*, the *sāṅkhya* system of philosophy. This authorized system of *yoga* teaches meditation on the transcendental form of the Lord. There is no question of meditating on something void or impersonal. When one can meditate on the transcendental form of Lord Viṣṇu even without practicing involved sitting postures, such meditation is called perfect *samādhi*. That this kind of meditation is perfect *samādhi* is confirmed at the end of the Sixth Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, where Lord Kṛṣṇa says that of all *yogīs*, the greatest is the one who constantly thinks of the Lord within the core of his heart with love and devotion.

On the basis of the *sāṅkhya* philosophy of *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*, which maintains that the Supreme Lord is simultaneously one with and different from His creation, Lord Caitanya taught that the most practical way for the mass of people to practice *sāṅkhya-yoga* meditation is simply to chant the holy name of the Lord. He taught that the holy name of the Lord is the sound incarnation of the Lord and that since the Lord is the absolute whole, there is no difference between His holy name and His transcendental form. Thus by chanting the holy name of the Lord one can directly associate with the Supreme Lord by sound vibration. As one practices chanting this sound vibration, one passes through three stages of development: the offensive stage, the clearing stage and the

transcendental stage. In the offensive stage of chanting one may desire all kinds of material happiness, but in the second stage one becomes clear of all material contamination. When one is situated on the transcendental stage, one attains the most coveted position—the stage of loving God. Lord Caitanya taught that this is the highest stage of perfection for human beings.

Yoga practice is essentially meant for controlling the senses. The central controlling factor of all the senses is the mind; therefore one first has to practice controlling the mind by engaging it in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. The gross activities of the mind are expressed through the external senses, either for the acquisition of knowledge or for the functioning of the senses in accordance with the will. The subtle activities of the mind are thinking, feeling and willing, which are carried out according to one's consciousness, either polluted or clear. If one's mind is fixed on Kṛṣṇa (His name, qualities, form, pastimes, entourage and paraphernalia), all one's activities—both subtle and gross—become favorable. The *Bhagavad-gītā's* process of purifying consciousness is the process of fixing one's mind on Kṛṣṇa by talking of His transcendental activities, cleansing His temple, going to His temple, seeing the beautiful transcendental form of the Lord nicely decorated, hearing His transcendental glories, tasting food offered to Him, associating with His devotees, smelling the flowers and *tulasī* leaves offered to Him, engaging in activities for the Lord's interest, becoming angry at those who are malicious toward devotees, etc. No one can bring the activities of the mind and senses to a stop, but one can purify these activities through a change in consciousness. This change is indicated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (2.39), where Kṛṣṇa tells Arjuna of the knowledge of *yoga* whereby one can work without fruitive results: "O son of Pṛthā, when you act in such knowledge you can free yourself from the bondage of works." A human being is sometimes restricted in sense gratification due to certain circumstances, such as disease, but such proscriptions are for the less intelligent. Without knowing the actual process by which the mind and senses can be controlled, less intelligent men may try to stop the mind and senses by force, but ultimately they give in to them and are carried away by the waves of sense gratification.

The eight principles of *sāṅkhya-yoga*—observing the regulative principles, following the rules, practicing the various sitting postures, performing the breathing exercises, withdrawing one’s senses from the sense objects, etc.—are meant for those who are too much engrossed in the bodily conception of life. The intelligent man situated in Kṛṣṇa consciousness does not try to forcibly stop his senses from acting. Rather, he engages his senses in the service of Kṛṣṇa. No one can stop a child from playing by leaving him inactive; rather, the child can be stopped from engaging in nonsense by being engaged in superior activities. Similarly, the forceful restraint of sense activities by the eight principles of *yoga* is recommended for inferior men; superior men, being engaged in the superior activities of Kṛṣṇa consciousness, naturally retire from the inferior activities of material existence.

In this way Lord Caitanya teaches the science of Kṛṣṇa consciousness. That science is absolute. Dry mental speculators try to restrain themselves from material attachment, but it is generally found that the mind is too strong to be controlled and that it drags them down to sensual activities. A person in Kṛṣṇa consciousness does not run this risk. One therefore has to engage one’s mind and senses in Kṛṣṇa conscious activities, and Lord Caitanya teaches one how to do this in practice.

Before accepting *sannyāsa* (the renounced order), Lord Caitanya was known as Viśvambhara. The word *viśvambhara* refers to one who maintains the entire universe and who leads all living entities. This maintainer and leader appeared as Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa Caitanya to give humanity these sublime teachings. Lord Caitanya is the ideal teacher of life’s prime necessities. He is the most munificent bestower of love of Kṛṣṇa. He is the complete reservoir of all mercies and good fortune. As confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, the *Bhagavad-gītā*, the *Mahābhārata* and the *Upaniṣads*, He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa Himself, and He is worshipable by everyone in this age of disagreement. Everyone can join in His *saṅkīrtana* movement. No previous qualification is necessary. Just by following His teachings, anyone can become a perfect human being. If a person is fortunate enough to be attracted by

Lord Caitanya, he is sure to be successful in his life's mission. In other words, those who are interested in attaining spiritual existence can easily be released from the clutches of *māyā* by the grace of Lord Caitanya. The teachings presented in this book are nondifferent from the Lord.

The conditioned soul, engrossed in the material body, increases the pages of history by all kinds of material activities. The teachings of Lord Caitanya can help the members of human society stop such unnecessary and temporary activities and be elevated to the topmost platform of spiritual activities, which begin after liberation from material bondage. Such liberated activities in Kṛṣṇa consciousness constitute the goal of human perfection. The false prestige one acquires by attempting to dominate material nature is illusory. Illuminating knowledge can be acquired by studying the teachings of Lord Caitanya, and by such knowledge one can advance in spiritual existence.

Everyone has to suffer or enjoy the fruits of his activity; no one can check the laws of material nature that govern such things. As long as one is engaged in fruitive activity, one is sure to be baffled in the attempt to attain the ultimate goal of life. I sincerely hope that by understanding the teachings of Lord Caitanya presented in this book, *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, human society will experience a new light of spiritual life, which will open the field of activity for the pure soul.

om tat sat

A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami

March 14, 1968

The Birthday of Lord Caitanya

Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa Temple

New York, N.Y.

Introduction

(Originally delivered as five morning lectures on the Caitanya-caritāmṛta—the authoritative biography of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu)

by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī—before the International Society for Krishna Consciousness, New York City, April 10–14, 1967.)

The word *caitanya* means “living force,” *carita* means “character,” and *amṛta* means “immortal.” As living entities we can move, but a table cannot because it does not possess living force. Movement and activity may be considered signs or symptoms of the living force. Indeed, it may be said that there can be no activity without the living force. Although the living force is present in the material condition, this condition is not *amṛta*, immortal. The words *caitanya-caritāmṛta*, then, may be translated as “the character of the living force in immortality.”

But how is this living force displayed immortally? It is not displayed by man or any other creature in this material universe, for none of us are immortal in these bodies. We possess the living force, we perform activities, and we are immortal by our nature and constitution, but the material condition into which we have been put does not allow our immortality to be displayed. It is stated in the *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* that eternality and the living force belong to both ourselves and God. Although this is true in that both God and ourselves are immortal, there is a difference. As living entities, we perform many activities, but we have a tendency to fall down into material nature. God has no such tendency. Being all-powerful, He never comes under the control of material nature. Indeed, material nature is but one display of His inconceivable energies.

An analogy will help us understand the distinction between ourselves and God. From the ground we may see only clouds in the sky, but if we fly above the clouds we can see the sun shining. From the sky, skyscrapers and cities seem very tiny; similarly, from God’s position this entire material creation is insignificant. The tendency of the living entity is to come down from the heights, where everything can be seen in perspective. God, however, does not have this tendency. The Supreme Lord is not subject to fall down into illusion (*māyā*) any more than the sun is subject to fall beneath the clouds. Impersonalist philosophers

(Māyāvādīs) maintain that both the living entity and God Himself are under the control of *māyā* when they come into this material world. This is the fallacy of their philosophy.

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu should therefore not be considered one of us. He is Kṛṣṇa Himself, the supreme living entity, and as such He never comes under the cloud of *māyā*. Kṛṣṇa, His expansions and even His higher devotees never fall into the clutches of illusion. Lord Caitanya came to earth simply to preach *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*, love of Kṛṣṇa. In other words, He is Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself teaching the living entities the proper way to approach Kṛṣṇa. He is like a teacher who, seeing a student doing poorly, takes up a pencil and writes, saying, “Do it like this: A, B, C.” From this one should not foolishly think that the teacher is learning his ABC’s. Similarly, although Lord Caitanya appears in the guise of a devotee, we should not foolishly think He is an ordinary human being; we should always remember that Lord Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa (God) Himself teaching us how to become Kṛṣṇa conscious, and we must study Him in that light.

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (18.66) Lord Kṛṣṇa says, “Give up all your nonsense and surrender to Me. I will protect you.”

We say, “Oh, surrender? But I have so many responsibilities.”

And *māyā*, illusion, says to us, “Don’t do it, or you’ll be out of my clutches. Just stay in my clutches, and I’ll kick you.”

It is a fact that we are constantly being kicked by *māyā*, just as the male ass is kicked in the face by the she-ass when he comes for sex. Similarly, cats and dogs are always fighting and whining when they have sex. Even an elephant in the jungle is caught by the use of a trained she-elephant who leads him into a pit. We should learn by observing these tricks of nature.

Māyā has many ways to entrap us, and her strongest shackle is the

female. Of course, in actuality we are neither male nor female, for these designations refer only to the outer dress, the body. We are all actually Kṛṣṇa's servants. But in conditioned life we are shackled by iron chains in the form of beautiful women. Thus every male is bound by sex, and therefore one who wishes to gain liberation from the material clutches must first learn to control the sex urge. Unrestricted sex puts one fully in the clutches of illusion. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu officially renounced this illusion at the age of twenty-four, although His wife was sixteen and His mother seventy and He was the only male in the family. Although He was a *brāhmaṇa* and was not rich, He took *sannyāsa*, the renounced order of life, and thus extricated Himself from family entanglement.

If we wish to become fully Kṛṣṇa conscious, we have to give up the shackles of *māyā*. Or, if we remain with *māyā*, we should live in such a way that we will not be subject to illusion, as did the many householders among Lord Caitanya's closest devotees. With His followers in the renounced order, however, Lord Caitanya was very strict. He even banished Junior Haridāsa, an important *kīrtana* leader, for glancing lustfully at a woman. The Lord told him, "You are living with Me in the renounced order, and yet you are looking at a woman with lust." Other devotees of the Lord had appealed to Him to forgive Haridāsa, but He replied, "All of you can forgive him and live with him. I shall live alone." On the other hand, when the Lord learned that the wife of one of His householder devotees was pregnant, He asked that the baby be given a certain auspicious name. So while the Lord approved of householders having regulated sex, He was like a thunderbolt with those in the renounced order who tried to cheat by the method known as "drinking water under water while bathing on a fast day." In other words, He tolerated no hypocrisy among His followers.

From the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* we learn how Lord Caitanya taught people to break the shackles of *māyā* and become immortal. Thus, as mentioned above, the title may be properly translated as "the character of the living force in immortality." The supreme living force is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He is also the supreme entity. There are

innumerable living entities, and all of them are individuals. This is very easy to understand: We are all individual in our thoughts and desires, and the Supreme Lord is also an individual person. He is different, though, in that He is the leader, the one whom no one can excel. Among the minute living entities, one being can excel another in one capacity or another. Like each of these living entities, the Lord is an individual, but He is different in that He is the supreme individual. God is also infallible, and thus in the *Bhagavad-gītā* He is addressed as Acyuta, which means “He who never falls down.” This name is appropriate because in the *Bhagavad-gītā* Arjuna falls into illusion but Kṛṣṇa does not. Kṛṣṇa Himself reveals His infallibility when he says to Arjuna, “When I appear in this world, I do so by My own internal potency.” (Bg. 4.6)

Thus we should not think that Kṛṣṇa is overpowered by the material potency when He is in the material world. Neither Kṛṣṇa nor His incarnations ever come under the control of material nature. They are totally free. Indeed, in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* one who has a godly nature is actually defined as one who is not affected by the modes of material nature although in material nature. If even a devotee can attain this freedom, then what to speak of the Supreme Lord?

The real question is, How can we remain unpolluted by material contamination while in the material world? Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī explains that we can remain uncontaminated while in the world if we simply make it our ambition to serve Kṛṣṇa. One may then justifiably ask, “How can I serve?” It is not simply a matter of meditation, which is just an activity of the mind, but of performing practical work for Kṛṣṇa. In such work, we should leave no resource unused. Whatever is there, whatever we have, should be used for Kṛṣṇa. We can use everything—typewriters, automobiles, airplanes, missiles. If we simply speak to people about Kṛṣṇa consciousness, we are also rendering service. If our mind, senses, speech, money and energies are thus engaged in the service of Kṛṣṇa, then we are no longer in material nature. By virtue of spiritual consciousness, or Kṛṣṇa consciousness, we transcend the platform of material nature. It is a fact that Kṛṣṇa, His expansions and His devotees—that is, those who

work for Him—are not in material nature, although people with a poor fund of knowledge think that they are.

The *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* teaches that the spirit soul is immortal and that our activities in the spiritual world are also immortal. The Māyāvādīs, who hold the view that the Absolute is impersonal and formless, contend that a realized soul has no need to talk. But the Vaiṣṇavas, devotees of Kṛṣṇa, contend that when one reaches the stage of realization, he really begins to talk. “Previously we only talked of nonsense,” the Vaiṣṇava says. “Now let us begin our real talks, talks of Kṛṣṇa.” In support of their view that the self-realized remain silent, the Māyāvādīs are fond of using the example of the water pot, maintaining that when a pot is not filled with water it makes a sound, but that when it is filled it makes no sound. But are we waterpots? How can we be compared to them? A good analogy utilizes as many similarities between two objects as possible. A waterpot is not an active living force, but we are. Ever-silent meditation may be adequate for a waterpot, but not for us. Indeed, when a devotee realizes how much he has to say about Kṛṣṇa, twenty-four hours in a day are not sufficient. It is the fool who is celebrated as long as he does not speak, for when he breaks his silence his lack of knowledge is exposed. The *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* shows that there are many wonderful things to discover by glorifying the Supreme.

In the beginning of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī writes, “I offer my respects to my spiritual masters.” He uses the plural here to indicate the disciplic succession. He offers obeisances not to his spiritual master alone but to the whole *paramparā*, the chain of disciplic succession beginning with Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself. Thus the author addresses the *guru* in the plural to show the highest respect for all his predecessor spiritual masters. After offering obeisances to the disciplic succession, the author pays obeisances to all other devotees, to the Lord Himself, to His incarnations, to the expansions of Godhead and to the manifestation of Kṛṣṇa’s internal energy. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu (sometimes called Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) is the embodiment of all of these: He is God, *guru*, devotee, incarnation, internal energy and expansion of God.

As His associate Nityānanda, He is the first expansion of God; as Advaita, He is an incarnation; as Gadādhara, He is the internal potency; and as Śrīvāsa, He is the marginal living entity in the role of a devotee. Thus Kṛṣṇa should not be thought of as being alone but should be considered as eternally existing with all His manifestations, as described by Rāmāṇujācārya. In the Viśiṣṭādvaita philosophy, God's energies, expansions and incarnations are considered to be oneness in diversity. In other words, God is not separate from all of these: everything together is God.

Actually, the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* is not intended for the novice, for it is the postgraduate study of spiritual knowledge. Ideally, one begins with the *Bhagavad-gītā* and advances through *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* to the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. Although all these great scriptures are on the same absolute level, for the sake of comparative study the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* is considered to be on the highest platform. Every verse in it is perfectly composed.

In the second verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, the author offers his obeisances to Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda. He compares them to the sun and the moon because They dissipate the darkness of the material world. In this instance the sun and the moon have risen together.

In the Western world, where the glories of Lord Caitanya are relatively unknown, one may inquire, “Who is Kṛṣṇa Caitanya?” The author of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja, answers that question in the third verse of his book. Generally, in the *Upaniṣads* the Supreme Absolute Truth is described in an impersonal way, but the personal aspect of the Absolute Truth is mentioned in the *Īśopaniṣad*, where we find the following verse:

*hiraṇmayena pātreṇa satyasyāpihitam mukham
tat tvam pūṣann apāvṛṇu satya-dharmāya dṛṣṭaye*

“O my Lord, sustainer of all that lives, Your real face is covered by Your

dazzling effulgence. Kindly remove that covering and exhibit Yourself to Your pure devotee.” (*Śrī Īśopaniṣad* 15) The impersonalists do not have the power to go beyond the effulgence of God and arrive at the Personality of Godhead, from whom this effulgence is emanating. The *Īśopaniṣad* is a hymn to that Personality of Godhead. It is not that the impersonal Brahman is denied; it is also described, but that Brahman is revealed to be the glaring effulgence of the body of Lord Kṛṣṇa. And in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* we learn that Lord Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa Himself. In other words, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the basis of the impersonal Brahman. The Paramātmā, or Supersoul, who is present within the heart of every living entity and within every atom of the universe, is but the partial representation of Lord Caitanya. Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, being the basis of both Brahman and the all-pervading Paramātmā as well, is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. As such, He is full in six opulences: wealth, fame, strength, beauty, knowledge and renunciation. In short, we should know that He is Kṛṣṇa, God, and that nothing is equal to or greater than Him. There is nothing superior to be conceived. He is the Supreme Person.

Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, a confidential devotee taught for more than ten days continually by Lord Caitanya, wrote:

*namo mahā-vadānyāya kṛṣṇa-prema-pradāya te
kṛṣṇāya kṛṣṇa-caitanya-nāmne gaura-tviṣe namaḥ*
[Madhya 19.53]

“I offer my respectful obeisances unto the Supreme Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who is more magnanimous than any other *avatāra*, even Kṛṣṇa Himself, because He is bestowing freely what no one else has ever given—pure love of Kṛṣṇa.”

Lord Caitanya’s teachings begin from the point of surrender to Kṛṣṇa. He does not pursue the paths of *karma-yoga* or *jñāna-yoga* or *haṭha-yoga* but begins at the end of material existence, at the point where one gives up all material attachment. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* Kṛṣṇa begins His teachings by

distinguishing the soul from matter, and in the Eighteenth Chapter He concludes at the point where the soul surrenders to Him in devotion. The Māyāvādīs would have all talk cease there, but at that point the real discussion only begins. As the *Vedānta-sūtra* says at the very beginning, *athāto brahma jijñāsā*: “Now let us begin to inquire about the Supreme Absolute Truth.” Rūpa Gosvāmī thus praises Lord Caitanya as the most munificent incarnation of all, for He gives the greatest gift by teaching the highest form of devotional service. In other words, He answers the most important inquiries that anyone can make.

There are different stages of devotional service and God realization. Strictly speaking, anyone who accepts the existence of God is situated in devotional service. To acknowledge that God is great is something, but not much. Lord Caitanya, preaching as an *ācārya*, a great teacher, taught that we can enter into a relationship with God and actually become God’s friend, parent or lover. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* Kṛṣṇa showed Arjuna His universal form because Arjuna was His very dear friend. Upon seeing Kṛṣṇa as the Lord of the universes, however, Arjuna asked Kṛṣṇa to forgive the familiarity of his friendship. Lord Caitanya goes beyond this point. Through Lord Caitanya we can become friends with Kṛṣṇa, and there will be no limit to this friendship. We can become friends of Kṛṣṇa not in awe or adoration but in complete freedom. We can even relate to God as His father or mother. This is the philosophy not only of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* but of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* as well. There are no other scriptures in the world in which God is treated as the son of a devotee. Usually God is seen as the almighty father who supplies the demands of His sons. The great devotees, however, sometimes treat God as a son in their execution of devotional service. The son demands, and the father and mother supply, and in supplying Kṛṣṇa the devotee becomes like a father or mother. Instead of taking from God, we give to God. It was in this relationship that Kṛṣṇa’s mother, Yaśodā, told the Lord, “Here, eat this or You’ll die. Eat nicely.” In this way Kṛṣṇa, although the proprietor of everything, depends on the mercy of His devotee. This is a uniquely high level of friendship, in which the devotee actually believes himself to be the father or mother of Kṛṣṇa.

However, Lord Caitanya's greatest gift was His teaching that Kṛṣṇa can be treated as one's lover. In this relationship the Lord becomes so much attached to His devotee that He expresses His inability to reciprocate. Kṛṣṇa was so obliged to the *gopīs*, the cowherd girls of Vṛndāvana, that He felt unable to return their love. "I cannot repay your love," He told them. "I have no more assets to give." Devotional service on this highest, most excellent platform of lover and beloved, which had never been given by any previous incarnation or *ācārya*, was given by Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Therefore Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja, quoting Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, writes in the fourth verse of his book, "Lord Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa in a yellow complexion, and He is Śacīnandana, the son of mother Śacī. He is the most charitable personality because He came to deliver *kṛṣṇa-prema*, unalloyed love for Kṛṣṇa, to everyone. May you always keep Him in your hearts. It will be easy to understand Kṛṣṇa through Him."

We have often heard the phrase "love of Godhead." How far this love of Godhead can actually be developed can be learned from the Vaiṣṇava philosophy. Theoretical knowledge of love of God can be found in many places and in many scriptures, but what that love of Godhead actually is and how it is developed can be found in the Vaiṣṇava literatures. It is the unique and highest development of love of God that is given by Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Even in this material world we can have a little sense of love. How is this possible? It is due to the presence of our original love of God. Whatever we find within our experience within this conditioned life is situated in the Supreme Lord, who is the ultimate source of everything. In our original relationship with the Supreme Lord there is real love, and that love is reflected pervertedly through material conditions. Our real love is continuous and unending, but because that love is reflected pervertedly in this material world, it lacks continuity and is inebriating. If we want real, transcendental love, we have to transfer our love to the supreme lovable object—Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This is the basic principle of Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

In material consciousness we are trying to love that which is not at all lovable. We give our love to cats and dogs, running the risk that at the time of death we may think of them and consequently take birth in a family of cats or dogs. Our consciousness at the time of death determines our next life. That is one reason why the Vedic scriptures stress the chastity of women: If a woman is very much attached to her husband, at the time of death she will think of him, and in the next life she will be promoted to a man's body. Generally a man's life is better than a woman's because a man usually has better facilities for understanding the spiritual science.

But Kṛṣṇa consciousness is so nice that it makes no distinction between man and woman. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.32), Lord Kṛṣṇa says, "Anyone who takes shelter of Me—whether a woman, *sūdra*, *vaiśya* or anyone else of low birth—is sure to achieve My association." This is Kṛṣṇa's guarantee.

Caitanya Mahāprabhu informs us that in every country and in every scripture there is some hint of love of Godhead. But no one knows what love of Godhead actually is. The Vedic scriptures, however, are different in that they can direct the individual in the proper way to love God. Other scriptures do not give information on how one can love God, nor do they actually define or describe *what* or *who* the Godhead actually is. Although they officially promote love of Godhead, they have no idea how to execute it. But Caitanya Mahāprabhu gives a practical demonstration of how to love God in a conjugal relationship. Taking the part of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, Caitanya Mahāprabhu tried to love Kṛṣṇa as Rādhārāṇī loved Him. Kṛṣṇa was always amazed by Rādhārāṇī's love. "How does Rādhārāṇī give Me such pleasure?" He would ask. In order to study Rādhārāṇī, Kṛṣṇa lived in Her role and tried to understand Himself. This is the secret of Lord Caitanya's incarnation. Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Kṛṣṇa, but He has taken the mood and role of Rādhārāṇī to show us how to love Kṛṣṇa. Thus the author writes in the fifth verse, "I offer my respectful obeisances unto the Supreme Lord, who is absorbed in Rādhārāṇī's thoughts."

This brings up the question of who Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is and what Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa is. Actually Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa is the exchange of love—but not ordinary love. Kṛṣṇa has immense potencies, of which three are principal: the internal, the external and the marginal potencies. In the internal potency there are three divisions: *samvit*, *hlādinī* and *sandhinī*. The *hlādinī* potency is Kṛṣṇa's pleasure potency. All living entities have this pleasure-seeking potency, for all beings are trying to have pleasure. This is the very nature of the living entity. At present we are trying to enjoy our pleasure potency by means of the body in the material condition. By bodily contact we are attempting to derive pleasure from material sense objects. But we should not entertain the nonsensical idea that Kṛṣṇa, who is always spiritual, also tries to seek pleasure on this material plane. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* Kṛṣṇa describes the material universe as a nonpermanent place full of miseries. Why, then, would He seek pleasure in matter? He is the Supersoul, the supreme spirit, and His pleasure is beyond the material conception.

To learn how Kṛṣṇa enjoys pleasure, we must study the first nine cantos of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and then we should study the Tenth Canto, in which Kṛṣṇa's pleasure potency is displayed in His pastimes with Rādhārāṇī and the damsels of Vraja. Unfortunately, unintelligent people turn at once to the sports of Kṛṣṇa in the *Daśama-skandha*, the Tenth Canto. Kṛṣṇa's embracing Rādhārāṇī or His dancing with the cowherd girls in the *rāsa* dance are generally not understood by ordinary men, because they consider these pastimes in the light of mundane lust. They foolishly think that Kṛṣṇa is like themselves and that He embraces the *gopīs* just as an ordinary man embraces a young girl. Some people thus become interested in Kṛṣṇa because they think that His religion allows indulgence in sex. This is not *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*, love of Kṛṣṇa, but *prākṛta-sahajiyā*—materialistic lust.

To avoid such errors, we should understand what Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa actually is. Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa display Their pastimes through Kṛṣṇa's internal energy. The pleasure potency of Kṛṣṇa's internal energy is a most difficult subject matter, and unless one understands what Kṛṣṇa is, one

cannot understand it. Kṛṣṇa does not take any pleasure in this material world, but He has a pleasure potency. Because we are part and parcel of Kṛṣṇa, the pleasure potency is within us also, but we are trying to exhibit that pleasure potency in matter. Kṛṣṇa, however, does not make such a vain attempt. The object of Kṛṣṇa's pleasure potency is Rādhārāṇī; Kṛṣṇa exhibits His potency as Rādhārāṇī and then engages in loving affairs with Her. In other words, Kṛṣṇa does not take pleasure in this external energy but exhibits His internal energy, His pleasure potency, as Rādhārāṇī and then enjoys with Her. Thus Kṛṣṇa manifests Himself as Rādhārāṇī in order to enjoy His internal pleasure potency. Of the many extensions, expansions and incarnations of the Lord, this pleasure potency is the foremost and chief.

It is not that Rādhārāṇī is separate from Kṛṣṇa. Rādhārāṇī is also Kṛṣṇa, for there is no difference between the energy and the energetic. Without energy, there is no meaning to the energetic, and without the energetic, there is no energy. Similarly, without Rādhā there is no meaning to Kṛṣṇa, and without Kṛṣṇa there is no meaning to Rādhā. Because of this, the Vaiṣṇava philosophy first of all pays obeisances to and worships the internal pleasure potency of the Supreme Lord. Thus the Lord and His potency are always referred to as Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa. Similarly, those who worship Nārāyaṇa first of all utter the name of Lakṣmī, as Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa. Similarly, those who worship Lord Rāma first of all utter the name of Sītā. In any case—Sītā-Rāma, Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa—the potency always comes first.

Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one, and when Kṛṣṇa desires to enjoy pleasure, He manifests Himself as Rādhārāṇī. The spiritual exchange of love between Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa is the actual display of Kṛṣṇa's internal pleasure potency. Although we speak of “when” Kṛṣṇa desires, just when He did desire we cannot say. We only speak in this way because in conditioned life we take it that everything has a beginning; however, in spiritual life everything is absolute, and so there is neither beginning nor end. Yet in order to understand that Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one and that They also become divided, the question “When?” automatically comes to mind.

When Kṛṣṇa desired to enjoy His pleasure potency, He manifested Himself in the separate form of Rādhārāṇī, and when He wanted to understand Himself through the agency of Rādhā, He united with Rādhārāṇī, and that unification is called Lord Caitanya. This is all explained by Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja in the fifth verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

In the next verse the author further explains why Kṛṣṇa assumed the form of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Kṛṣṇa desired to know the glory of Rādhā's love. "Why is She so much in love with Me?" Kṛṣṇa asked. "What is My special qualification that attracts Her so? And what is the actual way in which She loves Me?" It seems strange that Kṛṣṇa, as the Supreme, should be attracted by anyone's love. A man searches after the love of a woman because he is imperfect—he lacks something. The love of a woman, that potency and pleasure, is absent in man, and therefore a man wants a woman. But this is not the case with Kṛṣṇa, who is full in Himself. Thus Kṛṣṇa expressed surprise: "Why am I attracted by Rādhārāṇī? And when Rādhārāṇī feels My love, what is She actually feeling?" To taste the essence of that loving exchange, Kṛṣṇa made His appearance in the same way that the moon appears on the horizon of the sea. Just as the moon was produced by the churning of the sea, by the churning of spiritual loving affairs the moon of Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared. Indeed, Lord Caitanya's complexion was golden, just like the luster of the moon. Although this is figurative language, it conveys the meaning behind the appearance of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The full significance of His appearance will be explained in later chapters.

After offering respects to Lord Caitanya, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja begins offering them to Lord Nityānanda in the seventh verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. The author explains that Lord Nityānanda is Balarāma, who is the origin of Mahā-Viṣṇu. Kṛṣṇa's first expansion is Balarāma, a portion of whom is manifested as Saṅkarṣaṇa, who then expands as Pradyumna. In this way so many expansions take place. Although there are many expansions, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the origin, as confirmed in the *Brahma-saṁhitā*. He is like the original candle, from which many

thousands and millions of candles are lit. Although any number of candles can be lit, the original candle still retains its identity as the origin. In this way Kṛṣṇa expands Himself into so many forms, and all these expansions are called *viṣṇu-tattva*. Viṣṇu is a large light, and we are small lights, but all are expansions of Kṛṣṇa.

When it is necessary to create the material universes, Viṣṇu expands Himself as Mahā-Viṣṇu. Mahā-Viṣṇu lies down in the Causal Ocean and breathes all the universes from His nostrils. Thus from Mahā-Viṣṇu and the Causal Ocean spring all the universes, and all these universes, including ours, float in the Causal Ocean. In this regard there is the story of Vāmana, who, when He took three steps, stuck His foot through the covering of this universe. Water from the Causal Ocean flowed through the hole that His foot made, and it is said that that water became the river Ganges. Therefore the Ganges is accepted as the most sacred water of Viṣṇu and is worshiped by all Hindus, from the Himalayas down to the Bay of Bengal.

Mahā-Viṣṇu is actually an expansion of Balarāma, who is Kṛṣṇa's first expansion and, in the Vṛndāvana pastimes, His brother. In the *mahā-mantra*—Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare—the word “Rāma” refers to Balarāma. Since Lord Nityānanda is Balarāma, “Rāma” also refers to Lord Nityānanda. Thus Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Rāma addresses not only Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma but Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda as well.

The subject matter of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* primarily deals with what is beyond this material creation. The cosmic material expansion is called *māyā*, illusion, because it has no eternal existence. Because it is sometimes manifested and sometimes not, it is regarded as illusory. But beyond this temporary manifestation is a higher nature, as indicated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (8.20):

*paras tasmāt tu bhāvo 'nyo 'vyakto 'vyaktāt sanātanaḥ
yaḥ sa sarveṣu bhūteṣu naśyatsu na vinaśyati*

“Yet there is another unmanifested nature, which is eternal and is transcendental to this manifested and unmanifested matter. It is supreme and is never annihilated. When all in this world is annihilated, that part remains as it is.” The material world has a manifested state (*vyakta*) and a potential, unmanifested state (*avyakta*). The supreme nature is beyond both the manifested and the unmanifested material nature. This superior nature can be understood as the living force, which is present in the bodies of all living creatures. The body itself is composed of inferior nature, matter, but it is the superior nature that is moving the body. The symptom of that superior nature is consciousness. Thus in the spiritual world, where everything is composed of the superior nature, everything is conscious. In the material world there are inanimate objects that are not conscious, but in the spiritual world nothing is inanimate. There a table is conscious, the land is conscious, the trees are conscious—everything is conscious.

It is not possible to imagine how far this material manifestation extends. In the material world everything is calculated by imagination or by some imperfect method, but the Vedic literatures give real information of what lies beyond the material universe. Since it is not possible to obtain information of anything beyond this material nature by experimental means, those who believe only in experimental knowledge may doubt the Vedic conclusions, for such people cannot even calculate how far this universe extends, nor can they reach far into the universe itself. That which is beyond our power of conception is called *acintya*, inconceivable. It is useless to argue or speculate about the inconceivable. If something is truly inconceivable, it is not subject to speculation or experimentation. Our energy is limited, and our sense perception is limited; therefore we must rely on the Vedic conclusions regarding that subject matter which is inconceivable. Knowledge of the superior nature must simply be accepted without argument. How is it possible to argue about something to which we have no access? The method for understanding transcendental subject matter is given by Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, where Kṛṣṇa tells Arjuna at the beginning of the Fourth Chapter:

*imaṁ vivasvate yogaṁ proktavān ahaṁ avyayam
vivasvān manave prāha manur ikṣvākave 'bravīt*

“I instructed this imperishable science of *yoga* to the sun-god, Vivasvān, and Vivasvān instructed it to Manu, the father of mankind, and Manu in turn instructed it to Ikṣvāku.” (Bg. 4.1) This is the method of *paramparā*, or disciplic succession. Similarly, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* explains that Kṛṣṇa imparted knowledge into the heart of Brahmā, the first created being within the universe. Brahmā imparted those lessons to his disciple Nārada, and Nārada imparted that knowledge to his disciple Vyāsadeva. Vyāsadeva imparted it to Madhvācārya, and from Madhvācārya the knowledge came down to Mādhavendra Purī and then to Īśvara Purī, and from him to Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

One may ask that if Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Kṛṣṇa Himself, then why did He need a spiritual master? Of course He did not need a spiritual master, but because He was playing the role of *ācārya* (one who teaches by example), He accepted a spiritual master. Even Kṛṣṇa Himself accepted a spiritual master, for that is the system. In this way the Lord sets the example for men. We should not think, however, that the Lord takes a spiritual master because He is in want of knowledge. He is simply stressing the importance of accepting the disciplic succession. The knowledge of that disciplic succession actually comes from the Lord Himself, and if the knowledge descends unbroken, it is perfect. Although we may not be in touch with the original personality who first imparted the knowledge, we may receive the same knowledge through this process of transmission. In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* it is stated that Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, transmitted transcendental knowledge into the heart of Brahmā. This, then, is one way knowledge is received—through the heart. Thus there are two processes by which one may receive knowledge: One depends directly upon the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is situated as the Supersoul within the heart of all living entities, and the other depends upon the *guru*, or spiritual master, who is an expansion of Kṛṣṇa. Thus Kṛṣṇa transmits information both from within and from without. We simply have to receive it. If

knowledge is received in this way, it doesn't matter whether it is inconceivable or not.

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* there is a great deal of information given about the Vaikuṇṭha planetary systems, which are beyond the material universe. Similarly, a great deal of inconceivable information is given in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. Any attempt to arrive at this information through experimental knowledge will fail. The knowledge simply has to be accepted. According to the Vedic method, *śabda*, or transcendental sound, is regarded as evidence. Sound is very important in Vedic understanding, for, if it is pure, it is accepted as authoritative. Even in the material world we accept a great deal of information sent thousands of miles by telephone or radio. In this way we also accept sound as evidence in our daily lives. Although we cannot see the informant, we accept his information as valid on the basis of sound. Sound vibration, then, is very important in the transmission of Vedic knowledge.

The *Vedas* inform us that beyond this cosmic manifestation there are extensive planets in the spiritual sky. This material manifestation is regarded as only a small portion of the total creation. The material manifestation includes not only this universe but innumerable others as well, but all the material universes combined constitute only one fourth of the total creation. The remaining three fourths is situated in the spiritual sky. In that sky innumerable planets float, and these are called Vaikuṇṭhalokas. In every Vaikuṇṭhaloka, Nārāyaṇa presides with His four expansions: Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna, Aniruddha and Vāsudeva. This Saṅkarṣaṇa, states Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja in the eighth verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, is Lord Nityānanda.

As stated before, the material universes are manifested by the Lord in the form of Mahā-Viṣṇu. Just as a husband and wife combine to beget offspring, Mahā-Viṣṇu combines with His wife *māyā*, or material nature. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (14.4), where Kṛṣṇa states:

sarva-yoniṣu kaunteya mūrtayaḥ sambhavanti yāḥ

tāsām brahma mahad yonir aham bīja-pradaḥ pitā

“It should be understood that all species of life, O son of Kuntī, are made possible by birth in this material nature, and that I am the seed-giving father.” Viṣṇu impregnates *māyā*, the material nature, simply by glancing at her. This is the spiritual method. Materially we are limited to impregnating by only one particular part of our body, but the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa or Mahā-Viṣṇu, can impregnate by any part. Simply by glancing the Lord can conceive countless living entities in the womb of material nature. The *Brahma-saṁhitā* confirms that the spiritual body of the Supreme Lord is so powerful that any part of His body can perform the functions of any other part. We can touch only with our hands or skin, but Kṛṣṇa can touch just by glancing. We can see only with our eyes; we cannot touch or smell with them. Kṛṣṇa, however, can smell and also eat with His eyes. When food is offered to Kṛṣṇa, we do not see Him eating, but He eats simply by glancing at the food. We cannot imagine how things work in the spiritual world, where everything is spiritual. It is not that Kṛṣṇa does not eat or that we imagine that He eats; He actually eats, but His eating is different from ours. Our eating process will be similar to His when we are completely on the spiritual platform. On that platform every part of the body can act on behalf of any other part.

Viṣṇu does not require anything in order to create. He does not require the goddess Lakṣmī in order to give birth to Brahmā, for Brahmā is born from a lotus flower that grows from the navel of Viṣṇu. The goddess Lakṣmī sits at the feet of Viṣṇu and serves Him. In this material world sex is required to produce children, but in the spiritual world a man can produce as many children as he likes without having to take help from his wife. So there is no sex there. Because we have no experience with spiritual energy, we think that Brahmā’s birth from the navel of Viṣṇu is simply a fictional story. We are not aware that spiritual energy is so powerful that it can do anything and everything. Material energy is dependent on certain laws, but spiritual energy is fully independent.

Countless universes reside like seeds within the skin pores of Mahā-

Viṣṇu, and when He exhales, they are all manifested. In the material world we have no experience of such a thing, but we do experience a perverted reflection in the phenomenon of perspiration. We cannot imagine, however, the duration of one breath of Mahā-Viṣṇu, for within one breath all the universes are created and annihilated. This is stated in the *Brahma-saṁhitā*. Lord Brahmā lives only for the duration of one breath, and according to our time scale 4,320,000,000 years constitute only twelve hours for Brahmā, and Brahmā lives one hundred of his years. Yet the whole life of Brahmā is contained within one breath of Mahā-Viṣṇu. Thus it is not possible for us to imagine the breathing power of Mahā-Viṣṇu, who is but a partial manifestation of Lord Nityānanda. This the author of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* explains in the ninth verse.

In the tenth and eleventh verses Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja describes Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, successive plenary expansions of Mahā-Viṣṇu. Brahmā appears upon a lotus growing from the navel of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, and within the stem of that lotus are so many planetary systems. Then Brahmā creates the whole of human society, animal society—everything. Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu lies on the milk ocean within the universe, of which He is the controller and maintainer. Thus Brahmā is the creator, Viṣṇu is the maintainer, and when the time for annihilation arrives, Śiva will finish everything.

In the first eleven verses of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī thus discusses Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and Lord Nityānanda as Balarāma, the first expansion of Kṛṣṇa. Then in the twelfth and thirteenth verses he describes Advaitācārya, who is another principal associate of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's and an incarnation of Mahā-Viṣṇu. Thus Advaitācārya is also the Lord, or, more precisely, an expansion of the Lord. The word *advaita* means “nondual,” and His name is such because He is nondifferent from the Supreme Lord. He is also called *ācārya*, teacher, because He disseminated Kṛṣṇa consciousness. In this way He is just like Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Although Lord Caitanya is Śrī Kṛṣṇa

Himself, He appeared as a devotee to teach people in general how to love Kṛṣṇa. Similarly, although Advaitācārya is the Lord, He appeared just to distribute the knowledge of Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Thus He is also the Lord incarnated as a devotee.

In the pastimes of Lord Caitanya, Kṛṣṇa is manifested in five different features, known as the *pañca-tattva*, to whom Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja offers his obeisances in the fourteenth verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. Kṛṣṇa and His associates appear as devotees of the Supreme Lord in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, Śrī Advaitācārya, Śrī Gadādhara Prabhu and Śrīvāsa Prabhu. In all cases, Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the source of energy for all His devotees. Since this is the case, if we take shelter of Caitanya Mahāprabhu for the successful execution of Kṛṣṇa consciousness, we are sure to make progress. In a devotional song, Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura sings, “My dear Lord Caitanya, please have mercy upon me. There is no one who is as merciful as You. My plea is most urgent because Your mission is to deliver all fallen souls, and no one is more fallen than I. Therefore I beg priority.”

With verse 15, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī begins offering his obeisances directly to Kṛṣṇa Himself. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja was an inhabitant of Vṛndāvana and a great devotee. He had been living with his family in Katwa, a small town in the district of Burdwan, in Bengal. He worshiped Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa with his family, and once when there was some misunderstanding among his family members about devotional service, he was advised by Nityānanda Prabhu in a dream to leave home and go to Vṛndāvana. Although he was very old, he started out that very night and went to live in Vṛndāvana. While he was there, he met some of the Gosvāmīs, principal disciples of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He was requested to write the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* by the devotees of Vṛndāvana. Although he began this work at a very old age, by the grace of Lord Caitanya he finished it. Today it remains the most authoritative book on Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s philosophy and life.

When Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī was living in Vṛndāvana, there were

not very many temples. At that time the three principal temples were those of Madana-mohana, Govindajī and Gopīnātha. As a resident of Vṛndāvana, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja offers his respects to the Deities in these temples and requests God's favor: "My progress in spiritual life is very slow, so I'm asking Your help." In the fifteenth verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Kṛṣṇadāsa offers his obeisances to the Madana-mohana *vigraha*, the Deity who can help us progress in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. In the execution of Kṛṣṇa consciousness, our first business is to know Kṛṣṇa and our relationship with Him. To know Kṛṣṇa is to know one's self, and to know one's self is to know one's relationship with Kṛṣṇa. Since this relationship can be learned by worshiping the Madana-mohana *vigraha*, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī first establishes his relationship with Him.

When this is established, in the sixteenth verse Kṛṣṇadāsa offers his obeisances to the functional Deity, Govinda. The Govinda Deity is called the functional Deity because He shows us how to serve Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. The Madana-mohana Deity simply establishes that "I am Your eternal servant." With Govinda, however, there is actual acceptance of service. Govinda resides eternally in Vṛndāvana. In the spiritual world of Vṛndāvana the buildings are made of touchstone, the cows are known as *surabhi* cows, givers of abundant milk, and the trees are known as wish-fulfilling trees, for they yield whatever one desires. In Vṛndāvana Kṛṣṇa herds the *surabhi* cows, and He is worshiped by hundreds and thousands of *gopīs*, cowherd girls, who are all goddesses of fortune. When Kṛṣṇa descends to the material world, this same Vṛndāvana descends with Him, just as an entourage accompanies an important personage. Because when Kṛṣṇa comes His land also comes, Vṛndāvana is considered to exist beyond the material world. Therefore devotees take shelter of the Vṛndāvana in India, for it is considered to be a replica of the original Vṛndāvana. Although one may complain that no *kalpa-vṛkṣa*, wish-fulfilling trees, exist there, when the Gosvāmīs were there, *kalpa-vṛkṣa* were present. It is not that one can simply go to such a tree and make demands; one must first become a devotee. The Gosvāmīs would live under a tree for one night only, and the trees would satisfy all their desires. For the common man this may all seem very wonderful, but as

one makes progress in devotional service, all this can be realized.

Vṛndāvana is actually experienced as it is by persons who have stopped trying to derive pleasure from material enjoyment. “When will my mind become cleansed of all hankering for material enjoyment so I will be able to see Vṛndāvana?” one great devotee asks. The more Kṛṣṇa conscious we become and the more we advance, the more everything is revealed as spiritual. Thus Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī considered the Vṛndāvana in India to be as good as the Vṛndāvana in the spiritual sky, and in the sixteenth verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* he describes Rādhārāṇī and Kṛṣṇa as seated beneath a wish-fulfilling tree in Vṛndāvana, on a throne decorated with valuable jewels. There Kṛṣṇa’s dear *gopī* friends serve Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa by singing, dancing, offering betel nuts and refreshments, and decorating Their Lordships with flowers. Even today in India people decorate swinging thrones and re-create this scene during the month of July-August. Generally at that time people go to Vṛndāvana to offer their respects to the Deities there.

Finally Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī offers his blessings to his readers in the name of the Gopīnātha Deity, who is Kṛṣṇa as master and proprietor of the *gopīs*. When Kṛṣṇa played upon his flute, all the *gopīs*, or cowherd girls, were attracted by the sound and left their household duties, and when they came to Him, He danced with them. These activities are all described in the Tenth Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. These *gopīs* were childhood friends of Kṛṣṇa, and many were married, for in India the girls are generally married by the age of twelve. The boys, however, are not married before eighteen, so Kṛṣṇa, who was fifteen or sixteen at the time, was not married. Nonetheless, He called these girls from their homes and invited them to dance with Him. That dance is called the *rāsa-līlā* dance, and it is the most elevated of all the Vṛndāvana pastimes. Kṛṣṇa is therefore called Gopīnātha because He is the beloved master of the *gopīs*.

Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī petitions the blessings of Lord Gopīnātha: “May that Gopīnātha, the master of the *gopīs*, Kṛṣṇa, bless you. May you become blessed by Gopīnātha.” The author of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*

prays that just as Kṛṣṇa attracted the *gopīs* by the sweet sound of His flute, He will also attract the reader's mind by that transcendental vibration.

Chapter 1

The Spiritual Masters

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is none other than the combined form of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. He is the life of those devotees who strictly follow in the footsteps of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī are the two principal followers of Śrīla Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī, who acted as the most confidential servitor of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, known as Viśvambhara in His early life. A direct disciple of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī was Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. The author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, stands as the direct disciple of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī.

The direct disciple of Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī was Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura, who accepted Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī as his servitor. Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura accepted Śrīla Jagannātha dāsa Bābājī, the spiritual master of Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura, who in turn accepted Śrīla Gaurakiśora dāsa Bābājī, the spiritual master of Om Viṣṇupāda Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī Mahārāja, the divine master of our humble self.

Since we belong to this chain of disciplic succession from Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, this edition of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* will contain nothing newly manufactured by our tiny brains, but only remnants of food originally eaten by the Lord Himself. Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu does not belong to the mundane plane of the three qualitative modes. He belongs to the transcendental plane beyond the reach of the imperfect sense perception of a living being. Even the most erudite mundane scholar

cannot approach the transcendental plane unless he submits himself to transcendental sound with a receptive mood, for in that mood only can one realize the message of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. What will be described herein, therefore, has nothing to do with the experimental thoughts created by the speculative habits of inert minds. The subject matter of this book is not a mental concoction but a factual spiritual experience that one can realize only by accepting the line of disciplic succession described above. Any deviation from that line will bewilder the reader's understanding of the mystery of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, which is a transcendental literature meant for the postgraduate study of one who has realized all the Vedic literatures such as the *Upaniṣads* and *Vedānta-sūtra* and their natural commentaries such as *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and the *Bhagavad-gītā*.

This edition of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* is presented for the study of sincere scholars who are really seeking the Absolute Truth. It is not the arrogant scholarship of a mental speculator but a sincere effort to serve the order of a superior authority whose service is the life and soul of this humble effort. It does not deviate even slightly from the revealed scriptures, and therefore anyone who follows in the disciplic line will be able to realize the essence of this book simply by the method of aural reception.

The First Chapter of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* begins with fourteen Sanskrit verses that describe the Absolute Truth. Then the next three Sanskrit verses describe the principal Deities of Vṛndāvana, namely, Śrī Rādhā-Madana-mohana, Śrī Rādhā-Govindadeva and Śrī Rādhā-Gopīnāthajī. The first of the fourteen verses is a symbolic representation of the Supreme Truth, and the entire First Chapter is in actuality devoted to this single verse, which describes Lord Caitanya in His six different transcendental expansions.

The first manifestation described is the spiritual master, who appears in two plenary parts called the initiating spiritual master and instructing spiritual master. They are identical because both of them are phenomenal

manifestations of the Supreme Truth. Next described are the devotees, who are divided into two classes, namely, the apprentices and the graduates. Next are the incarnations (*avatāras*) of the Lord, who are explained to be nondifferent from the Lord. These incarnations are considered in three divisions—incarnations of the potency of the Lord, incarnations of His qualities, and incarnations of His authority. In this connection, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa's direct manifestations and His manifestations for transcendental pastimes are discussed. Next considered are the potencies of the Lord, of which three principal manifestations are described: the consorts in the kingdom of God (Vaikuṇṭha), the queens of Dvārakā-dhāma and, highest of all, the damsels of Vraja-dhāma. Finally, there is the Supreme Lord Himself, who is the fountainhead of all these manifestations.

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa and His plenary expansions are all in the category of the Lord Himself, the energetic Absolute Truth, whereas His devotees, His eternal associates, are His energies. The energy and energetic are fundamentally one, but since their functions are differently exhibited, they are simultaneously different also. Thus the Absolute Truth is manifested in diversity in one unit. This philosophical truth, which is pursuant to the *Vedānta-sūtra*, is called *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*, or the conception of simultaneous oneness and difference. In the latter portion of this chapter, the transcendental position of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and that of Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu are described with reference to the above theistic facts.

TEXT 1

vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān

īśam īśāvatārakān

tat-prakāśāṁś ca tac-chaktīḥ

kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam

SYNONYMS

vande—I offer respectful obeisances; *gurūn*—unto the spiritual masters; *īśa-bhaktān*—unto the devotees of the Supreme Lord; *īśam*—unto the Supreme Lord; *īśa-avatārakān*—unto the incarnations of the Supreme Lord; *tat*—of the Supreme Lord; *prakāśān*—unto the manifestations; *ca*—and; *tat*—of the Supreme Lord; *śaktiḥ*—unto the potencies; *kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *saṁjñakam*—named.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto the spiritual masters, the devotees of the Lord, the Lord's incarnations, His plenary portions, His energies and the primeval Lord Himself, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

TEXT 2

vande śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-

nityānandau sahoditau

gauḍodaye puṣpavantau

citrau śan-dau tamo-nudau

SYNONYMS

vande—I offer respectful obeisances; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—to Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *nityānandau*—and to Lord Nityānanda; *saha-uditau*—simultaneously arisen; *gauḍa-udaye*—on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa; *puṣpavantau*—the sun and moon together; *citrau*—wonderful; *śam-dau*—bestowing benediction; *tamaḥ-nudau*—dissipating darkness.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda, who are like the sun and moon. They have arisen simultaneously on the horizon of Gauḍa to dissipate the darkness of ignorance and thus wonderfully bestow benediction upon all.

TEXT 3

yad advaitam brahmopaniṣadi tad apy asya tanu-bhā

ya ātmāntar-yāmī puruṣa iti so 'syāṁśa-vibhavaḥ

ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ pūrṇo ya iha bhagavān sa svayam ayam

na caitanyāt kṛṣṇāj jagati para-tattvam param iha

SYNONYMS

yat—that which; *advaitam*—nondual; *brahma*—the impersonal Brahman; *upaniṣadi*—in the *Upaniṣads*; *tat*—that; *api*—certainly; *asya*—His; *tanu-bhā*—the effulgence of His transcendental body; *yaḥ*—who; *ātmā*—the Supersoul; *antaḥ-yāmī*—indwelling Lord; *puruṣaḥ*—supreme enjoyer; *iti*—thus; *saḥ*—He; *asya*—His; *āṁśa-vibhavaḥ*—plenary expansion; *ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ*—with all six opulences; *pūrṇaḥ*—full; *yaḥ*—who; *iha*—here; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *saḥ*—He; *svayam*—Himself; *ayam*—this; *na*—not; *caitanyāt*—than Lord Caitanya; *kṛṣṇāt*—than Lord Kṛṣṇa; *jagati*—in the world; *para*—higher; *tattvam*—truth; *param*—another; *iha*—here.

TRANSLATION

What the Upaniṣads describe as the impersonal Brahman is but the effulgence of His body, and the Lord known as the Supersoul is but His localized plenary portion. Lord Caitanya is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa Himself, full with six opulences. He is the Absolute Truth, and no other truth is greater than or equal to Him.

TEXT 4

anarpita-carīm cirāt karuṇayāvatīrṇaḥ kalau

samarpayitum unnatojjvala-rasām sva-bhakti-śriyam

hariḥ purāṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ

sadā hṛdaya-kandare sphuratu vaḥ śacī-nandanaḥ

SYNONYMS

anarpita—not bestowed; *carīm*—having been formerly; *cirāt*—for a long time; *karuṇayā*—by causeless mercy; *avatīrṇaḥ*—descended; *kalau*—in the Age of Kali; *samarpayitum*—to bestow; *unnata*—elevated; *ujjvala-rasām*—the conjugal mellow; *sva-bhakti*—of His own service; *śriyam*—the treasure; *hariḥ*—the Supreme Lord; *purāṭa*—than gold; *sundara*—more beautiful; *dyuti*—of splendor; *kadamba*—with a multitude; *sandīpitaḥ*—lighted up; *sadā*—always; *hṛdaya-kandare*—in the cavity of the heart; *sphuratu*—let Him be manifest; *vaḥ*—your; *śacī-nandanaḥ*—the son of mother Śacī.

TRANSLATION

May the Supreme Lord who is known as the son of Śrīmatī Śacī-devī be transcendently situated in the innermost chambers of your heart. Resplendent with the radiance of molten gold, He has appeared in the Age of Kali by His causeless mercy to bestow what no incarnation has ever offered before: the most sublime and radiant mellow of devotional service, the mellow of conjugal love.

TEXT 5

rādhā kṛṣṇa-praṇaya-vikṛtīr hlādinī śaktir asmād

ekātmānāv api bhuvi purā deha-bhedam gatau tau

caitanyākhyam prakāṣam adhunā tad-dvayam caikyam āptam

rādhā-bhāva-dyuti-suvalitam naumi kṛṣṇa-svarūpam

SYNONYMS

rādhā—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *praṇaya*—of love; *vikṛtiḥ*—the transformation; *hlādinī śaktiḥ*—pleasure potency; *asmāt*—from this; *eka-ātmānau*—both the same in identity; *api*—although; *bhuvi*—on earth; *purā*—from beginningless time; *deha-bhedam*—separate forms; *gatau*—obtained; *tau*—those two; *caitanya-ākhyam*—known as Śrī Caitanya; *prakāṣam*—manifest; *adhunā*—now; *tad-dvayam*—the two of Them; *ca*—and; *aikyam*—unity; *āptam*—obtained; *rādhā*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bhāva*—mood; *dyuti*—the luster; *su-valitam*—who is adorned with; *naumi*—I offer my obeisances; *kṛṣṇa-svarūpam*—to Him who is identical with Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

The loving affairs of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are transcendental manifestations of the Lord's internal pleasure-giving potency. Although Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Their identity, They separated Themselves eternally. Now these two transcendental identities have again united, in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. I bow down to Him, who has manifested Himself with the sentiment and complexion of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī although He is Kṛṣṇa Himself.

TEXT 6

śrī-rādhāyāḥ praṇaya-mahimā kīdrśo vānayaivā-

svādyo yenādbhuta-madhurimā kīdrśo vā madīyaḥ

saukhyam cāsyā mad-anubhavataḥ kīḍṛśam veti lobhāt

tad-bhāvāḍhyaḥ samajani śacī-garbha-sindhau harīnduḥ

SYNONYMS

śrī-rādhāyāḥ—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *praṇaya-mahimā*—the greatness of the love; *kīḍṛśaḥ*—of what kind; *vā*—or; *anayā*—by this one (Rādhā); *eva*—alone; *āsvādyāḥ*—to be relished; *yena*—by that love; *adbhuta-madhurimā*—the wonderful sweetness; *kīḍṛśaḥ*—of what kind; *vā*—or; *madīyaḥ*—of Me; *saukhyam*—the happiness; *ca*—and; *asyāḥ*—Her; *mat-anubhavataḥ*—from realization of My sweetness; *kīḍṛśam*—of what kind; *vā*—or; *iti*—thus; *lobhāt*—from the desire; *tat*—Her; *bhāva-āḍhyaḥ*—richly endowed with emotions; *samajani*—took birth; *śacī-garbha*—of the womb of Śrīmatī Śacī-devī; *sindhau*—in the ocean; *hari*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *induḥ*—like the moon.

TRANSLATION

Desiring to understand the glory of Rādhārāṇī's love, the wonderful qualities in Him that She alone relishes through Her love, and the happiness She feels when She realizes the sweetness of His love, the Supreme Lord Hari, richly endowed with Her emotions, appeared from the womb of Śrīmatī Śacī-devī, as the moon appeared from the ocean.

TEXT 7

saṅkarṣaṇaḥ kāraṇa-toya-śāyī

garbhoda-śāyī ca payobdhi-śāyī

śeṣaś ca yasyāmśa-kalāḥ sa nityā-

nandākhya-rāmaḥ śaraṇam mamāstu

SYNONYMS

saṅkarṣaṇaḥ—Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa in the spiritual sky; *kāraṇa-toya-śāyī*—Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who lies in the Causal Ocean; *garbha-uda-śāyī*—Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who lies in the Garbhodaka Ocean of the universe; *ca*—and; *payah-abdhi-śāyī*—Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who lies in the ocean of milk; *śeṣaḥ*—Śeṣa Nāga, the couch of Viṣṇu; *ca*—and; *yasya*—whose; *aṁśa*—plenary portions; *kalāḥ*—and parts of the plenary portions; *saḥ*—He; *nityānanda-ākhyā*—known as Lord Nityānanda; *rāmaḥ*—Lord Balarāma; *śaraṇam*—shelter; *mama*—my; *astu*—let there be.

TRANSLATION

May Śrī Nityānanda Rāma be the object of my constant remembrance. Saṅkarṣaṇa, Śeṣa Nāga and the Viṣṇus who lie on the Kāraṇa Ocean, Garbha Ocean and ocean of milk are His plenary portions and the portions of His plenary portions.

TEXT 8

māyātīte vyāpi-vaikuṇṭha-loke

pūrṇaiśvare śrī-catur-vyūha-madhye

rūpaṁ yasyodbhāti saṅkarṣaṇākhyam

taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye

SYNONYMS

māyā-atīte—beyond the material creation; *vyāpi*—all-expanding; *vaikuṇṭha-loke*—in Vaikuṇṭhaloka, the spiritual world; *pūrṇa-aiśvārye*—endowed with full opulence; *śrī-catuḥ-vyūha-madhye*—in the quadruple expansions (Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha); *rūpam*—form; *yasya*—whose; *udbhātī*—appears; *saṅkarṣaṇa-ākhyam*—known as Saṅkarṣaṇa; *tam*—to Him; *śrī-nityānanda-rāmam*—to Lord Balarāma in the form of Lord Nityānanda; *prapadye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

I surrender unto the lotus feet of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, who is known as Saṅkarṣaṇa in the midst of the catur-vyūha [consisting of Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha]. He possesses full opulences and resides in Vaikuṇṭhaloka, far beyond the material creation.

TEXT 9

māyā-bhartājāṇḍa-saṅghāśrayāṅgaḥ

śete sākṣāt kāraṇāmbhodhi-madhye

yasyaikāṁśaḥ śrī-pumān ādi-devas

tam śrī-nityānanda-rāmam prapadye

SYNONYMS

māyā-bhartā—the master of the illusory energy; *aja-aṇḍa-saṅgha*—of the multitude of universes; *āśraya*—the shelter; *aṅgaḥ*—whose body; *śete*—He lies; *sākṣāt*—directly; *kāraṇa-ambhodhi-madhye*—in the midst of the Causal Ocean; *yasya*—whose; *eka-aṁśaḥ*—one portion; *śrī-pumān*—the Supreme Person; *ādi-devaḥ*—the original *puruṣa* incarnation; *tam*—to Him; *śrī-nityānanda-rāmam*—to Lord Balarāma in the form of Lord Nityānanda; *prapadye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

I offer my full obeisances unto the feet of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose partial representation called Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, lying on the Kāraṇa Ocean, is the original puruṣa, the master of the illusory energy, and the shelter of all the universes.

TEXT 10

yasyāṁśāṁśaḥ śrīla-garbhoda-śāyī

yan-nābhy-abjaṁ loka-saṅghāta-nālam

loka-sraṣṭuḥ sūtikā-dhāma dhātus

tam śrī-nityānanda-rāmam prapadye

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *āṁśa-āṁśaḥ*—portion of a plenary portion; *śrīla-garbhoda-śāyī*—Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *yat*—of whom; *nābhi-abjaṁ*—the navel lotus; *loka-saṅghāta*—of the multitude of planets; *nālam*—having a stem that is the resting place; *loka-sraṣṭuḥ*—of Lord Brahmā, the creator of the planets; *sūtikā-dhāma*—the birthplace; *dhātuḥ*—of the creator; *tam*—to Him; *śrī-nityānanda-rāmam*—to Lord Balarāma in the form of Lord Nityānanda; *prapadye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

I offer my full obeisances unto the feet of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, a partial part of whom is Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. From the navel of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu sprouts the lotus that is the birthplace of Brahmā, the engineer of the universe. The stem of that lotus is the resting place of the multitude of planets.

TEXT 11

yasyāṁśāṁśāṁśaḥ parātmākhilānām

poṣṭā viṣṇur bhāti dugdhābdhi-śāyī

kṣauṇī-bhartā yat-kalā so 'py anantas

tam śrī-nityānanda-rāmam prapadye

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *amśa-amśa-amśaḥ*—a portion of a portion of a plenary portion; *para-ātmā*—the Supersoul; *akhilānām*—of all living entities; *poṣṭā*—the maintainer; *viṣṇuḥ*—Viṣṇu; *bhāti*—appears; *dugdha-abdhi-śāyī*—Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *kṣauṇī-bhartā*—upholder of the earth; *yat*—whose; *kalā*—portion of a portion; *saḥ*—He; *api*—certainly; *anantaḥ*—Śeṣa Nāga; *tam*—to Him; *śrī-nityānanda-rāmam*—to Lord Balarāma in the form of Lord Nityānanda; *prapadye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto the feet of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose secondary part is the Viṣṇu lying in the ocean of milk. That Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Supersoul of all living entities and the maintainer of all the universes. Śeṣa Nāga is His further subpart.

TEXT 12

mahā-viṣṇur jagat-kartā

māyayā yaḥ sṛjaty adaḥ

tasyāvatāra evāyam

advaitācārya īśvaraḥ

SYNONYMS

mahā-viṣṇuḥ—Mahā-Viṣṇu, the resting place of the efficient cause; *jagat-kartā*—the creator of the cosmic world; *māyayā*—by the illusory energy; *yaḥ*—who; *sṛjati*—creates; *adaḥ*—that universe; *tasya*—His; *avatāraḥ*—incarnation; *eva*—certainly; *ayam*—this; *advaita-ācāryaḥ*—Advaita Ācārya; *īśvaraḥ*—the Supreme Lord, the resting place of the material cause.

TRANSLATION

Lord Advaita Ācārya is the incarnation of Mahā-Viṣṇu, whose main function is to create the cosmic world through the actions of māyā.

TEXT 13

advaitam hariṇādvaitād

ācāryam bhakti-śamsanāt

bhaktāvatāram īśam tam

advaitācāryam āśraye

SYNONYMS

advaitam—known as Advaita; *hariṇā*—with Lord Hari; *advaitāt*—from being nondifferent; *ācāryam*—known as Ācārya; *bhakti-śamsanāt*—from the propagation of devotional service to Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *bhaktāvatāram*—the incarnation as a devotee; *īśam*—to the Supreme Lord; *tam*—to Him; *advaita-ācāryam*—to Advaita Ācārya; *āśraye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

Because He is nondifferent from Hari, the Supreme Lord, He is called Advaita, and because He propagates the cult of devotion, He is called Ācārya. He is the Lord and the incarnation of the Lord's devotee. Therefore I take shelter of Him.

TEXT 14

pañca-tattvātmakam kṛṣṇam

bhakta-rūpa-svarūpakam

bhaktāvatāram bhaktākhyam

namāmi bhakta-śaktikam

SYNONYMS

pañca-tattva-ātmakam—comprehending the five transcendental subject matters; *kṛṣṇam*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhakta-rūpa*—in the form of a devotee; *sva-rūpakam*—in the expansion of a devotee; *bhakta-avatāram*—in the incarnation of a devotee; *bhakta-ākhyam*—known as a devotee; *namāmi*—I offer my obeisances; *bhakta-śaktikam*—the energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who supplies energy to the devotee.

TRANSLATION

I offer my obeisances unto the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa, who is nondifferent from His features as a devotee, devotional incarnation, devotional manifestation, pure devotee and devotional energy.

TEXT 15

jayatām suratau paṅgor

mama manda-mater gatī

mat-sarvasva-padāmbhojau

rādhā-madana-mohanau

SYNONYMS

jayatām—all glory to; *su-ratau*—most merciful, or attached in conjugal love; *paṅgoḥ*—of one who is lame; *mama*—of me; *manda-mateḥ*—foolish; *gatī*—refuge; *mat*—my; *sarva-sva*—everything; *pada-ambhojau*—whose lotus feet; *rādhā-madana-mohanau*—Rādhārāṇī and Madana-mohana.

TRANSLATION

Glory to the all-merciful Rādhā and Madana-mohana! I am lame and ill advised, yet They are my directors, and Their lotus feet are everything to me.

TEXT 16

dīvyad-vṛndāraṇya-kalpa-drumādhaḥ-

śrīmad-ratnāgāra-simhāsana-sthau

śrīmad-rādhā-śrīla-govinda-devau

preṣṭhālībhiḥ sevyamānau smarāmi

SYNONYMS

dīvyat—shining; *vṛndā-raṇya*—in the forest of Vṛndāvana; *kalpa-druma*—desire tree; *adhaḥ*—beneath; *śrīmat*—most beautiful; *ratna-āgāra*—in a temple of jewels; *simha-āsana-sthau*—sitting on a throne;

śrīmat—very beautiful; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *śrīla-govinda-devau*—and Śrī Govindadeva; *preṣṭha-ālībhīḥ*—by most confidential associates; *sevyamānau*—being served; *smarāmi*—I remember.

TRANSLATION

In a temple of jewels in Vṛndāvana, underneath a desire tree, Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Govinda, served by Their most confidential associates, sit upon an effulgent throne. I offer my humble obeisances unto Them.

TEXT 17

śrīmān rāsa-rasārambhī

vaṁśīvaṭa-taṭa-sthitaḥ

karṣan veṇu-svanair gopīr

gopī-nāthaḥ śriye 'stu naḥ

SYNONYMS

śrī-mān—most beautiful; *rāsa*—of the *rāsa* dance; *rasa*—of the mellow; *ārambhī*—the initiator; *vaṁśī-vaṭa*—Vaṁśīvaṭa; *taṭa*—on the shore; *sthitaḥ*—standing; *karṣan*—attracting; *veṇu*—of the flute; *svanaiḥ*—by the sounds; *gopīḥ*—the cowherd girls; *gopī-nāthaḥ*—Śrī Gopīnātha; *śriye*—benediction; *astu*—let there be; *naḥ*—our.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Śrīla Gopīnātha, who originated the transcendental mellow of the *rāsa* dance, stands on the shore in Vaṁśīvaṭa and attracts the attention of the cowherd damsels with the sound of His celebrated flute. May they all confer upon us their benediction.

TEXT 18

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glory; *śrī-caitanya*—to Śrī Caitanya; *jaya*—all glory; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda; *jaya advaita-candra*—all glory to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya*—all glory; *gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—to the devotees of Lord Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

Glory to Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! And glory to all the devotees of Śrī Gaura [Lord Caitanya]!

TEXT 19

ei tina ṭhākura gauḍīyāke kariyāchena ātmasāt

e tintera caraṇa vandoṇ, tine mora nātha

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *tina*—three; *ṭhākura*—Deities; *gauḍīyāke*—the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas; *kariyāchena*—have done; *ātmasāt*—absorbed; *e*—these; *tintera*—of the three; *caraṇa*—lotus feet; *vandoṇ*—I worship; *tine*—these three; *mora*—my; *nātha*—Lords.

TRANSLATION

These three Deities of Vṛndāvana [Madana-mohana, Govinda and Gopīnātha] have absorbed the heart and soul of the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas

[followers of Lord Caitanya]. I worship Their lotus feet, for They are the Lords of my heart.

PURPORT

The author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* offers his respectful obeisances unto the three Deities of Vṛndāvana named Śrī Rādhā-Madana-mohana, Śrī Rādhā-Govindadeva and Śrī Rādhā-Gopīnāthajī. These three Deities are the life and soul of the Bengali Vaiṣṇavas, or Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas, who have a natural aptitude for residing in Vṛndāvana. The Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas who follow strictly in the line of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu worship the Divinity by chanting transcendental sounds meant to develop a sense of one's transcendental relationship with the Supreme Lord, a reciprocation of mellows (*rasas*) of mutual affection, and, ultimately, the achievement of the desired success in loving service. These three Deities are worshiped in three different stages of one's development. The followers of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu scrupulously follow these principles of approach.

Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas perceive the ultimate objective in Vedic hymns composed of eighteen transcendental letters that adore Kṛṣṇa as Madana-mohana, Govinda and Gopījana-vallabha. Madana-mohana is He who charms Cupid, the god of love, Govinda is He who pleases the senses and the cows, and Gopījana-vallabha is the transcendental lover of the *gopīs*. Kṛṣṇa Himself is called Madana-mohana, Govinda, Gopījana-vallabha and countless other names as He plays in His different pastimes with His devotees.

The three Deities—Madana-mohana, Govinda and Gopījana-vallabha—have very specific qualities. Worship of Madana-mohana is on the platform of reestablishing our forgotten relationship with the Personality of Godhead. In the material world we are presently in utter ignorance of our eternal relationship with the Supreme Lord. *Paṅgoḥ* refers to one who cannot move independently by his own strength, and *manda-mateḥ* is one who is less intelligent because he is too absorbed in materialistic

activities. It is best for such persons not to aspire for success in fruitive activities or mental speculation but instead simply to surrender to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The perfection of life is simply to surrender to the Supreme. In the beginning of our spiritual life we must therefore worship Madana-mohana so that He may attract us and nullify our attachment for material sense gratification. This relationship with Madana-mohana is necessary for neophyte devotees. When one wishes to render service to the Lord with strong attachment, one worships Govinda on the platform of transcendental service. Govinda is the reservoir of all pleasures. When by the grace of Kṛṣṇa and the devotees one reaches perfection in devotional service, he can appreciate Kṛṣṇa as Gopījana-vallabha, the pleasure Deity of the damsels of Vraja.

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu explained this mode of devotional service in three stages, and therefore these worshipable Deities were installed in Vṛndāvana by different Gosvāmīs. They are very dear to the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas there, who visit the temples at least once a day. Besides the temples of these three Deities, many other temples have been established in Vṛndāvana, such as the temple of Rādhā-Dāmodara of Jīva Gosvāmī, the temple of Śyāmasundara of Śyāmānanda Gosvāmī, the temple of Gokulānanda of Lokanātha Gosvāmī, and the temple of Rādhā-ramaṇa of Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī. There are seven principal temples over four hundred years old that are the most important of the five thousand temples now existing in Vṛndāvana.

Gauḍīya indicates the part of India between the southern side of the Himalayan Mountains and the northern part of the Vindhya Hills, which is called Āryāvarta, or the Land of the Āryans. This portion of India is divided into five parts or provinces (Pañca-gauḍadeśa): Sārasvata (Kashmir and Punjab), Kānyakubja (Uttar Pradesh, including the modern city of Lucknow), Madhya-gauḍa (Madhya Pradesh), Maithila (Bihar and part of Bengal) and Utkala (part of Bengal and the whole of Orissa). Bengal is sometimes called Gauḍadeśa, partly because it forms a portion of Maithila and partly because the capital of the Hindu king Rāja Lakṣmaṇa Sena was known as Gauḍa. This old capital later came to be

known as Gauḍapura and gradually Māyāpur.

The devotees of Orissa are called Uḍiyās, the devotees of Bengal are called Gauḍīyas, and the devotees of southern India are known as Drāviḍa devotees. As there are five provinces in Āryāvarta, so Dākṣiṇātya, southern India, is also divided into five provinces, which are called Pañca-draviḍa. The four Vaiṣṇava ācāryas who are the great authorities of the four Vaiṣṇava disciplic successions, as well as Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya of the Māyāvāda school, appeared in the Pañca-draviḍa provinces. Among the four Vaiṣṇava ācāryas, who are all accepted by the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas, Śrī Rāmānuja Ācārya appeared in the southern part of Andhra Pradesh at Mahābhūtapurī, Śrī Madhva Ācārya appeared at Pājakam (near Vimānagiri) in the district of Mangalore, Śrī Viṣṇu Svāmī appeared at Pāṇḍya, and Śrī Nimbārka appeared at Muṅgera-patana, in the extreme south.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted the chain of disciplic succession from Madhva Ācārya, but the Vaiṣṇavas in His line do not accept the Tattva-vādīs, who also claim to belong to the Mādhva-sampradāya. To distinguish themselves clearly from the Tattva-vādī branch of Madhva's descendants, the Vaiṣṇavas of Bengal prefer to call themselves Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas. Śrī Madhva Ācārya is also known as Śrī Gauḍa-pūrṇānanda, and therefore the name Mādhva-Gauḍīya-sampradāya is quite suitable for the disciplic succession of the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas. Our spiritual master, Oṃ Viṣṇupāda Śrīmad Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī Mahārāja, accepted initiation in the Mādhva-Gauḍīya-sampradāya.

TEXT 20

granthera ārambhe kari 'maṅgalācaraṇa'

guru, vaiṣṇava, bhagavān, — — tīnera smaraṇa

SYNONYMS

granthera—of this book; *ārambhe*—in the beginning; *kari*—I make; *maṅgala-ācaraṇa*—auspicious invocation; *guru*—the spiritual master; *vaiṣṇava*—the devotees of the Lord; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *tinera*—of these three; *smaraṇa*—remembering.

TRANSLATION

In the beginning of this narration, simply by remembering the spiritual master, the devotees of the Lord, and the Personality of Godhead, I have invoked their benedictions.

TEXT 21

tinera smaraṇe haya vighna-vināśana

anāyāse haya nija vāñchita-pūraṇa

SYNONYMS

tinera—of these three; *smaraṇe*—by remembrance; *haya*—there is; *vighna-vināśana*—the destruction of all difficulties; *anāyāse*—very easily; *haya*—there is; *nija*—our own; *vāñchita*—of the desired object; *pūraṇa*—fulfillment.

TRANSLATION

Such remembrance destroys all difficulties and very easily enables one to fulfill his own desires.

TEXT 22

se maṅgalācaraṇa haya tri-vidha prakāra

vastu-nirdeśa, āśīrvāda, namaskāra

SYNONYMS

se—that; *maṅgala-ācaraṇa*—auspicious invocation; *haya*—is; *tri-vidha*—three kinds; *prakāra*—processes; *vastu-nirdeśa*—defining the object; *āśīḥ-vāda*—benedictions; *namaḥ-kāra*—obeisances.

TRANSLATION

The invocation involves three processes: defining the objective, offering benedictions and offering obeisances.

TEXT 23

prathama dui śloke iṣṭa-deva-namaskāra

sāmānya-viśeṣa-rūpe dui ta' prakāra

SYNONYMS

prathama—in the first; *dui*—two; *śloke*—verses; *iṣṭa-deva*—worshipable Deity; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *sāmānya*—generally; *viśeṣa-rūpe*—and specifically; *dui*—two; *ta'*—certainly; *prakāra*—ways.

TRANSLATION

The first two verses offer respectful obeisances, generally and specifically, to the Lord, who is the object of worship.

TEXT 24

tr̥tīya ślokete kari vastura nirdeśa

yāhā ha-ite jāni para-tattvera uddeśa

SYNONYMS

tṛtīya śloketē—in the third verse; *kari*—I make; *vastura*—of the object; *nirdeśa*—indication; *yāhā ha-ite*—from which; *jāni*—I understand; *para-tattvera*—of the Absolute Truth; *uddeśa*—identification.

TRANSLATION

In the third verse I indicate the Absolute Truth, who is the ultimate substance. With such a description, one can visualize the Supreme Truth.

TEXT 25

caturtha śloketē kari jagate āśīrvāda

sarvatra māgiye kṛṣṇa-caitanya-prasāda

SYNONYMS

caturtha—fourth; *śloketē*—in the verse; *kari*—I make; *jagate*—for the world; *āśīh-vāda*—benediction; *sarvatra*—everywhere; *māgiye*—I am begging; *kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *prasāda*—the mercy.

TRANSLATION

In the fourth verse I have invoked the benediction of the Lord upon all the world, praying to Lord Caitanya for His mercy upon all.

TEXT 26

sei śloke kahi bāhyāvatāra-kāraṇa

pañca ṣaṣṭha śloke kahi mūla-prayojana

SYNONYMS

sei śloke—in that same verse; *kahi*—I tell; *bāhya*—the external; *avatāra*—for the incarnation of Lord Caitanya; *kāraṇa*—reason; *pañca*—the fifth; *ṣaṣṭha*—and the sixth; *śloke*—in the verses; *kahi*—I tell; *mūla*—the prime; *prayojana*—purpose.

TRANSLATION

In that verse I have also explained the external reason for Lord Caitanya's incarnation. But in the fifth and sixth verses I have explained the prime reason for His advent.

TEXT 27

ei chaya śloke kahi caitanyera tattva

āra pañca śloke nityānandera mahattva

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *chaya*—six; *śloke*—in verses; *kahi*—I describe; *caitanyera*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tattva*—truth; *āra*—further; *pañca śloke*—in five verses; *nityānandera*—of Lord Nityānanda; *mahattva*—the glory.

TRANSLATION

In these six verses I have described the truth about Lord Caitanya, whereas in the next five I have described the glory of Lord Nityānanda.

TEXT 28

āra dui śloke advaita-tattvākhyāna

āra eka śloke pañca-tattvera vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

āra—further; *dui śloke*—in two verses; *advaita*—of Śrī Advaita Prabhu; *tattva*—of the truth; *ākhyāna*—description; *āra*—further; *eka śloke*—in one verse; *pañca-tattvera*—of the Pañca-tattva; *vyākhyāna*—explanation.

TRANSLATION

The next two verses describe the truth of Advaita Prabhu, and the following verse describes the Pañca-tattva [the Lord, His plenary portion, His incarnation, His energies and His devotees].

TEXT 29

ei caudda śloke kari maṅgalācaraṇa

tañhi madhye kahi saba vastu-nirūpaṇa

SYNONYMS

ei caudda śloke—in these fourteen verses; *kari*—I make; *maṅgalācaraṇa*—auspicious invocation; *tañhi*—therefore in that; *madhye*—within; *kahi*—I speak; *saba*—all; *vastu*—object; *nirūpaṇa*—description.

TRANSLATION

These fourteen verses, therefore, offer auspicious invocations and describe the Supreme Truth.

TEXT 30

saba śrotā-vaiṣṇavere kari' namaskāra

ei saba ślokerā kari artha-vicāra

SYNONYMS

saba—all; *śrotā*—hearers or audience; *vaiṣṇavere*—unto the Vaiṣṇavas; *kari'*—offering; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *ei saba ślokerā*—of all these (fourteen) verses; *kari*—I make; *artha*—of the meaning; *vicāra*—analysis.

TRANSLATION

I offer my obeisances unto all my Vaiṣṇava readers as I begin to explain the intricacies of all these verses.

TEXT 31

sakala vaiṣṇava, śuna kari' eka-mana

caitanya-kṛṣṇera śāstra-mata-nirūpaṇa

SYNONYMS

sakala—all; *vaiṣṇava*—O devotees of the Lord; *śuna*—please hear; *kari'*—making; *eka-mana*—rapt attention; *caitanya*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *śāstra*—scriptural reference; *mata*—according to; *nirūpaṇa*—decision.

TRANSLATION

I request all my Vaiṣṇava readers to read and hear with rapt attention this narration of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya as inculcated in the revealed scriptures.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya is the Absolute Truth, Kṛṣṇa Himself. This is substantiated by evidence from the authentic spiritual scriptures.

Sometimes people accept a man as God on the basis of their whimsical sentiments and without reference to the revealed scriptures, but the author of *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* proves all his statements by citing the *śāstras*. Thus he establishes that Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 32

kṛṣṇa, guru, bhakta, śakti, avatāra, prakāśa

kṛṣṇa ei chaya-rūpe karena vilāsa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—the Supreme Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *guru*—the spiritual masters; *bhakta*—the devotees; *śakti*—the potencies; *avatāra*—the incarnations; *prakāśa*—plenary portions; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ei chaya-rūpe*—in these six features; *karena vilāsa*—enjoys.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa enjoys by manifesting Himself as the spiritual masters, the devotees, the diverse energies, the incarnations and the plenary portions. They are all six in one.

TEXT 33

ei chaya tattvera kari caraṇa vandana

prathame sāmānye kari maṅgalācaraṇa

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *chaya*—six; *tattvera*—of these expansions; *kari*—I make; *caraṇa*—the lotus feet; *vandana*—prayers; *prathame*—at first;

sāmānye—in general; *kari*—I make; *maṅgala-ācaraṇa*—auspicious invocation.

TRANSLATION

I therefore worship the lotus feet of these six diversities of the one truth by invoking their benedictions.

TEXT 34

vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān

īśam īśavatārakān

tat-prakāśānś ca tac-chaktīḥ

kṛṣṇa-caitanya-saṁjñakam

SYNONYMS

vande—I offer respectful obeisances; *gurūn*—unto the spiritual masters; *īśa-bhaktān*—unto the devotees of the Supreme Lord; *īśam*—unto the Supreme Lord; *īśa-avatārakān*—unto the incarnations of the Supreme Lord; *tat*—of the Supreme Lord; *prakāśān*—unto the manifestations; *ca*—and; *tac*—of the Supreme Lord; *śaktīḥ*—unto the potencies; *kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *saṁjñakam*—named.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto the spiritual masters, the devotees of the Lord, the Lord's incarnations, His plenary portions, His energies and the primeval Lord Himself, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī has composed this Sanskrit verse for the beginning of his book, and now he will explain it in detail. He offers his respectful obeisances to the six principles of the Absolute Truth. *Gurūn* is plural in number because anyone who gives spiritual instructions based on the revealed scriptures is accepted as a spiritual master. Although others give help in showing the way to beginners, the *guru* who first initiates one with the *mahā-mantra* is to be known as the initiator, and the saints who give instructions for progressive advancement in Kṛṣṇa consciousness are called instructing spiritual masters. The initiating and instructing spiritual masters are equal and identical manifestations of Kṛṣṇa, although they have different dealings. Their function is to guide the conditioned souls back home, back to Godhead. Therefore Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī accepted Nityānanda Prabhu and the six Gosvāmīs in the category of *guru*.

Īśa-bhaktān refers to the devotees of the Lord like Śrī Śrīvāsa and all other such followers, who are the energy of the Lord and are qualitatively nondifferent from Him. *Īśāvatārakān* refers to *ācāryas* like Advaita Prabhu, who is an *avatāra* of the Lord. *Tat-prakāśān* indicates the direct manifestation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Nityānanda Prabhu, and the initiating spiritual master. *Tac-chaktīḥ* refers to the spiritual energies (*śaktis*) of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Gadādhara, Dāmodara and Jagadānanda belong to this category of internal energy.

The six principles are differently manifested but all equally worshipable. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja begins by offering his obeisances unto them to teach us the method of worshiping Lord Caitanya. The external potency of Godhead, called *māyā*, can never associate with the Lord, just as darkness cannot remain in the presence of light; yet darkness, being but an illusory and temporary covering of light, has no existence independent of light.

TEXT 35

mantra-guru āra yata śikṣā-guru-gaṇa

tāñhāra caraṇa āge kariye vandana

SYNONYMS

mantra-guru—the initiating spiritual master; *āra*—and also; *yata*—as many (as there are); *śikṣā-guru-gaṇa*—all the instructing spiritual masters; *tāñhāra*—of all of them; *caraṇa*—unto the lotus feet; *āge*—at first; *kariye*—I offer; *vandana*—respectful obeisances.

TRANSLATION

I first offer my respectful obeisances at the lotus feet of my initiating spiritual master and all my instructing spiritual masters.

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, in his thesis *Bhakti-sandarbhā* (202), has stated that uncontaminated devotional service is the objective of pure Vaiṣṇavas and that one has to execute such service in the association of other devotees. By associating with devotees of Lord Kṛṣṇa, one develops a sense of Kṛṣṇa consciousness and thus becomes inclined toward the loving service of the Lord. This is the process of approaching the Supreme Lord by gradual appreciation in devotional service. If one desires unalloyed devotional service, one must associate with devotees of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, for by such association only can a conditioned soul achieve a taste for transcendental love and thus revive his eternal relationship with Godhead in a specific manifestation and in terms of the specific transcendental mellow (*rasa*) that one has eternally inherent in him.

If one develops love for Kṛṣṇa by Kṛṣṇa conscious activities, one can know the Supreme Absolute Truth, but he who tries to understand God simply by logical arguments will not succeed, nor will he get a taste for unalloyed devotion. The secret is that one must submissively listen to those who know perfectly the science of God, and one must begin the mode of service regulated by the preceptor. A devotee already attracted by

the name, form, qualities, etc., of the Supreme Lord may be directed to his specific manner of devotional service; he need not waste time in approaching the Lord through logic. The expert spiritual master knows well how to engage his disciple's energy in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, and thus he engages a devotee in a specific devotional service according to his special tendency. A devotee must have only one initiating spiritual master because in the scriptures acceptance of more than one is always forbidden. There is no limit, however, to the number of instructing spiritual masters one may accept. Generally a spiritual master who constantly instructs a disciple in spiritual science becomes his initiating spiritual master later on.

One should always remember that a person who is reluctant to accept a spiritual master and be initiated is sure to be baffled in his endeavor to go back to Godhead. One who is not properly initiated may present himself as a great devotee, but in fact he is sure to encounter many stumbling blocks on his path of progress toward spiritual realization, with the result that he must continue his term of material existence without relief. Such a helpless person is compared to a ship without a rudder, for such a ship can never reach its destination. It is imperative, therefore, that one accept a spiritual master if he at all desires to gain the favor of the Lord. The service of the spiritual master is essential. If there is no chance to serve the spiritual master directly, a devotee should serve him by remembering his instructions. There is no difference between the spiritual master's instructions and the spiritual master himself. In his absence, therefore, his words of direction should be the pride of the disciple. If one thinks that he is above consulting anyone else, including a spiritual master, he is at once an offender at the lotus feet of the Lord. Such an offender can never go back to Godhead. It is imperative that a serious person accept a bona fide spiritual master in terms of the śāstric injunctions. Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī advises that one not accept a spiritual master in terms of hereditary or customary social and ecclesiastical conventions. One should simply try to find a genuinely qualified spiritual master for actual advancement in spiritual understanding.

TEXT 36

śrī-rūpa, sanātana, bhaṭṭa-raghunātha

śrī-jīva, gopāla-bhaṭṭa, dāsa-raghunātha

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *sanātana*—Sanātana Gosvāmī; *bhaṭṭa-raghunātha*—Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī; *śrī-jīva*—Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī; *gopāla-bhaṭṭa*—Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī; *dāsa-raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

My instructing spiritual masters are Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī, Śrī Bhaṭṭa Raghunātha, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī, Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī and Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 37

ei chaya guru—śikṣā-guru ye āmāra

tān'-sabāra pāda-padme koṭi namaskāra

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *chaya*—six; *guru*—spiritual masters; *śikṣā-guru*—instructing spiritual masters; *ye*—who are; *āmāra*—my; *tān'-sabāra*—of all of them; *pāda-padme*—unto the lotus feet; *koṭi*—ten million; *namaskāra*—respectful obeisances.

TRANSLATION

These six are my instructing spiritual masters, and therefore I offer

millions of respectful obeisances unto their lotus feet.

PURPORT

By accepting the six Gosvāmīs as his instructing spiritual masters, the author specifically makes it clear that one should not be recognized as a Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava if he is not obedient to them.

TEXT 38

bhagavānera bhakta yata śrīvāsa pradhāna

tān'-sabhāra pāda-padme sahasra praṇāma

SYNONYMS

bhagavānera—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *bhakta*—the devotees; *yata*—as many (as there are); *śrīvāsa pradhāna*—headed by Śrī Śrīvāsa; *tān'-sabhāra*—of all of them; *pāda-padme*—unto the lotus feet; *sahasra*—thousands; *praṇāma*—respectful obeisances.

TRANSLATION

There are innumerable devotees of the Lord, of whom Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura is the foremost. I offer my respectful obeisances thousands of times unto their lotus feet.

TEXT 39

advaita ācārya—prabhura amśa-avatāra

tānra pāda-padme koṭi praṇati āmāra

SYNONYMS

advaita ācārya—Advaita Ācārya; *prabhura*—of the Supreme Lord;
aṁśa—partial; *avatāra*—incarnation; *tāñra*—of Him; *pāda-padme*—unto
the lotus feet; *koṭi*—ten million; *praṇati*—respectful obeisances;
āmāra—my.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya is the Lord’s partial incarnation, and therefore I offer my
obeisances millions of times at His lotus feet.

TEXT 40

nityānanda-rāya—*prabhura svarūpa-prakāśa*
tāñra pāda-padma vando yāñra muñi dāsa

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-rāya—Lord Nityānanda; *prabhura*—of the Supreme Lord;
sva-rūpa-prakāśa—personal manifestation; *tāñra*—of Him; *pāda-*
padma—unto the lotus feet; *vando*—I offer respectful obeisances;
yāñra—of whom; *muñi*—I am; *dāsa*—the servant.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Nityānanda Rāma is the plenary manifestation of the Lord, and I
have been initiated by Him. I therefore offer my respectful obeisances
unto His lotus feet.

TEXT 41

gadādhara-pañḍitādi—*prabhura nija-śakti*
tāñ’-sabāra caraṇe mora sahasra praṇati

SYNONYMS

gadādhara-pañḍita-ādi—headed by Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *prabhura*—of the Supreme Lord; *nija-śakti*—internal potencies; *tān'-sabāra*—of all of them; *carāṇe*—unto the lotus feet; *mora*—my; *sahasra*—thousands; *praṇati*—respectful obeisances.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto the internal potencies of the Lord, of whom Śrī Gadādhara Prabhu is the foremost.

TEXT 42

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu svayaṁ-bhagavān

tānhāra padāravinde ananta praṇāma

SYNONYMS

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya—Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *prabhu*—the Supreme Lord; *svayaṁ-bhagavān*—is the original Personality of Godhead; *tānhāra*—His; *pada-aravinde*—unto the lotus feet; *ananta*—innumerable; *praṇāma*—respectful obeisances.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Personality of Godhead Himself, and therefore I offer innumerable prostrations at His lotus feet.

TEXT 43

sāvaraṇe prabhure kariyā namaskāra

ei chaya teṇho yaiche—*kariye vicāra*

SYNONYMS

sa-āvaraṇe—along with His associates; *prabhure*—unto Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kariyā*—having made; *namaskāra*—respectful obeisances; *ei*—these; *chaya*—six; *teṇho*—He; *yaiche*—what they are like; *kariye*—I make; *vicāra*—discussion.

TRANSLATION

Having offered obeisances unto the Lord and all His associates, I shall now try to explain these six diversities in one.

PURPORT

There are many unalloyed devotees of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, all of whom are considered associates surrounding the Lord. Kṛṣṇa should be worshiped with His devotees. The diverse principles are therefore the eternal paraphernalia through which the Absolute Truth can be approached.

TEXT 44

yadyapi āmāra guru—caitanyera dāsa

tathāpi jāniye āmi tāṇhāra prakāśa

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—even though; *āmāra*—my; *guru*—spiritual master; *caitanyera*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dāsa*—the servitor; *tathāpi*—still; *jāniye*—know; *āmi*—I; *tāṇhāra*—of the Lord; *prakāśa*—direct manifestation.

TRANSLATION

Although I know that my spiritual master is a servitor of Śrī Caitanya, I know Him also as a plenary manifestation of the Lord.

PURPORT

Every living entity is essentially a servant of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and the spiritual master is also His servant. Still, the spiritual master is a direct manifestation of the Lord. With this conviction, a disciple can advance in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. The spiritual master is nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa because he is a manifestation of Kṛṣṇa.

Lord Nityānanda, who is Balarāma Himself, the first direct manifestation or expansion of Kṛṣṇa, is the original spiritual master. He helps Lord Kṛṣṇa in His pastimes, and He is a servant of the Lord.

Every living entity is eternally a servant of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; therefore the spiritual master cannot be other than a servant of Lord Caitanya. The spiritual master's eternal occupation is to expand the service of the Lord by training disciples in a service attitude. A spiritual master never poses as the Supreme Lord Himself; he is considered a representative of the Lord. The revealed scriptures prohibit one's pretending to be God, but a bona fide spiritual master is a most faithful and confidential servant of the Lord and therefore deserves as much respect as Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 45

guru kṛṣṇa-rūpa hana śāstrera pramāṇe

guru-rūpe kṛṣṇa kṛpā kareṇa bhakta-gaṇe

SYNONYMS

guru—the spiritual master; *kṛṣṇa-rūpa*—as good as Kṛṣṇa; *hana*—is; *śāstrera*—of revealed scriptures; *pramāṇe*—by the evidence; *guru-rūpe*—in the form of the spiritual master; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *kṛpā*—

mercy; *karena*—distributes; *bhakta-gaṇe*—unto His devotees.

TRANSLATION

According to the deliberate opinion of all revealed scriptures, the spiritual master is nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa. Lord Kṛṣṇa in the form of the spiritual master delivers His devotees.

PURPORT

The relationship of a disciple with his spiritual master is as good as his relationship with the Supreme Lord. A spiritual master always represents himself as the humblest servitor of the Personality of Godhead, but the disciple must look upon him as the manifested representation of Godhead.

TEXT 46

ācāryam mām vijānīyān

nāvamanyeta karhicit

na martya-buddhyāsūyeta

sarva-deva-mayo guruḥ

SYNONYMS

ācāryam—the spiritual master; *mām*—Myself; *vijānīyāt*—one should know; *na avamanyeta*—one should never disrespect; *karhicit*—at any time; *na*—never; *martya-buddhyā*—with the idea of his being an ordinary man; *asūyeta*—one should be envious; *sarva-deva*—of all demigods; *mayah*—representative; *guruḥ*—the spiritual master.

TRANSLATION

“One should know the ācārya as Myself and never disrespect him in any way. One should not envy him, thinking him an ordinary man, for he is the representative of all the demigods.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.17.27) spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa when He was questioned by Uddhava regarding the four social and spiritual orders of society. The Lord was specifically instructing how a *brahmacārī* should behave under the care of a spiritual master. A spiritual master is not an enjoyer of facilities offered by his disciples. He is like a parent. Without the attentive service of his parents, a child cannot grow to manhood; similarly, without the care of the spiritual master one cannot rise to the plane of transcendental service.

The spiritual master is also called *ācārya*, or a transcendental professor of spiritual science. The *Manu-saṁhitā* (2.140) explains the duties of an *ācārya*, describing that a bona fide spiritual master accepts charge of disciples, teaches them the Vedic knowledge with all its intricacies, and gives them their second birth. The ceremony performed to initiate a disciple into the study of spiritual science is called *upanīti*, or the function that brings one nearer to the spiritual master. One who cannot be brought nearer to a spiritual master cannot have a sacred thread, and thus he is indicated to be a *sūdra*. The sacred thread on the body of a *brāhmaṇa*, *kṣatriya* or *vaiśya* is a symbol of initiation by the spiritual master; it is worth nothing if worn merely to boast of high parentage. The duty of the spiritual master is to initiate a disciple with the sacred thread ceremony, and after this *saṁskāra*, or purificatory process, the spiritual master actually begins to teach the disciple about the *Vedas*. A person born a *sūdra* is not barred from such spiritual initiation, provided he is approved by the spiritual master, who is duly authorized to award a disciple the right to be a *brāhmaṇa* if he finds him perfectly qualified. In the *Vāyu Purāṇa* an *ācārya* is defined as one who knows the import of all Vedic literature, explains the purpose of the *Vedas*, abides by their rules and regulations, and teaches his disciples to act in the same way.

Only out of His immense compassion does the Personality of Godhead reveal Himself as the spiritual master. Therefore in the dealings of an *ācārya* there are no activities but those of transcendental loving service to the Lord. He is the Supreme Personality of Servitor Godhead. It is worthwhile to take shelter of such a steady devotee, who is called *āśraya-vigraha*, or the manifestation or form of the Lord of whom one must take shelter.

If one poses himself as an *ācārya* but does not have an attitude of servitorship to the Lord, he must be considered an offender, and this offensive attitude disqualifies him from being an *ācārya*. The bona fide spiritual master always engages in unalloyed devotional service to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. By this test he is known to be a direct manifestation of the Lord and a genuine representative of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. Such a spiritual master is known as *ācāryadeva*. Influenced by an envious temperament and dissatisfied because of an attitude of sense gratification, mundaners criticize a real *ācārya*. In fact, however, a bona fide *ācārya* is nondifferent from the Personality of Godhead, and therefore to envy such an *ācārya* is to envy the Personality of Godhead Himself. This will produce an effect subversive of transcendental realization.

As mentioned previously, a disciple should always respect the spiritual master as a manifestation of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, but at the same time one should always remember that a spiritual master is never authorized to imitate the transcendental pastimes of the Lord. False spiritual masters pose themselves as identical with Śrī Kṛṣṇa in every respect to exploit the sentiments of their disciples, but such impersonalists can only mislead their disciples, for their ultimate aim is to become one with the Lord. This is against the principles of the devotional cult.

The real Vedic philosophy is *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*, which establishes everything to be simultaneously one with and different from the Personality of Godhead. Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī confirms that this is the real position of a bona fide spiritual master and says that

one should always think of the spiritual master in terms of his intimate relationship with Mukunda (Śrī Kṛṣṇa). Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, in his *Bhakti-sandarbha* (213), has clearly explained that a pure devotee's observation of the spiritual master and Lord Śiva as being one with the Personality of Godhead exists in terms of their being very dear to the Lord, not identical with Him in all respects. Following in the footsteps of Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī and Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, later *ācāryas* like Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura have confirmed the same truths. In his prayers to the spiritual master, Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura confirms that all the revealed scriptures accept the spiritual master to be identical with the Personality of Godhead because he is a very dear and confidential servant of the Lord. Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas therefore worship Śrīla Gurudeva (the spiritual master) in the light of his being the servitor of the Personality of Godhead. In all the ancient literatures of devotional service and in the more recent songs of Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura, Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura and other unalloyed Vaiṣṇavas, the spiritual master is always considered either one of the confidential associates of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī or a manifested representation of Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu.

TEXT 47

śikṣā-guruke ta' jāni kṛṣṇera svarūpa

antaryāmī, bhakta-śreṣṭha, — — ei dui rūpa

SYNONYMS

śikṣā-guruke—the spiritual master who instructs; *ta'*—indeed; *jāni*—I know; *kṛṣṇera*—of Kṛṣṇa; *sva-rūpa*—the direct representative; *antaryāmī*—the indwelling Supersoul; *bhakta-śreṣṭha*—the best devotee; *ei*—these; *dui*—two; *rūpa*—forms.

TRANSLATION

One should know the instructing spiritual master to be the Personality of Kṛṣṇa. Lord Kṛṣṇa manifests Himself as the Supersoul and as the greatest devotee of the Lord.

PURPORT

Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī states that the instructing spiritual master is a bona fide representative of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself teaches us as the instructing spiritual master from within and without. From within He teaches as Paramātmā, our constant companion, and from without He teaches from the *Bhagavad-gītā* as the instructing spiritual master. There are two kinds of instructing spiritual masters. One is the liberated person fully absorbed in meditation in devotional service, and the other is he who invokes the disciple's spiritual consciousness by means of relevant instructions. Thus the instructions in the science of devotion are differentiated in terms of the objective and subjective ways of understanding. The *ācārya* in the true sense of the term, who is authorized to deliver Kṛṣṇa, enriches the disciple with full spiritual knowledge and thus awakens him to the activities of devotional service.

When by learning from the self-realized spiritual master one actually engages himself in the service of Lord Viṣṇu, functional devotional service begins. The procedures of this devotional service are known as *abhidheya*, or actions one is dutybound to perform. Our only shelter is the Supreme Lord, and one who teaches how to approach Kṛṣṇa is the functioning form of the Personality of Godhead. There is no difference between the shelter-giving Supreme Lord and the initiating and instructing spiritual masters. If one foolishly discriminates between them, he commits an offense in the discharge of devotional service.

Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī is the ideal spiritual master, for he delivers one the shelter of the lotus feet of Madana-mohana. Even though one may be unable to travel on the field of Vṛndāvana due to forgetfulness of his relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead, he can get an adequate opportunity to stay in Vṛndāvana and derive all spiritual

benefits by the mercy of Sanātana Gosvāmī. Śrī Govindajī acts exactly like the *śikṣā-guru* (instructing spiritual master) by teaching Arjuna the *Bhagavad-gītā*. He is the original preceptor, for He gives us instructions and an opportunity to serve Him. The initiating spiritual master is a personal manifestation of Śrīla Madana-mohana *vigraha*, whereas the instructing spiritual master is a personal representative of Śrīla Govindadeva *vigraha*. Both of these Deities are worshiped at Vṛndāvana. Śrīla Gopīnātha is the ultimate attraction in spiritual realization.

TEXT 48

naivopayanty apacitiṁ kavayaś taveśa

brahmāyusāpi kṛtam ṛddha-mudaḥ smarantaḥ

yo 'ntar bahis tanu-bhṛtām aśubham vidhunvann

ācārya-caitya-vapuṣā sva-gatiṁ vyanakti

SYNONYMS

na eva—not at all; *upayanti*—are able to express; *apacitiṁ*—their gratitude; *kavayaḥ*—learned devotees; *tava*—Your; *īśa*—O Lord; *brahma-āyusā*—with a lifetime equal to Lord Brahmā's; *api*—in spite of; *kṛtam*—magnanimous work; *ṛddha*—increased; *mudaḥ*—joy; *smarantaḥ*—remembering; *yaḥ*—who; *antaḥ*—within; *bahiḥ*—outside; *tanu-bhṛtām*—of those who are embodied; *aśubham*—misfortune; *vidhunvan*—dissipating; *ācārya*—of the spiritual master; *caitya*—of the Supersoul; *vapuṣā*—by the forms; *sva*—own; *gatiṁ*—path; *vyanakti*—shows.

TRANSLATION

“O my Lord! Transcendental poets and experts in spiritual science could not fully express their indebtedness to You, even if they were endowed

with the prolonged lifetime of Brahmā, for You appear in two features—externally as the ācārya and internally as the Supersoul—to deliver the embodied living being by directing him how to come to You.”

PURPORT

This verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.29.6) was spoken by Śrī Uddhava after he heard from Śrī Kṛṣṇa all necessary instructions about *yoga*.

TEXT 49

teṣāṁ satata-yuktānām

bhajatām prīti-pūrvakam

dadāmi buddhi-yogaṁ tam

yena mām upayānti te

SYNONYMS

teṣāṁ—unto them; *satata-yuktānām*—always engaged; *bhajatām*—in rendering devotional service; *prīti-pūrvakam*—in loving ecstasy; *dadāmi*—I give; *buddhi-yogaṁ*—real intelligence; *tam*—that; *yena*—by which; *mām*—unto Me; *upayānti*—come; *te*—they.

TRANSLATION

“To those who are constantly devoted to serving Me with love, I give the understanding by which they can come to Me.”

PURPORT

This verse of the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.10) clearly states how Govindadeva

instructs His bona fide devotee. The Lord declares that by enlightenment in theistic knowledge He awards attachment for Him to those who constantly engage in His transcendental loving service. This awakening of divine consciousness enthralls a devotee, who thus relishes his eternal transcendental mellow. Such an awakening is awarded only to those convinced by devotional service about the transcendental nature of the Personality of Godhead. They know that the Supreme Truth, the all-spiritual and all-powerful person, is one without a second and has fully transcendental senses. He is the fountainhead of all emanations. Such pure devotees, always merged in knowledge of Kṛṣṇa and absorbed in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, exchange thoughts and realizations as great scientists exchange their views and discuss the results of their research in scientific academies. Such exchanges of thoughts in regard to Kṛṣṇa give pleasure to the Lord, who therefore favors such devotees with all enlightenment.

TEXT 50

yathā brahmaṇe bhagavān

svayam upadiśyānubhāvitavān

SYNONYMS

yathā—just as; *brahmaṇe*—unto Lord Brahmā; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Lord; *svayam*—Himself; *upadiśya*—having instructed; *anubhāvitavān*—caused to perceive.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Personality of Godhead [svayam bhagavān] taught Brahmā and made him self-realized.

PURPORT

The English maxim that God helps those who help themselves is also applicable in the transcendental realm. There are many instances in the revealed scriptures of the Personality of Godhead's acting as the spiritual master from within. The Personality of Godhead was the spiritual master who instructed Brahmā, the original living being in the cosmic creation. When Brahmā was first created, he could not apply his creative energy to arrange the cosmic situation. At first there was only sound, vibrating the word *tapa*, which indicates the acceptance of hardships for spiritual realization. Refraining from sensual enjoyment, one should voluntarily accept all sorts of difficulties for spiritual realization. This is called *tapasya*. An enjoyer of the senses can never realize God, godliness or the science of theistic knowledge. Thus when Brahmā, initiated by Śrī Kṛṣṇa by the sound vibration *tapa*, engaged himself in acts of austerity, by the pleasure of Viṣṇu he was able to visualize the transcendental world, Śrī Vaikuṇṭha, through transcendental realization. Modern science can communicate using material discoveries such as radio, television and computers, but the science invoked by the austerities of Śrī Brahmā, the original father of mankind, was still more subtle. In time, material scientists may also know how we can communicate with the Vaikuṇṭha world. Lord Brahmā inquired about the potency of the Supreme Lord, and the Personality of Godhead answered his inquiry in the following six consecutive statements. These instructions, which are reproduced from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (2.9.31–36), were imparted by the Personality of Godhead, acting as the supreme spiritual master.

TEXT 51

jñānam parama-guhyam me

yad vijñāna-samanvitam

sa-rahasyam tad-aṅgam ca

grhāṇa gaditam mayā

SYNONYMS

jñānam—knowledge; *parama*—extremely; *guhyam*—confidential; *me*—of Me; *yat*—which; *viññāna*—realization; *samanvitam*—fully endowed with; *sa-rahasyam*—along with mystery; *tat*—of that; *aṅgam*—supplementary parts; *ca*—and; *grhāṇa*—just try to take up; *gaditam*—explained; *mayā*—by Me.

TRANSLATION

“Please hear attentively what I shall speak to you, for transcendental knowledge about Me is not only scientific but also full of mysteries.

PURPORT

Transcendental knowledge of Śrī Kṛṣṇa is deeper than the impersonal knowledge of Brahman, for it includes knowledge of not only His form and personality but also everything else related to Him. There is nothing in existence not related to Śrī Kṛṣṇa. In a sense, there is nothing but Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and yet nothing is Śrī Kṛṣṇa save and except His primeval personality. This knowledge constitutes a complete transcendental science, and Viṣṇu wanted to give Brahmājī full knowledge about that science. The mystery of this knowledge culminates in personal attachment to the Lord, with a resulting effect of detachment from anything “non-Kṛṣṇa.” There are nine alternative transcendental means of attaining this stage: hearing, chanting, remembering, serving the lotus feet of the Lord, worshiping, praying, assisting, fraternizing with the Lord, and sacrificing everything for Him. These are different parts of the same devotional service, which is full of transcendental mystery. The Lord said to Brahmā that since He was pleased with him, by His grace the mystery was being revealed.

TEXT 52

yāvān ahaṁ yathā-bhāvo

yad-rūpa-guṇa-karmakaḥ

tathaiva tattva-vijñānam

astu te mad-anugrahāt

SYNONYMS

yāvān—as I am in My eternal form; *aham*—I; *yathā*—in whichever manner; *bhāvaḥ*—transcendental existence; *yat*—whatever; *rūpa*—various forms and colors; *guṇa*—qualities; *karmakaḥ*—activities; *tathā eva*—exactly so; *tattva-vijñānam*—factual realization; *astu*—let there be; *te*—your; *mat*—My; *anugrahāt*—by causeless mercy.

TRANSLATION

“By My causeless mercy, be enlightened in truth about My personality, manifestations, qualities and pastimes.

PURPORT

The transcendental personal forms of the Lord are a mystery, and the symptoms of these forms, which are absolutely different from anything made of mundane elements, are also mysterious. The innumerable forms of the Lord, such as Śyāmasundara, Nārāyaṇa, Rāma and Gaurasundara; the colors of these forms (white, red, yellow, cloudlike *śyāma* and others); His qualities, as the responsive Personality of Godhead to pure devotees and as impersonal Brahman to dry speculators; His uncommon activities like lifting Govardhana Hill, marrying more than sixteen thousand queens at Dvārakā, and entering the *rāsa* dance with the damsels of Vraja, expanding Himself in as many forms as there were damsels in the dance—these and innumerable other uncommon acts and attributes are all mysteries, one aspect of which is presented in the scientific knowledge of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, which is read and adored all over the world by all classes of scholars, with as many interpretations as there are empiric

philosophers. The truth of these mysteries was revealed to Brahmā by the descending process, without the help of the ascending one. The Lord's mercy descends to a devotee like Brahmā and, through Brahmā, to Nārada, from Nārada to Vyāsa, from Vyāsadeva to Śukadeva and so on in the bona fide chain of disciplic succession. We cannot discover the mysteries of the Lord by our mundane endeavors; they are only revealed, by His grace, to the proper devotees. These mysteries are gradually disclosed to the various grades of devotees in proportion to the gradual development of their service attitude. In other words, impersonalists who depend upon the strength of their poor fund of knowledge and morbid speculative habits, without submission and service in the forms of hearing, chanting and the others mentioned above, cannot penetrate to the mysterious region of transcendence where the Supreme Truth is a transcendental person, free from all tinges of the material elements. Discovering the mystery of the Lord eliminates the impersonal feature realized by common spiritualists who are merely trying to enter the spiritual region from the mundane platform.

TEXT 53

aham evāsam evāgre

nānyad yat sad-asat param

paścād aham yad etac ca

yo 'vaśiṣyeta so 'smy aham

SYNONYMS

aham—I, the Personality of Godhead; *eva*—certainly; *āsam*—existed; *eva*—only; *agre*—before the creation; *na*—never; *anyat*—anything else; *yat*—which; *sat*—the effect; *asat*—the cause; *param*—the supreme; *paścāt*—at the end; *aham*—I, the Personality of Godhead; *yat*—which; *etat*—this creation; *ca*—also; *yaḥ*—who; *avaśiṣyeta*—remains; *saḥ*—

that; *asmi*—am; *aham*—I, the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

“Prior to the cosmic creation, only I exist, and no phenomena exist, either gross, subtle or primordial. After creation, only I exist in everything, and after annihilation, only I remain eternally.

PURPORT

Aham means “I”; therefore the speaker who is saying *aham*, “I,” must have His own personality. The Māyāvādī philosophers interpret this word *aham* as referring to the impersonal Brahman. The Māyāvādīs are very proud of their grammatical knowledge, but any person who has actual knowledge of grammar can understand that *aham* means “I” and that “I” refers to a personality. Therefore the Personality of Godhead, speaking to Brahmā, uses *aham* while describing His own transcendental form. *Aham* has a specific meaning; it is not a vague term that can be whimsically interpreted. *Aham*, when spoken by Kṛṣṇa, refers to the Supreme Personality of Godhead and nothing else.

Before the creation and after its dissolution, only the Supreme Personality of Godhead and His associates exist; there is no existence of the material elements. This is confirmed in the Vedic literature.

Vāsudevo vā idam agra āsīn na brahmā na ca śaṅkaraḥ. The meaning of this *mantra* is that before creation there was no existence of Brahmā or Śiva, for only Viṣṇu existed. Viṣṇu exists in His abode, the Vaikuṇṭhas. There are innumerable Vaikuṇṭha planets in the spiritual sky, and on each of them Viṣṇu resides with His associates and His paraphernalia. It is also confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* that although the creation is periodically dissolved, there is another abode, which is never dissolved. The word “creation” refers to the material creation because in the spiritual world everything exists eternally and there is no creation or dissolution.

The Lord indicates herein that before the material creation He existed in fullness with all transcendental opulences, including all strength, all wealth, all beauty, all knowledge, all fame and all renunciation. If one thinks of a king, he automatically thinks of his secretaries, ministers, military commanders, palaces and so on. Since a king has such opulences, one can simply try to imagine the opulences of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. When the Lord says *aḥam*, therefore, it is to be understood that He exists with full potency, including all opulences.

The word *yat* refers to Brahman, the impersonal effulgence of the Lord. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.40) it is said, *tad brahma niṣkalam anantam aśeṣa-bhūtam*: the Brahman effulgence expands unlimitedly. Just as the sun is a localized planet with the sunshine expanding unlimitedly from that source, so the Absolute Truth is the Supreme Personality of Godhead with His effulgence of energy, Brahman, expanding unlimitedly. From that Brahman energy the creation appears, just as a cloud appears in sunshine. From the cloud comes rain, from the rain comes vegetation, and from the vegetation come fruits and flowers, which are the basis of subsistence for many other forms of life. Similarly, the effulgent bodily luster of the Supreme Lord is the cause of the creation of infinite universes. The Brahman effulgence is impersonal, but the cause of that energy is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. From Him, in His abode, the Vaikuṇṭhas, this *brahmajyoti* emanates. He is never impersonal. Since impersonalists cannot understand the source of the Brahman energy, they mistakenly choose to think this impersonal Brahman the ultimate or absolute goal. But as stated in the *Upaniṣads*, one has to penetrate the impersonal effulgence to see the face of the Supreme Lord. If one desires to reach the source of the sunshine, he has to travel through the sunshine to reach the sun and then meet the predominating deity there. The Absolute Truth is the Supreme Person, Bhagavān, as *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* explains.

Sat means “effect,” *asat* means “cause,” and *param* refers to the ultimate truth, which is transcendental to cause and effect. The cause of the creation is called the *mahat-tattva*, or total material energy, and its effect

is the creation itself. But neither cause nor effect existed in the beginning; they emanated from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as did the energy of time. This is stated in the *Vedānta-sūtra* (*janmādy asya yataḥ* [SB 1.1.1]). The source of birth of the cosmic manifestation, or *mahat-tattva*, is the Personality of Godhead. This is confirmed throughout *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and the *Bhagavad-gītā*. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.8) the Lord says, *aham sarvasya prabhavaḥ*: “I am the fountainhead of all emanations.” The material cosmos, being temporary, is sometimes manifest and sometimes unmanifest, but its energy emanates from the Supreme Absolute Lord. Before the creation there was neither cause nor effect, but the Supreme Personality of Godhead existed with His full opulence and energy.

The words *paścād aham* indicate that the Lord exists after the dissolution of the cosmic manifestation. When the material world is dissolved, the Lord still exists personally in the Vaikuṇṭhas. During the creation the Lord also exists as He is in the Vaikuṇṭhas, and He also exists as the Supersoul within the material universes. This is confirmed in the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.37). *Goloka eva nivasati*: although He is perfectly and eternally present in Goloka Vṛndāvana in Vaikuṇṭha, He is nevertheless all-pervading (*akhilātma-bhūtaḥ*). The all-pervading feature of the Lord is called the Supersoul. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is said, *aham kṛtsnasya jagataḥ prabhavaḥ*: the cosmic manifestation is a display of the energy of the Supreme Lord. The material elements (earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intelligence and false ego) display the inferior energy of the Lord, and the living entities are His superior energy. Since the energy of the Lord is not different from Him, in fact everything that exists is Kṛṣṇa in His impersonal feature. Sunshine, sunlight and heat are not different from the sun, and yet simultaneously they are distinct energies of the sun. Similarly, the cosmic manifestation and the living entities are energies of the Lord, and they are considered to be simultaneously one with and different from Him. The Lord therefore says, “I am everything,” because everything is His energy and is therefore nondifferent from Him.

Yo 'vaśiṣyeta so 'smy aham indicates that the Lord is the balance that exists after the dissolution of the creation. The spiritual manifestation never vanishes. It belongs to the internal energy of the Supreme Lord and exists eternally. When the external manifestation is withdrawn, the spiritual activities in Goloka and the rest of the Vaikuṇṭhas continue, unrestricted by material time, which has no existence in the spiritual world. Therefore in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.6) it is said, *yad gatvā na nivartante tad dhāma paramam mama*: “The abode from which no one returns to this material world is the supreme abode of the Lord.”

TEXT 54

ṛte 'rtham yat pratīyeta

na pratīyeta cātmani

tad vidyād ātmano māyām

yathābhāso yathā tamaḥ

SYNONYMS

ṛte—without; *artham*—value; *yat*—that which; *pratīyeta*—appears to be; *na*—not; *pratīyeta*—appears to be; *ca*—certainly; *ātmani*—in relation to Me; *tat*—that; *vidyāt*—you must know; *ātmanaḥ*—My; *māyām*—illusory energy; *yathā*—just as; *ābhāsaḥ*—the reflection; *yathā*—just as; *tamaḥ*—the darkness.

TRANSLATION

“What appears to be truth without Me is certainly My illusory energy, for nothing can exist without Me. It is like a reflection of a real light in the shadows, for in the light there are neither shadows nor reflections.

PURPORT

In the previous verse the Absolute Truth and its nature have been explained. One must also understand the relative truth to actually know the Absolute. The relative truth, which is called *māyā*, or material nature, is explained here. *Māyā* has no independent existence. One who is less intelligent is captivated by the wonderful activities of *māyā*, but he does not understand that behind these activities is the direction of the Supreme Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.10) it is said, *mayādhyakṣeṇa prakṛtiḥ sūyate sa-carācaram*: the material nature is working and producing moving and nonmoving beings only by the supervision of Kṛṣṇa.

The real nature of *māyā*, the illusory existence of the material manifestation, is clearly explained in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. The Absolute Truth is substance, and the relative truth depends upon its relationship with the Absolute for its existence. *Māyā* means energy; therefore the relative truth is explained to be the energy of the Absolute Truth. Since it is difficult to understand the distinction between the absolute and relative truths, an analogy can be given for clarification. The Absolute Truth can be compared to the sun, which is appreciated in terms of two relative truths: reflection and darkness. Darkness is the absence of sunshine, and a reflection is a projection of sunlight into darkness. Neither darkness nor reflection has an independent existence. Darkness comes when the sunshine is blocked. For example, if one stands facing the sun, his back will be in darkness. Since darkness stands in the absence of the sun, it is therefore relative to the sun. The spiritual world is compared to the real sunshine, and the material world is compared to the dark regions where the sun is not visible.

When the material manifestation appears very wonderful, this is due to a perverted reflection of the supreme sunshine, the Absolute Truth, as confirmed in the *Vedānta-sūtra*. Whatever one can see here has its substance in the Absolute. As darkness is situated far away from the sun, so the material world is also far away from the spiritual world. The Vedic literature directs us not to be captivated by the dark regions (*tamaḥ*) but to try to reach the shining regions of the Absolute (*yogi-dhāma*).

The spiritual world is brightly illuminated, but the material world is wrapped in darkness. In the material world, sunshine, moonshine or different kinds of artificial light are required to dispel darkness, especially at night, for by nature the material world is dark. Therefore the Supreme Lord has arranged for sunshine and moonshine. But in His abode, as described in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.6), there is no necessity for lighting by sunshine, moonshine or electricity because everything is self-effulgent.

That which is relative, temporary and far away from the Absolute Truth is called *māyā*, or ignorance. This illusion is exhibited in two ways, as explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā*. The inferior illusion is inert matter, and the superior illusion is the living entity. The living entities are called illusory in this context only because they are implicated in the illusory structures and activities of the material world. Actually the living entities are not illusory, for they are parts of the superior energy of the Supreme Lord and do not have to be covered by *māyā* if they do not want to be so. The actions of the living entities in the spiritual kingdom are not illusory; they are the actual, eternal activities of liberated souls.

TEXT 55

yathā mahānti bhūtāni

bhūteṣūccāvaceṣv anu

praviṣṭāny apraviṣṭāni

tathā teṣu na teṣv aham

SYNONYMS

yathā—as; *mahānti*—the universal; *bhūtāni*—elements; *bhūteṣu*—in the living entities; *ucca-avaceṣu*—both gigantic and minute; *anu*—after; *praviṣṭāni*—situated internally; *apraviṣṭāni*—situated externally; *tathā*—so; *teṣu*—in them; *na*—not; *teṣv*—in them; *aham*—I.

TRANSLATION

“As the material elements enter the bodies of all living beings and yet remain outside them all, I exist within all material creations and yet am not within them.

PURPORT

The gross material elements (earth, water, fire, air and ether) combine with the subtle material elements (mind, intelligence and false ego) to construct the bodies of this material world, and yet they are beyond these bodies as well. Any material construction is nothing but an amalgamation or combination of material elements in varied proportions. These elements exist both within and beyond the body. For example, although the sky exists in space, it also enters within the body. Similarly, the Supreme Lord, who is the cause of the material energy, lives within the material world as well as beyond it. Without His presence within the material world, the cosmic body could not develop, just as without the presence of the spirit within the physical body, the body could not develop. The entire material manifestation develops and exists because the Supreme Personality of Godhead enters it as Paramātmā, or the Supersoul. The Personality of Godhead in His all-pervading feature of Paramātmā enters every entity, from the biggest to the most minute. His existence can be realized by one who has the single qualification of submissiveness and who thereby becomes a surrendered soul. The development of submissiveness is the cause of proportionate spiritual realization, by which one can ultimately meet the Supreme Lord in person, as a man meets another man face to face.

Because of his development of transcendental attachment for the Supreme Lord, a surrendered soul feels the presence of his beloved everywhere, and all his senses are engaged in the loving service of the Lord. His eyes are engaged in seeing the beautiful couple Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa sitting on a decorated throne beneath a desire tree in the transcendental land of Vṛndāvana. His nose is engaged in smelling the

spiritual aroma of the lotus feet of the Lord. Similarly, his ears are engaged in hearing messages from Vaikuṇṭha, and his hands embrace the lotus feet of the Lord and His associates. Thus the Lord is manifested to a pure devotee from within and without. This is one of the mysteries of the devotional relationship in which a devotee and the Lord are bound by a tie of spontaneous love. To achieve this love should be the goal of life for every living being.

TEXT 56

etāvad eva jijñāsyam

tattva-jijñāsunātmanaḥ

anvaya-vyatirekābhyām

yat syāt sarvatra sarvadā

SYNONYMS

etāvat—up to this; *eva*—certainty; *jijñāsyam*—to be inquired about; *tattva*—of the Absolute Truth; *jijñāsunā*—by the student; *ātmanaḥ*—of the Self; *anvaya*—directly; *vyatirekābhyām*—and indirectly; *yat*—whatever; *syāt*—it may be; *sarvatra*—everywhere; *sarvadā*—always.

TRANSLATION

“A person interested in transcendental knowledge must therefore always directly and indirectly inquire about it to know the all-pervading truth.”

PURPORT

Those who are serious about the knowledge of the transcendental world, which is far beyond the material cosmic creation, must approach a bona fide spiritual master to learn the science both directly and indirectly. One

must learn both the means to approach the desired destination and the hindrances to such progress. The spiritual master knows how to regulate the habits of a neophyte disciple, and therefore a serious student must learn the science in all its aspects from him.

There are different grades and standards of prosperity. The standard of comfort and happiness conceived by a common man engaged in material labor is the lowest grade of happiness, for it is in relationship with the body. The highest standard of such bodily comfort is achieved by a fruitive worker who by pious activities reaches the plane of heaven, or the kingdom of the creative gods with their delegated powers. But the conception of comfortable life in heaven is insignificant in comparison to the happiness enjoyed in the impersonal Brahman, and this *brahmānanda*, the spiritual bliss derived from impersonal Brahman, is like the water in the hoofprint of a calf compared to the ocean of love of Godhead. When one develops pure love for the Lord, he derives an ocean of transcendental happiness from the association of the Personality of Godhead. To qualify oneself to reach this stage of life is the highest perfection.

One should try to purchase a ticket to go back home, back to Godhead. The price of such a ticket is one's intense desire for it, which is not easily awakened, even if one continuously performs pious activities for thousands of lives. All mundane relationships are sure to be broken in the course of time, but once one establishes a relationship with the Personality of Godhead in a particular *rasa*, it is never to be broken, even after the annihilation of the material world.

One should understand, through the transparent medium of the spiritual master, that the Supreme Lord exists everywhere in His transcendental spiritual nature and that the living entities' relationships with the Lord are directly and indirectly existing everywhere, even in this material world. In the spiritual world there are five kinds of relationships with the Supreme Lord—*śānta*, *dāsyā*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *mādhurya*. The perverted reflections of these *rasas* are found in the material world. Land,

home, furniture and other inert material objects are related in *śānta*, or the neutral and silent sense, whereas servants work in the *dāsyā* relationship. The reciprocation between friends is called *sakhya*, the affection of a parent for a child is known as *vātsalya*, and the affairs of conjugal love constitute *mādhurya*. These five relationships in the material world are distorted reflections of the original, pure sentiments, which should be understood and perfected in relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master. In the material world the perverted *rasas* bring frustration. If these *rasas* are reestablished with Lord Kṛṣṇa, the result is eternal, blissful life.

From this and the preceding three verses of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, which have been selected from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, the missionary activities of Lord Caitanya can be understood. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* has eighteen thousand verses, which are summarized in the four verses beginning with *aham evāsam evāgre* (53) and concluding with *yat syāt sarvatra sarvadā* (56). In the first of these verses (53) the transcendental nature of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is explained. The second verse (54) further explains that the Lord is detached from the workings of the material energy, *māyā*. The living entities, although parts and parcels of Lord Kṛṣṇa, are prone to be controlled by the external energy; therefore, although they are spiritual, in the material world they are encased in bodies of material energy. The eternal relationship of the living entities with the Supreme Lord is explained in that verse. The next verse (55) instructs that the Supreme Personality of Godhead, by His inconceivable energies, is simultaneously one with and different from the living entities and the material energy. This knowledge is called *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*. When an individual living entity surrenders to the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa, he can then develop natural transcendental love for Him. This surrendering process should be the primary concern of a human being. In the next verse (56) it is said that a conditioned soul must ultimately approach a bona fide spiritual master and try to understand perfectly the material and spiritual worlds and his own existential position. Here the words *anvaya-vyatirekābhyām*, “directly

and indirectly,” suggest that one must learn the process of devotional service in its two aspects: one must directly execute the process of devotional service and indirectly avoid the impediments to progress.

TEXT 57

cintāmaṇiḥ jayati somagiriḥ gurur me

śikṣā-guruś ca bhagavān śikhi-piñcha-mauliḥ

yat-pāda-kalpataru-pallava-śekhareṣu

līlā-svayamvara-rasam labhate jayaśrīḥ

SYNONYMS

cintāmaṇiḥ jayati—all glory to Cintāmaṇi; *soma-giriḥ*—Somagiri (the initiating *guru*); *guruḥ*—spiritual master; *me*—my; *śikṣā-guruḥ*—instructing spiritual master; *ca*—and; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *śikhi-piñcha*—with peacock feathers; *mauliḥ*—whose head; *yat*—whose; *pāda*—of the lotus feet; *kalpa-taru*—like desire trees; *pallava*—like new leaves; *śekhareṣu*—at the toe nails; *līlā-svayamvara*—of conjugal pastimes; *rasam*—the mellow; *labhate*—obtains; *jayaśrīḥ*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

TRANSLATION

“All glories to Cintāmaṇi and my initiating spiritual master, Somagiri. All glories to my instructing spiritual master, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who wears peacock feathers in His crown. Under the shade of His lotus feet, which are like desire trees, Jayaśrī [Rādhārāṇī] enjoys the transcendental mellow of an eternal consort.”

PURPORT

This verse is from the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*, which was written by a great Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī* named Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura, who is also known as Līlāśuka. He intensely desired to enter into the eternal pastimes of the Lord, and he lived at Vṛndāvana for seven hundred years in the vicinity of Brahma-kuṇḍa, a still-existing bathing tank in Vṛndāvana. The history of Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura is given in a book called *Śrī-vallabha-digvijaya*. He appeared in the eighth century of the Śaka Era in the province of Draviḍa and was the chief disciple of Viṣṇu Svāmī. In a list of temples and monasteries kept in Śaṅkarācārya's monastery in Dvārakā, Bilvamaṅgala is mentioned as the founder of the Dvārakādhīśa temple there. He entrusted the service of his Deity to Hari Brahmācārī, a disciple of Vallabha Bhaṭṭa.

Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura actually entered into the transcendental pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa. He has recorded his transcendental experiences and appreciation in the book known as *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*. In the beginning of that book he has offered his obeisances to his different *gurus*, and it is to be noted that he has adored them all equally. The first spiritual master mentioned is Cintāmaṇi, who was one of his instructing spiritual masters because she first showed him the spiritual path. Cintāmaṇi was a prostitute with whom Bilvamaṅgala was intimate earlier in his life. She gave him the inspiration to begin on the path of devotional service, and because she convinced him to give up material existence to try for perfection by loving Kṛṣṇa, he has first offered his respects to her. Next he offers his respects to his initiating spiritual master, Somagiri, and then to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who was also his instructing spiritual master. He explicitly mentions Bhagavān, who has peacock feathers on His crown, because the Lord of Vṛndāvana, Kṛṣṇa the cowherd boy, used to come to Bilvamaṅgala to talk with him and supply him with milk. In his adoration of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, he states that Jayāśrī, the goddess of fortune, Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, takes shelter in the shade of His lotus feet to enjoy the transcendental *rasa* of nuptial love. The complete treatise *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta* is dedicated to the transcendental pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa and Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. It is a book to be read and understood by the most elevated devotees of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 58

jīve sākṣāt nāhi tāte guru caītya-rūpe

śikṣā-guru haya kṛṣṇa-mahānta-svarūpe

SYNONYMS

jīve—by the living entity; *sākṣāt*—direct experience; *nāhi*—there is not; *tāte*—therefore; *guru*—the spiritual master; *caītya-rūpe*—in the form of the Supersoul; *śikṣā-guru*—the spiritual master who instructs; *haya*—appears; *kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *mahānta*—the topmost devotee; *sva-rūpe*—in the form of.

TRANSLATION

Since one cannot visually experience the presence of the Supersoul, He appears before us as a liberated devotee. Such a spiritual master is none other than Kṛṣṇa Himself.

PURPORT

It is not possible for a conditioned soul to directly meet Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but if one becomes a sincere devotee and seriously engages in devotional service, Lord Kṛṣṇa sends an instructing spiritual master to show him favor and invoke his dormant propensity for serving the Supreme. The preceptor appears before the external senses of the fortunate conditioned soul, and at the same time the devotee is guided from within by the *caītya-guru*, Kṛṣṇa, who is seated as the spiritual master within the heart of the living entity.

TEXT 59

tato duḥsaṅgam utsrjya

satsu sajjeta buddhi-mān

santa evāśya chindanti

mano-vyāsaṅgam uktibhiḥ

SYNONYMS

tataḥ—therefore; *duḥsaṅgam*—bad association; *utsṛjya*—giving up; *satsu*—with the devotees; *sajjeta*—one should associate; *buddhi-mān*—an intelligent person; *santaḥ*—devotees; *eva*—certainly; *asya*—one’s; *chindanti*—cut off; *manaḥ-vyāsaṅgam*—opposing attachments; *uktibhiḥ*—by their instructions.

TRANSLATION

“One should therefore avoid bad company and associate only with devotees. With their realized instructions, such saints can cut the knot connecting one with activities unfavorable to devotional service.”

PURPORT

This verse, which appears in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.26.26), was spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa to Uddhava in the text known as the *Uddhava-gīta*. The discussion relates to the story of Purūravā and the heavenly courtesan Urvaśī. When Urvaśī left Purūravā, he was deeply affected by the separation and had to learn to overcome his grief.

It is indicated that to learn the transcendental science, it is imperative that one avoid the company of undesirable persons and always seek the company of saints and sages who are able to impart lessons of transcendental knowledge. The potent words of such realized souls penetrate the heart, thereby eradicating all misgivings accumulated through years of undesirable association. For a neophyte devotee there are two kinds of persons whose association is undesirable: (1) gross

materialists who constantly engage in sense gratification and (2) unbelievers who do not serve the Supreme Personality of Godhead but serve their senses and their mental whims in terms of their speculative habits. Intelligent persons seeking transcendental realization should very scrupulously avoid their company.

TEXT 60

satām prasaṅgān mama vīrya-saṁvido

bhavanti hṛt-karṇa-rasāyanāḥ kathāḥ

taj-joṣaṇād āśv apavarga-vartmani

śraddhā ratir bhaktir anukramiṣyati

SYNONYMS

satām—of the devotees; *prasaṅgāt*—by intimate association; *mama*—of Me; *vīrya-saṁvidāḥ*—talks full of spiritual potency; *bhavanti*—appear; *hṛt*—to the heart; *karṇa*—and to the ears; *rasa-āyanāḥ*—a source of sweetness; *kathāḥ*—talks; *tat*—of them; *joṣaṇāt*—from proper cultivation; *āśu*—quickly; *apavarga*—of liberation; *vartmani*—on the path; *śraddhā*—faith; *ratih*—attraction; *bhaktih*—love; *anukramiṣyati*—will follow one after another.

TRANSLATION

“The spiritually powerful message of Godhead can be properly discussed only in a society of devotees, and it is greatly pleasing to hear in that association. If one hears from devotees, the way of transcendental experience quickly opens, and gradually one attains firm faith that in due course develops into attraction and devotion.”

PURPORT

This verse appears in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.25.25), where Kapiladeva replies to the questions of His mother, Devahūti, about the process of devotional service. As one advances in devotional activities, the process becomes progressively clearer and more encouraging. Unless one gets this spiritual encouragement by following the instructions of the spiritual master, it is not possible to make advancement. Therefore, one's development of a taste for executing these instructions is the test of one's devotional service. Initially, one must develop confidence by hearing the science of devotion from a qualified spiritual master. Then, as he associates with devotees and tries to adopt the means instructed by the spiritual master in his own life, his misgivings and other obstacles are vanquished by his execution of devotional service. Strong attachment for the transcendental service of the Lord develops as he continues listening to the messages of Godhead, and if he steadfastly proceeds in this way, he is certainly elevated to spontaneous love for the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 61

īśvara-svarūpa bhakta tāñra adhiṣṭhāna

bhaktera hṛdaye kṛṣṇera satata viśrāma

SYNONYMS

īśvara—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *svarūpa*—identical with; *bhakta*—the pure devotee; *tāñra*—His; *adhiṣṭhāna*—abode; *bhaktera*—of the devotee; *hṛdaye*—in the heart; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *satata*—always; *viśrāma*—the resting place.

TRANSLATION

A pure devotee constantly engaged in the loving service of the Lord is identical with the Lord, who is always seated in his heart.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is one without a second, and therefore He is all-powerful. He has inconceivable energies, of which three are principal. The devotee is considered to be one of these energies, never the energetic. The energetic is always the Supreme Lord. The energies are related to Him for the purpose of eternal service. A living entity in the conditioned stage can uncover his aptitude for serving the Absolute Truth by the grace of Kṛṣṇa and the spiritual master. Then the Lord reveals Himself within his heart, and he can know that Kṛṣṇa is seated in the heart of every pure devotee. Kṛṣṇa is actually situated in the heart of every living entity, but only a devotee can realize this fact.

TEXT 62

sādhavo hṛdayam mahyam

sādhūnām hṛdayam tv aham

mad-anyat te na jñanti

nāham tebhyo manāg api

SYNONYMS

sādhavaḥ—the saints; *hṛdayam*—heart; *mahyam*—My; *sādhūnām*—of the saints; *hṛdayam*—the heart; *tu*—indeed; *aham*—I; *mat*—than Me; *anyat*—other; *te*—they; *na*—not; *jñanti*—know; *na*—nor; *aham*—I; *tebhyaḥ*—than them; *manāk*—slightly; *api*—even.

TRANSLATION

“Saints are My heart, and only I am their hearts. They do not know anyone but Me, and therefore I do not recognize anyone besides them as Mine.”

PURPORT

This verse appears in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (9.4.68) in connection with a misunderstanding between Durvāsā Muni and Mahārāja Ambarīṣa. As a result of this misunderstanding, Durvāsā Muni tried to kill the king, when the Sudarśana *cakra*, the celebrated weapon of Godhead, appeared on the scene for the devoted king's protection. When the Sudarśana *cakra* attacked Durvāsā Muni, he fled in fear of the weapon and sought shelter from all the great demigods in heaven. Not one of them was able to protect him, and therefore Durvāsā Muni prayed to Lord Viṣṇu for forgiveness. Lord Viṣṇu advised him, however, that if he wanted forgiveness he had to get it from Mahārāja Ambarīṣa, not from Him. In this context Lord Viṣṇu spoke this verse.

The Lord, being full and free from problems, can wholeheartedly care for His devotees. His concern is how to elevate and protect all those who have taken shelter at His feet. The same responsibility is also entrusted to the spiritual master. The bona fide spiritual master's concern is how the devotees who have surrendered to him as a representative of the Lord may make progress in devotional service. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is always mindful of the devotees who fully engage in cultivating knowledge of Him, having taken shelter at His lotus feet.

TEXT 63

bhavad-vidhā bhāgavatās

tīrtha-bhūtāḥ svayaṁ vibho

tīrthī-kurvanti tīrthāni

svāntaḥ-sthena gadā-bhṛtā

SYNONYMS

bhavat—your good self; *vidhāḥ*—like; *bhāgavatāḥ*—devotees; *tīrtha*—holy places of pilgrimage; *bhūtāḥ*—existing; *svayam*—themselves; *vibho*—O almighty one; *tīrthī-kurvanti*—make into holy places of pilgrimage; *tīrthāni*—the holy places; *sva-antaḥ-sthena*—being situated in their hearts; *gadā-bhṛtā*—by the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

“Saints of your caliber are themselves places of pilgrimage. Because of their purity, they are constant companions of the Lord, and therefore they can purify even the places of pilgrimage.”

PURPORT

This verse was spoken by Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira to Vidura in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.13.10). Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira was receiving his saintly uncle Vidura, who had been visiting sacred places of pilgrimage. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira told Vidura that pure devotees like him are personified holy places because the Supreme Personality of Godhead is always with them in their hearts. By their association, sinful persons are freed from sinful reactions, and therefore wherever a pure devotee goes is a sacred place of pilgrimage. The importance of holy places is due to the presence there of such pure devotees.

TEXT 64

sei bhakta-gaṇa haya dvi-vidha prakāra

pāriṣad-gaṇa eka, sādhaka-gaṇa āra

SYNONYMS

sei—these; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *haya*—are; *dvi-vidha*—twofold; *prakāra*—varieties; *pāriṣat-gaṇa*—factual devotees; *eka*—one; *sādhaka-gaṇa*—prospective devotees; *āra*—the other.

TRANSLATION

Such pure devotees are of two types: personal associates [pāriṣats] and neophyte devotees [sādhakas].

PURPORT

Perfect servitors of the Lord are considered His personal associates, whereas devotees endeavoring to attain perfection are called neophytes. Among the associates, some are attracted by the opulences of the Personality of Godhead, and others are attracted by nuptial love of Godhead. The former devotees are placed in the realm of Vaikuṇṭha to render reverential devotional service, whereas the latter devotees are placed in Vṛndāvana for the direct service of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXTS 65–66

īśvarera avatāra e-tina prakāra

aṁśa-avatāra, āra guṇa-avatāra

śaktyāveśa-avatāra—tṛtīya e-mata

aṁśa-avatāra—puruṣa-matsyādika yata

SYNONYMS

īśvarera—of the Supreme Lord; *avatāra*—incarnations; *e-tina*—these three; *prakāra*—kinds; *aṁśa-avatāra*—partial incarnations; *āra*—and; *guṇa-avatāra*—qualitative incarnations; *śakti-āveśa-avatāra*—empowered incarnations; *tṛtīya*—the third; *e-mata*—thus; *aṁśa-avatāra*—partial incarnations; *puruṣa*—the three *puruṣa* incarnations; *matsya*—the fish incarnation; *ādika*—and so on; *yata*—all.

TRANSLATION

There are three categories of incarnations of Godhead: partial incarnations, qualitative incarnations and empowered incarnations. The puruṣas and Matsya are examples of partial incarnations.

TEXT 67

brahmā viṣṇu śiva—tina guṇāvatāre gaṇi

śakty-āveśa—sanakādi, pṛthu, vyāsa-muni

SYNONYMS

brahmā—Lord Brahmā; *viṣṇu*—Lord Viṣṇu; *śiva*—Lord Śiva; *tina*—three; *guṇa-avatāre*—among the incarnations controlling the three modes of material nature; *gaṇi*—I count; *śakty-āveśa*—empowered incarnations; *sanaka-ādi*—the four Kumāras; *pṛthu*—King Pṛthu; *vyāsa-muni*—Vyāsadeva.

TRANSLATION

Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva are qualitative incarnations. Empowered incarnations are those like the Kumāras, King Pṛthu and Mahā-muni Vyāsa [the compiler of the Vedas].

TEXT 68

dui-rūpe haya bhagavānera prakāśa

eke ta' prakāśa haya, āre ta' vilāsa

SYNONYMS

dui-rūpe—in two forms; *haya*—are; *bhagavānera*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *prakāśa*—manifestations; *eke*—in one; *ta'*—certainly; *prakāśa*—manifestation; *haya*—is; *āre*—in the other; *ta'*—

certainly; *vilāsa*—engaged in pastimes.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead exhibits Himself in two kinds of forms: *prakāśa* and *vilāsa*.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord expands His personal forms in two primary categories. The *prakāśa* forms are manifested by Lord Kṛṣṇa for His pastimes, and their features are exactly like His. When Lord Kṛṣṇa married sixteen thousand queens in Dvārakā, He did so in sixteen thousand *prakāśa* expansions. Similarly, during the *rāsa* dance He expanded Himself in identical *prakāśa* forms to dance beside each and every *gopī* simultaneously. When the Lord manifests His *vilāsa* expansions, however, they are all somewhat different in their bodily features. Lord Balarāma is the first *vilāsa* expansion of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and the four-handed Nārāyaṇa forms in Vaikuṇṭha expand from Balarāma. There is no difference between the bodily forms of Śrī Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma except that Their bodily colors are different. Similarly, Śrī Nārāyaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha has four hands, whereas Kṛṣṇa has only two. The expansions of the Lord who manifest such bodily differences are known as *vilāsa-vigrahas*.

TEXTS 69–70

eka-i vighraha yadi haya bahu-rūpa

ākāre ta' bheda nāhi, eka-i svarūpa

mahiṣī-vivāhe, yaiche yaiche kaila rāsa

ihāke kahiye kṛṣṇera mukhya 'prakāśa'

SYNONYMS

eka-i—the same one; *vigraha*—person; *yadi*—if; *haya*—becomes; *bahu-rūpa*—many forms; *ākāre*—in appearance; *ta'*—certainly; *bheda*—difference; *nāhi*—there is not; *eka-i*—one; *sva-rūpa*—identity; *mahiṣī*—with the queens of Dvārakā; *vivāhe*—in the marriage; *yaiche yaiche*—in a similar way; *kaila*—He did; *rāsa*—*rāsa* dance; *ihāke*—this; *kahiye*—I say; *kṛṣṇera*—of Kṛṣṇa; *mukhya*—principal; *prakāśa*—manifested forms.

TRANSLATION

When the Personality of Godhead expands Himself in many forms, all nondifferent in Their features, as Lord Kṛṣṇa did when He married sixteen thousand queens and when He performed His *rāsa* dance, such forms of the Lord are called manifested forms [*prakāśa-vigrahas*].

TEXT 71

citram bataitad ekena

vapuṣā yugapat prthak

grheṣu dvy-aṣṭa-sāhasram

striya eka udāvahat

SYNONYMS

citram—wonderful; *bata*—oh; *etat*—this; *ekena*—with one; *vapuṣā*—form; *yugapat*—simultaneously; *prthak*—separately; *grheṣu*—in the houses; *dvi-aṣṭa-sāhasram*—sixteen thousand; *striyaḥ*—all the queens; *ekah*—the one Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *udāvahat*—married.

TRANSLATION

“It is astounding that Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who is one without a second, expanded Himself in sixteen thousand similar forms to marry sixteen thousand queens in their respective homes.”

PURPORT

This verse is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.69.2).

TEXT 72

rāsotsavaḥ sampravṛtto

gopī-maṇḍala-maṇḍitaḥ

yogeśvareṇa kṛṣṇena

tāsām madhye dvayor dvayoḥ

SYNONYMS

rāsa-utsavaḥ—the festival of the *rāsa* dance; *sampravṛttaḥ*—was begun; *gopī-maṇḍala*—by groups of *gopīs*; *maṇḍitaḥ*—decorated; *yoga-īśvareṇa*—by the master of all mystic powers; *kṛṣṇena*—by Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tāsām*—of them; *madhye*—in the middle; *dvayor dvayoḥ*—of each two.

TRANSLATION

“When Lord Kṛṣṇa, surrounded by groups of cowherd girls, began the festivities of the *rāsa* dance, the Lord of all mystic powers placed Himself between each two girls.”

PURPORT

This verse is also quoted from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.33.3).

TEXTS 73–74

praviṣṭena grhītānām

kaṇṭhe sva-nikaṭam striyaḥ

yam manyeran nabhas tāvad

vimāna-śata-saṅkulam

divaukasām sa-dārāṇām

aty-autsukya-bhṛtātmanām

tato dundubhayo nedur

nipetuḥ puṣpa-vṛṣṭayaḥ

SYNONYMS

praviṣṭena—having entered; *grhītānām*—of those embracing; *kaṇṭhe*—on the neck; *sva-nikaṭam*—situated at their own side; *striyaḥ*—the *gopīs*; *yam*—whom; *manyeran*—would think; *nabhaḥ*—the sky; *tāvat*—at once; *vimāna*—of airplanes; *śata*—with hundreds; *saṅkulam*—crowded; *diva-okasām*—of the demigods; *sa-dārāṇām*—with their wives; *ati-autsukya*—with eagerness; *bhṛta-ātmanām*—whose minds were filled; *tataḥ*—then; *dundubhayaḥ*—kettledrums; *neduḥ*—sounded; *nipetuḥ*—fell; *puṣpa-vṛṣṭayaḥ*—showers of flowers.

TRANSLATION

“When the cowherd girls and Kṛṣṇa thus joined together, each girl thought that Kṛṣṇa was dearly embracing her alone. To behold this wonderful pastime of the Lord’s, the denizens of heaven and their wives, all very eager to see the dance, flew in the sky in their hundreds of

airplanes. They showered flowers and beat sweetly on drums.”

PURPORT

This is another quotation from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.33.3–4).

TEXT 75

anekatra prakāṭatā

rūpasyaikasya yaikadā

sarvathā tat-svarūpaiva

sa prakāśa itīryate

SYNONYMS

anekatra—in many places; *prakāṭatā*—the manifestation; *rūpasya*—of form; *ekasya*—one; *yā*—which; *ekadā*—at one time; *sarvathā*—in every respect; *tat*—His; *sva-rūpa*—own form; *eva*—certainly; *saḥ*—that; *prakāśaḥ*—manifestive form; *iti*—thus; *īryate*—it is called.

TRANSLATION

“If numerous forms, all equal in their features, are displayed simultaneously, such forms are called prakāśa-vigrahas of the Lord.”

PURPORT

This is a quotation from the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (1.21), compiled by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 76

eka-i vighraha kintu ākāre haya āna
aneka prakāśa haya, 'vilāsa' tāra nāma

SYNONYMS

eka-i—one; *vighraha*—form; *kintu*—but; *ākāre*—in appearance; *haya*—
is; *āna*—different; *aneka*—many; *prakāśa*—manifestations; *haya*—
appear; *vilāsa*—pastime form; *tāra*—of that; *nāma*—the name.

TRANSLATION

But when the numerous forms are slightly different from one another,
they are called vilāsa-vighrahas.

TEXT 77

svarūpam anyākāram yat

tasya bhāti vilāsataḥ

prāyeṇātma-samam śaktyā

sa vilāso nigadyate

SYNONYMS

sva-rūpam—the Lord's own form; *anya*—other; *ākāram*—features of the
body; *yat*—which; *tasya*—His; *bhāti*—appears; *vilāsataḥ*—from
particular pastimes; *prāyena*—almost; *ātma-samam*—self-similar;
śaktyā—by His potency; *saḥ*—that; *vilāsaḥ*—the *vilāsa* (pastime) form;
nigadyate—is called.

TRANSLATION

“When the Lord displays numerous forms with different features by His inconceivable potency, such forms are called vilāsa-vigrahas.”

PURPORT

This is another quotation from the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (1.15).

TEXT 78

yaiche baladeva, paravyome nārāyaṇa

yaiche vāsudeva pradyumnādi saṅkarṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

yaiche—just as; *baladeva*—Baladeva; *para-vyome*—in the spiritual sky; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *yaiche*—just as; *vāsudeva*—Vāsudeva; *pradyumna-ādi*—Pradyumna, etc.; *saṅkarṣaṇa*—Saṅkarṣaṇa.

TRANSLATION

Examples of such vilāsa-vigrahas are Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha-dhāma, and the catur-vyūha—Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha.

TEXTS 79–80

īśvarera śakti haya e-tina prakāra

eka lakṣmī-gaṇa, pure mahiṣī-gaṇa āra

vraje gopī-gaṇa āra sabhāte pradhāna

vrajendra-nandana yā'te svayaṁ bhagavān

SYNONYMS

īśvarera—of the Supreme Lord; *śakti*—energy; *haya*—is; *e-tina*—these three; *prakāra*—kinds; *eka*—one; *lakṣmī-gaṇa*—the goddesses of fortune in Vaikuṇṭha; *pure*—in Dvārakā; *mahiṣī-gaṇa*—the queens; *āra*—and; *vraje*—in Vṛndāvana; *gopī-gaṇa*—the *gopīs*; *āra*—and; *sabhāte*—among all of them; *pradhāna*—the chief; *vraja-indra-nandana*—Kṛṣṇa, the son of the King of Vraja; *yā'te*—because; *svayam*—Himself; *bhagavān*—the primeval Lord.

TRANSLATION

The energies [consorts] of the Supreme Lord are of three kinds: the Lakṣmīs in Vaikuṇṭha, the queens in Dvārakā and the gopīs in Vṛndāvana. The gopīs are the best of all, for they have the privilege of serving Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the primeval Lord, the son of the King of Vraja.

TEXT 81

svayam-rūpa kṛṣṇera kāya-vyūha—tānra sama

bhakta sahite haya tānhāra āvaraṇa

SYNONYMS

svayam-rūpa—His own original form (two-handed Kṛṣṇa); *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kāya-vyūha*—personal expansions; *tānra*—with Him; *sama*—equal; *bhakta*—the devotees; *sahite*—associated with; *haya*—are; *tānhāra*—His; *āvaraṇa*—covering.

TRANSLATION

The personal associates of the primeval Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, are His devotees, who are identical with Him. He is complete with His entourage of devotees.

PURPORT

Śrī Kṛṣṇa and His various personal expansions are nondifferent in potential power. These expansions are associated with further, secondary expansions, or servitor expansions, who are called devotees.

TEXT 82

bhakta ādi krame kaila sabhāra vandana

e-sabhāra vandana sarva-śubhera kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

bhakta—the devotees; *ādi*—and so on; *krame*—in order; *kaila*—did; *sabhāra*—of the assembly; *vandana*—worship; *e-sabhāra*—of this assembly; *vandana*—worship; *sarva-śubhera*—of all good fortune; *kāraṇa*—the source.

TRANSLATION

Now I have worshiped all the various levels of devotees. Worshiping them is the source of all good fortune.

PURPORT

To offer prayers to the Lord, one should first offer prayers to His devotees and associates.

TEXT 83

prathama śloke kahi sāmānya maṅgalācaraṇa

dvitīya śloke kari viśeṣa vandana

SYNONYMS

prathama—first; *śloke*—in the verse; *kahi*—I express; *sāmānya*—general; *maṅgala-ācaraṇa*—invocation of benediction; *dvitīya*—second; *śloketē*—in the verse; *kari*—I do; *viśeṣa*—particular; *vandana*—offering of prayers.

TRANSLATION

In the first verse I have invoked a general benediction, but in the second I have prayed to the Lord in a particular form.

TEXT 84

vande śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-

nityānandau sahoditau

gauḍodaye puṣpavantau

citrau śan-dau tamo-nudau

SYNONYMS

vande—I offer respectful obeisances; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—to Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *nityānandau*—and to Lord Nityānanda; *saha-uditau*—simultaneously arisen; *gauḍa-udaye*—on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa; *puṣpavantau*—the sun and moon together; *citrau*—wonderful; *śam-dau*—bestowing benediction; *tamaḥ-nudau*—dissipating darkness.

TRANSLATION

“I offer my respectful obeisances unto Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda, who are like the sun and moon. They have arisen simultaneously on the horizon of Gauḍa to dissipate the darkness of

ignorance and thus wonderfully bestow benediction upon all.”

TEXTS 85–86

vraje ye vihare pūrve kṛṣṇa-balarāma

koṭī-sūrya-candra jini doṇhāra nija-dhāma

sei dui jagatere ha-iyā sadaya

gauḍadeśe pūrva-śaile karilā udaya

SYNONYMS

vraje—in Vraja (Vṛndāvana); *ye*—who; *vihare*—played; *pūrve*—formerly; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *balarāma*—Lord Balarāma; *koṭī*—millions; *sūrya*—suns; *candra*—moons; *jini*—overcoming; *doṇhāra*—of the two; *nija-dhāma*—the effulgence; *sei*—these; *dui*—two; *jagatere*—for the universe; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *sa-daya*—compassionate; *gauḍadeśe*—in the country of Gauḍa; *pūrva-śaile*—on the eastern horizon; *karilā*—did; *udaya*—arise.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, the Personalities of Godhead, who formerly appeared in Vṛndāvana and were millions of times more effulgent than the sun and moon, have arisen over the eastern horizon of Gauḍadeśa [West Bengal], being compassionate for the fallen state of the world.

TEXT 87

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya āra prabhu nityānanda

yāñhāra prakāśe sarva jagat ānanda

SYNONYMS

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya—Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *āra*—and; *prabhu nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *yāñhāra*—of whom; *prakāśe*—on the appearance; *sarva*—all; *jagat*—the world; *ānanda*—full of happiness.

TRANSLATION

The appearance of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Prabhu Nityānanda has surcharged the world with happiness.

TEXTS 88–89

sūrya-candra hare yaiche saba andhakāra

vastu prakāśiyā kare dharmera pracāra

ei mata dui bhāi jīvera ajñāna-

tamo-nāśa kari' kaila tattva-vastu-dāna

SYNONYMS

sūrya-candra—the sun and the moon; *hare*—drive away; *yaiche*—just as; *saba*—all; *andhakāra*—darkness; *vastu*—truth; *prakāśiyā*—manifesting; *kare*—do; *dharmera*—of inborn nature; *pracāra*—preaching; *ei mata*—like this; *dui*—two; *bhāi*—brothers; *jīvera*—of the living being; *ajñāna*—of ignorance; *tamaḥ*—of the darkness; *nāśa*—destruction; *kari'*—doing; *kaila*—made; *tattva-vastu*—of the Absolute Truth; *dāna*—gift.

TRANSLATION

As the sun and moon drive away darkness by their appearance and reveal the nature of everything, these two brothers dissipate the darkness of

ignorance covering the living beings and enlighten them with knowledge of the Absolute Truth.

TEXT 90

ajñāna-tamera nāma kahiye 'kaitava'

dharma-artha-kāma-mokṣa-vāñchā ādi saba

SYNONYMS

ajñāna-tamera—of the darkness of ignorance; *nāma*—name; *kahiye*—I call; *kaitava*—cheating process; *dharma*—religiosity; *artha*—economic development; *kāma*—sense gratification; *mokṣa*—liberation; *vāñchā*—desire for; *ādi*—and so on; *saba*—all.

TRANSLATION

The darkness of ignorance is called kaitava, the way of cheating, which begins with religiosity, economic development, sense gratification and liberation.

TEXT 91

dharmaḥ projjhita-kaitavo 'tra paramo nirmatsarāṇām satām

vedyaṁ vāstavam atra vastu śiva-daṁ tāpa-trayonmūlanam

śrīmad-bhāgavate mahā-muni-kṛte kim vā parair īśvaraḥ

sadyo hṛdy avarudhyate 'tra kṛtibhiḥ śuśrūṣubhis tat-kṣaṇāt

SYNONYMS

dharmaḥ—religiosity; *projjhita*—completely rejected; *kaitavaḥ*—in

which fruitive intention; *atra*—herein; *paramaḥ*—the highest; *nirmatsarāṇām*—of the one-hundred-percent pure in heart; *satām*—devotees; *vedyam*—to be understood; *vāstavam*—factual; *atra*—herein; *vastu*—substance; *śiva-dam*—giving well-being; *tāpa-traya*—of the threefold miseries; *unmūlanam*—causing uprooting; *śrīmat*—beautiful; *bhāgavate*—in the *Bhāgavata Purāṇa*; *mahā-muni*—by the great sage (Vyāsadeva); *kṛte*—compiled; *kim*—what; *vā*—indeed; *paraiḥ*—with others; *īśvaraḥ*—the Supreme Lord; *sadyaḥ*—at once; *hṛdi*—within the heart; *avarudhyate*—becomes confined; *atra*—herein; *kṛtibhiḥ*—by pious men; *śuśrūṣubhiḥ*—desiring to hear; *tat-kṣaṇāt*—without delay.

TRANSLATION

“The great scripture Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, compiled by Mahā-muni Vyāsadeva from four original verses, describes the most elevated and kindhearted devotees and completely rejects the cheating ways of materially motivated religiosity. It propounds the highest principle of eternal religion, which can factually mitigate the threefold miseries of a living being and award the highest benediction of full prosperity and knowledge. Those willing to hear the message of this scripture in a submissive attitude of service can at once capture the Supreme Lord in their hearts. Therefore there is no need for any scripture other than Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam.”

PURPORT

This verse appears in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.1.2). The words *mahā-muni-kṛte* indicate that *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* was compiled by the great sage Vyāsadeva, who is sometimes known as Nārāyaṇa Mahā-muni because he is an incarnation of Nārāyaṇa. Vyāsadeva, therefore, is not an ordinary man but is empowered by the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He compiled the beautiful *Bhāgavatam* to narrate some of the pastimes of the Supreme Personality of Godhead and His devotees.

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, a distinction between real religion and

pretentious religion has been clearly made. According to this original and genuine commentation on the *Vedānta-sūtra*, there are numerous pretentious faiths that pass as religion but neglect the real essence of religion. The real religion of a living being is his natural inborn quality, whereas pretentious religion is a form of nescience that artificially covers a living entity's pure consciousness under certain unfavorable conditions. Real religion lies dormant when artificial religion dominates from the mental plane. A living being can awaken this dormant religion by hearing with a pure heart.

The path of religion prescribed by *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is different from all forms of imperfect religiosity. Religion can be considered in the following three divisions: (1) the path of fruitive work, (2) the path of knowledge and mystic powers, and (3) the path of worship and devotional service.

The path of fruitive work (*karma-kāṇḍa*), even when decorated by religious ceremonies meant to elevate one's material condition, is a cheating process because it can never enable one to gain relief from material existence and achieve the highest goal. A living entity perpetually struggles hard to rid himself of the pangs of material existence, but the path of fruitive work leads him to either temporary happiness or temporary distress in material existence. By pious fruitive work one is placed in a position where he can temporarily feel material happiness, whereas vicious activities lead him to a distressful position of material want and scarcity. However, even if one is put into the most perfect situation of material happiness, he cannot in that way become free from the pangs of birth, death, old age and disease. A materially happy person is therefore in need of the eternal relief that mundane religiosity in terms of fruitive work can never award.

The paths of the culture of knowledge (*jñāna-mārga*) and of mystic powers (*yoga-mārga*) are equally hazardous, for one does not know where one will go by following these uncertain methods. An empiric philosopher in search of spiritual knowledge may endeavor most laboriously for many,

many births in mental speculation, but unless and until he reaches the stage of the purest quality of goodness—in other words, until he transcends the plane of material speculation—it is not possible for him to know that everything emanates from the Personality of Godhead Vāsudeva. His attachment to the impersonal feature of the Supreme Lord makes him unfit to rise to that transcendental stage of *vasudeva* understanding, and therefore because of his unclean state of mind he glides down again into material existence, even after having ascended to the highest stage of liberation. This falldown takes place due to his want of a *locus standi* in the service of the Supreme Lord.

As far as the mystic powers of the *yogīs* are concerned, they are also material entanglements on the path of spiritual realization. One German scholar who became a devotee of Godhead in India said that material science had already made laudable progress in duplicating the mystic powers of the *yogīs*. He therefore came to India not to learn the methods of the *yogīs*' mystic powers but to learn the path of transcendental loving service to the Supreme Lord, as mentioned in the great scripture *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. Mystic powers can make a *yogī* materially powerful and thus give temporary relief from the miseries of birth, death, old age and disease, as other material sciences can also do, but such mystic powers can never be a permanent source of relief from these miseries. Therefore, according to the *Bhāgavata* school, this path of religiosity is also a method of cheating its followers. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is clearly defined that the most elevated and powerful mystic *yogī* is one who can constantly think of the Supreme Lord within his heart and engage in the loving service of the Lord.

The path of worship of the innumerable *devas*, or administrative demigods, is still more hazardous and uncertain than the above-mentioned processes of *karma-kāṇḍa* and *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. This system of worshiping many gods, such as Durgā, Śiva, Gaṇeśa, Sūrya and the impersonal Viṣṇu form, is accepted by persons who have been blinded by an intense desire for sense gratification. When properly executed in terms of the rites mentioned in the *sāstras*, which are now very difficult to perform in this

age of want and scarcity, such worship can certainly fulfill one's desires for sense gratification, but the success obtained by such methods is certainly transient, and it is suitable only for a less intelligent person. That is the verdict of the *Bhagavad-gītā*. No sane man should be satisfied by such temporary benefits.

None of the above-mentioned three religious paths can deliver a person from the threefold miseries of material existence, namely, miseries caused by the body and mind, miseries caused by other living entities, and miseries caused by the demigods. The process of religion described in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, however, is able to give its followers permanent relief from the threefold miseries. The *Bhāgavatam* describes the highest religious form—reinstatement of the living entity in his original position of transcendental loving service to the Supreme Lord, which is free from the infections of desires for sense gratification, fruitive work, and the culture of knowledge with the aim of merging into the Absolute to become one with the Supreme Lord.

Any process of religiosity based on sense gratification, gross or subtle, must be considered a pretentious religion because it is unable to give perpetual protection to its followers. The word *projjhita* is significant. *Pra-* means “complete,” and *ujjhita* indicates rejection. Religiosity in the shape of fruitive work is directly a method of gross sense gratification, whereas the process of culturing spiritual knowledge with a view to becoming one with the Absolute is a method of subtle sense gratification. All such pretentious religiosity based on gross or subtle sense gratification is completely rejected in the process of *bhāgavata-dharma*, or the transcendental religion that is the eternal function of the living being.

Bhāgavata-dharma, or the religious principle described in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, of which the *Bhagavad-gītā* is a preliminary study, is meant for liberated persons of the highest order, who attribute very little value to the sense gratification of pretentious religiosity. The first and foremost concern of fruitive workers, elevationists, empiric philosophers and salvationists is to raise their material position. But devotees of Godhead

have no such selfish desires. They serve the Supreme Lord only for His satisfaction. Śrī Arjuna, wanting to satisfy his senses by becoming a so-called nonviolent and pious man, at first decided not to fight. But when he was fully situated in the principles of *bhāgavata-dharma*, culminating in complete surrender unto the will of the Supreme Lord, he changed his decision and agreed to fight for the satisfaction of the Lord. He then said:

*naṣṭo mohaḥ smṛtir labdhā
tvat-prasādān mayācyuta
sthito 'smi gata-sandehaḥ
kariṣye vacanaṁ tava*

“My dear Kṛṣṇa, O infallible one, my illusion is now gone. I have regained my memory by Your mercy. I am now firm and free from doubt and am prepared to act according to Your instructions.” (Bg. 18.73) It is the constitutional position of the living entity to be situated in this pure consciousness. Any so-called religious process that interferes with this unadulterated spiritual position of the living being must therefore be considered a pretentious process of religiosity.

The real form of religion is spontaneous loving service to Godhead. This relationship of the living being with the Absolute Personality of Godhead in service is eternal. The Personality of Godhead is described as *vastu*, or the Substance, and the living entities are described as *vāstavas*, or the innumerable samples of the Substance in relative existence. The relationship of these substantive portions with the Supreme Substance can never be annihilated, for it is an eternal quality inherent in the living being.

By contact with material nature the living entities exhibit varied symptoms of the disease of material consciousness. To cure this material disease is the supreme object of human life. The process that treats this disease is called *bhāgavata-dharma*, or *sanātana-dharma*—real religion. This is described in the pages of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. Therefore anyone who, because of his background of pious activities in previous lives, is

anxious to hear *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* immediately realizes the presence of the Supreme Lord within his heart and fulfills the mission of his life.

TEXT 92

tāra madhye mokṣa-vāñchā kaitava-pradhāna

yāhā haite kṛṣṇa-bhakti haya antardhāna

SYNONYMS

tāra—of them; *madhye*—in the midst; *mokṣa-vāñchā*—the desire to merge into the Supreme; *kaitava*—of cheating processes; *pradhāna*—the chief; *yāhā haite*—from which; *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*—devotion to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *haya*—becomes; *antardhāna*—disappearance.

TRANSLATION

The foremost process of cheating is to desire to achieve liberation by merging into the Supreme, for this causes the permanent disappearance of loving service to Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The desire to merge into the impersonal Brahman is the subtlest type of atheism. As soon as such atheism, disguised in the dress of liberation, is encouraged, one becomes completely unable to traverse the path of devotional service to the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 93

“pra-sābdena mokṣābhisandhir api nirastaḥ” iti

SYNONYMS

pra-śabdena—by the prefix *pra*; *mokṣa-abhisandhiḥ*—the intention of liberation; *api*—certainly; *nirastaḥ*—nullified; *iti*—thus.

TRANSLATION

“The prefix ‘pra’ [in the verse from Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam] indicates that the desire for liberation is completely rejected.”

PURPORT

This is an annotation by Śrīdhara Svāmī, the great commentator on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*.

TEXT 94

kṛṣṇa-bhaktira bādhaka—yata śubhāśubha karma

seha eka jīvera ajñāna-tamo-dharma

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-bhaktira—of devotional service to Kṛṣṇa; *bādhaka*—hindrance; *yata*—all; *śubha-aśubha*—auspicious or inauspicious; *karma*—activity; *seha*—that; *eka*—one; *jīvera*—of the living entity; *ajñāna-tamaḥ*—of the darkness of ignorance; *dharma*—the character.

TRANSLATION

All kinds of activities, both auspicious and inauspicious, that are detrimental to the discharge of transcendental loving service to Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa are actions of the darkness of ignorance.

PURPORT

The poetical comparison of Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda to the

sun and moon is very significant. The living entities are spiritual sparks, and their constitutional position is to render devotional service to the Supreme Lord in full Kṛṣṇa consciousness. So-called pious activities and other ritualistic performances, pious or impious, as well as the desire to escape from material existence, are all considered to be coverings of these spiritual sparks. The living entities must get free from these superfluous coverings and fully engage in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. The purpose of the appearance of Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda is to dispel the darkness of the soul. Before Their appearance, all these superfluous activities of the living entities were covering Kṛṣṇa consciousness, but after the appearance of these two brothers, people's hearts are becoming cleansed, and they are again becoming situated in the real position of Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

TEXT 95

yāñhāra prasāde ei tamo haya nāśa

tamo nāśa kari' kare tattvera prakāśa

SYNONYMS

yāñhāra—whose; *prasāde*—by the grace; *ei*—this; *tamaḥ*—darkness; *haya*—is; *nāśa*—destroyed; *tamaḥ*—darkness; *nāśa*—destruction; *kari'*—doing; *kare*—does; *tattvera*—of the truth; *prakāśa*—discovery.

TRANSLATION

By the grace of Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda, this darkness of ignorance is removed and the truth is brought to light.

TEXT 96

tattva-vastu——*kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa-bhakti, prema-rūpa*

nāma-saṅkīrtana—*saba ānanda-svarūpa*

SYNONYMS

tattva-vastu—Absolute Truth; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*—devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prema-rūpa*—taking the form of love for Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nāma-saṅkīrtana*—congregational chanting of the holy name; *saba*—all; *ānanda*—of bliss; *svarūpa*—the identity.

TRANSLATION

The Absolute Truth is Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and loving devotion to Śrī Kṛṣṇa exhibited in pure love is achieved through congregational chanting of the holy name, which is the essence of all bliss.

TEXT 97

sūrya candra bāhirera tamaḥ se vināśe

bahir-vastu ghaṭa-paṭa-ādi se prakāśe

SYNONYMS

sūrya—the sun; *candra*—the moon; *bāhirera*—of the external world; *tamaḥ*—darkness; *se*—they; *vināśe*—destroy; *bahir-vastu*—external things; *ghaṭa*—waterpots; *paṭa-ādi*—plates, etc.; *se*—they; *prakāśe*—reveal.

TRANSLATION

The sun and moon dissipate the darkness of the external world and thus reveal external material objects like pots and plates.

TEXT 98

dui bhāi hṛdayera kṣāli' andhakāra

dui bhāgavata-saṅge karāna sākṣātkāra

SYNONYMS

dui—two; *bhāi*—brothers; *hṛdayera*—of the heart; *kṣāli'*—purifying; *andhakāra*—darkness; *dui bhāgavata*—of the two *bhāgavatas*; *saṅge*—by the association; *karāna*—cause; *sākṣāt-kāra*—a meeting.

TRANSLATION

But these two brothers [Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda] dissipate the darkness of the inner core of the heart, and thus They help one meet the two kinds of *bhāgavatas* [persons or things in relationship with the Personality of Godhead].

TEXT 99

eka bhāgavata baḍa—bhāgavata-śāstra

āra bhāgavata—bhakta bhakti-rasa-pātra

SYNONYMS

eka—one; *bhāgavata*—in relation to the Supreme Lord; *baḍa*—great; *bhāgavata-śāstra*—*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *āra*—the other; *bhāgavata*—in relation to the Supreme Lord; *bhakta*—pure devotee; *bhakti-rasa*—of the mellow of devotion; *pātra*—the recipient.

TRANSLATION

One of the *bhāgavatas* is the great scripture *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and the other is the pure devotee absorbed in the mellows of loving devotion.

TEXT 100

dui bhāgavata dvārā diyā bhakti-rasa

tāñhāra hṛdaye tāñra preme haya vaśa

SYNONYMS

dui—two; *bhāgavata*—the *bhāgavatas*; *dvārā*—by; *diyā*—giving; *bhakti-rasa*—devotional inspiration; *tāñhāra*—of His devotee; *hṛdaye*—in the heart; *tāñra*—his; *preme*—by the love; *haya*—becomes; *vaśa*—under control.

TRANSLATION

Through the actions of these two bhāgavatas the Lord instills the mellows of transcendental loving service into the heart of a living being, and thus the Lord, in the heart of His devotee, comes under the control of the devotee's love.

TEXT 101

eka adbhuta—sama-kāle donhāra prakāśa

āra adbhuta—citta-guhāra tamaḥ kare nāśa

SYNONYMS

eka—one; *adbhuta*—wonderful thing; *sama-kāle*—at the same time; *donhāra*—of both; *prakāśa*—the manifestation; *āra*—the other; *adbhuta*—wonderful thing; *citta-guhāra*—of the core of the heart; *tamaḥ*—darkness; *kare*—do; *nāśa*—destruction.

TRANSLATION

The first wonder is that both brothers appear simultaneously, and the other is that They illuminate the innermost depths of the heart.

TEXT 102

ei candra sūrya dui parama sadaya

jagatera bhāgye gaude karilā udaya

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *candra*—moon; *sūrya*—sun; *dui*—two; *parama*—very much; *sa-daya*—kind; *jagatera*—of the people of the world; *bhāgye*—for the fortune; *gaude*—in the land of Gauḍa; *karilā*—did; *udaya*—appearance.

TRANSLATION

These two, the sun and moon, are very kind to the people of the world. Thus for the good fortune of all, They have appeared on the horizon of Bengal.

PURPORT

The celebrated ancient capital of the Sena dynasty, which was known as Gauḍadeśa or Gauḍa, was situated in what is now the modern district of Maldah. Later this capital was transferred to the ninth or central island on the western side of the Ganges at Navadvīpa, which is now known as Māyāpur and was then called Gauḍapura. Lord Caitanya appeared there, and Lord Nityānanda came there and joined Him from the district of Birbhum. They appeared on the horizon of Gauḍadeśa to spread the science of Kṛṣṇa consciousness, and it is predicted that as the sun and moon gradually move west, the movement They began five hundred years ago will come to the Western civilizations by Their mercy.

Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu drive away the five kinds

of ignorance of the conditioned souls. In the *Mahābhārata, Udyoga-parva*, Forty-third Chapter, these five kinds of ignorance are described. They are (1) accepting the body to be the self, (2) making material sense gratification one's standard of enjoyment, (3) being anxious due to material identification, (4) lamenting and (5) thinking that there is anything beyond the Absolute Truth. The teachings of Lord Caitanya eradicate these five kinds of ignorance. Whatever one sees or otherwise experiences one should know to be simply an exhibition of the Supreme Personality of Godhead's energy. Everything is a manifestation of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 103

sei dui prabhura kari caraṇa vandana

yāñhā ha-ite vighna-nāśa abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa

SYNONYMS

sei—these; *dui*—two; *prabhura*—of the Lords; *kari*—I do; *caraṇa*—feet; *vandana*—obeisance; *yāñhā ha-ite*—from which; *vighna-nāśa*—destruction of obstacles; *abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa*—fulfillment of desires.

TRANSLATION

Let us therefore worship the holy feet of these two Lords. Thus one can be rid of all difficulties on the path of self-realization.

TEXT 104

ei dui śloke kaila maṅgala-vandana

tr̥tīya ślokerā artha śuna sarva-jana

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *dui*—two; *śloke*—in the verses; *kaila*—I did; *maṅgala*—auspicious; *vandana*—obeisance; *ṭṭīya*—third; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—meaning; *śuna*—please hear; *sarva-jana*—everyone.

TRANSLATION

I have invoked the benediction of the Lords with these two verses [texts 1 and 2 of this chapter]. Now please hear attentively the purport of the third verse.

TEXT 105

vaktavya-bāhulya, grantha-vistārera dare

vistāre nā varṇi, sārārtha kahi alpākṣare

SYNONYMS

vaktavya—of words to be spoken; *bāhulya*—elaboration; *grantha*—of the book; *vistārera*—of the big volume; *dare*—in fear; *vistāre*—in expanded form; *nā*—not; *varṇi*—I describe; *sāra-artha*—essential meaning; *kahi*—I say; *alpa-akṣare*—in few words.

TRANSLATION

I purposely avoid extensive description for fear of increasing the bulk of this book. I shall describe the essence as concisely as possible.

TEXT 106

“mitam ca sāram ca vaco hi vāgmitā” iti

SYNONYMS

mitam—concise; *ca*—and; *sāram*—essential; *ca*—and; *vacaḥ*—speech;

hi—certainly; *vāgmitā*—eloquence; *iti*—thus.

TRANSLATION

“Essential truth spoken concisely is true eloquence.”

TEXT 107

śunile khaṇḍibe cittera ajñānādi doṣa

kṛṣṇe gāḍha prema habe, pāibe santoṣa

SYNONYMS

śunile—on one’s hearing; *khaṇḍibe*—will remove; *cittera*—of the heart; *ajñāna-ādi*—of ignorance, etc.; *doṣa*—the faults; *kṛṣṇe*—in Lord Kṛṣṇa; *gāḍha*—deep; *prema*—love; *habe*—there will be; *pāibe*—will obtain; *santoṣa*—satisfaction.

TRANSLATION

Simply hearing submissively will free one’s heart from all the faults of ignorance, and thus one will achieve deep love for Kṛṣṇa. This is the path of peace.

TEXTS 108–109

śrī-caitanya-nityānanda-advaita-mahattva

tānra bhakta-bhakti-nāma-prema-rasa-tattva

bhinna bhinna likhiyāchi kariyā vicāra

śunile jānibe saba vastu-tattva-sāra

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānanda*—of Lord Nityānanda; *advaita*—of Śrī Advaita; *mahattva*—greatness; *tāñra*—Their; *bhakta*—devotees; *bhakti*—devotion; *nāma*—names; *prema*—love; *rasa*—mellows; *tattva*—real nature; *bhinna bhinna*—different; *likhiyāchi*—I wrote; *kariyā*—doing; *vicāra*—consideration; *śunīle*—on hearing; *jāñibe*—will know; *saba*—all; *vastu-tattva-sāra*—the essence of the Absolute Truth.

TRANSLATION

If one patiently hears about the glories of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu and Śrī Advaita Prabhu—and Their devotees, devotional activities, names and fame, along with the mellows of Their transcendental loving exchanges—one will learn the essence of the Absolute Truth. Therefore I have described these [in the Caitanya-caritāmṛta] with logic and discrimination.

TEXT 110

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring

their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādī-līlā, First Chapter, describing the spiritual masters.

Chapter 2

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Supreme Personality of Godhead

This chapter explains that Lord Caitanya is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa Himself. Therefore, the Brahman effulgence is the bodily luster of Lord Caitanya, and the localized Supersoul situated in the heart of every living entity is His partial representation. The *puruṣa-avatāras* are also explained in this connection. Mahā-Viṣṇu is the reservoir of all conditioned souls, but, as confirmed in the authoritative scriptures, Lord Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate fountainhead, the source of numerous plenary expansions, including Nārāyaṇa, who is generally accepted by Māyāvādī philosophers to be the Absolute Truth. The Lord's manifestation of *prābhava* and *vaibhava* expansions, as well as partial incarnations and incarnations with delegated powers, are also explained. Lord Kṛṣṇa's ages of boyhood and youth are discussed, and it is explained that His age at the beginning of youth is His eternal form.

The spiritual sky contains innumerable spiritual planets, the Vaikuṇṭhas, which are manifestations of the Supreme Lord's internal energy.

Innumerable material universes are similarly exhibited by His external energy, and the living entities are manifested by His marginal energy. Because Lord Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is not different from Lord Kṛṣṇa, He is the cause of all causes; there is no cause beyond Him. He is eternal, and His form is spiritual. Lord Caitanya is directly the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa, as the evidence of authoritative scriptures proves. This chapter stresses that a devotee who wishes to advance in Kṛṣṇa consciousness must have

knowledge of Kṛṣṇa's personal form, His three principal energies, His pastimes and the relationship of the living entities with Him.

TEXT 1

śrī-caitanya-prabhum vande

bālo 'pi yad-anugrahāt

taren nānā-mata-grāha-

vyāptam siddhānta-sāgaram

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya-prabhum—to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *vande*—I offer obeisances; *bālaḥ*—an ignorant child; *api*—even; *yat*—of whom; *anugrahāt*—by the mercy; *taret*—may cross over; *nānā*—various; *mata*—of theories; *grāha*—the crocodiles; *vyāptam*—filled with; *siddhānta*—of conclusions; *sāgaram*—the ocean.

TRANSLATION

I offer my obeisances to Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by whose mercy even an ignorant child can swim across the ocean of conclusive truth, which is full of the crocodiles of various theories.

PURPORT

By the mercy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, even an inexperienced boy with no educational culture can be saved from the ocean of nescience, which is full of various types of philosophical doctrines that are like dangerous aquatic animals. The philosophy of the Buddha, the argumentative presentations of the *jñānīs*, the *yoga* systems of Patañjali and Gautama, and the systems of

philosophers like Kaṇāda, Kapila and Dattātreya are dangerous creatures in the ocean of nescience. By the grace of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu one can have real understanding of the essence of knowledge by avoiding these sectarian views and accepting the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa as the ultimate goal of life. Let us all worship Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu for His gracious mercy to the conditioned souls.

TEXT 2

kṛṣṇotkīrtana-gāna-nartana-kalā-pāthojani-bhrājitā

sad-bhaktāvali-haṁsa-cakra-madhupa-śreṇī-vihārāspadam

karṇānandi-kala-dhvanir vahatu me jihvā-maru-prāṅgaṇe

śrī-caitanya dayā-nidhe tava lasal-līlā-sudhā-svardhunī

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—of the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *utkīrtana*—loud chanting; *gāna*—singing; *nartana*—dancing; *kalā*—of the other fine arts; *pāthajani*—with lotuses; *bhrājitā*—beautified; *sat-bhakta*—of pure devotees; *āvali*—rows; *haṁsa*—of swans; *cakra*—*cakravāka* birds; *madhu-pa*—and bumble bees; *śreṇī*—like swarms; *vihāra*—of pleasure; *āspadam*—the abode; *karṇa-ānandi*—gladdening the ears; *kala*—melodious; *dhvaniḥ*—sound; *vahatu*—let it flow; *me*—my; *jihvā*—of the tongue; *maru*—desertlike; *prāṅgaṇe*—in the courtyard; *śrī-caitanya dayā-nidhe*—O Lord Caitanya, ocean of mercy; *tava*—of You; *lasat*—shining; *līlā-sudhā*—of the nectar of the pastimes; *svardhunī*—the Ganges.

TRANSLATION

O my merciful Lord Caitanya, may the nectarean Ganges waters of Your transcendental activities flow on the surface of my desertlike tongue. Beautifying these waters are the lotus flowers of singing, dancing and

loud chanting of Kṛṣṇa's holy name, which are the pleasure abodes of unalloyed devotees. These devotees are compared to swans, ducks and bees. The river's flowing produces a melodious sound that gladdens their ears.

PURPORT

Our tongues always engage in vibrating useless sounds that do not help us realize transcendental peace. The tongue is compared to a desert because a desert needs a constant supply of refreshing water to make it fertile and fruitful. Water is the substance most needed in the desert. The transient pleasure derived from mundane topics of art, culture, politics, sociology, dry philosophy, poetry and so on is compared to a mere drop of water because although such topics have a qualitative feature of transcendental pleasure, they are saturated with the modes of material nature. Therefore neither collectively nor individually can they satisfy the vast requirements of the desertlike tongue. Despite crying in various conferences, therefore, the desertlike tongue continues to be parched. For this reason, people from all parts of the world must call for the devotees of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who are compared to swans swimming around the beautiful lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu or bees humming around His lotus feet in transcendental pleasure, searching for honey. The dryness of material happiness cannot be moistened by so-called philosophers who cry for Brahman, liberation and similar dry speculative objects. The urge of the soul proper is different. The soul can be solaced only by the mercy of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His many bona fide devotees, who never leave the lotus feet of the Lord to become imitation Mahāprabhus but all cling to His lotus feet like bees that never leave a honey-soaked lotus flower.

Lord Caitanya's movement of Kṛṣṇa consciousness is full of dancing and singing about the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa. It is compared herein to the pure waters of the Ganges, which are full of lotus flowers. The enjoyers of these lotus flowers are the pure devotees, who are like bees and swans. They chant like the flowing of the Ganges, the river of the celestial

kingdom. The author desires such sweetly flowing waves to cover his tongue. He humbly compares himself to materialistic persons who always engage in dry talk from which they derive no satisfaction. If they were to use their dry tongues to chant the holy name of the Lord—Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare—as exemplified by Lord Caitanya, they would taste sweet nectar and enjoy life.

TEXT 3

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glory; *śrī-caitanya*—to Lord Caitanya; *jaya*—all glory; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda; *jaya*—all glory; *advaita-candra*—to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya*—all glory; *gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—to the devotees of Lord Gaurāṅga.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Lord Śrī Nityānanda!
All glories to Advaitacandra, and all glories to the devotees of Lord Gaurāṅga!

TEXT 4

tṛtīya ślokerā artha kari vivaraṇa

vastu-nirdeśa-rūpa maṅgalācaraṇa

SYNONYMS

tṛtīya—third; *śloka*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *kari*—I do; *vivaraṇa*—description; *vastu*—of the Absolute Truth; *nirdeśa-rūpa*—in the form of delineation; *maṅgala*—auspicious; *ācaraṇa*—conduct.

TRANSLATION

Let me describe the meaning of the third verse [of the first fourteen]. It is an auspicious vibration that describes the Absolute Truth.

TEXT 5

yad advaitam brahmopaniṣadi tad apy asya tanu-bhā

ya ātmāntar-yāmī puruṣa iti so 'syāṁśa-vibhavaḥ

ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ pūrṇo ya iha bhagavān sa svayam ayam

na caitanyāt kṛṣṇāj jagati para-tattvam param iha

SYNONYMS

yat—that which; *advaitam*—without a second; *brahma*—the impersonal Brahman; *upaniṣadi*—in the *Upaniṣads*; *tat*—that; *api*—certainly; *asya*—His; *tanu-bhā*—the effulgence of His transcendental body; *yaḥ*—who; *ātmā*—the Supersoul; *antaḥ-yāmī*—indwelling Lord ; *puruṣaḥ*—the supreme enjoyer; *iti*—thus; *saḥ*—He; *asya*—His; *amśa-vibhavaḥ*—expansion of a plenary portion; *ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ*—with the six opulences; *pūrṇaḥ*—full; *yaḥ*—who; *iha*—here; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *saḥ*—He; *svayam*—Himself; *ayam*—this one; *na*—not; *caitanyāt*—than Lord Caitanya; *kṛṣṇāt*—than Lord Kṛṣṇa; *jagati*—in the world; *para*—higher; *tattvam*—truth; *param*—another; *iha*—here.

TRANSLATION

What the Upaniṣads describe as the impersonal Brahman is but the effulgence of His body, and the Lord known as the Supersoul is but His localized plenary portion. Lord Caitanya is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa Himself, full with six opulences. He is the Absolute Truth, and no other truth is greater than or equal to Him.

PURPORT

The compilers of the *Upaniṣads* speak very highly of the impersonal Brahman. The *Upaniṣads*, which are considered the most elevated portion of the Vedic literatures, are meant for persons who desire to get free from material association and who therefore approach a bona fide spiritual master for enlightenment. The prefix *upa-* indicates that one must receive knowledge about the Absolute Truth from a spiritual master. One who has faith in his spiritual master actually receives transcendental instruction, and as his attachment for material life slackens, he is able to advance on the spiritual path. Knowledge of the transcendental science of the *Upaniṣads* can free one from the entanglement of existence in the material world, and when thus liberated, one can be elevated to the spiritual kingdom of the Supreme Personality of Godhead by advancement in spiritual life.

The beginning of spiritual enlightenment is realization of impersonal Brahman. Such realization is effected by gradual negation of material variegatedness. Impersonal Brahman realization is the partial, distant experience of the Absolute Truth that one achieves through the rational approach. It is compared to one's seeing a hill from a distance and taking it to be a smoky cloud. A hill is not a smoky cloud, but it appears to be one from a distance because of our imperfect vision. In imperfect or smoky realization of the Absolute Truth, spiritual variegatedness is conspicuous by its absence. This experience is therefore called *advaita-vāda*, or realization of the oneness of the Absolute.

The impersonal glowing effulgence of Brahman consists only of the personal bodily rays of the Supreme Godhead, Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Since Śrī

Gaurasundara, or Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, is identical with Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself, the Brahman effulgence consists of the rays of His transcendental body.

Similarly, the Supersoul, which is called the Paramātmā, is a plenary representation of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The *antar-yāmī*, the Supersoul in everyone's heart, is the controller of all living entities. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.15), wherein Lord Kṛṣṇa says, *sarvasya cāhaṁ hṛdi sanniviṣṭaḥ*: "I am situated in everyone's heart." The *Bhagavad-gītā* (5.29) also states, *bhoktāraṁ yajña-tapasāṁ sarva-loka-maheśvaram*, indicating that the Supreme Lord, acting in His expansion as the Supersoul, is the proprietor of everything. Similarly, the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.35) states, *aṇḍāntara-stha-paramāṇu-cayāntara-stham*. The Lord is present everywhere, within the heart of every living entity and within each and every atom as well. Thus by this Supersoul feature the Lord is all-pervading.

Furthermore, Lord Caitanya is also the master of all wealth, strength, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation because He is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself. He is described as *pūrṇa*, or complete. In the feature of Lord Caitanya, the Lord is an ideal renouncer, just as Śrī Rāma was an ideal king. Lord Caitanya accepted the order of *sannyāsa* and exemplified exceedingly wonderful principles in His own life. No one can compare to Him in the order of *sannyāsa*. Although in Kali-yuga acceptance of the *sannyāsa* order is generally forbidden, Lord Caitanya accepted it because He is complete in renunciation. Others cannot imitate Him but can only follow in His footsteps as far as possible. Those who are unfit for this order of life are strictly forbidden by the injunctions of the *śāstras* to accept it. Lord Caitanya, however, is complete in renunciation as well as all other opulences. He is therefore the highest principle of the Absolute Truth.

By an analytical study of the truth of Lord Caitanya, one will find that He is not different from the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa; no one is greater than or even equal to Him. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.7) Lord

Kṛṣṇa says to Arjuna, *mattaḥ parataram nānyat kiñcid asti dhanañjaya*: “O conqueror of wealth [Arjuna], there is no truth superior to Me.” Thus it is here confirmed that there is no truth higher than Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

The impersonal Brahman is the goal of those who cultivate the study of books of transcendental knowledge, and the Supersoul is the goal of those who perform the *yoga* practices. One who knows the Supreme Personality of Godhead surpasses realization of both Brahman and Paramātmā because Bhagavān is the ultimate platform of absolute knowledge.

The Personality of Godhead is the complete form of *sac-cid-ānanda* (full life, knowledge and bliss). By realization of the *sat* portion of the Complete Whole (unlimited existence), one realizes the impersonal Brahman aspect of the Lord. By realization of the *cit* portion of the Complete Whole (unlimited knowledge), one can realize the localized aspect of the Lord, the Paramātmā. But neither of these partial realizations of the Complete Whole can help one realize *ānanda*, or complete bliss. Without such realization of *ānanda*, knowledge of the Absolute Truth is incomplete.

This verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī is confirmed by a parallel statement in the *Tattva-sandarbha*, by Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī. In the Ninth Part of the *Tattva-sandarbha* it is said that the Absolute Truth is sometimes approached as impersonal Brahman, which, although spiritual, is only a partial representation of the Absolute Truth. Nārāyaṇa, the predominating Deity in Vaikuṇṭha, is to be known as an expansion of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, but Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Absolute Truth, the object of the transcendental love of all living entities.

TEXT 6

brahma, ātmā, bhagavān— —anuvāda tina

aṅga-prabhā, aṁśa, svarūpa— —tina vidheya-cihna

SYNONYMS

brahma—the impersonal Brahman; *ātmā*—the localized Paramātmā; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *anuvāda*—subjects; *tina*—three; *aṅga-prabhā*—bodily effulgence; *aṁśa*—partial manifestation; *svarūpa*—original form; *tina*—three; *vidheya-cihna*—predicates.

TRANSLATION

Impersonal Brahman, the localized Paramātmā and the Personality of Godhead are three subjects, and the glowing effulgence, the partial manifestation and the original form are their three respective predicates.

TEXT 7

anuvāda āge, pāche vidheya sthāpana

sei artha kahi, śuna śāstra-vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

anuvāda—the subject; *āge*—first; *pāche*—afterwards; *vidheya*—the predicate; *sthāpana*—placing; *sei*—this; *artha*—the meaning; *kahi*—I speak; *śuna*—please listen; *śāstra-vivaraṇa*—to the description of the scriptures.

TRANSLATION

A predicate always follows its subject. Now I shall explain the meaning of this verse according to the revealed scriptures.

TEXT 8

svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa, viṣṇu-paratattva

pūrṇa-jñāna pūrṇānanda parama mahattva

SYNONYMS

svayam—Himself; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *viṣṇu*—of all-pervading Viṣṇu; *para-tattva*—the ultimate truth; *pūrṇa-jñāna*—full knowledge; *pūrṇa-ānanda*—full bliss; *parama*—supreme; *mahattva*—greatness.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa, the original form of the Personality of Godhead, is the summum bonum of the all-pervading Viṣṇu. He is all-perfect knowledge and all-perfect bliss. He is the Supreme Transcendence.

TEXT 9

‘nanda-suta’ bali’ yāñre bhāgavate gāi

sei kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa caitanya-gosāñi

SYNONYMS

nanda-suta—the son of Nanda Mahārāja; *bali’*—as; *yāñre*—who; *bhāgavate*—in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *gāi*—is sung; *sei*—that; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatīrṇa*—descended; *caitanya-gosāñi*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

He whom Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam describes as the son of Nanda Mahārāja has descended to earth as Lord Caitanya.

PURPORT

According to the rules of rhetorical arrangement for efficient composition in literature, a subject should be mentioned before its predicate. The Vedic literature frequently mentions Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān, and therefore these three terms are widely known as the subjects of transcendental understanding. But it is not widely known that what is approached as the impersonal Brahman is the effulgence of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's transcendental body. Nor is it widely known that the Supersoul, or Paramātmā, is only a partial representation of Lord Caitanya, who is identical with Bhagavān Himself. Therefore the descriptions of Brahman as the effulgence of Lord Caitanya, the Paramātmā as His partial representation, and the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa as identical with Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu must be verified by evidence from authoritative Vedic literatures.

The author wants to establish first that the essence of the *Vedas* is the *viṣṇu-tattva*, the Absolute Truth, Viṣṇu, the all-pervading Godhead. The *viṣṇu-tattva* has different categories, of which the highest is Lord Kṛṣṇa, the ultimate *viṣṇu-tattva*, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* and throughout the Vedic literature. In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* the same Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa is described as Nanda-suta, the son of King Nanda. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī says that Nandasuta has again appeared as Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and he bases this statement on his understanding that the Vedic literature concludes there is no difference between Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. This the author will prove. If it is thus proved that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the origin of all *tattvas* (truths), namely Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān, and that there is no difference between Śrī Kṛṣṇa and Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, it will not be difficult to understand that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is also the same origin of all *tattvas*. The same Absolute Truth, as He is revealed to students of different realizations, is called Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān.

TEXT 10

prakāśa-viśeṣe teṇha dhare tina nāma

brahma, paramātmā āra svayaṁ-bhagavān

SYNONYMS

prakāśa—of manifestation; *viśeṣa*—in variety; *teṇha*—He; *dhare*—holds; *tina*—three; *nāma*—names; *brahma*—Brahman; *paramātmā*—Paramātmā (Supersoul); *āra*—and; *svayaṁ*—Himself; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

In terms of His various manifestations, He is known in three features, called the impersonal Brahman, the localized Paramātmā and the original Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī has explained the word *bhagavān* in his *Bhagavat-sandarbhā*. The Personality of Godhead, being full of all conceivable and inconceivable potencies, is the absolute Supreme Whole. Impersonal Brahman is a partial manifestation of the Absolute Truth realized in the absence of such complete potencies. The first syllable of the word *bhagavān* is *bha*, which means “sustainer” and “protector.” The next letter, *ga*, means “leader,” “pusher” and “creator.” *Va* means “dwelling” (all living beings dwell in the Supreme Lord, and the Supreme Lord dwells within the heart of every living being). Combining all these concepts, the word *bhagavān* carries the import of inconceivable potency in knowledge, energy, strength, opulence, power and influence, devoid of all varieties of inferiority. Without such inconceivable potencies, one cannot fully sustain or protect. Our modern civilization is sustained by scientific arrangements devised by many great scientific brains. We can just imagine, therefore, the gigantic brain whose arrangements sustain the gravity of the unlimited number of planets and satellites and who creates the unlimited space in which they float. If one considers the intelligence needed to orbit man-made satellites, one cannot be fooled into thinking

that there is not a gigantic intelligence responsible for the arrangements of the various planetary systems. There is no reason to believe that all the gigantic planets float in space without the superior arrangement of a superior intelligence. This subject is clearly dealt with in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.13), where the Personality of Godhead says, “I enter into each planet, and by My energy they stay in orbit.” Were the planets not held in the grip of the Personality of Godhead, they would all scatter like dust in the air. Modern scientists can only impractically explain this inconceivable strength of the Personality of Godhead.

The potencies of the syllables *bha*, *ga* and *va* apply in terms of many different meanings. Through His different potent agents, the Lord protects and sustains everything, but He Himself personally protects and sustains only His devotees, just as a king personally sustains and protects his own children, while entrusting the protection and sustenance of the state to various administrative agents. The Lord is the leader of His devotees, as we learn from the *Bhagavad-gītā*, which mentions that the Personality of Godhead personally instructs His loving devotees how to make certain progress on the path of devotion and thus surely approach the kingdom of God. The Lord is also the recipient of all the adoration offered by His devotees, for whom He is the objective and the goal. For His devotees the Lord creates a favorable condition for developing a sense of transcendental love of Godhead. Sometimes He does this by taking away a devotee’s material attachments by force and baffling all his material protective agents, for thus the devotee must completely depend on the Lord’s protection. In this way the Lord proves Himself the leader of His devotees.

The Lord is not directly attached to the creation, maintenance and destruction of the material world, for He is eternally busy in the enjoyment of transcendental bliss with paraphernalia composed of His internal potencies. Yet as the initiator of the material energy as well as the marginal potency (the living beings), He expands Himself as the *puruṣa-avatāras*, who are invested with potencies similar to His. The *puruṣa-avatāras* are also in the category of *bhagavat-tattva* because each

and every one of them is identical with the original form of the Personality of Godhead. The living entities are His infinitesimal particles and are qualitatively one with Him. They are sent into this material world for material enjoyment, to fulfill their desires to be independent individuals, but still they are subject to the supreme will of the Lord. The Lord deposes Himself in the state of Supersoul to supervise the arrangements for such material enjoyment. The example of a temporary fair is quite appropriate in this connection. If the citizens of a state assemble in a fair to enjoy for a short period, the government deposes a special officer to supervise it. Such an officer is invested with all governmental power, and therefore he is identical with the government. When the fair is over, there is no need for such an officer, and he returns home. The Paramātmā is compared to such an officer.

The living beings are not all in all. They are undoubtedly parts of the Supreme Lord and are qualitatively one with Him, yet they are subject to His control. Thus they are never equal to the Lord or one with Him. The Lord who associates with the living being is the Paramātmā, or supreme living being. No one, therefore, should view the tiny living beings and supreme living being to be on an equal level.

The all-pervading truth that exists eternally during the creation, maintenance and annihilation of the material world and in which the living beings rest in trance is called the impersonal Brahman.

TEXT 11

vadanti tat tattva-vidas

tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam

brahmeti paramātmēti

bhagavān iti śabdyate

SYNONYMS

vadanti—they say; *tat*—that; *tattva-vidaḥ*—learned souls; *tattvam*—the Absolute Truth; *yat*—which; *jñānam*—knowledge; *advayam*—nondual; *brahma*—Brahman; *iti*—thus; *paramātmā*—Paramātmā; *iti*—thus; *bhagavān*—Bhagavān; *iti*—thus; *śabdyate*—is known.

TRANSLATION

“Learned transcendentalists who know the Absolute Truth say that it is nondual knowledge and is called impersonal Brahman, the localized Paramātmā and the Personality of Godhead.”

PURPORT

This Sanskrit verse appears as the eleventh verse of the First Canto, Second Chapter, of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, where Sūta Gosvāmī answers the questions of the sages headed by Śaunaka Ṛṣi concerning the essence of all scriptural instructions. *Tattva-vidaḥ* refers to persons who have knowledge of the Absolute Truth. They can certainly understand knowledge without duality because they are on the spiritual platform. The Absolute Truth is known sometimes as Brahman, sometimes as Paramātmā and sometimes as Bhagavān. Persons who are in knowledge of the truth know that one who tries to approach the Absolute simply by mental speculation will ultimately realize the impersonal Brahman, and one who tries to approach the Absolute through *yoga* practice will be able to realize Paramātmā, but one who has complete knowledge and spiritual understanding realizes the spiritual form of Bhagavān, the Personality of Godhead.

Devotees of the Personality of Godhead know that Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the son of the King of Vraja, is the Absolute Truth. They do not discriminate between Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s name, form, quality and pastimes. One who wants to separate the Lord’s absolute name, form and qualities from the Lord Himself must be understood to be lacking in absolute knowledge. A pure

devotee knows that when he chants the transcendental name “Kṛṣṇa,” Śrī Kṛṣṇa is present as transcendental sound. He therefore chants with full respect and veneration. When he sees the forms of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, he does not see anything different from the Lord. If one sees otherwise, he must be considered untrained in absolute knowledge. This lack of absolute knowledge is called *māyā*. One who is not Kṛṣṇa conscious is ruled by the spell of *māyā* under the control of a duality in knowledge. In the Absolute, all manifestations of the Supreme Lord are nondual, just as the multifarious forms of Viṣṇu, the controller of *māyā*, are nondual. Empiric philosophers who pursue the impersonal Brahman accept only the knowledge that the personality of the living entity is not different from the personality of the Supreme Lord, and mystic *yogīs* who try to locate the Paramātmā accept only the knowledge that the pure soul is not different from the Supersoul. The absolute conception of a pure devotee, however, includes all others. A devotee does not see anything except in its relationship with Kṛṣṇa, and therefore his realization is the most perfect of all.

TEXT 12

tāñhāra aṅgera śuddha kiraṇa-maṇḍala

upaniṣat kahe tāñre brahma sunirmala

SYNONYMS

tāñhāra—His; *aṅgera*—of the body; *śuddha*—pure; *kiraṇa*—of rays; *maṇḍala*—realm; *upaniṣat*—the *Upaniṣads*; *kahe*—say; *tāñre*—unto that; *brahma*—Brahman; *su-nirmala*—transcendental.

TRANSLATION

What the Upaniṣads call the transcendental, impersonal Brahman is the realm of the glowing effulgence of the same Supreme Person.

PURPORT

Three *mantras* of the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* (2.2.9–11) give information regarding the bodily effulgence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. They state:

*hiraṇmaye pare kośe virajaṁ brahma niṣkalam
tac chubhram jyotiṣāṁ jyotis tad yad ātma-vido viduḥ*

*na tatra sūryo bhāti na candra-tāraḥ
nemā vidyuto bhānti kuto 'yam agniḥ*

*tam eva bhāntam anubhāti sarvaṁ
tasya bhāsā sarvaṁ idaṁ vibhāti*

*brahmaivedam amṛtaṁ purastād brahma
paścād brahma dakṣiṇataś cottareṇa*

*adhaś cordhvaṁ ca prasṛtaṁ brahmai-
vedaṁ viśvaṁ idaṁ variṣṭham*

“In the spiritual realm, beyond the material covering, is the unlimited Brahman effulgence, which is free from material contamination. That effulgent white light is understood by transcendentalists to be the light of all lights. In that realm there is no need of sunshine, moonshine, fire or electricity for illumination. Indeed, whatever illumination appears in the material world is only a reflection of that supreme illumination. That Brahman is in front and in back, in the north, south, east and west, and also overhead and below. In other words, that supreme Brahman effulgence spreads throughout both the material and spiritual skies.”

TEXT 13

carma-cakṣe dekhe yaiche sūrya nirviśeṣa

jñāna-mārge laite nāre kṛṣṇera viśeṣa

SYNONYMS

carma-cakṣe—by the naked eye; *dekhe*—one sees; *yaiche*—just as; *sūrya*—the sun; *nirviśeṣa*—without variegatedness; *jñāna-mārga*—by the path of philosophical speculation; *laite*—to accept; *nāre*—not able; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *viśeṣa*—the variety.

TRANSLATION

As with the naked eye one cannot know the sun except as a glowing substance, merely by philosophical speculation one cannot understand Lord Kṛṣṇa's transcendental varieties.

TEXT 14

yasya prabhā prabhavato jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-

koṭīṣv aśeṣa-vasudhādi-vibhūti-bhinnam

tad brahma niṣkalam anantam aśeṣa-bhūtaṁ

govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

yasya—of whom; *prabhā*—the effulgence; *prabhavataḥ*—of one who excels in power; *jagat-aṇḍa*—of universes; *koṭi-koṭīṣu*—in millions and millions; *aśeṣa*—unlimited; *vasudhā-ādi*—with planets, etc.; *vibhūti*—with opulences; *bhinnam*—becoming variegated; *tat*—that; *brahma*—Brahman; *niṣkalam*—without parts; *anantam*—unlimited; *aśeṣa-bhūtaṁ*—being complete; *govindam*—Lord Govinda; *ādi-puruṣaṁ*—the original person; *tam*—Him; *ahaṁ*—I; *bhajāmi*—worship.

TRANSLATION

“I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who is endowed with great power. The glowing effulgence of His transcendental form is the impersonal Brahman, which is absolute, complete and unlimited and which displays the varieties of countless planets, with their different opulences, in millions and millions of universes.”

PURPORT

This verse appears in the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.40). Each and every one of the countless universes is full of innumerable planets with different constitutions and atmospheres. All these come from the unlimited nondual Brahman, or Complete Whole, which exists in absolute knowledge. The origin of that unlimited Brahman effulgence is the transcendental body of Govinda, who is offered respectful obeisances as the original and supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 15

koṭī koṭī brahmāṇḍe ye brahmera vibhūti

sei brahma govindera haya aṅga-kānti

SYNONYMS

koṭī—tens of millions; *koṭī*—tens of millions; *brahma-aṇḍe*—in universes; *ye*—which; *brahmera*—of Brahman; *vibhūti*—opulences; *sei*—that; *brahma*—Brahman; *govindera*—of Lord Govinda; *haya*—is; *aṅga-kānti*—bodily effulgence.

TRANSLATION

[Lord Brahmā said:] “The opulences of the impersonal Brahman spread throughout the millions and millions of universes. That Brahman is but

the bodily effulgence of Govinda.

TEXT 16

sei govinda bhaji āmi, tehoṇ mora pati

tānhāra prasāde mora haya sṛṣṭi-śakti

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *govinda*—Lord Govinda; *bhaji*—worship; *āmi*—I; *tehoṇ*—He; *mora*—my; *pati*—Lord; *tānhāra*—His; *prasāde*—by the mercy; *mora*—my; *haya*—becomes; *sṛṣṭi*—of creation; *śakti*—power.

TRANSLATION

“I worship Govinda. He is my Lord. Only by His grace am I empowered to create the universe.”

PURPORT

Although the sun is situated far away from the other planets, its rays sustain and maintain them all. Indeed, the sun diffuses its heat and light all over the universe. Similarly, the supreme sun, Govinda, diffuses His heat and light everywhere in the form of His different potencies. The sun’s heat and light are nondifferent from the sun. In the same way, the unlimited potencies of Govinda are nondifferent from Govinda Himself. Therefore the all-pervasive Brahman is the all-pervasive Govinda. The *Bhagavad-gītā* (14.27) clearly mentions that the impersonal Brahman is dependent upon Govinda. That is the real conception of absolute knowledge.

TEXT 17

munayo vāta-vāsanāḥ

śramaṇā ūrdhva-manthinaḥ

brahmākhyam dhāma te yānti

śāntāḥ sannyāsino 'malāḥ

SYNONYMS

munayaḥ—saints; *vāta-vāsanāḥ*—naked; *śramaṇāḥ*—who perform severe physical penances; *ūrdhva*—raised up; *manthinaḥ*—whose semen; *brahma-ākhyam*—known as Brahmaloḥka; *dhāma*—to the abode; *te*—they; *yānti*—go; *śāntāḥ*—equipoised in Brahman; *sannyāsinaḥ*—who are in the renounced order of life; *amalāḥ*—pure.

TRANSLATION

“Naked saints and sannyāsīs who undergo severe physical penances, who can raise the semen to the brain, and who are completely equipoised in Brahman can live in the realm known as Brahmaloḥka.”

PURPORT

In this verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.6.47), *vāta-vāsanāḥ* refers to mendicants who do not care about anything material, including clothing, but who depend wholly on nature. Such sages do not cover their bodies even in severe winter or scorching sunshine. They take great pains not to avoid any kind of bodily suffering, and they live by begging from door to door. They never discharge their semen, either knowingly or unknowingly. By such celibacy they are able to raise the semen to the brain. Thus they become most intelligent and develop very sharp memories. Their minds are never disturbed or diverted from contemplation on the Absolute Truth, nor are they ever contaminated by desire for material enjoyment. By practicing austerities under strict discipline, such mendicants attain a neutral state transcendental to the modes of nature and merge into the impersonal Brahman.

TEXT 18

ātmāntaryāmī yāñre yoga-sāstre kaya

seha govindera amśa vibhūti ye haya

SYNONYMS

ātmā antaḥ-yāmī—in-dwelling Supersoul; *yāñre*—who; *yoga-sāstre*—in the scriptures of *yoga*; *kaya*—is spoken; *seha*—that; *govindera*—of Govinda; *amśa*—plenary portion; *vibhūti*—expansion; *ye*—which; *haya*—is.

TRANSLATION

He who is described in the *yoga-sāstras* as the indwelling Supersoul [*ātmā antar-yāmī*] is also a plenary portion of Govinda's personal expansion.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is by nature joyful. His enjoyments, or pastimes, are completely transcendental. He is in the fourth dimension of existence, for although the material world is measured by the limitations of length, breadth and height, the Supreme Lord is completely unlimited in His body, form and existence. He is not personally attached to any of the affairs within the material cosmos. The material world is created by the expansion of His *puruṣa-avatāras*, who direct the aggregate material energy and all the conditioned souls. By understanding the three expansions of the *puruṣa*, a living entity can transcend the position of knowing only the twenty-four elements of the material world.

One of the expansions of Mahā-Viṣṇu is Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, the Supersoul within every living entity. As the Supersoul of the total aggregate of living entities, or the second *puruṣa*, He is known as

Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. As the creator or original cause of innumerable universes, or the first *puruṣa*, who is lying on the Causal Ocean, He is called Mahā-Viṣṇu. The three *puruṣas* direct the affairs of the material world.

The authorized scriptures direct the individual souls to revive their relationship with the Supersoul. Indeed, the system of *yoga* is the process of transcending the influence of the material elements by establishing a connection with the *puruṣa* known as Paramātmā. One who has thoroughly studied the intricacies of creation can know very easily that this Paramātmā is the plenary portion of the Supreme Being, Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 19

ananta sphaṭike yaiche eka sūrya bhāse

taiche jīve govindera aṁśa prakāśe

SYNONYMS

ananta—unlimited; *sphaṭike*—in crystals; *yaiche*—just as; *eka*—one; *sūrya*—sun; *bhāse*—appears; *taiche*—just so; *jīve*—in the living entity; *govindera*—of Govinda; *aṁśa*—portion; *prakāśe*—manifests.

TRANSLATION

As the one sun appears reflected in countless jewels, so Govinda manifests Himself [as Paramātmā] in the hearts of all living beings.

PURPORT

The sun is situated in a specific location but is reflected in countless jewels and appears in innumerable localized aspects. Similarly, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, although eternally present in His transcendental abode, Goloka Vṛndāvana, is reflected in everyone's heart

as the Supersoul. In the *Upaniṣads* it is said that the *jīva* (living entity) and the Paramātmā (Supersoul) are like two birds sitting in the same tree. The Supersoul engages the living being in executing fruitive work as a result of his deeds in the past, but the Paramātmā has nothing to do with such engagements. As soon as the living being ceases to act in terms of fruitive work and takes to the service of the Lord (the Paramātmā), coming to know of His supremacy, he is immediately freed from all designations, and in that pure state he enters the kingdom of God, known as Vaikuṇṭha.

The Paramātmā, or Supersoul, the guide of the individual living beings, does not take part in fulfilling the desires of the living beings, but He arranges for their fulfillment by material nature. As soon as an individual soul becomes conscious of his eternal relationship with the Supersoul and looks only toward Him, he at once becomes free from the entanglements of material enjoyment. Christian philosophers who do not believe in the law of *karma* put forward the argument that it is absurd to say one must accept the results of past deeds of which he has no consciousness. A criminal is first reminded of his misdeeds by witnesses in a law court, and then he is punished. If death is complete forgetfulness, why should a person be punished for his past misdeeds? The conception of the Paramātmā is an invincible answer to these fallacious arguments. The Paramātmā is the witness of the past activities of the individual living being. A man may not remember what he has done in his childhood, but his father, who has seen him grow through different stages of development, certainly remembers. Similarly, the living being undergoes many changes of body through many lives, but the Supersoul is always with him and remembers all his activities, despite his evolution through different bodies.

TEXT 20

atha vā bahunaitena

kiṁ jñātena tavārjuna

viṣṭabhyāham idam kṛtsnam

ekāṁśena sthito jagat

SYNONYMS

atha vā—or; *bahunā*—much; *etena*—with this; *kim*—what use; *jñātena*—being known; *tava*—by you; *arjuna*—O Arjuna; *viṣṭabhya*—pervading; *aham*—I; *idam*—this; *kṛtsnam*—entire; *eka-aṁśena*—with one portion; *sthitaḥ*—situated; *jagat*—universe.

TRANSLATION

[The Personality of Godhead, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, said:] “What more shall I say to you? I live throughout this cosmic manifestation merely by My single plenary portion.”

PURPORT

Describing His own potencies to Arjuna, the Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa spoke this verse of the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.42).

TEXT 21

tam imam aham ajam śarīra-bhājām

hṛdi hṛdi dhiṣṭhitam ātma-kalpitānām

prati-dṛśam iva naikadhārkam ekam

samadhigato 'smi vidhūta-bheda-mohaḥ

SYNONYMS

tam—Him; *imam*—this; *aham*—I; *ajam*—the unborn; *śarīra-bhājām*—

of the conditioned souls endowed with bodies; *hṛdi hṛdi*—in each of the hearts; *dhiṣṭhitam*—situated; *ātma*—by themselves; *kalpitānām*—which are imagined; *prati-dṛśam*—for every eye; *iva*—like; *na eka-dhā*—not in one way; *arkam*—the sun; *ekam*—one; *samadhigataḥ*—one who has obtained; *asmi*—I am; *vidhūta*—removed; *bheda-mohaḥ*—whose misconception of duality.

TRANSLATION

[Grandfather Bhīṣma said:] “As the one sun appears differently situated to different seers, so also do You, the unborn, appear differently represented as the Paramātmā in every living being. But when a seer knows himself to be one of Your own servitors, no longer does he maintain such duality. Thus I am now able to comprehend Your eternal forms, knowing well the Paramātmā to be only Your plenary portion.”

PURPORT

This verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.9.42) was spoken by Bhīṣmadeva, the grandfather of the Kurus, when he was lying on a bed of arrows at the last stage of his life. Arjuna, Kṛṣṇa and numberless friends, admirers, relatives and sages had gathered on the scene as Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira took moral and religious instructions from the dying Bhīṣma. Just as the final moment arrived for him, Bhīṣma spoke this verse while looking at Lord Kṛṣṇa.

Just as the one sun is the object of vision of many different persons, so the one partial representation of Lord Kṛṣṇa who lives in the heart of every living entity as the Paramātmā is a variously perceived object. One who comes intimately in touch with Lord Kṛṣṇa by engaging in His eternal service sees the Supersoul as the localized partial representation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Bhīṣma knew the Supersoul to be a partial expansion of Lord Kṛṣṇa, whom he understood to be the supreme, unborn transcendental form.

TEXT 22

seita govinda sākṣāc caitanya gosāñi

jīva nistārite aiche dayālu āra nāi

SYNONYMS

seita—that; *govinda*—Govinda; *sākṣāt*—personally; *caitanya*—Lord Caitanya; *gosāñi*—Gosāñi; *jīva*—the fallen living entities; *nistārite*—to deliver; *aiche*—such; *dayālu*—a merciful Lord; *āra*—another; *nāi*—there is not.

TRANSLATION

That Govinda personally appears as Caitanya Gosāñi. No other Lord is as merciful in delivering the fallen souls.

PURPORT

Having described Govinda in terms of His Brahman and Paramātmā features, now the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* advances his argument to prove that Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the identical personality. The same Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, in the garb of a devotee of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, descended to this mortal world to reclaim the fallen human beings who had misunderstood the Personality of Godhead even after the explanation of the *Bhagavad-gītā*. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* the Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa directly instructed that the Supreme is a person, that the impersonal Brahman is His glowing effulgence, and that the Paramātmā is His partial representation. All men were therefore advised to follow the path of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, leaving aside all mundane “isms.” Offenders misunderstood this instruction, however, because of their poor fund of knowledge. Thus by His causeless, unlimited mercy Śrī Kṛṣṇa came again as Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi.

The author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* most emphatically stresses that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself. He is not an expansion of the *prakāśa* or *vilāsa* forms of Śrī Kṛṣṇa; He is the *svayam-rūpa*, Govinda. Apart from the relevant scriptural evidence forwarded by Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, there are innumerable other scriptural statements regarding Lord Caitanya's being the Supreme Lord Himself. The following examples may be cited:

(1) From the *Caitanya Upaniṣad* (5): *gauraḥ sarvātmā mahā-puruṣo mahātmā mahā-yogī tri-guṇātītaḥ sattva-rūpo bhaktiṁ loke kāśyati*. "Lord Gaura, who is the all-pervading Supersoul, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, appears as a great saint and powerful mystic who is above the three modes of nature and is the emblem of transcendental activity. He disseminates the cult of devotion throughout the world."

(2) From the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* (6.7 and 3.12):

*tam īśvarāṇām paramaṁ maheśvaram
tam devatānām paramaṁ ca daivatam
patiṁ patinām paramaṁ parastād
vidāma devaṁ bhuvaneśam idyam*

"O Supreme Lord, You are the Supreme Maheśvara, the worshipable Deity of all the demigods and the Supreme Lord of all lords. You are the controller of all controllers, the Personality of Godhead, the Lord of everything worshipable."

*mahān prabhur vai puruṣaḥ
sattvasyaīṣa pravartakaḥ
su-nīrmalām imām prāptim
īśāno jyotir avyayaḥ*

"The Supreme Personality of Godhead is Mahāprabhu, who disseminates transcendental enlightenment. Just to be in touch with Him is to be in contact with the indestructible *brahmajyoti*."

(3) From the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* (3.1.3):

*yadā paśyaḥ paśyate rukma-varṇam
kartāram īśam puruṣam brahma-yonim*

“One who sees that golden-colored Personality of Godhead, the Supreme Lord, the supreme actor, who is the source of the Supreme Brahman, is liberated.”

(4) From *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.5.33–34 and 7.9.38):

*dhyeyam sadā paribhava-ghnam abhīṣṭa-dohaṁ
tīrthāspadam śiva-viriñci-nutam śaraṇyam
bhṛtyārṭi-haṁ praṇata-pāla-bhavābdhi-potaṁ
vande mahā-puruṣa te caraṇāravindam*

“We offer our respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of Him, the Lord, upon whom one should always meditate. He destroys insults to His devotees. He removes the distresses of His devotees and satisfies their desires. He, the abode of all holy places and the shelter of all sages, is worshipable by Lord Śiva and Lord Brahmā. He is the boat of the demigods for crossing the ocean of birth and death.”

*tyaktvā sudustyaja-surepsita-rājya-lakṣmīm
dharmiṣṭha ārya-vacasā yad agād araṇyam
māyā-mṛgaṁ dayitayepsitam anvadhāvad
vande mahā-puruṣa te caraṇāravindam*

[SB 11.5.34]

“We offer our respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of the Lord, upon whom one should always meditate. He left His householder life, leaving aside His eternal consort, whom even the denizens of heaven adore. He went into the forest to deliver the fallen souls, who are put into illusion by material energy.”

Prahlāda said:

*itthaṁ nṛ-tīryag-ṛṣi-deva jhaṣāvatārair
lokān vibhāvayasi haṁsi jagat-pratīpān
dharmaṁ mahā-puruṣa pāsi yugānuvṛttaṁ
channaḥ kalau yad abhavas tri-yugo 'tha sa tvam*

“My Lord, You kill all the enemies of the world in Your multifarious incarnations in the families of men, animals, demigods, *ṛṣis*, aquatics and so on. Thus You illuminate the worlds with transcendental knowledge. In the Age of Kali, O Mahāpuruṣa, You sometimes appear in a covered incarnation. Therefore You are known as Tri-yuga [one who appears in only three *yugas*].”

(5) From the *Kṛṣṇa-yāmala-tantra*: *puṇya-kṣetre nava-dvīpe bhaviṣyāmi śacī-sutaḥ*. “I shall appear in the holy land of Navadvīpa as the son of Śacī-devī.”

(6) From the *Vāyu Purāṇa*: *kalau saṅkīrtanārambhe bhaviṣyāmi śacī-sutaḥ*. “In the Age of Kali when the *saṅkīrtana* movement is inaugurated, I shall descend as the son of Śacī-devī.”

(7) From the *Brahma-yāmala-tantra*:

*atha vāhaṁ dharādhāme
bhūtvā mad-bhakta-rūpa-dhṛk
māyāyāṁ ca bhaviṣyāmi
kalau saṅkīrtanāgame*

“Sometimes I personally appear on the surface of the world in the garb of a devotee. Specifically, I appear as the son of Śacī in Kali-yuga to start the *saṅkīrtana* movement.”

(8) From the *Ananta-saṁhitā*:

*ya eva bhagavān kṛṣṇo
rādhikā-prāṇa-vallabhaḥ
sṛṣṭy ādau sa jagan-nātho
gaura āsīn maheśvari*

“The Supreme Person, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself, who is the life of Śrī Rādhārāṇī and is the Lord of the universe in creation, maintenance and annihilation, appears as Gaura, O Maheśvari.”

TEXT 23

*para-vyomete vaise nārāyaṇa nāma
ṣaḍ-aiśvarya-pūrṇa lakṣmī-kānta bhagavān*

SYNONYMS

para-vyomete—in the transcendental world; *vaise*—sits; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *nāma*—of the name; *ṣaḍ-aiśvarya*—of six kinds of opulences; *pūrṇa*—full; *lakṣmī-kānta*—the husband of the goddess of opulence; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Lord Nārāyaṇa, who dominates the transcendental world, is full in six opulences. He is the Personality of Godhead, the Lord of the goddess of fortune.

TEXT 24

*veda, bhāgavata, upaniṣat, āgama
‘pūrṇa-tattva’ yāñre kahe, nāhi yāñra sama*

SYNONYMS

veda—the *Vedas*; *bhāgavata*—*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *upaniṣat*—the *Upaniṣads*; *āgama*—other transcendental literatures; *pūrṇa-tattva*—full truth; *yāñre*—unto whom; *kahe*—they say; *nāhi*—there is not; *yāñra*—whose; *sama*—equal.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead is He who is described as the Absolute Whole in the *Vedas*, *Bhāgavatam*, *Upaniṣads* and other transcendental literatures. No one is equal to Him.

PURPORT

There are innumerable authoritative statements in the *Vedas* regarding the personal feature of the Absolute Truth. Some of them are as follows:

(1) From the *Rk-saṁhitā* (1.22.20):

*tad viṣṇoḥ paramaṁ padaṁ sadā paśyanti sūrayaḥ
divīva cakṣur ātatam*

“The Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu is the Absolute Truth, whose lotus feet all the demigods are always eager to see. Like the sun-god, He pervades everything by the rays of His energy. He appears impersonal to imperfect eyes.”

(2) From the *Nārāyaṇātharva-sīra Upaniṣad* (1–2): *nārāyaṇād eva samutpadyante nārāyaṇāt pravartante nārāyaṇe praliyante. . . . atha nityo nārāyaṇah. . . . nārāyaṇa evedaṁ sarvaṁ yad bhūtaṁ yac ca bhavyam. . . . śuddho deva eko nārāyaṇo na dvitīyo ’sti kaścit.* “It is from Nārāyaṇa only that everything is generated, by Him only that everything is maintained, and in Him only that everything is annihilated. Therefore Nārāyaṇa is eternally existing. Everything that exists now or will be created in the future is nothing but Nārāyaṇa, who is the unadulterated Deity. There is only Nārāyaṇa and nothing else.”

(3) From the *Nārāyaṇa Upaniṣad* (1.4): *yataḥ prasūtā jagataḥ prasūtī*.
“Nārāyaṇa is the source from whom all the universes emanate.”

(4) From the *Hayaśīrṣa Pañcarātra: paramātmā harir devaḥ*. “Hari is the Supreme Lord.”

(5) From *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.3.34–35):

*nārāyaṇābhīdhānasya
brahmaṇaḥ paramātmānaḥ
niṣṭhām arhatha no vaktum
yūyaṁ hi brahma-vittamāḥ*

“O best of the *brāhmaṇas*, please tell us of the position of Nārāyaṇa, who is also known as Brahman and Paramātmā.”

*sthity-udbhava-pralaya-hetur ahetur asya
yat svapna-jāgara-suṣuptiṣu sad bahiś ca
dehendriyāsu-hṛdayāni caranti yena
sañjīvitāni tad avehi param narendra*

“O King, know Him who is causeless and yet is the cause of creation, maintenance and annihilation. He exists in the three states of consciousness—namely waking, dreaming and deep sleep—as well as beyond them. He enlivens the body, the senses, the breath of life, and the heart, and thus they move. Know Him to be supreme.”

TEXT 25

*bhakti-yoge bhakta pāya yānhāra darśana
sūrya yena savigraha dekhe deva-gaṇa*

SYNONYMS

bhakti-yoge—by devotional service; *bhakta*—the devotee; *pāya*—obtains; *yāñhāra*—whose; *darśana*—sight; *sūrya*—the sun-god; *yena*—like; *sa-vigraha*—with form; *dekhe*—they see; *deva-gaṇa*—the denizens of heaven.

TRANSLATION

Through their service, devotees see that Personality of Godhead, just as the denizens of heaven see the personality of the sun.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead has His eternal form, which cannot be seen by material eyes or mental speculation. Only by transcendental devotional service can one understand the transcendental form of the Lord. The comparison is made here to the qualifications for viewing the personal features of the sun-god. The sun-god is a person who, although not visible to our eyes, is seen from the higher planets by the demigods, whose eyes are suitable for seeing through the glaring sunshine that surrounds him. Every planet has its own atmosphere according to the influence of the arrangement of material nature. It is therefore necessary to have a particular type of bodily construction to reach a particular planet. The inhabitants of earth may be able to reach the moon, but the inhabitants of heaven can reach even the fiery sphere called the sun. What is impossible for man on earth is easy for the demigods in heaven because of their different bodies. Similarly, to see the Supreme Lord one must have the spiritual eyes of devotional service. The Personality of Godhead is unapproachable by those who are habituated to speculation about the Absolute Truth in terms of experimental scientific thought, without reference to the transcendental vibration. The ascending approach to the Absolute Truth ends in the realization of impersonal Brahman and the localized Paramātmā but not the Supreme Transcendental Personality.

TEXT 26

jñāna-yoga-mārge tāñre bhaje yei saba

brahma-ātma-rūpe tāñre kare anubhava

SYNONYMS

jñāna—of philosophical speculation; *yoga*—and of mystic *yoga*; *mārge*—on the paths; *tāñre*—Him; *bhaje*—worship; *yei*—who; *saba*—all; *brahma*—of impersonal Brahman; *ātma*—and of the Supersoul (Paramātmā); *rūpe*—in the forms; *tāñre*—Him; *kare*—do; *anubhava*—perceive.

TRANSLATION

Those who walk the paths of knowledge and yoga worship only Him, for it is Him they perceive as the impersonal Brahman and localized Paramātmā.

PURPORT

Those who are fond of mental speculation (*jñāna-mārga*) or want to meditate in mystic *yoga* to find the Absolute Truth must approach the impersonal effulgence of the Lord and His partial representation respectively. Such persons cannot realize the eternal form of the Lord.

TEXT 27

upāsanā-bhede jāni īśvara-mahimā

ataeva sūrya tāñra diyeta upamā

SYNONYMS

upāsanā-bhede—by the different paths of worship; *jāni*—I know; *īśvara*—of the Supreme Lord; *mahimā*—greatness; *ataeva*—therefore;

sūrya—the sun; *tāñra*—of Him; *diyeta*—was given; *upamā*—simile.

TRANSLATION

Thus one may understand the glories of the Lord through different modes of worship, as the analogy of the sun illustrates.

TEXT 28

sei nārāyaṇa kṛṣṇera svarūpa-abheda

eka-i vigraha, kintu ākāra-vibheda

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *svarūpa*—original form; *abheda*—not different; *eka-i*—one; *vigraha*—identity; *kintu*—but; *ākāra*—of bodily features; *vibheda*—difference.

TRANSLATION

Nārāyaṇa and Śrī Kṛṣṇa are the same Personality of Godhead, but although They are identical, Their bodily features are different.

TEXT 29

īnhota dvi-bhuja, tiñho dhare cāri hātha

īñho veṇu dhare, tiñho cakrādika sātha

SYNONYMS

īnhota—this one; *dvi-bhuja*—two arms; *tiñho*—He; *dhare*—manifests; *cāri*—four; *hātha*—hands; *īñho*—this one; *veṇu*—flute; *dhare*—holds; *tiñho*—He; *cakra-ādika*—the wheel, etc.; *sātha*—with.

TRANSLATION

This Personality of Godhead [Śrī Kṛṣṇa] has two hands and holds a flute, whereas the other [Nārāyaṇa] has four hands, with conch, wheel, mace and lotus.

PURPORT

Nārāyaṇa is identical to Śrī Kṛṣṇa. They are in fact the same person manifested differently, like a high court judge who is differently situated in his office and at home. As Nārāyaṇa the Lord is manifested with four hands, but as Kṛṣṇa He is manifested with two hands.

TEXT 30

nārāyaṇas tvam na hi sarva-dehinām

ātmāsy adhīśākhila-loka-sākṣī

nārāyaṇo 'ṅgam nara-bhū-jalāyanāt

tac cāpi satyam na tavaiva māyā

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇaḥ—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *tvam*—You; *na*—not; *hi*—certainly; *sarva*—all; *dehinām*—of the embodied beings; *ātmā*—the Supersoul; *asi*—You are; *adhīśa*—O Lord; *akhila-loka*—of all the worlds; *sākṣī*—the witness; *nārāyaṇaḥ*—known as Nārāyaṇa; *aṅgam*—plenary portion; *nara*—of Nara; *bhū*—born; *jala*—in the water; *ayanāt*—due to the place of refuge; *tat*—that; *ca*—and; *api*—certainly; *satyam*—highest truth; *na*—not; *tava*—Your; *eva*—at all; *māyā*—the illusory energy.

TRANSLATION

“O Lord of lords, You are the seer of all creation. You are indeed everyone’s dearest life. Are You not, therefore, my father, Nārāyaṇa? Nārāyaṇa refers to one whose abode is in the water born from Nara [Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu], and that Nārāyaṇa is Your plenary portion. All Your plenary portions are transcendental. They are absolute and are not creations of māyā.”

PURPORT

This statement, which is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.14.14), was spoken by Lord Brahmā in his prayers to Lord Kṛṣṇa after the Lord had defeated him by displaying His mystic powers. Brahmā had tried to test Lord Kṛṣṇa to see if He were really the Supreme Personality of Godhead playing as a cowherd boy. Brahmā stole all the other boys and their calves from the pasturing grounds, but when he returned to the pastures he saw that all the boys and calves were still there, for Lord Kṛṣṇa had created them all again. When Brahmā saw this mystic power of Lord Kṛṣṇa’s, he admitted defeat and offered prayers to the Lord, addressing Him as the proprietor and seer of everything in the creation and as the Supersoul who is within each and every living entity and is dear to all. That Lord Kṛṣṇa is Nārāyaṇa, the father of Brahmā, because Lord Kṛṣṇa’s plenary expansion Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, after placing Himself on the Garbha Ocean, created Brahmā from His own body. Mahā-Viṣṇu in the Causal Ocean and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, the Supersoul in everyone’s heart, are also transcendental expansions of the Supreme Truth.

TEXT 31

śīśu vatsa hari’ brahmā kari aparādha

aparādha kṣamāite māgena prasāda

SYNONYMS

śīśu—playmates; *vatsa*—calves; *hari’*—stealing; *brahmā*—Lord Brahmā;

kari—making; *aparādhā*—offense; *aparādhā*—offense; *kṣamāite*—to pardon; *māgena*—begged; *prasāda*—mercy.

TRANSLATION

After Brahmā had offended Kṛṣṇa by stealing His playmates and calves, he begged the Lord’s pardon for his offensive act and prayed for the Lord’s mercy.

TEXT 32

tomāra nābhi-padma haite āmāra janmodaya

tumi pitā-mātā, āmi tomāra tanaya

SYNONYMS

tomāra—Your; *nābhi-padma*—lotus of the navel; *haite*—from; *āmāra*—my; *janma-udaya*—birth; *tumi*—You; *pitā*—father; *mātā*—mother; *āmi*—I; *tomāra*—Your; *tanaya*—son.

TRANSLATION

“I took birth from the lotus that grew from Your navel. Thus You are both my father and my mother, and I am Your son.

TEXT 33

pitā mātā bālakera nā laya aparādhā

aparādhā kṣama, more karaha prasāda

SYNONYMS

pitā—father; *mātā*—mother; *bālakera*—of the child; *nā*—not; *laya*—

take seriously; *aparādha*—the offense; *aparādha*—the offense; *kṣama*—please pardon; *more*—unto me; *karaha*—please show; *prasāda*—mercy.

TRANSLATION

“Parents never take seriously the offenses of their children. I therefore beg Your pardon and ask for Your benediction.”

TEXT 34

kṛṣṇa kahena—brahmā, tomāra pitā nārāyaṇa

āmi gopa, tumi kaiche āmāra nandana

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kahena*—says; *brahmā*—O Lord Brahmā; *tomāra*—your; *pitā*—father; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *āmi*—I (am); *gopa*—cowherd boy; *tumi*—you; *kaiche*—how; *āmāra*—My; *nandana*—son.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Kṛṣṇa said, “O Brahmā, your father is Nārāyaṇa. I am but a cowherd boy. How can you be My son?”

TEXT 35

brahmā balena, tumi ki nā hao nārāyaṇa

tumi nārāyaṇa—śuna tāhāra kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

brahmā—Lord Brahmā; *balena*—says; *tumi*—You; *ki nā hao*—are not; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *tumi*—You; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa;

śuna—please hear; *tāhāra*—of that; *kāraṇa*—reason.

TRANSLATION

Brahmā replied, “Are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are certainly Nārāyaṇa. Please listen as I state the proofs.

TEXT 36

prākṛtāprākṛta-sṛṣṭye yata jīva-rūpa

tāhāra ye ātmā tumi mūla-svarūpa

SYNONYMS

prākṛta—material; *aprākṛta*—and spiritual; *sṛṣṭye*—in the creations; *yata*—as many as there are; *jīva-rūpa*—the living beings; *tāhāra*—of them; *ye*—who; *ātmā*—the Supersoul; *tumi*—You; *mūla-svarūpa*—ultimate source.

TRANSLATION

“All the living beings within the material and spiritual worlds are ultimately born of You, for You are the Supersoul of them all.

PURPORT

The cosmic manifestation is generated by the interaction of the three modes of material nature. The transcendental world has no such material modes, although it is nevertheless full of spiritual variegatedness. In that spiritual world there are also innumerable living entities, who are eternally liberated souls engaged in transcendental loving service to Lord Kṛṣṇa. The conditioned souls, who remain within the material cosmic creation, are subjected to the threefold miseries and pangs of material nature. They exist in different species of life because they are eternally

averse to transcendental loving devotion to the Supreme Lord.

Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original source of all living entities because they are all expansions of His marginal potency. Some of them are conditioned by material nature, whereas others are under the protection of the spiritual nature. The material nature is a conditional manifestation of spiritual nature, just as smoke is a conditional stage of fire. Smoke is dependent on fire, but in a blazing fire there is no place for smoke. Smoke disturbs, but fire serves. The serving spirit of the residents of the transcendental world is displayed in five varieties of relationships with the Supreme Lord, who is the central enjoyer. In the material world everyone is a self-centered enjoyer of mundane happiness and distress. One considers himself the lord of everything and tries to enjoy the illusory energy, but he is not successful because he is not independent: he is but a minute particle of the energy of Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa. All living beings exist under the control of the Supreme Lord, who is therefore called Nārāyaṇa.

TEXT 37

pr̥thvī yaiche ghaṭa-kulera kāraṇa āśraya

jīvera nidāna tumi, tumi sarvāśraya

SYNONYMS

pr̥thvī—the earth; *yaiche*—just as; *ghaṭa*—of earthen pots; *kulera*—of the multitude; *kāraṇa*—the cause; *āśraya*—the shelter; *jīvera*—of the living beings; *nidāna*—root cause; *tumi*—You; *tumi*—You; *sarva-āśraya*—shelter of all.

TRANSLATION

“As the earth is the original cause and shelter of all pots made of earth, so You are the ultimate cause and shelter of all living beings.

PURPORT

As the vast earth is the source for the ingredients of all earthen pots, so the Supreme Soul is the source for the complete substance of all individual living entities. The cause of all causes, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the cause of the living entities. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.10), where the Lord says, *bījaṁ māṁ sarva-bhūtānāṁ* (“I am the seed of all living entities”), and in the *Upaniṣads*, which say, *nityo nityānāṁ cetanaś cetanānāṁ* (“the Lord is the supreme leader among all the eternal living beings”).

The Lord is the reservoir of all cosmic manifestation, animate and inanimate. The advocates of Viśiṣṭādvaita-vāda philosophy explain the *Vedānta-sūtra* by saying that although the living entity has two kinds of bodies—subtle (consisting of mind, intelligence and false ego) and gross (consisting of the five basic elements)—and although he thus lives in three bodily dimensions (gross, subtle and spiritual), he is nevertheless a spiritual soul. Similarly, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who emanates the material and spiritual worlds, is the Supreme Spirit. As an individual spirit soul is almost identical to his gross and subtle bodies, so the Supreme Lord is almost identical to the material and spiritual worlds. The material world, full of conditioned souls trying to lord it over matter, is a manifestation of the external energy of the Supreme Lord, and the spiritual world, full of perfect servitors of the Lord, is a manifestation of His internal energy. Since all living entities are minute sparks of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, He is the Supreme Soul in both the material and spiritual worlds. The Vaiṣṇavas following Lord Caitanya stress the doctrine of *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*, which states that the Supreme Lord, being the cause and effect of everything, is inconceivably, simultaneously one with His manifestations of energy and different from them.

TEXT 38

‘nāra’-śabde kahe sarva jīvera nicaya

‘ayana’-śabdete kahe tāhāra āśraya

SYNONYMS

nāra-śabde—by the word *nāra*; *kahe*—one means; *sarva jīvera*—of all living entities; *nicaya*—the assemblage; *ayana-śabdete*—by the word *ayana*; *kahe*—one means; *tāhāra*—of them; *āśraya*—the refuge.

TRANSLATION

“The word ‘nāra’ refers to the aggregate of all the living beings, and the word ‘ayana’ refers to the refuge of them all.

TEXT 39

ataeva tumi hao mūla nārāyaṇa

ei eka hetu, śuna dvitīya kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *tumi*—You; *hao*—are; *mūla*—original; *nārāyaṇa*—Nārāyaṇa; *ei*—this; *eka*—one; *hetu*—reason; *śuna*—please listen; *dvitīya*—second; *kāraṇa*—to the reason.

TRANSLATION

“You are therefore the original Nārāyaṇa. This is one reason; please listen as I state the second.

TEXT 40

jīvera īśvara— —puruṣādi avatāra

tānhā sabā haite tomāra aiśvarya apāra

SYNONYMS

jīvera—of the living beings; *īśvara*—the Supreme Lord; *puruṣa-ādi*—*puruṣa* incarnations, etc.; *avatāra*—incarnations; *tāñhā*—Them; *sabā*—all; *haite*—than; *tomāra*—Your; *aśvarya*—opulences; *apāra*—boundless.

TRANSLATION

“The direct Lords of the living beings are the *puruṣa* incarnations. But Your opulence and power are more exalted than Theirs.

TEXT 41

ataeva adhīśvara tumi sarva pitā

tomāra śaktite tāñrā jagat-rakṣitā

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *adhīśvara*—primeval Lord; *tumi*—You; *sarva*—of all; *pitā*—father; *tomāra*—Your; *śaktite*—by the energy; *tāñrā*—They; *jagat*—of the cosmic creations; *rakṣitā*—protectors.

TRANSLATION

“Therefore You are the primeval Lord, the original father of everyone. They [the *puruṣas*] are protectors of the universes by Your power.

TEXT 42

nānera ayana yāte karaha pālana

ataeva hao tumi mūla nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

nārera—of the living beings; *ayana*—the shelters; *yāte*—those to whom; *karaha*—You give; *pālana*—protection; *ataeva*—therefore; *hao*—are; *tumī*—You; *mūla*—original; *nārāyaṇa*—Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

“Since You protect those who are the shelters of all living beings, You are the original Nārāyaṇa.

PURPORT

The controlling Deities of the living beings in the mundane worlds are the three *puruṣa-avatāras*. But the potent energy displayed by Śrī Kṛṣṇa is far more extensive than that of the *puruṣas*. Śrī Kṛṣṇa is therefore the original father and Lord who protects all creative manifestations through His various plenary portions. Since He sustains even the shelters of the collective living beings, there is no doubt that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa.

TEXT 43

tṛtīya kāraṇa śuna śrī-bhagavān

ananta brahmāṇḍa bahu vaikuṇṭhādi dhāma

SYNONYMS

tṛtīya—third; *kāraṇa*—reason; *śuna*—please hear; *śrī-bhagavān*—O Supreme Personality of Godhead; *ananta*—unlimited; *brahma-aṇḍa*—universes; *bahu*—many; *vaikuṇṭha-ādi*—Vaikuṇṭha, etc.; *dhāma*—planets.

TRANSLATION

“O my Lord, O Supreme Personality of Godhead! Kindly hear my third

reason. There are countless universes and fathomless transcendental Vaikuṇṭhas.

TEXT 44

ithe yata jīva, tāra trai-kālika karma

tāhā dekha, sākṣī tumi, jāna saba marma

SYNONYMS

ithe—in these; *yata*—as many; *jīva*—living beings; *tāra*—of them; *trai-kālika*—past, present and future; *karma*—the activities; *tāhā*—that; *dekha*—You see; *sākṣī*—witness; *tumi*—You; *jāna*—You know; *saba*—of everything; *marma*—the essence.

TRANSLATION

“Both in this material world and in the transcendental world, You see all the deeds of all living beings, in the past, present and future. Since You are the witness of all such deeds, You know the essence of everything.

TEXT 45

tomāra darśane sarva jagatera sthiti

tumi nā dekhile kāro nāhi sthiti gati

SYNONYMS

tomāra—Your; *darśane*—by the seeing; *sarva*—all; *jagatera*—of the universe; *sthiti*—maintenance; *tumi*—You; *nā dekhile*—in not seeing; *kāro*—of anyone; *nāhi*—there is not; *sthiti*—staying; *gati*—moving.

TRANSLATION

“All the worlds exist because You oversee them. None can live, move or have their being without Your supervision.

TEXT 46

nārera ayana yāte kara daraśana

tāhāteo hao tumi mūla nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

nārera—of the living beings; *ayana*—the motion; *yāte*—since; *kara*—You do; *daraśana*—seeing; *tāhāteo*—therefore; *hao*—are; *tumi*—You; *mūla*—original; *nārāyaṇa*—Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

“You oversee the wanderings of all living beings. For this reason also, You are the primeval Lord Nārāyaṇa.”

PURPORT

Śrī Kṛṣṇa, in His Paramātmā feature, lives in the hearts of all living beings in both the transcendental and mundane creations. As the Paramātmā, He witnesses all actions the living beings perform in all phases of time, namely past, present and future. Śrī Kṛṣṇa knows what the living beings have done for hundreds and thousands of past births, and He sees what they are doing now; therefore He knows the results of their present actions that will fructify in the future. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, the entire cosmic situation is created as soon as He glances over the material energy. Nothing can exist without His superintendence. Since He sees even the abode where the collective living beings rest, He is the original Nārāyaṇa.

TEXT 47

kṛṣṇa kahena—brahmā, tomāra nā bujhi vacana

jīva-hṛdi, jale vaise sei nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kahena*—says; *brahmā*—O Brahmā; *tomāra*—your; *nā*—not; *bujhi*—I understand; *vacana*—speech; *jīva*—of the living entity; *hṛdi*—in the heart; *jale*—in the water; *vaise*—sits; *sei*—that; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa said, “Brahmā, I cannot understand what you are saying. Lord Nārāyaṇa is He who sits in the hearts of all living beings and lies down in the waters of the Kāraṇa Ocean.”

TEXT 48

brahmā kahe—jale jīve yei nārāyaṇa

se saba tomāra aṁśa—e satya vacana

SYNONYMS

brahmā—Lord Brahmā; *kahe*—says; *jale*—in the water; *jīve*—in the living being; *yei*—who; *nārāyaṇa*—Nārāyaṇa; *se*—They; *saba*—all; *tomāra*—Your; *aṁśa*—plenary part; *e*—this; *satya*—truthful; *vacana*—word.

TRANSLATION

Brahmā replied, “What I have said is true. The same Lord Nārāyaṇa who lives on the waters and in the hearts of all living beings is but a plenary portion of You.

TEXT 49

kāraṇābdhi-garbhodaka-kṣīrodaka-śāyī

māyā-dvāre sṛṣṭi kare, tāte saba māyī

SYNONYMS

kāraṇa-abdhi—Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *garbha-udaka*—Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *kṣīra-udaka-śāyī*—Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *māyā-dvāre*—with the material energy; *sṛṣṭi*—creation; *kare*—They do; *tāte*—therefore; *saba*—all; *māyī*—connected with *māyā*.

TRANSLATION

“The Kāraṇodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī forms of Nārāyaṇa all create in cooperation with the material energy. In this way They are attached to māyā.

TEXT 50

sei tina jala-śāyī sarva-antaryāmī

brahmāṇḍa-vṛndera ātmā ye puruṣa-nāmī

SYNONYMS

sei—these; *tina*—three; *jala-śāyī*—lying in the water; *sarva*—of all; *antaḥ yāmī*—the Supersoul; *brahma-aṇḍa*—of universes; *vṛndera*—of the multitude; *ātmā*—Supersoul; *ye*—who; *puruṣa*—*puruṣa*; *nāmī*—named.

TRANSLATION

“These three Viṣṇus lying in the water are the Supersoul of everything.

The Supersoul of all the universes is known as the first puruṣa.

TEXT 51

hiraṇya-garbhera ātmā garbhodaka-śāyī

vyāṣṭi-jīva-antaryāmī kṣīrodaka-śāyī

SYNONYMS

hiraṇya-garbhera—of the total of the living entities; *ātmā*—the Supersoul; *garbha-udaka-śāyī*—Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *vyāṣṭi*—the individual; *jīva*—of the living entity; *antaḥ-yāmī*—Supersoul; *kṣīra-udaka-śāyī*—Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu.

TRANSLATION

“Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Supersoul of the aggregate of living entities, and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Supersoul of each individual living being.

TEXT 52

e sabhāra darśanete āche māyā-gandha

turīya kṛṣṇera nāhi māyāra sambandha

SYNONYMS

e—this; *sabhāra*—of the assembly; *darśanete*—in seeing; *āche*—there is; *māyā-gandha*—connection with *māyā*; *turīya*—the fourth; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nāhi*—there is not; *māyāra*—of the material energy; *sambandha*—connection.

TRANSLATION

“Superficially we see that these *puruṣas* have a relationship with *māyā*, but above them, in the fourth dimension, is Lord Kṛṣṇa, who has no contact with the material energy.

PURPORT

The three *puruṣas*—Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu—all have a relationship with the material energy, called *māyā*, because through *māyā* They create the material cosmos. These three *puruṣas*, who lie on the Kāraṇa, Garbha and Kṣīra oceans respectively, are the Supersoul of everything that be: Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Supersoul of the collective universes, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Supersoul of the collective living beings, and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Supersoul of all individual living entities. Because all of Them are somehow attracted to the affairs of the material energy, They can be said to have some affection for *māyā*. But the transcendental position of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself is not even slightly tinged by *māyā*. His transcendental state is called *turīya*, or the fourth-dimensional stage.

TEXT 53

virāḍ hiraṇya-garbhaś ca

kāraṇam cety upādhayaḥ

īśasya yat tribhir hīnam

turīyam tat pracakṣate

SYNONYMS

virāḍ—the *virāḍ* manifestation; *hiraṇya-garbhaḥ*—the *hiraṇyagarbha* manifestation; *ca*—and; *kāraṇam*—the *kāraṇa* manifestation; *ca*—and; *iti*—thus; *upādhayaḥ*—particular designations; *īśasya*—of the Lord; *yat*—that which; *tribhiḥ*—these three; *hīnam*—without; *turīyam*—the

fourth; *tat*—that; *pracakṣate*—is considered.

TRANSLATION

“In the material world the Lord is designated as *virāt*, *hiraṇyagarbha* and *kāraṇa*. But beyond these three designations, the Lord is ultimately in the fourth dimension.’

PURPORT

Virāt (the phenomenal manifestation of the Supreme Whole), *hiraṇyagarbha* (the numinous soul of everything), and *kāraṇa* (the cause, or causal nature) are all but designations of the *puruṣas*, who are responsible for material creation. The transcendental position surpasses these designations and is therefore called the position of the fourth dimension. This is a quotation from Śrīdhara Svāmī’s commentary on the Eleventh Canto, Fifteenth Chapter, verse 16, of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*.

TEXT 54

yadyapi tinera māyā la-iyā vyavahāra

tathāpi tat-sparsā nāhi, sabhe māyā-pāra

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *tinera*—of these three; *māyā*—the material energy; *la-iyā*—taking; *vyavahāra*—the dealings; *tathāpi*—still; *tat*—of that; *sparsā*—the touch; *nāhi*—there is not; *sabhe*—all of Them; *māyā-pāra*—beyond the material energy.

TRANSLATION

“Although these three features of the Lord deal directly with the material energy, none of Them are touched by it. They are all beyond illusion.

TEXT 55

etat īśanam īśasya

prakṛti-stho 'pi tad-guṇaiḥ

na yujyate sadātma-sthair

yathā buddhis tad-āśrayā

SYNONYMS

etat—this; *īśanam*—opulence; *īśasya*—of the Supreme Lord; *prakṛti-sthaḥ*—situated in the material nature; *api*—although; *tat*—of *māyā*; *guṇaiḥ*—by the qualities; *na*—not; *yujyate*—is affected; *sadā*—always; *ātma-sthaiḥ*—which are situated in His own energy; *yathā*—as also; *buddhiḥ*—the intelligence; *tat*—of Him; *āśrayā*—which has taken shelter.

TRANSLATION

“This is the opulence of the Lord: Although situated in the material nature, He is never affected by the modes of nature. Similarly, those who have surrendered to Him and fixed their intelligence upon Him are not influenced by the modes of nature.’

PURPORT

This text is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.11.38). Those who have taken shelter of the lotus feet of the Personality of Godhead do not identify with the material world, even while living in it. Pure devotees may deal with the three modes of material nature, but because of their transcendental intelligence in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, they are not influenced by the material qualities. The spell of material activities does not attract such devotees. Therefore, the Supreme Lord and His devotees

acting under Him are always free from material contamination.

TEXT 56

sei tina janera tumi parama āśraya

tumi mūla nārāyaṇa— —ithe ki saṁśaya

SYNONYMS

sei—these; *tina*—three; *janera*—of the plenary portions; *tumi*—You; *parama*—ultimate; *āśraya*—shelter; *tumi*—You; *mūla*—primeval; *nārāyaṇa*—Nārāyaṇa; *ithe*—in this; *ki*—what; *saṁśaya*—doubt.

TRANSLATION

“You are the ultimate shelter of these three plenary portions. Thus there is not the slightest doubt that You are the primeval Nārāyaṇa.

PURPORT

Brahmā has confirmed that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme, the source of the three manifestations known as Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu (Mahā-Viṣṇu). For His pastimes, Lord Kṛṣṇa has four original manifestations—namely Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. The first *puruṣa-avatāra*, Mahā-Viṣṇu in the Causal Ocean, who is the creator of the aggregate material energy, is an expansion of Saṅkarṣaṇa; the second *puruṣa*, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, is an expansion of Pradyumna; and the third *puruṣa*, Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, is an expansion of Aniruddha. All these are within the category of manifestations of Nārāyaṇa, who is a manifestation of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 57

sei tintera aṁśī paravyoma-nārāyaṇa

teñha tomāra vilāsa, tumi mūla-nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

sei—these; *tinera*—of the three; *aṁśī*—source; *para-vyoma*—in the spiritual sky; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *teñha*—He; *tomāra*—Your; *vilāsa*—pastime expansion; *tumi*—You; *mūla*—original; *nārāyaṇa*—Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

“The source of these three features is the Nārāyaṇa in the spiritual sky. He is Your vilāsa expansion. Therefore You are the ultimate Nārāyaṇa.”

TEXT 58

ataeva brahma-vākye—paravyoma-nārāyaṇa

teñho kṛṣṇera vilāsa—ei tattva-vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *brahma*—of Lord Brahmā; *vākye*—in the speech; *para-vyoma*—in the spiritual sky; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *teñho*—He; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vilāsa*—pastime incarnation; *ei*—this; *tattva*—of the truth; *vivaraṇa*—description.

TRANSLATION

Therefore according to the authority of Brahmā, the Nārāyaṇa who is the predominating Deity in the transcendental world is but the vilāsa feature of Kṛṣṇa. This has now been conclusively proved.

TEXT 59

ei śloka tattva-lakṣaṇa bhāgavata-sāra

paribhāṣā-rūpe ihāra sarvatrādhikāra

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *śloka*—verse; *tattva*—the truth; *lakṣaṇa*—indicating; *bhāgavata*—of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *sāra*—the essence; *paribhāṣā*—of synonyms; *rūpe*—in the form; *ihāra*—of this (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*); *sarvatra*—everywhere; *adhikāra*—jurisdiction.

TRANSLATION

The truth indicated in this verse [text 30] is the essence of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. This conclusion, through synonyms, applies everywhere.

TEXT 60

brahma, ātmā, bhagavān—kṛṣṇera vihāra

e artha nā jāni' mūrkhā artha kare āra

SYNONYMS

brahma—impersonal Brahman; *ātmā*—Supersoul; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vihāra*—manifestations; *e*—this; *artha*—meaning; *nā*—not; *jāni'*—knowing; *mūrkhā*—fools; *artha*—meaning; *kare*—make; *āra*—other.

TRANSLATION

Not knowing that Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are all features of Kṛṣṇa, foolish scholars speculate in various ways.

TEXT 61

avatārī nārāyaṇa, kṛṣṇa avatāra

teṇha catur-bhuja, iṇha manuṣya-ākāra

SYNONYMS

avatārī—source of incarnations; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatāra*—incarnation; *teṇha*—that; *catuḥ-bhuja*—four arms; *iṇha*—this; *manuṣya*—like a man; *ākāra*—form.

TRANSLATION

Because Nārāyaṇa has four hands whereas Kṛṣṇa looks just like a man, they say that Nārāyaṇa is the original God whereas Kṛṣṇa is but an incarnation.

PURPORT

Some scholars argue that because Nārāyaṇa has four hands whereas Śrī Kṛṣṇa has only two, Nārāyaṇa is the original Personality of Godhead and Kṛṣṇa is His incarnation. Such unintelligent scholars do not understand the features of the Absolute.

TEXT 62

ei-mate nānā-rūpa kare pūrva-pakṣa

tāhāre nirjite bhāgavata-padya dakṣa

SYNONYMS

ei-mate—thus; *nānā*—many; *rūpa*—forms; *kare*—takes; *pūrva-pakṣa*—the objections; *tāhāre*—them; *nirjite*—overcoming; *bhāgavata*—of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *padya*—poetry; *dakṣa*—expert.

TRANSLATION

In this way their arguments appear in various forms, but the poetry of the Bhāgavatam expertly refutes them all.

TEXT 63

vadanti tat tattva-vidas

tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam

brahmeti paramātmeti

bhagavān iti śabdyate

SYNONYMS

vadanti—they say; *tat*—that; *tattva-vidas*—learned souls; *tattvaṁ*—the Absolute Truth; *yaj*—which; *jñānam*—knowledge; *advayam*—nondual; *brahma*—Brahman; *iti*—thus; *paramātmā*—Paramātmā; *iti*—thus; *bhagavān*—Bhagavān; *iti*—thus; *śabdyate*—is known.

TRANSLATION

“Learned transcendentalists who know the Absolute Truth say that it is nondual knowledge and is called impersonal Brahman, the localized Paramātmā and the Personality of Godhead.”

PURPORT

This text is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.2.11).

TEXT 64

śuna bhāi ei śloka karaha vicāra

eka mukhya-tattva, tina tāhāra pracāra

SYNONYMS

śuna—please listen; *bhāi*—brothers; *ei*—this; *śloka*—verse; *karaha*—please give; *vicāra*—consideration; *eka*—one; *mukhya*—principal; *tattva*—truth; *tina*—three; *tāhāra*—of that; *pracāra*—manifestations.

TRANSLATION

My dear brothers, kindly listen to the explanation of this verse and consider its meaning: the one original entity is known in His three different features.

TEXT 65

advaya-jñāna tattva-vastu kṛṣṇera svarūpa

brahma, ātmā, bhagavān—tina tāñra rūpa

SYNONYMS

advaya-jñāna—knowledge without duality; *tattva-vastu*—the Absolute Truth; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sva-rūpa*—own nature; *brahma*—Brahman; *ātmā*—Paramātmā; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *tina*—three; *tāñra*—of Him; *rūpa*—forms.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself is the one undivided Absolute Truth, the ultimate reality. He manifests Himself in three features—as Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān.

PURPORT

In the verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* cited above (*Bhāg.* 1.2.11), the principal word, *bhagavān*, indicates the Personality of Godhead, and Brahman and Paramātmā are concomitants deduced from the Absolute Personality, as a government and its ministers are deductions from the supreme executive head. In other words, the principal truth is exhibited in three different phases. The Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa (Bhagavān), is also known as Brahman and Paramātmā, although all these features are identical.

TEXT 66

ei ślokerā arthe tumi hailā nirvacana

āra eka śuna bhāgavatera vacana

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *arthe*—by the meaning; *tumi*—you; *hailā*—have become; *nirvacana*—speechless; *āra*—other; *eka*—one; *śuna*—please hear; *bhāgavatera*—of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *vacana*—speech.

TRANSLATION

The import of this verse has stopped you from arguing. Now listen to another verse of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*.

TEXT 67

ete cāmśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ

kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam

indrāri-vyākulaṁ lokam

mṛdayanti yuge yuge

SYNONYMS

ete—these; *ca*—and; *aṁśa*—plenary portions; *kalāḥ*—parts of plenary portions; *puṁsaḥ*—of the *puruṣa-avatāras*; *kṛṣṇaḥ*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tu*—but; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *svayam*—Himself; *indra-ari*—the enemies of Lord Indra; *vyākulam*—full of; *lokam*—the world; *mṛdayanti*—make happy; *yuge yuge*—at the right time in each age.

TRANSLATION

“All these incarnations of Godhead are either plenary portions or parts of the plenary portions of the *puruṣa-avatāras*. But Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself. In every age He protects the world through His different features when the world is disturbed by the enemies of Indra.”

PURPORT

This statement of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.3.28) definitely negates the concept that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is an *avatāra* of Viṣṇu or Nārāyaṇa. Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead, the supreme cause of all causes. This verse clearly indicates that incarnations of the Personality of Godhead such as Śrī Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and Varāha all undoubtedly belong to the Viṣṇu group, but all of Them are either plenary portions or portions of plenary portions of the original Personality of Godhead, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 68

saba avatārera kari sāmānya-lakṣaṇa

tāra madhye kṛṣṇa-candrera karila gaṇana

SYNONYMS

saba—all; *avatāra*—of the incarnations; *kari*—making; *sāmānya*—general; *lakṣaṇa*—symptoms; *tāra*—of them; *madhye*—in the middle; *kṛṣṇa-candra*—of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *karila*—did; *gaṇana*—counting.

TRANSLATION

The Bhāgavatam describes the symptoms and deeds of the incarnations in general and counts Śrī Kṛṣṇa among them.

TEXT 69

tabe sūta gosāñi mane pāñā baḍa bhaya

yāra ye lakṣaṇa tāhā karila niścaya

SYNONYMS

tabe—then; *sūta gosāñi*—Sūta Gosvāmī; *mane*—in the mind; *pāñā*—obtaining; *baḍa*—great; *bhaya*—fear; *yāra*—of whom; *ye*—which; *lakṣaṇa*—symptoms; *tāhā*—that; *karila*—he made; *niścaya*—certainly.

TRANSLATION

This made Sūta Gosvāmī greatly apprehensive. Therefore he distinguished each incarnation by its specific symptoms.

TEXT 70

avatāra saba—puruṣera kalā, amśa

svayaṁ-bhagavān kṛṣṇa sarva-avatamśa

SYNONYMS

avatāra—the incarnations; *saba*—all; *puruṣera*—of the *puruṣa-avatāras*; *kalā*—parts of plenary portions; *aṁśa*—plenary portions; *svayam*—Himself; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sarva*—of all; *avataṁsa*—crest.

TRANSLATION

All the incarnations of Godhead are plenary portions or parts of the plenary portions of the *puruṣa-avatāras*, but the primeval Lord is Śrī Kṛṣṇa. He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the fountainhead of all incarnations.

TEXT 71

pūrva-pakṣa kahe — — *tomāra bhāla ta' vyākhyāna*

paravyoma-nārāyaṇa svayaṁ-bhagavān

SYNONYMS

pūrva-pakṣa—opposing side; *kahe*—says; *tomāra*—your; *bhāla*—nice; *ta'*—certainly; *vyākhyāna*—exposition; *para-vyoma*—situated in the spiritual sky; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *svayam*—Himself; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

An opponent may say, “This is your interpretation, but actually the Supreme Lord is Nārāyaṇa, who is in the transcendental realm.

TEXT 72

teṇha āśi' kṛṣṇa-rūpe kareṇa avatāra

ei artha śloke dekhi ki āra vicāra

SYNONYMS

ten̥ha—He (Nārāyaṇa); *āsi'*—coming; *kṛṣṇa-rūpe*—in the form of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karena*—makes; *avatāra*—incarnation; *ei*—this; *artha*—meaning; *śloke*—in the verse; *dekhi*—I see; *ki*—what; *āra*—other; *vicāra*—consideration.

TRANSLATION

“He [Nārāyaṇa] incarnates as Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is the meaning of the verse as I see it. There is no need for further consideration.”

TEXT 73

tāre kahe—*kene kara kutarkānumāna*

śāstra-viruddhārtha kabhu nā haya pramāṇa

SYNONYMS

tāre—to him; *kahe*—one says; *kene*—why; *kara*—you make; *kutarka*—of a fallacious argument; *anumāna*—conjecture; *śāstra-viruddha*—contrary to scripture; *artha*—a meaning; *kabhu*—at any time; *nā*—not; *haya*—is; *pramāṇa*—evidence.

TRANSLATION

To such a misguided interpreter we may reply, “Why should you suggest such fallacious logic? An interpretation is never accepted as evidence if it opposes the principles of scripture.

TEXT 74

anuvādam anuktvā tu

na vidheyam udīrayet

na hy alabdhāspadam kiñcit

kutrācit pratītiṣṭhati

SYNONYMS

anuvādam—the subject; *anuktvā*—not stating; *tu*—but; *na*—not; *vidheyam*—the predicate; *udīrayet*—one should speak; *na*—not; *hi*—certainly; *alabdhā-āspadam*—without a secure position; *kiñcit*—something; *kutrācit*—anywhere; *pratītiṣṭhati*—stands.

TRANSLATION

“One should not state a predicate before its subject, for it cannot thus stand without proper support.”

PURPORT

This rhetorical rule appears in the *Ekādaśī-tattva*, Thirteenth Canto, in connection with the metaphorical use of words. An unknown object should not be put before the known subject because the object has no meaning if the subject is not first given.

TEXT 75

anuvāda nā kahiṃ nā kahi vidheya

āge anuvāda kahi, paścād vidheya

SYNONYMS

anuvāda—the subject; *nā kahiṃ*—not saying; *nā*—not; *kahi*—I say; *vidheya*—the predicate; *āge*—first; *anuvāda*—the subject; *kahi*—I say;

paścāt—afterwards; *vidheya*—the predicate.

TRANSLATION

“If I do not state a subject, I do not state a predicate. First I speak the former and then I speak the latter.

TEXT 76

‘vidheya’ kahiye tāre, ye vastu ajñāta

‘anuvāda’ kahi tāre, yei haya jñāta

SYNONYMS

vidheya—the predicate; *kahiye*—I say; *tāre*—to him; *ye*—that; *vastu*—thing; *ajñāta*—unknown; *anuvāda*—the subject; *kahi*—I say; *tāre*—to him; *yei*—that which; *haya*—is; *jñāta*—known.

TRANSLATION

“The predicate of a sentence is what is unknown to the reader, whereas the subject is what is known to him.

TEXT 77

yaiche kahi, — — ei vipra parama paṇḍita

vipra — — anuvāda, ihāra vidheya — — pāṇḍitya

SYNONYMS

yaiche—just as; *kahi*—I say; *ei*—this; *vipra*—*brāhmaṇa*; *parama*—great; *paṇḍita*—learned man; *vipra*—the *brāhmaṇa*; *anuvāda*—subject; *ihāra*—of this; *vidheya*—predicate; *pāṇḍitya*—erudition.

TRANSLATION

“For example, we may say, ‘This vipra is a greatly learned man.’ In this sentence, the vipra is the subject, and the predicate is his erudition.

TEXT 78

vipratva vikhyāta tāra pāṇḍitya ajñāta

ataeva vipra āge, pāṇḍitya paścāta

SYNONYMS

vipratva—the quality of being a *vipra*; *vikhyāta*—well known; *tāra*—his; *pāṇḍitya*—erudition; *ajñāta*—unknown; *ataeva*—therefore; *vipra*—the word *vipra*; *āge*—first; *pāṇḍitya*—erudition; *paścāta*—afterwards.

TRANSLATION

“The man’s being a vipra is known, but his erudition is unknown. Therefore the person is identified first and his erudition later.

TEXT 79

taiche inha avatāra saba haila jñāta

kāra avatāra?—ei vastu avijñāta

SYNONYMS

taiche—in the same way; *inha*—these; *avatāra*—incarnations; *saba*—all; *haila*—were; *jñāta*—known; *kāra*—whose; *avatāra*—incarnations; *ei*—this; *vastu*—thing; *avijñāta*—unknown.

TRANSLATION

“In the same way, all these incarnations were known, but whose incarnations they are was unknown.

TEXT 80

‘ete’-śabde avatārera āge anuvāda

‘puruṣera aṁśa’ pāche vidheya-saṁvāda

SYNONYMS

ete-śabde—in the word *ete* (these); *avatārera*—of the incarnations; *āge*—first; *anuvāda*—the subject; *puruṣera*—of the *puruṣa-avatāras*; *aṁśa*—plenary portions; *pāche*—afterwards; *vidheya*—of the predicate; *saṁvāda*—message.

TRANSLATION

“First the word ‘ete’ [‘these’] establishes the subject [the incarnations]. Then ‘plenary portions of the puruṣa-avatāras’ follows as the predicate.

TEXT 81

taiche kṛṣṇa avatāra-bhitare haila jñāta

tānhāra viśeṣa-jñāna sei avijñāta

SYNONYMS

taiche—in the same way; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatāra-bhitare*—among the incarnations; *haila*—was; *jñāta*—known; *tānhāra*—of Him; *viśeṣa-jñāna*—specific knowledge; *sei*—that; *avijñāta*—unknown.

TRANSLATION

“In the same way, when Kṛṣṇa was first counted among the incarnations, specific knowledge about Him was still unknown.

TEXT 82

ataeva ‘kṛṣṇa’-śabda āge anuvāda

‘svayam-bhagavattā’ piche vidheya-saṁvāda

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *kṛṣṇa-śabda*—the word *kṛṣṇa*; *āge*—first; *anuvāda*—the subject; *svayam-bhagavattā*—being Himself the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *piche*—afterwards; *vidheya*—of the predicate; *saṁvāda*—the message

TRANSLATION

“Therefore first the word ‘kṛṣṇa’ appears as the subject, followed by the predicate, describing Him as the original Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 83

kṛṣṇera svayam-bhagavattā—ihā haila sādhyā

svayam-bhagavānera kṛṣṇatva haila bādhyā

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *svayam-bhagavattā*—the quality of being Himself the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *ihā*—this; *haila*—was; *sādhyā*—to be established; *svayam-bhagavānera*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇatva*—the quality of being Lord Kṛṣṇa; *haila*—was; *bādhyā*—obligatory

TRANSLATION

“This establishes that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead. The original Personality of Godhead is therefore necessarily Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 84

kṛṣṇa yadi amśa haita, amśi nārāyaṇa

tabe viparīta haita sūtera vacana

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yadi*—if; *amśa*—plenary portion; *haita*—were; *amśi*—the source of all expansions; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *tabe*—then; *viparīta*—the reverse; *haita*—would have been; *sūtera*—of Sūta Gosvāmī; *vacana*—the statement.

TRANSLATION

“Had Kṛṣṇa been the plenary portion and Nārāyaṇa the primeval Lord, the statement of Sūta Gosvāmī would have been reversed.

TEXT 85

nārāyaṇa amśi yei svayam-bhagavān

tenha śrī-kṛṣṇa— —aiche karita vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇa—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *amśi*—the source of all incarnations; *yei*—who; *svayam-bhagavān*—Himself the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *tenha*—He; *śrī-kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *aiche*—in such away; *karita*—would have made; *vyākhyāna*—explanation.

TRANSLATION

“Thus he would have said, ‘Nārāyaṇa, the source of all incarnations, is the original Personality of Godhead. He has appeared as Śrī Kṛṣṇa.’

TEXT 86

bhrama, pramāda, vipralipsā, karaṇāpāṭava

ārṣa-vijñā-vākye nāhi doṣa ei saba

SYNONYMS

bhrama—mistakes; *pramāda*—illusion; *vipralipsā*—cheating; *karaṇa-apāṭava*—imperfectness of the senses; *ārṣa*—of the authoritative sages; *vijñā-vākye*—in the wise speech; *nāhi*—not; *doṣa*—faults; *ei*—these; *saba*—all.

TRANSLATION

“Mistakes, illusions, cheating and defective perception do not occur in the sayings of the authoritative sages.

PURPORT

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam has listed the *avatāras*, the plenary expansions of the *puruṣa*, and Lord Kṛṣṇa appears among them. But the *Bhāgavatam* further explains Lord Kṛṣṇa’s specific position as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Since Lord Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead, reason and argument establish that His position is always supreme.

Had Kṛṣṇa been a plenary expansion of Nārāyaṇa, the original verse would have been differently composed; indeed, its order would have been reversed. But there cannot be mistakes, illusion, cheating or imperfect

perception in the words of liberated sages. Therefore there is no mistake in this statement that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Sanskrit statements of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* are all transcendental sounds. Śrīla Vyāsadeva revealed these statements after perfect realization, and therefore they are perfect, for liberated sages like Vyāsadeva never commit errors in their rhetorical arrangements. Unless one accepts this fact, there is no use in trying to obtain help from the revealed scriptures.

Bhrama refers to false knowledge or mistakes, such as accepting a rope as a snake or an oyster shell as gold. *Pramāda* refers to inattention or misunderstanding of reality, and *vipralipsā* is the cheating propensity. *Karaṇāpāṭava* refers to imperfectness of the material senses. There are many examples of such imperfection. The eyes cannot see that which is very distant or very small. One cannot even see his own eyelid, which is the closest thing to his eye, and if one is disturbed by a disease like jaundice, he sees everything to be yellow. Similarly, the ears cannot hear distant sounds. Since the Personality of Godhead and His plenary portions and self-realized devotees are all transcendently situated, they cannot be misled by such deficiencies.

TEXT 87

viruddhārtha kaha tumi, kahite kara roṣa

tomāra arthe avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa-doṣa

SYNONYMS

viruddha-artha—contrary meaning; *kaha*—say; *tumi*—you; *kahite*—pointing out; *kara*—you do; *roṣa*—anger; *tomāra*—your; *arthe*—in the meaning; *avimṛṣṭa-vidheya-aṁśa*—of the unconsidered predicate portion; *doṣa*—the fault.

TRANSLATION

“You say something contradictory and become angry when this is pointed out. Your explanation has the defect of a misplaced object. This is an unconsidered adjustment.

TEXT 88

yāñra bhagavattā haite anyera bhagavattā

‘svayaṁ-bhagavān’-śabdera tāhātei sattā

SYNONYMS

yāñra—of whom; *bhagavattā*—the quality of being the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *haite*—from; *anyera*—of others; *bhagavattā*—the quality of being the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *svayaṁ-bhagavān-śabdera*—of the word *svayaṁ-bhagavān*; *tāhātei*—in that; *sattā*—the presence.

TRANSLATION

“Only the Personality of Godhead, the source of all other Divinities, is eligible to be designated *svayaṁ bhagavān*, or the primeval Lord.

TEXT 89

dīpa haite yaiche bahu dīpera jvalana

mūla eka dīpa tāhā kariye gaṇana

SYNONYMS

dīpa—a lamp; *haite*—from; *yaiche*—just as; *bahu*—many; *dīpera*—of lamps; *jvalana*—lighting; *mūla*—the original; *eka*—one; *dīpa*—lamp; *tāhā*—that; *kariye*—I make; *gaṇana*—consideration

TRANSLATION

“When from one candle many others are lit, I consider that one the original.

PURPORT

The *Brahma-saṁhitā*, Chapter Five, verse 46, states that the *viṣṇu-tattva*, or the principle of the Absolute Personality of Godhead, is like a lamp because the expansions equal their origin in all respects. A burning lamp can light innumerable other lamps, and although they will not be inferior, still the lamp from which the others are lit must be considered the original. Similarly, the Supreme Personality of Godhead expands Himself in the plenary forms of the *viṣṇu-tattva*, and although they are equally powerful, the original powerful Personality of Godhead is considered the source. This analogy also explains the appearance of qualitative incarnations like Lord Śiva and Lord Brahmā. According to Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, *śambhus tu tamo-'dhiṣṭhānatvāt kajjalamaya-sūkṣma-dīpa-sikhā-sthānīyasya na tathā sāmyam*: “The *śambhu-tattva*, or the principle of Lord Śiva, is like a lamp covered with carbon because of his being in charge of the mode of ignorance. The illumination from such a lamp is very minute. Therefore the power of Lord Śiva cannot compare to that of the Viṣṇu principle.”

TEXT 90

taiche saba avatārera kṛṣṇa se kāraṇa

āra eka śloka śuna, kuvyākhyā-khaṇḍana

SYNONYMS

taiche—in a similar way; *saba*—all; *avatārera*—of the incarnations; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *se*—He; *kāraṇa*—the cause; *āra*—another; *eka*—one; *śloka*—verse; *śuna*—please hear; *ku-vyākhyā*—fallacious

explanations; *khaṇḍana*—refuting.

TRANSLATION

“Kṛṣṇa, in the same way, is the cause of all causes and all incarnations. Please hear another verse to defeat all misinterpretations.

TEXTS 91–92

atra sargo visargaś ca

sthānam poṣaṇam ūtayaḥ

manvantaresānukathā

nirodho muktir āśrayaḥ

daśamasya viśuddhy-artham

navānām iha lakṣaṇam

varṇayanti mahātmānaḥ

śrutenārthena cāñjasā

SYNONYMS

atra—in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *sargaḥ*—the creation of the ingredients of the universe; *visargaḥ*—the creations of Brahmā; *ca*—and; *sthānam*—the maintenance of the creation; *poṣaṇam*—the favoring of the Lord’s devotees; *ūtayaḥ*—impetuses for activity; *manu-antara*—prescribed duties given by the Manus; *īśa-anukathāḥ*—a description of the incarnations of the Lord; *nirodhaḥ*—the winding up of creation; *muktiḥ*—liberation; *āśrayaḥ*—the ultimate shelter, the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *daśamasya*—of the tenth (the *āśraya*); *viśuddhi-*

artham—for the purpose of perfect knowledge; *navānām*—of the nine; *iha*—here; *lakṣaṇam*—the nature; *varṇayanti*—describe; *mahā-ātmānaḥ*—the great souls; *śrutena*—by prayer; *arthena*—by explanation; *ca*—and; *añjasā*—direct.

TRANSLATION

“Here [in Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam] ten subjects are described: (1) the creation of the ingredients of the cosmos, (2) the creations of Brahmā, (3) the maintenance of the creation, (4) special favor given to the faithful, (5) impetuses for activity, (6) prescribed duties for law-abiding men, (7) a description of the incarnations of the Lord, (8) the winding up of the creation, (9) liberation from gross and subtle material existence, and (10) the ultimate shelter, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The tenth item is the shelter of all the others. To distinguish this ultimate shelter from the other nine subjects, the mahājanas have described these nine, directly or indirectly, through prayers or direct explanations.’

PURPORT

These verses from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (2.10.1–2) list the ten subject matters dealt with in the text of the *Bhāgavatam*. Of these, the tenth is the substance, and the other nine are categories derived from the substance. These ten subjects are listed as follows:

(1) *Sarga*: the first creation by Viṣṇu, the bringing forth of the five gross material elements, the five objects of sense perception, the ten senses, the mind, the intelligence, the false ego and the total material energy, or universal form.

(2) *Visarga*: the secondary creation, or the work of Brahmā in producing the moving and unmoving bodies in the universe (*brahmāṇḍa*).

(3) *Sthāna*: the maintenance of the universe by the Personality of Godhead, Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu’s function is more important and His glory

greater than Brahmā's and Lord Śiva's, for although Brahmā is the creator and Lord Śiva the destroyer, Viṣṇu is the maintainer.

(4) *Poṣaṇa*: special care and protection for devotees by the Lord. As a king maintains his kingdom and subjects but nevertheless gives special attention to the members of his family, so the Personality of Godhead gives special care to His devotees who are souls completely surrendered to Him.

(5) *Ūti*: the urge for creation, or initiative power, that is the cause of all inventions, according to the necessities of time, space and objects.

(6) *Manv-antara*: the periods controlled by the Manus, who teach regulative principles for living beings who desire to achieve perfection in human life. The rules of Manu, as described in the *Manu-saṁhitā*, guide the way to such perfection.

(7) *Īśānukathā*: scriptural information regarding the Personality of Godhead, His incarnations on earth and the activities of His devotees. Scriptures dealing with these subjects are essential for progressive human life.

(8) *Nirodha*: the winding up of all energies employed in creation. Such potencies are emanations from the Personality of Godhead who eternally lies in the Kāraṇa Ocean. The cosmic creations, manifested with His breath, are again dissolved in due course.

(9) *Mukti*: liberation of the conditioned souls encaged by the gross and subtle coverings of body and mind. When freed from all material affection, the soul, giving up the gross and subtle material bodies, can attain the spiritual sky in his original spiritual body and engage in transcendental loving service to the Lord in Vaikuṇṭhaloka or Kṛṣṇaloka. When the soul is situated in his original constitutional position of existence, he is said to be liberated. It is possible to engage in transcendental loving service to the Lord and become *jīvan-mukta*, a

liberated soul, even while in the material body.

(10) *Āśraya*: the Transcendence, the summum bonum, from whom everything emanates, upon whom everything rests, and in whom everything merges after annihilation. He is the source and support of all. The *āśraya* is also called the Supreme Brahman, as in the *Vedānta-sūtra* (*athāto brahma jijñāsā, janmādy asya yataḥ* [SB 1.1.1]). *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* especially describes this Supreme Brahman as the *āśraya*. Śrī Kṛṣṇa is this *āśraya*, and therefore the greatest necessity of life is to study the science of Kṛṣṇa.

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam accepts Śrī Kṛṣṇa as the shelter of all manifestations because Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the ultimate source of everything, the supreme goal of all.

Two different principles are to be considered herein—namely *āśraya*, the object providing shelter, and *āśrita*, the dependents requiring shelter. The *āśrita* exist under the original principle, the *āśraya*. The first nine categories, described in the first nine cantos of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, from creation to liberation—including the *puruṣa-avatāras*, the incarnations, the marginal energy, or living entities, and the external energy, or material world—are all *āśrita*. The prayers of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, however, aim for the *āśraya-tattva*, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Śrī Kṛṣṇa. The great souls expert in describing *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* have very diligently delineated the other nine categories, sometimes by direct narrations and sometimes by indirect narrations such as stories. The real purpose of doing this is to know perfectly the Absolute Transcendence, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, for the entire creation, both material and spiritual, rests on the body of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 93

āśraya jānīte kahi e nava padārtha

e navera utpatti-hetu sei āśrayārtha

SYNONYMS

āśraya—the ultimate shelter; *jānite*—to know; *kahi*—I discuss; *e*—these; *nava*—nine; *pada-artha*—categories; *e*—these; *navera*—of the nine; *utpatti*—of the origin; *hetu*—cause; *sei*—that; *āśraya*—of the shelter; *artha*—the meaning.

TRANSLATION

“To know distinctly the ultimate shelter of everything that be, I have described the other nine categories. The cause for the appearance of these nine is rightly called their shelter.

TEXT 94

kṛṣṇa eka sarvāśraya, kṛṣṇa sarva-dhāma

kṛṣṇera śarīre sarva-viśvera viśrāma

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *eka*—one; *sarva-āśraya*—shelter of all; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sarva-dhāma*—the abode of all; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *śarīre*—in the body; *sarva-viśvera*—of all the universes; *viśrāma*—resting place.

TRANSLATION

“The Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the shelter and abode of everything. All the universes rest in His body.

TEXT 95

daśame daśamaṁ lakṣyam

āśritāśraya-vigrahaṁ

śrī-kṛṣṇākhyam param dhāma

jagad-dhāma namāmi tat

SYNONYMS

daśame—in the Tenth Canto; *daśamam*—the tenth subject matter; *lakṣyam*—to be seen; *āśrita*—of the sheltered; *āśraya*—of the shelter; *vigraham*—who is the form; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-ākhyam*—known as Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *param*—supreme; *dhāma*—abode; *jagad-dhāma*—the abode of the universes; *namāmi*—I offer my obeisances; *tat*—to Him.

TRANSLATION

“The Tenth Canto of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam reveals the tenth object, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is the shelter of all surrendered souls. He is known as Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and He is the ultimate source of all the universes. Let me offer my obeisances unto Him.’

PURPORT

This quotation comes from Śrīdhara Svāmī’s commentary on the first verse of the Tenth Canto, Chapter One, of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*.

TEXT 96

kṛṣṇera svarūpa, āra śakti-traya-jñāna

yānra haya, tānra nāhi kṛṣṇete ajñāna

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sva-rūpa*—the real nature; *āra*—and; *śakti-traya*—of the three energies; *jñāna*—knowledge; *yānra*—whose; *haya*—there is; *tānra*—of him; *nāhi*—there is not; *kṛṣṇete*—in Lord Kṛṣṇa;

ajñāna—ignorance.

TRANSLATION

“One who knows the real feature of Śrī Kṛṣṇa and His three different energies cannot remain ignorant about Him.

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī states in his *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (16) that by His potencies, which act in natural sequences beyond the scope of the speculative human mind, the Supreme Transcendence, the summum bonum, eternally and simultaneously exists in four transcendental features: His personality, His impersonal effulgence, particles of His potency (the living beings), and the principal cause of all causes. The Supreme Whole is compared to the sun, which also exists in four features, namely the personality of the sun-god, the glare of his glowing sphere, the sun rays inside the sun planet, and the sun’s reflections in many other objects. The ambition to corroborate the existence of the transcendental Absolute Truth by limited conjectural endeavors cannot be fulfilled, because He is beyond the scope of our limited speculative minds. In an honest search for truth, we must admit that His powers are inconceivable to our tiny brains. The exploration of space has demanded the work of the greatest scientists of the world, yet there are countless problems regarding even fundamental knowledge of the material creation that bewilder scientists who confront them. Such material knowledge is far removed from the spiritual nature, and therefore the acts and arrangements of the Absolute Truth are, beyond all doubts, inconceivable.

The primary potencies of the Absolute Truth are mentioned to be three: internal, external and marginal. By the acts of His internal potency, the Personality of Godhead in His original form exhibits the spiritual cosmic manifestations known as the *Vaikuṇṭhalokas*, which exist eternally, even after the destruction of the material cosmic manifestation. By His

marginal potency the Lord expands Himself as living beings who are part of Him, just as the sun distributes its rays in all directions. By His external potency the Lord manifests the material creation, just as the sun with its rays creates fog. The material creation is but a perverse reflection of the eternal *Vaikuṇṭha* nature.

These three energies of the Absolute Truth are also described in the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, where it is said that the living being is equal in quality to the internal potency, whereas the external potency is indirectly controlled by the chief cause of all causes. *Māyā*, the illusory energy, misleads a living being as fog misleads a pedestrian by blocking off the light of the sun. Although the potency of *māyā* is inferior in quality to the marginal potency, which consists of the living beings, who are part and parcel of the Lord, it nevertheless has the power to control the living beings, just as fog can block the actions of a certain portion of the sun's rays although it cannot cover the sun. The living beings covered by the illusory energy evolve in different species of life, with bodies ranging from that of an insignificant ant to that of *Brahmā*, the constructor of the cosmos. The *pradhāna*, the chief cause of all causes in the impersonal vision, is none other than the Supreme Lord, whom one can see face to face in the internal potency. He takes the material all-pervasive form by His inconceivable power. Although all three potencies—namely internal, external and marginal—are essentially one in the ultimate issue, they are different in action, like electric energy, which can produce both cold and heat under different conditions. The external and marginal potencies are so called under various conditions, but in the original, internal potencies there are no such conditions, nor is it possible for the conditions of the external potency to exist in the marginal, or vice versa. One who is able to understand the intricacies of all these energies of the Supreme Lord can no longer remain an empiric impersonalist under the influence of a poor fund of knowledge.

TEXT 97

kṛṣṇera svarūpera haya ṣaḍ-vidha vilāsa

prābhava-vaibhava-rūpe dvi-vidha prakāśa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *svarūpera*—of the form; *haya*—there are; *ṣaṭ-vidha*—six kinds; *vīlāsa*—pastime forms; *prābhava-vaibhava-rūpe*—in the divisions of *prābhava* and *vaibhava*; *dvi-vidha*—two kinds; *prakāśa*—manifestations.

TRANSLATION

“The Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa enjoys Himself in six primary expansions. His two manifestations are *prābhava* and *vaibhava*.

PURPORT

Now the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* turns to a description of the Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa in His innumerable expansions. The Lord primarily expands Himself in two categories, namely *prābhava* and *vaibhava*. The *prābhava* forms are fully potent like Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and the *vaibhava* forms are partially potent. The *prābhava* forms are manifested in relation with potencies, but the *vaibhava* forms are manifested in relation with excellences. The potent *prābhava* manifestations are also of two varieties: temporary and eternal. The Mohinī, Hamsa and Śukla forms are manifested only temporarily, in terms of a particular age. Among the other *prābhavas*, who are not very famous according to the material estimation, are Dhanvantari, Rṣabha, Vyāsa, Dattātreya and Kapila. Among the *vaibhava-prakāśa* forms are Kūrma, Matsya, Nara-Nārāyaṇa, Varāha, Hayagrīva, Pṛśnigarbha, Baladeva, Yajña, Vibhu, Satyasena, Hari, Vaikuṇṭha, Ajita, Vāmana, Sārvabhauma, Rṣabha, Viṣvaksena, Dharmasetu, Sudhāmā, Yogeśvara and Bṛhadbhānu.

TEXT 98

aṁśa-śaktyāveśa-rūpe dvi-vidhāvatāra

bālya paugaṇḍa dharma dui ta' prakāra

SYNONYMS

aṁśa—of the plenary expansion; *śakti-āveśa*—of the empowered; *rūpe*—in the forms; *dvi-vidha*—two kinds; *avatāra*—incarnations; *bālya*—childhood; *paugaṇḍa*—boyhood; *dharma*—characteristics of age; *dui*—two; *ta'*—certainly; *prakāra*—kinds

TRANSLATION

“His incarnations are of two kinds, namely partial and empowered. He appears in two ages—childhood and boyhood.

PURPORT

The *vilāsa* forms are six in number. Incarnations are of two varieties, namely *śakty-āveśa* (empowered) and *aṁśāveśa* (partial). These incarnations also come within the category of *prābhava* and *vaibhava* manifestations. Childhood and boyhood are two special features of the Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa, but His permanent feature is His eternal form as an adolescent youth. The original Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa is always worshiped in this eternal adolescent form.

TEXT 99

kiśora-svarūpa kṛṣṇa svayaṁ avatārī

krīḍā kare ei chaya-rūpe viśva bhari'

SYNONYMS

kiśora-svarūpa—whose real nature is that of an adolescent; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *svayaṁ*—Himself; *avatārī*—the source of all incarnations; *krīḍā kare*—He plays; *ei*—these; *chaya-rūpe*—in six forms; *viśva*—the

universes; *bhari'*—maintaining

TRANSLATION

“The Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who is eternally an adolescent, is the primeval Lord, the source of all incarnations. He expands Himself in these six categories of forms to establish His supremacy throughout the universe.

TEXT 100

ei chaya-rūpe haya ananta vibheda

ananta-rūpe eka-rūpa, nāhi kichu bheda

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *chaya-rūpe*—in six forms; *haya*—there are; *ananta*—unlimited; *vibheda*—varieties; *ananta-rūpe*—in unlimited forms; *eka-rūpa*—one form; *nāhi*—there is not; *kichu*—any; *bheda*—difference.

TRANSLATION

“In these six kinds of forms there are innumerable varieties. Although they are many, they are all one: there is no difference between them.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead manifests Himself in six different features: (1) *prābhava*, (2) *vaibhava*, (3) empowered incarnations, (4) partial incarnations, (5) childhood and (6) boyhood. The Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa, whose permanent feature is adolescence, enjoys His transcendental proclivities by performing pastimes in these six forms. In these six features there are unlimited divisions of the Personality of Godhead's forms. The *jīvas*, or living beings, are differentiated parts and

parcels of the Lord. They are all diversities of the one without a second, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 101

cit-chakti, svarūpa-śakti, antaraṅgā nāma

tāhāra vaibhava ananta vaikuṇṭhādi dhāma

SYNONYMS

cit-śakti—spiritual energy; *svarūpa-śakti*—personal energy; *antaḥ-aṅgā*—internal; *nāma*—named; *tāhāra*—of that; *vaibhava*—manifestations; *ananta*—unlimited; *vaikuṇṭha-ādi*—Vaikuṇṭha, etc.; *dhāma*—abodes.

TRANSLATION

“The cit-śakti, which is also called svarūpa-śakti or antaraṅga-śakti, displays many varied manifestations. It sustains the kingdom of God and its paraphernalia.

TEXT 102

māyā-śakti, bahiraṅgā, jagat-kāraṇa

tāhāra vaibhava ananta brahmāṇḍera gaṇa

SYNONYMS

māyā-śakti—the illusory energy; *bahir-aṅgā*—external; *jagat-kāraṇa*—the cause of the universe; *tāhāra*—of that; *vaibhava*—manifestations; *ananta*—unlimited; *brahma-aṇḍera*—of universes; *gaṇa*—multitudes.

TRANSLATION

“The external energy, called *māyā-śakti*, is the cause of innumerable universes with varied material potencies.

TEXT 103

jīva-śakti taṭasthākhyā, nāhi yāra anta

mukhya tina śakti, tāra vibheda ananta

SYNONYMS

jīva-śakti—the energy of the living entity; *taṭa-stha-ākhyā*—known as marginal; *nāhi*—there is not; *yāra*—of which; *anta*—end; *mukhya*—principal; *tina*—three; *śakti*—energies; *tāra*—of them; *vibheda*—varieties; *ananta*—unlimited.

TRANSLATION

“The marginal potency, which is between these two, consists of the numberless living beings. These are the three principal energies, which have unlimited categories and subdivisions.

PURPORT

The internal potency of the Lord, which is called *cit-śakti* or *antaraṅga-śakti*, exhibits variegatedness in the transcendental *Vaikuṇṭha* cosmos. Besides ourselves, there are unlimited numbers of liberated living beings who associate with the Personality of Godhead in His innumerable features. The material cosmos displays the external energy, in which the conditioned living beings are provided all liberty to go back to the Personality of Godhead after leaving the material tabernacle. The *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* (6.8) informs us:

*na tasya kāryaṁ karaṇaṁ ca vidyate
na tat-samaś cābhyadhikaś ca dṛśyate*

*parāśya śaktir vividhaiva śrūyate
svābhāvikī jñāna-bala-kriyā ca*

“The Supreme Lord is one without a second. He has nothing to do personally, nor does He have material senses. No one is equal to Him or greater than Him. He has unlimited, variegated potencies of different names, which exist within Him as autonomous attributes and provide Him full knowledge, power and pastimes.”

TEXT 104

e-mata svarūpa-gaṇa, āra tina śakti

sabhāra āśraya kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇe sabhāra sthiti

SYNONYMS

e-mata—in this way; *svarūpa-gaṇa*—personal forms; *āra*—and; *tina*—three; *śakti*—energies; *sabhāra*—of the whole assembly; *āśraya*—the shelter; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṣṇe*—in Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sabhāra*—of the whole assembly; *sthiti*—the existence.

TRANSLATION

“These are the principal manifestations and expansions of the Personality of Godhead and His three energies. They are all emanations from Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Transcendence. They have their existence in Him.

TEXT 105

yadyapi brahmāṇḍa-gaṇera puruṣa āśraya

sei puruṣādi sabhāra kṛṣṇa mūlāśraya

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *brahma-aṇḍa-gaṇera*—of the multitude of universes; *puruṣa*—the *puruṣa-avatāra*; *āśraya*—the shelter; *sei*—that; *puruṣa-ādi*—of the *puruṣa-avatāras*, etc.; *sabhāra*—of the assembly; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mūla-āśraya*—original source.

TRANSLATION

“Although the three puruṣas are the shelter of all the universes, Lord Kṛṣṇa is the original source of the puruṣas.

TEXT 106

svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa sarvāśraya

parama īśvara kṛṣṇa sarva-śāstre kaya

SYNONYMS

svayaṁ—Himself; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sarva-āśraya*—the shelter of all; *parama*—Supreme; *īśvara*—Lord; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sarva-śāstre*—all scriptures; *kaya*—say.

TRANSLATION

“Thus the Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the original, primeval Lord, the source of all other expansions. All the revealed scriptures accept Śrī Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Lord.

TEXT 107

īśvaraḥ paramaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ

sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ

anādir ādir govindaḥ

sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam

SYNONYMS

īśvaraḥ—the controller; *paramaḥ*—supreme; *kṛṣṇaḥ*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sat*—eternal existence; *cit*—absolute knowledge; *ānanda*—absolute bliss; *vigrahaḥ*—whose form; *anādiḥ*—without beginning; *ādiḥ*—the origin; *govindaḥ*—Lord Govinda; *sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam*—the cause of all causes.

TRANSLATION

“Kṛṣṇa, who is known as Govinda, is the supreme controller. He has an eternal, blissful, spiritual body. He is the origin of all. He has no other origin, for He is the prime cause of all causes.”

PURPORT

This is the first verse of the Fifth Chapter of the *Brahma-saṁhitā* [Bs. 5.1].

TEXT 108

e saba siddhānta tumi jāna bhāla-mate

tabu pūrva-pakṣa kara āmā cālāite

SYNONYMS

e—these; *saba*—all; *siddhānta*—conclusions; *tumi*—you; *jāna*—know; *bhāla-mate*—in a good way; *tabu*—still; *pūrva-pakṣa*—objection; *kara*—you make; *āmā*—to me; *cālāite*—to give useless anxiety.

TRANSLATION

“You know all the conclusions of the scriptures very well. You create these logical arguments just to agitate me.”

PURPORT

A learned man who has thoroughly studied the scriptures cannot hesitate to accept Śrī Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. If such a man argues about this matter, certainly he must be doing so to agitate the minds of his opponents.

TEXT 109

sei kṛṣṇa avatārī vrajendra-kumāra

āpane caitanya-rūpe kaila avatāra

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatārī*—the source of all incarnations; *vrajendra-kumāra*—the son of the King of Vraja; *āpane*—personally; *caitanya-rūpe*—in the form of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kaila*—made; *avatāra*—incarnation.

TRANSLATION

That same Lord Kṛṣṇa, the fountainhead of all incarnations, is known as the son of the King of Vraja. He has descended personally as Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 110

ataeva caitanya gosāñi paratattva-sīmā

tāñre kṣīroda-śāyī kahi, ki tāñra mahimā

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *caitanya gosāñi*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *para-tattva-sīmā*—the highest limit of the Absolute Truth; *tāñre*—Him; *kṣīroda-śāyī*—Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *kahi*—if I say; *ki*—what; *tāñra*—of Him; *mahimā*—glory.

TRANSLATION

Therefore Lord Caitanya is the Supreme Absolute Truth. To call Him Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu does not add to His glory.

TEXT 111

sei ta' bhaktera vākya nahe vyabhicārī

sakala sambhave tāñte, yāte avatārī

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *ta'*—certainly; *bhaktera*—of a devotee; *vākya*—speech; *nahe*—is not; *vyabhicārī*—deviation; *sakala*—all; *sambhave*—possibilities; *tāñte*—in Him; *yāte*—since; *avatārī*—the source of all incarnations.

TRANSLATION

But such words from the lips of a sincere devotee cannot be false. All possibilities abide in Him, for He is the primeval Lord.

TEXT 112

avatārīra dehe saba avatārera sthiti

keho kona-mate kahe, yemana yāra matī

SYNONYMS

avatārīra—of the source; *dehe*—in the body; *saba*—all; *avatārera*—of the incarnations; *sthiti*—existence; *keho*—someone; *kona-mate*—in some way; *kahe*—says; *yemana*—as in the manner; *yāra*—of whom; *matī*—the opinion.

TRANSLATION

All other incarnations are situated in potential form in the original body of the primeval Lord. Thus according to one's opinion, one may address Him as any one of the incarnations.

PURPORT

It is not contradictory for a devotee to call the Supreme Lord by any one of the various names of His plenary expansions, because the original Personality of Godhead includes all such categories. Since the plenary expansions exist within the original person, one may call Him by any of these names. In *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata* (*Madhya* 6.95) Lord Caitanya says, “I was lying asleep in the ocean of milk, but I was awakened by the call of Nāḍā, Śrī Advaita Prabhu.” Here the Lord refers to His form as Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu.

TEXT 113

kṛṣṇake kahaye keha—nara-nārāyaṇa

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa haya sākṣāt vāmana

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇake—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kahaye*—says; *keha*—someone; *nara-nārāyaṇa*—

Nara-Nārāyaṇa; *keho*—someone; *kahe*—says; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *haya*—is; *sākṣāt*—directly; *vāmana*—Lord Vāmana.

TRANSLATION

Some say that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is directly Nara-Nārāyaṇa. Others say that He is directly Vāmana.

TEXT 114

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa kṣīroda-śāyī avatāra

asambhava nahe, satya vacana sabāra

SYNONYMS

keho—someone; *kahe*—says; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṣīroda-śāyī*—Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *avatāra*—incarnation; *asambhava*—impossible; *nahe*—is not; *satya*—true; *vacana*—speeches; *sabāra*—of all.

TRANSLATION

Some say that Kṛṣṇa is the incarnation of Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. None of these statements is impossible; each is as correct as the others.

PURPORT

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (5.383) states:

*ata evā purāṇāḍau kecin nara-sakhātmatām
mahendrānujātām kecit kecit kṣīrābdhi-śāyitām
sahasra-śīrṣatām kecit kecid vaikuṇṭha-nāthatām
brūyuhḥ kṛṣṇasya munayas tat-tad-vṛtty-anugāminah*

“According to the intimate relationships between Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the primeval

Lord, and His devotees, the *Purāṇas* describe Him by various names. Sometimes He is called Nārāyaṇa; sometimes Upendra (Vāmana), the younger brother of Indra, King of heaven; and sometimes Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. Sometimes He is called the thousand-hooded Śeṣa Nāga, and sometimes the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha.”

TEXT 115

keho kahe, para-vyome nārāyaṇa hari

sakala sambhave kṛṣṇe, yāte avatārī

SYNONYMS

keho—someone; *kahe*—says; *para-vyome*—in the transcendental world; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *hari*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *sakala sambhave*—all possibilities; *kṛṣṇe*—in Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yāte*—since; *avatārī*—the source of all incarnations.

TRANSLATION

Some call Him Hari, or the Nārāyaṇa of the transcendental world. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa, for He is the primeval Lord.

TEXT 116

saba śrotā-gaṇera kari caraṇa vandana

e saba siddhānta śuna, kari' eka mana

SYNONYMS

saba—all; *śrotā-gaṇera*—of the hearers; *kari*—I do; *caraṇa*—to the lotus feet; *vandana*—praying; *e*—these; *saba*—all; *siddhānta*—conclusions; *śuna*—please hear; *kari'*—making; *eka*—one; *mana*—mind.

TRANSLATION

I offer my obeisances unto the feet of all who hear or read this discourse.
Kindly hear with attention the conclusion of all these statements.

PURPORT

Prostrating himself at the feet of his readers, the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* entreats them in all humility to hear with rapt attention these conclusive arguments regarding the Absolute Truth. One should not fail to hear such arguments, for only by such knowledge can one perfectly know Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 117

siddhānta baliyā citte nā kara alasa

ihā ha-ite kṛṣṇe lāge sudṛḍha mānasa

SYNONYMS

siddhānta—conclusion; *baliyā*—considering; *citte*—in the mind; *nā kara*—do not be; *alasa*—lazy; *ihā*—this; *ha-ite*—from; *kṛṣṇe*—in Lord Kṛṣṇa; *lāge*—becomes fixed; *su-dṛḍha*—very firm; *mānasa*—the mind.

TRANSLATION

A sincere student should not neglect the discussion of such conclusions, considering them controversial, for such discussions strengthen the mind. Thus one's mind becomes attached to Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

There are many students who, in spite of reading the *Bhagavad-gītā*, misunderstand Kṛṣṇa because of imperfect knowledge and conclude Him

to be an ordinary historical personality. This one must not do. One should be particularly careful to understand the truth about Kṛṣṇa. If because of laziness one does not come to know Kṛṣṇa conclusively, one will be misguided about the cult of devotion, like those who declare themselves advanced devotees and imitate the transcendental symptoms sometimes observed in liberated souls. Although the use of thoughts and arguments is a most suitable process for inducing an uninitiated person to become a devotee, neophytes in devotional service must always alertly understand Kṛṣṇa through the vision of the revealed scriptures, the bona fide devotees and the spiritual master. Unless one hears about Śrī Kṛṣṇa from such authorities, one cannot make advancement in devotion to Śrī Kṛṣṇa. The revealed scriptures mention nine means of attaining devotional service, of which the first and foremost is hearing from authority. The seed of devotion cannot sprout unless watered by the process of hearing and chanting. One should submissively receive the transcendental messages from spiritually advanced sources and chant the very same messages for one's own benefit as well as the benefit of one's audience.

When Brahmā described the situation of pure devotees freed from the culture of empiric philosophy and fruitive actions, he recommended the process of hearing from persons who are on the path of devotion. Following in the footsteps of such liberated souls, who are able to vibrate real transcendental sound, can lead one to the highest stage of devotion, and thus one can become a *mahā-bhāgavata*. From the teachings of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to Sanātana Gosvāmī (*Madhya* 22.65) we learn:

*śāstra-yuktye sunipuṇa, dṛḍha-śraddhā yānra
'uttama-adhikārī' sei tāraye saṁsāra*

“A person who is expert in understanding the conclusion of the revealed scriptures and who fully surrenders to the cause of the Lord is actually able to deliver others from the clutches of material existence.” Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, in his *Upadeśāmṛta* (3), advises that to make rapid advancement in the cult of devotional service one should be very active

and should persevere in executing the duties specified in the revealed scriptures and confirmed by the spiritual master. Accepting the path of liberated souls and the association of pure devotees enriches such activities.

Imitation devotees, who wish to advertise themselves as elevated Vaiṣṇavas and who therefore imitate the previous *ācāryas* but do not follow them in principle, are condemned in the words of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (2.3.24) as stone-hearted. Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura has commented on their stone-hearted condition as follows: *bahir āśru-pulakayoḥ sator api yad dhṛdayaṁ na vikriyeta tad āśma-sāram iti kaniṣṭhādhikāriṇām eva āśru-pulakādi-mattve 'pi āśma-sāra-hṛdayatayā nindaiṣā*. “Those who shed tears by practice but whose hearts have not changed are to be known as stone-hearted devotees of the lowest grade. Their imitation crying, induced by artificial practice, is always condemned.” The desired change of heart referred to above is visible in the reluctance to do anything not congenial to the devotional way. To create such a change of heart, conclusive discussion about Śrī Kṛṣṇa and His potencies is absolutely necessary. False devotees may think that simply shedding tears will lead one to the transcendental plane, even if one has not had a factual change in heart, but such a practice is useless if there is no transcendental realization. False devotees, lacking the conclusion of transcendental knowledge, think that artificially shedding tears will deliver them. Similarly, other false devotees think that studying books of the previous *ācāryas* is unadvisable, like studying dry empiric philosophies. But Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, following the previous *ācāryas*, has inculcated the conclusions of the scriptures in the six theses called the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbhās*. False devotees who have very little knowledge of such conclusions fail to achieve pure devotion for want of zeal in accepting the favorable directions for devotional service given by self-realized devotees. Such false devotees are like impersonalists, who also consider devotional service no better than ordinary fruitive actions.

TEXT 118

caitanya-mahimā jāni e saba siddhānte

citta dṛḍha hañā lāge mahimā-jñāna haite

SYNONYMS

caitanya-mahimā—the glory of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jāni*—I know; *e*—these; *saba*—all; *siddhānte*—by the conclusions; *citta*—the mind; *dṛḍha*—firm; *hañā*—becoming; *lāge*—becomes fixed; *mahimā-jñāna*—knowledge of the greatness; *haite*—from.

TRANSLATION

By such conclusive studies I know the glories of Lord Caitanya. Only by knowing these glories can one become strong and fixed in attachment to Him.

PURPORT

One can know the glories of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu only by reaching, in knowledge, a conclusive decision about Śrī Kṛṣṇa, strengthened by bona fide study of the conclusions of the *ācāryas*.

TEXT 119

caitanya-prabhura mahimā kahibāra tare

kṛṣṇera mahimā kahi kariyā vistāre

SYNONYMS

caitanya-prabhura—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mahimā*—the glories; *kahibāra tare*—for the purpose of speaking; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mahimā*—the glories; *kahi*—I speak; *kariyā*—doing; *vistāre*—in expansion.

TRANSLATION

Just to enunciate the glories of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, I have tried to describe the glories of Śrī Kṛṣṇa in detail.

TEXT 120

caitanya-gosāñīra ei tattva-nirūpaṇa

svayam-bhagavān kṛṣṇa vrajendra-nandana

SYNONYMS

caitanya-gosāñīra—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ei*—this; *tattva*—of the truth; *nirūpaṇa*—settling; *svayam-bhagavān*—Himself the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vrajendra-nandana*—the son of the King of Vraja.

TRANSLATION

The conclusion is that Lord Caitanya is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, the son of the King of Vraja.

TEXT 121

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādilīlā, Second Chapter, describing Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Chapter 3

The External Reasons for the Appearance of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

In this chapter the author has fully discussed the external reasons for the descent of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, after displaying His pastimes as Lord Kṛṣṇa, thought it wise to make His advent in the form of a devotee to explain personally the transcendental mellows of reciprocal service and love exchanged between Himself and His servants, friends, parents and fiancées. According to the Vedic literature, the foremost occupational duty for humanity in this Age of Kali is *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, or congregational chanting of the holy name of the Lord. The incarnation for this age especially preaches this process, but only Kṛṣṇa Himself can explain the confidential loving service performed in the four principal varieties of loving affairs between the Supreme Lord and His devotees. Lord Kṛṣṇa therefore personally appeared, with His plenary portions, as Lord Caitanya. As stated in this chapter, it was for this purpose that Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared personally in Navadvīpa in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja has herein presented much authentic evidence from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and other scriptures to substantiate the identity of

Lord Caitanya with Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself. He has described bodily symptoms in Lord Caitanya that are visible only in the person of the Supreme Lord, and he has proved that Lord Caitanya appeared with His personal associates—Śrī Nityānanda, Advaita, Gadādhara, Śrīvāsa and other devotees—to preach the special significance of chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa. The appearance of Lord Caitanya is both significant and confidential. He can be appreciated only by pure devotees and only through the process of devotional service. The Lord tried to conceal His identity as the Supreme Personality of Godhead by representing Himself as a devotee, but His pure devotees could recognize Him by His special features. The *Vedas* and *Purāṇas* foretell the appearance of Lord Caitanya, but still He is sometimes called, significantly, the concealed descent of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Advaita Ācārya was a contemporary of Lord Caitanya's father. He felt sorry for the condition of the world because even after Lord Kṛṣṇa's appearance, no one had interest in devotional service to Kṛṣṇa. This forgetfulness was so overwhelming that Advaita Prabhu was convinced that no one but Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself could enlighten people about devotional service to the Supreme Lord. Therefore Advaita requested Lord Kṛṣṇa to appear as Lord Caitanya. Offering *tulasī* leaves and Ganges water, He cried for the Lord's appearance. The Lord, being satisfied by His pure devotees, descends to satisfy them. As such, being pleased by Advaita Ācārya, Lord Caitanya appeared.

TEXT 1

śrī-caitanya-prabhum vande

yat-pādāśraya-vīryataḥ

saṅgrhṇāty ākara-vrātād

ajñāḥ siddhānta-san-maṇīn

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya-prabhum—to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *vande*—I offer my respectful obeisances; *yat*—of whom; *pāda-āśraya*—of the shelter of the lotus feet; *vīryataḥ*—from the power; *saṅgrhṇāti*—collects; *ākara-vrātāt*—from the multitude of mines in the form of scriptures; *ajñāḥ*—a fool; *siddhānta*—of conclusion; *sat-maṇīn*—the best jewels.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. By the potency of the shelter of His lotus feet, even a fool can collect the valuable jewels of conclusive truth from the mines of the revealed scriptures.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-caitanya*—to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda; *jaya*—all glories; *advaita-candra*—to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya*—all glories; *gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—to all the devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Lord Caitanya! All glories to Lord Nityānanda! All glories to Advaitacandra! And all glories to all the devotees of Lord Caitanya!

TEXT 3

tṛtīya ślokerā artha kaila vivaraṇa

caturtha ślokerā artha śuna bhakta-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

tṛtīya—third; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—meaning; *kaila*—there was; *vivaraṇa*—description; *caturtha*—fourth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—meaning; *śuna*—please hear; *bhakta-gaṇa*—O devotees.

TRANSLATION

I have given the purport of the third verse. Now, O devotees, please listen to the meaning of the fourth with full attention.

TEXT 4

anarpita-carīm cirāt karuṇayāvatīrṇaḥ kalau

samarpayitum unnatojjvala-rasām sva-bhakti-śriyam

hariḥ puraṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ

sadā hṛdaya-kandare sphuratu vaḥ śacī-nandanah

SYNONYMS

anarpita—not bestowed; *carīm*—having been formerly; *cirāt*—for a long time; *karuṇayā*—by causeless mercy; *avatīrṇaḥ*—descended; *kalau*—in the Age of Kali; *samarpayitum*—to bestow; *unnata*—elevated; *ujjvala-rasām*—the conjugal mellow; *sva-bhakti*—of His own service; *śriyam*—the treasure; *hariḥ*—the Supreme Lord; *puraṭa*—than gold; *sundara*—more beautiful; *dyuti*—of splendor; *kadamba*—with a multitude; *sandīpitaḥ*—illuminated; *sadā*—always; *hṛdaya-kandare*—in the cavity of the heart; *sphuratu*—let Him be manifest; *vaḥ*—your; *śacī-nandanah*—

the son of mother Śacī.

TRANSLATION

“May the Supreme Lord who is known as the son of Śrīmatī Śacī-devī be transcendently situated in the innermost core of your heart. Resplendent with the radiance of molten gold, He has descended in the Age of Kali by His causeless mercy to bestow what no incarnation has ever offered before: the most elevated mellow of devotional service, the mellow of conjugal love.”

PURPORT

This is a quotation from the *Vidagdha-mādhava* (1.2), a drama compiled and edited by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 5

pūrṇa bhagavān kṛṣṇa vrajendra-kumāra

goloke vrajera saha nitya vihāra

SYNONYMS

pūrṇa—full; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vrajendra-kumāra*—the son of the King of Vraja; *goloke*—in Goloka; *vrajera saha*—along with Vrajadhāma; *nitya*—eternal; *vihāra*—pastimes.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa, the son of the King of Vraja, is the Supreme Lord. He eternally enjoys transcendental pastimes in His eternal abode, Goloka, which includes Vrajadhāma.

PURPORT

In the previous chapter it has been established that Kṛṣṇa, the son of Vrajendra (the King of Vraja), is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, with six opulences. He eternally enjoys transcendently variegated opulences on His planet, which is known as Goloka. The eternal pastimes of the Lord in the spiritual planet Kṛṣṇaloka are called *aprakāṣa*, or unmanifested, pastimes because they are beyond the purview of the conditioned souls. Lord Kṛṣṇa is always present everywhere, but when He is not present before our eyes, He is said to be *aprakāṣa*, or unmanifested.

TEXT 6

brahmāra eka dine tiñho eka-bāra

avatīrṇa hañā karena prakāṣa vihāra

SYNONYMS

brahmāra—of Lord Brahmā; *eka*—one; *dine*—in the day; *tiñho*—He; *eka-bāra*—one time; *avatīrṇa*—descended; *hañā*—being; *karena*—performs; *prakāṣa*—manifest; *vihāra*—pastimes.

TRANSLATION

Once in a day of Brahmā, He descends to this world to manifest His transcendental pastimes.

TEXT 7

satya, tretā, dvāpara, kali, cāri-yuga jāni

sei cāri-yuge divya eka-yuga māni

SYNONYMS

satya—Satya; *tretā*—Tretā; *dvāpara*—Dvāpara; *kali*—Kali; *cāri-yuga*—four ages; *jāni*—we know; *sei*—these; *cāri-yuge*—in the four ages; *divya*—divine; *eka-yuga*—one age; *māni*—we consider.

TRANSLATION

We know that there are four ages [yugas], namely Satya, Tretā, Dvāpara and Kali. These four together constitute one divya-yuga.

TEXT 8

ekāttara catur-yuge eka manv-antara

caudda manv-antara brahmāra divasa bhitara

SYNONYMS

ekāttara—seventy-one; *catuḥ-yuge*—in cycles of four ages; *eka*—one; *manu-antara*—period of a Manu; *caudda*—fourteen; *manu-antara*—periods of Manu; *brahmāra*—of Lord Brahmā; *divasa*—a day; *bhitara*—within.

TRANSLATION

Seventy-one divya-yugas constitute one manv-antara. There are fourteen manv-antaras in one day of Brahmā.

PURPORT

A *manv-antara* is the period controlled by one Manu. The reign of fourteen Manus equals the length of one day (twelve hours) in the life of Brahmā, and the night of Brahmā is of the same duration. These calculations are given in the authentic astronomy book known as the

Sūrya-siddhānta. A Bengali translation of this book was compiled by the great professor of astronomy and mathematics Bimal Prasād Datta, later known as Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī, who was our merciful spiritual master. He was honored with the title Siddhānta Sarasvatī for translating the *Sūrya-siddhānta*, and the title Gosvāmī Mahārāja was added when he accepted *sannyāsa*, the renounced order of life.

TEXT 9

‘vaivasvata’-nāma ei saptama manu-antara

sātāīśa catur-yuga tāhāra antara

SYNONYMS

vaivasvata-nāma—named Vaivasvata; *ei*—this; *saptama*—seventh; *manu-antara*—period of Manu; *sātāīśa*—twenty-seven; *catur-yuga*—cycles of four ages; *tāhāra*—of that; *antara*—period.

TRANSLATION

The present Manu, who is the seventh, is called Vaivasvata [the son of Vivasvān]. Twenty-seven divya-yugas [27 x 4,320,000 solar years] of his age have now passed.

PURPORT

The names of the fourteen Manus are as follows: (1) Svāyambhuva, (2) Svārociṣa, (3) Uttama, (4) Tāmasa, (5) Raivata, (6) Cākṣuṣa, (7) Vaivasvata, (8) Sāvarṇi, (9) Dakṣa-sāvarṇi, (10) Brahma-sāvarṇi, (11) Dharma-sāvarṇi, (12) Rudraputra (Rudra-sāvarṇi), (13) Raucya, or Deva-sāvarṇi, (14) and Bhautyaka, or Indra-sāvarṇi.

TEXT 10

aṣṭāviṁśa catur-yuge dvāparera śeṣe

vrajera sahite haya kṛṣṇera prakāśe

SYNONYMS

aṣṭāviṁśa—twenty-eighth; *catur-yuge*—in the cycle of four ages; *dvāparera*—of the Dvāpara-yuga; *śeṣe*—at the end; *vrajera sahite*—along with Vraja; *haya*—is; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prakāśe*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

At the end of the Dvāpara-yuga of the twenty-eighth divya-yuga, Lord Kṛṣṇa appears on earth with the full paraphernalia of His eternal Vrajadhāma.

PURPORT

Now is the term of Vaivasvata Manu, during which Lord Caitanya appears. First Lord Kṛṣṇa appears at the close of the Dvāpara-yuga of the twenty-eighth *divya-yuga*, and then Lord Caitanya appears in the Kali-yuga of the same *divya-yuga*. Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Caitanya appear once in each day of Brahmā, or once in fourteen *manv-antarās*, each of seventy-one *divya-yugas* in duration.

From the beginning of Brahmā's day of 4,320,000,000 years, six Manus appear and disappear before Lord Kṛṣṇa appears. Thus 1,975,320,000 years of the day of Brahmā elapse before the appearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is an astronomical calculation according to solar years.

TEXT 11

dāśya, sakhya, vātsalya, śṛṅgāra——*cāri rasa*

cāri bhāvera bhakta yata kṛṣṇa tāra vaśa

SYNONYMS

dāśya—servitude; *sakhya*—friendship; *vātsalya*—parental affection; *śṛṅgāra*—conjugal love; *cāri*—four; *rasa*—mellows; *cāri*—four; *bhāvera*—of the sentiments; *bhakta*—devotees; *yata*—as many as there are; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tāra*—by them; *vaśa*—subdued.

TRANSLATION

Servitude [*dāśya*], friendship [*sakhya*], parental affection [*vātsalya*] and conjugal love [*śṛṅgāra*] are the four transcendental mellows [*rasas*]. By the devotees who cherish these four mellows, Lord Kṛṣṇa is subdued.

PURPORT

Dāśya, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *śṛṅgāra* are the transcendental modes of loving service to the Lord. *Śānta-rasa*, or the neutral stage, is not mentioned in this verse because although in *śānta-rasa* one considers the Absolute Truth the sublime great, one does not go beyond that conception. *Śānta-rasa* is a very grand idea for materialistic philosophers, but such idealistic appreciation is only the beginning; it is the lowest among the relationships in the spiritual world. *Śānta-rasa* is not given much importance because as soon as there is a slight understanding between the knower and the known, active loving transcendental reciprocations and exchanges begin. *Dāśya-rasa* is the basic relationship between Kṛṣṇa and His devotees; therefore this verse considers *dāśya* the first stage of transcendental devotional service.

TEXT 12

dāśa-sakhā-pitā-mātā-kāntā-gaṇa lañā

vraje krīdā kare kṛṣṇa premāviṣṭa hañā

SYNONYMS

dāsa—servants; *sakhā*—friends; *pitā-mātā*—father and mother; *kāntā-gaṇa*—lovers; *lañā*—taking; *vraje*—in Vraja; *kṛḍā kare*—plays; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prema-āviṣṭa*—absorbed in love; *hañā*—being.

TRANSLATION

Absorbed in such transcendental love, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa enjoys in Vraja with His devoted servants, friends, parents and conjugal lovers.

PURPORT

The descent of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Personality of Godhead, is very purposeful. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is said that one who knows the truth about Śrī Kṛṣṇa's descent and His various activities is at once liberated and does not have to fall again to this existence of birth and death after he leaves his present material body. In other words, one who factually understands Kṛṣṇa makes his life perfect. Imperfect life is realized in material existence, in five different relationships we share with everyone within the material world: neutrality, servitorship, friendship, filial love and amorous love between husband and wife or lover and beloved. These five enjoyable relationships within the material world are perverted reflections of relationships with the Absolute Personality of Godhead in the transcendental nature. That Absolute Personality, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, descends to revive the five eternally existing relationships. Thus He manifests His transcendental pastimes in Vraja so that people may be attracted into that sphere of activities and leave aside their imitation relationships with the mundane. Then, after fully exhibiting all such activities, the Lord disappears.

TEXT 13

yatheṣṭa vihari' kṛṣṇa kare antardhāna

antardhāna kari' mane kare anumāna

SYNONYMS

yathā-iṣṭa—as much as He wishes; *vihari'*—enjoying; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kare*—makes; *antardhāna*—disappearance; *antardhāna kari'*—disappearing; *mane*—in the mind; *kare*—He makes; *anumāna*—consideration.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa enjoys His transcendental pastimes as long as He wishes, and then He disappears. After disappearing, however, He thinks thus:

TEXT 14

cira-kāla nāhi kari prema-bhakti dāna

bhakti vinā jagatera nāhi avasthāna

SYNONYMS

cira-kāla—for a long time; *nāhi kari*—I have not done; *prema-bhakti*—loving devotional service; *dāna*—giving; *bhakti*—devotional service; *vinā*—without; *jagatera*—of the universe; *nāhi*—not; *avasthāna*—existence.

TRANSLATION

“For a long time I have not bestowed unalloyed loving service to Me upon the inhabitants of the world. Without such loving attachment, the existence of the material world is useless.

PURPORT

The Lord seldom awards pure transcendental love, but without such pure love of God, freed from fruitive activities and empiric speculation, one

cannot attain perfection in life.

TEXT 15

sakala jagate more kare vidhi-bhakti

vidhi-bhaktye vraja-bhāva pāite nāhi śakti

SYNONYMS

sakala—all; *jagate*—in the universe; *more*—to Me; *kare*—they do; *vidhi-bhakti*—regulative devotional service; *vidhi-bhaktye*—by regulative devotional service; *vraja-bhāva*—the feelings of those in Vraja; *pāite*—to obtain; *nāhi*—not; *śakti*—the power.

TRANSLATION

“Everywhere in the world people worship Me according to scriptural injunctions. But simply by following such regulative principles one cannot attain the loving sentiments of the devotees in Vrajabhūmi.

TEXT 16

aiśvarya-jñānete saba jagat miśrita

aiśvarya-śīthila-preme nāhi mora prīta

SYNONYMS

aiśvarya-jñānete—with knowledge of the opulences; *saba*—all; *jagat*—the world; *miśrita*—mixed; *aiśvarya-śīthila-preme*—to love enfeebled by opulence; *nāhi*—there is not; *mora*—My; *prīta*—attraction.

TRANSLATION

“Knowing My opulences, the whole world looks upon Me with awe and veneration. But devotion made feeble by such reverence does not attract Me.

PURPORT

After His appearance, Lord Kṛṣṇa thought that He had not distributed the transcendental personal dealings with His devotees in *dāśya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *mādhurya*. One may understand the science of the Supreme Personality of Godhead from the Vedic literatures and thus become a devotee of the Lord and worship Him within the regulative principles described in the scriptures, but one will not know in this way how Kṛṣṇa is served by the residents of Vrajabhūmi. One cannot understand the dealings of the Lord in Vṛndāvana simply by executing the ritualistic regulative principles mentioned in the scriptures. By following scriptural injunctions one may enhance his appreciation for the glories of the Lord, but there is no chance for one to enter into personal dealings with Him. Giving too much attention to understanding the exalted glories of the Lord reduces the chance of one’s entering into personal loving affairs with the Lord. To teach the principles of such loving dealings, the Lord decided to appear as Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 17

aiśvarya-jñāne vidhi-bhajana kariyā

vaikuṇṭhake yāya catur-vidha mukti pāñā

SYNONYMS

aiśvarya-jñāne—in knowledge of the opulences; *vidhi*—according to rules and regulations; *bhajana*—worship; *kariyā*—doing; *vaikuṇṭhake*—to Vaikuṇṭha; *yāya*—they go; *catur-vidha*—four kinds; *mukti*—liberation; *pāñā*—achieving.

TRANSLATION

“By performing such regulated devotional service in awe and veneration, one may go to *Vaikuṇṭha* and attain the four kinds of liberation.

TEXT 18

sārṣṭi, sārūpya, āra sāmīpya, sālōkya

sāyujya nā laya bhakta yāte brahma-aikya

SYNONYMS

sārṣṭi—opulences equal with the Lord’s; *sārūpya*—the same form as the Lord’s; *āra*—and; *sāmīpya*—personal association with the Lord; *sālōkya*—residence on a *Vaikuṇṭha* planet; *sāyujya*—oneness with the Lord; *nā laya*—they do not accept; *bhakta*—devotees; *yāte*—since; *brahma-aikya*—oneness with Brahman.

TRANSLATION

“These liberations are *sārṣṭi* [achieving opulences equal to those of the Lord], *sārūpya* [having a form the same as the Lord’s], *sāmīpya* [living as a personal associate of the Lord] and *sālōkya* [living on a *Vaikuṇṭha* planet]. Devotees never accept *sāyujya*, however, since that is oneness with Brahman.

PURPORT

Those engaged in devotional service according to the ritualistic principles mentioned in the scriptures attain these different kinds of liberation. But although such devotees can attain *sārṣṭi*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and *sālōkya*, they are not concerned with these liberations, for such devotees are satisfied only in rendering transcendental loving service to the Lord. The fifth kind of liberation, *sāyujya*, is never accepted even by devotees who

perform only ritualistic worship. To attain *sāyujya*, or merging into the Brahman effulgence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the aspiration of the impersonalists. A devotee never cares for *sāyujya* liberation.

TEXT 19

yuga-dharma pravartāimu nāma-saṅkīrtana

cāri bhāva-bhakti diyā nācāmu bhuvana

SYNONYMS

yuga-dharma—the religion of the age; *pravartāimu*—I shall inaugurate; *nāma-saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the holy name; *cāri*—four; *bhāva*—of the moods; *bhakti*—devotion; *diyā*—giving; *nācāmu*—I shall cause to dance; *bhuvana*—the world.

TRANSLATION

“I shall personally inaugurate the religion of the age—*nāma-saṅkīrtana*, the congregational chanting of the holy name. I shall make the world dance in ecstasy, realizing the four mellows of loving devotional service.

TEXT 20

āpani karimu bhakta-bhāva aṅgikāre

āpani ācari' bhakti śikhāimu sabāre

SYNONYMS

āpani—personally; *karimu*—I shall make; *bhakta-bhāva*—the position of a devotee; *aṅgikāre*—acceptance; *āpani*—personally; *ācari'*—practicing; *bhakti*—devotional service; *śikhāimu*—I shall teach; *sabāre*—to all.

TRANSLATION

“I shall accept the role of a devotee, and I shall teach devotional service by practicing it Myself.

PURPORT

When one associates with a pure devotee, he becomes so elevated that he does not aspire even for *sārṣṭī*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* or *sālokya*, because he feels that such liberation is a kind of sense gratification. Pure devotees do not ask anything from the Lord for their personal benefit. Even if offered personal benefits, pure devotees do not accept them, because their only desire is to satisfy the Supreme Personality of Godhead by transcendental loving service. No one but the Lord Himself can teach this highest form of devotional service. Therefore, when the Lord took the place of the incarnation of Kali-yuga to spread the glories of chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa—the system of worship recommended in this age—He also distributed the process of devotional service performed on the platform of transcendental spontaneous love. To teach the highest principles of spiritual life, the Lord Himself appeared as a devotee in the form of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 21

āpane nā kaile dharma śikhāna nā yāya

ei ta' siddhānta gītā-bhāgavate gāya

SYNONYMS

āpane—personally; *nā kaile*—if not practiced; *dharma*—religion; *śikhāna*—the teaching; *nā yāya*—does not advance; *ei*—this; *ta'*—certainly; *siddhānta*—conclusion; *gītā*—in the *Bhagavad-gītā*; *bhāgavate*—in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *gāya*—they sing.

TRANSLATION

“Unless one practices devotional service himself, he cannot teach it to others. This conclusion is indeed confirmed throughout the Gītā and Bhāgavatam.

TEXT 22

yadā yadā hi dharmasya

glānir bhavati bhārata

abhyutthānam adharmasya

tadātmānam sṛjāmy aham

SYNONYMS

yadā yadā—whenever; *hi*—certainly; *dharmasya*—of religious principles; *glāniḥ*—decrease; *bhavati*—there is; *bhārata*—O descendant of Bharata; *abhyutthānam*—increase; *adharmasya*—of irreligion; *tadā*—then; *ātmānam*—Myself; *sṛjāmi*—manifest; *aham*—I.

TRANSLATION

“Whenever and wherever there is a decline in religious practice, O descendant of Bharata, and a predominant rise of irreligion—at that time I descend Myself.

TEXT 23

paritrāṇāya sādḥūnām

vināśāya ca duṣkṛtām

dharma-saṁsthāpanārthāya

sambhavāmi yuge yuge

SYNONYMS

paritrāṇāya—for the deliverance; *sādhūnām*—of the devotees;
vināśāya—for the destruction; *ca*—and; *duṣkṛtām*—of the miscreants;
dharma—religious principles; *saṁsthāpana-arthāya*—for the purpose of
establishing; *sambhavāmi*—I appear; *yuge yuge*—in every age.

TRANSLATION

“To deliver the pious and to annihilate the miscreants, as well as to
reestablish the principles of religion, I Myself appear, millennium after
millennium.’

PURPORT

Texts 22 and 23 were spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.7–
8). Texts 24 and 25, which follow, are also from the *Bhagavad-gītā* (3.24,
3.21).

TEXT 24

utsīdeyur ime lokā

na kuryām karma ced aham

saṅkarasya ca kartā syām

upahanyām imāḥ prajāḥ

SYNONYMS

utsīdeyuh—would fall into ruin; *ime*—these; *lokāḥ*—worlds; *na
kuryām*—did not perform; *karma*—action; *ced*—if; *aham*—I;

sañkarasya—of unwanted population; *ca*—and; *kartā*—the creator; *syām*—would become; *upahanyām*—would spoil; *imāḥ*—these; *prajāḥ*—living entities.

TRANSLATION

“If I did not show the proper principles of religion, all these worlds would fall into ruin. I would be the cause of unwanted population and would spoil all these living beings.’

TEXT 25

yad yad ācarati śreṣṭhas

tat tad evetaro janaḥ

sa yat pramāṇam kurute

lokas tad anuvartate

SYNONYMS

yat yat—however; *ācarati*—behaves; *śreṣṭhaḥ*—the best man; *tat tat*—that; *eva*—certainly; *itarāḥ*—the lesser; *janaḥ*—man; *saḥ*—he; *yat*—which; *pramāṇam*—standard; *kurute*—shows; *lokaḥ*—the people; *tat*—that; *anuvartate*—follow.

TRANSLATION

“Whatever actions a great man performs, common people follow. And whatever standards he sets by exemplary acts, all the world pursues.’

TEXT 26

yuga-dharma-pravartana haya amśa haite

āmā vinā anye nāre vraja-prema dite

SYNONYMS

yuga-dharma—of the religion of the age; *pravartana*—the inauguration; *haya*—is; *aṁśa*—the plenary portion; *haite*—from; *āmā*—for Me; *vinā*—except; *anye*—another; *nāre*—is not able; *vraja-prema*—love like that of the residents of Vraja; *dite*—to bestow.

TRANSLATION

“My plenary portions can establish the principles of religion for each age. No one but Me, however, can bestow the kind of loving service performed by the residents of Vraja.

TEXT 27

santv avatārā bahavaḥ

pañkaja-nābhasya sarvato-bhadrāḥ

kṛṣṇād anyāḥ ko vā latāsv

api prema-do bhavati

SYNONYMS

santu—let there be; *avatārāḥ*—incarnations; *bahavaḥ*—many; *pañkaja-nābhasya*—of the Lord, from whose navel grows a lotus flower; *sarvato-bhadrāḥ*—completely auspicious; *kṛṣṇāt*—than Lord Kṛṣṇa; *anyāḥ*—other; *kaḥ vā*—who possibly; *latāsu*—on the surrendered souls; *api*—also; *prema-daḥ*—the bestower of love; *bhavati*—is.

TRANSLATION

“There may be many all-auspicious incarnations of the Personality of Godhead, but who other than Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa can bestow love of God upon the surrendered souls?”

PURPORT

This quotation from the writings of Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura is found in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (1.5.37).

TEXT 28

tāhāte āpana bhakta-gaṇa kari’ saṅge

prthivīte avatari’ karimu nānā raṅge

SYNONYMS

tāhāte—in that; *āpana*—My own; *bhakta-gaṇa*—with devotees; *kari’*—doing; *saṅge*—in association; *prthivīte*—on the earth; *avatari’*—descending; *karimu*—I shall perform; *nānā*—various; *raṅge*—colorful pastimes.

TRANSLATION

“Therefore in the company of My devotees I shall appear on earth and perform various colorful pastimes.”

TEXT 29

eta bhāvi’ kali-kāle prathama sandhyāya

avatīrṇa hailā kṛṣṇa āpani nadīyāya

SYNONYMS

eta—thus; *bhāvi'*—thinking; *kali-kāle*—in the Age of Kali; *prathama*—first; *sandhyāya*—in the junction; *avatīrṇa hailā*—descended; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *āpani*—Himself; *nadīyāya*—in Nadia.

TRANSLATION

Thinking thus, the Personality of Godhead, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself, descended at Nadia early in the Age of Kali.

PURPORT

The *prathama-sandhyā* is the beginning of the age. According to astronomical calculation, the age is divided into twelve parts. The first of these twelve divisions is known as the *prathama-sandhyā*. The *prathama-sandhyā* and *śeṣa-sandhyā*, the last division of the preceding age, form the junction of the two ages. According to the *Sūrya-siddhānta*, the *prathama-sandhyā* of Kali-yuga lasts 36,000 solar years. Lord Caitanya appeared in the *prathama-sandhyā* after 4,586 solar years of Kali-yuga had passed.

TEXT 30

caitanya-simhera navadvīpe avatāra

simha-grīva, simha-vīrya, simhera hunkāra

SYNONYMS

caitanya-simhera—of the lionlike Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *navadvīpe*—at Navadvīpa; *avatāra*—the incarnation; *simha-grīva*—having the neck of a lion; *simha-vīrya*—the strength of a lion; *simhera hunkāra*—the roar of a lion.

TRANSLATION

Thus the lionlike Lord Caitanya has appeared in Navadvīpa. He has the shoulders of a lion, the powers of a lion, and the loud voice of a lion.

TEXT 31

sei simha vasuk jīvera hṛdaya-kandare

kalmaṣa-dvirada nāśe yāñhāra huñkāre

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *simha*—lion; *vasuk*—let Him sit; *jīvera*—of the living entities; *hṛdaya*—of the heart; *kandare*—in the cavern; *kalmaṣa*—of sins; *dvi-rada*—the elephant; *nāśe*—destroys; *yāñhāra*—of whom; *huñkāre*—the roar.

TRANSLATION

May that lion be seated in the core of the heart of every living being. Thus with His resounding roar may He drive away one's elephantine vices.

TEXT 32

prathama līlāya tāñra 'viśvambhara' nāma

bhakti-rase bharila, dharila bhūta-grāma

SYNONYMS

prathama—first; *līlāya*—in the pastimes; *tāñra*—of Him; *viśvambhara nāma*—the name Viśvambhara; *bhakti-rase*—with the mellow of devotional service; *bharila*—He filled; *dharila*—saved; *bhūta-grāma*—all the living entities.

TRANSLATION

In His early pastimes He is known as Viśvambhara because He floods the world with the nectar of devotion and thus saves the living beings.

TEXT 33

ḍubhṛñ dhātura artha—poṣaṇa, dhāraṇa

puṣiḷa, dharila prema diyā tri-bhuvana

SYNONYMS

ḍubhṛñ—known as *ḍubhṛñ* (*bhr*); *dhātura*—of the verbal root; *artha*—the meaning; *poṣaṇa*—nourishing; *dhāraṇa*—maintaining; *puṣiḷa*—nourished; *dharila*—maintained; *prema diyā*—distributing love of God; *tri-bhuvana*—in the three worlds.

TRANSLATION

The verbal root “ḍubhṛñ” [which is the root of the word “viśvambhara”] indicates nourishing and maintaining. He [Lord Caitanya] nourishes and maintains the three worlds by distributing love of God.

TEXT 34

śeṣa-lilāya dhare nāma ‘śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya’

śrī-kṛṣṇa jānāye saba viśva kaila dhanya

SYNONYMS

śeṣa-lilāya—in His final pastimes; *dhare*—He held; *nāma*—the name; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *śrī-kṛṣṇa*—about Lord Kṛṣṇa; *jānāye*—He taught; *saba*—all; *viśva*—the world; *kaila*—made; *dhanya*—

fortunate.

TRANSLATION

In His later pastimes He is known as Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. He blesses the whole world by teaching about the name and fame of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya remained a householder only until His twenty-fourth year had passed. Then He entered the renounced order and remained manifest in this material world until His forty-eighth year. Therefore His *śeṣa-līlā*, or the final portion of His activities, lasted twenty-four years.

Some so-called Vaiṣṇavas say that the renounced order of life was not accepted in the Vaiṣṇava *sampradāya*, or disciplic succession, until Lord Caitanya. This is not a very intelligent proposition. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu took the *sannyāsa* order from Śrīpāda Keśava Bhāratī, who belonged to the Śāṅkara sect, which approves of only ten names for *sannyāsīs*. Long before the advent of Śrīpāda Śāṅkarācārya, however, the *sannyāsa* order existed in the Vaiṣṇava line of Viṣṇu Svāmī. In the Viṣṇu Svāmī Vaiṣṇava *sampradāya*, there are ten different kinds of *sannyāsa* names and 108 different names for *sannyāsīs* who accept the *tri-daṇḍa*, the triple staff of *sannyāsa*. This is approved by the Vedic rules. Therefore Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsa* was existent even before the appearance of Śāṅkarācārya, although those who know nothing about Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsa* unnecessarily declare that there is no *sannyāsa* in the Vaiṣṇava *sampradāya*.

During the time of Lord Caitanya, the influence of Śāṅkarācārya in society was very strong. People thought that one could accept *sannyāsa* only in the disciplic succession of Śāṅkarācārya. Lord Caitanya could have performed His missionary activities as a householder, but He found householder life an obstruction to His mission. Therefore He decided to accept the renounced order, *sannyāsa*. Since His acceptance of *sannyāsa*

was also designed to attract public attention, Lord Caitanya, not wishing to disturb the social convention, took the renounced order of life from a *sannyāsī* in the disciplic succession of Śaṅkarācārya, although *sannyāsa* was also sanctioned in the Vaiṣṇava *sampradāya*.

In the Śaṅkara-sampradāya there are ten different names awarded to *sannyāsīs*: (1) Tīrtha, (2) Āśrama, (3) Vana, (4) Araṇya, (5) Giri, (6) Parvata, (7) Sāgara, (8) Sarasvatī, (9) Bhāratī and (10) Purī. Before one enters *sannyāsa*, he has one of the various names for a *brahmacārī*, the assistant to a *sannyāsī*. *Sannyāsīs* with the titles Tīrtha and Āśrama generally stay at Dvārakā, and their *brahmacārī* name is Svarūpa. Those known by the names Vana and Araṇya stay at Puruṣottama, or Jagannātha Purī, and their *brahmacārī* name is Prakāśa. Those with the names Giri, Parvata and Sāgara generally stay at Badarikāśrama, and their *brahmacārī* name is Ānanda. Those with the titles Sarasvatī, Bhāratī and Purī usually live at Śrīrgerī in South India, and their *brahmacārī* name is Caitanya.

Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya established four monasteries in India, in the four directions (north, south, east and west), and he entrusted them to four *sannyāsīs* who were his disciples. Now there are hundreds of branch monasteries under these four principal monasteries, and although there is an official symmetry among them, there are many differences in their dealings. The four different sects of these monasteries are known as Ānandavāra, Bhogavāra, Kīṭavāra and Bhūmivāra, and in course of time they have developed different ideas and different slogans.

According to the regulation of the disciplic succession, one who wishes to enter the renounced order in Śaṅkara's sect must first be trained as a *brahmacārī* under a bona fide *sannyāsī*. The *brahmacārī's* name is ascertained according to the group to which the *sannyāsī* belongs. Lord Caitanya accepted *sannyāsa* from Keśava Bhāratī. When He first approached Keśava Bhāratī, He was accepted as a *brahmacārī* with the name Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Brahmacārī. After He took *sannyāsa*, He preferred to keep the name Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

The great authorities in the disciplic succession had not offered to explain why Lord Caitanya refused to take the name Bhāratī after He took *sannyāsa* from a Bhāratī, until Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī Mahārāja volunteered the explanation that because a *sannyāsī* in the Śāṅkara-sampradāya thinks that he has become the Supreme, Lord Caitanya, wanting to avoid such a misconception, kept the name Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, placing Himself as an eternal servitor. A *brahmacārī* is supposed to serve the spiritual master; therefore He did not negate that relationship of servitude to His spiritual master. Accepting such a position is favorable for the relationship between the disciple and the spiritual master.

The authentic biographies also mention that Lord Caitanya accepted the *daṇḍa* (rod) and begging pot, symbolic of the *sannyāsa* order, at the time He took *sannyāsa*.

TEXT 35

tānra yugāvatāra jāni' garga mahāśaya

kṛṣṇera nāma-karaṇe kariyāche nirṇaya

SYNONYMS

tānra—of Him; *yuga-avatāra*—incarnation for the age; *jāni'*—knowing; *garga*—Garga Muni; *mahāśaya*—the great personality; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nāma-karaṇe*—in the name-giving ceremony; *kariyāche*—made; *nirṇaya*—ascertainment.

TRANSLATION

Knowing Him [Lord Caitanya] to be the incarnation for Kali-yuga, Garga Muni, during the naming ceremony of Kṛṣṇa, predicted His appearance.

TEXT 36

āsan varṇās trayo hy asya

grhṇato 'nu-yugam tanūḥ

śuklo raktaḥ tathā pīta

idānīm kṛṣṇatām gataḥ

SYNONYMS

āsan—were; *varṇāḥ*—colors; *trayaḥ*—three; *hi*—certainly; *asya*—of this one; *grhṇataḥ*—who is manifesting; *anu-yugam*—according to the age; *tanūḥ*—bodies; *śuklaḥ*—white; *raktaḥ*—red; *tathā*—thus; *pītaḥ*—yellow; *idānīm*—now; *kṛṣṇatām*—blackness; *gataḥ*—obtained.

TRANSLATION

“This boy [Kṛṣṇa] has three other colors—white, red and yellow—as He appears in different ages. Now He has appeared in a transcendental blackish color.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.8.13).

TEXT 37

śukla, rakta, pīta-varṇa—ei tina dyuti

satya-tretā-kali-kāle dharena śrī-pati

SYNONYMS

śukla—white; *rakta*—red; *pīta-varṇa*—the color yellow; *ei*—these; *tina*—three; *dyuti*—lusters; *satya*—in Satya-yuga; *tretā*—in Tretā-yuga;

kali-kāle—in the Age of Kali; *dharena*—manifests; *śrī-patī*—the husband of the goddess of fortune.

TRANSLATION

White, red and yellow—these are the three bodily lusters that the Lord, the husband of the goddess of fortune, assumes in the ages of Satya, Tretā and Kali respectively.

TEXT 38

idānīm dvāpare tīṇho hailā kṛṣṇa-varṇa

ei saba śāstrāgama-purāṇera marma

SYNONYMS

idānīm—now; *dvāpare*—in the Dvāpara-yuga; *tīṇho*—He; *hailā*—was; *kṛṣṇa-varṇa*—blackish color; *ei*—these; *saba*—all; *śāstra-āgama*—and Vedic literatures; *purāṇera*—of the *Purāṇas*; *marma*—the core.

TRANSLATION

Now, in the Dvāpara-yuga, the Lord had descended in a blackish hue. This is the essence of the statements in the Purāṇas and other Vedic literatures with reference to the context.

TEXT 39

dvāpare bhagavān śyāmaḥ

pīta-vāsā nijāyudhaḥ

śrī-vatsādibhir aṅkais ca

lakṣaṇair upalakṣitaḥ

SYNONYMS

dvāpare—in the Dvāpara-yuga; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *śyāmaḥ*—blackish; *pīta-vāsāḥ*—having yellow clothes; *nija*—own; *āyudhaḥ*—having weapons; *śrīvatsa-ādibhiḥ*—such as Śrīvatsa; *aṅkaiḥ*—by bodily markings; *ca*—and; *lakṣaṇaiḥ*—by external characteristics such as the Kaustubha jewel; *upalakṣitaḥ*—characterized.

TRANSLATION

“In the Dvāpara-yuga the Personality of Godhead appears in a blackish hue. He is dressed in yellow, He holds His own weapons, and He is decorated with the Kaustubha jewel and marks of Śrīvatsa. This is how His symptoms are described.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.5.27), spoken by Saint Karabhājana, one of the nine royal mystics who explained to King Nimi the different features of the Lord in different ages.

TEXT 40

kali-yuge yuga-dharma—nāmera pracāra

tathi lāgi' pīta-varṇa caitanyāvatāra

SYNONYMS

kali-yuge—in the Age of Kali; *yuga-dharma*—the religious practice for the age; *nāmera*—of the holy name; *pracāra*—propagation; *tathi*—this; *lāgi'*—for; *pīta-varṇa*—having a yellow color; *caitanya-avatāra*—the incarnation of Lord Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

The religious practice for the Age of Kali is to broadcast the glories of the holy name. Only for this purpose has the Lord, in a yellow color, descended as Lord Caitanya.

PURPORT

In this Age of Kali the practical system of religion for everyone is the chanting of the name of Godhead. This was introduced in this age by Lord Caitanya. *Bhakti-yoga* actually begins with the chanting of the holy name, as confirmed by Madhvācārya in his commentary on the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad*. He quotes this verse from the *Nārāyaṇa-saṁhitā*:

*dvāparīyair janair viṣṇuḥ
pañcarātrais tu kevalaiḥ
kalau tu nāma-mātreṇa
pūjyate bhagavān hariḥ*

“In the Dvāpara-yuga people should worship Lord Viṣṇu only by the regulative principles of the *Nārada-pañcarātra* and other such authorized books. In the Age of Kali, however, people should simply chant the holy names of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.” The Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* is specifically mentioned in many *Upaniṣads*, such as the *Kali-santaraṇa Upaniṣad*, where it is said:

*hare kṛṣṇa hare kṛṣṇa
kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa hare hare
hare rāma hare rāma
rāma rāma hare hare*

*iti ṣoḍaśakam nāmnām
kali-kalmaṣa-nāśanam
nātaḥ parataropāyaḥ
sarva-vedeṣu dṛśyate*

“After searching through all the Vedic literature, one cannot find a method of religion more sublime for this age than the chanting of Hare Kṛṣṇa.”

TEXT 41

tapta-hema-sama-kānti, prakāṇḍa śarīra

nava-megha jini kaṇṭha-dhvani ye gambhīra

SYNONYMS

tapta-hema—as molten gold; *sama-kānti*—same luster; *prakāṇḍa*—enormous; *śarīra*—body; *nava-megha*—new clouds; *jini*—conquering; *kaṇṭha-dhvani*—the sound of the voice; *ye*—that; *gambhīra*—deep.

TRANSLATION

The luster of His expansive body resembles molten gold. The deep sound of His voice conquers the thundering of newly assembled clouds.

TEXT 42

dairghya-vistāre yei āpanāra hāta

cāri hasta haya ‘mahā-puruṣa’ vikhyāta

SYNONYMS

dairghya—in length; *vistāre*—and in breadth; *yei*—who; *āpanāra*—of his own; *hāta*—hand; *cāri*—four; *hasta*—cubits; *haya*—is; *mahā-puruṣa*—as a great personality; *vikhyāta*—celebrated.

TRANSLATION

One who measures four cubits in height and in breadth by his own hand is celebrated as a great personality.

TEXT 43

‘nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala’ haya tāñra nāma

nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala-tanu caitanya guṇa-dhāma

SYNONYMS

nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala—*nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*; *haya*—is; *tāñra*—of him; *nāma*—the name; *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*—*nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*; *tanu*—having such a body; *caitanya*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *guṇa-dhāma*—the abode of good qualities.

TRANSLATION

Such a person is called *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who personifies all good qualities, has the body of a *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*.

PURPORT

No one other than the Supreme Lord Himself, who has engaged the conditioned souls by His own illusory energy, can possess these bodily features. These features certainly indicate an incarnation of Viṣṇu and no one else.

TEXT 44

ājānulambita-bhuja kamala-locana

tilaphula-jini-nāsā, sudhāṁśu-vadana

SYNONYMS

ā-jānu-lambita-bhuja—arms that reach the knees; *kamala-locana*—with lotus eyes; *tila-phula*—the blossom of the sesame plant; *jini*—conquering; *nāsā*—whose nose; *sudhā-amśu-vadana*—whose face is like the moon.

TRANSLATION

His arms are long enough to reach His knees, His eyes are just like lotus flowers, His nose is like a sesame flower, and His face is as beautiful as the moon.

TEXT 45

śānta, dānta, kṛṣṇa-bhakti-niṣṭhā-parāyaṇa

bhakta-vatsala, suśīla, sarva-bhūte sama

SYNONYMS

śānta—peaceful; *dānta*—controlled; *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*—to the service of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *niṣṭhā-parāyaṇa*—fully devoted; *bhakta-vatsala*—affectionate toward the devotees; *su-śīla*—good character; *sarva-bhūte*—to all living beings; *sama*—equal.

TRANSLATION

He is peaceful, self-controlled and fully devoted to the transcendental service of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa. He is affectionate toward His devotees, He is gentle, and He is equally disposed toward all living beings.

TEXT 46

candanera aṅgada-bālā, candana-bhūṣaṇa

nṛtya-kāle pari'arena kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana

SYNONYMS

candanera—of sandalwood; *aṅgada*—and armlets; *bālā*—bangles; *candana*—of sandalwood pulp; *bhūṣaṇa*—decorations; *nṛtya-kāle*—at the time of dancing; *pari'*—putting on; *karena*—does; *kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana*—congregational chanting of the name of Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

He is decorated with sandalwood bangles and armlets and anointed with the pulp of sandalwood. He especially wears these decorations to dance in śrī-kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana.

TEXT 47

ei saba guṇa lañā muni vaiśampāyana

sahasra-nāme kaila tāñra nāma-gaṇana

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *saba*—all; *guṇa*—qualities; *lañā*—taking; *muni*—the sage; *vaiśampāyana*—named Vaiśampāyana; *sahasra-nāme*—in the *Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma*; *kaila*—did; *tāñra*—of Him; *nāma-gaṇana*—counting of the name.

TRANSLATION

Recording all these qualities of Lord Caitanya, the sage Vaiśampāyana included His name in the *Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma*.

TEXT 48

dui līlā caitanya—ādi āra śeṣa

dui līlāya cāri cāri nāma viśeṣa

SYNONYMS

dui—two; *līlā*—pastimes; *caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ādi*—first; *āra*—and; *śeṣa*—final; *dui*—two; *līlāya*—in pastimes; *cāri*—four; *cāri*—and four; *nāma*—names; *viśeṣa*—specific.

TRANSLATION

The pastimes of Lord Caitanya have two divisions—the early pastimes [ādi-līlā] and the later pastimes [śeṣa-līlā]. He has four names in each of these two līlās.

TEXT 49

suvarṇa-varṇo hemāṅgo

varāṅgaś candanāṅgadī

sannyāsa-kṛc chamaḥ śānto

niṣṭhā-śānti-parāyaṇaḥ

SYNONYMS

suvarṇa—of gold; *varṇaḥ*—having the color; *hema-aṅgaḥ*—whose body was like molten gold; *vara-aṅgaḥ*—having a most beautiful body; *candana-aṅgadī*—whose body was smeared with sandalwood; *sannyāsa-kṛt*—practicing the renounced order of life; *śamaḥ*—equipoised; *śāntaḥ*—peaceful; *niṣṭhā*—devotion; *śānti*—and of peace; *parāyaṇaḥ*—the highest resort.

TRANSLATION

“In His early pastimes He appears as a householder with a golden complexion. His limbs are beautiful, and His body, smeared with the pulp of sandalwood, seems like molten gold. In His later pastimes He accepts the sannyāsa order, and He is equipoised and peaceful. He is the highest abode of peace and devotion, for He silences the impersonalist nondevotees.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Mahābhārata* (*Dāna-dharma, Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma-stotra*). In his commentary on the *Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma*, called the *Nāmārtha-sudhā*, Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa, commenting upon this verse, asserts that Lord Caitanya is the Supreme Personality of Godhead according to the evidence of the *Upaniṣads*. He explains that *suvarṇa-varṇaḥ* means a golden complexion. He also quotes the Vedic injunction *yadā paśyaḥ paśyate rukma-varṇam kartāram īśam puruṣam brahma-yonim* (*Muṇḍaka Up.* 3.1.3). *Rukma-varṇam kartāram īśam* refers to the Supreme Personality of Godhead as having a complexion the color of molten gold. *Puruṣam* means the Supreme Lord, and *brahma-yonim* indicates that He is also the Supreme Brahman. This evidence, too, proves that Lord Caitanya is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa. Another meaning of the description of the Lord as having a golden hue is that Lord Caitanya’s personality is as fascinating as gold is attractive. Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa has explained that the word *varāṅga* means “exquisitely beautiful.”

Lord Caitanya accepted *sannyāsa*, leaving aside His householder life, to preach His mission. He has equanimity in different senses. First, He describes the confidential truth of the Personality of Godhead, and second, He satisfies everyone by knowledge and attachment to Kṛṣṇa. He is peaceful because He renounces all topics not related to the service of Kṛṣṇa. Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa has explained that the word *niṣṭhā* indicates His being rigidly fixed in chanting the holy name of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

Lord Caitanya subdued all disturbing opponents of devotional service, especially the monists, who are actually averse to the personal feature of the Supreme Lord.

TEXT 50

vyakta kari' bhāgavate kahe bāra bāra

kali-yuge dharma—nāma-saṅkīrtana sāra

SYNONYMS

vyakta—evident; *kari'*—making; *bhāgavate*—in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *kahe*—they say; *bāra bāra*—time and time again; *kali-yuge*—in the Age of Kali; *dharma*—the religion; *nāma-saṅkīrtana*—congregational chanting of the holy name; *sāra*—the essence.

TRANSLATION

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* it is repeatedly and clearly said that the essence of religion in the Age of Kali is the chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 51

iti dvāpara urv-īśa

stuvanti jagad-īśvaram

nānā-tantra-vidhānena

kalāv api yathā śṛṇu

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *dvāpare*—in the Dvāpara Age; *uru-īśa*—O King; *stuvanti*—

they praise; *jagat-īśvaram*—the Lord of the universe; *nānā*—various; *tantra*—of scriptures; *vidhānena*—by the regulations; *kalau*—in the Age of Kali; *api*—also; *yathā*—in which manner; *śṛṇu*—please hear.

TRANSLATION

“O King, in this way people in Dvāpara-yuga worshiped the Lord of the universe. In Kali-yuga they also worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead by the regulations of the revealed scriptures. Kindly now hear of that from me.

PURPORT

This verse is spoken by Saint Karabhājana in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.5.31).

TEXT 52

kṛṣṇa-varṇam tviṣākṛṣṇam

sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam

yajñaiḥ saṅkīrtana-prāyaiḥ

yajanti hi su-medhasaḥ

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-varṇam—repeating the syllables *kṛṣ-ṇa*; *tviṣā*—with a luster; *akṛṣṇam*—not black (golden); *sa-aṅga*—along with associates; *upāṅga*—servitors; *astra*—weapons; *pārṣadam*—confidential companions; *yajñaiḥ*—by sacrifice; *saṅkīrtana-prāyaiḥ*—consisting chiefly of congregational chanting; *yajanti*—they worship; *hi*—certainly; *su-medhasaḥ*—intelligent persons.

TRANSLATION

“In the Age of Kali, intelligent persons perform congregational chanting to worship the incarnation of Godhead who constantly sings the name of Kṛṣṇa. Although His complexion is not blackish, He is Kṛṣṇa Himself. He is accompanied by His associates, servants, weapons and confidential companions.”

PURPORT

This text is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.5.32). Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī has explained this verse in his commentary on the *Bhāgavatam*, known as the *Krama-sandarbha*, wherein he says that Lord Kṛṣṇa also appears with a golden complexion. That golden Lord Kṛṣṇa is Lord Caitanya, who is worshiped by intelligent men in this age. That is confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* by Garga Muni, who said that although the child Kṛṣṇa was blackish, He also appears in three other colors—red, white and yellow. He exhibited His white and red complexions in the Satya and Tretā ages respectively. He did not exhibit the remaining color, yellow-gold, until He appeared as Lord Caitanya, who is known as Gaura Hari.

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī explains that *kṛṣṇa-varṇam* means Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. *Kṛṣṇa-varṇa* and Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are equivalent. The name Kṛṣṇa appears with both Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Caitanya Kṛṣṇa. Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but He always engages in describing Kṛṣṇa and thus enjoys transcendental bliss by chanting and remembering His name and form. Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself appears as Lord Caitanya to preach the highest gospel.

Lord Caitanya always chants the holy name of Kṛṣṇa and describes it also, and because He is Kṛṣṇa Himself, whoever meets Him will automatically chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa and later describe it to others. He injects one with transcendental Kṛṣṇa consciousness, which merges the chanter in transcendental bliss. In all respects, therefore, He appears before everyone as Kṛṣṇa, either by personality or by sound. Simply by seeing

Lord Caitanya one at once remembers Lord Kṛṣṇa. One may therefore accept Him as *viṣṇu-tattva*. In other words, Lord Caitanya is Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself.

Sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam further indicates that Lord Caitanya is Lord Kṛṣṇa. His body is always decorated with ornaments of sandalwood and with sandalwood paste. By His superexcellent beauty He subdues all the people of the age. In other descents the Lord sometimes used weapons to defeat the demoniac, but in this age the Lord subdues them with His all-attractive figure as Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī explains that His beauty is His *astra*, or weapon, to subdue the demons. Because He is all-attractive, it is to be understood that all the demigods lived with Him as His companions. His acts were uncommon and His associates wonderful. When He propagated the *saṅkīrtana* movement, He attracted many great scholars and *ācāryas*, especially in Bengal and Orissa. Lord Caitanya is always accompanied by His best associates like Lord Nityānanda, Advaita, Gadādhara and Śrīvāsa.

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī cites a verse from the Vedic literature which says that there is no necessity of performing sacrificial demonstrations or ceremonial functions. He comments that instead of engaging in such external, pompous exhibitions, all people, regardless of caste, color or creed, can assemble together and chant Hare Kṛṣṇa to worship Lord Caitanya. *Kṛṣṇa-varṇam tviṣākṛṣṇam* [SB 11.5.32] indicates that prominence should be given to the name of Kṛṣṇa. Lord Caitanya taught Kṛṣṇa consciousness and chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa. Therefore, to worship Lord Caitanya, everyone should together chant the *mahā-mantra*—Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare. To propagate worship in churches, temples or mosques is not possible, because people have lost interest in that. But anywhere and everywhere, people can chant Hare Kṛṣṇa. Thus worshiping Lord Caitanya, they can perform the highest activity and fulfill the highest religious purpose of satisfying the Supreme Lord.

Śrīla Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, a famous disciple of Lord Caitanya, said,

“The principle of transcendental devotional service having been lost, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya has appeared in order to deliver again the process of devotion. He is so kind that He is distributing love of Kṛṣṇa. Everyone should be attracted more and more to His lotus feet, as humming bees are attracted to a lotus flower.”

TEXT 53

śuna, bhāi, ei saba caitanya-mahimā

ei śloke kahe tāñra mahimāra sīmā

SYNONYMS

śuna—please hear; *bhāi*—O brothers; *ei*—this; *saba*—all; *caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mahimā*—the glories; *ei*—this; *śloke*—verse; *kahe*—says; *tāñra*—of Him; *mahimāra*—of the glories; *sīmā*—the limit.

TRANSLATION

My dear brothers, please hear all these glories of Lord Caitanya. This verse clearly summarizes His activities and characteristics.

TEXT 54

‘kṛṣṇa’ ei dui varṇa sadā yāñra mukhe

athavā, kṛṣṇake tiñho varṇe nija sukhe

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—*kṛṣ-ṇa*; *ei*—these; *dui*—two; *varṇa*—syllables; *sadā*—always; *yāñra*—of whom; *mukhe*—in the mouth; *athavā*—or else; *kṛṣṇake*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tiñho*—He; *varṇe*—describes; *nija*—His own; *sukhe*—in

happiness.

TRANSLATION

The two syllables “kṛṣṇa” are always in His mouth; or, He constantly describes Kṛṣṇa with great pleasure.

TEXT 55

kṛṣṇa-varṇa-śabdera artha dui ta pramāṇa

kṛṣṇa vinu tāñra mukhe nāhi āise āna

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-varṇa-śabdera—of the word *kṛṣṇa-varṇa*; *artha*—the meaning; *dui*—two; *ta*—certainly; *pramāṇa*—examples; *kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa; *vinu*—except for; *tāñra*—of Him; *mukhe*—in the mouth; *nāhi āise*—does not come; *āna*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

These are two meanings of the word “kṛṣṇa-varṇa.” Indeed, nothing else but Kṛṣṇa issues from His mouth.

TEXT 56

keha tāñre bale yadi kṛṣṇa-varaṇa

āra viśeṣaṇe tāra kare nivāraṇa

SYNONYMS

keha—someone; *tāñre*—to Him; *bale*—ascribes; *yadi*—if; *kṛṣṇa*—black; *varaṇa*—the color; *āra*—another; *viśeṣaṇe*—in the adjective; *tāra*—of

that; *kare*—does; *nivāraṇa*—prevention.

TRANSLATION

If someone tries to describe Him as being of blackish complexion, the next adjective [*tviṣā akṛṣṇam*] immediately restricts him.

TEXT 57

deha-kāntye haya teṇho akṛṣṇa-varaṇa

akṛṣṇa-varaṇe kahe pīta-varaṇa

SYNONYMS

deha-kāntye—in the luster of the body; *haya*—is; *teṇho*—He; *akṛṣṇa*—not black; *varaṇa*—the color; *akṛṣṇa-varaṇe*—by a color that is not blackish; *kahe*—one means; *pīta*—yellow; *varaṇa*—the color.

TRANSLATION

His complexion is certainly not blackish. Indeed, His not being blackish indicates that His complexion is yellow.

TEXT 58

kalau yaṁ vidvāṁsaḥ sphuṭam abhiyajante dyuti-bharād

akṛṣṇāṅgaṁ kṛṣṇaṁ makha-vidhibhir utkīrtana-mayaiḥ

upāsyam ca prāhur yaṁ akhila-caturthāśrama-juṣām

sa devaś caitanyākṛtir atitarām naḥ kṛpayatu

SYNONYMS

kalau—in the Age of Kali; *yam*—Him whom; *vidvāṁsaḥ*—the learned men; *sphuṭam*—clearly manifested; *abhiyajante*—worship; *dyuti-bharāt*—due to an abundance of bodily luster; *akṛṣṇa-aṅgam*—whose body is not blackish; *kṛṣṇam*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *makha-vidhibhiḥ*—by the performances of sacrifice; *utkīrtana-mayaiḥ*—consisting of loud chanting of the holy name; *upāsyam*—worshipable object; *ca*—and; *prāhuḥ*—they said; *yam*—whom; *akhila*—all; *caturtha-āśrama-juṣām*—of those who are in the fourth order of life (*sannyāsa*); *saḥ*—He; *devaḥ*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *caitanya-ākṛtiḥ*—having the form of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *atitarām*—excessively; *naḥ*—unto us; *kṛpayatu*—let Him show His mercy.

TRANSLATION

“By performing the sacrifice of congregational chanting of the holy name, learned scholars in the Age of Kali worship Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is now nonblackish because of the great upsurge of the feelings of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. He is the only worshipable Deity for the paramahāṁsas, who have attained the highest stage of the fourth order [*sannyāsa*]. May that Supreme Personality of Godhead, Lord Caitanya, show us His great causeless mercy.”

PURPORT

This verse is *Dvītiya Śrī Caitanyāṣṭaka* 1, from the *Stava-mālā* of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 59

pratyakṣa tāñhāra tapta-kāñcanera dyuti

yāñhāra chaṭāya nāśe ajñāna-tamastati

SYNONYMS

pratyakṣa—vivid; *tāñhāra*—of Him; *tapta*—molten; *kāñcanera*—of gold; *dyuti*—effulgence; *yāñhāra*—of whom; *chaṭāya*—by the luster; *nāśe*—destroys; *ajñāna*—of ignorance; *tamastati*—the extent of the darkness.

TRANSLATION

One can vividly see His glowing complexion of molten gold, which dispels the darkness of ignorance.

TEXT 60

jīvera kalmaṣa-tamo nāśa karibāre

aṅga-upāṅga-nāma nānā astra dhare

SYNONYMS

jīvera—of the living entity; *kalmaṣa*—of sinful activities; *tamaḥ*—the darkness; *nāśa karibāre*—for destroying; *aṅga*—associates; *upāṅga*—devotees; *nāma*—holy names; *nānā*—various; *astra*—weapons; *dhare*—He holds.

TRANSLATION

The sinful life of the living beings results from ignorance. To destroy that ignorance, He has brought various weapons, such as His plenary associates, His devotees and the holy name.

TEXT 61

bhaktira virodhī karma-dharma vā adharma

tāhāra 'kalmaṣa' nāma, sei mahā-tamaḥ

SYNONYMS

bhaktira—to devotional service; *virodhī*—averse; *karma*—activity; *dharma*—religious; *vā*—or; *adharma*—irreligious; *tāhāra*—of that; *kalmaṣa*—sin; *nāma*—the name; *sei*—this; *mahā-tamaḥ*—great darkness.

TRANSLATION

The greatest ignorance consists of activities, whether religious or irreligious, that are opposed to devotional service. They are to be known as sins [kalmaṣa].

TEXT 62

bāhu tuli' hari bali' prema-dṛṣṭye cāya

kariyā kalmaṣa nāśa premete bhāsāya

SYNONYMS

bāhu tuli'—raising the arms; *hari bali'*—chanting the holy name; *prema-dṛṣṭye*—with His glance of deep love; *cāya*—He looks; *kariyā*—causing; *kalmaṣa*—to sins; *nāśa*—destruction; *premete*—in love of God; *bhāsāya*—He floods.

TRANSLATION

Raising His arms, chanting the holy name and looking upon all with deep love, He drives away all sins and floods everyone with love of Godhead.

TEXT 63

smitālokaḥ śokaṁ harati jagatām yasya parito

girām tu prārambhaḥ kuśala-paṭalīm pallavayati

padāmbhaḥ kaṁ vā praṇayati na hi prema-nivaham

sa devaś caitanyākṛtir atitarām naḥ kṛpayatu

SYNONYMS

smīta—smiling; *ālokaḥ*—glance; *śokam*—the bereavement; *harati*—takes away; *jagatām*—of the world; *yasya*—whose; *paritaḥ*—all around; *girām*—of the speech; *tu*—also; *prārambhaḥ*—the beginning; *kuśala*—of auspiciousness; *paṭalīm*—the mass; *pallavayati*—causes to blossom; *pada-ālamḥ*—the taking hold of the lotus feet; *kam vā*—what possibly; *praṇayati*—leads to; *na*—not; *hi*—certainly; *prema-nivaham*—quantity of love of Godhead; *saḥ*—He; *devaḥ*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *caitanya-ākṛtiḥ*—having the form of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *atitarām*—excessively; *naḥ*—unto us; *kṛpayatu*—may He show His mercy.

TRANSLATION

“May the Supreme Personality of Godhead in the form of Lord Śrī Caitanya bestow His causeless mercy upon us. His smiling glance at once drives away all the bereavements of the world, and His very words enliven the auspicious creepers of devotion by expanding their leaves. Taking shelter of His lotus feet invokes transcendental love of God at once.”

PURPORT

This verse is *Dvitiya Śrī Caitanyāṣṭaka* 8, from the *Stava-mālā* of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 64

śrī-aṅga, śrī-mukha yei kare daraśana

tāra pāpa-kṣaya haya, pāya prema-dhana

SYNONYMS

śrī-aṅga—His body; *śrī-mukha*—His face; *yei*—anyone who; *kare*—does; *daraśana*—seeing; *tāra*—of him; *pāpa-kṣaya*—destruction of sins; *haya*—there is; *pāya*—obtains; *prema-dhana*—the wealth of love of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Anyone who looks upon His beautiful body or beautiful face becomes freed from all sins and obtains the wealth of love of Godhead.

TEXT 65

anya avatāre saba sainya-śastra saṅge

caitanya-kṛṣṇera sainya aṅga-upāṅge

SYNONYMS

anya—other; *avatāre*—in incarnations; *saba*—all; *sainya*—soldiers; *śastra*—and weapons; *saṅge*—along with; *caitanya-kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa as Lord Caitanya; *sainya*—soldiers; *aṅga*—plenary parts; *upāṅge*—and associates.

TRANSLATION

In other incarnations the Lord descended with armies and weapons, but in this incarnation His soldiers are His plenary parts and associates.

TEXT 66

sadopāśyaḥ śrīmān dhṛta-manuja-kāyair praṇayitām

vahadbhir gīr-vāṇair giriśa-parameṣṭhi-prabhṛtibhiḥ

sva-bhaktebhyaḥ śuddhām nija-bhajana-mudrām upadiśan

sa caitanyaḥ kim me punar api dṛśor yāsyati padam

SYNONYMS

sadā—always; *upāsyah*—worshipable; *śrīmān*—beautiful; *dhṛta*—who accepted; *manuja-kāyaiḥ*—the bodies of men; *pranayitām*—love; *vahadbhiḥ*—who were bearing; *giḥ-vāṇaiḥ*—by the demigods; *giriśa*—Lord Śiva; *parameṣṭhi*—Lord Brahmā; *prabhṛtibhiḥ*—headed by; *sva-bhaktebhyaḥ*—unto His own devotees; *śuddhām*—pure; *nija-bhajana*—of His own worship; *mudrām*—the mark; *upadiśan*—instructing; *sah*—He; *caitanyaḥ*—Lord Caitanya; *kim*—what; *me*—my; *punaḥ*—again; *api*—certainly; *dṛśoḥ*—of the two eyes; *yāsyati*—He will go; *padam*—to the abode.

TRANSLATION

“Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is always the most worshipable Deity of the demigods, including Lord Śiva and Lord Brahmā, who came in the garb of ordinary men, bearing love for Him. He instructs His own pure devotional service to His own devotees. Will He again be the object of my vision?”

PURPORT

This verse is *Prathama Śrī Caitanyāṣṭaka* 1, from the *Stava-mālā* of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 67

āṅgopāṅga astra kare sva-kārya-sādhana

‘aṅga’-śabdera artha āra śuna diyā mana

SYNONYMS

āṅga-upāṅga—plenary parts and associates; *astra*—weapons; *kare*—do; *sva-kārya*—of their own business; *sādhana*—as the accomplishment; *aṅga-śabdera*—of the word *aṅga*; *artha*—the meaning; *āra*—another; *śuna*—please hear; *diyā*—giving; *mana*—the mind.

TRANSLATION

His plenary parts and associates perform the work of weapons as their own specific duties. Please hear from me another meaning of the word “aṅga.”

TEXT 68

‘aṅga’-śabde aṁśa kahe śāstra-paramāṇa

aṅgera avayava ‘upāṅga’-vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

aṅga-śabde—by the word *aṅga*, or limb; *aṁśa*—part; *kahe*—says; *śāstra*—of the scriptures; *paramāṇa*—the evidence; *aṅgera*—of the limb; *avayava*—the constituent part; *upāṅga-vyākhyāna*—the exposition of the word *upāṅga*.

TRANSLATION

According to the evidence of the revealed scriptures, a bodily limb [aṅga] is also called a part [aṁśa], and a part of a limb is called a partial part [upāṅga].

TEXT 69

nārāyaṇas tvaṁ na hi sarva-dehinām

ātmāsy adhīśākhila-loka-sākṣī

nārāyaṇo 'ṅgam nara-bhū-jalāyanāt

tac cāpi satyaṁ na tavaiva māyā

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇaḥ—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *tvam*—You; *na*—not; *hi*—certainly; *sarva*—all; *dehinām*—of the embodied beings; *ātmā*—the Supersoul; *asi*—You are; *adhīśa*—O Lord; *akhila-loka*—of all the worlds; *sākṣī*—the witness; *nārāyaṇaḥ*—known as Nārāyaṇa; *aṅgam*—plenary portion; *nara*—of Nara; *bhū*—born; *jala*—in the water; *ayanāt*—due to the place of refuge; *tat*—that; *ca*—and; *api*—certainly; *satyaṁ*—highest truth; *na*—not; *tava*—Your; *eva*—at all; *māyā*—the illusory energy.

TRANSLATION

“O Lord of lords, You are the seer of all creation. You are indeed everyone’s dearest life. Are You not, therefore, my father, Nārāyaṇa? ‘Nārāyaṇa’ refers to one whose abode is in the water born from Nara [Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu], and that Nārāyaṇa is Your plenary portion. All Your plenary portions are transcendental. They are absolute and are not creations of māyā.”

PURPORT

This text was spoken to Lord Kṛṣṇa by Brahmā in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.14.14).

TEXT 70

jala-śāyī antar-yāmī yei nārāyaṇa

seho tomāra aṁśa, tumi mūla nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

jala-śāyī—lying in the water; *antaḥ-yāmī*—indwelling Supersoul; *yei*—He who; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *seho*—He; *tomāra*—Your; *aṁśa*—plenary portion; *tumi*—You; *mūla*—original; *nārāyaṇa*—Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

The manifestation of the Nārāyaṇa who predominates in everyone’s heart, as well as the Nārāyaṇa who lives in the waters [Kāraṇa, Garbha and Kṣīra], is Your plenary portion. You are therefore the original Nārāyaṇa.

TEXT 71

‘aṅga’-śabde aṁśa kahe, seho satya haya

māyā-kārya nahe—saba cid-ānanda-maya

SYNONYMS

aṅga-śabde—by the word *aṅga*; *aṁśa*—plenary portion; *kahe*—one means; *seho*—that; *satya*—the truth; *haya*—is; *māyā*—of the material energy; *kārya*—the work; *nahe*—is not; *saba*—all; *cid-ānanda-maya*—full of knowledge and bliss.

TRANSLATION

The word “aṅga” indeed refers to plenary portions. Such manifestations should never be considered products of material nature, for they are all transcendental, full of knowledge and full of bliss.

PURPORT

In the material world, if a fragment is taken from an original object, the

original object is reduced by the removal of that fragment. But the Supreme Personality of Godhead is not at all affected by the actions of *māyā*. The *Īśopaniṣad* says:

*om pūrṇam adaḥ pūrṇam idaṁ
pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate
pūrṇasya pūrṇam ādāya
pūrṇam evāvaśiṣyate*

“The Personality of Godhead is perfect and complete, and because He is completely perfect, all emanations from Him, such as this phenomenal world, are perfectly equipped as complete wholes. Whatever is produced of the complete whole is also complete in itself. Because He is the complete whole, even though so many complete units emanate from Him, He remains the complete balance.” (*Śrī Īśopaniṣad*, Invocation)

In the realm of the Absolute, one plus one equals one, and one minus one equals one. Therefore one should not conceive of a fragment of the Supreme Lord in the material sense. In the spiritual world there is no influence of the material energy or material calculations of fragments. In the Fifteenth Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, the Lord says that the living entities are His parts and parcels. There are innumerable living entities throughout the material and spiritual universes, but still Lord Kṛṣṇa is full in Himself. To think that God has lost His personality because His many parts and parcels are distributed all over the universe is an illusion. That is a material calculation. Such calculations are possible only under the influence of the material energy, *māyā*. In the spiritual world the material energy is conspicuous only by its absence.

In the category of *viṣṇu-tattva* there is no loss of power from one expansion to the next, any more than there is a loss of illumination as one candle kindles another. Thousands of candles may be kindled by an original candle, and all will have the same candle power. In this way it is to be understood that although all the *viṣṇu-tattvas*, from Kṛṣṇa and Lord Caitanya to Rāma, Nṛsiṃha, Varāha and so on, appear with different

features in different ages, all are equally invested with supreme potency.

Demigods such as Lord Brahmā and Lord Śiva come in contact with the material energy, and their power and potency are therefore of different gradations. All the incarnations of Viṣṇu, however, are equal in potency, for the influence of *māyā* cannot even approach Them.

TEXT 72

advaita, nityānanda—caitanyera dui aṅga

aṅgera avayava-gaṇa kahiye upāṅga

SYNONYMS

advaita—Advaita Ācārya; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *caitanyera*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dui*—two; *aṅga*—limbs; *aṅgera*—of the limbs; *avayava-gaṇa*—the constituent parts; *kahiye*—I say; *upāṅga*—parts.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Prabhu and Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu are both plenary portions of Lord Caitanya. Thus They are the limbs [aṅgas] of His body. The parts of these two limbs are called the upāṅgas.

TEXT 73

aṅgopāṅga tīkṣṇa astra prabhura sahite

sei saba astra haya pāṣaṇḍa dalite

SYNONYMS

aṅga-upāṅga—plenary portions and parts; *tīkṣṇa*—sharp; *astra*—

weapons; *prabhura sahite*—along with Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sei*—these; *saba*—all; *astra*—weapons; *haya*—are; *pāṣaṇḍa*—the atheists; *dalite*—to trample.

TRANSLATION

Thus the Lord is equipped with sharp weapons in the form of His parts and plenary portions. All these weapons are competent enough to crush the faithless atheists.

PURPORT

The word *pāṣaṇḍa* is very significant here. One who compares the Supreme Personality of Godhead to the demigods is known as a *pāṣaṇḍa*. *Pāṣaṇḍas* try to bring the Supreme Lord down to a mundane level. Sometimes they create their own imaginary God or accept an ordinary person as God and advertise him as equal to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. They are so foolish that they present someone as the next incarnation of Lord Caitanya or Kṛṣṇa although His activities are all contradictory to those of a genuine incarnation, and thus they fool the innocent public. One who is intelligent and who studies the characteristics of the Supreme Personality of Godhead with reference to the Vedic context cannot be bewildered by the *pāṣaṇḍas*.

Pāṣaṇḍas, or atheists, cannot understand the pastimes of the Supreme Lord or transcendental loving service to the Lord. They think that devotional service is no better than ordinary fruitive activities (*karma*). As the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.8) confirms, however, the Supreme Personality of Godhead and His devotees, saving the righteous and chastising the miscreants (*paritrāṇāya sādḥūnām vināśāya ca duṣkṛtām*), always curb these nonsensical atheists. Miscreants always want to deny the Supreme Personality of Godhead and put stumbling blocks in the path of devotional service. The Lord sends His bona fide representatives and appears Himself to curb this nonsense.

TEXT 74

nityānanda gosāñi sākṣāt haladhara

advaita ācārya gosāñi sākṣāt īśvara

SYNONYMS

nityānanda gosāñi—Lord Nityānanda Gosāñi; *sākṣāt*—directly; *haladhara*—Lord Balarāma, the holder of the plow; *advaita ācārya gosāñi*—Śrī Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi; *sākṣāt*—directly; *īśvara*—the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Nityānanda Gosāñi is directly Haladhara [Lord Balarāma], and Advaita Ācārya is the Personality of Godhead Himself.

TEXT 75

śrīvāsādi pāriṣada sainya saṅge lañā

dui senā-pati bule kīrtana kariyā

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsa-ādi—Śrīvāsa and others; *pāriṣada*—associates; *sainya*—soldiers; *saṅge*—along with; *lañā*—taking; *dui*—two; *senā-pati*—captains; *bule*—travel; *kīrtana kariyā*—chanting the holy name.

TRANSLATION

These two captains, with Their soldiers such as Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, travel everywhere, chanting the holy name of the Lord.

TEXT 76

pāṣaṇḍa-dalana-vānā nityānanda rāya

ācārya-huṅkāre pāpa-pāṣaṇḍī palāya

SYNONYMS

pāṣaṇḍa-dalana—of trampling the atheists; *vānā*—having the feature; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *rāya*—the honorable; *ācārya*—of Advaita Ācārya; *huṅkāre*—by the war cry; *pāpa*—sins; *pāṣaṇḍī*—and atheists; *palāya*—run away.

TRANSLATION

Lord Nityānanda's very features indicate that He is the subduer of the unbelievers. All sins and unbelievers flee from the loud shouts of Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 77

saṅkīrtana-pravartaka śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

saṅkīrtana-yajñe tāṇre bhaje, sei dhanya

SYNONYMS

saṅkīrtana-pravartaka—the initiator of congregational chanting; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *saṅkīrtana*—of congregational chanting; *yajñe*—by the sacrifice; *tāṇre*—Him; *bhaje*—worships; *sei*—he; *dhanya*—fortunate.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the initiator of saṅkīrtana [congregational

chanting of the holy name of the Lord]. One who worships Him through *saṅkīrtana* is fortunate indeed.

TEXT 78

sei ta' sumedhā, āra kubuddhi saṁsāra

sarva-yajña haite kṛṣṇa-nāma-yajña sāra

SYNONYMS

sei—he; *ta'*—certainly; *su-medhā*—intelligent; *āra*—others; *ku-buddhi*—poor understanding; *saṁsāra*—in the material world; *sarva-yajña haite*—than all other sacrifices; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—of chanting the name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yajña*—the sacrifice; *sāra*—the best.

TRANSLATION

Such a person is truly intelligent, whereas others, who have but a poor fund of knowledge, must endure the cycle of repeated birth and death. Of all sacrificial performances, the chanting of the Lord's holy name is the most sublime.

PURPORT

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the father and inaugurator of the *saṅkīrtana* movement. One who worships Him by sacrificing his life, money, intelligence and words for the *saṅkīrtana* movement is recognized by the Lord and endowed with His blessings. All others may be said to be foolish, for of all sacrifices in which a man may apply his energy, a sacrifice made for the *saṅkīrtana* movement is the most glorious.

TEXT 79

koṭi aśvamedha eka kṛṣṇa nāma sama

yei kahe, se pāṣaṇḍī, daṇḍe tāre yama

SYNONYMS

koṭi—ten million; *aśvamedha*—horse sacrifices; *eka*—one; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nāma*—name; *sama*—equal to; *yei*—one who; *kahe*—says; *se*—he; *pāṣaṇḍī*—atheist; *daṇḍe*—punishes; *tāre*—him; *yama*—Yamarāja.

TRANSLATION

One who says that ten million aśvamedha sacrifices are equal to the chanting of the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa is undoubtedly an atheist. He is sure to be punished by Yamarāja.

PURPORT

In the list of the ten kinds of offenses in chanting the holy name of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hare Kṛṣṇa, the eighth offense is *dharma-vrata-tyāga-hutādi-sarva-śubha-kriyā-sāmyam api pramādaḥ*. One should never consider the chanting of the holy name of Godhead equal to pious activities like giving charity to *brāhmaṇas* or saintly persons, opening charitable educational institutions, distributing free food and so on. The results of pious activities do not equal the results of chanting the holy name of Kṛṣṇa.

The Vedic scriptures say:

*go-koṭi-dānam grahaṇe khagasya
prayāga-gaṅgodaka-kalpa-vāsaḥ
yajñāyutaṁ meru-suvarṇa-dānam
govinda-kīrter na samam śatāṁśaiḥ*

“Even if one distributes ten million cows in charity during an eclipse of the sun, lives at the confluence of the Ganges and Yamunā for millions of

years, or gives a mountain of gold in sacrifice to the *brāhmaṇas*, he does not earn one hundredth part of the merit derived from chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa.” In other words, one who accepts the chanting of Hare Kṛṣṇa to be some kind of pious activity is completely misled. Of course, it is pious; but the real fact is that Kṛṣṇa and His name, being transcendental, are far above all mundane pious activity. Pious activity is on the material platform, but chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa is completely on the spiritual plane. Therefore, although *pāsaṇḍīs* do not understand this, pious activity can never compare to the chanting of the holy name.

TEXT 80

‘bhāgavata-sandarbha’-granthera maṅgalācaraṇe

e-śloka jīva-gosāñi kariyāchena vyākhyāne

SYNONYMS

bhāgavata-sandarbha-granthera—of the book called *Bhāgavata-sandarbha*; *maṅgala-ācaraṇe*—in the auspicious introduction; *e-śloka*—this verse; *jīva-gosāñi*—Jīva Gosvāmī; *kariyāchena*—has made; *vyākhyāne*—in explaining.

TRANSLATION

In the auspicious introduction to the *Bhāgavata-sandarbha*, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī has given the following verse as an explanation.

TEXT 81

antaḥ kṛṣṇaṁ bahir gauram

darśitāṅgādi-vaibhavam

kalau saṅkīrtanādyaiḥ sma

kṛṣṇa-caitanyam āśritāḥ

SYNONYMS

antaḥ—internally; *kṛṣṇam*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bahiḥ*—externally; *gauram*—fair-colored; *darśita*—displayed; *aṅga*—limbs; *ādi*—beginning with; *vaibhavam*—expansions; *kalau*—in the Age of Kali; *saṅkīrtana-ādyaiḥ*—by congregational chanting, etc.; *sma*—certainly; *kṛṣṇa-caitanyam*—unto Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *āśritāḥ*—sheltered.

TRANSLATION

“I take shelter of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is outwardly of a fair complexion but is inwardly Kṛṣṇa Himself. In this Age of Kali He displays His expansions [His aṅgas and upāṅgas] by performing congregational chanting of the holy name of the Lord.”

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī has placed the verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* quoted in text 52 (*kṛṣṇa-varṇam tviṣākṛṣṇam* [SB 11.5.32]) as the auspicious introduction to his *Bhāgavata-sandarbha*, or *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*. He has composed this text (81), which is, in effect, an explanation of the *Bhāgavatam* verse, as the second verse of the same work. The verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* was enunciated by Karabhājana, one of the nine great sages, and it is elaborately explained by the *Sarva-saṁvādinī*, Jīva Gosvāmī’s commentary on his own *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*.

Antaḥ kṛṣṇa refers to one who is always thinking of Kṛṣṇa. This attitude is a predominant feature of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. Even though many devotees always think of Kṛṣṇa, none can surpass the *gopīs*, among whom Rādhārāṇī is the leader in thinking of Kṛṣṇa. Rādhārāṇī’s Kṛṣṇa consciousness surpasses that of all other devotees. Lord Caitanya accepted the position of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī to understand Kṛṣṇa; therefore He was always thinking of Kṛṣṇa in the same way as Rādhārāṇī. By thinking of

Lord Kṛṣṇa, He always overlapped Kṛṣṇa.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who was outwardly very fair, with a complexion like molten gold, simultaneously manifested His eternal associates, opulences, expansions and incarnations. He preached the process of chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa, and those who are under His lotus feet are glorious.

TEXT 82

upa-purāṇeha śuni śrī-kṛṣṇa-vacana

kṛpā kari vyāsa prati kariyāchena kathana

SYNONYMS

upa-purāṇeha—in the *Upapurāṇas*; *śuni*—we hear; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-vacana*—the words of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛpā kari*—having mercy; *vyāsa prati*—toward Vyāsadeva; *kariyāchena*—He did; *kathana*—speaking.

TRANSLATION

In the *Upapurāṇas* we hear Śrī Kṛṣṇa showing His mercy to Vyāsadeva by speaking to him as follows.

TEXT 83

aham eva kvacid brahman

sannyāsāśramam āśritaḥ

hari-bhaktim grāhayāmi

kalau pāpa-hatān narān

SYNONYMS

aham—I; *eva*—certainly; *kvacit*—somewhere; *brahman*—O *brāhmaṇa*; *sannyāsa-āśramam*—the renounced order of life; *āśritaḥ*—taking recourse to; *hari-bhaktim*—devotional service to the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *grāhayāmi*—I shall give; *kalau*—in the Age of Kali; *pāpa-hatān*—sinful; *narān*—to men.

TRANSLATION

“O learned *brāhmaṇa*, sometimes I accept the renounced order of life to induce the fallen people of the Age of Kali to accept devotional service to the Lord.”

TEXT 84

bhāgavata, bhārata-śāstra, āgama, purāṇa

caitanya-kṛṣṇa-avatāre prakāṣa pramāṇa

SYNONYMS

bhāgavata—*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *bhārata-śāstra*—*Mahābhārata*; *āgama*—Vedic literatures; *purāṇa*—the *Purāṇas*; *caitanya*—as Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatāre*—in the incarnation; *prakāṣa*—displayed; *pramāṇa*—evidence.

TRANSLATION

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, the Mahābhārata, the Purāṇas and other Vedic literatures all give evidence to prove that Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the incarnation of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 85

pratyakṣe dekhaha nānā prakāṣa prabhāva

alaukika karma, alaukika anubhāva

SYNONYMS

pratyakṣe—directly; *dekhaha*—just see; *nānā*—various; *prakaṭa*—manifested; *prabhāva*—influence; *alaukika*—uncommon; *karma*—activities; *alaukika*—uncommon; *anubhāva*—realizations in Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

TRANSLATION

One can also directly see Lord Caitanya's manifest influence in His uncommon deeds and uncommon Kṛṣṇa conscious realization.

TEXT 86

dekhiyā nā dekhe yata abhaktera gaṇa

ulūke nā dekhe yena sūryera kiraṇa

SYNONYMS

dekhiyā—seeing; *nā dekhe*—they do not see; *yata*—all; *abhaktera*—of nondevotees; *gaṇa*—crowds; *ulūke*—the owl; *nā dekhe*—does not see; *yena*—just as; *sūryera*—of the sun; *kiraṇa*—rays.

TRANSLATION

But faithless unbelievers do not see what is clearly evident, just as owls do not see the rays of the sun.

TEXT 87

tvām śīla-rūpa-caritaiḥ parama-prakṛṣṭaiḥ

sattvena sāttvikatayā prabalaś ca śāstraiḥ
prakhyāta-daiva-paramārtha-vidām mataś ca
naivāsura-prakṛtayaḥ prabhavanti boddhum

SYNONYMS

tvām—You; *śīla*—character; *rūpa*—forms; *caritaiḥ*—by acts; *parama*—most; *prakṛṣṭaiḥ*—eminent; *sattvena*—by uncommon power; *sāttvikatayā*—with the quality of predominant goodness; *prabalaiḥ*—great; *ca*—and; *śāstraiḥ*—by the scriptures; *prakhyāta*—renowned; *daiva*—divine; *parama-artha-vidām*—of those who know the highest goal; *matāiḥ*—by the opinions; *ca*—and; *na*—not; *eva*—certainly; *āsura-prakṛtayaḥ*—those whose disposition is demoniac; *prabhavanti*—are able; *boddhum*—to know.

TRANSLATION

“O my Lord, those influenced by demoniac principles cannot realize You, although You are clearly the Supreme by dint of Your exalted activities, forms, character and uncommon power, which are confirmed by all the revealed scriptures in the quality of goodness and the celebrated transcendentalists in the divine nature.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Stotra-ratna* (12) of Yāmunācārya, the spiritual master of Rāmānujācārya. The authentic scriptures describe the transcendental activities, features, form and qualities of Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa explains Himself in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, the most authentic scripture in the world. He is further explained in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, which is considered the explanation of the *Vedānta-sūtra*. Lord Kṛṣṇa is accepted as the Supreme Personality of Godhead by these authentic scriptures, not simply by *vox populi*. In the modern age a certain class of fools think that

they can vote anyone into the position of God, as they can vote a man into the position of a political executive head. But the transcendental Supreme Personality of Godhead is perfectly described in the authentic scriptures. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* the Lord says that only fools deride Him, thinking that anyone can speak like Kṛṣṇa.

Even according to historical references, Kṛṣṇa's activities are most uncommon. Kṛṣṇa has affirmed, "I am God," and He has acted accordingly. Māyāvādīs think that everyone can claim to be God, but that is their illusion, for no one else can perform such extraordinary activities as Kṛṣṇa. When He was a child on the lap of His mother, He killed the demon Pūtanā. Then He killed the demons Tṛṇāvarta, Vatsāsura and Baka. When He was a little more grown up, He killed the demons Aghāsura and R̥ṣabhāsura. Therefore God is God from the very beginning. The idea that someone can become God by meditation is ridiculous. By hard endeavor one may realize his godly nature, but he will never become God. The *asuras*, or demons, who think that anyone can become God, are condemned.

The authentic scriptures are compiled by personalities like Vyāsadeva, Nārada, Asita and Parāśara, who are not ordinary men. All the followers of the Vedic way of life have accepted these famous personalities, whose authentic scriptures conform to the Vedic literature. Nevertheless, the demoniac do not believe their statements, and they purposely oppose the Supreme Personality of Godhead and His devotees. Today it is fashionable for common men to write whimsical words as so-called incarnations of God and be accepted as authentic by other common men. This demoniac mentality is condemned in the Seventh Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, wherein it is said that those who are miscreants and the lowest of mankind, who are fools and asses, cannot accept the Supreme Personality of Godhead because of their demoniac nature. They are compared to *ulūkas*, or owls, who cannot open their eyes in the sunlight. Because they cannot bear the sunlight, they hide themselves from it and never see it. They cannot believe that there is such illumination.

TEXT 88

āpanā lukāite kṛṣṇa nānā yatna kare

tathāpi tāñhāra bhakta jānaye tāñhāre

SYNONYMS

āpanā—Himself; *lukāite*—to hide; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nānā*—various; *yatna*—efforts; *kare*—makes; *tathāpi*—still; *tāñhāra*—His; *bhakta*—devotees; *jānaye*—know; *tāñhāre*—Him.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa tries to hide Himself in various ways, but nevertheless His pure devotees know Him as He is.

TEXT 89

ullaṅghita-trividha-sīma-samātiśāyi-

sambhāvanam tava parivraḍhima-svabhāvam

māyā-balena bhavatāpi niguhyamānam

paśyanti kecid anīśam tvad-ananya-bhāvāḥ

SYNONYMS

ullaṅghita—passed over; *tri-vidha*—three kinds; *sīma*—the limitations; *sama*—of equal; *atiśāyi*—and of excelling; *sambhāvanam*—by which the adequacy; *tava*—Your; *parivraḍhima*—of supremacy; *svabhāvam*—the real nature; *māyā-balena*—by the strength of the illusory energy; *bhavatā*—Your; *api*—although; *niguhyamānam*—being hidden; *paśyanti*—they see; *kecit*—some; *anīśam*—always; *tvad*—to You;

ananya-bhāvāḥ—those who are exclusively devoted.

TRANSLATION

“O my Lord, everything within material nature is limited by time, space and thought. Your characteristics, however, being unequaled and unsurpassed, are always transcendental to such limitations. You sometimes cover such characteristics by Your own energy, but nevertheless Your unalloyed devotees are always able to see You under all circumstances.”

PURPORT

This verse is also quoted from the *Stotra-ratna* (13) of Yāmunācārya. Everything covered by the influence of *māyā* is within the limited boundaries of space, time and thought. Even the greatest manifestation we can conceive, the sky, also has limitations. From the authentic scriptures, however, it is evident that beyond the sky is a covering of seven layers, each ten times thicker than the one preceding it. The covering layers are vast, but with or without coverings, space is limited. Our power to think about space and time is also limited. Time is eternal; we may imagine billions and trillions of years, but that will still be an inadequate estimate of the extent of time. Our imperfect senses, therefore, cannot think of the greatness of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, nor can we bring Him within the limitations of time or our thinking power. His position is accordingly described by the word *ullaṅghita*. He is transcendental to space, time and thought; although He appears within them, He exists transcendently. Even when the Lord’s transcendental existence is disguised by space, time and thought, however, pure devotees of the Supreme Lord can see Him in His personal features beyond space, time and thought. In other words, even though the Lord is not visible to the eyes of ordinary men, those who are beyond the covering layers because of their transcendental devotional service can still see Him.

The sun may appear covered by a cloud, but actually it is the eyes of the tiny people below the cloud that are covered, not the sun. If those tiny people rose above the cloud in an airplane, they could then see the sunshine and the sun without impediment. Similarly, although the covering of *māyā* is very strong, Lord Kṛṣṇa says in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.14):

*daivī hy eṣā guṇa-mayī
mama māyā duratyayā
mām eva ye prapadyante
māyām etāṁ taranti te*

“This divine energy of Mine, consisting of the three modes of material nature, is difficult to overcome. But those who have surrendered unto Me can easily cross beyond it.” To surpass the influence of the illusory energy is very difficult, but those who are determined to catch hold of the lotus feet of the Lord are freed from the clutches of *māyā*. Therefore, pure devotees can understand the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but demons, because of their miscreant behavior, cannot understand the Lord, in spite of seeing the many revealed scriptures and the uncommon activities of the Lord.

TEXT 90

asura-svabhāve kṛṣṇe kabhu nāhi jāne

lukāite nāre kṛṣṇa bhakta-jana-sthāne

SYNONYMS

asura-svabhāve—those whose nature is demoniac; *kṛṣṇe*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kabhu*—at any time; *nāhi*—not; *jāne*—know; *lukāite*—to hide; *nāre*—is not able; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhakta-jana*—of pure devotees; *sthāne*—in a place.

TRANSLATION

Those whose nature is demoniac cannot know Kṛṣṇa at any time, but He cannot hide Himself from His pure devotees.

PURPORT

People who develop the nature of *asuras* like Rāvaṇa and Hiraṇyakaśipu can never know Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, by challenging the authority of Godhead. But Śrī Kṛṣṇa cannot hide Himself from His pure devotees.

TEXT 91

dvau bhūta-sargau loke 'smin

daiva āsura eva ca

viṣṇu-bhaktaḥ smṛto daiva

āsuras tad-viparyayaḥ

SYNONYMS

dvau—two; *bhūta*—of the living beings; *sargau*—dispositions; *loke*—in the world; *asmin*—in this; *daivaḥ*—godly; *āsuraḥ*—demoniac; *eva*—certainly; *ca*—and; *viṣṇu-bhaktaḥ*—a devotee of Lord Viṣṇu; *smṛtaḥ*—remembered; *daivaḥ*—godly; *āsuraḥ*—demoniac; *tad-viparyayaḥ*—the opposite of that.

TRANSLATION

“There are two classes of men in the created world. One consists of the demoniac and the other of the godly. The devotees of Lord Viṣṇu are the godly, whereas those who are just the opposite are called demons.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Padma Purāṇa*. *Viṣṇu-bhaktas*, or devotees in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, are known as *devas* (demigods). Atheists, who do not believe in God or who declare themselves God, are *asuras* (demons). *Asuras* always engage in atheistic material activities, exploring ways to utilize the resources of matter to enjoy sense gratification. The *viṣṇu-bhaktas*, Kṛṣṇa conscious devotees, are also active, but their objective is to satisfy the Supreme Personality of Godhead by devotional service. Superficially both classes may appear to work in the same way, but their purposes are completely opposite because of a difference in consciousness. *Asuras* work for personal sense gratification, whereas devotees work for the satisfaction of the Supreme Lord. Both work conscientiously, but their motives are different.

The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is meant for *devas*, or devotees. Demons cannot take part in Kṛṣṇa conscious activities, nor can devotees in Kṛṣṇa consciousness take part in demoniac activities or work like cats and dogs simply for sense gratification. Such activity does not appeal to those in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Devotees accept only the bare necessities of life to keep themselves fit to act in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. The balance of their energy is used for developing Kṛṣṇa consciousness, through which one can be transferred to the abode of Kṛṣṇa by always thinking of Him, even at the point of death.

TEXT 92

ācārya gosāñi prabhura bhakta-avatāra

kṛṣṇa-avatāra-hetu yāñhāra huñkāra

SYNONYMS

ācārya gosāñi—Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *bhakta-avatāra*—incarnation of a devotee; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatāra*—of

the incarnation; *hetu*—the cause; *yāñhāra*—whose; *huñkāra*—loud calls.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya Gosvāmī is an incarnation of the Lord as a devotee. His loud calling was the cause for Kṛṣṇa's incarnation.

TEXT 93

kṛṣṇa yadi pṛthivīte karena avatāra

prathame karena guru-vargera sañcāra

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yadi*—if; *pṛthivīte*—on the earth; *karena*—makes; *avatāra*—incarnation; *prathame*—first; *karena*—makes; *guru-vargera*—of the group of respectable predecessors; *sañcāra*—the advent.

TRANSLATION

Whenever Śrī Kṛṣṇa desires to manifest His incarnation on earth, first He creates the incarnations of His respectable predecessors.

TEXT 94

pitā mātā guru ādi yata mānya-gaṇa

prathame karena sabāra pṛthivīte janama

SYNONYMS

pitā—father; *mātā*—mother; *guru*—spiritual master; *ādi*—headed by; *yata*—all; *mānya-gaṇa*—respectable members; *prathame*—first; *karena*—He makes; *sabāra*—of all of them; *pṛthivīte*—on earth;

janama—the births.

TRANSLATION

Thus respectable personalities such as His father, mother and spiritual master all take birth on earth first.

TEXT 95

mādhava-īśvara-purī, śacī, jagannātha

advaita ācārya prakāṣa hailā sei sātha

SYNONYMS

mādhava—Mādhavendra Purī; *īśvara-purī*—Īśvara Purī; *śacī*—Śacīmātā; *jagannātha*—Jagannātha Miśra; *advaita ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *prakāṣa*—manifested; *hailā*—were; *sei*—this; *sātha*—with.

TRANSLATION

Mādhavendra Purī, Īśvara Purī, Śrīmatī Śacīmātā and Śrīla Jagannātha Miśra all appeared with Śrī Advaita Ācārya.

PURPORT

Whenever the Supreme Personality of Godhead descends in His human form, He sends ahead all His devotees, who act as His father, teacher and associates in many roles. Such personalities appear before the descent of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Before the appearance of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, there appeared His devotees like Śrī Mādhavendra Purī; His spiritual master, Śrī Īśvara Purī; His mother, Śrīmatī Śacī-devī; His father, Śrī Jagannātha Miśra; and Śrī Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 96

prakaṭiyā dekhe ācārya sakalā saṁsāra

kṛṣṇa-bhakti gandha-hīna viṣaya-vyavahāra

SYNONYMS

prakaṭiyā—manifesting; *dekhe*—He saw; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *sakalā*—all; *saṁsāra*—material existence; *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*—of devotion to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *gandha-hīna*—without a trace; *viṣaya*—of the sense objects; *vyavahāra*—affairs.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya having appeared, He found the world devoid of devotional service to Śrī Kṛṣṇa because people were engrossed in material affairs.

TEXT 97

keha pāpe, keha puṇye kare viṣaya-bhoga

bhakti-gandha nāhi, yāte yāya bhava-roga

SYNONYMS

keha—someone; *pāpe*—in sinful activities; *keha*—someone; *puṇye*—in pious activities; *kare*—do; *viṣaya*—of the sense objects; *bhoga*—enjoyment; *bhakti-gandha*—a trace of devotional service; *nāhi*—there is not; *yāte*—by which; *yāya*—goes away; *bhava-roga*—the disease of material existence.

TRANSLATION

Everyone was engaged in material enjoyment, whether sinfully or virtuously. No one was interested in the transcendental service of the Lord, which can give total relief from the repetition of birth and death.

PURPORT

Advaita Ācārya saw the entire world to be engaged in activities of material piety and impiety, without a trace of devotional service, or Kṛṣṇa consciousness, anywhere. The fact is that in this material world there is no scarcity of anything except Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Material necessities are supplied by the mercy of the Supreme Lord. We sometimes feel scarcity because of our mismanagement, but the real problem is that people are out of touch with Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Everyone is engaged in material sense gratification, but people have no plan for making an ultimate solution to their real problems, namely birth, disease, old age and death. These four material miseries are called *bhava-roga*, or material diseases. They can be cured only by Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Therefore Kṛṣṇa consciousness is the greatest benediction for human society.

TEXT 98

loka-gati dekhi' ācārya karuṇa-hṛdaya

vicāra karena, lokera kaiche hita haya

SYNONYMS

loka-gati—the course of the world; *dekhi'*—seeing; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *karuṇa-hṛdaya*—compassionate heart; *vicāra karena*—considers; *lokera*—of the world; *kaiche*—how; *hita*—welfare; *haya*—there is.

TRANSLATION

Seeing the activities of the world, the Ācārya felt compassion and began to ponder how He could act for the people's benefit.

PURPORT

This sort of serious interest in the welfare of the public makes one a bona fide *ācārya*. An *ācārya* does not exploit his followers. Since the *ācārya* is a confidential servitor of the Lord, his heart is always full of compassion for humanity in its suffering. He knows that all suffering is due to the absence of devotional service to the Lord, and therefore he always tries to find ways to change people's activities, making them favorable for the attainment of devotion. That is the qualification of an *ācārya*. Although Śrī Advaita Prabhu Himself was powerful enough to do the work, as a submissive servitor He thought that without the personal appearance of the Lord, no one could improve the fallen condition of society.

In the grim clutches of *māyā*, the first-class prisoners of this material world wrongly think themselves happy because they are rich, powerful, resourceful and so on. These foolish creatures do not know that they are nothing but play dolls in the hands of material nature and that at any moment material nature's pitiless intrigues can crush to dust all their plans for godless activities. Such foolish prisoners cannot see that however they improve their position by artificial means, the calamities of repeated birth, death, disease and old age are always beyond the jurisdiction of their control. Foolish as they are, they neglect these major problems of life and busy themselves with false things that cannot help them solve their real problems. They know that they do not want to suffer death or the pangs of disease and old age, but under the influence of the illusory energy, they are grossly negligent and therefore do nothing to solve the problems. This is called *māyā*. People held in the grip of *māyā* are thrown into oblivion after death, and as a result of their *karma*, in the next life they become dogs or gods, although most of them become dogs. To become gods in the next life, they must engage in the devotional service of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; otherwise, they are sure to become dogs or hogs in terms of the laws of nature.

The third-class prisoners, being less materially opulent than the first-class prisoners, endeavor to imitate them, for they also have no information of

the real nature of their imprisonment. Thus they also are misled by the illusory material nature. The function of the *ācārya*, however, is to change the activities of both the first-class and third-class prisoners for their real benefit. This endeavor makes him a very dear devotee of the Lord, who says clearly in the *Bhagavad-gītā* that no one in human society is dearer to Him than a devotee who constantly engages in His service by finding ways to preach the message of Godhead for the real benefit of the world. The so-called *ācāryas* of the Age of Kali are more concerned with exploiting the resources of their followers than mitigating their miseries; but Śrī Advaita Prabhu, as an ideal *ācārya*, was concerned with improving the condition of the world situation.

TEXT 99

āpani śrī-kṛṣṇa yadi kareṇa avatāra

āpane ācari' bhakti kareṇa pracāra

SYNONYMS

āpani—Himself; *śrī-kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yadi*—if; *kareṇa*—He makes; *avatāra*—incarnation; *āpane*—Himself; *ācari'*—practicing; *bhakti*—devotional service; *kareṇa*—does; *pracāra*—propagation.

TRANSLATION

[Advaita Ācārya thought:] “If Śrī Kṛṣṇa were to appear as an incarnation, He Himself could preach devotion by His personal example.

TEXT 100

nāma vinu kali-kāle dharma nāhi āra

kali-kāle kaiche habe kṛṣṇa avatāra

SYNONYMS

nāma vinu—except for the holy name; *kali-kāle*—in the Age of Kali; *dharma*—religion; *nāhi*—there is not; *āra*—another; *kali-kāle*—in the Age of Kali; *kaiche*—how; *habe*—there will be; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatāra*—incarnation.

TRANSLATION

“In this Age of Kali there is no religion other than the chanting of the holy name of the Lord, but how in this age will the Lord appear as an incarnation?”

TEXT 101

śuddha-bhāve kariba kṛṣṇera ārādhana

nirantara sadainye kariba nivedana

SYNONYMS

śuddha-bhāve—in a purified state of mind; *kariba*—I shall do; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ārādhana*—worship; *nirantara*—constantly; *sa-dainye*—in humility; *kariba*—I shall make; *nivedana*—request.

TRANSLATION

“I shall worship Kṛṣṇa in a purified state of mind. I shall constantly petition Him in humbleness.

TEXT 102

āniyā kṛṣṇere karoṇ kīrtana sañcāra

tabe se ‘advaita’ nāma saphala āmāra

SYNONYMS

āṇiyā—bringing; *kṛṣṇere*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karoṇi*—I make; *kīrtana*—chanting of the holy name; *sañcāra*—advent; *tabe*—then; *se*—this; *advaita*—nondual; *nāma*—name; *sa-phala*—fulfilled; *āmāra*—My.

TRANSLATION

“My name, ‘Advaita,’ will be fitting if I am able to induce Kṛṣṇa to inaugurate the movement of the chanting of the holy name.”

PURPORT

The nondualist Māyāvādī philosopher who falsely believes that he is nondifferent from the Lord is unable to call Him like Advaita Prabhu. Advaita Prabhu is nondifferent from the Lord, yet in His relationship with the Lord He does not merge with Him but eternally renders service unto Him as a plenary portion. This is inconceivable for Māyāvādīs because they think in terms of mundane sense perception and therefore think that nondualism necessitates losing one’s separate identity. It is clear from this verse, however, that Advaita Prabhu, although retaining His separate identity, is nondifferent from the Lord.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu preached the philosophy of inconceivable, simultaneous oneness with the Lord and difference from Him. Conceivable dualism and monism are conceptions of the imperfect senses, which are unable to reach the Transcendence because the Transcendence is beyond the conception of limited potency. The actions of Śrī Advaita Prabhu, however, give tangible proof of inconceivable nondualism. One who therefore surrenders unto Śrī Advaita Prabhu can easily follow the philosophy of inconceivable simultaneous dualism and monism.

TEXT 103

kṛṣṇa vaśa karibena kon ārādhane

vicārite eka śloka āila tāñra mane

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vaśa karibena*—shall propitiate; *kon ārādhane*—by what worship; *vicārite*—while considering; *eka*—one; *śloka*—verse; *āila*—came; *tāñra*—of Him; *mane*—in the mind.

TRANSLATION

While He was thinking about how to propitiate Kṛṣṇa by worship, the following verse came to His mind.

TEXT 104

tulasī-dala-mātreṇa

jalasya culukena vā

vikrīṇīte svam ātmānam

bhaktebhyo bhakta-vatsalaḥ

SYNONYMS

tulasī—of *tulasī*; *dala*—a leaf; *mātreṇa*—by only; *jalasya*—of water; *culukena*—by a palmful; *vā*—and; *vikrīṇīte*—sells; *svam*—His own; *ātmānam*—self; *bhaktebhyah*—unto the devotees; *bhakta-vatsalaḥ*—Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is affectionate to His devotees.

TRANSLATION

“Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who is very affectionate toward His devotees, sells Himself to a devotee who offers Him merely a *tulasī* leaf and a palmful of water.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Gautamīya-tantra*.

TEXTS 105–106

ei ślokārtha ācārya karena vicāraṇa

kṛṣṇake tulasī-jala deya yei jana

tāra ṛṇa śodhite kṛṣṇa karena cintana—

‘jala-tulasīra sama kichu ghare nāhi dhana’

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *śloka*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *karena*—does; *vicāraṇa*—considering; *kṛṣṇake*—to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tulasī-jala*—*tulasī* and water; *deya*—gives; *yei jana*—that person who; *tāra*—to Him; *ṛṇa*—the debt; *śodhite*—to pay; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karena*—does; *cintana*—thinking; *jala-tulasīra sama*—equal to water and *tulasī*; *kichu*—any; *ghare*—in the house; *nāhi*—there is not; *dhana*—wealth.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya considered the meaning of the verse in this way: “Not finding any way to repay the debt He owes to one who offers Him a *tulasī* leaf and water, Lord Kṛṣṇa thinks, ‘There is no wealth in My possession that is equal to a *tulasī* leaf and water.’”

TEXT 107

tabe ātmā veci’ kare ṛṇera śodhana

eta bhāvi' ācārya karena ārādhana

SYNONYMS

tabe—then; *ātmā*—Himself; *veci'*—selling; *kare*—does; *ṛṇera*—of the debt; *śodhana*—payment; *eta*—thus; *bhāvi'*—thinking; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *karena*—does; *ārādhana*—worshiping.

TRANSLATION

“Thus the Lord liquidates the debt by offering Himself to the devotee.”
Considering in this way, the Ācārya began worshiping the Lord.

PURPORT

Through devotional service one can easily please Lord Kṛṣṇa with a leaf of the *tulasī* plant and a little water. As the Lord says in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.26), a leaf, a flower, a fruit or some water (*patraṁ puṣpaṁ phalaṁ toyam*), when offered with devotion, very much pleases Him. He universally accepts the services of His devotees. Even the poorest of devotees in any part of the world can secure a small flower, fruit or leaf and a little water, and if these offerings, and especially *tulasī* leaves and Ganges water, are offered to Kṛṣṇa with devotion, He is very satisfied. It is said that Kṛṣṇa is so much pleased by such devotional service that He offers Himself to His devotee in exchange for it. Śrīla Advaita Ācārya knew this fact, and therefore He decided to call for the Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa to descend by worshiping the Lord with *tulasī* leaves and the water of the Ganges.

TEXT 108

gaṅgā-jala, tulasī-mañjarī anukṣaṇa

kṛṣṇa-pāda-padma bhāvi' kare samarpaṇa

SYNONYMS

gaṅgā-jala—the water of the Ganges; *tulasī-mañjarī*—buds of the *tulasī* plant; *anukṣaṇa*—constantly; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pāda-padma*—lotus feet; *bhāvi*—thinking of; *kare*—does; *samarpaṇa*—offering.

TRANSLATION

Thinking of the lotus feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, He constantly offered *tulasī* buds in water from the Ganges.

TEXT 109

kṛṣṇera āhvāna kare kariyā huṅkāra

e-mate kṛṣṇere karāila avatāra

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *āhvāna*—invitation; *kare*—makes; *kariyā*—making; *huṅkāra*—loud shouts; *e-mate*—in this way; *kṛṣṇere*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karāila*—caused to make; *avatāra*—incarnation.

TRANSLATION

He appealed to Śrī Kṛṣṇa with loud calls and thus made it possible for Kṛṣṇa to appear.

TEXT 110

caitanyera avatāre ei mukhya hetu

bhaktera icchāya avatare dharma-setu

SYNONYMS

caitanya—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *avatāre*—in the incarnation; *ei*—this; *mukhya*—principal; *hetu*—cause; *bhaktera*—of the devotee; *icchāya*—by the desire; *avatare*—He descends; *dharma-setu*—protector of religion.

TRANSLATION

Therefore the principal reason for Śrī Caitanya’s descent is this appeal by Advaita Ācārya. The Lord, the protector of religion, appears by the desire of His devotee.

TEXT 111

tvam bhakti-yoga-paribhāvita-hṛt-saroja

āsse śrutekṣita-patho nanu nātha puṁsām

yad yad dhiyā ta urugāya vibhāvayanti

tat tad vapuḥ praṇayase sad-anugrahāya

SYNONYMS

tvam—You; *bhakti-yoga*—by devotional service; *paribhāvita*—saturated; *hṛt*—of the heart; *saroje*—on the lotus; *āsse*—dwell; *śruta*—heard; *īkṣita*—seen; *pathaḥ*—whose path; *nanu*—certainly; *nātha*—O Lord; *puṁsām*—by the devotees; *yat yat*—whatever; *dhiyā*—by the mind; *te*—they; *uru-gāya*—O Lord, who are glorified in excellent ways; *vibhāvayanti*—contemplate upon; *tat tat*—that; *vapuḥ*—form; *praṇayase*—You manifest; *sat*—to Your devotees; *anugrahāya*—to show favor.

TRANSLATION

“O my Lord, You always dwell in the vision and hearing of Your pure

devotees. You also live in their lotuslike hearts, which are purified by devotional service. O my Lord, who are glorified by exalted prayers, You show special favor to Your devotees by manifesting Yourself in the eternal forms in which they welcome You.”

PURPORT

This text from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.9.11) is a prayer by Lord Brahmā to the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa for His blessings in the work of creation. Knowledge of the Supreme Personality of Godhead can be understood from the descriptions of the Vedic scriptures. For example, the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.29) describes that in the abode of Lord Kṛṣṇa, which is made of *cintāmaṇi* (touchstone), the Lord, acting as a cowherd boy, is served by hundreds and thousands of goddesses of fortune. Māyāvādīs think that the devotees have imagined the form of Kṛṣṇa, but the authentic Vedic scriptures have actually described Kṛṣṇa and His various transcendental forms.

The word *śruta* in *śrutekṣita-pathaḥ* refers to the *Vedas*, and *īkṣita* indicates that the way to understand the Supreme Personality of Godhead is by proper study of the Vedic scriptures. One cannot imagine something about God or His form. Such imagination is not accepted by those who are serious about enlightenment. Here Brahmā says that one can know Kṛṣṇa through the path of properly understanding the Vedic texts. If by studying the form, name, qualities, pastimes and paraphernalia of the Supreme Godhead one is attracted to the Lord, he can execute devotional service, and the form of the Lord will be impressed in his heart and remain transcendently situated there. Unless a devotee actually develops transcendental love for the Lord, it is not possible for him to think always of the Lord within his heart. Such constant thought of the Lord is the sublime perfection of the yogic process, as the *Bhagavad-gītā* confirms in the Sixth Chapter (47), stating that anyone absorbed in such thought is the best of all *yogīs*. Such transcendental absorption is known as *samādhi*. A pure devotee who is always thinking of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the person qualified to see the Lord.

One cannot speak of Urugāya (the Lord, who is glorified by sublime prayers) unless one is transcendently elevated. The Lord has innumerable forms, as the *Brahma-saṁhitā* confirms (*advaitam acyutam anādim ananta-rūpam* [Bs 5.33]). The Lord expands Himself in innumerable *svāmśa* forms. When a devotee, hearing about these innumerable forms, becomes attached to one and always thinks of Him, the Lord appears to him in that form. Lord Kṛṣṇa is especially pleasing to such devotees, in whose hearts He is always present because of their highly elevated transcendental love.

TEXT 112

ei ślokerā artha kahi saṅkṣepera sāra

bhaktera icchāya kṛṣṇera sarva avatāra

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *kahi*—I relate; *saṅkṣepera*—of conciseness; *sāra*—the pith; *bhaktera*—of the devotee; *icchāya*—by the desire; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sarva*—all; *avatāra*—incarnations.

TRANSLATION

The essence of the meaning of this verse is that Lord Kṛṣṇa appears in all His innumerable eternal forms because of the desires of His pure devotees.

TEXT 113

caturtha ślokerā artha haila suniścite

avatīrṇa hailā gaura prema prakāśite

SYNONYMS

caturtha—fourth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *hailā*—was; *su-niścīte*—very surely; *avatīrṇa hailā*—incarnated; *gaura*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *prema*—love of God; *prakāśīte*—to manifest.

TRANSLATION

Thus I have surely determined the meaning of the fourth verse. Lord Gaurāṅga [Lord Caitanya] appeared as an incarnation to preach unalloyed love of God.

TEXT 114

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet of; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Third Chapter, describing the external reasons for the appearance of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Chapter 4

The Confidential Reasons for the Appearance of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

In this chapter of the epic *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī has stressed that Lord Caitanya appeared for three principal purposes of His own. The first purpose was to relish the position of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, who is the prime reciprocator of transcendental love of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Lord Kṛṣṇa is the reservoir of transcendental loving transactions with Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. The subject of those loving transactions is the Lord Himself, and Rādhārāṇī is the object. Thus the subject, the Lord, wanted to relish the loving mellow in the position of the object, Rādhārāṇī.

The second reason for His appearance was to understand the transcendental mellow of Himself. Lord Kṛṣṇa is all sweetness. Rādhārāṇī's attraction for Kṛṣṇa is sublime, and to experience that attraction and understand the transcendental sweetness of Himself, He accepted the mentality of Rādhārāṇī.

The third reason that Lord Caitanya appeared was to enjoy the bliss tasted by Rādhārāṇī. The Lord thought that undoubtedly Rādhārāṇī enjoyed His company and He enjoyed the company of Rādhārāṇī, but the exchange of transcendental mellow between the spiritual couple was more pleasing to Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī than to Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Rādhārāṇī felt more transcendental pleasure in the company of Kṛṣṇa than He could understand without taking Her position, but for Śrī Kṛṣṇa to enjoy in the position of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī was impossible because that position was completely foreign to Him. Kṛṣṇa is the transcendental male, and Rādhārāṇī is the transcendental female. Therefore, to know the transcendental pleasure of loving Kṛṣṇa, Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself appeared as Lord Caitanya, accepting the emotions and bodily luster of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

Lord Caitanya appeared in order to fulfill these confidential desires, and also to preach the special significance of chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare and to answer the call of Advaita Prabhu. These were secondary reasons.

Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī was the principal figure among Lord Caitanya's confidential devotees. The records of his diary have revealed these confidential purposes of the Lord. These revelations have been confirmed by the statements of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī in his various prayers and poems.

This chapter also specifically describes the difference between lust and love. The transactions of Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā are completely different from material lust. Therefore the author has very clearly distinguished between them.

TEXT 1

śrī-caitanya-prasādena

tad-rūpasya vinirṇayam

bālo 'pi kurute śāstram

dr̥ṣṭvā vraja-vilāsinah

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya-prasādena—by the mercy of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tat*—of Him; *rūpasya*—of the form; *vinirṇayam*—complete determination; *bālah*—a child; *api*—even; *kurute*—makes; *śāstram*—the revealed scriptures; *dr̥ṣṭvā*—having seen; *vraja-vilāsinah*—who enjoys the pastimes of Vraja.

TRANSLATION

By the mercy of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, even a foolish child can fully describe the real nature of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enjoyer of the pastimes of Vraja, according to the vision of the revealed scriptures.

PURPORT

One can ascertain the meaning of this Sanskrit *śloka* only when one is endowed with the causeless mercy of Lord Caitanya. Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, being the absolute Personality of Godhead, cannot be exposed to the mundane instruments of vision. He reserves the right not to be exposed by the intellectual feats of nondevotees. Notwithstanding this truth, even a small child can easily understand Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa and His transcendental pastimes in the land of Vṛndāvana by the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glory; *śrī-caitanya*—to Lord Caitanya; *jaya*—all glory; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda; *jaya*—all glory; *advaita-candra*—to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya*—all glory; *gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—to the devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

All glory to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu! All glory to Lord Nityānanda!
All glory to Śrī Advaita Ācārya! And all glory to all the devotees of Lord Caitanya!

TEXT 3

caturtha ślokerā artha kaila vivaraṇa

pañcama ślokerā artha śuna bhakta-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

caturtha—fourth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *kaila*—made; *vivaraṇa*—description; *pañcama*—fifth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *śuna*—please hear; *bhakta-gaṇa*—O devotees.

TRANSLATION

I have described the meaning of the fourth verse. Now, O devotees, kindly hear the explanation of the fifth verse.

TEXT 4

mūla-ślokerā artha karite prakāśa

artha lāgāite āge kahiye ābhāsa

SYNONYMS

mūla—original; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *karite*—to make; *prakāśa*—revelation; *artha*—the meaning; *lāgāite*—to touch; *āge*—first; *kahiye*—I shall speak; *ābhāsa*—hint.

TRANSLATION

Just to explain the original verse, I shall first suggest its meaning.

TEXT 5

caturtha ślokerā artha ei kaila sāra

prema-nāma pracārite ei avatāra

SYNONYMS

caturtha—fourth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *ei*—this; *kaila*—gave; *sāra*—essence; *prema*—love of Godhead; *nāma*—the holy name; *pracārite*—to propagate; *ei*—this; *avatāra*—incarnation.

TRANSLATION

I have given the essential meaning of the fourth verse: this incarnation [Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu] descends to propagate the chanting of the holy name and spread love of God.

TEXT 6

satya ei hetu, kintu eho bahiraṅga

āra eka hetu, śuna, āche antaraṅga

SYNONYMS

satya—true; *ei*—this; *hetu*—reason; *kintu*—but; *eho*—this; *bahiraṅga*—external; *āra*—another; *eka*—one; *hetu*—reason; *śuna*—please hear; *āche*—is; *antaraṅga*—internal.

TRANSLATION

Although this is true, this is but the external reason for the Lord's incarnation. Please hear one other reason—the confidential reason—for the Lord's appearance.

PURPORT

In the Third Chapter, fourth verse, it has been clearly said that Lord Caitanya appeared in order to distribute love of Kṛṣṇa and the chanting of His transcendental holy name, Hare Kṛṣṇa. That was the secondary purpose of Lord Caitanya's appearance. The real reason is different, as we shall see in this chapter.

TEXT 7

pūrve yena pṛthivīra bhāra haribāre

kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa hailā śāstrete pracāre

SYNONYMS

pūrve—previously; *yena*—as; *pṛthivīra*—of the earth; *bhāra*—burden; *haribāre*—to take away; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatīrṇa*—incarnated; *hailā*—was; *śāstrete*—the scriptures; *pracāre*—proclaim.

TRANSLATION

The scriptures proclaim that Lord Kṛṣṇa previously descended to take away the burden of the earth.

TEXT 8

svayam-bhagavānera karma nahe bhāra-haraṇa

sthiti-kartā viṣṇuarena jagat-pālana

SYNONYMS

svayam-bhagavānera—of the original Supreme Personality of Godhead; *karma*—the business; *nahe*—is not; *bhāra-haraṇa*—taking away the burden; *sthiti-kartā*—the maintainer; *viṣṇu*—Lord Viṣṇu; *karena*—does; *jagat-pālana*—protection of the universe.

TRANSLATION

To take away this burden, however, is not the work of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The maintainer, Lord Viṣṇu, is the one who protects the universe.

TEXT 9

kintu kṛṣṇera yei haya avatāra-kāla

bhāra-haraṇa-kāla tāte ha-ila miśāla

SYNONYMS

kintu—but; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yei*—that which; *haya*—is; *avatāra*—of incarnation; *kāla*—the time; *bhāra-haraṇa*—of taking away the burden; *kāla*—the time; *tāte*—in that; *ha-ila*—there was; *miśāla*—mixture.

TRANSLATION

But the time to lift the burden of the world mixed with the time for Lord Kṛṣṇa's incarnation.

PURPORT

We have information from the *Bhagavad-gītā* that the Lord appears at particular intervals to adjust a time-worn spiritual culture. Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa appeared at the end of Dvāpara-yuga to regenerate the spiritual culture of human society and also to manifest His transcendental pastimes. Viṣṇu is the authorized Lord who maintains the created cosmos, and He is also the principal Deity who makes adjustments when there is improper administration in the cosmic creation. But Śrī Kṛṣṇa, being the primeval Lord, appears not in order to make such administrative adjustments but only to exhibit His transcendental pastimes and thus

attract the fallen souls back home, back to Godhead.

However, the time for administrative rectification and the time for Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa's appearance coincided at the end of the last Dvāpara-yuga. Therefore when Śrī Kṛṣṇa appeared, Viṣṇu, the Lord of maintenance, merged with Him because all the plenary portions and parts of the absolute Personality of Godhead merge with Him during His appearance.

TEXT 10

pūrṇa bhagavān avatare yei kāle

āra saba avatāra tāṅte āsi' mile

SYNONYMS

pūrṇa—full; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *avatare*—incarnates; *yei*—that; *kāle*—at the time; *āra*—other; *saba*—all; *avatāra*—incarnations; *tāṅte*—in Him; *āsi'*—coming; *mile*—meet.

TRANSLATION

When the complete Supreme Personality of Godhead descends, all other incarnations of the Lord meet together within Him.

TEXTS 11–12

nārāyaṇa, catur-vyūha, matsyādy-avatāra

yuga-manvantarāvatāra, yata āche āra

sabe āsi' kṛṣṇa-aṅge haya avatīrṇa

aiche avatare kṛṣṇa bhagavān pūrṇa

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇa—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *catuḥ-vyūha*—the four expansions; *matsya-ādi*—beginning with Matsya; *avatāra*—the incarnations; *yuga-manv-antara-avatāra*—the *yuga* and *manv-antara* incarnations; *yata*—as many as; *āche*—there are; *āra*—other; *sabe*—all; *āsi'*—coming; *kṛṣṇa-aṅge*—in the body of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *haya*—are; *avatīrṇa*—incarnated; *aiche*—in this way; *avatare*—incarnates; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *pūrṇa*—full.

TRANSLATION

Lord Nārāyaṇa, the four primary expansions [Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha], Matsya and the other līlā incarnations, the yuga-avatāras, the manv-antara incarnations and as many other incarnations as there are—all descend in the body of Lord Kṛṣṇa. In this way the complete Supreme Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself, appears.

TEXT 13

ataeva viṣṇu takhana kṛṣṇera śarīre

viṣṇu-dvāre kare kṛṣṇa asura-saṁhāre

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *viṣṇu*—Lord Viṣṇu; *takhana*—at that time; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *śarīre*—in the body; *viṣṇu-dvāre*—by Lord Viṣṇu; *kare*—does; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *asura-saṁhāre*—killing the demons.

TRANSLATION

At that time, therefore, Lord Viṣṇu is present in the body of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and Lord Kṛṣṇa kills the demons through Him.

TEXT 14

ānuṣaṅga-karma ei asura-māraṇa

ye lāgi' avatāra, kahi se mūla kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

ānuṣaṅga-karma—secondary work; *ei*—this; *asura*—of the demons; *māraṇa*—killing; *ye*—that; *lāgi'*—for; *avatāra*—the incarnation; *kahi*—I shall speak; *se*—the; *mūla*—root; *kāraṇa*—cause.

TRANSLATION

Thus the killing of the demons is but secondary work. I shall now speak of the main reason for the Lord's incarnation.

TEXTS 15–16

prema-rasa-niryāsa karite āsvādana

rāga-mārga bhakti loka karite pracāraṇa

rasika-śekhara kṛṣṇa parama-karuṇa

ei dui hetu haite icchāra udgama

SYNONYMS

prema-rasa—of the mellow of love of God; *niryāsa*—the essence; *karite*—to do; *āsvādana*—tasting; *rāga-mārga*—the path of spontaneous attraction; *bhakti*—devotional service; *loka*—in the world; *karite*—to do; *pracāraṇa*—propagation; *rasika-śekhara*—the supremely jubilant; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *parama-karuṇa*—the most merciful; *ei*—these; *dui*—two; *hetu*—reasons; *haite*—from; *icchāra*—of desire; *udgama*—

the birth.

TRANSLATION

The Lord's desire to appear was born from two reasons: the Lord wanted to taste the sweet essence of the mellows of love of God, and He wanted to propagate devotional service in the world on the platform of spontaneous attraction. Thus He is known as supremely jubilant and as the most merciful of all.

PURPORT

During the period of Lord Kṛṣṇa's appearance, the killing of *asuras* or nonbelievers such as Kaṁsa and Jarāsandha was done by Viṣṇu, who was within the person of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Such apparent killing by Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa took place as a matter of course and was an incidental activity for Him. But the real purpose of Lord Kṛṣṇa's appearance was to stage a dramatic performance of His transcendental pastimes at Vrajabhūmi, thus exhibiting the highest limit of transcendental mellow in the exchanges of reciprocal love between the living entity and the Supreme Lord. These reciprocal exchanges of mellows are called *rāga-bhakti*, or devotional service to the Lord in transcendental rapture. Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa wants to make known to all the conditioned souls that He is more attracted by *rāga-bhakti* than *vidhi-bhakti*, or devotional service under scheduled regulations. It is said in the *Vedas* (*Taittirīya Up. 2.7*), *raso vai saḥ*: the Absolute Truth is the reservoir for all kinds of reciprocal exchanges of loving sentiments. He is also causelessly merciful, and He wants to bestow upon us this privilege of *rāga-bhakti*. Thus He appeared by His own internal energy. He was not forced to appear by any extraneous force.

TEXT 17

aiśvarya-jñānete saba jagat miśṛita

aiśvarya-śīthila-preme nahi mora prīta

SYNONYMS

aiśvarya jñānete—with knowledge of majesty; *saba*—all; *jagat*—the universe; *miśṛita*—mixed; *aiśvarya-śīthila*—weakened by majesty; *preme*—in love; *nāhi*—there is not; *mora*—My; *prīta*—pleasure.

TRANSLATION

[Lord Kṛṣṇa thought:] “All the universe is filled with the conception of My majesty, but love weakened by that sense of majesty does not satisfy Me.

TEXT 18

āmāre īśvara māne, āpanāke hīna

tāra preme vaśa āmi nā ha-i adhīna

SYNONYMS

āmāre—Me; *īśvara*—the Lord; *māne*—regards; *āpanāke*—himself; *hīna*—low; *tāra*—of him; *preme*—by the love; *vaśa*—controlled; *āmi*—I; *nā ha-i*—am not; *adhīna*—subservient.

TRANSLATION

“If one regards Me as the Supreme Lord and himself as a subordinate, I do not become subservient to his love, nor can it control Me.

TEXT 19

āmāke ta' ye ye bhakta bhaje yei bhāve

tāre se se bhāve bhajī, — — e mora svabhāve

SYNONYMS

āmāke—Me; *ta'*—certainly; *ye ye*—whatever; *bhakta*—devotee; *bhaje*—worships; *yei*—which; *bhāve*—in the mood; *tāre*—him; *se se*—that; *bhāve*—in the mood; *bhajī*—I reciprocate; *e*—this; *mora*—My; *svabhāve*—in the nature.

TRANSLATION

“In whatever transcendental mellow My devotee worships Me, I reciprocate with him. That is My natural behavior.

PURPORT

The Lord, by His inherent nature, reveals Himself before His devotees according to their inherent devotional service. The Vṛndāvana pastimes demonstrated that although generally people worship God with reverence, the Lord is more pleased when a devotee thinks of Him as his pet son, personal friend or most dear fiancé and renders service unto Him with such natural affection. The Lord becomes a subordinate object of love in such transcendental relationships. Such pure love of Godhead is unadulterated by any tinge of superfluous nondevotional desires and is not mixed with any sort of fruitive action or empiric philosophical speculation. It is pure and natural love of Godhead, spontaneously aroused in the absolute stage. This devotional service is executed in a favorable atmosphere freed from material affection.

TEXT 20

ye yathā mām prapadyante

tāṁs tathāiva bhajāmy aham

mama vartmānuvartante

manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ

SYNONYMS

ye—all who; *yathā*—as; *mām*—unto Me; *prapadyante*—surrender; *tān*—them; *tathā*—so; *eva*—certainly; *bhajāmi*—reward; *aham*—I; *mama*—My; *vartma*—path; *anuvartante*—follow; *manuṣyāḥ*—all men; *pārtha*—O son of Pṛthā; *sarvaśaḥ*—in all respects.

TRANSLATION

“In whatever way My devotees surrender unto Me, I reward them accordingly. Everyone follows My path in all respects, O son of Pṛthā.”

PURPORT

In the Fourth Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gītā* Lord Kṛṣṇa affirms that formerly (some 120 million years before the Battle of Kurukṣetra) He explained the mystic philosophy of the *Gītā* to the sun-god. The message was received through the chain of disciplic succession, but in course of time, the chain being broken somehow or other, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa appeared again and taught Arjuna the truths of the *Bhagavad-gītā*. At that time the Lord spoke this verse (Bg. 4.11) to His friend Arjuna.

TEXTS 21–22

mora putra, mora sakhā, mora prāṇa-patī

ei-bhāve yei more kare śuddha-bhakti

āpanāke baḍa māne, āmāre sama-hīna

sei bhāve ha-i āmi tāhāra adhīna

SYNONYMS

mora—my; *putra*—son; *mora*—my; *sakhā*—friend; *mora*—my; *prāṇa-patī*—lord of life; *ei bhāve*—in this way; *yei*—those who; *more*—unto Me; *kare*—do; *śuddha-bhakti*—pure devotion; *āpanāke*—himself; *baḍa*—great; *māne*—he regards; *āmāre*—Me; *sama*—equal; *hīna*—or lower; *sei bhāve*—in that way; *ha-i*—am; *āmi*—I; *tāhāra*—to him; *adhīna*—subordinate.

TRANSLATION

“If one cherishes pure loving devotion to Me, thinking of Me as his son, his friend or his beloved, regarding himself as great and considering Me his equal or inferior, I become subordinate to him.

PURPORT

In the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* three kinds of devotional service are described—namely, *bhakti* (ordinary devotional service), *śuddha-bhakti* (pure devotional service) and *viddha-bhakti* (mixed devotional service).

When devotional service is executed with some material purpose, involving fruitive activities, mental speculations or mystic *yoga*, it is called mixed or adulterated devotional service. Besides *bhakti-yoga*, the *Bhagavad-gītā* also describes *karma-yoga*, *jñāna-yoga* and *dhyāna-yoga*. *Yoga* means linking with the Supreme Lord, which is possible only through devotion. Fruitive activities ending in devotional service, philosophical speculation ending in devotional service, and the practice of mysticism ending in devotional service are known respectively as *karma-yoga*, *jñāna-yoga* and *dhyāna-yoga*. But such devotional service is adulterated by the three kinds of material activities.

For those grossly engaged in identifying the body as the self, pious activity, or *karma-yoga*, is recommended. For those who identify the mind with the self, philosophical speculation, or *jñāna-yoga*, is

recommended. But devotees standing on the spiritual platform have no need of such material conceptions of adulterated devotion. Adulterated devotional service does not directly aim for love of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore service performed strictly in conformity with the revealed scriptures is better than such *viddha-bhakti* because it is free from all kinds of material contamination. It is executed in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, solely to please the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Those who are spontaneously devoted to the Lord and have no aims for material gain are called attracted devotees. They are spontaneously attracted to the service of the Lord, and they follow in the footsteps of self-realized souls. Their pure devotion (*śuddha-bhakti*), manifested from pure love of Godhead, surpasses the regulative principles of the authoritative scriptures. Sometimes loving ecstasy transcends regulative principles; such ecstasy, however, is completely on the spiritual platform and cannot be imitated. The regulative principles help ordinary devotees rise to the stage of perfect love of Godhead. Pure love for Kṛṣṇa is the perfection of pure devotion, and pure devotional service is identical with spontaneous devotional service.

Flawless execution of regulative principles is exhibited in the Vaikuṇṭha planets. By strictly executing these principles one can be elevated to the Vaikuṇṭha planets. But spontaneous pure loving service is found in Kṛṣṇaloka alone.

TEXT 23

mayi bhaktir hi bhūtānām

amṛtatvāya kalpate

diṣṭyā yad āsīn mat-sneho

bhavatīnām mad-āpanaḥ

SYNONYMS

mayi—to Me; *bhaktiḥ*—devotional service; *hi*—certainly; *bhūtānām*—of the living beings; *amṛtatvāya*—the eternal life; *kalpate*—brings about; *diṣṭyā*—by good fortune; *yat*—which; *āsīt*—was; *mat*—for Me; *snehaḥ*—the affection; *bhavatīnām*—of all of you; *mat*—of Me; *āpanaḥ*—the obtaining.

TRANSLATION

“Devotional service rendered to Me by the living beings revives their eternal life. O My dear damsels of Vraja, your affection for Me is your good fortune, for it is the only means by which you have obtained My favor.’

PURPORT

Pure devotional service is represented in the activities of the residents of Vrajabhūmi (Vṛndāvana). During a solar eclipse, the Lord came from Dvārakā and met the inhabitants of Vṛndāvana at Samanta-pāñcaka. The meeting was intensely painful for the damsels of Vrajabhūmi because Lord Kṛṣṇa had apparently left them to reside at Dvārakā. But the Lord obligingly acknowledged the pure devotional service of the damsels of Vraja by speaking this verse (*Bhāg.* 10.82.44).

TEXT 24

mātā more putra-bhāve kareṇa bandhana

atihīna-jñāne kare lālana pālana

SYNONYMS

mātā—mother; *more*—Me; *putra-bhāve*—in the position of a son; *kareṇa*—does; *bandhana*—binding; *ati-hīna-jñāne*—in thinking very

poor; *kare*—does; *lālana*—nourishing; *pālana*—protecting.

TRANSLATION

“Mother sometimes binds Me as her son. She nourishes and protects Me, thinking Me utterly helpless.

TEXT 25

sakhā śuddha-sakhye kare, skandhe ārohaṇa

tumi kon baḍa loka,——tumi āmi sama

SYNONYMS

sakhā—the friend; *śuddha-sakhye*—in pure friendship; *kare*—does; *skandhe*—on the shoulders; *ārohaṇa*—mounting; *tumi*—You; *kon*—what; *baḍa*—big; *loka*—person; *tumi*—You; *āmi*—I; *sama*—the same.

TRANSLATION

“My friends climb on My shoulders in pure friendship, saying, ‘What kind of big man are You? You and I are equal.’

TEXT 26

priyā yadi māna kari’ karaye bhartsana

veda-stuti haite hare sei mora mana

SYNONYMS

priyā—the lover; *yadi*—if; *māna kari’*—sulking; *karaye*—does; *bhartsana*—rebuking; *veda-stuti*—the Vedic prayers; *haite*—from; *hare*—takes away; *sei*—that; *mora*—My; *mana*—mind.

TRANSLATION

“If My beloved consort reproaches Me in a sulky mood, that steals My mind from the reverent hymns of the Vedas.

PURPORT

According to the *Upaniṣads*, all living entities are dependent on the supreme living entity, the Personality of Godhead. As it is said (*Kaṭha Up.* 5.3), *nityo nityānām cetanaś cetanānām eko bahūnām yo vidadhāti kāmān*: one eternal living entity supports all the other eternal living entities. Because the Supreme Personality of Godhead maintains all the other living entities, they remain subordinate to the Lord, even when joined with Him in the reciprocation of loving affairs.

But in the course of exchanging transcendental love of the highest purity, sometimes the subordinate devotee tries to predominate over the predominator. One who lovingly engages with the Supreme Lord as if he were His mother or father sometimes supersedes the position of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Similarly, His fiancī or lover sometimes supersedes the position of the Lord. But such attempts are exhibitions of the highest love. Only out of pure love does the subordinate lover of the Supreme Personality of Godhead chide Him. The Lord, enjoying this chiding, takes it very nicely. The exhibition of natural love makes such activities very enjoyable. In worship of the Supreme Lord with veneration there is no manifestation of such natural love because the devotee considers the Lord his superior.

Regulative principles in devotional service are meant for those who have not invoked their natural love of Godhead. When natural love arises, all regulative methods are surpassed, and pure love is exhibited between the Lord and the devotee. Although on such a platform of love the devotee sometimes appears to predominate over the Lord or transgress regulative principles, such dealings are far more advanced than ordinary dealings through regulative principles with awe and veneration. A devotee who is

actually free from all designations due to complete attachment in love for the Supreme exhibits spontaneous love for Godhead, which is always superior to the devotion of regulative principles.

The informal language used between lover and beloved is indicative of pure affection. When devotees worship their beloved as the most venerable object, spontaneous loving sentiments are observed to be lacking. A neophyte devotee who follows the Vedic instructions that regulate those who lack pure love of Godhead may superficially seem more exalted than a devotee in spontaneous love of Godhead. But in fact such spontaneous pure love is far superior to regulated devotional service. Such pure love of Godhead is always glorious in all respects, more so than reverential devotional service rendered by a less affectionate devotee.

TEXTS 27–28

ei śuddha-bhakta lañā karimu avatāra

kariba vividha-vidha adbhuta vihāra

vaikuṇṭhādye nāhi ye ye līlāra pracāra

se se līlā kariba, yāte mora camatkāra

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *śuddha-bhakta*—pure devotees; *lañā*—taking; *karimu*—I shall make; *avatāra*—incarnation; *kariba*—I shall do; *vividha-vidha*—various kinds; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *vihāra*—pastimes; *vaikuṇṭha-ādye*—in the Vaikuṇṭha planets, etc.; *nāhi*—not; *ye ye*—whatever; *līlāra*—of the pastimes; *pracāra*—broadcasting; *se se*—those; *līlā*—pastimes; *kariba*—I shall perform; *yāte*—in which; *mora*—My; *camatkāra*—wonder.

TRANSLATION

“Taking these pure devotees with Me, I shall descend and sport in various wonderful ways, unknown even in Vaikuṇṭha. I shall broadcast such pastimes by which even I am amazed.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa in the form of Lord Caitanya educates His devotees to develop progressively to the stage of pure devotional service. Thus He appears periodically as a devotee to take part in various wonderful activities depicted in His sublime philosophy and teachings.

There are innumerable Vaikuṇṭha planets in the spiritual sky, and in all of them the Lord accepts the service rendered by His eternal devotees in a reverential mood. Therefore Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa presents His most confidential pastimes as He enjoys them in His transcendental realm. Such pastimes are so attractive that they attract even the Lord, and thus He relishes them in the form of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 29

mo-viṣaye gopī-gaṇera upapati-bhāve

yoga-māyā karibeka āpana-prabhāve

SYNONYMS

mo-viṣaye—on the subject of Me; *gopī-gaṇera*—of the *gopīs*; *upapati*—of a paramour; *bhāve*—in the position; *yoga-māyā*—*yogamāyā*, Lord Kṛṣṇa’s internal potency; *karibeka*—will make; *āpana*—her own; *prabhāve*—by the influence.

TRANSLATION

“The influence of *yogamāyā* will inspire the *gopīs* with the sentiment that I am their paramour.

PURPORT

Yogamāyā is the name of the internal potency that makes the Lord forget Himself and become an object of love for His pure devotee in different transcendental mellows. This *yogamāyā* potency creates a spiritual sentiment in the minds of the damsels of Vraja by which they think of Lord Kṛṣṇa as their paramour. This sentiment is never to be compared to mundane illicit sexual love. It has nothing to do with sexual psychology, although the pure love of such devotees seems to be sexual. One should know for certain that nothing can exist in this cosmic manifestation that has no real counterpart in the spiritual field. All material manifestations are emanations of the Transcendence. The erotic principles of amorous love reflected in mixed material values are perverted reflections of the reality of spirit, but one cannot understand the reality unless one is sufficiently educated in the spiritual science.

TEXT 30

āmiha nā jāni tāhā, nā jāne gopī-gaṇa

duñhāra rūpa-guṇe duñhāra nitya hare mana

SYNONYMS

āmiha—I; *nā jāni*—shall not know; *tāhā*—that; *nā jāne*—will not know; *gopī-gaṇa*—the *gopīs*; *duñhāra*—of the two; *rūpa-guṇe*—the beauty and qualities; *duñhāra*—of the two; *nitya*—always; *hare*—carry away; *mana*—the minds.

TRANSLATION

“Neither the *gopīs* nor I shall notice this, for our minds will always be entranced by one another’s beauty and qualities.

PURPORT

In the spiritual sky the Vaikuṇṭha planets are predominated by Nārāyaṇa. His devotees have the same features He does, and the exchange of devotion there is on the platform of reverence. But above all these Vaikuṇṭha planets is Goloka, or Kṛṣṇaloka, where the original Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, fully manifests His pleasure potency in free loving affairs. Since the devotees in the material world know almost nothing about these affairs, the Lord desires to show these affairs to them.

In Goloka Vṛndāvana there is an exchange of love known as *parakīya-rasa*. It is something like the attraction of a married woman for a man other than her husband. In the material world this sort of relationship is most abominable because it is a perverted reflection of the *parakīya-rasa* in the spiritual world, where it is the highest kind of loving affair. Such feelings between the devotee and the Lord are presented by the influence of *yogamāyā*. The *Bhagavad-gītā* states that devotees of the highest grade are under the care of *daiva-māyā*, or *yogamāyā*: *mahātmānas tu mām pārtha daivīm prakṛtim āśritāḥ* (Bg. 9.13). Those who are actually great souls (*mahātmās*) are fully absorbed in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, always engaged in the service of the Lord. They are under the care of *daivī-prakṛti*, or *yogamāyā*. *Yogamāyā* creates a situation in which the devotee is prepared to transgress all regulative principles simply to love Kṛṣṇa. A devotee naturally does not like to transgress the laws of reverence for the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but by the influence of *yogamāyā* he is prepared to do anything to love the Supreme Lord better.

Those under the spell of the material energy cannot at all appreciate the activities of *yogamāyā*, for a conditioned soul can hardly understand the pure reciprocation between the Lord and His devotee. But by executing devotional service under the regulative principles, one can become very highly elevated and then begin to appreciate the dealings of pure love under the management of *yogamāyā*.

In the spiritual loving sentiment induced by the *yogamāyā* potency, both Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa and the damsels of Vraja forget themselves in spiritual

rapture. By the influence of such forgetfulness, the attractive beauty of the *gopīs* plays a prominent part in the transcendental satisfaction of the Lord, who has nothing to do with mundane sex. Because spiritual love of Godhead is above everything mundane, the *gopīs* superficially seem to transgress the codes of mundane morality. This perpetually puzzles mundane moralists. Therefore *yogamāyā* acts to cover the Lord and His pastimes from the eyes of mundaners, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.25), where the Lord says that He reserves the right of not being exposed to everyone.

The acts of *yogamāyā* make it possible for the Lord and the *gopīs*, in loving ecstasy, to sometimes meet and sometimes separate. These transcendental loving affairs of the Lord are unimaginable to empiricists involved in the impersonal feature of the Absolute Truth. Therefore the Lord Himself appears before the mundaners to bestow upon them the highest form of spiritual realization and also personally relish its essence. The Lord is so merciful that He Himself descends to take the fallen souls back home to the kingdom of Godhead, where the erotic principles of Godhead are eternally relished in their real form, distinct from the perverted sexual love so much adored and indulged in by the fallen souls in their diseased condition. The reason the Lord displays the *rāsa-līlā* is essentially to induce all the fallen souls to give up their diseased morality and religiosity, and to attract them to the kingdom of God to enjoy the reality. A person who actually understands what the *rāsa-līlā* is will certainly hate to indulge in mundane sex life. For the realized soul, hearing the Lord's *rāsa-līlā* through the proper channel will result in complete abstinence from material sexual pleasure.

TEXT 31

dharma chāḍi' rāge duñhe karaye milana

kabhu mile, kabhu nā mile,——daivera ghaṭana

SYNONYMS

dharma chāḍi'—giving up religious customs; *rāge*—in love; *duñhe*—both; *karaye*—do; *milana*—meeting; *kabhu*—sometimes; *mile*—they meet; *kabhu*—sometimes; *nā mile*—they do not meet; *daivera*—of destiny; *ghaṭana*—the happening.

TRANSLATION

“Pure attachment will unite us even at the expense of moral and religious duties [dharma]. Destiny will sometimes bring us together and sometimes separate us.

PURPORT

The *gopīs* came out to meet Kṛṣṇa in the dead of night when they heard the sound of His flute. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī has accordingly composed a nice verse (see *Ādi* 5.224) that describes the beautiful boy called Govinda standing by the bank of the Yamunā with His flute to His lips in the shining moonlight. Those who want to enjoy life in the materialistic way of society, friendship and love should not go to the Yamunā to see the form of Govinda. The sound of Lord Kṛṣṇa’s flute is so sweet that it has made the *gopīs* forget all about their relationships with their kinsmen and flee to Kṛṣṇa in the dead of night.

By leaving home in that way, the *gopīs* transgressed the Vedic regulations of household life. This indicates that when natural feelings of love for Kṛṣṇa become fully manifest, a devotee can neglect conventional social rules and regulations. In the material world we are situated in designative positions only, but pure devotional service begins when one is freed from all designations. When love for Kṛṣṇa is awakened, the designative positions are overcome.

The spontaneous attraction of Śrī Kṛṣṇa for His dearest parts and parcels generates an enthusiasm that obliges Śrī Kṛṣṇa and the *gopīs* to meet together. To celebrate this transcendental enthusiasm, there is need of a sentiment of separation between the lover and beloved. In the condition

of material tribulation, no one wants the pangs of separation. But in the transcendental form, the very same separation, being absolute in its nature, strengthens the ties of love and enhances the desire of the lover and beloved to meet. The period of separation, evaluated transcendently, is more relishable than the actual meeting, which lacks the feelings of increasing anticipation because the lover and beloved are both present.

TEXT 32

ei saba rasa-niryāsa kariba āsvāda

ei dvāre kariba saba bhaktere prasāda

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *saba*—all; *rasa-niryāsa*—essence of mellows; *kariba*—I shall do; *āsvāda*—tasting; *ei dvāre*—by this; *kariba*—I shall do; *saba*—all; *bhaktere*—to the devotees; *prasāda*—favor.

TRANSLATION

“I shall taste the essence of all these rasas, and in this way I shall favor all the devotees.

TEXT 33

vrajera nirmala rāga śuni’ bhakta-gaṇa

rāga-mārga bhaje yena chāḍi’ dharma-karma

SYNONYMS

vrajera—of Vraja; *nirmala*—spotless; *rāga*—love; *śuni’*—hearing; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees; *rāga-mārga*—on the path of spontaneous

love; *bhaje*—they worship; *yena*—so that; *chāḍi'*—giving up; *dharma*—religiosity; *karma*—fruitive activity.

TRANSLATION

“Then, by hearing about the pure love of the residents of Vraja, devotees will worship Me on the path of spontaneous love, abandoning all rituals of religiosity and fruitive activity.”

PURPORT

Many realized souls, such as Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī and King Kulaśekhara, have recommended with great emphasis that one develop this spontaneous love of Godhead, even at the risk of transgressing all the traditional codes of morality and religiosity. Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, one of the six Gosvāmīs of Vṛndāvana, has written in his prayers called the *Manaḥ-śikṣā* that one should simply worship Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa with all attention. *Na dharmam nādharmam śruti-gaṇa-niruktaṁ kila kuru*: one should not be much interested in performing Vedic rituals or simply following rules and regulations.

King Kulaśekhara has written similarly, in his book *Mukunda-mālā-stotra* (5):

*nāsthā dharme na vasu-nicaye naiva kāmopabhoge
yad bhāvyam tad bhavatu bhagavan pūrva-karmānurūpam
etat prārthyam mama bahu-mataṁ janma-janmāntare 'pi
tvat-pādāmbho-ruha-yuga-gatā niścalā bhaktir astu*

“I have no attraction for performing religious rituals or holding any earthly kingdom. I do not care for sense enjoyments; let them appear and disappear in accordance with my previous deeds. My only desire is to be fixed in devotional service to the lotus feet of the Lord, even though I may continue to take birth here life after life.”

TEXT 34

anugrahāya bhaktānām

mānuṣaṁ deham āśritaḥ

bhajate tādrśīḥ krīḍā

yāḥ śrutvā tat-paro bhavet

SYNONYMS

anugrahāya—for showing favor; *bhaktānām*—to the devotees; *mānuṣam*—humanlike; *deham*—body; *āśritaḥ*—accepting; *bhajate*—He enjoys; *tādrśīḥ*—such; *krīḍāḥ*—pastimes; *yāḥ*—which; *śrutvā*—having heard; *tat-paraḥ*—fully intent upon Him; *bhavet*—one must become.

TRANSLATION

“Kṛṣṇa manifests His eternal humanlike form and performs His pastimes to show mercy to the devotees. Having heard such pastimes, one should engage in service to Him.”

PURPORT

This text is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.33.36). The Supreme Personality of Godhead has innumerable expansions of His transcendental form who eternally exist in the spiritual world. This material world is only a perverted reflection of the spiritual world, where everything is manifested without inebriety. There everything is in its original existence, free from the domination of time. Time cannot deteriorate or interfere with the conditions in the spiritual world, where different manifestations of the Supreme Personality of Godhead are the recipients of the worship of different living entities in their constitutional spiritual positions. In the spiritual world all existence is unadulterated

goodness. The goodness found in the material world is contaminated by the modes of passion and ignorance.

The saying that the human form of life is the best position for devotional service has its special significance because only in this form can a living entity revive his eternal relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The human form is considered the highest state in the cycle of the species of life in the material world. If one takes advantage of this highest kind of material form, one can regain his position of devotional service to the Lord.

Incarnations of the Supreme Personality of Godhead appear in all the species of life, although this is inconceivable to the human brain. The Lord's pastimes are differentiated according to the appreciating capacity of the different types of bodies of the living entities. The Supreme Lord bestows the most merciful benediction upon human society when He appears in His human form. It is then that humanity gets the opportunity to engage in different kinds of eternal service to the Lord.

Special natural appreciation of the descriptions of a particular pastime of Godhead indicates the constitutional position of a living entity. Adoration, servitorship, friendship, parental affection and conjugal love are the five primary relationships with Kṛṣṇa. The highest perfectional stage of the conjugal relationship, enriched by many sentiments, gives the maximum relishable mellow to the devotee.

The Lord appears in different incarnations—as a fish, tortoise and boar, as Paraśurāma, Lord Rāma, Buddha and so on—to reciprocate the different appreciations of living entities in different stages of evolution. The conjugal relationship of amorous love called *parakīya-rasa* is the unparalleled perfection of love exhibited by Lord Kṛṣṇa and His devotees.

A class of so-called devotees known as *sahajīyās* try to imitate the Lord's pastimes, although they have no understanding of the amorous love in His expansions of pleasure potency. Their superficial imitation can create

havoc on the path for the advancement of one's spiritual relationship with the Lord. Material sexual indulgence can never be equated with spiritual love, which is in unadulterated goodness. The activities of the *sahajiyās* simply lower one deeper into the material contamination of the senses and mind. Kṛṣṇa's transcendental pastimes display eternal servitorship to Adhokṣaja, the Supreme Lord, who is beyond all conception through material senses. Materialistic conditioned souls do not understand the transcendental exchanges of love, but they like to indulge in sense gratification in the name of devotional service. The activities of the Supreme Lord can never be understood by irresponsible persons who think the pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa to be ordinary affairs. The *rāsa* dance is arranged by Kṛṣṇa's internal potency *yogamāyā*, and it is beyond the grasp of the materially affected person. Trying to throw mud into transcendence with their perversity, the *sahajiyās* misinterpret the sayings *tat-paratvena nirmalam* and *tat-paro bhavet*. By misinterpreting *tādṛśīḥ kṛīḍāḥ*, they want to indulge in sex while pretending to imitate Lord Kṛṣṇa. But one must actually understand the imports of the words through the intelligence of the authorized *gosvāmīs*. Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura, in his prayers to the Gosvāmīs, has explained his inability to understand such spiritual affairs:

*rūpa-raghunātha-pade ha-ibe ākūti
kabe hāma bujhaba se yugala-pīṛīti*

“When I shall be eager to understand the literature given by the Gosvāmīs, then I shall be able to understand the transcendental love affairs of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.” In other words, unless one is trained under the disciplic succession of the Gosvāmīs, one cannot understand Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. The conditioned souls are naturally averse to understanding the spiritual existence of the Lord, and if they try to know the transcendental nature of the Lord's pastimes while they remain absorbed in materialism, they are sure to blunder like the *sahajiyās*.

TEXT 35

‘bhavet’ kriyā vidhiliṅ, sei ihā kaya

kartavya avaśya ei, anyathā pratyavāya

SYNONYMS

bhavet—*bhavet*; *kriyā*—the verb; *vidhi-liṅ*—an injunction of the imperative mood; *sei*—that; *ihā*—here; *kaya*—says; *kartavya*—to be done; *avaśya*—certainly; *ei*—this; *anyathā*—otherwise; *pratyavāya*—detriment.

TRANSLATION

Here the use of the verb “bhavet,” which is in the imperative mood, tells us that this certainly must be done. Noncompliance would be abandonment of duty.

PURPORT

This imperative is applicable to pure devotees. Neophytes will be able to understand these affairs only after being elevated by regulated devotional service under the expert guidance of the spiritual master. Then they too will be competent to hear of the love affairs of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

As long as one is in material, conditioned life, strict discipline is required in the matter of moral and immoral activities. The absolute world is transcendental and free from such distinctions because there inebriety is not possible. But in this material world a sexual appetite necessitates distinction between moral and immoral conduct. There are no sexual activities in the spiritual world. The transactions between lover and beloved in the spiritual world are pure transcendental love and unadulterated bliss.

One who has not been attracted by the transcendental beauty of *rasa* will certainly be dragged down into material attraction, thus to act in material

contamination and progress to the darkest region of hellish life. But by understanding the conjugal love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa one is freed from the grip of attraction to material so-called love between man and woman. Similarly, one who understands the pure parental love of Nanda and Yaśodā for Kṛṣṇa will be saved from being dragged into material parental affection. If one accepts Kṛṣṇa as the supreme friend, the attraction of material friendship will be finished for him, and he will not be dismayed by so-called friendship with mundane wranglers. If he is attracted by servitorship to Kṛṣṇa, he will no longer have to serve the material body in the degraded status of material existence, with the false hope of becoming master in the future. Similarly, one who sees the greatness of Kṛṣṇa in neutrality will certainly never again seek the so-called relief of impersonalist or voidist philosophy. If one is not attracted by the transcendental nature of Kṛṣṇa, one is sure to be attracted to material enjoyment, thus to become implicated in the clinging network of virtuous and sinful activities and to continue material existence by transmigrating from one material body to another. Only in Kṛṣṇa consciousness can one achieve the highest perfection of life.

TEXTS 36–37

ei vāñchā yaiche kṛṣṇa-prākāṣya-kāraṇa

asura-saṁhāra—ānuṣaṅga prayojana

ei mata caitanya-kṛṣṇa pūrṇa bhagavān

yuga-dharma-pravartana nahe tāṁra kāma

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *vāñchā*—desire; *yaiche*—just as; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prākāṣya*—for the manifestation; *kāraṇa*—reason; *asura-saṁhāra*—the killing of demons; *ānuṣaṅga*—secondary; *prayojana*—reason; *ei mata*—like this; *caitanya*—as Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa;

pūrṇa—full; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *yuga-dharma*—the religion of the age; *pravartana*—initiating; *nahe*—is not; *tānra*—of Him; *kāma*—the desire.

TRANSLATION

Just as these desires are the fundamental reason for Kṛṣṇa's appearance whereas destroying the demons is only an incidental necessity, so for Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, promulgating the dharma of the age is incidental.

TEXT 38

kona kāraṇe yabe haila avatāre mana

yuga-dharma-kāla haila se kāle milana

SYNONYMS

kona kāraṇe—by some reason; *yabe*—when; *haila*—there was; *avatāre*—in incarnation; *mana*—inclination; *yuga-dharma*—for the religion of the age; *kāla*—the time; *haila*—there was; *se kāle*—at that time; *milana*—conjunction.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord desired to appear for another reason, the time for promulgating the religion of the age also arose.

TEXT 39

dui hetu avatari' lañā bhakta-gaṇa

āpane āsvāde prema-nāma-saṅkīrtana

SYNONYMS

dui—two; *hetu*—reasons; *avatari'*—incarnating; *lañā*—taking; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees; *āpane*—Himself; *āsvāde*—tastes; *prema*—love of God; *nāma-saṅkīrtana*—and congregational chanting of the holy name.

TRANSLATION

Thus with two intentions the Lord appeared with His devotees and tasted the nectar of prema with the congregational chanting of the holy name.

TEXT 40

sei dvāre ācaṇḍāle kīrtana sañcāre

nāma-prema-mālā gāñthi' parāila saṁsāre

SYNONYMS

sei dvāre—by that; *ā-caṇḍāle*—even among the *caṇḍālas*; *kīrtana*—the chanting of the holy names; *sañcāre*—He infuses; *nāma*—of the holy names; *prema*—and of love of God; *mālā*—a garland; *gāñthi'*—stringing together; *parāila*—He put it on; *saṁsāre*—the whole material world.

TRANSLATION

Thus He spread kīrtana even among the untouchables. He wove a wreath of the holy name and prema, with which He garlanded the entire material world.

TEXT 41

ei-mata bhakta-bhāva kari' aṅgikāra

āpani ācari' bhakti karila pracāra

SYNONYMS

ei-mata—like this; *bhakta-bhāva*—the position of a devotee; *kari'*—making; *aṅgikāra*—acceptance; *āpani*—Himself; *ācari'*—practicing; *bhakti*—devotional service; *karila*—did; *pracāra*—propagation.

TRANSLATION

In this way, assuming the sentiment of a devotee, He preached devotional service while practicing it Himself.

PURPORT

When Rūpa Gosvāmī met Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Prayāga (Allahabad), he offered his respectful obeisances by submitting that Lord Caitanya was more magnanimous than any other *avatāra* of Kṛṣṇa because He was distributing love of Kṛṣṇa. His mission was to enhance love of Godhead. In the human form of life the highest achievement is to attain the platform of love of Godhead. Lord Caitanya did not invent a system of religion, as people sometimes assume. Religious systems are meant to show the existence of God, who is then generally approached as the cosmic order-supplier. But Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's transcendental mission is to distribute love of Godhead to everyone. Anyone who accepts God as the Supreme can take to the process of chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa and become a lover of God. Therefore Lord Caitanya is the most magnanimous. This munificent broadcasting of devotional service is possible only for Kṛṣṇa Himself. Therefore Lord Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa.

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* Kṛṣṇa has taught the philosophy of surrender to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. One who has surrendered to the Supreme can make further progress by learning to love Him. Therefore the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement propagated by Lord Caitanya is especially meant for those who are cognizant of the presence of the Supreme Godhead, the ultimate controller of everything. His mission is

to teach people how to dovetail themselves into engagements of transcendental loving service. He is Kṛṣṇa teaching His own service from the position of a devotee. The Lord's acceptance of the role of a devotee in the eternal form of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is another of the Lord's wonderful features. A conditioned soul cannot reach the absolute Personality of Godhead by his imperfect endeavor, and therefore it is wonderful that Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, in the form of Lord Gaurāṅga, has made it easy for everyone to approach Him.

Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī has described Lord Caitanya as Kṛṣṇa Himself with the attitude of Rādhārāṇī, or a combination of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. The intention of Lord Caitanya is to taste Kṛṣṇa's sweetness in transcendental love. He does not care to think of Himself as Kṛṣṇa, because He wants the position of Rādhārāṇī. We should remember this. A class of so-called devotees called the *nadīyā-nāgarīs* or *gaura-nāgarīs* pretend that they have the sentiment of *gopīs* toward Lord Caitanya, but they do not realize that He placed Himself not as the enjoyer, Kṛṣṇa, but as the enjoyed, the devotee of Kṛṣṇa. The concoctions of unauthorized persons pretending to be bona fide have not been accepted by Lord Caitanya. Presentations such as those of the *gaura-nāgarīs* are only disturbances to the sincere execution of the mission of Lord Caitanya. Lord Caitanya is undoubtedly Kṛṣṇa Himself, and He is always nondifferent from Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. But the emotion technically called *vipralambha-bhāva*, which the Lord adopted for confidential reasons, should not be disturbed in the name of service. A mundaner should not unnecessarily intrude into affairs of transcendence and thereby displease the Lord. One must always be on guard against this sort of devotional anomaly. A devotee is not meant to create disturbances to Kṛṣṇa. As Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī has explained, devotional service is *ānukūlyena*, or favorable to Kṛṣṇa. Acting unfavorably toward Kṛṣṇa is not devotion. Kāṁsa was the enemy of Kṛṣṇa. He always thought of Kṛṣṇa, but he thought of Him as an enemy. One should always avoid such unfavorable so-called service.

Lord Caitanya has accepted the role of Rādhārāṇī, and we should support

that position, as Svarūpa Dāmodara did in the Gambhīrā (the room where Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu stayed in Purī). He always reminded Lord Caitanya of Rādhā's feelings of separation as they are described in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and Lord Caitanya appreciated his assistance. But the *gaura-nāgarīs*, who place Lord Caitanya in the position of enjoyer and themselves as His enjoyed, are not approved by Lord Caitanya or by Lord Caitanya's followers. Instead of being blessed, the foolish imitators are left completely apart. Their concoctions are against the principles of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The doctrine of transcendental enjoyment by Kṛṣṇa cannot be mixed up with the doctrine of transcendental feeling of separation from Kṛṣṇa in the role of Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 42

dāśya, sakhya, vātsalya, āra ye śṛṅgāra

cāri prema, catur-vidha bhakta-i ādhāra

SYNONYMS

dāśya—servitude; *sakhya*—friendship; *vātsalya*—parental affection; *āra*—and; *ye*—that; *śṛṅgāra*—conjugal love; *cāri*—four types; *prema*—love of God; *catur-vidha*—four kinds; *bhakta-i*—devotees; *ādhāra*—the containers.

TRANSLATION

Four kinds of devotees are the receptacles of the four kinds of mellows in love of God, namely servitude, friendship, parental affection and conjugal love.

TEXT 43

nija nija bhāva sabe śreṣṭha kari' māne

nija-bhāve kare kṛṣṇa-sukha āsvādane

SYNONYMS

nija nija—each his own; *bhāva*—mood; *sabe*—all; *śreṣṭha kari'*—making the best; *māne*—accepts; *nija-bhāve*—in his own mood; *kare*—does; *kṛṣṇa-sukha*—happiness with Lord Kṛṣṇa; *āsvādane*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

Each kind of devotee feels that his sentiment is the most excellent, and thus in that mood he tastes great happiness with Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 44

taṭastha ha-iyā mane vicāra yadi kari

saba rasa haite śṛṅgāre adhika mādhuri

SYNONYMS

taṭa-stha ha-iyā—becoming impartial; *mane*—in the mind; *vicāra*—consideration; *yadi*—if; *kari*—doing; *saba rasa*—all the mellows; *haite*—than; *śṛṅgāre*—in conjugal love; *adhika*—greater; *mādhuri*—sweetness.

TRANSLATION

But if we compare the sentiments in an impartial mood, we find that the conjugal sentiment is superior to all others in sweetness.

PURPORT

No one is higher or lower than anyone else in transcendental relationships with the Lord, for in the absolute realm everything is equal. But although these relationships are absolute, there are also

transcendental differences between them. Thus the transcendental relationship of conjugal love is considered the highest perfection.

TEXT 45

yathottaram asau svāda-

viśeṣollāsamayy api

ratir vāsanayā svādvī

bhāsate kāpi kasyacit

SYNONYMS

yathā-uttaram—one after another; *asau*—that; *svāda-viśeṣa*—of particular tastes; *ullāsa-mayī*—consisting of the increase; *api*—although; *ratih*—love; *vāsanayā*—by the different desire; *svādvī*—sweet; *bhāsate*—exists; *kā api*—any; *kasyacit*—of someone (the devotee).

TRANSLATION

“Increasing love is experienced in various tastes, one above another. But that love which has the highest taste in the gradual succession of desire manifests itself in the form of conjugal love.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī’s *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (2.5.38).

TEXT 46

ataeva madhura rasa kahi tāra nāma

svakīyā-parakīyā-bhāve dvi-vidha saṁsthāna

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *madhura*—sweet; *rasa*—mellow; *kahi*—I say; *tāra*—of that; *nāma*—the name; *svakīyā*—*svakīyā* (own); *parakīyā*—and named *parakīyā* (another's); *bhāve*—in the moods; *dvi-vidha*—two types; *saṁsthāna*—positions.

TRANSLATION

Therefore I call it madhura-rasa. It has two further divisions, namely wedded and unwedded love.

TEXT 47

parakīyā-bhāve ati rasera ullāsa

vraja vinā ihāra anyatra nāhi vāsa

SYNONYMS

parakīyā-bhāve—in the mood of *parakīyā*, or conjugal relations outside of marriage; *ati*—very great; *rasera*—of mellow; *ullāsa*—increase; *vraja vinā*—except for Vraja; *ihāra*—of this; *anyatra*—anywhere else; *nāhi*—there is not; *vāsa*—residence.

TRANSLATION

There is a great increase of mellow in the unwedded conjugal mood. Such love is found nowhere but in Vraja.

TEXT 48

vraja-vadhū-gaṇera ei bhāva niravadhi

tāra madhye śrī-rādhāya bhāvera avadhi

SYNONYMS

vraja-vadhū-gaṇera—of the young wives of Vraja; *ei*—this; *bhāva*—mood; *niravadhi*—unbounded; *tāra madhye*—among them; *śrī-rādhāya*—in Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bhāvera*—of the mood; *avadhi*—the highest limit.

TRANSLATION

This mood is unbounded in the damsels of Vraja, but among them it finds its perfection in Śrī Rādhā.

TEXT 49

prauḍha nirmala-bhāva prema sarvottama

kṛṣṇera mādhyura-rasa-āsvāda-kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

prauḍha—matured; *nirmala-bhāva*—pure condition; *prema*—love; *sarvottama*—best of all; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mādhyura-rasa*—of the mellow of the conjugal relationship; *āsvāda*—of the tasting; *kāraṇa*—the cause.

TRANSLATION

Her pure, mature love surpasses that of all others. Her love is the cause of Lord Kṛṣṇa's tasting the sweetness of the conjugal relationship.

TEXT 50

ataeva sei bhāva aṅgikāra kari'

sādhilena nija vāñchā gaurāṅga-śrī-hari

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *sei bhāva*—that mood; *aṅgikāra kari'*—accepting; *sādhilena*—fulfilled; *nija*—His own; *vāñchā*—desire; *gaurāṅga*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *śrī-hari*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Therefore Lord Gaurāṅga, who is Śrī Hari Himself, accepted the sentiments of Rādhā and thus fulfilled His own desires.

PURPORT

Of the four kinds of reciprocation of loving service—*dāsyā*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *mādhurya*—*mādhurya* is considered the fullest. But the conjugal relationship is further divided into two varieties, namely *svakīya* and *parakīya*. *Svakīya* is the relationship with Kṛṣṇa as a formally married husband, and *parakīya* is the relationship with Kṛṣṇa as a paramour. Expert analysts have decided that the transcendental ecstasy of the *parakīya* mellow is better because it is more enthusiastic. This phase of conjugal love is found in those who have surrendered to the Lord in intense love, knowing well that such illicit love with a paramour is not morally approved in society. The risks involved in such love of Godhead make this emotion superior to the relationship in which such risk is not involved. The validity of such risk, however, is possible only in the transcendental realm. *Svakīya* and *parakīya* conjugal love of Godhead have no existence in the material world, and *parakīya* is not exhibited anywhere in Vaikuṇṭha, but only in the portion of Goloka Vṛndāvana known as Vraja.

Some devotees think that Kṛṣṇa is eternally the enjoyer in Goloka Vṛndāvana but only sometimes comes to the platform of Vraja to enjoy *parakīya-rasa*. The six Gosvāmīs of Vṛndāvana, however, have explained

that Kṛṣṇa's pastimes in Vraja are eternal, like His other activities in Goloka Vṛndāvana. Vraja is a confidential part of Goloka Vṛndāvana. Kṛṣṇa exhibited His Vraja pastimes on the surface of this world, and similar pastimes are eternally exhibited in Vraja in Goloka Vṛndāvana, where *parakīya-rasa* is ever existent.

In the Third Chapter of this epic, Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī has explicitly accepted the fact that Kṛṣṇa appears in this material world at the end of the Dvāpara age of the twenty-eighth *catur-yuga* of Vaivasvata Manu and brings with Him His Vrajadhāma, which is the eternal abode of His highest pastimes. As the Lord appears by His own internal potency, so He also brings all His paraphernalia by the same internal potency, without extraneous help. It is further stated here in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* that the *parakīya* sentiment exists only in that transcendental realm and nowhere else. This highest form of ecstasy can exist only in the most confidential part of the transcendental world, but by the causeless mercy of the Lord we can have a peep into that invisible Vraja.

The transcendental mellow relished by the *gopīs* in Vraja is superexcellently featured in Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. Mature assimilation of the transcendental humor of conjugal love is represented by Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, whose feelings are incomprehensible even to the Lord Himself. The intensity of Her loving service is the highest form of ecstasy. No one can surpass Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī in relishing the qualities of the Lord through this supreme transcendental mellow. Therefore the Lord Himself agreed to assume the position of Rādhārāṇī in the form of Lord Śrī Gaurāṅga. He then relished the highest position of *parakīya-rasa*, as exhibited in the transcendental abode of Vraja.

TEXT 51

suresānām durgam gatir atīśayenopaniṣadām

munīnām sarva-svaṁ praṇata-paṭalīnām madhurimā

viniryāsaḥ premṇo nikhīla-pāśu-pālāmbuja-dṛśām

sa caitanyaḥ kim me punar api dṛśor yāsyati padam

SYNONYMS

sura-īśānām—of the kings of the demigods; *durgam*—fortress; *gatiḥ*—the goal; *atiśayena*—eminently; *upaniṣadām*—of the *Upaniṣads*; *munīnām*—of the sages; *sarva-svam*—the be-all and end-all; *praṇata-pāṭalīnām*—of the groups of the devotees; *madhurimā*—the sweetness; *viniryāsaḥ*—the essence; *premṇaḥ*—of love; *nikhīla*—all; *pāśu-pālā*—of the cowherd women; *ambuja-dṛśām*—lotus-eyed; *saḥ*—He; *caitanyaḥ*—Lord Caitanya; *kim*—what; *me*—my; *punaḥ*—again; *api*—certainly; *dṛśoḥ*—of the two eyes; *yāsyati*—will come; *padam*—to the abode.

TRANSLATION

“Lord Caitanya is the shelter of the demigods, the goal of the Upaniṣads, the be-all and end-all of the great sages, the beautiful shelter of His devotees, and the essence of the love of the lotus-eyed gopīs. Will He again be the object of my vision?”

TEXT 52

apāram kasyāpi praṇayi-jana-vṛndasya kutukī

rasa-stomam hṛtvā madhuram upabhoktum kam api yaḥ

rucaṁ svām āvavre dyutim iha tadīyām prakāṣayan

sa devaś caitanyākṛtir atitarām naḥ kṛpayatu

SYNONYMS

apāram—boundless; *kasya api*—of someone; *praṇayi-jana-vṛndasya*—of

the multitude of lovers; *kutukī*—one who is curious; *rasa-stomam*—the group of mellows; *hṛtvā*—stealing; *madhuram*—sweet; *upabhoktum*—to enjoy; *kam api*—some; *yaḥ*—who; *rucam*—luster; *svām*—own; *āvavre*—covered; *dyutim*—luster; *iha*—here; *tadīyām*—related to Him; *prakaṭayan*—manifesting; *saḥ*—He; *devaḥ*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *caitanya-ākṛtiḥ*—having the form of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *atitarām*—greatly; *naḥ*—unto us; *kṛpayatu*—may He show His mercy.

TRANSLATION

“Lord Kṛṣṇa desired to taste the limitless nectarean mellows of the love of one of His multitude of loving damsels [Śrī Rādhā], and so He has assumed the form of Lord Caitanya. He has tasted that love while hiding His own dark complexion with Her effulgent yellow color. May that Lord Caitanya confer upon us His grace.”

PURPORT

Texts 51 and 52 are, respectively, *Prathama Śrī Caitanyāṣṭaka* 2 and *Dvītiya Śrī Caitanyāṣṭaka* 3, from the *Stava-mālā* of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 53

bhāva-grahaṇera hetu kaila dharma-sthāpana

tāra mukhya hetu kahi, śuna sarva-jana

SYNONYMS

bhāva-grahaṇera—of accepting the mood; *hetu*—the reason; *kaila*—did; *dharma*—religion; *sthāpana*—establishing; *tāra*—of that; *mukhya*—principal; *hetu*—reason; *kahi*—I say; *śuna*—please hear; *sarva-jana*—everyone.

TRANSLATION

To accept ecstatic love is the main reason He appeared and reestablished the religious system for this age. I shall now explain that reason. Everyone please listen.

TEXT 54

mūla hetu āge ślokerā kaila ābhāsa

ebe kahi sei ślokerā artha prakāśa

SYNONYMS

mūla hetu—the root cause; *āge*—in the beginning; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *kaila*—gave; *ābhāsa*—hint; *ebe*—now; *kahi*—I shall speak; *sei*—that; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—meaning; *prakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

Having first given hints about the verse describing the principal reason why the Lord appeared, now I shall manifest its full meaning.

TEXT 55

rādhā kṛṣṇa-praṇaya-vikṛtīr hlādinī śaktir asmād

ekātmānāv api bhuvi purā deha-bhedam gatau tau

caitanyākhyam prakṛtam adhunā tad-dvayam caikyam āptam

rādhā-bhāva-dyuti-suvalitam naumi kṛṣṇa-svarūpam

SYNONYMS

rādhā—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *praṇaya*—of love; *vikṛtiḥ*—the transformation; *hlādinī śaktiḥ*—pleasure potency; *asmāt*—from this; *eka-ātmānau*—both the same in identity; *api*—although; *bhuvī*—on earth; *purā*—from beginningless time; *deha-bhedam*—separate forms; *gatau*—obtained; *tau*—these two; *caitanya-ākhyam*—known as Śrī Caitanya; *prakaṣam*—manifest; *adhunā*—now; *tat-dvayam*—the two of Them; *ca*—and; *aikyam*—unity; *āptam*—obtained; *rādhā*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bhāva*—mood; *dyuti*—the luster; *suvalitam*—who is adorned with; *naumi*—I offer my obeisances; *kṛṣṇa-svarūpam*—to Him who is identical with Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

“The loving affairs of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are transcendental manifestations of the Lord’s internal pleasure-giving potency. Although Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one in Their identity, They separated Themselves eternally. Now these two transcendental identities have again united, in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. I bow down to Him, who has manifested Himself with the sentiment and complexion of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī although He is Kṛṣṇa Himself.”

PURPORT

This text is from the diary of Śrīla Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī. It appears as the fifth of the first fourteen verses of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 56

rādhā-kṛṣṇa eka ātmā, dui deha dhari’

anyonye vilase rasa āsvādana kari’

SYNONYMS

rādhā-kṛṣṇa—Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa; *eka*—one; *ātmā*—self; *dui*—two;

deha—bodies; *dhari'*—assuming; *anyone*—one another; *vilase*—They enjoy; *rasa*—the mellows of love; *āsvādana kari'*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are one and the same, but They have assumed two bodies. Thus They enjoy each other, tasting the mellows of love.

PURPORT

The two transcendentalists Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are a puzzle to materialists. The above description of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa from the diary of Śrīla Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī is a condensed explanation, but one needs great spiritual insight to understand the mystery of these two personalities. One is enjoying in two. Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the potent factor, and Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is the internal potency. According to Vedānta philosophy, there is no difference between the potent and the potency; they are identical. We cannot differentiate between one and the other, any more than we can separate fire from heat.

Everything in the Absolute is inconceivable in relative existence. Therefore in relative cognizance it is very difficult to assimilate this truth of the oneness between the potent and the potency. The philosophy of inconceivable oneness and difference propounded by Lord Caitanya is the only source of understanding for such intricacies of transcendence.

In fact, Rādhārāṇī is the internal potency of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and She eternally intensifies the pleasure of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Impersonalists cannot understand this without the help of a *mahā-bhāgavata* devotee. The very name “Rādhā” suggests that Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is eternally the topmost mistress of the comforts of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. As such, She is the medium transmitting the living entities’ service to Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Devotees in Vṛndāvana therefore seek the mercy of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī in order to be recognized as loving servitors of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu personally approaches the fallen conditioned souls of the iron age to deliver the highest principle of transcendental relationships with the Lord. The activities of Lord Caitanya are primarily in the role of the pleasure-giving portion of His internal potency.

The absolute Personality of Godhead, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, is the omnipotent form of transcendental existence, knowledge and bliss in full. His internal potency is exhibited first as *sat*, or existence—or, in other words, as the portion that expands the existence function of the Lord. When the same potency displays full knowledge it is called *cit*, or *samvit*, which expands the transcendental forms of the Lord. Finally, when the same potency plays as a pleasure-giving medium it is known as *hlādinī*, or the transcendental blissful potency. Thus the Lord manifests His internal potency in three transcendental divisions.

TEXT 57

sei dui eka ebe caitanya gosāñi

rasa āsvādite donhe hailā eka-ṭhāñi

SYNONYMS

sei—these; *dui*—two; *eka*—one; *ebe*—now; *caitanya gosāñi*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *rasa*—mellow; *āsvādite*—to taste; *donhe*—the two; *hailā*—have become; *eka-ṭhāñi*—one body.

TRANSLATION

Now, to enjoy rasa, They have appeared in one body as Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 58

ithi lāgi' āge kari tāra vivaraṇa

yāhā haite haya gaurera mahimā-kathana

SYNONYMS

ithi lāgi'—for this; *āge*—first; *kari*—I shall do; *tāra*—of that; *vīvaraṇa*—description; *yāhā haite*—from which; *haya*—there is; *gaurera*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mahimā*—the glory; *kathana*—relating.

TRANSLATION

Therefore I shall first delineate the position of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. From that description the glory of Lord Caitanya will be known.

TEXT 59

rādhikā hayena kṛṣṇera praṇaya-vikāra

svarūpa-śakti——‘*hlādinī*’ *nāma yāñhāra*

SYNONYMS

rādhikā—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *hayena*—is; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *praṇaya-vikāra*—transformation of love; *svarūpa-śakti*—personal energy; *hlādinī*—*hlādinī*; *nāma*—name; *yāñhāra*—whose.

TRANSLATION

Śrīmatī Rādhikā is the transformation of Kṛṣṇa’s love. She is His internal energy called *hlādinī*.

TEXT 60

hlādinī karāya kṛṣṇe ānandāsvādana

hlādinīra dvārā kare bhaktera poṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

hlādinī—the *hlādinī* energy; *karāya*—causes to do; *kṛṣṇe*—in Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ānanda-āsvādana*—the tasting of bliss; *hlādinīra dvārā*—by the pleasure potency; *kare*—does; *bhaktera*—of the devotee; *poṣaṇa*—nourishing.

TRANSLATION

That *hlādinī* energy gives Kṛṣṇa pleasure and nourishes His devotees.

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī has elaborately discussed the *hlādinī* potency in his *Prīti-sandarbha*. He says that the *Vedas* clearly state, “Only devotional service can lead one to the Personality of Godhead. Only devotional service can help a devotee meet the Supreme Lord face to face. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is attracted by devotional service, and as such the ultimate supremacy of Vedic knowledge rests in knowing the science of devotional service.”

What is the particular attraction that makes the Supreme Lord enthusiastic to accept devotional service, and what is the nature of such service? The Vedic scriptures inform us that the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the Absolute Truth, is self-sufficient, and that *māyā*, nescience, can never influence Him at all. Therefore the potency that overcomes the Supreme must be purely spiritual. Such a potency cannot be anything of the material manifestation. The bliss enjoyed by the Supreme Personality of Godhead cannot be of material composition, like the impersonalist conception of the bliss of Brahman. Devotional service is reciprocation between two, and therefore it cannot be located simply within one’s self. Therefore the bliss of self-realization, *brahmānanda*, cannot be equated with devotional service.

The Supreme Personality of Godhead has three kinds of internal potency, namely the *hlādinī-śakti*, or pleasure potency, the *sandhinī-śakti*, or existential potency, and the *samvit-śakti*, or cognitive potency. In the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* (1.12.69) the Lord is addressed as follows: “O Lord, You are the support of everything. The three attributes *hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *samvit* exist in You as one spiritual energy. But the material modes, which cause happiness, misery and mixtures of the two, do not exist in You, for You have no material qualities.”

Hlādinī is the personal manifestation of the blissfulness of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, by which He enjoys pleasure. Because the pleasure potency is perpetually present in the Supreme Lord, the theory of the impersonalist that the Lord appears in the material mode of goodness cannot be accepted. The impersonalist conclusion is against the Vedic version that the Lord possesses a transcendental pleasure potency. When the pleasure potency of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is exhibited by His grace in the person of a devotee, that manifestation is called love of God. “Love of God” is an epithet for the pleasure potency of the Lord. Therefore devotional service reciprocated between the Lord and His devotee is an exhibition of the transcendental pleasure potency of the Lord.

The potency of the Supreme Personality of Godhead that always enriches Him with transcendental bliss is not material, but the Śāṅkarites have accepted it as such because they are ignorant of the identity of the Supreme Lord and His pleasure potency. Those ignorant persons cannot understand the distinction between impersonal spiritual bliss and the variegatedness of the spiritual pleasure potency. The *hlādinī* potency gives the Lord all transcendental pleasure, and the Lord bestows such a potency upon His pure devotee.

TEXT 61

sac-cid-ānanda, pūrṇa, kṛṣṇera svarūpa

eka-i cic-chakti tāñra dhare tina rūpa

SYNONYMS

sat-cit-ānanda—eternity, knowledge and bliss; *pūrṇa*—full; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sva-rūpa*—own form; *eka-i*—one; *cit-śakti*—spiritual energy; *tāñra*—of Him; *dhare*—manifests; *tina*—three; *rūpa*—forms.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa's body is eternal [sat], full of knowledge [cit] and full of bliss [ānanda]. His one spiritual energy manifests three forms.

TEXT 62

ānandāṁśe hlādinī, sad-aṁśe sandhinī

cid-aṁśe samvit—yāre jñāna kari' māni

SYNONYMS

ānanda-aṁśe—in the bliss portion; *hlādinī*—the pleasure energy; *sat-aṁśe*—in the eternal portion; *sandhinī*—the existence-expanding energy; *cit-aṁśe*—in the cognizant portion; *samvit*—the full energy of knowledge; *yāre*—which; *jñāna kari'*—as knowledge; *māni*—I accept.

TRANSLATION

Hlādinī is His aspect of bliss; sandhinī, of eternal existence; and samvit, of cognizance, which is also accepted as knowledge.

PURPORT

In his thesis *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (103), Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī explains the potencies of the Lord as follows: The transcendental potency of the

Supreme Personality of Godhead by which He maintains His existence is called *sandhinī*. The transcendental potency by which He knows Himself and causes others to know Him is called *samvit*. The transcendental potency by which He possesses transcendental bliss and causes His devotees to have bliss is called *hlādinī*.

The total exhibition of these potencies is called *viśuddha-sattva*, and this platform of spiritual variegatedness is displayed even in the material world when the Lord appears here. The pastimes and manifestations of the Lord in the material world are therefore not at all material; they belong to the pure transcendental state. The *Bhagavad-gītā* confirms that anyone who understands the transcendental nature of the Lord's appearance, activities and disappearance becomes eligible for freedom from material bondage upon quitting the present material tabernacle. He can enter the spiritual kingdom to associate with the Supreme Personality of Godhead and reciprocate the *hlādinī* potency in transactions between him and the Lord. In the mundane mode of goodness there are tinges of passion and ignorance. Therefore mundane goodness, being mixed, is called *miśra-sattva*. But the transcendental variegatedness of *viśuddha-sattva* is completely free from all mundane qualities. *Viśuddha-sattva* is therefore the proper atmosphere in which to experience the Personality of Godhead and His transcendental pastimes. Spiritual variegatedness is eternally independent of all material conditions and is nondifferent from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, both being absolute. The Lord and His devotees simultaneously perceive the *hlādinī* potency directly by the power of the *samvit* potency.

The material modes of nature control the conditioned souls, but the Supreme Personality of Godhead is never influenced by these modes, as all Vedic literatures directly and indirectly corroborate. Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself says in the Eleventh Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.25.12), *sattvaṁ rajas tama iti guṇā jīvasya naiva me*: "The material modes of goodness, passion and ignorance are connected with the conditioned souls, but never with Me, the Supreme Personality of Godhead." The *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* confirms this as follows:

*sattvādayo na santīśe yatra na prākṛtā gunāḥ
sa śuddhaḥ sarva-śuddhebhyaḥ pumān ādyaḥ prasīdatu*

“The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Viṣṇu, is beyond the three qualities goodness, passion and ignorance. No material qualities exist in Him. May that original person, Nārāyaṇa, who is situated in a completely transcendental position, be pleased with us.” In the Tenth Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.27.4), Indra praises Kṛṣṇa as follows:

*viśuddha-sattvaṁ tava dhāma śāntaṁ
tapo-mayaṁ dhvasta-rajās-tamaskam
māyā-mayo 'yaṁ guṇa-sampravāho
na vidyate te 'grahaṇānubandhaḥ*

“My dear Lord, Your abode is *viśuddha-sattva*, always undisturbed by the material qualities, and the activities there are in transcendental loving service unto Your feet. The goodness, austerity and penance of the devotees enhance such activities, which are always free from the contamination of passion and ignorance. Material qualities cannot touch You under any circumstances.”

When not manifested, the modes of material nature are said to be in goodness. When they are externally manifested and active in producing the varieties of material existence, they are said to be in passion. And when there is a lack of activity and variegatedness, they are said to be in ignorance. In other words, the pensive mood is goodness, activity is passion, and inactivity is ignorance. Above all these mundane qualitative manifestations is *viśuddha-sattva*. When it is predominated by the *sandhinī* potency, it is perceivable as the existence of all that be. When predominated by the *samvit* potency, it is perceived as knowledge in transcendence. And when predominated by the *hlādinī* potency, it is perceived as the most confidential love of Godhead. *Viśuddha-sattva*, the simultaneous manifestation of these three in one, is the main feature of the kingdom of God.

The Absolute Truth is therefore the substance of reality, eternally manifest in three energies. The manifestation of the internal energy of the Lord is the inconceivably variegated spiritual world, the manifestation of the marginal energy comprises the living entities, and the manifestation of the external energy is the material cosmos. Therefore the Absolute Truth includes these four principles—the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself, His internal energy, His marginal energy and His external energy. The form of the Lord and the expansions of His form as *svayaṁ-rūpa* and *vaibhava-prakāśa* are directly the enjoyers of the internal energy, which is the eternal exhibitor of the spiritual world, the most confidential of the manifestations of energy. The external manifestation, the material energy, provides the covering bodies of the conditioned living entities, from Brahmā down to the insignificant ant. This covering energy is manifested under the three modes of material nature and appreciated in various ways by living entities in both the higher and lower forms of life.

Each of the three divisions of the internal potency—the *sandhinī*, *samvit* and *hlādinī* energies—influences one of the external potencies by which the conditioned souls are conducted. Such influence manifests the three qualitative modes of material nature, proving definitely that the living entities, the marginal potency, are eternally servitors of the Lord and are therefore controlled by either the internal or the external potency.

TEXT 63

hlādinī sandhinī samvit

tvayy ekā sarva-saṁsthita

hlāda-tāpa-karī miśrā

tvayī no guṇa-varjite

SYNONYMS

hlādinī—pleasure potency; *sandhinī*—existence potency; *samvit*—knowledge potency; *tvayi*—in You; *ekā*—one; *sarva-saṁsthītau*—who are the basis of all things; *hlāda*—pleasure; *tāpa*—and misery; *karī*—causing; *miśrā*—a mixture of the two; *tvayi*—in You; *na u*—not; *guṇa-varjite*—who are without the three modes of material nature.

TRANSLATION

“O Lord, You are the support of everything. The three attributes *hlādinī*, *sandhinī* and *samvit* exist in You as one spiritual energy. But the material modes, which cause happiness, misery and mixtures of the two, do not exist in You, for You have no material qualities.”

PURPORT

This text is from the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* (1.12.69).

TEXT 64

sandhinīra sāra amśa——‘*śuddha-sattva*’ *nāma*

bhagavānera sattā haya yāhāte viśrāma

SYNONYMS

sandhinīra—of the existence potency; *sāra*—essence; *amśa*—portion; *śuddha-sattva*—*śuddha-sattva* (pure existence); *nāma*—named; *bhagavānera*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *sattā*—the existence; *haya*—is; *yāhāte*—in which; *viśrāma*—the resting place.

TRANSLATION

The essential portion of the *sandhinī* potency is *śuddha-sattva*. Lord Kṛṣṇa’s existence rests upon it.

TEXT 65

mātā, pitā, sthāna, gṛha, śayyāsana āra

e-saba kṛṣṇera śuddha-sattvera vikāra

SYNONYMS

mātā—mother; *pitā*—father; *sthāna*—place; *gṛha*—house; *śayya-āsana*—beds and seats; *āra*—and; *e-saba*—all these; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *śuddha-sattvera*—of the *śuddha-sattva*; *vikāra*—transformations.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa’s mother, father, abode, house, bedding, seats and so on are all transformations of *śuddha-sattva*.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa’s father, mother and household affairs are all displayed in the same *viśuddha-sattva* existence. A living entity situated in the status of pure goodness can understand the form, qualities and other features of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Kṛṣṇa consciousness begins on the platform of pure goodness. Although there is a faint realization of Kṛṣṇa at first, Kṛṣṇa is actually realized as Vāsudeva, the absolute proprietor of omnipotence or the prime predominating Deity of all potencies. When the living entity is situated in *viśuddha-sattva*, transcendental to the three material modes of nature, he can perceive the form, quality and other features of the Supreme Personality of Godhead through his service attitude. The status of pure goodness is the platform of understanding, for the Supreme Lord is always in spiritual existence.

Kṛṣṇa is always all-spiritual. Aside from the parents of the Personality of Godhead, all the other paraphernalia of His existence are also essentially a manifestation of *sandhinī-śakti*, or a transformation of *viśuddha-sattva*.

To make this more clear, it may be said that this *sandhinī-śakti* of the internal potency maintains and manifests all the variegatedness of the spiritual world. In the kingdom of God, the Lord's servants and maidservants, His consorts, His father and mother and everything else are all transformations of the spiritual existence of *sandhinī-śakti*. The existential *sandhinī-śakti* in the external potency similarly expands all the variegatedness of the material cosmos, from which we can have a glimpse of the spiritual field.

TEXT 66

sattvaṁ viśuddhaṁ vasudeva-śabditam

yad īyate tatra pumān apāvṛtaḥ

sattve ca tasmin bhagavān vāsudevo

hy adhokṣajo me manasā vidhīyate

SYNONYMS

sattvaṁ—existence; *viśuddham*—pure; *vasudeva-śabditam*—named *vasudeva*; *yad*—from which; *īyate*—appears; *tatra*—in that; *pumān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *apāvṛtaḥ*—without any covering; *sattve*—in goodness; *ca*—and; *tasmin*—that; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *vāsudevaḥ*—Vāsudeva; *hi*—certainly; *adhokṣajaḥ*—who is beyond the senses; *me*—my; *manasā*—by the mind; *vidhīyate*—is procured.

TRANSLATION

“The condition of pure goodness [śuddha-sattva], in which the Supreme Personality of Godhead is revealed without any covering, is called *vasudeva*. In that pure state the Supreme Godhead, who is beyond the material senses and who is known as Vāsudeva, is perceived by my

mind.”

PURPORT

This text from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (4.3.23), spoken by Lord Śiva when he condemned Dakṣa, the father of Satī, as an opponent of Viṣṇu, confirms beyond a doubt that Lord Kṛṣṇa, His name, His fame, His qualities and everything in connection with His paraphernalia exist in the *sandhinī-śakti* of the Lord’s internal potency.

TEXT 67

kṛṣṇe bhagavattā-jñāna—samvītera sāra

brahma-jñānādika saba tāra parivāra

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇe—in Kṛṣṇa; *bhagavattā*—of the quality of being the original Supreme Personality of Godhead; *jñāna*—knowledge; *samvītera*—of the knowledge potency; *sāra*—the essence; *brahma-jñāna*—knowledge of Brahman; *ādika*—and so on; *saba*—all; *tāra*—of that; *parivāra*—dependents.

TRANSLATION

The essence of the samvit potency is knowledge that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is Lord Kṛṣṇa. All other kinds of knowledge, such as the knowledge of Brahman, are its components.

PURPORT

The activities of the *samvit-śakti* produce the effect of cognition. Both the Lord and the living entities are cognizant. Śrī Kṛṣṇa, as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, has full knowledge of everything everywhere,

and therefore there are no hindrances to His cognition. He can have knowledge merely by glancing over an object, whereas innumerable impediments block the cognition of ordinary living beings. The cognition of the living beings has three divisions: direct knowledge, indirect knowledge and perverted knowledge. Sense perception of material objects by the mundane senses, such as the eye, ear, nose and hand, always produces definitely perverted knowledge. This illusion is a presentation of the material energy, which is influenced by the *samvit-śakti* in a perverted manner. Negative cognition of an object beyond the reach of sense perception is the way of indirect knowledge, which is not altogether imperfect but which produces only fragmentary knowledge in the form of impersonal spiritual realization and monism. But when the *samvit* factor of cognition is enlightened by the *hlādinī* potency of the same internal energy, they work together, and only thus can one attain knowledge of the Personality of Godhead. The *samvit-śakti* should be maintained in that state. Material knowledge and indirect spiritual knowledge are by-products of the *samvit-śakti*.

TEXT 68

hlādinīra sāra ‘prema’, prema-sāra ‘bhāva’

bhāvera parama-kāṣṭhā, nāma—‘mahā-bhāva’

SYNONYMS

hlādinīra—of the pleasure potency; *sāra*—the essence; *prema*—love for God; *prema-sāra*—the essence of such love; *bhāva*—emotion; *bhāvera*—of emotion; *parama-kāṣṭhā*—the highest limit; *nāma*—named; *mahā-bhāva*—*mahābhāva*.

TRANSLATION

The essence of the *hlādinī* potency is love of God, the essence of love of God is emotion [*bhāva*], and the ultimate development of emotion is

mahābhāva.

PURPORT

The product of the *hlādinī-śakti* is love of Godhead, which has two divisions—namely, pure love of Godhead and adulterated love of Godhead. Only when the *hlādinī-śakti* emanates from Śrī Kṛṣṇa and is bestowed upon the living being to attract Him does the living being become a pure lover of God. But when the same *hlādinī-śakti* is adulterated by the external, material energy and emanates from the living being, it does not attract Kṛṣṇa; on the contrary, the living being becomes attracted by the glamor of the material energy. At that time instead of becoming mad with love of Godhead, the living being becomes mad after material sense enjoyment, and because of his association with the qualitative modes of material nature, he is captivated by its interactions of distressful, unhappy feelings.

TEXT 69

mahābhāva-svarūpā śrī-rādhā-ṭhākurāṇī

sarva-guṇa-khani kṛṣṇa-kāntā-sīromaṇi

SYNONYMS

mahā-bhāva—of *mahābhāva*; *sva-rūpā*—the form; *śrī-rādhā-ṭhākurāṇī*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *sarva-guṇa*—of all good qualities; *khanī*—mine; *kṛṣṇa-kāntā*—of the lovers of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sīromaṇi*—crown jewel.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī is the embodiment of mahābhāva. She is the repository of all good qualities and the crest jewel among all the lovely consorts of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The unadulterated action of the *hlādinī-śakti* is displayed in the dealings of the damsels of Vraja and Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, who is the topmost participant in that transcendental group. The essence of the *hlādinī-śakti* is love of Godhead, the essence of love of Godhead is *bhāva*, or transcendental sentiment, and the highest pitch of that *bhāva* is called *mahābhāva*. Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is the personified embodiment of these three aspects of transcendental consciousness. She is therefore the highest principle in love of Godhead and is the supreme lovable object of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 70

tayor apy ubhayor madhye

rādhikā sarvathādhikā

mahābhāva-svarūpeyam

guṇair ativarīyasī

SYNONYMS

tayoḥ—of them; *api*—even; *ubhayoḥ*—of both (Candrāvalī and Rādhārāṇī); *madhye*—in the middle; *rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *sarvathā*—in every way; *adhikā*—greater; *mahā-bhāva-svarūpā*—the form of *mahābhāva*; *iyam*—this one; *guṇaiḥ*—with good qualities; *ativarīyasī*—the best of all.

TRANSLATION

“Of these two gopīs [Rādhārāṇī and Candrāvalī], Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is superior in all respects. She is the embodiment of mahābhāva, and She surpasses all in good qualities.”

PURPORT

This is a quotation from Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī's *Ujjvala-nīlamanī* (*Rādhā-prakarāṇa* 3).

TEXT 71

kṛṣṇa-prema-bhāvita yāñra cittendriya-kāya

kṛṣṇa-nija-śakti rādhā krīḍāra sahāya

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-prema—love for Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhāvita*—steeped in; *yāñra*—whose; *citta*—mind; *indriya*—senses; *kāya*—body; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nija-śakti*—His own energy; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *krīḍāra*—of pastimes; *sahāya*—companion.

TRANSLATION

Her mind, senses and body are steeped in love for Kṛṣṇa. She is Kṛṣṇa's own energy, and She helps Him in His pastimes.

PURPORT

Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is as fully spiritual as Kṛṣṇa. No one should consider Her to be material. She is definitely not like the conditioned souls, who have material bodies, gross and subtle, covered by material senses. She is all-spiritual, and both Her body and Her mind are of the same spiritual embodiment. Because Her body is spiritual, Her senses are also spiritual. Thus Her body, mind and senses fully shine in love of Kṛṣṇa. She is the personified *hlādinī-śakti* (the pleasure-giving energy of the Lord's internal potency), and therefore She is the only source of enjoyment for Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa cannot enjoy anything that is internally different from Him. Therefore Rādhā and Śrī Kṛṣṇa are identical. The *sandhinī* portion of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's internal potency has manifested the all-attractive form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and the same internal potency, in the *hlādinī* feature, has presented Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, who is the attraction for the all-attractive. No one can match Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī in the transcendental pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 72

ānanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhis

tābhir ya eva nija-rūpatayā kalābhiḥ

goloka eva nivasaty akhilātma-bhūto

govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

ānanda—bliss; *cit*—and knowledge; *maya*—consisting of; *rasa*—mellows; *prati*—at every second; *bhāvitābhiḥ*—who are engrossed with; *tābhiḥ*—with those; *yaḥ*—who; *eva*—certainly; *nija-rūpatayā*—with His own form; *kalābhiḥ*—who are parts of portions of His pleasure potency; *goloke*—in Goloka Vṛndāvana; *eva*—certainly; *nivasati*—resides; *akhilā-ātma*—as the soul of all; *bhūtaḥ*—who exists; *govindam*—Lord Govinda; *ādi-puruṣam*—the original personality; *tam*—Him; *aham*—I; *bhajāmi*—worship.

TRANSLATION

“I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who resides in His own realm, Goloka, with Rādhā, who resembles His own spiritual figure and who embodies the ecstatic potency [hlādinī]. Their companions are Her confidantes, who embody extensions of Her bodily form and who are

imbued and permeated with ever-blissful spiritual rasa.”

PURPORT

This text is from the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.37).

TEXT 73

kṛṣṇere karāya yaiche rasa āsvādana

kṛīḍāra sahāya yaiche, śuna vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇere—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karāya*—causes to do; *yaiche*—how; *rasa*—the mellows; *āsvādana*—tasting; *kṛīḍāra*—of pastimes; *sahāya*—helper; *yaiche*—how; *śuna*—please hear; *vivaraṇa*—the description.

TRANSLATION

Now please listen to how Lord Kṛṣṇa’s consorts help Him taste rasa and how they help in His pastimes.

TEXTS 74–75

kṛṣṇa-kāntā-gaṇa dekhi tri-vidha prakāra

eka lakṣmī-gaṇa, pure mahiṣī-gaṇa āra

vrajāṅganā-rūpa, āra kāntā-gaṇa-sāra

śrī-rādhikā haite kāntā-gaṇera vistāra

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-kāntā-gaṇa—the lovers of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dekhi*—I see; *tri-vidha*—three; *prakāra*—kinds; *eka*—one; *lakṣmī-gaṇa*—the goddesses of fortune; *pure*—in the city; *mahiṣī-gaṇa*—the queens; *āra*—and; *vraja-aṅganā*—of the beautiful women of Vraja; *rūpa*—having the form; *āra*—another type; *kāntā-gaṇa*—of the lovers; *sāra*—the essence; *śrī-rādhikā haite*—from Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *kāntā-gaṇera*—of the lovers of Kṛṣṇa; *vistāra*—the expansion.

TRANSLATION

The beloved consorts of Lord Kṛṣṇa are of three kinds: the goddesses of fortune, the queens, and the milkmaids of Vraja, who are the foremost of all. These consorts all proceed from Rādhikā.

TEXT 76

avatārī kṛṣṇa yaiche kare avatāra

aṁśinī rādhā haite tina gaṇera vistāra

SYNONYMS

avatārī—the source of all incarnations; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yaiche*—just as; *kare*—makes; *avatāra*—incarnation; *aṁśinī*—the source of all portions; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *haite*—from; *tina*—three; *gaṇera*—of the groups; *vistāra*—expansion.

TRANSLATION

Just as the fountainhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa, is the cause of all incarnations, so Śrī Rādhā is the cause of all these consorts.

TEXT 77

vaibhava-gaṇa yena tānra aṅga-vibhūti

bimba-pratibimba-rūpa mahiṣīra tati

SYNONYMS

vaibhava-gaṇa—the expansions; *yena*—as it were; *tāñra*—of Her; *aṅga*—of the body; *vibhūti*—powerful expansions; *bimba*—reflections; *pratibimba*—counterreflections; *rūpa*—having the form; *mahiṣīra*—of the queens; *tati*—the expansion.

TRANSLATION

The goddesses of fortune are partial manifestations of Śrīmatī Rādhikā, and the queens are reflections of Her image.

TEXT 78

lakṣmī-gaṇa tāñra vaibhava-vilāsāṁśa-rūpa

mahiṣī-gaṇa vaibhava-prakāśa-svarūpa

SYNONYMS

lakṣmī-gaṇa—the goddesses of fortune; *tāñra*—Her; *vaibhava-vilāsa*—as *vaibhava-vilāsa*; *āṁśa*—of plenary portions; *rūpa*—having the form; *mahiṣī-gaṇa*—the queens; *vaibhava-prakāśa*—of *vaibhava-prakāśa*; *svarūpa*—having the nature.

TRANSLATION

The goddesses of fortune are Her plenary portions, and they display the forms of *vaibhava-vilāsa*. The queens are of the nature of Her *vaibhava-prakāśa*.

TEXT 79

ākāra svabhāva-bhede vraja-devī-gaṇa

kāya-vyūha-rūpa tāñra rasera kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

ākāra—of features; *svabhāva*—of natures; *bhede*—with differences; *vraja-devī-gaṇa*—the *gopīs*; *kāya*—of Her body; *vyūha*—of expansions; *rūpa*—having the form; *tāñra*—of Her; *rasera*—of mellows; *kāraṇa*—instruments.

TRANSLATION

The Vraja-devīs have diverse bodily features. They are Her expansions and are the instruments for expanding rasa.

TEXT 80

bahu kāntā vinā nahe rasera ullāsa

līlāra sahāya lāgi' bahuta prakāśa

SYNONYMS

bahu—many; *kāntā*—lovers; *vinā*—without; *nahe*—there is not; *rasera*—of mellow; *ullāsa*—exultation; *līlāra*—of pastimes; *sahāya*—helper; *lāgi'*—for the purpose of being; *bahuta*—many; *prakāśa*—manifestations.

TRANSLATION

Without many consorts, there is not such exultation in rasa. Therefore there are many manifestations of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī to assist in the Lord's pastimes.

TEXT 81

tāra madhye vraje nānā bhāva-rasa-bhede

kṛṣṇake karāya rāsādikā-līlāsvāde

SYNONYMS

tāra madhye—among them; *vraje*—in Vraja; *nānā*—various; *bhāva*—of moods; *rasa*—and of mellows; *bhede*—by differences; *kṛṣṇake*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karāya*—cause to do; *rāsa-ādika*—beginning with the *rāsa* dance; *līlā*—of the pastimes; *āsvāde*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

Among them are various groups of consorts in Vraja who have varieties of sentiments and mellows. They help Lord Kṛṣṇa taste all the sweetness of the *rāsa* dance and other pastimes.

PURPORT

As already explained, Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā are one in two. They are identical. Kṛṣṇa expands Himself in multi-incarnations and plenary portions like the *puruṣas*. Similarly, Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī expands Herself in multiforms as the goddesses of fortune, the queens and the damsels of Vraja. Such expansions from Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī are all Her plenary portions. All these womanly forms of Kṛṣṇa are expansions corresponding to His plenary expansions of Viṣṇu forms. These expansions have been compared to reflected forms of the original form. There is no difference between the original form and the reflected forms. The female reflections of Kṛṣṇa's pleasure potency are as good as Kṛṣṇa Himself.

The plenary expansions of Kṛṣṇa's personality are called *vaibhava-vilāsa* and *vaibhava-prakāśa*, and Rādhā's expansions are similarly described. The goddesses of fortune are Her *vaibhava-vilāsa* forms, and the queens

are Her *vaibhava-prakāśa* forms. The personal associates of Rādhārāṇī, the damsels of Vraja, are direct expansions of Her body. As expansions of Her personal form and transcendental disposition, they are agents of different reciprocations of love in the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa, under the supreme direction of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. In the transcendental realm, enjoyment is fully relished in variety. The exuberance of transcendental mellows is increased by the association of a large number of personalities similar to Rādhārāṇī, who are also known as *gopīs* or *sakhīs*. The variety of innumerable mistresses is a source of relish for Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and therefore these expansions from Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī are necessary for enhancing the pleasure potency of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Their transcendental exchanges of love are the superexcellent affairs of the pastimes in Vṛndāvana. By these expansions of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī's personal body, She helps Lord Kṛṣṇa taste the *rāsa* dance and other, similar activities. Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, being the central petal of the *rāsa-līlā* flower, is also known by the names found in the following verses.

TEXT 82

govindānandinī rādhā, govinda-mohinī

govinda-sarvasva, sarva-kāntā-śīromaṇi

SYNONYMS

govinda-ānandinī—She who gives pleasure to Govinda; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *govinda-mohinī*—She who mystifies Govinda; *govinda-sarvasva*—the be-all and end-all of Lord Govinda; *sarva-kāntā*—of all the Lord's lovers; *śīromaṇi*—the crown jewel.

TRANSLATION

Rādhā is the one who gives pleasure to Govinda, and She is also the enchantress of Govinda. She is the be-all and end-all of Govinda, and the crest jewel of all His consorts.

TEXT 83

devī kṛṣṇa-mayī proktā

rādhikā para-devatā

sarva-lakṣmī-mayī sarva-

kāntiḥ sammohinī parā

SYNONYMS

devī—who shines brilliantly; *kṛṣṇa-mayī*—nondifferent from Lord Kṛṣṇa; *proktā*—called; *rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *para-devatā*—most worshipable; *sarva-lakṣmī-mayī*—presiding over all the goddesses of fortune; *sarva-kāntiḥ*—in whom all splendor exists; *sammohinī*—whose character completely bewilders Lord Kṛṣṇa; *parā*—the superior energy.

TRANSLATION

“The transcendental goddess Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is the direct counterpart of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa. She is the central figure for all the goddesses of fortune. She possesses all the attractiveness to attract the all-attractive Personality of Godhead. She is the primeval internal potency of the Lord.”

PURPORT

This text is from the *Bṛhad-gautamīya-tantra*.

TEXT 84

‘devī’ kahi dyotamānā, paramā sundarī

kimvā, kṛṣṇa-pūjā-kṛidāra vasatī nagarī

SYNONYMS

devī—the word *devī*; *kahi*—I say; *dyotamānā*—shining; *paramā*—most; *sundarī*—beautiful; *kimvā*—or; *kṛṣṇa-pūjā*—of the worship of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛīḍāra*—and of sports; *vasatī*—the abode; *nagarī*—the town.

TRANSLATION

“Devī” means “resplendent and most beautiful.” Or else it means “the lovely abode of the worship and love sports of Lord Kṛṣṇa.”

TEXT 85

kṛṣṇa-mayī—*kṛṣṇa yāra bhitare bāhire*

yāñhā yāñhā netra paḍe tāñhā kṛṣṇa sphure

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-mayī—the word *kṛṣṇa-mayī*; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yāra*—of whom; *bhitare*—the within; *bāhire*—the without; *yāñhā yāñhā*—wherever; *netra*—the eyes; *paḍe*—fall; *tāñhā*—there; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sphure*—manifests.

TRANSLATION

“Kṛṣṇa-mayī” means “one whose within and without are Lord Kṛṣṇa.” She sees Lord Kṛṣṇa wherever She casts Her glance.

TEXT 86

kimvā, prema-rasa-maya kṛṣṇera svarūpa

tāñra śakti tāñra saha haya eka-rūpa

SYNONYMS

kimvā—or; *prema-rasa*—the mellows of love; *maya*—made of; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *svarūpa*—the real nature; *tāñira*—of Him; *śakti*—the energy; *tāñira saha*—with Him; *haya*—there is; *eka-rūpa*—oneness.

TRANSLATION

Or “*kṛṣṇa-mayī*” means that She is identical with Lord Kṛṣṇa, for She embodies the mellows of love. The energy of Lord Kṛṣṇa is identical with Him.

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇa-mayī has two different imports. First, a person who always thinks of Kṛṣṇa both within and without and who always remembers only Kṛṣṇa, wherever he goes or whatever he sees, is called *kṛṣṇa-mayī*. Also, since Kṛṣṇa’s personality is full of love, His loving potency, Rādhārāṇī, being nondifferent from Him, is called *kṛṣṇa-mayī*.

TEXT 87

kṛṣṇa-vāñchā-pūrti-rūpa kare ārādhane

ataeva ‘rādhikā’ nāma purāṇe vākhāne

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-vāñchā—of the desire of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pūrti-rūpa*—of the nature of fulfillment; *kare*—does; *ārādhane*—worship; *ataeva*—therefore; *rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhikā; *nāma*—named; *purāṇe*—in the *Purāṇas*; *vākhāne*—in the description.

TRANSLATION

Her worship [ārādhana] consists of fulfilling the desires of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Therefore the Purāṇas call Her Rādhikā.

PURPORT

The name “Rādhā” is derived from the root word *ārādhana*, which means “worship.” The personality who excels all in worshiping Kṛṣṇa may therefore be called Rādhikā, the greatest servitor.

TEXT 88

anayārādhito nūnam

bhagavān harir īśvaraḥ

yan no vihāya govindaḥ

prīto yām anayat rahaḥ

SYNONYMS

anayā—by this one; *ārādhitaḥ*—worshiped; *nūnam*—certainly; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *hariḥ*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *īśvaraḥ*—the Supreme Lord; *yat*—from which; *naḥ*—us; *vihāya*—leaving aside; *govindaḥ*—Govinda; *prītaḥ*—pleased; *yām*—whom; *anayat*—lead; *rahaḥ*—to a lonely place.

TRANSLATION

“Truly the Personality of Godhead has been worshiped by Her. Therefore Lord Govinda, being pleased, has brought Her to a lonely spot, leaving us all behind.”

PURPORT

This text is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.30.28).

TEXT 89

ataeva sarva-pūjyā, parama-devatā

sarva-pālikā, sarva jagatera mātā

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *sarva-pūjyā*—worshipable by all; *parama*—supreme; *devatā*—goddess; *sarva-pālikā*—the protectress of all; *sarva jagatera*—of all the universes; *mātā*—the mother.

TRANSLATION

Therefore Rādhā is parama-devatā, the supreme goddess, and She is worshipable for everyone. She is the protectress of all, and She is the mother of the entire universe.

TEXT 90

‘sarva-lakṣmī’-śabda pūrve kariyāchi vyākhyāna

sarva-lakṣmī-gaṇera tinho hana adhiṣṭhāna

SYNONYMS

sarva-lakṣmī-śabda—the word *sarva-lakṣmī*; *pūrve*—previously; *kariyāchi*—I have done; *vyākhyāna*—explanation; *sarva-lakṣmī-gaṇera*—of all the goddesses of fortune; *tinho*—She; *hana*—is; *adhiṣṭhāna*—abode.

TRANSLATION

I have already explained the meaning of “sarva-lakṣmī.” Rādhā is the original source of all the goddesses of fortune.

TEXT 91

kimvā, ‘sarva-lakṣmī’——kṛṣṇera ṣaḍ-vidha aiśvarya

tāñra adhiṣṭhātrī śakti——sarva-śakti-varya

SYNONYMS

kimvā—or; *sarva-lakṣmī*—the word *sarva-lakṣmī*; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ṣaḍ-vidha*—six kinds; *aiśvarya*—opulences; *tāñra*—of Him; *adhiṣṭhātrī*—chief; *śakti*—energy; *sarva-śakti*—of all energies; *varya*—the best.

TRANSLATION

Or “sarva-lakṣmī” indicates that She fully represents the six opulences of Kṛṣṇa. Therefore She is the supreme energy of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 92

sarva-saundarya-kānti vaisaye yāñhāte

sarva-lakṣmī-gaṇera śobhā haya yāñhā haite

SYNONYMS

sarva-saundarya—of all beauty; *kānti*—the splendor; *vaisaye*—sits; *yāñhāte*—in whom; *sarva-lakṣmī-gaṇera*—of all the goddesses of fortune; *śobhā*—the splendor; *haya*—is; *yāñhā haite*—from whom.

TRANSLATION

The word “sarva-kānti” indicates that all beauty and luster rest in Her body. All the lakṣmīs derive their beauty from Her.

TEXT 93

kimvā ‘kānti’-śabde kṛṣṇera saba icchā kahe

kṛṣṇera sakala vāñchā rādhātei rahe

SYNONYMS

kimvā—or; *kānti-śabde*—by the word *kānti*; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *saba*—all; *icchā*—desires; *kahe*—says; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sakala*—all; *vāñchā*—desires; *rādhātei*—in Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *rahe*—remain.

TRANSLATION

“Kānti” may also mean “all the desires of Lord Kṛṣṇa.” All the desires of Lord Kṛṣṇa rest in Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 94

rādhikā karena kṛṣṇera vāñchita pūraṇa

‘sarva-kānti’-śabdera ei artha vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

rādhikā—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *karena*—does; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vāñchita*—desired object; *pūraṇa*—fulfilling; *sarva-kānti-śabdera*—of the word *sarva-kānti*; *ei*—this; *artha*—meaning; *vivaraṇa*—the description.

TRANSLATION

Śrīmatī Rādhikā fulfills all the desires of Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is the meaning of “sarva-kānti.”

TEXT 95

jagat-mohana kṛṣṇa, tāñhāra mohinī

ataeva samastera parā ṭhākurāṇī

SYNONYMS

jagat-mohana—enchanting the universe; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tāñhāra*—of Him; *mohinī*—the enchantress; *ataeva*—therefore; *samastera*—of all; *parā*—foremost; *ṭhākurāṇī*—goddess.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa enchants the world, but Śrī Rādhā enchants even Him. Therefore She is the supreme goddess of all.

TEXT 96

rādhā—pūrṇa-śakti, kṛṣṇa—pūrṇa-śaktimān

dui vastu bheda nāi, śāstra-paramāṇa

SYNONYMS

rādhā—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *pūrṇa-śakti*—the complete energy; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pūrṇa-śaktimān*—the complete possessor of energy; *dui*—two; *vastu*—things; *bheda*—difference; *nāi*—there is not; *śāstra-paramāṇa*—the evidence of revealed scripture.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Rādhā is the full power, and Lord Kṛṣṇa is the possessor of full power. The two are not different, as evidenced by the revealed scriptures.

TEXT 97

mṛgamada, tāra gandha—yaiche aviccheda

agni, jvālāte—yaiche kabhu nāhi bheda

SYNONYMS

mṛga-mada—musk; *tāra*—of that; *gandha*—fragrance; *yaiche*—just as; *aviccheda*—inseparable; *agni*—the fire; *jvālāte*—temperature; *yaiche*—just as; *kabhu*—any; *nāhi*—there is not; *bheda*—difference.

TRANSLATION

They are indeed the same, just as musk and its scent are inseparable, or as fire and its heat are nondifferent.

TEXT 98

rādhā-kṛṣṇa aiche sadā eka-i svarūpa

līlā-rasa āsvādite dhare dui-rūpa

SYNONYMS

rādhā-kṛṣṇa—Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa; *aiche*—in this way; *sadā*—always; *eka-i*—one; *svarūpa*—nature; *līlā-rasa*—the mellows of a pastime; *āsvādite*—to taste; *dhare*—manifest; *dui-rūpa*—two forms.

TRANSLATION

Thus Rādhā and Lord Kṛṣṇa are one, yet They have taken two forms to

enjoy the mellows of pastimes.

TEXTS 99–100

prema-bhakti śikhāite āpane avatari

rādhā-bhāva-kānti dui aṅgikāra kari'

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-rūpe kaila avatāra

ei ta' pañcama ślokerā artha paracāra

SYNONYMS

prema-bhakti—devotional service in love of Godhead; *śikhāite*—to teach; *āpane*—Himself; *avatari*—descending; *rādhā-bhāva*—the mood of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *kānti*—and luster; *dui*—two; *aṅgikāra kari'*—accepting; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *rūpe*—in the form; *kaila*—made; *avatāra*—incarnation; *ei*—this; *ta'*—certainly; *pañcama*—fifth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—meaning; *paracāra*—proclamation.

TRANSLATION

To promulgate prema-bhakti [devotional service in love of Godhead], Kṛṣṇa appeared as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya with the mood and complexion of Śrī Rādhā. Thus I have explained the meaning of the fifth verse.

TEXT 101

ṣaṣṭha ślokerā artha karite prakāśa

prathame kahiye sei ślokerā ābhāsa

SYNONYMS

ṣaṣṭha—sixth; *śloka*—of the verse; *artha*—meaning; *karite*—to do; *prakāśa*—manifestation; *prathame*—first; *kahiye*—I shall speak; *sei*—that; *śloka*—of the verse; *ābhāsa*—hint.

TRANSLATION

To explain the sixth verse, I shall first give a hint of its meaning.

TEXT 102

avatari' prabhu pracāṛila saṅkīrtana

eho bāhya hetu, pūrve kariyāchi sūcana

SYNONYMS

avatari'—incarnating; *prabhu*—the Lord; *pracāṛila*—propagated; *saṅkīrtana*—the congregational chanting of the holy name; *eho*—this; *bāhya*—external; *hetu*—reason; *pūrve*—previously; *kariyāchi*—I have given; *sūcana*—indication.

TRANSLATION

The Lord came to propagate saṅkīrtana. That is an external purpose, as I have already indicated.

TEXT 103

avatārera āra eka āche mukhya-bīja

rasika-śekhara kṛṣṇera sei kārya nija

SYNONYMS

avatārera—of the incarnation; *āra*—another; *eka*—one; *āche*—there is;

mukhya-bīja—principal seed; *rasika-śekhara*—the foremost enjoyer of the mellows of love; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sei*—that; *kārya*—business; *nija*—own.

TRANSLATION

There is a principal cause for Lord Kṛṣṇa's appearance. It grows from His own engagements as the foremost enjoyer of loving exchanges.

TEXT 104

ati gūḍha hetu sei tri-vidha prakāra

dāmodara-svarūpa haite yāhāra pracāra

SYNONYMS

ati—very; *gūḍha*—esoteric; *hetu*—reason; *sei*—that; *tri-vidha*—three; *prakāra*—kinds; *dāmodara-svarūpa haite*—from Svarūpa Dāmodara; *yāhāra*—of which; *pracāra*—the proclamation.

TRANSLATION

That most confidential cause is threefold. Svarūpa Dāmodara has revealed it.

TEXT 105

svarūpa-gosāñi—prabhura ati antaraṅga

tāhāte jānena prabhura e-saba prasaṅga

SYNONYMS

svarūpa-gosāñi—Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosāñi; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya

Mahāprabhu; *ati*—very; *antaraṅga*—confidential associate; *tāhāte*—by that; *jānena*—he knows; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *e-saba*—all these; *prasaṅga*—topics.

TRANSLATION

Svarūpa Gosāñi is the most intimate associate of the Lord. He therefore knows all these topics well.

PURPORT

Prior to the Lord's acceptance of the renounced order, Puruṣottama Bhaṭṭācārya, a resident of Navadvīpa, desired to enter the renounced order of life. Therefore he left home and went to Benares, where he accepted the position of *brahmacarya* from a Māyāvādī *sannyāsī*. When he became a *brahmacārī*, he was given the name Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa. He left Benares shortly thereafter, without taking *sannyāsa*, and he came to Nilācala, Jagannātha Purī, where Lord Caitanya was staying. He met Caitanya Mahāprabhu there and dedicated his life for the service of the Lord. He became Lord Caitanya's secretary and constant companion. He used to enhance the pleasure potency of the Lord by singing appropriate songs, which were very much appreciated. Svarūpa Dāmodara could understand the secret mission of Lord Caitanya, and it was by his grace only that all the devotees of Lord Caitanya could know the real purpose of the Lord.

Svarūpa Dāmodara has been identified as Lalitā-devī, the second expansion of Rādhārāṇī. However, text 160 of Kavi-karṇapūra's authoritative *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* describes Svarūpa Dāmodara as the same Viśākhā-devī who serves the Lord in Goloka Vṛndāvana. Therefore it is to be understood that Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara is a direct expansion of Rādhārāṇī who helps the Lord experience the attitude of Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 106

rādhikāra bhāva-mūrti prabhura antara

sei bhāve sukha-duḥkha uṭhe nirantara

SYNONYMS

rādhikāra—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bhāva-mūrti*—the form of the emotions; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *antara*—the heart; *sei*—that; *bhāve*—in the condition; *sukha-duḥkha*—happiness and distress; *uṭhe*—arise; *nirantara*—constantly.

TRANSLATION

The heart of Lord Caitanya is the image of Śrī Rādhikā's emotions. Thus feelings of pleasure and pain arise constantly therein.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya's heart was full of the feelings of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, and His appearance resembled Hers. Svarūpa Dāmodara has explained His attitude as *rādhā-bhāva-mūrti*, the attitude of Rādhārāṇī. One who engages in sense gratification on the material platform can hardly understand *rādhā-bhāva*, but one who is freed from the demands of sense gratification can understand it. *Rādhā-bhāva* must be understood from the Gosvāmīs, those who are actually controllers of the senses. From such authorized sources it is to be known that the attitude of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is the highest perfection of conjugal love, which is the highest of the five transcendental mellows, and it is the complete perfection of love of Kṛṣṇa.

These transcendental affairs can be understood on two platforms. One is called elevated, and the other is called superelevated. The loving affairs exhibited in Dvārakā are the elevated form. The superelevated position is reached in the manifestations of the pastimes of Vṛndāvana. The attitude of Lord Caitanya is certainly superelevated.

From the life of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, an intelligent person engaged in pure devotional service can understand that He always felt separation from Kṛṣṇa within Himself. In that separation He sometimes felt that He had found Kṛṣṇa and was enjoying the meeting. The significance of this separation and meeting is very specific. If someone tries to understand the exalted position of Lord Caitanya without knowing this, he is sure to misunderstand it. One must first become fully self-realized. Otherwise one may misidentify the Lord as *nāgara*, or the enjoyer of the damsels of Vraja, thus committing the mistake of *rasābhāsa*, or overlapping understanding.

TEXT 107

śeṣa-līlāya prabhura kṛṣṇa-viraha-unmāda

bhrama-maya ceṣṭā, āra pralāpa-maya vāda

SYNONYMS

śeṣa-līlāya—in the final pastimes; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kṛṣṇa-viraha*—from separation from Lord Kṛṣṇa; *unmāda*—the madness; *bhrama-maya*—erroneous; *ceṣṭā*—efforts; *āra*—and; *pralāpa-maya*—delirious; *vāda*—talk.

TRANSLATION

In the final portion of His pastimes, Lord Caitanya was obsessed with the madness of separation from Lord Kṛṣṇa. He acted in erroneous ways and talked deliriously.

PURPORT

Lord Śrī Caitanya exhibited the highest stage of the feelings of a devotee in separation from the Lord. This exhibition was sublime because He was completely perfect in the feelings of separation. Materialists, however,

cannot understand this. Sometimes materialistic scholars think He was diseased or crazy. Their problem is that they always engage in material sense gratification and can never understand the feelings of the devotees and the Lord. Materialists are most abominable in their ideas. They think that they can enjoy directly perceivable gross objects by their senses and that they can similarly deal with the transcendental features of Lord Caitanya. But the Lord is understood only in pursuance of the principles laid down by the Gosvāmīs, headed by Svarūpa Dāmodara. Doctrines like those of the *nadīyā-nāgarīs*, a class of so-called devotees, are never presented by authorized persons like Svarūpa Dāmodara or the six Gosvāmīs. The ideas of the *gaurāṅga-nāgarīs* are simply a mental concoction, and they are completely on the mental platform.

TEXT 108

rādhikāra bhāva yaiche uddhava-darsāne

sei bhāve matta prabhu rahe rātri-dine

SYNONYMS

rādhikāra—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bhāva*—emotion; *yaiche*—just as; *uddhava-darsāne*—in seeing Śrī Uddhava; *sei*—that; *bhāve*—in the state; *matta*—maddened; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *rahe*—remains; *rātri-dine*—day and night.

TRANSLATION

Just as Rādhikā went mad at the sight of Uddhava, so Lord Caitanya was obsessed day and night with the madness of separation.

PURPORT

Those under the shelter of the lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu can understand that His mode of worship of the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa in

separation is the real worship of the Lord. When the feelings of separation become very intense, one attains the stage of meeting Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

So-called devotees like the *sahajiyās* cheaply imagine they are meeting Kṛṣṇa in Vṛndāvana. Such thinking may be useful, but actually meeting Kṛṣṇa is possible through the attitude of separation taught by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 109

rātre pralāpa kare svarūpera kaṇṭha dhari'

āveśe āpana bhāva kahaye ughāḍi'

SYNONYMS

rātre—at night; *pralāpa*—delirium; *kare*—does; *svarūpera*—of Svarūpa Dāmodara; *kaṇṭha dhari'*—embracing the neck; *āveśe*—in ecstasy; *āpana*—His own; *bhāva*—mood; *kahaye*—speaks; *ughāḍi'*—exuberantly.

TRANSLATION

At night He talked incoherently in grief with His arms around Svarūpa Dāmodara's neck. He spoke out His heart in ecstatic inspiration.

TEXT 110

yabe yei bhāva uṭhe prabhura antara

sei gīti-sloke sukha dena dāmodara

SYNONYMS

yabe—when; *yei*—that; *bhāva*—mood; *uṭhe*—arises; *prabhura*—of Lord

Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *antara*—in the heart; *sei*—that; *gīti*—by the song; *śloke*—or verse; *sukha*—happiness; *dena*—gives; *dāmodara*—Svarūpa Dāmodara.

TRANSLATION

Whenever a particular sentiment arose in His heart, Svarūpa Dāmodara satisfied Him by singing songs or reciting verses of the same nature.

TEXT 111

ebe kārya nāhi kichu e-saba vicāre

āge ihā vivariba kariyā vistāre

SYNONYMS

ebe—now; *kārya*—business; *nāhi*—there is not; *kichu*—any; *e-saba*—all these; *vicāre*—in the considerations; *āge*—ahead; *ihā*—this; *vivariba*—I shall describe; *kariyā*—doing; *vistāre*—in expanded detail.

TRANSLATION

To analyze these pastimes is not necessary now. Later I shall describe them in detail.

TEXT 112

pūrve vraje kṛṣṇera tri-vidha vayo-dharma

kaumāra, paugaṇḍa, āra kaiśora atimarma

SYNONYMS

pūrve—previously; *vraje*—in Vraja; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tri-*

vidha—three sorts; *vayaḥ-dharma*—characteristics of age; *kaumāra*—childhood; *paugaṇḍa*—boyhood; *āra*—and; *kaiśora*—adolescence; *ati-marma*—the very core.

TRANSLATION

Formerly in Vraja Lord Kṛṣṇa displayed three ages, namely childhood, boyhood and adolescence. His adolescence is especially significant.

TEXT 113

vātsalya-āveśe kaila kaumāra saphala

paugaṇḍa saphala kaila lañā sakhāvala

SYNONYMS

vātsalya—of parental love; *āveśe*—in the attachment; *kaila*—made; *kaumāra*—childhood; *sa-phala*—fruitful; *paugaṇḍa*—boyhood; *sa-phala*—fruitful; *kaila*—made; *lañā*—taking along; *sakhā-āvala*—friends.

TRANSLATION

Parental affection made His childhood fruitful. His boyhood was successful with His friends.

TEXT 114

rādhikādi lañā kaila rāsādi-vilāsa

vāñchā bhari' āsvādila rasera niryāsa

SYNONYMS

rādhikā-ādi—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī and the other *gopīs*; *lañā*—taking along;

kaila—did; *rāsa-ādi*—beginning with the *rāsa* dance; *vilāsa*—pastimes; *vāñchā bhari'*—fulfilling desires; *āsvādila*—He tasted; *rasera*—of mellow; *niryāsa*—the essence.

TRANSLATION

In youth He tasted the essence of rasa, fulfilling His desires in pastimes like the rāsa dance with Śrīmatī Rādhikā and the other gopīs.

TEXT 115

kaiśora-vayase kāma, jagat-sakala

rāsādi-lilāya tina karila saphala

SYNONYMS

kaiśora-vayase—in the adolescent age; *kāma*—amorous love; *jagat-sakala*—the entire universe; *rāsa-ādi*—such as the *rāsa* dance; *lilāya*—by pastimes; *tina*—three; *karila*—made; *sa-phala*—successful.

TRANSLATION

In His youth Lord Kṛṣṇa made all three of His ages, and the entire universe, successful by His pastimes of amorous love like the rāsa dance.

TEXT 116

so 'pi kaiśoraka-vayo

mānayan madhusūdanaḥ

reme strī-ratna-kūṭa-sthaḥ

kṣapāsu kṣapitāhitaḥ

SYNONYMS

saḥ—He; *api*—especially; *kaiśoraka-vayaḥ*—the age of adolescence; *mānayan*—honoring; *madhu-sūdanaḥ*—the killer of the Madhu demon; *reme*—enjoyed; *strī-ratna*—of the gopīs; *kūṭa*—in multitudes; *sthaḥ*—situated; *kṣapāsu*—in the autumn nights; *kṣapita-ahitaḥ*—who destroys misfortune.

TRANSLATION

“Lord Madhusūdana enjoyed His youth with pastimes on autumn nights in the midst of the jewellike milkmaids. Thus He dispelled all the misfortunes of the world.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* (5.13.60).

TEXT 117

vācā sūcīta-śarvarī-ratī-kalā-prāgalbhyayā rādhikām
vrīḍā-kuñcīta-locanām viracayann agre sakhīnām asau
tad-vakṣo-ruha-citra-kelī-makarī-pāṇḍitya-pāram gataḥ
kaiśoram saphalī-karoti kalayan kuñje vihāram hariḥ

SYNONYMS

vācā—by speech; *sūcīta*—revealing; *śarvarī*—of the night; *ratī*—in amorous pastimes; *kalā*—of the portion; *prāgalbhyayā*—the importance; *rādhikām*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *vrīḍā*—from shame; *kuñcīta-locanām*—having Her eyes closed; *viracayan*—making; *agre*—before; *sakhīnām*—Her friends; *asau*—that one; *tad*—of Her; *vakṣaḥ-ruha*—on the breasts;

citra-keli—with variegated pastimes; *makarī*—in drawing dolphins; *pāṇḍitya*—of cleverness; *pāram*—the limit; *gataḥ*—who reached; *kaiśoram*—adolescence; *sa-phalī-karoti*—makes successful; *kalayan*—performing; *kuñje*—in the bushes; *vihāram*—pastimes; *hariḥ*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

“Lord Kṛṣṇa made Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī close Her eyes in shame before Her friends by His words relating Their amorous activities on the previous night. Then He showed the highest limit of cleverness in drawing pictures of dolphins in various playful sports on Her breasts. In this way Lord Hari made His youth successful by performing pastimes in the bushes with Śrī Rādhā and Her friends.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (2.1.231) of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 118

harir eṣa na ced avātariṣyan

mathurāyām madhurākṣi rādhikā ca

abhaviṣyad iyaṁ vṛthā viśṛṣṭir

makarāṅkas tu viśeṣatas tadātra

SYNONYMS

hariḥ—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *eṣaḥ*—this; *na*—not; *cet*—if; *avātariṣyat*—would have descended; *mathurāyām*—in Mathurā; *madhura-akṣi*—O lovely-eyed one (Paurṇamāsī); *rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhikā; *ca*—and;

abhaviṣyat—would have been; *iyam*—this; *vr̥thā*—useless; *viṣṣṭiḥ*—the whole creation; *makara-aṅkaḥ*—the demigod of love, Cupid; *tu*—then; *viśeṣataḥ*—above all; *tadā*—then; *atra*—in this.

TRANSLATION

“O Paurṇamāsī, if Lord Hari had not descended in Mathurā with Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, this entire creation—and especially Cupid, the demigod of love—would have been useless.”

PURPORT

This verse is spoken by Śrī Vṛndā-devī in the *Vidagdha-mādhava* (7.3) of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXTS 119–120

ei mata pūrve kṛṣṇa rasera sadana

yadyapi karila rasa-niryāsa-carvaṇa

tathāpi nahila tina vāñchita pūraṇa

tāhā āsvādite yadi karila yatana

SYNONYMS

ei mata—like this; *pūrve*—previously; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *rasera*—of mellows; *sadana*—the reservoir; *yadyapi*—even though; *karila*—did; *rasa*—of the mellows; *niryāsa*—the essence; *carvaṇa*—chewing; *tathāpi*—still; *nahila*—was not; *tina*—three; *vāñchita*—desired objects; *pūraṇa*—fulfilling; *tāhā*—that; *āsvādite*—to taste; *yadi*—though; *karila*—were made; *yatana*—efforts.

TRANSLATION

Even though Lord Kṛṣṇa, the abode of all mellows, had previously in this way chewed the essence of the mellows of love, still He was unable to fulfill three desires, although He made efforts to taste them.

TEXT 121

tāñhāra prathama vāñchā kariye vyākhyāna

kṛṣṇa kahe, — — ‘āmi ha-i rasera nidāna

SYNONYMS

tāñhāra—His; *prathama*—first; *vāñchā*—desire; *kariye*—I do; *vyākhyāna*—explanation; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kahe*—says; *āmi*—I; *ha-i*—am; *rasera*—of mellow; *nidāna*—primary cause.

TRANSLATION

I shall explain His first desire. Kṛṣṇa says, “I am the primary cause of all rasas.

TEXT 122

pūrṇānanda-maya āmi cīn-maya pūrṇa-tattva

rādhikāra preme āmā karāya unmatta

SYNONYMS

pūrṇa-ānanda-maya—made of full joy; *āmi*—I; *cīn-maya*—spiritual; *pūrṇa-tattva*—full of truth; *rādhikāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *preme*—the love; *āmā*—Me; *karāya*—makes; *unmatta*—maddened.

TRANSLATION

“I am the full spiritual truth and am made of full joy, but the love of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī drives Me mad.

TEXT 123

nā jāni rādhāra preme āche kata bala

ye bale āmāre kare sarvadā vihvala

SYNONYMS

nā jāni—I do not know; *rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *preme*—in the love; *āche*—there is; *kata*—how much; *bala*—strength; *ye*—which; *bale*—strength; *āmāre*—Me; *kare*—makes; *sarvadā*—always; *vihvala*—overwhelmed.

TRANSLATION

“I do not know the strength of Rādhā’s love, with which She always overwhelms Me.

TEXT 124

rādhikāra prema—guru, āmi—śiṣya naṭa

sadā āmā nānā nṛtye nācāya udbhaṭa

SYNONYMS

rādhikāra—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *prema*—the love; *guru*—teacher; *āmi*—I; *śiṣya*—disciple; *naṭa*—dancer; *sadā*—always; *āmā*—Me; *nānā*—various; *nṛtye*—in dances; *nācāya*—causes to dance; *udbhaṭa*—novel.

TRANSLATION

“The love of Rādhikā is My teacher, and I am Her dancing pupil. Her prema makes Me dance various novel dances.”

TEXT 125

kasmād vṛnde priya-sakhi hareḥ pāda-mūlāt kuto 'sau

kuṇḍāraṇye kim iha kurute nṛtya-sīkṣām guruḥ kaḥ

taṁ tvan-mūrtiḥ prati-taru-lataṁ dig-vidikṣu sphuranti

śailūṣīva bhramati parito nartayanti sva-paścāt

SYNONYMS

kasmāt—from where; *vṛnde*—O Vṛndā; *priyā-sakhi*—O dear friend; *hareḥ*—of Lord Hari; *pāda-mūlāt*—from the lotus feet; *kutaḥ*—where; *asau*—that one (Lord Kṛṣṇa); *kuṇḍa-araṇye*—in the forest on the bank of Rādhā-kuṇḍa; *kim*—what; *iha*—here; *kurute*—He does; *nṛtya-sīkṣām*—dancing practice; *guruḥ*—teacher; *kaḥ*—who; *taṁ*—Him; *tvat-mūrtiḥ*—Your form; *prati-taru-lataṁ*—on every tree and vine; *dik-vidikṣu*—in all directions; *sphuranti*—appearing; *śailūṣī*—expert dancer; *iva*—like; *bhramati*—wanders; *paritaḥ*—all around; *nartayanti*—causing to dance; *sva-paścāt*—behind.

TRANSLATION

“O my beloved friend Vṛndā, where are you coming from?”

“I am coming from the feet of Śrī Hari.”

“Where is He?”

“In the forest on the bank of Rādhā-kuṇḍa.”

“What is He doing there?”

“He is learning dancing.”

“Who is His master?”

“Your image, Rādhā, revealing itself in every tree and creeper in every direction, is roaming like a skillful dancer, making Him dance behind.”

PURPORT

This text is from the *Govinda-līlāmṛta* (8.77) of Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TEXT 126

nija-premāsvāde mora haya ye āhlāda

tāhā ha'te koṭi-guṇa rādhā-premāsvāda

SYNONYMS

nija—own; *prema*—love; *āsvāde*—in tasting; *mora*—My; *haya*—there is; *ye*—whatever; *āhlāda*—pleasure; *tāhā ha'te*—than that; *koṭi-guṇa*—ten million times greater; *rādhā*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *prema-āsvāda*—the tasting of love.

TRANSLATION

“Whatever pleasure I get from tasting My love for Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, She tastes ten million times more than Me by Her love.

TEXT 127

āmi yaiche paraspara viruddha-dharmāśraya

rādhā-prema taiche sadā viruddha-dharma-maya

SYNONYMS

āmi—I; *yaiche*—just as; *paraspara*—mutually; *viruddha-dharma*—of conflicting characteristics; *āśraya*—the abode; *rādhā-prema*—the love of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *taiche*—just so; *sadā*—always; *viruddha-dharma-maya*—consists of conflicting characteristics.

TRANSLATION

“Just as I am the abode of all mutually contradictory characteristics, so Rādhā’s love is always full of similar contradictions.

TEXT 128

rādhā-premā vibhu—yāra bāḍite nāhi ṭhāñi

tathāpi se kṣaṇe kṣaṇe bāḍaye sadāi

SYNONYMS

rādhā-premā—the love of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *vibhu*—all-pervading; *yāra*—of which; *bāḍite*—to increase; *nāhi*—there is not; *ṭhāñi*—space; *tathāpi*—still; *se*—that; *kṣaṇe kṣaṇe*—every second; *bāḍaye*—increases; *sadāi*—always.

TRANSLATION

“Rādhā’s love is all-pervading, leaving no room for expansion. But still it is expanding constantly.

TEXT 129

yāhā va-i guru vastu nāhi sunīścita

tathāpi gurura dharma gaurava-varjita

SYNONYMS

yāhā—which; *va-i*—besides; *guru*—great; *vastu*—thing; *nāhi*—there is not; *sunīścita*—quite certainly; *tathāpi*—still; *gurura*—of greatness; *dharma*—characteristics; *gaurava-varjita*—devoid of pride.

TRANSLATION

“There is certainly nothing greater than Her love. But Her love is devoid of pride. That is the sign of its greatness.

TEXT 130

yāhā haite sunirmala dvitīya nāhi āra

tathāpi sarvadā vāmya-vakra-vyavahāra

SYNONYMS

yāhā haite—than which; *su-nirmala*—very pure; *dvitīya*—second; *nāhi*—there is not; *āra*—another; *tathāpi*—still; *sarvadā*—always; *vāmya*—perverse; *vakra*—crooked; *vyavahāra*—behavior.

TRANSLATION

“Nothing is purer than Her love. But its behavior is always perverse and crooked.”

TEXT 131

vibhur api kalayan sadābhivṛddhim

gurur api gaurava-caryayā vihīnaḥ

muhur upacita-vakrimāpi śuddho

jayati mura-dviṣi rādhikānurāgaḥ

SYNONYMS

vibhuḥ—all-pervading; *api*—although; *kalayan*—making; *sadā*—always; *abhivṛddhim*—increase; *guruḥ*—important; *api*—although; *gaurava-caryayā vihīnaḥ*—without proud behavior; *muhuḥ*—again and again; *upacita*—increased; *vakrimā*—duplicity; *api*—although; *śuddhaḥ*—pure; *jayati*—all glories to; *mura-dviṣi*—for Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of the demon Mura; *rādhikā*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *anurāgaḥ*—the love.

TRANSLATION

“All glories to Rādhā’s love for Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of the demon Mura! Although it is all-pervading, it tends to increase at every moment. Although it is important, it is devoid of pride. And although it is pure, it is always beset with duplicity.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Dāna-keli-kaumudī* (2) of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 132

sei premāra śrī-rādhikā parama ‘āśraya’

sei premāra āmi ha-i kevala ‘viṣaya’

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *premāra*—of the love; *śrī-rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *parama*—highest; *āśraya*—abode; *sei*—that; *premāra*—of the love; *āmi*—I; *ha-i*—am; *kevala*—only; *viṣaya*—object.

TRANSLATION

“Śrī Rādhikā is the highest abode of that love, and I am its only object.

TEXT 133

viṣaya-jātīya sukha āmāra āsvāda

āmā haite koṭi-guṇa āśrayera āhlāda

SYNONYMS

viṣaya-jātīya—relating to the object; *sukha*—happiness; *āmāra*—My; *āsvāda*—tasting; *āmā haite*—than Me; *koṭi-guṇa*—ten million times more; *āśrayera*—of the abode; *āhlāda*—pleasure.

TRANSLATION

“I taste the bliss to which the object of love is entitled. But the pleasure of Rādhā, the abode of that love, is ten million times greater.

TEXT 134

āśraya-jātīya sukha pāite mana dhāya

yatne āsvādite nāri, ki kari upāya

SYNONYMS

āśraya-jātīya—relating to the abode; *sukha*—happiness; *pāite*—to obtain; *mana*—the mind; *dhāya*—chases; *yatne*—by effort; *āsvādite*—to taste; *nāri*—I am unable; *ki*—what; *kari*—I do; *upāya*—way.

TRANSLATION

“My mind races to taste the pleasure experienced by the abode, but I cannot taste it, even by My best efforts. How may I taste it?”

TEXT 135

kabhu yadi ei premāra ha-iye āśraya

tabe ei premānandera anubhava haya

SYNONYMS

kabhu—sometime; *yadi*—if; *ei*—this; *premāra*—of the love; *ha-iye*—I become; *āśraya*—the abode; *tabe*—then; *ei*—this; *prema-ānandera*—of the joy of love; *anubhava*—experience; *haya*—there is.

TRANSLATION

“If sometime I can be the abode of that love, only then may I taste its joy.”

PURPORT

Viśaya and *āśraya* are two very significant words relating to the reciprocation between Kṛṣṇa and His devotee. The devotee is called the *āśraya*, and his beloved, Kṛṣṇa, is the *viśaya*. Different ingredients are involved in the exchange of love between the *āśraya* and *viśaya*, which are known as *vibhāva*, *anubhāva*, *sāttvika* and *vyabhicārī*. *Vibhāva* is divided into the two categories *ālambana* and *uddīpana*. *Ālambana* may be further divided into *āśraya* and *viśaya*. In the loving affairs of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, Rādhārāṇī is the *āśraya* feature and Kṛṣṇa the *viśaya*. The transcendental consciousness of the Lord tells Him, “I am Kṛṣṇa, and I experience pleasure as the *viśaya*. The pleasure enjoyed by Rādhārāṇī, the *āśraya*, is many times greater than the pleasure I feel.” Therefore, to feel the pleasure of the *āśraya* category, Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 136

eta cinti' rahe kṛṣṇa parama-kautukī

hṛdaye bāḍaye prema-lobha dhakdhakī

SYNONYMS

eta cinti'—thinking this; *rahe*—remains; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *parama-kautukī*—the supremely curious; *hṛdaye*—in the heart; *bāḍaye*—increases; *prema-lobha*—eager desire for love; *dhakdhakī*—blazing.

TRANSLATION

Thinking in this way, Lord Kṛṣṇa was curious to taste that love. His eager desire for that love increasingly blazed in His heart.

TEXT 137

ei eka, śuna āra lobhera prakāra

sva-mādhurya dekhi' kṛṣṇa karena vicāra

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *eka*—one; *śuna*—please hear; *āra*—another; *lobhera*—of eager desire; *prakāra*—type; *sva-mādhurya*—own sweetness; *dekhi'*—seeing; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karena*—does; *vicāra*—consideration.

TRANSLATION

That is one desire. Now please hear of another. Seeing His own beauty, Lord Kṛṣṇa began to consider.

TEXT 138

adbhuta, ananta, pūrṇa mora madhurimā

tri-jagate ihāra keha nāhi pāya sīmā

SYNONYMS

adbhuta—wonderful; *ananta*—unlimited; *pūrṇa*—full; *mora*—My; *madhurimā*—sweetness; *tri-jagate*—in the three worlds; *ihāra*—of this; *keha*—someone; *nāhi*—not; *pāya*—obtains; *sīmā*—limit.

TRANSLATION

“My sweetness is wonderful, infinite and full. No one in the three worlds can find its limit.

TEXT 139

ei prema-dvāre nitya rādhikā ekali

āmāra mādihuryāmṛta āsvāde sakali

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *prema-dvāre*—by means of the love; *nitya*—always; *rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *ekali*—only; *āmāra*—of Me; *mādihurya-amṛta*—the nectar of the sweetness; *āsvāde*—tastes; *sakali*—all.

TRANSLATION

“Only Rādhikā, by the strength of Her love, tastes all the nectar of My sweetness.

TEXT 140

yadyapi nirmala rādhāra sat-prema-darpaṇa

tathāpi svacchatā tāra bāḍhe kṣaṇe kṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *nirmala*—pure; *rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *sat-prema*—of real love; *darpaṇa*—the mirror; *tathāpi*—still; *svacchatā*—transparency; *tāra*—of that; *bāḍhe*—increases; *kṣaṇe kṣaṇa*—every moment.

TRANSLATION

“Although Rādhā’s love is pure like a mirror, its purity increases at every moment.

TEXT 141

āmāra mādhyura nāhi bāḍhite avakāśe

e-darpaṇera āge nava nava rūpe bhāse

SYNONYMS

āmāra—of Me; *mādhyura*—sweetness; *nāhi*—not; *bāḍhite*—to increase; *avakāśe*—opportunity; *e-darpaṇera āge*—in front of this mirror; *nava nava*—newer and newer; *rūpe*—in beauty; *bhāse*—shines.

TRANSLATION

“My sweetness also has no room for expansion, yet it shines before that mirror in newer and newer beauty.

TEXT 142

man-mādhyura rādhāra prema—donhe hoḍa kari’

kṣaṇe kṣaṇe bāḍe donhe, keha nāhi hāri

SYNONYMS

mat-mādhurya—My sweetness; *rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *prema*—the love; *donhe*—both together; *hoḍa kari'*—challenging; *kṣaṇe kṣaṇe*—every second; *bāḍe*—increase; *donhe*—both; *keha nāhi*—no one; *hāri*—defeated.

TRANSLATION

“There is constant competition between My sweetness and the mirror of Rādhā’s love. They both go on increasing, but neither knows defeat.

TEXT 143

āmāra mādhurya nitya nava nava haya

sva-sva-prema-anurūpa bhakte āsvādaya

SYNONYMS

āmāra—of Me; *mādhurya*—the sweetness; *nitya*—always; *nava nava*—newer and newer; *haya*—is; *sva-sva-prema-anurūpa*—according to one’s own love; *bhakte*—the devotee; *āsvādaya*—tastes.

TRANSLATION

“My sweetness is always newer and newer. Devotees taste it according to their own respective love.

TEXT 144

darpaṇādye dekhi' yadi āpana mādhuri

āsvādite haya lobha, āsvādite nāri

SYNONYMS

darpaṇa-ādye—beginning in a mirror; *dekhi'*—seeing; *yadi*—if; *āpana*—own; *mādhurī*—sweetness; *āsvādite*—to taste; *haya*—there is; *lobha*—desire; *āsvādite*—to taste; *nāri*—I am not able.

TRANSLATION

“If I see My sweetness in a mirror, I am tempted to taste it, but nevertheless I cannot.

TEXT 145

vicāra kariye yadi āsvāda-upāya

rādhikā-svarūpa ha-ite tabe mana dhāya

SYNONYMS

vicāra—consideration; *kariye*—I do; *yadi*—if; *āsvāda*—to taste; *upāya*—way; *rādhikā-svarūpa*—the nature of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *ha-ite*—to become; *tabe*—then; *mana*—mind; *dhāya*—chases.

TRANSLATION

“If I deliberate on a way to taste it, I find that I hanker for the position of Rādhikā.”

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇa’s attractiveness is wonderful and unlimited. No one can know the end of it. Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī alone can relish such extensiveness from Her position in the *āśraya* category. The mirror of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī’s

transcendental love is perfectly clear, yet it appears clearer and clearest in the transcendental method of understanding Kṛṣṇa. In the mirror of Rādhārāṇī's heart, the transcendental features of Kṛṣṇa appear increasingly new and fresh. In other words, the attraction of Kṛṣṇa increases in proportion to the understanding of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. Each tries to supersede the other. Neither wants to be defeated in increasing the intensity of love. Desiring to understand Rādhārāṇī's attitude of increasing love, Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 146

aparikalita-pūrvah kaś camatkāra-kārī

sphurati mama garīyān eṣa mādhyura-pūrah

ayam aham api hanta prekṣya yaṁ lubdha-cetāḥ

sarabhasam upabhoktum kāmaya rādhikeva

SYNONYMS

aparikalita—not experienced; *pūrvah*—previously; *kaḥ*—who; *camatkāra-kārī*—causing wonder; *sphurati*—manifests; *mama*—My; *garīyān*—more great; *eṣaḥ*—this; *mādhyura-pūrah*—abundance of sweetness; *ayam*—this; *aham*—I; *api*—even; *hanta*—alas; *prekṣya*—seeing; *yaṁ*—which; *lubdha-cetāḥ*—My mind being bewildered; *sarabhasam*—impetuously; *upabhoktum*—to enjoy; *kāmaya*—desire; *rādhikā iva*—like Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

TRANSLATION

“Who manifests an abundance of sweetness greater than Mine, which has never been experienced before and which causes wonder to all? Alas, I Myself, My mind bewildered upon seeing this beauty, impetuously desire to enjoy it like Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.”

PURPORT

This text is from the *Lalita-mādhava* (8.34) of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī. It was spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa when He saw the beauty of His own reflection in a jeweled fountain in Dvārakā.

TEXT 147

kṛṣṇa-mādhuryera eka svābhāvika bala

kṛṣṇa-ādi nara-nārī karaye cañcala

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mādhuryera*—of the sweetness; *eka*—one; *svābhāvika*—natural; *bala*—strength; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ādi*—beginning with; *nara-nārī*—men and women; *karaye*—makes; *cañcala*—perturbed.

TRANSLATION

The beauty of Kṛṣṇa has one natural strength: it thrills the hearts of all men and women, beginning with Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself.

TEXT 148

śravaṇe, darśane ākarṣaye sarva-mana

āpanā āsvādite kṛṣṇa karena yatana

SYNONYMS

śravaṇe—in hearing; *darśane*—in seeing; *ākarṣaye*—attracts; *sarva-mana*—all minds; *āpanā*—Himself; *āsvādite*—to taste; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karena*—makes; *yatana*—efforts.

TRANSLATION

All minds are attracted by hearing His sweet voice and flute, or by seeing His beauty. Even Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself makes efforts to taste that sweetness.

TEXT 149

e mādihuryāmṛta pāna sadā yei kare

tr̥ṣṇā-sānti nahe, tr̥ṣṇā bādhe nirantare

SYNONYMS

e—this; *mādhurya-amṛta*—nectar of sweetness; *pāna*—drinks; *sadā*—always; *yei*—that person who; *kare*—does; *tr̥ṣṇā-sānti*—satisfaction of thirst; *nahe*—there is not; *tr̥ṣṇā*—thirst; *bādhe*—increases; *nirantare*—constantly.

TRANSLATION

The thirst of one who always drinks the nectar of that sweetness is never satisfied. Rather, that thirst increases constantly.

TEXT 150

atr̥pta ha-iyā kare vidhira nindana

avidagdha vidhi bhāla nā jāne sṛjana

SYNONYMS

atr̥pta—unsatisfied; *ha-iyā*—being; *kare*—do; *vidhira*—of Lord Brahmā; *nindana*—blaspheming; *avidagdha*—inexperienced; *vidhi*—Lord Brahmā; *bhāla*—well; *nā jāne*—does not know; *sṛjana*—creating.

TRANSLATION

Such a person, being unsatisfied, begins to blaspheme Lord Brahmā, saying that he does not know the art of creating well and is simply inexperienced.

TEXT 151

koṭi netra nāhi dila, sabe dila dui

tāhāte nimeṣa,——kṛṣṇa ki dekhiba muñi

SYNONYMS

koṭi—ten million; *netra*—eyes; *nāhi dila*—did not give; *sabe*—to all; *dila*—gave; *dui*—two; *tāhāte*—in that; *nimeṣa*—a blink; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ki*—how; *dekhiba*—shall see; *muñi*—I.

TRANSLATION

He has not given millions of eyes to see the beauty of Kṛṣṇa. He has given only two eyes, and even those eyes blink. How then shall I see the lovely face of Kṛṣṇa?

TEXT 152

aṭati yad bhavān ahni kānanam

truṭir yugāyate tvām apaśyatām

kuṭila-kuntalam śrī-mukham ca te

jaḍa udikṣatām pakṣma-kṛd dṛśām

SYNONYMS

aṭati—goes; *yat*—when; *bhavān*—Your Lordship; *ahni*—in the day; *kānanam*—to the forest; *truṭiḥ*—half a second; *yugāyate*—appears like a *yuga*; *tvām*—You; *apaśyatām*—of those not seeing; *kuṭīla-kuntalam*—adorned with curled hair; *śrī-mukham*—beautiful face; *ca*—and; *te*—Your; *jaḍaḥ*—stupid; *udīkṣatām*—looking at; *pakṣma-kṛt*—the maker of eyelashes; *drśām*—of the eyes.

TRANSLATION

[The *gopīs* said:] “O Kṛṣṇa, when You go to the forest during the day and we do not see Your sweet face, which is surrounded by beautiful curling hair, half a second becomes as long as an entire age for us. And we consider the creator, who has put eyelids on the eyes we use for seeing You, to be simply a fool.”

PURPORT

This verse is spoken by the *gopīs* in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.31.15).

TEXT 153

gopyaś ca kṛṣṇam upalabhya cirād abhīṣṭam

yat-prekṣaṇe drśīṣu pakṣma-kṛtam śapanti

dr̥gbhir hṛdī-kṛtam alam parirabhya sarvās

tad-bhāvam āpur api nitya-yujām durāpam

SYNONYMS

gopyaḥ—the *gopīs*; *ca*—and; *kṛṣṇam*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *upalabhya*—seeing; *cirāt*—after a long time; *abhīṣṭam*—desired object; *yat-prekṣaṇe*—in the seeing of whom; *drśīṣu*—in the eyes; *pakṣma-kṛtam*—the maker of eyelashes; *śapanti*—curse; *dr̥gbhiḥ*—with the eyes; *hṛdī kṛtam*—who

entered the hearts; *alam*—enough; *parirabhya*—embracing; *sarvāḥ*—all; *tat-bhāvam*—that highest stage of joy; *āpuḥ*—obtained; *api*—although; *nitya-yujām*—by perfected *yogīs*; *durāpam*—difficult to obtain.

TRANSLATION

“The gopīs saw their beloved Kṛṣṇa at Kurukṣetra after a long separation. They secured and embraced Him in their hearts through their eyes, and they attained a joy so intense that not even perfect yogīs can attain it. The gopīs cursed the creator for creating eyelids that interfered with their vision.”

PURPORT

This text is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.82.39).

TEXT 154

kṛṣṇāvalokana vinā netra phala nāhi āna

yei jana kṛṣṇa dekhe, sei bhāgyavān

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avalokana*—looking at; *vinā*—without; *netra*—the eyes; *phala*—fruit; *nāhi*—not; *āna*—other; *yei*—who; *jana*—the person; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dekhe*—sees; *sei*—he; *bhāgyavān*—very fortunate.

TRANSLATION

There is no consummation for the eyes other than the sight of Kṛṣṇa. Whoever sees Him is most fortunate indeed.

TEXT 155

akṣaṇvatām phalam idam na param vidāmaḥ

sakhyaiḥ paśūn anuviveśayator vayasyaiḥ

vaktram vrajeśa-sutayor anuveṇu-juṣṭam

yair vā nipītam anurakta-kaṭākṣa-mokṣam

SYNONYMS

akṣaṇvatām—of those who have eyes; *phalam*—the fruit; *idam*—this; *na*—not; *param*—other; *vidāmaḥ*—we know; *sakhyaiḥ*—O friends; *paśūn*—the cows; *anuviveśayatoḥ*—causing to enter one forest from another; *vayasyaiḥ*—with Their friends of the same age; *vaktram*—the faces; *vraja-īśa*—of Mahārāja Nanda; *sutayoḥ*—of the two sons; *anuveṇu-juṣṭam*—possessed of flutes; *yaiḥ*—by which; *vā*—or; *nipītam*—imbibed; *anurakta*—loving; *kaṭa-akṣa*—glances; *mokṣam*—giving off.

TRANSLATION

[The gopīs said:] “O friends, those eyes that see the beautiful faces of the sons of Mahārāja Nanda are certainly fortunate. As these two sons enter the forest, surrounded by Their friends, driving the cows before Them, They hold Their flutes to Their mouths and glance lovingly upon the residents of Vṛndāvana. For those who have eyes, we think there is no greater object of vision.”

PURPORT

Like the *gopīs*, one can see Kṛṣṇa continuously if one is fortunate enough. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* it is said that sages whose eyes have been smeared with the ointment of pure love can see the form of Śyāmasundara (Kṛṣṇa) continuously in the centers of their hearts. This text from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.21.7) was sung by the *gopīs* on the

advent of the *śarat* season.

TEXT 156

gopyas tapaḥ kim acarān yad amuṣya rūpam

lāvaṇya-sāram asamordhvam ananya-siddham

ḍṛgbhiḥ pibanty anusavābhinavam durāpam

ekānta-dhāma yaśasaḥ śriya aiśvarasya

SYNONYMS

gopyaḥ—the *gopīs*; *tapaḥ*—austerities; *kim*—what; *acarān*—performed; *yad*—from which; *amuṣya*—of such a one (Lord Kṛṣṇa); *rūpam*—the form; *lāvaṇya-sāram*—the essence of loveliness; *asama-ūrdhvam*—not paralleled or surpassed; *ananya-siddham*—not perfected by any other ornament (self-perfect); *ḍṛgbhiḥ*—by the eyes; *pibanti*—they drink; *anusava-abhinavam*—constantly new; *durāpam*—difficult to obtain; *ekānta-dhāma*—the only abode; *yaśasaḥ*—of fame; *śriyaḥ*—of beauty; *aiśvarasya*—of opulence.

TRANSLATION

[The women of Mathurā said:] “What austerities must the *gopīs* have performed? With their eyes they always drink the nectar of the form of Lord Kṛṣṇa, which is the essence of loveliness and is not to be equaled or surpassed. That loveliness is the only abode of beauty, fame and opulence. It is self-perfect, ever fresh and extremely rare.”

PURPORT

This text from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.44.14) was spoken by the women of Mathurā when they saw Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma in the arena with King

Kaṁsa's great wrestlers Muṣṭika and Cāṇūra.

TEXT 157

apūrva mādhurī kṛṣṇera, apūrva tāra bala

yāhāra śravaṇe mana haya ṭalamala

SYNONYMS

apūrva—unprecedented; *mādhurī*—sweetness; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *apūrva*—unprecedented; *tāra*—of that; *bala*—the strength; *yāhāra*—of which; *śravaṇe*—in hearing; *mana*—the mind; *haya*—becomes; *ṭalamala*—unsteady.

TRANSLATION

The sweetness of Lord Kṛṣṇa is unprecedented, and its strength is also unprecedented. Simply by one's hearing of such beauty, the mind becomes unsteady.

TEXT 158

kṛṣṇera mādhurye kṛṣṇe upajaya lobha

samyak āsvādite nāre, mane rahe kṣobha

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mādhurye*—in the sweetness; *kṛṣṇe*—in Lord Kṛṣṇa; *upajaya*—arises; *lobha*—eager desire; *samyak*—fully; *āsvādite*—to taste; *nāre*—is not able; *mane*—in the mind; *rahe*—remains; *kṣobha*—sorrow.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa's own beauty attracts Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself. But because He cannot fully enjoy it, His mind remains full of sorrow.

TEXT 159

ei ta' dvitīya hetura kahila vivaraṇa

tṛtīya hetura ebe śunaha lakṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ta'*—certainly; *dvitīya*—second; *hetura*—of the reason; *kahila*—has been said; *vivaraṇa*—description; *tṛtīya*—the third; *hetura*—of the reason; *ebe*—now; *śunaha*—please hear; *lakṣaṇa*—the characteristic.

TRANSLATION

This is a description of His second desire. Now please listen as I describe the third.

TEXT 160

atyanta-nigūḍha ei rasera siddhānta

svarūpa-gosāñi mātra jānena ekānta

SYNONYMS

atyanta—extremely; *nigūḍha*—deep; *ei*—this; *rasera*—of mellow; *siddhānta*—conclusion; *svarūpa-gosāñi*—Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī; *mātra*—only; *jānena*—knows; *ekānta*—much.

TRANSLATION

This conclusion of rasa is extremely deep. Only Svarūpa Dāmodara knows much about it.

TEXT 161

yebā keha anya jāne, seho tāñhā haite

caitanya-gosāñīra teñha atyanta marma yāte

SYNONYMS

yebā—whoever; *keha*—someone; *anya*—other; *jāne*—knows; *seho*—he; *tāñhā haite*—from him (Svarūpa Dāmodara); *caitanya-gosāñīra*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *teñha*—he; *atyanta*—extremely; *marma*—secret core; *yāte*—since.

TRANSLATION

Anyone else who claims to know it must have heard it from him, for he was the most intimate companion of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 162

gopī-gaṇera premera ‘rūḍha-bhāva’ nāma

viśuddha nirmala prema, kabhu nahe kāma

SYNONYMS

gopī-gaṇera—of the *gopīs*; *premera*—of the love; *rūḍha-bhāva*—*rūḍha-bhāva*; *nāma*—named; *viśuddha*—pure; *nirmala*—spotless; *prema*—love; *kabhu*—at anytime; *nahe*—is not; *kāma*—lust.

TRANSLATION

The love of the gopīs is called rūḍha-bhāva. It is pure and spotless. It is not at any time lust.

PURPORT

As already explained, the position of the *gopīs* in their loving dealings with Kṛṣṇa is transcendental. Their emotion is called *rūḍha-bhāva*. Although it is apparently like mundane sex, one should not confuse it with mundane sexual love, for it is pure and unadulterated love of Godhead.

TEXT 163

premaiva gopa-rāmānām

kāma ity agamat prathām

ity uddhavādayo 'py etam

vāñchanti bhagavat-priyāḥ

SYNONYMS

prema—love; *eva*—only; *gopa-rāmānām*—of the women of Vraja; *kāmaḥ*—lust; *iti*—as; *agamat*—went to; *prathām*—fame; *iti*—thus; *uddhava-ādayaḥ*—headed by Śrī Uddhava; *api*—even; *etam*—this; *vāñchanti*—desire; *bhagavat-priyāḥ*—dear devotees of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

“The pure love of the gopīs has become celebrated by the name ‘lust.’ The dear devotees of the Lord, headed by Śrī Uddhava, desire to taste that love.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (1.2.285).

TEXT 164

kāma, prema, — — doṇhākāra vibhinna lakṣaṇa

lauha āra hema yaiche svarūpe vilakṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

kāma—lust; *prema*—love; *doṇhākāra*—of the two; *vibhinna*—separate; *lakṣaṇa*—symptoms; *lauha*—iron; *āra*—and; *hema*—gold; *yaiche*—just as; *svarūpe*—in nature; *vilakṣaṇa*—different.

TRANSLATION

Lust and love have different characteristics, just as iron and gold have different natures.

PURPORT

One should try to discriminate between sexual love and pure love, for they belong to different categories, with a gulf of difference between them. They are as different from one another as iron is from gold.

TEXT 165

ātmendriya-prīti-vāñchā — — tāre bali ‘kāma’

kṛṣṇendriya-prīti-icchā dhare ‘prema’ nāma

SYNONYMS

ātma-indriya-prīti—for the pleasure of one’s own senses; *vāñchā*—desires; *tāre*—to that; *bali*—I say; *kāma*—lust; *kṛṣṇa-indriya-prīti*—for the pleasure of Lord Kṛṣṇa’s senses; *icchā*—desire; *dhare*—holds; *prema*—love; *nāma*—the name.

TRANSLATION

The desire to gratify one’s own senses is *kāma* [lust], but the desire to please the senses of Lord Kṛṣṇa is *prema* [love].

PURPORT

The revealed scriptures describe pure love as follows:

*sarvathā dhvaṁsa-rahitaṁ saty api dhvaṁsa-kāraṇe
yad bhāva-bandhanaṁ yūnoḥ sa premā parikīrtitaḥ*

“If there is ample reason for the dissolution of a conjugal relationship and yet such a dissolution does not take place, such a relationship of intimate love is called pure.”

The predominated *gopīs* were bound to Kṛṣṇa in such pure love. For them there was no question of sexual love based on sense gratification. Their only engagement in life was to see Kṛṣṇa happy in all respects, regardless of their own personal interests. They dedicated their souls only for the satisfaction of the Personality of Godhead, Śrī Kṛṣṇa. There was not the slightest tinge of sexual love between the *gopīs* and Kṛṣṇa.

The author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* asserts with authority that sexual love is a matter of personal sense enjoyment. All the regulative principles in the *Vedas* pertaining to desires for popularity, fatherhood, wealth and so on are different phases of sense gratification. Acts of sense gratification may be performed under the cover of public welfare, nationalism, religion, altruism, ethical codes, Biblical codes, health directives, fruitive action, bashfulness, tolerance, personal comfort, liberation from material

bondage, progress, family affection or fear of social ostracism or legal punishment, but all these categories are different subdivisions of one substance—sense gratification. All such good acts are performed basically for one’s own sense gratification, for no one can sacrifice his personal interest while discharging these much-advertised moral and religious principles. But above all this is a transcendental stage in which one feels himself to be only an eternal servitor of Kṛṣṇa, the absolute Personality of Godhead. All acts performed in this sense of servitude are called pure love of God because they are performed for the absolute sense gratification of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. However, any act performed for the purpose of enjoying its fruits or results is an act of sense gratification. Such actions are visible sometimes in gross and sometimes in subtle forms.

TEXT 166

kāmera tātparya—nija-sambhoga kevala

kṛṣṇa-sukha-tātparya-mātra prema ta’ prabala

SYNONYMS

kāmera—of lust; *tātparya*—the intent; *nija*—own; *sambhoga*—enjoyment; *kevala*—only; *kṛṣṇa-sukha*—for Lord Kṛṣṇa’s happiness; *tātparya*—the intent; *mātra*—only; *prema*—love; *ta’*—certainly; *prabala*—powerful.

TRANSLATION

The object of lust is only the enjoyment of one’s own senses. But love caters to the enjoyment of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and thus it is very powerful.

TEXTS 167–169

loka-dharma, veda-dharma, deha-dharma, karma

lajjā, dhairya, deha-sukha, ātma-sukha-marma

dustyaja ārya-patha, nija parijana

sva-jane karaye yata tādāna-bhartsana

sarva-tyāga kari' kare kṛṣṇera bhajana

kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu kare prema-sevana

SYNONYMS

loka-dharma—customs of the people; *veda-dharma*—Vedic injunctions; *deha-dharma*—necessities of the body; *karma*—fruitive work; *lajjā*—bashfulness; *dhairya*—patience; *deha-sukha*—the happiness of the body; *ātma-sukha*—the happiness of the self; *marma*—the essence; *dustyaja*—difficult to give up; *ārya-patha*—the path of *varṇāśrama*; *nija*—own; *parijana*—family members; *sva-jane*—one's own family; *karaye*—do; *yata*—all; *tādāna*—punishment; *bhartsana*—scolding; *sarva-tyāga kari'*—giving up everything; *kare*—do; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhajana*—worship; *kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu*—for the purpose of Lord Kṛṣṇa's happiness; *kare*—do; *prema*—out of love; *sevana*—service.

TRANSLATION

Social customs, scriptural injunctions, bodily demands, fruitive action, shyness, patience, bodily pleasures, self-gratification and the path of *varṇāśrama-dharma*, which is difficult to give up—the gopīs have forsaken all these, along with their families, and suffered their relatives' punishment and scolding, all for the sake of serving Lord Kṛṣṇa. They render loving service to Him for the sake of His enjoyment.

TEXT 170

ihāke kahiye kṛṣṇe dr̥ḍha anurāga

svaccha dhauta-vastre yaiche nāhi kona dāga

SYNONYMS

ihāke—this; *kahiye*—I say; *kṛṣṇe*—in Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dṛḍha*—strong; *anurāga*—love; *svaccha*—pure; *dhauta*—clean; *vastre*—in cloth; *yaiche*—just as; *nāhi*—not; *kona*—some; *dāga*—mark.

TRANSLATION

That is called firm attachment to Lord Kṛṣṇa. It is spotlessly pure, like a clean cloth that has no stain.

PURPORT

The author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* advises everyone to give up all engagements of sense gratification and, like the *gopīs*, dovetail oneself entirely with the will of the Supreme Lord. That is the ultimate instruction of Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhagavad-gītā*. We should be prepared to do anything and everything to please the Lord, even at the risk of violating the Vedic principles or ethical laws. That is the standard of love of Godhead. Such activities in pure love of Godhead are as spotless as white linen that has been completely washed. Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura warns us in this connection that we should not mistakenly think that the idea of giving up everything implies the renunciation of duties necessary in relation to the body and mind. Even such duties are not sense gratification if they are undertaken in a spirit of service to Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 171

ataeva kāma-preme bahuta antara

kāma—*andha-tamaḥ*, *prema*—*nirmala bhāskara*

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *kāma-preme*—in lust and love; *bahuta*—much; *antara*—space between; *kāma*—lust; *andha-tamaḥ*—blind darkness; *prema*—love; *nirmala*—pure; *bhāskara*—sun.

TRANSLATION

Therefore lust and love are quite different. Lust is like dense darkness, but love is like the bright sun.

TEXT 172

ataeva gopī-gaṇera nāhi kāma-gandha

kṛṣṇa-sukha lāgi mātra, kṛṣṇa se sambandha

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *gopī-gaṇera*—of the *gopīs*; *nāhi*—not; *kāma-gandha*—the slightest bit of lust; *kṛṣṇa-sukha*—the happiness of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *lāgi*—for; *mātra*—only; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *se*—that; *sambandha*—the relationship.

TRANSLATION

Thus there is not the slightest taint of lust in the *gopīs*' love. Their relationship with Kṛṣṇa is only for the sake of His enjoyment.

TEXT 173

yat te sujāta-caraṇāmburuhaṁ staneṣu

bhītāḥ śanaiḥ priya dadhīmahi karkaśeṣu

tenāṭavīm aṭasi tad vyathate na kiṁ svit

kūrpādibhir bhramati dhīr bhavad-āyusām naḥ

SYNONYMS

yat—which; *te*—Your; *sujāta*—very fine; *caraṇa-ambu-ruham*—lotus feet; *staneṣu*—on the breasts; *bhītāḥ*—being afraid; *śanaiḥ*—gently; *priya*—O dear one; *dadhīmahi*—we place; *karkaśeṣu*—rough; *tena*—with them; *aṭavīm*—the path; *aṭasi*—You roam; *tat*—they; *vyathate*—are distressed; *na*—not; *kim svit*—we wonder; *kūrpa-ādibhiḥ*—by small stones and so on; *bhramati*—flutters; *dhīḥ*—the mind; *bhavad-āyusām*—of those of whom Your Lordship is the very life; *naḥ*—of us.

TRANSLATION

“O dearly beloved! Your lotus feet are so soft that we place them gently on our breasts, fearing that Your feet will be hurt. Our life rests only in You. Our minds, therefore, are filled with anxiety that Your tender feet might be wounded by pebbles as You roam about on the forest path.”

PURPORT

This text from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.31.19) was spoken by the *gopīs* when Kṛṣṇa left them in the midst of the *rāsa-līlā*.

TEXT 174

ātma-sukha-duḥkhe gopīra nāhika vicāra

kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu ceṣṭā mano-vyavahāra

SYNONYMS

ātma-sukha-duḥkhe—in personal happiness or distress; *gopīra*—of the *gopīs*; *nāhika*—not; *vicāra*—consideration; *kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu*—for the purpose of Lord Kṛṣṇa’s happiness; *ceṣṭā*—activity; *manaḥ*—of the mind;

vyavahāra—the business.

TRANSLATION

The gopīs do not care for their own pleasures or pains. All their physical and mental activities are directed toward offering enjoyment to Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 175

kṛṣṇa lāgi' āra saba kare parityāga

kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu kare śuddha anurāga

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa lāgi'—for Lord Kṛṣṇa; *āra*—other; *saba*—all; *kare*—do; *parityāga*—give up; *kṛṣṇa-sukha-hetu*—for the purpose of Lord Kṛṣṇa's happiness; *kare*—do; *śuddha*—pure; *anurāga*—attachments.

TRANSLATION

They renounced everything for Kṛṣṇa. They have pure attachment to giving Kṛṣṇa pleasure.

TEXT 176

evam mad-arthojjhita-loka-veda-

svānām hi vo mayy anuvṛttaye 'balāḥ

mayā parokṣam bhajatā tirohitam

māsūyitum mārhattha tat priyam priyāḥ

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *mat-artha*—for Me; *ujjhita*—rejected; *loka*—popular customs; *veda*—Vedic injunctions; *svānām*—own families; *hi*—certainly; *vaḥ*—of you; *mayi*—Me; *anuvṛttaye*—to increase regard for; *abalāḥ*—O women; *mayā*—by Me; *parokṣam*—invisible; *bhajatā*—favoring; *tirohitam*—withdrawn from sight; *mā*—Me; *asūyitum*—to be displeased with; *mā arhatha*—you do not deserve; *tat*—therefore; *priyam*—who is dear; *priyāḥ*—O dear ones.

TRANSLATION

“O My beloved gopīs, you have renounced social customs, scriptural injunctions and your relatives for My sake. I disappeared behind you only to increase your concentration upon Me. Since I disappeared for your benefit, you should not be displeased with Me.”

PURPORT

This text from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.32.21) was spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa when He returned to the arena of the *rāsa-līlā*.

TEXT 177

kṛṣṇera pratijñā eka āche pūrva haite

ye yaiche bhaje, kṛṣṇa tāre bhaje taiche

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pratijñā*—promise; *eka*—one; *āche*—there is; *pūrva haite*—from before; *ye*—whoever; *yaiche*—just as; *bhaje*—he worships; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tāre*—to him; *bhaje*—reciprocates; *taiche*—just so.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa has a promise from before to reciprocate with His devotees according to the way they worship Him.

TEXT 178

ye yathā mām prapadyante

tāṁs tathaiva bhajāmy aham

mama vartmānuvartante

manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ

SYNONYMS

ye—those who; *yathā*—as; *mām*—to Me; *prapadyante*—surrender; *tān*—them; *tathā*—so; *eva*—certainly; *bhajāmi*—reward; *aham*—I; *mama*—My; *vartma*—path; *anuvartante*—follow; *manuṣyāḥ*—men; *pārtha*—O son of Pṛthā; *sarvaśaḥ*—in all respects.

TRANSLATION

“In whatever way My devotees surrender unto Me, I reward them accordingly. Everyone follows My path in all respects, O son of Pṛthā.”

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇa was never ungrateful to the *gopīs*, for as He declares to Arjuna in this verse from the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.11), He reciprocates with His devotees in proportion to the transcendental loving service they render unto Him. Everyone follows the path that leads toward Him, but there are different degrees of progress on that path, and the Lord is realized in proportion to one’s advancement. The path is one, but the progress in

approaching the ultimate goal is different, and therefore the proportion of realization of this goal—namely the absolute Personality of Godhead—is also different. The *gopīs* attained the highest goal, and Lord Caitanya affirmed that there is no method of worshiping God higher than that followed by the *gopīs*.

TEXT 179

se pratijñā bhaṅga haila gopīra bhajane

tāhāte pramāṇa kṛṣṇa-śrī-mukha-vacane

SYNONYMS

se—that; *pratijñā*—promise; *bhaṅga haila*—was broken; *gopīra*—of the *gopīs*; *bhajane*—by the worship; *tāhāte*—in that; *pramāṇa*—the proof; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *śrī-mukha-vacane*—by the words from the mouth.

TRANSLATION

That promise has been broken by the worship of the *gopīs*, as Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself admits.

TEXT 180

na pāraye 'ham niravadya-samyujām

sva-sādhū-kṛtyām vibudhāyusāpi vaḥ

yā mābhajan durjaya-geha-śṛṅkhalāḥ

saṁvṛścyā tad vaḥ pratiyātu sādhunā

SYNONYMS

na—not; *pāraye*—am able to make; *aham*—I; *niravadya-saṁyujām*—to those who are completely free from deceit; *sva-sādhū-kṛtyam*—proper compensation; *vibudha-āyusā*—with a lifetime as long as that of the demigods; *api*—although; *vaḥ*—to you; *yāḥ*—who; *mā*—Me; *abhajan*—have worshiped; *durjaya-geha-śṛṅkhalāḥ*—the chains of household life, which are difficult to overcome; *saṁvṛścyā*—cutting; *tat*—that; *vaḥ*—of you; *pratiyātu*—let it be returned; *sādhunā*—by the good activity itself.

TRANSLATION

“O gopīs, I am not able to repay My debt for your spotless service, even within a lifetime of Brahmā. Your connection with Me is beyond reproach. You have worshiped Me, cutting off all domestic ties, which are difficult to break. Therefore please let your own glorious deeds be your compensation.”

PURPORT

This verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.32.22) was spoken by Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself when He returned to the *gopīs* upon hearing their songs of separation.

TEXT 181

tabe ye dekhiye gopīra nija-dehe prīta

seho ta' kṛṣṇera lāgi, jāniha niścita

SYNONYMS

tabe—now; *ye*—whatever; *dekhiye*—we see; *gopīra*—of the *gopīs*; *nija-dehe*—for their own bodies; *prīta*—affection; *seho*—that; *ta'*—certainly; *kṛṣṇera lāgi*—for Lord Kṛṣṇa; *jāniha*—know; *niścita*—for certain.

TRANSLATION

Now, whatever affection we see the gopīs show for their own bodies, know it for certain to be only for the sake of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The selfless love of Godhead exhibited by the *gopīs* cannot have any parallel. We should not, therefore, misunderstand the carefulness of the *gopīs* in their personal decoration. The *gopīs* dressed themselves as beautifully as possible just to make Kṛṣṇa happy by seeing them. They had no ulterior desires. They dedicated their bodies, and everything they possessed, to the service of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, taking it for granted that their bodies were meant for His enjoyment. They dressed themselves with the understanding that Kṛṣṇa would be happy by seeing and touching them.

TEXT 182

‘ei deha kailuṁ āmi kṛṣṇe samarpaṇa

tāñra dhana tāñra ihā sambhoga-sādhana

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *deha*—body; *kailuṁ*—have done; *āmi*—I; *kṛṣṇe*—to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *samarpaṇa*—offering; *tāñra*—of Him; *dhana*—the wealth; *tāñra*—of Him; *ihā*—this; *sambhoga-sādhana*—brings about the enjoyment.

TRANSLATION

[The gopīs think:] “I have offered this body to Lord Kṛṣṇa. He is its owner, and it brings Him enjoyment.

TEXT 183

e-deha-darsāna-sparsē kṛṣṇa-santoṣaṇa’

ei lāgi' kare dehera mārjana-bhūsaṇa

SYNONYMS

e-deha—of this body; *darśana*—by sight; *sparsē*—and touch; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *santoṣaṇa*—the satisfaction; *ei lāgi'*—for this; *kare*—they do; *dehera*—of the body; *mārjana*—cleaning; *bhūsaṇa*—decorating.

TRANSLATION

“Kṛṣṇa finds joy in seeing and touching this body.” It is for this reason that they cleanse and decorate their bodies.

TEXT 184

nijāṅgam api yā gopyo

mameti samupāsate

tābhyaḥ paraṁ na me pārtha

nigūḍha-prema-bhājanam

SYNONYMS

nija-aṅgam—own body; *api*—although; *yāḥ*—who; *gopyaḥ*—the *gopīs*; *mama*—Mine; *iti*—thus thinking; *samupāsate*—engage in decorating; *tābhyaḥ*—than them; *param*—greater; *na*—not; *me*—for Me; *pārtha*—O Arjuna; *nigūḍha-prema*—of deep love; *bhājanam*—receptacles.

TRANSLATION

“O Arjuna, there are no greater receptacles of deep love for Me than the *gopīs*, who cleanse and decorate their bodies because they consider them Mine.”

PURPORT

This verse is spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa in the *Ādi Purāṇa*.

TEXT 185

āra eka adbhuta gopī-bhāvera svabhāva

buddhira gocara nahe yāhāra prabhāva

SYNONYMS

āra—another; *eka*—one; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *gopī-bhāvera*—of the emotion of the *gopīs*; *svabhāva*—nature; *buddhira*—of the intelligence; *gocara*—an object of perception; *nahe*—is not; *yāhāra*—of which; *prabhāva*—the power.

TRANSLATION

There is another wonderful feature of the emotion of the *gopīs*. Its power is beyond the comprehension of the intelligence.

TEXT 186

gopī-gaṇa kare yabe kṛṣṇa-daraśana

sukha-vāñchā nāhi, sukha haya koṭi-guṇa

SYNONYMS

gopī-gaṇa—the *gopīs*; *kare*—do; *yabe*—when; *kṛṣṇa-daraśana*—seeing Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sukha-vāñchā*—desire for happiness; *nāhi*—there is not; *sukha*—the happiness; *haya*—there is; *koṭi-guṇa*—ten million times.

TRANSLATION

When the *gopīs* see Lord Kṛṣṇa, they derive unbounded bliss, although they have no desire for such pleasure.

TEXT 187

gopikā-darsāne kṛṣṇera ye ānanda haya

tāhā haite koṭi-guṇa gopī āsvādaya

SYNONYMS

gopikā-darsāne—in seeing the *gopīs*; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ye*—whatever; *ānanda*—joy; *haya*—there is; *tāhā haite*—than that; *koṭi-guṇa*—ten million times more; *gopī*—the *gopīs*; *āsvādaya*—taste.

TRANSLATION

The *gopīs* taste a pleasure ten million times greater than the pleasure Lord Kṛṣṇa derives from seeing them.

PURPORT

The wonderful characteristics of the *gopīs* are beyond imagination. They have no desire for personal satisfaction, yet when Kṛṣṇa is happy by seeing them, that happiness of Kṛṣṇa makes the *gopīs* a million times more happy than Kṛṣṇa Himself.

TEXT 188

tān sabāra nāhi nija-sukha-anurodha

tathāpi bādhaye sukha, paḍila virodha

SYNONYMS

tān sabāra—of all of them; *nāhi*—not; *nija-sukha*—for their own happiness; *anurodha*—entreaty; *tathāpi*—still; *bādhaye*—increases; *sukha*—happiness; *padīla*—happened; *virodha*—contradiction.

TRANSLATION

The gopīs have no inclination for their own enjoyment, and yet their joy increases. That is indeed a contradiction.

TEXT 189

e virodhera eka mātra dekhi samādhāna

gopikāra sukha kṛṣṇa-sukhe paryavasāna

SYNONYMS

e—this; *virodhera*—of the contradiction; *eka*—one; *mātra*—only; *dekhi*—I see; *samādhāna*—solution; *gopikāra*—of the gopīs; *sukha*—the happiness; *kṛṣṇa-sukhe*—in the happiness of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *paryavasāna*—the conclusion.

TRANSLATION

For this contradiction I see only one solution: the joy of the gopīs lies in the joy of their beloved Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The situation of the *gopīs* is perplexing, for although they did not want personal happiness, it was imposed upon them. The solution to this perplexity is that Śrī Kṛṣṇa's sense of happiness is limited by the happiness of the *gopīs*. Devotees at Vṛndāvana therefore try to serve the *gopīs*, namely Rādhārāṇī and Her associates. If one gains the favor of the *gopīs*, he easily gains the favor of Kṛṣṇa because on the recommendation

of the *gopīs* Kṛṣṇa at once accepts the service of a devotee. Lord Caitanya, therefore, wanted to please the *gopīs* instead of Kṛṣṇa. But His contemporaries misunderstood Him, and for this reason Lord Caitanya renounced the order of householder life and became a *sannyāsī*.

TEXT 190

gopikā-darśane kṛṣṇera bāḍhe praphullatā

se mādhyura bāḍhe yāra nāhika samatā

SYNONYMS

gopikā-darśane—in seeing the *gopīs*; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bāḍhe*—increases; *praphullatā*—the cheerfulness; *se*—that; *mādhyura*—sweetness; *bāḍhe*—increases; *yāra*—of which; *nāhika*—there is not; *samatā*—equality.

TRANSLATION

When Lord Kṛṣṇa sees the *gopīs*, His joy increases, and His unparalleled sweetness increases also.

TEXT 191

āmāra darśane kṛṣṇa pāila eta sukha

ei sukhe gopīra praphulla aṅga-mukha

SYNONYMS

āmāra darśane—in seeing me; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pāila*—obtained; *eta*—so much; *sukha*—happiness; *ei*—this; *sukhe*—in happiness; *gopīra*—of the *gopīs*; *praphulla*—full-blown; *aṅga-mukha*—bodies and faces.

TRANSLATION

[The gopīs think:] “Kṛṣṇa has obtained so much pleasure by seeing me.”
That thought increases the fullness and beauty of their faces and bodies.

TEXT 192

gopī-śobhā dekhi’ kṛṣṇera śobhā bāḍhe yata

kṛṣṇa-śobhā dekhi’ gopīra śobhā bāḍhe tata

SYNONYMS

gopī-śobhā—the beauty of the *gopīs*; *dekhi’*—seeing; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *śobhā*—the beauty; *bāḍhe*—increases; *yata*—as much as; *kṛṣṇa-śobhā*—the beauty of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dekhi’*—seeing; *gopīra*—of the *gopīs*; *śobhā*—the beauty; *bāḍhe*—increases; *tata*—that much.

TRANSLATION

The beauty of Lord Kṛṣṇa increases at the sight of the beauty of the gopīs. And the more the gopīs see Lord Kṛṣṇa’s beauty, the more their beauty increases.

TEXT 193

ei-mata paraspara paḍe huḍāhuḍi

paraspara bāḍhe, keha mukha nāhi muḍi

SYNONYMS

ei mata—like this; *paraspara*—reciprocal; *paḍe*—happens; *huḍāhuḍi*—jostling; *paraspara*—mutually; *bāḍhe*—increases; *keha*—someone; *mukha*—face; *nāhi*—not; *muḍi*—covering.

TRANSLATION

In this way a competition takes place between them in which no one acknowledges defeat.

TEXT 194

kintu kṛṣṇera sukha haya gopī-rūpa-guṇe

tāñra sukhe sukha-vṛddhi haye gopī-gaṇe

SYNONYMS

kintu—but; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sukha*—the happiness; *haya*—is; *gopī-rūpa-guṇe*—in the qualities and beauty of the *gopīs*; *tāñra*—of Him; *sukhe*—in the happiness; *sukha-vṛddhi*—increase of happiness; *haye*—there is; *gopī-gaṇe*—in the *gopīs*.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa, however, derives pleasure from the beauty and good qualities of the *gopīs*. And when the *gopīs* see His pleasure, the joy of the *gopīs* increases.

TEXT 195

ataeva sei sukha kṛṣṇa-sukha poṣe

ei hetu gopī-preme nāhi kāma-doṣe

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *sei*—that; *sukha*—happiness; *kṛṣṇa-sukha*—the happiness of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *poṣe*—nourishes; *ei*—this; *hetu*—reason; *gopī-preme*—in the love of the *gopīs*; *nāhi*—there is not; *kāma-doṣe*—the

fault of lust.

TRANSLATION

Therefore we find that the joy of the gopīs nourishes the joy of Lord Kṛṣṇa. For that reason the fault of lust is not present in their love.

PURPORT

By looking at the beautiful *gopīs* Kṛṣṇa becomes enlivened, and this enlivens the *gopīs*, whose youthful faces and bodies blossom. This competition of increasing beauty between the *gopīs* and Kṛṣṇa, which is without limitations, is so delicate that sometimes mundane moralists mistake these dealings to be purely amorous. But these affairs are not at all mundane, because the *gopīs*' intense desire to satisfy Kṛṣṇa surcharges the entire scene with pure love of Godhead, with not a spot of sexual indulgence.

TEXT 196

upetya pathi sundarī-tatibhir ābhir abhyarcitam

smitāṅkura-karambitair naṭad-apāṅga-bhaṅgī-śataiḥ

stana-stavaka-sañcaran-nayana-cañcarikāñcalaṁ

vraje vijayinam bhaje vipina-deśataḥ keśavam

SYNONYMS

upetya—having mounted their palaces; *pathi*—on the path; *sundarī-tatibhiḥ ābhiḥ*—by the women of Vraja; *abhyarcitam*—who is worshiped; *smita-aṅkura-karambitaiḥ*—intermingled with the sprouts of gentle smiles; *naṭat*—dancing; *apāṅga*—of glances; *bhaṅgī-śataiḥ*—with a hundred manners; *stana-stavaka*—the multitude of breasts; *sañcarat*—

wandering about; *nayana*—of the two eyes; *cañcarika*—like bees; *añcalam*—Him whose corners; *vraje*—in Vraja; *vijayinam*—coming; *bhaje*—I worship; *vipina-deśataḥ*—from the forest; *keśavam*—Lord Keśava.

TRANSLATION

“I worship Lord Keśava. Coming back from the forest of Vraja, He is worshiped by the gopīs, who mount the roofs of their palaces and meet Him on the path with a hundred manners of dancing glances and gentle smiles. The corners of His eyes wander, like large black bees, around the gopīs’ breasts.”

PURPORT

This statement appears in the *Keśavāṣṭaka* (8) of the *Stava-mālā*, compiled by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 197

āra eka gopī-premera svābhāvika cihna

ye prakāre haya prema kāma-gandha-hīna

SYNONYMS

āra—another; *eka*—one; *gopī-premera*—of the love of the gopīs; *svābhāvika*—natural; *cihna*—symptom; *ye*—which; *prakāre*—in the way; *haya*—is; *prema*—the love; *kāma-gandha-hīna*—without a trace of lust.

TRANSLATION

There is another natural symptom of the gopīs’ love that shows it to be without a trace of lust.

TEXT 198

gopī-preme kare kṛṣṇa-mādhuryera puṣṭi
mādhurye bāḍhāya prema hañā mahā-tuṣṭi

SYNONYMS

gopī-preme—the love of the *gopīs*; *kare*—does; *kṛṣṇa-mādhuryera*—of the sweetness of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *puṣṭi*—nourishment; *mādhurye*—the sweetness; *bāḍhāya*—causes to increase; *prema*—the love; *hañā*—being; *mahā-tuṣṭi*—greatly pleased.

TRANSLATION

The love of the *gopīs* nourishes the sweetness of Lord Kṛṣṇa. That sweetness in turn increases their love, for they are greatly satisfied.

TEXT 199

prīti-viṣayānande tad-āśrayānanda
tānhā nāhi nija-sukha-vāñchāra sambandha

SYNONYMS

prīti-viṣaya-ānande—in the joy of the object of love; *tat*—of that love; *āśraya-ānanda*—the joy of the abode; *tānhā*—that; *nāhi*—not; *nija-sukha-vāñchāra*—of desire for one's own happiness; *sambandha*—relationship.

TRANSLATION

The happiness of the abode of love is in the happiness of the object of that love. This is not a relationship of desire for personal gratification.

TEXTS 200–201

nirupādhi prema yāñhā, tāñhā ei rīti

prīti-viṣaya-sukhe āśrayera prīti

nija-premānande kṛṣṇa-sevānanda bādhe

se ānandera prati bhaktera haya mahā-krodhe

SYNONYMS

nirupādhi—without identification; *prema*—love; *yāñhā*—which; *tāñhā*—that; *ei*—this; *rīti*—style; *prīti-viṣaya*—of the object of love; *sukhe*—in the happiness; *āśrayera*—of the abode of that love; *prīti*—the pleasure; *nija*—one’s own; *prema*—of love; *ānande*—by the joy; *kṛṣṇa*—to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *seva-ānanda*—the joy of service; *bādhe*—is obstructed; *se*—that; *ānandera prati*—toward the joy; *bhaktera*—of the devotee; *haya*—is; *mahā-krodhe*—great anger.

TRANSLATION

Whenever there is unselfish love, that is its style. The reservoir of love derives pleasure when the lovable object is pleased. When the pleasure of love interferes with the service of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the devotee becomes angry toward such ecstasy.

PURPORT

As mentioned above, the *gopīs* are the predominated lovers, and Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the predominator, the beloved. The love of the predominated nourishes the love of the predominator. The *gopīs* had no desire for selfish enjoyment. Their feeling of happiness was indirect, for it was dependent on the pleasure of Kṛṣṇa. Causeless love of Godhead is always so. Such pure love is possible only when the predominated is made happy

by the happiness of the predominator. Such unadulterated love is exemplified when the lover deprecates her happiness in service that hinders her from discharging it.

TEXT 202

aṅga-stambhārambham uttuṅgayantaṁ

premānandaṁ dāruko nābhyanandat

kaṁsārāter vījane yena sākṣāt

akṣodīyān antarāyo vyadhāyi

SYNONYMS

aṅga—of the limbs; *stambha-ārambham*—the beginning of stupefaction; *uttuṅgayantaṁ*—which was causing him to reach; *prema-ānandaṁ*—the joy of love; *dārukaḥ*—Dāruka, the Lord’s chariot driver; *na*—not; *abhyanandat*—welcomed; *kaṁsa-arāteḥ*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kāṁsa; *vījane*—in fanning with a *cāmara* fan; *yena*—by which; *sākṣāt*—clearly; *akṣodīyān*—greater; *antarāyaḥ*—obstacle; *vyadhāyi*—has been created.

TRANSLATION

“Śrī Dāruka did not relish his ecstatic feelings of love, for they caused his limbs to become stunned and thus obstructed his service of fanning Lord Kṛṣṇa.”

PURPORT

This verse is from the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (3.2.62).

TEXT 203

govinda-prekṣaṇākṣepi-

bāṣpa-pūrābhivarṣiṇam

uccair anindat ānandam

aravinda-vilocanā

SYNONYMS

govinda—of Lord Govinda; *prekṣaṇa*—the seeing; *ākṣepi*—hindering;
bāṣpa-pūra—groups of tears; *abhivarṣiṇam*—which cause to rain;
uccaiḥ—powerfully; *anindat*—condemned; *ānandam*—the bliss;
aravinda-vilocanā—the lotus-eyed Rādhārāṇī.

TRANSLATION

“The lotus-eyed Rādhārāṇī powerfully condemned the ecstatic love that caused a flow of tears that hindered Her sight of Govinda.”

PURPORT

This verse is also from the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (2.3.54).

TEXT 204

āra śuddha-bhakta kṛṣṇa-prema-sevā vine

sva-sukhārtha sālokyādi nā kare grahaṇe

SYNONYMS

āra—and; *śuddha-bhakta*—the pure devotee; *kṛṣṇa-prema*—out of love for Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sevā*—service; *vine*—without; *sva-sukha-artha*—for the purpose of one’s own pleasure; *sālokyā-di*—the five types of liberation,

beginning from *sālokya* (residing on the same spiritual planet as the Lord); *nā kare*—do not do; *grahṇe*—acceptance.

TRANSLATION

Furthermore, pure devotees never forsake the loving service of Lord Kṛṣṇa to aspire for their own personal pleasure through the five kinds of liberation.

PURPORT

A pure devotee of Kṛṣṇa who loves Him exclusively will flatly refuse to accept any sort of liberation, beginning from merging with the body of the Lord and extending to the other varieties of liberation, such as equality of form, opulence or abode and the opulence of living near the Lord.

TEXT 205

mad-guṇa-śruti-mātreṇa

mayi sarva-guhāśaye

mano-gatir avicchinnā

yathā gaṅgāmbhaso 'mbudhau

SYNONYMS

mat—of Me; *guṇa*—of the qualities; *śruti-mātreṇa*—only by hearing; *mayi*—to Me; *sarva-guhā*—in all hearts; *āśaye*—who am situated; *manaḥ-gatiḥ*—the movement of the mind; *avicchinnā*—unobstructed; *yathā*—just as; *gaṅgā-ambhasaḥ*—of the celestial waters of the Ganges; *ambudhau*—to the ocean.

TRANSLATION

“Just as the celestial waters of the Ganges flow unobstructed into the ocean, so when My devotees simply hear of Me, their minds come to Me, who reside in the hearts of all.

TEXT 206

lakṣaṇam bhakti-yogasya

nirguṇasya hy udāhṛtam

ahaituky avyavahitā

yā bhaktiḥ puruṣottame

SYNONYMS

lakṣaṇam—the symptom; *bhakti-yogasya*—of devotional service; *nirguṇasya*—beyond the three modes of nature; *hi*—certainly; *udāhṛtam*—is cited; *ahaitukī*—causeless; *avyavahitā*—uninterrupted; *yā*—which; *bhaktiḥ*—devotional service; *puruṣottame*—to the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

“These are the characteristics of transcendental loving service to Puruṣottama, the Supreme Personality of Godhead: it is causeless, and it cannot be obstructed in any way.

TEXT 207

sālokya-sārṣṭi-sārūpya-

sāmīpyaikatvam apy uta

dīyamānam na grhṇanti

vinā mat-sevanam janāḥ

SYNONYMS

sālokya—being on the same planet as Me; *sārṣṭi*—having opulence equal to Mine; *sārūpya*—having the same form as Me; *sāmīpya*—having direct association with Me; *ekatvam*—oneness with Me; *api*—even; *uta*—or; *dīyamānam*—being given; *na*—not; *grhṇanti*—accept; *vinā*—without; *mat-sevanam*—My service; *janāḥ*—the devotees.

TRANSLATION

“My devotees do not accept *sālokya*, *sārṣṭi*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* or oneness with Me—even if I offer these liberations—in preference to serving Me.”

PURPORT

These three verses from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.29.11–13) were spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa in the form of Kapiladeva.

TEXT 208

mat-sevayā pratītam te

sālokyādi-catuṣṭayam

necchanti sevayā pūrṇāḥ

kuto 'nyat kāla-viplutam

SYNONYMS

mat—of Me; *sevayā*—by service; *pratītam*—obtained; *te*—they; *sālokyādi*—liberation, beginning *sālokya*; *catuṣṭayam*—four kinds of; *na*

icchanti—do not desire; *sewayā*—by service; *pūrṇāḥ*—complete; *kutaḥ*—where; *anyat*—other things; *kāla-viplutam*—which are lost in time.

TRANSLATION

“My devotees, having fulfilled their desires by serving Me, do not accept the four kinds of salvation that are easily earned by such service. Why then should they accept any pleasures that are lost in the course of time?”

PURPORT

This verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (9.4.67) was spoken by the Lord in connection with the characteristics of Mahārāja Ambarīṣa. Merging into the existence of the Absolute is as temporary as living in the celestial kingdom. Both of them are controlled by time; neither position is permanent.

TEXT 209

kāma-gandha-hīna svābhāvika gopī-prema

nirmala, ujjala, śuddha yena dagdha hema

SYNONYMS

kāma-gandha-hīna—without any scent of lust; *svābhāvika*—natural; *gopī-prema*—the love of the *gopīs*; *nirmala*—spotless; *ujjala*—blazing; *śuddha*—pure; *yena*—like; *dagdha hema*—molten gold.

TRANSLATION

The natural love of the *gopīs* is devoid of any trace of lust. It is faultless, bright and pure, like molten gold.

TEXT 210

kṛṣṇera sahāya, guru, bāndhava, preyasī

gopikā hayena priyā śiṣyā, sakhī dāsī

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sahāya*—helpers; *guru*—teachers; *bāndhava*—friends; *preyasī*—wives; *gopikā*—the *gopīs*; *hayena*—are; *priyā*—dear; *śiṣyā*—students; *sakhī*—confidantes; *dāsī*—servants.

TRANSLATION

The *gopīs* are the helpers, teachers, friends, wives, dear disciples, confidantes and serving maids of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 211

sahāyā guravaḥ śiṣyā

bhujīṣyā bāndhavāḥ striyaḥ

satyaṁ vadāmi te pārtha

gopyaḥ kim me bhavanti na

SYNONYMS

sahāyāḥ—helpers; *guravaḥ*—teachers; *śiṣyāḥ*—students; *bhujīṣyāḥ*—servants; *bāndhavāḥ*—friends; *striyaḥ*—wives; *satyaṁ*—truthfully; *vadāmi*—I say; *te*—unto you; *pārtha*—O Arjuna; *gopyaḥ*—the *gopīs*; *kim*—what; *me*—for Me; *bhavanti*—are; *na*—not.

TRANSLATION

“O Pārtha, I speak to you the truth. The gopīs are My helpers, teachers, disciples, servants, friends and consorts. I do not know what they are not to Me.”

PURPORT

This verse was spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa in the *Gopī-premāmṛta*.

TEXT 212

gopikā jānena kṛṣṇera manera vāñchita

prema-sevā-paripāṭī, iṣṭa-samīhita

SYNONYMS

gopikā—the *gopīs*; *jānena*—know; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *manera*—of the mind; *vāñchita*—the desired object; *prema-sevā*—of service in love; *paripāṭī*—perfection; *iṣṭa-samīhita*—achievement of the desired goal of life.

TRANSLATION

The gopīs know Kṛṣṇa’s desires, and they know how to render perfect loving service for His enjoyment. They perform their service expertly for the satisfaction of their beloved.

TEXT 213

man-māhātmyam mat-saparyām

mac-chraddhām man-mano-gatam

jānanti gopikāḥ pārtha

nānye jānanti tattvataḥ

SYNONYMS

mat-māhātmyam—My greatness; *mat-saparyām*—My service; *mat-śraddhām*—respect for Me; *mat-manaḥ-gatam*—the intention of My mind; *jānanti*—they know; *gopikāḥ*—the *gopīs*; *pārtha*—O Arjuna; *na*—not; *anye*—others; *jānanti*—know; *tattvataḥ*—factually.

TRANSLATION

“O Pārtha, the *gopīs* know My greatness, My loving service, respect for Me, and My mentality. Others cannot really know these.”

PURPORT

This verse was spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa to Arjuna in the *Ādi Purāṇa*.

TEXT 214

sei gopī-gaṇa-madhye uttamā rādhikā

rūpe, guṇe, saubhāgye, preme sarvādhikā

SYNONYMS

sei—those; *gopī-gaṇa*—the *gopīs*; *madhye*—among; *uttamā*—the highest; *rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *rūpe*—in beauty; *guṇe*—in qualities; *saubhāgye*—in good fortune; *preme*—in love; *sarva-adhikā*—above all.

TRANSLATION

Among the *gopīs*, Śrīmatī Rādhikā is the foremost. She surpasses all in beauty, in good qualities, in good fortune and, above all, in love.

PURPORT

Among all the *gopīs*, Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is the most exalted. She is the most beautiful, the most qualified and, above all, the greatest lover of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 215

yathā rādhā priyā viṣṇoḥ

tasyāḥ kuṇḍam priyam tathā

sarva-gopīṣu saivaikā

viṣṇor atyanta-vallabhā

SYNONYMS

yathā—just as; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *priyā*—very dear; *viṣṇoḥ*—to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tasyāḥ*—Her; *kuṇḍam*—bathing place; *priyam*—very dear; *tathā*—so also; *sarva-gopīṣu*—among all the *gopīs*; *sā*—She; *eva*—certainly; *ekā*—alone; *viṣṇoḥ*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *atyanta-vallabhā*—most dear.

TRANSLATION

“Just as Rādhā is dear to Lord Kṛṣṇa, so Her bathing place [Rādhā-kuṇḍa] is dear to Him. She alone is His most beloved of all the *gopīs*.”

PURPORT

This verse is from the *Padma Purāṇa*.

TEXT 216

traī-lokye pṛthivī dhanyā

yatra vṛndāvanam purī

tatrāpi gopikāḥ pārtha

yatra rādhābhīdhā mama

SYNONYMS

traī-lokye—in the three worlds; *pṛthivī*—the earth; *dhanyā*—fortunate; *yatra*—where; *vṛndāvanam*—Vṛndāvana; *purī*—the town; *tatra*—there; *api*—certainly; *gopikāḥ*—the *gopīs*; *pārtha*—O Arjuna; *yatra*—where; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *abhīdhā*—named; *mama*—My.

TRANSLATION

“O Pārtha, in all the three planetary systems, this earth is especially fortunate, for on earth is the town of Vṛndāvana. And there the gopīs are especially glorious because among them is My Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.”

PURPORT

This verse, spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa to Arjuna, is cited from the *Ādi Purāṇa*.

TEXT 217

rādhā-saha kṛīḍā rasa-vṛddhira kāraṇa

āra saba gopī-gaṇa rasopakaraṇa

SYNONYMS

rādhā-saha—with Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *kṛīḍā*—pastimes; *rasa*—of mellow;

vṛddhira—of the increase; *kāraṇa*—the cause; *āra*—the other; *saba*—all; *gopī-gaṇa*—*gopīs*; *rasa-upakaraṇa*—accessories of mellow.

TRANSLATION

All the other *gopīs* help increase the joy of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes with Rādhārāṇī. The *gopīs* act as the instruments of Their mutual enjoyment.

PURPORT

It is said that the *gopīs* are divided into five groups, namely the *sakhīs*, *nitya-sakhīs*, *prāṇa-sakhīs*, *priya-sakhīs* and *parama-preṣṭha-sakhīs*. All these fair-complexioned associates of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, the Queen of Vṛndāvana-dhāma, are expert artists in evoking erotic sentiments in Kṛṣṇa. The *parama-preṣṭha-sakhīs* are eight in number, and in the ecstatic dealings of Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā they side sometimes with Kṛṣṇa and at other times with Rādhārāṇī, just to create a situation in which it appears that they favor one against the other. That makes the exchange of mellows more palatable.

TEXT 218

kṛṣṇera vallabhā rādhā kṛṣṇa-prāṇa-dhana

tāñhā vinu sukha-hetu nahe gopī-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vallabhā*—beloved; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *kṛṣṇa-prāṇa-dhana*—the wealth of the life of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tāñhā*—Her; *vinu*—without; *sukha-hetu*—cause of happiness; *nahe*—are not; *gopī-gaṇa*—the *gopīs*.

TRANSLATION

Rādhā is the beloved consort of Kṛṣṇa, and She is the wealth of His life.
Without Her, the gopīs cannot give Him pleasure.

TEXT 219

*kaṁsārīr api saṁsāra-
vāsanā-baddha-śṛṅkhalām
rādhām ādhāya hṛdaye
tatyāja vraja-sundarīḥ*

SYNONYMS

kaṁsa-ariḥ—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kāṁsa; *api*—moreover;
saṁsāra—for the essence of enjoyment (*rāsa-līlā*); *vāsanā*—by the desire;
baddha—tied on; *śṛṅkhalām*—who was like the chains; *rādhām*—Śrīmatī
Rādhārāṇī; *ādhāya*—taking; *hṛdaye*—in the heart; *tatyāja*—left aside;
vraja-sundarīḥ—the other *gopīs*.

TRANSLATION

“Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kāṁsa, left aside the other *gopīs* during the *rāsa* dance and took Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī to His heart, for She is the helper of the Lord in realizing the essence of His desires.”

PURPORT

In this verse from the *Gīta-govinda* (3.1), Jayadeva Gosvāmī describes Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s leaving the *rāsa-līlā* to search for Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 220

sei rādhāra bhāva lañā caitanya-avatāra

yuga-dharma nāma-prema kaila paracāra

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bhāva*—the emotion; *lañā*—taking; *caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya; *avatāra*—the incarnation; *yuga-dharma*—the religion of the age; *nāma-prema*—the holy name and love of Godhead; *kaila*—did; *paracāra*—preaching.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya appeared with the sentiment of Rādhā. He preached the dharma of this age—the chanting of the holy name and pure love of God.

TEXT 221

sei bhāve nija-vāñchā karila pūraṇa

avatārera ei vāñchā mūla-kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *bhāve*—in the mood; *nija-vāñchā*—His own desires, *karila*—did; *pūraṇa*—fulfilling; *avatārera*—of the incarnation; *ei*—this; *vāñchā*—desire; *mūla*—root; *kāraṇa*—cause.

TRANSLATION

In the mood of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, He also fulfilled His own desires. This is the principal reason for His appearance.

TEXT 222

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gosāñi vrajendra-kumāra

rasa-maya-mūrti kṛṣṇa sākṣāt śṛṅgāra

SYNONYMS

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gosāñi—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *vrajendra-kumāra*—the child of King Nanda; *rasa-maya*—consisting of mellows; *mūrti*—the form; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sākṣāt*—directly; *śṛṅgāra*—amorous love.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa [Vrajendra-kumāra], the embodiment of rasas. He is amorous love personified.

TEXT 223

sei rasa āsvādite kaila avatāra

ānusaṅge kaila saba rasera pracāra

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *rasa*—mellow; *āsvādite*—to taste; *kaila*—made; *avatāra*—incarnation; *ānusaṅge*—as a secondary motive; *kaila*—did; *saba*—all; *rasera*—of mellows; *pracāra*—broadcasting.

TRANSLATION

He made His appearance to taste that conjugal mellow and incidentally to broadcast all the rasas.

TEXT 224

viśveṣām anurañjanena janayann ānandam indīvara-

śreṇī-śyāmala-komalair upanayann aṅgair anaṅgotsavam

svacchandam vraja-sundarībhir abhitaḥ prati-aṅgam āliṅgitaḥ

śṛṅgāraḥ sakhi mūrtimān iva madhau mugdho hariḥ krīḍati

SYNONYMS

viśveṣām—of all the *gopīs*; *anurañjanena*—by the act of pleasing;
janayan—producing; *ānandam*—the bliss; *indīvara-śreṇī*—like a row of
blue lotuses; *śyāmala*—bluish black; *komalaiḥ*—and soft; *upanayan*—
bringing; *aṅgaiḥ*—with His limbs; *anaṅga-utsavam*—a festival for Cupid;
svacchandam—without restriction; *vraja-sundarībhiḥ*—by the young
women of Vraja; *abhitaḥ*—on both sides; *prati-aṅgam*—each limb;
āliṅgitaḥ—embraced; *śṛṅgāraḥ*—amorous love; *sakhi*—O friend;
mūrtimān—embodied; *iva*—like; *madhau*—in the springtime;
mugdhaḥ—perplexed; *hariḥ*—Lord Hari; *krīḍati*—plays.

TRANSLATION

“My dear friends, just see how Śrī Kṛṣṇa is enjoying the season of spring!
With the *gopīs* embracing each of His limbs, He is like amorous love
personified. With His transcendental pastimes, He enlivens all the *gopīs*
and the entire creation. With His soft bluish-black arms and legs, which
resemble blue lotus flowers, He has created a festival for Cupid.”

PURPORT

This is also a verse from the *Gīta-govinda* (1.11).

TEXT 225

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gosāñi rasera sadana

aśeṣa-viśeṣe kaila rasa āsvādana

SYNONYMS

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gosāñi—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *rasera*—of mellow; *sadana*—the residence; *aśeṣa-viśeṣe*—unlimited varieties of enjoyment; *kaila*—did; *rasa*—mellow; *āsvādana*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the abode of rasa. He Himself tasted the sweetness of rasa in endless ways.

TEXT 226

sei dvāre pravartāila kali-yuga-dharma

caitanyera dāse jāne ei saba marma

SYNONYMS

sei dvāre—in that way; *pravartāila*—He initiated; *kali-yuga*—of the Age of Kali; *dharma*—the religion; *caitanyera*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dāse*—the servant; *jāne*—knows; *ei*—these; *saba*—all; *marma*—secrets.

TRANSLATION

Thus He initiated the dharma for the Age of Kali. The devotees of Lord Caitanya know all these truths.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself, the absolute enjoyer of the love of the *gopīs*. He Himself assumes the role of the *gopīs* to taste the predominated happiness of transcendental mellows. He appeared in that mode, but simultaneously He propagated the religious process for this age

in a most fascinating way. Only the confidential devotees of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu can understand this transcendental secret.

TEXTS 227–228

advaita ācārya, nityānanda, śrīnivāsa

gadādhara, dāmodara, murāri, haridāsa

āra yata caitanya-kṛṣṇera bhakta-gaṇa

bhakti-bhāve śīre dhari sabāra caraṇa

SYNONYMS

advaita ācārya—Advaita Ācārya; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *śrīnivāsa*—Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita; *gadādhara*—Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *dāmodara*—Svarūpa Dāmodara; *murāri*—Murāri Gupta; *haridāsa*—Haridāsa Ṭhākura; *āra*—other; *yata*—all; *caitanya-kṛṣṇera*—of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *bhakti-bhāve*—with a devotional attitude; *śīre*—on my head; *dhari*—I take; *sabāra*—of all of them; *caraṇa*—the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya, Lord Nityānanda, Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Murāri Gupta, Haridāsa Ṭhākura and all the other devotees of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya—bowing down with devotion, I hold their lotus feet on my head.

PURPORT

The author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* teaches us that we must offer our respectful obeisances to all such pure confidential devotees of Lord Caitanya if we indeed want to know Him in truth.

TEXT 229

ṣaṣṭha-slokerā ei kahila ābhāsa

mūla slokerā artha śuna kariye prakāśa

SYNONYMS

ṣaṣṭha-slokerā—of the sixth verse; *ei*—this; *kahila*—has been spoken; *ābhāsa*—a hint; *mūla slokerā*—of the original verse; *artha*—meaning; *śuna*—please hear; *kariye prakāśa*—I am revealing.

TRANSLATION

I have given a hint of the sixth verse. Now please hear as I reveal the meaning of that original verse.

TEXT 230

śrī-rādhāyāḥ praṇaya-mahimā kīḍṛśo vānayaivā-

svādyo yenaḍbhuta-madhurimā kīḍṛśo vā madīyaḥ

saukhyam cāsyā mad-anubhavataḥ kīḍṛśam veti lobhāt

tad-bhāvāḍhyaḥ samajani śacī-garbha-sindhau harīnduḥ

SYNONYMS

śrī-rādhāyāḥ—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *praṇaya-mahimā*—the greatness of the love; *kīḍṛśaḥ*—of what kind; *vā*—or; *anaya*—by this one (Rādhā); *eva*—alone; *āsvādyāḥ*—to be relished; *yena*—by that love; *adbhuta-madhurimā*—the wonderful sweetness; *kīḍṛśaḥ*—of what kind; *vā*—or; *madīyaḥ*—of Me; *saukhyam*—the happiness; *ca*—and; *asyāḥ*—Her; *mat-anubhavataḥ*—from realization of My sweetness; *kīḍṛśam*—of what

kind; *vā*—or; *iti*—thus; *lobhāt*—from the desire; *tat*—Her; *bhāva-āḍhyaḥ*—richly endowed with the emotions; *samajani*—took birth; *śacī-garbha*—of the womb of Śacī-devī; *sindhau*—in the ocean; *hari*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *induḥ*—like the moon.

TRANSLATION

“Desiring to understand the glory of Rādhārāṇī’s love, the wonderful qualities in Him that She alone relishes through Her love, and the happiness She feels when She realizes the sweetness of His love, the Supreme Lord Hari, richly endowed with Her emotions, appeared from the womb of Śrīmatī Śacī-devī, as the moon appeared from the ocean.”

TEXT 231

e saba siddhānta gūḍha, — — kahite nā yuyāya

nā kahile, keha ihāra anta nāhi pāya

SYNONYMS

e—this; *saba*—all; *siddhānta*—conclusions; *gūḍha*—very confidential; *kahite*—to speak; *nā*—not; *yuyāya*—quite fit; *nā*—not; *kahile*—speaking; *keha*—anyone; *ihāra*—of it; *anta*—end; *nāhi*—not; *pāya*—gets.

TRANSLATION

All these conclusions are unfit to disclose in public. But if they are not disclosed, no one will understand them.

TEXT 232

ataeva kahi kichu kariñā nigūḍha

bujhibe rasika bhakta, nā bujhibe mūḍha

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *kahi*—I speak; *kichu*—something; *kariṇā*—squeezing; *nigūḍha*—essence; *bujhibe*—can understand; *rasika*—humorous; *bhakta*—devotees; *nā*—not; *bujhibe*—will understand; *mūḍha*—rascals.

TRANSLATION

Therefore I shall mention them, revealing only their essence, so that loving devotees will understand them but fools will not.

TEXT 233

hṛdaye dharaye ye caitanya-nityānanda

e-saba siddhānte sei pāibe ānanda

SYNONYMS

hṛdaye—in the heart; *dharaye*—captures; *ye*—anyone who; *caitanya*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānanda*—and Lord Nityānanda; *e-saba*—all these; *siddhānte*—by transcendental conclusions; *sei*—that man; *pāibe*—will get; *ānanda*—bliss.

TRANSLATION

Anyone who has captured Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Lord Nityānanda Prabhu in his heart will become blissful by hearing all these transcendental conclusions.

TEXT 234

e saba siddhānta haya āmrera pallava

bhakta-gaṇa-kokilera sarvadā vallabha

SYNONYMS

e—these; *saba*—all; *siddhānta*—transcendental conclusions; *haya*—are; *āmrera*—of mango; *pallava*—twigs; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees; *kokilera*—to those who are just like cuckoo birds; *sarvadā*—always; *vallabha*—pleasing.

TRANSLATION

All these conclusions are like the newly grown twigs of a mango tree; they are always pleasing to the devotees, who in this way resemble cuckoo birds.

TEXT 235

abhakta-uṣṭrera ithe nā haya praveśa

tabe citte haya mora ānanda-viśeṣa

SYNONYMS

abhakta—nondevotee; *uṣṭrera*—of a camel; *ithe*—in this; *nā*—not; *haya*—is there; *praveśa*—entrance; *tabe*—then; *citte*—in my heart; *haya*—there is; *mora*—my; *ānanda-viśeṣa*—special jubilation.

TRANSLATION

The camellike nondevotees cannot enter into these topics. Therefore there is special jubilation in my heart.

TEXT 236

ye lāgi kahite bhaya, se yadi nā jāne

ihā va-i kibā sukha āche tribhuvane

SYNONYMS

ye lāgi—for the matter of which; *kahite bhaya*—afraid to speak; *se yadi nā jāne*—if they do not know; *ihā va-i*—except this; *kibā*—what; *sukha*—happiness; *āche*—there is; *tri-bhuvane*—in the three worlds.

TRANSLATION

For fear of them I do not wish to speak, but if they do not understand, then what can be happier in all the three worlds?

TEXT 237

ataeva bhakta-gaṇe kari namaskāra

niḥśaṅke kahiye, tāra hauk camatkāra

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *bhakta-gaṇe*—unto the devotees; *kari*—I offer; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *niḥśaṅke*—without any doubt; *kahiye*—I say; *tāra*—of the devotees; *hauk*—let there be; *camatkāra*—astonishment.

TRANSLATION

Therefore after offering obeisances to the devotees, for their satisfaction I shall speak without hesitating.

TEXT 238

kṛṣṇera vicara eka āchaye antare

pūrṇānanda-pūrṇa-rasa-rūpa kahe more

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vicāra*—consideration; *eka*—one; *āchaye*—is; *antare*—within the heart; *pūrṇa-ānanda*—complete transcendental bliss; *pūrṇa-rasa-rūpa*—full with transcendental mellows; *kahe more*—they say unto Me.

TRANSLATION

Once Lord Kṛṣṇa considered within His heart, “Everyone says that I am complete bliss, full of all rasas.

TEXT 239

āmā ha-ite ānandita haya tribhuvana

āmāke ānanda dibe— —aiche kon jana

SYNONYMS

āmā ha-ite—from Me; *ānandita*—pleased; *haya*—becomes; *tri-bhuvana*—all the three worlds; *āmāke*—unto Me; *ānanda dibe*—will give pleasure; *aiche*—such; *kon jana*—what person.

TRANSLATION

“All the world derives pleasure from Me. Is there anyone who can give Me pleasure?

TEXT 240

āmā haite yāra haya śata śata guṇa

sei-jana āhlādite pāre mora mana

SYNONYMS

āmā haite—than Me; *yāra*—whose; *haya*—there is; *śata śata guṇa*—hundreds of qualities more; *sei-jana*—that person; *āhlādite*—to give pleasure; *pāre*—is able; *mora*—My; *mana*—to the mind.

TRANSLATION

“One who has a hundred times more qualities than Me could give pleasure to My mind.

TEXT 241

āmā haite guṇī baḍa jagate asambhava

ekali rādhāte tāhā kari anubhava

SYNONYMS

āmā haite—than Me; *guṇī*—qualified; *baḍa*—greater; *jagate*—in the world; *asambhava*—there is no possibility; *ekali*—only; *rādhāte*—in Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *tāhā*—that; *kari anubhava*—I can understand.

TRANSLATION

“One more qualified than Me is impossible to find in the world. But in Rādhā alone I feel the presence of one who can give Me pleasure.

TEXTS 242–243

koṭi-kāma jini’ rūpa yadyapi āmāra

asamordhva-mādhurya—sāmya nāhi yāra

mora rūpe āpyāyita haya tribhuvana

rādhāra darśane mora juḍāya nayana

SYNONYMS

koṭi-kāma—ten million Cupids; *jini'*—conquering; *rūpa*—beauty; *yadyapi*—although; *āmāra*—Mine; *asama-ūrdhva*—unequaled and unsurpassed; *mādhurya*—sweetness; *sāmya*—equality; *nāhi*—there is not; *yāra*—of whom; *mora*—My; *rūpe*—in beauty; *āpyāyita*—pleased; *haya*—becomes; *tri-bhuvana*—all three worlds; *rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *darśane*—seeing; *mora*—My; *juḍāya*—satisfies; *nayana*—eyes.

TRANSLATION

“Although My beauty defeats the beauty of ten million Cupids, although it is unequaled and unsurpassed, and although it gives pleasure to the three worlds, seeing Rādhārāṇī gives pleasure to My eyes.

TEXT 244

mora vaṁsī-gīte ākarṣaye tri-bhuvana

rādhāra vacane hare āmāra śravaṇa

SYNONYMS

mora—My; *vaṁsī-gīte*—by the vibration of the flute; *ākarṣaye*—I attract; *tri-bhuvana*—the three worlds; *rādhāra vacane*—the words of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *hare*—conquers; *āmāra*—My; *śravaṇa*—hearing power.

TRANSLATION

“The vibration of My transcendental flute attracts the three worlds, but My ears are enchanted by the sweet words of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 245

yadyapi āmāra gandhe jagat sugandha

mora citta-prāṇa hare rādhā-aṅga-gandha

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *āmāra*—My; *gandhe*—by the fragrance; *jagat*—the whole universe; *su-gandha*—sweet-smelling; *mora*—My; *citta-prāṇa*—mind and heart; *hare*—attracts; *rādhā*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *aṅga*—bodily; *gandha*—flavor.

TRANSLATION

“Although My body lends fragrance to the entire creation, the scent of Rādhārāṇī’s limbs captivates My mind and heart.

TEXT 246

yadyapi āmāra rase jagat sarasa

rādhāra adhara-rasa āmā kare vaśa

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *āmāra*—of Me; *rase*—by the taste; *jagat*—the whole world; *sa-rasa*—is palatable; *rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *adhara-rasa*—the taste of the lips; *āmā*—Me; *kare*—makes; *vaśa*—submissive.

TRANSLATION

“Although the entire creation is full of different tastes because of Me, I am charmed by the nectarean taste of the lips of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 247

yadyapi āmāra sparsā koṭīndu-sītala

rādhikāra sparsē āmā kare suśītala

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *āmāra*—My; *sparsā*—touch; *koṭī-indu*—like millions upon millions of moons; *sītala*—cool; *rādhikāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *sparsē*—the touch; *āmā*—Me; *kare*—makes; *su-sītala*—very, very cool.

TRANSLATION

“And although My touch is cooler than ten million moons, I am refreshed by the touch of Śrīmatī Rādhikā.

TEXT 248

ei mata jagatera sukhe āmi hetu

rādhikāra rūpa-guṇa āmāra jīvātu

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *jagatera*—of the whole world; *sukhe*—in the matter of happiness; *āmi*—I am; *hetu*—the cause; *rādhikāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *rūpa-guṇa*—beauty and attributes; *āmāra*—My; *jīvātu*—life and soul.

TRANSLATION

“Thus although I am the source of happiness for the entire world, the beauty and attributes of Śrī Rādhikā are My life and soul.

TEXT 249

ei mata anubhava āmāra pratīta

vicāri’ dekhiye yadī, saba viparīta

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *anubhava*—affectionate feelings; *āmāra*—My; *pratīta*—understood; *vicāri’*—by consideration; *dekhiye*—I see; *yadī*—if; *saba*—everything; *viparīta*—contrary.

TRANSLATION

“In this way My affectionate feelings for Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī may be understood, but on analysis I find them contradictory.

TEXT 250

rādhāra darśane mora juḍāya nayana

āmāra darśane rādhā sukhe ageyāna

SYNONYMS

rādhāra—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *darśane*—in meeting; *mora*—My; *juḍāya*—are satisfied; *nayana*—eyes; *āmāra*—of Me; *darśane*—in meeting; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *sukhe*—in happiness; *ageyāna*—more advanced.

TRANSLATION

“My eyes are fully satisfied when I look upon Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, but by looking upon Me, She becomes even more advanced in satisfaction.

TEXT 251

paraspara veṇu-gīte haraye cetana

mora bhrame tamālere kare ālīngana

SYNONYMS

paraspara—against each other; *veṇu-gīte*—the singing of the bamboo; *haraye*—attracts; *cetana*—consciousness; *mora*—of Me; *bhrame*—in mistake; *tamālere*—a black tree known as *tamāla*; *kare*—She does; *ālīngana*—embracing.

TRANSLATION

“The flutelike murmur of the bamboos rubbing against one another steals Rādhārāṇī’s consciousness, for She thinks it to be the sound of My flute. And She embraces a tamāla tree, mistaking it for Me.

TEXT 252

kṛṣṇa-ālīngana pāinu, janama saphale

kṛṣṇa-sukhe magna rahe vṛkṣa kari’ kole

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ālīngana*—the embrace; *pāinu*—I have gotten; *janama sa-phale*—My birth is now fulfilled; *kṛṣṇa-sukhe*—in the matter of pleasing Kṛṣṇa; *magna*—immersed; *rahe*—She remains; *vṛkṣa*—the tree; *kari’*—taking; *kole*—on the lap.

TRANSLATION

“I have gotten the embrace of Śrī Kṛṣṇa,’ She thinks, ‘so now My life is fulfilled.’ Thus She remains immersed in pleasing Kṛṣṇa, taking the tree in Her arms.

TEXT 253

anukūla-vāte yadi pāya mora gandha

uḍiyā paḍite cāhe, preme haya andha

SYNONYMS

anukūla-vāte—in a favorable breeze; *yadi*—if; *pāya*—there is; *mora*—My; *gandha*—fragrance; *uḍiyā*—flying; *paḍite*—to drop; *cāhe*—She wants; *preme*—in ecstatic love; *haya*—becomes; *andha*—blind.

TRANSLATION

“When a favorable breeze carries to Her the fragrance of My body, She is blinded by love and tries to fly into that breeze.

TEXT 254

tāmbūla-carvita yabe kare āsvādane

ānanda-samudre ḍube, kichui nā jāne

SYNONYMS

tāmbūla—betel nut; *carvita*—chewed; *yabe*—when; *kare*—does; *āsvādane*—tasting; *ānanda-samudre*—in an ocean of transcendental bliss; *ḍube*—drowns; *kichui*—anything; *nā*—not; *jāne*—knows.

TRANSLATION

“When She tastes the betel chewed by Me, She merges in an ocean of joy and forgets everything else.

TEXT 255

āmāra saṅgame rādhā pāya ye ānanda

śata-mukhe bali, tabu nā pāi tāra anta

SYNONYMS

āmāra—My; *saṅgame*—in association; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *pāya*—gets; *ye*—whatever; *ānanda*—transcendental bliss; *śata-mukhe*—in hundreds of mouths; *bali*—if I say; *tabu*—still; *nā*—not; *pāi*—I reach; *tāra*—its; *anta*—limitation.

TRANSLATION

“Even with hundreds of mouths I could not express the transcendental pleasure She derives from My association.

TEXT 256

līlā-ante sukhe inhāra aṅgera mādhuri

tāhā dekhi’ sukhe āmi āpanā pāsari

SYNONYMS

līlā-ante—at the end of Our pastimes; *sukhe*—in happiness; *inhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *aṅgera*—of the body; *mādhuri*—sweetness; *tāhā*—that; *dekhi’*—seeing; *sukhe*—in happiness; *āmi*—I; *āpanā*—Myself; *pāsari*—forget.

TRANSLATION

“Seeing the luster of Her complexion after Our pastimes together, I forget My own identity in happiness.

TEXT 257

doñhāra ye sama-rasa, bharata-muni māne

āmāra vrajera rasa seha nāhi jāne

SYNONYMS

doñhāra—of both; *ye*—whatever; *sama-rasa*—equal mellows; *bharata-muni*—the saintly person named Bharata Muni; *māne*—accepts; *āmāra*—My; *vrajera*—of Vṛndāvana; *rasa*—mellows; *seha*—he; *nāhi*—not; *jāne*—knows.

TRANSLATION

“The sage Bharata has said that the mellows of lover and beloved are equal. But he does not know the mellows of My Vṛndāvana.

PURPORT

According to expert sexologists like Bharata Muni, the male and the female enjoy equally in material sexual pleasure. But in the spiritual world the relationships are different, although this is unknown to mundane experts.

TEXT 258

anyera saṅgame āmi yata sukha pāi

tāhā haite rādhā-sukha śata adhikāi

SYNONYMS

anyera—others; *saṅgame*—by meeting; *āmi*—I; *yata*—all; *sukha*—happiness; *pāi*—get; *tāhā haite*—than that; *rādhā-sukha*—happiness by association with Rādhārāṇī; *śata*—one hundred times; *adhikāi*—increased.

TRANSLATION

“The happiness I feel when meeting Rādhārāṇī is a hundred times greater than the happiness I get from meeting others.

TEXT 259

nirdhūtāmṛta-mādhurī-parimalaḥ kalyāṇi bimbādhara

vaktram pañkaja-saurabham kuharita-ślāghā-bhidas te girāḥ

aṅgam candana-śītaḥ tanur iyaṁ saundarya-sarvasva-bhāk

tvām āśādyā mamedam indriya-kulam rādhe muhur modate

SYNONYMS

nirdhūta—defeats; *amṛta*—of nectar; *mādhurī*—the sweetness; *parimalaḥ*—whose flavor; *kalyāṇi*—O most auspicious one; *bimba-adharaḥ*—red lips; *vaktram*—face; *pañkaja-saurabham*—which smells like a lotus flower; *kuharita*—of the sweet sounds made by the cuckoos; *ślāghā*—the pride; *bhidaḥ*—which defeat; *te*—Your; *girāḥ*—words; *aṅgam*—limbs; *candana-śītaḥ*—as cool as sandalwood pulp; *tanuḥ*—body; *iyaṁ*—this; *saundarya*—of beauty; *sarva-sva-bhāk*—which displays the all-in-all; *tvām*—You; *āśādyā*—tasting; *mama*—My; *idaṁ*—this; *indriya-kulam*—all the senses; *rādhe*—O Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *muhur*—again and again; *modate*—become pleased.

TRANSLATION

“My dear auspicious Rādhārāṇī, Your body is the source of all beauty. Your red lips are softer than the sense of immortal sweetness, Your face bears the aroma of a lotus flower, Your sweet words defeat the vibrations of the cuckoo, and Your limbs are cooler than the pulp of sandalwood. All My transcendental senses are overwhelmed in ecstatic pleasure by tasting You, who are completely decorated by beautiful qualities.’

PURPORT

This verse, spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa to Rādhā, is recorded in the *Lalita-mādhava* (9.9) of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 260

rūpe kām̐sa-harasya lubdha-nayanām sparśe ’tihr̥ṣyat-tvacam

vāṇyām utkalita-śrutim̐ parimale sam̐hr̥ṣṭa-nāsā-putām

ārajyat-rasanām̐ kilādhara-pute nyañcan-mukhāmbho-ruhām̐

dambhodgīrṇa-mahā-dhṛtim̐ bahir api prodyad-vikārākulām

SYNONYMS

rūpe—in the beauty; *kām̐sa-harasya*—of Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kām̐sa; *lubdha*—captivated; *nayanām*—whose eyes; *sparśe*—in the touch; *ati-hṛṣyat*—very jubilant; *tvacam*—whose skin; *vāṇyām*—in the vibration of the words; *utkalita*—very eager; *śrutim̐*—whose ear; *parimale*—in the fragrance; *sam̐hr̥ṣṭa*—stolen by happiness; *nāsā-putām*—whose nostrils; *ārajyat*—being completely attracted; *rasanām̐*—whose tongue; *kila*—what to speak of; *adhara-pute*—to the lips; *nyañcat*—bending down; *mukha*—whose face; *ambhaḥ-ruhām̐*—like a lotus flower; *dambha*—by pride; *udgīrṇa*—manifesting; *mahā-dhṛtim̐*—great patience; *bahir*—

externally; *api*—although; *prodyat*—manifesting; *vikāra*—transformations; *ākulām*—overwhelmed.

TRANSLATION

“Her eyes are enchanted by the beauty of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kāṁsa. Her body thrills in pleasure at His touch. Her ears are always attracted to His sweet voice, Her nostrils are enchanted by His fragrance, and Her tongue hankers for the nectar of His soft lips. She hangs down her lotuslike face, exercising self-control only by pretense, but She cannot help showing the external signs of Her spontaneous love for Lord Kṛṣṇa.’

PURPORT

Thus Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī describes the countenance of Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 261

tāte jāni, mote āche kona eka rasa

āmāra mohinī rādhā, tāre kare vaśa

SYNONYMS

tāte—thereupon; *jāni*—I can understand; *mote*—in Me; *āche*—there is; *kona*—some; *eka*—one; *rasa*—transcendental mellow; *āmāra*—My; *mohinī*—captivator; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *tāre*—Her; *kare vaśa*—subdues.

TRANSLATION

“Considering this, I can understand that some unknown mellow in Me controls the entire existence of My captivator, Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 262

āmā haite rādhā pāya ye jātiya sukha

tāhā āsvādite āmi sadāi unmukha

SYNONYMS

āmā haite—from Me; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *pāya*—gets; *ye*—whatever; *jātiya*—types of; *sukha*—happiness; *tāhā*—that; *āsvādite*—to taste; *āmi*—I; *sadāi*—always; *unmukha*—very eager.

TRANSLATION

“I am always eager to taste the joy that Rādhārāṇī derives from Me.

TEXT 263

nānā yatna kari āmi, nāri āsvādite

sei sukha-mādhurya-ghrāṇe lobha bāḍhe citte

SYNONYMS

nānā—various; *yatna*—attempts; *kari*—do; *āmi*—I; *nāri*—I am not able; *āsvādite*—to taste; *sei*—that; *sukha*—of the happiness; *mādhurya*—the sweetness; *ghrāṇe*—by smelling; *lobha*—desire; *bāḍhe*—increases; *citte*—in the mind.

TRANSLATION

“In spite of various efforts, I have not been able to taste it. But My desire to relish that pleasure increases as I smell its sweetness.

TEXT 264

rasa āsvādīte āmi kaila avatāra

prema-rasa āsvādīla vividha prakāra

SYNONYMS

rasa—mellows; *āsvādīte*—to taste; *āmi*—I; *kaila*—made; *avatāra*—incarnation; *prema-rasa*—transcendental mellows of love; *āsvādīla*—I tasted; *vividha prakāra*—different varieties of.

TRANSLATION

“Formerly I appeared in the world to taste mellows, and I tasted the mellows of pure love in various ways.

TEXT 265

rāga-mārga bhakta bhakti kare ye prakāre

tāhā śikhāila līlā-ācaraṇa-dvāre

SYNONYMS

rāga-mārga—on the path of spontaneous love; *bhakta*—the devotee; *bhakti*—devotional service; *kare*—does; *ye prakāre*—in what way; *tāhā*—that; *śikhāila*—I taught; *līlā*—pastimes; *ācaraṇa-dvāre*—by means of practical demonstration.

TRANSLATION

“I taught devotional service that springs from the devotees’ spontaneous love by demonstrating it with My pastimes.

TEXT 266

ei tina tṛṣṇā mora nahila pūraṇa

viṣṭīya-bhāve nahe tāhā āsvādana

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *tina*—three; *tṛṣṇā*—desires; *mora*—My; *nahila*—were not; *pūraṇa*—satisfied; *viṣṭīya*—of the opposite partner of a relationship; *bhāve*—in ecstasy; *nahe*—is not possible; *tāhā*—that; *āsvādana*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

“But these three desires of Mine were not satisfied, for one cannot enjoy them in a contrary position.

TEXT 267

rādhikāra bhāva-kānti aṅgikāra vine

sei tina sukha kabhu nahe āsvādane

SYNONYMS

rādhikāra—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bhāva-kānti*—luster of ecstatic love; *aṅgikāra*—accepting; *vine*—without; *sei*—those; *tina*—three; *sukha*—happiness; *kabhu*—at any time; *nahe*—is not possible; *āsvādane*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

“Unless I accept the luster of the ecstatic love of Śrī Rādhikā, these three desires cannot be fulfilled.

TEXT 268

rādhā-bhāva aṅgikari' dhari' tāra varṇa

tina-sukha āsvādite haba avatīrṇa

SYNONYMS

rādhā-bhāva—the moods of Rādhārāṇī; *aṅgikari'*—accepting; *dhari'*—taking; *tāra varṇa*—Her bodily complexion; *tina*—three; *sukha*—happiness; *āsvādite*—to taste; *haba*—I shall; *avatīrṇa*—descend as an incarnation.

TRANSLATION

“Therefore, assuming Rādhārāṇī’s sentiments and bodily complexion, I shall descend to fulfill these three desires.”

TEXT 269

sarva-bhāve kaila kṛṣṇa ei ta' niścaya

hena-kāle āila yugāvatāra-samaya

SYNONYMS

sarva-bhāve—in all respects; *kaila*—made; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ei*—this; *ta'*—certainly; *niścaya*—decision; *hena-kāle*—at this time; *āila*—came; *yuga-avatāra*—of the incarnation according to the age; *samaya*—the time.

TRANSLATION

In this way Lord Kṛṣṇa came to a decision. Simultaneously, the time came for the incarnation of the age.

TEXT 270

sei-kāle śrī-advaita kareṇa ārādhana

tāñhāra huñkāre kaila kṛṣṇe ākarṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

sei-kāle—at that time; *śrī-advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *kareṇa*—performs; *ārādhana*—worship; *tāñhāra*—of Him; *huñkāre*—by the tumultuous call; *kaila*—did; *kṛṣṇe*—to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ākarṣaṇa*—attraction.

TRANSLATION

At that time Śrī Advaita was earnestly worshiping Him. Advaita attracted Him with His loud calls.

TEXTS 271–272

pitā-mātā, guru-gaṇa, āge avatāri'

rādhikāra bhāva-varṇa aṅgikāra kari'

nava-dvīpe śacī-garbha-śuddha-dugdha-sindhu

tāhāte prakāṣa hailā kṛṣṇa pūrṇa indu

SYNONYMS

pitā-mātā—parents; *guru-gaṇa*—teachers; *āge*—first; *avatāri'*—descending; *rādhikāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bhāva-varṇa*—the luster of transcendental ecstasy; *aṅgikāra kari'*—accepting; *navadvīpe*—in Navadvīpa; *śacī-garbha*—the womb of Śacī; *śuddha*—pure; *dugdha-sindhu*—the ocean of milk; *tāhāte*—in that; *prakāṣa*—manifested; *hailā*—became; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pūrṇa indu*—full moon.

TRANSLATION

First Lord Kṛṣṇa made His parents and elders appear. Then Kṛṣṇa Himself, with the sentiments and complexion of Rādhikā, appeared in Navadvīpa, like the full moon, from the womb of mother Śacī, which is like an ocean of pure milk.

TEXT 273

ei ta' kariluṁ ṣaṣṭha ślokerā vyākhyāna

śrī-rūpa-gosāñīra pāda-padma kari' dhyāna

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—thus; *kariluṁ*—I have made; *ṣaṣṭha ślokerā*—of the sixth verse; *vyākhyāna*—explanation; *śrī-rūpa*—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *gosāñīra*—of the master; *pāda-padma*—lotus feet; *kari'*—doing; *dhyāna*—meditation.

TRANSLATION

Meditating on the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, I have thus explained the sixth verse.

TEXT 274

ei dui ślokerā āmi ye karila artha

śrī-rūpa-gosāñīra śloka pramāṇa samartha

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *dui*—two; *ślokerā*—of the verses; *āmi*—I; *ye*—whatever; *karila*—gave; *artha*—the meanings; *śrī-rūpa-gosāñīra*—of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī; *śloka*—verse; *pramāṇa*—evidence; *samartha*—competent.

TRANSLATION

I can support the explanation of these two verses [verses 5 and 6 of the First Chapter] with a verse by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 275

apāraṁ kasyāpi praṇayi-jana-vṛndasya kutukī

rasa-stomaṁ hṛtvā madhuram upabhoktum kam api yaḥ

rucam svām āvavre dyutim iha tadīyām prakāṣayan

sa devaś caitanyākṛtir atitarām naḥ kṛpayatu

SYNONYMS

apāram—boundless; *kasya api*—of someone; *praṇayi-jana-vṛndasya*—of the multitude of lovers; *kutukī*—one who is curious; *rasa-stomaṁ*—the group of mellows; *hṛtvā*—stealing; *madhuram*—sweet; *upabhoktum*—to enjoy; *kam api*—some; *yaḥ*—who; *rucam*—luster; *svām*—own; *āvavre*—covered; *dyutim*—luster; *iha*—here; *tadīyām*—related to Him; *prakāṣayan*—manifesting; *saḥ*—He; *devaḥ*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *caitanya-ākṛtiḥ*—having the form of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *atitarām*—greatly; *naḥ*—unto us; *kṛpayatu*—may He show His mercy.

TRANSLATION

“Lord Kṛṣṇa desired to taste the limitless nectarean mellows of the love possessed by one of His multitude of loving damsels [Śrī Rādhā], and so He has assumed the form of Lord Caitanya. He has tasted that love while hiding His own dark complexion with Her effulgent yellow color. May that Lord Caitanya confer upon us His grace.”

PURPORT

This is the third verse of the second *Caitanyāṣṭaka* of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī's *Stava-mālā*.

TEXT 276

maṅgalācaraṇam kṛṣṇa-

caitanya-tattva-lakṣaṇam

prayojanam cāvatāre

śloka-ṣaṭkair nirūpitam

SYNONYMS

maṅgala-ācaraṇam—invoking auspiciousness; *kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tattva-lakṣaṇam*—symptoms of the truth; *prayojanam*—necessity; *ca*—also; *avatāre*—in the matter of His incarnation; *śloka*—verses; *ṣaṭkaiḥ*—by six; *nirūpitam*—ascertained.

TRANSLATION

Thus the auspicious invocation, the essential nature of the truth of Lord Caitanya, and the need for His appearance have been set forth in six verses.

TEXT 277

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa

Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Fourth Chapter, describing the confidential reasons for the appearance of Lord Caitanya.

Chapter 5

The Glories Of Lord Nityānanda Balarāma

This chapter is chiefly devoted to describing the essential nature and glories of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the absolute Personality of Godhead, and His first expansion in a form for pastimes is Śrī Balarāma.

Beyond the limitation of this material world is the spiritual sky, *paravyoma*, which has many spiritual planets, the supreme of which is called Kṛṣṇaloka. Kṛṣṇaloka, the abode of Kṛṣṇa, has three divisions, which are known as Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula. In that abode the Personality of Godhead expands Himself into four plenary portions—Kṛṣṇa, Balarāma, Pradyumna (the transcendental Cupid) and Aniruddha. They are known as the original quadruple forms.

In Kṛṣṇaloka is a transcendental place known as Śvetadvīpa or Vṛndāvana. Below Kṛṣṇaloka in the spiritual sky are the Vaikuṇṭha planets. On each Vaikuṇṭha planet a four-handed Nārāyaṇa, expanded

from the first quadruple manifestation, is present. The Personality of Godhead known as Śrī Balarāma in Kṛṣṇaloka is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa (attracting Deity), and from this Saṅkarṣaṇa expands another Saṅkarṣaṇa, called Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa, who resides in one of the Vaikuṇṭha planets. By His internal potency, Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa maintains the transcendental existence of all the planets in the spiritual sky, where all the living beings are eternally liberated souls. The influence of the material energy is conspicuous there by its absence. On those planets the second quadruple manifestation is present.

Outside of the Vaikuṇṭha planets is the impersonal manifestation of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, which is known as Brahmaloka. On the other side of Brahmaloka is the spiritual *kāraṇa-samudra*, or Causal Ocean. The material energy exists on the other side of the Causal Ocean, without touching it. In the Causal Ocean is Mahā-Viṣṇu, the original *puruṣa* expansion from Saṅkarṣaṇa. Mahā-Viṣṇu places His glance over the material energy, and by a reflection of His transcendental body He amalgamates Himself within the material elements.

As the source of the material elements, the material energy is known as *pradhāna*, and as the source of the manifestations of the material energy it is known as *māyā*. But material nature is inert in that she has no independent power to do anything. She is empowered to make the cosmic manifestation by the glance of Mahā-Viṣṇu. Therefore the material energy is not the original cause of the material manifestation. Rather, the transcendental glance of Mahā-Viṣṇu over material nature produces that cosmic manifestation.

Mahā-Viṣṇu again enters every universe as the reservoir of all living entities, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. From Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu expands Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, the Supersoul of every living entity. Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu also has His own Vaikuṇṭha planet in every universe, where He lives as the Supersoul or supreme controller of the universe. Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu reclines in the midst of the watery portion of the universe and generates the first living creature of the

universe, Brahmā. The imaginary universal form is a partial manifestation of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu.

On the Vaikuṇṭha planet in every universe is an ocean of milk, and within that ocean is an island called Śvetadvīpa, where Lord Viṣṇu lives. Therefore this chapter describes two Śvetadvīpas—one in the abode of Kṛṣṇa and the other in the ocean of milk in every universe. The Śvetadvīpa in the abode of Kṛṣṇa is identical with Vṛndāvana-dhāma, which is the place where Kṛṣṇa appears Himself to display His loving pastimes. In the Śvetadvīpa within every universe is a Śeṣa form of Godhead who serves Viṣṇu by assuming the form of His umbrella, slippers, couch, pillows, garments, residence, sacred thread, throne and so on.

Lord Baladeva in Kṛṣṇaloka is Nityānanda Prabhu. Therefore Nityānanda Prabhu is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa, and Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa and His expansions as the *puruṣas* in the universes are plenary expansions of Nityānanda Prabhu.

In this chapter the author has described the history of his leaving home for a personal pilgrimage to Vṛndāvana and his achieving all success there. In this description it is revealed that the author's original paternal home and birthplace were in the district of Katwa, in the village of Jhāmaṭapura, which is near Naihātī. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja's brother invited Śrī Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa, a great devotee of Lord Nityānanda, to his home, but a priest named Guṇārṇava Mīśra did not receive him well, and Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī's brother, not recognizing the glories of Lord Nityānanda, also took sides with the priest. Therefore Rāmadāsa became sorry, broke his flute and went away. This was a great disaster for the brother of Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī. But on that very night Lord Nityānanda Prabhu Himself graced Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī in a dream and ordered him to leave on the next day for Vṛndāvana.

TEXT 1

vande 'nantādbhutaiśvaryam

śrī-nityānandam īśvaram

yasyecchayā tat-svarūpam

ajñenāpi nirūpyate

SYNONYMS

vande—let me offer my obeisances; *ananta*—unlimited; *adbhuta*—and wonderful; *aiśvaryam*—whose opulence; *śrī-nityānandam*—unto Lord Nityānanda; *īśvaram*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *yasya*—whose; *icchayā*—by the will; *tat-svarūpam*—His identity; *ajñena*—by the ignorant; *api*—even; *nirūpyate*—can be ascertained.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my obeisances to Lord Śrī Nityānanda, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, whose opulence is wonderful and unlimited. By His will, even a fool can understand His identity.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-caitanya*—to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jaya nityānanda*—all glories to Lord Nityānanda; *jaya advaita-candra*—all glories to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—all glories to the devotees of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu! All glories to Lord Nityānanda!
All glories to Advaita Ācārya! And all glories to all the devotees of Lord
Caitanya Mahāprabhu!

TEXT 3

ei ṣaṭ-sloke kahila kṛṣṇa-caitanya-mahimā

pañca-sloke kahi nityānanda-tattva-sīmā

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ṣaṭ-sloke*—in six verses; *kahila*—described; *kṛṣṇa-caitanya-mahimā*—the glories of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *pañca-sloke*—in five verses; *kahi*—let me explain; *nityānanda*—of Lord Nityānanda; *tattva*—of the truth; *sīmā*—the limitation.

TRANSLATION

I have described the glory of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya in six verses. Now, in five verses I shall describe the glory of Lord Nityānanda.

TEXT 4

sarva-avatārī kṛṣṇa svayam bhagavān

tānhāra dvitīya deha śrī-balarāma

SYNONYMS

sarva-avatārī—the source of all incarnations; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *svayam*—personally; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *tānhāra*—His; *dvitīya*—second; *deha*—expansion of the body; *śrī-*

balārāma—Lord Balarāma.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, is the fountainhead of all incarnations. Lord Balarāma is His second body.

PURPORT

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the absolute Personality of Godhead, is the primeval Lord, the original form of Godhead, and His first expansion is Śrī Balarāma. The Personality of Godhead can expand Himself in innumerable forms. The forms that have unlimited potency are called *svāmśa*, and forms that have limited potencies (the living entities) are called *vibhinnāmśa*.

TEXT 5

eka-i svarūpa donhe, bhinna-mātra kāya

ādya kāya-vyūha, kṛṣṇa-līlāra sahāya

SYNONYMS

eka-i—one; *svarūpa*—identity; *donhe*—both of Them; *bhinna-mātra kāya*—only two different bodies; *ādya*—original; *kāya-vyūha*—quadruple expansions; *kṛṣṇa-līlāra*—in the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sahāya*—assistance.

TRANSLATION

These two are one and the same identity. They differ only in form. Lord Balarāma is the first bodily expansion of Kṛṣṇa, and He assists in Lord Kṛṣṇa's transcendental pastimes.

PURPORT

Balarāma is a *svāṁśā* expansion of the Lord, and therefore there is no difference in potency between Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma. The only difference is in Their bodily structure. As the first expansion of Godhead, Balarāma is the chief Deity among the first quadruple forms, and He is the foremost assistant of Śrī Kṛṣṇa in His transcendental activities.

TEXT 6

sei kṛṣṇa—navadvīpe śrī-caitanya-candra

sei balarāma—saṅge śrī-nityānanda

SYNONYMS

sei kṛṣṇa—that original Kṛṣṇa; *navadvīpe*—at Navadvīpa; *śrī-caitanya-candra*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sei balarāma*—that Lord Balarāma; *saṅge*—with Him; *śrī-nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda.

TRANSLATION

That original Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared in Navadvīpa as Lord Caitanya, and Balarāma appeared with Him as Lord Nityānanda.

TEXT 7

saṅkarṣaṇaḥ kāraṇa-toya-sāyī

garbhoda-sāyī ca payobdhi-sāyī

śeṣaś ca yasyāṁśa-kalāḥ sa nityā-

nandākhya-rāmaḥ śaraṇaṁ mamāstu

SYNONYMS

sañkarṣaṇaḥ—Mahā-sañkarṣaṇa in the spiritual sky; *kāraṇa-toya-sāyī*—Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who lies in the Causal Ocean; *garbha-uda-sāyī*—Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who lies in the Garbhodaka Ocean of the universe; *ca*—and; *payah-abdhi-sāyī*—Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who lies in the ocean of milk; *śeṣaḥ*—Śeṣa Nāga, the couch of Viṣṇu; *ca*—and; *yasya*—whose; *aṁśa*—plenary portions; *kalāḥ*—and parts of the plenary portions; *saḥ*—He; *nityānanda-ākhyā*—known as Lord Nityānanda; *rāmaḥ*—Lord Balarāma; *śaraṇam*—shelter; *mama*—my; *astu*—let there be.

TRANSLATION

May Śrī Nityānanda Rāma be the object of my constant remembrance. Sañkarṣaṇa, Śeṣa Nāga and the Viṣṇus who lie on the Kāraṇa Ocean, Garbha Ocean and ocean of milk are His plenary portions and the portions of His plenary portions.

PURPORT

Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī has recorded this verse in his diary to offer his respectful obeisances to Lord Nityānanda Prabhu. This verse also appears as the seventh of the first fourteen verses of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 8

śrī-balarāma gosāñi mūla-sañkarṣaṇa

pañca-rūpa dhari' kareṇa kṛṣṇera sevana

SYNONYMS

śrī-balarāma—Balarāma; *gosāñi*—the Lord; *mūla-sañkarṣaṇa*—the

original Saṅkarṣaṇa; *pañca-rūpa dhari'*—accepting five bodies; *karena*—does; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sevana*—service.

TRANSLATION

Lord Balarāma is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa. He assumes five other forms to serve Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 9

āpane karena kṛṣṇa-līlāra sahāya

sṛṣṭi-līlā-kārya kare dhari' cāri kāya

SYNONYMS

āpane—personally; *karena*—performs; *kṛṣṇa-līlāra sahāya*—assistance in the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sṛṣṭi-līlā*—of the pastimes of creation; *kārya*—the work; *kare*—does; *dhari'*—accepting; *cāri kāya*—four bodies.

TRANSLATION

He Himself helps in the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and He does the work of creation in four other forms.

TEXT 10

sṛṣṭy-ādika sevā, — — tānra ājñāra pālana

'śeṣa'-rūpe kare kṛṣṇera vividha sevana

SYNONYMS

sṛṣṭi-ādika sevā—service in the matter of creation; *tānra*—His; *ājñāra*—

of the order; *pālana*—execution; *śeṣa-rūpe*—the form of Lord Śeṣa; *kare*—does; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vividha sevana*—varieties of service.

TRANSLATION

He executes the orders of Lord Kṛṣṇa in the work of creation, and in the form of Lord Śeṣa He serves Kṛṣṇa in various ways.

PURPORT

According to expert opinion, Balarāma, as the chief of the original quadruple forms, is also the original Saṅkarṣaṇa. Balarāma, the first expansion of Kṛṣṇa, expands Himself in five forms: (1) Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa, (2) Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, (3) Garbhodakaśāyī, (4) Kṣīrodakaśāyī, and (5) Śeṣa. These five plenary portions are responsible for both the spiritual and material cosmic manifestations. In these five forms Lord Balarāma assists Lord Kṛṣṇa in His activities. The first four of these forms are responsible for the cosmic manifestations, whereas Śeṣa is responsible for personal service to the Lord. Śeṣa is called Ananta, or unlimited, because He assists the Personality of Godhead in His unlimited expansions by performing an unlimited variety of services. Śrī Balarāma is the servitor Godhead who serves Lord Kṛṣṇa in all affairs of existence and knowledge. Lord Nityānanda Prabhu, who is the same servitor Godhead, Balarāma, performs the same service to Lord Gaurāṅga by constant association.

TEXT 11

sarva-rūpe āsvādaye kṛṣṇa-sevānanda

sei balarāma—gaura-saṅge nityānanda

SYNONYMS

sarva-rūpe—in all these forms; *āsvādaye*—tastes; *kṛṣṇa-sevā-ānanda*—

the transcendental bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa; *sei balarāma*—that Lord Balarāma; *gaura-saṅge*—with Gaurasundara; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda.

TRANSLATION

In all the forms He tastes the transcendental bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa. That same Balarāma is Lord Nityānanda, the companion of Lord Gaurasundara.

TEXT 12

saptama ślokerā artha kari cāri-śloke

yāte nityānanda-tattva jāne sarva-loke

SYNONYMS

saptama ślokerā—of the seventh verse; *artha*—the meaning; *kari*—I do; *cāri-śloke*—in four verses; *yāte*—in which; *nityānanda-tattva*—the truth of Lord Nityānanda; *jāne*—one knows; *sarva-loke*—all over the world.

TRANSLATION

I have explained the seventh verse in four subsequent verses. By these verses all the world can know the truth about Lord Nityānanda.

TEXT 13

māyātīte vyāpi-vaikuṇṭha-loke

pūrṇaiśvare śrī-catur-vyūha-madhye

rūpaṁ yasyodbhāti saṅkarṣaṇākhyam

taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmam prapadye

SYNONYMS

māyā-atīte—beyond the material creation; *vyāpi*—all-expanding; *vaikuṇṭha-loke*—in Vaikuṇṭhaloka, the spiritual world; *pūrṇa-aiśvārye*—endowed with full opulence; *śrī-catuḥ-vyūha-madhye*—in the quadruple expansions (Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha); *rūpam*—form; *yasya*—whose; *udbhāti*—appears; *saṅkarṣaṇa-ākhyam*—known as Saṅkarṣaṇa; *taṁ*—to Him; *śrī-nityānanda-rāmam*—to Lord Balarāma in the form of Lord Nityānanda; *prapadye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

I surrender unto the lotus feet of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, who is known as Saṅkarṣaṇa in the midst of the catur-vyūha [consisting of Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha]. He possesses full opulences and resides in Vaikuṇṭhaloka, far beyond the material creation.

PURPORT

This is a verse from Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī's diary. It appears as the eighth of the first fourteen verses of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 14

prakṛtira pāra 'paravyoma'-nāme dhāma

kṛṣṇa-vigraha yaiche vibhūty-ādi-guṇavān

SYNONYMS

prakṛtira—the material nature; *pāra*—beyond; *para-vyoma*—the spiritual sky; *nāme*—in name; *dhāma*—the place; *kṛṣṇa-vigraha*—the form of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yaiche*—just as; *vibhūti-ādi*—like the six opulences; *guṇa-vān*—full with transcendental attributes.

TRANSLATION

Beyond the material nature lies the realm known as paravyoma, the spiritual sky. Like Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself, it possesses all transcendental attributes, such as the six opulences.

PURPORT

According to Sāṅkhya philosophy, the material cosmos is composed of twenty-four elements: the five gross material elements, the three subtle material elements, the five knowledge-acquiring senses, the five active senses, the five objects of sense pleasure, and the *mahat-tattva* (the total material energy). Empiric philosophers, unable to go beyond these elements, speculate that anything beyond them must be *avyakta*, or inexplicable. But the world beyond the twenty-four elements is not inexplicable, for it is explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā* as the eternal (*sanātana*) nature. Beyond the manifested and unmanifested existence of material nature (*vyaktāvyakta*) is the *sanātana* nature, which is called the *paravyoma*, or the spiritual sky. Since that nature is spiritual in quality, there are no qualitative differences there: everything there is spiritual, everything is good, and everything possesses the spiritual form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself. That spiritual sky is the manifested internal potency of Śrī Kṛṣṇa; it is distinct from the material sky, manifested by His external potency.

The all-pervading Brahman, composed of the impersonal glowing rays of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, exists in the spiritual world with the Vaikuṇṭha planets. We can get some idea of that spiritual sky by a comparison to the material sky, for the rays of the sun in the material sky can be compared to the *brahmajyoti*, the glowing rays of the Personality of Godhead. In the

brahmajyoti there are unlimited Vaikuṇṭha planets, which are spiritual and therefore self-luminous, with a glow many times greater than that of the sun. The Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa, His innumerable plenary portions and the portions of His plenary portions dominate each Vaikuṇṭha planet. In the highest region of the spiritual sky is the planet called Kṛṣṇaloka, which has three divisions, namely Dvārakā, Mathurā and Goloka, or Gokula.

To a gross materialist this kingdom of God, Vaikuṇṭha, is certainly a mystery. But to an ignorant man everything is a mystery for want of sufficient knowledge. The kingdom of God is not a myth. Even the material planets, which float over our heads in the millions and billions, are still a mystery to the ignorant. Material scientists are now attempting to penetrate this mystery, and a day may come when the people of this earth will be able to travel in outer space and see the variegatedness of these millions of planets with their own eyes. In every planet there is as much material variegatedness as we find in our own planet.

This planet earth is but an insignificant spot in the cosmic structure. Yet foolish men, puffed up by a false sense of scientific advancement, have concentrated their energy in the pursuit of so-called economic development on this planet, not knowing of the variegated economic facilities available on other planets. According to modern astronomy, the gravity of the moon is different from that of earth. Therefore one who goes to the moon will be able to pick up large weights and jump vast distances. In the *Rāmāyaṇa*, Hanumān is described as being able to lift huge weights as heavy as hills and jump over the ocean. Modern astronomy has confirmed that this is indeed possible.

The disease of the modern civilized man is his disbelief of everything in the revealed scriptures. Faithless nonbelievers cannot make progress in spiritual realization, for they cannot understand the spiritual potency. The small fruit of a banyan contains hundreds of seeds, and in each seed is the potency to produce another banyan tree with the potency to produce millions more of such fruits. This law of nature is visible before

us, although how it works is beyond our understanding. This is but an insignificant example of the potency of Godhead; there are many similar phenomena that no scientist can explain.

Everything, in fact, is inconceivable, for the truth is revealed only to the proper persons. Although there are varieties of personalities, from Brahmā down to the insignificant ant, all of whom are living beings, their development of knowledge is different. Therefore we have to gather knowledge from the right source. Indeed, in reality we can get knowledge only from the Vedic sources. The four *Vedas*, with their supplementary *Purāṇas*, the *Mahābhārata*, the *Rāmāyaṇa* and their corollaries, which are known as *smṛtis*, are all authorized sources of knowledge. If we are at all to gather knowledge, we must gather it from these sources without hesitation.

Revealed knowledge may in the beginning be unbelievable because of our paradoxical desire to verify everything with our tiny brains, but the speculative means of attaining knowledge is always imperfect. The perfect knowledge propounded in the revealed scriptures is confirmed by the great *ācāryas*, who have left ample commentations upon them; none of these *ācāryas* has disbelieved in the *śāstras*. One who disbelieves in the *śāstras* is an atheist, and we should not consult an atheist, however great he may be. A staunch believer in the *śāstras*, with all their diversities, is the right person from whom to gather real knowledge. Such knowledge may seem inconceivable in the beginning, but when put forward by the proper authority its meaning is revealed, and then one no longer has any doubts about it.

TEXT 15

sarvaga, ananta, vibhu— —vaikuṇṭhādi dhāma

kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa-avatārera tāhāñi viśrāma

SYNONYMS

sarva-ga—all-pervading; *ananta*—unlimited; *vibhu*—greatest;
vaikuṇṭha-ādi dhāma—all the places known as Vaikuṇṭhaloka; *kṛṣṇa*—of
Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṣṇa-avatārera*—of the incarnations of Lord Kṛṣṇa;
tāhāñi—there; *viśrāma*—the residence.

TRANSLATION

That Vaikuṇṭha region is all-pervading, infinite and supreme. It is the
residence of Lord Kṛṣṇa and His incarnations.

TEXT 16

tāhāra upari-bhāge 'kṛṣṇa-loka'-khyāti

dvārakā-mathurā-gokula——*tri-vidhatve sthiti*

SYNONYMS

tāhāra—of all of them; *upari-bhāge*—on the top; *kṛṣṇa-loka-khyāti*—the
planet known as Kṛṣṇaloka; *dvārakā-mathurā-gokula*—the three places
known as Dvārakā, Mathurā and Vṛndāvana; *tri-vidhatve*—in three
departments; *sthiti*—situated.

TRANSLATION

In the highest region of that spiritual sky is the spiritual planet called
Kṛṣṇaloka. It has three divisions—Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula.

TEXT 17

sarvopari śrī-gokula——*vrajaloka-dhāma*

śrī-goloka, śvetadvīpa, vṛndāvana nāma

SYNONYMS

sarva-upari—above all of them; *śrī-gokula*—the place known as Gokula; *vraja-loka-dhāma*—the place of Vraja; *śrī-goloka*—the place named Goloka; *śveta-dvīpa*—the white island; *vṛndāvana nāma*—also named Vṛndāvana.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Gokula, the highest of all, is also called Vraja, Goloka, Śvetadvīpa and Vṛndāvana.

TEXT 18

sarvaga, ananta, vibhu, kṛṣṇa-tanu-sama

upary-adho vyāpiyāche, nāhika niyama

SYNONYMS

sarva-ga—all-pervading; *ananta*—unlimited; *vibhu*—the greatest; *kṛṣṇa-tanu-sama*—exactly like the transcendental body of Kṛṣṇa; *upari-adhaḥ*—up and down; *vyāpiyāche*—expanded; *nāhika*—there is no; *niyama*—regulation.

TRANSLATION

Like the transcendental body of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Gokula is all-pervading, infinite and supreme. It expands both above and below, without any restriction.

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, the great authority and philosopher in the line of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, has discussed the abode of Kṛṣṇa in his *Kṛṣṇa-sandarbhā*. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* the Lord refers to “My abode.” Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, examining the nature of Kṛṣṇa’s abode, refers to the *Skanda*

Purāṇa, which states:

*yā yathā bhuvi vartante puryo bhagavataḥ priyāḥ
tās tathā santi vaikuṇṭhe tat-tal-līlārtham ādṛtāḥ*

“The abodes of Godhead in the material world, such as Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula, are facsimiles representing the abodes of Godhead in the kingdom of God, Vaikuṇṭha-dhāma.” The unlimited spiritual atmosphere of that Vaikuṇṭha-dhāma is far above and beyond the material cosmos. This is confirmed in the *Svāyambhuva-tantra*, in a discussion between Lord Śiva and Pārvatī regarding the effect of chanting the *mantra* of fourteen syllables. There it is stated:

*nānā-kalpa-latākīrṇam vaikuṇṭham vyāpakam smaret
adhaḥ sāmyaṁ guṇānām ca prakṛtiḥ sarva-kāraṇam*

“While chanting the *mantra*, one should always remember the spiritual world, which is very extensive and full of desire trees that can yield anything one desires. Below that Vaikuṇṭha region is the potential material energy, which causes the material manifestation.” The places of the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa, such as Dvārakā, Mathurā and Vṛndāvana, eternally and independently exist in Kṛṣṇaloka. They are the actual abodes of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and there is no doubt that they are situated above the material cosmic manifestation.

The abode known as Vṛndāvana or Gokula is also known as Goloka. The *Brahma-saṁhitā* states that Gokula, the highest region of the kingdom of God, resembles a lotus flower with thousands of petals. The outer portion of that lotuslike planet is a square place known as Śvetadvīpa. In the inner portion of Gokula there is an elaborate arrangement for Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s residence with His eternal associates such as Nanda and Yaśodā. That transcendental abode exists by the energy of Śrī Baladeva, who is the original whole of Śeṣa, or Ananta. The *tantras* also confirm this description by stating that the abode of Śrī Anantadeva, a plenary portion of Baladeva, is called the kingdom of God. Vṛndāvana-dhāma is the

innermost abode within the quadrangular realm of Śvetadvīpa, which lies outside of the boundary of Gokula Vṛndāvana.

According to Jīva Gosvāmī, Vaikuṇṭha is also called Brahmaloḥa. The *Nārada-pañcarātra*, in a statement concerning the mystery of Vijaya, describes:

*tat sarvopari goloke tatra lokopari svayam
viharet paramānandī govindo 'tula-nāyakaḥ*

“The predominator of the *gopīs*, Govinda, the principal Deity of Gokula, always enjoys Himself in a place called Goloka, in the topmost part of the spiritual sky.”

From the authoritative evidence cited by Jīva Gosvāmī we may conclude that Kṛṣṇaloka is the supreme planet in the spiritual sky, which is far beyond the material cosmos. For the enjoyment of transcendental variety, the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa there have three divisions, and these pastimes are performed in the three abodes Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula. When Kṛṣṇa descends to this universe, He enjoys the pastimes in places of the same name. These places on earth are nondifferent from those original abodes, for they are facsimiles of those original holy places in the transcendental world. They are as good as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself and are equally worshipable. Lord Caitanya declared that Lord Kṛṣṇa, who presents Himself as the son of the King of Vraja, is worshipable, and that Vṛndāvana-dhāma is equally worshipable.

TEXT 19

brahmāṇḍe prakāśa tāra kṛṣṇera icchāya

eka-i svarūpa tāra, nāhi dui kāya

SYNONYMS

brahmāṇḍe—within the material world; *prakāśa*—manifestation; *tāra*—of it; *kṛṣṇera icchāya*—by the supreme will of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *eka-i*—it is the same; *svarūpa*—identity; *tāra*—of it; *nāhi*—not; *dui*—two; *kāya*—bodies.

TRANSLATION

That abode is manifested within the material world by the will of Lord Kṛṣṇa. It is identical to that original Gokula; they are not two different bodies.

PURPORT

The above-mentioned *dhāmas* are movable, by the omnipotent will of Lord Kṛṣṇa. When Śrī Kṛṣṇa appears on the face of the earth, He can also make His *dhāmas* appear, without changing their original structure. One should not discriminate between the *dhāmas* on the earth and those in the spiritual sky, thinking those on earth to be material and the original abodes to be spiritual. All of them are spiritual. Only for us, who cannot experience anything beyond matter in our present conditioned state, do the *dhāmas* and the Lord Himself, in His *arcā* form, appear before us resembling matter to give us the facility to see spirit with material eyes. In the beginning this may be difficult for a neophyte to understand, but in due course, when one is advanced in devotional service, it will be easier, and he will appreciate the Lord's presence in these tangible forms.

TEXT 20

cintāmaṇi-bhūmi, kalpa-vṛkṣa-maya vana

carma-cakṣe dekhe tāre prapañcera sama

SYNONYMS

cintāmaṇi-bhūmi—the land of touchstone; *kalpa-vṛkṣa-maya*—full of desire trees; *vana*—forests; *carma-cakṣe*—the material eyes; *dekhe*—see; *tāre*—it; *prapañcera sama*—equal to the material creation.

TRANSLATION

The land there is touchstone [*cintāmaṇi*], and the forests abound with desire trees. Material eyes see it as an ordinary place.

PURPORT

By the grace of the Lord His *dhāmas* and He Himself can all be present simultaneously, without losing their original importance. Only when one fully develops in affection and love of Godhead can one see those *dhāmas* in their original appearance.

Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura, a great *ācārya* in the preceptorial line of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, has said for our benefit that one can perfectly see the *dhāmas* only when one completely gives up the mentality of lording it over material nature. One's spiritual vision develops proportionately to one's giving up the debased mentality of unnecessarily enjoying matter. A diseased person who has become diseased because of a certain bad habit must be ready to follow the advice of the physician, and as a natural sequence he must attempt to give up the cause of the disease. The patient cannot indulge in the bad habit and at the same time expect to be cured by the physician. Modern materialistic civilization, however, is maintaining a diseased atmosphere. The living being is a spiritual spark, as spiritual as the Lord Himself. The only difference is that the Lord is great and the living being is small. Qualitatively they are one, but quantitatively they are different. Therefore, since the living being is spiritual in constitution, he can be happy only in the spiritual sky, where there are unlimited spiritual spheres called *Vaikuṇṭhas*. A spiritual being conditioned by a material body must therefore try to get rid of his disease instead of developing the cause of the disease.

Foolish persons engrossed in their material assets are unnecessarily proud of being leaders of the people, but they ignore the spiritual value of man. Such illusioned leaders make plans covering any number of years, but they can hardly make humanity happy in a state conditioned by the threefold miseries inflicted by material nature. One cannot control the laws of nature by any amount of struggling. One must at last be subject to death, nature's ultimate law. Death, birth, old age and illness are symptoms of the diseased condition of the living being. The highest aim of human life should therefore be to get free from these miseries and go back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 21

prema-netre dekhe tāra svarūpa-prakāśa

gopa-gopī-saṅge yāñhā kṛṣṇera vilāsa

SYNONYMS

prema-netre—with the eyes of love of Godhead; *dekhe*—one sees; *tāra*—its; *svarūpa-prakāśa*—manifestation of identity; *gopa*—cowherd boys; *gopī-saṅge*—with the cowherd damsels; *yāñhā*—where; *kṛṣṇera vilāsa*—the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

But with the eyes of love of Godhead one can see its real identity as the place where Lord Kṛṣṇa performs His pastimes with the cowherd boys and cowherd girls.

TEXT 22

cintāmaṇi-prakara-sadmasu kalpa-vṛkṣa-

lakṣāvṛteṣu surabhīr abhipālayantam

lakṣmī-sahasra-śata-sambhrama-sevyamānam

govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

cintāmaṇi—touchstone; *prakara*—groups made of; *sadmasu*—in abodes; *kalpa-vṛkṣa*—of desire trees; *lakṣa*—by millions; *āvrteṣu*—surrounded; *surabhīḥ*—*surabhi* cows; *abhipālayantam*—tending; *lakṣmī*—of goddesses of fortune; *sahasra*—of thousands; *śata*—by hundreds; *sambhrama*—with great respect; *sevyamānam*—being served; *govindam*—Govinda; *ādi-puruṣam*—the original person; *tam*—Him; *aham*—I; *bhajāmi*—worship.

TRANSLATION

“I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, the first progenitor, who is tending cows yielding all desires in abodes built with spiritual gems and surrounded by millions of purpose trees. He is always served with great reverence and affection by hundreds and thousands of goddesses of fortune.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.29). This description of the abode of Kṛṣṇa gives us definite information of the transcendental place where not only is life eternal, blissful and full of knowledge, but there are ample vegetables, milk, jewels, and beautiful homes and gardens tended by lovely damsels who are all goddesses of fortune. Kṛṣṇaloka is the topmost planet in the spiritual sky, and below it are innumerable spheres, a description of which can be found in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. In the beginning of Lord Brahmā’s self-realization he was shown a transcendental vision of the Vaikuṇṭha spheres by the grace of Nārāyaṇa. Later, by the grace of Kṛṣṇa, he was shown a transcendental vision of Kṛṣṇaloka. This transcendental vision is like the reception of television

from the moon via a mechanical system for receiving modulated waves, but it is achieved by penance and meditation within oneself.

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (Second Canto) states that in *Vaikuṇṭhaloka* the material modes of nature, represented by the qualities of goodness, passion and ignorance, have no influence. In the material world the highest qualitative manifestation is goodness, which is characterized by truthfulness, mental equilibrium, cleanliness, control of the senses, simplicity, essential knowledge, faith in God, scientific knowledge and so on. Nevertheless, all these qualities are mixed with passion and imperfection. But the qualities in *Vaikuṇṭha* are a manifestation of God's internal potency, and therefore they are purely spiritual and transcendental, with no trace of material infection. No material planet, even *Satyaloka*, is comparable in quality to the spiritual planets, where the five inherent qualities of the material world—namely ignorance, misery, egoism, anger and envy—are completely absent.

In the material world, everything is a creation. Anything we can think of within our experience, including even our own bodies and minds, was created. This process of creation began with the life of *Brahmā*, and the creative principle is prevalent all over the material universe because of the quality of passion. But since the quality of passion is conspicuous by its absence in the *Vaikuṇṭha* planets, nothing there is created; everything there is eternally existent. And because there is no mode of ignorance, there is also no question of annihilation or destruction. In the material world one may try to make everything permanent by developing the above-mentioned qualities of goodness, but because the goodness in the material world is mixed with passion and ignorance, nothing here can exist permanently, despite all the good plans of the best scientific brains. Therefore in the material world we have no experience of eternity, bliss and fullness of knowledge. But in the spiritual world, because of the complete absence of the qualitative modes, everything is eternal, blissful and cognizant. Everything can speak, everything can move, everything can hear, and everything can see in fully blessed existence for eternity. The situation being so, naturally space and time, in the forms of past,

present and future, have no influence there. In the spiritual sky there is no change because time has no influence. Consequently, the influence of *māyā*, the total external energy, which induces us to become more and more materialistic and forget our relationship with God, is also absent there.

As spiritual sparks of the beams emanating from the transcendental body of the Lord, we are all permanently related with Him and equal to Him in quality. The material energy is a covering of the spiritual spark, but in the absence of that material covering, the living beings in *Vaikuṇṭhaloka* are never forgetful of their identities: they are eternally cognizant of their relationship with God in their constitutional position of rendering transcendental loving service to the Lord. Because they constantly engage in the transcendental service of the Lord, it is natural to conclude that their senses are also transcendental, for one cannot serve the Lord with material senses. The inhabitants of *Vaikuṇṭhaloka* do not possess material senses with which to lord it over material nature.

Persons with a poor fund of knowledge conclude that a place void of material qualities must be some sort of formless nothingness. In reality, however, there are qualities in the spiritual world, but they are different from the material qualities because everything there is eternal, unlimited and pure. The atmosphere there is self-illuminating, and thus there is no need of a sun, a moon, fire, electricity and so on. One who can reach that abode does not come back to the material world with a material body. There is no difference between atheists and the faithful in the *Vaikuṇṭha* planets because all who settle there are freed from the material qualities, and thus *suras* and *asuras* become equally obedient loving servitors of the Lord.

The residents of *Vaikuṇṭha* have brilliantly black complexions much more fascinating and attractive than the dull white and black complexions found in the material world. Their bodies, being spiritual, have no equals in the material world. The beauty of a bright cloud when lightning flashes on it merely hints at their beauty. Generally the inhabitants of *Vaikuṇṭha*

dress in yellow clothing. Their bodies are delicate and attractively built, and their eyes are like the petals of lotus flowers. Like Lord Viṣṇu, the residents of Vaikuṇṭha have four hands decorated with a conchshell, wheel, club and lotus flower. Their chests are beautifully broad and fully decorated with necklaces of a brilliant diamondlike metal surrounded by costly jewels never to be found in the material world. The residents of Vaikuṇṭha are always powerful and effulgent. Some of them have complexions like red coral cat's eyes and lotus flowers, and each of them has earrings of costly jewels. On their heads they wear flowery crowns resembling garlands.

In the Vaikuṇṭhas there are airplanes, but they make no tumultuous sounds. Material airplanes are not at all safe: they can fall down and crash at any time, for matter is imperfect in every respect. In the spiritual sky, however, the airplanes are also spiritual, and they are spiritually brilliant and bright. These airplanes do not fly business executives, politicians or planning commissions as passengers, nor do they carry cargo or postal bags, for these are all unknown there. These planes are for pleasure trips only, and the residents of Vaikuṇṭha fly in them with their heavenly, beautiful, fairylike consorts. Therefore these airplanes, full of residents of Vaikuṇṭha, both male and female, increase the beauty of the spiritual sky. We cannot imagine how beautiful they are, but their beauty may be compared to the clouds in the sky accompanied by silver branches of electric lightning. The spiritual sky of Vaikuṇṭhaloka is always decorated in this way.

The full opulence of the internal potency of Godhead is always resplendent in Vaikuṇṭhaloka, where goddesses of fortune are ever-increasingly attached to serving the lotus feet of the Personality of Godhead. These goddesses of fortune, accompanied by their friends, always create a festive atmosphere of transcendental mirth. Always singing the glories of the Lord, they are not silent even for a moment.

There are unlimited Vaikuṇṭha planets in the spiritual sky, and the ratio of these planets to the material planets in the material sky is three to one.

Thus the poor materialist is busy making political adjustments on a planet that is most insignificant in God's creation. To say nothing of this planet earth, the whole universe, with innumerable planets throughout the galaxies, is comparable to a single mustard seed in a bag full of mustard seeds. But the poor materialist makes plans to live comfortably here and thus wastes his valuable human energy in something that is doomed to frustration. Instead of wasting his time with business speculations, he should seek the life of plain living and high spiritual thinking and thus save himself from perpetual materialistic unrest.

Even if a materialist wants to enjoy developed material facilities, he can transfer himself to planets where he can experience material pleasures much more advanced than those available on earth. The best plan is to prepare oneself to return to the spiritual sky after leaving the body. However, if one is intent on enjoying material facilities, one can transfer himself to other planets in the material sky by utilizing yogic powers. The playful spaceships of the astronauts are but childish entertainments and are of no use for this purpose. The *aṣṭāṅga-yoga* system is a materialistic art of controlling air by transferring it from the stomach to the navel, from the navel to the heart, from the heart to the collarbone, from there to the eyeballs, from there to the cerebellum and from there to any desired planet. The velocities of air and light are taken into consideration by the material scientist, but he has no information of the velocity of the mind and intelligence. We have some limited experience of the velocity of the mind because in a moment we can transfer our minds to places hundreds of thousands of miles away. Intelligence is even finer. Finer than intelligence is the soul, which is not matter like mind and intelligence but is spirit, or antimatter. The soul is hundreds of thousands of times finer and more powerful than intelligence. We can thus only imagine the velocity of the soul in its traveling from one planet to another. Needless to say, the soul travels by its own strength and not with the help of any kind of material vehicle.

The bestial civilization of eating, sleeping, fearing and sense-gratifying has misled modern man into forgetting how powerful a soul he has. As we

have already described, the soul is a spiritual spark many, many times more illuminating, dazzling and powerful than the sun, moon or electricity. Human life is spoiled when man does not realize his real identity with his soul. Lord Caitanya appeared with Lord Nityānanda to save man from this type of misleading civilization.

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam also describes how *yogīs* can travel to all the planets in the universe. When the vital force is lifted to the cerebellum, there is every chance that this force will burst out from the eyes, nose, ears, etc., as these are places that are known as the seventh orbit of the vital force. But the *yogīs* can block these holes by complete suspension of air. The *yogī* then concentrates the vital force in the middle position, that is, between the eyebrows. At this position, the *yogī* can think of the planet to which he wants to go after leaving the body. He can then decide whether he wants to go to the abode of Kṛṣṇa in the transcendental Vaikuṇṭhas, from which he will not be required to descend into the material world, or to travel to higher planets in the material universe. The perfect *yogī* is at liberty to do either.

For the perfect *yogī* who has attained success in the method of leaving his body in perfect consciousness, transferring from one planet to another is as easy as an ordinary man's walking to the grocery store. As already discussed, the material body is just a covering of the spiritual soul. Mind and intelligence are the undercoverings, and the gross body of earth, water, air and so on is the overcoating of the soul. As such, any advanced soul who has realized himself by the yogic process, who knows the relationship between matter and spirit, can leave the gross dress of the soul in perfect order and as he desires. By the grace of God, we have complete freedom. Because the Lord is kind to us, we can live anywhere—either in the spiritual sky or in the material sky, upon whichever planet we desire. However, misuse of this freedom causes one to fall down into the material world and suffer the threefold miseries of conditioned life. The living of a miserable life in the material world by dint of the soul's choice is nicely illustrated by Milton in *Paradise Lost*. Similarly, by choice the soul can regain paradise and return home, back to

Godhead.

At the critical time of death, one can place the vital force between the two eyebrows and decide where he wants to go. If he is reluctant to maintain any connection with the material world, he can, in less than a second, reach the transcendental abode of *Vaikuṇṭha* and appear there completely in his spiritual body, which will be suitable for him in the spiritual atmosphere. He has simply to desire to leave the material world both in finer and in grosser forms and then move the vital force to the topmost part of the skull and leave the body from the hole in the skull called the *brahma-randhra*. This is easy for one perfect in the practice of *yoga*.

Of course, man is endowed with free will, and as such if he does not want to free himself from the material world he may enjoy the life of *brahma-pada* (occupation of the post of *Brahmā*) and visit *Siddhaloka*, the planets of materially perfect beings, who have full capacities to control gravity, space and time. To visit these higher planets in the material universe, one need not give up his mind and intelligence (finer matter), but need only give up grosser matter (the material body).

Each and every planet has its particular atmosphere, and if one wants to travel to any particular planet within the material universe, one has to adapt his material body to the climatic condition of that planet. For instance, if one wants to go from India to Europe, where the climatic condition is different, one has to change his dress accordingly. Similarly, a complete change of body is necessary if one wants to go to the transcendental planets of *Vaikuṇṭha*. However, if one wants to go to the higher material planets, he can keep his finer dress of mind, intelligence and ego, but has to leave his gross dress (body) made of earth, water, fire, etc.

When one goes to a transcendental planet, it is necessary to change both the finer and gross bodies, for one has to reach the spiritual sky completely in a spiritual form. This change of dress will take place

automatically at the time of death if one so desires.

The *Bhagavad-gītā* confirms that one will attain his next material body according to his desires at the time he leaves his body. The desire of the mind carries the soul to a suitable atmosphere as the wind carries aromas from one place to another. Unfortunately, those who are not *yogīs* but gross materialists, who throughout their lives indulge in sense gratification, are puzzled by the disarrangement of the bodily and mental condition at the time of death. Such gross sensualists, encumbered by the main ideas, desires and associations of the lives they have led, desire something against their interest and thus foolishly take on new bodies that perpetuate their material miseries.

Systematic training of the mind and intelligence is therefore needed so that at the time of death one may consciously desire a suitable body, either on this planet or another material planet or even a transcendental planet. A civilization that does not consider the progressive advancement of the immortal soul merely fosters a bestial life of ignorance.

It is foolish to think that every soul that passes away goes to the same place. Either the soul goes to a place he desires at the time of death, or upon leaving his body he is forced to accept a position according to his acts in his previous life. The difference between the materialist and the *yogī* is that a materialist cannot determine his next body, whereas a *yogī* can consciously attain a suitable body for enjoyment in the higher planets. Throughout his life, the gross materialist who is constantly after sense gratification spends all day earning his livelihood to maintain his family, and at night he wastes his energy in sex enjoyment or else goes to sleep thinking about all he has done in the daytime. That is the monotonous life of the materialist. Although differently graded as businessmen, lawyers, politicians, professors, judges, coolies, pickpockets, laborers and so on, materialists all simply engage in eating, sleeping, fearing and sense gratification and thus spoil their valuable lives pursuing luxury and neglecting to perfect their lives through spiritual realization.

Yogīs, however, try to perfect their lives, and therefore the *Bhagavad-gītā* enjoins that everyone should become a *yogī*. *Yoga* is the system for linking the soul in the service of the Lord. Only under superior guidance can one practice such *yoga* in his life without changing his social position. As already described, a *yogī* can go anywhere he desires without mechanical help, for a *yogī* can place his mind and intelligence within the air circulating inside his body, and by practicing the art of breath control he can mix that air with the air that blows all over the universe outside his body. With the help of this universal air, a *yogī* can travel to any planet and get a body suitable for its atmosphere. We can understand this process by comparing it to the electronic transmission of radio messages. With radio transmitters, sound waves produced at a certain station can travel all over the earth in seconds. But sound is produced from the ethereal sky, and as already explained, subtler than the ethereal sky is the mind, and finer than the mind is the intelligence. Spirit is still finer than the intelligence, and by nature it is completely different from matter. Thus we can just imagine how quickly the spirit soul can travel through the universal atmosphere.

To come to the stage of manipulating finer elements like mind, intelligence and spirit, one needs appropriate training, an appropriate mode of life and appropriate association. Such training depends upon sincere prayers, devotional service, achievement of success in mystic perfection, and the successful merging of oneself in the activities of the soul and Supersoul. A gross materialist, whether he be an empiric philosopher, a scientist, a psychologist or whatever, cannot attain such success through blunt efforts and word jugglery.

Materialists who perform *yajñas*, or great sacrifices, are comparatively better than grosser materialists who do not know anything beyond laboratories and test tubes. The advanced materialists who perform such sacrifices can reach the planet called Vaiśvānara, a fiery planet similar to the sun. On this planet, which is situated on the way to Brahmaloka, the topmost planet in the universe, such an advanced materialist can free himself from all traces of vice and its effects. When such a materialist is

purified, he can rise to the orbit of the pole star (Dhruvaloka). Within this orbit, which is called the Śiśumāra-cakra, are situated the Āditya-lokas and the Vaikuṇṭha planet within this universe.

A purified materialist who has performed many sacrifices, undergone severe penances and given the major portion of his wealth in charity can reach such planets as Dhruvaloka, and if he becomes still more qualified there, he can penetrate still higher orbits and pass through the navel of the universe to reach the planet Maharloka, where sages like Bhṛgu Muni live. In Maharloka one can live even to the time of the partial annihilation of the universe. This annihilation begins when Anantadeva, from the lowest position in the universe, produces a great blazing fire. The heat of this fire reaches even Maharloka, and then the residents of Maharloka travel to Brahmaloка, which exists for twice the duration of *parārdha* time.

In Brahmaloка there is an unlimited number of airplanes that are controlled not by *yantra* (machine) but by *mantra* (psychic action). Because of the existence of the mind and intelligence on Brahmaloка, its residents have feelings of happiness and distress, but there is no cause of lamentation from old age, death, fear or distress. They feel sympathy, however, for the suffering living beings who are consumed in the fire of annihilation. The residents of Brahmaloка do not have gross material bodies to change at death, but they transform their subtle bodies into spiritual bodies and thus enter the spiritual sky. The residents of Brahmaloка can attain perfection in three different ways. Virtuous persons who reach Brahmaloка by dint of their pious work become masters of various planets after the resurrection of Brahmā, those who have worshiped Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu are liberated with Brahmā, and those who are pure devotees of the Personality of Godhead at once push through the covering of the universe and enter the spiritual sky.

The numberless universes exist together in foamlike clusters, and so only some of them are surrounded by the water of the Causal Ocean. When agitated by the glance of Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, material nature produces

the total elements, which are eight in number and which gradually evolve from finer to gross. A part of ego is the sky, a part of which is air, a part of which is fire, a part of which is water, a part of which is earth. Thus one universe inflates to an area of four billion miles in diameter. A *yogī* who desires gradual liberation must penetrate all the different coverings of the universe, including the subtle coverings of the three qualitative modes of material nature. One who does this never has to return to this mortal world.

According to Śukadeva Gosvāmī, the above description of the material and spiritual skies is neither imaginary nor utopian. The actual facts are recorded in the Vedic hymns, and Lord Vāsudeva disclosed them to Lord Brahmā when Brahmā satisfied Him. One can achieve the perfection of life only when he has a definite idea of Vaikuṇṭha and the Supreme Godhead. One should always think about and describe the Supreme Personality of Godhead, for this is recommended in both the *Bhagavad-gītā* and the *Bhāgavata Purāṇa*, which are two authorized commentaries upon the *Vedas*. Lord Caitanya has made all these subject matters easier for the fallen people of this age to accept, and *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* has therefore presented them for the easy understanding of all concerned.

TEXT 23

mathurā-dvārakāya nija-rūpa prakāśīyā

nānā-rūpe vilasaye catur-vyūha haiṇā

SYNONYMS

mathurā—in Mathurā; *dvārakāya*—in Dvārakā; *nija-rūpa*—personal body; *prakāśīyā*—manifesting; *nānā-rūpe*—in various ways; *vilasaye*—enjoys pastimes; *catur-vyūha haiṇā*—expanding into four wonderful forms.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa manifests His own form in Mathurā and Dvārakā. He enjoys pastimes in various ways by expanding into the quadruple forms.

TEXT 24

vāsudeva-saṅkarṣaṇa-pradyumnāniruddha

sarva-catur-vyūha-amṣī, turīya, viśuddha

SYNONYMS

vāsudeva—Lord Vāsudeva; *saṅkarṣaṇa*—Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa; *pradyumna*—Lord Pradyumna; *aniruddha*—and Lord Aniruddha; *sarva-catuḥ-vyūha*—of all other quadruple expansions; *amṣī*—source; *turīya*—transcendental; *viśuddha*—pure.

TRANSLATION

Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the primary quadruple forms, from whom all other quadruple forms are manifested. They are all purely transcendental.

TEXT 25

ei tina loke kṛṣṇa kevala-līlā-maya

nija-gaṇa lañā khele ananta samaya

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *tina*—three; *loke*—in the locations; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kevala*—only; *līlā-maya*—consisting of pastimes; *nija-gaṇa lañā*—with His personal associates; *khele*—He plays; *ananta samaya*—unlimited time.

TRANSLATION

Only in these three places [Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula] does the all-sporting Lord Kṛṣṇa perform His endless pastimes with His personal associates.

TEXT 26

para-vyoma-madhye kari' svarūpa prakāśa

nārāyaṇa-rūpe kareṇa vividha vilāsa

SYNONYMS

para-vyoma-madhye—within the spiritual sky; *kari'*—making; *svarūpa prakāśa*—manifesting His identity; *nārāyaṇa-rūpe*—the form of Lord Nārāyaṇa; *kareṇa*—performs; *vividha vilāsa*—varieties of pastimes.

TRANSLATION

In the Vaikuṇṭha planets of the spiritual sky the Lord manifests His identity as Nārāyaṇa and performs pastimes in various ways.

TEXTS 27–28

svarūpa-vigraha kṛṣṇera kevala dvi-bhuja

nārāyaṇa-rūpe sei tanu catur-bhuja

śaṅkha-cakra-gadā-padma, mahaiśvarya-maya

śrī-bhū-nīlā-śakti yāñra caraṇa sevaya

SYNONYMS

svarūpa-vigraha—personal form; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kevala*—only; *dvi-bhuja*—two hands; *nārāyaṇa-rūpe*—in the form of Lord Nārāyaṇa; *sei*—that; *tanu*—body; *catuḥ-bhuja*—four-handed; *śaṅkha-cakra*—conchshell and disc; *gadā*—club; *padma*—lotus flower; *mahā*—very great; *aiśvarya-maya*—full of opulence; *śrī*—named *śrī*; *bhū*—named *bhū*; *nīlā*—named *nīlā*; *śakti*—energies; *yāñra*—whose; *caraṇa sevaya*—serve the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa's own form has only two hands, but in the form of Lord Nārāyaṇa He has four hands. Lord Nārāyaṇa holds a conchshell, disc, club and lotus flower, and He is full of great opulence. The *śrī*, *bhū* and *nīlā* energies serve at His lotus feet.

PURPORT

In the Rāmānuja and Madhva sects of Vaiṣṇavism there are extensive descriptions of the *śrī*, *bhū* and *nīlā* energies. In Bengal the *nīlā* energy is sometimes called the *līlā* energy. These three energies are employed in the service of four-handed Nārāyaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha. Relating how three of the Ālvārs, namely Bhūta-yogī, Sara-yogī and Bhrānta-yogī, saw Nārāyaṇa in person when they took shelter at the house of a *brāhmaṇa* in the village of Gehalī, the *Prapannāmṛta* of the Śrī-sampradāya describes Nārāyaṇa as follows:

*tārksyādhirūḍhaṁ taḍid-ambudābhaṁ
lakṣmī-dharaṁ vakṣasi pañkajākṣam*

*hasta-dvaye śobhita-śaṅkha-cakraṁ
viṣṇuṁ dadṛśur bhagavantam ādyam*

*ā-jānu-bāhuṁ kamanīya-gātraṁ
pārśva-dvaye śobhita-bhūmi-nīlam*

*pītāmbaram bhūṣaṇa-bhūṣitāṅgam
catur-bhujam candana-ruṣitāṅgam*

“They saw the lotus-eyed Lord Viṣṇu, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, mounted on Garuḍa and holding Lakṣmī, the goddess of fortune, to His chest. He resembled a bluish rain cloud with flashing lightning, and in two of His four hands He held a conchshell and disc. His arms stretched down to His knees, and all His beautiful limbs were smeared with sandalwood and decorated with glittering ornaments. He wore yellow clothes, and by either side stood His energies Bhūmi and Nīlā.”

There is the following reference to the *śrī*, *bhū* and *nīlā* energies in the *Sītopaniṣad*: *mahā-lakṣmīr deveśasya bhinnābhinna-rūpā cetanācetanātmikā. sā devī tri-vidhā bhavati, śakty-ātmanā icchā-śaktiḥ kriyā-śaktiḥ sākṣāc-chaktir iti. icchā-śaktis tri-vidhā bhavati, śrī-bhūmi-nīlātmikā.* “Mahā-Lakṣmī, the supreme energy of the Lord, is experienced in different ways. She is divided into material and spiritual potencies, and in both features she acts as the willing energy, creative energy and the internal energy. The willing energy is again divided into three, namely *śrī*, *bhū* and *nīlā*.”

Quoting from the revealed scriptures in his commentary on the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.6), Madhvācārya has stated that mother material nature, which is conceived of as the illusory energy, Durgā, has three divisions, namely *śrī*, *bhū* and *nīlā*. She is the illusory energy for those who are weak in spiritual strength because such energies are created energies of Lord Viṣṇu. Although each energy has no direct relationship with the unlimited, they are subordinate to the Lord because the Lord is the master of all energies.

In his *Bhagavat-sandarbhā* (Text 23), Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu states, “The *Padma Purāṇa* refers to the eternally auspicious abode of Godhead, which is full in all opulences, including the energies *śrī*, *bhū* and *nīlā*. The *Mahā-saṁhitā*, which discusses the transcendental name and form of

Godhead, also mentions Durgā as the potency of the Supersoul in relationship with the living entities. The internal potency acts in relation with His personal affairs, and the material potency manifests the three modes.” Quoting elsewhere from the revealed scriptures, he states that *śrī* is the energy of Godhead that maintains the cosmic manifestation, *bhū* is the energy that creates the cosmic manifestation, and *nīlā*, Durgā, is the energy that destroys the creation. All these energies act in relation with the living beings, and thus they are together called *jīva-māyā*.

TEXT 29

yadyapi kevala tāñra krīḍā-mātra dharma

tathāpi jīvere kṛpāya kare eka karma

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *kevala*—only; *tāñra*—His; *krīḍā-mātra*—pastime only; *dharma*—characteristic function; *tathāpi*—still; *jīvere*—to the fallen souls; *kṛpāya*—by the causeless mercy; *kare*—does; *eka*—one; *karma*—activity.

TRANSLATION

Although His pastimes are His only characteristic functions, by His causeless mercy He performs one activity for the fallen souls.

TEXT 30

sālokya-sāmīpya-sārṣṭi-sārūpya-prakāra

cāri mukti diyā kare jīvera nistāra

SYNONYMS

sālokya—the liberation called *sālokya*; *sāmīpya*—the liberation called *sāmīpya*; *sārṣṭi*—the liberation called *sārṣṭi*; *sārūpya*—the liberation called *sārūpya*; *prakāra*—varieties; *cāri*—four; *mukti*—liberation; *diyā*—giving; *kare*—does; *jīvera*—of the fallen souls; *nistāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

He delivers the fallen living entities by offering them the four kinds of liberation—*sālokya*, *sāmīpya*, *sārṣṭi* and *sārūpya*.

PURPORT

There are two kinds of liberated souls—those who are liberated by the favor of the Lord and those who are liberated by their own effort. One who gets liberation by his own effort is called an impersonalist, and he merges into the glaring effulgence of the Lord, the *brahmajyoti*. But devotees of the Lord who qualify themselves for liberation by devotional service are offered four kinds of liberation, namely *sālokya* (status equal to that of the Lord), *sāmīpya* (constant association with the Lord), *sārṣṭi* (opulence equal to that of the Lord) and *sārūpya* (features like those of the Lord).

TEXT 31

brahma-sāyujya-muktera tāhā nāhi gati

vaikuṇṭha-bāhire haya tā'-sabāra sthiti

SYNONYMS

brahma-sāyujya—of merging into the Supreme Brahman; *muktera*—of the liberation; *tāhā*—there (in Vaikuṇṭha); *nāhi*—not; *gati*—entrance; *vaikuṇṭha-bāhire*—outside the Vaikuṇṭha planets; *haya*—there is; *tā'-sabāra sthiti*—the residence of all of them.

TRANSLATION

Those who attain brahma-sāyujya liberation cannot gain entrance into Vaikuṇṭha; their residence is outside the Vaikuṇṭha planets.

TEXT 32

vaikuṇṭha-bāhire eka jyotir-maya maṇḍala

kṛṣṇera aṅgera prabhā, parama ujjala

SYNONYMS

vaikuṇṭha-bāhire—outside the Vaikuṇṭhalokas; *eka*—one; *jyotiḥ-maya maṇḍala*—the atmosphere of the glowing effulgence; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *aṅgera*—of the body; *prabhā*—rays; *parama*—supremely; *ujjala*—bright.

TRANSLATION

Outside the Vaikuṇṭha planets is the atmosphere of the glowing effulgence, which consists of the supremely bright rays of the body of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 33

‘siddha-loka’ nāma tāra prakṛtira pāra

cit-svarūpa, tānhā nāhi cic-chakti vikāra

SYNONYMS

‘siddha-loka’—the region of the Siddhas; *nāma*—named; *tāra*—of the effulgent atmosphere; *prakṛtira pāra*—beyond this material nature; *cit-svarūpa*—full of knowledge; *tānhā*—there; *nāhi*—there is not; *cit-śakti-*

vikāra—change of the spiritual energy.

TRANSLATION

That region is called Siddhaloka, and it is beyond the material nature. Its essence is spiritual, but it does not have spiritual varieties.

TEXT 34

sūrya-maṇḍala yena bāhire nirviśeṣa

bhitare sūryera ratha-ādi saviśeṣa

SYNONYMS

sūrya-maṇḍala—the sun globe; *yena*—like; *bāhire*—externally; *nirviśeṣa*—with out varieties; *bhitare*—within; *sūryera*—of the sun-god; *ratha-ādi*—opulences like chariots and other things; *sa-viśeṣa*—full of varieties.

TRANSLATION

It is like the homogeneous effulgence around the sun. But inside the sun are the chariots, horses and other opulences of the sun-god.

PURPORT

Outside of Vaikuṇṭha, the abode of Kṛṣṇa, which is called *paravyoma*, is the glaring effulgence of Kṛṣṇa's bodily rays. This is called the *brahmajyoti*. The transcendental region of that effulgence is called Siddhaloka or Brahmaloaka. When impersonalists achieve liberation, they merge into that Brahmaloaka effulgence. This transcendental region is undoubtedly spiritual, but it contains no manifestations of spiritual activities or variegatedness. It is compared to the glow of the sun. Within the sun's glow is the sphere of the sun, where one can experience all sorts

of varieties.

TEXT 35

kāmād dveṣād bhayāt snehād

yathā bhaktyeśvare manaḥ

āveśya tad agham hitvā

bahavas tad gatim gatāḥ

SYNONYMS

kāmāt—influenced by lusty desire; *dveṣāt*—by envy; *bhayāt*—by fear; *snehāt*—or by affection; *yathā*—as; *bhaktyā*—by devotion; *īśvare*—in the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *manaḥ*—the mind; *āveśya*—fully absorbing; *tat*—that; *agham*—sinful activity; *hitvā*—giving up; *bahavaḥ*—many; *tat*—that; *gatim*—destination; *gatāḥ*—achieved.

TRANSLATION

“As through devotion to the Lord one can attain His abode, many have attained that goal by abandoning their sinful activities and absorbing their minds in the Lord through lust, envy, fear or affection.”

PURPORT

As the powerful sun, by its glowing rays, can purify all kinds of impurities, so the all-spiritual Personality of Godhead can purify all material qualities in a person He attracts. Even if one is attracted by Godhead in the mode of material lust, such attraction is converted into spiritual love of Godhead by His grace. Similarly, if one is related to the Lord in fear and animosity, he also becomes purified by the spiritual attraction of the Lord. Although God is great and the living entity small,

they are spiritual individuals, and therefore as soon as there is a reciprocal exchange by the living entity's free will, at once the great spiritual being attracts the small living entity, thus freeing him from all material bondage. This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (7.1.30).

TEXT 36

yad arīṇām priyāṇām ca

prāpyam ekam ivoditam

tad brahma-kṛṣṇayor aikyāt

kiraṇārkopamā-juṣoḥ

SYNONYMS

yat—that; *arīṇām*—of the enemies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *priyāṇām*—of the devotees, who are very dear to the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *ca*—and; *prāpyam*—destination; *ekam*—one only; *iva*—thus; *uditam*—said; *tad*—that; *brahma*—of impersonal Brahman; *kṛṣṇayoḥ*—and of Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *aikyāt*—due to the oneness; *kiraṇa*—the sunshine; *arka*—and the sun; *upamā*—the comparison; *juṣoḥ*—which is understood by.

TRANSLATION

“Where it has been stated that the Lord’s enemies and devotees attain the same destination, this refers to the ultimate oneness of Brahman and Lord Kṛṣṇa. This may be understood by the analogy of the sun and the sunshine, in which Brahman is like the sunshine and Kṛṣṇa Himself is like the sun.”

PURPORT

This verse is from the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (1.2.278) of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, who further discusses this same topic in his *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva* 5.41). There he refers to the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* (4.15.1), where Maitreya Muni asked Parāśara, in regard to Jaya and Vijaya, how it was that Hiraṇyakaśipu next became Rāvaṇa and enjoyed more material happiness than the demigods but did not attain salvation, although when he became Śiśupāla, quarreled with Kṛṣṇa and was killed, he attained salvation and merged into the body of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Parāśara replied that Hiraṇyakaśipu failed to recognize Lord Nṛsimhadeva as Lord Viṣṇu. He thought that Nṛsimhadeva was some living entity who had acquired such opulence by various pious activities. Being overcome by the mode of passion, he considered Lord Nṛsimhadeva an ordinary living entity, not understanding His form. Nevertheless, because Hiraṇyakaśipu was killed by the hands of Lord Nṛsimhadeva, in his next life he became Rāvaṇa and had proprietorship of unlimited opulence. As Rāvaṇa, with unlimited material enjoyment, he could not accept Lord Rāma as the Personality of Godhead. Therefore even though he was killed by Rāma, he did not attain *sāyujya*, or oneness with the body of the Lord. In his Rāvaṇa body he was too much attracted to Rāma's wife, Jānakī, and because of that attraction he was able to see Lord Rāma. But instead of accepting Lord Rāma as an incarnation of Viṣṇu, Rāvaṇa thought Him an ordinary living being. When killed by the hands of Rāma, therefore, he got the privilege of taking birth as Śiśupāla, who had such immense opulence that he could think himself a competitor to Kṛṣṇa. Although Śiśupāla was always envious of Kṛṣṇa, he frequently uttered the name of Kṛṣṇa and always thought of the beautiful features of Kṛṣṇa. Thus by constantly thinking and chanting of Kṛṣṇa, even unfavorably, he was cleansed of the contamination of his sinful activities. When Śiśupāla was killed by the Sudarśana *cakra* of Kṛṣṇa as an enemy, his constant remembrance of Kṛṣṇa dissolved the reactions of his vices, and he attained salvation by becoming one with the body of the Lord.

From this incident one can understand that even a person who thinks of Kṛṣṇa as an enemy and is killed by Him may be liberated by becoming one with the body of Kṛṣṇa. What then must be the destination of

devotees who always think favorably of Kṛṣṇa as their master or friend? These devotees must attain a situation better than Brahmaloḥa, the impersonal bodily effulgence of Kṛṣṇa. Devotees cannot be situated in the impersonal Brahman effulgence, into which impersonalists desire to merge. The devotees are placed in Vaikuṇṭhaloḥa or Kṛṣṇaloḥa.

This discussion between Maitreya Muni and Parāśara Muni centered on whether devotees come down into the material world in every millennium like Jaya and Vijaya, who were cursed by the Kumāras to that effect. In the course of these instructions to Maitreya about Hiraṇyakaśipu, Rāvaṇa and Śiśupāla, Parāśara did not say that these demons were formerly Jaya and Vijaya. He simply described the transmigration through three lives. It is not necessary for the Vaikuṇṭha associates of the Supreme Personality of Godhead to come to take the roles of His enemies in all the millenniums in which He appears. The “falldown” of Jaya and Vijaya occurred in a particular millennium; Jaya and Vijaya do not come down in every millennium to act as demons. To think that some associates of the Lord fall down from Vaikuṇṭha in every millennium to become demons is totally incorrect.

The Supreme Personality of Godhead has all the tendencies that may be found in the living entity, for He is the chief living entity. Therefore it is natural that sometimes Lord Viṣṇu wants to fight. Just as He has the tendencies to create, to enjoy, to be a friend, to accept a mother and father, and so on, He also has the tendency to fight. Sometimes important landlords and kings keep wrestlers with whom they practice mock fighting, and Viṣṇu makes similar arrangements. The demons who fight with the Supreme Personality of Godhead in the material world are sometimes His associates. When there is a scarcity of demons and the Lord wants to fight, He instigates some of His associates of Vaikuṇṭha to come and play as demons. When it is said that Śiśupāla merged into the body of Kṛṣṇa, it should be noted that in this case he was not Jaya or Vijaya: he was actually a demon.

In his *Bṛhad-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī has explained that

the attainment of salvation by merging into the Brahman effulgence of the Lord cannot be accepted as the highest success in life, because demons like Kāṁsa, who were famous for killing *brāhmaṇas* and cows, attained that salvation. For devotees such salvation is abominable. Devotees are actually in a transcendental position, whereas nondevotees are candidates for hellish conditions of life. There is always a difference between the life of a devotee and the life of a demon, and their realizations are as different as heaven and hell.

Demons are always accustomed to being malicious toward devotees and to killing *brāhmaṇas* and cows. For demons, merging into the Brahman effulgence may be very glorious, but for devotees it is hellish. A devotee's aim in life is to attain perfection in loving the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Those who aspire to merge into the Brahman effulgence are as abominable as demons. Devotees who aspire to associate with the Supreme Lord to render Him transcendental loving service are far superior.

TEXT 37

taiche para-vyome nānā cic-chakti-vilāsa

nirviśeṣa jyotir-bimba bāhire prakāśa

SYNONYMS

taiche—in that way; *para-vyome*—in the spiritual sky; *nānā*—varieties; *cit-śakti-vilāsa*—pastimes of spiritual energy; *nirviśeṣa*—impersonal; *jyotiḥ*—of the effulgence; *bimba*—reflection; *bāhire*—externally; *prakāśa*—manifested.

TRANSLATION

Thus in the spiritual sky there are varieties of pastimes within the spiritual energy. Outside the Vaikuṇṭha planets appears the impersonal

reflection of light.

TEXT 38

nirviśeṣa-brahma sei kevala jyotir-maya

sāyujyera adhikārī tāñhā pāya laya

SYNONYMS

nirviśeṣa-brahma—the impersonal Brahman effulgence; *sei*—that; *kevala*—only; *jyotiḥ-maya*—effulgent rays; *sāyujyera*—the liberation called *sāyujya* (oneness with the Supreme); *adhikārī*—one who is fit for; *tāñhā*—there (in the impersonal Brahman effulgence); *pāya*—gets; *laya*—merging.

TRANSLATION

That impersonal Brahman effulgence consists only of the effulgent rays of the Lord. Those fit for *sāyujya* liberation merge into that effulgence.

TEXT 39

siddha-lokas tu tamasaḥ

pāre yatra vasanti hi

siddhā brahma-sukhe magnā

daityāś ca hariṇā hatāḥ

SYNONYMS

siddha-lokaḥ—Siddhaloka, or impersonal Brahman; *tu*—but; *tamasaḥ*—of darkness; *pāre*—beyond the jurisdiction; *yatra*—where; *vasanti*—

reside; *hi*—certainly; *siddhāḥ*—the spiritually perfect; *brahma-sukhe*—in the transcendental bliss of becoming one with the Supreme; *magnāḥ*—absorbed; *daityāḥ ca*—as well as the demons; *harinā*—by the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *hatāḥ*—killed.

TRANSLATION

“Beyond the region of ignorance [the material cosmic manifestation] lies the realm of Siddhaloka. The Siddhas reside there, absorbed in the bliss of Brahman. Demons killed by the Lord also attain that realm.”

PURPORT

Tamas means darkness. The material world is dark, and beyond the material world is light. In other words, after passing through the entire material atmosphere, one can come to the luminous spiritual sky, whose impersonal effulgence is known as Siddhaloka. Māyāvādī philosophers who aspire to merge with the body of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as well as demoniac persons who are killed by Kṛṣṇa, such as Kāmsa and Śiśupāla, enter that Brahman effulgence. *Yogīs* who attain oneness through meditation according to the Patañjali *yoga* system also reach Siddhaloka. This is a verse from the *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa*.

TEXT 40

sei para-vyome nārāyaṇera cāri pāśe

dvārakā-catur-vyūhera dvitīya prakāśe

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *para-vyome*—in the spiritual sky; *nārāyaṇera*—of Lord Nārāyaṇa; *cāri pāśe*—on four sides; *dvārakā*—Dvārakā; *catur-vyūhera*—of the quadruple expansions; *dvitīya*—the second; *prakāśe*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

In that spiritual sky, on the four sides of Nārāyaṇa, are the second expansions of the quadruple expansions of Dvārakā.

PURPORT

Within the spiritual sky is a second manifestation of the quadruple forms of Dvārakā from the abode of Kṛṣṇa. Among these forms, which are all spiritual and immune to the material modes, Śrī Baladeva is represented as Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa.

The activities in the spiritual sky are manifested by the internal potency in pure spiritual existence. They expand in six transcendental opulences, which are all manifestations of Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa, who is the ultimate reservoir and objective of all living entities. Although belonging to the marginal potency, known as *jīva-śakti*, the spiritual sparks known as the living entities are subjected to the conditions of material energy. It is because these sparks are related with both the internal and external potencies of the Lord that they are known as belonging to the marginal potency.

In considering the quadruple forms of the absolute Personality of Godhead, known as Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha, the impersonalists, headed by Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya, have interpreted the aphorisms of the *Vedānta-sūtra* in a way suitable for the impersonalist school. To provide the intrinsic import of such aphorisms, however, Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, the leader of the six Gosvāmīs of Vṛndāvana, has properly replied to the impersonalists in his *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, which is a natural commentary on the aphorisms of the *Vedānta-sūtra*.

The *Padma Purāṇa*, as quoted by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī in his *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describes that in the spiritual sky there are four directions, corresponding to east, west, north and south, in which Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Aniruddha and Pradyumna are situated. The

same forms are also situated in the material sky. The *Padma Purāṇa* also describes a place in the spiritual sky known as Vedavatī-pura, where Vāsudeva resides. In Viṣṇuloka, which is above Satyaloka, Saṅkarṣaṇa resides. Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa is another name of Saṅkarṣaṇa. Pradyumna lives in Dvārakā-pura, and Aniruddha lies on the eternal bed of Śeṣa, generally known as *ananta-śayyā*, on the island called Śvetadvīpa, in the ocean of milk.

TEXT 41

vāsudeva-saṅkarṣaṇa-pradyumnāniruddha

‘dvitīya catur-vyūha’ ei—turīya, viśuddha

SYNONYMS

vāsudeva—the expansion named Vāsudeva; *saṅkarṣaṇa*—the expansion named Saṅkarṣaṇa; *pradyumna*—the expansion named Pradyumna; *aniruddha*—the expansion named Aniruddha; *dvitīya catur-vyūha*—the second quadruple expansion; *ei*—this; *turīya*—transcendental; *viśuddha*—free from all material contamination.

TRANSLATION

Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha constitute this second quadruple. They are purely transcendental.

PURPORT

Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya has misleadingly explained the quadruple form (*catur-vyūha*) in his interpretation of the forty-second aphorism of Chapter Two of the second *khaṇḍa* of the *Vedānta-sūtra* (*utpatty-asambhavāt*). In verses 41 through 47 of this chapter of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī answers Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya’s misleading objections to the personal feature of the

Absolute Truth.

The Supreme Personality of Godhead, the Absolute Truth, is not like a material object that can be known by experimental knowledge or sense perception. In the *Nārada-pañcarātra* this fact has been explained by Nārāyaṇa Himself to Lord Śiva. But Śaṅkarācārya, the incarnation of Śiva, under the order of Nārāyaṇa, his master, had to mislead the monists, who favor ultimate extinction. In the conditioned stage of existence, all living entities have four basic defects, of which one is the cheating propensity. Śaṅkarācārya has carried this cheating propensity to the extreme to mislead the monists.

Actually, the explanation of the quadruple forms in the Vedic literature cannot be understood by the speculation of a conditioned soul. The quadruple forms should therefore be accepted just as They are described. The authority of the *Vedas* is such that even if one does not understand something by his limited perception, he should accept the Vedic injunction and not create interpretations to suit his imperfect understanding. In his *Śārīraka-bhāṣya*, however, Śaṅkarācārya has increased the misunderstanding of the monists.

The quadruple forms have a spiritual existence that can be realized in *vasudeva-sattva* (*śuddha-sattva*), or unqualified goodness, which accompanies complete absorption in the understanding of Vāsudeva. The quadruple forms, who are full in the six opulences of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, are the enjoyers of the internal potency. Thinking the absolute Personality of Godhead to be poverty-stricken or to have no potency—or, in other words, to be impotent—is simply rascaldom. This rascaldom is the profession of the conditioned soul, and it increases his bewilderment. One who cannot understand the distinctions between the spiritual world and the material world has no qualification to examine or know the situation of the transcendental quadruple forms. In his commentary on *Vedānta-sūtra* 2.2.42–45, His Holiness Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya has made a futile attempt to nullify the existence of these quadruple forms in the spiritual world.

Śaṅkarācārya says (*sūtra* 42) that devotees think the Supreme Personality of Godhead Vāsudeva, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, to be one, to be free from material qualities and to have a transcendental body full of bliss and eternal existence. He is the ultimate goal of the devotees, who believe that the Supreme Personality of Godhead expands Himself into four other eternal transcendental forms—Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. From Vāsudeva, who is the primary expansion, come Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha in that order. Another name of Vāsudeva is Paramātmā, another name of Saṅkarṣaṇa is *jīva* (the living entity), another name of Pradyumna is mind, and another name of Aniruddha is *ahaṅkāra* (false ego). Among these expansions, Vāsudeva is considered the origin of the material nature. Therefore Śaṅkarācārya says that Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha must be creations of that original cause.

Great souls assert that Nārāyaṇa, who is known as the Paramātmā, or Supersoul, is beyond material nature, and this is in accordance with the statements of the Vedic literature. Māyāvādīs also agree that Nārāyaṇa can expand Himself in various forms. Śaṅkara says that he does not attempt to argue that portion of the devotees' understanding, but he must protest the idea that Saṅkarṣaṇa is produced from Vāsudeva, Pradyumna is produced from Saṅkarṣaṇa, and Aniruddha is produced from Pradyumna, for if Saṅkarṣaṇa is understood to represent the living entities created from the body of Vāsudeva, the living entities would have to be noneternal. The living entities are supposed to be freed from material contamination by engaging in prolonged temple worship of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, reading Vedic literature and performing *yoga* and pious activities to attain the Supreme Lord. But if the living entities had been created from material nature at a certain point, they would be noneternal and would have no chance to be liberated and associate with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. When a cause is nullified, its results are nullified. In the second chapter of the *Vedānta-sūtra's* second *khaṇḍa*, Ācārya Vedavyāsa has also refuted the conception that the living beings were ever born (*nātmā śruter nityatvāc ca tābhyah*). Because there is no creation for the living entities, they must be eternal.

Śaṅkarācārya says (*sūtra* 43) that devotees think that Pradyumna, who is considered to represent the senses, has sprung from Saṅkarṣaṇa, who is considered to represent the living entities. But we cannot actually experience that a person can produce senses. Devotees also say that from Pradyumna has sprung Aniruddha, who is considered to represent the ego. But Śaṅkarācārya says that unless the devotees can show how ego and the means of knowledge can generate from a person, such an explanation of the *Vedānta-sūtra* cannot be accepted, for no other philosophers accept the *sūtras* in that way.

Śaṅkarācārya also says (*sūtra* 44) that he cannot accept the devotees' idea that Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are equally as powerful as the absolute Personality of Godhead, full in the six opulences of knowledge, wealth, strength, fame, beauty and renunciation, and free from the flaw of generation at a certain point. Even if They are full expansions, the flaw of generation remains. Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha, being distinct individual persons, cannot be one. Therefore if They are accepted as absolute, full and equal, there would have to be many Personalities of Godhead. But there is no need to accept that there are many Personalities of Godhead, because acceptance of one omnipotent God is sufficient for all purposes. The acceptance of more than one God is contradictory to the conclusion that Lord Vāsudeva, the absolute Personality of Godhead, is one without a second. Even if we agree to accept that the quadruple forms of Godhead are all identical, we cannot avoid the incongruous flaw of noneternity. Unless we accept that there are some differences among the personalities, there is no meaning to the idea that Saṅkarṣaṇa is an expansion of Vāsudeva, Pradyumna is an expansion of Saṅkarṣaṇa, and Aniruddha is an expansion of Pradyumna. There must be a distinction between cause and effect. For example, a pot is distinct from the earth from which it is made, and therefore we can ascertain that the earth is the cause and the pot is the effect. Without such distinctions, there is no meaning to cause and effect. Furthermore, the followers of the Pāñcarātric principles do not accept any differences in knowledge and qualities between Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. The devotees accept all these

expansions to be one, but why should they restrict oneness to these quadruple expansions? Certainly we should not do so, for all living entities, from Brahmā to the insignificant ant, are expansions of Vāsudeva, as accepted in all the *śrutis* and *smṛtis*.

Śaṅkarācārya also says (*sūtra* 45) that the devotees who follow the *Pañcarātra* state that God's qualities and God Himself, as the owner of the qualities, are the same. But how can the *Bhāgavata* school state that the six opulences—wisdom, wealth, strength, fame, beauty and renunciation—are identical with Lord Vāsudeva? This is impossible.

In his *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva* 5.165–193), Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī has refuted the charges directed against the devotees by Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya regarding their explanation of the quadruple forms Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. Rūpa Gosvāmī says that these four expansions of Nārāyaṇa are present in the spiritual sky, where They are famous as Mahāvastha. Among Them, Vāsudeva is worshiped within the heart by meditation because He is the predominating Deity of the heart, as explained in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (4.3.23).

Saṅkarṣaṇa, the second expansion, is Vāsudeva's personal expansion for pastimes, and since He is the reservoir of all living entities, He is sometimes called *jīva*. The beauty of Saṅkarṣaṇa is greater than that of innumerable full moons radiating light beams. He is worshipable as the principle of ego. He has invested Anantadeva with all the potencies of sustenance. For the dissolution of the creation, He also exhibits Himself as the Supersoul in Rudra, in Adharma (the personality of irreligion), in *sarpa* (snakes), in Antaka (Yamarāja, the lord of death) and in the demons.

Pradyumna, the third manifestation, appears from Saṅkarṣaṇa. Those who are especially intelligent worship this Pradyumna expansion of Saṅkarṣaṇa as the principle of the intelligence. The goddess of fortune always chants the glories of Pradyumna in the place known as *Ilāvṛta-varṣa*, and she always serves Him with great devotion. His complexion

appears sometimes golden and sometimes bluish like new monsoon clouds in the sky. He is the origin of the creation of the material world, and He has invested His creative principle in Cupid. It is by His direction only that all men and demigods and other living entities function with energy for regeneration.

Aniruddha, the fourth of the quadruple expansions, is worshiped by great sages and psychologists as the principle of the mind. His complexion is similar to the bluish hue of a blue cloud. He engages in the maintenance of the cosmic manifestation and is the Supersoul of Dharma (the deity of religiosity), the Manus (the progenitors of mankind) and the *devatās* (demigods). The *Mokṣa-dharma* Vedic scripture indicates that Pradyumna is the Deity of the total mind, whereas Aniruddha is the Deity of the total ego, but previous statements regarding the quadruple forms are confirmed in the *Pañcarātra tantras* in all respects.

In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva* 5.86–100), there is a lucid explanation of the inconceivable potencies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Negating Śaṅkarācārya's statements, the *Mahā-varāha Purāṇa* declares:

*sarve nityāḥ śāśvatās ca dehās tasya parātmanaḥ
hānopādāna-rahitā naiva prakṛti-jāḥ kvacit*

“All the varied expansions of the Personality of Godhead are transcendental and eternal, and all of them repeatedly descend to all the different universes of the material creation. Their bodies, composed of eternity, bliss and knowledge, are everlasting; there is no chance of their decaying, for they are not creations of the material world. Their forms are concentrated spiritual existence, always complete with all spiritual qualities and devoid of material contamination.”

Confirming these statements, the *Nārada-pañcarātra* asserts:

maṇir yathā vibhāgena nīla-pītādibhir yutaḥ

rūpa-bhedam avāpnoti dhyāna-bhedāt tathācyutaḥ

“The infallible Personality of Godhead can manifest His body in different ways according to different modes of worship, just as the *vaidūrya* gem can manifest itself in various colors, such as blue and yellow.” Each incarnation is distinct from all the others. This is possible by the Lord’s inconceivable potency, by which He can simultaneously represent Himself as one, as various partial forms and as the origin of these partial forms. Nothing is impossible for His inconceivable potencies.

Kṛṣṇa is one without a second, but He manifests Himself in different bodies, as stated by Nārada in the Tenth Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*:

*citram bataitad ekena vapuṣā yugapat prthak
grheṣu dvy-aṣṭa-sāhasraṁ striya eka udāvahat*

“It is wonderful indeed that one Kṛṣṇa has simultaneously become different Kṛṣṇas in 16,000 palaces to accept 16,000 queens as His wives.” (*Bhāg.* 10.69.2) The *Padma Purāṇa* also explains:

*sa devo bahudhā bhūtvā nirguṇaḥ puruṣottamaḥ
ekī-bhūya punaḥ śete nirdoṣo harir ādi-kṛt*

“The same Personality of Godhead, Puruṣottama, the original person, who is always devoid of material qualities and contamination, can exhibit Himself in various forms and at the same time lie down in one form.”

In the Tenth Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* it is said, *yajanti tvan-mayās tvām vai bahu-mūrti-eka-mūrtikam*: “O my Lord, although You manifest Yourself in varieties of forms, You are one without a second. Therefore pure devotees concentrate upon You and worship only You.” (*Bhāg.* 10.40.7) In the *Kūrma Purāṇa* it is said:

*asthūlās cāṇaṇuś caiva sthūlo ’ṇuś caiva sarvataḥ
avarṇaḥ sarvataḥ proktaḥ śyāmo raktānta-locanaḥ*

“The Lord is personal although impersonal, He is atomic although great, and He is blackish and has red eyes although He is colorless.” By material calculation all this may appear contradictory, but if we understand that the Supreme Personality of Godhead has inconceivable potencies, we can accept these facts as eternally possible in Him. In our present condition we cannot understand the spiritual activities and how they occur, but although they are inconceivable in the material context, we should not disregard such contradictory conceptions.

Although it is apparently inconceivable, it is quite possible for the Absolute to reconcile all opposing elements. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* establishes this in the Sixth Canto (6.9.34–37):

“O my Lord, Your transcendental pastimes and enjoyments all appear inconceivable because they are not limited by the causal and effective actions of material thought. You can do everything without performing bodily work. The *Vedas* say that the Absolute Truth has multifarious potencies and does not need to do anything personally. My dear Lord, You are entirely devoid of material qualities. Without anyone’s help, You can create, maintain and dissolve the entire qualitative material manifestation, yet in all such activities You do not change. You do not accept the results of Your activities, unlike ordinary demons and demigods, who suffer or enjoy the reactions of their activities in the material world. Unaffected by the reactions of work, You eternally exist with Your full spiritual potency. This we cannot fully understand.

“Because You are unlimited in Your six opulences, no one can count Your transcendental qualities. Philosophers and other thoughtful persons are overwhelmed by the contradictory manifestations of the physical world and the propositions of logical arguments and judgments. Because they are bewildered by word jugglery and disturbed by the different calculations of the scriptures, their theories cannot touch You, who are the ruler and controller of everyone and whose glories are beyond conception.

“Your inconceivable potency keeps You unattached to the mundane qualities. Surpassing all conceptions of material contemplation, Your pure transcendental knowledge keeps You beyond all speculative processes. By Your inconceivable potency, there is nothing contradictory in You.

“People may sometimes think of You as impersonal or personal, but You are one. For persons who are confused or bewildered, a rope may appear to manifest itself as different kinds of snakes. For similar confused persons who are uncertain about You, You create various philosophical methods in pursuance of their uncertain positions.”

We should always remember the differences between spiritual and material actions. The Supreme Lord, being all-spiritual, can perform any act without extraneous help. In the material world, if we want to manufacture an earthen pot, we need the ingredients, a machine and also a laborer. But we should not extend this idea to the actions of the Supreme Lord, for He can create anything in a moment without that which appears necessary in our own conception. When the Lord appears as an incarnation to fulfill a particular purpose, this does not indicate that He is unable to fulfill it without appearing. He can do anything simply by His will, but by His causeless mercy He appears to be dependent upon His devotees. He appears as the son of Yaśodāmātā not because He is dependent on her care but because He accepts such a role by His causeless mercy. When He appears for the protection of His devotees, He naturally accepts trials and tribulations on their behalf.

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is said that the Lord, being equally disposed toward every living being, has no enemies and no friends but that He has special affection for a devotee who always thinks of Him in love. Therefore neutrality and partiality are both among the transcendental qualities of the Lord, and they are properly adjusted by His inconceivable energy. The Lord is Parabrahman, or the source of the impersonal Brahma, which is His all-pervading feature of neutrality. In His personal feature, however, as the owner of all transcendental opulences, the Lord displays His partiality by taking the side of His devotees. Partiality,

neutrality and all such qualities are present in God; otherwise they could not be experienced in the creation. Since He is the total existence, all things are properly adjusted in the Absolute. In the relative world such qualities are displayed in a perverted manner, and therefore we experience nonduality as a perverted reflection. Because there is no logic to explain how things happen in the realm of spirit, the Lord is sometimes described as being beyond the range of experience. But if we simply accept the Lord's inconceivability, we can then adjust all things in Him. Nondevotees cannot understand the Lord's inconceivable energy, and consequently for them it is said that He is beyond the range of conceivable expression. The author of the *Brahma-sūtras* accepts this fact and says, *śrutes tu śabda-mūlatvāt*: the Supreme Personality of Godhead, being inconceivable to an ordinary man, can be understood only through the evidence of the Vedic injunctions. The *Skanda Purāṇa* confirms, *acintyāḥ khalu ye bhāvā na tāṁs tarkeṇa yojayet*: "Matters inconceivable to a common man should not be a subject for argument." We find very wonderful qualities even in such material things as jewels and drugs. Indeed, their qualities often appear inconceivable. Therefore if we do not attribute inconceivable potencies to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, we cannot establish His supremacy. It is because of these inconceivable potencies that the glories of the Lord have always been accepted as difficult to understand.

Ignorance and the jugglery of words are very common in human society, but they do not help one understand the inconceivable energies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. If we accept such ignorance and word jugglery, we cannot accept the Supreme Lord's perfection in six opulences. For example, one of the opulences of the Supreme Lord is complete knowledge. Therefore, how could ignorance be conceivable in Him? Vedic instructions and sensible arguments establish that the Lord's maintaining the cosmic manifestation and simultaneously being indifferent to the activities of its maintenance cannot be contradictory, because of His inconceivable energies. To a person who is always absorbed in the thought of snakes, a rope always appears to be a snake, and similarly to a person bewildered by material qualities and devoid of

knowledge of the Absolute, the Supreme Personality of Godhead appears according to diverse bewildered conclusions.

Someone might argue that the Absolute would be affected by duality if He were both all-cognizance (Brahman) and the Personality of Godhead with six opulences in full (Bhagavān). To refute such an argument, the aphorism *svarūpa-dvayam īkṣyate* declares that in spite of appearances, there is no chance of duality in the Absolute, for He is but one in diverse manifestations. Understanding that the Absolute displays varied pastimes by the influence of His energies at once removes the apparent incongruity of His inconceivably opposite energies. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.4.16) gives the following description of the inconceivable potency of the Lord:

*karmāṇy anīhasya bhavo 'bhavasya te
durgāśrayo 'thāri-bhayāt palāyanam
kālātmano yat pramadā-yutāśrayaḥ
svātman-rateḥ khidyati dhīr vidām iha*

“Although the Supreme Personality of Godhead has nothing to do, He nevertheless acts; although He is always unborn, He nevertheless takes birth; although He is time, fearful to everyone, He flees Mathurā in fear of His enemy to take shelter in a fort; and although He is self-sufficient, He marries 16,000 women. These pastimes seem like bewildering contradictions, even to the most intelligent.” Had these activities of the Lord not been a reality, sages would not have been puzzled by them. Therefore such activities should never be considered imaginary. Whenever the Lord desires, His inconceivable energy (*yogamāyā*) serves Him in creating and performing such pastimes.

The scriptures known as the *Pañcarātra-śāstras* are recognized Vedic scriptures that have been accepted by the great *ācāryas*. These scriptures are not products of the modes of passion and ignorance. Learned scholars and *brāhmaṇas* therefore always refer to them as *sātvata-saṁhitās*. The original speaker of these scriptures is Nārāyaṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This is especially mentioned in the *Mokṣa-dharma* (349.68),

which is part of the *Śānti-parva* of the *Mahābhārata*. Liberated sages like Nārada and Vyāsa, who are free from the four defects of conditioned souls, are the propagators of these scriptures. Śrī Nārada Muni is the original speaker of the *Pañcarātra-sāstra*. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is also considered a *sātvata-saṁhitā*. Indeed, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu declared, *śrīmad-bhāgavatam purāṇam amalām*: “*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is a spotless *Purāṇa*.” Malicious editors and scholars who attempt to misrepresent the *Pañcarātra-sāstras* to refute their regulations are most abominable. In the modern age, such malicious scholars have even commented misleadingly upon the *Bhagavad-gītā*, which was spoken by Kṛṣṇa, to prove that there is no Kṛṣṇa. How the Māyāvādīs have misrepresented the *pāñcarātrika-vidhi* will be shown below.

(1) In commenting on *Vedānta-sūtra* 2.2.42, Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya has claimed that Saṅkarṣaṇa is a *jīva*, an ordinary living entity, but there is no evidence in any Vedic scripture that devotees of the Lord have ever said that Saṅkarṣaṇa is an ordinary living entity. He is an infallible plenary expansion of the Supreme Personality of Godhead in the Viṣṇu category, and He is beyond the creation of material nature. He is the original source of the living entities. The *Upaniṣads* declare, *nityo nityānāṁ cetanaś cetanānām*: “He is the supreme living entity among all the living entities.” Therefore He is *vibhu-caitanya*, the greatest. He is directly the cause of the cosmic manifestation and the infinitesimal living beings. He is the infinite living entity, and ordinary living entities are infinitesimal. Therefore He is never to be considered an ordinary living being, for that would be against the conclusion of the authorized scriptures. The living entities are also beyond the limitations of birth and death. This is the version of the *Vedas*, and it is accepted by those who follow scriptural injunctions and who have actually descended in the disciplic succession.

(2) In answer to Śaṅkarācārya’s commentary on *Vedānta-sūtra* 2.2.43, it must be said that the original Viṣṇu of all the Viṣṇu categories, which are distributed in several ways, is Mūla-saṅkarṣaṇa. *Mūla* means “the original.” Saṅkarṣaṇa is also Viṣṇu, but from Him all other Viṣṇus

expand. This is confirmed in the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.46), wherein it is said that just as a flame transferred from another flame acts like the original, so the Viṣṇus who emanate from Mūlasaṅkarṣaṇa are as good as the original Viṣṇu. One should worship that Supreme Personality of Godhead, Govinda, who thus expands Himself.

(3) In reply to the commentary of Śaṅkarācārya on the forty-fourth aphorism, it may be said that no pure devotees strictly following the principles of the *Pañcarātra* will ever accept the statement that all the expansions of Viṣṇu are different identities, for this idea is completely false. Even Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya, in his commentary on the forty-second aphorism, has accepted that the Personality of Godhead can automatically expand Himself variously. Therefore his commentary on the forty-second aphorism and his commentary on the forty-fourth aphorism are contradictory. It is a defect of Māyāvāda commentaries that they make one statement in one place and a contradictory statement in another place as a tactic to refute the Bhāgavata school. Thus Māyāvādī commentators do not even follow regulative principles. It should be noted that the Bhāgavata school accepts the quadruple forms of Nārāyaṇa, but that does not mean that it accepts many Gods. Devotees know perfectly well that the Absolute Truth, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is one without a second. They are never pantheists, worshipers of many Gods, for this is against the injunction of the *Vedas*. Devotees completely believe, with strong faith, that Nārāyaṇa is transcendental and has inconceivable proprietorship of various transcendental potencies. We therefore recommend that scholars consult the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, where these ideas are explicitly stated. Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya has tried to prove that Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha expand through cause and effect. He has compared Them with earth and earthen pots. That is completely ignorant, however, for there is no such thing as cause and effect in Their expansions (*nānyad yat sad-asat-param*). The *Kūrma Purāṇa* also confirms, *deha-dehi-vibhedo 'yaṁ neśvare vidyate kvacit*: “There is no difference between body and soul in the Supreme Personality of Godhead.” Cause and effect are material. For example, it is seen that a father’s body is the cause of a son’s body, but

the soul is neither cause nor effect. On the spiritual platform there are none of the differences we find in cause and effect. Since all the forms of the Supreme Personality of Godhead are spiritually supreme, They are equally controllers of material nature. Standing on the fourth dimension, They are predominating figures on the transcendental platform. There is no trace of material contamination in Their expansions because material laws cannot influence Them. There is no such rule as cause and effect outside of the material world. Therefore the understanding of cause and effect cannot approach the full, transcendental, complete expansions of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Vedic literature proves this:

*om pūrṇam adaḥ pūrṇam idaṁ pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate
pūrṇasya pūrṇam ādāya pūrṇam evāvaśiṣyate*

“The Personality of Godhead is perfect and complete, and because He is completely perfect, all emanations from Him, such as this phenomenal world, are perfectly equipped as complete wholes. Whatever is produced of the complete whole is also complete by itself. Because He is the complete whole, even though so many complete units emanate from Him, He remains the complete balance.” (*Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 5.1) It is most apparent that nondevotees violate the rules and regulations of devotional service to equate the whole cosmic manifestation, which is the external feature of Viṣṇu, with the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is the controller of *māyā*, or with His quadruple expansions. Equating *māyā* with spirit, or *māyā* with the Lord, is a sign of atheism. The cosmic creation, which manifests life in forms from Brahmā to the ant, is the external feature of the Supreme Lord. It comprises one fourth of the Lord’s energy, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (*ekāṁśena sthito jagat*). The cosmic manifestation of the illusory energy is material nature, and everything within material nature is made of matter. Therefore, one should not try to compare the expansions of material nature to the *catur-vyūha*, the quadruple expansions of the Personality of Godhead, but unfortunately the Māyāvādī school unreasonably attempts to do this.

(4) To answer Śaṅkarācārya’s commentary on *Vedānta-sūtra* 2.2.45, the

substance of the transcendental qualities and their spiritual nature is described in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva* 5.208–214) as follows: “Some say that transcendence must be void of all qualities because qualities are manifested only in matter. According to them, all qualities are like temporary, flickering mirages. But this is not acceptable. Since the Supreme Personality of Godhead is absolute, His qualities are nondifferent from Him. His form, name, qualities and everything else pertaining to Him are as spiritual as He is. Every qualitative expansion of the absolute Personality of Godhead is identical with Him. Since the Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, is the reservoir of all pleasure, all the transcendental qualities that expand from Him are also reservoirs of pleasure. This is confirmed in the scripture known as *Brahma-tarka*, which states that the Supreme Lord Hari is qualified by Himself, and therefore Viṣṇu and His pure devotees and their transcendental qualities cannot be different from their persons. In the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* Lord Viṣṇu is worshiped in the following words: ‘Let the Supreme Personality of Godhead be merciful toward us. His existence is never infected by material qualities.’ In the same *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* it is also said that all the qualities attributed to the Supreme Lord, such as knowledge, opulence, beauty, strength and influence, are known to be nondifferent from Him. This is also confirmed in the *Padma Purāṇa*, which explains that whenever the Supreme Lord is described as having no qualities, this should be understood to indicate that He is devoid of material qualities. In the First Chapter of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.16.29) it is said, ‘O Dharma, protector of religious principles, all noble and sublime qualities are eternally manifested in the person of Kṛṣṇa, and devotees and transcendentalists who aspire to become faithful also desire to possess such transcendental qualities.’” It is therefore to be understood that Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the transcendental form of absolute bliss, is the fountainhead of all pleasurable transcendental qualities and inconceivable potencies. In this connection we may recommend references to *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Third Canto, Chapter Twenty-six, verses 21, 25, 27 and 28.

Śrīpāda Rāmānujācārya has also refuted the arguments of Śaṅkara in his own commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra*, which is known as the *Śrī-*

bhāṣya: “Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya has tried to equate the *Pañcarātras* with the philosophy of the atheist Kapila, and thus he has tried to prove that the *Pañcarātras* contradict the Vedic injunctions. The *Pañcarātras* state that the personality of *jīva* called Saṅkarṣaṇa has emerged from Vāsudeva, the supreme cause of all causes, that Pradyumna, the mind, has come from Saṅkarṣaṇa, and that Aniruddha, the ego, has come from Pradyumna. But one cannot say that the living entity (*jīva*) takes birth or is created, for such a statement is against the injunction of the *Vedas*. As stated in the *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* (2.18), living entities, as individual spiritual souls, can have neither birth nor death. All Vedic literature declares that the living entities are eternal. Therefore when it is said that Saṅkarṣaṇa is *jīva*, this indicates that He is the predominating Deity of the living entities. Similarly, Pradyumna is the predominating Deity of the mind, and Aniruddha is the predominating Deity of the ego.

“It has been said that Pradyumna, the mind, was produced from Saṅkarṣaṇa. But if Saṅkarṣaṇa were a living entity, this could not be accepted, because a living entity cannot be the cause of the mind. The Vedic injunctions state that everything—including life, mind and the senses—comes from the Supreme Personality of Godhead. It is impossible for the mind to be produced by a living entity, for the *Vedas* state that everything comes from the Absolute Truth, the Supreme Lord.

“Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha have all the potent features of the absolute Personality of Godhead, according to the revealed scriptures, which contain undeniable facts that no one can refute. Therefore these members of the quadruple manifestation are never to be considered ordinary living beings. Each of Them is a plenary expansion of the Absolute Godhead, and thus each is identical with the Supreme Lord in knowledge, opulence, energy, influence, prowess and potencies. The evidence of the *Pañcarātras* cannot be neglected. Only untrained persons who have not genuinely studied the *Pañcarātras* think that the *Pañcarātras* contradict the *śrutis* regarding the birth or beginning of the living entity. In this connection, we must accept the verdict of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, which says, ‘The absolute Personality of Godhead, who is

known as Vāsudeva and who is very affectionate toward His surrendered devotees, expands Himself in quadruple forms who are subordinate to Him and at the same time identical with Him in all respects.’ The *Pauṣkara-saṁhitā* states, ‘The scriptures that recommend that *brāhmaṇas* worship the quadruple forms of the Supreme Personality of Godhead are called *āgamas* [authorized Vedic literatures].’ In all Vaiṣṇava literature it is said that worshipping these quadruple forms is as good as worshipping the Supreme Personality of Godhead Vāsudeva, who in His different expansions, complete in six opulences, can accept offerings from His devotees of the results of their prescribed duties. Worshipping the expansions for pastimes, such as Nṛsiṁha, Rāma, Śeṣa and Kūrma, promotes one to the worship of the Saṅkarṣaṇa quadruple. From that position one is raised to the platform of worshipping Vāsudeva, the Supreme Brahman. In the *Pauṣkara-saṁhitā* it is said, ‘If one fully worships according to the regulative principles, one can attain the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Vāsudeva.’ It is to be accepted that Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are as good as Lord Vāsudeva, for They all have inconceivable power and can accept transcendental forms like Vāsudeva. Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are never born, but They can manifest Themselves in various incarnations before the eyes of pure devotees. This is the conclusion of all Vedic literature. That the Lord can manifest Himself before His devotees by His inconceivable power is not against the teaching of the *Pañcarātras*. Since Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are, respectively, the predominating Deities of all living entities, the total mind and the total ego, the designation of Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha as ‘*jīva*,’ ‘mind’ and ‘ego’ are never contradictory to the statements of the scriptures. These terms identify these Deities, just as the terms ‘sky’ and ‘light’ sometimes identify the Absolute Brahman.

“The scriptures completely deny the birth or production of the living entity. In the *Parama-saṁhitā* it is described that material nature, which is used for others’ purposes, is factually inert and always subject to transformation. The field of material nature is the arena of the activities of fruitive actors, and since the material field is externally related with

the Supreme Personality of Godhead, it is also eternal. In every *saṁhitā*, the *jīva* (living entity) has been accepted as eternal, and in the *Pañcarātras* the birth of the *jīva* is completely denied. Anything that is produced must also be annihilated. Therefore if we accept the birth of the living entity, we also have to accept his annihilation. But since the Vedic literatures say that the living entity is eternal, one should not think the living being to be produced at a certain time. In the beginning of the *Parama-saṁhitā* it is definitely stated that the face of material nature is constantly changeable. Therefore ‘beginning,’ ‘annihilation’ and all such terms are applicable only in the material nature.

“Considering all these points, one should understand that Śaṅkarācārya’s statement that Saṅkarṣaṇa is born as a *jīva* is completely against the Vedic statements. His assertions are completely refuted by the above arguments. In this connection the commentary of Śrīdhara Svāmī on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.1.34) is very helpful.”

For a detailed refutation of Śaṅkarācārya’s arguments attempting to prove Saṅkarṣaṇa an ordinary living being, one may refer to Śrīmat Sudarśanācārya’s commentary on the *Śrī-bhāṣya*, which is known as the *Śrūta-prakāśikā*.

The original quadruple forms—Kṛṣṇa, Baladeva, Pradyumna and Aniruddha—expand into another quadruple, which is present in the Vaikuṇṭha planets of the spiritual sky. Therefore the quadruple forms in the spiritual sky are the second manifestation of the original quadruple in Dvārakā. As explained above, Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are all changeless, transcendental plenary expansions of the Supreme Lord who have no relation to the material modes. The Saṅkarṣaṇa form in the second quadruple is not only a representation of Balarāma but also the original cause of the Causal Ocean, where Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu lies asleep, breathing out the seeds of innumerable universes.

In the spiritual sky there is a spiritual creative energy technically called

śuddha-sattva, which is a pure spiritual energy that sustains all the Vaikuṇṭha planets with the full opulences of knowledge, wealth, prowess, etc. All these actions of *śuddha-sattva* display the potencies of Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa, who is the ultimate reservoir of all individual living entities who are suffering in the material world. When the cosmic creation is annihilated, the living entities, who are indestructible by nature, rest in the body of Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa. Saṅkarṣaṇa is therefore sometimes called the total *jīva*. As spiritual sparks, the living entities have the tendency to be inactive in the association of the material energy, just as sparks of a fire have the tendency to be extinguished as soon as they leave the fire. The spiritual nature of the living being can be rekindled, however, in association with the Supreme Being. Because the living being can appear either in matter or in spirit, the *jīva* is called the marginal potency.

Saṅkarṣaṇa is the origin of Kāraṇa Viṣṇu, who is the original form who creates the universes, and that Saṅkarṣaṇa is but a plenary expansion of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma.

TEXT 42

tānhā ye rāmera rūpa—mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa

cit-chakti-āśraya tiṅho, kāraṇera kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

tānhā—there; *ye*—which; *rāmera rūpa*—the personal feature of Balarāma; *mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa*—Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa; *cit-śakti-āśraya*—the shelter of the spiritual potency; *tiṅho*—He; *kāraṇera kāraṇa*—the cause of all causes.

TRANSLATION

There [in the spiritual sky] the personal feature of Balarāma called Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of the spiritual energy. He is the primary cause,

the cause of all causes.

TEXT 43

cic-chakti-vilāsa eka— —‘śuddha-sattva’ nāma

śuddha-sattva-maya yata vaikuṇṭhādi-dhāma

SYNONYMS

cit-śakti-vilāsa—pastimes in the spiritual energy; *eka*—one; *śuddha-sattva nāma*—named *śuddha-sattva*, pure existence, free from material contamination; *śuddha-sattva-maya*—of purely spiritual existence; *yata*—all; *vaikuṇṭha-ādi-dhāma*—the spiritual planets, known as Vaikuṇṭhas.

TRANSLATION

One variety of the pastimes of the spiritual energy is described as pure goodness [viśuddha-sattva]. It comprises all the abodes of Vaikuṇṭha.

TEXT 44

ṣaḍ-vidhaiśvarya tāñhā sakala cinmaya

saṅkarṣaṇera vibhūti saba, jāniha niścaya

SYNONYMS

ṣaḍ-vidha-aiśvarya—six kinds of opulences; *tāñhā*—there; *sakala cit-maya*—everything spiritual; *saṅkarṣaṇera*—of Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa; *vibhūti saba*—all different opulences; *jāniha niścaya*—know certainly.

TRANSLATION

The six attributes are all spiritual. Know for certain that they are all manifestations of the opulence of Saṅkarṣaṇa.

TEXT 45

‘jīva’-nāma taṭasthākhyā eka śakti haya

mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa—saba jīvera āśraya

SYNONYMS

jīva—the living entity; *nāma*—named; *taṭa-sthā-ākhyā*—known as the marginal potency; *eka*—one; *śakti*—energy; *haya*—is; *mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa*—Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa; *saba*—all; *jīvera*—of living entities; *āśraya*—the shelter.

TRANSLATION

There is one marginal potency, known as the jīva. Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of all jīvas.

TEXT 46

yāñhā haite viśvotpatti, yāñhāte pralaya

sei puruṣera saṅkarṣaṇa samāśraya

SYNONYMS

yāñhā haite—from whom; *viśva-utpatti*—the creation of the material cosmic manifestation; *yāñhāte*—in whom; *pralaya*—merging; *sei puruṣera*—of that Supreme Personality of Godhead; *saṅkarṣaṇa*—Saṅkarṣaṇa; *samāśraya*—the original shelter.

TRANSLATION

Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original shelter of the puruṣa, from whom this world is created and in whom it is dissolved.

TEXT 47

sarvāśraya, sarvādbhuta, aiśvarya apāra

‘ananta’ kahite nāre mahimā yāñhāra

SYNONYMS

sarva-āśraya—the shelter of everything; *sarva-adbhuta*—wonderful in every respect; *aiśvarya*—opulences; *apāra*—unfathomed; *ananta*—Ananta Śeṣa; *kahite nāre*—cannot speak; *mahimā yāñhāra*—the glories of whom.

TRANSLATION

He [Saṅkarṣaṇa] is the shelter of everything. He is wonderful in every respect, and His opulences are infinite. Even Ananta cannot describe His glory.

TEXT 48

turīya, viśuddha-sattva, ‘saṅkarṣaṇa’ nāma

tiñho yāñra amśa, sei nityānanda-rāma

SYNONYMS

turīya—transcendental; *viśuddha-sattva*—pure existence; *saṅkarṣaṇa nāma*—named Saṅkarṣaṇa; *tiñho yāñra amśa*—of whom that Saṅkarṣaṇa is also a partial expansion; *sei nityānanda-rāma*—that person is known as Balarāma or Nityānanda.

TRANSLATION

That Saṅkarṣaṇa, who is transcendental pure goodness, is a partial expansion of Nityānanda Balarāma.

TEXT 49

aṣṭama ślokerā kaila saṅkṣepe vivaraṇa

navama ślokerā artha śuna diyā mana

SYNONYMS

aṣṭama—eighth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *kaila*—I have done; *saṅkṣepe*—in brief; *vivaraṇa*—description; *navama*—the ninth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—the meaning; *śuna*—please hear; *diyā mana*—with mental attention.

TRANSLATION

I have briefly explained the eighth verse. Now please listen with attention as I explain the ninth verse.

TEXT 50

māyā-bhartājāṇḍa-saṅghāśrayāṅgaḥ

śete sākṣāt kāraṇāmbhodhi-madhye

yasyaikāṁśaḥ śrī-pumān ādi-devas

taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye

SYNONYMS

māyā-bhartā—the master of the illusory energy; *ajā-aṇḍa-saṅgha*—of the multitude of universes; *āśraya*—the shelter; *aṅgaḥ*—whose body; *śete*—He lies; *sākṣāt*—directly; *kāraṇa-ambhodhi-madhye*—in the midst of the Causal Ocean; *yasya*—whose; *eka-amśaḥ*—one portion; *śrī-pumān*—the Supreme Person; *ādi-devaḥ*—the original *puruṣa* incarnation; *tam*—to Him; *śrī-nityānanda-rāmam*—to Lord Balarāma in the form of Lord Nityānanda; *prapadye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

I offer my full obeisances unto the feet of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose partial representation called Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, lying on the Kāraṇa Ocean, is the original *puruṣa*, the master of the illusory energy, and the shelter of all the universes.

TEXT 51

vaikuṇṭha-bāhire yei jyotir-maya dhāma

tāhāra bāhire 'kāraṇārṇava' nāma

SYNONYMS

vaikuṇṭha-bāhire—outside the Vaikuṇṭha planets; *yei*—that; *jyotiḥ-maya dhāma*—impersonal Brahman effulgence; *tāhāra bāhire*—outside that effulgence; *kāraṇa-arṇava nāma*—an ocean called Kāraṇa.

TRANSLATION

Outside the Vaikuṇṭha planets is the impersonal Brahman effulgence, and beyond that effulgence is the Kāraṇa Ocean, or Causal Ocean.

PURPORT

The impersonal glowing effulgence known as impersonal Brahman is the

outer space of the Vaikuṇṭha planets in the spiritual sky. Beyond that impersonal Brahman is the great Causal Ocean, which lies between the material and spiritual skies. The material nature is a by-product of this Causal Ocean.

Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who lies on the Causal Ocean, creates the universes merely by glancing upon material nature. Therefore Kṛṣṇa personally has nothing to do with the material creation. The *Bhagavad-gītā* confirms that the Lord glances over material nature and thus she produces the many material universes. Neither Kṛṣṇa in Goloka nor Nārāyaṇa in Vaikuṇṭha comes directly in contact with the material creation. They are completely aloof from the material energy.

It is the function of Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa in the form of Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu to glance over the material creation, which is situated beyond the limits of the Causal Ocean. Material nature is connected with the Personality of Godhead by His glance over her and nothing more. It is said that she is impregnated by the energy of His glance. The material energy, *māyā*, never even touches the Causal Ocean, for the Lord's glance focuses upon her from a great distance away.

The glancing power of the Lord agitates the entire cosmic energy, and thus its actions begin at once. This indicates that matter, however powerful she may be, has no power by herself. Her activity begins by the grace of the Lord, and then the entire cosmic creation is manifested in a systematic way. The analogy of a woman's conception can help us understand this subject to a certain extent. The mother is passive, but the father puts his energy within the mother, and thus she conceives. She supplies the ingredients for the birth of the child in her womb. Similarly, the Lord activates material nature, which then supplies the ingredients for cosmic development.

Material nature has two different phases. The aspect called *pradhāna* supplies the material ingredients for cosmic development, and the aspect called *māyā* causes the manifestation of her ingredients, which are

temporary, like foam in the ocean. In reality, the temporary manifestations of material nature are originally caused by the spiritual glance of the Lord. The Personality of Godhead is the direct, or remote, cause of creation, and material nature is the indirect, or immediate, cause. Materialistic scientists, puffed-up by the magical changes their so-called inventions have brought about, cannot see the real potency of Godhead behind matter. Therefore the jugglery of science is gradually leading people to a godless civilization at the cost of the goal of human life. Having missed the goal of life, materialists run after self-sufficiency, not knowing that material nature is already self-sufficient by the grace of God. Thus creating a colossal hoax in the name of civilization, they create an imbalance in the natural self-sufficiency of material nature.

To think of material nature as all in all, not knowing the original cause, is ignorance. Lord Caitanya appeared in order to dissipate this darkness of ignorance by igniting the spark of spiritual life that can, by His causeless mercy, enlighten the entire world.

To explain how *māyā* acts by Kṛṣṇa's power, the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* gives the analogy of an iron rod in a fire: although the rod is not fire, it becomes red-hot and acts like fire itself. Similarly, all the actions and reactions of material nature are not actually the work of material nature but are actions and reactions of the energy of the Supreme Lord manifested through matter. The power of electricity is transmitted through the medium of copper, but this does not mean that the copper is electricity. The power is generated at a powerhouse under the control of an expert living being. Similarly, behind all the jugglery of the natural laws is a great living being, who is a person like the mechanical engineer in the powerhouse. It is by His intelligence that the entire cosmic creation moves in a systematic way.

The modes of nature, which directly cause material actions, are also originally activated by Nārāyaṇa. A simple analogy will explain how this is so: When a potter manufactures a pot from clay, the potter's wheel, his tools and the clay are the immediate causes of the pot, but the potter is

the chief cause. Similarly, Nārāyaṇa is the chief cause of all material creations, and the material energy supplies the ingredients of matter. Therefore without Nārāyaṇa, all other causes are useless, just as the potter's wheel and tools are useless without the potter himself. Since materialistic scientists ignore the Personality of Godhead, it is as if they were concerned with the potter's wheel and its rotation, the potter's tools and the ingredients for the pots, but had no knowledge of the potter himself. Therefore modern science has created an imperfect, godless civilization that is in gross ignorance of the ultimate cause. Scientific advancement should have a great goal to attain, and that great goal should be the Personality of Godhead. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is said that after conducting research for many, many births, great men of knowledge who stress the importance of experimental thought can know the Personality of Godhead, who is the cause of all causes. When one knows Him perfectly, one surrenders unto Him and then becomes a *mahātmā*.

TEXT 52

vaikuṇṭha beḍiyā eka āche jala-nidhi

ananta, apāra—tāra nāhika avadhi

SYNONYMS

vaikuṇṭha—the spiritual planets of Vaikuṇṭha; *beḍiyā*—surrounding; *eka*—one; *āche*—there is; *jala-nidhi*—ocean of water; *ananta*—unlimited; *apāra*—unfathomed; *tāra*—of that; *nāhika*—no; *avadhi*—limitation.

TRANSLATION

Surrounding Vaikuṇṭha is a mass of water that is endless, unfathomed and unlimited.

TEXT 53

vaikuṇṭhara pṛthivy-ādi sakala cinmaya

māyika bhūtera tathi janma nāhi haya

SYNONYMS

vaikuṇṭhara—of the spiritual world; *pṛthivī-ādi*—earth, water, etc.; *sakala*—all; *cit-maya*—spiritual; *māyika*—material; *bhūtera*—of elements; *tathi*—there; *janma*—generation; *nāhi haya*—there is not.

TRANSLATION

The earth, water, fire, air and ether of Vaikuṇṭha are all spiritual. Material elements are not found there.

TEXT 54

cinmaya-jala sei parama kāraṇa

yāra eka kaṇā gaṅgā patita-pāvana

SYNONYMS

cit-maya—spiritual; *jala*—water; *sei*—that; *parama kāraṇa*—original cause; *yāra*—of which; *eka*—one; *kaṇā*—drop; *gaṅgā*—the sacred Ganges; *patita-pāvana*—the deliverer of fallen souls.

TRANSLATION

The water of the Kāraṇa Ocean, which is the original cause, is therefore spiritual. The sacred Ganges, which is but a drop of it, purifies the fallen souls.

TEXT 55

sei ta' kāraṇārṇave sei saṅkarṣaṇa

āpanāra eka aṁśe karena śayana

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *ta'*—certainly; *kāraṇa-arṇave*—in the ocean of cause, or Causal Ocean; *sei*—that; *saṅkarṣaṇa*—Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa; *āpanāra*—of His own; *eka*—one; *aṁśe*—by the part; *karena śayana*—lies down.

TRANSLATION

In that ocean lies a plenary portion of Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa.

TEXT 56

mahat-sraṣṭā puruṣa, tiṅho jagat-kāraṇa

ādya-avatāra kare māyāya īkṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

mahat-sraṣṭā—the creator of the total material energy; *puruṣa*—the person; *tiṅho*—He; *jagat-kāraṇa*—the cause of the material cosmic manifestation; *ādya*—original; *avatāra*—incarnation; *kare*—does; *māyāya*—over the material energy; *īkṣaṇa*—glance.

TRANSLATION

He is known as the first puruṣa, the creator of the total material energy. He, the cause of the universes, the first incarnation, casts His glance over māyā.

TEXT 57

māyā-śakti rahe kāraṇābdhira bāhire

kāraṇa-samudra māyā paraśīte nāre

SYNONYMS

māyā-śakti—material energy; *rahe*—remains; *kāraṇa-abdhira*—to the Causal Ocean; *bāhire*—external; *kāraṇa-samudra*—the Causal Ocean; *māyā*—material energy; *paraśīte nāre*—cannot touch.

TRANSLATION

Māyā-śakti resides outside the Kāraṇa Ocean. Māyā cannot touch its waters.

TEXT 58

sei ta' māyāra dui-vidha avasthiti

jagatera upādāna 'pradhāna', prakṛti

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *ta'*—certainly; *māyāra*—of the material energy; *dui-vidha*—two varieties; *avasthiti*—existence; *jagatera*—of the material world; *upādāna*—the ingredients; *pradhāna*—named *pradhāna*; *prakṛti*—material nature.

TRANSLATION

Māyā has two varieties of existence. One is called *pradhāna* or *prakṛti*. It supplies the ingredients of the material world.

PURPORT

Māyā, the external energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is divided into two parts. *Māyā* is both the cause of the cosmic manifestation and the agent who supplies its ingredients. As the cause of the cosmic manifestation she is known as *māyā*, and as the agent supplying the ingredients of the cosmic manifestation she is known as *pradhāna*. An explicit description of these divisions of the external energy is given in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.24.1–4). Elsewhere in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.63.26) the ingredients and cause of the material cosmic manifestation are described as follows:

*kālo daivam karma jīvaḥ svabhāvo
dravyam kṣetram prāṇa ātmā vikāraḥ
tat-saṅghāto bīja-roha-pravāhas
tvan-māyaiṣā tan-niṣedham prapadye*

“O my Lord! Time, activity, providence and nature are four parts of the causal aspect [*māyā*] of the external energy. The conditioned vital force, the subtle material ingredients called the *dravya*, and material nature (which is the field of activity where the false ego acts as the soul), as well as the eleven senses and five elements (earth, water, fire, air and ether), which are the sixteen ingredients of the body—these are the ingredient aspect of *māyā*. The body is generated from activity, and activity is generated from the body, just as a tree is generated from a seed that is generated from a tree. This reciprocal cause and effect is called *māyā*. My dear Lord, You can save me from this cycle of cause and effect. I worship Your lotus feet.”

Although the living entity is primarily related to the causal portion of *māyā*, he is nevertheless conducted by the ingredients of *māyā*. Three forces work in the causal portion of *māyā*: knowledge, desire and activity. The material ingredients are a manifestation of *māyā* as *pradhāna*. In other words, when the three qualities of *māyā* are in a dormant stage, they exist as *prakṛti*, *avyakta* or *pradhāna*. The word *avyakta*, referring to the nonmanifested, is another name of *pradhāna*. In the *avyakta* stage, material nature is without varieties. Varieties are manifested by the

pradhāna portion of *māyā*. The word *pradhāna* is therefore more important than *avyakta* or *prakṛti*.

TEXT 59

jagat-kāraṇa nahe prakṛti jaḍa-rūpā

śakti sañcāriyā tāre kṛṣṇa kare kṛpā

SYNONYMS

jagat—of the material world; *kāraṇa*—the cause; *nahe*—cannot be; *prakṛti*—the material nature; *jaḍa-rūpā*—dull, without action; *śakti*—energy; *sañcāriyā*—infusing; *tāre*—unto the dull material nature; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kare*—shows; *kṛpā*—mercy.

TRANSLATION

Because *prakṛti* is dull and inert, it cannot actually be the cause of the material world. But Lord Kṛṣṇa shows His mercy by infusing His energy into the dull, inert material nature.

TEXT 60

kṛṣṇa-śaktye prakṛti haya gauṇa kāraṇa

agni-śaktye lauha yaiche karaye jāraṇa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-śaktye—by the energy of Kṛṣṇa; *prakṛti*—the material nature; *haya*—becomes; *gauṇa*—indirect; *kāraṇa*—cause; *agni-śaktye*—by the energy of fire; *lauha*—iron; *yaiche*—just as; *karaye*—becomes; *jāraṇa*—powerful or red-hot.

TRANSLATION

Thus prakṛti, by the energy of Lord Kṛṣṇa, becomes the secondary cause, just as iron becomes red-hot by the energy of fire.

TEXT 61

ataeva kṛṣṇa mūla-jagat-kāraṇa

prakṛti—kāraṇa yaiche ajā-gala-stana

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mūla*—original; *jagat-kāraṇa*—the cause of the cosmic manifestation; *prakṛti*—material nature; *kāraṇa*—cause; *yaiche*—exactly like; *ajā-gala-stana*—nipples on the neck of a goat.

TRANSLATION

Therefore Lord Kṛṣṇa is the original cause of the cosmic manifestation. Prakṛti is like the nipples on the neck of a goat, for they cannot give any milk.

PURPORT

The external energy, composed of *pradhāna* or *prakṛti* as the ingredient-supplying portion and *māyā* as the causal portion, is known as *māyā-śakti*. Inert material nature is not the actual cause of the material manifestation, for Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī, Mahā-Viṣṇu, the plenary expansion of Kṛṣṇa, activates all the ingredients. It is in this way that material nature has the power to supply the ingredients. The analogy given is that iron has no power to heat or burn, but after coming in contact with fire the iron becomes red-hot and can then diffuse heat and burn other things. Material nature is like iron, for it has no independence to act without the

touch of Viṣṇu, who is compared to fire. Lord Viṣṇu activates material nature by the power of His glance, and then the ironlike material nature becomes a material-supplying agent just as iron made red-hot becomes a burning agent. Material nature cannot independently become an agent for supplying the material ingredients. This is more clearly explained by Śrī Kapiladeva, an incarnation of Godhead, in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.28.40):

*yatholmukād visphulingād dhūmād vāpi sva-sambhavāt
apy ātmatvenābhimatād yathāgniḥ prthag ulmukāt*

“Although smoke, flaming wood, and sparks are all considered together as ingredients of a fire, the flaming wood is nevertheless different from the fire, and the smoke is different from the flaming wood.” The material elements (earth, water, fire, etc.) are like smoke, the living entities are like sparks, and material nature as *pradhāna* is like the flaming wood. But all of them together are recipients of power from the Supreme Personality of Godhead and are thus able to manifest their individual capacities. In other words, the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the origin of all manifestations. Material nature can supply only when it is activated by the glance of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Just as a woman can deliver a child after being impregnated by the semen of a man, so material nature can supply the material elements after being glanced upon by Mahā-Viṣṇu. Therefore *pradhāna* cannot be independent of the superintendence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.10): *mayādhyakṣeṇa prakṛtiḥ sūyate sa-carācaram. Prakṛti*, the total material energy, works under the superintendence of the Lord. The original source of the material elements is Kṛṣṇa. Therefore the attempt of the atheistic Sāṅkhya philosophers to consider material nature the source of these elements, forgetting Kṛṣṇa, is useless, like trying to get milk from the nipplelike bumps of skin hanging on the neck of a goat.

TEXT 62

māyā-amśe kahi tāre nimitta-kāraṇa

seha nahe, yāte kartā-hetu—nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

māyā-amśe—to the other portion of the material nature; *kahi*—I say; *tāre*—unto her; *nimitta-kāraṇa*—immediate cause; *seha nahe*—that cannot be; *yāte*—because; *kartā-hetu*—the original cause; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

The *māyā* aspect of material nature is the immediate cause of the cosmic manifestation. But it cannot be the real cause, for the original cause is Lord Nārāyaṇa.

TEXT 63

ghaṭera nimitta-hetu yaiche kumbhakāra

taiche jagatera kartā—puruṣāvatāra

SYNONYMS

ghaṭera—of the earthen pot; *nimitta-hetu*—original cause; *yaiche*—just as; *kumbhakāra*—the potter; *taiche*—similarly; *jagatera kartā*—the creator of the material world; *puruṣa-avatāra*—the *puruṣa* incarnation, or Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Viṣṇu.

TRANSLATION

Just as the original cause of an earthen pot is the potter, so the creator of the material world is the first *puruṣa* incarnation [Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Viṣṇu].

TEXT 64

kṛṣṇa—kartā, māyā tāñra kareṇa sahāya

ghaṭera kāraṇa—cakra-daṇḍādi upāya

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kartā*—the creator; *māyā*—material energy; *tāñra*—His; *kareṇa*—does; *sahāya*—assistance; *ghaṭera kāraṇa*—the cause of the earthen pot; *cakra-daṇḍādi*—the wheel, the rod, and so on; *upāya*—instruments.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa is the creator, and māyā only helps Him as an instrument, just like the potter's wheel and other instruments, which are the instrumental causes of a pot.

TEXT 65

dūra haite puruṣa kare māyāte avadhāna

jīva-rūpa vīrya tāte kareṇa ādhāna

SYNONYMS

dūra haite—from a distance; *puruṣa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kare*—does; *māyāte*—unto the material energy; *avadhāna*—glancing over; *jīva-rūpa*—the living entities; *vīrya*—seed; *tāte*—in her; *kareṇa*—does; *ādhāna*—impregnation.

TRANSLATION

The first puruṣa casts His glance at māyā from a distance, and thus He

impregnates her with the seed of life in the form of the living entities.

TEXT 66

eka aṅgābhāse kare māyāte milana

māyā haite janme tabe brahmāṇḍera gaṇa

SYNONYMS

eka—one; *aṅga-ābhāse*—bodily reflection; *kare*—does; *māyāte*—in the material energy; *milana*—mixture; *māyā*—the material energy; *haite*—from; *janme*—grows; *tabe*—then; *brahma-aṇḍera gaṇa*—the groups of universes.

TRANSLATION

The reflected rays of His body mix with māyā, and thus māyā gives birth to myriad universes.

PURPORT

The Vedic conclusion is that the cosmic manifestation visible to the eyes of the conditioned soul is caused by the Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, through the exertion of His specific energies, although in the conclusion of atheistic deliberations this manifested cosmic exhibition is attributed to material nature. The energy of the Absolute Truth is exhibited in three ways: spiritual, material and marginal. The Absolute Truth is identical with His spiritual energy. Only when contacted by the spiritual energy can the material energy work and the temporary material manifestations thus appear active. In the conditioned state the living entities of the marginal energy are a mixture of spiritual and material energies. The marginal energy is originally under the control of the spiritual energy, but, under the control of the material energy, the living entities have been wandering in forgetfulness within the material world

since time immemorial.

The conditioned state is caused by misuse of the individual independence of the spiritual platform, for this separates the living entity from the association of the spiritual energy. But when the living entity is enlightened by the grace of the Supreme Lord or His pure devotee and becomes inclined to revive his original state of loving service, he is on the most auspicious platform of eternal bliss and knowledge. The marginal *jīva*, or living entity, misuses his independence and becomes averse to the eternal service attitude when he independently thinks he is not energy but the energetic. This misconception of his own existence leads him to the attitude of lording it over material nature.

Material nature appears to be just the opposite of the spiritual energy. The fact is that the material energy can work only when in contact with the spiritual energy. Originally the energy of Kṛṣṇa is spiritual, but it works in diverse ways, like electrical energy, which can exhibit the functions of refrigerating or heating through its manifestations in different ways. The material energy is spiritual energy covered by a cloud of illusion, or *māyā*. Therefore, the material energy is not self-sufficient in working. Kṛṣṇa invests His spiritual energy into material energy, and then it can act, just as iron can act like fire after being heated by fire. The material energy can act only when empowered by the spiritual energy.

When covered by the cloud of material energy, the living entity, who is also a spiritual energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, forgets about the activities of the spiritual energy and considers all that happens in the material manifestation to be wonderful. But a person who is engaged in devotional service in full Kṛṣṇa consciousness and who is therefore already situated in the spiritual energy can understand that the material energy has no independent powers: whatever actions are going on are due to the help of the spiritual energy. The material energy, which is a perverted form of the spiritual energy, presents everything pervertedly, thus causing misconceptions and duality. Material scientists

and philosophers conditioned by the spell of material nature suppose that material energy acts automatically, and therefore they are frustrated, like an illusioned person who tries to get milk from the nipplelike bunches of skin on the neck of a goat. As there is no possibility of getting milk from these bunches of skin, there is similarly no possibility that anyone will be successful in understanding the original cause of creation by putting forward theories produced by the material energy. Such an attempt is a manifestation of ignorance.

The material energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is called *māyā*, or illusion, because in two capacities (by supplying the material elements and by causing the material manifestation) it makes the conditioned soul unable to understand the real truth of creation. However, when a living entity is liberated from the conditioned life of matter, he can understand the two different activities of material nature, namely covering and bewildering.

The origin of creation is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. As confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.10), the cosmic manifestation is working under the direction of the Supreme Lord, who invests the material energy with three material qualities. Agitated by these qualities, the elements supplied by the material energy produce varieties of things, just as an artist produces varieties of pictures by mixing the three colors red, yellow and blue. Yellow represents the quality of goodness, red represents passion, and blue represents ignorance. Therefore the colorful material creation is but an interaction of these three qualities, represented in eighty-one varieties of mixtures (3×3 equaling 9, 9×9 thus equaling 81). Deluded by material energy, the conditioned soul, enamored by these eighty-one varieties of manifestations, wants to lord it over material energy, just as a moth wants to enjoy a fire. This illusion is the net result of the conditioned soul's forgetfulness of his eternal relationship with the Supreme personality of Godhead. When conditioned, the soul is impelled by the material energy to engage in sense gratification, whereas one enlightened by the spiritual energy engages himself in the service of the Supreme Lord in his eternal relationship.

Kṛṣṇa is the original cause of the spiritual world, and He is the covered cause of the material manifestation. He is also the original cause of the marginal potency, the living entities. He is both the leader and maintainer of the living entities, who are called the marginal potency because they can act under the protection of the spiritual energy or under the cover of the material energy. With the help of the spiritual energy we can understand that independence is visible only in Kṛṣṇa, who by His inconceivable energy is able to act in any way He likes.

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is the Absolute Whole, and the living entities are parts of the Absolute Whole. This relationship of the Supreme Personality of Godhead and the living entities is eternal. One should never mistakenly think that the spiritual whole can be divided into small parts by the small material energy. The *Bhagavad-gītā* does not support this Māyāvāda theory. Rather, it clearly states that the living entities are eternally small fragments of the supreme spiritual whole. As a part can never be equal with the whole, so a living entity, as a minute fragment of the spiritual whole, cannot be equal at any time to the Supreme Whole, the absolute Personality of Godhead. Although the Supreme Lord and the living entities are quantitatively related as the whole and the parts, the parts are nevertheless qualitatively one with the whole. Thus the living entities, although always qualitatively one with the Supreme Lord, are in a relative position. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is the controller of everything, and the living entities are always controlled, either by the spiritual energy or by the material energy. Therefore a living entity can never become the controller of material or spiritual energies. The natural position of the living being is always as a subordinate of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. When one agrees to act in such a position, he attains perfection in life, but if one rebels against this principle, he is in the conditioned state.

TEXT 67

agaṇya, ananta yata aṇḍa-sanniveśa

tata-rūpe puruṣa kare sabāte prakāśa

SYNONYMS

agaṇya—innumerable; *ananta*—unlimited; *yata*—all; *aṇḍa*—universes; *sanniveśa*—groups; *tata-rūpe*—in as many forms; *puruṣa*—the Lord; *kare*—does; *sabāte*—in every one of them; *prakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

The puruṣa enters each and every one of the countless universes. He manifests Himself in as many separate forms as there are universes.

TEXT 68

puruṣa-nāsāte yabe bāhirāya śvāsa

niśvāsa sahite haya brahmāṇḍa-prakāśa

SYNONYMS

puruṣa-nāsāte—in the nostrils of the Lord; *yabe*—when; *bāhirāya*—expels; *śvāsa*—breath; *niśvāsa sahite*—with that exhalation; *haya*—there is; *brahmāṇḍa-prakāśa*—manifestation of universes.

TRANSLATION

When the puruṣa exhales, the universes are manifested with each outward breath.

TEXT 69

punarapī śvāsa yabe praveśe antare

śvāsa-saha brahmāṇḍa paiśe puruṣa-śarīre

SYNONYMS

punarapī—thereafter; *śvāsa*—breath; *yabe*—when; *praveśe*—enters; *antare*—within; *śvāsa-saha*—with that inhaled breath; *brahmāṇḍa*—universes; *paśe*—enter; *puruṣa-śarīre*—within the body of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, when He inhales, all the universes again enter His body.

PURPORT

In His form as Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu the Lord impregnates material nature by His glance. The transcendental molecules of that glance are particles of spirit, or spiritual atoms, which appear in different species of life according to the seeds of their individual *karma* from the previous cosmic manifestation. And the Lord Himself, by His partial representation, creates a body of innumerable universes and again enters each of those universes as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. His coming in contact with *māyā* is explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā* by a comparison between air and the sky. The sky enters everything material, yet it is far away from us.

TEXT 70

gavākṣera randhre yena trasareṇu cale

puruṣera loma-kūpe brahmāṇḍera jāle

SYNONYMS

gavākṣera—of windows of a room; *randhre*—within the holes; *yena*—like; *trasareṇu*—six atoms together; *cale*—moves; *puruṣera*—of the Lord; *loma-kūpe*—in the holes of the hair; *brahmāṇḍera*—of universes; *jāle*—a network.

TRANSLATION

Just as atomic particles of dust pass through the openings of a window, so the networks of universes pass through the pores of the skin of the puruṣa.

TEXT 71

yasyaika-niśvasita-kālam athāvalambya

jīvanti loma-vila-jā jagad-aṇḍa-nāthāḥ

viṣṇur mahān sa iha yasya kalā-viśeṣo

govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *eka*—one; *niśvasita*—of breath; *kālam*—time; *atha*—thus; *avalambya*—taking shelter of; *jīvanti*—live; *loma-vila-jāḥ*—grown from the hair holes; *jagat-aṇḍa-nāthāḥ*—the masters of the universes (the Brahmās); *viṣṇuḥ mahān*—the Supreme Lord, Mahā-Viṣṇu; *saḥ*—that; *iha*—here; *yasya*—whose; *kalā-viśeṣaḥ*—particular plenary portion or expansion; *govindam*—Lord Govinda; *ādi-puruṣam*—the original person; *tam*—Him; *aham*—I; *bhajāmi*—worship.

TRANSLATION

“The Brahmās and other lords of the mundane worlds appear from the pores of Mahā-Viṣṇu and remain alive for the duration of His one exhalation. I adore the primeval Lord, Govinda, of whom Mahā-Viṣṇu is a portion of a plenary portion.”

PURPORT

This description of the Lord's creative energy is from the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.48), which Lord Brahmā compiled after his personal realization. When Mahā-Viṣṇu exhales, the spiritual seeds of the universes emanate from Him in the form of molecular particles like those that are visible, three times the size of an atom, when sunlight is diffused through a small hole. In these days of atomic research it will be a worthwhile engagement for atomic scientists to learn from this statement how the entire creation develops from the spiritual atoms emanating from the body of the Lord.

TEXT 72

kvāhaṁ tamo-mahad-aham-kha-carāgni-vār-bhū-

saṁveṣṭitāṇḍa-ghaṭa-sapta-vitasti-kāyaḥ

kvedṛg-vidhāvigaṇitāṇḍa-parāṇu-caryā-

vātādhva-roma-vivarasya ca te mahitvam

SYNONYMS

kva—where; *aham*—I; *tamaḥ*—material nature; *mahat*—the total material energy; *aham*—false ego; *kha*—ether; *cara*—air; *agni*—fire; *vāḥ*—water; *bhū*—earth; *saṁveṣṭita*—surrounded by; *aṇḍa-ghaṭa*—a potlike universe; *sapta-vitasti*—seven *vitastis*; *kāyaḥ*—body; *kva*—where; *īdṛk*—such; *vidha*—like; *avigaṇita*—unlimited; *aṇḍa*—universes; *para-aṇu-caryā*—moving like the atomic dust; *vāta-adhva*—air holes; *roma*—of hair on the body; *vivarasya*—of the holes; *ca*—also; *te*—Your; *mahitvam*—greatness.

TRANSLATION

“Where am I, a small creature of seven spans the measure of my own hand? I am enclosed in the universe composed of material nature, the

total material energy, false ego, ether, air, water and earth. And what is Your glory? Unlimited universes pass through the pores of Your body just like particles of dust passing through the opening of a window.”

PURPORT

When Lord Brahmā, after having stolen all Kṛṣṇa’s calves and cowherd boys, returned and saw that the calves and boys were still roaming with Kṛṣṇa, he offered this prayer (*Bhāg.* 10.14.11) in his defeat. A conditioned soul, even one so great as Brahmā, who manages the affairs of the entire universe, cannot compare to the Personality of Godhead, for He can produce numberless universes simply by the spiritual rays emanating from the pores of His body. Material scientists should take lessons from the utterances of Śrī Brahmā regarding our insignificance in comparison to God. In these prayers of Brahmā there is much to learn for those who are falsely puffed up by the accumulation of power.

TEXT 73

aṁśera aṁśa yei, ‘kalā’ tāra nāma

govindera pratimūrti śrī-balarāma

SYNONYMS

aṁśera—of the part; *aṁśa*—part; *yei*—that which; *kalā*—a *kalā*, or part of the plenary portion; *tāra*—its; *nāma*—name; *govindera*—of Lord Govinda; *prati-mūrti*—counterform; *śrī-balarāma*—Lord Balarāma.

TRANSLATION

A part of a part of a whole is called a *kalā*. Śrī Balarāma is the counterform of Lord Govinda.

TEXT 74

tāñra eka svarūpa—śrī-mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa

tāñra aṁśa ‘puruṣa’ haya kalāte gaṇana

SYNONYMS

tāñra—His; *eka*—one; *svarūpa*—manifestation; *śrī-mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa*—the great Lord Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa; *tāñra*—His; *aṁśa*—part; *puruṣa*—the Mahā-Viṣṇu incarnation; *haya*—is; *kalāte gaṇana*—counted as a *kalā*.

TRANSLATION

Balarāma’s own expansion is called Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa, and His fragment, the *puruṣa*, is counted as a *kalā*, or a part of a plenary portion.

TEXT 75

yāñhāke ta’ kalā kahi, tiñho mahā-viṣṇu

mahā-puruṣāvatārī teñho sarva-jīṣṇu

SYNONYMS

yāñhāke—unto whom; *ta’*—certainly; *kalā kahi*—I say *kalā*; *tiñho*—He; *mahā-viṣṇu*—Lord Mahā-Viṣṇu; *mahā-puruṣāvatārī*—Mahā-Viṣṇu, the source of other *puruṣa* incarnations; *teñho*—He; *sarva-jīṣṇu*—all-pervading.

TRANSLATION

I say that this *kalā* is Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is the Mahā-puruṣa, who is the source of the other *puruṣas* and who is all-pervading.

TEXT 76

garbhoda-kṣīroda-śāyī doṇhe ‘puruṣa’ nāma

sei dui, yāñra aṁśa,——viṣṇu, viśva-dhāma

SYNONYMS

garbha-uda—in the ocean known as Garbhodaka within the universe; *kṣīra-uda-śāyī*—one who lies in the ocean of milk; *doṇhe*—both of Them; *puruṣa nāma*—known as *puruṣa*, Lord Viṣṇu; *sei*—those; *dui*—two; *yāñra aṁśa*—whose plenary portions; *viṣṇu viśva-dhāma*—Lord Viṣṇu, the abode of the total universes.

TRANSLATION

Garbhodaśāyī and Kṣīrodaśāyī are both called puruṣas. They are plenary portions of Kāraṇodaśāyī Viṣṇu, the first puruṣa, who is the abode of all the universes.

PURPORT

The symptoms of the *puruṣa* are described in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*. While describing the incarnations of the Supreme personality of Godhead, the author has quoted from the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* (6.8.59), where it is said, “Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto Puruṣottama, Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is always free from the contamination of the six material dualities; whose plenary expansion, Mahā-Viṣṇu, glances over matter to create the cosmic manifestation; who expands Himself in various transcendental forms, all of which are one and the same; who is the master of all living entities; who is always free and liberated from the contamination of material energy; and who, when He appears in this material world, seems one of us, although He has an eternally spiritual, blissful, transcendental form.” In summarizing this statement, Rūpa Gosvāmī has concluded that the plenary expansion of the Supreme Personality of Godhead who acts in cooperation with the material energy is called the *puruṣa*.

TEXT 77

viṣṇoḥ tu trīṇi rūpāṇi

puruṣākhyāny atho viduḥ

ekam tu mahataḥ sraṣṭṛ

dvitīyam tv aṇḍa-saṁsthitam

tṛtīyam sarva-bhūta-stham

tāni jñātvā vimucyate

SYNONYMS

viṣṇoḥ—of Lord Viṣṇu; *tu*—certainly; *trīṇi*—three; *rūpāṇi*—forms; *puruṣa-ākhyāni*—celebrated as the *puruṣa*; *atho*—how; *viduḥ*—they know; *ekam*—one of them; *tu*—but; *mahataḥ sraṣṭṛ*—the creator of the total material energy; *dvitīyam*—the second; *tu*—but; *aṇḍa-saṁsthitam*—situated within the universe; *tṛtīyam*—the third; *sarva-bhūta-stham*—within the hearts of all living entities; *tāni*—these three; *jñātvā*—knowing; *vimucyate*—one becomes liberated.

TRANSLATION

“Viṣṇu has three forms called puruṣas. The first, Mahā-Viṣṇu, is the creator of the total material energy [mahat], the second is Garbhodaśāyī, who is situated within each universe, and the third is Kṣīrodaśāyī, who lives in the heart of every living being. He who knows these three becomes liberated from the clutches of māyā.”

PURPORT

This verse appears in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva* 2.9), where it has

been quoted from the *Sātvata-tantra*.

TEXT 78

yadyapi kahiye tāñre kṛṣṇera 'kalā' kari

matsya-kūrmādy-avatārera tiñho avatārī

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *kahiye*—I say; *tāñre*—to Him; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kalā*—part of the part; *kari*—making; *matsya*—the fish incarnation; *kūrma-ādi*—the tortoise incarnation and others; *avatārera*—of all these incarnations; *tiñho*—He; *avatārī*—the original source.

TRANSLATION

Although Kāraṇodaśāyī Viṣṇu is called a *kalā* of Lord Kṛṣṇa, He is the source of Matsya, Kūrma and the other incarnations.

TEXT 79

ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ

kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam

indrāri-vyākulaṁ lokam

mṛdayanti yuge yuge

SYNONYMS

ete—all these; *ca*—also; *aṁśa-kalāḥ*—part or part of the part; *puṁsaḥ*—of the Supreme Person; *kṛṣṇas tu*—but Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhagavān*—the original Personality of Godhead; *svayam*—Himself; *indra-ari*—the

demons; *vyākulam*—disturbed; *lokam*—all the planets; *mṛdayanti*—makes them happy; *yuge yuge*—in different millenniums.

TRANSLATION

“All these incarnations of Godhead are either plenary portions or parts of the plenary portions of the puruṣa-avatāras. But Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself. In every age He protects the world through His different features when the world is disturbed by the enemies of Indra.”

PURPORT

This quotation is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.3.28).

TEXT 80

sei puruṣa sṛṣṭi-sthiti-pralayera kartā

nānā avatāra kare, jagatera bhartā

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *puruṣa*—the Personality of Godhead; *sṛṣṭi-sthiti-pralayera*—of creation, maintenance and annihilation; *kartā*—creator; *nānā*—various; *avatāra*—incarnations; *kare*—makes; *jagatera*—of the material world; *bhartā*—maintainer.

TRANSLATION

That puruṣa [Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu] is the performer of creation, maintenance and destruction. He manifests Himself in many incarnations, for He is the maintainer of the world.

TEXT 81

sṛṣṭy-ādi-nimitte yei amśera avadhāna

sei ta' amśere kahi 'avatāra' nāma

SYNONYMS

sṛṣṭi-ādi-nimitte—for the cause of creation, maintenance and annihilation; *yei*—which; *amśera avadhāna*—manifestation of the part; *sei ta'*—that certainly; *amśere kahi*—I speak about that plenary expansion; *avatāra nāma*—by the name “incarnation.”

TRANSLATION

That fragment of the Supreme Lord, known as the Mahā-puruṣa, appears for the purpose of creation, maintenance and annihilation and is called an incarnation.

TEXT 82

ādyāvatāra, mahā-puruṣa, bhagavān

sarva-avatāra-bīja, sarvāśraya-dhāma

SYNONYMS

ādyā-avatāra—the original incarnation; *mahā-puruṣa*—Lord Mahā-Viṣṇu; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *sarva-avatāra-bīja*—the seed of all different kinds of incarnations; *sarva-āśraya-dhāma*—the shelter of everything.

TRANSLATION

That Mahā-puruṣa is identical with the Personality of Godhead. He is the original incarnation, the seed of all others, and the shelter of everything.

TEXT 83

ādyo 'vatāraḥ puruṣaḥ parasya

kālaḥ svabhāvaḥ sad-āsan manaś ca

dravyam vikāro guṇa indriyāṇi

virāṭ svarāṭ sthāśnu carīṣṇu bhūmnaḥ

SYNONYMS

ādyah *avatārah*—the original incarnation; *puruṣaḥ*—Mahā-Viṣṇu; *parasya*—of the Supreme Lord; *kālaḥ*—time; *svabhāvaḥ*—nature; *sat-asat*—cause and effect; *manaḥ ca*—as well as the mind; *dravyam*—the five elements; *vikārah*—transformation or the false ego; *guṇaḥ*—modes of nature; *indriyāṇi*—senses; *virāṭ*—the universal form; *svarāṭ*—complete independence; *sthāśnu*—immovable; *carīṣṇu*—movable; *bhūmnaḥ*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

“The puruṣa [Mahā-Viṣṇu] is the primary incarnation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Time, nature, prakṛti (as cause and effect), the mind, the material elements, false ego, the modes of nature, the senses, the universal form, complete independence and the moving and nonmoving beings appear subsequently as His opulences.”

PURPORT

Describing the incarnations and their symptoms, the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* has stated that when Lord Kṛṣṇa descends to conduct the creative affairs of the material manifestation, He is an *avatāra*, or incarnation. The two categories of *avatāras* are empowered devotees and *tad-ekātma-rūpa* (the Lord Himself). An example of *tad-ekātma-rūpa* is

Śeṣa, and an example of a devotee is Vasudeva, the father of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa has commented that the material cosmic manifestation is a partial kingdom of God where God must sometimes come to execute a specific function. The plenary portion of the Lord through whom Lord Kṛṣṇa executes such actions is called Mahā-Viṣṇu, who is the primal beginning of all incarnations. Inexperienced observers presume that the material energy provides both the cause and the elements of the cosmic manifestation and that the living entities are the enjoyers of material nature. But the devotees of the Bhāgavata school, which has scrutinizingly examined the entire situation, can understand that material nature can independently be neither the supplier of the material elements nor the cause of the material manifestation. Material nature gets the power to supply the material elements from the glance of the supreme *puruṣa*, Mahā-Viṣṇu, and when empowered by Him she is called the cause of the material manifestation. Both features of material nature, as the cause of the material creation and as the source of its elements, exist due to the glance of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The various expansions of the Supreme Lord who act to empower the material energy are known as plenary expansions or incarnations. As illustrated by the analogy of many flames lit from one flame, all these plenary expansions and incarnations are as good as Viṣṇu Himself; nevertheless, because of their activities in controlling *māyā*, sometimes they are known as *māyika*, or having a relationship with *māyā*. This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (2.6.42).

TEXT 84

jagṛhe pauruṣaṁ rūpaṁ

bhagavān mahad-ādibhiḥ

sambhūtaṁ ṣoḍaśa-kalam

ādau loka-sisṛkṣayā

SYNONYMS

jagrhe—accepted; *pauruṣam*—the *puruṣa* incarnation; *rūpam*—the form; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *mahat-ādibhiḥ*—by the total material energy etc.; *sambhūtam*—created; *ṣoḍaśa*—sixteen; *kalam*—energies; *ādau*—originally; *loka*—the material worlds; *sisṛkṣayā*—with the desire to create.

TRANSLATION

“In the beginning of the creation, the Lord expanded Himself in the form of the *puruṣa* incarnation, accompanied by all the ingredients of material creation. First He created the sixteen principal energies suitable for creation. This was for the purpose of manifesting the material universes.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.3.1). The commentary of Madhva on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* mentions that the following sixteen spiritual energies are present in the spiritual world: (1) *śrī*, (2) *bhū*, (3) *līlā*, (4) *kānti*, (5) *kīrti*, (6) *tuṣṭi*, (7) *gīr*, (8) *puṣṭi*, (9) *satyā* (10) *jñānājñānā*, (11) *jayā utkarṣiṇī*, (12) *vimalā*, (13) *yogamāyā*, (14) *prahvī*, (15) *īśānā* and (16) *anugrahā*. In his commentary on the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa has said that the above energies are also known by nine names: (1) *vimalā*, (2) *utkarṣiṇī* (3) *jñānā*, (4) *kriyā*, (5) *yogā*, (6) *prahvī*, (7) *satyā*, (8) *īśānā* and (9) *anugrahā*. In the *Bhagavat-sandarbhā* of Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī (text 103) they are described as *śrī*, *puṣṭi*, *gīr*, *kānti*, *kīrti*, *tuṣṭi*, *ilā*, *jaya*; *vidyāvidyā*, *māyā*, *samvit*, *sandhinī*, *hlādinī*, *bhakti*, *mūrti*, *vimalā*, *yogā*, *prahvī*, *īśānā*, *anugrahā*, etc. All these energies act in different spheres of the Lord’s supremacy.

TEXT 85

yadyapi sarvāśraya tīñho, tāñhāte saṁsāra

antarātmā-rūpe tiñho jagat-ādhāra

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *sarva-āśraya*—the shelter of everything; *tiñho*—He (the Lord); *tāñhāte*—in Him; *sañsāra*—the material creation; *antaḥ-ātmā-rūpe*—in the form of the Supersoul; *tiñho*—He; *jagat-ādhāra*—the support of the whole creation.

TRANSLATION

Although the Lord is the shelter of everything and although all the universes rest in Him, He, as the Supersoul, is also the support of everything.

TEXT 86

prakṛti-sahite tāñra ubhaya sambandha

tathāpi prakṛti-saha nāhi sparsā-gandha

SYNONYMS

prakṛti-sahite—with the material energy; *tāñra*—His; *ubhaya sambandha*—both relationships; *tathāpi*—still; *prakṛti-saha*—with the material nature; *nāhi*—there is not; *sparsā-gandha*—even the slightest contact.

TRANSLATION

Although He is thus connected with the material energy in two ways, He does not have the slightest contact with it.

PURPORT

In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, commenting upon the Lord's transcendental position beyond the material qualities, says that Viṣṇu, as the controller and superintendent of material nature, has a connection with the material qualities. That connection is called *yoga*. However, the person who directs a prison is not also a prisoner. Similarly, although the Supreme Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu directs or supervises the qualitative nature, He has no connection with the material modes of nature. The expansions of Lord Viṣṇu always retain their supremacy; they are never connected with the material qualities. One may argue that Mahā-Viṣṇu cannot have any connection with the material qualities, because if He were so connected, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* would not state that material nature, ashamed of her thankless task of acting to induce the living entities to become averse to the Supreme Lord, remains behind the Lord in shyness. In answer to this argument, it may be said that the word *guṇa* means "regulation." Lord Viṣṇu, Lord Brahmā and Lord Śiva are situated within this universe as the directors of the three modes, and their connection with the modes is known as *yoga*. This does not indicate, however, that these personalities are bound by the qualities of nature. Lord Viṣṇu specifically is always the controller of the three qualities. There is no question of His coming under their control.

Although the causal and element-supplying features exist in material nature by dint of the glance of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the Lord is never affected by glancing over the material qualities. By the will of the Supreme Lord the different qualitative changes in the material world take place, but there is no possibility of material affection, change or contamination for Lord Viṣṇu.

TEXT 87

etad īśanam īśasya

prakṛti-stho 'pi tad-guṇaiḥ

na yujyate sadātmā-sthair

yathā buddhis tad-āśrayā

SYNONYMS

etat—this is; *īśanam*—opulence; *īśasya*—of the Lord; *prakṛti-sthaḥ*—within this material world; *api*—although; *tat-guṇaiḥ*—by the material qualities; *na yujyate*—never affected; *sadā*—always; *ātma-sthaiḥ*—situated in His own energy; *yathā*—as also; *buddhiḥ*—intelligence; *tat*—His; *āśrayā*—devotees.

TRANSLATION

“This is the opulence of the Lord. Although situated within the material nature, He is never affected by the modes of nature. Similarly, those who have surrendered to Him and have fixed their intelligence upon Him are not influenced by the modes of nature.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.11.38).

TEXT 88

ei mata gītāteha punaḥ punaḥ kaya

sarvadā īśvara-tattva acintya-śakti haya

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *gītāteha*—in the *Bhagavad-gītā*; *punaḥ punaḥ*—again and again; *kaya*—it is said; *sarvadā*—always; *īśvara-tattva*—the truth of the Absolute Truth; *acintya-śakti haya*—is inconceivable.

TRANSLATION

Thus the Bhagavad-gītā also states again and again that the Absolute Truth always possesses inconceivable power.

TEXT 89

āmi ta' jagate vasi, jagat āmāte

nā āmi jagate vasi, nā āmā jagate

SYNONYMS

āmi—I; *ta'*—certainly; *jagate*—in the material world; *vasi*—situated; *jagat*—the whole material creation; *āmāte*—in Me; *nā*—not; *āmi*—I; *jagate*—within the material world; *vasi*—situated; *nā*—nor; *āmā*—in Me; *jagate*—the material world.

TRANSLATION

[Lord Kṛṣṇa said:] “I am situated in the material world, and the world rests in Me. But at the same time I am not situated in the material world, nor does it rest in Me in truth.

PURPORT

Nothing in existence is possible unless energized by the will of the Lord. The entire manifested creation is therefore resting on the energy of the Lord, but one should not therefore presume that the material manifestation is identical with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. A cloud may rest in the sky, but that does not mean that the sky and the cloud are one and the same. Similarly, the qualitative material nature and its products are never identical with the Supreme Lord. The tendency to lord it over material nature, or *māyā*, cannot be a feature of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. When He descends to the material world, He maintains His transcendental nature, unaffected by the material qualities. In both the spiritual and material worlds, He is always the controller of

all energies. The uncontaminated spiritual nature always exists within Him. The Lord appears and disappears in the material world in different features for His pastimes, yet He is the origin of all cosmic manifestations.

The material manifestation cannot exist separate from the Supreme Lord, yet Lord Viṣṇu, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, in spite of His connection with the material nature, cannot be subordinate to nature's influence. His original form of eternal bliss and knowledge is never subordinate to the three qualities of material nature. This is a specific feature of the Supreme Lord's inconceivable potencies.

TEXT 90

acintya aiśvarya ei jāniha āmāra

ei ta' gītāra artha kaila paracāra

SYNONYMS

acintya—inconceivable; *aiśvarya*—opulence; *ei*—this; *jāniha*—you must know; *āmāra*—of Me; *ei ta'*—this; *gītāra artha*—the meaning of the *Bhagavad-gītā*; *kaila paracāra*—Lord Kṛṣṇa propagated.

TRANSLATION

“O Arjuna, you should know this as My inconceivable opulence.” This is the meaning propagated by Lord Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhagavad-gītā*.

TEXT 91

sei ta' puruṣa yānra 'aṁśa' dhare nāma

caitanyera saṅge sei nityānanda-rāma

SYNONYMS

sei ta'—that; *puruṣa*—Supreme Person; *yāñra*—of whom; *aṁśa*—as part; *dhare nāma*—is known; *caitanya* *saṅge*—with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sei*—that; *nityānanda-rāma*—Lord Nityānanda or Balarāma.

TRANSLATION

That Mahā-puruṣa [Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu] is known as a plenary part of Him who is Lord Nityānanda Balarāma, the favorite associate of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 92

ei ta' navama ślokerā artha-vivaraṇa

daśama ślokerā artha śuna diyā mana

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—thus; *navama ślokerā*—of the ninth verse; *artha-vivaraṇa*—description of the meaning; *daśama ślokerā*—of the tenth verse; *artha*—meaning; *śuna*—hear; *diyā mana*—with attention.

TRANSLATION

I have thus explained the ninth verse, and now I shall explain the tenth. Please listen with rapt attention.

TEXT 93

yasyāṁśāṁśaḥ śrīla-garbhoda-śāyī

yan-nābhy-abjaṁ loka-saṅghāta-nālam

loka-sraṣṭuḥ sūtikā-dhāma dhātus

taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmam prapadye

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *aṁśa-aṁśaḥ*—portion of a plenary portion; *śrīla-garbha-uda-sāyī*—Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *yat*—of whom; *nābhi-abjam*—the navel lotus; *loka-saṅghāta*—of the multitude of planets; *nālam*—having a stem that is the resting place; *loka-sraṣṭuḥ*—of Lord Brahmā, creator of the planets; *sūtikā-dhāma*—the birthplace; *dhātuḥ*—of the creator; *taṁ*—to Him; *śrī-nityānanda-rāmam*—to Lord Balarāma in the form of Lord Nityānanda; *prapadye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

I offer my full obeisances unto the feet of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, a partial part of whom is Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. From the navel of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu sprouts the lotus that is the birthplace of Brahmā, the engineer of the universe. The stem of that lotus is the resting place of the multitude of planets.

PURPORT

In the *Mahābhārata*, *Śānti-parva*, it is said that He who is Pradyumna is also Aniruddha. He is also the father of Brahmā. Thus Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu are identical plenary expansions of Pradyumna, the original Deity of Brahmā, who is born from the lotus flower. It is Pradyumna who gives Brahmā direction for cosmic management. A full description of Brahmā's birth is given in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.8.15–16).

Describing the features of the three *puruṣas*, the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* says that Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu has a four-handed form, and when He Himself enters the hollow of the universe and lies down in the ocean of

milk He is known as Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who is the Supersoul of all living entities, including the demigods. In the *Sātvata-tantra* it is said that the third *puruṣa* incarnation, Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, is situated as the Supersoul in everyone's heart. This Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is an expansion of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu for pastimes.

TEXT 94

sei ta' puruṣa ananta-brahmāṇḍa sṛjyā
saba aṇḍe praveśilā bahu-mūrti hañā

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *ta'*—certainly; *puruṣa*—incarnation; *ananta-brahmāṇḍa*—innumerable universes; *sṛjyā*—creating; *saba*—all; *aṇḍe*—in the egglike universes; *praveśilā*—entered; *bahu-mūrti hañā*—taking multifarious forms.

TRANSLATION

After creating millions of universes, the first *puruṣa* entered into each of them in a separate form, as Śrī Garbhodakaśāyī.

TEXT 95

bhitare praveśi' dekhe saba andhakāra
rahite nāhika sthāna karila vicāra

SYNONYMS

bhitare—within the universe; *praveśi'*—entering; *dekhe*—He sees; *saba*—all; *andhakāra*—darkness; *rahite*—to stay; *nāhika*—there is not; *sthāna*—place; *karila vicāra*—considered.

TRANSLATION

Entering the universe, He found only darkness, with no place in which to reside. Thus He began to consider.

TEXT 96

nijāṅga-sveda-jala karīla sṛjana

sei jale kaila ardha-brahmāṇḍa bharāṇa

SYNONYMS

nija-aṅga—of His own body; *sveda-jala*—water from perspiration; *karīla*—did; *sṛjana*—creation; *sei jale*—with that water; *kaila*—did; *ardha-brahmāṇḍa*—half of the universe; *bharāṇa*—filling.

TRANSLATION

Then He created water from the perspiration of His own body and with that water filled half the universe.

TEXT 97

brahmāṇḍa-pramāṇa pañcāśat-koṭi-yojana

āyāma, vistāra, dui haya eka sama

SYNONYMS

brahmāṇḍa-pramāṇa—measurement of the universe; *pañcāśat*—fifty; *koṭi*—ten millions; *yojana*—lengths of eight miles; *āyāma*—length; *vistāra*—breadth; *dui*—both of them; *haya*—are; *eka sama*—one and the same.

TRANSLATION

The universe measures five hundred million yojanas. Its length and breadth are one and the same.

TEXT 98

jale bhari' ardha tāñhā kaila nija-vāsa

āra ardhe kaila caudda-bhuvana prakāśa

SYNONYMS

jale—with water; *bhari'*—filling; *ardha*—half; *tāñhā*—there; *kaila*—made; *nija-vāsa*—own residence; *āra*—other; *ardhe*—in the half; *kaila*—did; *caudda-bhuvana*—fourteen worlds; *prakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

After filling half the universe with water, He made His own residence therein and manifested the fourteen worlds in the other half.

PURPORT

The fourteen worlds are enumerated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Second Canto, Fifth Chapter. The upper planetary systems are (1) Bhū, (2) Bhuvar, (3) Svar, (4) Mahar, (5) Janas, (6) Tapas and (7) Satya. The seven lower planetary systems are (1) Tala, (2) Atala, (3) Vitala, (4) Nitala, (5) Talātala, (6) Mahātala and (7) Sutala. The lower planets as a whole are called Pātāla. Among the upper planetary systems, Bhū, Bhuvar and Svar constitute Svargaloka, and the rest are called Martya. The entire universe is thus known as Triloka.

TEXT 99

tāñhāi prakāṭa kaila vaikuṇṭha nija-dhāma

śeṣa-śayana-jale karila viśrāma

SYNONYMS

tāñhāi—there; *prakāṭa*—manifestation; *kaila*—did; *vaikuṇṭha*—the spiritual world; *nija-dhāma*—His own abode; *śeṣa*—of Lord Śeṣa; *śayana*—on the bed; *jale*—on the water; *karila*—did; *viśrāma*—rest.

TRANSLATION

There He manifested Vaikuṇṭha as His own abode and rested in the waters on the bed of Lord Śeṣa.

TEXTS 100–101

ananta-śayyāte tāñhā karila śayana

sahasra mastaka tāñra sahasra vadana

sahasra-caraṇa-hasta, sahasra-nayana

sarva-avatāra-bīja, jagat-kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

ananta-śayyāte—on Lord Ananta as a bed; *tāñhā*—there; *karila śayana*—lay down; *sahasra*—thousands; *mastaka*—heads; *tāñra*—His; *sahasra vadana*—thousands of faces; *sahasra*—thousands; *caraṇa*—legs; *hasta*—hands; *sahasra-nayana*—thousands of eyes; *sarva-avatāra-bīja*—the seed of all incarnations; *jagat-kāraṇa*—the cause of the material world.

TRANSLATION

He lay there with Ananta as His bed. Lord Ananta is a divine serpent having thousands of heads, thousands of faces, thousands of eyes and thousands of hands and feet. He is the seed of all incarnations and is the cause of the material world.

PURPORT

In the reservoir of water first created by the perspiration of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, the Lord lies on the Śeṣa plenary expansion of Viṣṇu, who is described in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and in the four *Vedas* as follows:

*sahasra-śīrṣā puruṣaḥ sahasrākṣaḥ sahasra-pāt
sa bhūmiṁ viśvato vṛtvātyatiṣṭhad daśāṅgulam*

The Viṣṇu form called Ananta-śayana has thousands of hands and legs and thousands of eyes, and He is the active generator of all the incarnations within the material world.

TEXT 102

tānra nābhi-padma haite uṭhila eka padma

sei padme haila brahmāra janma-sadma

SYNONYMS

tānra—His; *nābhi-padma*—lotus navel; *haite*—from; *uṭhila*—grew; *eka*—one; *padma*—lotus flower; *sei padme*—on that lotus; *haila*—there was; *brahmāra*—of Lord Brahmā; *janma-sadma*—the place of birth.

TRANSLATION

From His navel grew a lotus flower, which became the birthplace of Lord Brahmā.

TEXT 103

sei padma-nāle haila caudda-bhuvana

teñho brahmā hañā sṛṣṭi karila sṛjana

SYNONYMS

sei padma-nāle—within the stem of that lotus flower; *haila*—were; *caudda-bhuvana*—the fourteen worlds; *teñho*—He Himself; *brahmā hañā*—appearing as Brahmā; *sṛṣṭi*—the creation; *karila sṛjana*—created.

TRANSLATION

Within the stem of that lotus were the fourteen worlds. Thus the Supreme Lord, as Brahmā, created the entire creation.

TEXT 104

viṣṇu-rūpa hañā kare jagat pālāne

guṇātīta-viṣṇu sparsā nāhi māyā-guṇe

SYNONYMS

viṣṇu-rūpa—the form of Lord Viṣṇu; *hañā*—becoming; *kare*—does; *jagat pālāne*—maintenance of the material world; *guṇa-atīta*—beyond the material qualities; *viṣṇu*—Lord Viṣṇu; *sparsā*—touch; *nāhi*—not; *māyā-guṇe*—in the material qualities.

TRANSLATION

And as Lord Viṣṇu He maintains the entire world. Lord Viṣṇu, being beyond all material attributes, has no touch with the material qualities.

PURPORT

Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa says that although Viṣṇu is the predominating Deity of the quality of goodness in the material world, He is never affected by the quality of goodness, for He directs that quality simply by His supreme will. It is said that all living entities can derive all good fortune from the Lord simply by His will. In the *Vāmana Purāṇa* it is said that the same Viṣṇu expands Himself as Brahmā and Śiva to direct the different qualities.

Because Lord Viṣṇu expands the quality of goodness, He has the name Sattvatanu. The multifarious incarnations of Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu are known as Sattvatanu. Therefore in all Vedic scriptures Viṣṇu has been described as being free from all material qualities. In the Tenth Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* it is said:

*harir hi nirguṇaḥ sākṣāt puruṣaḥ prakṛteḥ paraḥ
sa sarva-dṛg upadraṣṭā taṁ bhajan nirguṇo bhavet*

“The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari, is always uncontaminated by the modes of material nature, for He is beyond the material manifestation. He is the source of the knowledge of all the demigods, headed by Lord Brahmā, and He is the witness of everything. Therefore one who worships the Supreme Lord Viṣṇu also attains freedom from the contamination of material nature.” (*Bhāg.* 10.88.5) One can attain freedom from the contamination of material nature by worshipping Viṣṇu, and therefore He is called Sattvatanu, as described above.

TEXT 105

*rudra-rūpa dhari' kare jagat saṁhāra
srṣṭi-sthiti-pralaya—icchāya yāñhāra*

SYNONYMS

rudra-rūpa—the form of Lord Śiva; *dhari'*—accepting; *kare*—does; *jagat saṁhāra*—annihilation of the material world; *sṛṣṭi-sthiti-pralaya*—creation, maintenance and annihilation; *icchāya*—by the will; *yāñhāra*—of whom.

TRANSLATION

Assuming the form of Rudra, He destroys the creation. Thus creation, maintenance and dissolution are created by His will.

PURPORT

Maheśvara, or Lord Śiva, is not an ordinary living being, nor is he equal to Lord Viṣṇu. Effectively comparing Lord Viṣṇu and Lord Śiva, the *Brahma-saṁhitā* says that Viṣṇu is like milk, whereas Śiva is like yogurt. Yogurt is nothing like milk, but nevertheless it is milk also.

TEXT 106

hiraṇya-garbha, antaryāmī, jagat-kāraṇa

yāñra aṁśa kari' kare virāṭa-kalpana

SYNONYMS

hiraṇya-garbha—Hiraṇyagarbha; *antaḥ-yāmī*—the Supersoul; *jagat-kāraṇa*—the cause of the material world; *yāñra aṁśa kari'*—taking as His expansion; *kare*—does; *virāṭa-kalpana*—conception of the universal form.

TRANSLATION

He is the Supersoul, Hiraṇyagarbha, the cause of the material world. The universal form is conceived as His expansion.

TEXT 107

hena nārāyaṇa,——yāñira aṁśera aṁśa

sei prabhu nityānanda—sarva-avatamśa

SYNONYMS

hena—such; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *yāñira*—of whom; *aṁśera*—of the plenary part; *aṁśa*—apart; *sei*—that; *prabhu*—the Lord; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda; *sarva-avatamśa*—the source of all incarnations.

TRANSLATION

That Lord Nārāyaṇa is a part of a plenary part of Lord Nityānanda Balarāma, who is the source of all incarnations.

TEXT 108

daśama ślokerā artha kaila vivaraṇa

ekādaśa ślokerā artha śuna diyā mana

SYNONYMS

daśama—tenth; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—meaning; *kaila*—have done; *vivaraṇa*—description; *ekādaśa*—eleventh; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—meaning; *śuna*—please hear; *diyā mana*—with the mind.

TRANSLATION

I have thus explained the tenth verse. Now please listen to the meaning of the eleventh verse with all your mind.

TEXT 109

yasyāṁśāṁśāṁśaḥ parātmākhilānām

poṣṭā viṣṇur bhāti dugdhābdhi-śāyī

kṣauṇī-bhartā yat-kalā so 'py anantas

tam śrī-nityānanda-rāmam prapadye

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *amśa-amśa-amśaḥ*—a portion of a portion of a plenary portion; *para-ātmā*—the Supersoul; *akhilānām*—of all living entities; *poṣṭā*—the maintainer; *viṣṇuḥ*—Viṣṇu; *bhāti*—appears; *dugdha-abdhi-śāyī*—Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu; *kṣauṇī-bhartā*—upholder of the earth; *yat*—whose; *kalā*—portion of a portion; *saḥ*—He; *api*—certainly; *anantaḥ*—Śeṣa Nāga; *tam*—to Him; *śrī-nityānanda-rāmam*—to Lord Balarāma in the form of Lord Nityānanda; *prapadye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto the feet of Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose secondary part is the Viṣṇu lying in the ocean of milk. That Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Supersoul of all living entities and the maintainer of all the universes. Śeṣa Nāga is His further subpart.

TEXT 110

nārāyaṇera nābhi-nāla-madhyete dharaṇī

dharaṇīra madhye sapta samudra ye gaṇi

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇera—of Lord Nārāyaṇa; *nābhi-nāla*—the stem from the navel; *madhyete*—within; *dharaṇī*—the material planets; *dharaṇīra madhye*—among the material planets; *sapta*—seven; *samudra*—oceans; *ye gaṇi*—they count.

TRANSLATION

The material planets rest within the stem that grows from the lotus navel of Lord Nārāyaṇa. Among these planets are seven oceans.

TEXT 111

tāñhā kṣīrodadhi-madhye 'śvetadvīpa' nāma

pālayitā viṣṇu, — — tāñra sei nija dhāma

SYNONYMS

tāñhā—within that; *kṣīra-udadhi-madhye*—in part of the ocean known as the ocean of milk; *śvetadvīpa nāma*—the island named Śvetadvīpa; *pālayitā viṣṇu*—the maintainer, Lord Viṣṇu; *tāñra*—of Him; *sei*—that; *nija dhāma*—own residential quarters.

TRANSLATION

There, in part of the ocean of milk, lies Śvetadvīpa, the abode of the sustainer, Lord Viṣṇu.

PURPORT

In the *Siddhānta-sīromaṇi*, an astrological text, the different oceans are described as follows: (1) the ocean of salt water, (2) the ocean of milk, (3) the ocean of yogurt, (4) the ocean of clarified butter, (5) the ocean of sugarcane juice, (6) the ocean of liquor and (7) the ocean of sweet water. On the southern side of the ocean of salt water is the ocean of milk,

where Lord Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu resides. He is worshiped there by demigods like Brahmā.

TEXT 112

sakala jīvera tiñho haye antaryāmī

jagat-pālaka tiñho jagatera svāmī

SYNONYMS

sakala—all; *jīvera*—of the living entities; *tiñho*—He; *haye*—is; *antaḥ-yāmī*—the Supersoul; *jagat-pālaka*—the maintainer of the material world; *tiñho*—He; *jagatera svāmī*—the Lord of the material world.

TRANSLATION

He is the Supersoul of all living entities. He maintains this material world, and He is its Lord.

PURPORT

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (*Pūrva* 2.36–42) gives the following description of the Viṣṇuloka within this universe, quoted from the *Viṣṇu-dharmottara*: “Above Rudraloka, the planet of Lord Śiva, is the planet called Viṣṇuloka, 400,000 miles in circumference, which is inaccessible to any mortal living being. Above that Viṣṇuloka and east of the Sumeru Hill is a golden island called Mahā-Viṣṇuloka, in the ocean of salt water. Lord Brahmā and other demigods sometimes go there to meet Lord Viṣṇu. Lord Viṣṇu lies there with the goddess of fortune, and it is said that during the four months of the rainy season He enjoys sleeping on that Śeṣa Nāga bed. East of Sumeru is the ocean of milk, in which there is a white city on a white island where the Lord can be seen sitting with His consort, Lakṣmījī, on a throne of Śeṣa. That feature of Viṣṇu also enjoys sleeping during the four months of the rainy season. The

Śvetadvīpa in the milk ocean is situated just south of the ocean of salt water. It is calculated that the area of Śvetadvīpa is 200,000 square miles. This transcendently beautiful island is decorated with desire trees to please Lord Viṣṇu and His consort.” There are references to Śvetadvīpa in the *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa*, *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, *Mahābhārata* and *Padma Purāṇa*, and there is the following reference in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.15.18).

*śvetadvīpa-patau cittam śuddhe dharma-maye mayi
dhārayaṇ chvetatām yāti ṣaḍ-ūrmi-rahito narah*

“My dear Uddhava, you may know that My transcendental form of Viṣṇu in Śvetadvīpa is identical with Me in divinity. Anyone who places this Lord of Śvetadvīpa within his heart can surpass the pangs of the six material tribulations: hunger, thirst, birth, death, lamentation and illusion. Thus one can attain his original, transcendental form.”

TEXT 113

yuga-manvantare dhari’ nānā avatāra

dharma saṁsthāpana kare, adharma saṁhāra

SYNONYMS

yuga-manu-antare—in the ages and millenniums of Manu; *dhari’*—accepting; *nānā*—various; *avatāra*—incarnations; *dharma saṁsthāpana kare*—establishes the principles of religion; *adharma saṁhāra*—vanquishing irreligious principles.

TRANSLATION

In the ages and millenniums of Manu, He appears as different incarnations to establish the principles of real religion and vanquish the principles of irreligion.

PURPORT

The Lord Viṣṇu who lies in the ocean of milk incarnates Himself in various forms to maintain the laws of the cosmos and annihilate the causes of disturbance. Such incarnations are visible in every *manv-antara* (i.e., in the course of the reign of each Manu, who lives for 71 x 4,320,000 years). Fourteen such Manus take their birth and die, to yield a place for the next, during one day of Brahmā.

TEXT 114

deva-gaṇe nā pāya yāñhāra daraśana

kṣīrodaka-tīre yāi'arena stavana

SYNONYMS

deva-gaṇe—the demigods; *nā*—not; *pāya*—get; *yāñhāra*—whose; *daraśana*—sight; *kṣīra-udaka-tīre*—on the shore of the ocean of milk; *yāi'*—go; *arena stavana*—offer prayers.

TRANSLATION

Unable to see Him, the demigods go to the shore of the ocean of milk and offer prayers to Him.

PURPORT

The denizens of heaven, who live in the planetary systems beginning from Svarloka, cannot even see Lord Viṣṇu in Śvetadvīpa. Unable to reach the island, they can simply approach the beach of the milk ocean to offer transcendental prayers to the Lord, appealing to Him on special occasions to appear as an incarnation.

TEXT 115

tabe avatari' kare jagat pālana

ananta vaibhava tāñra nāhika gaṇana

SYNONYMS

tabe—at that time; *avatari'*—descending; *kare*—does; *jagat pālana*—maintenance of the material world; *ananta*—unlimited; *vaibhava*—the opulences; *tāñra*—of Him; *nāhika*—there is not; *gaṇana*—counting.

TRANSLATION

He then descends to maintain the material world. His unlimited opulences cannot be counted.

TEXT 116

sei viṣṇu haya yāñra amśāṁśera amśa

sei prabhu nityānanda—sarva-avatamśa

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *viṣṇu*—Lord Viṣṇu; *haya*—is; *yāñra*—whose; *amśa-amśera*—of the part of the plenary part; *amśa*—part; *sei*—that; *prabhu*—Lord; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda; *sarva-avatamśa*—the source of all incarnations.

TRANSLATION

That Lord Viṣṇu is but a part of a part of a plenary portion of Lord Nityānanda, who is the source of all incarnations.

PURPORT

The Lord of Śvetadvīpa has immense potency for creation and destruction. Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, being Baladeva Himself, the original form of Saṅkarṣaṇa, is the original form of the Lord of Śvetadvīpa.

TEXT 117

sei viṣṇu 'śeṣa'-rūpe dharena dharaṇī

kāñhā āche mahī, śire, hena nāhi jāni

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *viṣṇu*—Lord Viṣṇu; *śeṣa-rūpe*—in form of Lord Śeṣa; *dharena*—carries; *dharaṇī*—the planets; *kāñhā*—where; *āche*—are; *mahī*—the planets; *śire*—on the head; *hena nāhi jāni*—I cannot understand.

TRANSLATION

That same Lord Viṣṇu, in the form of Lord Śeṣa, holds the planets upon His heads, although He does not know where they are, for He cannot feel their existence upon His heads.

TEXT 118

sahasra vistīrṇa yāñra phaṇāra maṇḍala

sūrya jini' maṇi-gaṇa kare jhala-mala

SYNONYMS

sahasra—thousands; *vistīrṇa*—spread; *yāñra*—whose; *phaṇāra*—of the hoods; *maṇḍala*—group; *sūrya*—the sun; *jini'*—conquering; *maṇi-gaṇa*—jewels; *kare*—do; *jhala-mala*—glittering.

TRANSLATION

His thousands of extended hoods are adorned with dazzling jewels surpassing the sun.

TEXT 119

pañcāśat-koṭi-yojana prthivī-vistāra

yāñira eka-phañe rahe sarṣapa-ākāra

SYNONYMS

pañcāśat—fifty; *koṭi*—ten millions; *yojana*—eight miles; *prthivī*—of the universe; *vistāra*—breadth; *yāñira*—whose; *eka-phañe*—on one of the hoods; *rahe*—stays; *sarṣapa-ākāra*—like a mustard seed.

TRANSLATION

The universe, which measures five hundred million yojanas in diameter, rests on one of His hoods like a mustard seed.

PURPORT

The Lord of Śvetadvīpa expands Himself as Śeṣa Nāga, who sustains all the planets upon His innumerable hoods. These huge global spheres are compared to grains of mustard resting on the spiritual hoods of Śeṣa Nāga. The scientists' law of gravity is a partial explanation of Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa's energy. The name "Saṅkarṣaṇa" has an etymological relationship to the idea of gravity. There is a reference to Śeṣa Nāga in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (5.17.21), where it is said:

*yam āhur asya sthiti janma-saṁyamam
tribhir vihinam yam anantam ṛṣayaḥ
na veda siddhāram iva kvacit sthitam*

bhū-maṇḍalaṁ mūrdha-sahasra-dhāmasu

“O my Lord, the hymns of the *Vedas* proclaim that You are the effective cause for the creation, maintenance and destruction. But in fact You are transcendental to all limitations and are therefore known as unlimited. On Your thousands of hoods rest the innumerable global spheres, like grains of mustard so insignificant that You have no perception of their weight.” The *Bhāgavatam* further says (5.25.2):

*yasyedaṁ kṣīti-maṇḍalaṁ bhagavato 'nanta-mūrteḥ sahasra-śīrasa
ekasminn eva śīrṣaṇi dhriyamāṇaṁ siddhārtha iva lakṣyate.*

“Lord Anantadeva has thousands of hoods. Each sustains a global sphere that appears like a grain of mustard.”

TEXT 120

sei ta' 'ananta' 'śeṣa' — — bhakta-avatāra

īśvarera sevā vinā nāhi jāne āra

SYNONYMS

sei ta'—that; *ananta*—Lord Ananta; *śeṣa*—the incarnation Śeṣa; *bhakta-avatāra*—incarnation of a devotee; *īśvarera sevā*—the service of the Lord; *vinā*—without; *nāhi*—not; *jāne*—knows; *āra*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

That Ananta Śeṣa is the devotee incarnation of Godhead. He knows nothing but service to Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, in his *Kṛṣṇa-sandarbhā*, has described Śeṣa Nāga as

follows: “Śrī Anantadeva has thousands of faces and is fully independent. Always ready to serve the Supreme Personality of Godhead, He waits upon Him constantly. Saṅkarṣaṇa is the first expansion of Vāsudeva, and because He appears by His own will, He is called *svarāṭ*, fully independent. He is therefore infinite and transcendental to all limits of time and space. He Himself appears as the thousand-headed Śeṣa.” In the *Skanda Purāṇa*, in the *Ayodhyā-māhātmya* chapter, the demigod Indra requested Lord Śeṣa, who was standing before him as Lakṣmaṇa, “Please go to Your eternal abode, Viṣṇuloka, where Your expansion Śeṣa, with His serpentine hoods, is also present.” After thus dispatching Lakṣmaṇa to the regions of Pātāla, Lord Indra returned to his abode. This quotation indicates that the Saṅkarṣaṇa of the quadruple form descends with Lord Rāma as Lakṣmaṇa. When Lord Rāma disappears, Śeṣa again separates Himself from the personality of Lakṣmaṇa. Śeṣa then returns to His own abode in the Pātāla regions, and Lakṣmaṇa returns to His abode in Vaikuṇṭha.

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* gives the following description: “The Saṅkarṣaṇa of the second group of quadruple forms appears as Rāma, taking with Him Śeṣa, who bears the global spheres. There are two features of Śeṣa. One is the bearer of the globes, and the other is the bedstead servitor. The Śeṣa who bears the globes is a potent incarnation of Saṅkarṣaṇa, and therefore He is sometimes also called Saṅkarṣaṇa. The bedstead feature of Śeṣa always presents himself as an eternal servitor of the Lord.”

TEXT 121

sahasra-vadane kare kṛṣṇa-guṇa gāna

niravadhi guṇa gā'na, anta nāhi pā'na

SYNONYMS

sahasra-vadane—in thousands of mouths; *kare*—does; *kṛṣṇa-guṇa*

gāna—chanting of the holy attributes of Kṛṣṇa; *niravadhi*—continuously; *guṇa gā'na*—chanting of the transcendental qualities; *anta nāhi pā'na*—does not reach the end.

TRANSLATION

With His thousands of mouths He sings the glories of Lord Kṛṣṇa, but although He always sings in that way, He does not find an end to the qualities of the Lord.

TEXT 122

sanakādi bhāgavata śune yāñra mukhe

bhagavānera guṇa kahe, bhāse prema-sukhe

SYNONYMS

sanaka-ādi—the great sages headed by Sanaka, Sananda, etc.; *bhāgavata*—*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *śune*—hear; *yāñra mukhe*—from whose mouth; *bhagavānera*—of the Personality of Godhead; *guṇa*—attributes; *kahe*—say; *bhāse*—float; *prema-sukhe*—in the transcendental bliss of love of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

The four Kumāras hear Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam from His lips, and they in turn repeat it in the transcendental bliss of love of Godhead.

TEXT 123

chatra, pādukā, śayyā, upādhāna, vasana

ārāma, āvāsa, yajña-sūtra, śimhāsana

SYNONYMS

chatra—umbrella; *pādukā*—slippers; *śayyā*—bed; *upādhāna*—pillow; *vasana*—garments; *ārāma*—resting chair; *āvāsa*—residence; *yajña-sūtra*—sacred thread; *śimha-āsana*—throne.

TRANSLATION

He serves Lord Kṛṣṇa, assuming all the following forms: umbrella, slippers, bedding, pillow, garments, resting chair, residence, sacred thread and throne.

TEXT 124

eta mūrti-bheda kari' kṛṣṇa-sevā kare

kṛṣṇera śeṣatā pāñā 'śeṣa' nāma dhare

SYNONYMS

eta—so many; *mūrti-bheda*—different forms; *kari'*—taking; *kṛṣṇa-sevā kare*—serves Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *śeṣatā*—ultimate end; *pāñā*—having reached; *śeṣa nāma dhare*—assumes the name Śeṣa Nāga.

TRANSLATION

He is thus called Lord Śeṣa, for He has attained the ultimate end of servitude to Kṛṣṇa. He takes many forms for the service of Kṛṣṇa, and thus He serves the Lord.

TEXT 125

sei ta' ananta, yāñira kahi eka kalā

hena prabhu nityānanda, ke jāne tāñra khelā

SYNONYMS

sei ta'—that; *ananta*—Lord Ananta; *yāñra*—of whom; *kahi*—I say; *eka kalā*—one part of the part; *hena*—such; *prabhu nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *ke*—who; *jāne*—knows; *tāñra*—His; *khelā*—pastimes.

TRANSLATION

That person of whom Lord Ananta is a kalā, or part of a plenary part, is Lord Nityānanda Prabhu. Who, therefore, can know the pastimes of Lord Nityānanda?

TEXT 126

e-saba pramāṇe jāni nityānanda-tattva-sīmā

tāñhāke 'ananta' kahi, ki tāñra mahimā

SYNONYMS

e-saba—all these; *pramāṇe*—by the evidences; *jāni*—I know; *nityānanda-tattva-sīmā*—the limit of the truth of Lord Nityānanda; *tāñhāke*—to Him (Lord Nityānanda, Balarāma); *ananta*—Lord Ananta; *kahi*—if I say; *ki tāñre mahimā*—what glory do I speak about Him.

TRANSLATION

From these conclusions we can know the limit of the truth of Lord Nityānanda. But what glory is there in calling Him Ananta?

TEXT 127

athavā bhaktera vākya māni satya kari'

sakala sambhave tānte, yāte avatārī

SYNONYMS

athavā—otherwise; *bhaktera vākya*—anything spoken by a pure devotee; *māni*—I accept; *satya kari'*—as truth; *sakala*—everything; *sambhave*—possible; *tānte*—in Him; *yāte*—since; *avatārī*—the original source of all incarnations.

TRANSLATION

But I accept it as the truth because it has been said by devotees. Since He is the source of all incarnations, everything is possible in Him.

TEXT 128

avatāra-avatārī—abhedā, ye jāne

pūrve yaiche kṛṣṇake keho kāho kari' māne

SYNONYMS

avatāra-avatārī—an incarnation and the source of all incarnations; *abhedā*—identical; *ye jāne*—anyone who knows; *pūrve*—formerly; *yaiche*—just as; *kṛṣṇake*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *keho*—somebody; *kāho*—somewhere; *kari'*—making; *māne*—accepts.

TRANSLATION

They know that there is no difference between the incarnation and the source of all incarnations. Previously Lord Kṛṣṇa was regarded in the light of different principles by different people.

TEXT 129

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa sākṣāt nara-nārāyaṇa

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa haya sākṣāt vāmana

SYNONYMS

keho kahe—someone says; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sākṣāt*—directly; *nara-nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nara-Nārāyaṇa; *keho kahe*—someone says; *kṛṣṇa haya*—Kṛṣṇa is; *sākṣāt vāmana*—Lord Vāmanadeva.

TRANSLATION

Some said that Kṛṣṇa was directly Lord Nara-Nārāyaṇa, and some called Him Lord Vāmanadeva incarnate.

TEXT 130

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa kṣīroda-śāyī avatāra

asambhava nahe, satya vacana sabāra

SYNONYMS

keho kahe—someone says; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṣīroda-śāyī avatāra*—an incarnation of Lord Viṣṇu lying in the ocean of milk; *asambhava nahe*—there is not impossibility; *satya*—true; *vacana sabāra*—everyone's statement.

TRANSLATION

Some called Lord Kṛṣṇa an incarnation of Lord Kṣīrodakaśāyī. All these names are true; nothing is impossible.

TEXT 131

kṛṣṇa yabe avatare sarvāmśa-āśraya

sarvāmśa āsi' tabe kṛṣṇete milaya

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yabe*—when; *avatare*—descends; *sarva-amśa-āśraya*—the shelter of all other *viṣṇu-tattvas*; *sarva-amśa*—all plenary portions; *āsi'*—coming; *tabe*—at that time; *kṛṣṇete*—in Kṛṣṇa; *milaya*—join.

TRANSLATION

When the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa appears, He is the shelter of all plenary parts. Thus at that time all His plenary portions join in Him.

TEXT 132

yei yei rūpe jāne, sei tāhā kahe

sakala sambhave kṛṣṇe, kichu mithyā nahe

SYNONYMS

yei yei—whatever; *rūpe*—in the form; *jāne*—one knows; *sei*—he; *tāhā*—that; *kahe*—says; *sakala sambhave kṛṣṇe*—everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa; *kichu mithyā nahe*—there is no falsity.

TRANSLATION

In whatever form one knows the Lord, one speaks of Him in that way. In this there is no falsity, since everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

In this connection we may mention an incident that took place between two of our *sannyāsīs* while we were preaching the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* in Hyderabad. One of them stated that “Hare Rāma” refers to Śrī Balarāma, and the other protested that “Hare Rāma” means Lord Rāma. Ultimately the controversy came to me, and I gave the decision that if someone says that the “Rāma” in “Hare Rāma” is Lord Rāmacandra and someone else says that the “Rāma” in “Hare Rāma” is Śrī Balarāma, both are correct because there is no difference between Śrī Balarāma and Lord Rāma. Here in *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* we find that Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī has stated the same conclusion:

*yei yei rūpe jāne, sei tāhā kahe
sakala sambhave kṛṣṇe, kichu mithyā nahe*

If someone calls Lord Rāmacandra by the vibration Hare Rāma, understanding it to mean “O Lord Rāmacandra!” he is quite right. Similarly, if one says that Hare Rāma means “O Śrī Balarāma!” he is also right. Those who are aware of the *viṣṇu-tattva* do not fight over all these details.

In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī has explained Kṛṣṇa’s being both Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and Nārāyaṇa in the spiritual sky and expanding in the quadruple forms known as Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. He has refuted the idea that Kṛṣṇa is an incarnation of Nārāyaṇa. Some devotees think that Nārāyaṇa is the original Personality of Godhead and that Kṛṣṇa is an incarnation. Even Śaṅkarācārya, in his commentary on the *Bhagavad-gītā*, has accepted Nārāyaṇa as the transcendental Personality of Godhead who appeared as Kṛṣṇa, the son of Devakī and Vasudeva. Therefore this matter may be difficult to understand. But the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava-sampradāya, headed by Rūpa Gosvāmī, has established the principle of the *Bhagavad-gītā* that everything emanates from Kṛṣṇa, who says in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, *aham sarvasya prabhavaḥ*: “I am the original source of everything.”

“Everything” includes Nārāyaṇa. Therefore Rūpa Gosvāmī, in his *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, has established that Kṛṣṇa, not Nārāyaṇa, is the original Personality of Godhead.

In this connection he has quoted a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.2.15) that states:

*sva-śānta-rūpeṣv itaraiḥ svarūpair
abhyardyamāneṣv anukampitātmā
parāvareśo mahad-aṁśa-yukto
hy ajo 'pi jāto bhagavān yathāgniḥ*

“When pure devotees of the Lord like Vasudeva are greatly disturbed by dangerous demons like Kāṁsa, Lord Kṛṣṇa joins with all His pastime expansions, such as the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha, and, although unborn, becomes manifest, just as fire becomes manifest by the friction of *araṇi* wood.” *Araṇi* wood is used to ignite a sacrificial fire without matches or any other flame. Just as fire appears from *araṇi* wood, the Supreme Lord appears when there is friction between devotees and nondevotees. When Kṛṣṇa appears, He appears in full, including within Himself all His expansions, such as Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Aniruddha and Pradyumna. Kṛṣṇa is always integrated with His other incarnations, like Nṛsimhadeva, Varāha, Vāmana, Nara-Nārāyaṇa, Hayagrīva and Ajita. In Vṛndāvana Lord Kṛṣṇa sometimes exhibits the functions of such incarnations.

In the *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa* it is said, “The same Personality of Godhead who is known in Vaikuṇṭha as the four-handed Nārāyaṇa, the friend of all living entities, and in the milk ocean as the Lord of Śvetadvīpa, and who is the best of all *puruṣas*, appeared as the son of Nanda. In a fire there are many sparks of different dimensions; some of them are very big, and some are small. The small sparks are compared to the living entities, and the large sparks are compared to the Viṣṇu expansions of Lord Kṛṣṇa. All the incarnations emanate from Kṛṣṇa, and after the end of their pastimes they again merge with Kṛṣṇa.”

Therefore in the various *Purāṇas* Kṛṣṇa is described sometimes as Nārāyaṇa, sometimes as Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, sometimes as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and sometimes as Vaikuṇṭhanātha, the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha. Because Kṛṣṇa is always full, Mūla-saṅkarṣaṇa is in Kṛṣṇa, and since all incarnations are manifested from Mūla-saṅkarṣaṇa, it should be understood that He can manifest different incarnations by His supreme will, even in the presence of Kṛṣṇa. Great sages have therefore glorified the Lord by different names. Thus when the original person, the source of all incarnations, is sometimes described as an incarnation, there is no discrepancy.

TEXT 133

ataeva śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gosāñi

sarva avatāra-līlā kari' sabāre dekhāi

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gosāñi*—the Lord; *sarva*—all; *avatāra-līlā*—the pastimes of different incarnations; *kari'*—exhibiting; *sabāre*—to everyone; *dekhāi*—He showed.

TRANSLATION

Therefore Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu has exhibited to everyone all the pastimes of all the various incarnations.

TEXT 134

ei-rūpe nityānanda 'ananta'-prakāśa

sei-bhāve—kahe muñi caitanyera dāsa

SYNONYMS

ei-rūpe—in this way; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *ananta-prakāśa*—unlimited manifestations; *sei-bhāve*—in that transcendental emotion; *kahe*—He says; *muñi*—I; *caitanyera dāsa*—the servant of Lord Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

Thus Lord Nityānanda has unlimited incarnations. In transcendental emotion He calls Himself a servant of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 135

kabhu guru, kabhu sakhā, kabhu bhr̥tya-līlā

pūrve yena tina-bhāve vraje kaila khelā

SYNONYMS

kabhu—sometimes; *guru*—spiritual master; *kabhu*—sometimes; *sakhā*—friend; *kabhu*—sometimes; *bhr̥tya-līlā*—pastimes as a servant; *pūrve*—formerly; *yena*—as; *tina-bhāve*—in three different moods; *vraje*—in Vṛndāvana; *kaila khelā*—plays with Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

Sometimes He serves Lord Caitanya as His guru, sometimes as His friend and sometimes as His servant, just as Lord Balarāma played with Lord Kṛṣṇa in these three different moods in Vraja.

TEXT 136

vṛṣa hañā kṛṣṇa-sane māthā-māthi raṇa

kabhu kṛṣṇa kare tāñra pāda-saṁvāhana

SYNONYMS

vṛṣa hañā—becoming a bull; *kṛṣṇa-sane*—with Kṛṣṇa; *māthā-māthi*
raṇa—fighting head to head; *kabhu*—sometimes; *kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa; *kare*—
does; *tāñra*—His; *pāda-saṁvāhana*—massaging the feet.

TRANSLATION

Playing like a bull, Lord Balarāma fights with Kṛṣṇa head to head. And
sometimes Lord Kṛṣṇa massages the feet of Lord Balarāma.

TEXT 137

āpanāke bhṛtya kari' kṛṣṇe prabhu jāne

kṛṣṇera kalāra kalā āpanāke māne

SYNONYMS

āpanāke—Himself; *bhṛtya kari'*—considering a servant; *kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa;
prabhu—master; *jāne*—He knows; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kalāra*
kalā—as a plenary portion of a plenary portion; *āpanāke*—Himself;
māne—He accepts.

TRANSLATION

He considers Himself a servant and knows Kṛṣṇa to be His master. Thus
He regards Himself as a fragment of His plenary portion.

TEXT 138

vṛṣāyamāṇau nardantau

yuyudhāte parasparam

anukṛtya rutair jantūṁś

ceratuḥ prākṛtau yathā

SYNONYMS

vṛṣāyamāṇau—becoming like bulls; *nardantau*—making roaring sounds; *yuyudhāte*—both used to fight; *parasparam*—each other; *anukṛtya*—imitating; *rutaiḥ*—with cries; *jantūn*—the animals; *ceratuḥ*—used to play; *prākṛtau*—ordinary boys; *yathā*—just like.

TRANSLATION

“Acting just like ordinary boys, They played like roaring bulls as They fought each other, and They imitated the calls of various animals.”

PURPORT

This and the following quotation are from the *Bhāgavatam* (10.11.40 and 10.15.14).

TEXT 139

kvacit krīḍā-parīśrāntam

gopotsaṅgopabarhaṇam

svayaṁ viśrāmayaty āryaṁ

pāda-saṁvāhanādibhiḥ

SYNONYMS

kvacit—sometimes; *kṛīḍā*—playing; *parīśrāntam*—very much fatigued; *gopa-utsaṅga*—the lap of a cowherd boy; *upabarhaṇam*—whose pillow; *svayam*—personally Lord Kṛṣṇa; *viśrāmayati*—causing to rest; *āryam*—His elder brother; *pāda-saṁvāhana-ādibhiḥ*—by massaging His feet, etc.

TRANSLATION

“Sometimes when Lord Kṛṣṇa’s elder brother, Lord Balarāma, felt tired after playing and lay His head on the lap of a cowherd boy, Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself served Him by massaging His feet.”

TEXT 140

keyam vā kuta āyātā

daivī vā nāry utāsuri

prāyo māyāstu me bhartur

nānyā me 'pi vimohinī

SYNONYMS

kā—who; *iyam*—this; *vā*—or; *kutaḥ*—from where; *āyātā*—has come; *daivī*—whether demigod; *vā*—or; *nārī*—woman; *uta*—or; *āsuri*—demoness; *prāyaḥ*—in most cases; *māyā*—illusory energy; *astu*—she must be; *me*—My; *bhartuḥ*—of the master, Lord Kṛṣṇa; *na*—not; *anyā*—any other; *me*—My; *api*—certainly; *vimohinī*—bewilderer.

TRANSLATION

“Who is this mystic power, and where has she come from? Is she a demigod or a demoness? She must be the illusory energy of My master, Lord Kṛṣṇa, for who else can bewilder Me?”

PURPORT

The playful pastimes of the Lord caused suspicion in the mind of Lord Brahmā, and therefore Lord Brahmā, to test Kṛṣṇa's Lordship, stole all the Lord's calves and cowherd boys with his own mystic power. Śrī Kṛṣṇa responded, however, by replacing all the calves and boys in the field. Lord Balarāma's thoughts of astonishment at such wonderful retaliation are recorded in this verse (*Bhāg.* 10.13.37).

TEXT 141

yasyāṅghri-paṅkaja-rajo 'khila-loka-pālair

mauly-uttamair dhṛtam upāsita-tīrtha-tīrtham

brahmā bhavo 'ham api yasya kalāḥ kalāyāḥ

śrīś codvahoma ciram asya nṛpāsanam kva

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *āṅghri-paṅkaja*—lotuslike feet; *rajaḥ*—the dust; *akhila-loka*—of the universal planetary systems; *pālaiḥ*—by the masters; *mauli-uttamaiḥ*—with valuable turbans on their heads; *dhṛtam*—accepted; *upāsita*—worshipped; *tīrtha-tīrtham*—the sanctifier of the holy places; *brahmā*—Lord Brahmā; *bhavaḥ*—Lord Śiva; *aham api*—even I; *yasya*—of whom; *kalāḥ*—portions; *kalāyāḥ*—of a plenary portion; *śrīḥ*—the goddess of fortune; *ca*—and; *udvahoma*—we carry; *ciram*—eternally; *asya*—of Him; *nṛpa-āsanam*—the throne of a king; *kva*—where.

TRANSLATION

“What is the value of a throne to Lord Kṛṣṇa? The masters of the various planetary systems accept the dust of His lotus feet on their crowned heads. That dust makes the holy places sacred, and even Lord Brahmā,

Lord Śiva, Lakṣmī and I Myself, who are all portions of His plenary portion, eternally carry that dust on our heads.”

PURPORT

When the Kauravas, to flatter Baladeva so that He would become their ally, spoke ill of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Lord Baladeva became angry and spoke this verse (*Bhāg.* 10.68.37).

TEXT 142

ekale īśvara kṛṣṇa, āra saba bhr̥tya

yāre yaiche nācāya, se taiche kare nṛtya

SYNONYMS

ekale—alone; *īśvara*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa; *āra*—others; *saba*—all; *bhr̥tya*—servants; *yāre*—unto whom; *yaiche*—as; *nācāya*—He causes to dance; *se*—He; *taiche*—in that way; *kare nṛtya*—dances.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa alone is the supreme controller, and all others are His servants. They dance as He makes them do so.

TEXT 143

ei mata caitanya-gosāñi ekale īśvara

āra saba pāriṣada, keha vā kiṅkara

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *caitanya-gosāñī*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ekale*—alone; *īśvara*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *āra saba*—all others; *pāriṣada*—associates; *keha*—someone; *vā*—or; *kiṅkara*—servants.

TRANSLATION

Thus Lord Caitanya is also the only controller. All others are His associates or servants.

TEXTS 144–145

guru-varga, — — *nityānanda*, *advaita ācārya*

śrīvāsādi, *āra yata* — — *laghu*, *sama*, *ārya*

sabe pāriṣada, *sabe līlāra sahāya*

sabā lañā nija-kārya sādhe gaura-rāya

SYNONYMS

guru-varga—elders; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *advaita ācārya*—and Advaita Ācārya; *śrīvāsa-ādi*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura and others; *āra*—others; *yata*—all; *laghu*, *sama*, *ārya*—junior, equal or superior; *sabe*—everyone; *pāriṣada*—associates; *sabe*—everyone; *līlāra sahāya*—helpers in the pastimes; *sabā lañā*—taking all of them; *nija-kārya*—His own aims; *sādhe*—executes; *gaura-rāya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

His elders such as Lord Nityānanda, Advaita Ācārya and Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, as well as His other devotees—whether His juniors, equals or superiors—are all His associates who help Him in His pastimes. Lord Gaurāṅga fulfills His aims with their help.

TEXT 146

advaita ācārya, nityānanda, — — dui aṅga

dui-jana lañā prabhura yata kichu raṅga

SYNONYMS

advaita ācārya—Śrī Advaita Ācārya; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *dui aṅga*—two limbs of the Lord; *dui-jana lañā*—taking the two of Them; *prabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yata*—all; *kichu*—some; *raṅga*—playful activities.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya and Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu, who are plenary parts of the Lord, are His principal associates. With these two the Lord performs His pastimes in various ways.

TEXT 147

advaita-ācārya-gosāñi sākṣāt īśvara

prabhu guru kari' māne, tiñho ta' kiṅkara

SYNONYMS

advaita-ācārya—Advaita Ācārya; *gosāñi*—the Lord; *sākṣāt īśvara*—directly the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *guru kari' māne*—accepts Him as His teacher; *tiñho ta' kiṅkara*—but He is the servant.

TRANSLATION

Lord Advaita Ācārya is directly the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Although Lord Caitanya accepts Him as His preceptor, Advaita Ācārya is a servant of the Lord.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya always offered respects to Advaita Prabhu as He would to His father because Advaita was even older than His father; yet Advaita Prabhu always considered Himself a servant of Lord Caitanya. Śrī Advaita Prabhu and Īśvara Purī, Lord Caitanya's spiritual master, were both disciples of Mādhavendra Purī, who was also the spiritual master of Nityānanda Prabhu. Thus Advaita Prabhu, as Lord Caitanya's spiritual uncle, was always to be respected because one should respect one's spiritual master's Godbrothers as one respects one's spiritual master. Because of all these considerations, Śrī Advaita Prabhu was superior to Lord Caitanya, yet Advaita Prabhu considered Himself Lord Caitanya's subordinate.

TEXT 148

ācārya-gosāñīra tattva nā yāya kathana

kṛṣṇa avatāri yeñho tārila bhuvana

SYNONYMS

ācārya-gosāñīra—of Advaita Ācārya; *tattva*—the truth; *nā yāya kathana*—cannot be described; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatāri*—making descend; *yeñho*—who; *tārila*—delivered; *bhuvana*—all the world.

TRANSLATION

I cannot describe the truth of Advaita Ācārya. He has delivered the entire world by making Lord Kṛṣṇa descend.

TEXT 149

nityānanda-svarūpa pūrve ha-iyā lakṣmaṇa

laghu-bhrātā haiyā kare rāmera sevana

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-svarūpa—Lord Nityānanda Svarūpa; *pūrve*—formerly; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *lakṣmaṇa*—Lakṣmaṇa, Lord Rāmacandra’s younger brother; *laghu-bhrātā haiyā*—becoming the younger brother; *kare*—does; *rāmera sevana*—service to Lord Rāmacandra.

TRANSLATION

Lord Nityānanda Svarūpa formerly appeared as Lakṣmaṇa and served Lord Rāmacandra as His younger brother.

PURPORT

Among the *sannyāsīs* of the Śāṅkara-sampradāya there are different names for *brahmacārīs*. Each *sannyāsī* has some assistants, known as *brahmacārīs*, who are called by different names according to the names of the *sannyāsī*. Among such *brahmacārīs* there are four names: Svarūpa, Ānanda, Prakāśa and Caitanya. Nityānanda Prabhu maintained Himself as a *brahmacārī*; He never took *sannyāsa*. As a *brahmacārī* His name was Nityānanda Svarūpa, and therefore the *sannyāsī* under whom He was living must have been from the *tīrthas* or *āśramas* of the Śāṅkara-sampradāya, because one of the names for the assistant *brahmacārī* of such a *sannyāsī* is Svarūpa.

TEXT 150

rāmera caritra saba,——duḥkhera kāraṇa

svatantra līlāya duḥkha sahena lakṣmaṇa

SYNONYMS

rāmera caritra saba—all the activities of Lord Rāmacandra; *duḥkhera kāraṇa*—causes of suffering; *sva-tantra*—although independent; *līlāya*—in the pastimes; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *sahena lakṣmaṇa*—Lakṣmaṇa tolerates.

TRANSLATION

The activities of Lord Rāma were full of suffering, but Lakṣmaṇa, of His own accord, tolerated that suffering.

TEXT 151

niṣedha karite nāre, yāte choṭa bhāi

mauna dhari' rahe lakṣmaṇa mane duḥkha pāi'

SYNONYMS

niṣedha karite nāre—unable to prohibit Lord Rāmacandra; *yāte*—because; *choṭa bhāi*—younger brother; *mauna dhari'*—becoming silent; *rahe*—remains; *lakṣmaṇa*—Lakṣmaṇa; *mane*—in the mind; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *pāi'*—getting.

TRANSLATION

As a younger brother He could not stop Lord Rāma from His resolution, and so He remained silent, although unhappy in His mind.

TEXT 152

kṛṣṇa-avatāre jyeṣṭha hailā sevāra kāraṇa

kṛṣṇake karāila nānā sukha āsvādana

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-avatāre—in the incarnation of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *jyeṣṭha hailā*—He became the elder brother; *sevāra kārāṇa*—for the purpose of service; *kṛṣṇake*—to Kṛṣṇa; *karāila*—made; *nānā*—various; *sukha*—happinenses; *āsvādana*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

When Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared, He [Balarāma] became His elder brother to serve Him to His heart's content and make Him enjoy all sorts of happiness.

TEXT 153

rāma-lakṣmaṇa—*kṛṣṇa-rāmera amśa-viśeṣa*

avatāra-kāle donhe donhāte praveśa

SYNONYMS

rāma-lakṣmaṇa—Rāmacandra and Lakṣmaṇa; *kṛṣṇa-rāmera amśa-viśeṣa*—particular expansions of Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Balarāma; *avatāra-kāle*—at the time of incarnation; *donhe*—both of Them (Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa); *donhāte praveśa*—entered into Them both (Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma).

TRANSLATION

Śrī Rāma and Śrī Lakṣmaṇa, who are plenary portions of Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Balarāma respectively, entered into Them at the time of Kṛṣṇa's and Balarāma's appearance.

PURPORT

With reference to the *Viṣṇu-dharmottara*, the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* explains that Rāma is an incarnation of Vāsudeva, Lakṣmaṇa is an incarnation of Saṅkarṣaṇa, Bharata is an incarnation of Pradyumna, and Śatrughna is an incarnation of Aniruddha. The *Padma Purāṇa* describes that Rāmacandra is Nārāyaṇa and that Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata and Śatrughna are respectively Śeṣa, Cakra and Śaṅkha (the conchshell in the hand of Nārāyaṇa). In the *Rāma-gīta* of the *Skanda Purāṇa*, Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata and Śatrughna have been described as the triple attendants of Lord Rāma.

TEXT 154

sei amśa lañā jyeṣṭha-kaniṣṭhābhimāna

amśāamśī-rūpe śāstre karaye vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

sei amśa lañā—taking that plenary portion; *jyeṣṭha-kaniṣṭha-abhimāna*—considering Themselves the elder or younger; *amśa-amśī-rūpe*—as the expansion and the original Supreme Personality of Godhead; *śāstre*—in the revealed scriptures; *karaye*—does; *vyākhyāna*—explanation.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma present Themselves as younger brother and elder brother, but in the scriptures They are described as the original Supreme Personality of Godhead and His expansion.

TEXT 155

rāmādi-mūrtiṣu kalā-niyamena tiṣṭhan

nānāvatāram akarod bhuvaneṣu kintu

kṛṣṇaḥ svayaṁ samabhavat paramaḥ pumān yo

govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

rāma-ādi—the incarnation of Lord Rāma, etc.; *mūrtiṣu*—in different forms; *kalā-niyamena*—by the order of plenary portions; *tiṣṭhan*—existing; *nānā*—various; *avatāram*—incarnations; *akarot*—executed; *bhuvaneṣu*—within the worlds; *kintu*—but; *kṛṣṇaḥ*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *svayam*—personally; *samabhavat*—appeared; *paramaḥ*—the supreme; *pumān*—person; *yaḥ*—who; *govindam*—unto Lord Govinda; *ādi-puruṣam*—the original person; *tam*—unto Him; *aham*—I; *bhajāmi*—offer obeisances.

TRANSLATION

“I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who by His various plenary portions appears in the world in different forms and incarnations such as Lord Rāma, but who personally appears in His supreme original form as Lord Kṛṣṇa.”

PURPORT

This is a quotation from *Brahma-saṁhitā* (5.39).

TEXT 156

śrī-caitanya——*sei kṛṣṇa*, *nityānanda*——*rāma*

nityānanda pūrṇa kare caitanyera kāma

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya—Lord Śrī Caitanya; *sei kṛṣṇa*—that original Kṛṣṇa; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *rāma*—Balarāma; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *pūrṇa kare*—fulfills; *caitanyera kāma*—all the desires of

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya is the same Lord Kṛṣṇa, and Lord Nityānanda is Lord Balarāma. Lord Nityānanda fulfills all of Lord Caitanya's desires.

TEXT 157

nityānanda-mahimā-sindhu ananta, apāra

eka kaṇā sparśi mātra, — — se kṛpā tāñhāra

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-mahimā—of the glories of Lord Nityānanda; *sindhu*—the ocean; *ananta*—unlimited; *apāra*—unfathomed; *eka kaṇā*—one fragment; *sparśi*—I touch; *mātra*—only; *se*—that; *kṛpā*—mercy; *tāñhāra*—His.

TRANSLATION

The ocean of Lord Nityānanda's glories is infinite and unfathomable. Only by His mercy can I touch even a drop of it.

TEXT 158

āra eka śuna tāñra kṛpāra mahimā

adhama jīvere caḍhāila ūrdhva-sīmā

SYNONYMS

āra—another; *eka*—one; *śuna*—please hear; *tāñra kṛpāra mahimā*—glory of His mercy; *adhama jīvere*—the downtrodden living being;

caḍhāila—He elevated; *ūrdhva-sīmā*—to the topmost limit.

TRANSLATION

Please listen to another glory of His mercy. He made a fallen living entity climb to the highest limit.

TEXT 159

veda-guhya kathā ei ayogya kahite

tathāpi kahiye tāñra kṛpā prakāśite

SYNONYMS

veda—like the *Vedas*; *guhya*—very confidential; *kathā*—incident; *ei*—this; *ayogya kahite*—not fit to disclose; *tathāpi*—still; *kahiye*—I speak; *tāñra*—His; *kṛpā*—mercy; *prakāśite*—to manifest.

TRANSLATION

To disclose it is not proper, for it should be kept as confidential as the *Vedas*, yet I shall speak of it to make His mercy known to all.

TEXT 160

ullāsa-upari lekhoñ tomāra prasāda

nityānanda prabhu, mora kṣama aparādha

SYNONYMS

ullāsa-upari—on account of great ecstasy; *lekhoñ*—I write; *tomāra prasāda*—Your mercy; *nityānanda prabhu*—Lord Nityānanda; *mora*—my; *kṣama*—please excuse; *aparādha*—offenses.

TRANSLATION

O Lord Nityānanda, I write of Your mercy out of great exultation. Please forgive me for my offenses.

TEXT 161

avadhūta gosāñīra eka bhṛtya prema-dhāma

mīnaketana rāmadāsa haya tāñira nāma

SYNONYMS

avadhūta—the mendicant; *gosāñīra*—of Lord Nityānanda; *eka*—one; *bhṛtya*—servant; *prema-dhāma*—reservoir of love; *mīnaketana*—Mīnaketana; *rāma-dāsa*—Rāmadāsa; *haya*—is; *tāñira*—his; *nāma*—name.

TRANSLATION

Lord Nityānanda Prabhu had a servant named Śrī Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa, who was a reservoir of love.

TEXT 162

āmāra ālaye aho-rātra-saṅkīrtana

tāhāte āilā teñho pāñā nimantraṇa

SYNONYMS

āmāra ālaye—at my house; *aho-rātra*—day and night; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *tāhāte*—on account of this; *āilā*—came; *teñho*—he; *pāñā nimantraṇa*—getting an invitation.

TRANSLATION

At my house there was saṅkīrtana day and night, and therefore he visited there, having been invited.

TEXT 163

mahā-prema-maya tiñho vasilā aṅgane

sakala vaiṣṇava tāñra vandilā caraṇe

SYNONYMS

mahā-prema-maya—absorbed in emotional love; *tiñho*—he; *vasilā*—sat; *aṅgane*—in the courtyard; *sakala vaiṣṇava*—all other Vaiṣṇavas; *tāñra*—his; *vandilā*—worshiped; *caraṇe*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Absorbed in emotional love, he sat in my courtyard, and all the Vaiṣṇavas bowed down at his feet.

TEXT 164

namaskāra karite, kā'ra uparete caḍe

preme kā're vaṁsī māre, kāhāke cāpaḍe

SYNONYMS

namaskāra karite—while offering obeisances, bowing down; *kā'ra*—of someone; *uparete*—on the body; *caḍe*—gets up; *preme*—in ecstatic love; *kā're*—someone; *vaṁsī*—the flute; *māre*—strikes; *kāhāke*—someone; *cāpaḍe*—slaps.

TRANSLATION

In a joyful mood of love of God he sometimes climbed upon the shoulder of someone offering obeisances, and sometimes he struck others with his flute or mildly slapped them.

TEXT 165

ye nayana dekhite aśru haya mane yāra

sei netre avicchinna vahe aśru-dhāra

SYNONYMS

ye—his; *nayana*—eyes; *dekhite*—seeing; *aśru*—tears; *haya*—appear; *mane*—from the mind; *yāra*—of someone; *sei netre*—in his eyes; *avicchinna*—continuously; *vahe*—flows; *aśru-dhāra*—a shower of tears.

TRANSLATION

When someone saw the eyes of Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa, tears would automatically flow from his own eyes, for a constant shower of tears flowed from the eyes of Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.

TEXT 166

kabhu kona aṅge dekhi pulaka-kadamba

eka aṅge jāḍya tāṅra, āra aṅge kampa

SYNONYMS

kabhu—sometimes; *kona*—some; *aṅge*—in parts of the body; *dekhi*—I see; *pulaka-kadamba*—eruptions of ecstasy like *kadamba* flowers; *eka aṅge*—in one part of the body; *jāḍya*—stunned; *tāṅra*—his; *āra aṅge*—in another limb; *kampa*—trembling.

TRANSLATION

Sometimes there were eruptions of ecstasy like kadamba flowers on some parts of his body, and sometimes one limb would be stunned while another would be trembling.

TEXT 167

nityānanda bali' yabe karena huñkāra

tāhā dekhi' lokera haya mahā-camatkāra

SYNONYMS

nityānanda—the name Nityānanda; *bali'*—saying; *yabe*—whenever; *karena huñkāra*—makes a great sound; *tāhā dekhi'*—seeing that; *lokera*—of the people; *haya*—there is; *mahā-camatkāra*—great wonder and astonishment.

TRANSLATION

Whenever he shouted aloud the name Nityānanda, the people around him were filled with great wonder and astonishment.

TEXT 168

guṇārṇava miśra nāme eka vipra ārya

śrī-mūrti-nikaṭe teñho kare sevā-kārya

SYNONYMS

guṇārṇava miśra—of Guṇārṇava Miśra; *nāme*—by the name; *eka*—one; *vipra*—*brāhmaṇa*; *ārya*—very respectable; *śrī-mūrti-nikaṭe*—by the side of the Deity; *teñho*—he; *kare*—does; *sevā-kārya*—activities in devotion.

TRANSLATION

One respectable brāhmaṇa named Śrī Guṇārṇava Mīśra was serving the Deity.

TEXT 169

aṅgane āsiyā teṅho nā kaila sambhāṣa

tāhā dekhi' kruddha hañā bale rāmadāsa

SYNONYMS

aṅgane—to the courtyard; *āsiyā*—coming; *teṅho*—he; *nā*—not; *kaila*—did; *sambhāṣa*—address; *tāhā dekhi'*—seeing this; *kruddha hañā*—becoming angry; *bale*—says; *rāma-dāsa*—Śrī Rāmadāsa.

TRANSLATION

When Mīnaketana was seated in the yard, this brāhmaṇa did not offer him respect. Seeing this, Śrī Rāmadāsa became angry and spoke.

TEXT 170

'ei ta' dvitīya sūta romaharaṣaṇa

baladeva dekhi' ye nā kaila pratyudgama'

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—this; *dvitīya*—second; *sūta romaharaṣaṇa*—Romaharaṣaṇa-sūta; *baladeva dekhi'*—seeing Lord Balarāma; *ye*—who; *nā*—not; *kaila*—did; *pratyudgama*—stand up.

TRANSLATION

“Here I find the second Romaharṣaṇa-sūta, who did not stand to show honor when he saw Lord Balarāma.”

TEXT 171

eta bali' nāce gāya, karaye santoṣa

kṛṣṇa-kārya kare vipra—nā karīla roṣa

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *nāce*—he dances; *gāya*—chants; *karaye santoṣa*—becomes satisfied; *kṛṣṇa-kārya*—the duties of Deity worship; *kare*—performs; *vipra*—the *brāhmaṇa*; *nā karīla*—did not become; *roṣa*—angry.

TRANSLATION

After saying this, he danced and sang to his heart's content, but the *brāhmaṇa* did not become angry, for he was then serving Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa was a great devotee of Lord Nityānanda. When he entered the house of Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja, Guṇārṇava Miśra, the priest who was worshiping the Deity installed in the house, did not receive him very well. A similar event occurred when Romaharṣaṇa-sūta was speaking to the great assembly of sages at Naimiṣāraṇya. Lord Baladeva entered that great assembly, but since Romaharṣaṇa-sūta was on the *vyāsāsana*, he did not get down to offer respect to Lord Baladeva. The behavior of Guṇārṇava Miśra indicated that he had no great respect for Lord Nityānanda, and this idea was not at all palatable to Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa. For this reason the mentality of Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa is never deprecated by devotees.

TEXT 172

utsavānte gelā tīṇho kariyā prasāda

mora bhrātā-sane tāṇra kichu haila vāda

SYNONYMS

utsava-ante—after the festival; *gelā*—went away; *tīṇho*—he; *kariyā prasāda*—showing mercy; *mora*—of me; *bhrātā-sane*—with the brother; *tāṇra*—of him; *kichu*—some; *haila*—there was; *vāda*—controversy.

TRANSLATION

At the end of the festival Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa went away, offering his blessings to everyone. At that time he had some controversy with my brother.

TEXT 173

caitanya-prabhute tāṇra sudṛḍha viśvāsa

nityānanda-prati tāṇra viśvāsa-ābhāsa

SYNONYMS

caitanya-prabhute—unto Lord Caitanya; *tāṇra*—his; *su-dṛḍha*—fixed; *viśvāsa*—faith; *nityānanda-prati*—unto Lord Nityānanda; *tāṇra*—his; *viśvāsa-ābhāsa*—dim reflection of faith.

TRANSLATION

My brother had firm faith in Lord Caitanya but only a dim glimmer of faith in Lord Nityānanda.

TEXT 174

ihā jāni' rāmadāsera duḥkha ha-ila mane

tabe ta' bhrātāre āmi karinu bhartsane

SYNONYMS

ihā—this; *jāni'*—knowing; *rāma-dāsera*—of the saint Rāmadāsa; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *ha-ila*—there was; *mane*—in the mind; *tabe*—at that time; *ta'*—certainly; *bhrātāre*—to my brother; *āmi*—I; *karinu*—did; *bhartsane*—chastisement.

TRANSLATION

Knowing this, Śrī Rāmadāsa felt unhappy in his mind. I then rebuked my brother.

TEXT 175

dui bhāi eka-tanu—samāna-prakāśa

nityānanda nā māna, tomāra habe sarva-nāśa

SYNONYMS

dui bhāi—two brothers; *eka-tanu*—one body; *samāna-prakāśa*—equal manifestation; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *nā māne*—you do not believe; *tomāra*—your; *habe*—that will be; *sarva-nāśa*—downfall.

TRANSLATION

“These two brothers,” I told him, “are like one body; They are identical manifestations. If you do not believe in Lord Nityānanda, you will fall down.”

TEXT 176

ekete viśvāsa, anye nā kara sammāna

“ardha-kukkuṭi-nyāya” tomāra pramāṇa

SYNONYMS

ekete viśvāsa—faith in one; *anye*—in the other; *nā*—not; *kara*—do; *sammāna*—respect; *ardha-kukkuṭi-nyāya*—the logic of accepting half of a hen; *tomāra*—your; *pramāṇa*—evidence.

TRANSLATION

“If you have faith in one but disrespect the other, your logic is like the logic of accepting half a hen.

TEXT 177

kimvā, donhā nā māniñā hao ta’ pāṣaṇḍa

eke māni’ āre nā māni,——ei-mata bhaṇḍa

SYNONYMS

kimvā—otherwise; *donhā*—both of Them; *nā*—not; *māniñā*—accepting; *hao*—you become; *ta’*—certainly; *pāṣaṇḍa*—atheist; *eke*—one of Them; *māni’*—accepting; *āre*—the other; *nā māni*—not accepting; *ei-mata*—this kind of faith; *bhaṇḍa*—hypocrisy.

TRANSLATION

“It would be better to be an atheist by slighting both brothers than a hypocrite by believing in one and slighting the other.”

TEXT 178

kruddha haiyā vaṁsī bhāṅgi' cale rāmadāsa

tat-kāle āmāra bhrātāra haila sarva-nāśa

SYNONYMS

kruddha haiyā—being very angry; *vaṁsī*—the flute; *bhāṅgi'*—breaking; *cale*—departs; *rāma-dāsa*—Rāmadāsa; *tat-kāle*—at that time; *āmāra*—my; *bhrātāra*—of the brother; *haila*—there was; *sarva-nāśa*—downfall.

TRANSLATION

Thus Śrī Rāmadāsa broke his flute in anger and went away, and at that time my brother fell down.

TEXT 179

ei ta' kahila tāñra sevaka-prabhāva

āra eka kahi tāñra dayāra svabhāva

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—thus; *kahila*—explained; *tāñra*—of Him; *sevaka-prabhāva*—the power of the servant; *āra*—other; *eka*—one; *kahi*—I say; *tāñra*—His; *dayāra*—of mercy; *svabhāva*—characteristic.

TRANSLATION

I have thus described the power of the servants of Lord Nityānanda. Now I shall describe another characteristic of His mercy.

TEXT 180

bhāike bhartsinu muñi, lañā ei guṇa

sei rātre prabhu more dilā daraśana

SYNONYMS

bhāike—my brother; *bhartsinu*—chastised; *muñi*—I; *lañā*—taking; *ei*—this; *guṇa*—as a good quality; *sei rātre*—on that night; *prabhu*—my Lord; *more*—unto me; *dilā*—gave; *daraśana*—appearance.

TRANSLATION

That night Lord Nityānanda appeared to me in a dream because of my good quality in chastising my brother.

TEXT 181

naiḥāṭi-nikaṭe 'jhāmaṭapura' nāme grāma

tānhā swapne dekhā dilā nityānanda-rāma

SYNONYMS

naiḥāṭi-nikaṭe—near the village Naiḥāṭi; *jhāmaṭapura*—Jhāmaṭapura; *nāme*—by the name; *grāma*—village; *tānhā*—there; *swapne*—in a dream; *dekhā*—appearance; *dilā*—gave; *nityānanda-rāma*—Lord Nityānanda Balarāma.

TRANSLATION

In the village of Jhāmaṭapura, which is near Naiḥāṭi, Lord Nityānanda appeared to me in a dream.

PURPORT

There is now a railway line to Jhāmaṭapura. If one wants to go there, he can take a train on the Katwa railway line and go directly to the station known as Sālāra. From that station one can go directly to Jhāmaṭapura.

TEXT 182

daṇḍavat haiyā āmi paḍinu pāyete

nija-pāda-padma prabhu dilā mora māthe

SYNONYMS

daṇḍavat haiyā—offering obeisances; *āmi*—I; *paḍinu*—fell down; *pāyete*—at His lotus feet; *nija-pāda-padma*—His own lotus feet; *prabhu*—the Lord; *dilā*—placed; *mora*—my; *māthe*—on the head.

TRANSLATION

I fell at His feet, offering my obeisances, and He then placed His own lotus feet upon my head.

TEXT 183

‘uṭha’, ‘uṭha’ bali’ more bale bāra bāra

uṭhi’ tānra rūpa dekhi’ hainu camatkāra

SYNONYMS

uṭha uṭha—get up, get up; *bali’*—saying; *more*—unto me; *bale*—says; *bāra bāra*—again and again; *uṭhi’*—getting up; *tānra*—His; *rūpa dekhi’*—seeing the beauty; *hainu*—became; *camatkāra*—astonished.

TRANSLATION

“Arise! Get up!” He told me again and again. Upon rising, I was greatly astonished to see His beauty.

TEXT 184

śyāma-cikkaṇa kānti, prakāṇḍa śarīra

sākṣāt kandarpa, yaiche mahā-malla-vīra

SYNONYMS

śyāma—blackish; *cikkaṇa*—glossy; *kānti*—luster; *prakāṇḍa*—heavy; *śarīra*—body; *sākṣāt*—directly; *kandarpa*—Cupid; *yaiche*—like; *mahā-malla*—very stout and strong; *vīra*—hero.

TRANSLATION

He had a glossy blackish complexion, and His tall, strong, heroic stature made Him seem like Cupid himself.

TEXT 185

suvalita hasta, pada, kamala-nayāna

paṭṭa-vastra śīre, paṭṭa-vastra paridhāna

SYNONYMS

suvalita—well-formed; *hasta*—hands; *pada*—legs; *kamala-nayāna*—eyes like lotus flowers; *paṭṭa-vastra*—silk cloth; *śīre*—on the head; *paṭṭa-vastra*—silk garments; *paridhāna*—wearing.

TRANSLATION

He had beautifully formed hands, arms and legs, and eyes like lotus

flowers. He wore a silk cloth, with a silk turban on His head.

TEXT 186

suvarṇa-kuṇḍala karṇe, svarṇāṅgada-vālā

pāyete nūpura bāje, kaṇṭhe puṣpa-mālā

SYNONYMS

suvarṇa-kuṇḍala—gold earrings; *karṇe*—on the ears; *svarṇa-aṅgada*—golden armlets; *vālā*—and bangles; *pāyete*—on the feet; *nūpura*—ankle bells; *bāje*—tinkle; *kaṇṭhe*—on the neck; *puṣpa-mālā*—flower garland.

TRANSLATION

He wore golden earrings on His ears, and golden armlets and bangles. He wore tinkling anklets on His feet and a garland of flowers around His neck.

TEXT 187

candana-lepita-aṅga, tilaka suṭhāma

matta-gaja jini' mada-manthara payāna

SYNONYMS

candana—with sandalwood pulp; *lepita*—smeared; *aṅga*—body; *tilaka suṭhāma*—nicely decorated with *tilaka*; *matta-gaja*—a mad elephant; *jini'*—surpassing; *mada-manthara*—maddened by drinking; *payāna*—movement.

TRANSLATION

His body was anointed with sandalwood pulp, and He was nicely decorated with tilaka. His movements surpassed those of a maddened elephant.

TEXT 188

koṭi-candra jini' mukha ujjvala-varaṇa

dāḍimba-bīja-sama danta tāmbūla-carvaṇa

SYNONYMS

koṭi-candra—millions upon millions of moons; *jini'*—surpassing; *mukha*—face; *ujjvala-varaṇa*—bright and brilliant; *dāḍimba-bīja*—pomegranate seeds; *sama*—like; *danta*—teeth; *tāmbūla-carvaṇa*—chewing betel nut.

TRANSLATION

His face was more beautiful than millions upon millions of moons, and His teeth were like pomegranate seeds because of His chewing betel.

TEXT 189

preme matta aṅga ḍāhine-vāme dole

'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' baliyā gambhīra bola bale

SYNONYMS

preme—in ecstasy; *matta*—absorbed; *aṅga*—the whole body; *ḍāhine*—to the right side; *vāme*—to the left side; *dole*—moves; *kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa; *baliyā*—saying; *gambhīra*—deep; *bola*—words; *bale*—was uttering.

TRANSLATION

His body moved to and fro, right and left, for He was absorbed in ecstasy.
He chanted “Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa” in a deep voice.

TEXT 190

rāṅgā-yaṣṭi haste dole yena matta simha

cāri-pāśe veḍi āche caraṇete bhṛṅga

SYNONYMS

rāṅgā-yaṣṭi—a red stick; *haste*—in the hand; *dole*—moves; *yena*—like; *matta*—mad; *simha*—lion; *cāri-pāśe*—all around; *veḍi*—surrounding; *āche*—there is; *caraṇete*—at the lotus feet; *bhṛṅga*—bumblebees.

TRANSLATION

His red stick moving in His hand, He seemed like a maddened lion. All around the four sides of His feet were bumblebees.

TEXT 191

pāriṣada-gaṇe dekhi' saba gopa-veśe

'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' kahe sabe saprema āveśe

SYNONYMS

pāriṣada-gaṇe—associates; *dekhi'*—seeing; *saba*—all; *gopa-veśe*—in the dress of cowherd boys; *kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa; *kahe*—says; *sabe*—all; *sa-prema*—of ecstatic love; *āveśe*—in absorption.

TRANSLATION

His devotees, dressed like cowherd boys, surrounded His feet like so many bees and also chanted “Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa,” absorbed in ecstatic love.

TEXT 192

śīṅgā vāṁśī bājāya keha, keha nāce gāya

sevaka yogāya tāmbūla, cāmara dhulāya

SYNONYMS

śīṅgā vāṁśī—horns and flutes; *bājāya*—play; *keha*—some; *keha*—some of them; *nāce*—dance; *gāya*—sing; *sevaka*—a servant; *yogāya*—supplies; *tāmbūla*—betel nut; *cāmara*—fan; *dhulāya*—moves.

TRANSLATION

Some of them played horns and flutes, and others danced and sang. Some of them offered betel nuts, and others waved cāmara fans about Him.

TEXT 193

nityānanda-svarūpera dekhiyā vaibhava

kibā rūpa, guṇa, līlā—alaukika saba

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-svarūpera—of Lord Nityānanda Svarūpa; *dekhiyā*—seeing; *vaibhava*—the opulence; *kibā rūpa*—what a wonderful form; *guṇa*—qualities; *līlā*—pastimes; *alaukika*—uncommon; *saba*—all.

TRANSLATION

Thus I saw such opulence in Lord Nityānanda Svarūpa. His wonderful

form, qualities and pastimes are all transcendental.

TEXT 194

ānande vihvala āmi, kichu nāhi jāni

tabe hāsi' prabhu more kahilena vāṇī

SYNONYMS

ānande—in transcendental ecstasy; *vihvala*—overwhelmed; *āmi*—I; *kichu*—anything; *nāhi*—not; *jāni*—know; *tabe*—at that time; *hāsi'*—smiling; *prabhu*—the Lord; *more*—unto me; *kahilena*—says; *vāṇī*—some words.

TRANSLATION

I was overwhelmed with transcendental ecstasy, not knowing anything else. Then Lord Nityānanda smiled and spoke to me as follows.

TEXT 195

āre āre kṛṣṇadāsa, nā karaha bhaya

vṛndāvane yāha, — — tānhā sarva labhya haya

SYNONYMS

āre āre—O! O!; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa; *nā*—not; *karaha*—make; *bhaya*—fear; *vṛndāvane yāha*—go to Vṛndāvana; *tānhā*—there; *sarva*—everything; *labhya*—available; *haya*—is.

TRANSLATION

“O my dear Kṛṣṇadāsa, do not be afraid. Go to Vṛndāvana, for there you

will attain all things.”

TEXT 196

eta bali’ prerilā more hātasāni diyā

antardhāna kaila prabhu nija-gaṇa lañā

SYNONYMS

eta bali’—saying this; *prerilā*—dispatched; *more*—me; *hātasāni*—indication of the hand; *diyā*—giving; *antardhāna kaila*—disappeared; *prabhu*—my Lord; *nija-gaṇa lañā*—taking His personal associates.

TRANSLATION

After saying this, He directed me toward Vṛndāvana by waving His hand. Then He disappeared with His associates.

TEXT 197

mūrcchita ha-iyā muñi paḍinu bhūmite

svapna-bhaṅga haila, dekhi, hañāche prabhāte

SYNONYMS

mūrcchita ha-iyā—fainting; *muñi*—I; *paḍinu*—fell; *bhūmite*—on the ground; *svapna-bhaṅga*—breaking of the dream; *haila*—there was; *dekhi*—I saw; *hañāche*—there was; *prabhāte*—morning light.

TRANSLATION

I fainted and fell to the ground, my dream broke, and when I regained consciousness I saw that morning had come.

TEXT 198

ki dekhinu ki śuninu, kariye vicāra

prabhu-ājñā haila vṛndāvana yāibāra

SYNONYMS

ki dekhinu—what did I see; *ki śuninu*—what did I hear; *kariye vicāra*—I began to consider; *prabhu-ājñā*—the order of my Lord; *haila*—there was; *vṛndāvana*—to Vṛndāvana; *yāibāra*—to go.

TRANSLATION

I thought about what I had seen and heard and concluded that the Lord had ordered me to proceed to Vṛndāvana at once.

TEXT 199

sei kṣaṇe vṛndāvane karinu gamana

prabhura kṛpāte sukhe āinu vṛndāvana

SYNONYMS

sei kṣaṇe—that very second; *vṛndāvane*—toward Vṛndāvana; *karinu*—I did; *gamana*—starting; *prabhura kṛpāte*—by the mercy of Lord Nityānanda; *sukhe*—in great happiness; *āinu*—arrived; *vṛndāvana*—at Vṛndāvana.

TRANSLATION

That very second I started for Vṛndāvana, and by His mercy I reached there in great happiness.

TEXT 200

jaya jaya nityānanda, nityānanda-rāma

yāñhāra kṛpāte pāinu vṛndāvana-dhāma

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda; *nityānanda-rāma*—to Lord Balarāma, who appeared as Nityānanda; *yāñhāra kṛpāte*—by whose mercy; *pāinu*—I got; *vṛndāvana-dhāma*—shelter at Vṛndāvana.

TRANSLATION

All glory, all glory to Lord Nityānanda Balarāma, by whose mercy I have attained shelter in the transcendental abode of Vṛndāvana!

TEXT 201

jaya jaya nityānanda, jaya kṛpā-maya

yāñhā haite pāinu rūpa-sanātanaśraya

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda; *jaya kṛpā-maya*—all glories to the most merciful Lord; *yāñhā haite*—from whom; *pāinu*—I got; *rūpa-sanātana-śraya*—shelter at the lotus feet of Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

All glory, all glory to the merciful Lord Nityānanda, by whose mercy I have attained shelter at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Sanātana!

TEXT 202

yāñhā haite pāinu raghunātha-mahāśaya

yāñhā haite pāinu śrī-svarūpa-āśraya

SYNONYMS

yāñhā haite—from whom; *pāinu*—I got; *raghunātha-mahā-āśaya*—the shelter of Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *yāñhā haite*—from whom; *pāinu*—I got; *śrī-svarūpa-āśraya*—shelter at the feet of Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

By His mercy I have attained the shelter of the great personality Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, and by His mercy I have found the refuge of Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara.

PURPORT

Anyone desiring to become expert in the service of Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa should always aspire to be under the guidance of Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī, Rūpa Gosvāmī, Sanātana Gosvāmī and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. To come under the protection of the Gosvāmīs, one must get the mercy and grace of Nityānanda Prabhu. The author has tried to explain this fact in these two verses.

TEXT 203

sanātana-kṛpāya pāinu bhaktira siddhānta

śrī-rūpa-kṛpāya pāinu bhakti-rasa-prānta

SYNONYMS

sanātana-kṛpāya—by the mercy of Sanātana Gosvāmī; *pāīnu*—I got; *bhaktira siddhānta*—the conclusions of devotional service; *śrī-rūpa-kṛpāya*—by the mercy of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *pāīnu*—I got; *bhakti-rasa-prānta*—the limit of the mellows of devotional service.

TRANSLATION

By the mercy of Sanātana Gosvāmī I have learned the final conclusions of devotional service, and by the grace of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī I have tasted the highest nectar of devotional service.

PURPORT

Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī Prabhu, the teacher of the science of devotional service, wrote several books, of which the *Bṛhad-bhāgavatāmṛta* is very famous; anyone who wants to know about the subject matter of devotees, devotional service and Kṛṣṇa must read this book. Sanātana Gosvāmī also wrote a special commentary on the Tenth Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* known as the *Daśama-ṭippanī*, which is so excellent that by reading it one can understand very deeply the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa in His exchanges of loving activities. Another famous book by Sanātana Gosvāmī is the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, which states the rules and regulations for all divisions of Vaiṣṇavas, namely, Vaiṣṇava householders, Vaiṣṇava *brahmacārīs*, Vaiṣṇava *vānaprasthas* and Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsīs*. This book was especially written, however, for Vaiṣṇava householders. Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī has described Sanātana Gosvāmī in his prayer *Vilāpa-kusumāñjali*, verse six, where he has expressed his obligation to Sanātana Gosvāmī in the following words:

*vairāgya-yug-bhakti-rasaṁ prayatnair
apāyayan mām anabhīpsum andhamkṛp
āmbudhir yaḥ para-duḥkha-duḥkhī
sanātanas taṁ prabhum āśrayāmi*

“I was unwilling to drink the nectar of devotional service possessed of

renunciation, but Sanātana Gosvāmī, out of his causeless mercy, made me drink it, even though I was otherwise unable to do so. Therefore he is an ocean of mercy. He is very compassionate to fallen souls like me, and thus it is my duty to offer my respectful obeisances unto his lotus feet.”

Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī also, in the last section of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, specifically mentions the names of Rūpa Gosvāmī, Sanātana Gosvāmī and Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī and offers his respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of these three spiritual masters, as well as Raghunātha dāsa. Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī also accepted Sanātana Gosvāmī as the teacher of the science of devotional service. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī is described as the *bhakti-rasācārya*, or one who knows the essence of devotional service. His famous book *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* is the science of devotional service, and by reading this book one can understand the meaning of devotional service. Another of his famous books is the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*. In this book he elaborately explains the loving affairs and transcendental activities of Lord Kṛṣṇa and Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 204

jaya jaya nityānanda-caraṇāravinda

yānhā haite pāinu śrī-rādhā-govinda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories to; *nityānanda*—of Lord Nityānanda; *caraṇa-aravinda*—the lotus feet; *yānhā haite*—from whom; *pāinu*—I got; *śrī-rādhā-govinda*—the shelter of Śrī Rādhā and Govinda.

TRANSLATION

All glory, all glory to the lotus feet of Lord Nityānanda, by whose mercy I have attained Śrī Rādhā-Govinda!

PURPORT

Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura, who is famous for his poetic composition known as *Prārthanā*, has lamented in one of his prayers, “When will Lord Nityānanda be merciful upon me so that I will forget all material desires?” Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura confirms that unless one is freed from material desires to satisfy the needs of the body and senses, one cannot understand the transcendental abode of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Vṛndāvana. He also confirms that one cannot understand the loving affairs of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa without going through the direction of the six Gosvāmīs. In another verse Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura has stated that without the causeless mercy of Nityānanda Prabhu, one cannot enter into the affairs of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 205

jagāi mādhai haite muñi se pāpiṣṭha

purīṣera kīṭa haite muñi se laghiṣṭha

SYNONYMS

jagāi mādhai—the two brothers Jagāi and Mādhai; *haite*—than; *muñi*—I; *se*—that; *pāpiṣṭha*—more sinful; *purīṣera*—in stool; *kīṭa*—the worms; *haite*—than; *muñi*—I am; *se*—that; *laghiṣṭha*—lower.

TRANSLATION

I am more sinful than Jagāi and Mādhai and even lower than the worms in the stool.

TEXT 206

mora nāma śune yei tāra puṇya kṣaya

mora nāma laya yei tāra pāpa haya

SYNONYMS

mora nāma—my name; *śune*—hears; *yei*—anyone who; *tāra*—his; *punya kṣaya*—destruction of piety; *mora nāma*—my name; *laya*—takes; *yei*—anyone; *tāra*—his; *pāpa*—sin; *haya*—is.

TRANSLATION

Anyone who hears my name loses the results of his pious activities.
Anyone who utters my name becomes sinful.

TEXT 207

emana nirghṛṇa more kebā kṛpā kare

eka nityānanda vinu jagat bhitare

SYNONYMS

emana—such; *nirghṛṇa*—abominable; *more*—unto me; *kebā*—who; *kṛpā*—mercy; *kare*—shows; *eka*—one; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *vinu*—but; *jagat*—world; *bhitare*—within.

TRANSLATION

Who in this world but Nityānanda could show His mercy to such an abominable person as me?

TEXT 208

preme matta nityānanda kṛpā-avatāra

uttama, adhama, kichu nā kare vicāra

SYNONYMS

preme—in ecstatic love; *matta*—mad; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *kṛpā*—merciful; *avatāra*—incarnation; *uttama*—good; *adhama*—bad; *kichu*—any; *nā*—not; *kare*—makes; *vicāra*—consideration.

TRANSLATION

Because He is intoxicated by ecstatic love and is an incarnation of mercy, He does not distinguish between the good and the bad.

TEXT 209

ye āge paḍaye, tāre karaye nistāra

ataeva nistārīlā mo-hena durācāra

SYNONYMS

ye—whoever; *āge*—in front; *paḍaye*—falls down; *tāre*—unto him; *karaye*—does; *nistāra*—deliverance; *ataeva*—therefore; *nistārīlā*—delivered; *mo*—as me; *hena*—such; *durācāra*—sinful and fallen person.

TRANSLATION

He delivers all those who fall down before Him. Therefore He has delivered such a sinful and fallen person as me.

TEXT 210

mo-pāpiṣṭhe ānilena śrī-vṛndāvana

mo-hena adhame dilā śrī-rūpa-caraṇa

SYNONYMS

mo-pāpiṣṭhe—unto me, who am so sinful; *ānilena*—He brought; *śrī-*

vṛndāvana—to Vṛndāvana; *mo-hena*—such as me; *adhame*—to the lowest of mankind; *dilā*—delivered; *śrī-rūpa-caraṇa*—the lotus feet of Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Although I am sinful and I am the most fallen, He has conferred upon me the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 211

śrī-madana-gopāla-śrī-govinda-daraśana

kahibāra yogya nahe e-saba kathana

SYNONYMS

śrī-madana-gopāla—Lord Madana Gopāla; *śrī-govinda*—Lord Rādhā-Govinda; *daraśana*—visiting; *kahibāra*—to speak; *yogya*—fit; *nahe*—not; *e-saba kathana*—all these confidential words.

TRANSLATION

I am not fit to speak all these confidential words about my visiting Lord Madana Gopāla and Lord Govinda.

TEXT 212

vṛndāvana-purandara śrī-madana-gopāla

rāsa-vilāsī sākṣāt vrajendra-kumāra

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-purandara—the chief Deity of Vṛndāvana; *śrī-madana-*

gopāla—Lord Madana Gopāla; *rāsa-vilāsi*—the enjoyer of the *rāsa* dance; *sākṣāt*—directly; *vrajendra-kumāra*—the son of Nanda Mahārāja.

TRANSLATION

Lord Madana Gopāla, the chief Deity of Vṛndāvana, is the enjoyer of the *rāsa* dance and is directly the son of the King of Vraja.

TEXT 213

śrī-rādhā-lalitā-saṅge rāsa-vilāsa

manmatha-manmatha-rūpe yāñhāra prakāśa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rādhā—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *lalitā*—Her personal associate named Lalitā; *saṅge*—with; *rāsa-vilāsa*—enjoyment of the *rāsa* dance; *manmatha*—of Cupid; *manmatha-rūpe*—in the form of Cupid; *yāñhāra*—of whom; *prakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

He enjoys the *rāsa* dance with Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, Śrī Lalitā and others.
He manifests Himself as the Cupid of Cupids.

TEXT 214

tāsām āvirabhūc chauriḥ

smayamāna-mukhāmbujaḥ

pītāmbara-dharaḥ sragvī

sākṣān manmatha-manmathaḥ

SYNONYMS

tāsām—among them; *āvirabhūt*—appeared; *śauriḥ*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *smayamāna*—smiling; *mukha-ambujaḥ*—lotus face; *pīta-ambara-dharaḥ*—dressed with yellow garments; *sragvī*—decorated with a flower garland; *sākṣāt*—directly; *manmatha*—of Cupid; *manmathaḥ*—Cupid.

TRANSLATION

“Wearing yellow garments and decorated with a flower garland, Lord Kṛṣṇa, appearing among the gopīs with His smiling lotus face, looked directly like the charmer of the heart of Cupid.”

PURPORT

This is a quotation from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.32.2).

TEXT 215

sva-mādhurye lokera mana kare ākarṣaṇa

dui pāśe rādhā lalitā kareṇa sevana

SYNONYMS

sva-mādhurye—in His own sweetness; *lokera*—of all people; *mana*—the minds; *kare*—does; *ākarṣaṇa*—attracting; *dui pāśe*—on two sides; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *lalitā*—and Her associate Lalitā; *kareṇa*—do; *sevana*—service.

TRANSLATION

With Rādhā and Lalitā serving Him on His two sides, He attracts the hearts of all by His own sweetness.

TEXT 216

nityānanda-dayā more tāñre dekhāila

śrī-rādhā-madana-mohane prabhu kari' dila

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-dayā—the mercy of Lord Nityānanda; *more*—unto me; *tāñre*—Madana-mohana; *dekhāila*—showed; *śrī-rādhā-madana-mohane*—Rādhā-Madana-mohana; *prabhu kari' dila*—gave as my Lord and master.

TRANSLATION

The mercy of Lord Nityānanda showed me Śrī Madana-mohana and gave me Śrī Madana-mohana as my Lord and master.

TEXT 217

mo-adhame dila śrī-govinda daraśana

kahibāra kathā nahe akathya-kathana

SYNONYMS

mo-adhame—to one as abominable as me; *dila*—delivered; *śrī-govinda daraśana*—the audience of Lord Śrī Govinda; *kahibāra*—to speak this; *kathā*—words; *nahe*—there are not; *akathya*—unspeakable; *kathana*—narration.

TRANSLATION

He granted to one as low as me the sight of Lord Govinda. Words cannot describe this, nor is it fit to be disclosed.

TEXTS 218–219

vṛndāvane yoga-pīṭhe kalpa-taru-vane

ratna-maṇḍapa, tāhe ratna-simhāsane

śrī-govinda vasiyāchena vrajendra-nandana

mādhurya prakāśi'arena jagat mohana

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvane—at Vṛndāvana; *yoga-pīṭhe*—at the principal temple; *kalpa-taru-vane*—in the forest of desire trees; *ratna-maṇḍapa*—an altar made of gems; *tāhe*—upon it; *ratna-simha-āsane*—on the throne of gems; *śrī-govinda*—Lord Govinda; *vasiyāchena*—was sitting; *vrajendra-nandana*—the son of Nanda Mahārāja; *mādhurya prakāśi'*—manifesting His sweetness; *karena*—does; *jagat mohana*—enchantment of the whole world.

TRANSLATION

On an altar made of gems in the principal temple of Vṛndāvana, amidst a forest of desire trees, Lord Govinda, the son of the King of Vraja, sits upon a throne of gems and manifests His full glory and sweetness, thus enchanting the entire world.

TEXT 220

vāma-pārśve śrī-rādhikā sakhī-gaṇa-saṅge

rāsādika-līlā prabhu kare kata raṅge

SYNONYMS

vāma-pārsve—on the left side; *śrī-rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *sakhī-gaṇa-saṅge*—with Her personal friends; *rāsa-ādikā-līlā*—pastimes like the *rāsa* dance; *prabhu*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kare*—performs; *kata raṅge*—in many ways.

TRANSLATION

By His left side is Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī and Her personal friends. With them Lord Govinda enjoys the *rāsa-līlā* and many other pastimes.

TEXT 221

yāñra dhyāna nija-loke kare padmāsana

aṣṭādaśākṣara-mantre kare upāsana

SYNONYMS

yāñra—of whom; *dhyāna*—the meditation; *nija-loke*—in his own abode; *kare*—does; *padma-āsana*—Lord Brahmā; *aṣṭādaśa-akṣara-mantre*—by the hymn composed of eighteen letters; *kare*—does; *upāsana*—worshipping.

TRANSLATION

Lord Brahmā, sitting on his lotus seat in his own abode, always meditates on Him and worships Him with the mantra consisting of eighteen syllables.

PURPORT

In his own planet, Lord Brahmā, with the inhabitants of that planet, worships the form of Lord Govinda, Kṛṣṇa, by the *mantra* of eighteen syllables, *klīm kṛṣṇāya govindāya gopī-jana-vallabhāya svāhā*. Those who are initiated by a bona fide spiritual master and who chant the Gāyatrī

mantra three times a day know this *aṣṭādaśākṣara* (eighteen-syllable) *mantra*. The inhabitants of Brahmaloka and the planets below Brahmaloka worship Lord Govinda by meditating with this *mantra*. There is no difference between meditating and chanting, but in the present age meditation is not possible on this planet. Therefore loud chanting of a *mantra* like the *mahā-mantra*, Hare Kṛṣṇa, with soft chanting of the *aṣṭādaśākṣara*, the *mantra* of eighteen syllables, is recommended.

Lord Brahmā lives in the highest planetary system, known as Brahmaloka or Satyaloka. In every planet there is a predominating deity. As the predominating deity in Satyaloka is Lord Brahmā, so in the heavenly planets Indra is the predominating deity, and on the sun, the sun-god, Vivasvān, is the predominating deity. The inhabitants and predominating deities of every planet are all recommended to worship Govinda either by meditation or by chanting.

TEXT 222

caudda-bhuvane yāñra sabe kare dhyāna

vaikuṇṭhādi-pure yāñra līlā-guṇa gāna

SYNONYMS

caudda-bhuvane—within the fourteen worlds; *yāñra*—of whom; *sabe*—all; *kare dhyāna*—perform meditation; *vaikuṇṭha-ādi-pure*—in the abodes of the Vaikuṇṭha planets; *yāñra*—of whom; *līlā-guṇa*—attributes and pastimes; *gāna*—chanting.

TRANSLATION

Everyone in the fourteen worlds meditates upon Him, and all the denizens of Vaikuṇṭha sing of His qualities and pastimes.

TEXT 223

yāñra mādthurīte kare lakṣmī ākarṣaṇa

rūpa-gosāñi kariyāchena se-rūpa varṇana

SYNONYMS

yāñra—of whom; *mādthurīte*—by the sweetness; *kare*—does; *lakṣmī*—the goddess of fortune; *ākarṣaṇa*—attraction; *rūpa-gosāñi*—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *kariyāchena*—has done; *se*—that; *rūpa*—of the beauty; *varṇana*—enunciation.

TRANSLATION

The goddess of fortune is attracted by His sweetness, which Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī has described in this way:

PURPORT

Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, in his *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, has quoted from the *Padma Purāṇa*, where it is stated that Lakṣmī-devī, the goddess of fortune, after seeing the attractive features of Lord Kṛṣṇa, was attracted to Him, and to get the favor of Lord Kṛṣṇa she engaged herself in meditation. When asked by Kṛṣṇa why she engaged in meditation with austerity, Lakṣmī-devī answered, “I want to be one of Your associates like the *gopīs* in Vṛndāvana.” Hearing this, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa replied that it was quite impossible. Lakṣmī-devī then said that she wanted to remain just like a golden line on the chest of the Lord. The Lord granted the request, and since then Lakṣmī has always been situated on the chest of Lord Kṛṣṇa as a golden line. The austerity and meditation of Lakṣmī-devī are also mentioned in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.16.36), where the Nāga-patnīs, the wives of the serpent Kāliya, in the course of their prayers to Kṛṣṇa, said that the goddess of fortune, Lakṣmī, also wanted His association as a *gopī* and desired the dust of His lotus feet.

TEXT 224

smerām bhaṅgī-traya-paricitām sāci-vistīrṇa-dṛṣṭim
vaṁsī-nyastādhara-kisālayām ujjaḥvalām candrakeṇa
govindākhyām hari-tanum itaḥ keśī-tīrthopakāṇṭhe
mā prekṣiṣṭhās tava yadi sakhe bandhu-saṅge 'sti raṅgaḥ

SYNONYMS

smerām—smiling; *bhaṅgī-traya-paricitām*—bent in three places, namely the neck, waist and knees; *sāci-vistīrṇa-dṛṣṭim*—with a broad sideways glance; *vaṁsī*—on the flute; *nyasta*—placed; *adhara*—lips; *kisālayām*—newly blossomed; *ujjaḥvalām*—very bright; *candrakeṇa*—by the moonshine; *govinda-ākhyām*—named Lord Govinda; *hari-tanum*—the transcendental body of the Lord; *itaḥ*—here; *keśī-tīrtha-upakāṇṭhe*—on the bank of the Yamunā in the neighborhood of Keśīghāṭa; *mā*—do not; *prekṣiṣṭhāḥ*—glance over; *tava*—your; *yadi*—if; *sakhe*—O dear friend; *bandhu-saṅge*—to worldly friends; *asti*—there is; *raṅgaḥ*—attachment.

TRANSLATION

“My dear friend, if you are indeed attached to your worldly friends, do not look at the smiling face of Lord Govinda as He stands on the bank of the Yamunā at Keśīghāṭa. Casting sidelong glances, He places His flute to His lips, which seem like newly blossomed twigs. His transcendental body, bending in three places, appears very bright in the moonlight.”

PURPORT

This is a verse quoted from the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (1.2.239) in connection with practical devotional service. Generally people in their conditioned life engage in the pleasure of society, friendship and love.

This so-called love is lust, not love. But people are satisfied with such a false understanding of love. Vidyāpati, a great and learned poet of Mithilā, has said that the pleasure derived from friendship, society and family life in the material world is like a drop of water, but our hearts desire pleasure like an ocean. Thus the heart is compared to a desert of material existence that requires the water of an ocean of pleasure to satisfy its dryness. If there is a drop of water in the desert, one may indeed say that it is water, but such a minute quantity of water has no value. Similarly, in this material world no one is satisfied in the dealings of society, friendship and love. Therefore if one wants to derive real pleasure within his heart, he must seek the lotus feet of Govinda. In this verse Rūpa Gosvāmī indicates that if one wants to be satisfied in the pleasure of society, friendship and love, he need not seek shelter at the lotus feet of Govinda, for if one takes shelter under His lotus feet he will forget that minute quantity of so-called pleasure. One who is not satisfied with that so-called pleasure may seek the lotus feet of Govinda, who stands on the shore of the Yamunā at Keśītīrtha, or Keśīghāṭa, in Vṛndāvana and attracts all the *gopīs* to His transcendental loving service.

TEXT 225

sākṣāt vrajendra-suta ithe nāhi āna

yebā ajñe kare tāñre pratimā-hena jñāna

SYNONYMS

sākṣāt—directly; *vrajendra-suta*—the son of Nanda Mahārāja; *ithe*—in this matter; *nāhi*—there is not; *āna*—any exception; *yebā*—whatever; *ajñe*—a foolish person; *kare*—does; *tāñre*—unto Him; *pratimā-hena*—as a statue; *jñāna*—such a consideration.

TRANSLATION

Without a doubt He is directly the son of the King of Vraja. Only a fool

considers Him a statue.

TEXT 226

sei aparādhe tāra nāhika nistāra

ghora narakete paḍe, ki baliba āra

SYNONYMS

sei aparādhe—by that offense; *tāra*—his; *nāhika*—there is not; *nistāra*—deliverance; *ghora*—terrible; *narakete*—in a hellish condition; *paḍe*—falls down; *ki baliba*—what will I say; *āra*—more.

TRANSLATION

For that offense, he cannot be liberated. Rather, he will fall into a terrible hellish condition. What more should I say?

PURPORT

In his *Bhakti-sandarbha* Jīva Gosvāmī has stated that those who are actually very serious about devotional service do not differentiate between the form of the Lord made of clay, metal, stone or wood and the original form of the Lord. In the material world a person and his photograph, picture or statue are different. But the statue of Lord Kṛṣṇa and Kṛṣṇa Himself, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, are not different, because the Lord is absolute. What we call stone, wood and metal are energies of the Supreme Lord, and energies are never separate from the energetic. As we have several times explained, no one can separate the sunshine energy from the energetic sun. Therefore material energy may appear separate from the Lord, but transcendently it is nondifferent from the Lord.

The Lord can appear anywhere and everywhere because His diverse

energies are distributed everywhere like sunshine. We should therefore understand whatever we see to be the energy of the Supreme Lord and should not differentiate between the Lord and His *arcā* form made from clay, metal, wood or paint. Even if one has not developed this consciousness, one should accept it theoretically from the instructions of the spiritual master and should worship the *arcā-mūrti*, or form of the Lord in the temple, as nondifferent from the Lord.

The *Padma Purāṇa* specifically mentions that anyone who thinks the form of the Lord in the temple to be made of wood, stone or metal is certainly in a hellish condition. Impersonalists are against the worship of the Lord's form in the temple, and there is even a group of people who pass as Hindus but condemn such worship. Their so-called acceptance of the *Vedas* has no meaning, for all the *ācāryas*, even the impersonalist Śaṅkarācārya, have recommended the worship of the transcendental form of the Lord. Impersonalists like Śaṅkarācārya recommend the worship of five forms, known as *pañcopāsanā*, which include Lord Viṣṇu. Vaiṣṇavas, however, worship the forms of Lord Viṣṇu in His varied manifestations, such as Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa, Sītā-Rāma and Rukmiṇī-Kṛṣṇa. Māyāvādīs admit that worship of the Lord's form is required in the beginning, but they think that in the end everything is impersonal. Therefore, since they are ultimately against worship of the Lord's form, Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu has described them as offenders.

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam has condemned those who think the body to be the self as *bhauma ijya-dhīḥ*. *Bhauma* means earth, and *ijya-dhīḥ* means worshiper. There are two kinds of *bhauma ijya-dhīḥ*: those who worship the land of their birth, such as nationalists, who make many sacrifices for the motherland, and those who condemn the worship of the form of the Lord. One should not worship the planet earth or land of his birth, nor should one condemn the form of the Lord, which is manifested in metal or wood for our facility. Material things are also the energy of the Supreme Lord.

TEXT 227

hena ye govinda prabhu, pāinu yāñhā haite

tāñhāra caraṇa-kṛpā ke pāre varṇite

SYNONYMS

hena—thus; *ye govinda*—this Lord Govinda; *prabhu*—master; *pāinu*—I got; *yāñhā haite*—from whom; *tāñhāra*—His; *caraṇa-kṛpā*—mercy of the lotus feet; *ke*—who; *pāre*—is able; *varṇite*—to describe.

TRANSLATION

Therefore who can describe the mercy of the lotus feet of Him [Lord Nityānanda] by whom I have attained the shelter of this Lord Govinda?

TEXT 228

vṛndāvane vaise yata vaiṣṇava-maṇḍala

kṛṣṇa-nāma-parāyaṇa, parama-maṅgala

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvane—in Vṛndāvana; *vaise*—there are; *yata*—all; *vaiṣṇava-maṇḍala*—groups of devotees; *kṛṣṇa-nāma-parāyaṇa*—addicted to the name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *parama-maṅgala*—all-auspicious.

TRANSLATION

All the groups of Vaiṣṇavas who live in Vṛndāvana are absorbed in chanting the all-auspicious name of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 229

yāñra prāṇa-dhana— —nityānanda-śrī-caitanya

rādhā-kṛṣṇa-bhakti vine nāhi jāne anya

SYNONYMS

yāñra—whose; *prāṇa-dhana*—life and soul; *nityānanda-śrī-caitanya*—Lord Nityānanda and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *rādhā-kṛṣṇa*—to Kṛṣṇa and Rādhārāṇī; *bhakti*—devotional service; *vine*—except; *nāhi jāne anya*—do not know anything else.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda are the life and soul of those Vaiṣṇavas, who do not know anything but devotional service to Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 230

se vaiṣṇavera pada-reṇu, tāra pada-chāyā

adhamere dila prabhu-nityānanda-dayā

SYNONYMS

se vaiṣṇavera—of all those Vaiṣṇavas; *pada-reṇu*—the dust of the feet; *tāra*—their; *pada-chāyā*—the shade of the feet; *adhamere*—unto this fallen soul; *dila*—gave; *prabhu-nityānanda-dayā*—the mercy of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

The dust and shade of the lotus feet of the Vaiṣṇavas have been granted to this fallen soul by the mercy of Lord Nityānanda.

TEXT 231

‘tāñhā sarva labhya haya’—prabhura vacana

sei sūtra—ei tāra kaila vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

tāñhā—at that place; *sarva*—everything; *labhya*—obtainable; *haya*—is; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *vacana*—the word; *sei sūtra*—that synopsis; *ei*—this; *tāra*—His; *kaila vivaraṇa*—has been described.

TRANSLATION

Lord Nityānanda said, “In Vṛndāvana all things are possible.” Here I have explained His brief statement in detail.

TEXT 232

se saba pāinu āmi vṛndāvane āya

sei saba labhya ei prabhura kṛpāya

SYNONYMS

se saba—all this; *pāinu*—got; *āmi*—I; *vṛndāvane*—to Vṛndāvana; *āya*—coming; *sei saba*—all this; *labhya*—obtainable; *ei*—this; *prabhura kṛpāya*—by the mercy of Lord Nityānanda.

TRANSLATION

I have attained all this by coming to Vṛndāvana, and this was made possible by the mercy of Lord Nityānanda.

PURPORT

All the inhabitants of Vṛndāvana are Vaiṣṇavas. They are all-auspicious

because somehow or other they always chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa. Even though some of them do not strictly follow the rules and regulations of devotional service, on the whole they are devotees of Kṛṣṇa and chant His name directly or indirectly. Purposely or without purpose, even when they pass on the street they are fortunate enough to exchange greetings by saying the name of Rādhā or Kṛṣṇa. Thus directly or indirectly they are auspicious.

The present city of Vṛndāvana has been established by the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas since the six Gosvāmīs went there and directed the construction of their different temples. Of all the temples in Vṛndāvana, ninety percent belong to the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava sect, the followers of the teachings of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda, and seven temples are very famous. The inhabitants of Vṛndāvana do not know anything but the worship of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. In recent years some unscrupulous so-called priests known as caste *gosvāmīs* have introduced the worship of demigods privately, but no genuine and rigid Vaiṣṇavas participate in this. Those who are serious about the Vaiṣṇava method of devotional activities do not take part in such worship of demigods.

The Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas never differentiate between Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa and Lord Caitanya. They say that since Lord Caitanya is the combined form of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, He is not different from Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. But some misled people try to prove that they are greatly elevated by saying that they like to chant the holy name of Lord Gaura instead of the names of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. Thus they purposely differentiate between Lord Caitanya and Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa. According to them, the system of *nadīyā-nāgarī*, which they have recently invented in their fertile brains, is the worship of Gaura, Lord Caitanya, but they do not like to worship Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. They put forward the argument that since Lord Caitanya Himself appeared as Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa combined, there is no necessity of worshipping Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. Such differentiation by so-called devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is considered disruptive by pure devotees. Anyone who differentiates between Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa and Gaurāṅga is to be considered a plaything in the hands of *māyā*.

There are others who are against the worship of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, thinking Him mundane. But any sect that differentiates between Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, either by worshiping Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa as distinct from Lord Caitanya or by worshiping Lord Caitanya but not Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, is in the group of *prākṛta-sahajiyās*.

Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, predicts in verses 225 and 226 that in the future those who manufacture imaginary methods of worship will gradually give up the worship of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, and although they will call themselves devotees of Lord Caitanya, they will also give up the worship of Caitanya Mahāprabhu and fall down into material activities. For the real worshipers of Lord Caitanya, the ultimate goal of life is to worship Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 233

āpanāra kathā likhi nirlajja ha-iyā

nityānanda-guṇe lekhāya unmatta kariyā

SYNONYMS

āpanāra—personal; *kathā*—description; *likhi*—I write; *nirlajja ha-iyā*—being shameless; *nityānanda-guṇe*—the attributes of Nityānanda; *lekhāya*—cause to write; *unmatta kariyā*—making like a madman.

TRANSLATION

I have described my own story without reservations. The attributes of Lord Nityānanda, making me like a madman, force me to write these things.

TEXT 234

nityānanda-prabhura guṇa-mahimā apāra

‘sahasra-vadane’ śeṣa nāhi pāya yāñra

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-prabhura—of Lord Nityānanda; *guṇa-mahimā*—glories of transcendental attributes; *apāra*—unfathomable; *sahasra-vadane*—in thousands of mouths; *śeṣa*—ultimate end; *nāhi*—does not; *pāya*—get; *yāñra*—whose.

TRANSLATION

The glories of Lord Nityānanda’s transcendental attributes are unfathomable. Even Lord Śeṣa, with His thousands of mouths, cannot find their limit.

TEXT 235

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-

līlā, Fifth Chapter, describing the glories of Lord Nityānanda Balarāma.

Chapter 6

The Glories of Śrī Advaita Ācārya

The truth of Advaita Ācārya has been described in two verses. It is said that material nature has two features, namely the material cause and the efficient cause. The efficient causal activities are caused by Mahā-Viṣṇu, and the material causal activities are caused by another form of Mahā-Viṣṇu, known as Advaita. That Advaita, the superintendent of the cosmic manifestation, has descended in the form of Advaita Ācārya to associate with Lord Caitanya. When He is addressed as the servitor of Lord Caitanya, His glories are magnified because unless one is invigorated by this mentality of servitorship one cannot understand the mellows derived from devotional service to the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 1

vande tam śrīmad-advaitā-

cāryam adbhuta-ceṣṭitam

yasya prasādād ajño 'pi

tat-svarūpaṁ nirūpayet

SYNONYMS

vande—I offer my respectful obeisances; *tam*—unto Him; *śrīmat*—with all opulences; *advaita-ācāryam*—Śrī Advaita Ācārya; *adbhuta-ceṣṭitam*—whose activities are wonderful; *yasya*—of whom; *prasādāt*—by the mercy; *ajñāḥ api*—even a foolish person; *tat-svarūpaṁ*—His characteristics; *nirūpayet*—may describe.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances to Śrī Advaita Ācārya, whose activities are all wonderful. By His mercy, even a foolish person can describe His characteristics.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-caitanya*—to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda; *jaya advaita-candra*—all glories to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—all glories to the devotees of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu! All glories to Lord Nityānanda! All glories to Advaita Ācārya! And all glories to all the devotees of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu!

TEXT 3

pañca śloke kahila śrī-nityānanda-tattva

śloka-dvaye kahi advaitācāryera mahattva

SYNONYMS

pañca śloke—in five verses; *kahila*—described; *śrī-nityānanda-tattva*—the truth of Śrī Nityānanda; *śloka-dvaye*—in two verses; *kahi*—I

describe; *advaita-ācāryera*—of Advaita Ācārya; *mahattva*—the glories.

TRANSLATION

In five verses I have described the principle of Lord Nityānanda. Then in the following two verses I describe the glories of Śrī Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 4

mahā-viṣṇur jagat-kartā

māyayā yaḥ sṛjaty adaḥ

tasyāvatāra evāyam

advaitācārya īśvaraḥ

SYNONYMS

mahā-viṣṇuḥ—Mahā-Viṣṇu, the resting place of the efficient cause; *jagat-kartā*—the creator of the cosmic world; *māyayā*—by the illusory energy; *yaḥ*—who; *sṛjati*—creates; *adaḥ*—that universe; *tasya*—His; *avatāraḥ*—incarnation; *eva*—certainly; *ayam*—this; *advaita-ācāryaḥ*—Advaita Ācārya; *īśvaraḥ*—the Supreme Lord, the resting place of the material cause.

TRANSLATION

Lord Advaita Ācārya is the incarnation of Mahā-Viṣṇu, whose main function is to create the cosmic world through the actions of māyā.

TEXT 5

advaitam hariṇādvaitād

ācāryam bhakti-śaṁsanāt

bhaktāvatāram īśam tam

advaitācāryam āśraye

SYNONYMS

advaitam—known as Advaita; *hariṇā*—with Lord Hari; *advaitāt*—from being nondifferent; *ācāryam*—known as Ācārya; *bhakti-śaṁsanāt*—from the propagation of devotional service to Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *bhakta-avatāram*—the incarnation as a devotee; *īśam*—to the Supreme Lord; *tam*—to Him; *advaita-ācāryam*—to Advaita Ācārya; *āśraye*—I surrender.

TRANSLATION

Because He is nondifferent from Hari, the Supreme Lord, He is called Advaita, and because He propagates the cult of devotion, He is called Ācārya. He is the Lord and the incarnation of the Lord's devotee. Therefore I take shelter of Him.

TEXT 6

advaita-ācārya gosāñi sākṣāt īśvara

yāñhāra mahimā nahe jīvera gocara

SYNONYMS

advaita-ācārya—Advaita Ācārya; *gosāñi*—the Lord; *sākṣāt īśvara*—directly the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *yāñhāra mahimā*—whose glories; *nahe*—not; *jīvera gocara*—within the reach of the understanding of ordinary living beings.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya is indeed directly the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself. His glory is beyond the conception of ordinary living beings.

TEXT 7

mahā-viṣṇu sṛṣṭi kareṇa jagad-ādi kārya

tāñra avatāra sākṣāt advaita ācārya

SYNONYMS

mahā-viṣṇu—the original Viṣṇu; *sṛṣṭi*—creation; *kareṇa*—does; *jagad-ādi*—the material world; *kārya*—the occupation; *tāñra*—His; *avatāra*—incarnation; *sākṣāt*—directly; *advaita ācārya*—Prabhu Advaita Ācārya.

TRANSLATION

Mahā-Viṣṇu performs all the functions for the creation of the universes. Śrī Advaita Ācārya is His direct incarnation.

TEXT 8

ye puruṣa sṛṣṭi-sthiti kareṇa māyāya

ananta brahmāṇḍa sṛṣṭi kareṇa līlāya

SYNONYMS

ye puruṣa—that personality who; *sṛṣṭi-sthiti*—creation and maintenance; *kareṇa*—performs; *māyāya*—through the external energy; *ananta brahmāṇḍa*—unlimited universes; *sṛṣṭi*—creation; *kareṇa*—does; *līlāya*—by pastimes.

TRANSLATION

That puruṣa creates and maintains with His external energy. He creates innumerable universes in His pastimes.

TEXT 9

icchāya ananta mūrti karena prakāśa

eka eka mūrte karena brahmāṇḍe praveśa

SYNONYMS

icchāya—by His will; *ananta mūrti*—unlimited forms; *karena*—does; *prakāśa*—manifestation; *eka eka*—each and every; *mūrte*—form; *karena*—does; *brahmāṇḍe*—within the universe; *praveśa*—entrance.

TRANSLATION

By His will He manifests Himself in unlimited forms, in which He enters each and every universe.

TEXT 10

se puruṣera aṁśa—advaita, nāhi kichu bheda

śarīra-viśeṣa tāṇra—nāhika viccheda

SYNONYMS

se—that; *puruṣera*—of the Lord; *aṁśa*—part; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *nāhi*—not; *kichu*—any; *bheda*—difference; *śarīra-viśeṣa*—another specific transcendental body; *tāṇra*—of Him; *nāhika viccheda*—there is no separation.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya is a plenary part of that puruṣa and so is not different from Him. Indeed, Śrī Advaita Ācārya is not separate but is another form of that puruṣa.

TEXT 11

sahāya kareṇa tāñra la-iyā ‘pradhāna’

koṭi brahmāṇḍa kareṇa icchāya nirmāṇa

SYNONYMS

sahāya kareṇa—He helps; *tāñra*—His; *la-iyā*—with; *pradhāna*—the material energy; *koṭi-brahmāṇḍa*—millions of universes; *kareṇa*—does; *icchāya*—only by the will; *nirmāṇa*—creation.

TRANSLATION

He [Advaita Ācārya] helps in the pastimes of the puruṣa, with whose material energy and by whose will He creates innumerable universes.

TEXT 12

jagat-maṅgala advaita, maṅgala-guṇa-dhāma

maṅgala-caritra sadā, ‘maṅgala’ yāñra nāma

SYNONYMS

jagat-maṅgala—all-auspicious for the world; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *maṅgala-guṇa-dhāma*—the reservoir of all auspicious attributes; *maṅgala-caritra*—all characteristics are auspicious; *sadā*—always; *maṅgala*—auspicious; *yāñra nāma*—whose name.

TRANSLATION

Being a reservoir of all auspicious attributes, Śrī Advaita Ācārya is all-auspicious for the world. His characteristics, activities and name are always auspicious.

PURPORT

Śrī Advaita Prabhu, who is an incarnation of Mahā-Viṣṇu, is an *ācārya*, or teacher. All His activities and all the other activities of Viṣṇu are auspicious. Anyone who can view the all-auspiciousness in the pastimes of Lord Viṣṇu also becomes auspicious simultaneously. Therefore, since Lord Viṣṇu is the fountainhead of auspiciousness, anyone who is attracted by the devotional service of Lord Viṣṇu can render the greatest service to human society. Rejected persons of the material world who refuse to understand pure devotional service as the eternal function of the living entities, and as actual liberation of the living being from conditioned life, become bereft of all devotional service because of their poor fund of knowledge.

In the teachings of Advaita Prabhu there is no question of fruitive activities or impersonal liberation. Bewildered by the spell of the material energy, however, persons who could not understand that Advaita Prabhu is nondifferent from Viṣṇu wanted to follow Him with their impersonal conceptions. The attempt of Advaita Prabhu to punish them is also auspicious. Lord Viṣṇu and His activities can bestow all good fortune, directly and indirectly. In other words, being favored by Lord Viṣṇu and being punished by Lord Viṣṇu are one and the same because all the activities of Viṣṇu are absolute. According to some, Maṅgala was another name of Advaita Prabhu. As the causal incarnation, or Lord Viṣṇu's incarnation for a particular occasion, He is the supply agent or ingredient in material nature. However, He is never to be considered material. All His activities are spiritual. Anyone who hears about and glorifies Him becomes glorified himself, for such activities free one from all kinds of misfortune. One should not invest any material contamination or impersonalism in the Viṣṇu form. Everyone should try to understand the real identity of Lord Viṣṇu, for by such knowledge one can attain the

highest stage of perfection.

TEXT 13

koṭi amśa, koṭi śakti, koṭi avatāra

eta lañā sṛje puruṣa sakala saṁsāra

SYNONYMS

koṭi amśa—millions of parts and parcels; *koṭi śakti*—millions and millions of energies; *koṭi avatāra*—millions upon millions of incarnations; *eta*—all this; *lañā*—taking; *sṛje*—creates; *puruṣa*—the original person, Mahā-Viṣṇu; *sakala saṁsāra*—all the material world.

TRANSLATION

Mahā-Viṣṇu creates the entire material world with millions of His parts, energies and incarnations.

TEXTS 14–15

māyā yaiche dui amśa—‘nimitta’, ‘upādāna’

māyā—‘nimitta’-hetu, upādāna—‘pradhāna’

puruṣa īśvara aiche dvi-mūrti ha-iyā

viśva-sṛṣṭi kare ‘nimitta’ ‘upādāna’ lañā

SYNONYMS

māyā—the external energy; *yaiche*—as; *dui amśa*—two parts; *nimitta*—the cause; *upādāna*—the ingredients; *māyā*—the material energy; *nimitta-hetu*—original cause; *upādāna*—ingredients; *pradhāna*—

immediate cause; *puruṣa*—the person Lord Viṣṇu; *īśvara*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *aiche*—in that way; *dvi-mūrti ha-iyā*—taking two forms; *viśva-sṛṣṭi kare*—creates this material world; *nimitta*—the original cause; *upādāna*—the material cause; *lañā*—with.

TRANSLATION

Just as the external energy consists of two parts—the efficient cause [nimitta] and the material cause [upādāna], māyā being the efficient cause and pradhāna the material cause—so Lord Viṣṇu, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, assumes two forms to create the material world with the efficient and material causes.

PURPORT

There are two kinds of research to find the original cause of creation. One conclusion is that the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the all-blissful, eternal, all knowing form, is indirectly the cause of this cosmic manifestation and directly the cause of the spiritual world, where there are innumerable spiritual planets known as Vaikuṇṭhas, as well as His personal abode, known as Goloka Vṛndāvana. In other words, there are two manifestations—the material cosmos and the spiritual world. As in the material world there are innumerable planets and universes, so in the spiritual world there are also innumerable spiritual planets and universes, including the Vaikuṇṭhas and Goloka. The Supreme Lord is the cause of both the material and spiritual worlds. The other conclusion, of course, is that this cosmic manifestation is caused by an inexplicable unmanifested void. This argument is meaningless.

The first conclusion is accepted by the Vedānta philosophers, and the second is supported by the atheistic philosophical system of the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*, which directly opposes the Vedāntic philosophical conclusion. Material scientists cannot see any cognizant spiritual substance that might be the cause of the creation. Such atheistic Sāṅkhya philosophers think that the symptoms of knowledge and living force visible in the

innumerable living creatures are caused by the three qualities of the cosmic manifestation. Therefore the Sāṅkhyites are against the conclusion of Vedānta regarding the original cause of creation.

Factually, the supreme absolute spirit soul is the cause of every kind of manifestation, and He is always complete, both as the energy and as the energetic. The cosmic manifestation is caused by the energy of the Supreme Absolute Person, in whom all energies are conserved.

Philosophers who are subjectively engaged in the cosmic manifestation can appreciate only the wonderful energies of matter. Such philosophers accept the conception of God only as a product of the material energy. According to their conclusions, the source of the energy is also a product of the energy. Such philosophers wrongly observe that the living creatures within the cosmic manifestation are caused by the material energy, and they think that the supreme absolute conscious being must similarly be a product of the material energy.

Since materialistic philosophers and scientists are too much engaged with their imperfect senses, naturally they conclude that the living force is a product of a material combination. But the actual fact is just the opposite. Matter is a product of spirit. According to the *Bhagavad-gītā*, the supreme spirit, the Personality of Godhead, is the source of all energies. When one advances in research work by studying a limited substance within the limits of space and time, one is amazed by the various wonderful cosmic manifestations, and naturally one goes on hypnotically accepting the path of research work or the inductive method. Through the deductive way of understanding, however, one accepts the Supreme Absolute Person, the Personality of Godhead, as the cause of all causes, who is full with diverse energies and who is neither impersonal nor void. The impersonal manifestation of the Supreme Person is another display of His energy. Therefore the conclusion that matter is the original cause of creation is completely different from the real truth. The material manifestation is caused by the glance of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is inconceivably potent. Material nature is electrified by the supreme authority, and the conditioned soul, within the limits of time and space, is

trapped by awe of the material manifestation. In other words, the Supreme Personality of Godhead is actually realized in the vision of a material philosopher and scientist through the manifestations of His material energy. For one who does not understand the power of the Supreme Personality of Godhead or His diverse energies because of not knowing the relationship between the source of the energies and the energies themselves, there is always a chance of error, which is known as *vivarta*. As long as materialistic scientists and philosophers do not come to the right conclusion, certainly they will hover above the material field, bereft of proper understanding of the Absolute Truth.

The great Vaiṣṇava philosopher Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa has very nicely explained the materialistic conclusion in his *Govinda-bhāṣya*, a commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra*. He writes as follows:

“The Sāṅkhya philosopher Kapila has connected the different elementary truths according to his own opinion. Material nature, according to him, consists of the equilibrium of the three material qualities—goodness, passion and ignorance. Material nature produces the material energy, known as *mahat*, and *mahat* produces the false ego. The ego produces the five objects of sense perception, which produce the ten senses (five for acquiring knowledge and five for working), the mind and the five gross elements. Counting the *puruṣa*, or the enjoyer, with these twenty-four elements, there are twenty-five different truths. The nonmanifested stage of these twenty-five elementary truths is called *prakṛti*, or material nature. The qualities of material nature can associate in three different stages, namely as the cause of happiness, the cause of distress and the cause of illusion. The quality of goodness is the cause of material happiness, the quality of passion is the cause of material distress, and the quality of ignorance is the cause of illusion. Our material experience lies within the boundaries of these three manifestations of happiness, distress and illusion. For example, a beautiful woman is certainly a cause of material happiness for one who possesses her as a wife, but the same beautiful woman is a cause of distress to a man whom she rejects or who is the cause of her anger, and if she leaves a man she becomes the cause of

illusion.

“The two kinds of senses are the ten external senses and the one internal sense, the mind. Thus there are eleven senses. According to Kapila, material nature is eternal and all-powerful. Originally there is no spirit, and matter has no cause. Matter itself is the chief cause of everything. It is the all-pervading cause of all causes. The Sāṅkhya philosophy regards the total energy (*mahat-tattva*), the false ego and the five objects of sense perception as the seven diverse manifestations of material nature, which has two features, known as the material cause and efficient cause. The *puruṣa*, the enjoyer, is without transformation, whereas material nature is always subject to transformation. But although material nature is inert, it is the cause of enjoyment and salvation for many living creatures. Its activities are beyond the conception of sense perception, but still one may guess at them by superior intelligence. Material nature is one, but because of the interaction of the three qualities, it can produce the total energy and the wonderful cosmic manifestation. Such transformations divide material nature into two features, namely the efficient and material causes. The *puruṣa*, the enjoyer, is inactive and without material qualities, although at the same time He is the master, existing separately in each and every body as the emblem of knowledge. By understanding the material cause, one can guess that the *puruṣa*, the enjoyer, being without activity, is aloof from all kinds of enjoyment or superintendence. Sāṅkhya philosophy, after describing the nature of *prakṛti* (material nature) and *puruṣa* (the enjoyer), asserts that the creation is only a product of their unification or proximity to one another. With such unification the living symptoms are visible in material nature, but one can guess that in the person of the enjoyer, the *puruṣa*, there are powers of control and enjoyment. When the *puruṣa* is illusioned for want of sufficient knowledge, He feels Himself to be the enjoyer, and when He is in full knowledge He is liberated. In the Sāṅkhya philosophy the *puruṣa* is described to be always indifferent to the activities of *prakṛti*.

“The Sāṅkhya philosopher accepts three kinds of evidences, namely direct perception, hypothesis and traditional authority. When such

evidence is complete, everything is perfect. The process of comparison is within such perfection. Beyond such evidence there is no proof. There is not much controversy regarding direct perceptual evidence or authorized traditional evidence. The Sāṅkhya system of philosophy identifies three kinds of procedures—namely, *pariṇāmāt* (transformation), *samanvayāt* (adjustment) and *śaktiṭaḥ* (performance of energies)—as the causes of the cosmic manifestation.”

Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa, in his commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra*, has tried to nullify this conclusion because he thinks that discrediting these so-called causes of the cosmic manifestation will nullify the entire Sāṅkhya philosophy. Materialistic philosophers accept matter to be the material and efficient cause of creation; for them, matter is the cause of every type of manifestation. Generally they give the example of a water pot and clay. Clay is the cause of the waterpot, but the clay can be found as both cause and effect. The waterpot is the effect and clay itself is the cause, but clay is visible everywhere. A tree is matter, but a tree produces fruit. Water is matter, but water flows. In this way, say the Sāṅkhyites, matter is the cause of movements and production. As such, matter can be considered the material and efficient cause of everything in the cosmic manifestation. Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa has therefore enunciated the nature of *pradhāna* as follows:

“Material nature is inert, and as such it cannot be the cause of matter, neither as the material nor as the efficient cause. Seeing the wonderful arrangement and management of the cosmic manifestation generally suggests that a living brain is behind this arrangement, for without a living brain such an arrangement could not exist. One should not imagine that such an arrangement can exist without conscious direction. In our practical experience we never see that inert bricks can themselves construct a big building.

“The example of the water pot cannot be accepted because a waterpot has no perception of pleasure and distress. Such perception is within. Therefore the covering body, or the waterpot, cannot be synchronized

with it.

“Sometimes the material scientist suggests that trees grow from the earth automatically, without assistance from a gardener, because that is a tendency of matter. They also consider the intuition of living creatures from birth to be material. But such material tendencies as bodily intuition cannot be accepted as independent, for they suggest the existence of a spirit soul within the body. Actually, neither the tree nor any other body of a living creature has any tendency or intuition; the tendency and intuition exist because the soul is present within the body. In this connection, the example of a car and driver may be given very profitably. The car has a tendency to turn right and left, but one cannot say that the car itself, as matter, turns right and left without the direction of a driver. A material car has neither tendencies nor intuitions independent of the intentions of the driver within the car. The same principle applies for the automatic growth of trees in the forest. The growth takes place because of the soul’s presence within the tree.

“Sometimes foolish people take it for granted that because scorpions are born from heaps of rice, the rice has produced the scorpions. The real fact, however, is that the mother scorpion lays eggs within the rice and by the proper fermentation of the rice the eggs give birth to several baby scorpions, which in due course come out. This does not mean that the rice gives birth to the scorpions. Similarly, sometimes bugs are seen to come from dirty beds. This does not mean, however, that the beds give birth to the bugs. It is the living soul that comes forth, taking advantage of the dirty condition of the bed. There are different kinds of living creatures. Some of them come from embryos, some from eggs and some from the fermentation of perspiration. Different living creatures have different sources of appearance, but one should not conclude that matter produces such living creatures.

“The example cited by materialists that trees automatically come from the earth follows the same principle. Taking advantage of a certain condition, a living entity comes from the earth. According to the *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka*

Upaniṣad, every living being is forced by divine superintendence to take a certain type of body according to his past deeds. There are many varieties of bodies, and because of a divine arrangement a living entity takes bodies of different shapes.

“When a person thinks ‘I am doing this,’ the ‘I am’ does not refer to the body. It refers to something more than the body, or within the body. As such, the body as it is has neither tendencies nor intuition; the tendencies and intuition belong to the soul within the body. Material scientists sometimes suggest that the tendencies of male and female bodies cause their union and that this is the cause of the birth of the child. But since the *puruṣa*, according to Sāṅkhya philosophy, is always unaffected, where does the tendency to give birth come from?

“Sometimes material scientists give the example that milk turns into curd automatically and that distilled water pouring from the clouds falls down to earth, produces different kinds of trees, and enters different kinds of flowers and fruits with different fragrances and tastes. Therefore, they say, matter produces varieties of material things on its own. In reply to this argument, the same proposition of the *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad*—that different kinds of living creatures are put into different kinds of bodies by the management of a superior power—is repeated. Under superior superintendence, various souls, according to their past activities, are given the chance to take a particular type of body, such as that of a tree, animal, bird or beast, and thus their different tendencies develop under these circumstances. The *Bhagavad-gītā* (13.22) also further affirms:

*puruṣaḥ prakṛti-stho hi
bhuñkte prakṛti-jān guṇān
kāraṇaṁ guṇa-saṅgo 'sya
sad-asad-yoni-janmasu*

‘The living entity in material nature thus follows the ways of life, enjoying the three modes of nature. This is due to his association with

that material nature. Thus he meets with good and evil among various species.’ The soul is given different types of bodies. For example, were souls not given varieties of tree bodies, the different varieties of fruits and flowers could not be produced. Each class of tree produces a particular kind of fruit and flower; it is not that there is no distinction between the different classes. An individual tree does not produce flowers of different colors or fruits of different tastes. There are demarcated classes, as we find them among humans, animals, birds and other species. There are innumerable living entities, and their activities, performed in the material world according to the different qualities of the material modes of nature, give them the chance to have different kinds of lives.

“Thus one should understand that *pradhāna*, matter, cannot act unless impelled by a living creature. The materialistic theory that matter independently acts cannot, therefore, be accepted. Matter is called *prakṛti*, which refers to female energy. A woman is *prakṛti*, a female. A female cannot produce a child without the association of a *puruṣa*, a man. The *puruṣa* causes the birth of a child because the man injects the soul, which is sheltered in the semen, into the womb of the woman. The woman, as the material cause, supplies the body of the soul, and as the efficient cause she gives birth to the child. But although the woman appears to be the material and efficient cause of the birth of a child, originally the *puruṣa*, the male, is the cause of the child. Similarly, this material world gives rise to varieties of manifestations due to the entrance of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu within the universe. He is present not only within the universe but within the bodies of all living creatures, as well as within the atom. We understand from the *Brahma-saṁhitā* that the Supersoul is present within the universe, within the atom and within the heart of every living creature. Therefore the theory that matter is the cause of the entire cosmic manifestation cannot be accepted by any man with sufficient knowledge of matter and spirit.

“Materialists sometimes give the argument that as straw eaten by a cow produces milk automatically, so material nature, under different circumstances, produces varieties of manifestations. Thus originally

matter is the cause. In refuting this argument, we may say that an animal of the same species as the cow—namely, the bull—also eats straw like the cow but does not produce milk. Under the circumstances, it cannot be said that straw in connection with a particular species produces milk. The conclusion should be that there is superior management, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.10), where the Lord says, *mayādhyakṣeṇa prakṛtiḥ sūyate sa-carācaram*: ‘This material nature is working under My direction, O son of Kuntī, and it is producing all moving and unmoving beings.’ The Supreme Lord says, *mayādhyakṣeṇa* (‘under My superintendence’). When He desires that the cow produce milk by eating straw, there is milk, and when He does not so desire it, the mixture of such straw cannot produce milk. If the way of material nature had been that straw produced milk, a stack of straw could also produce milk. But that is not possible. And the same straw given to a human female also cannot produce milk. That is the meaning of the *Bhagavad-gītā*’s statement that only under superior orders does anything take place. Matter itself has no power to produce independently. The conclusion, therefore, is that matter, which has no self-knowledge, cannot be the cause of the material creation. The ultimate creator is the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

“If matter were accepted as the original cause of creation, all the authorized scriptures in the world would be useless, for in every scripture, especially the Vedic scriptures like the *Manu-smṛiti*, the Supreme Personality of Godhead is said to be the ultimate creator. The *Manu-smṛiti* is considered the highest Vedic direction to humanity. Manu is the giver of law to mankind, and in the *Manu-smṛiti* it is clearly stated that before the creation the entire universal space was darkness, without information and without variety, and was in a state of complete suspension, like a dream. Everything was darkness. The Supreme Personality of Godhead then entered the universal space, and although He is invisible, He created the visible cosmic manifestation. In the material world the Supreme Personality of Godhead is not manifested by His personal presence, but the presence of the cosmic manifestation in different varieties is the proof that everything has been created under His

direction. He entered the universe with all creative potencies, and thus He removed the darkness of the unlimited space.

“The form of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is described to be transcendental, very subtle, eternal, all-pervading, inconceivable and therefore nonmanifested to the material senses of a conditioned living creature. He desired to expand Himself into many living entities, and with such a desire He first created a vast expanse of water within the universal space and then impregnated that water with living entities. By that process of impregnation a massive body appeared, blazing like a thousand suns, and in that body was the first creative principle, Brahmā. The great Parāśara Ṛṣi has confirmed this in the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*. He says that the cosmic manifestation visible to us is produced from Lord Viṣṇu and sustained under His protection. He is the principal maintainer and destroyer of the universal form.

“This cosmic manifestation is one of the diverse energies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. As a spider secretes saliva and weaves a web by its own movements but at the end winds up the web within its body, so Lord Viṣṇu produces this cosmic manifestation from His transcendental body and at the end winds it up within Himself. All the great sages of the Vedic understanding have accepted that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the original creator.

“It is sometimes claimed that the impersonal speculations of great philosophers are meant for the advancement of knowledge without religious ritualistic principles. But the religious ritualistic principles are actually meant for the advancement of spiritual knowledge. By performance of religious rituals one ultimately reaches the supreme goal of knowledge by understanding that Vāsudeva, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the cause of everything. It is clearly stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* that even those who are advocates of knowledge alone, without any religious ritualistic processes, advance in knowledge after many, many lifetimes of speculation and thus come to the conclusion that Vāsudeva is the supreme cause of everything that be. As a result of this

achievement of the goal of life, such an advanced learned scholar or philosopher surrenders unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Religious ritualistic performances are actually meant to cleanse the contaminated mind in the material world, and the special feature of this Age of Kali is that one can easily execute the process of cleansing the mind of contamination by chanting the holy names of God—Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare.

“A Vedic injunction states, *sarve vedā yat padam āmananti* (*Kaṭha Up.* 1.2.15): all Vedic knowledge is searching after the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Similarly, another Vedic injunction states, *nārāyaṇa-parā vedāḥ*: the *Vedas* are meant for understanding Nārāyaṇa, the Supreme Lord. Similarly, the *Bhagavad-gītā* also confirms, *vedaiś ca sarvair aham eva vedyah*: [Bg. 15.15] by all the *Vedas*, Kṛṣṇa is to be known. Therefore, the main purpose of understanding the *Vedas*, performing Vedic sacrifices and speculating on the *Vedānta-sūtra* is to understand Kṛṣṇa. Accepting the impersonalist view of voidness or the nonexistence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead negates all study of the *Vedas*. Impersonal speculation aims at disproving the conclusion of the *Vedas*. Therefore any impersonal speculative presentation should be understood to be against the principles of the *Vedas*, or standard scriptures. Since the speculation of the impersonalists does not follow the principles of the *Vedas*, their conclusion must be considered to be against the Vedic principles. Anything not supported by the Vedic principles must be considered imaginary and lacking in standard proof. Therefore no impersonalist explanation of any Vedic literature can be accepted.

“If one tries to nullify the conclusions of the *Vedas* by accepting an unauthorized scripture or so-called scripture, it will be very hard for him to come to the right conclusion about the Absolute Truth. The system for adjusting two contradictory scriptures is to refer to the *Vedas*, for references from the *Vedas* are accepted as final judgments. When we refer to a particular scripture, it must be authorized, and for this authority it must strictly follow the Vedic injunctions. If someone

presents an alternative doctrine he himself has manufactured, that doctrine will prove itself useless, for any doctrine that tries to prove that Vedic evidence is meaningless immediately proves itself meaningless. The followers of the *Vedas* unanimously accept the authority of Manu and Parāśara in the disciplic succession. Their statements, however, do not support the atheistic Kapila, because the Kapila mentioned in the *Vedas* is a different Kapila, the son of Kardama and Devahūti. The atheist Kapila is a descendant of the dynasty of Agni and is one of the conditioned souls. But the Kapila who is the son of Kardama Muni is accepted as an incarnation of Vāsudeva. The *Padma Purāṇa* gives evidence that the Supreme Personality of Godhead Vāsudeva takes birth in the incarnation of Kapila and, by His expansion of theistic Sāṅkhya philosophy, teaches all the demigods and a *brāhmaṇa* of the name Āsuri. In the doctrine of the atheist Kapila there are many statements directly against the Vedic principles. The atheist Kapila does not accept the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He says that the living entity is himself the Supreme Lord and that no one is greater than him. His conceptions of so-called conditioned and liberated life are materialistic, and he refuses to accept the importance of immortal time. All such statements are against the principles of the *Vedānta-sūtra*.”

TEXT 16

āpane puruṣa—visvera ‘nimitta’-kāraṇa

advaita-rūpe ‘upādāna’ hana nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

āpane—personally; *puruṣa*—Lord Viṣṇu; *visvera*—of the entire material world; *nimitta kāraṇa*—the original cause; *advaita-rūpe*—in the form of Advaita; *upādāna*—the material cause; *hana*—becomes; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

Lord Viṣṇu Himself is the efficient [nimitta] cause of the material world, and Nārāyaṇa in the form of Śrī Advaita is the material cause [upādāna].

TEXT 17

‘nimittāṁśe’ kare teṇho māyāte īkṣaṇa

‘upādāna’ advaita kareṇa brahmāṇḍa-sṛjana

SYNONYMS

nimitta-aṁśe—in the portion as the original cause; *kare*—does; *teṇho*—He; *māyāte*—in the external energy; *īkṣaṇa*—glancing; *upādāna*—the material cause; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *kareṇa*—does; *brahmāṇḍa-sṛjana*—creation of the material world.

TRANSLATION

Lord Viṣṇu, in His efficient aspect, glances over the material energy, and Śrī Advaita, as the material cause, creates the material world.

TEXT 18

yadyapi sāṅkhya māne, ‘pradhāna’——kāraṇa

jaḍa ha-ite kabhu nahe jagat-sṛjana

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *sāṅkhya*—Sāṅkhya philosophy; *māne*—accepts; *pradhāna*—ingredients; *kāraṇa*—cause; *jaḍa ha-ite*—from matter; *kabhu*—at any time; *nahe*—there is not; *jagat-sṛjana*—the creation of the material world.

TRANSLATION

Although the Sāṅkhya philosophy accepts that the material ingredients are the cause, the creation of the world never arises from dead matter.

TEXT 19

nija sṛṣṭi-śakti prabhu sañcāre pradhāne

īśvarera śaktye tabe haye ta' nirmāṇe

SYNONYMS

nija—own; *sṛṣṭi-śakti*—power for creation; *prabhu*—the Lord; *sañcāre*—infuses; *pradhāne*—in the ingredients; *īśvarera śaktye*—by the power of the Lord; *tabe*—then; *haye*—there is; *ta'*—certainly; *nirmāṇe*—the beginning of creation.

TRANSLATION

The Lord infuses the material ingredients with His own creative potency. Then, by the power of the Lord, creation takes place.

TEXT 20

advaita-rūpe kare śakti-sañcāraṇa

ataeva advaita hayena mukhya kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

advaita-rūpe—in the form of Advaita Ācārya; *kare*—does; *śakti-sañcāraṇa*—infusion of the energy; *ataeva*—therefore; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *hayena*—is; *mukhya kāraṇa*—the original cause.

TRANSLATION

In the form of Advaita He infuses the material ingredients with creative energy. Therefore, Advaita is the original cause of creation.

TEXT 21

advaita-ācārya koṭi-brahmāṇḍera kartā

āra eka eka mūrtye brahmāṇḍera bhartā

SYNONYMS

advaita-ācārya—Advaita Ācārya; *koṭi-brahmāṇḍera kartā*—the creator of millions and millions of universes; *āra*—and; *eka eka*—each and every; *mūrtye*—by expansions; *brahmāṇḍera bhartā*—maintainer of the universe.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya is the creator of millions and millions of universes, and by His expansions [as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu] He maintains each and every universe.

TEXT 22

sei nārāyaṇera mukhya aṅga,——advaita

‘aṅga’-śabde aṁśa kari’ kahe bhāgavata

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *nārāyaṇera*—of Lord Nārāyaṇa; *mukhya aṅga*—the primary part; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *aṅga-śabde*—by the word *aṅga*; *aṁśa kari’*—taking as a plenary portion; *kahe*—says; *bhāgavata*—Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita is the principal limb [aṅga] of Nārāyaṇa. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam speaks of “limb” [aṅga] as “a plenary portion” [amśa] of the Lord.

TEXT 23

nārāyaṇas tvam na hi sarva-dehinām

ātmāsy adhīśākhila-loka-sākṣī

nārāyaṇo 'ṅgam nara-bhū-jalāyanāt

tac cāpi satyam na tavaiva māyā

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇaḥ—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *tvam*—You; *na*—not; *hi*—certainly; *sarva*—all; *dehinām*—of the embodied beings; *ātmā*—the Supersoul; *asi*—You are; *adhīśa*—O Lord; *akhila-loka*—of all the worlds; *sākṣī*—the witness; *nārāyaṇaḥ*—known as Nārāyaṇa; *aṅgam*—plenary portion; *nara*—of Nara; *bhū*—born; *jala*—in the water; *ayanāt*—due to the place of refuge; *tat*—that; *ca*—and; *api*—certainly; *satyam*—highest truth; *na*—not; *tava*—Your; *eva*—at all; *māyā*—the illusory energy.

TRANSLATION

“O Lord of lords, You are the seer of all creation. You are indeed everyone’s dearest life. Are You not, therefore, my father, Nārāyaṇa? ‘Nārāyaṇa’ refers to one whose abode is in the water born from Nara [Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu], and that Nārāyaṇa is Your plenary portion. All Your plenary portions are transcendental. They are absolute and are not creations of māyā.”

PURPORT

This text is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.14.14).

TEXT 24

īśvarera ‘aṅga’ amśa—cid-ānanda-maya

māyāra sambandha nāhi’ ei śloke kaya

SYNONYMS

īśvarera—of the Lord; *aṅga*—limb; *amśa*—part; *cit-ānanda-maya*—all-spiritual; *māyāra*—of the material energy; *sambandha*—relationship; *nāhi’*—there is not; *ei śloke*—this verse; *kaya*—says.

TRANSLATION

This verse describes that the limbs and plenary portions of the Lord are all spiritual; They have no relationship with the material energy.

TEXT 25

‘amśa’ nā kahiyā, kene kaha tāñre ‘aṅga’

‘amśa’ haite ‘aṅga,’ yāte haya antaraṅga

SYNONYMS

amśa—part; *nā kahiyā*—not saying; *kene*—why; *kaha*—you say; *tāñre*—Him; *aṅga*—limb; *amśa haite*—than a part; *aṅga*—limb; *yāte*—because; *haya*—is; *antaraṅga*—more.

TRANSLATION

Why has Śrī Advaita been called a limb and not a part? The reason is that “limb” implies greater intimacy.

TEXT 26

mahā-viṣṇura amśa—advaita guṇa-dhāma

īśvare abheda, teñi ‘advaita’ pūrṇa nāma

SYNONYMS

mahā-viṣṇura—of Lord Mahā-Viṣṇu; *amśa*—part; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *guṇa-dhāma*—reservoir of all attributes; *īśvare*—from the Lord; *abheda*—nondifferent; *teñi*—therefore; *advaita*—nondifferent; *pūrṇa nāma*—full name.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita, who is a reservoir of virtues, is the main limb of Mahā-Viṣṇu. His full name is Advaita, for He is identical in all respects with that Lord.

TEXT 27

pūrve yaiche kaila sarva-viśvera sṛjana

avatari’ kaila ebe bhakti-pravartana

SYNONYMS

pūrve—formerly; *yaiche*—as; *kaila*—performed; *sarva*—all; *viśvera*—of the universes; *sṛjana*—creation; *avatari’*—taking incarnation; *kaila*—did; *ebe*—now; *bhakti-pravartana*—inauguration of the *bhakti* cult.

TRANSLATION

As He had formerly created all the universes, now He descended to introduce the path of bhakti.

TEXT 28

jīva nistārila kṛṣṇa-bhakti kari' dāna

gītā-bhāgavate kaila bhaktira vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

jīva—the living entities; *nistārila*—delivered; *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*—devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kari'*—making; *dāna*—gift; *gītā-bhāgavate*—in the *Bhagavad-gītā* and *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *kaila*—performed; *bhaktira vyākhyāna*—explanation of devotional service.

TRANSLATION

He delivered all living beings by offering the gift of kṛṣṇa-bhakti. He explained the Bhagavad-gītā and Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam in the light of devotional service.

PURPORT

Although Śrī Advaita Prabhu is an incarnation of Viṣṇu, for the welfare of the conditioned souls He manifested Himself as a servitor of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and throughout all His activities He showed Himself to be an eternal servitor. Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda also manifested the same principle, although They also belong to the category of Viṣṇu. If Lord Caitanya, Lord Nityānanda and Advaita Prabhu had exhibited Their all-powerful Viṣṇu potencies within this material world, people would have become greater impersonalists, monists and self-worshippers than they had already become under the spell of this age. Therefore the Personality of Godhead and His different incarnations and forms played the parts of devotees to instruct the conditioned souls how to approach the transcendental stage of devotional service. Advaita Ācārya especially intended to teach the conditioned souls about devotional service. The word *ācārya* means “teacher.” The special

function of such a teacher is to make people Kṛṣṇa conscious. A bona fide teacher following in the footsteps of Advaita Ācārya has no other business than to spread the principles of Kṛṣṇa consciousness all over the world. The real qualification of an *ācārya* is that he presents himself as a servant of the Supreme. Such a bona fide *ācārya* can never support the demoniac activities of atheistic men who present themselves as God. It is the main business of an *ācārya* to defy such imposters posing as God before the innocent public.

TEXT 29

bhakti-upadeśa vinu tāñra nāhi kārya

ataeva nāma haila ‘advaita ācārya’

SYNONYMS

bhakti-upadeśa—instruction of devotional service; *vinu*—without; *tāñra*—His; *nāhi*—there is not; *kārya*—occupation; *ataeva*—therefore; *nāma*—the name; *haila*—became; *advaita ācārya*—the supreme teacher (*ācārya*) Advaita Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

Since He has no other occupation than to teach devotional service, His name is Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 30

vaiṣṇavera guru teñho jagatera ārya

dui-nāma-milane haila ‘advaita-ācārya’

SYNONYMS

vaiṣṇavera—of the devotees; *guru*—spiritual master; *teñho*—He; *jagatera ārya*—the most respectable personality in the world; *dui-nāma-milane*—by combining the two names; *haila*—there was; *advaita-ācārya*—the name Advaita Ācārya.

TRANSLATION

He is the spiritual master of all devotees and is the most revered personality in the world. By a combination of these two names, His name is Advaita Ācārya.

PURPORT

Śrī Advaita Ācārya is the prime spiritual master of the Vaiṣṇavas, and He is worshipable by all Vaiṣṇavas. Vaiṣṇavas must follow in the footsteps of Advaita Ācārya, for by so doing one can actually engage in the devotional service of the Lord.

TEXT 31

kamala-nayanera teñho, yāte ‘aṅga’ ‘amśa’

‘kamalākṣa’ kari dhare nāma avataṁsa

SYNONYMS

kamala-nayanera—of the lotus-eyed; *teñho*—He; *yāte*—since; *aṅga*—limb; *amśa*—part; *kamala-akṣa*—the lotus-eyed; *kari’*—accepting that; *dhare*—takes; *nāma*—the name; *avataṁsa*—partial expansion.

TRANSLATION

Since He is a limb or part of the lotus-eyed Supreme Lord, He also bears the name Kamalākṣa.

TEXT 32

īśvara-sārūpya pāya pāriṣada-gaṇa

catur-bhuja, pīta-vāsa, yaiche nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

īśvara-sārūpya—the same bodily features as the Lord; *pāya*—gets; *pāriṣada-gaṇa*—the associates; *catur-bhuja*—four hands; *pīta-vāsa*—yellow dress; *yaiche*—just as; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

His associates have the same bodily features as the Lord. They all have four arms and are dressed in yellow garments like Nārāyaṇa.

TEXT 33

advaita-ācārya—īśvarera amśa-varya

tānra tattva-nāma-guṇa, sakali āścarya

SYNONYMS

advaita-ācārya—Advaita Ācārya Prabhu; *īśvarera*—of the Supreme Lord; *amśa-varya*—principal part; *tānra*—His; *tattva*—truths; *nāma*—names; *guṇa*—attributes; *sakali*—all; *āścarya*—wonderful.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya is the principal limb of the Supreme Lord. His truths, names and attributes are all wonderful.

TEXT 34

yāñhāra tulasī-jale, yāñhāra huñkāre

sva-gaṇa sahite caitanyera avatāre

SYNONYMS

yāñhāra—whose; *tulasī-jale*—by *tulasī* leaves and Ganges water; *yāñhāra*—of whom; *huñkāre*—by the loud voice; *sva-gaṇa*—His personal associates; *sahite*—accompanied by; *caitanyera*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *avatāre*—in the incarnation.

TRANSLATION

He worshiped Kṛṣṇa with *tulasī* leaves and water of the Ganges and called for Him in a loud voice. Thus Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared on earth, accompanied by His personal associates.

TEXT 35

yāñra dvārā kaila prabhu kīrtana pracāra

yāñra dvārā kaila prabhu jagat nistāra

SYNONYMS

yāñra dvārā—by whom; *kaila*—did; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kīrtana pracāra*—spreading of the *sañkīrtana* movement; *yāñra dvārā*—by whom; *kaila*—did; *prabhu*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jagat nistāra*—deliverance of the entire world.

TRANSLATION

It is through Him [Advaita Ācārya] that Lord Caitanya spread the *sañkīrtana* movement and through Him that He delivered the world.

TEXT 36

ācārya gosāñīra guṇa-mahimā apāra

jīva-kīṭa kothāya pāibeka tāra pāra

SYNONYMS

ācārya gosāñīra—of Advaita Ācārya; *guṇa-mahimā*—the glory of the attributes; *apāra*—unfathomable; *jīva-kīṭa*—a living being who is just like a worm; *kothāya*—where; *pāibeka*—will get; *tāra*—of that; *pāra*—the other side.

TRANSLATION

The glory and attributes of Advaita Ācārya are unlimited. How can the insignificant living entities fathom them?

TEXT 37

ācārya gosāñī caitanyera mukhya aṅga

āra eka aṅga tāñra prabhu nityānanda

SYNONYMS

ācārya gosāñī—Advaita Ācārya; *caitanyera*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mukhya*—primary; *aṅga*—part; *āra*—another; *eka*—one; *aṅga*—part; *tāñra*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *prabhu nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya is a principal limb of Lord Caitanya. Another limb of the Lord is Nityānanda Prabhu.

TEXT 38

prabhura upāṅga—śrīvāsādi bhakta-gaṇa

hasta-mukha-netra-aṅga cakrādy-astra-sama

SYNONYMS

prabhura upāṅga—Lord Caitanya’s smaller parts; *śrīvāsa-ādi*—headed by Śrīvāsa; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees; *hasta*—hands; *mukha*—face; *netra*—eyes; *aṅga*—parts of the body; *cakra-ādi*—the disc; *astra*—weapons; *sama*—like.

TRANSLATION

The devotees headed by Śrīvāsa are His smaller limbs. They are like His hands, face and eyes and His disc and other weapons.

TEXT 39

e-saba la-iyā caitanya-prabhura vihāra

e-saba la-iyā karena vāñchita pracāra

SYNONYMS

e-saba—all these; *la-iyā*—taking; *caitanya-prabhura*—of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *vihāra*—pastimes; *e-saba*—all of them; *la-iyā*—taking; *karena*—does; *vāñchita pracāra*—spreading His mission.

TRANSLATION

With all of them Lord Caitanya performed His pastimes, and with them He spread His mission.

TEXT 40

mādhavendra-purīra inho śiṣya, ei jñāne

ācārya-gosāñire prabhu guru kari' māne

SYNONYMS

mādhavendra-purīra—of Mādhavendra Purī; *inho*—Advaita Ācārya; *śiṣya*—disciple; *ei jñāne*—by this consideration; *ācārya-gosāñire*—unto Advaita Ācārya; *prabhu*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *guru*—spiritual master; *kari'*—taking as; *māne*—obeys Him.

TRANSLATION

Thinking “He [Śrī Advaita Ācārya] is a disciple of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī,” Lord Caitanya obeys Him, respecting Him as His spiritual master.

PURPORT

Śrī Mādhavendra Purī is one of the *ācāryas* in the disciplic succession from Madhvācārya. Mādhavendra Purī had two principal disciples, Īśvara Purī and Śrī Advaita Prabhu. Therefore the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava-sampradāya is a disciplic succession from Madhvācārya. This fact has been accepted in the authorized books known as *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* and *Prameya-ratnāvalī*, as well as by Gopāla Guru Gosvāmī. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (22) clearly states the disciplic succession of the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas as follows: “Lord Brahmā is the direct disciple of Viṣṇu, the Lord of the spiritual sky. His disciple is Nārada, Nārada’s disciple is Vyāsa, and Vyāsa’s disciples are Śukadeva Gosvāmī and Madhvācārya. Padmanābha Ācārya is the disciple of Madhvācārya, and Narahari is the disciple of Padmanābha Ācārya. Mādhava is the disciple of Narahari, Akṣobhya is the direct disciple of Mādhava, and Jayatīrtha is the disciple of Akṣobhya. Jayatīrtha’s disciple is Jñānasindhu, and his disciple is Mahānidhi. Vidyānidhi is the disciple of Mahānidhi, and

Rājendra is the disciple of Vidyānidhi. Jayadharma is the disciple of Rājendra. Puruṣottama is the disciple of Jayadharma. Śrīmān Lakṣmīpati is the disciple of Vyāsatīrtha, who is the disciple of Puruṣottama. And Mādhavendra Purī is the disciple of Lakṣmīpati.”

TEXT 41

laukika-līlāte dharma-maryādā-rakṣaṇa

stuti-bhaktye kareṇa tāñra caraṇa vandana

SYNONYMS

laukika—popular; *līlāte*—in pastimes; *dharma-maryādā*—etiquette of religious principles; *rakṣaṇa*—observing; *stuti*—prayers; *bhaktye*—by devotion; *kareṇa*—He does; *tāñra*—of Advaita Ācārya; *caraṇa*—lotus feet; *vandana*—worshiping.

TRANSLATION

To maintain the proper etiquette for the principles of religion, Lord Caitanya bows down at the lotus feet of Śrī Advaita Ācārya with reverential prayers and devotion.

TEXT 42

caitanya-gosāñike ācārya kare ‘prabhu’-jñāna

āpanāke kareṇa tāñra ‘dāsa’-abhimāna

SYNONYMS

caitanya-gosāñike—unto Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *kare*—does; *prabhu-jñāna*—considering His master; *āpanāke*—unto Himself; *kareṇa*—does; *tāñra*—of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu;

dāsa—as a servant; *abhimāna*—conception.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya, however, considers Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu His master, and He thinks of Himself as a servant of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

The *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* of Rūpa Gosvāmī explains the superexcellent quality of devotional service as follows:

*brahmānando bhaved eṣa cet parārdha-guṇī-kṛtaḥ
naiti bhakti-sukhāmbhodheḥ paramāṇu-tulām api*

“If multiplied billions of times, the transcendental pleasure derived from impersonal Brahman realization still could not compare to even an atomic portion of the ocean of *bhakti*, or transcendental service.” (*B.r.s.* 1.1.38) Similarly, the *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* states:

*tvat-kathāmṛta-pāthodhau viharanto mahā-mudaḥ
kurvanti kṛtinaḥ kecic catur-vargaṁ tṛṇopamam*

“For those who take pleasure in the transcendental topics of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the four progressive realizations of religiosity, economic development, sense gratification and liberation, all combined together, cannot compare, any more than a straw could, to the happiness derived from hearing about the transcendental activities of the Lord.” Those who engage in the transcendental service of the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa, being relieved of all material enjoyment, have no attraction to topics of impersonal monism. In the *Padma Purāṇa*, in connection with the glorification of the month of Kārttika, it is stated that devotees pray:

varaṁ deva mokṣaṁ na mokṣāvadhiṁ vā

na cānyam vṛṇe 'haṁ vareśād apīha

*idaṁ te vapur nātha gopāla-bālaṁ
sadā me manasy āvirāstāṁ kim anyaiḥ*

*kuverātmajau baddha-mūrtyaiva yadvat
tvayā mocitau bhakti-bhājau kṛtau ca*

*tathā prema-bhaktiṁ svakāṁ me prayaccha
na mokṣe graho me 'sti dāmodareha*

“Dear Lord, always remembering Your childhood pastimes at Vṛndāvana is better for us than aspiring to merge into the impersonal Brahman. During Your childhood pastimes You liberated the two sons of Kuvera and made them great devotees of Your Lordship. Similarly, I wish that instead of giving me liberation You may award me such devotion unto You.” In the *Hayaśiṛṣīya-śrī-nārāyaṇa-vyūha-stava*, in the chapter called *Nārāyaṇa-stotra*, it is stated:

*na dharmam kāmam artham vā
mokṣam vā vara-deśvara
prārthaye tava pādābje
dāsyam evābhikāmaye*

“My dear Lord, I do not wish to become a man of religion or a master of economic development or sense gratification, nor do I wish for liberation. Although I can have all these from You, the supreme bestower of benedictions, I do not pray for any of these. I simply pray that I may always be engaged as a servant of Your lotus feet.” Nṛsiṁhadeva offered Prahāda Mahārāja all kinds of benedictions, but Prahāda Mahārāja did not accept any of them, for he simply wanted to engage in the service of the lotus feet of the Lord. Similarly, a pure devotee wishes to be blessed like Mahārāja Prahāda by being thus endowed with devotional service. Devotees also offer their respects to Hanumān, who always remained a servant of Lord Rāma. The great devotee Hanumān prayed:

*bhava-bandha-cchide tasyai sprhayāmi na muktaye
bhavān prabhur ahaṁ dāsa iti yatra vilupyate*

“I do not wish to take liberation or to merge in the Brahman effulgence, where the conception of being a servant of the Lord is completely lost.” Similarly, in the *Nārada-pañcarātra* it is stated:

*dharmārtha-kāma-mokṣeṣu necchā mama kadācana
tvat-pāda-paṅkajasyādho jīvitaṁ dīyatāṁ mama*

“I do not want any one of the four desirable stations. I simply want to engage as a servant of the lotus feet of the Lord.” King Kulaśekhara, in his very famous book *Mukunda-mālā-stotra*, prays:

*nāhaṁ vande tava caraṇayor dvandvam advandva-hetoḥ
kumbhī-pākaṁ gurum api hare nārakaṁ nāpanetum
ramyā-rāmā-mṛdu-tanu-latā-nandane nābhirantum
bhāve bhāve hṛdaya-bhavane bhāvayeyaṁ bhavantam*

“My Lord, I do not worship You to be liberated from this material entanglement, nor do I wish to save myself from the hellish condition of material existence, nor do I ever pray for a beautiful wife to enjoy in a nice garden. I wish only that I may always be in full ecstasy with the pleasure of serving Your Lordship.” (MM 4) In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* also there are many instances in the Third and Fourth cantos in which devotees pray to the Lord simply to be engaged in His service, and nothing else (*Bhāg.* 3.4.15, 3.25.34, 3.25.36, 4.8.22, 4.9.10 and 4.20.24).

TEXT 43

sei abhimāna-sukhe āpanā pāsare

‘kṛṣṇa-dāsa’ hao—jīve upadeśa kare

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *abhimāna-sukhe*—in the happiness of that conception;
āpanā—Himself; *pāsare*—He forgets; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa hao*—You are servants
of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *jīve*—the living beings; *upadeśa kare*—He instructs.

TRANSLATION

He forgets Himself in the joy of that conception and teaches all living
entities, “You are servants of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.”

PURPORT

The transcendental devotional service of the Supreme Personality of
Godhead is so ecstatic that even the Lord Himself plays the part of a
devotee. Forgetting Himself to be the Supreme, He personally teaches the
whole world how to render service to the Supreme Personality of
Godhead.

TEXT 44

kṛṣṇa-dāsa-abhimāne ye ānanda-sindhu

koṭī-brahma-sukha nahe tāra eka bindu

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-dāsa-abhimāne—under this impression of being a servant of Kṛṣṇa;
ye—that; *ānanda-sindhu*—ocean of transcendental bliss; *koṭī-brahma-*
sukha—ten million times the transcendental bliss of becoming one with
the Absolute; *nahe*—not; *tāra*—of the ocean of transcendental bliss;
eka—one; *bindu*—drop.

TRANSLATION

The conception of servitude to Śrī Kṛṣṇa generates such an ocean of joy
in the soul that even the joy of oneness with the Absolute, if multiplied

ten million times, could not compare to a drop of it.

TEXT 45

muñi ye caitanya-dāsa āra nityānanda

dāsa-bhāva-sama nahe anyatra ānanda

SYNONYMS

muñi—I; *ye*—that; *caitanya-dāsa*—servant of Lord Caitanya; *āra*—and; *nityānanda*—of Lord Nityānanda; *dāsa-bhāva*—the emotion of being a servant; *sama*—equal to; *nahe*—not; *anyatra*—anywhere else; *ānanda*—transcendental bliss.

TRANSLATION

He says, “Nityānanda and I are servants of Lord Caitanya.” Nowhere else is there such joy as that which is tasted in this emotion of servitude.

TEXT 46

parama-preyasī lakṣmī hṛdaye vasati

teṇho dāsyā-sukha māge kariyā minati

SYNONYMS

parama-preyasī—the most beloved; *lakṣmī*—the goddess of fortune; *hṛdaye*—on the chest; *vasati*—residence; *teṇho*—she; *dāsyā-sukha*—the happiness of being a maidservant; *māge*—begs; *kariyā*—offering; *minati*—prayers.

TRANSLATION

The most beloved goddess of fortune resides on the chest of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, yet she too, earnestly praying, begs for the joy of service at His feet.

TEXT 47

dāśya-bhāve ānandita pāriṣada-gaṇa

vidhi, bhava, nārada āra śuka, sanātana

SYNONYMS

dāśya-bhāve—in the conception of being a servant; *ānandita*—very pleased; *pāriṣada-gaṇa*—all the associates; *vidhi*—Lord Brahmā; *bhava*—Lord Śiva; *nārada*—the great sage Nārada; *āra*—and; *śuka*—Śukadeva Gosvāmī; *sanātana*—and Sanātana Kumāra.

TRANSLATION

All the associates of Lord Kṛṣṇa, such as Brahmā, Śiva, Nārada, Śuka and Sanātana Kumāra, are very pleased in the sentiment of servitude.

TEXT 48

nityānanda avadhūta sabāte āgala

caitanya dāśya-preme ha-ilā pāgala

SYNONYMS

nityānanda avadhūta—the mendicant Lord Nityānanda; *sabāte*—among all; *āgala*—foremost; *caitanya dāśya-preme*—in the emotional ecstatic love of being a servant of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ha-ilā pāgala*—became mad.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Nityānanda, the wandering mendicant, is the foremost of all the associates of Lord Caitanya. He became mad in the ecstasy of service to Lord Caitanya.

TEXTS 49–50

śrīvāsa, haridāsa, rāmadāsa, gadādhara

murāri, mukunda, candraśekhara, vakreśvara

e-saba paṇḍita-loka parama-mahattva

caitanyera dāsyē sabāya karaye unmatta

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsa—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *haridāsa*—Haridāsa Ṭhākura; *rāmadāsa*—Rāmadāsa; *gadādhara*—Gadādhara; *murāri*—Murāri; *mukunda*—Mukunda; *candraśekhara*—Candraśekhara; *vakreśvara*—Vakreśvara; *e-saba*—all of them; *paṇḍita-loka*—very learned scholars; *parama-mahattva*—very much glorified; *caitanyera*—of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dāsyē*—the servitude; *sabāya*—all of them; *karaye unmatta*—makes mad.

TRANSLATION

Śrīvāsa, Haridāsa, Rāmadāsa, Gadādhara, Murāri, Mukunda, Candraśekhara and Vakreśvara are all glorious and are all learned scholars, but the sentiment of servitude to Lord Caitanya makes them mad in ecstasy.

TEXT 51

ei mata gāya, nāce, kare aṭṭahāsa

loke upadeśe,——‘hao caitanyera dāsa’

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *gāya*—chant; *nāce*—dance; *kare*—do; *aṭṭa-hāsa*—laughing like madmen; *loke*—unto the people in general; *upadeśe*—instruct; *hao*—just become; *caitanyera dāsa*—servants of Śrī Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

Thus they dance, sing and laugh like madmen, and they instruct everyone, “Just be loving servants of Lord Caitanya.”

TEXT 52

caitanya-gosāñi more kare guru jñāna

tathāpiha mora haya dāsa-abhimāna

SYNONYMS

caitanya-gosāñi—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *more*—unto Me; *kare*—does; *guru-jñāna*—consideration as a spiritual master; *tathāpiha*—still; *mora*—My; *haya*—there is; *dāsa-abhimāna*—the conception of being His servant.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya thinks, “Lord Caitanya considers Me His spiritual master, yet I feel Myself to be only His servant.”

TEXT 53

kṛṣṇa-premera ei eka apūrva prabhāva

guru-sama-laghuke karāya dāsyā-bhāva

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-premera—of love of Kṛṣṇa; *ei*—this; *eka*—one; *apūrva prabhāva*—unprecedented influence; *guru*—to those on the level of the spiritual master; *sama*—equal level; *laghuke*—unto the less important; *karāya*—makes; *dāsyā-bhāva*—the conception of being a servant.

TRANSLATION

Love for Kṛṣṇa has this one unique effect: it imbues superiors, equals and inferiors with the spirit of service to Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

There are two kinds of devotional service: the way of *pāñcarātrika* regulative principles and the way of *bhāgavata* transcendental loving service. The love of Godhead of those engaged in *pāñcarātrika* regulative principles depends more or less on the opulent and reverential platform, but the worship of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa is purely on the platform of transcendental love. Even persons who play as the superiors of Kṛṣṇa also take the chance to offer transcendental loving service to the Lord. The service attitude of the devotees who play the parts of superiors of the Lord is very difficult to understand, but it can be very plainly understood in connection with the superexcellence of their particular service to Lord Kṛṣṇa. A vivid example is the service of mother Yaśodā to Kṛṣṇa, which is distinct. In the feature of Nārāyaṇa, the Lord can accept services only from His associates who play parts in which they are equal to or less than Him, but in the feature of Lord Kṛṣṇa He accepts service very plainly from His fathers, teachers and other elders who are His superiors, as well as from His equals and His subordinates. This is very wonderful.

TEXT 54

ihāra pramāṇa śuna—sāstrera vyākhyāna

mahad-anubhava yāte sudṛḍha pramāṇa

SYNONYMS

ihāra—of this; *pramāṇa*—evidence; *śuna*—please hear; *sāstrera vyākhyāna*—the description in the revealed scriptures; *mahat-anubhava*—the conception of great souls; *yāte*—by which; *su-dṛḍha*—strong; *pramāṇa*—evidence.

TRANSLATION

For evidence, please listen to the examples described in the revealed scriptures, which are corroborated by the realization of great souls.

TEXTS 55–56

anyera kā kathā, vraje nanda mahāśaya

tāra sama ‘guru’ kṛṣṇera āra keha naya

śuddha-vātsalye īśvara-jñāna nāhi tāra

tāhākei preme karāya dāsyā-anukāra

SYNONYMS

anyera—of others; *kā*—what; *kathā*—to speak; *vraje*—in Vṛndāvana; *nanda mahāśaya*—Nanda Mahārāja; *tāra sama*—like him; *guru*—a superior; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *āra*—another; *keha*—anyone; *naya*—not; *śuddha-vātsalye*—in transcendental paternal love; *īśvara-jñāna*—conception of the Supreme Lord; *nāhi*—not; *tāra*—his; *tāhākei*—unto him; *preme*—ecstatic love; *karāya*—makes; *dāsyā-anukāra*—the conception of being a servant.

TRANSLATION

Although no one is a more respected elder for Kṛṣṇa than Nanda Mahārāja in Vraja, who in transcendental paternal love has no knowledge that his son is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, still ecstatic love makes him, what to speak of others, feel himself to be a servant of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 57

teṅho rati-mati māge kṛṣṇera caraṇe

tāhāra śrī-mukha-vāṇī tāhāte pramāṇe

SYNONYMS

teṅho—he also; *rati-mati*—affection and attraction; *māge*—begs; *kṛṣṇera caraṇe*—unto the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa; *tāhāra*—his; *śrī-mukha-vāṇī*—words from his mouth; *tāhāte*—in that; *pramāṇe*—evidence.

TRANSLATION

He too prays for attachment and devotion to the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, as the words from his own mouth give evidence.

TEXTS 58–59

śuna uddhava, satya, kṛṣṇa—āṁāra tanaya

teṅho īśvara—hena yadi tomāra mane laya

tathāpi tānhāte rahu mora mano-vṛtti

tomāra īśvara-kṛṣṇe hauka mora mati

SYNONYMS

śuna uddhava—my dear Uddhava, please hear me; *satya*—the truth; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *āmāra tanaya*—my son; *teṇho*—He; *īśvara*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *hena*—thus; *yadi*—if; *tomāra*—your; *mane*—the mind; *laya*—takes; *tathāpi*—still; *tāñhāte*—unto Him; *rahu*—let there be; *mora*—my; *manaḥ-vṛtti*—mental functions; *tomāra*—your; *īśvara-kṛṣṇe*—to Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Lord; *hauka*—let there be; *mora*—my; *matī*—attention.

TRANSLATION

“My dear Uddhava, please hear me. In truth Kṛṣṇa is my son, but even if you think that He is God, I would still bear toward Him my own feelings for my son. May my mind be attached to your Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 60

manaso vṛttayo naḥ syuḥ

kṛṣṇa-pādāmbujāśrayāḥ

vāco 'bhidhāyinīr nāmnām

kāyaś tat-prahvaṇādiṣu

SYNONYMS

manasaḥ—of the mind; *vṛttayaḥ*—activities (thinking, feeling and willing); *naḥ*—of us; *syuḥ*—let there be; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pāda-ambuja*—the lotus feet; *āśrayāḥ*—those sheltered by; *vācaḥ*—the words; *abhidhāyinīḥ*—speaking; *nāmnām*—of His holy names; *kāyaḥ*—the body; *tat*—to Him; *prahvaṇa-ādiṣu*—bowing down to Him, etc.

TRANSLATION

“May our minds be attached to the lotus feet of your Lord Kṛṣṇa, may our tongues chant His holy names, and may our bodies lie prostrate before Him.

TEXT 61

karmabhir bhrāmyamāṇānām

yatra kvāpīśvarecchayā

maṅgalācaritair dānai

ratir naḥ kṛṣṇa īśvare

SYNONYMS

karmabhiḥ—by the activities; *bhrāmyamāṇānām*—of those wandering within the material universe; *yatra*—wherever; *kva api*—anywhere; *īśvara-icchayā*—by the supreme will of the Personality of Godhead; *maṅgala-ācaritaiḥ*—by auspicious activities; *dānaiḥ*—like charity and philanthropy; *ratih*—the attraction; *naḥ*—our; *kṛṣṇe*—in Kṛṣṇa; *īśvare*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

“Wherever we wander in the material universe under the influence of karma by the will of the Lord, may our auspicious activities cause our attraction to Lord Kṛṣṇa to increase.”

PURPORT

These verses from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.47.66–67) were spoken by the denizens of Vṛndāvana, headed by Mahārāja Nanda and his associates, to Uddhava, who had come from Mathurā.

TEXT 62

śrīdāmādi vraje yata sakhāra nicaya

aiśvarya-jñāna-hīna, kevala-sakhya-maya

SYNONYMS

śrīdāmā-ādi—Kṛṣṇa's friends, headed by Śrīdāmā; *vraje*—in Vṛndāvana; *yata*—all; *sakhāra*—of the friends; *nicaya*—the group; *aiśvarya*—of opulence; *jñāna*—knowledge; *hīna*—without; *kevala*—purely; *sakhya-maya*—fraternal affection.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa's friends in Vṛndāvana, headed by Śrīdāmā, have pure fraternal affection for Lord Kṛṣṇa and have no idea of His opulences.

TEXT 63

kṛṣṇa-saṅge yuddha kare, skandhe ārohaṇa

tārā dāsya-bhāve kare caraṇa-sevana

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-saṅge—with Kṛṣṇa; *yuddha kare*—fight; *skandhe*—on His shoulders; *ārohaṇa*—getting up; *tārā*—they; *dāsya-bhāve*—in the conception of being Lord Kṛṣṇa's servants; *kare*—do; *caraṇa-sevana*—worship the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Although they fight with Him and climb upon His shoulders, they worship His lotus feet in a spirit of servitude.

TEXT 64

pāda-saṁvāhanam cakruḥ

kecit tasya mahātmanaḥ

apare hata-pāpmāno

vyajanaiḥ samavījayan

SYNONYMS

pāda-saṁvāhanam—massaging the feet; *cakruḥ*—performed; *kecit*—some of them; *tasya*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mahā-ātmanaḥ*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *apare*—others; *hata*—destroyed; *pāpmānaḥ*—whose resultant actions of sinful life; *vyajanaiḥ*—with hand-held fans; *samavījayan*—fanned very pleasingly.

TRANSLATION

“Some of the friends of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, massaged His feet, and others whose sinful reactions had been destroyed fanned Him with hand-held fans.”

PURPORT

This verse, quoted from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.15.17), describes how Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Balarāma were playing with the cowherd boys after killing Dhenukāsura in Tālavana.

TEXTS 65–66

kṛṣṇera preyasī vraje yata gopī-gaṇa

yāñra pada-dhūli kare uddhava prārthana

yāñ-sabāra upare kṛṣṇera priya nāhi āna

tāñhārā āpanāke kare dāsī-abhimāna

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *preyasī*—the beloved girls; *vraje*—in Vṛndāvana; *yata*—all; *gopī-gaṇa*—the *gopīs*; *yāñra*—of whom; *pada-dhūli*—the dust of the feet; *kare*—does; *uddhava*—Uddhava; *prārthana*—desiring; *yāñ-sabāra*—all of them; *upare*—beyond; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *priya*—dear; *nāhi*—there is not; *āna*—anyone else; *tāñhārā*—all of them; *āpanāke*—to themselves; *kare*—do; *dāsī-abhimāna*—the conception of being maidservants.

TRANSLATION

Even the beloved girlfriends of Lord Kṛṣṇa in Vṛndāvana, the *gopīs*, the dust of whose feet was desired by Śrī Uddhava and who are more dear to Kṛṣṇa than anyone else, regard themselves as Kṛṣṇa's maidservants.

TEXT 67

vraja-janārti-han vīra yoṣitām

nija-jana-smaya-dhvaṁsana-smīta

bhaja sakhe bhavat-kiṅkariṇ sma no

jala-ruhānanam cāru darśaya

SYNONYMS

vraja-jana-ārti-han—O one who diminishes all the painful conditions of the inhabitants of Vṛndāvana; *vīra*—O hero; *yoṣitām*—of women; *nija*—personal; *jana*—of the associates; *smaya*—the pride; *dhvaṁsana*—

destroying; *smita*—whose smile; *bhaja*—worship; *sakhe*—O dear friend; *bhavat-kiṅkarīḥ*—Your servants; *sma*—certainly; *naḥ*—unto us; *jala-ruha-ānanam*—a face exactly like a lotus flower; *cāru*—attractive; *darsāya*—please show.

TRANSLATION

“O Lord, remover of the afflictions of the inhabitants of Vṛndāvana! O hero of all women! O Lord who destroy the pride of Your devotees by Your sweet, gentle smile! O friend! We are Your maidservants. Please fulfill our desires and show us Your attractive lotus face.”

PURPORT

This verse in connection with the *rāsa* dance of Kṛṣṇa with the *gopīs* is quoted from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.31.6). When Kṛṣṇa disappeared from His companions in the course of dancing, the *gopīs* sang like this in separation from Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 68

api bata madhu-puryām ārya-putro 'dhunāste

smarati sa pitṛ-gehān saumya bandhūmś ca gopān

kvacid api sa kathām naḥ kiṅkariṇām grṇīte

bhujam aguru-sugandham mūrdhny adhāsyat kadā nu

SYNONYMS

api—certainly; *bata*—regrettable; *madhu-puryām*—in the city of Mathurā; *ārya-putraḥ*—the son of Nanda Mahārāja; *adhunā*—now; *āste*—resides; *smarati*—remembers; *saḥ*—He; *pitṛ-gehān*—the household affairs of His father; *saumya*—O great soul (Uddhava);

bandhūn—His many friends; *ca*—and; *gopān*—the cowherd boys; *kvacit*—sometimes; *api*—or; *saḥ*—He; *kathām*—talks; *naḥ*—of us; *kiṅkarīṇām*—of the maidservants; *grṇīte*—relates; *bhujam*—hand; *aguru-su-gandham*—having the fragrance of *aguru*; *mūrdhni*—on the head; *adhāsyat*—will keep; *kadā*—when; *nu*—may be.

TRANSLATION

“O Uddhava! It is indeed regrettable that Kṛṣṇa resides in Mathurā. Does He remember His father’s household affairs and His friends, the cowherd boys? O great soul! Does He ever talk about us, His maidservants? When will He lay on our heads His aguru-scented hand?”

PURPORT

This verse appears in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.47.21), in the section known as the *Bhramara-gītā*. When Uddhava came to Vṛndāvana, Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, in complete separation from Kṛṣṇa, sang like this.

TEXTS 69–70

tān-sabāra kathā rahu,——śrīmatī rādhikā

sabā haite sakalāmśe parama-adhikā

tenho yānra dāsī haiñā sevena caraṇa

yānra prema-guṇe kṛṣṇa baddha anukṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

tān-sabāra—of the *gopīs*; *kathā*—talk; *rahu*—let alone; *śrīmatī rādhikā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *sabā haite*—than all of them; *sakala-amśe*—in every respect; *parama-adhikā*—highly elevated; *tenho*—She also; *yānra*—whose; *dāsī*—maidservant; *haiñā*—becoming; *sevena*—

worships; *caraṇa*—the lotus feet; *yāñra*—whose; *prema-guṇe*—because of loving attributes; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *baddha*—obliged; *anukṣaṇa*—always.

TRANSLATION

What to speak of the other gopīs, even Śrī Rādhikā, who in every respect is the most elevated of them all and who has bound Śrī Kṛṣṇa forever by Her loving attributes, serves His feet as His maidservant.

TEXT 71

hā nātha ramaṇa preṣṭha

kvāsi kvāsi mahā-bhuja

dāsyās te kṛpaṇāyā me

sakhe darśaya sannidhim

SYNONYMS

hā—O; *nātha*—My Lord; *ramaṇa*—O My husband; *preṣṭha*—O My most dear one; *kva asi kva asi*—where are You, where are You; *mahā-bhuja*—O mighty-armed one; *dāsyāḥ*—of the maidservant; *te*—You; *kṛpaṇāyāḥ*—very much aggrieved by Your absence; *me*—to Me; *sakhe*—O My friend; *darśaya*—show; *sannidhim*—nearness to You.

TRANSLATION

“O My Lord, O My husband, O most dearly beloved! O mighty-armed Lord! Where are You? Where are You? O My friend, reveal Yourself to Your maidservant, who is very much aggrieved by Your absence.”

PURPORT

This verse is quoted from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.30.39). When the *rāsa* dance was going on in full swing, Kṛṣṇa left all the *gopīs* and took only Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī with Him. At that time all the *gopīs* lamented, and Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, being proud of Her position, requested Kṛṣṇa to carry Her wherever He liked. Then Kṛṣṇa immediately disappeared from the scene, and Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī began to lament.

TEXT 72

dvārakāte rukmiṇy-ādi yateka mahiṣī

tāñhārāo āpanāke māne kṛṣṇa-dāsī

SYNONYMS

dvārakāte—in Dvārakā-dhāma; *rukmiṇī-ādi*—headed by Rukmiṇī; *yateka*—all of them; *mahiṣī*—the queens; *tāñhārāo*—all of them also; *āpanāke*—themselves; *māne*—consider; *kṛṣṇa-dāsī*—maidservants of Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

In Dvārakā-dhāma, all the queens, headed by Rukmiṇī, also consider themselves maidservants of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 73

caidyāya mārpayitum udyata-kārmukeṣu

rājasv ajeya-bhaṭa-śekhara-tānghri-reṇuḥ

ninye mṛgendra iva bhāgam ajāvi-yūthāt

tac chrī-niketa-carāṇo 'stu mamārcanāya

SYNONYMS

caidyāya—unto Śiśupāla; *mā*—me; *arpayitum*—to deliver or to give in charity; *udyata*—upraised; *kārmukeṣu*—whose bows and arrows; *rājasu*—among the kings headed by Jarāsandha; *ajeya*—unconquerable; *bhaṭa*—of the soldiers; *śekhharita-aṅghri-reṇuḥ*—the dust of whose lotus feet is the crown; *ninye*—forcibly took; *mṛga-indraḥ*—the lion; *iva*—like; *bhāgam*—the share; *aṇa*—of the goats; *avi*—and sheep; *yūthāt*—from the midst; *tat*—that; *śrī-niketa*—of the shelter of the goddess of fortune; *caraṇaḥ*—the lotus feet; *astu*—let there be; *mama*—my; *arcanāya*—for worshiping .

TRANSLATION

“When Jarāsandha and other kings, bows and arrows upraised, stood ready to deliver me in charity to Śiśupāla, He forcibly took me from their midst, as a lion takes its share of goats and sheep. The dust of His lotus feet is therefore the crown of unconquerable soldiers. May those lotus feet, which are the shelter of the goddess of fortune, be the object of my worship.”

PURPORT

This verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.83.8) was spoken by Queen Rukmiṇī.

TEXT 74

tapaś carantīm ājñāya

sva-pāda-sparsānāśayā

sakhyopetyāgrahīt pāṇīm

sāhaṁ tad-gr̥ha-mārjanī

SYNONYMS

tapah—austerity; *carantīm*—performing; *ājñāya*—knowing; *sva-pāda-sparsāna*—of touching His feet; *āśayā*—with the desire; *sakhyā*—with His friend Arjuna; *upetya*—coming; *agrahīt*—accepted; *pāṇim*—my hand; *sā*—that woman; *aham*—I; *tat*—His; *gṛha-mārjanī*—keeper of the home.

TRANSLATION

“Knowing me to be performing austerities with the desire to touch His feet, He came with His friend Arjuna and accepted my hand. Yet I am but a maidservant engaged in sweeping the floor of the house of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.”

PURPORT

Like the previous verse, this verse appears in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.83.11) in connection with the meeting of the family ladies of the Kuru and Yadu dynasties at Samanta-pāñcaka. At the time of that meeting, the queen of Kṛṣṇa named Kālindī spoke to Draupadī in this way.

TEXT 75

ātmārāmasya tasyemā

vayaṁ vai gṛha-dāsikāḥ

sarva-saṅga-nivṛttyāddhā

tapasā ca babhūvima

SYNONYMS

ātmārāmasya—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is satisfied in Himself; *tasya*—His; *imāḥ*—all; *vayam*—we; *vai*—certainly; *grha-dāsikāḥ*—the maidservants of the home; *sarva*—all; *saṅga*—association; *nivṛttyā*—fully bereft of; *addhā*—directly; *tapasā*—on account of austerity; *ca*—also; *babhūvima*—we have become.

TRANSLATION

“Through austerity and through renunciation of all attachments, we have become maidservants in the home of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is satisfied in Himself.”

PURPORT

During the same incident, this verse, quoted from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.83.39), was spoken to Draupadī by a queen of Kṛṣṇa’s named Lakṣmaṇā.

TEXT 76

ānera ki kathā, baladeva mahāśaya

yānra bhāva—śuddha-sakhya-vātsalyādi-maya

SYNONYMS

ānera—of others; *ki kathā*—what to speak; *baladeva*—Lord Baladeva; *mahāśaya*—the Supreme Personality; *yānra*—His; *bhāva*—emotion; *śuddha-sakhya*—pure friendship; *vātsalya-ādi-maya*—with a touch of paternal love.

TRANSLATION

What to speak of others, even Lord Baladeva, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is full of emotions like pure friendship and paternal love.

PURPORT

Although Lord Baladeva appeared before the birth of Lord Kṛṣṇa and is therefore Kṛṣṇa's worshipable elder brother, He used to act as Kṛṣṇa's eternal servitor. In the spiritual sky all the Vaikuṇṭha planets are predominated by the quadruple expansions of Kṛṣṇa known as the *catur-vyūha*. They are direct expansions from Baladeva. It is the singularity of the Supreme Lord that everyone in the spiritual sky thinks himself a servitor of the Lord. According to social convention one may be superior to Kṛṣṇa, but factually everyone engages in His service. Therefore in the spiritual sky or the material sky, in all the different planets, no one is able to supersede Lord Kṛṣṇa or demand service from Him. On the contrary, everyone engages in the service of Lord Kṛṣṇa. As such, the more a person engages in the service of the Lord, the more he is important; and, conversely, the more one is bereft of the transcendental service of Kṛṣṇa, the more he invites the bad fortune of material contamination. In the material world, although materialists want to become one with God or compete with God, everyone directly or indirectly engages in the service of the Lord. The more one is forgetful of the service of Kṛṣṇa, the more he is considered to be dying. Therefore, when one develops pure Kṛṣṇa consciousness, he immediately develops his eternal servitorship to Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 77

teṅho āpanāke kareṇa dāsa-bhāvanā

kṛṣṇa-dāsa-bhāva vinu āche kona janā

SYNONYMS

teṅho—He also; *āpanāke*—Himself; *kareṇa*—does; *dāsa-bhāvanā*—considering a servant; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa-bhāva*—the conception of being a servant of Kṛṣṇa; *vinu*—without; *āche*—is; *kona*—what; *janā*—person.

TRANSLATION

He also considers Himself a servant of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Indeed, who is there who does not have this conception of being a servant of Lord Kṛṣṇa?

TEXT 78

sahasra-vadane yeṇho śeṣa-saṅkarṣaṇa

daśa deha dhari' kare kṛṣṇera sevana

SYNONYMS

sahasra-vadane—with thousands of mouths; *yeṇho*—one who; *śeṣa-saṅkarṣaṇa*—Lord Śeṣa, the incarnation of Saṅkarṣaṇa; *daśa*—ten; *deha*—bodies; *dhari'*—accepting; *kare*—does; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sevana*—service.

TRANSLATION

He who is Śeṣa, Saṅkarṣaṇa, with His thousands of mouths, serves Śrī Kṛṣṇa by assuming ten forms.

TEXT 79

ananta brahmāṇḍe rudra—sadāśīvera amśa

guṇāvatāra teṇho, sarva-deva-avatamśa

SYNONYMS

ananta—unlimited; *brahmāṇḍe*—in the universes; *rudra*—Lord Śiva; *sadāśīvera amśa*—part and parcel of Sadāśīva; *guṇa-avatāra*—an incarnation of a quality; *teṇho*—he also; *sarva-deva-avatamśa*—the ornament of all the demigods.

TRANSLATION

Rudra, who is an expansion of Sadāśiva and who appears in unlimited universes, is also a guṇāvatāra [qualitative incarnation] and is the ornament of all the demigods in the endless universes.

PURPORT

There are eleven expansions of Rudra, or Lord Śiva. They are as follows: Ajaikapāt, Ahibradhna, Virūpākṣa, Raivata, Hara, Bahurūpa, Devaśreṣṭha Tryambaka, Sāvitra, Jayanta, Pināki and Aparājita. Besides these expansions there are eight forms of Rudra called earth, water, fire, air, sky, the sun, the moon and *soma-yājī*. Generally all these Rudras have five faces, three eyes and ten arms. Sometimes it is found that Rudra is compared to Brahmā and considered a living entity. But when Rudra is explained to be a partial expansion of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, he is compared to Śeṣa. Lord Śiva is therefore simultaneously an expansion of Lord Viṣṇu and, in his capacity for annihilating the creation, one of the living entities. As an expansion of Lord Viṣṇu he is called Hara, and he is transcendental to the material qualities, but when he is in touch with *tamo-guṇa* he appears contaminated by the material modes of nature. This is explained in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and the *Brahma-saṁhitā*. In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Tenth Canto, it is stated that Lord Rudra is always associated with the material nature when she is in the neutral, unmanifested stage, but when the modes of material nature are agitated he associates with material nature from a distance. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* the relationship between Viṣṇu and Lord Śiva is compared to that between milk and yogurt. Milk is converted into yogurt by certain additives, but although milk and yogurt have the same ingredients, they have different functions. Similarly, Lord Śiva is an expansion of Lord Viṣṇu, yet because of his taking part in the annihilation of the cosmic manifestation, he is considered to be changed, like milk converted into yogurt. In the *Purāṇas* it is found that Śiva appears sometimes from the heads of Brahmā and sometimes from the head of Viṣṇu. The annihilator, Rudra, is born from Saṅkarṣaṇa and the ultimate fire to burn the whole creation. In the *Vāyu Purāṇa* there is a description of Sadāśiva in one of the Vaikuṇṭha planets. That Sadāśiva is

a direct expansion of Lord Kṛṣṇa's form for pastimes. It is said that Sadāśiva (Lord Śambhu) is an expansion from the Sadāśiva in the Vaikuṇṭha planets (Lord Viṣṇu) and that his consort, Mahāmāyā, is an expansion of Ramā-devī, or Lakṣmī. Mahāmāyā is the origin or birthplace of material nature.

TEXT 80

teṇho karena kṛṣṇera dāsya-pratyāśa
nirantara kahe śiva, 'muñi kṛṣṇa-dāsa'

SYNONYMS

teṇho—he; *karena*—does; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dāsya-pratyāśa*—expectation of being a servant; *nirantara*—constantly; *kahe*—says; *śiva*—Lord Śiva; *muñi*—I; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—a servant of Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

He also desires only to be a servant of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Śrī Sadāśiva always says, “I am a servant of Lord Kṛṣṇa.”

TEXT 81

kṛṣṇa-preme unmatta, vihvala digambara
kṛṣṇa-guṇa-līlā gāya, nāce nirantara

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-preme—in ecstatic love of Kṛṣṇa; *unmatta*—almost mad; *vihvala*—overwhelmed; *digambara*—without any dress; *kṛṣṇa*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *guṇa*—attributes; *līlā*—pastimes; *gāya*—chants; *nāce*—dances; *nirantara*—constantly.

TRANSLATION

Intoxicated by ecstatic love for Lord Kṛṣṇa, he becomes overwhelmed and incessantly dances without clothing and sings about Lord Kṛṣṇa's qualities and pastimes.

TEXT 82

pitā-mātā-guru-sakhā-bhāva kene naya

kṛṣṇa-premera svabhāve dāsyā-bhāva se karaya

SYNONYMS

pitā—father; *mātā*—mother; *guru*—superior teacher; *sakhā*—friend; *bhāva*—the emotion; *kene naya*—let it be; *kṛṣṇa-premera*—of love of Kṛṣṇa; *svabhāve*—in a natural inclination; *dāsyā bhāva*—the emotion of becoming a servant; *se*—that; *karaya*—does.

TRANSLATION

All the emotions, whether those of father, mother, teacher or friend, are full of sentiments of servitude. That is the nature of love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 83

eka kṛṣṇa—sarva-sevya, jagat-īśvara

āra yata saba,—tānra sevakānucara

SYNONYMS

eka kṛṣṇa—one Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sarva-sevya*—worthy of being served by all; *jagat-īśvara*—the Lord of the universe; *āra yata saba*—all others; *tānra*—His; *sevaka-anucara*—servants of the servants.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa, the one master and the Lord of the universe, is worthy of being served by everyone. Indeed, everyone is but a servant of His servants.

TEXT 84

sei kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa—caitanya-īśvara

ataeva āra saba,—tāñhāra kiṅkara

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatīrṇa*—descended; *caitanya-īśvara*—Lord Caitanya, the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *ataeva*—therefore; *āra*—others; *saba*—all; *tāñhāra kiṅkara*—His servants.

TRANSLATION

That same Lord Kṛṣṇa has descended as Lord Caitanya, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Everyone, therefore, is His servant.

TEXT 85

keha māne, keha nā māne, saba tāñra dāsa

ye nā māne, tāra haya sei pāpe nāśa

SYNONYMS

keha māne—someone accepts; *keha nā māne*—someone does not accept; *saba tāñra dāsa*—all His servants; *ye nā māne*—one who does not accept; *tāra*—of him; *haya*—there is; *sei*—that; *pāpe*—in sinful activity; *nāśa*—annihilation.

TRANSLATION

Some accept Him whereas others do not, yet everyone is His servant. One who does not accept Him, however, will be ruined by his sinful activities.

PURPORT

When a living entity forgets his constitutional position, he prepares himself to be an enjoyer of the material resources. Sometimes he is also misguided by the thought that service to the Supreme Personality of Godhead is not absolute engagement. In other words, he thinks that there are many other engagements for a living entity besides the service of the Lord. Such a foolish person does not know that in any position he either directly or indirectly engages in activities of service to the Supreme Lord. Actually, if a person does not engage in the service of the Lord, all inauspicious activities encumber him because service to the Supreme Lord, Lord Caitanya, is the constitutional position of the infinitesimal living entities. Because the living entity is infinitesimal, the allurements of material enjoyment attract him, and he tries to enjoy matter, forgetting his constitutional position. But when his dormant Kṛṣṇa consciousness is awakened, he no longer engages in the service of matter but engages in the service of the Lord. In other words, when one is forgetful of his constitutional position, he appears in the position of the lord of material nature. Even at that time he remains a servant of the Supreme Lord, but in an unqualified or contaminated state.

TEXT 86

caitanyera dāsa muñi, caitanyera dāsa

caitanyera dāsa muñi, tāñra dāsera dāsa

SYNONYMS

caitanya—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dāsa*—servant; *muñi*—I; *caitanya dāsa*—a servant of Lord Caitanya; *caitanya dāsa muñi*—I am a servant of Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tānra dāsera dāsa*—a servant of His servant.

TRANSLATION

“I am a servant of Lord Caitanya, a servant of Lord Caitanya. I am a servant of Lord Caitanya, and a servant of His servants.”

TEXT 87

eta bali' nāce, gāya, huṅkāra gambhīra

kṣaṇeke vasilā ācārya haiñā susthira

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *nāce*—dances; *gāya*—sings; *huṅkāra*—loud vibrations; *gambhīra*—deep; *kṣaṇeke*—in a moment; *vasilā*—sits down; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *haiñā su-sthira*—being very patient.

TRANSLATION

Saying this, Advaita Prabhu dances and loudly sings. Then at the next moment He quietly sits down.

TEXT 88

bhakta-abhimāna mūla śrī-balarāme

sei bhāve anugata tānra amśa-gaṇe

SYNONYMS

bhakta-abhimāna—to think oneself a devotee; *mūla*—original; *śrī-balarāme*—in Lord Balarāma; *sei bhāve*—in that ecstasy; *anugata*—followers; *tāñra amśa-gaṇe*—all His parts and parcels.

TRANSLATION

The source of the sentiment of servitude is indeed Lord Balarāma. The plenary expansions who follow Him are all influenced by that ecstasy.

TEXT 89

tāñra avatāra eka śrī-saṅkarṣaṇa

bhakta bali' abhimāna kare sarva-kṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

tāñra avatāra—His incarnation; *eka*—one; *śrī-saṅkarṣaṇa*—Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa; *bhakta bali'*—as a devotee; *abhimāna*—conception; *kare*—does; *sarva-kṣaṇa*—always.

TRANSLATION

Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa, who is one of His incarnations, always considers Himself a devotee.

TEXT 90

tāñra avatāra āna śrī-yuta lakṣmaṇa

śrī-rāmera dāsya tiñho kaila anukṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

tāñra avatāra—His incarnation; *āna*—another; *śrī-yuta*—with all beauty

and opulence; *lakṣmaṇa*—Lord Lakṣmaṇa; *śrī-rāmera*—of Rāmacandra; *dāśya*—servitude; *tiṇho*—He; *kaila*—did; *anukṣaṇa*—always.

TRANSLATION

Another of His incarnations, Lakṣmaṇa, who is very beautiful and opulent, always serves Lord Rāma.

TEXT 91

saṅkarṣaṇa-avatāra kāraṇābdhi-śāyī

tāṇhāra hṛdaye bhakta-bhāva anuyāyī

SYNONYMS

saṅkarṣaṇa-avatāra—an incarnation of Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa; *kāraṇa-abdhi-śāyī*—Lord Viṣṇu lying on the Causal Ocean; *tāṇhāra*—His; *hṛdaye*—in the heart; *bhakta-bhāva*—the emotion of being a devotee; *anuyāyī*—accordingly.

TRANSLATION

The Viṣṇu who lies on the Causal Ocean is an incarnation of Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa, and, accordingly, the emotion of being a devotee is always present in His heart.

TEXT 92

tāṇhāra prakāśa-bheda, advaita-ācārya

kāya-mano-vākye tāṇra bhakti sadā kārya

SYNONYMS

tāñhāra—His; *prakāśa-bheda*—separate expansion; *advaita-ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *kāya-manaḥ-vākye*—by His body, mind and words; *tāñra*—His; *bhakti*—devotion; *sadā*—always; *kārya*—occupational duty.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya is a separate expansion of Him. He always engages in devotional service with His thoughts, words and actions.

TEXT 93

vākye kahe, ‘muñi caitanyera anucara’

muñi tāñra bhakta—mane bhāve nirantara

SYNONYMS

vākye—by words; *kahe*—He says; *muñi*—I am; *caitanyera anucara*—a follower of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *muñi*—I; *tāñra*—His; *bhakta*—devotee; *mane*—in His mind; *bhāve*—in this condition; *nirantara*—always.

TRANSLATION

By His words He declares, “I am a servant of Lord Caitanya.” Thus with His mind He always thinks, “I am His devotee.”

TEXT 94

jala-tulasī diyā kare kāyāte sevana

bhakti pracāriyā saba tārīlā bhuvana

SYNONYMS

jala-tulasī—Ganges water and *tulasī* leaves; *diyā*—offering together; *kare*—does; *kāyāte*—with the body; *sevana*—worship; *bhakti*—the cult of devotional service; *pracāriyā*—preaching; *saba*—all; *tārīlā*—delivered; *bhuvana*—the universe.

TRANSLATION

With His body He worshiped the Lord by offering Ganges water and *tulasī* leaves, and by preaching devotional service He delivered the entire universe.

TEXT 95

pr̥thivī dharena yei śeṣa-saṅkarṣaṇa

kāya-vyūha kari' kareṇa kṛṣṇera sevana

SYNONYMS

pr̥thivī—planets; *dharena*—holds; *yei*—that one who; *śeṣa-saṅkarṣaṇa*—Lord Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa; *kāya-vyūha kari'*—expanding Himself in different bodies; *kareṇa*—does; *kṛṣṇera sevana*—service to Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa, who holds all the planets on His heads, expands Himself in different bodies to render service to Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 96

ei saba haya śrī-kṛṣṇera avatāra

nirantara dekhi sabāra bhaktira ācāra

SYNONYMS

ei saba—all of them; *haya*—are; *śrī-kṛṣṇera avatāra*—incarnations of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nirantara*—constantly; *dekhi*—I see; *sabāra*—of all; *bhaktira ācāra*—behavior as devotees.

TRANSLATION

These are all incarnations of Lord Kṛṣṇa, yet we always find that they act as devotees.

TEXT 97

e-sabāke śāstre kahe 'bhakta-avatāra'

'bhakta-avatāra'-pada upari sabāra

SYNONYMS

e-sabāke—all of them; *śāstre*—the scriptures; *kahe*—say; *bhakta-avatāra*—incarnations as devotees; *bhakta-avatāra*—of such an incarnation as a devotee; *pada*—the position; *upari sabāra*—above all other positions.

TRANSLATION

The scriptures call them incarnations as devotees [bhakta-avatāra]. The position of being such an incarnation is above all others.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead appears in different incarnations, but His appearance in the role of a devotee is more beneficial to the conditioned souls than the other incarnations, with all their opulences. Sometimes a conditioned soul is bewildered when he tries to understand the incarnation of Godhead with full opulence. Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared and performed many uncommon activities, and some materialists

misunderstood Him, but in His appearance as Lord Caitanya He did not show much of His opulences, and therefore fewer conditioned souls were bewildered. Misunderstanding the Lord, many fools consider themselves incarnations of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but the result is that after leaving the material body they enter the species of jackals. Persons who cannot understand the real significance of an incarnation must attain such lower species of life as punishment. Conditioned souls who are puffed up by false egoism and who try to become one with the Supreme Lord become Māyāvādīs.

TEXT 98

eka-mātra ‘amṣī’——kṛṣṇa, ‘amśa’——avatāra

amṣī amśe dekhi jyeṣṭha-kaniṣṭha-ācāra

SYNONYMS

eka-mātra—only one; *amṣī*—source of all incarnations; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *amśa*—of the part; *avatāra*—incarnations; *amṣī*—is the source of all incarnations; *amśe*—in the incarnation; *dekhi*—we can see; *jyeṣṭha*—as superior; *kaniṣṭha*—and inferior; *ācāra*—behavior.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa is the source of all incarnations, and all others are His parts or partial incarnations. We find that the whole and the part behave as superior and inferior.

TEXT 99

jyeṣṭha-bhāve amṣīte haya prabhu-jñāna

kaniṣṭha-bhāve āpanāte bhakta-abhimāna

SYNONYMS

jyeṣṭha-bhāve—in the emotion of being superior; *aṁśīte*—in the original source of all incarnations; *haya*—there is; *prabhu-jñāna*—knowledge as master; *kaniṣṭha-bhāve*—in an inferior conception; *āpanāte*—in Himself; *bhakta-abhimāna*—the conception of being a devotee.

TRANSLATION

The source of all incarnations has the emotions of a superior when He considers Himself the master, and He has the emotions of an inferior when He considers Himself a devotee.

PURPORT

A fraction of a particular thing is called a part, and that from which the fraction is distinguished is called the whole. Therefore the fraction, or part, is included within the whole. The Lord is the whole, and the devotee is the part or fractional part. That is the relationship between the Lord and the devotee. There are also gradations of devotees, who are calculated as greater or lesser. When a devotee is great he is called *prabhu*, and when he is lesser he is called *bhakta*, or a devotee. The supreme whole is Kṛṣṇa, and Baladeva and all Viṣṇu incarnations are His fractions. Lord Kṛṣṇa is therefore conscious of His superior position, and all Viṣṇu incarnations are conscious of Their positions as devotees.

TEXT 100

kṛṣṇera samatā haite baḍa bhakta-pada

ātmā haite kṛṣṇera bhakta haya premāspada

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—with Lord Kṛṣṇa; *samatā*—equality; *haite*—than this; *baḍa*—

greater; *bhakta-pada*—the position of a devotee; *ātmā haite*—than His own self; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhakta*—a devotee; *haya*—is; *prema-āspada*—the object of love.

TRANSLATION

The position of being a devotee is higher than that of equality with Lord Kṛṣṇa, for the devotees are dearer to Lord Kṛṣṇa than His own self.

PURPORT

The conception of oneness with the Supreme Personality of Godhead is inferior to that of eternal service to the Lord because Lord Kṛṣṇa is more affectionate to devotees than to His personal self. In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (9.4.68) the Lord clearly says:

*sādhavo hṛdayaṁ mahyaṁ
sādhūnāṁ hṛdayaṁ tv aham
mad anyat te na jānanti
nāhaṁ tebhyo manāg api*

“The devotees are My heart, and I am the heart of My devotees. My devotees do not know anyone but Me; similarly, I do not know anyone but My devotees.” This is the intimate relationship between the Lord and His devotees.

TEXT 101

ātmā haite kṛṣṇa bhakte baḍa kari' māne

ihāte bahuta sāstra-vacana pramāṇe

SYNONYMS

ātmā haite—than His own self; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhakte*—His

devotee; *baḍa kari' māne*—accepts as greater; *ihāte*—in this connection; *bahuta*—many; *śāstra-vacana*—quotations from revealed scripture; *pramāṇe*—evidences.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa considers His devotees greater than Himself. In this connection the scriptures provide an abundance of evidence.

TEXT 102

na tathā me priya-tama

ātma-yonir na śaṅkaraḥ

na ca saṅkarṣaṇo na śrīr

naivātmā ca yathā bhavān

SYNONYMS

na tathā—not so much; *me*—My; *priya-tamaḥ*—deardest; *ātma-yonir*—Lord Brahmā; *na śaṅkaraḥ*—nor Śaṅkara (Lord Śiva); *na ca*—nor; *saṅkarṣaṇaḥ*—Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa; *na*—nor; *śrīr*—the goddess of fortune; *na*—nor; *eva*—certainly; *ātmā*—My self; *ca*—and; *yathā*—as; *bhavān*—you.

TRANSLATION

“O Uddhava! Neither Brahmā, nor Śaṅkara, nor Saṅkarṣaṇa, nor Lakṣmī, nor even My own self is as dear to Me as you.”

PURPORT

This text is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.14.15).

TEXT 103

kṛṣṇa-sāmye nahe tāñra mādihuryāsvādana

bhakta-bhāve kare tāñra mādihurya carvaṇa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-sāmye—on an equal level with Kṛṣṇa; *nahe*—not; *tāñra*—His; *mādihurya-āsvādana*—relishing the sweetness; *bhakta-bhāve*—as a devotee; *kare*—does; *tāñra*—His; *mādihurya carvaṇa*—chewing of the sweetness.

TRANSLATION

The sweetness of Lord Kṛṣṇa is not to be tasted by those who consider themselves equal to Kṛṣṇa. It is to be tasted only through the sentiment of servitude.

TEXT 104

śāstrera siddhānta ei,——vijñera anubhava

mūḍha-loka nāhi jāne bhāvera vaibhava

SYNONYMS

śāstrera—of the revealed scriptures; *siddhānta*—conclusion; *ei*—this; *vijñera anubhava*—realization by experienced devotees; *mūḍha-loka*—fools and rascals; *nāhi jāne*—do not know; *bhāvera vaibhava*—devotional opulences.

TRANSLATION

This conclusion of the revealed scriptures is also the realization of

experienced devotees. Fools and rascals, however, cannot understand the opulences of devotional emotions.

PURPORT

When a person is liberated in the *sārūpya* form of liberation, having a spiritual form exactly like Viṣṇu, it is not possible for him to relish the relationship of Kṛṣṇa's personal associates in their exchanges of mellows. The devotees of Kṛṣṇa, however, in their loving relationships with Kṛṣṇa, sometimes forget their own identities; sometimes they think themselves one with Kṛṣṇa and yet relish still greater transcendental mellow in that way. People in general, because of their foolishness only, try to become masters of everything, forgetting the transcendental mellow of servitorship to the Lord. When a person is actually advanced in spiritual understanding, however, he can accept the transcendental servitorship of the Lord without hesitation.

TEXTS 105–106

bhakta-bhāva aṅgīkari' balarāma, lakṣmaṇa

advaita, nityānanda, śeṣa, saṅkarṣaṇa

kṛṣṇera mādhubhya-rasāmṛta kare pāna

sei sukhe matta, kichu nāhi jāne āna

SYNONYMS

bhakta-bhāva—the conception of being a devotee; *aṅgīkari'*—accepting; *balarāma*—Lord Balarāma; *lakṣmaṇa*—Lord Lakṣmaṇa; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *śeṣa*—Lord Śeṣa; *saṅkarṣaṇa*—Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mādhubhya*—transcendental bliss; *rasa-amṛta*—the nectar of such a taste; *kare pāna*—they drink; *sei sukhe*—in such happiness; *matta*—mad; *kichu*—anything; *nāhi*—do

not; *jāne*—know; *āna*—else.

TRANSLATION

Baladeva, Lakṣmaṇa, Advaita Ācārya, Lord Nityānanda, Lord Śeṣa and Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa taste the nectarean mellows of the transcendental bliss of Lord Kṛṣṇa by recognizing Themselves as being His devotees and servants. They are all mad with that happiness, and they know nothing else.

TEXT 107

anyera āchuk kārya, āpane śrī-kṛṣṇa

āpana-mādhurya-pāne ha-ilā satṛṣṇa

SYNONYMS

anyera—of others; *āchuk*—let be; *kārya*—the business; *āpane*—personally; *śrī-kṛṣṇa*—Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *āpana-mādhurya*—personal sweetness; *pāne*—in drinking; *ha-ilā*—became; *sa-tṛṣṇa*—very eager.

TRANSLATION

What to speak of others, even Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself becomes thirsty to taste His own sweetness.

TEXT 108

svā-mādhurya āsvādite kareṇa yatana

bhakta-bhāva vinu nahe tāhā āsvādana

SYNONYMS

svā-mādhurya—the sweetness of Himself; *āsvādīte*—to taste; *karena yatana*—makes endeavors; *bhakta-bhāva*—the emotion of being a devotee; *vinu*—without; *nahe*—there is not; *tāhā*—that; *āsvādana*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

He tries to taste His own sweetness, but He cannot do so without accepting the emotions of a devotee.

PURPORT

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa wanted to relish the transcendental mellow of a devotee, and therefore He accepted the role of a devotee by appearing as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 109

bhakta-bhāva aṅgīkari' hailā avatīrṇa

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-rūpe sarva-bhāve pūrṇa

SYNONYMS

bhakta-bhāva—the ecstasy of being a devotee; *aṅgīkari'*—accepting; *hailā*—became; *avatīrṇa*—incarnated; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-rūpe*—in the form of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *sarva-bhāve pūrṇa*—complete in every respect.

TRANSLATION

Therefore Lord Kṛṣṇa accepted the position of a devotee and descended in the form of Lord Caitanya, who is complete in every respect.

TEXT 110

nānā-bhakta-bhāve kareṇa sva-mādhurya pāna

pūrve kariyāchi ei siddhānta vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

nānā-bhakta-bhāve—various emotions of a devotee; *kareṇa*—does; *sva-mādhurya pāna*—drinking the sweetness of Himself; *pūrve*—formerly; *kariyāchi*—I discussed; *ei*—this; *siddhānta*—conclusion; *vyākhyāna*—the explanation.

TRANSLATION

He tastes His own sweetness through the various emotions of a devotee. I have formerly explained this conclusion.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya, who is known as Śrī Gaurahari, is complete in relishing all the different mellows, namely neutrality, servitorship, fraternity, parental affection and conjugal love. By accepting the ecstasy of different grades of devotees, He is complete in relishing all the mellows of these relationships.

TEXT 111

avatāra-gaṇera bhakta-bhāve adhikāra

bhakta-bhāva haite adhika sukha nāhi āra

SYNONYMS

avatāra-gaṇera—of all the incarnations; *bhakta-bhāve*—in the emotion of a devotee; *adhikāra*—there is the right; *bhakta-bhāva*—the emotion of being a devotee; *haite*—than; *adhika*—greater; *sukha*—happiness;

nāhi—not; *āra*—any other.

TRANSLATION

All the incarnations are entitled to the emotions of devotees. There is no higher bliss than this.

PURPORT

All the different incarnations of Lord Viṣṇu have the right to play the roles of servitors of Lord Kṛṣṇa by descending as devotees. When an incarnation gives up the understanding of His Godhood and plays the part of a servitor, He enjoys a greater taste of transcendental mellows than when He plays the part of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 112

mūla bhakta-avatāra śrī-saṅkarṣaṇa

bhakta-avatāra tañhi advaite gaṇana

SYNONYMS

mūla—original; *bhakta*—of a devotee; *avatāra*—incarnation; *śrī-saṅkarṣaṇa*—Lord Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa; *bhakta-avatāra*—the incarnation of a devotee; *tañhi*—as that; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *gaṇana*—counting.

TRANSLATION

The original bhakta-avatāra is Saṅkarṣaṇa. Śrī Advaita is counted among such incarnations.

PURPORT

Although Śrī Advaita Prabhu belongs to the Viṣṇu category, He displays

servitorship to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu as one of His associates. When Lord Viṣṇu appears as a servitor, He is called an incarnation of a devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa, who is an incarnation of Viṣṇu in the spiritual sky known as the greater Vaikuṇṭha, is the chief of the quadruple incarnations and is the original incarnation of a devotee. Lord Mahā-Viṣṇu, who is lying on the Causal Ocean, is a manifestation of Saṅkarṣaṇa. He is the original Personality of Godhead who glances over the material and efficient causes of the cosmic manifestation. Advaita Prabhu is accepted as an incarnation of Mahā-Viṣṇu. All the plenary manifestations of Saṅkarṣaṇa are indirect expansions of Lord Kṛṣṇa. That consideration also makes Advaita Prabhu an eternal servitor of Gaura Kṛṣṇa. Therefore He is accepted as a devotee incarnation.

TEXT 113

advaita-ācārya gosāñīra mahimā apāra

yāñhāra huñkāre kaila caitanyāvatāra

SYNONYMS

advaita-ācārya—Advaita Ācārya; *gosāñīra*—of the Lord; *mahimā apāra*—unlimited glories; *yāñhāra*—of whom; *huñkāre*—by the vibration; *kaila*—brought; *caitanya-avatāra*—the incarnation of Lord Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

The glories of Śrī Advaita Ācārya are boundless, for His sincere vibrations brought about Lord Caitanya's descent upon this earth.

TEXT 114

sañkīrtana pracāriyā saba jagat tārila

advaita-prasāde loka prema-dhana pāila

SYNONYMS

saṅkīrtana pracāriyā—by preaching the cult of *saṅkīrtana*; *saba*—all; *jagat*—the universe; *tārila*—delivered; *advaita-prasāde*—by the mercy of Advaita Ācārya; *loka*—all people; *prema-dhana pāila*—received the treasure of loving God.

TRANSLATION

He liberated the universe by preaching saṅkīrtana. Thus the people of the world received the treasure of love of Godhead through the mercy of Śrī Advaita.

TEXT 115

advaita-mahimā ananta ke pāre kahite

sei likhi, yei śuni mahājana haite

SYNONYMS

advaita-mahimā—the glories of Advaita Ācārya; *ananta*—unlimited; *ke*—who; *pāre*—is able; *kahite*—to say; *sei*—that; *likhi*—I write; *yei*—whatever; *śuni*—I hear; *mahājana haite*—from authority.

TRANSLATION

Who can describe the unlimited glories of Advaita Ācārya? I write here as much as I have known from great authorities.

TEXT 116

ācārya-caraṇe mora koṭi namaskāra

ithe kichu aparādha nā labe āmāra

SYNONYMS

ācārya-caraṇe—at the lotus feet of Advaita Ācārya; *mora*—my; *koṭi namaskāra*—offering obeisances ten million times; *ithe*—in this connection; *kichu*—some; *aparādha*—offense; *nā labe*—please do not take; *āmāra*—my.

TRANSLATION

I offer my obeisances ten million times to the lotus feet of Śrī Advaita Ācārya. Please do not take offense at this.

TEXT 117

tomāra mahimā—koṭi-samudra agādha

tāhāra iyattā kahi,—e baḍa aparādha

SYNONYMS

tomāra mahimā—Your glories; *koṭi-samudra agādha*—as unfathomable as the millions of seas and oceans; *tāhāra*—of that; *iyattā*—the measure; *kahi*—I say; *e*—this; *baḍa*—great; *aparādha*—offense.

TRANSLATION

Your glories are as fathomless as millions of oceans and seas. Speaking of its measure is a great offense indeed.

TEXT 118

jaya jaya jaya śrī-advaita ācārya

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya, nityānanda ārya

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *jaya*—all glories; *śrī-advaita ācārya*—to Śrī Advaita Ācārya; *jaya jaya*—all glories; *śrī-caitanya*—to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *ārya*—the superior.

TRANSLATION

All glories, all glories to Śrī Advaita Ācārya! All glories to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and the superior Lord Nityānanda!

TEXT 119

dui śloke kahila advaita-tattva-nirūpaṇa

pañca-tattvera vicāra kichu śuna, bhakta-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

dui śloke—in two verses; *kahila*—described; *advaita*—Advaita; *tattva-nirūpaṇa*—ascertaining the truth; *pañca-tattvera*—of the five truths; *vicāra*—consideration; *kichu*—something; *śuna*—please hear; *bhakta-gaṇa*—O devotees.

TRANSLATION

Thus in two verses I have described the truth concerning Advaita Ācārya. Now, O devotees, please hear about the five truths [pañca-tattva].

TEXT 120

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādilīlā, Sixth Chapter, describing the glories of Śrī Advaita Ācārya.

Chapter 7

Lord Caitanya in Five Features

TEXT 1

agaty-eka-gatim natvā

hīnāarthādhika-sādhakam

śrī-caitanyam likhyate 'sya

prema-bhakti-vadānyatā

SYNONYMS

agati—of the most fallen; *eka*—the only one; *gatim*—destination; *natvā*—after offering obeisances; *hīna*—inferior; *artha*—interest;

adhika—greater than that; *sādhakam*—who can render; *śrī-caitanyam*—unto Lord Śrī Caitanya; *likhyate*—is being written; *asya*—of the Lord, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *prema*—love; *bhakti*—devotional service; *vadānyatā*—magnanimity.

TRANSLATION

Let me first offer my respectful obeisances unto Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is the ultimate goal of life for one bereft of all possessions in this material world and is the only meaning for one advancing in spiritual life. Thus let me write about His magnanimous contribution of devotional service in love of God.

PURPORT

A person in the conditioned stage of material existence is in an atmosphere of helplessness, but the conditioned soul, under the illusion of *māyā*, or the external energy, thinks that he is completely protected by his country, society, friendship and love, not knowing that at the time of death none of these can save him. The laws of material nature are so strong that none of our material possessions can save us from the cruel hands of death. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (13.9) it is stated, *janma-mṛtyu-jarā-vyādhi-duḥkha-doṣānudarśanam*: one who is actually advancing must always consider the four principles of miserable life, namely, birth, death, old age and disease. One cannot be saved from all these miseries unless he takes shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is therefore the only shelter for all conditioned souls. An intelligent person, therefore, does not put his faith in any material possessions, but completely takes shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord. Such a person is called *akiñcana*, or one who does not possess anything in this material world. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is also known as Akiñcana-gocara, for He can be achieved by a person who does not put his faith in material possessions. Therefore, for the fully surrendered soul who has no material possessions on which to depend, Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the only shelter.

Everyone depends upon *dharma* (religiosity), *artha* (economic development), *kāma* (sense gratification) and ultimately *mokṣa* (salvation), but Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, due to His magnanimous character, can give more than salvation. Therefore in this verse the words *hīnārthādhika-sādhakam* indicate that although by material estimation salvation is of a quality superior to the inferior interests of religiosity, economic development and sense gratification, above salvation there is the position of devotional service and transcendental love for the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the bestower of this great benediction. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu said, *premā pum-artho mahān*: “Love of Godhead is the ultimate benediction for all human beings.” Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, therefore first offers his respectful obeisances unto Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu before describing His magnanimity in bestowing love of Godhead.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya mahāprabhu śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

tānhāra caraṇāśrita, sei baḍa dhanya

SYNONYMS

jaya—all glories; *jaya*—all glories; *mahāprabhu*—unto the Supreme Lord; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *tānhāra*—of His; *caraṇa-āśrita*—one who has taken shelter of the lotus feet; *sei*—he; *baḍa*—is very much; *dhanya*—glorified.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer glorification to the Supreme Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. One who has taken shelter of His lotus feet is the most glorified person.

PURPORT

Prabhu means master. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the supreme master of all masters; therefore He is called Mahāprabhu. Any person who takes shelter of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu is most glorified because by the mercy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu he is able to get promotion to the platform of loving service to the Lord, which is transcendental to salvation.

TEXT 3

pūrve gurv-ādi chaya tattve kaila namaskāra

guru-tattva kahiyāchi, ebe pāñcera vicāra

SYNONYMS

pūrve—in the beginning; *guru-ādi*—the spiritual master and others; *chaya*—six; *tattve*—in the subjects of; *kaila*—I have done; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *guru-tattva*—the truth in understanding the spiritual master; *kahiyāchi*—I have already described; *ebe*—now; *pāñcera*—of the five; *vicāra*—consideration.

TRANSLATION

In the beginning I have discussed the truth about the spiritual master. Now I shall try to explain the Pañca-tattva.

PURPORT

In the First Chapter of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā*, the author, Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, has described the initiator spiritual master and the instructor spiritual master in the verse beginning with the words *vande gurūn īśa-bhaktān īśam īśāvatārakān* [Cc. Ādi 1.1]. In that verse there are six transcendental subject matters, of which the truth regarding the spiritual master has already been described. Now the author will describe the other five *tattvas* (truths), namely, *īśa-tattva* (the

Supreme Lord), His expansion *tattva*, His incarnation *tattva*, His energy *tattva* and His devotee *tattva*.

TEXT 4

pañca-tattva avatīrṇa caitanyera saṅge

pañca-tattva lañā kareṇa saṅkīrtana raṅge

SYNONYMS

pañca-tattva—these five *tattvas*; *avatīrṇa*—advented; *caitanyera*—with Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *saṅge*—in company with; *pañca-tattva*—the same five subjects; *lañā*—taking with Himself; *kareṇa*—He does; *saṅkīrtana*—the *saṅkīrtana* movement; *raṅge*—in great pleasure.

TRANSLATION

These five *tattvas* incarnate with Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and thus the Lord executes His *saṅkīrtana* movement with great pleasure.

PURPORT

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.5.32) there is the following statement regarding Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu:

*kṛṣṇa-varṇam tviṣākṛṣṇam sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam
yajñaiḥ saṅkīrtana-prāyair yajanti hi su-medhasaḥ*

“In the Age of Kali, people who are endowed with sufficient intelligence will worship the Lord, who is accompanied by His associates, by performance of the *saṅkīrtana-yajña*.” Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is always accompanied by His plenary expansion Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, His incarnation Śrī Advaita Prabhu, His internal potency Śrī Gadādhara Prabhu and His marginal potency Śrīvāsa Prabhu. He is in the midst of

them as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. One should know that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is always accompanied by these other *tattvas*. Therefore our obeisances to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu are complete when we say *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. As preachers of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, we first offer our obeisances to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu by chanting this Pañca-tattva *mantra*; then we say Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare. There are ten offenses in the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, but these are not considered in the chanting of the Pañca-tattva *mantra*, namely, *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is known as *mahā-vadānyāvatāra*, the most magnanimous incarnation, for He does not consider the offenses of the fallen souls. Thus to derive the full benefit of the chanting of the *mahā-mantra* (Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare), we must first take shelter of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, learn the Pañca-tattva *mahā-mantra*, and then chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. That will be very effective.

Taking advantage of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, many unscrupulous devotees manufacture a *mahā-mantra* of their own. Sometimes they sing *bhaja nitāi gaura rādhe śyāma hare kṛṣṇa hare rāma* or *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda hare kṛṣṇa hare rāma śrī-rādhe govinda*. Actually, however, one should chant the names of the full Pañca-tattva (*śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*) and then the sixteen words Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare. But these unscrupulous, less intelligent men confuse the entire process. Of course, since they are also devotees they can express their feelings in that way, but the method prescribed by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's pure devotees is to first chant the full Pañca-tattva *mantra* and then chant the *mahā-mantra*—Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare.

TEXT 5

pañca-tattva—eka-vastu, nāhi kichu bheda

rasa āsvādite tabu vividha vibheda

SYNONYMS

pañca-tattva—the five subjects; *eka-vastu*—they are one in five; *nāhi*—there is not; *kichu*—anything; *bheda*—difference; *rasa*—mellows; *āsvādite*—to taste; *tabu*—yet; *vividha*—varieties; *vibheda*—differences.

TRANSLATION

Spiritually there are no differences between these five tattvas, for on the transcendental platform everything is absolute. Yet there are also varieties in the spiritual world, and in order to taste these spiritual varieties one should distinguish between them.

PURPORT

In his *Anubhāṣya* commentary Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura describes the Pañca-tattva as follows: The supreme energetic, the Personality of Godhead, manifesting in order to enjoy five kinds of pastimes, appears as the members of the Pañca-tattva. Actually there is no difference between them because they are situated on the absolute platform, but they manifest different spiritual varieties as a challenge to the impersonalists to taste different kinds of spiritual humors (*rasas*). In the *Vedas* it is said, *parāśya śaktir vividhaiva śrūyate*: “The varieties of energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead are differently known.” From this statement of the *Vedas* one can understand that there are eternal varieties of humors, or tastes, in the spiritual world. Śrī Gaurāṅga, Śrī Nityānanda, Śrī Advaita, Śrī Gadādhara and Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura are all on the same platform, but in spiritually distinguishing between them one should understand that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is

the form of a devotee, Nityānanda Prabhu appears in the form of a devotee's spiritual master, Advaita Prabhu is the form of a *bhakta* (devotee) incarnation, Gadādhara Prabhu is the energy of a *bhakta*, and Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura is a pure devotee. Thus there are spiritual distinctions between them. The *bhakta-rūpa* (Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu), the *bhakta-svarūpa* (Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu) and the *bhakta-avatāra* (Śrī Advaita Prabhu) are described as the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself, His immediate manifestation and His plenary expansion, and They all belong to the Viṣṇu category. Although the spiritual and marginal energies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead are nondifferent from the Supreme Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu, they are predominated subjects, whereas Lord Viṣṇu is the predominator. As such, although they are on the same platform, they have appeared differently in order to facilitate tasting of transcendental mellows. Actually, however, there is no possibility of one being different from the other, for the worshiper and the worshipable cannot be separated at any stage. On the absolute platform, one cannot be understood without the other.

TEXT 6

pañca-tattvātmakam kṛṣṇam

bhakta-rūpa-svarūpakam

bhaktāvatāram bhaktākhyam

namāmi bhakta-śaktikam

SYNONYMS

pañca-tattva-ātmakam—comprehending the five transcendental subject matters; *kṛṣṇam*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhakta-rūpa*—in the form of a devotee; *svarūpakam*—in the expansion of a devotee; *bhakta-avatāram*—in the incarnation of a devotee; *bhakta-ākhyam*—known as a devotee; *namāmi*—I offer my obeisances; *bhakta-śaktikam*—the energy of the

Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my obeisances unto Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who has manifested Himself in five as a devotee, expansion of a devotee, incarnation of a devotee, pure devotee and devotional energy.

PURPORT

Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu is the immediate expansion of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as His brother. He is the personified spiritual bliss of *sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha* [Bs. 5.1]. His body is transcendental and full of ecstasy in devotional service. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is therefore called *bhakta-rūpa* (the form of a devotee), and Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu is called *bhakta-svarūpa* (the expansion of a devotee). Śrī Advaita Prabhu, the incarnation of a devotee, is *viṣṇu-tattva* and belongs to the same category. There are also different types of *bhaktas*, or devotees, on the platforms of neutrality, servitude, friendship, parenthood and conjugal love. Devotees like Śrī Dāmodara, Śrī Gadādhara and Śrī Rāmānanda are different energies. This confirms the Vedic *sūtra parāśya śaktir vividhaiva śrūyate*. All these *bhakta* subjects taken together constitute Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is Kṛṣṇa Himself.

TEXT 7

svayam bhagavān kṛṣṇa ekale īśvara

advitīya, nandātmaja, rasika-śekhara

SYNONYMS

svayam—Himself; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ekale*—the only one; *īśvara*—the supreme controller; *advitīya*—without a second; *nanda-ātmaja*—appeared as the

son of Mahārāja Nanda; *rasika*—enjoyer of mellows; *śekhara*—summit.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa, the reservoir of all pleasure, is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself, the supreme controller. No one is greater than or equal to Śrī Kṛṣṇa, yet He appears as the son of Mahārāja Nanda.

PURPORT

In this verse Kavirāja Gosvāmī gives an accurate description of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, by stating that although no one is equal to or greater than Him and He is the reservoir of all spiritual pleasure, He nevertheless appears as the son of Mahārāja Nanda and Yaśodāmayī.

TEXT 8

rāsādi-vilāsī, vrajalalanā-nāgara

āra yata saba dekha, — — tāñra parikara

SYNONYMS

rāsa-ādi—the *rāsa* dance; *vilāsī*—the enjoyer; *vraja-lalanā*—the damsels of Vṛndāvana; *nāgara*—the leader; *āra*—others; *yata*—all; *saba*—everyone; *dekha*—must know; *tāñra*—His; *parikara*—associates.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the supreme enjoyer in the *rāsa* dance. He is the leader of the damsels of Vraja, and all others are simply His associates.

PURPORT

The word *rāsādi-vilāsī* (“the enjoyer of the *rāsa* dance”) is very important. The *rāsa* dance can be enjoyed only by Śrī Kṛṣṇa because He is the supreme leader and chief of the damsels of Vṛndāvana. All others are His devotees and associates. Although no one can compare with Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, there are many unscrupulous rascals who imitate the *rāsa* dance of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. They are Māyāvādīs, and people should be wary of them. The *rāsa* dance can be performed only by Śrī Kṛṣṇa and no one else.

TEXT 9

sei kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

sei parikara-gaṇa saṅge saba dhanya

SYNONYMS

sei kṛṣṇa—that very Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatīrṇa*—has advented; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—in the form of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sei*—those; *parikara-gaṇa*—associates; *saṅge*—with Him; *saba*—all; *dhanya*—glorious.

TRANSLATION

The selfsame Lord Kṛṣṇa advented Himself as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu with all His eternal associates, who are also equally glorious.

TEXT 10

ekale īśvara-tattva caitanya-īśvara

bhakta-bhāvamaya tāṇra śuddha kalevara

SYNONYMS

ekale—only one person; *īśvara-tattva*—the supreme controller; *caitanya*—the supreme living force; *īśvara*—controller; *bhakta-bhāva-maya*—in the ecstasy of a devotee; *tāñra*—His; *śuddha*—transcendental; *kalevara*—body.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is the supreme controller, the one Personality of Godhead, has ecstatically become a devotee, yet His body is transcendental and not materially tinged.

PURPORT

There are different *tattvas*, or truths, including *īśa-tattva*, *jīva-tattva* and *śakti-tattva*. *īśa-tattva* refers to the Supreme Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu, who is the supreme living force. In the *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* it is said, *nityo nityānāṁ cetanaś cetanānām*: the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the supreme eternal and the supreme living force. The living entities are also eternal and are also living forces, but they are very minute in quantity, whereas the Supreme Lord is the supreme living force and the supreme eternal. The supreme eternal never accepts a body of a temporary material nature, whereas the living entities, who are part and parcel of the supreme eternal, are prone to do so. Thus according to the Vedic *mantras* the Supreme Lord is the supreme master of innumerable living entities.

The Māyāvādī philosophers, however, try to equate the minute living entities with the supreme living entity. Because they recognize no distinctions between them, their philosophy is called Advaita-vāda, or monism. Factually, however, there is a distinction. This verse is especially meant to impart to the Māyāvādī philosopher the understanding that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the supreme controller. The supreme controller, the Personality of Godhead, is Kṛṣṇa Himself, but as a transcendental pastime He has accepted the form of a devotee, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

As stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, when the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa comes to this planet exactly like a human being, some rascals consider Him to be one of the ordinary humans. One who thinks in that mistaken way is described as *mūḍha*, or foolish. Therefore one should not foolishly consider Caitanya Mahāprabhu to be an ordinary human being. He has accepted the ecstasy of a devotee, but He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Since the time of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, there have been many imitation incarnations of Kṛṣṇa who cannot understand that Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Kṛṣṇa Himself and not an ordinary human being. Less intelligent men create their own “Gods” by advertising a human being as God. This is their mistake. Therefore here the words *tāñira śuddha kalevara* warn that Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s body is not material but purely spiritual. One should not, therefore, accept Caitanya Mahāprabhu as an ordinary devotee, although He has assumed the form of a devotee. Yet one must certainly know that although Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, because He accepted the ecstasy of a devotee one should not misunderstand His pastimes and place Him in exactly the same position as Kṛṣṇa. It is for this reason only that when Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu was addressed as Kṛṣṇa or Viṣṇu He blocked His ears, not wanting to hear Himself addressed as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. There is a class of devotees called Gaurāṅga-nāgarī, who stage plays of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes using a *vigraha*, or form, of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. This is a mistake that is technically called *rasābhāsa*. While Caitanya Mahāprabhu is trying to enjoy as a devotee, one should not disturb Him by addressing Him as the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 11

kṛṣṇa-mādhuryera eka adbhuta svabhāva

āpanā āsvādīte kṛṣṇa kare bhakta-bhāva

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-mādhuryera—the supreme pleasure potency of Kṛṣṇa; *eka*—is one; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *svabhāva*—nature; *āpanā*—Himself; *āsvādite*—to taste; *kṛṣṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kare*—does; *bhakta-bhāva*—accept the form of a devotee.

TRANSLATION

The transcendental mellow of conjugal love of Kṛṣṇa is so wonderful that Kṛṣṇa Himself accepts the form of a devotee to relish and taste it fully.

PURPORT

Although Kṛṣṇa is the reservoir of all pleasure, He has a special intention to taste Himself by accepting the form of a devotee. It is to be concluded that although Lord Caitanya is present in the form of a devotee, He is Kṛṣṇa Himself. Therefore Vaiṣṇavas sing, *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya rādhā-kṛṣṇa nahe anya*: “Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa combined together are Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu.” And as Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī has said, *caitanyākhyam prakāṣam adhunā tad-dvayam caikyam āptam*: Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa assumed oneness in the form of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 12

ithe bhakta-bhāva dhare caitanya gosāñi

‘bhakta-svarūpa’ tānra nityānanda-bhāi

SYNONYMS

ithe—for this reason; *bhakta-bhāva*—the ecstasy of a devotee; *dhare*—accepts; *caitanya*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gosāñi*—the transcendental teacher; *bhakta-svarūpa*—exactly like a pure devotee; *tānra*—His; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *bhāi*—brother.

TRANSLATION

For this reason Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the supreme teacher, accepts the form of a devotee and accepts Lord Nityānanda as His elder brother.

TEXT 13

‘bhakta-avatāra’ tāñra ācārya-gosāñī

ei tina tattva sabe prabhu kari’ gāi

SYNONYMS

bhakta-avatāra—incarnation as a devotee; *tāñra*—His; *ācārya-gosāñī*—the supreme teacher, Advaita Ācārya Prabhu; *ei*—all these; *tina*—three; *tattva*—truths; *sabe*—all; *prabhu*—the predominator; *kari’*—by such understanding; *gāi*—we sing.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya is Lord Caitanya’s incarnation as a devotee. Therefore these three tattvas [Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu and Advaita Gosāñī] are the predominators, or masters.

PURPORT

Gosāñī means *gosvāmī*. A person who has full control over the senses and mind is called a *gosvāmī* or *gosāñī*. One who does not have such control is called a *godāsa*, or a servant of the senses, and cannot become a spiritual master. A spiritual master who actually has control over the mind and senses is called *Gosvāmī*. Although the *Gosvāmī* title has become a hereditary designation for unscrupulous men, actually the title *Gosāñī*, or *Gosvāmī*, began from Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, who presented himself as an ordinary *gr̥hastha* and minister in government service but became a *gosvāmī* when he was actually elevated by the instruction of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Therefore *Gosvāmī* is not a hereditary title but refers to one’s qualifications. When one is highly elevated in spiritual

advancement, regardless of wherefrom he comes, he may be called Gosvāmī. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu and Śrī Advaita Gosāñi Prabhu are natural *gosvāmīs* because They belong to the *viṣṇu-tattva* category. As such, all of Them are *prabhus* (“predominators” or “masters”), and They are sometimes called Caitanya Gosāñi, Nityānanda Gosāñi and Advaita Gosāñi. Unfortunately, Their so-called descendants who do not have the qualifications of *gosvāmīs* have accepted this title as a hereditary designation or a professional degree. That is not in accord with the śāstric injunctions.

TEXT 14

eka mahāprabhu, āra prabhu duijana

dui prabhu seve mahāprabhura caraṇa

SYNONYMS

eka mahāprabhu—one Mahāprabhu, or the supreme predominator; *āra prabhu duijana*—and the other two (Nityānanda and Advaita) are two *prabhus* (masters); *dui prabhu*—the two *prabhus* (Nityānanda and Advaita Gosāñi); *seve*—serve; *mahāprabhura*—of the supreme predominator, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *caraṇa*—the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

One of Them is Mahāprabhu, and the other two are prabhus. These two prabhus serve the lotus feet of Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

Although Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu and Śrī Advaita Prabhu all belong to the same Viṣṇu category, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is nevertheless accepted as the Supreme, and the other two *prabhus* engage in His transcendental loving service to teach ordinary

living entities that every one of us is subordinate to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. In another place in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* (Ādi 5.142) it is said, *ekale īśvara kṛṣṇa, āra saba bhr̥tya*: the only supreme master is Kṛṣṇa, and all others, both *viṣṇu-tattva* and *jīva-tattva*, engage in the service of the Lord. Both the *viṣṇu-tattva* (as Nityānanda Prabhu and Advaita) and the *jīva-tattva* (*śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*) engage in the service of the Lord, but one must distinguish between the *viṣṇu-tattva* servitors and the *jīva-tattva* servitors. The *jīva-tattva* servitor, the spiritual master, is actually the servitor God. As explained in previous verses, in the absolute world there are no such differences, yet one must observe these differences in order to distinguish the Supreme from His subordinates.

TEXT 15

ei tina tattva,——‘sarvārādhya’ kari māni

caturtha ye bhakta-tattva,——‘ārādhaka’ jāni

SYNONYMS

ei tina tattva—all three of these truths; *sarva-ārādhya*—worshipable by all living entities; *kari māni*—accepting such; *caturtha*—fourth; *ye*—who is; *bhakta-tattva*—in the category of devotees; *ārādhaka*—worshiper; *jāni*—I understand.

TRANSLATION

The three predominators [Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu and Advaita Prabhu] are worshipable by all living entities, and the fourth principle [Śrī Gadādhara Prabhu] is to be understood as Their worshiper.

PURPORT

In his *Anubhāṣya*, Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, describing the

truth about the Pañca-tattva, explains that we should understand that Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the supreme predominator and that Nityānanda Prabhu and Advaita Prabhu are His subordinates but are also predominators. Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Supreme Lord, and Nityānanda Prabhu and Advaita Prabhu are manifestations of the Supreme Lord. All of Them are *viṣṇu-tattva*, the Supreme, and are therefore worshipable by the living entities. Although the other two *tattvas* within the category of Pañca-tattva—namely, *śakti-tattva* and *jīva-tattva*, represented by Gadādhara and Śrīvāsa—are worshipers of the Supreme Lord, they are in the same category because they eternally engage in the transcendental loving service of the Lord.

TEXT 16

śrīvāsādi yata koṭi koṭi bhakta-gaṇa

‘śuddha-bhakta’-tattva-madhye tān-sabāra gaṇana

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsa-ādi—devotees headed by Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *yata*—all others; *koṭi koṭi*—innumerable; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *śuddha-bhakta*—pure devotees; *tattva-madhye*—in the truth; *tān-sabāra*—all of them; *gaṇana*—counted.

TRANSLATION

There are innumerable pure devotees of the Lord, headed by Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, who are known as unalloyed devotees.

TEXT 17

gadādhara-pañḍitādi prabhura ‘śakti’-avatāra

‘antaraṅga-bhakta’ kari’ gaṇana yānhāra

SYNONYMS

gadādhara—Gadādhara; *paṇḍita*—of the learned scholar; *ādi*—headed by; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *śakti*—potency; *avatāra*—incarnation; *antaraṅga*—very confidential; *bhakta*—devotee; *kari'*—accepting; *gaṇana*—counting; *yāñhāra*—of whom.

TRANSLATION

The devotees headed by Gadādhara Paṇḍita are to be considered incarnations of the internal potency of the Lord. They are confidential devotees engaged in the service of the Lord.

PURPORT

In connection with verses 16 and 17, Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura explains in his *Anubhāṣya*: “There are specific symptoms by which the internal devotees and the unalloyed or pure devotees are to be known. All unalloyed devotees are *śakti-tattvas*, or potencies of the Lord. Some of them are situated in conjugal love and others in filial affection, fraternity and servitude. Certainly all of them are devotees, but by making a comparative study it is found that the devotees or potencies who are engaged in conjugal love are better situated than the others. Thus devotees who are in a relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead in conjugal love are considered to be the most confidential devotees of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Those who engage in the service of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu and Lord Advaita Prabhu generally have relationships of parental love, fraternity, servitude and neutrality. When such devotees develop great attachment for Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, they too become situated within the intimate circle of devotees in conjugal love.” This gradual development of devotional service is described by Śrī Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura as follows:

gaurāṅga balite habe pulaka śarīra
hari hari balite nayane ba'be nīra

*āra kabe nitāicānda karuṇā karibe
saṁsāra-vāsanā mora kabe tuccha habe*

*viṣaya chāḍiyā kabe śuddha habe mana
kabe hāma heraba śrī-vṛndāvana*

*rūpa-raghunātha-pade ha-ibe ākuti
kabe hāma bujhaba śrī-yugala-pirīti*

“When will there be eruptions on my body as soon as I chant the name of Lord Caitanya, and when will there be incessant torrents of tears as soon as I chant the holy names Hare Kṛṣṇa? When will Lord Nityānanda be merciful toward me and free me from all desires for material enjoyment? When will my mind be completely freed from all contamination of desires for material pleasure? Only at that time will it be possible for me to understand Vṛndāvana. Only if I become attached to the instructions given by the six Gosvāmīs, headed by Rūpa Gosvāmī and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, will it be possible for me to understand the conjugal love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.” By attachment to the devotional service of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, one immediately comes to the ecstatic position. When he develops his love for Nityānanda Prabhu he is freed from all attachment to the material world, and at that time he becomes eligible to understand the Lord’s pastimes in Vṛndāvana. In that condition, when one develops his love for the six Gosvāmīs, he can understand the conjugal love between Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. These are the different stages of a pure devotee’s promotion to conjugal love in the service of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa in an intimate relationship with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXTS 18–19

yāñ-sabā lañā prabhura nitya vihāra

yāñ-sabā lañā prabhura kīrtana-pracāra

yāñ-sabā lañā karena prema āsvādana

yāñ-sabā lañā dāna kare prema-dhana

SYNONYMS

yāñ-sabā—all; *lañā*—taking company; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *nitya*—eternal; *viḥāra*—pastime; *yāñ-sabā*—all those who are; *lañā*—taking company; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *kīrtana*—*sañkīrtana*; *pracāra*—movement; *yāñ-sabā*—persons with whom; *lañā*—in accompaniment; *karena*—He does; *prema*—love of God; *āsvādana*—taste; *yāñ-sabā*—those who are; *lañā*—in accompaniment; *dāna kare*—gives in charity; *prema-dhana*—love of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

The internal devotees or potencies are all eternal associates in the pastimes of the Lord. Only with them does the Lord advent to propound the sañkīrtana movement, only with them does the Lord taste the mellow of conjugal love, and only with them does He distribute this love of God to people in general.

PURPORT

Distinguishing between pure devotees and internal or confidential devotees, Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, in his book *Upadeśāmṛta*, traces the following gradual process of development. Out of many thousands of *karmīs*, one is better when he is situated in perfect Vedic knowledge. Out of many such learned scholars and philosophers, one who is actually liberated from material bondage is better, and out of many such persons who are actually liberated, one who is a devotee of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is considered to be the best. Among the many such transcendental lovers of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the *gopīs* are the best, and among the *gopīs* Śrīmatī Rādhikā is the best. Śrīmatī Rādhikā is very dear to Lord Kṛṣṇa, and similarly Her ponds, namely, Śyāma-kuṇḍa and Rādhā-kuṇḍa, are also very dear to the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura comments in his *Anubhāṣya* that among the five *tattvas*, two are energies (*śakti-tattva*) and the three others are energetic (*śaktimān tattva*). Unalloyed and internal devotees are both engaged in the favorable culture of Kṛṣṇa consciousness untinted by philosophical speculation or fruitive activities. They are all understood to be pure devotees, and those among them who simply engage in conjugal love are called *mādhurya-bhaktas*, or internal devotees. The loving services in parental love, fraternity and servitude are included in conjugal love of God. In conclusion, therefore, every confidential devotee is a pure devotee of the Lord.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu enjoys His pastimes with His immediate expansion Nityānanda Prabhu. His pure devotees and His three *puruṣa* incarnations, namely, Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, always accompany the Supreme Lord to propound the *saṅkīrtana* movement.

TEXTS 20–21

sei pañca-tattva mili' prthivī āsiyā

pūrva-premabhāṇḍārera mudrā ughāḍiyā

pāñce mili' luṭe prema, kare āsvādana

yata yata piye, tṛṣṇā bāḍhe anukṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

sei—those; *pañca-tattva*—five truths; *mili'*—combined together; *prthivī*—on this earth; *āsiyā*—descending; *pūrva*—original; *prema-bhāṇḍārera*—the store of transcendental love; *mudrā*—seal; *ughāḍiyā*—opening; *pāñce mili'*—mixing together all these five; *luṭe*—plunder; *prema*—love of Godhead; *kare āsvādana*—taste; *yata yata*—as much as; *piye*—drink; *tṛṣṇā*—thirst; *bāḍhe*—increases; *anukṣaṇa*—again and

again.

TRANSLATION

The characteristics of Kṛṣṇa are understood to be a storehouse of transcendental love. Although that storehouse of love certainly came with Kṛṣṇa when He was present, it was sealed. But when Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu came with His associates of the Pañca-tattva, they broke the seal and plundered the storehouse to taste transcendental love of Kṛṣṇa. The more they tasted it, the more their thirst for it grew.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is called *mahā-vadānyāvatāra* because although He is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself, He is even more favorably disposed to the poor fallen souls than Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa. When Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself was personally present, He demanded that everyone surrender unto Him and promised that He would then give one all protection, but when Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu came to this earth with His associates, He simply distributed transcendental love of God without discrimination. Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, therefore, could understand that Lord Caitanya was none other than Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself, for no one but the Supreme Personality of Godhead can distribute confidential love of the Supreme Person.

TEXT 22

punaḥ punaḥ piyāiyā haya mahāmatta

nāce, kānde, hāse, gāya, yaiche mada-matta

SYNONYMS

punaḥ punaḥ—again and again; *piyāiyā*—causing to drink; *haya*—becomes; *mahā-matta*—highly ecstatic; *nāce*—dances; *kānde*—cries; *hāse*—laughs; *gāya*—chants; *yaiche*—as if; *mada-matta*—one is drunk.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Pañca-tattva themselves danced again and again and thus made it easier to drink nectarean love of Godhead. They danced, cried, laughed and chanted like madmen, and in this way they distributed love of Godhead.

PURPORT

People generally cannot understand the actual meaning of chanting and dancing. Describing the Gosvāmīs, Śrī Śrīnivāsa Ācārya stated, *kṛṣṇotkīrtana-gāna-nartana-parau*: not only did Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His associates demonstrate this chanting and dancing, but the six Gosvāmīs also followed in the next generation. The present Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement follows the same principle, and therefore simply by chanting and dancing we have received good responses all over the world. It is to be understood, however, that this chanting and dancing do not belong to this material world. They are actually transcendental activities, for the more one engages in chanting and dancing, the more he can taste the nectar of transcendental love of Godhead.

TEXT 23

pātrāpātra-vicāra nāhi, nāhi sthānāsthāna

yei yānhā pāya, tānhā kare prema-dāna

SYNONYMS

pātra—recipient; *apātra*—not a recipient; *vicāra*—consideration; *nāhi*—there is none; *nāhi*—there is none; *sthāna*—favorable place; *asthāna*—unfavorable place; *yei*—anyone; *yānhā*—wherever; *pāya*—gets the opportunity; *tānhā*—there only; *kare*—does; *prema-dāna*—distribution of love of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

In distributing love of Godhead, Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His associates did not consider who was a fit candidate and who was not, nor where such distribution should or should not take place. They made no conditions. Wherever they got the opportunity, the members of the Pañca-tattva distributed love of Godhead.

PURPORT

There are some rascals who dare to speak against the mission of Lord Caitanya by criticizing the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement for accepting Europeans and Americans as *brāhmaṇas* and offering them *sannyāsa*. But here is an authoritative statement that in distributing love of Godhead one should not consider whether the recipients are Europeans, Americans, Hindus, Muslims, etc. The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement should be spread wherever possible, and one should accept those who thus become Vaiṣṇavas as being greater than *brāhmaṇas*, Hindus or Indians. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu desired that His name be spread in each and every town and village on the surface of the globe. Therefore, when the cult of Caitanya Mahāprabhu is spread all over the world, should those who embrace it not be accepted as Vaiṣṇavas, *brāhmaṇas* and *sannyāsīs*? These foolish arguments are sometimes raised by envious rascals, but Kṛṣṇa conscious devotees do not care about them. We strictly follow the principles set down by the Pañca-tattva.

TEXT 24

luṭiyā, khāiyā, diyā, bhāṇḍāra ujāḍe

āścārya bhāṇḍāra, prema śata-guṇa bāḍe

SYNONYMS

luṭiyā—plundering; *khāiyā*—eating; *diyā*—distributing; *bhāṇḍāra*—

store; *ujāḍe*—emptied; *āścārya*—wonderful; *bhāṇḍāra*—store; *prema*—love of Godhead; *śata-guṇa*—one hundred times; *bāḍe*—increases.

TRANSLATION

Although the members of the Pañca-tattva plundered the storehouse of love of Godhead and ate and distributed its contents, there was no scarcity, for this wonderful storehouse is so complete that as the love is distributed, the supply increases hundreds of times.

PURPORT

A pseudo incarnation of Kṛṣṇa once told his disciple that he had emptied himself by giving him all knowledge and was thus spiritually bankrupt. Such bluffers speak in this way to cheat the public, but actual spiritual consciousness is so perfect that the more it is distributed, the more it increases. Bankruptcy is a term that applies in the material world, but the storehouse of love of Godhead in the spiritual world can never be depleted. Kṛṣṇa is providing for millions and trillions of living entities by supplying all their necessities, and even if all the innumerable living entities wanted to become Kṛṣṇa conscious, there would be no scarcity of love of Godhead, nor would there be insufficiency in providing for their maintenance. Our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement was started single-handedly, and no one provided for our livelihood, but at present we are spending hundreds and thousands of dollars all over the world, and the movement is increasing more and more. Thus there is no question of scarcity. Although jealous persons may be envious, if we stick to our principles and follow in the footsteps of the Pañca-tattva, this movement will go on unchecked by imitation *svāmīs*, *sannyāsīs*, religionists, philosophers or scientists, for it is transcendental to all material considerations. Therefore those who propagate the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement should not be afraid of such rascals and fools.

TEXT 25

uchalīla prema-vanyā caudike veḍāya

strī, vṛddha, bālaka, yuvā, sabāre ḍubāya

SYNONYMS

uchalīla—became agitated; *prema-vanyā*—the inundation of love of Godhead; *caudike*—in all directions; *veḍāya*—surrounding; *strī*—women; *vṛddha*—old men; *bālaka*—children; *yuvā*—young men; *sabāre*—all of them; *ḍubāya*—merged into.

TRANSLATION

The flood of love of Godhead swelled in all directions, and thus young men, old men, women and children were all immersed in that inundation.

PURPORT

When the contents of the storehouse of love of Godhead is thus distributed, there is a powerful inundation that covers the entire land. In Śrīdhāma Māyāpur there is sometimes a great flood after the rainy season. This is an indication that from the birthplace of Lord Caitanya the inundation of love of Godhead should be spread all over the world, for this will help everyone, including old men, young men, women and children. The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is so powerful that it can inundate the entire world and interest all classes of men in the subject of love of Godhead.

TEXT 26

saj-jana, durjana, paṅgu, jaḍa, andha-gaṇa

prema-vanyāya ḍubāila jagatera jana

SYNONYMS

sat-jana—gentle men; *durjana*—rogues; *paṅgu*—lame; *jaḍa*—invalid; *andha-gaṇa*—blind men; *prema-vanyāya*—in the inundation of love of Godhead; *ḍubāila*—drowned; *jagatera*—all over the world; *jana*—people.

TRANSLATION

The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement will inundate the entire world and drown everyone, whether one be a gentleman, a rogue or even lame, invalid or blind.

PURPORT

Here again it may be emphasized that although jealous rascals protest that Europeans and Americans cannot be given the sacred thread or *sannyāsa*, there is no need even to consider whether one is a gentleman or a rogue because this is a spiritual movement which is not concerned with the external body of skin and bones. Because it is being properly conducted under the guidance of the Pañca-tattva, strictly following the regulative principles, it has nothing to do with external impediments.

TEXT 27

jagat ḍubila, jīvera haila bīja nāśa

tāhā dekhi' pāñca janera parama ullāsa

SYNONYMS

jagat—the whole world; *ḍubila*—drowned; *jīvera*—of the living entities; *haila*—it so became; *bīja*—the seed; *nāśa*—completely finished; *tāhā*—then; *dekhi'*—by seeing; *pāñca*—five; *janera*—of the persons; *parama*—highest; *ullāsa*—happiness.

TRANSLATION

When the five members of the Pañca-tattva saw the entire world drowned in love of Godhead and the seed of material enjoyment in the living entities completely destroyed, they all became exceedingly happy.

PURPORT

In this connection, Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya* that since the living entities all belong to the marginal potency of the Lord, each and every living entity has a natural tendency to become Kṛṣṇa conscious, although at the same time the seed of material enjoyment is undoubtedly within him. The seed of material enjoyment, watered by the course of material nature, fructifies to become a tree of material entanglement that endows the living entity with all kinds of material enjoyment. To enjoy such material facilities is to be afflicted with the three material miseries. However, when by nature's law there is a flood, the seeds within the earth become inactive. Similarly, as the inundation of love of Godhead spreads all over the world, the seeds of material enjoyment become impotent. Thus the more the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement spreads, the more the desire for material enjoyment decreases. The seed of material enjoyment automatically becomes impotent with the increase of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement.

Instead of being envious that Kṛṣṇa consciousness is spreading all over the world by the grace of Lord Caitanya, those who are jealous should be happy, as indicated here by the words *parama ullāsa*. But because they are *kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs* or *prākṛta-bhaktas* (materialistic devotees who are not advanced in spiritual knowledge), they are envious instead of happy, and they try to find faults in the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. Yet Śrīmat Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī writes in his *Caitanya-candrāmṛta* that when influenced by Lord Caitanya's Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, materialists become averse to talking about their wives and children, supposedly learned scholars give up their tedious studies of Vedic literature, *yogīs* give up their impractical practices of mystic *yoga*, ascetics give up their austere activities of penance and austerity, and *sannyāsīs*

give up their study of Sāṅkhya philosophy. Thus they are all attracted by the *bhakti-yoga* practices of Lord Caitanya and cannot relish a mellow superior to that of Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

TEXT 28

yata yata prema-vṛṣṭi kare pañca-jane

tata tata bāḍhe jala, vyāpe tri-bhuvane

SYNONYMS

yata—as many; *yata*—so many; *prema-vṛṣṭi*—showers of love of Godhead; *kare*—causes; *pañca-jane*—the five members of the Pañca-tattva; *tata tata*—as much as; *bāḍhe*—increases; *jala*—water; *vyāpe*—spreads; *tri-bhuvane*—all over the three worlds.

TRANSLATION

The more the five members of the Pañca-tattva cause the rains of love of Godhead to fall, the more the inundation increases and spreads all over the world.

PURPORT

The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is not stereotyped or stagnant. It will spread all over the world in spite of all objections by fools and rascals that European and American *mlecchas* cannot be accepted as *brāhmaṇas* or *sannyāsīs*. Here it is indicated that this process will spread and inundate the entire world with Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

TEXTS 29–30

māyāvādī, karma-niṣṭha kutārkika-gaṇa

nindaka, pāsaṇḍī yata paḍuyā adhama

sei saba mahādakṣa dhāñā palāila

sei vanyā tā-sabāre chuñite nārila

SYNONYMS

māyāvādī—the impersonalist philosophers; *karma-niṣṭha*—the fruitive workers; *kutārkika-gaṇa*—the false logicians; *nindaka*—the blasphemers; *pāsaṇḍī*—nondevotees; *yata*—all; *paḍuyā*—students; *adhama*—the lowest class; *sei saba*—all of them; *mahā-dakṣa*—they are very expert; *dhāñā*—running; *palāila*—went away; *sei vanyā*—that inundation; *tā-sabāre*—all of them; *chuñite*—touching; *nārila*—could not.

TRANSLATION

The impersonalists, fruitive workers, false logicians, blasphemers, nondevotees and lowest among the student community are very expert in avoiding the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, and therefore the inundation of Kṛṣṇa consciousness cannot touch them.

PURPORT

Like Māyāvādī philosophers in the past such as Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī of Benares, modern impersonalists are not interested in Lord Caitanya's Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. They do not know the value of this material world; they consider it false and cannot understand how the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement can utilize it. They are so absorbed in impersonal thought that they take it for granted that all spiritual variety is material. Because they do not know anything beyond their misconception of the *brahmajyoti*, they cannot understand that Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is spiritual and therefore beyond the conception of material illusion. Whenever Kṛṣṇa incarnates personally or as a devotee, these Māyāvādī philosophers accept Him as an

ordinary human being. This is condemned in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.11):

*avajānanti mām mūḍhā mānuṣīm tanum āśritam
param bhāvam ajānanto mama bhūta-maheśvaram*

“Fools deride Me when I descend in the human form. They do not know My transcendental nature as the Supreme Lord of all that be.”

There are also other unscrupulous persons who exploit the Lord’s appearance by posing as incarnations to cheat the innocent public. An incarnation of God should pass the tests of the statements of the *śāstras* and also perform uncommon activities. One should not accept a rascal as an incarnation of God but should test his ability to act as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. For example, Kṛṣṇa taught Arjuna in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, and Arjuna also accepted Him as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but for our understanding Arjuna requested the Lord to manifest His universal form, thus testing whether He was actually the Supreme Lord. Similarly, one must test a so-called incarnation of Godhead according to the standard criteria. To avoid being misled by an exhibition of mystic powers, it is best to examine a so-called incarnation of God in the light of the statements of the *śāstras*. Caitanya Mahāprabhu is described in the *śāstras* as an incarnation of Kṛṣṇa; therefore if one wants to imitate Lord Caitanya and claim to be an incarnation, he must show evidence from the *śāstras* about his appearance to substantiate his claim.

TEXTS 31–32

tāhā dekhi’ mahāprabhu karena cintana

jagat ḍubāite āmi kariluṅ yatana

keha keha eḍāila, pratijñā ha-ila bhaṅga

tā-sabā ḍubaite pātiba kichu raṅga

SYNONYMS

tāhā dekhi'—observing this advancement; *mahāprabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *karena*—does; *cintana*—thinking; *jagat*—the whole world; *ḍubāite*—to drown; *āmi*—I; *karilun*—endeavored; *yatana*—attempts; *keha keha*—some of them; *eḍāila*—escaped; *pratijñā*—promise; *ha-ila*—became; *bhaṅga*—broken; *tā-sabā*—all of them; *ḍubāite*—to make them drown; *pātiba*—shall devise; *kichu*—some; *raṅga*—trick.

TRANSLATION

Seeing that the Māyāvādīs and others were fleeing, Lord Caitanya thought, “I wanted everyone to be immersed in this inundation of love of Godhead, but some of them have escaped. Therefore I shall devise a trick to drown them also.”

PURPORT

Here is an important point. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted to invent a way to capture the Māyāvādīs and others who did not take interest in the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. This is the symptom of an *ācārya*. An *ācārya* who comes for the service of the Lord cannot be expected to conform to a stereotype, for he must find the ways and means by which Kṛṣṇa consciousness may be spread. Sometimes jealous persons criticize the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement because it engages equally both boys and girls in distributing love of Godhead. Not knowing that boys and girls in countries like Europe and America mix very freely, these fools and rascals criticize the boys and girls in Kṛṣṇa consciousness for intermingling. But these rascals should consider that one cannot suddenly change a community's social customs. However, since both the boys and the girls are being trained to become preachers, those girls are not ordinary girls but are as good as their brothers who are preaching Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Therefore, to engage both boys and girls in fully transcendental activities is a policy intended to spread the Kṛṣṇa

consciousness movement. These jealous fools who criticize the intermingling of boys and girls will simply have to be satisfied with their own foolishness because they cannot think of how to spread Kṛṣṇa consciousness by adopting ways and means that are favorable for this purpose. Their stereotyped methods will never help spread Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Therefore, what we are doing is perfect by the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, for it is He who proposed to invent a way to capture those who strayed from Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

TEXT 33

eta bali' mane kichu kariyā vicāra

sannyāsa-āśrama prabhu kailā aṅgikāra

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *mane*—within the mind; *kichu*—something; *kariyā*—doing; *vicāra*—consideration; *sannyāsa-āśrama*—the renounced order of life; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kailā*—did; *aṅgikāra*—accept.

TRANSLATION

Thus the Lord accepted the sannyāsa order of life after full consideration.

PURPORT

There was no need for Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu to accept *sannyāsa*, for He is God Himself and therefore has nothing to do with the material bodily concept of life. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu did not identify Himself with any of the eight *varṇas* and *āśramas*, namely, *brāhmaṇa*, *kṣatriya*, *vaiśya*, *sūdra*, *brahmacārī*, *grhastha*, *vānaprastha* and *sannyāsa*. He identified Himself as the Supreme Spirit. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, or for that matter any pure devotee, never identifies with these social and spiritual divisions of life, for a devotee is always transcendental to these

different gradations of society. Nevertheless, Lord Caitanya decided to accept *sannyāsa* on the grounds that when He became a *sannyāsī* everyone would show Him respect and in that way be favored. Although there was actually no need for Him to accept *sannyāsa*, He did so for the benefit of those who might think Him an ordinary human being. The main purpose of His accepting *sannyāsa* was to deliver the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*. This will be evident later in this chapter.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura has explained the term “Māyāvādī” as follows: “The Supreme Personality of Godhead is transcendental to the material conception of life. A Māyāvādī is one who considers the body of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa to be made of *māyā* and who also considers the abode of the Lord and the process of approaching Him, devotional service, to be *māyā*. The Māyāvādī considers all the paraphernalia of devotional service to be *māyā*.” *Māyā* refers to material existence, which is characterized by the reactions of fruitive activities. Māyāvādīs consider devotional service to be among such fruitive activities. According to them, when *bhāgavatas* (devotees) are purified by philosophical speculation, they will come to the real point of liberation. Those who speculate in this way regarding devotional service are called *kutārkikas* (false logicians), and those who consider devotional service to be fruitive activity are called *karma-niṣṭhas*. Those who criticize devotional service are called *nindakas* (blasphemers). Similarly, nondevotees who consider devotional activities to be material are called *pāṣaṇḍīs*, and scholars with a similar viewpoint are called *adhama paḍuyās*.

The *kutārkikas*, *nindakas*, *pāṣaṇḍīs* and *adhama paḍuyās* all avoided the benefit of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s movement of developing love of Godhead. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu felt compassion for them, and it is for this reason that He decided to accept the *sannyāsa* order, for by seeing Him as a *sannyāsī* they would offer Him respects. The *sannyāsa* order is still respected in India. Indeed, the very dress of a *sannyāsī* still commands respect from the Indian public. Therefore Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted *sannyāsa* to facilitate preaching His devotional cult,

although otherwise He had no need to accept the fourth order of spiritual life.

TEXT 34

cabbiśa vatsara chilā gr̥hastha-āśrame

pañca-vimśati varṣe kaila yati-dharme

SYNONYMS

cabbiśa—twenty-four; *vatsara*—years; *chilā*—He remained; *gr̥hastha*—householder life; *āśrame*—the order of; *pañca*—five; *vimśati*—twenty; *varṣe*—in the year; *kaila*—did; *yati-dharme*—accepted the *sannyāsa* order.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu remained in householder life for twenty-four years, and on the verge of His twenty-fifth year He accepted the *sannyāsa* order.

PURPORT

There are four orders of spiritual life, namely, *brahmacarya*, *gr̥hastha*, *vānaprastha* and *sannyāsa*, and in each of these *āśramas* there are four divisions. The divisions of the *brahmacarya-āśrama* are *sāvitrya*, *prājāpatya*, *brāhma* and *bṛhat*, and the divisions of the *gr̥hasthāśrama* are *vārtā* (professionals), *sañcaya* (accumulators), *śālīna* (those who do not ask anything from anyone) and *śīloñchana* (those who collect grains from the paddy fields). Similarly, the divisions of the *vānaprastha-āśrama* are *vaikhānasa*, *vāḷakhilya*, *auḍumbara* and *pheṇapa*, and the divisions of *sannyāsa* are *kuṭīcaka*, *bahūdaka*, *haṁsa* and *niṣkriya*. There are two kinds of *sannyāsīs*, who are called *dhīras* and *narottamas*, as stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.13.26–27). At the end of the month of January in

the year 1432 *śakābda* (A.D. 1510), Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted the *sannyāsa* order from Keśava Bhāratī, who belonged to the Śaṅkara-sampradāya.

TEXT 35

sannyāsa kariyā prabhu kailā ākarṣaṇa

yateka pālāñāchila tārīkādigaṇa

SYNONYMS

sannyāsa—the *sannyāsa* order; *kariyā*—accepting; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kailā*—did; *ākarṣaṇa*—attract; *yateka*—all; *pālāñāchila*—fled; *tārīka-ādi-gaṇa*—all persons, beginning with the logicians.

TRANSLATION

After accepting the *sannyāsa* order, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu attracted the attention of all those who had evaded Him, beginning with the logicians.

TEXT 36

paḍuyā, pāṣaṇḍī, karmī, nindakādi yata

tārā āsi' prabhu-pāya haya avanata

SYNONYMS

paḍuyā—students; *pāṣaṇḍī*—material adjusters; *karmī*—fruitive actors; *nindaka-ādi*—critics; *yata*—all; *tārā*—they; *āsi'*—coming; *prabhu*—the Lord's; *pāya*—lotus feet; *haya*—became; *avanata*—surrendered.

TRANSLATION

Thus the students, infidels, fruitive workers and critics all came to surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord.

TEXT 37

aparādha kṣamāila, dubila prema-jale

kebā eḍāibe prabhura prema-mahājāle

SYNONYMS

aparādha—offense; *kṣamāila*—excused; *dubila*—merged into; *prema-jale*—in the ocean of love of Godhead; *kebā*—who else; *eḍāibe*—will go away; *prabhura*—the Lord’s; *prema*—loving; *mahā-jāle*—network.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya excused them all, and they merged into the ocean of devotional service, for no one can escape the unique loving network of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was an ideal *ācārya*. An *ācārya* is an ideal teacher who knows the purpose of the revealed scriptures, behaves exactly according to their injunctions and teaches his students to adopt these principles also. As an ideal *ācārya*, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu devised ways to capture all kinds of atheists and materialists. Every *ācārya* has a specific means of propagating his spiritual movement with the aim of bringing men to Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Therefore, the method of one *ācārya* may be different from that of another, but the ultimate goal is never neglected. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī recommends:

*tasmāt kenāpy upāyena manaḥ kṛṣṇe niveśayet
sarve vidhi-niṣedhā syur etayor eva kiṅkarāḥ*

An *ācārya* should devise a means by which people may somehow or other come to Kṛṣṇa consciousness. First they should become Kṛṣṇa conscious, and all the prescribed rules and regulations may later gradually be introduced. In our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement we follow this policy of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. For example, since boys and girls in the Western countries freely intermingle, special concessions regarding their customs and habits are necessary to bring them to Kṛṣṇa consciousness. The *ācārya* must devise a means to bring them to devotional service. Therefore, although I am a *sannyāsī* I sometimes take part in getting boys and girls married, although in the history of *sannyāsa* no *sannyāsī* has personally taken part in marrying his disciples.

TEXT 38

sabā nistārite prabhu kṛpā-avatāra

sabā nistārite kare cāturī apāra

SYNONYMS

sabā—all; *nistārite*—to deliver; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kṛpā*—mercy; *avatāra*—incarnation; *sabā*—all; *nistārite*—to deliver; *kare*—did; *cāturī*—devices; *apāra*—unlimited.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared in order to deliver all the fallen souls. Therefore He devised many methods to liberate them from the clutches of *māyā*.

PURPORT

It is the concern of the *ācārya* to show mercy to the fallen souls. In this connection, *deśa-kāla-pātra* (the place, the time and the object) should be taken into consideration. Since the European and American boys and girls

in our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement preach together, less intelligent men criticize that they are mingling without restriction. In Europe and America boys and girls mingle unrestrictedly and have equal rights; therefore it is not possible to completely separate the men from the women. However, we are thoroughly instructing both men and women how to preach, and actually they are preaching wonderfully. Of course, we very strictly prohibit illicit sex. Boys and girls who are not married are not allowed to sleep together or live together, and there are separate arrangements for boys and girls in every temple. *Gṛhasthas* live outside the temple, for in the temple we do not allow even husband and wife to live together. The results of this are wonderful. Both men and women are preaching the gospel of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Lord Kṛṣṇa with redoubled strength. In this verse the words *sabā nistārite kare cāturī apāra* indicate that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted to deliver one and all. Therefore it is a principle that a preacher must strictly follow the rules and regulations laid down in the *śāstras* yet at the same time devise a means by which the preaching work to reclaim the fallen may go on with full force.

TEXT 39

tabe nija bhakta kaila yata mleccha ādi

sabe eḍāila mātra kāsīra māyāvādī

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *nija*—own; *bhakta*—devotee; *kaila*—converted; *yata*—all; *mleccha*—one who does not follow the Vedic principles; *ādi*—heading the list; *sabe*—all those; *eḍāila*—escaped; *mātra*—only; *kāsīra*—of Vārāṇasī; *māyāvādī*—impersonalists.

TRANSLATION

All were converted into devotees of Lord Caitanya, even the mlecchas

and yavanas. Only the impersonalist followers of Śaṅkarācārya evaded Him.

PURPORT

In this verse it is clearly indicated that although Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu converted Muslims and other *mlecchas* into devotees, the impersonalist followers of Śaṅkarācārya could not be converted. After accepting the renounced order of life, Caitanya Mahāprabhu converted many *karma-niṣṭhas* who were addicted to fruitive activities, many great logicians like Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, *nindakas* (blasphemers) like Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, *pāṣaṇḍīs* (nondevotees) like Jagāi and Mādhāi, and *adhama paḍuyās* (degraded students) like Mukunda and his friends. All of them gradually became devotees of the Lord, even the Pāṭhāns (Muslims), but the worst offenders, the impersonalists, were extremely difficult to convert, for they very tactfully escaped the devices of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

In describing the Kāśīra Māyāvādīs, Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura has explained that persons who are bewildered by empiric knowledge or direct sensual perception, and who thus consider that even this limited material world can be gauged by their material estimations, conclude that anything that one can discern by direct sense perception is but *māyā*, or illusion. They maintain that although the Absolute Truth is beyond the range of sense perception, it includes no spiritual variety or enjoyment. According to the Kāśīra Māyāvādīs, the spiritual world is simply void. They do not believe in the Personality of the Absolute Truth or in His varieties of activities in the spiritual world. Although they have their own arguments, which are not very strong, they have no conception of the variegated activities of the Absolute Truth. These impersonalists, who are followers of Śaṅkarācārya, are generally known as Kāśīra Māyāvādīs (impersonalists residing in Vārāṇasī).

Near Vārāṇasī there is another group of impersonalists, who are known as Saranātha Māyāvādīs. Outside the city of Vārāṇasī is a place known as

Saranātha, where there is a big Buddhist *stūpa*. Many followers of Buddhist philosophy live there, and they are known as Saranātha Māyāvādīs. The impersonalists of Saranātha differ from those of Vārāṇasī, for the Vārāṇasī impersonalists propagate the idea that the impersonal Brahman is truth whereas material varieties are false, but the Saranātha impersonalists do not even believe that the Absolute Truth, or Brahman, can be understood as the opposite of *māyā*, or illusion. According to their vision, materialism is the only manifestation of the Absolute Truth.

Factually both the Kāśīra and the Saranātha Māyāvādīs, as well as any other philosophers who have no knowledge of the spirit soul, are advocates of utter materialism. None of them have clear knowledge regarding the Absolute or the spiritual world. Philosophers like the Saranātha Māyāvādīs who do not believe in the spiritual existence of the Absolute Truth but consider material varieties to be everything do not believe that there are two kinds of nature, inferior (material) and superior (spiritual), as described in the *Bhagavad-gītā*. Actually, neither the Vārāṇasī nor Saranātha Māyāvādīs accept the principles of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, due to a poor fund of knowledge.

Since these impersonalists who do not have perfect spiritual knowledge cannot understand the principles of *bhakti-yoga*, they must be classified among the nondevotees who are against the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. We sometimes feel inconvenienced by the hindrances offered by these impersonalists, but we do not care about their so-called philosophy, for we are propagating our own philosophy as presented in *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is* and getting successful results. Theorizing as if devotional service were subject to their mental speculation, both kinds of Māyāvādī impersonalists conclude that the subject matter of *bhakti-yoga* is a creation of *māyā* and that Kṛṣṇa, devotional service and the devotee are also *māyā*. Therefore, as stated by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, *māyāvādī kṛṣṇe aparādhī*: “All the Māyāvādīs are offenders to Lord Kṛṣṇa.” (Cc. *Madhya* 17.129) It is not possible for them to understand the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement; therefore we do not value their

philosophical conclusions. However expert such quarrelsome impersonalists are in putting forward their so-called logic, we defeat them in every respect and go forward with our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. Their imaginative mental speculation cannot deter the progress of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, which is completely spiritual and is never under the control of such Māyāvādīs.

TEXT 40

vṛndāvana yāite prabhu rahilā kāsīte

māyāvādi-gaṇa tāñre lāgila nindite

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana—the holy place called Vṛndāvana; *yāite*—while going there; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *rahilā*—remained; *kāsīte*—at Vārāṇasī; *māyāvādi-gaṇa*—the Māyāvādī philosophers; *tāñre*—unto Him; *lāgila*—began; *nindite*—to speak against Him.

TRANSLATION

While Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was passing through Vārāṇasī on His way to Vṛndāvana, the Māyāvādī sannyāsī philosophers blasphemed against Him in many ways.

PURPORT

While preaching Kṛṣṇa consciousness with full vigor, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu faced many Māyāvādī philosophers. Similarly, we are also facing opposing *svāmīs*, *yogīs*, impersonalists, scientists, philosophers and other mental speculators, and by the grace of Lord Kṛṣṇa we successfully defeat all of them without difficulty.

TEXT 41

sannyāsī ha-iyā kare gāyana, nācana

nā kare vedānta-pāṭha, kare saṅkīrtana

SYNONYMS

sannyāsī—a person in the renounced order of life; *ha-iyā*—accepting such a position; *kare*—does; *gāyana*—singing; *nācana*—dancing; *nā kare*—does not practice; *vedānta-pāṭha*—study of the Vedānta philosophy; *kare saṅkīrtana*—but simply engages in *saṅkīrtana*.

TRANSLATION

The blasphemers said, “Although a *sannyāsī*, He does not take interest in the study of Vedānta but instead always engages in chanting and dancing in *saṅkīrtana*.

PURPORT

Fortunately or unfortunately, we also meet such Māyāvādīs who criticize our method of chanting and accuse us of not being interested in study. They do not know that we have translated volumes and volumes of books into English and that the students in our temples regularly study them in the morning, afternoon and evening. We are writing and printing books, and our students study them and distribute them all over the world. No Māyāvādī school can present as many books as we have; nevertheless, they accuse us of not being fond of study. Such accusations are completely false. But although we study, we do not study the nonsense of the Māyāvādīs.

Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* neither chant nor dance. Their technical objection is that this method of chanting and dancing is called *tauryatṛika*, which indicates that a *sannyāsī* should completely avoid such activities and engage his time in the study of Vedānta. Actually, such men do not understand what is meant by Vedānta. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.15)

Kṛṣṇa says, *vedaīś ca sarvair aham eva vedyo vedānta-kṛd veda-vid eva cāham*: “By all the *Vedas* I am to be known; indeed I am the compiler of Vedānta, and I am the knower of the *Vedas*.” Lord Kṛṣṇa is the actual compiler of Vedānta, and whatever He speaks is Vedānta philosophy. Although they are lacking the knowledge of Vedānta presented by the Supreme Personality of Godhead in the transcendental form of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, the Māyāvādīs are very proud of their study. Foreseeing the bad effects of their presenting Vedānta philosophy in a perverted way, Śrīla Vyāsadeva compiled *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* as a commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra*. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is

bhāṣyo 'yaṁ brahma-sūtrāṇām; in other words, all the Vedānta philosophy in the aphorisms of the *Brahma-sūtra* is thoroughly described in the pages of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. Thus the factual propounder of Vedānta philosophy is a Kṛṣṇa conscious person who always engages in reading and understanding the *Bhagavad-gītā* and *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and teaching the purport of these books to the entire world. The Māyāvādīs are very proud of having monopolized the Vedānta philosophy, but devotees have their own commentaries on Vedānta such as *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and others written by the *ācāryas*. The commentary of the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas is the *Govinda-bhāṣya*.

The Māyāvādīs' accusation that devotees do not study Vedānta is false. The Māyāvādīs do not know that chanting, dancing and preaching the principles of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, called *bhāgavata-dharma*, are the same as studying Vedānta. Since they think that reading Vedānta philosophy is the only function of a *sannyāsī* and they did not find Caitanya Mahāprabhu engaged in such direct study, they criticized the Lord. Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya has given special stress to the study of Vedānta philosophy: *vedānta-vākyeṣu sadā ramantaḥ kaupīnavantaḥ khalu bhāgyavantaḥ*. “A *sannyāsī*, accepting the renounced order very strictly and wearing nothing more than a loincloth, should always enjoy the philosophical statements in the *Vedānta-sūtra*. Such a person in the renounced order is to be considered very fortunate.” The Māyāvādīs in Vārāṇasī blasphemed Lord Caitanya because His behavior did not follow

these principles. Lord Caitanya, however, bestowed His mercy upon these Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* and delivered them by means of His Vedānta discourses with Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī and Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya.

TEXT 42

mūrkhā sannyāsī nija-dharma nāhi jane

bhāvuka ha-iyā phere bhāvukera sane

SYNONYMS

mūrkhā—illiterate; *sannyāsī*—one in the renounced order of life; *nija-dharma*—own duty; *nāhi*—does not; *jāne*—know; *bhāvuka*—in ecstasy; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *phere*—wanders; *bhāvukera*—with another ecstatic person; *sane*—with.

TRANSLATION

“This Caitanya Mahāprabhu is an illiterate *sannyāsī* and therefore does not know His real function. Guided only by His sentiments, He wanders about in the company of other sentimentalists.”

PURPORT

Foolish Māyāvādīs, not knowing that the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is based on a solid philosophy of transcendental science, superficially conclude that those who dance and chant do not have philosophical knowledge. Those who are Kṛṣṇa conscious actually have full knowledge of the essence of Vedānta philosophy, for they study the real commentary on the Vedānta philosophy, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and follow the actual words of the Supreme Personality of Godhead as found in *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is*. After understanding the Bhāgavata philosophy, or *bhāgavata-dharma*, they become fully spiritually conscious or Kṛṣṇa conscious, and therefore their chanting and dancing is not material but is on the spiritual

platform. Although everyone admires the ecstatic chanting and dancing of the devotees, who are therefore popularly known as “the Hare Kṛṣṇa people,” Māyāvādīs cannot appreciate these activities because of their poor fund of knowledge.

TEXT 43

e saba śuniyā prabhu hāse mane mane

upekṣā kariyā kāro nā kaila sambhāṣaṇe

SYNONYMS

e saba—all these; *śuniyā*—after hearing; *prabhu*—the Lord; *hāse*—smiled; *mane mane*—within His mind; *upekṣā*—rejection; *kariyā*—doing so; *kāro*—with anyone; *nā*—did not; *kaila*—make; *sambhāṣaṇe*—conversation.

TRANSLATION

Hearing all this blasphemy, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu merely smiled to Himself, rejected all these accusations and did not talk with the Māyāvādīs.

PURPORT

As Kṛṣṇa conscious devotees, we do not like to converse with Māyāvādī philosophers simply to waste valuable time, but whenever there is an opportunity we impress our philosophy upon them with great vigor and success.

TEXT 44

upekṣā kariyā kaila mathurā gamana

mathurā dekhiyā punaḥ kaila āgamana

SYNONYMS

upekṣā—neglecting them; *kariyā*—doing so; *kaila*—did; *mathurā*—the town named Mathurā; *gamana*—traveling; *mathurā*—Mathurā; *dekhiyā*—after seeing it; *punaḥ*—again; *kaila āgamana*—came back.

TRANSLATION

Thus neglecting the blasphemy of the Vārāṇasī Māyāvādīs, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu proceeded to Mathurā, and after visiting Mathurā He returned to meet the situation.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu did not talk with the Māyāvādī philosophers when He first visited Vārāṇasī, but He returned there from Mathurā to convince them of the real purpose of Vedānta.

TEXT 45

kāśīte lekhaka śūdra-śrīcandraśekhara

tānra ghare rahilā prabhu svatantra īśvara

SYNONYMS

kāśīte—in Vārāṇasī; *lekhaka*—writer; *śūdra*—born of a *śūdra* family; *śrī-candraśekhara*—Candraśekhara; *tānra ghare*—in his house; *rahilā*—remained; *prabhu*—the Lord; *svatantra*—independent; *īśvara*—the supreme controller.

TRANSLATION

This time Lord Caitanya stayed at the house of Candrasēkhara, although he was regarded as a *śūdra* or *kāyastha*, for the Lord, as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is completely independent.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya stayed at the house of Candrasēkhara, a clerk, although a *sannyāsī* is not supposed to reside in a *śūdra*'s house. Five hundred years ago, especially in Bengal, it was the system that persons who were born in the families of *brāhmaṇas* were accepted as *brāhmaṇas*, and all those who took birth in other families—even the higher castes, namely, the *kṣatriyas* and *vaiśyas*—were considered *śūdras* non-*brāhmaṇas*. Therefore although Śrī Candrasēkhara was a clerk from a *kāyastha* family in upper India, he was considered a *śūdra*. Similarly, *vaiśyas*, especially those of the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* community, were accepted as *śūdras* in Bengal, and even the *vaidyas*, who were generally physicians, were also considered *śūdras*. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, however, did not accept this artificial principle, which was introduced in society by self-interested men, and later the *kāyasthas*, *vaidyas* and *vaṇiks* all began to accept the sacred thread, despite objections from the so-called *brāhmaṇas*.

Before the time of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* class was condemned by Ballāl Sen, who was then the King of Bengal, due to a personal grudge. In Bengal the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* class are always very rich, for they are bankers and dealers in gold and silver. Therefore, Ballāl Sen used to borrow money from a *suvarṇa-vaṇik* banker. Ballāl Sen's bankruptcy later obliged the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* banker to stop advancing money to him, and thus Ballāl Sen became angry and condemned the entire *suvarṇa-vaṇik* society as belonging to the *śūdra* community. He tried to induce the *brāhmaṇas* not to accept the *suvarṇa-vaṇiks* as followers of the instructions of the *Vedas* under the brahminical directions, but although some *brāhmaṇas* approved of Ballāl Sen's actions, others did not. Thus the *brāhmaṇas* also became divided amongst themselves, and those who supported the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* class were rejected from the *brāhmaṇa* community. At the present day the same

biases are still being followed.

There are many Vaiṣṇava families in Bengal whose members, although not actually born *brāhmaṇas*, act as *ācāryas* by initiating disciples and offering the sacred thread as enjoined in the Vaiṣṇava *tantras*. For example, in the families of Ṭhākura Raghunandana Ācārya, Ṭhākura Kṛṣṇadāsa, Navanī Hoḍa and Rasikānanda-deva (a disciple of Śyāmānanda Prabhu), the sacred thread ceremony is performed, as it is for the caste Gosvāmīs, and this system has continued for the past three to four hundred years. Accepting disciples born in *brāhmaṇa* families, they are bona fide spiritual masters who have the facility to worship the *śālagrāma-śilā*, which is worshiped with the Deity. As of this writing, *śālagrāma-śilā* worship has not yet been introduced in our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, but soon it will be introduced in all our temples as an essential function of *arcana-mārga* (Deity worship).

TEXT 46

tapana-miśrera ghare bhikṣā-nirvāhaṇa

sannyāsīra saṅge nāhi māne nimantraṇa

SYNONYMS

tapana-miśrera—of Tapana Miśra; *ghare*—in the house; *bhikṣā*—accepting food; *nirvāhaṇa*—regularly executed; *sannyāsīra*—with other Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *saṅge*—in company with them; *nāhi*—never; *māne*—accepted; *nimantraṇa*—invitation.

TRANSLATION

As a matter of principle, Lord Caitanya regularly accepted His food at the house of Tapana Miśra. He never mixed with other *sannyāsīs*, nor did He accept invitations from them.

PURPORT

This exemplary behavior of Lord Caitanya definitely proves that a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī* cannot accept invitations from Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* or intimately mix with them.

TEXT 47

sanātana gosāñi āsi' tāñhāi mililā

tāñra śikṣā lāgi' prabhu du-māsa rahilā

SYNONYMS

sanātana—Sanātana; *gosāñi*—a great devotee; *āsi'*—coming there; *tāñhai*—there at Vārāṇasī; *mililā*—visited Him; *tāñra*—His; *śikṣā*—instruction; *lāgi'*—for the matter of; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *du-māsa*—two months; *rahilā*—remained there.

TRANSLATION

When Sanātana Gosvāmī came from Bengal, he met Lord Caitanya at the house of Tapana Miśra, where Lord Caitanya remained continuously for two months to teach him devotional service.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya taught Sanātana Gosvāmī in the line of disciplic succession. Sanātana Gosvāmī was a very learned scholar in Sanskrit and other languages, but until instructed by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu he did not write anything about Vaiṣṇava behavior. His very famous book *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, which gives directions for Vaiṣṇava candidates, was written completely in compliance with the instructions of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. In this *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī gives definite instructions that by proper initiation by a bona fide spiritual

master one can immediately become a *brāhmaṇa*. In this connection he says:

*yathā kāñcanatām yāti kāmśyaṁ rasa-vidhānataḥ
tathā dikṣā-vidhānena dvijatvaṁ jāyate nṛṇām*

“As bell metal is turned to gold when mixed with mercury in an alchemical process, so one who is properly trained and initiated by a bona fide spiritual master immediately becomes a *brāhmaṇa*.” Sometimes those born in *brāhmaṇa* families protest this, but they have no strong arguments against this principle. By the grace of Kṛṣṇa and His devotee, one’s life can change. This is confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* by the words *jahāti bandham* and *sudhyanti*. *Jahāti bandham* indicates that a living entity is conditioned by a particular type of body. The body is certainly an impediment, but one who associates with a pure devotee and follows his instructions can avoid this impediment and become a regular *brāhmaṇa* by initiation under his strict guidance. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī states how a non-*brāhmaṇa* can be turned into a *brāhmaṇa* by the association of a pure devotee. *Prabhaviṣṇave namaḥ*: Lord Viṣṇu is so powerful that He can do anything He likes. Therefore it is not difficult for Viṣṇu to change the body of a devotee who is under the guidance of a pure devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 48

tānre śikhāilā saba vaiṣṇavera dharma

bhāgavata-ādi śāstrera yata gūḍha marma

SYNONYMS

tānre—unto him (Sanātana Gosvāmī); *śikhāilā*—the Lord taught him; *saba*—all; *vaiṣṇavera*—of the devotees; *dharma*—regular activities; *bhāgavata*—*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *ādi*—beginning with; *śāstrera*—of the revealed scriptures; *yata*—all; *gūḍha*—confidential; *marma*—purpose.

TRANSLATION

On the basis of scriptures like Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, which reveal these confidential directions, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu instructed Sanātana Gosvāmī regarding all the regular activities of a devotee.

PURPORT

In the *paramparā* system, the instructions taken from the bona fide spiritual master must also be based on revealed Vedic scriptures. One who is in the line of disciplic succession cannot manufacture his own way of behavior. There are many so-called followers of the Vaiṣṇava cult in the line of Caitanya Mahāprabhu who do not scrupulously follow the conclusions of the *śāstras*, and therefore they are considered to be *apa-sampradāya*, which means “outside of the *sampradāya*.” Some of these groups are known as *āula*, *bāula*, *kartābhajā*, *neḍā*, *daraveśa*, *sāñi sahajiyā*, *sakhībhekī*, *smārta*, *jāta-gosāñi*, *ativāḍī*, *cūḍādhārī* and *gaurāṅga-nāgarī*. In order to follow strictly the disciplic succession of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, one should not associate with these *apasampradāya* communities.

One who is not taught by a bona fide spiritual master cannot understand the Vedic literature. To emphasize this point, Lord Kṛṣṇa, while instructing Arjuna, clearly said that it was because Arjuna was His devotee and confidential friend that he could understand the mystery of the *Bhagavad-gītā*. It is to be concluded, therefore, that one who wants to understand the mystery of revealed scriptures must approach a bona fide spiritual master, hear from him very submissively and render service to him. Then the import of the scriptures will be revealed. It is stated in the *Vedas* (Śvetāśvatara Up. 6.23):

*yasya deve parā bhaktir yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthā prakāśante mahātmanah*
[ŚU ⁱⁱ6.23]

“The real import of the scriptures is revealed to one who has unflinching faith in both the Supreme Personality of Godhead and the spiritual master.” Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura advises, *sādhū-sāstra-guru-vākya, hṛdaye kariyā aikya*. The meaning of this instruction is that one must consider the instructions of the *sādhū*, the revealed scriptures and the spiritual master in order to understand the real purpose of spiritual life. Neither a *sādhū* (saintly person or Vaiṣṇava) nor a bona fide spiritual master says anything that is beyond the scope of the sanction of the revealed scriptures. Thus the statements of the revealed scriptures correspond to those of the bona fide spiritual master and saintly persons. One must therefore act with reference to these three important sources of understanding.

TEXT 49

itimadhye candraśekhara, miśra-tapana

duḥkhī hañā prabhu-pāya kaila nivedana

SYNONYMS

iti-madhye—in the meantime; *candraśekhara*—the clerk of the name Candraśekhara; *miśra-tapana*—as well as Tapana Miśra; *duḥkhī hañā*—becoming very unhappy; *prabhu-pāya*—at the lotus feet of the Lord; *kaila*—made; *nivedana*—an appeal.

TRANSLATION

While Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was instructing Sanātana Gosvāmī, both Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra became very unhappy. Therefore they submitted an appeal unto the lotus feet of the Lord.

TEXT 50

kateka śunība prabhu tomāra nindana

nā pāri sahite, ebe chāḍiba jīvana

SYNONYMS

kateka—how much; *śuniba*—shall we hear; *prabhu*—O Lord; *tomāra*—Your; *nindana*—blasphemy; *nā pāri*—we are not able; *sahite*—to tolerate; *ebe*—now; *chāḍiba*—give up; *jīvana*—life.

TRANSLATION

“How long can we tolerate the blasphemy by Your critics against Your conduct? We should give up our lives rather than hear such blasphemy.

PURPORT

One of the most important instructions by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu regarding regular Vaiṣṇava behavior is that a Vaiṣṇava should be tolerant like a tree and submissive like grass.

*tṛṇād api su-nīcena taror iva sahiṣṇunā
amāninā māna-dena kīrtanīyaḥ sadā hariḥ*

[Cc. adi 17.31]

“One should chant the holy name of the Lord in a humble state of mind, thinking oneself lower than the straw in the street; one should be more tolerant than a tree, devoid of all sense of false prestige and ready to offer all respect to others. In such a state of mind one can chant the holy name of the Lord constantly.” Nevertheless, the author of these instructions, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, did not tolerate the misbehavior of Jagāi and Mādhāi. When they harmed Lord Nityānanda Prabhu, He immediately became angry and wanted to kill them, and it was only by the mercy of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu that they were saved. One should be very meek and humble in his personal transactions, and if insulted a Vaiṣṇava should be tolerant and not angry. But if there is blasphemy against one’s *guru* or another Vaiṣṇava, one should be as angry as fire. This was exhibited by

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. One should not tolerate blasphemy against a Vaiṣṇava but should immediately take one of three actions. If someone blasphemes a Vaiṣṇava, one should stop him with arguments and higher reason. If one is not expert enough to do this he should give up his life on the spot, and if he cannot do this, he must go away. While Caitanya Mahāprabhu was in Benares or Kāśī, the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* blasphemed Him in many ways because although He was a *sannyāsī* He was indulging in chanting and dancing. Tapana Miśra and Candrasekhara heard this criticism, and it was intolerable for them because they were great devotees of Lord Caitanya. They could not stop it, however, and therefore they appealed to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu because this blasphemy was so intolerable that they had decided to give up their lives.

TEXT 51

tomāre nindaye yata sannyāsīra gaṇa

śunite nā pāri, phāṭe hṛdaya-śravaṇa

SYNONYMS

tomāre—unto You; *nindaye*—blasphemes; *yata*—all; *sannyāsīra gaṇa*—the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *śunite*—to hear; *nā*—cannot; *pāri*—tolerate; *phāṭe*—it breaks; *hṛdaya*—our hearts; *śravaṇa*—while hearing such blasphemy.

TRANSLATION

“The Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* are all criticizing Your Holiness. We cannot tolerate hearing such criticism, for this blasphemy breaks our hearts.”

PURPORT

This is a manifestation of real love for Kṛṣṇa and Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. There are three categories of Vaiṣṇavas: *kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs*,

madhyama-adhikārīs and *uttama-adhikārīs*. The *kaniṣṭha-adhikārī*, or the devotee in the lowest stage of Vaiṣṇava life, has firm faith but is not familiar with the conclusions of the *śāstras*. The devotee in the second stage, the *madhyama-adhikārī*, is completely aware of the śāstric conclusion and has firm faith in his *guru* and the Lord. He, therefore, avoiding nondevotees, preaches to the innocent. However, the *mahā-bhāgavata* or *uttama-adhikārī*, the devotee in the highest stage of devotional life, does not see anyone as being against the Vaiṣṇava principles, for he regards everyone as a Vaiṣṇava but himself. This is the essence of Caitanya Mahāprabhu's instruction that one be more tolerant than a tree and think oneself lower than the straw in the street (*tṛṇād api su-nīcena taror iva sahiṣṇunā*). However, even if a devotee is in the *uttama-bhāgavata* status he must come down to the second status of life, *madhyama-adhikārī*, to be a preacher, for a preacher should not tolerate blasphemy against another Vaiṣṇava. Although a *kaniṣṭha-adhikārī* also cannot tolerate such blasphemy, he is not competent to stop it by citing śāstric evidences. Therefore Tapanā Mīśra and Candrasekhara are understood to be *kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs* because they could not refute the arguments of the *sannyāsīs* in Benares. They appealed to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to take action, for they felt that they could not tolerate such criticism although they also could not stop it.

TEXT 52

ihā śuni rahe prabhu iṣat hāsiyā

sei kāle eka vipra milila āsiyā

SYNONYMS

ihā—this; *śuni*—hearing; *rahe*—remained; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *iṣat*—slightly; *hāsiyā*—smiling; *sei kāle*—at that time; *eka*—one; *vipra*—*brāhmaṇa*; *milila*—met; *āsiyā*—coming there.

TRANSLATION

While Tapana Miśra and Candraśekhara were thus talking with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, He only smiled slightly and remained silent. At that time a brāhmaṇa came there to meet the Lord.

PURPORT

Because the blasphemy was cast against Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu Himself, He did not feel sorry, and therefore He was smiling. This is ideal Vaiṣṇava behavior. One should not become angry upon hearing criticism of himself, but if other Vaiṣṇavas are criticized one must be prepared to act as previously suggested. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was very compassionate for His pure devotees Tapana Miśra and Candraśekhara; therefore by His grace this *brāhmaṇa* immediately came to Him. By His omnipotency the Lord created this situation for the happiness of His devotees.

TEXT 53

āsi' nivedana kare caraṇe dhariyā

eka vastu māgoṇ, deha prasanna ha-iyā

SYNONYMS

āsi'—coming there; *nivedana*—submissive statement; *kare*—made; *caraṇe*—unto the lotus feet; *dhariyā*—capturing; *eka*—one; *vastu*—thing; *māgoṇ*—beg from You; *deha*—kindly give it to me; *prasanna*—being pleased; *ha-iyā*—becoming so.

TRANSLATION

The brāhmaṇa immediately fell at the lotus feet of Caitanya Mahāprabhu and requested Him to accept his proposal in a joyful mood.

PURPORT

The Vedic injunctions state, *tad viddhi praṇipātena paripraśnena sevayā*: one must approach a superior authority in humbleness (Bg. 4.34). One cannot challenge a superior authority, but with great submission one can submit his proposal for acceptance by the spiritual master or spiritual authorities. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is an ideal teacher by His personal behavior, and so also are all His disciples. Thus this *brāhmaṇa*, being purified in association with Caitanya Mahāprabhu, followed these principles in submitting his request to the higher authority. He fell down at the lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and then spoke as follows.

TEXT 54

sakala sannyāsī muñi kainu nimantraṇa

tumi yadi āisa, pūrṇa haya mora mana

SYNONYMS

sakala—all; *sannyāsī*—renouncers; *muñi*—I; *kainu*—made; *nimantraṇa*—invited; *tumi*—Your good self; *yadi*—if; *āisa*—come; *pūrṇa*—fulfillment; *haya*—becomes; *mora*—my; *mana*—mind.

TRANSLATION

“My dear Lord, I have invited all the sannyāsīs of Benares to my home. My desires will be fulfilled if You also accept my invitation.”

PURPORT

This *brāhmaṇa* knew that Caitanya Mahāprabhu was the only Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī* in Benares at that time and all the others were Māyāvādīs. It is the duty of a *gṛhasṭha* to sometimes invite *sannyāsīs* to take food at his home. This *gṛhasṭha-brāhmaṇa* wanted to invite all the *sannyāsīs* to his

house, but he also knew that it would be very difficult to induce Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to accept such an invitation because the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* would be present. Therefore he fell down at His feet and fervently appealed to the Lord to be compassionate and grant his request. Thus he humbly submitted his desire.

TEXT 55

nā yāha sannyāsi-goṣṭhī, ihā āmi jāni

more anugraha kara nimantraṇa māni'

SYNONYMS

nā—not; *yāha*—You go; *sannyāsi-goṣṭhī*—the association of Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *ihā*—this; *āmi*—I; *jāni*—know; *more*—unto me; *anugraha*—merciful; *kara*—become; *nimantraṇa*—invitation; *māni'*—accepting.

TRANSLATION

“My dear Lord, I know that You never mix with other *sannyāsīs*, but please be merciful unto me and accept my invitation.

PURPORT

An *ācārya*, or great personality of the Vaiṣṇava school, is very strict in his principles, but although he is as hard as a thunderbolt, sometimes he is as soft as a rose. Thus actually he is independent. He follows all the rules and regulations strictly, but sometimes he slackens this policy. It was known that Lord Caitanya never mixed with the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, yet He conceded to the request of the *brāhmaṇa*, as stated in the next verse.

TEXT 56

prabhu hāsi' nimantraṇa kaila aṅgikāra

sannyāsire kṛpā lāgi' e bhaṅgī tāñhāra

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *hāsi'*—smiling; *nimantraṇa*—invitation; *kaila*—made; *aṅgikāra*—acceptance; *sannyāsire*—unto the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *kṛpā*—to show them mercy; *lāgi'*—for the matter of; *e*—this; *bhaṅgī*—gesture; *tāñhāra*—His.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya smiled and accepted the invitation of the brāhmaṇa. He made this gesture to show His mercy to the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs.

PURPORT

Tapana Miśra and Candraśekhara appealed to the lotus feet of the Lord regarding their grief at the criticism of Him by the *sannyāsīs* in Benares. Caitanya Mahāprabhu merely smiled, yet He wanted to fulfill the desires of His devotees, and the opportunity came when the *brāhmaṇa* came to request Him to accept his invitation to be present in the midst of the other *sannyāsīs*. This coincidence was made possible by the omnipotency of the Lord.

TEXT 57

se vipra jānena prabhu nā yā'na kā'ra ghare

tāñhāra preraṇāya tāñre atyāgraha kare

SYNONYMS

se—that; *vipra*—*brāhmaṇa*; *jānena*—knew it; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya

Mahāprabhu; *nā*—never; *yā'na*—goes; *kā'ra*—anyone's; *ghare*—house; *tañhāra*—His; *preraṇāya*—by inspiration; *tāñre*—unto Him; *atyāgraha kare*—strongly urging to accept the invitation.

TRANSLATION

The brāhmaṇa knew that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu never went to anyone else's house, yet due to inspiration from the Lord he earnestly requested Him to accept this invitation.

TEXT 58

āra dine gelā prabhu se vipra-bhavane

dekhilena, vasiyāchena sannyāsira gaṇe

SYNONYMS

āra—next; *dine*—day; *gelā*—went; *prabhu*—the Lord; *se*—that; *vipra*—*brāhmaṇa*; *bhavane*—in the house of; *dekhilena*—He saw; *vasiyāchena*—there were sitting; *sannyāsira*—all the *sannyāsīs*; *gaṇe*—in a group.

TRANSLATION

The next day, when Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu went to the house of that brāhmaṇa, He saw all the sannyāsīs of Benares sitting there.

TEXT 59

sabā namaskari' gelā pāda-prakṣālane

pāda prakṣālana kari vasilā sei sthāne

SYNONYMS

sabā—to all; *namaskari'*—offering obeisances; *gelā*—went; *pāda*—foot; *prakṣālane*—for washing; *pāda*—foot; *prakṣālana*—washing; *kari*—finishing; *vasilā*—sat down; *sei*—in that; *sthāne*—place.

TRANSLATION

As soon as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu saw the *sannyāsīs* He immediately offered obeisances, and then He went to wash His feet. After washing His feet, He sat down by the place where He had done so.

PURPORT

By offering His obeisances to the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu very clearly exhibited His humbleness to everyone. Vaiṣṇavas must not be disrespectful to anyone, to say nothing of a *sannyāsī*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu teaches, *amāninā māna-dena*: one should always be respectful to others but should not demand respect for himself. A *sannyāsī* should always walk barefoot, and therefore when he enters a temple or a society of devotees he should first wash his feet and then sit down in a proper place. In India it is still the prevalent custom that one put his shoes in a specified place and then enter the temple barefoot after washing his feet. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is an ideal *ācārya*, and those who follow in His footsteps should practice the methods of devotional life that He teaches us.

TEXT 60

vasiyā karilā kichu aiśvarya prakāśa

mahātejomaya vapu koṭi-sūryābhāsa

SYNONYMS

vasiyā—after sitting; *karilā*—exhibited; *kichu*—some; *aiśvarya*—mystic power; *prakāśa*—manifested; *mahā-tejo-maya*—very brilliantly; *vapu*—

body; *koṭi*—millions; *sūrya*—sun; *ābhāsa*—reflection.

TRANSLATION

After sitting on the ground, Caitanya Mahāprabhu exhibited His mystic power by manifesting an effulgence as brilliant as the illumination of millions of suns.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, as the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa, is full of all potencies. Therefore it is not remarkable for Him to manifest the illumination of millions of suns. Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa is known as Yogeśvara, the master of all mystic powers. Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself; therefore He can exhibit any mystic power.

TEXT 61

prabhāve ākarṣila saba sannyāsira mana

uṭhila sannyāsī saba chāḍiyā āsana

SYNONYMS

prabhāve—by such illumination; *ākarṣila*—He attracted; *saba*—all; *sannyāsira*—the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *mana*—mind; *uṭhila*—stood up; *sannyāsī*—all the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *saba*—all; *chāḍiyā*—giving up; *āsana*—sitting places.

TRANSLATION

When the sannyāsīs saw the brilliant illumination of the body of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, their minds were attracted, and they all immediately gave up their sitting places and stood in respect.

PURPORT

To draw the attention of common men, sometimes saintly persons, *ācāryas* and teachers exhibit extraordinary opulences. This is necessary to attract the attention of fools, but a saintly person should not misuse such power for personal sense gratification like false saints who declare themselves to be God. Even a magician can exhibit extraordinary feats that are not understandable to common men, but this does not mean that the magician is God. It is a most sinful activity to attract attention by exhibiting mystic powers and then to utilize this opportunity to declare oneself to be God. A real saintly person never declares himself to be God but always places himself in the position of a servant of God. For a servant of God there is no need to exhibit mystic powers, and he does not like to do so, but on behalf of the Supreme Personality of Godhead a humble servant of God performs his activities in such a wonderful way that no common man can dare try to act like him. Yet a saintly person never takes credit for such actions because he knows very well that when wonderful things are done on his behalf by the grace of the Supreme Lord, all credit goes to the master and not to the servant.

TEXT 62

prakāśānanda-nāme sarva sannyāsi-pradhāna

prabhuke kahila kichu kariyā sammāna

SYNONYMS

prakāśānanda—Prakāśānanda; *nāme*—of the name; *sarva*—all; *sannyāsi-pradhāna*—chief of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *prabhuke*—unto the Lord; *kahila*—said; *kichu*—something; *kariyā*—showing Him; *sammāna*—respect.

TRANSLATION

The leader of all the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs present was named Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, and after standing up he addressed Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu as follows with great respect.

PURPORT

As Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu showed respect to all the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, similarly the leader of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, Prakāśānanda, also showed his respects to the Lord.

TEXT 63

ihāṇ āisa, ihāṇ āisa, śunaha śrīpāda

apavitra sthāne vaisa, kibā avasāda

SYNONYMS

ihāṇ āisa—come here; *ihāṇ āisa*—come here; *śunaha*—kindly hear; *śrīpāda*—Your Holiness; *apavitra*—unholy; *sthāne*—place; *vaisa*—You are sitting; *kibā*—what is that; *avasāda*—lamentation.

TRANSLATION

“Please come here. Please come here, Your Holiness. Why do You sit in that unclean place? What has caused Your lamentation?”

PURPORT

Here is the distinction between Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī. In the material world everyone wants to introduce himself as very important and great, but Caitanya Mahāprabhu introduced Himself very humbly and meekly. The Māyāvādīs were sitting in an exalted position, and Caitanya Mahāprabhu sat in a place that was not even clean. Therefore the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* thought that He must

have been aggrieved for some reason, and Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī inquired about the cause for His lamentation.

TEXT 64

prabhu kahe,—āmi ha-i hīna-sampradāya

tomā-sabāra sabhāya vasite nā yuyāya

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord replied; *āmi*—I; *ha-i*—am; *hīna-sampradāya*—belonging to a lower spiritual school; *tomā-sabāra*—of all of you; *sabhāya*—in the assembly; *vasite*—to sit down; *nā*—never; *yuyāya*—I can dare.

TRANSLATION

The Lord replied, “I belong to a lower order of *sannyāsīs*. Therefore I do not deserve to sit with you.”

PURPORT

Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* are always very puffed up because of their knowledge of Sanskrit and because they belong to the Śāṅkara-sampradāya. They are always under the impression that unless one is a *brāhmaṇa* and a very good Sanskrit scholar, especially in grammar, one cannot accept the renounced order of life or become a preacher. Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* always misinterpret all the *śāstras* with their word jugglery and grammatical compositions, yet Śrīpāda Śāṅkarācārya himself condemned such jugglery of words in the verse *prāpte sannihite kāle na hi na hi rakṣati dukṛṇ karaṇe*. *Dukṛṇ* refers to suffixes and prefixes in Sanskrit grammar. Śāṅkarācārya warned his disciples that if they concerned themselves only with the principles of grammar, not worshiping Govinda, they were fools who would never be saved. Yet in spite of Śrīpāda Śāṅkarācārya’s

instructions, foolish Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* are always busy juggling words on the basis of strict Sanskrit grammar.

Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* are very puffed up if they hold the elevated *sannyāsa* title Tīrtha, Āśrama or Sarasvatī. Even among Māyāvādīs, those who belong to other *sampradāyas* and hold other titles, such as Vana, Araṇya or Bhāratī, are considered to be lower-grade *sannyāsīs*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted *sannyāsa* from the Bhāratī-sampradāya, and thus He considered Himself a lower *sannyāsī* than Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī. To remain distinct from Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsīs*, the *sannyāsīs* of the Māyāvādī-sampradāya always think themselves to be situated in a very much elevated spiritual order, but Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, in order to teach them how to become humble and meek, accepted Himself as belonging to a lower *sampradāya* of *sannyāsīs*. Thus He wanted to point out clearly that a *sannyāsī* is one who is advanced in spiritual knowledge. One who is advanced in spiritual knowledge should be accepted as occupying a better position than those who lack such knowledge.

The Māyāvādī-sampradāya *sannyāsīs* are generally known as Vedāntīs, as if Vedānta were their monopoly. Actually, however, Vedāntī refers to a person who perfectly knows Kṛṣṇa. As confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.15), *vedaiś ca sarvair aham eva vedyah*: By all the *Vedas* it is Kṛṣṇa who is to be known. The so-called Māyāvādī Vedāntīs do not know who Kṛṣṇa is; therefore their title of Vedāntī, or “knower of Vedānta philosophy,” is simply a pretension. Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* always think of themselves as real *sannyāsīs* and consider *sannyāsīs* of the Vaiṣṇava order to be *brahmacārīs*. A *brahmacārī* is supposed to engage in the service of a *sannyāsī* and accept him as his *guru*. Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* therefore declare themselves to be not only *gurus* but *jagad-gurus*, or the spiritual masters of the entire world, although, of course, they cannot see the entire world. Sometimes they dress gorgeously and travel on the backs of elephants in processions, and thus they are always puffed up, accepting themselves as *jagad-gurus*. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, however, has explained that *jagad-guru* properly refers to one who is the controller of his tongue, mind, words, belly, genitals and anger. *Prṥthivīm sa śiṣyāt*: such a *jagad-guru* is

completely fit to make disciples all over the world. Due to false prestige, Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* who do not have these qualifications sometimes harass and blaspheme a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī* who humbly engages in the service of the Lord.

TEXT 65

āpane prakāśānanda hātete dhariyā

vasāilā sabhā-madhye sammāna kariyā

SYNONYMS

āpane—personally; *prakāśānanda*—Prakāśānanda; *hātete*—by His hand; *dhariyā*—capturing; *vasāilā*—made Him sit; *sabhā-madhye*—in the assembly of; *sammāna*—with great respect; *kariyā*—offering Him.

TRANSLATION

Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, however, caught Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu personally by the hand and seated Him with great respect in the midst of the assembly.

PURPORT

The respectful behavior of Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī toward Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is very much to be appreciated. Such behavior is calculated to be *ajñāta-sukṛti*, or pious activities that one executes unknowingly. Thus Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu very tactfully gave Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī an opportunity to advance in *ajñāta-sukṛti* so that in the future he might actually become a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī*.

TEXT 66

puchila, tomāra nāma ‘śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya’

keśava-bhāratīra śiṣya, tāte tumi dhanya

SYNONYMS

puchila—inquired; *tomāra*—Your; *nāma*—name; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—the name Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *keśava-bhāratīra śiṣya*—You are a disciple of Keśava Bhāratī; *tāte*—in that connection; *tumi*—You are; *dhanya*—glorious.

TRANSLATION

Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī then said, “I understand that Your name is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. You are a disciple of Śrī Keśava Bhāratī, and therefore You are glorious.

TEXT 67

sāmpradāyika sannyāsī tumi, raha ei grāme

ki kāraṇe āmā-sabāra nā kara darśane

SYNONYMS

sāmpradāyika—of the community; *sannyāsī*—Māyāvādī *sannyāsī*; *tumi*—You are; *raha*—live; *ei*—this; *grāme*—in Vārāṇasī; *ki kāraṇe*—for what reason; *āmā-sabāra*—with us; *nā*—do not; *kara*—endeavor; *darśane*—to mix.

TRANSLATION

“You belong to our Śaṅkara-sampradāya and live in our village, Vārāṇasī. Why then do You not associate with us? Why is it that You avoid even seeing us?

PURPORT

A Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī* or a Vaiṣṇava in the second stage of advancement in spiritual knowledge can understand four principles—namely, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the devotees, the innocent and the jealous—and he behaves differently with each. He tries to increase his love for Godhead, make friendship with devotees and preach Kṛṣṇa consciousness among the innocent, but he avoids the jealous who are envious of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu Himself exemplified such behavior, and this is why Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī inquired why He did not associate or even talk with them. Caitanya Mahāprabhu confirmed by example that a preacher of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement generally should not waste his time talking with Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, but when there are arguments on the basis of *śāstra*, a Vaiṣṇava must come forward to talk and defeat them in philosophy.

According to Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, only one who takes *sannyāsa* in the disciplic succession from Śaṅkarācārya is a Vedic *sannyāsī*. Sometimes it is challenged that the *sannyāsīs* who are preaching in the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement are not genuine because they do not belong to *brāhmaṇa* families, for Māyāvādīs do not offer *sannyāsa* to one who does not belong to a *brāhmaṇa* family by birth. Unfortunately, however, they do not know that at present everyone is born a *śūdra* (*kalau śūdra-sambhavaḥ*). It is to be understood that there are no *brāhmaṇas* in this age because those who claim to be *brāhmaṇas* simply on the basis of birthright do not have the brahminical qualifications. However, even if one is born in a non-*brāhmaṇa* family, if he has the brahminical qualifications he should be accepted as a *brāhmaṇa*, as confirmed by Śrīla Nārada Muni and the great saint Śrīdhara Svāmī. This is also stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. Both Nārada and Śrīdhara Svāmī completely agree that one cannot be a *brāhmaṇa* by birthright but must possess the qualities of a *brāhmaṇa*. Thus in our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement we never offer the *sannyāsa* order to a person whom we do not find to be qualified in terms of the prescribed brahminical principles. Although it is a fact that unless one is a *brāhmaṇa* he cannot become a *sannyāsī*, it is not a valid principle that an unqualified man who is born in a *brāhmaṇa*

family is a *brāhmaṇa* whereas a brahminically qualified person born in a non-*brāhmaṇa* family cannot be accepted. The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement strictly follows the injunctions of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, avoiding misleading heresy and manufactured conclusions.

TEXT 68

sannyāsī ha-iyā kara nartana-gāyana

bhāvuka saba saṅge lañā kara saṅkīrtana

SYNONYMS

sannyāsī—the renounced order of life; *ha-iyā*—accepting; *kara*—You do; *nartana-gāyana*—dancing and chanting; *bhāvuka*—fanatics; *saba*—all; *saṅge*—in Your company; *lañā*—accepting them; *kara*—You do; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the holy name of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

“You are a *sannyāsī*. Why then do You indulge in chanting and dancing, engaging in Your *saṅkīrtana* movement in the company of fanatics?

PURPORT

This is a challenge by Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya* that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is the object of Vedānta philosophical research, has very kindly determined who is an appropriate candidate for study of Vedānta philosophy. The first qualification of such a candidate is expressed by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu in His *Śikṣāṣṭaka*:

*trṇād api su-nīcena taror iva sahiṣṇunā
amāninā māna-dena kīrtanīyaḥ sadā hariḥ*
[Cc. adi 17.3I]

This statement indicates that one can hear or speak about Vedānta philosophy through the disciplic succession. One must be very humble and meek, more tolerant than a tree and more humble than the grass. One should not claim respect for himself but should be prepared to give all respect to others. One must have these qualifications to be eligible to understand Vedic knowledge.

TEXT 69

vedānta-paṭhana, dhyāna, — — sannyāsīra dharma

tāhā chāḍī' kara kene bhāvukera karma

SYNONYMS

vedānta-paṭhana—studying Vedānta philosophy; *dhyāna*—meditation; *sannyāsīra*—of a *sannyāsī*; *dharma*—duties; *tāhā chāḍī'*—giving them up; *kara*—You do; *kene*—why; *bhāvukera*—of the fanatics; *karma*—activities.

TRANSLATION

“Meditation and the study of Vedānta are the sole duties of a *sannyāsī*. Why do You abandon these to dance with fanatics?”

PURPORT

As explained in regard to verse 41, Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* do not approve of chanting and dancing. Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, like Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, misunderstood Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu to be a misled young *sannyāsī*, and therefore he asked Him why He indulged in the association of fanatics instead of executing the duty of a *sannyāsī*.

TEXT 70

prabhāve dekhiye tomā sākṣāt nārāyaṇa

hīnācāra kara kene, ithe ki kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

prabhāve—in Your opulence; *dekhiye*—I see; *tomā*—You; *sākṣāt*—directly; *nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *hīna-ācāra*—lower-class behavior; *kara*—You do; *kene*—why; *ithe*—in this; *ki*—what is; *kāraṇa*—reason.

TRANSLATION

“You look as brilliant as if You were Nārāyaṇa Himself. Will You kindly explain the reason that You have adopted the behavior of lower-class people?”

PURPORT

Due to renunciation, Vedānta study, meditation and the strict regulative principles of their daily routine, Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* are certainly in a position to execute pious activities. Thus Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, on account of his piety, could understand that Caitanya Mahāprabhu was not an ordinary person but the Supreme Personality of Godhead. *Sākṣāt nārāyaṇa*: he considered Him to be Nārāyaṇa Himself. Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* address one another as Nārāyaṇa because they think that they are all going to be Nārāyaṇa or merge with Nārāyaṇa in the next life. Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī appreciated that Caitanya Mahāprabhu had already directly become Nārāyaṇa and did not need to wait until His next life. One difference between the Vaiṣṇava and Māyāvādī philosophies is that Māyāvādī philosophers think that after giving up their bodies they are going to become Nārāyaṇa by merging with His body, whereas Vaiṣṇava philosophers understand that after the body dies they are going to have a transcendental, spiritual body in which to associate with Nārāyaṇa.

TEXT 71

prabhu kahe—śuna, śrīpāda, ihāra kāraṇa

guru more mūrkhā dekhi' karīla śāsana

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord replied; *śuna*—kindly hear; *śrīpāda*—Your Holiness; *ihāra*—of this; *kāraṇa*—reason; *guru*—My spiritual master; *more*—Me; *mūrkhā*—fool; *dekhi'*—understanding; *karīla*—he did; *śāsana*—chastisement.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu replied to Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, “My dear sir, kindly hear the reason. My spiritual master considered Me a fool, and therefore he chastised Me.

PURPORT

When Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī inquired from Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu why He neither studied Vedānta nor performed meditation, Lord Caitanya presented Himself as a number one fool in order to indicate that the present age, Kali-yuga, is an age of fools and rascals in which it is not possible to obtain perfection simply by reading Vedānta philosophy and meditating. The *śāstras* strongly recommend:

harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam
kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva nāsty eva gatir anyathā
[Adi 17.21]

“In this age of quarrel and hypocrisy the only means of deliverance is the chanting of the holy names of the Lord. There is no other way. There is no other way. There is no other way.” People in general in Kali-yuga are

so fallen that it is not possible for them to obtain perfection simply by studying the *Vedānta-sūtra*. One should therefore seriously take to the constant chanting of the holy name of the Lord.

TEXT 72

mūrkhā tumi, tomāra nāhika vedāntādhikāra

‘kṛṣṇa-mantra’ japa sadā,——ei mantra-sāra

SYNONYMS

mūrkhā tumi—You are a fool; *tomāra*—Your; *nāhika*—there is not; *vedānta*—Vedānta philosophy; *adhikāra*—qualification to study; *kṛṣṇa-mantra*—the hymn of Kṛṣṇa (Hare Kṛṣṇa); *japa*—chant; *sadā*—always; *ei*—this; *mantra*—hymn; *sāra*—essence of all Vedic knowledge.

TRANSLATION

“‘You are a fool,’ he said. ‘You are not qualified to study Vedānta philosophy, and therefore You must always chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa. This is the essence of all mantras, or Vedic hymns.

PURPORT

Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī Mahārāja comments in this connection, “One can become perfectly successful in the mission of his life if he acts exactly according to the words he hears from the mouth of his spiritual master.” This acceptance of the words of the spiritual master is called *śrauta-vākya*, which indicates that the disciple must carry out the spiritual master’s instructions without deviation. Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura remarks in this connection that a disciple must accept the words of his spiritual master as his life and soul. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu here confirms this by saying that since His spiritual master ordered Him only to chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa, He always chanted

the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* according to this direction ('*kṛṣṇa-mantra*' *japa sadā,—ei mantra-sāra*).

Kṛṣṇa is the origin of everything. Therefore when a person is fully Kṛṣṇa conscious it is to be understood that his relationship with Kṛṣṇa has been fully confirmed. Lacking Kṛṣṇa consciousness, one is only partially related with Kṛṣṇa and is therefore not in his constitutional position. Although Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa, the spiritual master of the entire universe, He nevertheless took the position of a disciple in order to teach by example how a devotee should strictly follow the orders of a spiritual master in executing the duty of always chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. One who is very much attracted to the study of Vedānta philosophy must take lessons from Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. In this age, no one is actually competent to study Vedānta, and therefore it is better that one chant the holy name of the Lord, which is the essence of all Vedic knowledge, as Kṛṣṇa Himself confirms in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.15):

*vedaiś ca sarvair aham eva vedyo
vedānta-kṛd veda-vid eva cāham*

“By all the *Vedas*, I am to be known. Indeed, I am the compiler of *Vedānta*, and I am the knower of the *Vedas*.”

Only fools give up the service of the spiritual master and think themselves advanced in spiritual knowledge. In order to check such fools, Caitanya Mahāprabhu Himself presented the perfect example of how to be a disciple. A spiritual master knows very well how to engage each disciple in a particular duty, but if a disciple, thinking himself more advanced than his spiritual master, gives up his orders and acts independently, he checks his own spiritual progress. Every disciple must consider himself completely unaware of the science of Kṛṣṇa and must always be ready to carry out the orders of the spiritual master to become competent in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. A disciple should always remain a fool before his spiritual master. Therefore sometimes pseudo spiritualists

accept a spiritual master who is not even fit to become a disciple because they want to keep him under their control. This is useless for spiritual realization.

One who imperfectly knows Kṛṣṇa consciousness cannot know Vedānta philosophy. A showy display of Vedānta study without Kṛṣṇa consciousness is a feature of the external energy, *māyā*, and as long as one is attracted by the inebrieties of this ever-changing material energy, he deviates from devotion to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. An actual follower of Vedānta philosophy is a devotee of Lord Viṣṇu, who is the greatest of the great and the maintainer of the entire universe. Unless one surpasses the field of activities in service to the limited, one cannot reach the unlimited. Knowledge of the unlimited is actual *brahma-jñāna*, or knowledge of the Supreme. Those who are addicted to fruitive activities and speculative knowledge cannot understand the value of the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa, which is always completely pure, eternally liberated and full of spiritual bliss. One who has taken shelter of the holy name of the Lord, which is identical with the Lord, does not have to study Vedānta philosophy, for he has already completed all such study.

One who is unfit to chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa but thinks that the holy name is different from Kṛṣṇa and thus takes shelter of Vedānta study in order to understand Him must be considered a number one fool, as confirmed by Caitanya Mahāprabhu by His personal behavior, and philosophical speculators who want to make Vedānta philosophy an academic career are also considered to be within the material energy. A person who always chants the holy name of the Lord, however, is already beyond the ocean of nescience, and thus even a person born in a low family who engages in chanting the holy name of the Lord is considered to be beyond the study of Vedānta philosophy. In this connection *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (3.33.7) states:

*aho bata śva-paco 'to garīyān
yaj-jihvāgre vartate nāma tubhyam
tepus tapas te juhuvuḥ sasnur āryā*

brahmānūcur nāma gr̥ṇanti ye te

“If a person born in a family of dog-eaters takes to the chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa, it is to be understood that in his previous life he must have executed all kinds of austerities and penances and performed all the Vedic *yajñas*.” Another quotation states:

*ṛg-vedo 'tha yajur-vedaḥ sāma-vedo 'py atharvaṇaḥ
adhītās tena yenoktaṁ harir ity akṣara-dvayam*

“A person who chants the two syllables *ha-ri* has already studied the four *Vedas*—*Sāma*, *Ṛg*, *Yajur* and *Atharva*.”

Taking advantage of these verses, there are some *sahajiyās* who, taking everything very cheaply, consider themselves elevated Vaiṣṇavas but do not care even to touch the *Vedānta-sūtra* or Vedānta philosophy. A real Vaiṣṇava should, however, study Vedānta philosophy, but if after studying Vedānta one does not adopt the chanting of the holy name of the Lord, he is no better than a Māyāvādī. Therefore, one should not be a Māyāvādī, yet one should not be unaware of the subject matter of Vedānta philosophy. Indeed, Caitanya Mahāprabhu exhibited His knowledge of Vedānta in His discourses with Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī. Thus it is to be understood that a Vaiṣṇava should be completely conversant with Vedānta philosophy, yet he should not think that studying Vedānta is all in all and therefore be unattached to the chanting of the holy name. A devotee must know the importance of simultaneously understanding Vedānta philosophy and chanting the holy names. If by studying Vedānta one becomes an impersonalist, he has not been able to understand Vedānta. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.15).

Vedānta means “the end of knowledge.” The ultimate end of knowledge is knowledge of Kṛṣṇa, who is identical with His holy name. Cheap Vaiṣṇavas (*sahajiyās*) do not care to study the Vedānta philosophy as commented upon by the four *ācāryas*. In the Gauḍīya-sampradāya there is a Vedānta commentary called the *Govinda-bhāṣya*, but the *sahajiyās* consider such commentaries to be untouchable philosophical speculation,

and they consider the *ācāryas* to be mixed devotees. Thus they clear their way to hell.

TEXT 73

kṛṣṇa-mantra haite habe saṁsāra-mocana

kṛṣṇa-nāma haite pābe kṛṣṇera caraṇa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-mantra—the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*; *haite*—from; *habe*—it will be; *saṁsāra*—material existence; *mocana*—deliverance; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *haite*—from; *pābe*—one will get; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *caraṇa*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

“Simply by chanting the holy name of Kṛṣṇa one can obtain freedom from material existence. Indeed, simply by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra one will be able to see the lotus feet of the Lord.

PURPORT

In his *Anubhāṣya*, Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī says that the actual effect that will be visible as soon as one achieves transcendental knowledge is that he will immediately become free from the clutches of *māyā* and fully engage in the service of the Lord. Unless one serves the Supreme Personality of Godhead Mukunda, one cannot become free from fruitive activities under the external energy. However, when one chants the holy name of the Lord offenselessly, one can realize a transcendental position that is completely aloof from the material conception of life. Rendering service to the Lord, a devotee relates to the Supreme Personality of Godhead in one of five relationships—namely, *śānta*, *dāsyā*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* or *mādhurya*—and thus he relishes transcendental

bliss in that relationship. Such a relationship certainly transcends the body and mind. When one realizes that the holy name of the Lord is identical with the Supreme Person, he becomes completely eligible to chant the holy name of the Lord. Such an ecstatic chanter and dancer must be considered to have a direct relationship with the Lord.

According to the Vedic principles, there are three stages of spiritual advancement, namely, *sambandha-jñāna*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*. *Sambandha-jñāna* refers to establishing one's original relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead, *abhidheya* refers to acting according to that constitutional relationship, and *prayojana* is the ultimate goal of life, which is to develop love of Godhead (*premā pum-artho mahān*). If one adheres to the regulative principles under the order of the spiritual master, he very easily achieves the ultimate goal of his life. A person who is addicted to the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* very easily gets the opportunity to serve the Supreme Personality of Godhead directly. There is no need for such a person to understand the grammatical jugglery in which Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* generally indulge. Śrī Śaṅkarācārya also stressed this point: *na hi na hi rakṣati dukṛtṁ karaṇe*. "Simply by juggling grammatical suffixes and prefixes one cannot save himself from the clutches of death." The grammatical word jugglers cannot bewilder a devotee who engages in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. Simply addressing the energy of the Supreme Lord as Hare and the Lord Himself as Kṛṣṇa very soon situates the Lord within the heart of the devotee. By thus addressing Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, one directly engages in His Lordship's service. The essence of all revealed scriptures and all knowledge is present when one addresses the Lord and His energy by the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, for this transcendental vibration can completely liberate a conditioned soul and directly engage him in the service of the Lord.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu presented Himself as a grand fool, yet He maintained that all the words that He had heard from His spiritual master strictly followed the principles stated by Vyāsadeva in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.7.6).

*anarthopaśamaṁ sākṣād bhakti-yogam adhokṣaje
lokasyājānato vidvāṁś cakre sātvata-saṁhitām*

“The material miseries of a living entity, which are superfluous to him, can be directly mitigated by the linking process of devotional service. But the mass of people do not know this, and therefore the learned Vyāsadeva compiled this Vedic literature [*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*], which is in relation to the Supreme Truth.” One can overcome all misconceptions and entanglement in the material world by practicing *bhakti-yoga*, and therefore Vyāsadeva, acting on the instruction of Śrī Nārada, has very kindly introduced *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* to relieve the conditioned souls from the clutches of *māyā*. Lord Caitanya’s spiritual master instructed Him, therefore, that one must read *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* regularly and with scrutiny to gradually become attached to the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

The holy name and the Lord are identical. One who is completely free from the clutches of *māyā* can understand this fact. This knowledge, which is achieved by the mercy of the spiritual master, places one on the supreme transcendental platform. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu presented Himself as a fool because prior to accepting the shelter of a spiritual master He could not understand that simply by chanting one can be relieved from all material conditions. But as soon as He became a faithful servant of His spiritual master and followed his instructions, He very easily saw the path of liberation. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* must be understood to be devoid of all offenses. The ten offenses against the holy name are as follows: (1) to blaspheme a devotee of the Lord, (2) to consider the Lord and the demigods to be on the same level or to think that there are many gods, (3) to neglect the orders of the spiritual master, (4) to minimize the authority of scriptures (*Vedas*), (5) to interpret the holy name of God, (6) to commit sins on the strength of chanting, (7) to instruct the glories of the Lord’s name to the unfaithful, (8) to compare the chanting of the holy name with material piety, (9) to be inattentive while chanting the holy name, and (10) to be attached to material things in spite of chanting the holy name.

TEXT 74

nāma vinu kali-kāle nāhi āra dharma

sarva-mantra-sāra nāma, ei śāstra-marma

SYNONYMS

nāma—the holy name; *vinu*—without; *kali-kāle*—in this Age of Kali; *nāhi*—there is none; *āra*—or any alternative; *dharma*—religious principle; *sarva*—all; *mantra*—hymns; *sāra*—essence; *nāma*—the holy name; *ei*—this is; *śāstra*—revealed scriptures; *marma*—purport.

TRANSLATION

“In this Age of Kali there is no religious principle other than the chanting of the holy name, which is the essence of all Vedic hymns. This is the purport of all scriptures.’

PURPORT

The principles of the *paramparā* system were strictly honored in previous ages—Satya-yuga, Tretā-yuga and Dvāpara-yuga—but in the present age, Kali-yuga, people neglect the importance of this system of *śrauta-paramparā*, or receiving knowledge by disciplic succession. In this age, people are prepared to argue that they can understand that which is beyond their limited knowledge and perception through so-called scientific observations and experiments, not knowing that actual truth comes down to man from authorities. This argumentative attitude is against the Vedic principles, and it is very difficult for one who adopts it to understand that the holy name of Kṛṣṇa is as good as Kṛṣṇa Himself. Since Kṛṣṇa and His holy name are identical, the holy name is eternally pure and beyond material contamination. It is the Supreme Personality of Godhead as a transcendental vibration. The holy name is completely different from material sound, as confirmed by Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura:

golokera prema-dhana, hari-nāma-saṅkīrtana. The transcendental vibration of *hari-nāma-saṅkīrtana* is imported from the spiritual world. Thus although materialists who are addicted to experimental knowledge and the so-called “scientific method” cannot place their faith in the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, it is a fact that simply by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* offenselessly one can be freed from all subtle and gross material conditions. The spiritual world is called Vaikuṇṭha, which means “without anxiety.” In the material world everything is full of anxiety (*kuṇṭha*), whereas in the spiritual world (Vaikuṇṭha) everything is free from anxiety. Therefore those who are afflicted by a combination of anxieties cannot understand the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, which is free from all anxiety. In the present age the vibration of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* is the only process that is in a transcendental position, beyond material contamination. Since the holy name can deliver a conditioned soul, it is explained here to be *sarva-mantra-sāra*, the essence of all Vedic hymns.

A name that represents an object of this material world may be subjected to arguments and experimental knowledge, but in the absolute world a name and its owner, the fame and the famous, are identical, and similarly the qualities, pastimes and everything else pertaining to the Absolute are also absolute. Although Māyāvādīs profess monism, they differentiate between the holy name of the Supreme Lord and the Lord Himself. For this offense of *nāmāparādha* they gradually glide down from their exalted position of *brahma-jñāna*, as confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.2.32):

*āruhya kṛcchreṇa param padam tataḥ
patanty adho 'nādr̥ta-yuṣmad-aṅghrayaḥ*

Although by severe austerities they rise to the exalted position of *brahma-jñāna*, they nevertheless fall down due to imperfect knowledge of the Absolute Truth. Although they profess to understand the Vedic *mantra sarvaṁ khalv idaṁ brahma* (*Chāndogya Up.* 3.14.1), which means “Everything is Brahman,” they are unable to understand that the holy name is also Brahman. If they regularly chant the *mahā-mantra*, however,

they can be relieved from this misconception. Unless one properly takes shelter of the holy name, he cannot be relieved from the offensive stage in chanting the holy name.

TEXT 75

eta bali' eka śloka śikhāila more

kaṇṭhe kari' ei śloka kariha vicāre

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *eka śloka*—one verse; *śikhāila*—taught; *more*—Me; *kaṇṭhe*—in the throat; *kari'*—keeping; *ei*—this; *śloka*—verse; *kariha*—You should do; *vicāre*—in consideration.

TRANSLATION

“After describing the potency of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra, My spiritual master taught Me another verse, advising Me to always keep it within My throat.

TEXT 76

harer nāma harer nāma

harer nāmaiva kevalam

kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva

nāsty eva gatir anyathā

[Adi 17.21]

SYNONYMS

hareḥ nāma—the holy name of the Lord; *hareḥ nāma*—the holy name of the Lord; *eva*—certainly; *kevalam*—only; *kalau*—in this Age of Kali; *na asti*—there is none; *eva*—certainly; *na asti*—there is none; *eva*—certainly; *na asti*—there is none; *eva*—certainly; *gatiḥ*—progress; *anyathā*—otherwise.

TRANSLATION

“For spiritual progress in this Age of Kali, there is no alternative, there is no alternative, there is no alternative to the holy name, the holy name, the holy name of the Lord.’

PURPORT

For progress in spiritual life, the *śāstras* recommend meditation in Satya-yuga, sacrifice for the satisfaction of Lord Viṣṇu in Tretā-yuga and gorgeous worship of the Lord in the temple in Dvāpara-yuga, but in the Age of Kali one can achieve spiritual progress only by chanting the holy name of the Lord. This is confirmed in various scriptures. In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* there are many references to this fact. In the Twelfth Canto (3.51) it is said:

*kaler doṣa-nidhe rājann asti hy eko mahān guṇaḥ
kīrtanād eva kṛṣṇasya mukta-saṅgaḥ param vrajet*

In the Age of Kali there are many faults, for people are subjected to many miserable conditions, yet in this age there is one great benediction—simply by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* one can be freed from all material contamination and thus be elevated to the spiritual world. The *Nārada-pañcarātra* also praises the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* as follows:

*trayo vedāḥ ṣaḍ-aṅgāni chandāmsi vividhāḥ surāḥ
sarvam aṣṭākṣarāntaḥ-sthaṁ yac cānyad api vān-mayam
sarva-vedānta-sārārthaḥ saṁsārārṇava-tāraṇaḥ*

“The essence of all Vedic knowledge—comprehending the three kinds of Vedic activity [*karma-kāṇḍa*, *jñāna-kāṇḍa* and *upāsanā-kāṇḍa*], the *chandās*, or Vedic hymns, and the processes for satisfying the demigods—is included in the eight syllables Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa. This is the reality of all Vedānta. The chanting of the holy name is the only means to cross the ocean of nescience.” Similarly, the *Kali-santarāṇa Upaniṣad* states, “Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare—these sixteen names composed of thirty-two syllables are the only means to counteract the evil effects of Kali-yuga. In all the *Vedas* it is seen that to cross the ocean of nescience there is no alternative to the chanting of the holy name.” Similarly, Śrī Madhvācārya, while commenting upon the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad*, has quoted the following verse from the *Nārāyaṇa-saṁhitā*:

*dvāparīyair janair viṣṇuḥ pañcarātrais tu kevalaiḥ
kalau tu nāma-mātreṇa pūjyate bhagavān hariḥ*

“In Dvāpara-yuga one could satisfy Kṛṣṇa or Viṣṇu only by worshiping Him gorgeously according to the *pañcarātrikī* system, but in the Age of Kali one can satisfy and worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead Hari simply by chanting the holy name.” In his *Bhakti-sandarbhā* (text 284), Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī strongly emphasizes the chanting of the holy name of the Lord as follows:

*nanu bhagavan-nāmātmakā eva mantrāḥ, tatra viśeṣeṇa namaḥ-
śabdādy-alanḱṛtāḥ śrī-bhagavatā śrīmad-ṛṣibhiś cāhita-śakti-viśeṣāḥ, śrī-
bhagavatā samam ātma-sambandha-viśeṣa-pratipādakāś ca tatra kevalāni
śrī-bhagavan-nāmāny api nirapekṣāny eva parama-puruṣārtha-phala-
paryanta-dāna-samarthāni tato mantreṣu nāmato 'py adhika-sāmarthyē
labdhe katham dīkṣādy-apekṣā. ucyate—yady api svarūpato nāsti, tathāpi
prāyaḥ svabhāvato dehādī-sambandhena kadarya-śīlānām vikṣipta-
cittānām janānām tat-saṅkocī-karaṇāya śrīmad-ṛṣi-prabhṛtibhir atrārcana-
mārge kvacit kvacit kācīt kācin maryādā sthāpitāstī.*

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī states that the substance of all the Vedic *mantras* is

the chanting of the holy name of the Lord. Every *mantra* begins with the prefix *nama om* and eventually addresses by name the Supreme Personality of Godhead. By the supreme will of the Lord there is a specific potency in each and every *mantra* chanted by great sages like Nārada Muni and other *ṛṣis*. Chanting the holy name of the Lord immediately renovates the transcendental relationship of the living being with the Supreme Lord.

To chant the holy name of the Lord, one need not depend upon other paraphernalia, for one can immediately get all the desired results of linking with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. It may therefore be questioned why there is a necessity for initiation or further spiritual activities in devotional service for one who engages in the chanting of the holy name of the Lord. The answer is that although it is correct that one who fully engages in chanting the holy name need not depend upon the process of initiation, generally a devotee is addicted to many abominable material habits due to material contamination from his previous life. In order to get quick relief from all these contaminations, it is required that one engage in the worship of the Lord in the temple. The worship of the Deity in the temple is essential to reduce one's restlessness due to the contaminations of conditioned life. Thus Nārada, in his *pāñcarātrikī-vidhi*, and other great sages have sometimes stressed that since every conditioned soul has a bodily concept of life aimed at sense enjoyment, to restrict this sense enjoyment the rules and regulations for worshiping the Deity in the temple are essential. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī has described that the holy name of the Lord can be chanted by liberated souls, but almost all the souls we have to initiate are conditioned. It is advised that one chant the holy name of the Lord without offenses and according to the regulative principles, yet due to their past bad habits they violate these rules and regulations. Thus the regulative principles for worship of the Deity are also simultaneously essential.

TEXT 77

ei ājñā pāñā nāma la-i anukṣaṇa

nāma laite laite mora bhrānta haila mana

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ājñā*—order; *pāñā*—receiving; *nāma*—the holy name; *la-i*—chant; *anukṣaṇa*—always; *nāma*—the holy name; *laite*—accepting; *laite*—accepting; *mora*—My; *bhrānta*—bewilderment; *haila*—taking place; *mana*—in the mind.

TRANSLATION

“Since I received this order from My spiritual master, I always chant the holy name, but I thought that by chanting and chanting the holy name I had been bewildered.

TEXT 78

dhairya dharite nāri, hailāma unmatta

hāsi, kāndi, nāci, gāi, yaiche madamatta

SYNONYMS

dhairya—patience; *dharite*—capturing; *nāri*—unable to take; *hailāma*—I have become; *unmatta*—mad after it; *hāsi*—laugh; *kāndi*—cry; *nāci*—dance; *gāi*—sing; *yaiche*—as much as; *madamatta*—madman.

TRANSLATION

“While chanting the holy name of the Lord in pure ecstasy, I lose myself, and thus I laugh, cry, dance and sing just like a madman.

TEXT 79

tabe dhairya dhari’ mane kariluṅ vicāra

kṛṣṇa-nāme jñānācchanna ha-ila āmāra

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *dhairya*—patience; *dhari'*—accepting; *mane*—in the mind; *kariluṅ*—I did; *vicāra*—consideration; *kṛṣṇa-nāme*—in the holy name of Kṛṣṇa; *jñāna ācchanna*—covering of My knowledge; *ha-ila*—has become; *āmāra*—of Me.

TRANSLATION

“Collecting My patience, therefore, I began to consider that chanting the holy name of Kṛṣṇa had covered all My spiritual knowledge.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu hints in this verse that to chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa one does not need to speculate on the philosophical aspects of the science of God, for one automatically becomes ecstatic and without consideration immediately chants, dances, laughs, cries and sings just like a madman.

TEXT 80

pāgala ha-ilān āmi, dhairya nāhi mane

eta cinti' nivediluṅ gurura caraṇe

SYNONYMS

pāgala—madman; *ha-ilān*—I have become; *āmi*—I; *dhairya*—patience; *nāhi*—not; *mane*—in the mind; *eta*—thus; *cinti'*—considering; *nivediluṅ*—I submitted; *gurura*—of the spiritual master; *caraṇe*—at his lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

“I saw that I had become mad by chanting the holy name, and I immediately submitted this at the lotus feet of my spiritual master.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, as an ideal teacher, shows us how a disciple should deal with his spiritual master. Whenever there is doubt regarding any point, he should refer the matter to his spiritual master for clarification. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu said that while chanting and dancing He had developed the kind of mad ecstasy that is possible only for a liberated soul. Yet even in His liberated position, He referred everything to His spiritual master whenever there were doubts. Thus in any condition, even when liberated, we should never think ourselves independent of the spiritual master, but must refer to him as soon as there is some doubt regarding our progressive spiritual life.

TEXT 81

kibā mantra dilā, gosāñi, kibā tāra bala

japite japite mantra karila pāgala

SYNONYMS

kibā—what kind of; *mantra*—hymn; *dilā*—you have given; *gosāñi*—My lord; *kibā*—what is; *tāra*—its; *bala*—strength; *japite*—chanting; *japite*—chanting; *mantra*—the hymn; *karila*—has made Me; *pāgala*—madman.

TRANSLATION

“My dear lord, what kind of mantra have you given Me? I have become mad simply by chanting this mahā-mantra!

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu prays in His *Śikṣāṣṭaka*:

*yugāyitaṁ nimeṣeṇa cakṣuṣā prāvṛṣāyitaṁ
śūnyāyitaṁ jagat sarvaṁ govinda-virahena me*

“O Govinda! Feeling Your separation, I am considering a moment to be like twelve years or more. Tears are flowing from my eyes like torrents of rain, and I am feeling all vacant in the world in Your absence.” It is the aspiration of a devotee that while he chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* his eyes will fill with tears, his voice falter and his heart throb. These are good signs in chanting the holy name of the Lord. In ecstasy, one should feel the entire world to be vacant without the presence of Govinda. This is a sign of separation from Govinda. In material life we are all separated from Govinda and are absorbed in material sense gratification. Therefore, when one comes to his senses on the spiritual platform he becomes so eager to meet Govinda that without Govinda the entire world becomes a vacant place.

TEXT 82

hāsāya, nācāya, more karāya krandana

eta śuni’ guru hāsi balilā vacana

SYNONYMS

hāsāya—it causes Me to laugh; *nācāya*—it causes Me to dance; *more*—unto Me; *karāya*—it causes; *krandana*—crying; *eta*—thus; *śuni’*—hearing; *guru*—My spiritual master; *hāsi*—smiling; *balilā*—said; *vacana*—words.

TRANSLATION

“Chanting the holy name in ecstasy causes Me to dance, laugh and cry.’
When My spiritual master heard all this, he smiled and then began to speak.

PURPORT

When a disciple very perfectly makes progress in spiritual life, this gladdens the spiritual master, who then also smiles in ecstasy, thinking, “How successful my disciple has become!” He feels so glad that he smiles as he enjoys the progress of the disciple, just as a smiling parent enjoys the activities of a child who is trying to stand up or crawl perfectly.

TEXT 83

kṛṣṇa-nāma-mahā-mantrera ei ta’ svabhāva

yei jape, tāra kṛṣṇe upajaye bhāva

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-nāma—the holy name of Kṛṣṇa; *mahā-mantrera*—of the supreme hymn; *ei ta’*—this is its; *svabhāva*—nature; *yei*—anyone; *jape*—chants; *tāra*—his; *kṛṣṇe*—unto Kṛṣṇa; *upajaye*—develops; *bhāva*—ecstasy.

TRANSLATION

“It is the nature of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra that anyone who chants it immediately develops his loving ecstasy for Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

In this verse it is explained that one who chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* develops *bhāva*, ecstasy, which is the point at which revelation begins. It is the preliminary stage in developing one’s original love for God. Lord Kṛṣṇa mentions this *bhāva* stage in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.8):

*aham sarvasya prabhavo mattaḥ sarvaṁ pravartate
iti matvā bhajante mām budhā bhāva-samanvitāḥ*

“I am the source of all spiritual and material worlds. Everything emanates from Me. The wise who know this perfectly engage in My devotional service and worship Me with all their hearts.” A neophyte disciple begins by hearing and chanting, associating with devotees and practicing the regulative principles, and thus he vanquishes all of his unwanted bad habits. In this way he develops attachment for Kṛṣṇa and cannot forget Kṛṣṇa even for a moment. *Bhāva* is the almost successful stage of spiritual life.

A sincere student aurally receives the holy name from the spiritual master, and after being initiated he follows the regulative principles given by the spiritual master. When the holy name is properly served in this way, automatically the spiritual nature of the holy name spreads; in other words, the devotee becomes qualified in offenselessly chanting the holy name. When one is completely fit to chant the holy name in this way, he is eligible to make disciples all over the world, and he actually becomes *jagad-guru*. Then the entire world, under his influence, begins to chant the holy names of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. Thus all the disciples of such a spiritual master increase in attachment for Kṛṣṇa, and therefore he sometimes cries, sometimes laughs, sometimes dances and sometimes chants. These symptoms are very prominently manifest in the body of a pure devotee. Sometimes when our students of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement chant and dance, even in India people are astonished to see how these foreigners have learned to chant and dance in this ecstatic fashion. As explained by Caitanya Mahāprabhu, however, actually this is not due to practice, for without extra endeavor these symptoms become manifest in anyone who sincerely chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

Many fools, not knowing the transcendental nature of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, sometimes impede our loudly chanting this *mantra*, yet one who is actually advanced in the fulfillment of chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* induces others to chant also. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī

explains, *kṛṣṇa-śakti vinā nahe tāra pravartana*: unless one receives special power of attorney from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, he cannot preach the glories of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. As devotees propagate the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, the general population of the entire world gets the opportunity to understand the glories of the holy name. While chanting and dancing or hearing the holy name of the Lord, one automatically remembers the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and because there is no difference between the holy name and Kṛṣṇa, the chanter is immediately linked with Kṛṣṇa. Thus connected, a devotee develops his original attitude of service to the Lord. In this attitude of constantly serving Kṛṣṇa, which is called *bhāva*, he always thinks of Kṛṣṇa in many different ways. One who has attained this *bhāva* stage is no longer under the clutches of the illusory energy. When other spiritual ingredients, such as trembling, perspiration and tears, are added to this *bhāva* stage, the devotee gradually attains love of Kṛṣṇa.

The holy name of Kṛṣṇa is called the *mahā-mantra*. Other *mantras* mentioned in the *Nārada-pañcarātra* are known simply as *mantras*, but the chanting of the holy name of the Lord is called the *mahā-mantra*.

TEXT 84

kṛṣṇa-viṣayaka premā—parama puruṣārtha

yāra āge tṛṇa-tulya cāri puruṣārtha

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-viṣayaka—in the subject of Kṛṣṇa; *premā*—love; *parama*—the highest; *puruṣa-artha*—achievement of the goal of life; *yāra*—whose; *āge*—before; *tṛṇa-tulya*—like the grass in the street; *cāri*—four; *puruṣa-artha*—achievements.

TRANSLATION

“Religiosity, economic development, sense gratification and liberation are known as the four goals of life, but before love of Godhead, the fifth and highest goal, these appear as insignificant as straw in the street.

PURPORT

While chanting the holy name of the Lord, one should not desire the material advancements represented by religiosity, economic development, sense gratification and ultimately liberation from the material world. As stated by Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the highest perfection in life is to develop one’s love for Kṛṣṇa (*premā pum-artho mahān śrī-caitanya-mahāprabhor matam idam*). When we compare love of Godhead with religiosity, economic development, sense gratification and liberation, we can understand that these achievements may be desirable objectives for *bubhukṣus*, or those who desire to enjoy this material world, and *mumukṣus*, or those who desire liberation from it, but they are very insignificant in the eyes of a pure devotee who has developed *bhāva*, the preliminary stage of love of Godhead.

Dharma (religiosity), *artha* (economic development), *kāma* (sense gratification) and *mokṣa* (liberation) are the four principles of religion that pertain to the material world. Therefore in the beginning of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* it is declared, *dharmāḥ projjhita-kaitavo ’tra*: [SB 1.1.2] cheating religious systems in terms of these four material principles are completely discarded from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, for *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* teaches only how to develop one’s dormant love of God. The *Bhagavad-gītā* is the preliminary study of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and therefore it ends with the words *sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇam vraja*: “Abandon all varieties of religion and just surrender unto Me.” (Bg. 18.66) To adopt this means, one should reject all ideas of religiosity, economic development, sense gratification and liberation and fully engage in the service of the Lord, which is transcendental to these four principles. Love of Godhead is the original function of the spirit soul, and it is as eternal as the soul and the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This eternity is called *sanātana*. When a devotee revives his loving service to

the Supreme Personality of Godhead, it should be understood that he has been successful in achieving the desired goal of his life. At that time everything is automatically done by the mercy of the holy name, and the devotee automatically advances in his spiritual progress.

TEXT 85

pañcama puruṣārtha—premānandāmṛta-sindhu

mokṣādi ānanda yāra nahe eka bindu

SYNONYMS

pañcama—fifth; *puruṣa-artha*—goal of life; *prema-ānanda*—the spiritual bliss of love of Godhead; *amṛta*—eternal; *sindhu*—ocean; *mokṣa-ādi*—liberation and other principles of religiosity; *ānanda*—pleasures derived from them; *yāra*—whose; *nahe*—never comparable; *eka*—one; *bindu*—drop.

TRANSLATION

“For a devotee who has actually developed bhāva, the pleasure derived from dharma, artha, kāma and mokṣa appears like a drop in the presence of the sea.

TEXT 86

kṛṣṇa-nāmera phala—‘premā’, sarva-śāstre kaya

bhāgye sei premā tomāya karila udaya

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-nāmera—of the holy name of the Lord; *phala*—result; *premā*—love of Godhead; *sarva*—in all; *śāstre*—revealed scriptures; *kaya*—

describe; *bhāgye*—fortunately; *sei*—that; *premā*—love of Godhead; *tomāya*—Your; *karila*—has done; *udaya*—arisen.

TRANSLATION

“The conclusion of all revealed scriptures is that one should awaken his dormant love of Godhead. You are greatly fortunate to have already done so.

TEXT 87

premāra svabhāve kare citta-tanu kṣobha

kṛṣṇera caraṇa-prāptye upajāya lobha

SYNONYMS

premāra—out of love of Godhead; *svabhāve*—by nature; *kare*—it induces; *citta*—the consciousness; *tanu*—the body; *kṣobha*—agitated; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *caraṇa*—lotus feet; *prāptye*—to obtain; *upajāya*—it so becomes; *lobha*—aspiration.

TRANSLATION

“It is a characteristic of love of Godhead that by nature it induces transcendental symptoms in one’s body and makes one more and more greedy to achieve the shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord.

TEXT 88

premāra svabhāve bhakta hāse, kānde, gāya

unmatta ha-iyā nāce, iti-uti dhāya

SYNONYMS

premāra—by such love of Godhead; *svabhāve*—by nature; *bhakta*—the devotee; *hāse*—laughs; *kānde*—cries; *gāya*—chants; *unmatta*—mad; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *nāce*—dances; *iti*—here; *uti*—there; *dhāya*—moves.

TRANSLATION

“When one actually develops love of Godhead, he naturally sometimes cries, sometimes laughs, sometimes chants and sometimes runs here and there just like a madman.

PURPORT

In this connection Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī says that sometimes persons who have no love of Godhead at all display ecstatic bodily symptoms. Artificially they sometimes laugh, cry and dance just like madmen, but this cannot help one progress in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Rather, such artificial agitation of the body is to be given up when one naturally develops the necessary bodily symptoms. Actual blissful life, manifested in genuine spiritual laughing, crying and dancing, is the symptom of real advancement in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, which can be achieved by a person who always voluntarily engages in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. If one who is not yet developed imitates such symptoms artificially, he creates chaos in the spiritual life of human society.

TEXTS 89–90

sveda, kampa, romāñcāśru, gadgada, vaivarṇya

unmāda, viṣāda, dhairya, garva, harṣa, dainya

eta bhāve premā bhaktagaṇere nācāya

kṛṣṇera ānandāmṛta-sāgare bhāsāya

SYNONYMS

sveda—perspiration; *kampa*—trembling; *romāñca*—standing of the hairs on the body; *āśru*—tears; *gadgada*—faltering; *vaivarṇya*—changing of bodily color; *unmāda*—madness; *viśāda*—melancholy; *dhairya*—patience; *garva*—pride; *harṣa*—joyfulness; *dainya*—humbleness; *eta*—in many ways; *bhāve*—in ecstasy; *premā*—love of Godhead; *bhakta-gaṇere*—unto the devotees; *nācāya*—causes to dance; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ānanda*—transcendental bliss; *amṛta*—nectar; *sāgare*—in the ocean; *bhāsāya*—floats.

TRANSLATION

“Perspiration, trembling, standing on end of one’s bodily hairs, tears, faltering voice, fading complexion, madness, melancholy, patience, pride, joy and humility—these are various natural symptoms of ecstatic love of Godhead, which causes a devotee to dance and float in an ocean of transcendental bliss while chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra.

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, in his *Prīti-sandarbhā* (66), explains this stage of love of Godhead: *bhagavat-prīti-rūpā vṛttir māyādi-mayī na bhavati. kim tarhi, svarūpa-śakty-ānanda-rūpā, yad-ānanda-parādhīnaḥ śrī-bhagavān apīti*. Similarly, in the 69th text he offers further explanation: *tad evaṁ prīter lakṣaṇaṁ citta-dravas tasya ca roma-harṣādikam. kathañcij jāte ’pi citta-drave roma-harṣādi ke vā na ced āśaya-śuddhis tadāpi na bhakteḥ samyag-āvirbhāva iti jñāpitam. āśaya-śuddhir nāma cānya-tātparya-parityāgaḥ prīti-tātparyaṁ ca. ata evānimittā svābhāvikī ceti tad viśeṣaṇam*.

Transcendental love of Godhead is not under the jurisdiction of the material energy, for it is the transcendental bliss and pleasure potency of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Since the Supreme Lord is also under the influence of transcendental bliss, when one comes in touch with such bliss in love of Godhead, one’s heart melts, and the symptoms of this are standing of the hairs on end, etc. Sometimes a person thus

melts and manifests these transcendental symptoms yet at the same time is not well behaved in his personal transactions. This indicates that he has not yet reached complete perfection in devotional life. In other words, a devotee who dances in ecstasy but after dancing and crying appears to be attracted to material affairs has not yet reached the perfection of devotional service, which is called *āśaya-śuddhi*, or the perfection of existence. One who attains the perfection of existence is completely averse to material enjoyment and engrossed in transcendental love of Godhead. It is therefore to be concluded that the ecstatic symptoms of *āśaya-śuddhi* are visible when a devotee's service has no material cause and is purely spiritual in nature. These are characteristics of transcendental love of Godhead, as stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.2.6):

*sa vai puṁsām paro dharmo yato bhaktir adhokṣaje
ahaituky apratihātā yayātmā suprasīdati*

“That religion is best which causes its followers to become ecstatic in love of God that is unmotivated and free from material impediments, for this alone can completely satisfy the self.”

TEXT 91

*bhāla haila, pāile tumi parama-puruṣārtha
tomāra premete āmi hailān kṛtārtha*

SYNONYMS

bhāla haila—let it be good; *pāile*—You have gotten; *tumi*—You; *parama-puruṣārtha*—superexcellent goal of life; *tomāra*—Your; *premete*—by development in love of Godhead; *āmi*—I; *hailān*—become; *kṛta-artha*—very much obliged.

TRANSLATION

“It is very good, my dear child, that You have attained the supreme goal of life by developing love of Godhead. Thus You have pleased me very much, and I am very much obliged to You.

PURPORT

According to the revealed scriptures, if a spiritual master can convert even one soul into a perfectly pure devotee, his mission in life is fulfilled. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura always used to say, “Even at the expense of all the properties, temples and *mathas* that I have, if I could convert even one person into a pure devotee, my mission would be fulfilled.” It is very difficult, however, to understand the science of Kṛṣṇa, what to speak of developing love of Godhead. Therefore if by the grace of Lord Caitanya and the spiritual master a disciple attains the standard of pure devotional service, the spiritual master is very happy. The spiritual master is not actually happy if the disciple brings him money, but when he sees that a disciple is following the regulative principles and advancing in spiritual life, he is very glad and feels obliged to such an advanced disciple.

TEXT 92

nāca, gāo, bhakta-saṅge kara saṅkīrtana

kṛṣṇa-nāma upadeśī' tāra' sarva-jana

SYNONYMS

nāca—go on dancing; *gāo*—chant; *bhakta-saṅge*—in the society of devotees; *kara*—continue; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the holy name in assembly; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Kṛṣṇa; *upadeśī'*—by instructing; *tāra'*—deliver; *sarva-jana*—all fallen souls.

TRANSLATION

“My dear child, continue dancing, chanting and performing saṅkīrtana in association with devotees. Furthermore, go out and preach the value of chanting kṛṣṇa-nāma, for by this process You will be able to deliver all fallen souls.’

PURPORT

It is another ambition of the spiritual master to see his disciples not only chant, dance and follow the regulative principles but also preach the *saṅkīrtana* movement to others in order to deliver them, for the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is based on the principle that one should become as perfect as possible in devotional service oneself and also preach the cult for others’ benefit. There are two classes of unalloyed devotees—namely, *goṣṭhy-ānandīs* and *bhajanānandīs*. *Bhajanānandī* refers to one who is satisfied to cultivate devotional service for himself, and *goṣṭhy-ānandī* is one who is not satisfied simply to become perfect himself but wants to see others also take advantage of the holy name of the Lord and advance in spiritual life. The outstanding example is Prahlāda Mahārāja. When he was offered a benediction by Lord Nṛsiṃhadeva, Prahlāda Mahārāja said:

*naivodviḥ para duratyaya-vaitaraṇyās
tvad-vīrya-gāyana-mahāmṛta-magna-cittaḥ
śoce tato vimukha-cetasa indriyārtha-
māyā-sukhāya bharam udvahato vimūḍhān*

“My dear Lord, I have no problems and want no benediction from You because I am quite satisfied to chant Your holy name. This is sufficient for me because whenever I chant I immediately merge in an ocean of transcendental bliss. I only lament to see others bereft of Your love. They are rotting in material activities for transient material pleasure and spoiling their lives toiling all day and night simply for sense gratification, with no attachment for love of Godhead. I am simply lamenting for them and devising various plans to deliver them from the clutches of *māyā*.”
(*Bhāg.* 7.9.43)

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura explains in his *Anubhāṣya*, “A person who has attracted the attention of the spiritual master by his sincere service likes to dance and chant with similarly developed Kṛṣṇa conscious devotees. The spiritual master authorizes such a devotee to deliver fallen souls in all parts of the world. Those who are not advanced prefer to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* in a solitary place.” Such activities constitute, in the language of Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, a type of cheating process in the sense that they imitate the activities of exalted personalities like Haridāsa Ṭhākura. One should not attempt to imitate such exalted devotees. Rather, everyone should endeavor to preach the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu in all parts of the world and thus become successful in spiritual life. One who is not very expert in preaching may chant in a secluded place, avoiding bad association, but for one who is actually advanced, preaching and meeting people who are not engaged in devotional service are not disadvantages. A devotee gives the nondevotees his association but is not affected by their misbehavior. Thus by the activities of a pure devotee even those who are bereft of love of Godhead get a chance to become devotees of the Lord one day. In this connection Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura advises that one discuss the verse in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* beginning *naitat samācarej jātu manasāpi hy anīśvaraḥ* (10.33.30), and the following verse in *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (1.2.255):

*anāsaktasya viṣayān yathārham upayuñjataḥ
nirbandhaḥ kṛṣṇa-sambandhe yuktaṁ vairāgyam ucyate*

One should not imitate the activities of great personalities. One should be detached from material enjoyment and should accept everything in connection with Kṛṣṇa’s service.

TEXT 93

eta bali’ eka śloka śikhāila more

bhāgavatera sāra ei—bale vāre vāre

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *eka*—one; *śloka*—verse; *śikhāila*—has taught; *more*—unto Me; *bhāgavatera*—of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *sāra*—essence; *ei*—this is; *bale*—he said; *vāre vāre*—again and again.

TRANSLATION

“Saying this, My spiritual master taught Me a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. It is the essence of all the *Bhāgavatam*’s instructions; therefore he recited this verse again and again.

PURPORT

This verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.2.40) was spoken by Śrī Nārada Muni to Vasudeva to teach him about *bhāgavata-dharma*. Vasudeva had already achieved the result of *bhāgavata-dharma* because Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared in his house as his son, yet in order to teach others, he desired to hear from Śrī Nārada Muni to be enlightened in the process of *bhāgavata-dharma*. This is the humbleness of a great devotee.

TEXT 94

evam-vrataḥ sva-priya-nāma-kīrtiyā

jātānurāgo druta-citta ucchaiḥ

hasaty atho roditi rauti gāyaty

unmāda-van nṛtyati loka-bāhyaḥ

SYNONYMS

evam-vrataḥ—when one thus engages in the vow to chant and dance; *sva*—own; *priya*—very dear; *nāma*—holy name; *kīrtiyā*—by chanting;

jāta—in this way develops; *anurāgaḥ*—attachment; *druta-cittaḥ*—very eagerly; *uccaiḥ*—loudly; *hasati*—laughs; *atho*—also; *roditi*—cries; *rauti*—becomes agitated; *gāyati*—chants; *unmāda-vat*—like a madman; *nṛtyati*—dancing; *loka-bāhyaḥ*—without caring for outsiders.

TRANSLATION

“When a person is actually advanced and takes pleasure in chanting the holy name of the Lord, who is very dear to him, he is agitated and loudly chants the holy name. He also laughs, cries, becomes agitated and chants just like a madman, not caring for outsiders.’

TEXTS 95–96

ei tāñra vākye āmi dṛḍha viśvāsa dhari’

nirantara kṛṣṇa-nāma saṅkīrtana kari

sei kṛṣṇa-nāma kabhu gāoyāya, nācāya

gāhi, nāci nāhi āmi āpana-icchāya

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *tāñra*—his (My spiritual master’s); *vākye*—in the words of; *āmi*—I; *dṛḍha*—firm; *viśvāsa*—faith; *dhari’*—depend; *nirantara*—always; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting; *kari*—continue; *sei*—that; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kabhu*—sometimes; *gāoyāya*—causes Me to chant; *nācāya*—causes Me to dance; *gāhi*—by chanting; *nāci*—dancing; *nāhi*—not; *āmi*—Myself; *āpana*—own; *icchāya*—will.

TRANSLATION

“I firmly believe in these words of My spiritual master, and therefore I

always chant the holy name of the Lord, alone and in the association of devotees. That holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa sometimes causes Me to chant and dance, and therefore I chant and dance. Please do not think that I intentionally do it. I do it automatically.

PURPORT

A person who cannot keep his faith in the words of his spiritual master but acts independently never receives the authority to chant the holy name of the Lord. It is said in the *Vedas* (*Śvetāśvatara Up.* 6.23):

*yasya deve parā bhaktir yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāḥ prakāśante mahātmanaḥ*
[ŚU ⁱⁱⁱ6.23]

“Only unto those great souls who have implicit faith in both the Lord and the spiritual master are all the imports of Vedic knowledge automatically revealed.” This Vedic injunction is very important, and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu supported it by His personal behavior. Believing in the words of His spiritual master, He introduced the *saṅkīrtana* movement, just as the present Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement was started with belief in the words of our spiritual master. He wanted to preach, we believed in his words and tried somehow or other to fulfill them, and now this movement has become successful all over the world. Therefore faith in the words of the spiritual master and in the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the secret of success. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu never disobeyed the orders of His spiritual master and stopped propagating the *saṅkīrtana* movement. Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī, at the time of his passing away, ordered all his disciples to work conjointly to preach the mission of Caitanya Mahāprabhu all over the world. Later, however, some self-interested, foolish disciples disobeyed his orders. Each one of them wanted to become head of the mission, and they fought in the courts, neglecting the order of the spiritual master, and the entire mission was defeated. We are not proud of this; however, the truth must be explained. We believed in the words of our spiritual master and started in

a humble way—in a helpless way—but due to the spiritual force of the order of the supreme authority, this movement has become successful.

It is to be understood that when Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu chanted and danced, He did so by the influence of the pleasure potency of the spiritual world. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu never considered the holy name of the Lord to be a material vibration, nor does any pure devotee mistake the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* to be a material musical manifestation. Lord Caitanya never tried to be the master of the holy name; rather He taught us how to be servants of the holy name. If one chants the holy name of the Lord just to make a show, not knowing the secret of success, he may increase his bile secretion, but he will never attain perfection in chanting the holy name. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu presented himself in this way: “I am a great fool and do not have knowledge of right and wrong. In order to understand the real meaning of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, I never followed the explanation of the Śāṅkara-sampradāya or Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*. I’m very much afraid of the illogical arguments of the Māyāvādī philosophers. Therefore I think I have no authority regarding their explanations of the *Vedānta-sūtra*. I firmly believe that simply chanting the holy name of the Lord can remove all misconceptions of the material world. I believe that simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord one can attain the shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord. In this age of quarrel and disagreement, the chanting of the holy names is the only way to liberation from the material clutches.

“By chanting the holy name,” Lord Caitanya continued, “I became almost mad. However, after inquiring from My spiritual master I have come to the conclusion that instead of striving for achievement in the four principles of religiosity [*dharma*], economic development [*artha*], sense gratification [*kāma*] and liberation [*mokṣa*], it is better if somehow or other one develops transcendental love of Godhead. That is the greatest success in life. One who has attained love of Godhead chants and dances by his nature, not caring for the public.” This stage of life is known as *bhāgavata-jīvana*, or the life of a devotee.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu continued, “I never chanted and danced to make an artificial show. I dance and chant because I firmly believe in the words of My spiritual master. Although the Māyāvādī philosophers do not like this chanting and dancing, I nevertheless perform it on the strength of his words. Therefore it is to be concluded that I deserve very little credit for these activities of chanting and dancing, for they are being done automatically by the grace of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.”

TEXT 97

kṛṣṇa-nāme ye ānanda-sindhu-āsvādana

brahmānanda tāra āge khātodaka-sama

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-nāme—in the holy name of the Lord; *ye*—which; *ānanda*—transcendental bliss; *sindhu*—ocean; *āsvādana*—tasting; *brahma-ānanda*—the transcendental bliss of impersonal understanding; *tāra*—its; *āge*—in front; *khāta-udaka*—shallow water in the canals; *sama*—like.

TRANSLATION

“Compared to the ocean of transcendental bliss that one tastes by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra, the pleasure derived from impersonal Brahman realization [brahmānanda] is like the shallow water in a canal.

PURPORT

In the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (1.1.38) it is stated:

*brahmānando bhaved eṣa cet parārdha-guṇī-kṛtaḥ
naiti bhakti-sukhāmbhodheḥ paramāṇu-tulām api*

“If *brahmānanda*, the transcendental bliss derived from understanding

impersonal Brahman, were multiplied a million times, such a quantity of *brahmānanda* could not compare with even an atomic portion of the pleasure relished in pure devotional service.”

TEXT 98

tvat-sākṣāt-karaṇāhlāda-

viśuddhābdhi-sthitasya me

sukhāni goṣpadāyante

brāhmaṇy api jagad-guro

SYNONYMS

tvat—Your; *sākṣāt*—meeting; *karaṇa*—such action; *āhlāda*—pleasure; *viśuddha*—spiritually purified; *abdhi*—ocean; *sthitasya*—being situated; *me*—by me; *sukhāni*—happiness; *goṣpadāyante*—a small hole created by the hoof of a calf; *brāhmaṇi*—the pleasure derived from impersonal Brahman understanding; *api*—also; *jagad-guro*—O master of the universe.

TRANSLATION

“My dear Lord, O master of the universe, since I have directly seen You, my transcendental bliss has taken the shape of a great ocean. Being situated in that ocean, I now realize all other so-called happiness to be like the water contained in the hoofprint of a calf.”

PURPORT

The transcendental bliss enjoyed in pure devotional service is like an ocean, whereas material happiness and even the happiness to be derived from the realization of impersonal Brahman are just like the water in the

hoofprint of a calf. This is a verse from the *Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya* (14.36).

TEXT 99

prabhura miṣṭa-vākya śuni' sannyāsira gaṇa

citta phiri' gela, kahe madhura vacana

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *miṣṭa-vākya*—sweet words; *śuni'*—after hearing; *sannyāsira gaṇa*—all the groups of *sannyāsīs*; *citta*—consciousness; *phiri'*—moved; *gela*—went; *kahe*—said; *madhura*—pleasing; *vacana*—words.

TRANSLATION

After hearing Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, all the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs were moved. Their minds changed, and thus they spoke with pleasing words.

PURPORT

The Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* met Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Vārāṇasī to criticize the Lord regarding His participation in the *saṅkīrtana* movement, which they did not like. This demonic nature of opposition to the *saṅkīrtana* movement perpetually exists. As it existed in the time of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, similarly it existed long before that, even in the time of Prahlāda Mahārāja. He used to chant in *saṅkīrtana* although his father did not like it, and that was the reason for the misunderstanding between the father and son. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.15) the Lord says:

na mām duṣkṛtino mūḍhāḥ prapadyante narādhamāḥ

māyayāpahṛta-jñānā āsuram bhāvam āśritāḥ

“Those miscreants who are grossly foolish, who are lowest among mankind, whose knowledge is stolen by illusion, and who partake of the atheistic nature of demons do not surrender unto Me.” The Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* are *āsuram bhāvam āśritāḥ*, which means that they have taken the path of the *asuras* (demons), who do not believe in the existence of the form of the Lord. The Māyāvādīs say that the ultimate source of everything is impersonal, and in this way they deny the existence of God. Saying that there is no God is direct denial of God, and saying that God exists but has no head, legs or hands and cannot speak, hear or eat is a negative way of denying His existence. A person who cannot see is called blind, one who cannot walk is called lame, one who has no hands is called helpless, one who cannot speak is called dumb, and one who cannot hear is called deaf. The Māyāvādīs’ proposition that God has no legs, no eyes, no ears and no hands is an indirect way of insulting Him by defining Him as blind, deaf, dumb, lame, helpless, etc. Therefore although they present themselves as great Vedāntists, they are factually *māyayāpahṛta-jñāna*; in other words, they seem to be very learned scholars, but the essence of their knowledge has been taken away.

Impersonalist Māyāvādīs always try to defy Vaiṣṇavas because Vaiṣṇavas accept the Supreme Personality as the supreme cause and want to serve Him, talk with Him and see Him, just as the Lord is also eager to see His devotees and talk, eat and dance with them. These personal exchanges of love do not appeal to the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*. Therefore the original purpose of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* of Benares in meeting Caitanya Mahāprabhu was to defeat His personal conception of God. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, however, as a preacher, turned the minds of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*. They were melted by the sweet words of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and thus became friendly and spoke to Him also in sweet words. Similarly, all preachers will have to meet opponents, but they should not make them more inimical. They are already enemies, and if we talk with them harshly or impolitely their enmity will merely increase. We should therefore follow in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya

Mahāprabhu as far as possible and try to convince the opposition by quoting from the *śāstras* and presenting the conclusion of the *ācāryas*. It is in this way that we should try to defeat all the enemies of the Lord.

TEXT 100

ye kichu kahile tumi, saba satya haya

kṛṣṇa-premā sei pāya, yāra bhāgyodaya

SYNONYMS

ye—all; *kichu*—that; *kahile*—You spoke; *tumi*—You; *saba*—everything; *satya*—truth; *haya*—becomes; *kṛṣṇa-premā*—love of Godhead; *sei*—anyone; *pāya*—achieves; *yāra*—whose; *bhāgya-udaya*—fortune is now awakened.

TRANSLATION

“Dear Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, what You have said is all true. Only one who is favored by fortune attains love of Godhead.

PURPORT

One who is actually very fortunate can begin Kṛṣṇa consciousness, as stated by Caitanya Mahāprabhu to Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī:

*brahmāṇḍa bhramite kona bhāgyavān jīva
guru-kṛṣṇa-prasāde pāya bhakti-latā-bīja*

(Cc. Madhya 19.151)

There are millions of living entities who have become conditioned by the laws of material nature, and they are wandering throughout the planetary systems of this universe in different bodily forms. Among them, one who

is fortunate meets a bona fide spiritual master by the grace of Kṛṣṇa and comes to understand the meaning of devotional service. By discharging devotional service under the direction of the bona fide spiritual master, or *ācārya*, he develops love of Godhead. One whose love of Godhead (*kṛṣṇa-prema*) is awakened and who thus becomes a devotee of the inconceivable Supreme Personality of Godhead is to be considered extremely fortunate. The Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* admitted this fact to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. It is not easy for one to become a Kṛṣṇa conscious person, but by the mercy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu it can be possible, as will be proven in the course of this narration.

TEXT 101

kṛṣṇe bhakti kara—ihāya sabāra santoṣa

vedānta nā śuna kene, tāra kibā doṣa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇe—unto Kṛṣṇa; *bhakti*—devotional service; *kara*—do; *ihāya*—in this matter; *sabāra*—of everyone; *santoṣa*—there is satisfaction; *vedānta*—the philosophy of the *Vedānta-sūtra*; *nā*—do not; *śuna*—hear; *kene*—why; *tāra*—of the philosophy; *kibā*—what is; *doṣa*—fault.

TRANSLATION

“Dear Sir, there is no objection to Your being a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Everyone is satisfied with this. But why do You avoid discussion on the Vedānta-sūtra? What is the fault in it?”

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura comments in this connection, “Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* accept that the commentary by Śrī Śaṅkarācārya known as *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* gives the real meaning of the *Vedānta-sūtra*. In

other words, Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* accept the meanings expressed in the explanations of the *Vedānta-sūtra* by Śaṅkarācārya, which are based on monism. Thus they explain the *Vedānta-sūtra*, the *Upaniṣads* and all such Vedic literatures in their own impersonal way.” The great Māyāvādī *sannyāsī* Sadānanda Yogīndra has written a book known as *Vedānta-sāra*, in which he writes, *vedānto nāma upaniṣat-pramāṇam. tad-upakāriṇi śārīraka-sūtrādīni ca*. According to Sadānanda Yogīndra, the *Vedānta-sūtra* and *Upaniṣads*, as presented by Śrī Śaṅkarācārya in his *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* commentary, are the only sources of Vedic evidence. Actually, however, *Vedānta* refers to the essence of Vedic knowledge, and it is not a fact that there is nothing more than Śaṅkarācārya’s *Śārīraka-bhāṣya*. There are other *Vedānta* commentaries, written by Vaiṣṇava *ācāryas*, none of whom follow Śrī Śaṅkarācārya or accept the imaginative commentary of his school. Their commentaries are based on the philosophy of duality. Monist philosophers like Śaṅkarācārya and his followers want to establish that God and the living entity are one, and instead of worshiping the Supreme Personality of Godhead they present themselves as God. They want to be worshiped as God by others. Such persons do not accept the philosophies of the Vaiṣṇava *ācāryas*, which are known as *śuddhādvaita* (purified monism), *śuddha-dvaita* (purified dualism), *viśiṣṭādvaita* (specific monism), *dvaitādvaita* (monism and dualism) and *acintya-bhedābheda* (inconceivable oneness and difference). Māyāvādīs do not discuss these philosophies, for they are firmly convinced of their own philosophy of *kevalādvaita*, exclusive monism. Accepting this system of philosophy as the pure understanding of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, they believe that Kṛṣṇa has a body made of material elements and that the activities of loving service to Kṛṣṇa are sentimentality. They are known as Māyāvādīs because according to their opinion Kṛṣṇa has a body made of *māyā* and the loving service of the Lord executed by devotees is also *māyā*. They consider such devotional service to be an aspect of fruitive activities (*karma-kāṇḍa*). According to their view, *bhakti* consists of mental speculation or sometimes meditation. This is the difference between the Māyāvādī and Vaiṣṇava philosophies.

TEXT 102

eta śuni' hāsi' prabhu balilā vacana

duḥkha nā mānaha yadi, kari nivedana

SYNONYMS

eta—thus; *śuni'*—hearing; *hāsi'*—smiling; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *balilā*—said; *vacana*—His words; *duḥkha*—unhappy; *nā*—do not; *mānaha*—take it; *yadi*—if; *kari*—I say; *nivedana*—something unto you.

TRANSLATION

After hearing the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* speak in that way, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu smiled slightly and said, “My dear sirs, if you don’t mind I can say something to you regarding Vedānta philosophy.”

PURPORT

The Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, appreciating Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, inquired from Him why He did not discuss Vedānta philosophy. Actually, however, the entire system of Vaiṣṇava activities is based on Vedānta philosophy. Vaiṣṇavas do not neglect Vedānta, but they do not care to understand Vedānta on the basis of the *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* commentary. Therefore, to clarify the situation, Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, with the permission of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, wanted to speak regarding Vedānta philosophy.

The Vaiṣṇavas are by far the greatest philosophers in the world, and the greatest among them was Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu, whose philosophy was again presented less than four hundred years later by Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura Mahārāja. Therefore one must know very well that Vaiṣṇava philosophers are not sentimentalists or cheap devotees like the *sahajiyās*. All the Vaiṣṇava *ācāryas* were vastly learned scholars who understood Vedānta philosophy fully, for unless one knows

Vedānta philosophy he cannot be an *ācārya*. To be accepted as an *ācārya* among Indian transcendentalists who follow the Vedic principles, one must become a vastly learned scholar in Vedānta philosophy, either by studying it or hearing it.

Bhakti develops in pursuance of Vedānta philosophy. This is stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.2.12):

*tac chraddadhānā munayo jñāna-vairāgya-yuktayā
paśyanty ātmani cātmānaṁ bhaktyā śruta-grhītayā*

The words *bhaktyā śruta-grhītayā* in this verse are very important, for they indicate that *bhakti* must be based upon the philosophy of the *Upaniṣads* and *Vedānta-sūtra*. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī said:

*śruti-smṛti-purāṇādi-pañcarātra-vidhiṁ vinā
aikāntikī harer bhaktir utpātāyaiva kalpate*

[BRS ^{iv}1.2.101]

“Devotional service performed without reference to the *Vedas*, *Purāṇas*, *Pañcarātras*, etc., must be considered sentimentalism, and it causes nothing but disturbance to society.” There are different grades of Vaiṣṇavas (*kaniṣṭha-adhikārī*, *madhyama-adhikārī* and *uttama-adhikārī*), but to be a *madhyama-adhikārī* preacher one must be a learned scholar in the *Vedānta-sūtra* and other Vedic literatures because when *bhakti-yoga* develops on the basis of Vedānta philosophy it is factual and steady. In this connection we may quote the translation and purport of the verse mentioned above (*Bhāg.* 1.2.12):

TRANSLATION

The seriously inquisitive student or sage, well equipped with knowledge and detachment, realizes that Absolute Truth by rendering devotional service in terms of what he has heard from the *Vedānta-śruti*.

PURPORT

The Absolute Truth is realized in full by the process of devotional service to the Lord, Vāsudeva, or the Personality of Godhead, who is the full-fledged Absolute Truth. Brahman is His transcendental bodily effulgence, and Paramātmā is His partial representation. As such, Brahman or Paramātmā realization of the Absolute Truth is but a partial realization. There are four different types of human beings—the *karmīs*, the *jñānīs*, the *yogīs* and the devotees. The *karmīs* are materialistic, whereas the other three are transcendental. The first-class transcendentalists are the devotees who have realized the Supreme Person. The second-class transcendentalists are those who have partially realized the plenary portion of the absolute person. And the third-class transcendentalists are those who have barely realized the spiritual focus of the absolute person. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* and other Vedic literatures, the Supreme Person is realized by devotional service which is backed by full knowledge and detachment from material association. We have already discussed the point that devotional service is followed by knowledge and detachment from material association. As Brahman and Paramātmā realization are imperfect realizations of the Absolute Truth, so the means of realizing Brahman and Paramātmā, i.e., the paths of *jñāna* and *yoga*, are also imperfect means of realizing the Absolute Truth. Devotional service which is based on the foreground of full knowledge combined with detachment from material association, and which is fixed by dint of the aural reception of the *Vedānta-śruti*, is the only perfect method by which the seriously inquisitive student can realize the Absolute Truth. Devotional service is not, therefore, meant for the less intelligent class of transcendentalists.

There are three classes of devotees, namely, first, second and third class. The third-class devotees, or the neophytes, who have no knowledge and are not detached from material association, but who are simply attracted by the preliminary process of worshiping the Deity in the temple, are called material devotees. Material devotees are more attached to material benefit than transcendental profit. Therefore, one has to make definite

progress from the position of material devotional service to the second-class devotional position. In the second-class position, the devotee can see four principles in the devotional line, namely, the Personality of Godhead, His devotees, the ignorant and the envious. One has to raise himself at least to the stage of a second-class devotee and thus become eligible to know the Absolute Truth.

A third-class devotee, therefore, has to receive the instructions of devotional service from the authoritative sources of *Bhāgavata*. The number one *Bhāgavata* is the established personality of devotee, and the other *Bhāgavata* is the message of Godhead. The third-class devotee therefore has to go to the personality of devotee in order to learn the instructions of devotional service. Such a personality of devotee is not a professional man who earns his livelihood by the business of the *Bhāgavatam*. Such a devotee must be a representative of Śukadeva Gosvāmī, like Sūta Gosvāmī, and must preach the cult of devotional service for the all-around benefit of all people. A neophyte devotee has very little taste for hearing from the authorities. Such a neophyte devotee makes a show of hearing from the professional man to satisfy his senses. This sort of hearing and chanting has spoiled the whole thing, so one should be very careful about the faulty process. The holy messages of Godhead, as inculcated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* or in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, are undoubtedly transcendental subjects, but even though they are so, such transcendental matters are not to be received from the professional man, who spoils them as the serpent spoils milk simply by the touch of his tongue.

A sincere devotee must, therefore, be prepared to hear the Vedic literature like the *Upaniṣads*, *Vedānta-sūtra* and other literatures left by the previous authorities, or Gosvāmīs, for the benefit of his progress. Without hearing such literatures, one cannot make actual progress. And without hearing and following the instructions, the show of devotional service becomes worthless and therefore a sort of disturbance in the path of devotional service. Unless, therefore, devotional service is established on the principles of *śruti*, *smṛti*, *Purāṇa* and *Pañcarātra* authorities, the

make-show of devotional service should at once be rejected. An unauthorized devotee should never be recognized as a pure devotee. By assimilation of such messages from the Vedic literatures, one can see the all-pervading localized aspect of the Personality of Godhead within his own self constantly. This is called *samādhi*.

TEXT 103

ihā śuni' bale sarva sannyāsīra gaṇa

tomāke dekhiye yaiche sākṣāt nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

ihā—this; *śuni'*—hearing; *bale*—spoke; *sarva*—all; *sannyāsīra*—of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *gaṇa*—group; *tomāke*—unto You; *dekhiye*—we see; *yaiche*—exactly like; *sākṣāt*—directly; *nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Hearing this, the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* became somewhat humble and addressed Caitanya Mahāprabhu as Nārāyaṇa Himself, who they all agreed He was.

PURPORT

Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* address each other as Nārāyaṇa. Whenever they see another *sannyāsī*, they offer him respect by calling *om namo nārāyaṇāya* (“I offer my respect unto you, Nārāyaṇa”), although they know perfectly well what kind of Nārāyaṇa he is. Nārāyaṇa has four hands, but although they are puffed up with the idea of being Nārāyaṇa, they cannot exhibit more than two. Since their philosophy declares that Nārāyaṇa and an ordinary human being are on the same level, they sometimes use the term *daridra-nārāyaṇa* (“poor Nārāyaṇa”), which was invented by a so-called

svāmī who did not know anything about Vedānta philosophy. Therefore although all these Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* who called themselves Nārāyaṇa were actually unaware of the position of Nārāyaṇa, due to their austerities Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu enabled them to understand Him to be Nārāyaṇa Himself. Lord Caitanya is certainly the Supreme Personality of Godhead Nārāyaṇa appearing as a devotee of Nārāyaṇa, and thus the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, understanding that He was directly Nārāyaṇa Himself whereas they were false, puffed-up Nārāyaṇas, spoke to Him as follows.

TEXT 104

tomāra vacana śuni’ juḍāya śravaṇa

tomāra mādhuri dekhi’ juḍāya nayana

SYNONYMS

tomāra—Your; *vacana*—speeches; *śuni’*—hearing; *juḍāya*—very much satisfied; *śravaṇa*—aural reception; *tomāra*—Your; *mādhuri*—nectar; *dekhi’*—seeing; *juḍāya*—satisfies; *nayana*—our eyes.

TRANSLATION

“Dear Caitanya Mahāprabhu,” they said, “to tell You the truth, we are greatly pleased to hear Your words, and furthermore Your bodily features are so pleasing that we feel extraordinary satisfaction in seeing You.

PURPORT

In the *sāstras* it is said:

*ataḥ śrī-kṛṣṇa-nāmādi na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiḥ
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ*
[BRS. '1.2.234]

“With one’s materially contaminated senses one cannot understand the Supreme Personality of Godhead or His name, form, qualities or paraphernalia, but if one renders service unto Him, the Lord reveals Himself.” (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.234) Here one can see the effect of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*’ service toward Nārāyaṇa. Because the Māyāvādīs offered a little respect to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and because they were pious and actually followed the austere rules and regulations of *sannyāsa*, they had some understanding of Vedānta philosophy, and by the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu they could appreciate that He was none other than the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is endowed with all six opulences. One of these opulences is His beauty. By His extraordinarily beautiful bodily features, the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* recognized Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as Nārāyaṇa Himself. He was not a farcical Nārāyaṇa like the *daridra-nārāyaṇas* invented by so-called *sannyāsīs*.

TEXT 105

tomāra prabhāve sabāra ānandita mana

kabhu asaṅgata nahe tomāra vacana

SYNONYMS

tomāra—Your; *prabhāve*—by influence; *sabāra*—of everyone; *ānandita*—joyful; *mana*—mind; *kabhu*—at anytime; *asaṅgata*—unreasonable; *nahe*—does not; *tomāra*—Your; *vacana*—speeches.

TRANSLATION

“Dear Sir, by Your influence our minds are greatly satisfied, and we believe that Your words will never be unreasonable. Therefore You may speak on the Vedānta-sūtra.”

PURPORT

In this verse the words *tomāra prabhāve* (“Your influence”) are very important. Unless one is spiritually advanced he cannot influence an audience. Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura has sung, *śuddha-bhakata-caraṇa-reṇu, bhajana-anukūla*. “Unless one associates with a pure devotee, he cannot be influenced to understand devotional service.” These Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* were fortunate enough to meet the Supreme Personality of Godhead in the form of a devotee, and certainly they were greatly influenced by the Lord. They knew that since a perfectly advanced spiritualist never says anything false, all his words are reasonable and agree with the Vedic version. A highly realized person never says anything that has no meaning. Māyāvādī philosophers claim to be the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and this has no meaning, but Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu never uttered such nonsense. The Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* were convinced about His personality, and therefore they wanted to hear the purport of Vedānta philosophy from Him.

TEXT 106

prabhu kahe, vedānta-sūtra īśvara-vacana

vyāsa-rūpe kaila yāhā śrī-nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord began to speak; *vedānta-sūtra*—the philosophy of *Vedānta-sūtra*; *īśvara-vacana*—spoken by the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *vyāsa-rūpe*—in the form of Vyāsadeva; *kaila*—He has made; *yāhā*—whatever; *śrī-nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

The Lord said, “Vedānta philosophy consists of words spoken by the Supreme Personality of Godhead Nārāyaṇa in the form of Vyāsadeva.

PURPORT

The *Vedānta-sūtra*, which consists of aphorisms revealing the method of understanding Vedic knowledge, is the concise form of all Vedic knowledge. It begins with the words *athāto brahma jijñāsā*: “Now is the time to inquire about the Absolute Truth.” The human form of life is especially meant for this purpose, and therefore the *Vedānta-sūtra* very concisely explains the human mission. This is confirmed by the words of the *Vāyu* and *Skanda Purāṇas*, which define a *sūtra* as follows:

*alpākṣaram asandigdham sāra-vat viśvato-mukham
astobham anavadyam ca sūtram sūtra-vido viduḥ*

“A *sūtra* is a compilation of aphorisms that expresses the essence of all knowledge in a minimum of words. It must be universally applicable and faultless in its linguistic presentation.” Anyone familiar with such *sūtras* must be aware of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, which is well known among scholars by the following additional names: (1) *Brahma-sūtra*, (2) *Śārīraka*, (3) *Vyāsa-sūtra*, (4) *Bādarāyaṇa-sūtra*, (5) *Uttara-mīmāṃsā* and (6) *Vedānta-darśana*.

There are four chapters (*adhyāyas*) in the *Vedānta-sūtra*, and there are four divisions (*pādas*) in each chapter. Therefore the *Vedānta-sūtra* may be referred to as *ṣoḍaśa-pāda*, or sixteen divisions of aphorisms. The theme of each and every division is fully described in terms of five different subject matters (*adhikaraṇas*), which are technically called *pratijñā*, *hetu*, *udāharaṇa*, *upanaya* and *nigamana*. Every theme must necessarily be explained with reference to *pratijñā*, or a solemn declaration of the purpose of the treatise. The solemn declaration given in the beginning of the *Vedānta-sūtra* is *athāto brahma jijñāsā*, which indicates that this book was written with the solemn declaration to inquire about the Absolute Truth. Similarly, reasons must be expressed (*hetu*), examples must be given in terms of various facts (*udāharaṇa*), the theme must gradually be brought nearer for understanding (*upanaya*), and finally it must be supported by authoritative quotations from the Vedic *śāstras* (*nigamana*).

According to the great dictionary compiler Hemacandra, also known as Koṣakāra, Vedānta refers to the purport of the *Upaniṣads* and the *Brāhmaṇa* portion of the *Vedas*. Professor Apte, in his dictionary, describes the *Brāhmaṇa* portion of the *Vedas* as that portion which states the rules for employment of hymns at various sacrifices and gives detailed explanations of their origin, sometimes with lengthy illustrations in the form of legends and stories. It is distinct from the *mantra* portion of the *Vedas*. Hemacandra says that the supplement of the *Vedas* is called the *Vedānta-sūtra*. *Veda* means knowledge, and *anta* means the end. In other words, proper understanding of the ultimate purpose of the *Vedas* is called Vedānta knowledge. Such knowledge, as given in the aphorisms of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, must be supported by the *Upaniṣads*.

According to learned scholars, there are three different sources of knowledge, which are called *prasthāna-traya*. According to these scholars, Vedānta is one of such sources, for it presents Vedic knowledge on the basis of logic and sound arguments. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (13.5) the Lord says, *brahma-sūtra-padais caiva hetumadbhir viniścitaiḥ*: “Understanding of the ultimate goal of life is ascertained in the *Brahma-sūtra* by legitimate logic and argument concerning cause and effect.” Therefore the *Vedānta-sūtra* is known as *nyāya-prasthāna*, the *Upaniṣads* are known as *śruti-prasthāna*, and the *Gītā*, *Mahābhārata* and *Purāṇas* are known as *smṛti-prasthāna*. All scientific knowledge of transcendence must be supported by *śruti*, *smṛti* and a sound logical basis.

It is said that both the Vedic knowledge and the supplement of the *Vedas* called the *Sātvata-pañcarātra* emanated from the breathing of Nārāyaṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The *Vedānta-sūtra* aphorisms were compiled by Śrīla Vyāsadeva, a powerful incarnation of Śrī Nārāyaṇa, although it is sometimes said that they were compiled by a great sage named Apāntaratamā. The *Pañcarātra* and *Vedānta-sūtra*, however, express the same opinions. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu therefore confirms that there is no difference in opinion between the two, and He declares that because the *Vedānta-sūtra* was compiled by Śrīla Vyāsadeva, it may be understood to have emanated from the breathing of Śrī Nārāyaṇa. Śrīla

Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura comments that while Vyāsadeva was compiling the *Vedānta-sūtra*, seven of his great saintly contemporaries were also engaged in similar work. These saints were Ātreya Ṛṣi, Āśmarathya, Auḍulomi, Kārṣṇājini, Kāśakṛtsna, Jaimini and Bādarī. In addition, it is stated that Pārāśarī and Karmandī-bhikṣu also discussed the *Vedānta-sūtra* aphorisms before Vyāsadeva.

As mentioned above, the *Vedānta-sūtra* consists of four chapters. The first two chapters discuss the relationship of the living entity with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This is known as *sambandha-jñāna*, or knowledge of the relationship. The third chapter describes how one can act in his relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This is called *abhidheya-jñāna*. The relationship of the living entity with the Supreme Lord is described by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu: *jīvera 'svarūpa' haya kṛṣṇera 'nitya-dāsa'* [Cc. *Madhya* 20.108]. “The living entity is an eternal servant of Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme God.” (Cc. *Madhya* 20.108) Therefore, to act in that relationship one must perform *sādhana-bhakti*, or the prescribed duties of service to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This is called *abhidheya-jñāna*. The fourth chapter describes the result of such devotional service (*prayojana-jñāna*). This ultimate goal of life is to go back home, back to Godhead. The words *anāvṛttiḥ śabdāt* in the *Vedānta-sūtra* indicate this ultimate goal.

Śrīla Vyāsadeva, a powerful incarnation of Nārāyaṇa, compiled the *Vedānta-sūtra*, and in order to protect it from unauthorized commentaries, he personally composed *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* on the instruction of his spiritual master, Nārada Muni, as the original commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra*. Besides *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, there are commentaries on the *Vedānta-sūtra* composed by all the major Vaiṣṇava *ācāryas*, and in each of them devotional service to the Lord is described very explicitly. Only those who follow Śaṅkara's commentary have described the *Vedānta-sūtra* in an impersonal way, without reference to *viṣṇu-bhakti*, or devotional service to the Lord, Viṣṇu. Generally people very much appreciate this *Śārīraka-bhāṣya*, or impersonal description of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, but all commentaries that are devoid of devotional

service to Lord Viṣṇu must be considered to differ in purpose from the original *Vedānta-sūtra*. In other words, Lord Caitanya definitely confirmed that the commentaries, or *bhāṣyas*, written by the Vaiṣṇava *ācāryas* on the basis of devotional service to Lord Viṣṇu, and not the *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* of Śaṅkarācārya, give the actual explanation of the *Vedānta-sūtra*.

TEXT 107

bhrama, pramāda, vipralipsā, karaṇāpāṭava

īśvarera vākye nāhi doṣa ei saba

SYNONYMS

bhrama—mistake; *pramāda*—illusion; *vipralipsā*—cheating purposes; *karaṇa-apāṭava*—inefficiency of the material senses; *īśvarera*—of the Lord; *vākye*—in the speech; *nāhi*—there is not; *doṣa*—fault; *ei saba*—all this.

TRANSLATION

“The material defects of mistakes, illusions, cheating and sensory inefficiency do not exist in the words of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

A mistake is the acceptance of an object to be different from what it is or the acceptance of false knowledge. For example, one may see a rope in the dark and think it to be a serpent, or one may see a glittering oyster shell and think it to be gold. These are mistakes. Similarly, an illusion is a misunderstanding that arises from inattention while hearing, and cheating is the transmission of such defective knowledge to others. Materialistic scientists and philosophers generally use such words as “maybe” and

“perhaps” because they do not have actual knowledge of complete facts. Therefore their instructing others is an example of cheating. The final defect of the materialistic person is his inefficient senses. Although our eyes, for example, have the power to see, they cannot see that which is situated at a distance, nor can they see the eyelid, which is the object nearest to the eye. To our untrained eyes the sun appears to be just like a plate, and to the eyes of one who is suffering from jaundice everything appears to be yellow. Therefore we cannot rely on the knowledge acquired through such imperfect eyes. The ears are equally imperfect. We cannot hear a sound vibrated a long distance away unless we put a telephone to our ear. Similarly, if we analyze all our senses in this way, we will find them all to be imperfect. Therefore it is useless to acquire knowledge through the senses. The Vedic process is to hear from authority. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.2) the Lord says, *evam paramparā-prāptam imam rājarṣayo viduḥ*: “The supreme science was thus received through the chain of disciplic succession, and the saintly kings understood it in that way.” We have to hear not from a telephone but from an authorized person, for it is he who has real knowledge.

TEXT 108

upaniṣat-sahita sūtra kahe yei tattva

mukhya-vṛttye sei artha parama mahattva

SYNONYMS

upaniṣat—the authorized Vedic version; *sahita*—along with; *sūtra*—the *Vedānta-sūtra*; *kahe*—it is said; *yei*—the subject matter; *tattva*—in truth; *mukhya-vṛttye*—by direct understanding; *sei*—that truth; *artha*—meaning; *parama*—ultimate; *mahattva*—glory.

TRANSLATION

“The Absolute Truth is described in the Upaniṣads and Brahma-sūtra,

but one must understand the verses as they are. That is the supreme glory in understanding.

PURPORT

It has become fashionable since the time of Śaṅkarācārya to explain everything regarding the *sāstras* in an indirect way. Scholars take pride in explaining everything in their own way, and they declare that one can understand the Vedic scriptures in any way he likes. This “any way you like” method is foolishness, and it has created havoc in the Vedic culture. One cannot accept scientific knowledge in his own whimsical way. In the science of mathematics, for example, two plus two equals four, and one cannot make it equal three or five. Yet although it is not possible to alter real knowledge, people have taken to the fashion of understanding Vedic knowledge in any way they like. It is for this reason that we have presented *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is*. We do not create meanings by concoction. Sometimes commentators say that the word *kurukṣetra* in the first verse of the *Bhagavad-gītā* refers to one’s body, but we do not accept this. We understand that Kurukṣetra is a place that still exists, and according to the Vedic version it is a *dharma-kṣetra*, or a place of pilgrimage. People still go there to perform Vedic sacrifices. Foolish commentators, however, say that *kurukṣetra* means the body and that *pañca-pāṇḍava* refers to the five senses. In this way they distort the meaning, and people are misled. Here Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu confirms that all Vedic literatures, including the *Upaniṣads*, *Brahma-sūtra* and others, whether *śruti*, *smṛti* or *nyāya*, must be understood according to their original statements. To describe the direct meaning of the Vedic literatures is glorious, but to describe them in one’s own way, using imperfect senses and imperfect knowledge, is a disastrous blunder. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu fully deprecated the attempt to describe the *Vedas* in this way.

Regarding the *Upaniṣads*, the following eleven *Upaniṣads* are considered to be the topmost: *Īśa*, *Kena*, *Kaṭha*, *Praśna*, *Muṇḍaka*, *Māṇḍūkya*, *Taittirīya*, *Aitareya*, *Chāndogya*, *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka* and *Śvetāśvatara*.

However, in the *Muktikopaniṣad*, verses 30–39, there is a description of 108 *Upaniṣads*. They are as follows: (1) *Īśopaniṣad*, (2) *Kenopaniṣad*, (3) *Kāthopaniṣad*, (4) *Praśnopaniṣad*, (5) *Muṇḍakopaniṣad*, (6) *Māṇḍūkyopaniṣad*, (7) *Taittirīyopaniṣad*, (8) *Aitareyopaniṣad*, (9) *Chāndogyopaniṣad*, (10) *Brhad-āraṇyakopaniṣad*, (11) *Brahmopaniṣad*, (12) *Kaivalyopaniṣad*, (13) *Jābālopaniṣad*, (14) *Śvetāśvataropaniṣad*, (15) *Hamsopaniṣad*, (16) *Āruṇeyopaniṣad*, (17) *Garbhopaniṣad*, (18) *Nārāyaṇopaniṣad*, (19) *Paramahamsopaniṣad*, (20) *Amṛta-bindūpaniṣad*, (21) *Nāda-bindūpaniṣad*, (22) *Śiropaniṣad*, (23) *Atharva-sīkhopaniṣad*, (24) *Maitrāyaṇy-upaniṣad*, (25) *Kauṣītaky-upaniṣad*, (26) *Brhaj-jābālopaniṣad*, (27) *Nṛsimha-tāpanīyopaniṣad*, (28) *Kālāgni-rudropaniṣad*, (29) *Maitreyy-upaniṣad*, (30) *Subālopaniṣad*, (31) *Kṣurikopaniṣad*, (32) *Mantrikopaniṣad*, (33) *Sarva-sāropaniṣad*, (34) *Nirāmbopaniṣad*, (35) *Śuka-rahasyopaniṣad*, (36) *Vajra-sūcikopaniṣad*, (37) *Tejo-bindūpaniṣad*, (38) *Nāda-bindūpaniṣad*, (39) *Dhyāna-bindūpaniṣad*, (40) *Brahma-vidyopaniṣad*, (41) *Yoga-tattvopaniṣad*, (42), *Ātma-bodhopaniṣad*, (43) *Nārada-parivrājakopaniṣad*, (44) *Trisīkhy-upaniṣad*, (45) *Sītopaniṣad*, (46) *Yoga-cūḍāmaṇy-upaniṣad*, (47) *Nirvāṇopaniṣad*, (48) *Maṇḍala-brāhmaṇopaniṣad*, (49) *Dakṣiṇā-mūrty-upaniṣad*, (50) *Śarabhopaniṣad*, (51) *Skandopaniṣad*, (52) *Mahānārāyaṇopaniṣad*, (53) *Advaya-tārakopaniṣad*, (54) *Rāma-rahasyopaniṣad*, (55) *Rāma-tāpaṇy-upaniṣad*, (56) *Vāsudevopaniṣad*, (57) *Mudgalopaniṣad*, (58) *Śāṇḍilyopaniṣad*, (59) *Paiṅgalopaniṣad*, (60) *Bhikṣūpaniṣad*, (61) *Mahad-upaniṣad*, (62) *Śārīrakopaniṣad*, (63) *Yoga-sīkhopaniṣad*, (64) *Turīyātītopaniṣad*, (65) *Sannyāsopaniṣad*, (66) *Paramahamṣa-parivrājakopaniṣad*, (67) *Mālikopaniṣad*, (68) *Avyaktopaniṣad*, (69) *Ekākṣaropaniṣad*, (70) *Pūrṇopaniṣad*, (71) *Sūryopaniṣad*, (72) *Akṣy-upaniṣad*, (73) *Adhyātmopaniṣad*, (74) *Kuṇḍikopaniṣad*, (75) *Sāvitry-upaniṣad*, (76) *Ātmopaniṣad*, (77) *Pāśupatopaniṣad*, (78) *Param-brahmopaniṣad*, (79) *Avadhūttopaniṣad*, (80) *Tripurātapanopaniṣad*, (81) *Devy-upaniṣad*, (82) *Tripuropaniṣad*, (83) *Kātha-rudropaniṣad*, (84) *Bhāvanopaniṣad*, (85) *Hṛdayopaniṣad*, (86) *Yoga-kuṇḍalīny-upaniṣad*, (87) *Bhasmopaniṣad*, (88) *Rudrākṣopaniṣad*, (89) *Gaṇopaniṣad*, (90) *Darśanopaniṣad*, (91) *Tāra-sāropaniṣad*, (92) *Mahā-vākyopaniṣad*, (93) *Pañca-brahmopaniṣad*, (94) *Prāṇāgni-hotropaniṣad*, (95) *Gopāla-tāpaṇy-upaniṣad*, (96)

Kṛṣṇopaniṣad, (97) *Yājñavalkyopaniṣad*, (98) *Varāhopaniṣad*, (99) *Śātyāyany-upaniṣad*, (100) *Hayagrīvopaniṣad*, (101) *Dattātreyaopaniṣad*, (102) *Gāruḍopaniṣad*, (103) *Kaly-upaniṣad*, (104) *Jābāly-upaniṣad*, (105) *Saubhāgyopaniṣad*, (106) *Sarasvatī-rahasyopaniṣad*, (107) *Bahvṛcopaniṣad* and (108) *Muktikopaniṣad*. Thus there are 108 generally accepted *Upaniṣads*, of which eleven are the most important, as previously stated.

TEXT 109

gauṇa-vṛttye yebā bhāṣya karila ācārya

tāhāra śravaṇe nāśa haya sarva kārya

SYNONYMS

gauṇa-vṛttye—by indirect meanings; *yebā*—which; *bhāṣya*—commentary; *karila*—prepared; *ācārya*—Śaṅkarācārya; *tāhāra*—its; *śravaṇe*—hearing; *nāśa*—destruction; *haya*—becomes; *sarva*—all; *kārya*—business.

TRANSLATION

“Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya has described all the Vedic literatures in terms of indirect meanings. One who hears such explanations is ruined.

TEXT 110

tānhāra nāhika doṣa, īśvara-ājñā pāñā

gauṇārtha karila mukhya artha ācchādiyā

SYNONYMS

tānhāra—of Śrī Śaṅkarācārya; *nāhika*—there is none; *doṣa*—fault; *īśvara*—the Supreme Lord; *ājñā*—order; *pāñā*—receiving; *gauṇa-artha*—

indirect meaning; *karila*—make; *mukhya*—direct; *artha*—meaning; *ācchādiyā*—covering.

TRANSLATION

“Śaṅkarācārya is not at fault, for it is under the order of the Supreme Personality of Godhead that he has covered the real purpose of the Vedas.

PURPORT

The Vedic literature is to be considered a source of real knowledge, but if one does not take it as it is, one will be misled. For example, the *Bhagavad-gītā* is an important Vedic literature that has been taught for many years, but because it was commented upon by unscrupulous rascals, people derived no benefit from it, and no one came to the conclusion of Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Since the purpose of the *Bhagavad-gītā* is now being presented as it is, however, within four or five short years thousands of people all over the world have become Kṛṣṇa conscious. That is the difference between direct and indirect explanations of the Vedic literature. Therefore Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu said, *mukhya-vṛttye sei artha parama mahattva*: “To teach the Vedic literature according to its direct meaning, without false commentary, is glorious.” Unfortunately, Śrī Śaṅkarācārya, by the order of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, compromised between atheism and theism in order to cheat the atheists and bring them to theism, and to do so he gave up the direct method of Vedic knowledge and tried to present a meaning which is indirect. It is with this purpose that he wrote his *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra*.

One should not, therefore, attribute very much importance to the *Śārīraka-bhāṣya*. In order to understand Vedānta philosophy, one must study *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, which begins with the words *om namo bhagavate vāsudevāya, janmādy asya yato ’nvayād itarataś cārtheṣv abhijñāḥ sva-rāṭ*: [SB 1.1.1] “I offer my obeisances unto Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, son of Vasudeva, who is the Supreme All-pervading Personality of

Godhead. I meditate upon Him, the transcendent reality, who is the primeval cause of all causes, from whom all manifested universes arise, in whom they dwell and by whom they are destroyed. I meditate upon that eternally effulgent Lord, who is directly and indirectly conscious of all manifestations and yet is fully independent.” (*Bhāg.* 1.1.1) *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is the real commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra*. Unfortunately, if one is attracted to Śrī Śaṅkarācārya’s commentary, *Śārīraka-bhāṣya*, his spiritual life is doomed.

One may argue that since Śaṅkarācārya is an incarnation of Lord Śiva, how is it that he cheated people in this way? The answer is that he did so on the order of his master, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This is confirmed in the *Padma Purāṇa*, in the words of Lord Śiva himself:

*māyāvādam asac chāstram pracchannaṁ bauddham ucyate
mayaiva kalpitaṁ devī kalau brāhmaṇa-rūpiṇā*

*brahmaṇas cāparam rūpaṁ nirguṇam vakṣyate mayā
sarva-svam jagato ’py asya mohanārtham kalau yuge*

*vedānte tu mahā-sāstre māyāvādam avaidikam
mayaiva vakṣyate devī jagatām nāśa-kāraṇāt*

“The Māyāvāda philosophy,” Lord Śiva informed his wife Pārvatī, “is impious [*asac chāstra*]. It is covered Buddhism. My dear Pārvatī, in Kali-yuga I assume the form of a *brāhmaṇa* and teach this imagined Māyāvāda philosophy. In order to cheat the atheists, I describe the Supreme Personality of Godhead to be without form and without qualities. Similarly, in explaining Vedānta I describe the same Māyāvāda philosophy in order to mislead the entire population toward atheism by denying the personal form of the Lord.” In the *Śiva Purāṇa* the Supreme Personality of Godhead told Lord Śiva:

*dvāparāḍau yuge bhūtvā kalayā mānuṣādiṣu
svāgamaih kalpitaṁ tvaṁ ca janān mad-vimukhān kuru*

“In Kali-yuga, mislead the people in general by propounding imaginary meanings for the *Vedas* to bewilder them.” These are the descriptions of the *Purāṇas*.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura comments that *mukhya-vṛtti* (“the direct meaning”) is *abhidhā-vṛtti*, or the meaning that one can understand immediately from the statements of dictionaries, whereas *gauṇa-vṛtti* (“the indirect meaning”) is a meaning that one imagines without consulting the dictionary. For example, one politician has said that Kurukṣetra refers to the body, but in the dictionary there is no such definition. Therefore this imaginary meaning is *gauṇa-vṛtti*, whereas the direct meaning found in the dictionary is *mukhya-vṛtti* or *abhidhā-vṛtti*. This is the distinction between the two. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu recommends that one understand the Vedic literature in terms of *abhidhā-vṛtti*, and the *gauṇa-vṛtti* He rejects. Sometimes, however, as a matter of necessity, the Vedic literature is described in terms of the *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti* or *gauṇa-vṛtti*, but one should not accept such explanations as permanent truths.

The purpose of the discussions in the *Upaniṣads* and *Vedānta-sūtra* is to philosophically establish the personal feature of the Absolute Truth. The impersonalists, however, in order to establish their philosophy, accept these discussions in terms of *lakṣaṇā-vṛtti*, or indirect meanings. Thus instead of being *tattva-vāda*, or in search of the Absolute Truth, they become Māyāvāda, or illusioned by the material energy. When Śrī Viṣṇu Svāmī, one of the four *ācāryas* of the Vaiṣṇava cult, presented his thesis on the subject matter of *śuddhādvaita-vāda*, immediately the Māyāvādīs took advantage of this philosophy and tried to establish their *advaita-vāda* or *kevalādvaita-vāda*. To defeat this *kevalādvaita-vāda*, Śrī Rāmāṇujācārya presented his philosophy as *viśiṣṭādvaita-vāda*, and Śrī Madhvācārya presented his philosophy of *tattva-vāda*, both of which are stumbling blocks to the Māyāvādīs because they defeat their philosophy in scrupulous detail. Students of Vedic philosophy know very well how strongly Śrī Rāmāṇujācārya’s *viśiṣṭādvaita-vāda* and Śrī Madhvācārya’s *tattva-vāda* contest the impersonal Māyāvāda philosophy. Śrī Caitanya

Mahāprabhu, however, accepted the direct meaning of the Vedānta philosophy and thus defeated the Māyāvāda philosophy immediately. He opined in this connection that anyone who follows the principles of the *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* is doomed. This is confirmed in the *Padma Purāṇa*, where Lord Śiva tells Pārvatī:

*śṛṇu devī pravakṣyāmi tāmasāni yathā-kramam
yeṣāṁ śravaṇa-mātreṇa pātityaṁ jñāninām api*

*apārthaṁ śruti-vākyānāṁ darśayaḥ loka-garhitam
karma-svarūpa-tyājyatvam atra ca pratipādyate*

*sarva-karma-paribhramśān naiṣkarmyaṁ tatra cocyate
parātmā-jīvayor aikyaṁ mayātra pratipādyate*

“My dear wife, hear my explanations of how I have spread ignorance through Māyāvāda philosophy. Simply by hearing it, even an advanced scholar will fall down. In this philosophy, which is certainly very inauspicious for people in general, I have misrepresented the real meaning of the *Vedas* and recommended that one give up all activities in order to achieve freedom from *karma*. In this Māyāvāda philosophy I have described the *jīvātmā* and *Paramātmā* to be one and the same.” How the Māyāvāda philosophy was condemned by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His followers is described in *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, *Antya-līlā*, Second Chapter, verses 94 through 99, where Svarūpa-dāmodara Gosvāmī says that anyone who is eager to understand the Māyāvāda philosophy must be considered insane. This especially applies to a Vaiṣṇava who reads the *Śārīraka-bhāṣya* and considers himself to be one with God. The Māyāvādī philosophers have presented their arguments in such attractive, flowery language that hearing Māyāvāda philosophy may sometimes change the mind of even a *mahā-bhāgavata*, or very advanced devotee. An actual Vaiṣṇava cannot tolerate any philosophy that claims God and the living being to be one and the same.

TEXT 111

‘brahma’-śabde mukhya arthe kahe—‘bhagavān’

cid-aśvarya-paripūrṇa, anūrdhva-samāna

SYNONYMS

brahma—the Absolute Truth; *śabde*—by this word; *mukhya*—direct; *arthe*—meaning; *kahe*—says; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *cid-aśvarya*—spiritual opulence; *paripūrṇa*—full of; *anūrdhva*—unsurpassed by anyone; *samāna*—not equaled by anyone.

TRANSLATION

“According to direct understanding, the Absolute Truth is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who has all spiritual opulences. No one can be equal to or greater than Him.

PURPORT

This statement by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.2.11):

*vadanti tat tattva-vidas tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam
brahmeti paramātmetye bhagavān iti śabdyate*

“Learned transcendentalists who know the Absolute Truth call this nondual substance Brahman, Paramātmā or Bhagavān.” The Absolute Truth is ultimately understood as Bhagavān, partially understood as Paramātmā and vaguely understood as the impersonal Brahman. Bhagavān, or the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is opulent in all excellence; no one can be equal to or greater than Him. This is also confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.7), where the Lord says, *mattaḥ parataraṁ nānyat kiñcid asti dhanañjaya*: “O conqueror of wealth [Arjuna], there is no truth superior to Me.” There are many other verses which prove that the Absolute Truth in the ultimate sense is understood

to be the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 112

tāñhāra vibhūti, deha,——saba cid-ākāra

cid-vibhūti ācchādi’ tāñre kahe ‘nirākāra’

SYNONYMS

tāñhāra—His (the Supreme Personality of Godhead’s); *vibhūti*—spiritual power; *deha*—body; *saba*—everything; *cid-ākāra*—spiritual form; *cid-vibhūti*—spiritual opulence; *ācchādi’*—covering; *tāñre*—Him; *kahe*—says; *nirākāra*—without form.

TRANSLATION

“Everything about the Supreme Personality of Godhead is spiritual, including His body, opulence and paraphernalia. Māyāvāda philosophy, however, covering His spiritual opulence, advocates the theory of impersonalism.

PURPORT

It is stated in the *Brahma-saṁhitā*, *īśvaraḥ paramaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ* [Bs. 5.1]: “The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, has a spiritual body which is full of knowledge, eternity and bliss.” In this material world everyone’s body is just the opposite—temporary, full of ignorance and full of misery. Therefore when the Supreme Personality of Godhead is sometimes described as *nirākāra*, this is to indicate that He does not have a material body like us.

Māyāvādī philosophers do not know how it is that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is formless. The Supreme Lord does not have a form like ours but has a spiritual form. Not knowing this, Māyāvādī

philosophers simply advocate the onesided view that the Supreme Godhead, or Brahman, is formless (*nirākāra*). In this connection Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura offers many quotes from the Vedic literature. If one accepts the real or direct meaning of these Vedic statements, one can understand that the Supreme Personality of Godhead has a spiritual body (*sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha* [Bs. 5.1]).

In the *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* (5.1.1) it is said, *pūrṇam adaḥ pūrṇam idaṁ pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate*. This indicates that the body of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is spiritual, for even though He expands in many ways, He remains the same. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.8) the Lord says, *ahaṁ sarvasya prabhavo mattaḥ sarvaṁ pravartate*: “I am the origin of all. Everything emanates from Me.” Māyāvādī philosophers materialistically think that if the Supreme Truth expands Himself in everything, He must lose His original form. Thus they think that there cannot be any form other than the expansive gigantic body of the Lord. But the *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* confirms, *pūrṇam idaṁ pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate*: “Although He expands in many ways, He keeps His original personality. His original spiritual body remains as it is.” Similarly, elsewhere it is stated, *vicitra-śaktiḥ puruṣaḥ purāṇaḥ*: “The Supreme Personality of Godhead, the original person [*puruṣa*], has multifarious energies.” And the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* declares, *sa vṛkṣa-kālākṛtibhiḥ paro 'nyo yasmāt prapañcaḥ parivartate 'yaṁ dharmāvahaṁ pāpanudam bhageśam*: “He is the origin of material creation, and it is due to Him only that everything changes. He is the protector of religion and annihilator of all sinful activities. He is the master of all opulences.” (*Śvet. Up.* 6.6) *Vedāham etaṁ puruṣaṁ mahāntam āditya-varṇaṁ tamaśaḥ parastāt*: “Now I understand the Supreme Personality of Godhead to be the greatest of the great. He is effulgent like the sun and is beyond this material world.” (*Śvet. Up.* 3.8) *Patim patinām paramaṁ parastāt*: “He is the master of all masters, the superior of all superiors.” (*Śvet. Up.* 6.7) *Mahān prabhur vai puruṣaḥ*: “He is the supreme master and supreme person.” (*Śvet. Up.* 3.12) *Parāsyā śaktir vividhaiva śrūyate*: “We can understand His opulences in different ways.” (*Śvet. Up.* 6.8) Similarly, in the *R̥g Veda* it is stated, *tad viṣṇoḥ paramaṁ padam sadā*

paśyanti sūrayaḥ: “Viṣṇu is the Supreme, and those who are actually learned think only of His lotus feet.” In the *Praśna Upaniṣad* (6.3) it is said, *sa iṅṣāṁ cakre*: “He glanced over the material creation.” In the *Aitareya Upaniṣad* (1.1.1–2) it is said, *sa aikṣata*—“He glanced over the material creation”—and *sa imāl lokān asṛjata*—“He created this entire material world.”

Thus many verses can be quoted from the *Upaniṣads* and *Vedas* which prove that the Supreme Godhead is not impersonal. In the *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* (2.2.13) it is also said, *nityo nityānām cetanaś cetanānām eko bahūnām yo vidadhāti kāmān*: “He is the supreme eternally conscious person, who maintains all other living entities.” From all these Vedic references one can understand that the Absolute Truth is a person and that no one can equal or excel Him. Although there are many foolish Māyāvādī philosophers who think that they are even greater than Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa is *asamaurdhva*: no one is equal to or above Him.

As stated in the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* (3.19), *apāṇi-pādo javano grahītā*. This verse describes the Absolute Truth as having no legs or hands. Although this is an impersonal description, it does not mean that the Absolute Personality of Godhead has no form. He has a spiritual form that is distinct from the forms of matter. In this verse Caitanya Mahāprabhu clarifies this distinction.

TEXT 113

cid-ānanda—*tenho*, *tānra sthāna*, *parivāra*

tānre kahe—*prākṛta-sattvera vikāra*

SYNONYMS

cit-ānanda—spiritual bliss; *tenho*—He is personally; *tānra*—His; *sthāna*—abode; *parivāra*—entourage; *tānre*—unto Him; *kahe*—someone says; *prākṛta*—material; *sattvera*—goodness; *vikāra*—transformation.

TRANSLATION

“The Supreme Personality of Godhead is full of spiritual potencies. Therefore His body, name, fame and entourage are all spiritual. The Māyāvādī philosopher, due to ignorance, says that these are all merely transformations of the material mode of goodness.

PURPORT

In the Seventh Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gītā* the Supreme Personality of Godhead has classified His energies in two distinct divisions—namely, *prākṛta* and *aprākṛta*, or *parā-prakṛti* and *aparā-prakṛti*. In the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* the same distinction is made. The Māyāvādī philosophers cannot understand these two *prakṛtis*, or natures—material and spiritual—but one who is actually intelligent can understand them. Considering the many varieties and activities in material nature, why should the Māyāvādī philosophers deny the spiritual varieties of the spiritual world? The *Bhāgavatam* (10.2.32) says:

*ye 'nye 'ravindākṣa vimukta-māninas
tvayy asta-bhāvād aviśuddha-buddhayaḥ*

The intelligence of those who think themselves liberated but have no information of the spiritual world is not yet clear. In this verse the term *aviśuddha-buddhayaḥ* refers to unclean intelligence. Due to unclean intelligence or a poor fund of knowledge, the Māyāvādī philosophers cannot understand the distinction between material and spiritual varieties; therefore they cannot even think of spiritual varieties because they take it for granted that all variety is material.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, therefore, explains in this verse that Kṛṣṇa—the Supreme Personality of Godhead, or the Absolute Truth—has a spiritual body that is distinct from material bodies, and thus His name, abode, entourage and qualities are all spiritual. The material mode of goodness has nothing to do with spiritual varieties. Māyāvādī

philosophers, however, cannot clearly understand spiritual varieties; therefore they imagine a negation of the material world to be the spiritual world. The material qualities of goodness, passion and ignorance cannot act in the spiritual world, which is therefore called *nirguṇa*, as clearly indicated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (*traī-guṇya-viṣayā vedā nīstrai-guṇyo bhavārjuna*). The material world is a manifestation of the three modes of material nature, but one has to become free from these modes to come to the spiritual world, where their influence is completely absent. Now Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu will disassociate Lord Śiva from Māyāvāda philosophy in the following verse.

TEXT 114

tāñra doṣa nāhi, teñho ājñā-kārī dāsa

āra yei śune tāra haya sarva-nāśa

SYNONYMS

tāñra—his (Lord Śiva’s); *doṣa*—fault; *nāhi*—there is none; *teñho*—he; *ājñā-kārī*—obedient order-carrier; *dāsa*—servant; *āra*—others; *yei*—anyone; *śune*—hears (the Māyāvāda philosophy); *tāra*—of him; *haya*—becomes; *sarva-nāśa*—everything lost

TRANSLATION

“Śaṅkarācārya, who is an incarnation of Lord Śiva, is faultless because he is a servant carrying out the orders of the Lord. But those who follow his Māyāvādī philosophy are doomed. They will lose all their advancement in spiritual knowledge.

PURPORT

Māyāvādī philosophers are very proud of exhibiting their Vedānta knowledge through grammatical jugglery, but in the *Bhagavad-gītā* Lord

Śrī Kṛṣṇa certifies that they are *māyayāpahṛta-jñāna*, bereft of real knowledge due to *māyā*. *Māyā* has two potencies with which to execute her two functions—the *prakṣepātmikā-śakti*, the power to throw the living entity into the ocean of material existence, and *āvaraṇātmikā-śakti*, the power to cover the knowledge of the living entity. The function of the *āvaraṇātmikā-śakti* is explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā* by the word *māyayāpahṛta-jñānāḥ*.

Why the *daivī-māyā*, or illusory energy of Kṛṣṇa, takes away the knowledge of the Māyāvādī philosophers is also explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā* by the use of the words *āsuram bhāvam āśritāḥ*, which refer to a person who does not agree to the existence of the Lord. The Māyāvādīs, who are not in agreement with the existence of the Lord, can be classified in two groups, exemplified by the impersonalist Śāṅkarites of Vārāṇasī and the Buddhists of Saranātha. Both groups are Māyāvādīs, and Kṛṣṇa takes away their knowledge due to their atheistic philosophies. Neither group agrees to accept the existence of a personal God. The Buddhist philosophers clearly deny both the soul and God, and although the Śāṅkarites do not openly deny God, they say that the Absolute is *nirākāra*, or formless. Thus both the Buddhists and the Śāṅkarites are *aviśuddha-buddhayaḥ*, or imperfect and unclean in their knowledge and intelligence.

The most prominent Māyāvādī scholar, Sadānanda Yogīndra, has written a book called *Vedānta-sāra*, in which he expounds the philosophy of Śāṅkarācārya, and all the followers of Śāṅkara's philosophy attribute great importance to his statements. In this *Vedānta-sāra* Sadānanda Yogīndra defines Brahman as *sac-cid-ānanda* combined with knowledge and without duality, and he defines ignorance (*jaḍa*) as knowledge distinct from that of *sat* and *asat*. This is almost inconceivable, but it is a product of the three material qualities. Thus he considers anything other than pure knowledge to be material. The center of ignorance is considered to be sometimes all-pervading and sometimes individual. Thus according to his opinion both the all-pervading Viṣṇu and the individual living entities are products of ignorance.

In simple language, it is the opinion of Sadānanda Yogīndra that since everything is *nirākāra* (formless), the conception of Viṣṇu and the conception of the individual soul are both products of ignorance. He also explains that the *viśuddha-sattva* conception of the Vaiṣṇavas is nothing but *pradhāna*, or the chief principle of creation. He maintains that when all-pervading knowledge is contaminated by the *viśuddha-sattva*, which consists of a transformation of the quality of goodness, there arises the conception of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is the omnipotent, omniscient supreme ruler, the Supersoul, the cause of all causes, the supreme *īśvara*, etc. According to Sadānanda Yogīndra, because *īśvara*, the Supreme Lord, is the reservoir of all ignorance, He may be called *sarva-jña*, or omniscient, but one who denies the existence of the omnipotent Supreme Personality of Godhead is more than *īśvara*, or the Lord. His conclusion, therefore, is that the Supreme Personality of Godhead (*īśvara*) is a transformation of material ignorance and that the living entity (*jīva*) is covered by ignorance. Thus he describes both collective and individual existence in darkness. According to Māyāvādī philosophers, the Vaiṣṇava conception of the Lord as the Supreme Personality of Godhead and of the *jīva*, or individual soul, as His eternal servant is a manifestation of ignorance. If we accept the judgment of Lord Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, however, the Māyāvādīs are to be considered *māyayāpahṛta-jñāna*, or bereft of all knowledge, because they do not recognize the existence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead or they claim that His existence is a product of the material conception (*māyā*). These are characteristics of *asuras*, or demons.

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, in His discourses with Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, said:

*jīvera nistāra lāgi' sūtra kaila vyāsa
māyāvādī-bhāṣya śunile haya sarva-nāśa*

(Cc. Madhya 6.169)

Vyāsadeva composed the *Vedānta-sūtra* to deliver the conditioned souls

from this material world, but Śaṅkarācārya, by presenting the *Vedānta-sūtra* in his own way, has clearly done a great disservice to human society, for one who follows his Māyāvāda philosophy is doomed. In the *Vedānta-sūtra*, devotional service is clearly indicated, but the Māyāvādī philosophers refuse to accept the spiritual body of the Supreme Absolute Person and refuse to accept that the living entity has an individual existence separate from that of the Supreme Lord. Thus they have created atheistic havoc all over the world, for such a conclusion is against the very nature of the transcendental process of pure devotional service. The Māyāvādī philosophers' unrealizable ambition to become one with the Supreme through denying the existence of the Personality of Godhead results in a most calamitous misrepresentation of spiritual knowledge, and one who follows this philosophy is doomed to remain perpetually in this material world. Therefore the Māyāvādīs are called *aviśuddha-buddhayaḥ*, or unclean in knowledge. Because they are unclean in knowledge, all their austerities and penances end in frustration. Thus although they may be honored at first as very learned scholars, ultimately they descend to physical activities of politics, social work, etc. Instead of becoming one with the Supreme Lord, they again become one with these material activities. This is explained in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.2.32):

*āruhya kṛcchreṇa param padam tataḥ
patanty adho 'nādrta-yuṣmad-aṅghrayaḥ*

In actuality the Māyāvādī philosophers very strictly follow the austerities and penances of spiritual life and in this way are elevated to the impersonal Brahman platform, but due to their negligence of the lotus feet of the Lord they again fall down to material existence.

TEXT 115

*prākṛta kariyā māne viṣṇu-kalevara
viṣṇu-nindā āra nāhi ihāra upara*

SYNONYMS

prākṛta—material; *kariyā*—taking it to be so; *māne*—accepts; *viṣṇu*—Lord Viṣṇu’s; *kalevara*—body; *viṣṇu-nindā*—defaming or blaspheming Lord Viṣṇu; *āra*—beyond this; *nāhi*—none; *ihāra*—of this; *upara*—above.

TRANSLATION

“One who considers the transcendental body of Lord Viṣṇu to be made of material nature is the greatest offender at the lotus feet of the Lord. There is no greater blasphemy against the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī explains that the variegated personal feature of the Absolute Truth is the *viṣṇu-tattva* and that the material energy, which creates this cosmic manifestation, is the energy of Lord Viṣṇu. The creative force is merely the energy of the Lord, but the foolish conclude that because the Lord has distributed Himself in an impersonal form He has no separate existence. The impersonal Brahman, however, cannot possess energies, nor do the Vedic literatures state that *māyā* (the illusory energy) is covered by another *māyā*. There are hundreds and thousands of references, however, to *viṣṇu-māyā* (*parāśya śaktiḥ*), or the energy of Lord Viṣṇu. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.14) Kṛṣṇa refers to *mama māyā* (“My energy”). *Māyā* is controlled by the Supreme Personality of Godhead; it is not that He is covered by *māyā*. Therefore Lord Viṣṇu cannot be a product of the material energy. In the beginning of the *Vedānta-sūtra* it is said, *janmādy asya yataḥ* [SB 1.1.1], indicating that the material energy is also an emanation of the Supreme Brahman. How then could He be covered by the material energy? If that were possible, material energy would be greater than the Supreme Brahman. Even these simple arguments, however, cannot be understood by the *Māyāvādī* philosophers, and therefore the term *māyayāpahṛta-jñāna*,

which is applied to them in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, is extremely appropriate. Anyone who thinks that Lord Viṣṇu is a product of the material energy, as explained by Sadānanda Yogīndra, should immediately be understood to be insane, for his knowledge has been stolen by the illusory energy.

Lord Viṣṇu cannot be placed within the category of the demigods. Those who are actually bewildered by the Māyāvāda philosophy and are still in the darkness of ignorance consider Lord Viṣṇu to be a demigod, in defiance of the Ṛg-vedic *mantra om tad viṣṇoḥ paramaṁ padam* (“Viṣṇu is always in a superior position”). This *mantra* is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā*: *mattaḥ parataram nānyat* [Bg. 7.7]—there is no truth superior to Lord Kṛṣṇa, or Viṣṇu. Thus only those whose knowledge has been bewildered consider Lord Viṣṇu to be a demigod and therefore suggest that one may worship either Lord Viṣṇu, the goddess Kālī (Durgā) or whomever one likes and achieve the same result. This is an ignorant conclusion that is not accepted in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.25), which distinctly says, *yānti deva-vratā devān . . . yānti mad-yājino ’pi mām*: The worshipers of the demigods will be promoted to the respective planets of the demigods, but devotees of the Supreme Lord will go back home, back to Godhead. Lord Kṛṣṇa explains very clearly in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.14) that His material energy is very difficult to overcome: *daivī hy eṣā guṇa-mayī mama māyā duratyayā*. *Māyā’s* influence is so strong that even learned scholars and spiritualists are also covered by *māyā* and think themselves to be as good as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Actually, however, to free oneself from the influence of *māyā* one must surrender to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as Kṛṣṇa also states in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.14): *mām eva ye prapadyante māyām etāṁ taranti te*. It is to be concluded, therefore, that Lord Viṣṇu does not belong to this material creation but to the spiritual world. To misconceive Lord Viṣṇu to have a material body or to equate Him with the demigods is the most offensive blasphemy against Lord Viṣṇu, and offenders against the lotus feet of Lord Viṣṇu cannot advance in spiritual knowledge. They are called *māyayāpahṛta-jñāna*, or those whose knowledge has been stolen by the influence of illusion.

One who thinks that there is a difference between Lord Viṣṇu's body and His soul dwells in the darkest region of ignorance. There is no difference between Lord Viṣṇu's body and Viṣṇu's soul, for they are *advaya-jñāna*, one knowledge. In this world there is a difference between the material body and the spiritual soul, but in the spiritual world everything is spiritual and there are no such differences. The greatest offense of the Māyāvādī philosophers is to consider Lord Viṣṇu and the living entities to be one and the same. In this connection the *Padma Purāṇa* states, *arcye viṣṇau śilā-dhir guruṣu nara-matir vaiṣṇave jāti-buddhiḥ . . . yasya vā nārakī saḥ*: “One who considers the *arcā-mūrti*, the worshipable Deity of Lord Viṣṇu, to be stone, the spiritual master to be an ordinary human being, and a Vaiṣṇava to belong to a particular caste or creed is possessed of hellish intelligence.” One who follows such conclusions is doomed.

TEXT 116

īśvarera tattva—yena jvalita jvalana

jīvera svarūpa—yaiche sphuliṅgera kaṇa

SYNONYMS

īśvarera tattva—the truth of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *yena*—is like; *jvalita*—blazing; *jvalana*—fire; *jīvera*—of the living entities; *svarūpa*—identity; *yaiche*—is like; *sphuliṅgera*—of the spark; *kaṇa*—particle.

TRANSLATION

“The Lord is like a great blazing fire, and the living entities are like small sparks of that fire.

PURPORT

Although sparks and a big fire are both fire and both have the power to

burn, the burning power of the fire and that of the spark are not the same. Why should one artificially try to become like a big fire although by constitution he is like a small spark? It is due to ignorance. One should therefore understand that neither the Supreme Personality of Godhead nor the small sparklike living entities have anything to do with matter, but when the spiritual spark comes in contact with the material world his fiery quality is extinguished. That is the position of the conditioned souls. Because they are in touch with the material world, their spiritual quality is almost dead, but because these spiritual sparks are all Kṛṣṇa's parts and parcels, as the Lord states in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (*mamaivāṁśaḥ*), they can revive their original position by getting free from material contact. This is pure philosophical understanding. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* the spiritual sparks are declared to be *sanātana* (eternal); therefore the material energy, *māyā*, cannot affect their constitutional position.

Someone may argue, "Why is there a need to create the spiritual sparks?" The answer can be given in this way: Since the Absolute Personality of Godhead is omnipotent, He has both unlimited and limited potencies. This is the meaning of omnipotent. To be omnipotent, He must have not only unlimited potencies but limited potencies also. Thus to exhibit His omnipotency He displays both. The living entities are endowed with limited potency although they are part of the Lord. The Lord displays the spiritual world by His unlimited potencies, whereas by His limited potencies the material world is displayed. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.5) the Lord says:

*apareyam itas tv anyāṁ prakṛtiṁ viddhi me parāṁ
jīva-bhūtāṁ mahā-bāho yayedam dhāryate jagat*

"Besides these inferior energies, O mighty-armed Arjuna, there is another, superior energy of Mine, which comprises all living entities who are exploiting the resources of this material, inferior nature." The *jīva-bhūta*, the living entities, control this material world with their limited potencies. Generally, people are bewildered by the activities of scientists and technologists. Due to *māyā* they think that there is no need of God

and that they can do everything and anything, but actually they cannot. Since this cosmic manifestation is limited, their existence is also limited. Everything in this material world is limited, and for this reason there is creation, sustenance and dissolution. However, in the world of unlimited energy, the spiritual world, there is neither creation nor destruction.

If the Personality of Godhead did not possess both limited and unlimited energies, He could not be called omnipotent. *Aṇor aṇīyān mahato mahīyān*: “The Lord is greater than the greatest and smaller than the smallest.” He is smaller than the smallest in the form of the living entities and greater than the greatest in His form of Kṛṣṇa. If there were no one to control, there would be no meaning to the conception of the supreme controller (*īśvara*), just as there is no meaning to a king without his subjects. If all the subjects became king, there would be no distinction between the king and an ordinary citizen. Thus for the Lord to be the supreme controller there must be a creation to control. The basic principle for the existence of the living entities is called *cid-vilāsa*, or spiritual pleasure. The omnipotent Lord displays His pleasure potency as the living entities. The Lord is described in the *Vedānta-sūtra* (1.1.12) as *ānanda-mayo ’bhyāsāt*. He is by nature the reservoir of all pleasures, and because He wants to enjoy pleasure, there must be energies to give Him pleasure or supply Him the impetus for pleasure. This is the perfect philosophical understanding of the Absolute Truth.

TEXT 117

jīva-tattva—*śakti*, *kṛṣṇa-tattva*—*śaktimān*

gītā-viṣṇupurāṇādi tāhāte pramāṇa

SYNONYMS

jīva-tattva—the truth of the living entities; *śakti*—energy; *kṛṣṇa-tattva*—the truth of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *śakti-mān*—the possessor of the energies; *gītā*—the *Bhagavad-gītā*; *viṣṇu-purāṇa*—

ādi— *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* and other *Purāṇas*; *tāhāte*—in them; *pramāṇa*—there are evidences.

TRANSLATION

“The living entities are energies, not the energetic. The energetic is Kṛṣṇa. This is very vividly described in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* and other Vedic literatures.

PURPORT

As already explained, there are three *prasthānas* on the path of advancement in spiritual knowledge—namely, *nyāya-prasthāna* (Vedānta philosophy), *śruti-prasthāna* (the *Upaniṣads* and Vedic *mantras*) and *smṛti-prasthāna* (the *Bhagavad-gītā*, *Mahābhārata*, *Purāṇas*, etc.). Unfortunately, Māyāvādī philosophers do not accept the *smṛti-prasthāna*. *Smṛti* refers to the conclusions drawn from the Vedic evidence. Sometimes Māyāvādī philosophers do not accept the authority of the *Bhagavad-gītā* and the *Purāṇas*, and this is called *ardha-kukkuṭi-nyāya*, “the logic of half a hen” (See *Ādi-līlā* 5.176). If one believes in the Vedic literatures, one must accept all the Vedic literatures recognized by the great *ācāryas*, but the Māyāvādī philosophers accept only the *nyāya-prasthāna* and *śruti-prasthāna*, rejecting the *smṛti-prasthāna*. Here, however, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu cites evidence from the *Gītā*, *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, etc., which are *smṛti-prasthāna*. No one can avoid the Personality of Godhead in the statements of the *Bhagavad-gītā* and other Vedic literatures such as the *Mahābhārata* and the *Purāṇas*. Lord Caitanya therefore quotes a passage from the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.5).

TEXT 118

apareyam itas tv anyām

prakṛtiṁ viddhi me parām

jīva-bhūtām mahā-bāho

yayedam dhāryate jagat

SYNONYMS

aparā—inferior energy; *iyam*—this material world; *itaḥ*—beyond this; *tu*—but; *anyām*—another; *prakṛtim*—energy; *viddhi*—you must know; *me*—of Me; *parām*—which is superior energy; *jīva-bhūtām*—they are the living entities; *mahā-bāho*—O mighty-armed; *yayā*—by which; *idam*—this material world; *dhāryate*—is being conducted; *jagat*—the cosmic manifestation.

TRANSLATION

“Besides these inferior energies, O mighty-armed Arjuna, there is another, superior energy of Mine, which comprises the living entities who are exploiting the resources of this material, inferior nature.’

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is explained that the five elements earth, water, fire, air and ether constitute the gross energy of the Absolute Truth and that there are also three subtle energies, namely, the mind, intelligence and false ego, or identification with the phenomenal world. Thus the entire cosmic manifestation is divided into eight energies, all of which are inferior. As explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (*mama māyā duratyayā*), the inferior energy, known as *māyā*, is so strong that although the living entity does not belong to this energy, due to the superior strength of the inferior energy the living entity (*jīva-bhūta*) forgets his real position and identifies with it. Kṛṣṇa says distinctly that beyond the material energy there is a superior energy which is known as the *jīva-bhūta*, or living entities. When in contact with the material energy, this superior energy conducts all the activities of the entire material, phenomenal world.

The supreme cause is Kṛṣṇa (*janmādy asya yataḥ* [SB 1.1.1]), who is the origin of all energies, which work variously. The Supreme Personality of Godhead has both inferior and superior energies, and the difference between them is that the superior energy is factual whereas the inferior energy is a reflection of the superior. A reflection of the sun in a mirror or on water appears to be the sun but is not. Similarly, the material world is but a reflection of the spiritual world. Although it appears to be factual, it is not; it is only a temporary reflection, whereas the spiritual world is a factual reality. The material world, with its gross and subtle forms, is merely a reflection of the spiritual world.

The living entity is not a product of the material energy; he is spiritual energy, but in contact with matter he forgets his identity. Thus the living entity identifies himself with matter and enthusiastically engages in material activities in the guises of a technologist, scientist, philosopher, etc. He does not know that he is not at all a material product but is spiritual. His real identity thus being lost, he struggles very hard in the material world, and the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement, or Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, is trying to revive his original consciousness. His activities in manufacturing big skyscrapers are evidence of intelligence, but this kind of intelligence is not at all advanced. He should know that his only real concern is how to get free from material contact, for by absorbing his mind in material activities he takes material bodies again and again, and although he falsely claims to be very intelligent, in material consciousness he is not at all intelligent. When we speak about the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, which is meant to make people intelligent, the conditioned living entity therefore misunderstands it. He is so engrossed in the material concept of life that he does not think there can be any activities that are actually based on intelligence beyond the construction of skyscrapers and big roads and the manufacturing of cars. This is proof of *māyayāpahṛta-jñāna*, or loss of all intelligence due to the influence of *māyā*. When a living entity is freed from such misconceptions, he is called liberated. When one is actually liberated he no longer identifies with the material world. The symptom of *mukti* (liberation) is that one engages in spiritual activities instead of falsely engaging in material activities.

Transcendental loving devotional service is the spiritual activity of the spirit soul. Māyāvādī philosophers confuse such spiritual activity with material activity, but the *Bhagavad-gītā* (14.26) confirms:

*mām ca yo 'vyabhicāreṇa bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guṇān samatītyaitān brahma-bhūyāya kalpate*

One who engages in the spiritual activities of unalloyed devotional service (*avyabhicāriṇī-bhakti*) is immediately elevated to the transcendental platform, and he is to be considered *brahma-bhūta*, which indicates that he is no longer in the material world but is in the spiritual world.

Devotional service is enlightenment, or awakening. When the living entity perfectly performs spiritual activities under the direction of the spiritual master, he becomes perfect in knowledge and understands that he is not God but a servant of God. As explained by Caitanya Mahāprabhu, *jīvera 'svarūpa' haya—kṛṣṇera 'nitya-dāsa'*: the real identity of the living entity is that he is an eternal servant of the Supreme (Cc. *Madhya* 20.108). As long as one does not come to this conclusion, he must be in ignorance. This is also confirmed by the Lord in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.19): *bahūnām janmanām ante jñānavān mām prapadyate . . . sa mahātmā su-durlabhaḥ*. “After many births of struggling for existence and cultivating knowledge, when one comes to the point of real knowledge he surrenders unto Me. Such an advanced *mahātmā*, or great soul, is very rarely to be seen.” Thus although the Māyāvādī philosophers appear to be very much advanced in knowledge, they are not yet perfect. To come to the point of perfection they must voluntarily surrender to Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 119

viṣṇu-śaktiḥ parā proktā

kṣetra-jñākhyā tathā parā

avidyā-karma-saṁjñānyā

tr̥tīyā śaktir iṣyate

SYNONYMS

viṣṇu-śaktiḥ—the potency of Lord Viṣṇu; *parā*—spiritual; *proktā*—it is said; *kṣetra-jñā-ākhyā*—the potency known as *kṣetra-jñā*; *tathā*—as well as; *parā*—spiritual; *avidyā*—ignorance; *karma*—fruitive activities; *saṁjñā*—known as; *anyā*—other; *tr̥tīyā*—third; *śaktiḥ*—potency; *iṣyate*—known thus.

TRANSLATION

“The potency of Lord Viṣṇu is summarized in three categories—namely, the spiritual potency, the living entities and ignorance. The spiritual potency is full of knowledge; the living entities, although belonging to the spiritual potency, are subject to bewilderment; and the third energy, which is full of ignorance, is always visible in fruitive activities.’

PURPORT

This is a quotation from the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* (6.7.61).

In the previous verse, quoted from the *Bhagavad-gītā*, it has been established that the living entities are to be categorized among the Lord’s potencies. The Lord is potent, and there are varieties of potencies (*parāsyā śaktir vividhaiva śrūyate*). Now, in this quotation from the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, this is further confirmed. There are varieties of potencies, and they have been divided into three categories—namely, spiritual, marginal and external.

The spiritual potency is manifested in the spiritual world. Kṛṣṇa’s form, qualities, activities and entourage are all spiritual. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.5):

aḥo ’pi sann avyayātmā bhūtānām īśvaro ’pi san

prakṛtiṁ svām adhiṣṭhāya sambhavāmy ātma-māyayā
[Bg. 4.6]

“Although I am unborn and My transcendental body never deteriorates, and although I am the Lord of all living entities, by My spiritual potency I still appear in every millennium in My original transcendental form.” *Ātma-māyā* refers to the spiritual potency. When Kṛṣṇa comes to this or any other universe, He does so with His spiritual potency. We take birth by the force of the material potency, but as stated here with reference to the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, the *kṣetra-jñā*, or living entity, belongs to the spiritual potency; thus when we free ourselves from the clutches of the material potency we can also enter the spiritual world.

The material potency is the energy of darkness, or complete ignorance of spiritual activities. In the material potency, the living entity engages himself in fruitive activities, thinking that he can be happy through expansion in terms of material energy. This fact is prominently manifest in this Age of Kali because human society, not understanding the spiritual nature, is busily expanding in material activities. The men of the present day are almost unaware of their spiritual identity. They think that they are products of the elements of the material world and that everything will end with the annihilation of the body. Therefore they conclude that as long as one has a material body consisting of material senses, one should enjoy the senses as much as possible. Since they are atheists, they do not care whether there is a next life. Such activities are described in this verse as *avidyā-karma-saṁjñānyā*.

The material energy is separated from the spiritual energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Thus although it is originally created by the Supreme Lord, He is not actually present within it. The Lord also confirms in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.4), *mat-sthāni sarva-bhūtāni*: “Everything is resting on Me.” This indicates that everything is resting on His own energy. For example, the planets are resting within outer space, which is the separated energy of Kṛṣṇa. The Lord explains in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.4):

*bhūmir āpo 'nalo vāyuḥ khaṁ mano buddhir eva ca
ahaṁkāra itīyaṁ me bhinnā prakṛtir aṣṭadhā*

“Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intelligence and false ego—all together these eight constitute My separated material energies.” The separated energy acts as if it were independent, but here it is said that although such energies are certainly factual, they are not independent but merely separated.

The separated energy can be understood from a practical example. I compose books by speaking into a dictaphone, and when the dictaphone is replayed, it appears that I am speaking personally, but actually I am not. I spoke personally, but then the dictaphone tape, which is separate from me, acts exactly like me. Similarly, the material energy originally emanates from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but it acts separately, although the energy is supplied by the Lord. This is also explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.10): *mayādhyakṣeṇa prakṛtiḥ sūyate sa-carācaram*. “This material nature is working under My direction, O son of Kuntī, and it is producing all moving and unmoving beings.” Under the guidance or superintendence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the material energy works as if independent, although it is not actually independent.

In this verse from the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* the total energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is classified in three divisions—namely, the spiritual or internal potency of the Lord, the marginal potency, or *kṣetra-jñā* (the living entity), and the material potency, which is separated from the Supreme Personality of Godhead and appears to act independently. When Śrīla Vyāsadeva, by meditation and self-realization, saw the Supreme Personality of Godhead, he also saw the separated energy of the Lord standing behind Him (*apaśyat puruṣaṁ pūrṇaṁ māyāṁ ca tad-apāśrayam*). Vyāsadeva also realized that it is this separated energy of the Lord, the material energy, that covers the knowledge of the living entities (*yayā sammohito jīva ātmānaṁ tri-guṇātmakam*). The separated, material energy bewilders the living entities (*jīvas*), and thus they work very hard

under its influence, not knowing that they are not fulfilling their mission in life. Unfortunately, most of them think that they are the body and should therefore enjoy the material senses irresponsibly since when death comes everything will be finished. This atheistic philosophy also flourished in India, where it was sometimes propagated by Cārvāka Muni, who said:

*ṛṇaṁ kṛtvā ghr̥taṁ pibet yāvaj jīvet sukhaṁ jīvet
bhasmī-bhūtasya dehasya kutaḥ punar āgamano bhavet*

His theory was that as long as one lives one should eat as much ghee as possible. In India, ghee (clarified butter) is a basic ingredient in preparing many varieties of food. Since everyone wants to enjoy nice food, Cārvāka Muni advised that one eat as much ghee as possible. One may say, “I have no money. How shall I purchase ghee?” Cārvāka Muni, however, says, “If you have no money, then beg, borrow or steal, but in some way secure ghee and enjoy life.” For one who further objects that he will be held accountable for such unauthorized activities as begging, borrowing and stealing, Cārvāka Muni replies, “You will not be held responsible. As soon as your body is burned to ashes after death, everything is finished.”

This is called ignorance. From the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is understood that one does not die with the annihilation of his body (*na hanyate hanyamāne śarīre* [Bg. 2.20]). The annihilation of one body involves changing to another (*tathā dehāntara-prāptiḥ*). Therefore, to perform irresponsible activities in the material world is very dangerous. Without knowledge of the spirit soul and its transmigration, people are allured by the material energy to engage in many such activities, as if one could become happy simply by dint of material knowledge, without reference to spiritual existence. Therefore the entire material world and its activities are referred to as *avidyā-karma-samjñānyā*.

In order to dissipate the ignorance of the human beings who work under the material energy, which is separated from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the Lord comes down to revive their original nature of spiritual

activities (*yadā yadā hi dharmasya glānir bhavati bhārata* [Bg. 4.7]). As soon as they deviate from their original nature, the Lord comes to teach them, *sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja*: “My dear living entities, give up all material activities and simply surrender unto Me for protection.” (Bg. 18.66)

It is the statement of Cārvāka Muni that one should beg, borrow or steal money to purchase ghee and enjoy life (*ṛṇaṁ kṛtvā ghṛtaṁ pibet*). Thus even the greatest atheist of India recommends that one eat ghee, not meat. No one could conceive of human beings’ eating meat like tigers and dogs, but men have become so degraded that they are just like animals and can no longer claim to have a human civilization.

TEXT 120

hena jīva-tattva lañā likhi’ para-tattva

ācchanna karila śreṣṭha īśvara-mahattva

SYNONYMS

hena—such degraded; *jīva-tattva*—the living entities; *lañā*—taking them; *likhi’*—having written; *para-tattva*—as the Supreme; *ācchanna*—covering; *karila*—did; *śreṣṭha*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *īśvara*—the Lord’s; *mahattva*—glories.

TRANSLATION

“The Māyāvāda philosophy is so degraded that it has taken the insignificant living entities to be the Lord, the Supreme Truth, thus covering the glory and supremacy of the Absolute Truth with monism.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura comments in this connection that in all

Vedic scriptures the *jīva-tattva*, the truth of the living entities, is mentioned to be one of the energies of the Lord. If one does not accept the living entity to be a minute, infinitesimal spark of the Supreme but equates the *jīva-tattva* with the Supreme Brahman or Supreme Personality of Godhead, it must be understood that his entire philosophy is based on a misunderstanding. Unfortunately, Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya purposely claimed the *jīva-tattva*, or living entities, to be equal to the Supreme God. Therefore his entire philosophy is based on a misunderstanding, and it misguides people to become atheists, whose mission in life is unfulfilled. The mission of human life, as described in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, is to surrender unto the Supreme Lord and become His devotee, but the Māyāvāda philosophy misleads one to defy the existence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead and pose oneself as the Supreme Lord. Thus it has misguided hundreds of thousands of innocent men.

In the *Vedānta-sūtra*, Vyāsadeva has described that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is potent and that everything, material or spiritual, is but an emanation of His energy. The Lord, the Supreme Brahman, is the origin or source of everything (*janmādy asya yataḥ* [SB 1.1.1]), and all other manifestations are emanations of different energies of the Lord. This is also confirmed in the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*:

*ekadeśa-sthitasyāgner jyotsnā vistāriṇī yathā
parasya brahmaṇaḥ śaktis tathedam akhilaṁ jagat*

“Whatever we see in this world is simply an expansion of different energies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is exactly like a fire that spreads illumination for a long distance although it is situated in one place.” This is a very vivid analogy. Similarly, it is stated that just as everything in the material world exists in the sunshine, which is the energy of the sun, so everything exists on the basis of the spiritual and material energies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Thus although Kṛṣṇa is situated in His own abode (*goloka eva nivasaty akhilātma-bhūtaḥ* [Bs. 5.37]), where He enjoys His transcendental pastimes with

the cowherd boys and *gopīs*, He is nevertheless present everywhere, even within the atoms of this universe (*aṇḍāntara-stha-paramāṇu-cayāntara-stham*). This is the verdict of the Vedic literature.

Unfortunately, the Māyāvāda philosophy, misguiding people by claiming the living entity to be the Lord, has created havoc throughout the entire world and led almost everyone to godlessness. By thus covering the glories of the Supreme Lord, the Māyāvādī philosophers have done the greatest disservice to human society. It is to counteract these most abominable activities of the Māyāvādī philosophers that Lord Caitanya has introduced the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

*harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam
kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva nāsty eva gatir anyathā*
[Adi 17.21]

“In this age of quarrel and hypocrisy, the only means of deliverance is chanting the holy name of the Lord. There is no other way. There is no other way. There is no other way.” People should simply engage in the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, for thus they will gradually come to understand that they are not the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as they have been taught by the Māyāvādī philosophers, but are eternal servants of the Lord. As soon as one engages himself in the transcendental service of the Lord, he becomes free.

*mām ca yo ’vyabhicāreṇa bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guṇān samatītyaitān brahma-bhūyāya kalpate*

“One who engages in full devotional service, unfailing in all circumstances, at once transcends the modes of material nature and thus comes to the level of Brahman.” (Bg. 14.26) Therefore the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement, or Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, is the only light for the foolish living entities who think either that there is no God or that if God exists He is formless and they themselves are also God. These misconceptions are very dangerous, and the only way to counteract them

is to spread the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement.

TEXT 121

vyāsera sūtrete kahe ‘pariṇāma’-vāda

‘vyāsa bhrānta’——bali’ tāra uṭhāila vivāda

SYNONYMS

vyāsera—of Śrīla Vyāsadeva; *sūtrete*—in the aphorisms; *kahe*—describes; *pariṇāma*—transformation; *vāda*—philosophy; *vyāsa*—Śrīla Vyāsadeva; *bhrānta*—mistaken; *bali’*—accusing him; *tāra*—his; *uṭhāila*—raised; *vivāda*—opposition.

TRANSLATION

“In his Vedānta-sūtra Śrīla Vyāsadeva has described that everything is but a transformation of the energy of the Lord. Śaṅkarācārya, however, has misled the world by commenting that Vyāsadeva was mistaken. Thus he has raised great opposition to theism throughout the entire world.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura explains, “In the *Vedānta-sūtra* of Śrīla Vyāsadeva it is definitely stated that all cosmic manifestations result from transformations of various energies of the Lord. Śaṅkarācārya, however, not accepting the energy of the Lord, thinks that it is the Lord who is transformed. He has taken many clear statements from the Vedic literature and twisted them to try to prove that if the Lord, or the Absolute Truth, were transformed, His oneness would be disturbed. Thus he has accused Śrīla Vyāsadeva of being mistaken. In developing his philosophy of monism, therefore, he has established *vivarta-vāda*, or the Māyāvāda theory of illusion.”

In the *Brahma-sūtra*, Second Chapter, the first aphorism is as follows: *tad-ananyatvam ārambhaṇa-śabdādibhyaḥ*. Commenting on this *sūtra* in his *Śārīraka-bhāṣya*, Śaṅkarācārya has introduced the statement *vācārambhaṇam vikāro nāmadheyam* from the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* (6.1.4) to try to prove that acceptance of the transformation of the energy of the Supreme Lord is faulty. He has tried to defy this transformation of energy in a misguided way, which will be explained later. Since his conception of God is impersonal, he does not believe that the entire cosmic manifestation is a transformation of the energies of the Lord, for as soon as one accepts the various energies of the Absolute Truth, one must immediately accept the Absolute Truth to be personal, not impersonal. A person can create many things by the transformation of his energy. For example, a businessman transforms his energy by establishing many big factories or business organizations, yet he remains a person although his energy has been transformed into these many factories or business concerns. The Māyāvādī philosophers do not understand this simple fact. Their tiny brains and poor fund of knowledge cannot afford them sufficient enlightenment to realize that when a man's energy is transformed, the man himself is not transformed but remains the same person.

Not believing in the fact that the energy of the Absolute Truth is transformed, Śaṅkarācārya has propounded his theory of illusion. This theory states that although the Absolute Truth is never transformed, we think that it is transformed, which is an illusion. Śaṅkarācārya does not believe in the transformation of the energy of the Absolute Truth, for he claims that everything is one and that the living entity is therefore also one with the Supreme. This is the Māyāvāda theory.

Śrīla Vyāsadeva has explained that the Absolute Truth is a person who has different potencies. Merely by His desire that there be creation and by His glance (*sa aikṣata*), He created this material world (*sa asṛjata*). After creation, He remains the same person: He is not transformed into everything. One should accept that the Lord has inconceivable energies and that it is by His order and will that varieties of manifestations have

come into existence. In the Vedic literature it is said, *sa-tattvato 'nyathā-buddhir vikāra ity udāhṛtaḥ*. This *mantra* indicates that from one fact another fact is generated. For example, a father is one fact, and a son generated from the father is a second fact. Thus both of them are truths, although one is generated from the other. This generation of a second, independent truth from a first truth is called *vikāra*, or transformation resulting in a by-product. The Supreme Brahman is the Absolute Truth, and the energies that have emanated from Him and are existing separately, such as the living entities and the cosmic manifestation, are also truths. This is an example of transformation, which is called *vikāra* or *pariṇāma*. To give another example of *vikāra*, milk is a truth, but the same milk may be transformed into yogurt. Thus yogurt is a transformation of milk, although the ingredients of yogurt and milk are the same.

In the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* there is the following *mantra*: *aitad-ātmyam idaṁ sarvam*. This *mantra* indicates without a doubt that the entire world is Brahman. The Absolute Truth has inconceivable energies, as confirmed in the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* (*parāśya śaktir vividhaiva śrūyate*), and the entire cosmic manifestation is evidence of these different energies of the Supreme Lord. The Supreme Lord is a fact, and therefore whatever is created by the Supreme Lord is also factual. Everything is true and complete (*pūrṇam*), but the original *pūrṇam*, the complete Absolute Truth, always remains the same. *Pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate pūrṇasya pūrṇam ādāya*. The Absolute Truth is so perfect that although innumerable energies emanate from Him and manifest creations which appear to be different from Him, He nevertheless maintains His personality. He never deteriorates under any circumstances.

It is to be concluded that the entire cosmic manifestation is a transformation of the energy of the Supreme Lord, not of the Supreme Lord or Absolute Truth Himself, who always remains the same. The material world and the living entities are transformations of the energy of the Lord, the Absolute Truth or Brahman, who is the original source. In other words, the Absolute Truth, Brahman, is the original ingredient,

and the other manifestations are transformations of this ingredient. This is also confirmed in the *Taittirīya Upaniṣad* (3.1): *yato vā imāni bhūtāni jāyante*. “This entire cosmic manifestation is made possible by the Absolute Truth, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.” In this verse it is indicated that Brahman, the Absolute Truth, is the original cause and that the living entities (*jīvas*) and the cosmic manifestation are effects of this cause. The cause being a fact, the effects are also factual. They are not illusion. Śaṅkarācārya has inconsistently tried to prove that it is an illusion to accept the material world and the *jīvas* as by-products of the Supreme Lord because (in his conception) the existence of the material world and the *jīvas* is different and separate from that of the Absolute Truth. With this jugglery of understanding, Māyāvādī philosophers have propagated the slogan *brahma satyaṁ jagan mithyā*, which declares that the Absolute Truth is fact but the cosmic manifestation and the living entities are simply illusions, or that all of them are in fact the Absolute Truth and that the material world and living entities do not separately exist.

It is therefore to be concluded that Śaṅkarācārya, in order to present the Supreme Lord, the living entities and the material nature as indivisible and ignorant, tries to cover the glories of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He maintains that the material cosmic manifestation is *mithyā*, or false, but this is a great blunder. If the Supreme Personality of Godhead is a fact, how can His creation be false? Even in ordinary dealings, one cannot think the material cosmic manifestation to be false. Therefore Vaiṣṇava philosophers say that the cosmic creation is not false but temporary. It is separated from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but since it is wonderfully created by the energy of the Lord, to say that it is false is blasphemous.

Nondevotees factually appreciate the wonderful creation of material nature, but they cannot appreciate the intelligence and energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is behind this material creation. Śrīpāda Rāmānujācārya, however, refers to a *sūtra* from the *Aitareya Upaniṣad* (1.1.1), *ātmā vā idam agra āsīt*, which points out that the

supreme *ātmā*, the Absolute Truth, existed before the creation. One may argue, “If the Supreme Personality of Godhead is completely spiritual, how is it possible for Him to be the origin of creation and have within Himself both material and spiritual energies?” To answer this challenge, Śrīpāda Rāmānujācārya quotes a *mantra* from the *Taittirīya Upaniṣad* (3.1) that states:

*yato vā imāni bhūtāni jāyante yena jātāni jīvanti yat prayanty
abhisamviśanti*

This *mantra* confirms that the entire cosmic manifestation emanates from the Absolute Truth, rests upon the Absolute Truth and after annihilation again reenters the body of the Absolute Truth, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The living entity is originally spiritual, and when he enters the spiritual world or the body of the Supreme Lord, he still retains his identity as an individual soul. In this connection Śrīpāda Rāmānujācārya gives the analogy that when a green bird enters a green tree it does not become one with the tree: it retains its identity as a bird, although it appears to merge with the greenness of the tree. To give another analogy, an animal that enters a forest keeps its individuality, although apparently the beast merges with the forest. Similarly, in material existence, both the material energy and the living entities of the marginal potency maintain their individuality. Thus although the energies of the Supreme Personality of Godhead interact within the cosmic manifestation, each keeps its separate individual existence. Merging with the material or spiritual energies, therefore, does not involve loss of individuality. According to Śrī Rāmānujapāda’s theory of Viśiṣṭādvaita, although all the energies of the Lord are one, each keeps its individuality (*vaiśiṣṭya*).

Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya has tried to mislead the readers of the *Vedānta-sūtra* by misinterpreting the words *ānanda-mayo ’bhyāsāt*, and he has even tried to find fault with Vyāsadeva. All the aphorisms of the *Vedānta-sūtra* need not be examined here, however, since we intend to present the *Vedānta-sūtra* in a separate volume.

TEXT 122

pariṇāma-vāde īśvara hayena vikārī

eta kahi' 'vivarta'-vāda sthāpanā ye kari

SYNONYMS

pariṇāma-vāde—by accepting the theory of transformation of energy; *īśvara*—the Supreme Lord; *hayena*—becomes; *vikārī*—transformed; *eta kahi'*—saying this; *vivarta*—illusion; *vāda*—theory; *sthāpanā*—establishing; *ye*—what; *kari*—do.

TRANSLATION

“According to Śaṅkarācārya, by accepting the theory of the transformation of the energy of the Lord, one creates an illusion by indirectly accepting that the Absolute Truth is transformed.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura comments that if one does not clearly understand the meaning of *pariṇāma-vāda*, or transformation of energy, one is sure to misunderstand the truth regarding this material cosmic manifestation and the living entities. In the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* (6.8.4) it is said, *san-mūlāḥ saumyemāḥ prajāḥ sad-āyatanāḥ sat-pratiṣṭhāḥ*. The material world and the living entities are separate beings, and they are eternally true, not false. Śaṅkarācārya, however, unnecessarily fearing that by *pariṇāma-vāda* (transformation of energy) Brahman would be transformed (*vikārī*), has imagined both the material world and the living entities to be false and to have no individuality. By word jugglery he has tried to prove that the individual identities of the living entities and the material world are illusory, and he has cited the examples of mistaking a rope for a snake or an oyster shell for gold. Thus he has most abominably cheated people in general.

The analogy of misunderstanding a rope to be a snake is mentioned in the *Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad*, but it is meant to explain the error of identifying the body with the soul. Since the soul is actually a spiritual particle, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (*mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke*), it is due to illusion (*vivarta-vāda*) that a human being, like an animal, identifies the body with the self. This is a proper example of *vivarta*, or illusion. The verse *atattvato 'nyathā-buddhir vivarta ity udāhṛtaḥ* describes such an illusion. To not know actual facts and thus to mistake one thing for another (as, for example, to accept the body as oneself) is called *vivarta-vāda*. Every conditioned living entity who considers the body to be the soul is deluded by this *vivarta-vāda*. One can be attacked by this *vivarta-vāda* philosophy when he forgets the inconceivable power of the omnipotent Personality of Godhead.

How the Supreme Personality of Godhead remains as He is, never changing, is explained in the *Īśopaniṣad*: *pūrṇasya pūrṇam ādāya pūrṇam evāvaśiṣyate*. God is complete. Even if a complete manifestation is taken away from Him, He continues to be complete. The material creation is manifested by the energy of the Lord, but He is still the same person. His form, entourage, qualities and so on never deteriorate. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, in his *Paramātmā-sandarbhā*, comments regarding the *vivarta-vāda* as follows: “Under the spell of *vivarta-vāda* one imagines the separate entities, namely the cosmic manifestation and the living entities, to be one with Brahman. This is due to complete ignorance regarding the actual fact. The Absolute Truth, or Parabrahman, is always one and always the same. He is completely free from all other conceptions of existence. He is completely free from false ego, for He is the full spiritual identity. It is absolutely impossible for Him to be subjected to ignorance and fall under the spell of a misconception (*vivarta-vāda*). The Absolute Truth is beyond our conception. One must admit that He has unblemished qualities that He does not share with every living entity. He is never tainted in the slightest degree by the flaws of ordinary living beings. Everyone must therefore understand the Absolute Truth to possess inconceivable potencies.”

TEXT 123

vastutaḥ pariṇāma-vāda—sei se pramāṇa

dehe ātma-buddhi—ei vivartera sthāna

SYNONYMS

vastutaḥ—factually; *pariṇāma-vāda*—transformation of the energy; *sei*—that; *se*—only; *pramāṇa*—proof; *dehe*—in the body; *ātma-buddhi*—concept of self; *ei*—this; *vivartera*—of illusion; *sthāna*—place.

TRANSLATION

“Transformation of energy is a proven fact. It is the false bodily conception of the self that is an illusion.

PURPORT

The *jīva*, or living entity, is a spiritual spark who is part of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Unfortunately, he thinks the body to be the self, and that misunderstanding is called *vivarta*, or acceptance of untruth to be truth. The body is not the self, but animals and foolish people think that it is. *Vivarta* (illusion) does not, however, denote a change in the identity of the spirit soul; it is the misconception that the body is the self that is an illusion. Similarly, the Supreme Personality of Godhead does not change when His external energy, consisting of the eight gross and subtle material elements listed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (*bhūmir āpo ’nalo vāyuh*, etc.), acts and reacts in different phases.

TEXT 124

avicintya-śakti-yukta śrī-bhagavān

icchāya jagad-rūpe pāya pariṇāma

SYNONYMS

avicintya—inconceivable; *śakti*—potency; *yukta*—possessed of; *śrī*—the affluent; *bhagavān*—Personality of Godhead; *icchāya*—by His wish; *jagat-rūpe*—in the form of the cosmic manifestation; *pāya*—becomes; *pariṇāma*—transformed by His energy.

TRANSLATION

“The Supreme Personality of Godhead is opulent in all respects. Therefore by His inconceivable energies He has transformed the material cosmic manifestation.

TEXT 125

tathāpi acintya-śaktye haya avikārī

prākṛta cintāmaṇi tāhe dṛṣṭānta ye dhari

SYNONYMS

tathāpi—yet; *acintya-śaktye*—by inconceivable potency; *haya*—remains; *avikārī*—without change; *prākṛta*—material; *cintāmaṇi*—touchstone; *tāhe*—in that respect; *dṛṣṭānta*—example; *ye*—which; *dhari*—we accept.

TRANSLATION

“Using the example of a touchstone, which by its energy turns iron to gold and yet remains the same, we can understand that although the Supreme Personality of Godhead transforms His innumerable energies, He remains unchanged.

TEXT 126

nānā ratna-rāśi haya cintāmaṇi haite

tathāpiha maṇi rahe svarūpe avikṛte

SYNONYMS

nānā—varieties; *ratna-rāśi*—valuable jewels; *haya*—become possible; *cintāmaṇi*—the touchstone; *haite*—from; *tathāpiha*—still, certainly; *maṇi*—the touchstone; *rahe*—remains; *svarūpe*—in its original form; *avikṛte*—without change.

TRANSLATION

“Although a touchstone produces many varieties of valuable jewels, it nevertheless remains the same. It does not change its original form.

TEXT 127

prākṛta-vastute yadi acintya-śakti haya

īśvarera acintya-śakti,——ithe ki vismaya

SYNONYMS

prākṛta-vastute—in material things; *yadi*—if; *acintya*—inconceivable; *śakti*—potency; *haya*—becomes possible; *īśvarera*—of the Supreme Lord; *acintya*—inconceivable; *śakti*—potency; *ithe*—in this; *ki*—what; *vismaya*—wonderful.

TRANSLATION

“If there is such inconceivable potency in material objects, why should we not believe in the inconceivable potency of the Supreme Personality of Godhead?

PURPORT

The argument of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu described in this verse can be very easily understood even by a common man if he simply thinks of the activities of the sun, which has been giving off unlimited amounts of heat and light since time immemorial and yet has not even slightly decreased in power. Modern science believes that it is by sunshine that the entire cosmic manifestation is maintained, and actually one can see how the actions and reactions of sunshine maintain order throughout the universe. The growth of vegetables and even the rotation of the planets take place due to the heat and light of the sun. Sometimes, therefore, modern scientists consider the sun to be the original cause of creation, not knowing that the sun is only a medium, for it is also created by the supreme energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Aside from the sun and the touchstone, there are many other material things that transform their energy in different ways and yet remain as they are. It is not necessary, therefore, for the original cause, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, to change due to the changes or transformations of His different energies.

The falsity of Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya's explanation of *vivarta-vāda* and *pariṇāma-vāda* has been detected by the Vaiṣṇava *ācāryas*, especially Jīva Gosvāmī, whose opinion is that actually Śaṅkara did not understand the *Vedānta-sūtra*. In Śaṅkara's explanation of one *sūtra*, *ānanda-mayo 'bhyāsāt*, he has interpreted the affix *mayat* with such word jugglery that this very explanation proves that he had little knowledge of the *Vedānta-sūtra* but simply wanted to support his impersonalism through the aphorisms of the Vedānta philosophy. Actually, however, he failed to do so because he could not put forward strong arguments. In this connection, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī cites the phrase *brahma pucchaṁ pratiṣṭhā* (*Taittirīya Up. 2.5*), which gives Vedic evidence that Brahman is the origin of everything. In explaining this verse, Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya interpreted various Sanskrit words in such a way that he implied, according to Jīva Gosvāmī, that Vyāsadeva had very little knowledge of higher logic. Such unscrupulous deviation from the real meaning of the *Vedānta-sūtra* has created a class of men who by word jugglery try to derive various indirect meanings from the Vedic literatures, especially the *Bhagavad-gītā*. One of

them has even explained that the word *kurukṣetra* refers to the body. Such interpretations imply, however, that neither Lord Kṛṣṇa nor Vyāsadeva had a proper sense of word usage or etymological adjustment. They lead one to assume that since Lord Kṛṣṇa could not personally sense the meaning of what He was speaking and Vyāsadeva did not know the meaning of what he was writing, Lord Kṛṣṇa left His book to be explained later by the Māyāvādīs. Such interpretations merely prove, however, that their proponents have very little philosophical sense.

Instead of wasting one's time falsely deriving such indirect meanings from the *Vedānta-sūtra* and other Vedic literatures, one should accept the words of these books as they are. In presenting *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is*, therefore, we have not changed the meaning of the original words. Similarly, if one studies the *Vedānta-sūtra* as it is, without whimsical and capricious adulteration, one can understand the *Vedānta-sūtra* very easily. Śrīla Vyāsadeva therefore explains the *Vedānta-sūtra*, beginning from the first *sūtra*, *janmādy asya yataḥ* [SB 1.1.1], in his *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.1.1):

janmādy asya yato 'nvayād itarataś cārtheṣv abhijñāḥ sva-rāṭ [SB 1.1.1].

“I meditate upon Him [Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa], the transcendent reality, who is the primeval cause of all causes, from whom all manifested universes arise, in whom they dwell, and by whom they are destroyed. I meditate upon that eternally effulgent Lord, who is directly and indirectly conscious of all manifestations and yet is fully independent.” The Supreme Personality of Godhead knows very well how to do everything perfectly. He is *abhijñā*, always fully conscious. The Lord therefore says in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.26) that He knows everything, past, present and future, but that no one but a devotee knows Him as He is. Therefore, the Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, is at least partially understood by devotees of the Lord, but the Māyāvādī philosophers, who unnecessarily speculate to understand the Absolute Truth, simply waste their time.

TEXT 128

‘praṇava’ se mahāvākya—vedera nidāna

īśvara-svarūpa praṇava sarva-viśva-dhāma

SYNONYMS

praṇava—the *omkāra*; *se*—that; *mahā-vākya*—transcendental sound vibration; *vedera*—of the *Vedas*; *nidāna*—basic principle; *īśvara-svarūpa*—direct representation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *praṇava*—*omkāra*; *sarva-viśva*—of all universes; *dhāma*—is the reservoir.

TRANSLATION

“The Vedic sound vibration *omkāra*, the principal word in the Vedic literatures, is the basis of all Vedic vibrations. Therefore one should accept *omkāra* as the sound representation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead and the reservoir of the cosmic manifestation.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (8.13) the glories of *omkāra* are described as follows:

*om ity ekākṣaram brahma vyāharan mām anusmaran
yaḥ prayāti tyajan deham sa yāti paramām gatim*

This verse indicates that *omkāra*, or *praṇava*, is a direct representation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore if at the time of death one simply remembers *omkāra*, he remembers the Supreme Personality of Godhead and is therefore immediately transferred to the spiritual world. *Omkāra* is the basic principle of all Vedic *mantras*, for it is a representation of Lord Kṛṣṇa, understanding of whom is the ultimate goal of the *Vedas*, as stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (*vedaiś ca sarvair aham eva*

vedyaḥ [Bg. 15.15]). Māyāvādī philosophers cannot understand these simple facts explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, and yet they are very proud of being Vedāntīs. Sometimes, therefore, we refer to the Vedāntī philosophers as Vidantīs, those who have no teeth (*vi* means “without,” and *dantī* means “possessing teeth”). The statements of the Śāṅkara philosophy, which are the teeth of the Māyāvādī philosopher, are always broken by the strong arguments of Vaiṣṇava philosophers such as the great *ācāryas*, especially Rāmānujācārya. Śrīpāda Rāmānujācārya and Madhvācārya break the teeth of the Māyāvādī philosophers, who can therefore be called Vidantīs, “toothless.”

As mentioned above, the transcendental vibration *omkāra* is explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter Eight, verse thirteen:

*om ity ekākṣaram brahma vyāharan mām anusmaran
yaḥ prayāti tyajan deham sa yāti paramām gatim*

“After being situated in this *yoga* practice and vibrating the sacred syllable *om*, the supreme combination of letters, if one thinks of the Supreme Personality of Godhead and quits his body, he will certainly reach the spiritual planets.” If one actually understands that *omkāra* is the sound representation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, whether he chants *omkāra* or the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, the result is certainly the same.

The transcendental vibration of *omkāra* is further explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter Nine, verse seventeen:

*pitāham asya jagato mātā dhātā pitāmahaḥ
vedyaṁ pavitram omkāra ṛk sāma yajur eva ca*

“I am the father of this universe, the mother, the support and the grandsire. I am the object of knowledge, the purifier and the syllable *om*. I am also the *Ṛg*, the *Sāma* and the *Yajur Vedas*.”

Similarly, the transcendental sound *om̐* is further explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, Chapter Seventeen, verse twenty-three:

*om̐ tat sad iti nirdeśo brahmaṇas tri-vidhaḥ smṛtaḥ
brāhmaṇās tena vedās ca yajñās ca vihitāḥ purā*

“From the beginning of creation, the three syllables *om̐ tat sat* have been used to indicate the Supreme Absolute Truth [Brahman]. They were uttered by *brāhmaṇas* while chanting Vedic hymns and during sacrifices for the satisfaction of the Supreme.”

Throughout all the Vedic literatures the glories of *om̐kāra* are specifically mentioned. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, in his thesis *Bhagavat-sandarbhā*, says that in the Vedic literature *om̐kāra* is considered to be the sound vibration of the holy name of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Only this vibration of transcendental sound can deliver a conditioned soul from the clutches of *māyā*. Sometimes *om̐kāra* is also called the deliverer (*tāra*). *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* begins with the *om̐kāra* vibration: *om̐ namo bhagavate vāsudevāya*. Therefore *om̐kāra* has been described by the great commentator Śrīdhara Svāmī as *tārāṅkura*, the seed of deliverance from the material world. Since the Supreme Godhead is absolute, His holy name and His sound vibration *om̐kāra* are as good as He Himself. Caitanya Mahāprabhu says that the holy name, or *om̐kāra*, the transcendental representation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, has all the potencies of the Personality of Godhead.

*nāmnām akāri bahudhā nija-sarva-śaktis
tatrārpitā niyamitaḥ smaraṇe na kālaḥ*

All potencies are invested in the holy vibration of the holy name of the Lord. There is no doubt that the holy name of the Lord, or *om̐kāra*, is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself. In other words, anyone who chants *om̐kāra* and the holy name of the Lord, Hare Kṛṣṇa, immediately meets the Supreme Lord directly in His sound form. In the *Nārada-pañcarātra* it is clearly said that the Supreme Personality of Godhead

Nārāyaṇa personally appears before the chanter who engages in chanting the *aṣṭākṣara*, or eight-syllable *mantra*, *om namo nārāyaṇāya*. A similar statement in the *Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad* declares that whatever one sees in the spiritual world is all an expansion of the spiritual potency of *omkāra*.

On the basis of all the *Upaniṣads*, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī says that *omkāra* is the Supreme Absolute Truth and is accepted as such by all the *ācāryas* and authorities. *Omkāra* is beginningless, changeless, supreme and free from deterioration and external contamination. *Omkāra* is the origin, middle and end of everything, and any living entity who thus understands *omkāra* attains the perfection of spiritual identity in *omkāra*. *Omkāra*, being situated in everyone's heart, is *īśvara*, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (18.61): *īśvaraḥ sarva-bhūtānāṃ hṛd-deśe 'rjuna tiṣṭhati*. *Omkāra* is as good as Viṣṇu because *omkāra* is as all-pervasive as Viṣṇu. One who knows *omkāra* and Lord Viṣṇu to be identical no longer has to lament or hanker. One who chants *omkāra* no longer remains a *sūdra* but immediately comes to the position of a *brāhmaṇa*. Simply by chanting *omkāra* one can understand the whole creation to be one unit, or an expansion of the energy of the Supreme Lord: *idaṁ hi viśvaṁ bhagavān ivetaro yato jagat-sthāna-nirodha-sambhavāḥ*. “The Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is Himself this cosmos, and still He is aloof from it. From Him only this cosmic manifestation has emanated, in Him it rests, and unto Him it enters after annihilation.” (*Bhāg.* 1.5.20) Although one who does not understand concludes otherwise, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* states that the entire cosmic manifestation is but an expansion of the energy of the Supreme Lord. Realization of this is possible simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord, *omkāra*.

One should not, however, foolishly conclude that because the Supreme Personality of Godhead is omnipotent, we have manufactured a combination of letters—*a*, *u* and *m*—to represent Him. Factually the transcendental sound *omkāra*, although a combination of the three letters *a*, *u* and *m*, has transcendental potency, and one who chants *omkāra* will very soon realize *omkāra* and Lord Viṣṇu to be nondifferent. Kṛṣṇa

declares, *praṇavaḥ sarva-vedeṣu*: “I am the syllable *om* in the Vedic *mantras*.” (Bg. 7.8) One should therefore conclude that among the many incarnations of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, *omkāra* is the sound incarnation. All the *Vedas* accept this thesis. One should always remember that the holy name of the Lord and the Lord Himself are always identical (*abhinnatvān nāma-nāminoḥ*). Since *omkāra* is the basic principle of all Vedic knowledge, it is uttered before one begins to chant any Vedic hymn. Without *omkāra*, no Vedic *mantra* is successful. The Gosvāmīs therefore declare that *praṇava* (*omkāra*) is the complete representation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and they have analyzed *omkāra* in terms of its alphabetical constituents as follows:

a-kāreṇocyate kṛṣṇaḥ sarva-lokaika-nāyakaḥ
u-kāreṇocyate rādhā ma-kāro jīva-vācakaḥ

Omkāra is a combination of the letters *a*, *u* and *m*. *A-kāreṇocyate kṛṣṇaḥ*: the letter *a* (*a-kāra*) refers to Kṛṣṇa, who is *sarva-lokaika-nāyakaḥ*, the master of all living entities and planets, material and spiritual. *Nāyaka* means “leader.” He is the supreme leader (*nityo nityānām cetanaś cetanānām*). The letter *u* (*u-kāra*) indicates Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, the pleasure potency of Kṛṣṇa, and *m* (*ma-kāra*) indicates the living entities (*jīvas*). Thus *om* is the complete combination of Kṛṣṇa, His potency and His eternal servitors. In other words, *omkāra* represents Kṛṣṇa, His name, fame, pastimes, entourage, expansions, devotees, potencies and everything else pertaining to Him. As Caitanya Mahāprabhu states in the present verse of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, *sarva-viśva-dhāma*: *omkāra* is the resting place of everything, just as Kṛṣṇa is the resting place of everything (*brahmaṇo hi pratiṣṭhāham*).

The Māyāvādī philosophers consider many Vedic *mantras* to be the *mahā-vākya*, or principal Vedic *mantra*, such as *tat tvam asi* (*Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 6.8.7), *idaṁ sarvaṁ yad ayam ātmā* and *brahmedaṁ sarvaṁ* (*Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 2.5.1), *ātmaivedaṁ sarvaṁ* (*Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 7.25.2) and *neha nānāsti kiñcana* (*Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 2.1.11). That is a great mistake. Only *omkāra* is the *mahā-vākya*. All these other

mantras that the Māyāvādīs accept as the *mahā-vākya* are only incidental. They cannot be taken as the *mahā-vākya*, or *mahā-mantra*. The *mantra tat tvam asi* indicates only a partial understanding of the *Vedas*, unlike *om̐kāra*, which represents the full understanding of the *Vedas*. Therefore the transcendental sound that includes all Vedic knowledge is *om̐kāra* (*praṇava*).

Aside from *om̐kāra*, none of the words uttered by the followers of Śaṅkarācārya can be considered the *mahā-vākya*. They are merely passing remarks. Śaṅkarācārya, however, has never stressed chanting of the *mahā-vākya om̐kāra*; he has accepted only *tat tvam asi* as the *mahā-vākya*. Imagining the living entity to be God, he has misrepresented all the *mantras* of the *Vedānta-sūtra* with the motive of proving that there is no separate existence of the living entities and the Supreme Absolute Truth. This is similar to the politician's attempt to prove nonviolence from the *Bhagavad-gītā*. Kṛṣṇa is violent to demons, and to attempt to prove that Kṛṣṇa is not violent is ultimately to deny Kṛṣṇa. As such explanations of the *Bhagavad-gītā* are absurd, so also is Śaṅkarācārya's explanation of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, and no sane and reasonable man will accept it. At present, however, the *Vedānta-sūtra* is misrepresented not only by the so-called Vedāntīs but also by other unscrupulous persons who are so degraded that they even recommend that *sannyāsīs* eat meat, fish and eggs. In this way, the so-called followers of Śaṅkara, the impersonalist Māyāvādīs, are sinking lower and lower. How can these degraded men explain the *Vedānta-sūtra*, which is the essence of all Vedic literature?

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu has declared, *māyāvādi-bhāṣya śunile haya sarva-nāśa*: "Anyone who hears commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra* from the Māyāvāda school is completely doomed." As explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.15), *vedaiś ca sarvair aham eva vedyah*: all Vedic literature aims at understanding Kṛṣṇa. Māyāvāda philosophy, however, has deviated everyone from Kṛṣṇa. Therefore there is a great need for the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement all over the world to save the world from degradation. Every intelligent and sane man must abandon the philosophical explanation of the Māyāvādīs and accept the explanation of

Vaiṣṇava ācāryas. One should read *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is* to try to understand the real purpose of the *Vedas*.

TEXT 129

sarvāśraya īśvarera praṇava uddeśa

‘tat tvam asi’—vākya haya vedera ekadeśa

SYNONYMS

sarva-āśraya—the reservoir of everything; *īśvarera*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *praṇava*—*omkāra*; *uddeśa*—purpose; *tat tvam asi*—the Vedic *mantra tat tvam asi* (“you are the same”); *vākya*—statement; *haya*—becomes; *vedera*—of the Vedic literature; *eka-deśa*—partial understanding.

TRANSLATION

“It is the purpose of the Supreme Personality of Godhead to present praṇava [omkāra] as the reservoir of all Vedic knowledge. The words ‘tat tvam asi’ are only a partial explanation of the Vedic knowledge.

PURPORT

Tat tvam asi means “you are the same spiritual identity.”

TEXT 130

‘praṇava, mahā-vākya—tāhā kari’ ācchādana

mahāvākye kari ‘tat tvam asi’ra sthāpana

SYNONYMS

praṇava—oṃkāra; mahā-vākya—principal mantra; tāhā—that; kari’—making; ācchādana—covered; mahā-vākya—in place of the principal mantra; kari—I do; ‘tat tvam asi’ra sthāpana—establishment of the statement tat tvam asi.

TRANSLATION

“Praṇava [oṃkāra] is the mahā-vākya [mahā-mantra] in the Vedas. Śaṅkarācārya’s followers cover this to stress without authority the mantra tat tvam asi.

PURPORT

The Māyāvādī philosophers stress the statements *tat tvam asi, so ’ham*, etc., but they do not stress the real *mahā-mantra, praṇava (oṃkāra)*. Therefore, because they misrepresent Vedic knowledge, they are the greatest offenders to the lotus feet of the Lord. Caitanya Mahāprabhu says clearly, *māyāvādī kṛṣṇe aparādhī*: “Māyāvādī philosophers are the greatest offenders to Lord Kṛṣṇa.” Lord Kṛṣṇa declares:

*tān ahaṁ dviṣataḥ krūrān saṁsāreṣu narādhamān
kṣipāmy ajasram aśubhān āsurīṣv eva yoniṣu*

“Those who are envious and mischievous, who are the lowest among mankind, I perpetually cast into the ocean of material existence, into various demoniac species of life.” (Bg. 16.19) Life in demoniac species awaits the Māyāvādī philosophers after death because they are envious of Kṛṣṇa. When Kṛṣṇa says in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.34) *man-manā bhava mad-bhakto mad-yājī māṁ namaskuru* (“Engage your mind always in thinking of Me, become My devotee, offer obeisances to Me and worship Me”), one demoniac scholar says that it is not Kṛṣṇa to whom one must surrender. This scholar is already suffering in this life, and he will have to suffer again in the next if in this life he does not complete his prescribed suffering. One should be very careful not to be envious of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. In the next verse, therefore, Śrī

Caitanya Mahāprabhu clearly states the purpose of the *Vedas*.

TEXT 131

sarva-veda-sūtre kare kṛṣṇera abhidhāna

mukhya-vṛtti chāḍi' kaila lakṣaṇā-vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

sarva-veda-sūtre—in all the aphorisms of the *Vedānta-sūtra*; *kare*—establishes; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *abhidhāna*—explanation; *mukhya-vṛtti*—direct interpretation; *chāḍi'*—giving up; *kaila*—made; *lakṣaṇā*—indirect; *vyākhyāna*—explanation.

TRANSLATION

“In all the Vedic sūtras and literatures, it is Lord Kṛṣṇa who is to be understood, but the followers of Śaṅkarācārya have covered the real meaning of the Vedas with indirect explanations.

PURPORT

It is said:

vede rāmāyaṇe caiva purāṇe bhārata tathā

ādāv ante ca madhye ca hariḥ sarvatra gīyate

“In the Vedic literature, including the *Rāmāyaṇa*, *Purāṇas* and *Mahābhārata*, from the very beginning (*ādau*) to the end (*ante ca*), as well as within the middle (*madhye ca*), only Hari, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is explained.”

TEXT 132

svataḥ-pramāṇa veda—pramāṇa-sīromaṇi

lakṣaṇā karile svataḥ-pramāṇatā-hāni

SYNONYMS

svataḥ-pramāṇa—self-evident; *veda*—the Vedic literatures; *pramāṇa*—evidence; *sīromaṇi*—topmost; *lakṣaṇā*—interpretation; *karile*—doing; *svataḥ-pramāṇatā*—self-evidence; *hāni*—lost.

TRANSLATION

“The self-evident Vedic literatures are the highest evidence of all, but if these literatures are interpreted, their self-evident nature is lost.

PURPORT

We quote Vedic evidence to support our statements, but if we interpret it according to our own judgment, the authority of the Vedic literature is rendered imperfect or useless. In other words, by interpreting the Vedic version one minimizes the value of Vedic evidence. When one quotes from Vedic literature, it is understood that the quotations are authoritative. How can one bring the authority under his own control? That is a case of *princiipiis obsta*.

TEXT 133

ei mata pratisūtre saḥajārtha chāḍiyā

gauṇārtha vyākhyā kare kalpanā kariyā

SYNONYMS

ei mata—like this; *prati-sūtre*—in every *sūtra*, or aphorism, of the *Vedānta-sūtra*; *saḥaja-artha*—the clear, simple meaning; *chāḍiyā*—giving

up; *gauṇa-artha*—indirect meaning; *vyākhyā*—explanation; *kare*—he makes; *kalpanā kariyā*—by imagination.

TRANSLATION

“To prove their philosophy, the members of the Māyāvāda school have given up the real, easily understood meaning of the Vedic literature and introduced indirect meanings based on their imaginative powers.”

PURPORT

Unfortunately, the Śāṅkarite interpretation has covered almost the entire world. Therefore there is a great need to present the original, easily understood natural import of the Vedic literature. We have therefore begun by presenting *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is*, and we propose to present all the Vedic literature in terms of the direct meaning of its words.

TEXT 134

ei mate pratisūtre karena dūṣaṇa

śuni' camatkāra haila sannyāsira gaṇa

SYNONYMS

ei mate—in this way; *prati-sūtre*—in each and every aphorism; *karena*—shows; *dūṣaṇa*—defects; *śuniyā*—hearing; *camatkāra*—struck with wonder; *haila*—they became; *sannyāsira*—of all the Māyāvādīs; *gaṇa*—the group.

TRANSLATION

When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu thus showed for each and every sūtra the defects in Śāṅkarācārya's explanations, all the assembled Māyāvādī sannyāsīs were struck with wonder.

TEXT 135

sakala sannyāsī kahe, — — ‘śunaha śrīpāda

tumi ye khaṇḍile artha, e nahe vivāda

SYNONYMS

sakala—all; *sannyāsī*—the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *kahe*—say; *śunaha*—please hear; *śrīpāda*—Your Holiness; *tumi*—You; *ye*—that; *khaṇḍile*—refuted; *artha*—meaning; *e*—this; *nahe*—not; *vivāda*—quarrel.

TRANSLATION

All the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs said, “Your Holiness, kindly know from us that we actually have no quarrel with Your refutation of these meanings, for You have given a clear understanding of the sūtras.

TEXT 136

ācārya-kalpita artha, — — ihā sabhe jāni

sampradāya-anurodhe tabu tāhā māni

SYNONYMS

ācārya—Śaṅkarācārya; *kalpita*—imaginative; *artha*—meaning; *ihā*—this; *sabhe*—all of us; *jāni*—know; *sampradāya-anurodhe*—but for the sake of our party; *tabu*—still; *tāhā*—that; *māni*—we accept.

TRANSLATION

“We know that all this word jugglery springs from the imagination of Śaṅkarācārya, and yet because we belong to his sect, we accept it although it does not satisfy us.

TEXT 137

mukhyārtha vyākhyā kara, dekhi tomāra bala’

mukhyārthe lāgāla prabhu sūtra-sakala

SYNONYMS

mukhya-artha—direct meaning; *vyākhyā*—explanation; *kara*—You do; *dekhi*—let us see; *tomāra*—Your; *bala*—strength; *mukhya-arthe*—direct meaning; *lāgāla*—began; *prabhu*—the Lord; *sūtra-sakala*—all the aphorisms of the *Vedānta-sūtra*.

TRANSLATION

“Now let us see,” the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs continued, “how well You can describe the sūtras in terms of their direct meaning.” Hearing this, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu began His direct explanation of the Vedānta-sūtra.

TEXT 138

bṛhad-vastu ‘brahma’ kahi—‘śrī-bhagavān’

ṣaḍ-vidhaiśvarya-pūrṇa, para-tattva-dhāma

SYNONYMS

bṛhat-vastu—the substance, which is greater than the greatest; *brahma*—called by the name Brahman; *kahi*—we call; *śrī-bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *ṣaḍ*—six; *vidha*—varieties; *aiśvarya*—opulences; *pūrṇa*—full; *para-tattva*—Absolute Truth; *dhāma*—reservoir.

TRANSLATION

“Brahman, who is greater than the greatest, is the Supreme Personality of

Godhead. He is full in six opulences, and therefore He is the reservoir of ultimate truth and absolute knowledge.

PURPORT

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* it is said that the Absolute Truth is understood in three phases of realization: the impersonal Brahman, the localized Paramātmā and ultimately the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The impersonal Brahman and localized Paramātmā are expansions of the potency of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is complete in six opulences, namely wealth, fame, strength, beauty, knowledge and renunciation. Since He possesses His six opulences, the Personality of Godhead is the ultimate truth in absolute knowledge.

TEXT 139

svarūpa-aiśvare tānra nāhi māyā-gandha

sakala vedera haya bhagavān se 'sambandha'

SYNONYMS

svarūpa—in His original form; *aiśvare*—opulence; *tānra*—His; *nāhi*—there is none; *māyā-gandha*—contamination of the material world; *sakala*—in all; *vedera*—*Vedas*; *haya*—it is so; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *se*—that; *sambandha*—relationship.

TRANSLATION

“In His original form the Supreme Personality of Godhead is full with transcendental opulences, which are free from the contamination of the material world. It is to be understood that in all Vedic literature the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the ultimate goal.

TEXT 140

tāñre 'nirviśeṣa' kahi, cic-chakti nā māni

ardha-svarūpa nā māñile pūrṇatā haya hāñi

SYNONYMS

tāñre—unto Him; *nirviśeṣa*—impersonal; *kahi*—we say; *cit-śakti*—spiritual energy; *nā*—do not; *māni*—accept; *ardha*—half; *svaṛūpa*—form; *nā*—not; *māñile*—accepting; *pūrṇatā*—fullness; *haya*—becomes; *hāñi*—defective.

TRANSLATION

“When we speak of the Supreme as impersonal, we deny His spiritual potencies. Logically, if you accept half of the truth, you cannot understand the whole.

PURPORT

In the *Upaniṣads* it is said:

*om pūrṇam adaḥ pūrṇam idaṁ pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate
pūrṇasya pūrṇam ādāya pūrṇam evāvaśiṣyate
[Īśopaniṣad, Invocation]*

This verse, which is mentioned in the *Īśopaniṣad*, *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* and many other *Upaniṣads*, indicates that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is full in six opulences. His position is unique, for He possesses all riches, strength, influence, beauty, knowledge and renunciation. Brahman means the greatest, but the Supreme Personality of Godhead is greater than the greatest, just as the sun globe is greater than the sunshine, which is all-pervading in the universe. Although the sunshine that spreads all over the universes appears very great to the less knowledgeable, greater than the sunshine is the sun itself, and greater than the sun is the sun-god. Similarly, impersonal Brahman is not the

greatest, although it appears to be so. Impersonal Brahman is only the bodily effulgence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but the transcendental form of the Lord is greater than both the impersonal Brahman and localized Paramātmā. Therefore whenever the word “Brahman” is used in the Vedic literature, it is understood to refer to the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* the Lord is also addressed as Parabrahman. Māyāvādīs and others sometimes misunderstand Brahman because every living entity is also Brahman. Therefore Kṛṣṇa is referred to as Parabrahman (the Supreme Brahman). In the Vedic literature, whenever the words “Brahman” or “Parabrahman” are used, they are to be understood to refer to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa. This is their real meaning. Since the entire Vedic literature deals with the subject of Brahman, Kṛṣṇa is therefore the ultimate goal of Vedic understanding. The impersonal *brahmajyoti* rests on the personal form of the Lord. Therefore although the impersonal effulgence, the *brahmajyoti*, is the first realization, one must enter into it, as mentioned in the *Īśopaniṣad*, to find the Supreme Person, and then one’s knowledge is perfect. The *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.19) also confirms this: *bahūnām janmanām ante jñānavān mām prapadyate*. One’s search for the Absolute Truth by dint of speculative knowledge is complete when one comes to the point of understanding Kṛṣṇa and surrenders unto Him. That is the real point of perfectional knowledge.

Partial realization of the Absolute Truth as impersonal Brahman denies the complete opulences of the Lord. This is a hazardous understanding of the Absolute Truth. Unless one accepts all the features of the Absolute Truth—namely impersonal Brahman, localized Paramātmā and ultimately the Supreme Personality of Godhead—one’s knowledge is imperfect. Śrīpāda Rāmānujācārya, in his *Vedārtha-saṅgraha*, says, *jñānena dharmeṇa svarūpam api nirūpitam, na tu jñāna-mātram brahmeti katham idam avagamyate*. He thus indicates that the real identity of the Absolute Truth must be understood in terms of both His knowledge and His characteristics. Simply to understand the Absolute Truth to be full of

knowledge is not sufficient. In the Vedic literature (*Muṇḍaka Up.* 1.1.9) we find the statement *yaḥ sarva-jñāḥ sarva-vit*, which means that the Absolute Truth knows everything perfectly, but we also learn from the Vedic description *parāśya śaktir vividhaiva śrūyate* that not only does He know everything, but He also acts accordingly by utilizing His different energies. Thus to understand that Brahman, the Supreme, is conscious is not sufficient. One must know how He consciously acts through His different energies. Māyāvāda philosophy simply informs us of the consciousness of the Absolute Truth but does not give us information of how He acts with His consciousness. That is the defect of that philosophy.

TEXT 141

bhagavān-prāpti-hetu ye kari upāya

śravaṇādi bhakti—kṛṣṇa-prāptira sahāya

SYNONYMS

bhagavān—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *prāpti-hetu*—the means by which He can be approached; *ye*—what; *kari*—I do; *upāya*—means; *śravaṇa-ādi*—devotional service, beginning with hearing; *bhakti*—devotional service; *kṛṣṇa*—the Supreme Lord; *prāptira*—to approach Him; *sahāya*—means.

TRANSLATION

“It is only by devotional service, beginning with hearing, that one can approach the Supreme Personality of Godhead. That is the only means to approach Him.

PURPORT

Māyāvādī philosophers are satisfied simply to understand Brahman to be

the sum total of knowledge, but Vaiṣṇava philosophers not only know in detail about the Supreme Personality of Godhead but also know how to approach Him directly. The method for this is described by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as nine kinds of devotional service, beginning with hearing:

*śravaṇaṁ kīrtanaṁ viṣṇoḥ smaraṇaṁ pāda-sevanam
arcanaṁ vandanaṁ dāsyam sakhyam ātma-nivedanam*

(*Bhāg. 7.5.23*)

The nine kinds of devotional service are hearing about Kṛṣṇa, chanting about Him, remembering Him, offering service to His lotus feet, offering Him worship in the temple, offering prayers to Him, working as His servant, making friendship with Him and unreservedly surrendering to Him. One can directly approach the Supreme Personality of Godhead simply by executing these nine kinds of devotional service, of which hearing about the Lord is the most important (*śravaṇādī*). Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu has very favorably stressed the importance of this process of hearing. According to His method, if people are simply given a chance to hear about Kṛṣṇa, certainly they will gradually develop their dormant awareness, or love of Godhead. *Śravaṇādi-suddha-citte karaye udaya* (Cc. *Madhya* 22.107). Love of God is dormant in everyone, and if one is given a chance to hear about the Lord, certainly that love develops. Our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement acts on this principle. We simply give people the chance to hear about the Supreme Personality of Godhead and give them *prasādam* to eat, and the actual result is that all over the world people are responding to this process and becoming pure devotees of Lord Kṛṣṇa. We have opened hundreds of centers all over the world just to give people in general a chance to hear about Kṛṣṇa and accept Kṛṣṇa's *prasādam*. These two processes can be accepted by anyone, even a child. It doesn't matter whether one is poor or rich, learned or foolish, black or white, old or still a child—anyone who simply hears about the Supreme Personality of Godhead and takes *prasādam* is certainly elevated to the transcendental position of devotional service.

TEXT 142

sei sarva-vedera 'abhidheya' nāma

sādhana-bhakti haite haya premera udgama

SYNONYMS

sei sarva-vedera—that is the essence of all Vedic literature; *abhidheya nāma*—the process called *abhidheya*, or devotional activities; *sādhana-bhakti*—another name of this process, “devotional service in practice”; *haite*—from this; *haya*—there is; *premera*—of love of Godhead; *udgama*—awakening.

TRANSLATION

“By practicing this regulated devotional service under the direction of the spiritual master, certainly one awakens his dormant love of Godhead. This process is called *abhidheya*.

PURPORT

By the practice of devotional service, beginning with hearing and chanting, the impure heart of a conditioned soul is purified, and thus he can understand his eternal relationship with the Supreme personality of Godhead. That eternal relationship is described by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu: *jīvera 'svarūpa' haya kṛṣṇera 'nitya-dāsa.'* [Cc. *Madhya* 20.108]. “The living entity is an eternal servitor of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.” When one is convinced about this relationship, which is called *sambandha*, he then acts accordingly. That is called *abhidheya*. The next step is *prajoyana-siddhi*, or fulfillment of the ultimate goal of one’s life. If one can understand his relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead and act accordingly, automatically his mission in life is fulfilled. The Māyāvādī philosophers miss even the first stage in self-realization because they have no conception of God’s being

personal. He is the master of all, and He is the only person who can accept the service of all living entities, but since this knowledge is lacking in Māyāvāda philosophy, Māyāvādīs do not have knowledge even of their relationship with God. They wrongly think that everyone is God or that everyone is equal to God. Therefore, since the real position of the living entity is not clear to them, how can they advance further? Although they are very much puffed up at being liberated, Māyāvādī philosophers very shortly fall down again to material activities due to their neglecting the lotus feet of the Lord. That is called *patanty adhaḥ*:

*ye 'nye 'ravindākṣa vimukta-māninas
tvayy asta-bhāvād aviśuddha-buddhayaḥ
āruhya kṛcchreṇa param padam tataḥ
patanty adho 'nāḍṛta-yuṣmad-aṅghrayaḥ*

(*Bhāg. 10.2.32*)

Here it is said that persons who think themselves liberated but do not execute devotional service, not knowing their relationship with the Lord, are certainly misled. One must know his relationship with the Lord and act accordingly. Then the fulfillment of his life's mission will be possible.

TEXT 143

kṛṣṇera caraṇe haya yadi anurāga

kṛṣṇa vinu anyatra tāra nāhi rahe rāga

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Kṛṣṇa; *caraṇe*—at the lotus feet; *haya*—becomes; *yadi*—if; *anurāga*—attachment; *kṛṣṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *vinu*—without; *anyatra*—anywhere else; *tāra*—his; *nāhi*—there does not; *rahe*—remain; *rāga*—attachment.

TRANSLATION

“If one develops his love of Godhead and becomes attached to the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa, gradually he loses his attachment to everything else.

PURPORT

This is a test of advancement in devotional service. As stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.2.42), *bhaktir pareśānubhavo viraktir anyatra ca*: in *bhakti*, a devotee’s only attachment is Kṛṣṇa; he no longer wants to maintain his attachments to many other things. Although Māyāvādī philosophers are supposed to be very much advanced on the path of liberation, we see that after some time they descend to politics and philanthropic activities. Many big *sannyāsīs* who were supposedly liberated and very advanced have come down again to materialistic activities, although they left this world as *mithyā* (false). When a devotee develops in devotional service, however, he no longer has attachments to such philanthropic activities. He is simply inspired to serve the Lord, and he engages his entire life in such service. This is the difference between Vaiṣṇava and Māyāvādī philosophers. Devotional service, therefore, is practical, whereas Māyāvāda philosophy is merely mental speculation.

TEXT 144

pañcama puruṣārtha sei prema-mahādhana

kṛṣṇera mādhyura-rasa karāya āsvādana

SYNONYMS

pañcama—fifth; *puruṣa-artha*—goal of life; *sei*—that; *prema*—love of God; *mahā-dhana*—foremost wealth; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mādhyura*—conjugal love; *rasa*—mellow; *karāya*—causes; *āsvādana*—taste.

TRANSLATION

“Love of Godhead is so exalted that it is considered to be the fifth goal of human life. By awakening one’s love of Godhead, one can attain the platform of conjugal love, tasting it even during the present span of life.

PURPORT

The Māyāvādī philosophers consider the highest goal of perfection to be liberation (*mukti*), which is the fourth perfectional platform. Generally people are aware of four principal goals of life—religiosity (*dharma*), economic development (*artha*), sense gratification (*kāma*) and ultimately liberation (*mokṣa*)—but devotional service is situated on the platform above liberation. In other words, when one is actually liberated (*mukta*) he can understand the meaning of love of Godhead (*kṛṣṇa-prema*). While teaching Rūpa Gosvāmī, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu stated, *koṭi-mukta-madhye ‘durlabha’ eka kṛṣṇa-bhakta*: “Out of millions of liberated persons, one may become a devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa.”

The most elevated Māyāvādī philosopher can rise to the platform of liberation, but *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*, devotional service to Kṛṣṇa, is transcendental to such liberation. Śrīla Vyāsadeva explains this fact in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.1.2):

*dharmāḥ projjhita-kaitavo ’tra paramo nirmatsarāṇām satām
vedyaṁ vāstavam atra vastu śīva-daṁ tāpa-trayonmūlanam*

“Completely rejecting all religions which are materially motivated, the *Bhāgavata Purāṇa* propounds the highest truth, which is understandable by those devotees who are pure in heart. The highest truth is reality distinguished from illusion for the welfare of all. Such truth uproots the threefold miseries.” *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, the explanation of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, is meant for *paramo nirmatsarāṇām*, those who are completely aloof from jealousy. Māyāvādī philosophers are jealous of the existence of the Personality of Godhead. Therefore the *Vedānta-sūtra* is not actually

meant for them. They unnecessarily poke their noses into the *Vedānta-sūtra*, but they have no ability to understand it because, as the author of the *Vedānta-sūtra* writes in his commentary, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, it is meant for those who are pure in heart (*paramo nirmatsarāṇām*). If one is envious of Kṛṣṇa, how can he understand the *Vedānta-sūtra* or *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*? The Māyāvādīs' primary occupation is to offend the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa. For example, although Kṛṣṇa demands our surrender in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, the greatest scholar and so-called philosopher in modern India has protested that it is “not to Kṛṣṇa” that we have to surrender. Therefore, he is envious. Since Māyāvādīs of all different descriptions are envious of Kṛṣṇa, they have no scope for understanding the meaning of the *Vedānta-sūtra*. Even if they were on the liberated platform, as they falsely claim, love of Kṛṣṇa is beyond the state of liberation—a fact stated by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and repeated here by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TEXT 145

premā haite kṛṣṇa haya nija bhakta-vaśa

premā haite pāya kṛṣṇera sevā-sukha-rasa

SYNONYMS

premā—love of Kṛṣṇa; *haite*—from; *kṛṣṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *haya*—becomes; *nija*—His own; *bhakta-vaśa*—submissive to devotees; *premā*—love of God; *haite*—from; *pāya*—he gets; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sevā-sukha-rasa*—the mellow of devotional service.

TRANSLATION

“The Supreme Lord, who is greater than the greatest, becomes submissive to even a very insignificant devotee because of his devotional service. It is the beautiful and exalted nature of devotional service that the infinite Lord becomes submissive to the infinitesimal living entity

because of it. In reciprocal devotional activities with the Lord, the devotee actually enjoys the transcendental mellow of devotional service.

PURPORT

Becoming one with the Supreme Personality of Godhead is not very important for a devotee. *Muktiḥ svayaṁ mukulitāñjali sevate 'smān* (*Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta* 107). Speaking from his actual experience, Śrīla Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura says that if one develops love of Godhead, *mukti* (liberation) becomes subservient and unimportant to him. *Mukti* stands before the devotee and is prepared to render all kinds of services. The Māyāvādī philosophers' standard of *mukti* is very insignificant for a devotee, for by devotional service even the Supreme Personality of Godhead becomes subordinate to him. An actual example is that the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa became the chariot driver of Arjuna, and when Arjuna asked Him to draw his chariot between the two armies (*senayor ubhayor madhye ratham sthāpaya me 'cyuta*), Kṛṣṇa executed his order. Such is the relationship between the Supreme Lord and a devotee that although the Lord is greater than the greatest, He is prepared to render service to the insignificant devotee by dint of his sincere and unalloyed devotional service.

TEXT 146

sambandha, abhidheya, prayojana nāma

ei tina artha sarva-sūtre paryavasāna

SYNONYMS

sambandha—relationship; *abhidheya*—functional duties; *prayojana*—the goal of life; *nāma*—name; *ei*—there; *tina*—three; *artha*—purport; *sarva*—all; *sūtre*—in the aphorisms of the *Vedānta*; *paryavasāna*—culmination.

TRANSLATION

“One’s relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead, activities in terms of that relationship, and the ultimate goal of life [to develop love of God]—these three subjects are explained in every aphorism of the Vedānta-sūtra, for they form the culmination of the entire Vedānta philosophy.”

PURPORT

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (5.5.5) it is said:

*parābhavas tāvad abodha-jāto
yāvan na jijñāsata ātma-tattvam*

“A human being is defeated in all his activities as long as he does not know the goal of life, which can be understood when one is inquisitive about Brahman.” It is such inquiry that begins the *Vedānta-sūtra: athāto brahma jijñāsā*. A human being should be inquisitive to know who he is, what the universe is, what God is, and what the relationship is between himself, God and the material world. Such questions cannot be asked by cats and dogs, but they must arise in the heart of a real human being. Knowledge of these four items—namely oneself, the universe, God, and their internal relationship—is called *sambandha-jñāna*, or the knowledge of one’s relationship. When one’s relationship with the Supreme Lord is established, the next program is to act in that relationship. This is called *abhidheya*, or activity in relationship with the Lord. After executing such prescribed duties, when one attains the highest goal of life, love of Godhead, he achieves *prayojana-siddhi*, or the fulfillment of his human mission. In the *Brahma-sūtra*, or *Vedānta-sūtra*, these subjects are very carefully explained. Therefore one who does not understand the *Vedānta-sūtra* in terms of these principles is simply wasting his time. This is the version of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.2.8):

dharmāḥ sv-anuṣṭhitāḥ puṁsāṁ viṣvaksena-kathāsu yaḥ

notpādayed yadi ratim śrama eva hi kevalam

One may be a very learned scholar and execute his prescribed duty very nicely, but if he does not ultimately become inquisitive about the Supreme Personality of Godhead and is indifferent to *śravaṇam kīrtanam* (hearing and chanting), all that he has done is but a waste of time. Māyāvādī philosophers, who do not understand the relationship between themselves, the cosmic manifestation and the Supreme Personality of Godhead, are simply wasting their time, and their philosophical speculation has no value.

TEXT 147

ei-mata sarva-sūtrera vyākhyāna śuniyā

sakala sannyāsī kahe vinaya kariyā

SYNONYMS

ei-mata—in this way; *sarva-sūtrera*—of all the aphorisms of the *Vedānta-sūtra*; *vyākhyāna*—explanation; *śuniyā*—by hearing; *sakala*—all; *sannyāsī*—the groups of Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *kahe*—said; *vinaya*—humbly; *kariyā*—doing so.

TRANSLATION

When all the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs thus heard the explanation of Caitanya Mahāprabhu on the basis of sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana, they spoke very humbly.

PURPORT

Everyone who actually desires to understand the Vedānta philosophy must certainly accept the explanation of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and the Vaiṣṇava *ācāryas* who have also commented on the *Vedānta-sūtra*

according to the principles of *bhakti-yoga*. After hearing the explanation of the *Vedānta-sūtra* from Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, all the *sannyāsīs*, headed by Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, became very humble and obedient to the Lord, and they spoke as follows.

TEXT 148

vedamaya-mūrti tumi, — — sākṣāt nārāyaṇa

kṣama aparādha, — — pūrve ye kailuṇ nindana

SYNONYMS

veda-maya—transformation of the Vedic knowledge; *mūrti*—form; *tumi*—You; *sākṣāt*—directly; *nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kṣama*—excuse; *aparādha*—offense; *pūrve*—before; *ye*—that; *kailuṇ*—we have done; *nindana*—criticism.

TRANSLATION

“Dear Sir, You are Vedic knowledge personified and are directly Nārāyaṇa Himself. Kindly excuse us for the offenses we previously committed by criticizing You.”

PURPORT

The complete path of *bhakti-yoga* is based upon the process of becoming humble and submissive. By the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, all the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* were very humble and submissive after hearing His explanation of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, and they begged to be pardoned for the offenses they had committed by criticizing the Lord for simply chanting and dancing and not taking part in the study of the *Vedānta-sūtra*. We are propagating the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement simply by following in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. We may not be very well versed in the *Vedānta-sūtra* aphorisms and may not understand

their meaning, but we follow in the footsteps of the *ācāryas*, and because of our strictly and obediently following in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, it is to be understood that we know everything regarding the *Vedānta-sūtra*.

TEXT 149

sei haite sannyāsīra phiri gela mana

‘kṛṣṇa’ ‘kṛṣṇa’ nāma sadā karaye grahaṇa

SYNONYMS

sei haite—from that time; *sannyāsīra*—all the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *phiri*—turn; *gela*—became; *mana*—mind; *kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa*—the holy name of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa; *nāma*—name; *sadā*—always; *karaye*—do; *grahaṇa*—accept.

TRANSLATION

From that moment when the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs heard the explanation of the Vedānta-sūtra from the Lord, their minds changed, and on the instruction of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, they too chanted “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” always.

PURPORT

In this connection it may be mentioned that sometimes the *sahajiyā* class of devotees opine that Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī and Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī are the same man. Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī was a great Vaiṣṇava devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, but Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī, the head of the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* in Benares, was a different person. Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī belonged to the Rāmānuja-sampradāya, whereas Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī belonged to the Śāṅkarācārya-sampradāya. Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī wrote a number of books, among

which are the *Caitanya-candrāmṛta*, *Rādhā-rasa-sudhā-nidhi*, *Śaṅgīta-mādhava*, *Vṛndāvana-śataka* and *Navadvīpa-śataka*. While traveling in southern India, Caitanya Mahāprabhu met Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī, who had two brothers, Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa and Tirumalaya Bhaṭṭa, who were Vaiṣṇavas of the Rāmānuja-sampradāya. Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī was the nephew of Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī. From historical records it is found that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu traveled in South India in the year 1433 Śakābda (A.D. 1511) during the Cāturmāsya period, and it was at that time that He met Prabodhānanda, who belonged to the Rāmānuja-sampradāya. How then could the same person meet Him as a member of the Śāṅkara-sampradāya in 1435 Śakābda, two years later? It is to be concluded that the guess of the *sahajiyā-sampradāya* that Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī and Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī were the same man is a mistaken idea.

TEXT 150

ei-mate tān-sabāra kṣami' aparādha

sabākāre kṛṣṇa-nāma karilā prasāda

SYNONYMS

ei-mate—in this way; *tān-sabāra*—of all the *sannyāsīs*; *kṣami'*—excusing; *aparādha*—offense; *sabākāre*—all of them; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Kṛṣṇa; *karilā*—gave; *prasāda*—as mercy.

TRANSLATION

Thus Lord Caitanya excused all the offenses of the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs and very mercifully blessed them with kṛṣṇa-nāma.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the mercy incarnation of the Supreme

Personality of Godhead. He is addressed by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī as *mahā-vadānyāvatāra*, or the most magnanimous incarnation. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī also says, *karuṇayāvatīrṇaḥ kalau*: it is only by His mercy that He has descended in this Age of Kali. Here this is exemplified. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu did not like to see Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* because He thought of them as offenders to the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa, but here He excuses them (*tān-sabāra kṣami' aparādha*). This is an example in preaching. *Āpani ācari' bhakti śikhāimu sabāre*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu teaches us that those whom preachers meet are almost all offenders who are opposed to Kṛṣṇa consciousness, but it is a preacher's duty to convince them of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement and then induce them to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. Our propagation of the *saṅkīrtana* movement is continuing, despite many opponents, and people are taking up this chanting process even in remote parts of the world like Africa. By inducing the offenders to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu exemplified the success of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. We should follow very respectfully in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya, and there is no doubt that we shall be successful in our attempts.

TEXT 151

tabe saba sannyāsī mahāprabhuke laiyā

bhikṣā karilena sabhe, madhye vasāiyā

SYNONYMS

tabe—after this; *saba*—all; *sannyāsī*—the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *mahāprabhuke*—Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *laiyā*—taking Him; *bhikṣā karilena*—took *prasādam*, or took lunch; *sabhe*—all together; *madhye*—in the middle; *vasāiyā*—seating Him.

TRANSLATION

After this, all the *sannyāsīs* took the Lord into their midst, and thus they all took their meal together.

PURPORT

Previously Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu had neither mixed nor talked with the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, but now He took lunch with them. It is to be concluded that when Lord Caitanya induced them to chant Hare Kṛṣṇa and excused them for their offenses, they were purified, and therefore there was no objection to taking lunch, or *bhagavat-prasādam*, with them, although Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu knew that the food was not offered to the Deity. Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* do not worship the Deity, or if they do so they generally worship the deity of Lord Śiva or the *pañcopāsanā* (Lord Viṣṇu, Lord Śiva, Durgā-devī, Gaṇeśa and Sūrya). Here we do not find any mention of the demigods or Viṣṇu, and yet Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted food in the midst of the *sannyāsīs* on the basis that they had chanted the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* and that He had excused their offenses.

TEXT 152

bhikṣā kari' mahāprabhu āilā vāsāghara

hena citra-lilā kare gaurāṅga-sundara

SYNONYMS

bhikṣā—accepting food from others; *kari'*—accepting; *mahāprabhu*—Lord Caitanya; *āilā*—returned; *vāsāghara*—to His residence; *hena*—thus; *citra-lilā*—wonderful pastimes; *kare*—does; *gaurāṅga*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sundara*—very beautiful.

TRANSLATION

After taking lunch among the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*, Śrī Caitanya

Mahāprabhu, who is known as Gaurasundara, returned to His residence.
Thus the Lord performs His wonderful pastimes.

TEXT 153

candraśekhara, tapana miśra, āra sanātana

śuni' dekhi' ānandita sabākāra mana

SYNONYMS

candraśekhara—Candraśekhara; *tapana miśra*—Tapana Miśra; *āra*—and; *sanātana*—Sanātana; *śuni'*—hearing; *dekhi'*—seeing; *ānandita*—very pleased; *sabākāra*—all of them; *mana*—minds.

TRANSLATION

Hearing the arguments of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and seeing His victory, Candraśekhara, Tapana Miśra and Sanātana Gosvāmī were all extremely pleased.

PURPORT

Here is an example of how a *sannyāsī* should preach. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu went to Vārāṇasī, He went there alone, not with a big party. Locally, however, He made friendships with Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra, and Sanātana Gosvāmī also came to see Him. Therefore, although He did not have many friends there, due to His sound preaching and His victory in arguing with the local *sannyāsīs* on the Vedānta philosophy, He became greatly famous in that part of the country, as explained in the next verse.

TEXT 154

prabhuke dekhite āise sakala sannyāsī

prabhura praśāṁsā kare saba vārāṇasī

SYNONYMS

prabhuke—unto Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dekhite*—to see; *āise*—they came; *sakala*—all; *sannyāsī*—the Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs*; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *praśāṁsā*—praise; *kare*—they do; *saba*—all; *vārāṇasī*—the city of Vārāṇasī.

TRANSLATION

Many Māyāvādī sannyāsīs of Vārāṇasī came to see the Lord after this incident, and the entire city praised Him.

TEXT 155

vārāṇasī-purī āilā śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

purī-saha sarva-loka haila mahā-dhanya

SYNONYMS

vārāṇasī—of the name Vārāṇasī; *purī*—city; *āilā*—came; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *purī*—city; *saha*—with; *sarva-loka*—all the people; *haila*—became; *mahā-dhanya*—thankful.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu visited the city of Vārāṇasī, and all of its people were very thankful.

TEXT 156

lakṣa lakṣa loka āise prabhuke dekhite

mahā-bhīḍa haila dvāre, nāre praveśīte

SYNONYMS

lakṣa lakṣa—hundreds of thousands; *loka*—people; *āise*—came; *prabhuke*—unto the Lord; *dekhite*—to see; *mahā-bhīḍa*—a great crowd; *haila*—there happened; *dvāre*—at the door; *nāre*—may not; *praveśīte*—to enter.

TRANSLATION

The crowd at the door of His residence was so great that it numbered hundreds of thousands.

TEXT 157

prabhu yabe yā'na viśveśvara-daraśane

lakṣa lakṣa loka āsi' mile sei sthāne

SYNONYMS

prabhu—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yabe*—when; *yā'na*—goes; *viśveśvara*—the deity of Vārāṇasī; *daraśane*—to visit; *lakṣa lakṣa*—hundreds of thousands; *loka*—people; *āsi'*—come; *mile*—meet; *sei*—that; *sthāne*—on the place.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord went to visit the temple of Viśveśvara, hundreds of thousands of people assembled to see Him.

PURPORT

The important point in this verse is that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

regularly visited the temple of Viśveśvara (Lord Śiva) at Vārāṇasī. Vaiṣṇavas generally do not visit a demigod's temple, but here we see that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu regularly visited the temple of Viśveśvara, who was the predominating deity of Vārāṇasī. Generally Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* and worshipers of Lord Śiva live in Vārāṇasī, but how is it that Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who took the part of a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī*, also visited the Viśveśvara temple? The answer is that a Vaiṣṇava does not behave impudently toward the demigods. A Vaiṣṇava gives proper respect to all, although he never accepts a demigod to be as good as the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* there are *mantras* offering obeisances to Lord Śiva, Lord Brahmā, the sun-god and Lord Gaṇeśa, as well as Lord Viṣṇu, all of whom are worshiped by the impersonalists as *pañcopāsanā*. In their temples impersonalists install deities of Lord Viṣṇu, Lord Śiva, the sun-god, goddess Durgā and sometimes Lord Brahmā also, and this system is continuing at present in India under the guise of the Hindu religion. Vaiṣṇavas can also worship all these demigods, but only on the principles of the *Brahma-saṁhitā*, which is recommended by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. We may note in this connection the *mantras* for worshiping Lord Śiva, Lord Brahmā, goddess Durgā, the sun-god and Gaṇeśa, as described in the *Brahma-saṁhitā*.

*sṛṣṭi-sthiti-pralaya-sādhana-śaktir ekā
chāyeva yasya bhuvanāni bibharti durgā
icchānurūpam apī yasya ca ceṣṭate sā
govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi*

“The external potency, *māyā*, who is of the nature of the shadow of the *cit* [spiritual] potency, is worshiped by all people as Durgā, the creating, preserving and destroying agency of this mundane world. I adore the primeval Lord, Govinda, in accordance with whose will Durgā conducts herself.” (Bs. 5.44)

kṣīraṁ yathā dadhi vikāra-viśeṣa-yogāt

*sañjāyate na hi tataḥ pṛthag asti hetoḥ
yaḥ śambhutām api tathā samupaiti kāryād
govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi*

“Milk is transformed into curd by the actions of acids, yet the effect, curd, is neither the same as nor different from its cause, viz., milk. I adore the primeval Lord, Govinda, of whom the state of Śambhu is a similar transformation for the performance of the work of destruction.” (Bs. 5.45)

*bhāsvān yathāśma-śakaleṣu nījeṣu tejaḥ
svīyam kiyat prakāṣayaty api tadvad atra
brahmā ya eṣa jagad-aṇḍa-vidhāna-kartā
govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi*

“I adore the primeval Lord, Govinda, from whom the separated subjective portion Brahmā receives his power for the regulation of the mundane world, just as the sun manifests a portion of his own light in all the effulgent gems that bear such names as *sūrya-kānta*.” (Bs. 5.49)

*yat-pāda-pallava-yugam vinidhāya kumbha-
dvandve praṇāma-samaye sa gaṇādhirājaḥ
vighnān vihantum alam asya jagat-trayasya
govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi*

“I worship the primeval Lord, Govinda. Gaṇeśa always holds His lotus feet upon the pair of *tumuli* protruding from his elephant head in order to obtain power for his function of destroying all obstacles on the path of progress in the three worlds.” (Bs. 5.50)

*yac cakṣur eṣa savitā sakala-grahāṇām
rājā samasta-sura-mūrtir aśeṣa-tejāḥ
yasyājñayā bhramati sambhṛta-kāla-cakro
govindam ādi-puruṣam tam aham bhajāmi*

“The sun, full of infinite effulgence, who is the king of all the planets and the image of the good soul, is like the eye of this world. I adore the primeval Lord, Govinda, in pursuance of whose order the sun performs his journey, mounting the wheel of time.” (Bs. 5.52)

All the demigods are servants of Kṛṣṇa; they are not equal with Kṛṣṇa. Therefore even if one goes to a temple of the *pañcopāsanā*, as mentioned above, one should not accept the deities as they are accepted by the impersonalists. All of them are to be accepted as personal demigods, but they all serve the order of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Śaṅkarācārya, for example, is understood to be an incarnation of Lord Śiva, as described in the *Padma Purāṇa*. He propagated the Māyāvāda philosophy under the order of the Supreme Lord. We have already discussed this point in text 114 of this chapter: *tāñra doṣa nāhi, teñho ājñā-kārī dāsa*. “Śaṅkarācārya is not at fault, for he has thus covered the real purpose of the *Vedas* under the order of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.” Although Lord Śiva, in the form of a *brāhmaṇa* (Śaṅkarācārya), preached the false philosophy of Māyāvāda, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu nevertheless said that since he did it on the order of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, there was no fault on his part (*tāñra doṣa nāhi*).

We must offer proper respects to all the demigods. If one can offer respects even to an ant, why not to the demigods? One must always know, however, that no demigod is equal to or above the Supreme Lord. *Ekale īśvara kṛṣṇa, āra saba bhr̥tya*: “Only Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and all others, including the demigods such as Lord Śiva, Lord Brahmā, goddess Durgā and Ganeśa, are His servants.” Everyone serves the purpose of the Supreme Godhead, and what to speak of such small and insignificant living entities as ourselves? We are surely eternal servants of the Lord. The Māyāvāda philosophy maintains that the demigods, the living entities and the Supreme Personality of Godhead are all equal. It is therefore a most foolish misrepresentation of Vedic knowledge.

TEXT 158

snāna karite yabe yā'na gaṅgā-tīre

tāhāñi sakala loka haya mahā-bhīḍe

SYNONYMS

snāna—bath; *karite*—taking; *yabe*—when; *yā'na*—goes; *gaṅgā*—Ganges; *tīre*—bank; *tāhāñi*—then and there; *sakala*—all; *loka*—people; *haya*—assembled; *mahā-bhīḍe*—in great crowds.

TRANSLATION

Whenever Lord Caitanya went to the banks of the Ganges to take His bath, big crowds of many hundreds of thousands of people assembled there.

TEXT 159

bāhu tuli' prabhu bale,——bala hari hari

hari-dhvani kare loka svarga-martya bhari'

SYNONYMS

bāhu tuli'—raising the arms; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bale*—speaks; *bala*—all of you chant; *hari hari*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa (Hari); *hari-dhvani*—the sound vibration of Hari; *kare*—does; *loka*—all people; *svarga-martya*—in heaven, the sky and the land; *bhari'*—completely filling.

TRANSLATION

Whenever the crowds were too great, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu stood up,

raised His hands and chanted, “Hari! Hari!” to which all the people responded, filling both the land and sky with the vibration.

TEXT 160

loka nistāriyā prabhura calite haila mana

vṛndāvane pāṭhāilā śrī-sanātana

SYNONYMS

loka—people; *nistāriyā*—delivering; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *calite*—to leave; *haila*—became; *mana*—mind; *vṛndāvane*—toward Vṛndāvana; *pāṭhāilā*—sent; *śrī-sanātana*—Sanātana Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

After thus delivering the people in general, the Lord desired to leave Vārāṇasī. After instructing Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī, He sent him toward Vṛndāvana.

PURPORT

The actual purpose of Lord Caitanya’s stay at Vārāṇasī after coming back from Vṛndāvana was to meet Sanātana Gosvāmī and teach him. Sanātana Gosvāmī met Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu after the Lord’s return to Vārāṇasī, where the Lord taught him for two months about the intricacies of Vaiṣṇava philosophy and Vaiṣṇava activities. After completely instructing him, He sent him to Vṛndāvana to execute His orders. When Sanātana Gosvāmī went to Vṛndāvana, there were no temples. The city was lying vacant like an open field. Sanātana Gosvāmī sat down on the bank of the Yamunā, and after some time he gradually constructed the first temple; then other temples were constructed, and now the city is full of temples, numbering about five thousand.

TEXT 161

rātri-divase lokera śuni' kolāhala

vārāṇasī chāḍī' prabhu āilā nīlācala

SYNONYMS

rātri—night; *divase*—day; *lokera*—of the people in general; *śuni*—hearing; *kolāhala*—tumult; *vārāṇasī*—the city of Benares; *chāḍī'*—leaving; *prabhu*—the Lord; *āilā*—returned; *nīlācala*—to Purī.

TRANSLATION

Because the city of Vārāṇasī was always full of tumultuous crowds, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, after sending Sanātana to Vṛndāvana, returned to Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 162

ei līlā kahiba āge vistāra kariyā

saṅkṣepe kahilān ihān prasaṅga pāiyā

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *līlā*—pastimes; *kahiba*—I shall speak; *āge*—later on; *vistāra*—vivid description; *kariyā*—making; *saṅkṣepe*—in short; *kahilān*—I have spoken; *ihān*—in this place; *prasaṅga*—topics; *pāiyā*—taking advantage of.

TRANSLATION

I have here given a brief account of these pastimes of Lord Caitanya, but later I shall describe them in an extensive way.

TEXT 163

ei pañca-tattva-rūpe śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

kṛṣṇa-nāma-prema diyā viśva kailā dhanya

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *pañca-tattva-rūpe*—the Lord in His five forms; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prema*—love of Kṛṣṇa; *diyā*—delivering; *viśva*—the whole world; *kailā*—made; *dhanya*—thankful.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His associates of the Pañca-tattva distributed the holy name of the Lord to invoke love of Godhead throughout the universe, and thus the entire universe was thankful.

PURPORT

Here it is said that Lord Caitanya made the entire universe thankful to Him for propagating the *saṅkīrtana* movement with His associates. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu has already sanctified the entire universe by His presence five hundred years ago, and therefore anyone who attempts to serve Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu sincerely by following in His footsteps and following the instructions of the *ācāryas* will successfully be able to preach the holy names of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* all over the universe. There are some foolish critics who say that Europeans and Americans cannot be offered *sannyāsa*, but here we find that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted to preach the *saṅkīrtana* movement all over the universe. For preaching work, *sannyāsīs* are essential. These critics think that only Indians or Hindus should be offered *sannyāsa* to preach, but their knowledge is practically nil. Without *sannyāsīs*, the preaching work will be impeded. Therefore, under the instruction of Lord Caitanya and

with the blessings of His associates, there should be no discrimination in this matter, but people in all parts of the world should be trained to preach and given *sannyāsa* so that the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's *saṅkīrtana* movement will expand boundlessly. We do not care about the criticism of fools. We shall go on with our work and simply depend on the blessings of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His associates, the Pañca-tattva.

TEXT 164

mathurāte pāṭhāila rūpa-sanātana

dui senā-pati kaila bhakti pracāraṇa

SYNONYMS

mathurāte—toward Mathurā; *pāṭhāila*—sent; *rūpa-sanātana*—the two brothers Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī; *dui*—both of them; *senā-pati*—as commanders in chief; *kaila*—He made them; *bhakti*—devotional service; *pracāraṇa*—to broadcast.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya dispatched the two generals Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī to Vṛndāvana to preach the bhakti cult.

PURPORT

When Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī went to Vṛndāvana, there was not a single temple, but by their preaching they were gradually able to construct various temples. Sanātana Gosvāmī constructed the Madana-mohana temple, and Rūpa Gosvāmī constructed the Govindajī temple. Similarly, their nephew Jīva Gosvāmī constructed the Rādhā-Dāmodara temple, Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī constructed the Rādhā-ramaṇa temple, Śrī Lokanātha Gosvāmī constructed the Gokulānanda temple, and

Śyāmānanda Gosvāmī constructed the Śyāmasundara temple. In this way, many temples were gradually constructed. For preaching, construction of temples is also necessary. The Gosvāmīs not only engaged in writing books but also constructed temples because both are needed for preaching work. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted the cult of His *saṅkīrtana* movement to spread all over the world. Now that the International Society for Krishna Consciousness has taken up this task of preaching the cult of Lord Caitanya, its members should not only construct temples in every town and village of the globe but also distribute the books that have already been written and further increase the number of books. Both distribution of books and construction of temples must continue side by side in parallel lines.

TEXT 165

nityānanda-gosāṇe pāṭhāilā gauḍa-deśe

teṇho bhakti pracārilā aśeṣa-viśeṣe

SYNONYMS

nityānanda—Lord Nityānanda; *gosāṇe*—the *ācārya*; *pāṭhāilā*—was sent; *gauḍa-deśe*—in Bengal; *teṇho*—He; *bhakti*—devotional cult; *pracārilā*—preached; *aśeṣa-viśeṣe*—in a very extensive way.

TRANSLATION

As Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī were sent toward Mathurā, so Nityānanda Prabhu was sent to Bengal to preach extensively the cult of Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

The name of Lord Nityānanda is very famous in Bengal. Of course, anyone who knows Lord Nityānanda knows Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

also, but there are some misguided devotees who stress the importance of Lord Nityānanda more than that of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. This is not good. Nor should Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu be stressed more than Lord Nityānanda. The author of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, left his home because of his brother's stressing the importance of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu over that of Nityānanda Prabhu. Actually, one should offer respect to the Pañca-tattva without such foolish discrimination, not considering Nityānanda Prabhu to be greater, Caitanya Mahāprabhu to be greater or Advaita Prabhu to be greater. The respect should be offered equally: *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. All devotees of Lord Caitanya or Nityānanda are worshipable persons.

TEXT 166

āpane dakṣiṇa deśa karilā gamana

grāme grāme kailā kṛṣṇa-nāma pracāraṇa

SYNONYMS

āpane—personally; *dakṣiṇa deśa*—South India; *karilā*—went; *gamana*—traveling; *grāme grāme*—in each and every village; *kailā*—He did; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pracāraṇa*—broadcasting.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu personally went to South India, and He broadcast the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa in every village and town.

TEXT 167

setubandha paryanta kailā bhaktira pracāra

kṛṣṇa-prema diyā kailā sabāra nistāra

SYNONYMS

setubandha—the place where Lord Rāmacandra constructed His bridge; *panyanta*—up to that place; *kailā*—did; *bhaktira*—of the cult of devotional service; *pracāra*—broadcast; *kṛṣṇa-prema*—love of Kṛṣṇa; *diyā*—delivering; *kailā*—did; *sabāra*—everyone; *nistāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

Thus the Lord went to the southernmost tip of the Indian peninsula, known as Setubandha [Cape Comorin]. Everywhere He distributed the bhakti cult and love of Kṛṣṇa, and in this way He delivered everyone.

TEXT 168

ei ta' kahila pañca-tattvera vyākhyāna

ihāra śravaṇe haya caitanya-tattva jñāna

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—this; *kahila*—described; *pañca-tattvera*—of the Pañca-tattva; *vyākhyāna*—explanation; *ihāra*—of this; *śravaṇe*—hearing; *haya*—becomes; *caitanya-tattva*—the truth of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jñāna*—knowledge.

TRANSLATION

I have thus explained the truth of the Pañca-tattva. One who hears this explanation increases in knowledge of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

The Pañca-tattva is a very important factor in understanding Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. There are *sahajiyās* who, not knowing the

importance of the Pañca-tattva, concoct their own slogans, such as *bhaja nitāi gaura, rādhe śyāma, japa hare kṛṣṇa hare rāma* or *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda hare kṛṣṇa hare rāma śrī-rādhe govinda*. Such chants may be good poetry, but they cannot help us to go forward in devotional service. In such chants there are also many discrepancies, which need not be discussed here. Strictly speaking, when chanting the names of the Pañca-tattva, one should fully offer his obeisances: *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. By such chanting one is blessed with the competency to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* without offense. When chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, one should also chant it fully: Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare. One should not foolishly adopt any of the slogans concocted by imaginative devotees. If one actually wants to derive the effects of chanting, one must strictly follow the great *ācāryas*. This is confirmed in the *Mahābhārata*: *mahā-jano yena gataḥ sa panthāḥ*. “The real path of progress is that which is traversed by great *ācāryas* and authorities.”

TEXT 169

śrī-caitanya, nityānanda, advaita,——tina jana

śrīvāsa-gadādhara-ādi yata bhakta-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya, nityānanda, advaita—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu and Advaita Prabhu; *tina*—these three; *jana*—personalities; *śrīvāsa-gadādhara*—Śrīvāsa and Gadādhara; *ādi*—etc.; *yata*—all; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees.

TRANSLATION

While chanting the Pañca-tattva mahā-mantra, one must chant the names of Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda, Advaita, Gadādhara and Śrīvāsa with their

many devotees. This is the process.

TEXT 170

sabākāra pādapadme koṭi namaskāra

yaiche taiche kahi kichu caitanya-vihāra

SYNONYMS

sabākāra—all of them; *pāda-padme*—on the lotus feet; *koṭi*—countless; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *yaiche taiche*—somehow or other; *kahi*—I speak; *kichu*—something; *caitanya-vihāra*—about the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

I again and again offer obeisances unto the Pañca-tattva. Thus I think that I will be able to describe something about the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 171

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted to preach the *saṅkīrtana* movement of love of Kṛṣṇa throughout the entire world, and therefore during His presence He inspired the *saṅkīrtana* movement. Specifically, He sent Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī to Vṛndāvana and Nityānanda to Bengal and personally went to South India. In this way He kindly left the task of preaching His cult in the rest of the world to the International Society for Krishna Consciousness. The members of this Society must always remember that if they stick to the regulative principles and preach sincerely according to the instructions of the *ācāryas*, surely they will have the profound blessings of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and their preaching work will be successful everywhere throughout the world.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Seventh Chapter, describing Lord Caitanya in five features.

Chapter 8

The Author Receives the Orders of Kṛṣṇa and Guru

The Eighth Chapter of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* is summarized by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. In this chapter the glories of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda are described, and it is also stated that one who commits offenses in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* does not achieve love of Godhead, even after chanting for many years. In this connection, Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura warns against artificial displays of the bodily symptoms called *aṣṭa-sāttvika-vikāra*. That

is also an offense. One should seriously and sincerely continue to chant the Pañca-tattva names *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. All these *ācāryas* will bestow their causeless mercy upon a devotee and gradually purify his heart. When he is actually purified, automatically he will experience ecstasy in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. Previous to the composition of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura wrote a book called *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*. Only those subjects which were not discussed by Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura in his *Caitanya-bhāgavata* have been taken up by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī to be depicted in *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. In his very old age, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī went to Vṛndāvana, and by the order of Śrī Madana-mohanaji he wrote *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. Thus we are now able to relish its transcendental bliss.

TEXT 1

vande caitanya-devam tam

bhagavantam yad-icchayā

prasabham nartyate citram

lekha-raṅge jaḍo 'py ayam

SYNONYMS

vande—I offer my respectful obeisances; *caitanya-devam*—unto Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tam*—Him; *bhagavantam*—the Personality of Godhead; *yad-icchayā*—by whose desires; *prasabham*—all of a sudden; *nartyate*—dancing; *citram*—wonderfully; *lekha-raṅge*—in the matter of writing; *jaḍaḥ*—dull fool; *api*—although; *ayam*—this.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respects to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by whose desire I have become like a dancing dog and suddenly taken to the writing of Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, although I am a fool.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gauracandra

jaya jaya paramānanda jaya nityānanda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gaura-candra*—whose name is Lord Gaurāṅga; *jaya jaya*—all glories; *paramānanda*—most joyful; *jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—unto Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is known as Gaurasundara. I also offer my respectful obeisances unto Nityānanda Prabhu, who is always very joyful.

TEXT 3

jaya jayādvaita ācārya kṛpāmaya

jaya jaya gadādhara paṇḍita mahāśaya

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *advaita*—unto Advaita Prabhu; *ācārya*—teacher; *kṛpāmaya*—very merciful; *jaya jaya*—all glories to; *gadādhara*—Gadādhara; *paṇḍita*—learned scholar; *mahāśaya*—great personality.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto Advaita Ācārya, who is very merciful, and also to that great personality Gadādhara Paṇḍita, the learned scholar.

TEXT 4

jaya jaya śrīvāsādi yata bhakta-gaṇa

praṇata ha-iyā vandoni sabāra caraṇa

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrīvāsa-ādi*—unto Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, etc.; *yata*—all; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *praṇata*—offering obeisances; *ha-iyā*—doing so; *vandoni*—I pray; *sabāra*—all; *caraṇa*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura and all the other devotees of the Lord. I fall down to offer them respect. I worship their lotus feet.

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī teaches us first to offer respect to the Pañca-tattva—Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu, Advaita Prabhu, Gadādhara Prabhu and Śrīvāsa Prabhu and other devotees. We must strictly follow the principle of offering our respects to the Pañca-tattva, as summarized in the *mantra śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. At the beginning of every function in preaching, especially before chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*—Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare—we must chant

the Pañca-tattva's names and offer our respects to them.

TEXT 5

mūka kavitva kare yāñ-sabāra smaraṇe

paṅgu giri laṅghe, andha dekhe tārā-gaṇe

SYNONYMS

mūka—dumb; *kavitva*—poet; *kare*—becomes; *yāñ*—whose; *sabāra*—all; *smaraṇe*—by remembering; *paṅgu*—the lame; *giri*—mountains; *laṅghe*—crosses; *andha*—blind; *dekhe*—sees; *tārā-gaṇe*—the stars.

TRANSLATION

By remembering the lotus feet of the Pañca-tattva, a dumb man can become a poet, a lame man can cross mountains, and a blind man can see the stars in the sky.

PURPORT

In Vaiṣṇava philosophy there are three ways for perfection—namely *sādhana-siddha*, perfection attained by executing devotional service according to the rules and regulations, *nitya-siddha*, eternal perfection attained by never forgetting Kṛṣṇa at any time, and *kṛpā-siddha*, perfection attained by the mercy of the spiritual master or another Vaiṣṇava. Kavirāja Gosvāmī here stresses *kṛpā-siddha*, perfection by the mercy of superior authorities. This mercy does not depend on the qualifications of a devotee. By such mercy, even if a devotee is dumb he can speak or write to glorify the Lord splendidly, even if lame he can cross mountains, and even if blind he can see the stars in the sky.

TEXT 6

e-saba nā māne yei paṇḍita sakala

tā-sabāra vidyā-pāṭha bheka-kolāhala

SYNONYMS

e-saba—all these; *nā*—does not; *māne*—accept; *yei*—anyone; *paṇḍita*—so-called learned; *sakala*—all; *tā-sabāra*—of all of them; *vidyā-pāṭha*—the educational cultivation; *bheka*—of frogs; *kolāhala*—tumultuous sound.

TRANSLATION

The education cultivated by so-called learned scholars who do not believe these statements of Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta is like the tumultuous croaking of frogs.

PURPORT

The croaking of the frogs in the rainy season resounds very loudly in the forest, with the result that snakes, hearing the croaking in the darkness, approach the frogs and swallow them. Similarly, the so-called educational vibrations of the tongues of university professors who do not have spiritual knowledge is like the croaking of frogs.

TEXT 7

ei saba nā māne yebā kare kṛṣṇa-bhakti

kṛṣṇa-kṛpā nāhi tāre, nāhi tāra gati

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *saba*—all; *nā māne*—does not accept; *yebā*—anyone who; *kare*—executes; *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*—devotional service; *kṛṣṇa-kṛpā*—mercy

of Kṛṣṇa; *nāhi*—is not; *tāre*—unto him; *nāhi*—there is not; *tāra*—his; *gati*—advancement.

TRANSLATION

One who does not accept the glories of the Pañca-tattva but still makes a show of devotional service to Kṛṣṇa can never achieve the mercy of Kṛṣṇa or advance to the ultimate goal.

PURPORT

If one is seriously interested in Kṛṣṇa conscious activities, he must be ready to follow the rules and regulations laid down by the *ācāryas*, and he must understand their conclusions. The *sāstra* says, *dharmasya tattvam nihitam guhāyām mahā-jano yena gataḥ sa panthāḥ* (*Mahābhārata*, *Vana-parva* 313.117). It is very difficult to understand the secret of Kṛṣṇa consciousness, but one who advances by the instruction of the previous *ācāryas* and follows in the footsteps of his predecessors in the line of disciplic succession will have success. Others will not. Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura says in this connection, *chāḍiyā vaiṣṇava-sevā nistāra peyeche kebā*: “Unless one serves the spiritual master and *ācāryas*, one cannot be liberated.” Elsewhere he says:

*ei chaya gosāñi yāñra—mui tāñra dāsa
tāñ-sabāra pada-reṇu mora pañca-grāsa*

“I simply accept a person who follows in the footsteps of the six Gosvāmīs, and the dust of such a person’s lotus feet is my food.”

TEXT 8

pūrve yaiche jarāsandha-ādi rāja-gaṇa

veda-dharma kari’ kare viṣṇura pūjana

SYNONYMS

pūrve—formerly; *yaiche*—as it was; *jarāsandha*—King Jarāsandha; *ādi*—heading; *rāja-gaṇa*—kings; *veda-dharma*—performance of Vedic rituals; *kari’*—doing; *kare*—does; *viṣṇura*—of Lord Viṣṇu; *pūjana*—worship.

TRANSLATION

Formerly kings like Jarāsandha [the father-in-law of Kāṁsa] strictly followed the Vedic rituals, thus worshiping Lord Viṣṇu.

PURPORT

In these verses the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, is very seriously stressing the importance of worship of the Pañca-tattva. If one becomes a devotee of Gaurasundara or Kṛṣṇa but does not give importance to the Pañca-tattva (*śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*), his activities are considered to be offenses, or, in the words of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, *utpāta* (disturbances). One must therefore be ready to offer due respects to the Pañca-tattva before becoming a devotee of Lord Gaurasundara or of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 9

kṛṣṇa nāhi māne, tāte daitya kari’ māni

caitanya nā mānile taiche daitya tāre jāni

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nāhi*—does not; *māne*—accept; *tāte*—therefore; *daitya*—demon; *kari’ māni*—we accept; *caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nā*—without; *mānile*—accepting; *taiche*—similarly;

daitya—demon; *tāre*—to him; *jāni*—we know.

TRANSLATION

One who does not accept Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead is certainly a demon. Similarly, anyone who does not accept Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as Kṛṣṇa, the same Supreme Lord, is also to be considered a demon.

PURPORT

Formerly there were kings like Jarāsandha who strictly followed the Vedic rituals, acted as charitable, competent *kṣatriyas*, possessed all *kṣatriya* qualities and were even obedient to the brahminical culture but who did not accept Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Jarāsandha attacked Kṛṣṇa many times, and each time, of course, he was defeated. Like Jarāsandha, any man who performs Vedic rituals but does not accept Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead must be considered an *asura*, or demon. Similarly, one who does not accept Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as Kṛṣṇa Himself is also a demon. This is the conclusion of authoritative scriptures. Therefore, both so-called devotion to Gaurasundara without devotional service to Kṛṣṇa and so-called *kṛṣṇa-bhakti* without devotional service to Gaurasundara are nondevotional activities. If one wants to be successful on the path of Kṛṣṇa consciousness, he must be thoroughly conscious of the personality of Gaurasundara as well as the personality of Kṛṣṇa. Knowing the personality of Gaurasundara means knowing the personalities of *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. The author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, pursuant to the authorities, stresses this principle for perfection in Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

TEXT 10

more nā mānile saba loka habe nāśa

ithi lāgi' kṛpārdra prabhu karila sannyāsa

SYNONYMS

more—unto Me; *nā*—without; *mānile*—accepting; *saba*—all; *loka*—people in general; *habe*—will go to; *nāśa*—destruction; *ithi*—for this; *lāgi'*—for the reason of; *kṛpā-ārdra*—all merciful; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya; *karila*—accepted; *sannyāsa*—the *sannyāsa* order.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu thought, “Unless people accept Me they will all be destroyed.” Thus the merciful Lord accepted the *sannyāsa* order.

PURPORT

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (12.3.51) it is said, *kīrtanād eva kṛṣṇasya mukta-saṅgaḥ param vrajet*: “Simply by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, or Lord Kṛṣṇa’s name, one is liberated and goes back home, back to Godhead.” This Kṛṣṇa consciousness must be achieved through the mercy of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. One cannot be complete in Kṛṣṇa consciousness unless he accepts Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His associates as the only means for success. It is because of these considerations that the Lord accepted *sannyāsa*, for thus people would offer Him respect and very quickly come to the platform of Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Since Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is Kṛṣṇa Himself, inaugurated the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, without His mercy one cannot be elevated to the transcendental platform of Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

TEXT 11

sannyāsi-buddhye more karibe namaskāra

tathāpi khaṇḍibe duḥkha, pāibe nistāra

SYNONYMS

sannyāsi-buddhye—by consideration of a *sannyāsi*; *more*—unto Me; *karibe*—they will; *namaskāra*—offer obeisances; *tathāpi*—therefore; *khaṇḍibe*—will diminish; *duḥkha*—distress; *pāibe*—will get; *nistāra*—liberation.

TRANSLATION

“If a person offers obeisances to Me, even due to accepting Me only as an ordinary *sannyāsi*, his material distresses will diminish, and he will ultimately get liberation.”

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇa is so merciful that He always thinks of how to liberate the conditioned souls from the material platform. It is for this reason that Kṛṣṇa incarnates, as clearly indicated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.7):

*yadā yadā hi dharmasya glānir bhavati bhārata
abhyutthānam adharmasya tadātmānaṁ sṛjāmy aham*

“Whenever and wherever there is a decline in religious practice, O descendant of Bharata, and a predominant rise of irreligion—at that time I descend Myself.” Kṛṣṇa always protects the living entities in many ways. He comes Himself, He sends His own confidential devotees, and He leaves behind Him *sāstras* like the *Bhagavad-gītā*. Why? It is so that people may take advantage of the benediction to be liberated from the clutches of *māyā*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted *sannyāsa* so that even a foolish person who accepted Him as an ordinary *sannyāsi* would offer Him respect, for this would help diminish his material distresses and ultimately liberate him from the material clutches. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī points out in this connection that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the combined form of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa (*mahāprabhu śrī-caitanya, rādhā-kṛṣṇa—nahe anya*). Therefore when fools considered

Caitanya Mahāprabhu to be an ordinary human being and thus treated Him disrespectfully, the merciful Lord, in order to deliver these offenders, accepted *sannyāsa* so that they would offer Him obeisances, accepting Him as a *sannyāsī*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted *sannyāsa* to bestow His great mercy on people in general, who cannot appreciate Him as Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa Themselves.

TEXT 12

hena kṛpāmaya caitanya nā bhaje yei jana

sarvottama ha-ileo tāre asure gaṇana

SYNONYMS

hena—such; *kṛpāmaya*—merciful; *caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya; *nā*—does not; *bhaje*—worship; *yei*—one; *jana*—person; *sarvottama*—supreme; *ha-ileo*—in spite of his being; *tāre*—unto him; *asure*—among the demons; *gaṇana*—the calculation.

TRANSLATION

One who does not show respect unto this merciful Lord, Caitanya Mahāprabhu, or does not worship Him should be considered a demon, even if he is very much exalted in human society.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Mahārāja says in this connection: “O living entities, simply engage yourselves in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. This is the message of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.” Lord Caitanya preached this cult, instructing the philosophy of Kṛṣṇa consciousness in His eight verses, or *Śikṣāṣṭaka*, and He said, *ihā haite sarva-siddhi haibe tomāra*: “By chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, one will get all perfection in life.” Therefore one who does not show Him respect or cannot appreciate His

mercy despite all these merciful gestures is an *asura*, or opponent of bona fide devotional service to Lord Viṣṇu, even though he may be very much exalted in human society. The word *asura* refers to one who is against devotional service to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Viṣṇu. It should be noted that unless one worships Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu it is useless to become a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, and unless one worships Kṛṣṇa it is also useless to become a devotee of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Such devotional service is to be understood to be a product of Kali-yuga. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura remarks in this connection that atheist *smārtas*, or worshipers of the five kinds of demigods, worship Lord Viṣṇu for a little satisfaction in material success but have no respect for Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Thinking Him to be one of the ordinary living entities, they discriminate between Gaurasundara and Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Such understanding is also demoniac and is against the conclusion of the *ācāryas*. Such a conclusion is a product of Kali-yuga.

TEXT 13

ataeva punaḥ kahoṁ ūrdhva-bāhu hañā

caitanya-nityānanda bhaja kutarka chāḍiyā

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *punaḥ*—again; *kahoṁ*—I speak; *ūrdhva*—lifting; *bāhu*—arms; *hañā*—so doing; *caitanya*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *bhaja*—worship; *kutarka*—useless arguments; *chāḍiyā*—giving up.

TRANSLATION

Therefore I say again, lifting my arms: O fellow human beings, please worship Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda without false arguments!

PURPORT

Because a person who performs *kṛṣṇa-bhakti* but does not understand Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Prabhu Nityānanda will simply waste his time, the author, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, requests everyone to take to the worship of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda Prabhu and the Pañca-tattva. He assures everyone that any person who does so will be successful in Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

TEXT 14

yadi vā tār̥kika kahe,——tarka se pramāṇa

tarka-sāstre siddha yei, sei sevyamāna

SYNONYMS

yadi—if; *vā*—or; *tār̥kika*—logician; *kahe*—says; *tarka*—logic; *se*—that; *pramāṇa*—evidence; *tarka-sāstre*—in the logic; *siddha*—accepted; *yei*—whatever; *sei*—that; *sevyamāna*—is worshipable.

TRANSLATION

Logicians say, “Unless one gains understanding through logic and argument, how can one decide upon a worshipable Deity?”

TEXT 15

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-dayā karaḥa vicāra

vicāra karite citte pābe camatkāra

SYNONYMS

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dayā*—His mercy; *karaḥa*—just put into; *vicāra*—consideration; *vicāra*—when such consideration; *karite*—will be done by you; *citte*—in your heart; *pābe*—

you will get; *camatkāra*—striking wonder.

TRANSLATION

If you are indeed interested in logic and argument, kindly apply it to the mercy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. If you do so, you will find it to be strikingly wonderful.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura comments in this connection that people in general, in their narrow-minded conception of life, create many different types of humanitarian activities, but the humanitarian activities inaugurated by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu are different. For logicians who want to accept only that which is proven through logic and argument, it is a fact that without logic and reason there can be no question of accepting the Absolute Truth. Unfortunately, when such logicians take to this path without the mercy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, they remain on the platform of logic and argument and do not advance in spiritual life. However, if one is intelligent enough to apply his arguments and logic to the subtle understanding of the fundamental spiritual substance, he will be able to know that a poor fund of knowledge established on the basis of material logic cannot help one understand the Absolute Truth, which is beyond the reach of imperfect senses. The *Mahābhārata* therefore says, *acintyāḥ khalu ye bhāvā na tāṁs tarkeṇa yojayet. (Mahābhārata, Bhīṣma-parva 5.22)* How can that which is beyond the imagination or sensory speculation of mundane creatures be approached simply by logic? Logic and argument are very poor in spiritual strength and always imperfect when applied to spiritual understanding. By putting forward mundane logic one frequently comes to the wrong conclusion regarding the Absolute Truth, and as a result of such a conclusion one may fall down to accept a body like that of a jackal.

Despite all this, those who are actually inquisitive to understand the philosophy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu through logic and argument are

welcome. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī addresses them, “Please put Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s mercy to your crucial test, and if you are actually a logician you will come to the right conclusion that there is no personality more merciful than Lord Caitanya.” Let the logicians compare all the results of other humanitarian work with the merciful activities of Lord Caitanya. If their judgment is impartial, they will understand that no other humanitarian activities can surpass those of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Everyone is engaged in humanitarian activities on the basis of the body, but from the *Bhagavad-gītā* (2.18) we understand, *anta-vanta ime dehā nityasyoktāḥ śārīraṇaḥ*: “The material body is ultimately subject to destruction, whereas the spiritual soul is eternal.” Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s philanthropic activities are performed in connection with the eternal soul. However one tries to benefit the body, it will be destroyed, and one will have to accept another body according to his present activities. If one does not, therefore, understand this science of transmigration but considers the body to be all in all, his intelligence is not very advanced. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, without neglecting the necessities of the body, imparted spiritual advancement to purify the existential condition of humanity. Therefore if a logician makes his judgment impartially, he will surely find that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the *mahā-vadānyāvatāra*, the most magnanimous incarnation. He is even more magnanimous than Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself. Lord Kṛṣṇa demanded that one surrender unto Him, but He did not distribute love of Godhead as magnanimously as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Therefore Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī offers Lord Caitanya his respectful obeisances with the words *namo mahā-vadānyāya kṛṣṇa-prema-pradāya te/ kṛṣṇāya kṛṣṇa-caitanya-nāmne gaura-tviṣe namaḥ* [Madhya 19.53]. Lord Kṛṣṇa simply gave the *Bhagavad-gītā*, by which one can understand Lord Kṛṣṇa as He is, but Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is also Kṛṣṇa Himself, gave people love of Kṛṣṇa without discrimination.

TEXT 16

bahu janma kare yadi śravaṇa, kīrtana

tabu ta' nā pāya kṛṣṇa-pade prema-dhana

SYNONYMS

bahu—many; *janma*—births; *kare*—does; *yadi*—if; *śravaṇa*—hearing; *kīrtana*—chanting; *tabu*—still; *ta'*—in spite of; *nā*—does not; *pāya*—get; *kṛṣṇa-pade*—unto the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa; *prema-dhana*—love of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

If one is infested with the ten offenses in the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra, despite his endeavor to chant the holy name for many births, he will not get the love of Godhead that is the ultimate goal of this chanting.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura says in this connection that although one may go on chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* for many, many years, there is no possibility of attaining the platform of devotional service unless one accepts Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. One must follow strictly the instruction of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu given in the *Śikṣāṣṭaka* (3):

*tṛṇād api su-nīcena taror iva sahiṣṇunā
amāninā māna-dena kīrtanīyaḥ sadā hariḥ*

[Cc. adi 17.31]

“One should chant the holy name of the Lord in a humble state of mind, thinking oneself lower than the straw in the street; one should be more tolerant than a tree, devoid of all sense of false prestige, and should be ready to offer all respect to others. In such a state of mind one can chant

the holy name of the Lord constantly.” One who follows this direction, being freed from the ten kinds of offenses, becomes successful in Kṛṣṇa consciousness and ultimately reaches the platform of loving service to the Personality of Godhead.

One must come to the understanding that the holy name of the Lord and the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself are identical. One cannot reach this conclusion unless one is offenseless in chanting the holy name. By our material calculation we see a difference between the name and the substance, but in the spiritual world the Absolute is always absolute: the name, form, qualities and pastimes of the Absolute are all as good as the Absolute Himself. Thus one is understood to be an eternal servant of the Supreme Personality of Godhead if he considers himself an eternal servant of the holy name and in this spirit distributes the holy name to the world. One who chants in that spirit, without offenses, is certainly elevated to the platform of understanding that the holy name and the Personality of Godhead are identical. To associate with the holy name and chant the holy name is to associate with the Personality of Godhead directly. In the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* it is clearly said, *sevonmukhe hi jihvādau svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ*. The holy name becomes manifest when one engages in the service of the holy name. This service in a submissive attitude begins with one’s tongue. *Sevonmukhe hi jihvādau*: One must engage his tongue in the service of the holy name. Our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is based on this principle. We try to engage all the members of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement in the service of the holy name. Since the holy name and Kṛṣṇa are nondifferent, the members of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement not only chant the holy name of the Lord offenselessly, but also do not allow their tongues to eat anything that is not first offered to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Supreme Lord declares:

*patraṁ puṣpaṁ phalaṁ toyam yo me bhaktyā prayacchati
tad ahaṁ bhakty-upahṛtaṁ aśnāmi prayatātmanaḥ*

“If one offers Me with love and devotion a leaf, a flower, a fruit or water,

I will accept it.” (Bg. 9.26) Therefore the International Society for Krishna Consciousness has many temples all over the world, and in each and every temple the Lord is offered these foods. On the basis of His demands, the devotees chant the holy name of the Lord offenselessly and never eat anything that is not first offered to the Lord. The functions of the tongue in devotional service are to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* and eat *prasādam* that is offered to the Lord.

TEXT 17

jñānataḥ su-labhā muktir

bhuktir yajñādi-puṇyataḥ

seyaṁ sādhana-sāhasrair

hāri-bhaktiḥ su-durlabhā

SYNONYMS

jñānataḥ—by cultivation of knowledge; *su-labhā*—easily obtainable; *muktiḥ*—liberation; *bhuktiḥ*—sense enjoyment; *yajña-ādi*—performance of sacrifices, etc.; *puṇyataḥ*—and by performing pious activities; *sā*—that; *iyam*—this; *sādhana-sāhasraiḥ*—execution of thousands of sacrifices; *hari-bhaktiḥ*—devotional service; *su-durlabhā*—is very rare.

TRANSLATION

“By cultivating philosophical knowledge one can understand his spiritual position and thus be liberated, and by performing sacrifices and pious activities one can achieve sense gratification in a higher planetary system, but the devotional service of the Lord is so rare that even by executing hundreds and thousands of such sacrifices one cannot obtain it.”

PURPORT

Prahlāda Mahārāja instructs:

*matir na kṛṣṇe parataḥ svato vā
mitho 'bhipadyeta gṛha-vratānām*

(*Bhāg. 7.5.30*)

*naiṣāṁ matis tāvad urukramāṅghriṁ
sprśaty anarthāpagamo yad-arthaḥ*

*mahīyasāṁ pāda-rajo- 'bhiṣekaṁ
niṣkiñcanānām na vṛṇīta yāvat*

(*Bhāg. 7.5.32*)

These *śloka*s are to be discussed. Their purport is that one cannot obtain *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*, or the devotional service of the Lord, by official execution of the Vedic rituals. One has to approach a pure devotee. Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura sings, *chāḍiyā vaiṣṇava-sevā nistāra pāyeche kebā*: “Who has been elevated without rendering service to a pure Vaiṣṇava?” It is the statement of Prahlāda Mahārāja that unless one is able to accept the dust from the lotus feet of a pure Vaiṣṇava there is no possibility of achieving the platform of devotional service. That is the secret. The above-mentioned *tantra-vacana*, quoted from the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (1.1.36), is our perfect guidance in this connection.

TEXT 18

kṛṣṇa yadi chuṭe bhakte bhukti mukti diyā

kabhu prema-bhakti nā dena rākhena lukāiyā

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yadi*—of course; *chuṭe*—goes away; *bhakte*—unto

the devotee; *bhukti*—material enjoyment; *mukti*—liberation; *diyā*—offering; *kabhu*—at any time; *prema-bhakti*—love of Godhead; *nā*—does not; *dena*—give; *rākhena*—keeps; *lukāiyā*—hiding.

TRANSLATION

If a devotee wants liberation or material sense gratification from the Lord, Kṛṣṇa immediately delivers it, but pure devotional service He keeps hidden.

TEXT 19

rājan patir gurur alaṁ bhavatām yadūnām
daivam priyaḥ kula-patiḥ kva ca kiṅkaro vaḥ
astv evaṁ aṅga bhagavān bhajatām mukundo
muktim dadāti karhicit sma na bhakti-yogam

SYNONYMS

rājan—O King; *patiḥ*—master; *guruḥ*—spiritual master; *alaṁ*—certainly; *bhavatām*—of your; *yadūnām*—of the Yadus; *daivam*—God; *priyaḥ*—very dear; *kula-patiḥ*—head of the family; *kva*—even sometimes; *ca*—also; *kiṅkaraḥ*—order carrier; *vaḥ*—you; *astu*—there is; *evaṁ*—thus; *aṅga*—however; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *bhajatām*—those who are in devotional service; *mukundaḥ*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *muktim*—liberation; *dadāti*—gives; *karhicit*—sometimes; *sma*—certainly; *na*—not; *bhakti-yogam*—devotional service.

TRANSLATION

[The great sage Nārada said:] “My dear Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira, the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa is always ready to help you. He is

your master, guru, God, very dear friend and head of your family. Yet sometimes He agrees to act as your servant or order-carrier. You are greatly fortunate because this relationship is possible only by bhakti-yoga. The Lord can give liberation [mukti] very easily, but He does not very easily give one bhakti-yoga, because by that process He is bound to the devotee.”

PURPORT

This passage is a quotation from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (5.6.18). While Śukadeva Gosvāmī was describing the character of R̥ṣabhadeva, he distinguished between *bhakti-yoga* and liberation by reciting this verse. In relationship with the Yadus and Pāṇḍavas, the Lord acted sometimes as their master, sometimes as their advisor, sometimes as their friend, sometimes as the head of their family and sometimes even as their servant. Kṛṣṇa once had to carry out an order of Yudhiṣṭhira’s by carrying a letter Yudhiṣṭhira had written to Duryodhana regarding peace negotiations. Similarly, He also became the chariot driver of Arjuna. This illustrates that in *bhakti-yoga* there is a relationship established between the Supreme Personality of Godhead and the devotee. Such a relationship is established in the transcendental mellows known as *dāsyā*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *mādhurya*. If a devotee wants simple liberation, he gets it very easily from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as confirmed by Bilvamaṅgala Ṭhākura. *Muktiḥ svayaṁ mukulitāñjali sevate ’smān*: for a devotee, *mukti* is not very important because *mukti* is always standing on his doorstep waiting to serve him in some way. A devotee, therefore, must be attracted by the behavior of the inhabitants of Vṛndāvana, who live in a relationship with Kṛṣṇa. The land, water, cows, trees and flowers serve Kṛṣṇa in *śānta-rasa*, His servants serve Him in *dāsyā-rasa*, and His cowherd friends serve Him in *sakhya-rasa*. Similarly, the elder *gopīs* and *gopas* serve Kṛṣṇa as father and mother, uncle and other relatives, and the young *gopīs*, the cowherd girls, serve Kṛṣṇa in conjugal love.

While executing devotional service, one must be naturally inclined to serve Kṛṣṇa in one of these transcendental relationships. That is the

actual success of life. For a devotee, to get liberation is not very difficult. Even one who is unable to establish a relationship with Kṛṣṇa can achieve liberation by merging into the Brahman effulgence. This is called *sāyujya-mukti*. Vaiṣṇavas never accept *sāyujya-mukti*, although sometimes they accept the other forms of liberation, namely *sārūpya*, *sālokya*, *sāmīpya* and *sārṣṭi*. A pure devotee, however, does not accept any kind of *mukti*. He wants only to serve Kṛṣṇa in a transcendental relationship. This is the perfectional stage of spiritual life. Māyāvādī philosophers desire to merge into the existence of the Brahman effulgence, although this aspect of liberation is always neglected by devotees. Śrīla Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, describing this kind of *mukti*, which is called *kaivalya*, or becoming one with the Supreme, has said, *kaivalyam narakāyate*: “Becoming one with the Supreme is as good as going to hell.” Therefore the ideal of Māyāvāda philosophy, becoming one with the Supreme, is hellish for a devotee; he never accepts it. Māyāvādī philosophers do not know that even if they merge into the effulgence of the Supreme, this will not give them ultimate rest. An individual soul cannot live in the Brahman effulgence in a state of inactivity; after some time, he must desire to be active. However, since he is not aware of his relationship with the Supreme Personality of Godhead and therefore has no spiritual activity, he must come down for further activities in this material world. This is confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.2.32):

*āruhya kṛcchreṇa param padam tataḥ
patanty adho 'nādrta-yuṣmad-aṅghrayaḥ*

Because Māyāvādī philosophers have no information regarding the transcendental service of the Lord, even after attaining liberation from material activities and merging into the Brahman effulgence, they must come down again to this material world to open hospitals or schools or perform similar philanthropic activities.

TEXT 20

hena prema śrī-caitanya dilā yathā tathā

jagāi mādhai paryanta—anyera kā kathā

SYNONYMS

hena—such; *prema*—love of Godhead; *śrī-caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dilā*—has given; *yathā*—anywhere; *tathā*—everywhere; *jagāi*—Jagāi; *mādhai*—Mādhāi; *paryanta*—up to them; *anyera*—of others; *kā*—what to speak; *kathā*—words.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu has freely given this love of Kṛṣṇa everywhere and anywhere, even to the most fallen, such as Jagāi and Mādhāi. What then to speak of those who are already pious and elevated?

PURPORT

The distinction between Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s gift to human society and the gifts of others is that whereas so-called philanthropic and humanitarian workers have given some relief to human society as far as the body is concerned, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu offers the best facilities for going back home, back to Godhead, with love of Godhead. If one seriously makes a comparative study of the two gifts, certainly if he is at all sober he will give the greatest credit to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. It was with this purpose that Kavirāja Gosvāmī said:

*śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-dayā karaha vicāra
vicāra karile citte pābe camatkāra*

“If you are indeed interested in logic and argument, kindly apply it to the mercy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. If you do so, you will find it to be strikingly wonderful.” (Cc. *Ādi* 8.15)

Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura says:

*dīna-hīna yata chila, hari-nāme uddhārila,
tāra sākṣī jagāi mādhai*

The two brothers Jagāi and Mādhai epitomize the sinful population of this Age of Kali. They were most disturbing elements in society because they were meat-eaters, drunkards, woman-hunters, rogues and thieves. Yet Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu delivered them, to say nothing of others who were sober, pious, devoted and conscientious. The *Bhagavad-gītā* confirms that to say nothing of the brahminically qualified devotees and *rājārṣis* (*kiṁ punar brāhmaṇāḥ puṇyā bhaktā rājārṣayas tathā*), anyone who by the association of a pure devotee comes to Kṛṣṇa consciousness becomes eligible to go back home, back to Godhead. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.32) the Lord thus declares:

*mām hi pārtha vyapāśritya ye 'pi syuḥ pāpa-yonayaḥ
striyo vaiśyās tathā sūdrās te 'pi yānti parām gatim*

“O son of Pṛthā, those who take shelter in Me, though they be of lower birth—women, *vaiśyas* [merchants] and *sūdras* [workers]—can attain the supreme destination.”

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu delivered the two fallen brothers Jagāi and Mādhai, but the entire world is presently full of Jagāis and Mādhai, or, in other words, woman-hunters, meat-eaters, gamblers, thieves and other rogues, who create all kinds of disturbances in society. The activities of such persons have now become common practices. It is no longer considered abominable to be a drunkard, woman-hunter, meat-eater, thief or rogue, for these elements have been assimilated by human society. That does not mean, however, that the abominable qualities of such persons will help free human society from the clutches of *māyā*. Rather, they will entangle humanity more and more in the reactions of the stringent laws of material nature. One's activities are all performed under the influence of the modes of material nature (*prakṛteḥ kriyamāṇāni guṇaiḥ karmāṇi sarvaśaḥ* [Bg. 3.27]). Because people are now associating with the modes of ignorance (*tamo-guṇa*) and, to some extent, passion

(*rajo-guṇa*), with no trace of goodness (*sattva-guṇa*), they are becoming increasingly greedy and lusty, for that is the effect of associating with these modes. *Tadā rajas-tamo-bhavāḥ kāma-lobhādayaś ca ye:* “By associating with the two lower qualities of material nature, one becomes lusty and greedy.” (*Bhāg.* 1.2.19) Actually, in modern human society, everyone is greedy and lusty, and therefore the only means for deliverance is Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s *saṅkīrtana* movement, which can promote all the Jagāis and Mādhāis to the topmost position of *sattva-guṇa*, or brahminical culture.

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (1.2.18–19) states:

*naṣṭa-prāyeṣv abhadreṣu nityaṁ bhāgavata-sevayā
bhagavaty uttama-śloke bhaktir bhavati naiṣṭhikī
tadā rajas-tamo-bhāvāḥ kāma-lobhādayaś ca ye
ceta etair anāviddham sthitam sattve prasīdati*

Considering the chaotic condition of human society, if one actually wants peace and tranquillity, one must take to the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement and engage always in *bhāgavata-dharma*. Engagement in *bhāgavata-dharma* dissipates all ignorance and passion, and when ignorance and passion are dissipated one is freed from greed and lust. When freed from greed and lust, one becomes brahminically qualified, and when a brahminically qualified person makes further advancement, he becomes situated on the Vaiṣṇava platform. It is only on this Vaiṣṇava platform that it is possible to awaken one’s dormant love of Godhead, and as soon as one does so, his life is successful.

At present, human society is specifically cultivating the mode of ignorance (*tamo-guṇa*), although there may also be some symptoms of passion (*rajo-guṇa*). Full of *kāma* and *lobha*, lust and greed, the entire population of the world consists mostly of *sūdras* and a few *vaiśyas*, and gradually it is coming about that there are *sūdras* only. Communism is a movement of *sūdras*, and capitalism is meant for *vaiśyas*. In the fighting between these two factions, the *sūdras* and *vaiśyas*, gradually, due to the

abominable condition of society, the communists will emerge triumphant, and as soon as this takes place, whatever is left of society will be ruined. The only possible remedy that can counteract the tendency toward communism is the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, which can give even communists the real idea of communist society. According to the doctrine of communism, the state should be the proprietor of everything. But the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, expanding this same idea, accepts God as the proprietor of everything. People cannot understand this because they have no sense of God, but the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement can help them to understand God and to understand that everything belongs to God. Since everything is the property of God, and all living entities—not only human beings but even animals, birds, plants and so on—are children of God, everyone has the right to live at the cost of God with God consciousness. This is the sum and substance of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement.

TEXT 21

svatantra īśvara prema-nigūḍha-bhāṇḍāra

bilāila yāre tāre, nā kaila vicāra

SYNONYMS

svatantra—fully independent; *īśvara*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *prema*—love of God; *nigūḍha*—very confidential; *bhāṇḍāra*—stock; *bilāila*—distributed; *yāre*—to anyone; *tāre*—to everyone; *nā*—not; *kaila*—did; *vicāra*—consideration.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, as the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself, is fully independent. Therefore, although it is the most confidentially stored benediction, He can distribute love of Godhead to anyone and everyone without consideration.

PURPORT

This is the benefit of Lord Caitanya's movement. If one somehow or other comes in contact with the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement, without consideration of his being a *sūdra*, *vaiśya*, *Jagāi*, *Mādhāi* or even lower, he becomes advanced in spiritual consciousness and immediately develops love of Godhead. We now have actual experience that throughout the entire world this movement is making many such persons lovers of God simply by the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. Actually, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu has appeared as the spiritual master of the entire world. He does not discriminate between offenders and the innocent. *Kṛṣṇa-prema-pradāya te*: [Madhya 19.53] He liberally gives love of Godhead to anyone and everyone. This can be actually experienced, as stated in the next verse.

TEXT 22

adyāpiha dekha caitanya-nāma yei laya

kṛṣṇa-preme pulakāśru-vihvala se haya

SYNONYMS

adyāpiha—even up to date; *dekha*—you see; *caitanya-nāma*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's name; *yei*—anyone; *laya*—who takes; *kṛṣṇa-preme*—in love of Kṛṣṇa; *pulaka-aśru*—tears in ecstasy; *vihvala*—overwhelmed; *se*—he; *haya*—becomes.

TRANSLATION

Whether he is offensive or inoffensive, anyone who even now chants śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda is immediately overwhelmed with ecstasy, and tears fill his eyes.

PURPORT

The *prākṛta-sahajiyās* who chant *nītāi-gaura rādhe śyāma* have very little knowledge of the *Bhāgavata* conclusion, and they hardly follow the Vaiṣṇava rules and regulations, and yet because they chant *bhaja nītāi-gaura*, their chanting immediately evokes tears and other signs of ecstasy. Although they do not know the principles of Vaiṣṇava philosophy and are not very much advanced in education, by these symptoms they attract many men to become their followers. Their ecstatic tears will of course help them in the long run, for as soon as they come in contact with a pure devotee their lives will become successful. Even in the beginning, however, because they are chanting the holy names of *nītāi-gaura*, their swift advancement on the path of love of Godhead is very prominently visible.

TEXT 23

‘nityānanda’ balite haya kṛṣṇa-premodaya

āulāya sakala aṅga, aśru-gaṅgā vaya

SYNONYMS

nityānanda balite—while talking of Nityānanda Prabhu; *haya*—it so becomes; *kṛṣṇa-prema-udaya*—awakening of love of Kṛṣṇa; *āulāya*—agitated; *sakala*—all; *aṅga*—limbs of the body; *aśru-gaṅgā*—tears like the Ganges waters; *vaya*—flow down.

TRANSLATION

Simply by talking of Nityānanda Prabhu one awakens his love for Kṛṣṇa. Thus all his bodily limbs are agitated by ecstasy, and tears flow from his eyes like the waters of the Ganges.

TEXT 24

‘kṛṣṇa-nāma’ kare aparādhera vicāra

kṛṣṇa balile aparādhīra nā haya vikāra

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-nāma—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kare*—takes; *aparādhīra*—of offenses; *vicāra*—consideration; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *balile*—if one chants; *aparādhīra*—of the offenders; *nā*—never; *haya*—becomes; *vikāra*—changed.

TRANSLATION

There are offenses to be considered while chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra. Therefore simply by chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa one does not become ecstatic.

PURPORT

It is very beneficial to chant the names *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda* before chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* because by chanting these two holy names—*śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda*—one immediately becomes ecstatic, and if he then chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* he becomes free of offenses.

There are ten offenses to avoid in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. The first offense is to blaspheme great personalities who are engaged in distributing the holy name of the Lord. It is said in the *śāstra* (Cc. *Antya* 7.11), *kṛṣṇa-śakti vinā nahe tāra pravartana*: one cannot distribute the holy names of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* unless he is empowered by the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore one should not criticize or blaspheme a devotee who is thus engaged.

Śrī Padma Purāṇa states:

*satām nindā nāmnaḥ paramam aparādhām vitanute
yataḥ khyātim yātaṁ katham u sahate tad-vigarhām*

To blaspheme the great saintly persons who are engaged in preaching the glories of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* is the worst offense at the lotus feet of the holy name. One should not criticize a preacher of the glories of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. If one does so, he is an offender. The Nāma-prabhu, who is identical with Kṛṣṇa, will never tolerate such blasphemous activities, even from one who passes as a great devotee.

The second *nāmāparādha* is described as follows:

*śivasya śrī-viṣṇor ya iha guṇa-nāmādi-sakalam
dhiyā bhinnam paśyet sa khalu hari-nāmāhita-karaḥ*

In this material world, the holy name of Viṣṇu is all-auspicious. Viṣṇu's name, form, qualities and pastimes are all transcendental, absolute knowledge. Therefore, if one tries to separate the Absolute Personality of Godhead from His holy name or His transcendental form, qualities and pastimes, thinking them to be material, that is offensive. Similarly, to think that the names of demigods such as Lord Śiva are as good as the name of Lord Viṣṇu—or, in other words, to think that Lord Śiva and the other demigods are other forms of God and therefore equal to Viṣṇu—is also blasphemous. This is the second offense at the lotus feet of the holy name of the Lord.

The third offense at the lotus feet of the holy name, which is called *guror avajāñā*, is to consider the spiritual master to be material and therefore to envy his exalted position. The fourth offense (*śruti-śāstra-nindanam*) is to blaspheme Vedic literatures such as the four *Vedas* and the *Purāṇas*. The fifth offense (*artha-vādaḥ*) is to consider the glories of the holy name to be exaggerations. Similarly, the sixth offense (*hari-nāmni kalpanam*) is to consider the holy name of the Lord to be imaginary.

The seventh offense is described as follows:

*nāmno balād yasya hi pāpa-buddhir
na vidyate tasya yamair hi śuddhiḥ*

To think that since the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* can counteract all sinful reactions one may therefore go on with his sinful activities and at the same time chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* to neutralize them is the greatest offense at the lotus feet of *hari-nāma*.

The eighth offense is stated thus:

*dharma-vrata-tyāga-hutādi-sarva-
śubha-kriyā-sāmyam api pramādaḥ*

It is offensive to consider the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* to be a religious ritualistic ceremony. Performing religious ceremonies, following vows and practicing renunciation and sacrifice are all materialistic auspicious activities. The chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* must not be compared to such materialistic religiosity. This is an offense at the lotus feet of the holy name of the Lord.

The ninth offense is described as follows:

*aśraddadhāne vimukhe 'py aśṛṇvati
yaś copadeśaḥ śiva-nāmāparādhaḥ*

It is an offense to preach the glories of the holy name among persons who have no intelligence or no faith in the subject matter. Such people should be given the chance to hear the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, but in the beginning they should not be instructed about the glories or the spiritual significance of the holy name. By constant hearing of the holy name, their hearts will be purified, and then they will be able to understand the transcendental position of the holy name.

The tenth offense is as follows:

*śrute 'pi nāma-māhātmye yaḥ prīti-rahito naraḥ
ahaṁ-mamādi-paramo nāmni so 'py aparādha-kṛt*

If one has heard the glories of the transcendental holy name of the Lord but nevertheless continues in a materialistic concept of life, thinking “I am this body and everything belonging to this body is mine [*aham mameti* SB 5.5.8],” and does not show respect and love for the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, that is an offense.

TEXT 25

tad aśma-sāram hṛdayam batedam

yad gr̥hyamāṇair hari-nāmadheyaiḥ

na vikriyetātha yadā vikāro

netre jalam gātra-ruheṣu harṣaḥ

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *aśma-sāram*—as hard as iron; *hṛdayam*—heart; *bata*—O; *idam*—this; *yat*—which; *gr̥hyamāṇaiḥ*—in spite of taking the chanting; *hari-nāmadheyaiḥ*—meditating on the holy name of the Lord; *na*—does not; *vikriyeta*—change; *atha*—thus; *yadā*—when; *vikāraḥ*—transformation; *netre*—in the eyes; *jalam*—tears; *gātra-ruheṣu*—in the pores of the body; *harṣaḥ*—ecstasy.

TRANSLATION

“If one’s heart does not change, tears do not flow from his eyes, his body does not shiver, and his bodily hairs do not stand on end as he chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, it should be understood that his heart is as hard as iron. This is due to his offenses at the lotus feet of the Lord’s holy name.”

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, commenting on this verse, which is a quotation from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (2.3.24), remarks that sometimes a *mahā-bhāgavata*, or very advanced devotee, does not manifest such transcendental symptoms as tears in the eyes, whereas sometimes a *kaniṣṭha-adhikārī*, a neophyte devotee, displays them artificially. This does not mean, however, that the neophyte is more advanced than the *mahā-bhāgavata* devotee. The test of the real change of heart that takes place when one chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* is that one becomes detached from material enjoyment. This is the real change. *Bhaktir pareśānubhavo viraktir anyatra ca* (*Bhāg.* 11.2.42). If one is actually advancing in spiritual life, he must become very much detached from material enjoyment. If it is sometimes found that a *kaniṣṭha-adhikārī* (neophyte devotee) shows artificial tears in his eyes while chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* but is still completely attached to material things, his heart has not really changed. The change must be manifested in terms of one's real activities.

TEXT 26

‘eka’ kṛṣṇa-nāme kare sarva-pāpa nāśa

premera kāraṇa bhakti kareṇa prakāśa

SYNONYMS

eka—one; *kṛṣṇa-nāme*—by chanting the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kare*—makes; *sarva*—all; *pāpa*—sinful life; *nāśa*—exhausted; *premera*—of love of Godhead; *kāraṇa*—cause; *bhakti*—devotional service; *kareṇa*—becomes; *prakāśa*—manifest.

TRANSLATION

Simply chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* without offenses vanquishes all sinful activities. Thus pure devotional service, which is the cause of love of Godhead, becomes manifest.

PURPORT

One cannot be situated in the devotional service of the Lord unless one is free from sinful life. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.28):

*yeṣāṁ tv anta-gataṁ pāpaṁ janānāṁ puṇya-karmanām
te dvandva-moha-nirmuktā bhajante mām dṛḍha-vratāḥ*

“Persons who have acted piously in previous lives and in this life and whose sinful actions are completely eradicated are freed from the duality of delusion, and they engage themselves in My service with determination.” A person who is already cleansed of all tinges of sinful life engages without deviation or duality of purpose in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. In this age, although people are greatly sinful, simply chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* can relieve them from the reactions of their sins. *Eka kṛṣṇa-nāme*: only by chanting Kṛṣṇa’s name is this possible. This is confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (12.3.51): *kīrtanād eva kṛṣṇasya mukta-saṅgaḥ*. Caitanya Mahāprabhu has also taught us this. While passing on the road, He used to chant:

*kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa he
kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa he
kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa rakṣa mām
kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa pāhi mām
rāma rāghava rāma rāghava rāma rāghava rakṣa mām
kṛṣṇa keśava kṛṣṇa keśava kṛṣṇa keśava pāhi mām*

If one always chants the holy name of Kṛṣṇa, gradually one is freed from all reactions of sinful life, provided he chants offenselessly and does not commit more sinful activities on the strength of chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*. In this way one is purified, and his devotional service causes the arousal of his dormant love of God. If one simply chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* and does not commit sinful activities and offenses, one’s life is purified, and thus one comes to the fifth stage of perfection, or engagement in the loving service of the Lord (*premā pum-artho mahān*).

TEXT 27

premera udaye haya premera vikāra

sveda-kampa-pulakādi gadgadāśrudhāra

SYNONYMS

premera—of love of Godhead; *udaye*—when there is awakening; *haya*—it becomes so; *premera*—of love of Godhead; *vikāra*—transformation; *sveda*—perspiration; *kampa*—trembling; *pulaka-ādi*—throbbing of the heart; *gadgada*—faltering; *āśru-dhāra*—tears in the eyes.

TRANSLATION

When one's transcendental loving service to the Lord is actually awakened, it generates transformations in the body such as perspiration, trembling, throbbing of the heart, faltering of the voice and tears in the eyes.

PURPORT

These bodily transformations are automatically manifested when one is actually situated in love of Godhead. One should not artificially imitate them. Our disease is desire for that which is material; even while advancing in spiritual life, we want material acclaim. One must be freed from this disease. Pure devotion must be *anyābhilāṣitā-sūnyam* [*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* ^{vi}1.1.11], without desire for anything material. Advanced devotees manifest many bodily transformations, which are symptoms of ecstasy, but one should not imitate them to achieve cheap adoration from the public. When one actually attains the advanced stage, the ecstatic symptoms will appear automatically; one does not need to imitate them.

TEXT 28

anāyāse bhava-kṣaya, kṛṣṇera sevana

eka kṛṣṇa-nāmera phale pāi eta dhana

SYNONYMS

anāyāse—without hard labor; *bhava-kṣaya*—stoppage of repetition of birth and death; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *sevana*—service; *eka*—one; *kṛṣṇa-nāmera*—chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa; *phale*—as a result of; *pāi*—we achieve; *eta*—so much; *dhana*—wealth.

TRANSLATION

As a result of chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra, one makes such great advancement in spiritual life that simultaneously his material existence terminates and he receives love of Godhead. The holy name of Kṛṣṇa is so powerful that by chanting even one name, one very easily achieves these transcendental riches.

TEXTS 29–30

hena kṛṣṇa-nāma yadi laya bahu-bāra

tabu yadi prema nahe, nahe aśrudhāra

tabe jāni, aparādha tāhāte pracura

kṛṣṇa-nāma-bija tāhe nā kare aṅkura

SYNONYMS

hena—such; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—holy name of the Lord; *yadi*—if; *laya*—one takes; *bahu-bāra*—again and again; *tabu*—still; *yadi*—if; *prema*—love of Godhead; *nahe*—is not visible; *nahe aśru-dhāra*—there are no tears in the eyes; *tabe*—then; *jāni*—I understand; *aparādha*—offense; *tāhāte*—

there (in that process); *pracura*—enough; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Kṛṣṇa; *bija*—seed; *tāhe*—in those activities; *nā*—does not; *kare*—do; *aṅkura*—sprout.

TRANSLATION

If one chants the exalted holy name of the Lord again and again and yet his love for the Supreme Lord does not develop and tears do not appear in his eyes, it is evident that because of his offenses in chanting, the seed of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa does not sprout.

PURPORT

If one chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* offensively, one does not achieve the desired result. Therefore one should carefully avoid the offenses, which have already been described in connection with verse 24.

TEXT 31

caitanya-nityānande nāhi esaba vicāra

nāma laite prema dena, vahe aśrudhāra

SYNONYMS

caitanya-nityānande—when chanting the holy names of Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda; *nāhi*—there are not; *esaba*—all these; *vicāra*—considerations; *nāma*—the holy name; *laite*—simply by chanting; *prema*—love of Godhead; *dena*—they give; *vahe*—there is a flow; *aśru-dhāra*—tears in the eyes.

TRANSLATION

But if one only chants, with some slight faith, the holy names of Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda, very quickly he is cleansed of all offenses.

Thus as soon as he chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra, he feels the ecstasy of love for God.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura remarks in this connection that if one takes shelter of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda, follows Their instructions to become more tolerant than the tree and humbler than the grass, and in this way chants the holy name of the Lord, very soon he achieves the platform of transcendental loving service to the Lord, and tears appear in his eyes. There are offenses to be considered in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, but there are no such considerations in chanting the names of Gaura-Nityānanda. Therefore, if one chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* but his life is still full of sinful activities, it will be very difficult for him to achieve the platform of loving service to the Lord. But if in spite of being an offender one chants the holy names of Gaura-Nityānanda, he is very quickly freed from the reactions to his offenses. Therefore, one should first approach Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda, or worship Guru-Gaurāṅga, and then come to the stage of worshiping Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa. In our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, our students are first advised to worship Guru-Gaurāṅga, and then, when they are somewhat advanced, the Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa Deity is installed, and they are engaged in the worship of the Lord.

One should first take shelter of Gaura-Nityānanda in order to reach, ultimately, Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa. Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura sings in this connection:

gaurāṅga balite ha'be pulaka śārīra
hari hari balite nayane ba'be nīra

āra kabe nitāi-cāndera karuṇā karibe
saṁsāra-vāsanā mora kabe tuccha habe

viṣaya chāḍiyā kabe śuddha habe mana

kabe hāma heraba śrī-vṛndāvana

In the beginning one should very regularly chant Śrī Gaurasundara's holy name and then chant the holy name of Lord Nityānanda. Thus one's heart will be cleansed of impure desires for material enjoyment. Then one can approach Vṛndāvana-dhāma to worship Lord Kṛṣṇa. Unless one is favored by Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda, there is no need to go to Vṛndāvana, for unless one's mind is purified, he cannot see Vṛndāvana, even if he goes there. Actually going to Vṛndāvana involves taking shelter of the six Gosvāmīs by reading the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Vidagdha-mādhava*, *Lalita-mādhava* and the other books that they have given. In this way one can understand the transcendental loving affairs between Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. *Kabe hāma bujhaba se yugala-pirīti*. The conjugal love between Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa is not an ordinary human affair; it is fully transcendental. In order to understand Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, worship Them and engage in Their loving service, one must be guided by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu and the six Gosvāmīs, Lord Caitanya's direct disciples.

For an ordinary man, worship of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda Prabhu or the Pañca-tattva is easier than worship of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. Unless one is very fortunate, he should not be induced to worship Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa directly. A neophyte student who is not sufficiently educated or enlightened should not indulge in the worship of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa or the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*. Even if he does so, he cannot get the desired result. One should therefore chant the names of Nitāi-Gaura and worship Them without false prestige. Since everyone within this material world is more or less influenced by sinful activities, in the beginning it is essential that one take to the worship of Guru-Gaurāṅga and ask their favor, for thus despite all his disqualifications one will very soon become qualified to worship the Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa *vigraha*.

It should be noted in this connection that the holy names of Lord Kṛṣṇa and Gaurasundara are both identical with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore one should not consider one name to be more potent

than the other. Considering the position of the people of this age, however, the chanting of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's name is more essential than the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* because Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the most magnanimous incarnation and His mercy is very easily achieved. Therefore one must first take shelter of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu by chanting *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. By serving Gaura-Nityānanda one is freed from the entanglements of material existence and thus becomes qualified to worship the Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa Deity.

TEXT 32

svatantra īśvara prabhu atyanta udāra

tāñre nā bhajile kabhu nā haya nistāra

SYNONYMS

svatantra īśvara—the fully independent Supreme Lord; *prabhu*—the Lord; *atyanta*—very; *udāra*—magnanimous; *tāñre*—unto Him; *nā*—without; *bhajile*—worshiping; *kabhu nā*—never at any time; *haya*—becomes so; *nistāra*—liberation.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the independent Supreme Personality of Godhead, is greatly magnanimous. Unless one worships Him, one can never be liberated.

PURPORT

Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura here remarks that one should not give up the worship of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa to worship Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. By worshiping either Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa or Lord Caitanya alone, one cannot become advanced. One should not try to supersede the

instructions of the six Gosvāmīs, for they are *ācāryas* and very dear to Lord Caitanya. Therefore Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura sings:

*rūpa-raghunātha-pade haibe ākuti
kabe hāma bujhaba se yugala-pirīti*

One must be a submissive student of the six Gosvāmīs, from Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī to Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. Not following their instructions but imagining how to worship Gaurasundara and Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa is a great offense, as a result of which one clears a path to hell. If one neglects the instructions of the six Gosvāmīs and yet becomes a so-called devotee of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, he merely criticizes the real devotees of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa. As a result of speculation, he considers Gaurasundara to be an ordinary devotee and therefore cannot make progress in serving the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 33

ore mūḍha loka, śuna caitanya-maṅgala

caitanya-mahimā yāte jānibe sakala

SYNONYMS

ore—O all of you; *mūḍha*—foolish; *loka*—people; *śuna*—just hear; *caitanya-maṅgala*—the book of this name; *caitanya*—Lord Caitanya's; *mahimā*—glories; *yāte*—in which; *jānibe*—you will know; *sakala*—all.

TRANSLATION

O fools, just read Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala! By reading this book you can understand all the glories of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura's *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata* was originally entitled *Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala*, but when Śrīla Locana dāsa Ṭhākura later wrote another book named *Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala*, Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura changed the name of his own book, which is now therefore known as *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*. The life of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is very elaborately described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, and Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī has already informed us that in his *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* he has described whatever Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has not mentioned. This acceptance of *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata* by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī indicates his acceptance of the disciplic succession. A writer of transcendental literature never tries to surpass the previous *ācāryas*.

TEXT 34

kṛṣṇa-līlā bhāgavate kahe veda-vyāsa

caitanya-līlāra vyāsa—vṛndāvana-dāsa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-līlā—the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhāgavate*—in the book *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *kahe*—tells; *veda-vyāsa*—Vyāsadeva, the editor of the Vedic literatures; *caitanya-līlāra*—of the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *vyāsa*—compiler; *vṛndāvana-dāsa*—is Vṛndāvana dāsa.

TRANSLATION

As Vyāsadeva has compiled all the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa has depicted the pastimes of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 35

vṛndāvana-dāsa kaila 'caitanya-maṅgala'

yāñhāra śravaṇe nāśe sarva amaṅgala

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-dāsa—Vṛndāvana dāsa; *kaila*—compiled; *caitanya-maṅgala*—the book named *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *yāñhāra*—of which; *śravaṇe*—by hearing; *nāśe*—annihilated; *sarva*—all; *amaṅgala*—inauspiciousness.

TRANSLATION

Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa has composed Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala. Hearing this book annihilates all misfortune.

TEXT 36

caitanya-nitāira yāte jāniye mahimā

yāte jāni kṛṣṇa-bhakti-siddhāntera sīmā

SYNONYMS

caitanya-nitāira—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu; *yāte*—in which; *jāniye*—one can know; *mahimā*—all glories; *yāte*—in which; *jāni*—I can understand; *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*—of devotion to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *siddhāntera*—of the conclusion; *sīmā*—limit.

TRANSLATION

By reading Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala one can understand all the glories and truths of Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda and come to the ultimate conclusion of devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam is the authoritative reference book from which to

understand devotional service, but because it is very elaborate, few men can understand its purport. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is the original commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra*, which is called *nyāya-prasthāna*. It was written to enable one to understand the Absolute Truth through infallible logic and argument, and therefore its natural commentary, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, is extremely elaborate. Professional reciters have created the impression that *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* deals only with Kṛṣṇa's *rāsa-līlā*, although Kṛṣṇa's *rāsa-līlā* is described only in chapters 29 through 33 of the Tenth Canto. They have in this way presented Kṛṣṇa to the Western world as a great woman-hunter, and therefore we sometimes have to deal with such misconceptions in preaching. Another difficulty in understanding *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is that the professional reciters have introduced *bhāgavata-saptāha*, or seven-day readings of the *Bhāgavatam*. They want to finish *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* in a week, although it is so sublime that even one verse of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, if properly explained, cannot be completed in three months. Under these circumstances, it is a great aid for the common man to read Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura's *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, for thus he can actually understand devotional service, Kṛṣṇa, Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī has said:

*śruti-smṛti-purāṇādi-pañcarātra-vidhiṁ vinā
aikāntikī harer bhaktir utpātāyaiva kalpate*
[BRS ^{vii}1.2.101]

“Devotional service to the Lord that ignores the authorized Vedic literatures—the *Upaniṣads*, *Purāṇas*, *Nārada-pañcarātra*, etc.—is simply an unnecessary disturbance in society.” Due to misunderstanding *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, people are misled regarding the science of Kṛṣṇa. However, by reading Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura's book one can very easily understand this science.

TEXT 37

bhāgavate yata bhakti-siddhāntera sāra

likhiyāchena inñā jāni' kariyā uddhāra

SYNONYMS

bhāgavate—in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *yata*—all; *bhakti-siddhāntera*—in understanding devotional service; *sāra*—essence; *likhiyāchena*—has written; *inñā*—this; *jāni'*—I know; *kariyā*—making; *uddhāra*—quotation.

TRANSLATION

In Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala [later known as Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata] Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has given the conclusion and essence of devotional service by quoting the authoritative statements of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam.

TEXT 38

'caitanya-maṅgala' śune yadi pāṣaṇḍī, yavana

seha mahā-vaiṣṇava haya tatakṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

caitanya-maṅgala—the book named *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *śune*—anyone hears; *yadi*—if; *pāṣaṇḍī*—great atheist; *yavana*—a nonbeliever in the Vedic culture; *seha*—he also; *mahā-vaiṣṇava*—great devotee; *haya*—becomes; *tatakṣaṇa*—immediately.

TRANSLATION

If even a great atheist hears Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala, he immediately becomes a great devotee.

TEXT 39

manuṣye racīte nāre aiche grantha dhanya

vṛndāvana-dāsa-mukhe vaktā śrī-caitanya

SYNONYMS

manuṣye—a human being; *racīte*—compiled; *nāre*—cannot; *aiche*—such; *grantha*—book; *dhanya*—so glorious; *vṛndāvana-dāsa*—the author, Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *mukhe*—from his mouth; *vaktā*—speaker; *śrī-caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

The subject matter of this book is so sublime that it appears that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu has personally spoken through the writings of Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura.

PURPORT

Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī has written in his *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*:

avaīṣṇava-mukhodgīrṇaṁ pūtaṁ hari-kathāmr̥tam
śravaṇaṁ naiva kartavyaṁ sarpocchiṣṭaṁ yathā payaḥ

“One should not hear anything about Kṛṣṇa from a non-Vaiṣṇava. Milk touched by the lips of a serpent has poisonous effects; similarly, talks about Kṛṣṇa given by a non-Vaiṣṇava are also poisonous.”

Transcendental literature that strictly follows the Vedic principles and the conclusion of the *Purāṇas* and *pāñcarātri-ka-vidhi* can be written only by a pure devotee. It is not possible for a common man to write books on *bhakti*, for his writings will not be effective. He may be a very great scholar and may be expert in presenting literature in flowery language, but this is not at all helpful in understanding transcendental literature. Even if transcendental literature is written in faulty language, it is

acceptable if it is written by a devotee, whereas so-called transcendental literature written by a mundane scholar, even if it is a very highly polished literary presentation, cannot be accepted. The secret in a devotee's writing is that when he writes about the pastimes of the Lord, the Lord helps him; he does not write alone. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.10), *dadāmi buddhi-yogaṁ taṁ yena mām upayānti te*. Since a devotee writes in service to the Lord, the Lord from within gives him so much intelligence that he sits down near the Lord and goes on writing books. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī confirms that what Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura wrote was actually spoken by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and he simply repeated it. The same holds true for *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī wrote *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* in his old age, in an invalid condition, but it is such a sublime literature that Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī Mahārāja used to say, “The time will come when the people of the world will learn Bengali to read *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.” We are trying to present *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* in English and do not know how successful it will be, but if one reads the original *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* in Bengali he will relish increasing ecstasy in devotional service.

TEXT 40

vṛndāvana-dāsa-pade koṭi namaskāra

aiche grantha kari' teṇho tārīlā saṁsāra

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-dāsa-pade—unto the lotus feet of Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *koṭi*—millions; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *aiche*—such; *grantha*—book; *kari'*—compiling; *teṇho*—he; *tārīlā*—delivered; *saṁsāra*—all the world.

TRANSLATION

I offer millions of obeisances unto the lotus feet of Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura. No one else could write such a wonderful book for the deliverance of all fallen souls.

TEXT 41

nārāyaṇī—caitanya ucchiṣṭa-bhājana

tāṇra garbhe janmilā śrī-dāsa-vṛndāvana

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇī—Nārāyaṇī; *caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ucchiṣṭa-bhājana*—eater of the remnants of food; *tāṇra*—of her; *garbhe*—in the womb; *janmilā*—took birth; *śrī-dāsa-vṛndāvana*—Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura.

TRANSLATION

Nārāyaṇī eternally eats the remnants of the food of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura was born of her womb.

PURPORT

In text 43 of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, a book written by Kavi-karṇapūra that describes all the associates of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and who they previously were, there is the following statement regarding Nārāyaṇī:

*ambikāyāḥ svasā yāsīn nāmnā śrīla-kilimbikā
kṛṣṇocchiṣṭaṁ prabhuñjānā seyaṁ nārāyaṇī matā*

When Lord Kṛṣṇa was a child, He was nursed by a woman named Ambikā, who had a younger sister named Kilimbikā. During the time of Lord Caitanya’s incarnation, the same Kilimbikā used to eat the remnants

of food left by Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. That Kilimbikā was Nārāyaṇī, who was a niece of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura's. Later on, when she grew up and married, Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura was born from her womb. A devotee of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa is celebrated in terms of devotional service rendered to the Lord; thus we know Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura as the son of Nārāyaṇī. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura notes in this connection that there is no reference to his paternal ancestry because there is no need to understand it.

TEXT 42

tāñra ki adbhuta caitanya-carita-varṇana

yāhāra śravaṇe śuddha kaila tri-bhuvana

SYNONYMS

tāñra—Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura's; *ki*—what; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *caitanya-carita*—of the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *varṇana*—description; *yāhāra*—of which; *śravaṇe*—by hearing; *śuddha*—purified; *kaila*—made; *tri-bhuvana*—the three worlds.

TRANSLATION

What a wonderful description he has given of the pastimes of Lord Caitanya! Anyone in the three worlds who hears it is purified.

TEXT 43

ataeva bhaja, loka, caitanya-nityānanda

khaṇḍibe saṁsāra-duḥkha, pābe premānanda

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *bhaja*—worship; *loka*—O people in general; *caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda Prabhu; *khaṇḍibe*—will vanquish; *saṁsāra-duḥkha*—miserable condition of material existence; *pābe*—he will get; *premānanda*—the transcendental bliss of devotional service.

TRANSLATION

I fervently appeal to everyone to adopt the method of devotional service given by Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda and thus be freed from the miseries of material existence and ultimately achieve the loving service of the Lord.

TEXT 44

vṛndāvana-dāsa kaila 'caitanya-maṅgala'

tāhāte caitanya-līlā varṇila sakala

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-dāsa—Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *kaila*—did; *caitanya-maṅgala*—the book of the name *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *tāhāte*—in that book; *caitanya-līlā*—the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *varṇila*—described; *sakala*—everything.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has written Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala and therein described in all respects the pastimes of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 45

sūtra kari' saba līlā karila granthana

pāche vistāriyā tāhāra kaila vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

sūtra kari'—making a synopsis; *saba*—all; *līlā*—pastimes; *karīla*—did; *granthana*—writing in the book; *pāche*—later; *vistāriyā*—vividly describing; *tāhāra*—all of them; *kaila*—did; *vivaraṇa*—description.

TRANSLATION

He first summarized all the pastimes of the Lord and later described them vividly in detail.

TEXT 46

caitanya-candrera līlā ananta apāra

varṇite varṇite grantha ha-ila vistāra

SYNONYMS

caitanya-candrera—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *līlā*—pastimes; *ananta*—unlimited; *apāra*—unfathomable; *varṇite*—describing; *varṇite*—describing; *grantha*—the book; *ha-ila*—became; *vistāra*—expansive.

TRANSLATION

The pastimes of Lord Caitanya are unlimited and unfathomable. Therefore, in describing all those pastimes, the book became voluminous.

TEXT 47

vistāra dekhiyā kichu saṅkoca haila mana

sūtra-dhṛta kona līlā nā kaila varṇana

SYNONYMS

vistāra—expansive; *dekhiyā*—seeing; *kichu*—some; *saṅkoca*—with hesitation; *haila*—became; *mana*—mind; *sūtra-dhṛta*—taking the synopsis; *kona*—some; *līlā*—pastimes; *nā*—did not; *kaila*—make; *varṇana*—description.

TRANSLATION

He saw them to be so extensive that he later felt that some had not been properly described.

TEXT 48

nityānanda-līlā-varṇane ha-ila āveśa

caitanyera śeṣa-līlā rahila avaśeṣa

SYNONYMS

nityānanda—Lord Nityānanda; *līlā*—pastimes; *varṇane*—in the matter of description; *ha-ila*—there was; *āveśa*—ecstasy; *caitanyera*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *śeṣa-līlā*—pastimes in the last portion of His life; *rahila*—remained; *avaśeṣa*—supplement.

TRANSLATION

He ecstatically described the pastimes of Lord Nityānanda, but the later pastimes of Caitanya Mahāprabhu remained untold.

TEXT 49

sei saba līlāra śūnite vivaraṇa

vṛndāvana-vāsī bhaktera utkaṇṭhita mana

SYNONYMS

sei—those; *saba*—all; *līlāra*—of the pastimes; *śunite*—to hear;
vīvaraṇa—description; *vṛndāvana-vāsī*—the inhabitants of Vṛndāvana;
bhaktera—of devotees; *utkaṇṭhita*—in anxiety; *mana*—minds.

TRANSLATION

The devotees of Vṛndāvana were all very anxious to hear those pastimes.

TEXT 50

vṛndāvane kalpa-drume suvarṇa-sadana

mahā-yogapīṭha tāhāṇi, ratna-simhāsana

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvane—in Vṛndāvana; *kalpa-drume*—under the desire trees;
suvarṇa-sadana—golden throne; *mahā*—great; *yoga-pīṭha*—pious temple;
tāhāṇi—there; *ratna*—bedecked with jewels; *simhāsana*—throne.

TRANSLATION

In Vṛndāvana, in a great place of pilgrimage underneath the desire trees,
is a golden throne bedecked with jewels.

TEXT 51

tāte vasi' āche sadā vrajendra-nandana

'śrī-govinda-deva' nāma sākṣāt madana

SYNONYMS

tāte—on that throne; *vasi'*—sitting; *āche*—there is; *sadā*—always; *vrajendra-nandana*—the son of Mahārāja Nanda; *śrī-govinda-deva*—whose name is Govinda; *nāma*—name; *sākṣāt*—direct; *madana*—transcendental Cupid.

TRANSLATION

On that throne sits the son of Nanda Mahārāja, Śrī Govindadeva, the transcendental Cupid.

TEXT 52

rāja-sevā haya tāñhā vicitra prakāra

divya sāmagrī, divya vastra, alaṅkāra

SYNONYMS

rāja-sevā—majestic service; *haya*—render; *tāñhā*—there; *vicitra*—varieties; *prakāra*—all kinds of; *divya*—spiritual; *sāmagrī*—ingredients; *divya*—spiritual; *vastra*—garments; *alaṅkāra*—ornaments.

TRANSLATION

Varieties of majestic service are rendered to Govinda there. His garments, ornaments and paraphernalia are all transcendental.

TEXT 53

sahasra sevaka sevā kare anukṣaṇa

sahasra-vadane sevā nā yāya varṇana

SYNONYMS

sahasra—many thousands; *sevaka*—servitors; *sevā*—service; *kare*—render; *anukṣaṇa*—always; *sahasra*—thousands; *vadane*—mouths; *sevā*—process of service; *nā*—not possible; *yāya*—goes on; *varṇana*—description.

TRANSLATION

In that temple of Govindajī, thousands of servitors always render service to the Lord in devotion. Even with thousands of mouths, one could not describe this service.

TEXT 54

sevāra adhyakṣa—*—śrī-pañḍita haridāsa*

tānra yaśaḥ-guṇa sarva-jagate prakāśa

SYNONYMS

sevāra—of the service; *adhyakṣa*—commander; *śrī-pañḍita haridāsa*—Haridāsa Paṇḍita; *tānra*—of his; *yaśaḥ*—fame; *guṇa*—quality; *sarva-jagate*—all over the world; *prakāśa*—known.

TRANSLATION

In that temple the chief servitor was Śrī Haridāsa Paṇḍita. His qualities and fame are known all over the world.

PURPORT

Śrī Haridāsa Paṇḍita was a disciple of Śrī Ananta Ācārya, who was a disciple of Gadādhara Paṇḍita.

TEXT 55

susīla, sahiṣṇu, śānta, vadānya, gambhīra

madhura-vacana, madhura-ceṣṭā, mahā-dhīra

SYNONYMS

susīla—well behaved; *sahiṣṇu*—tolerant; *śānta*—peaceful; *vadānya*—magnanimous; *gambhīra*—grave; *madhura-vacana*—sweet words; *madhura-ceṣṭā*—sweet endeavor; *mahā-dhīra*—completely sober.

TRANSLATION

He was gentle, tolerant, peaceful, magnanimous, grave, sweet in his words and very sober in his endeavors.

TEXT 56

sabāra sammāna-kartā, karena sabāra hita

kauṭilya-mātsarya-himsā nā jāne tāñra cita

SYNONYMS

sabāra—of all; *sammāna-kartā*—respectful; *karena*—does; *sabāra*—everyone's; *hita*—benefit; *kauṭilya*—diplomatic; *mātsarya*—jealousy; *himsā*—envy; *nā jāne*—does not know; *tāñra*—his; *cita*—heart.

TRANSLATION

He was respectful to everyone and worked for the benefit of all.
Diplomacy, envy and jealousy were unknown to his heart.

TEXT 57

kṛṣṇera ye sādhāraṇa sad-guṇa pañcāśa

se saba guṇera tāñra śarīre nivāsa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ye*—that; *sādhāraṇa*—general; *sat-guṇa*—good qualities; *pañcāśa*—fifty; *se*—those; *saba*—all; *guṇera*—qualities; *tāñra*—his; *śarīre*—in the body; *nivāsa*—were always present.

TRANSLATION

The fifty qualities of Lord Kṛṣṇa were all present in his body.

PURPORT

In the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, the transcendental qualities of Śrī Kṛṣṇa are mentioned. Among these, fifty are primary (*ayaṁ netā su-ramyāṅgaḥ*, etc.), and in minute quantity they were all present in the body of Śrī Haridāsa Paṇḍita. Since every living entity is a part of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, all fifty of these good qualities of Śrī Kṛṣṇa are originally minutely present in every living being. Due to his contact with material nature, these qualities are not visible in the conditioned soul, but when one becomes a purified devotee, they all automatically manifest themselves. This is stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (5.18.12), as mentioned in the text below.

TEXT 58

yasyāsti bhaktir bhagavaty akiñcanā

sarvair guṇais tatra samāsate surāḥ

harāv abhaktasya kuto mahad-guṇā

mano-rathenāsati dhāvato bahiḥ

SYNONYMS

yasya—one who; *asti*—has; *bhaktiḥ*—devotional service; *bhagavati*—unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *akiñcanā*—without motive; *sarvaiḥ*—all; *guṇaiḥ*—qualities; *tatra*—there; *samāsate*—become manifested; *surāḥ*—with all the demigods; *harau*—unto the Supreme Personality; *abhaktasya*—one who is not a devotee; *kutaḥ*—where; *mahat-guṇāḥ*—high qualities; *manaḥ-rathena*—concoction; *asati*—the material existence; *dhāvataḥ*—run on; *bahiḥ*—externally.

TRANSLATION

“In one who has unflinching devotional faith in Kṛṣṇa, all the good qualities of Kṛṣṇa and the demigods are consistently manifested. However, one who has no devotion to the Supreme Personality of Godhead has no good qualifications because he is engaged by mental concoction in material existence, which is the external feature of the Lord.”

TEXT 59

paṇḍita-gosāññira śiṣya— —ananta ācārya

kṛṣṇa-premamaya-tanu, udāra, sarva-ārya

SYNONYMS

paṇḍita-gosāññira—of Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *śiṣya*—disciple; *ananta ācārya*—Ananta Ācārya; *kṛṣṇa-premamaya*—always overwhelmed by love of God; *tanu*—body; *udāra*—magnanimous; *sarva*—in all respects; *ārya*—advanced.

TRANSLATION

Ananta Ācārya was a disciple of Gadādhara Paṇḍita. His body was always absorbed in love of Godhead. He was magnanimous and advanced in all respects.

TEXT 60

tāñhāra ananta guṇa ke karu prakāśa

tāñra priya śiṣya iñha—paṇḍita haridāsa

SYNONYMS

tāñhāra—his; *ananta*—unlimited; *guṇa*—qualities; *ke*—who; *karu*—can; *prakāśa*—display; *tāñra*—his; *priya*—dear; *śiṣya*—disciple; *iñha*—this person; *paṇḍita haridāsa*—Haridāsa Paṇḍita.

TRANSLATION

Ananta Ācārya was a reservoir of all good qualities. No one can estimate how great he was. Paṇḍita Haridāsa was his beloved disciple.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Śrī Ananta Ācārya is one of the eternal associates of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Previously, during the advent of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Ananta Ācārya was Sudevī, one of the eight *gopīs*. This is stated in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (165), as follows: *anantācārya-gosvāmī yā su-devī purā vraje*. ‘Ananta Ācārya Gosvāmī was formerly Sudevī-gopī in Vraja [Vṛndāvana].’ In Jagannātha Purī, or Puruṣottama-kṣetra, there is a monastery known as Gaṅgā-mātā Maṭha that was established by Ananta Ācārya. In the disciplic succession of the Gaṅgā-mātā Maṭha, he is known as Vinoda-maṇjarī. One of his disciples was Haridāsa Paṇḍita Gosvāmī, who is also known as Śrī Raghu Gopāla and as Śrī Rāsa-maṇjarī. His disciple Lakṣmīpriyā was the maternal aunt of Gaṅgā-mātā, a

princess who was the daughter of the King of Puṭiyā. Gaṅgā-mātā brought a Deity of the name Śrī Rasika-rāya from Kṛṣṇa Miśra of Jaipur and installed Him in the house of Sārvabhauma in Jagannātha Purī. The disciple in the fifth generation after Śrī Ananta Ācārya was Śrī Vanamālī; in the sixth generation, Śrī Bhagavān dāsa, who was a Bengali; in the seventh generation, Madhusūdana dāsa, who was an Oriyā; in the eighth generation, Nīlāmbara dāsa; in the ninth generation, Śrī Narottama dāsa; in the tenth generation, Pītāmbara dāsa; and in the eleventh generation, Śrī Mādhava dāsa. The disciple in the twelfth generation is presently in charge of the Gaṅgā-mātā monastery.”

TEXT 61

caitanya-nityānande tāñra parama viśvāsa

caitanya-carite tāñra parama ullāsa

SYNONYMS

caitanya—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānande*—in Lord Nityānanda; *tāñra*—his; *parama*—very great; *viśvāsa*—faith; *caitanya-carite*—in the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *tāñra*—his; *parama*—great; *ullāsa*—satisfaction.

TRANSLATION

Paṇḍita Haridāsa had great faith in Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda. Therefore he took great satisfaction in knowing about Their pastimes and qualities.

TEXT 62

vaiṣṇavera guṇa-grāhī, nā dekhaye doṣa

kāya-mano-vākye kare vaiṣṇava-santoṣa

SYNONYMS

vaiṣṇavera—of devotees; *guṇa-grāhī*—accepting good qualities; *nā*—never; *dekhaḥ*—sees; *doṣa*—any fault; *kāya-manaḥ-vākye*—with heart and soul; *kare*—does; *vaiṣṇava*—devotee; *santoṣa*—pacification.

TRANSLATION

He always accepted the good qualities of Vaiṣṇavas and never found fault in them. He engaged his heart and soul only to satisfy the Vaiṣṇavas.

PURPORT

It is a qualification of a Vaiṣṇava that he is *adoṣa-darsī*: he never sees others' faults. Of course, every human being has both good qualities and faults. Therefore it is said, *saj-janā guṇam icchanti doṣam icchanti pāmarāḥ*: everyone has a combination of faults and glories. But a Vaiṣṇava, a sober man, accepts only a man's glories and not his faults, for flies seek sores whereas honeybees seek honey. Haridāsa Paṇḍita never found fault with a Vaiṣṇava but considered only his good qualities.

TEXT 63

nirantara śune teṇho 'caitanya-maṅgala'

tānhāra prasāde śunena vaiṣṇava-sakala

SYNONYMS

nirantara—always; *śune*—hears; *teṇho*—he; *caitanya-maṅgala*—the book *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *tānhāra*—by his; *prasāde*—mercy; *śunena*—hear; *vaiṣṇava-sakala*—all other Vaiṣṇavas.

TRANSLATION

He always heard the reading of Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala, and all the other Vaiṣṇavas used to hear it by his grace.

TEXT 64

kathāya sabhā ujjala kare yena pūrṇa-candra

nija-guṇāmṛte bāḍāya vaiṣṇava-ānanda

SYNONYMS

kathāya—by words; *sabhā*—assembly; *ujjala*—illuminated; *kare*—does; *yena*—as; *pūrṇa-candra*—full moon; *nija*—own; *guṇa-amṛte*—nectar of qualities; *bāḍāya*—increases; *vaiṣṇava*—of the devotees; *ānanda*—pleasure.

TRANSLATION

Like the full moon, he illuminated the entire assembly of Vaiṣṇavas by speaking Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala, and by the nectar of his qualities he increased their transcendental bliss.

TEXT 65

tenho ati kṛpā kari' ājñā kailā more

gaurāṅgera śeṣa-līlā varṇibāra tare

SYNONYMS

tenho—he; *ati*—very much; *kṛpā*—mercy; *kari'*—showing; *ājñā*—order; *kailā*—made it; *more*—unto me; *gaurāṅgera*—of Lord Caitanya; *śeṣa-līlā*—last portion of the pastimes; *varṇibāra*—describing; *tare*—for the matter of.

TRANSLATION

By his causeless mercy he ordered me to write about the last pastimes of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 66

kāśīśvara gosāñīra śiṣya—govinda gosāñī

govindera priya-sevaka tāñra sama nāñi

SYNONYMS

kāśīśvara gosāñīra—of Kāśīśvara Gosvāmī; *śiṣya*—disciple; *govinda*—Govinda; *gosāñī*—spiritual master; *govindera*—of Govinda; *priya-sevaka*—most confidential servitor; *tāñra*—his; *sama*—equal; *nāñi*—is none.

TRANSLATION

Govinda Gosāñi, the priest engaged in the service of Lord Govinda in Vṛndāvana, was a disciple of Kāśīśvara Gosāñi. There was no servant more dear to the Govinda Deity.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Kāśīśvara Gosāñi was one of the contemporaries of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu who was with the Lord in Jagannātha Purī. Also known as Kāśīśvara Paṇḍita, he was a disciple of Īśvara Purī and son of Vāsudeva Bhaṭṭācārya, who belonged to the dynasty of Kāñjilāla Kānu. His surname was Caudhurī. His nephew, his sister’s son, who was named Rudra Paṇḍita, was the original priest of Vallabhapura, which is situated about one mile from the Śrīrāmapura railway station in the village of Cātarā. Installed there are the Deities of Rādhā-Govinda and Lord Śrī

Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Kāśīśvara Gosāñi was a very strong man, and therefore when Lord Caitanya visited the temple of Jagannātha, he used to protect the Lord from the crowds. Another of his duties was to distribute *prasādam* to the devotees after *kīrtana*.”

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura visited this temple at Vallabhapura. At that time the person in charge was a Śaivite, Śrī Śivacandra Caudhurī, who was a descendant of Kāśīśvara Gosāñi’s brother. In Vallabhapura there was a permanent arrangement to cook nine kilos of rice, vegetables and other foodstuffs daily, and near the village there is sufficient land, which belonged to the Deity, on which this rice was grown. Unfortunately, the descendants of Kāśīśvara Gosāñi’s brother have sold a major portion of this land, and therefore the Deity worship has now been hampered.

It is said in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (137) that the servant of Kṛṣṇa in Vṛndāvana named Bhṛṅgāra descended as Kāśīśvara Gosāñi during the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. In our householder life we also sometimes visited this temple of Vallabhapura and took *prasādam* there at noon. The Deities of this temple, Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Govinda and the Gaurāṅga *vigraha*, are extremely beautiful. Near Vallabhapura is a beautiful temple of Jagannātha. We sometimes used to take *prasādam* in this Jagannātha temple also. These two temples are situated within a one mile-radius of the Śrīrāmapura railway station, near Calcutta.

TEXT 67

yādavācārya gosāñi śrī-rūpera saṅgī

caitanya-carite teṅho atī baḍa raṅgī

SYNONYMS

yādavācārya—Yādavācārya; *gosāñi*—spiritual master; *śrī-rūpera*—of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *saṅgī*—associate; *caitanya-carite*—in the pastimes

of Lord Caitanya; *teñho*—he; *ati*—very; *baḍa*—great; *rañgī*—enthusiastic.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Yādavācārya Gosāñi, a constant associate of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, was also very enthusiastic in hearing and chanting about Lord Caitanya's pastimes.

TEXT 68

paṇḍita-gosāñira śiṣya—bhugarbha gosāñi

gaura-kathā vinā āra mukhe anya nāi

SYNONYMS

paṇḍita-gosāñira—of Paṇḍita Gosāñi (Gadādhara Paṇḍita); *śiṣya*—disciple; *bhugarbha gosāñi*—Bhugarbha Gosāñi; *gaura-kathā*—topics of Lord Caitanya; *vinā*—without; *āra*—else; *mukhe*—in his mouth; *anya nāi*—nothing else.

TRANSLATION

Bhugarbha Gosāñi, a disciple of Paṇḍita Gosāñi, was always engaged in topics regarding Lord Caitanya, knowing nothing else.

TEXT 69

tāñra śiṣya—govinda pūjaka caitanya-dāsa

mukundānanda cakravartī, premī kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

tāñira śiṣya—his disciple; *govinda*—the Govinda Deity; *pūjaka*—priest; *caitanya-dāsa*—Caitanya dāsa; *mukundānanda cakravartī*—Mukundānanda Cakravartī; *premī*—a great lover of God; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa.

TRANSLATION

Among his disciples were Caitanya dāsa, who was a priest of the Govinda Deity, as well as Mukundānanda Cakravartī and the great devotee Kṛṣṇadāsa.

TEXT 70

ācārya-gosāññira śiṣya—*—cakravartī śivānanda*

niravadhi tāñira citte caitanya-nityānanda

SYNONYMS

ācārya-gosāññira—of Ācārya Gosāññi; *śiṣya*—the disciple; *cakravartī śivānanda*—Śivānanda Cakravartī; *niravadhi*—always; *tāñira*—his; *citte*—in the heart; *caitanya-nityānanda*—Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda are situated.

TRANSLATION

Among the disciples of Ananta Ācārya was Śivānanda Cakravartī, in whose heart Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda constantly dwelled.

TEXT 71

āra yata vṛndāvane baise bhakta-gaṇa

śeṣa-lilā sūnite sabāra haila mana

SYNONYMS

āra yata—there are many others; *vṛndāvane*—in Vṛndāvana; *baise*—residents; *bhakta-gaṇa*—great devotees; *śeṣa-līlā*—the last portions of Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s pastimes; *śunite*—to hear; *sabāra*—of everyone; *haila*—became; *mana*—the mind.

TRANSLATION

In Vṛndāvana there were also many other great devotees, all of whom desired to hear the last pastimes of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 72

more ājñā karilā sabe karuṇā kariyā

tān-sabāra bole likhi nirlajja ha-iyā

SYNONYMS

more—unto me; *ājñā*—order; *karilā*—gave; *sabe*—all; *karuṇā*—merciful; *kariyā*—doing so; *tān-sabāra*—of all of them; *bole*—by the order; *likhi*—I write; *nirlajja*—without shame; *ha-iyā*—becoming.

TRANSLATION

By their mercy, all these devotees ordered me to write of the last pastimes of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Because of their order only, although I am shameless, I have attempted to write this Caitanya-caritāmṛta.

PURPORT

To write about the transcendental pastimes of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is not an ordinary endeavor. Unless one is empowered by the higher authorities, or advanced devotees, one cannot write transcendental

literature, for all such literature must be above suspicion, or, in other words, it must have none of the defects of conditioned souls, namely mistakes, illusions, cheating and imperfect sense perceptions. The words of Kṛṣṇa and of the disciplic succession that carries the orders of Kṛṣṇa are actually authoritative. To be empowered to write transcendental literature is a privilege in which a writer can take great pride. As a humble Vaiṣṇava, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, being thus empowered, felt very much ashamed that it was he who was to narrate the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 73

vaiṣṇavera ājñā pāñā cintita-antare

madana-gopāle gelān ājñā māgibāre

SYNONYMS

vaiṣṇavera—of all the Vaiṣṇava devotees; *ājñā*—order; *pāñā*—receiving; *cintita-antare*—anxiety within myself; *madana-gopāle*—to the temple of Śrī Madana-mohana; *gelān*—I went; *ājñā*—order; *māgibāre*—to receive.

TRANSLATION

Having received the order of the Vaiṣṇavas but being anxious within my heart, I went to the temple of Madana-mohana in Vṛndāvana to ask His permission also.

PURPORT

A Vaiṣṇava always follows the order of *guru* and Kṛṣṇa. *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* was written by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī by their mercy. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī considered all the devotees that have been mentioned to be his preceptor *gurus*, or spiritual masters, and Madana-gopāla (Śrī Madana-mohana *vigraha*) is Kṛṣṇa Himself. Thus he took

permission from both of them, and when he received the mercy of both *guru* and Kṛṣṇa, he was able to write this great literature, *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. This example should be followed. Anyone who attempts to write about Kṛṣṇa must first take permission from the spiritual master and Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa is situated in everyone's heart, and the spiritual master is His direct external representative. Thus Kṛṣṇa is situated *antar-bahih*, within and without. One must first become a pure devotee by following the strict regulative principles and chanting sixteen rounds daily, and when one thinks that he is actually on the Vaiṣṇava platform, he must then take permission from the spiritual master, and that permission must also be confirmed by Kṛṣṇa from within his heart. Then, if one is very sincere and pure, he can write transcendental literature, either prose or poetry.

TEXT 74

daraśana kari kailuṇ caraṇa vandana

gosāñi-dāsa pūjārī kare caraṇa-sevana

SYNONYMS

daraśana—by visiting; *kari*—doing; *kailuṇ*—made; *carāṇa*—lotus feet; *vandana*—worship; *gosāñi-dāsa*—Gosāñi dāsa; *pūjārī*—priest; *kare*—does; *carāṇa*—lotus feet; *sevana*—service.

TRANSLATION

When I visited the temple of Madana-mohana, the priest Gosāñi dāsa was serving the feet of the Lord, and I also prayed at the Lord's lotus feet.

TEXT 75

prabhura carāṇe yadī ājñā māgila

prabhu-kaṇṭha haite mālā khasiyā paḍila

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *caraṇe*—lotus feet; *yadi*—when; *ājñā*—order; *māgila*—requested; *prabhu-kaṇṭha*—the neck of the Lord; *haite*—from; *mālā*—garland; *khasiyā*—slipped; *paḍila*—fell down.

TRANSLATION

When I prayed to the Lord for permission, a garland from His neck immediately slipped down.

TEXT 76

saba vaiṣṇava-gaṇa hari-dhvani dila

gosāñi-dāsa āni' mālā mora gale dila

SYNONYMS

saba—all; *vaiṣṇava*—devotees; *gaṇa*—group; *hari-dhvani*—chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa; *dila*—made; *gosāñi-dāsa*—Gosāñi dāsa; *āni'*—bringing; *mālā*—garland; *mora*—my; *gale*—on the neck; *dila*—gave it.

TRANSLATION

As soon as this happened, the Vaiṣṇavas standing there all loudly chanted, “Haribol!” and the priest, Gosāñi dāsa, brought me the garland and put it around my neck.

TEXT 77

ājñā-mālā pāñā āmāra ha-ila ānanda

tāhāni karinu ei granthera ārambha

SYNONYMS

ājñā-mālā—the garland of order; *pāñā*—receiving; *āmāra*—my; *ha-ila*—became; *ānanda*—great pleasure; *tāhāni*—then and there; *karinu*—attempted; *ei*—this; *granthera*—of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *ārambha*—beginning.

TRANSLATION

I was greatly pleased to have the garland signifying the order of the Lord, and then and there I commenced to write this book.

TEXT 78

ei grantha lekhāya more ‘madana-mohana’

āmāra likhana yena śukera paṭhana

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *grantha*—great literature; *lekhāya*—causes me to write; *more*—unto me; *madana-mohana*—the Deity; *āmāra*—my; *likhana*—writing; *yena*—like; *śukera*—of the parrot; *paṭhana*—responding.

TRANSLATION

Actually *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* is not my writing but the dictation of *Śrī Madana-mohana*. My writing is like the repetition of a parrot.

PURPORT

This should be the attitude of all devotees. When the Supreme Personality of Godhead recognizes a devotee, He gives him intelligence

and dictates how he may go back home, back to Godhead. This is confirmed in *Śrīmad Bhagavad-gītā* (10.10):

*teṣāṁ satata-yuktānāṁ bhajatām prīti-pūrvakam
dadāmi buddhi-yogaṁ taṁ yena mām upayānti te*

“To those who are constantly devoted to serving Me with love, I give the understanding by which they can come to Me.” The opportunity to engage in the transcendental loving service of the Lord is open to everyone because every living entity is constitutionally a servant of the Lord. To engage in the service of the Lord is the natural function of the living entity, but because he is covered by the influence of *mayā*, the material energy, he thinks it to be a very difficult task. But if he places himself under the guidance of a spiritual master and does everything sincerely, immediately the Lord, who is situated within everyone’s heart, dictates how to serve Him (*dadāmi buddhi-yogaṁ tam*). The Lord gives this direction, and thus the devotee’s life becomes perfect. Whatever a pure devotee does is done by the dictation of the Supreme Lord. Thus it is confirmed by the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* that whatever he wrote was written under the direction of the Śrī Madana-mohana Deity.

TEXT 79

sei likhi, madana-gopāla ye likhāya

kāṣṭhera puttālī yena kuhake nācāya

SYNONYMS

sei likhi—I write that; *madana-gopāla*—the Deity Madana-gopāla; *ye*—whatever; *likhāya*—dictates to me; *kāṣṭhera*—wooden; *puttālī*—a doll; *yena*—like; *kuhake*—the enchanter; *nācāya*—causes to dance.

TRANSLATION

As a wooden doll is made to dance by a magician, I write as Madana-gopāla orders me to do so.

PURPORT

This is the position of a pure devotee. One should not take any responsibility on his own but should be a soul surrendered to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who will then give him dictation as the *caittya-guru*, or the spiritual master within. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is pleased to guide a devotee from within and without. From within He guides him as the Supersoul, and from without He guides him as the spiritual master.

TEXT 80

kulādhidevatā mora—madana-mohana

yāñra sevaka—raghunātha, rūpa, sanātana

SYNONYMS

kula-adhidevatā—the family Deity; *mora*—mine; *madana-mohana*—Lord Madana-mohana; *yāñra*—whose; *sevaka*—servitor; *raghunātha*—Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *rūpa*—Rūpa Gosvāmī; *sanātana*—Sanātana Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

I accept as my family Deity Madana-mohana, whose worshipers are Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī.

TEXT 81

ṛṇdāvana-dāsera pāda-padma kari' dhyāna

tāñra ājñā lañā likhi yāhāte kalyāṇa

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-dāsera—of Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *pāda-padma*—lotus feet; *kari'*—doing; *dhyāna*—meditation; *tāñra*—his; *ājñā*—order; *lañā*—receiving; *likhi*—I write; *yāhāte*—in which permission; *kalyāṇa*—all auspiciousness.

TRANSLATION

I took permission from Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura by praying at his lotus feet, and upon receiving his order I have attempted to write this auspicious literature.

PURPORT

Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī took permission not only from the Vaiṣṇavas and Madana-mohana but also from Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, who is understood to be the Vyāsa of the pastimes of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 82

caitanya-līlāte 'vyāsa'——vṛndāvana-dāsa

tāñra kṛpā vinā anye nā haya prakāśa

SYNONYMS

caitanya-līlāte—in describing the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *vyāsa*—Vyāsadeva; *vṛndāvana-dāsa*—is Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *tāñra*—his; *kṛpā*—mercy; *vinā*—without; *anye*—other; *nā*—never; *haya*—becomes; *prakāśa*—manifest.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura is the authorized writer on the pastimes of Lord Caitanya. Without his mercy, therefore, one cannot describe these pastimes.

TEXT 83

mūrkhā, nīca, kṣudra muñi viṣaya-lālasa

vaiṣṇavājñā-bale kari eteka sāhasa

SYNONYMS

mūrkhā—foolish; *nīca*—lowborn; *kṣudra*—very insignificant; *muñi*—I; *viṣaya*—material; *lālasa*—desires; *vaiṣṇava*—of the Vaiṣṇavas; *ājñā*—order; *bale*—on the strength of; *kari*—I do; *eteka*—so much; *sāhasa*—energy.

TRANSLATION

I am foolish, lowborn and insignificant, and I always desire material enjoyment; yet by the order of the Vaiṣṇavas I am greatly enthusiastic to write this transcendental literature.

TEXT 84

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-caraṇera ei bala

yānra smṛte siddha haya vāñchita-sakala

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *caraṇera*—of the lotus feet; *ei*—this; *bala*—strength; *yānra*—whose;

smṛte—by remembrance; *siddha*—successful; *haya*—becomes; *vāñchita-sakala*—all desires.

TRANSLATION

The lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī are my source of strength. Remembering their lotus feet can fulfill all one's desires.

TEXT 85

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Eighth Chapter, in the matter of the author's receiving the orders of the authorities—Kṛṣṇa and guru.

CHAPTER 9

The Desire Tree of Devotional Service

A summary of Chapter Nine has been given as follows by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. In this chapter the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* has devised a figurative example by describing “the desire tree of *bhakti*.” He considers Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is known as Viśvambhara, to be the gardener of this tree because He is the main personality who has taken charge of it. As the supreme enjoyer, He enjoyed the fruits Himself and distributed them as well. The seed of the tree was first sown in Navadvīpa, the birth site of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and then the tree was brought to Puruṣottama-kṣetra (Jagannātha Purī), and then to Vṛndāvana. The seed fructified first in Śrīla Mādhavendra Purī, and then in his disciple Śrī Īśvara Purī. It is figuratively described that both the tree itself and the trunk of the tree are Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Paramānanda Purī and eight other great *sannyāsīs* are like the spreading roots of the tree. From the main trunk there extend two special branches, Advaita Prabhu and Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, and from those branches grow other branches and twigs. The tree surrounds the entire world, and the fruits of the tree are to be distributed to everyone. In this way the tree of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu intoxicates the entire world. It should be noted that this is a figurative example meant to explain the mission of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 1

taṁ śrīmat-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-

devaṁ vande jagad-gurum

yasyānukampayā śvāpi

mahābdhiṁ santaret sukham

SYNONYMS

tam—unto Him; *śrīmat*—with all opulence; *kṛṣṇa-caitanya-devam*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva; *vande*—I offer obeisances; *jagat-gurum*—spiritual master of the world; *yasya*—whose; *anukampayā*—by the mercy of; *śvā api*—even a dog; *mahā-abdhim*—great ocean; *santaret*—can swim; *sukham*—without difficulty.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the spiritual master of the entire world, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by whose mercy even a dog can swim across a great ocean.

PURPORT

Sometimes it is to be seen that a dog can swim in the water for a few yards and then come back to the shore. Here, however, it is stated that if a dog is blessed by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he can swim across an ocean. Similarly, the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, placing himself in a helpless condition, states that he has no personal power, but by the desire of Lord Caitanya, expressed through the Vaiṣṇavas and the Madana-mohana *vigraha*, it is possible for him to cross a transcendental ocean to present *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gauracandra

jaya jayādvaita jaya jaya nityānanda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gauracandra*—whose name is Gaurahari; *jaya jaya*—all glories; *advaita*—to Advaita Gosāñi; *jaya jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Nityānanda.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who is known as Gaurahari! All glories to Advaita Ācārya and Nityānanda Prabhu!

TEXT 3

jaya jaya śrīvāsādi gaura-bhakta-gaṇa

sarvābhīṣṭa-pūrti-hetu yāñhāra smaraṇa

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrīvāsa-ādi*—to Śrīvāsa and others; *gaura-bhakta-gaṇa*—all the devotees of Lord Caitanya; *sarva-abhīṣṭa*—all ambition; *pūrti*—satisfaction; *hetu*—for the matter of; *yāñhāra*—whose; *smaraṇa*—remembrance.

TRANSLATION

All glories to the devotees of Lord Caitanya, headed by Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura!
In order to fulfill all my desires, I remember their lotus feet.

PURPORT

The author here continues to follow the same principles of worship of the Pañca-tattva that were described in the Seventh Chapter of the *Ādi-līlā*.

TEXT 4

śrī-rūpa, sanātana, bhaṭṭa raghunātha

śrī-jīva, gopāla-bhaṭṭa, dāsa-raghunātha

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *sanātana*—Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī;
bhaṭṭa raghunātha—Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī; *śrī-jīva*—Śrī Jīva
Gosvāmī; *gopāla-bhaṭṭa*—Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī; *dāsa-raghunātha*—
Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

I also remember the six Gosvāmīs—Rūpa, Sanātana, Bhaṭṭa Raghunātha, Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and Dāsa Raghunātha.

PURPORT

This is the process for writing transcendental literature. A sentimentalist who has no Vaiṣṇava qualifications cannot produce transcendental writings. There are many fools who consider *kṛṣṇa-līlā* to be a subject of art and who write or paint pictures about the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa with the *gopīs*, sometimes depicting them in a manner practically obscene. These fools take pleasure in material sense gratification, but one who wants to make advancement in spiritual life must scrupulously avoid their literature. Unless one is a servant of Kṛṣṇa and the Vaiṣṇavas, as Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī presents himself to be in offering respects to Lord Caitanya, His associates and His disciples, one should not attempt to write transcendental literature.

TEXT 5

esaba-prasāde likhi caitanya-līlā-guṇa

jāni vā nā jāni, kari āpana-śodhana

SYNONYMS

esaba—all these; *prasāde*—by the mercy of; *likhi*—I write; *caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya; *līlā-guṇa*—pastimes and qualities; *jāni*—know; *vā*—or; *nā*—not; *jāni*—know; *kari*—do; *āpana*—self; *śodhana*—purification.

TRANSLATION

It is by the mercy of all these Vaiṣṇavas and gurus that I attempt to write about the pastimes and qualities of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Whether I know it or know not, it is for self-purification that I write this book.

PURPORT

This is the sum and substance of transcendental writing. One must be an authorized Vaiṣṇava, humble and pure. One should write transcendental literature to purify oneself, not for credit. By writing about the pastimes of the Lord, one associates with the Lord directly. One should not ambitiously think, “I shall become a great author. I shall be celebrated as a writer.” These are material desires. One should attempt to write for self-purification. It may be published or it may not be published, but that does not matter. If one is actually sincere in writing, all his ambitions will be fulfilled. Whether one is known as a great author is incidental. One should not attempt to write transcendental literature for material name and fame.

TEXT 6

mālā-kāraḥ svayam kṛṣṇa-

premāmara-taruḥ svayam

dātā bhoktā tat-phalānām

yas taṁ caitanya āśraye

SYNONYMS

mālā-kāraḥ—gardener; *svayam*—Himself; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prema*—love; *amara*—transcendental; *taruḥ*—tree; *svayam*—Himself; *dātā*—giver; *bhoktā*—enjoyer; *tat-phalānām*—of all the fruits of that tree;

yaḥ—one who; *tam*—unto Him; *caitanya*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *āśraye*—I take shelter.

TRANSLATION

I take shelter of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who Himself is the tree of transcendental love of Kṛṣṇa, its gardener and also the bestower and enjoyer of its fruits.

TEXT 7

prabhu kahe, āmi ‘viśvambhara’ nāma dhari

nāma sārthaka haya, yadi preme viśva bhari

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord said; *āmi*—I; *viśvambhara*—Viśvambhara; *nāma*—named; *dhari*—accept; *nāma*—the name; *sārthaka*—complete; *haya*—becomes; *yadi*—if; *preme*—in love of God; *viśva*—the whole universe; *bhari*—fulfilled.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya thought, “My name is Viśvambhara, ‘one who maintains the entire universe.’ Its meaning will be actualized if I can fill the whole universe with love of Godhead.”

TEXT 8

eta cinti’ lailā prabhu mālākāra-dharma

navadvīpe ārambhilā phalodyāna-karma

SYNONYMS

eta cinti'—thinking like this; *lailā*—took; *prabhu*—the Lord; *mālā-kāra-dharma*—the business of a gardener; *navadvīpe*—in Navadvīpa; *ārambhilā*—began; *phala-udyāna*—garden; *karma*—activities.

TRANSLATION

Thinking in this way, He accepted the duty of a planter and began to grow a garden in Navadvīpa.

TEXT 9

śrī-caitanya mālākāra pṛthivīte āni'

bhakti-kalpataru ropilā siñci' icchā-pāni

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mālā-kāra*—gardener; *pṛthivīte*—on this planet; *āni'*—bringing; *bhakti-kalpa-taru*—the desire tree of devotional service; *ropilā*—sowed; *siñci'*—watering; *icchā*—will; *pāni*—water.

TRANSLATION

Thus the Lord brought the desire tree of devotional service to this earth and became its gardener. He sowed the seed and sprinkled upon it the water of His will.

PURPORT

In many places devotional service has been compared to a creeper. One has to sow the seed of the devotional creeper, *bhakti-latā*, within his heart. As he regularly hears and chants, the seed will fructify and gradually grow into a mature plant and then produce the fruit of devotional service, namely love of Godhead, which the gardener (*mālā-*

kāra) can then enjoy without impediments.

TEXT 10

jaya śrī mādhavapurī kṛṣṇa-prema-pūra

bhakti-kalpatarura teṇho prathama aṅkura

SYNONYMS

jaya—all glories; *śrī mādhaba-purī*—unto Mādhavendra Purī; *kṛṣṇa-prema-pūra*—a storehouse of all love of Godhead; *bhakti-kalpa-tarura*—of the desire tree of devotional service; *teṇho*—he is; *prathama*—first; *aṅkura*—fructification.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, the storehouse of all devotional service unto Kṛṣṇa! He is a desire tree of devotional service, and it is in him that the seed of devotional service first fructified.

PURPORT

Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, also known as Śrī Mādhava Purī, belonged to the disciplic succession from Madhvācārya and was a greatly celebrated *sannyāsī*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was the third disciplic descendant from Śrī Mādhavendra Purī. The process of worship in the disciplic succession of Madhvācārya was full of ritualistic ceremonies, with hardly a sign of love of Godhead. Śrī Mādhavendra Purī was the first person in that disciplic succession to exhibit the symptoms of love of Godhead and the first to write a poem beginning with the words *ayi dīna-dayādra nātha*, “O supremely merciful Personality of Godhead.” In that poem is the seed of Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s cultivation of love of Godhead.

TEXT 11

śrī-īśvarapurī-rūpe aṅkura puṣṭa haila

āpane caitanya-mālī skandha upajila

SYNONYMS

śrī-īśvara-purī—by the name Śrī Īśvara Purī; *rūpe*—in the form of; *aṅkura*—the seed; *puṣṭa*—cultivated; *haila*—became; *āpane*—Himself; *caitanya-mālī*—the gardener of the name Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *skandha*—trunk; *upajila*—expanded.

TRANSLATION

The seed of devotional service next fructified in the form of Śrī Īśvara Purī, and then the gardener Himself, Caitanya Mahāprabhu, became the main trunk of the tree of devotional service.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Śrī Īśvara Purī was a resident of Kumāra-haṭṭa, where there is now a railroad station known as Kāmarhaṭṭa. Nearby there is another station, named Hālisahara, which belongs to the Eastern Railway. This railway runs from the eastern section of Calcutta.”

Īśvara Purī appeared in a *brāhmaṇa* family and was the most beloved disciple of Śrīla Mādhavendra Purī. In the last portion of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* (*Antya* 8.28–31), it is stated:

*īśvara-purī gosāñi kare śrī-pada sevana
sva-haste karena mala-mūtrādi mārjana*

*nirantara kṛṣṇa-nāma karāya smaraṇa
kṛṣṇa-nāma kṛṣṇa-līlā śunāya anukṣaṇa*

*tuṣṭa hañā purī tāñre kaila ālīngana
vara dilā kṛṣṇe tomāra ha-uka prema-dhana
sei haite īśvara-purī premera sāgara*

“At the last stage of his life Śrī Mādhavendra Purī became an invalid and was completely unable to move, and Īśvara Purī so completely engaged himself in his service that he personally cleaned up his stool and urine. Always chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* and reminding Śrī Mādhavendra Purī about the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa in the last stage of his life, Īśvara Purī gave the best service among his disciples. Thus Mādhavendra Purī, being very pleased with him, blessed him, saying, ‘My dear boy, I can only pray to Kṛṣṇa that He will be pleased with you.’ Thus Īśvara Purī, by the grace of his spiritual master, Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, became a great devotee in the ocean of love of Godhead.” Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī states in his *Gurv-aṣṭaka* prayer, *yasya prasādād bhagavat-prasādo yasyāprasādān na gatiḥ kuto 'pi: *** “By the mercy of the spiritual master one is blessed by the mercy of Kṛṣṇa. Without the grace of the spiritual master one cannot make any advancement.” It is by the mercy of the spiritual master that one becomes perfect, as vividly exemplified here. A Vaiṣṇava is always protected by the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but if he appears to be an invalid, this gives a chance to his disciples to serve him. Īśvara Purī pleased his spiritual master by service, and by the blessings of his spiritual master he became such a great personality that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted him as His spiritual master.

Śrīla Īśvara Purī was the spiritual master of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, but before initiating Lord Caitanya he went to Navadvīpa and lived for a few months in the house of Gopīnātha Ācārya. At that time Lord Caitanya became acquainted with him, and it is understood that he served Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu by reciting his book, *Kṛṣṇa-līlāmṛta*. This is explained in *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata, Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Eleven.

To teach others by example how to be a faithful disciple of one’s spiritual master, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Supreme Personality of Godhead,

visited the birthplace of Īśvara Purī at Kumāra-haṭṭa and collected some earth from his birth site. This He kept very carefully, and He used to eat a small portion of it daily. This is stated in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata, Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Seventeen. It has now become customary for devotees, following the example of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, to go there and collect some earth from that place.

TEXT 12

nijācintya-śaktye mālī hañā skandha haya

sakala śākhāra sei skandha mūlāśraya

SYNONYMS

nija—His own; *acintya*—inconceivable; *śaktye*—by potency; *mālī*—gardener; *hañā*—becoming; *skandha*—trunk; *haya*—became; *sakala*—all; *śākhāra*—of other branches; *sei*—that; *skandha*—trunk; *mūlāśraya*—original support.

TRANSLATION

By His inconceivable powers, the Lord became the gardener, the trunk and the branches simultaneously.

TEXTS 13–15

paramānanda purī, āra keśava bhāratī

brahmānanda purī, āra brahmānanda bhāratī

viṣṇu-purī, keśava-purī, purī kṛṣṇānanda

śrī-nṛsimhatīrtha, āra purī sukhānanda

ei nava mūla nikasila vṛkṣa-mūle

ei nava mūle vṛkṣa karīla niścale

SYNONYMS

paramānanda purī—Paramānanda Purī; *āra*—and; *keśava bhāratī*—Keśava Bhāratī; *brahmānanda purī*—Brahmānanda Purī; *āra*—and; *brahmānanda bhāratī*—Brahmānanda Bhāratī; *viṣṇu-purī*—Viṣṇu Purī; *keśava-purī*—Keśava Purī; *purī kṛṣṇānanda*—Kṛṣṇānanda Purī; *śrī-nṛsimha-tīrtha*—Śrī Nṛsimha Tīrtha; *āra*—and; *purī sukhānanda*—Sukhānanda Purī; *ei nava*—of these nine; *mūla*—roots; *nikasila*—fructified; *vṛkṣa-mūle*—in the trunk of the tree; *ei nava mūle*—in these nine roots; *vṛkṣa*—the tree; *karīla niścale*—became very steadfast.

TRANSLATION

Paramānanda Purī, Keśava Bhāratī, Brahmānanda Purī and Brahmānanda Bhāratī, Śrī Viṣṇu Purī, Keśava Purī, Kṛṣṇānanda Purī, Śrī Nṛsimha Tīrtha and Sukhānanda Purī—these nine sannyāsī roots all sprouted from the trunk of the tree. Thus the tree stood steadfastly on the strength of these nine roots.

PURPORT

Paramānanda Purī: Paramānanda Purī belonged to a *brāhmaṇa* family of the Trihut district in Uttara Pradesh. Mādhavendra Purī was his spiritual master. In relationship with Mādhavendra Purī, Paramānanda Purī was very dear to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, there is the following statement:

*sannyāsīra madhye īśvarera priya-pātra
āra nāhi eka purī gosāñi se mātra*

dāmodara-svarūpa paramānanda-purī

sannyāsī-pārṣade ei dui adhikārī

*niravadhi nikaṭe thākena dui jana
prabhura sannyāse kare daṇḍera grahaṇa*

*purī dhyāna-para dāmodarera kīrtana
yata-prīti īśvarera purī-gosāñire
dāmodara-svarūpereo tata prīti kare*

“Among his *sannyāsī* disciples, Īśvara Purī and Paramānanda Purī were very dear to Mādhavendra Purī. Thus Paramānanda Purī, like Svarūpa Dāmodara, who was also a *sannyāsī*, was very dear to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and was His constant associate. When Lord Caitanya accepted the renounced order, Paramānanda Purī offered Him the *daṇḍa*. Paramānanda Purī was always engaged in meditation, and Śrī Svarūpa was always engaged in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. As Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu offered full respect to His spiritual master, Īśvara Purī, He similarly respected Paramānanda Purī and Svarūpa Dāmodara.” It is described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Three, that when Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu first saw Paramānanda Purī He made the following statement:

*āji dhanya locana, saphala āji janma
saphala āmāra āji haila sarva-dharma*

*prabhu bale āji mora saphala sannyāsa
āji mādhavendra more ha-ilā prakāśa*

“My eyes, My mind, My religious activities and My acceptance of the *sannyāsa* order have now all become perfect because today Mādhavendra Purī is manifest before Me in the form of Paramānanda Purī.” The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* further states:

*kathokṣaṇe anyo 'nye kareṇa praṇāma
paramānanda-purī caitanyera priya-dhāma*

“Thus Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu exchanged respectful obeisances with Paramānanda Purī, who was very dear to Him.” Paramānanda Purī established a small monastery behind the western side of the Jagannātha temple, where he had a well dug to supply water. The water, however, was bitter, and therefore Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu prayed to Lord Jagannātha to allow Ganges water to come into the well to make it sweet. When Lord Jagannātha granted the request, Lord Caitanya told all the devotees that from that day hence, the water of Paramānanda Purī’s well should be celebrated as Ganges water, for any devotee who would drink it or bathe in it would certainly get the same benefit as that derived from drinking or bathing in the waters of the Ganges. Such a person would certainly develop pure love of Godhead. It is stated in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (*Antya* 3.255):

*prabhu bale āmi ye āchiye pr̥thivīte
niścaya-i jāniha purī-gosāñīra prīte*

“Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu used to say, ‘I am living in this world only on account of the excellent behavior of Śrī Paramānanda Purī.’” The *Gaura-ṅaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (118) states, *purī śrī-paramānando ya āsīd uddhavaḥ purā*. “Paramānanda Purī is none other than Uddhava.” Uddhava was Lord Kṛṣṇa’s friend and cousin, and in *caitanya-līlā* the same Uddhava became the friend of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His uncle in terms of their relationship in the disciplic succession.

Keśava Bhāratī: The Sarasvatī, Bhāratī and Purī *sampradāyas* belong to the Śṛṅgerī-maṭha in South India, and Śrī Keśava Bhāratī, who at that time was situated in a monastery in Katwa, belonged to the Bhāratī-sampradāya. According to some authoritative opinions, although Keśava Bhāratī belonged to the Śāṅkara-sampradāya, he had formerly been initiated by a Vaiṣṇava. He is said to have been a Vaiṣṇava on account of having been initiated by Mādhavendra Purī, for some say that he took *sannyāsa* from Mādhavendra Purī. The temple and Deity worship started by Keśava Bhāratī are still existing in the village known as Khāṭundi, which is under the postal jurisdiction of Kāndarā in the district of

Burdwan. According to the managers of that *maṭha*, the priests are descendants of Keśava Bhāratī, and some say that the worshipers of the Deity are descendants of the sons of Keśava Bhāratī. In his householder life he had two sons, Niśāpati and Ūśāpati, and a *brāhmaṇa* of the name Śrī Nakaḍicandra Vidyāratna, who was a member of the family of Niśāpati, was the priest in charge at the time that Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī visited this temple. According to some, the priests of the temple belong to the family of Keśava Bhāratī's brother. Still another opinion is that they descend from Mādhava Bhāratī, who was another disciple of Keśava Bhāratī's. Mādhava Bhāratī's disciple Balabhadra, who also later became a *sannyāsī* of the Bhāratī-sampradāya, had two sons in his family life, named Madana and Gopāla. Madana, whose family's surname was Bhāratī, lived in the village of Āuriyā, and Gopāla, whose family's surname was Brahmacārī, lived in the village of Denduḍa. There are still many living descendants of both families.

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (52), it is said:

*mathurāyām yajña-sūtram purā kṛṣṇāya yo muniḥ
dadau sāndīpaniḥ so 'bhūd adya keśava-bhāratī*

“Sāndīpani Muni, who formerly offered the sacred thread to Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, later became Keśava Bhāratī.” It is he who offered *sannyāsa* to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. There is another statement about Keśava Bhāratī from the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (117): *iti kecit prabhāṣante 'krūraḥ keśava-bhāratī*. “According to some authoritative opinions, Keśava Bhāratī is an incarnation of Akrūra.” Keśava Bhāratī offered the *sannyāsa* order to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu in the year 1432 *śakābda* (A.D. 1510) in Katwa. This is stated in the *Vaiṣṇava-maṅjuṣā*, Part Two.

Brahmānanda Purī: Śrī Brahmānanda Purī was one of the associates of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu while He was performing *kīrtana* in Navadvīpa, and he also joined Lord Caitanya in Jagannātha Purī. We may note in this connection that the name Brahmānanda is accepted not only by Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* but by Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsīs* also. One of our foolish

Godbrothers criticized our *sannyāsī* Brahmānanda Svāmī, saying that this was a Māyāvādī name. The foolish man did not know that Brahmānanda does not always refer to the impersonal Brahman. Parabrahman, the Supreme Brahman, is Kṛṣṇa. A devotee of Kṛṣṇa can therefore also be called Brahmānanda; this is evident from the fact that Brahmānanda Purī was one of the chief *sannyāsī* associates of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Brahmānanda Bhāratī: Brahmānanda Bhāratī went to see Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha-dhāma. At that time he used to wear only a deerskin to cover himself, and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu indirectly indicated that He did not like this deerskin covering. Brahmānanda Bhāratī therefore gave it up and accepted a loincloth of saffron color, as used by Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsīs*. For some time he lived with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 16

madhya-mūla paramānanda purī mahā-dhīra

aṣṭa dike aṣṭa mūla vṛkṣa kaila sthira

SYNONYMS

madhya-mūla—the middle root; *paramānanda purī*—Paramānanda Purī; *mahā-dhīra*—most sober; *aṣṭa dike*—in the eight directions; *aṣṭa mūla*—eight roots; *vṛkṣa*—the tree; *kaila sthira*—fixed.

TRANSLATION

With the sober and grave Paramānanda Purī as the central root and the other eight roots in the eight directions, the tree of Caitanya Mahāprabhu stood firmly.

TEXT 17

skandhera upare bahu śākhā upajila

upari upari śākhā asaṅkhyā ha-ila

SYNONYMS

skandhera upare—upon the trunk; *bahu śākhā*—many branches; *upajila*—grew; *upari upari*—over and above them; *śākhā*—other branches; *asaṅkhyā*—innumerable; *ha-ila*—fructified.

TRANSLATION

From the trunk grew many branches, and above them innumerable others.

TEXT 18

viśa viśa śākhā kari' eka eka maṇḍala

mahā-mahā-śākhā chāila brahmāṇḍa sakala

SYNONYMS

viśa viśa—twenty, twenty; *śākhā*—branches; *kari'*—making a group; *eka eka maṇḍala*—form a society; *mahā-mahā-śākhā*—big branches; *chāila*—covered; *brahmāṇḍa*—the whole universe; *sakala*—all.

TRANSLATION

Thus the branches of the Caitanya tree formed a cluster or society, with great branches covering all the universe.

PURPORT

Our International Society for Krishna Consciousness is one of the

branches of the Caitanya tree.

TEXT 19

ekaika śākhāte upaśākhā śata śata

yata upajīla śākhā ke gaṇibe kata

SYNONYMS

ekaika—each branch; *śākhāte*—in the branch; *upaśākhā*—subbranches; *śata śata*—hundreds and hundreds; *yata*—all; *upajīla*—grew; *śākhā*—branches; *ke*—who; *gaṇibe*—can count; *kata*—how much.

TRANSLATION

From each branch grew many hundreds of subbranches. No one can count how many branches thus grew.

TEXT 20

mukhya mukhya śākhā-gaṇera nāma agaṇana

āge ta' kariba, śuna vṛkṣera varṇana

SYNONYMS

mukhya mukhya—the foremost of them all; *śākhā-gaṇera*—of the branches; *nāma*—name; *agaṇana*—uncountable; *āge*—subsequently; *ta'* *kariba*—I shall do; *śuna*—please hear; *vṛkṣera varṇana*—the description of the Caitanya tree.

TRANSLATION

I shall try to name the foremost of the innumerable branches. Please hear

the description of the Caitanya tree.

TEXT 21

vrkṣera upare śākhā haila dui skandha

eka ‘advaita’ nāma, āra ‘nityānanda’

SYNONYMS

vrkṣera—of the tree; *upare*—on the top; *śākhā*—branch; *haila*—became; *dui*—two; *skandha*—trunks; *eka*—one; *advaita*—Śrī Advaita Prabhu; *nāma*—of the name; *āra*—and; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

At the top of the tree the trunk branched into two. One trunk was named Śrī Advaita Prabhu and the other Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu.

TEXT 22

sei dui-skandhe bahu śākhā upajila

tāra upaśākhā-gaṇe jagat chāila

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *dui-skandhe*—in two trunks; *bahu*—many; *śākhā*—branches; *upajila*—grew; *tāra*—of them; *upaśākhā-gaṇe*—subbranches; *jagat*—the whole world; *chāila*—covered.

TRANSLATION

From these two trunks grew many branches and subbranches that covered the entire world.

TEXT 23

baḍa śākhā, upasākhā, tāra upasākhā

yata upajila tāra ke karibe lekhā

SYNONYMS

baḍa śākhā—the big branches; *upasākhā*—subbranches; *tāra*—their; *upasākhā*—subbranches; *yata*—all that; *upajila*—grew; *tāra*—of them; *ke*—who; *karibe*—can count; *lekhā*—or write.

TRANSLATION

These branches and subbranches and their subbranches became so numerous that no one can actually write about them.

TEXT 24

śiṣya, praśiṣya, āra upaśiṣya-gaṇa

jagat vyāpila tāra nāhika gaṇana

SYNONYMS

śiṣya—disciples; *praśiṣya*—granddisciples; *āra*—and; *upaśiṣya-gaṇa*—admirers; *jagat*—the whole world; *vyāpila*—spread; *tāra*—of that; *nāhika*—there is none; *gaṇana*—enumeration.

TRANSLATION

Thus the disciples and the granddisciples and their admirers spread throughout the entire world, and it is not possible to enumerate them all.

TEXT 25

uḍumbara-vṛkṣa yena phale sarva aṅge

ei mata bhakti-vṛkṣe sarvatra phala lāge

SYNONYMS

uḍumbara-vṛkṣa—a big fig tree; *yena*—as if; *phale*—grew fruits; *sarva*—all; *aṅge*—parts of the body; *ei*—this; *mata*—like; *bhakti-vṛkṣe*—in the tree of devotional service; *sarvatra*—all over; *phala*—fruit; *lāge*—appears.

TRANSLATION

As a big fig tree bears fruits all over its body, each part of the tree of devotional service bore fruit.

PURPORT

This tree of devotional service is not of this material world. It grows in the spiritual world, where there is no distinction between one part of the body and another. It is something like a tree of sugar, for whichever part of such a tree one tastes, it is always sweet. The tree of *bhakti* has varieties of branches, leaves and fruits, but they are all meant for the service of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. There are nine different processes of devotional service (*śravaṇam kīrtanam viṣṇoḥ smaraṇam pāda-sevanam arcanam vandanam dāsyam sakhyam ātma-nivedanam* [SB 7.5.23]), but all of them are meant only for the service of the Supreme Lord. Therefore whether one hears, chants, remembers or worships, his activities will yield the same result. Which one of these processes will be the most suitable for a particular devotee depends upon his taste.

TEXT 26

mūla-skandhera śākhā āra upasākhā-gaṇe

lāgilā ye prema-phala, — — amṛtake jine

SYNONYMS

mūla-skandhera—of the chief trunk; *sākhā*—branches; *āra*—and; *upasākhā-gaṇe*—subbranches; *lāgilā*—as it grew; *ye*—that; *prema-phala*—the fruit of love; *amṛtake jine*—such a fruit conquers nectar.

TRANSLATION

Since Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu was the original trunk, the taste of the fruits that grew on the branches and subbranches surpassed the taste of nectar.

TEXT 27

pākila ye prema-phala amṛta-madhura

vilāya caitanya-mālī, nāhi laya mūla

SYNONYMS

pākila—ripened; *ye*—that; *prema-phala*—the fruit of love of Godhead; *amṛta*—nectarean; *madhura*—sweet; *vilāya*—distributes; *caitanya-mālī*—the gardener, Lord Caitanya; *nāhi*—does not; *laya*—take; *mūla*—price.

TRANSLATION

The fruits ripened and became sweet and nectarean. The gardener, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, distributed them without asking any price.

TEXT 28

tri-jagate yata āche dhana-ratnamaṇi

eka-phalera mūlya kari' tāhā nāhi gaṇi

SYNONYMS

tri-jagate—in the three worlds; *yata*—as much as; *āche*—there is; *dhana-ratna-maṇi*—wealth and riches; *eka-phalera*—one fruit's; *mūlya*—price; *kari'*—calculated; *tāhā*—that; *nāhi*—do not; *gaṇi*—count.

TRANSLATION

All the wealth in the three worlds cannot equal the value of one such nectarean fruit of devotional service.

TEXT 29

māge vā nā māge keha, pātra vā apātra

ihāra vicāra nāhi jāne, deya mātra

SYNONYMS

māge—begs; *vā*—or; *nā*—not; *māge*—begs; *keha*—anyone; *pātra*—candidate; *vā*—or; *apātra*—not a candidate; *ihāra*—of this; *vicāra*—consideration; *nāhi*—does not; *jāne*—know; *deya*—gives; *mātra*—only.

TRANSLATION

Not considering who asked for it and who did not, nor who was fit and who unfit to receive it, Caitanya Mahāprabhu distributed the fruit of devotional service.

PURPORT

This is the sum and substance of Lord Caitanya's *saṅkīrtana* movement.

There is no distinction made between those who are fit and those who are not fit to hear or take part in the *sañkīrtana* movement. It should therefore be preached without discrimination. The only purpose of the preachers of the *sañkīrtana* movement must be to go on preaching without restriction. That is the way in which Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu introduced this *sañkīrtana* movement to the world.

TEXT 30

añjali añjali bhari' phele caturdiśe

daridra kuḍāñā khāya, mālākāra hāse

SYNONYMS

añjali—handful; *añjali*—handful; *bhari'*—filling; *phele*—distributes; *catur-diśe*—in all directions; *daridra*—poor; *kuḍāñā*—picking up; *khāya*—eats; *mālā-kāra*—the gardener; *hāse*—smiles.

TRANSLATION

The transcendental gardener, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, distributed handful after handful of fruit in all directions, and when the poor, hungry people ate the fruit, the gardener smiled with great pleasure.

TEXT 31

mālākāra kahe, — — śuna, vṛkṣa-parivāra

mūlasākhā-upasākhā yateka prakāra

SYNONYMS

mālā-kāra—the gardener; *kahe*—said; *śuna*—hear; *vṛkṣa-parivāra*—the family of this transcendental tree of devotional service; *mūla-sākhā*—

chief branches; *upaśākhā*—subbranches; *yateka*—as many; *prakāra*—varieties.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya thus addressed the multifarious varieties of branches and subbranches of the tree of devotional service:

TEXT 32

alaukika vṛkṣa kare sarvendriya-karma

sthāvara ha-iyā dhare jaṅgamera dharma

SYNONYMS

alaukika—transcendental; *vṛkṣa*—tree; *kare*—does; *sarva-indriya*—all senses; *karma*—activities; *sthāvara*—immovable; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *dhare*—accepts; *jaṅgamera*—of the movable; *dharma*—activities.

TRANSLATION

“Since the tree of devotional service is transcendental, every one of its parts can perform the action of all the others. Although a tree is supposed to be immovable, this tree nevertheless moves.

PURPORT

It is our experience in the material world that trees stand in one place, but in the spiritual world a tree can go from one place to another. Therefore everything in the spiritual world is called *alaukika*, uncommon or transcendental. Another feature of such a tree is that it can act universally. In the material world the roots of a tree go deep within the earth to gather food, but in the spiritual world the twigs, branches and leaves of the upper portion of the tree can act like the roots.

TEXT 33

e vṛkṣera aṅga haya saba sa-cetana

bāḍiyā vyāpila sabe sakala bhuvana

SYNONYMS

e—this; *vṛkṣera*—of the Caitanya tree; *aṅga*—parts; *haya*—are; *saba*—all; *sa-cetana*—spiritually cognizant; *bāḍiyā*—increasing; *vyāpila*—overflooded; *sabe*—all the parts; *sakala*—all; *bhuvana*—the world.

TRANSLATION

“All the parts of this tree are spiritually cognizant, and thus as they grow they spread all over the world.

TEXT 34

ekalā mālākāra āmi kāhān kāhān yāba

ekalā vā kata phala pāḍiyā vilāba

SYNONYMS

ekalā—alone; *mālā-kāra*—gardener; *āmi*—I am; *kāhān*—where; *kāhān*—where; *yāba*—shall I go; *ekalā*—alone; *vā*—or; *kata*—how many; *phala*—fruits; *pāḍiyā*—picking; *vilāba*—shall distribute.

TRANSLATION

“I am the only gardener. How many places can I go? How many fruits can I pick and distribute?

PURPORT

Here Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu indicates that the distribution of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* should be performed by combined forces. Although He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, He laments, “How can I act alone? How can I alone pick the fruit and distribute it all over the world?” This indicates that all classes of devotees should combine to distribute the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* without consideration of the time, place or situation.

TEXT 35

ekalā uṭhāñā dite haya parísrama

keha pāya, keha nā pāya, rahe mane bhrama

SYNONYMS

ekalā—alone; *uṭhāñā*—picking up; *dite*—to give; *haya*—it becomes; *parísrama*—too laborious; *keha*—someone; *pāya*—does get; *keha*—someone; *nā*—not; *pāya*—does get; *rahe*—remains; *mane*—in the mind; *bhrama*—suspicion.

TRANSLATION

“It would certainly be a very laborious task to pick the fruits and distribute them alone, and still I suspect that some would receive them and others would not.

TEXT 36

ataeva āmī āññā diluṇ sabākāre

yāhān tāhān prema-phala deha’ yāre tāre

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *āmi*—I; *ājñā*—order; *diluṇ*—give; *sabākāre*—to everyone; *yāhān*—wherever; *tāhān*—everywhere; *prema-phala*—the fruit of love of Godhead; *deha'*—distribute; *yāre*—anyone; *tāre*—everyone.

TRANSLATION

“Therefore I order every man within this universe to accept this Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement and distribute it everywhere.

PURPORT

In this connection there is a song sung by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura:

enechi auṣadhi māyā nāśibāra lāgi'
harināma-mahāmantra lao tumi māgi'
bhaktivinoda prabhu-carāṇe paḍiyā
sei harināma-mantra la-ila māgiyā

The *saṅkīrtana* movement has been introduced by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu just to dispel the illusion of *māyā*, by which everyone in this material world thinks himself to be a product of matter and therefore to have many duties pertaining to the body. Actually, the living entity is not his material body: he is a spirit soul. He has a spiritual need to be eternally blissful and full of knowledge, but unfortunately he identifies himself with the body, sometimes as a human being, sometimes as an animal, sometimes a tree, sometimes an aquatic, sometimes a demigod, and so on. Thus with each change of body he develops a different type of consciousness with different types of activities and thus becomes increasingly entangled in material existence, transmigrating perpetually from one body to another. Under the spell of *māyā*, or illusion, he does not consider the past or future but is simply satisfied with the short life span that he has gotten for the present. To eradicate this illusion, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu has brought the *saṅkīrtana* movement, and He requests everyone to accept and distribute it. A person who is actually a

follower of Śrī Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura must immediately accept the request of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu by offering respectful obeisances unto His lotus feet and thus beg from Him the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. If one is fortunate enough to beg from the Lord this Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, his life is successful.

TEXT 37

ekalā mālākāra āmi kata phala khāba

nā diyā vā ei phala āra ki kariba

SYNONYMS

ekalā—alone; *mālā-kāra*—gardener; *āmi*—I; *kata*—how many; *phala*—fruits; *khāba*—eat; *nā*—without; *diyā*—giving; *vā*—or; *ei*—this; *phala*—fruits; *āra*—else; *ki*—what; *kariba*—shall I do.

TRANSLATION

“I am the only gardener. If I do not distribute these fruits, what shall I do with them? How many fruits can I alone eat?”

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu produced so many fruits of devotional service that they must be distributed all over the world; otherwise, how could He alone relish and taste each and every fruit? The original reason that Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa descended as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was to understand Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī’s love for Kṛṣṇa and to taste that love. The fruits of the tree of devotional service were innumerable, and therefore He wanted to distribute them unrestrictedly to everyone. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī therefore writes:

anarpita-carīm cirāt karuṇayāvatīrṇaḥ kalau

*samarpayitum unnatojjvala-rasām sva-bhakti-śriyam
hariḥ puraṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ
sadā hṛdaya-kandare sphuratu vaḥ śacī-nandanah*

There were many previous incarnations of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but none were so generous, kind and magnanimous as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, for He distributed the most confidential aspect of devotional service, namely, the conjugal love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. Therefore Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhupāda desires that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu live perpetually in the hearts of all devotees, for thus they can understand and relish the loving affairs of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī and Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 38

ātma-icchāmṛte vṛkṣa siñci nirantara

tāhāte asaṅkhyā phala vṛkṣera upara

SYNONYMS

ātma—self; *icchā-amṛte*—by the nectar of the will; *vṛkṣa*—the tree; *siñci*—sprinkle; *nirantara*—constantly; *tāhāte*—there; *asaṅkhyā*—unlimited; *phala*—fruits; *vṛkṣera*—on the tree; *upara*—upper.

TRANSLATION

“By the transcendental desire of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, water has been sprinkled all over the tree, and thus there are innumerable fruits of love of Godhead.

PURPORT

God is unlimited, and His desires are also unlimited. This example of unlimited fruits is factually appropriate even within the material context,

for with the good will of the Supreme Personality of Godhead there can be enough fruits, grain and other foodstuffs produced so that all the people in the world could not finish them, even if they ate ten times their capacity. In this material world there is actually no scarcity of anything but Kṛṣṇa consciousness. If people become Kṛṣṇa conscious, by the transcendental will of the Supreme Personality of Godhead there will be enough foodstuffs produced so that people will have no economic problems at all. One can very easily understand this fact. The production of fruits and flowers depends not upon our will but upon the supreme will of the Personality of Godhead. If He is pleased, He can supply enough fruits, flowers, etc., but if people are atheistic and godless, then nature, by His will, restricts the supply of food. For example, in several provinces in India, especially Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh and other adjoining states, there is sometimes a great scarcity of foodstuffs due to lack of rainfall. So-called scientists and economists cannot do anything about this. Therefore, to solve all problems, one must seek the good will of the Supreme Personality of Godhead by becoming Kṛṣṇa conscious and worshiping Him regularly in devotional service.

TEXT 39

ataeva saba phala deha' yāre tāre

khāiyā ha-uk loka ajara amare

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *saba*—all; *phala*—fruits; *deha'*—distribute; *yāre tāre*—to everyone and anyone; *khāiyā*—eating; *ha-uk*—let them become; *loka*—all people; *ajara*—without old age; *amare*—without death.

TRANSLATION

“Distribute this Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement all over the world. Let people eat these fruits and ultimately become free from old age and death.

PURPORT

The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement introduced by Lord Caitanya is extremely important because one who takes to it becomes eternal, being freed from birth, death and old age. People do not recognize that the real distresses in life are the four principles of birth, death, old age and disease. They are so foolish that they resign themselves to these four miseries, not knowing the transcendental remedy of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. Simply by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, one can become free from all misery, but because they are enchanted by the illusory energy, people do not take this movement seriously. Therefore those who are actually servants of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu must seriously distribute this movement all over the world to render the greatest benefit to human society. Of course, animals and other lower species are not capable of understanding this movement, but if even a small number of human beings take it seriously, then by their chanting loudly, all living entities, including even trees, animals and other lower species, will be benefited. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu inquired from Haridāsa Ṭhākura how he was to benefit living entities other than humans, Śrīla Haridāsa Ṭhākura replied that the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* is so potent that if it is chanted loudly, everyone will benefit, including the lower species of life.

TEXT 40

jagat vyāpiyā mora habe puṇya khyāti

sukhī ha-iyā loka mora gāhibeka kīrti

SYNONYMS

jagat vyāpiyā—spreading all over the world; *mora*—My; *habe*—there will be; *puṇya*—pious; *khyāti*—reputation; *sukhī*—happy; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *loka*—all the people; *mora*—My; *gāhibeka*—glorify; *kīrti*—reputation.

TRANSLATION

“If the fruits are distributed all over the world, My reputation as a pious man will be known everywhere, and thus all people will glorify My name with great pleasure.

PURPORT

This prediction of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s is now actually coming to pass. The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is being distributed all over the world through the chanting of the holy name of the Lord, the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, and people who were leading confused, chaotic lives are now feeling transcendental happiness. They are finding peace in *saṅkīrtana*, and therefore they are acknowledging the supreme benefit of this movement. This is the blessing of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. His prediction is now factually being fulfilled, and those who are sober and conscientious are appreciating the value of this great movement.

TEXT 41

bhārata-bhūmite haila manuṣya janma yāra

janma sārthaka kari’ kara para-upakāra

SYNONYMS

bhārata—of India; *bhūmite*—in the land; *haila*—has become; *manuṣya*—human being; *janma*—birth; *yāra*—anyone; *janma*—such a birth; *sārthaka*—fulfillment; *kari’*—doing so; *kara*—do; *para*—others; *upakāra*—benefit.

TRANSLATION

“One who has taken his birth as a human being in the land of India [Bhārata-varṣa] should make his life successful and work for the benefit

of all other people.

PURPORT

The magnanimity of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is expressed in this very important verse. Although He was born in Bengal and Bengalis therefore have a special duty toward Him, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is addressing not only Bengalis but all the inhabitants of India. It is in the land of India that actual human civilization can be developed.

Human life is especially meant for God realization, as stated in the *Vedānta-sūtra: athāto brahma jijñāsā*. Anyone who takes birth in the land of India (Bhārata-varṣa) has the special privilege of being able to take advantage of the instruction and guidance of the Vedic civilization. He automatically receives the basic principles of spiritual life, for 99.9% of the Indian people, even simple village farmers and others who are neither educated nor sophisticated, believe in the transmigration of the soul, believe in past and future lives, believe in God, and naturally want to worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead or His representative. These ideas are the natural inheritance of a person born in India. India has many holy places of pilgrimage, such as Gayā, Benares, Mathurā, Prayāga, Vṛndāvana, Haridvāra, Rāmeśvaram and Jagannātha Purī, and still people go there by the hundreds and thousands. Although the present leaders of India are influencing the people not to believe in God, not to believe in a next life and not to believe in a distinction between pious and impious life, and although they are teaching them how to drink wine, eat meat and become supposedly civilized, people are nevertheless afraid of the four activities of sinful life—namely illicit sex, meat-eating, intoxication and gambling—and whenever there is a religious festival, they gather together by the thousands. We have actual experience of this. Whenever the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement holds a *saṅkīrtana* festival in a big city like Calcutta, Bombay, Madras, Ahmedabad or Hyderabad, thousands of people come to hear. Sometimes we speak in English, but even though most people do not understand English, they nevertheless come to hear us. Even when imitation incarnations of Godhead speak,

people gather in the thousands, for everyone who is born in the land of India has a natural spiritual inclination and is taught the basic principles of spiritual life; they merely need to be a little more educated in the Vedic principles. Therefore Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu says here, *janma sārthaka kari' kara para-upakāra*: if an Indian is educated in the Vedic principles, he is able to perform the most beneficial welfare activity for the entire world.

At present, for want of Kṛṣṇa consciousness, or God consciousness, the entire world is in darkness, having been covered by the four principles of sinful life—meat-eating, illicit sex, gambling and intoxication. Therefore there is a need for vigorous propaganda to educate people to refrain from sinful activities. This will bring peace and prosperity; the rogues, thieves and debauchees will naturally decrease in number, and all of human society will be God conscious.

The practical effect of our spreading the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement all over the world is that now the most degraded debauchees are becoming the most elevated saints. This is only one Indian's humble service to the world. If all Indians had taken to this path, as advised by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, India would have given a unique gift to the world, and thus India would have been glorified. Now, however, India is known as a poverty-stricken country, and whenever anyone from America or another opulent country goes to India, he sees many people lying by the footpaths for whom there are not even provisions for two meals a day. There are also institutions collecting money from all parts of the world in the name of welfare activities for poverty-stricken people, but they are spending it for their own sense gratification. Now, on the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement has been started, and people are benefiting from this movement. Therefore it is now the duty of the leading men of India to consider the importance of this movement and train many Indians to go outside of India to preach this cult. People will accept it, there will be cooperation among the Indian people and among the other people of the world, and the mission of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu will then be fulfilled. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu will then be

glorified all over the world, and people will naturally be happy, peaceful and prosperous, not only in this life but also in the next, for as stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, anyone who understands Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, will very easily get salvation, or freedom from the repetition of birth and death, and go back home, back to Godhead. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu therefore requests every Indian to become a preacher of His cult to save the world from disastrous confusion.

This is not only the duty of Indians but the duty of everyone, and we are very happy that American and European boys and girls are seriously cooperating with this movement. One should know definitely that the best welfare activity for all of human society is to awaken man's God consciousness, or Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Therefore everyone should help this great movement. This is confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Tenth Canto, Twenty-second Chapter, verse 35, which is next quoted in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 42

etāvaj janma-sāphalyam

dehinām iha dehiṣu

prāṇair arthair dhiyā vācā

śreya-ācaraṇam sadā

SYNONYMS

etāvat—up to this; *janma*—of birth; *sāphalyam*—perfection; *dehinām*—of every living being; *iha*—in this world; *dehiṣu*—toward those who are embodied; *prāṇaiḥ*—by life; *arthaiḥ*—by wealth; *dhiyā*—by intelligence; *vācā*—by words; *śreyaḥ*—eternal good fortune; *ācaraṇam*—acting practically; *sadā*—always.

TRANSLATION

“It is the duty of every living being to perform welfare activities for the benefit of others with his life, wealth, intelligence and words.’

PURPORT

There are two kinds of general activities—*śreyas*, or activities which are ultimately beneficial and auspicious, and *preyas*, or those which are immediately beneficial and auspicious. For example, children are fond of playing. They do not want to go to school to receive an education, and they think that to play all day and night and enjoy with their friends is the aim of life. Even in the transcendental life of Lord Kṛṣṇa, we find that when He was a child He was very fond of playing with His friends of the same age, the cowherd boys. He would not even go home to take His dinner. Mother Yaśodā would have to come out to induce Him to come home. Thus it is a child’s nature to engage all day and night in playing, not caring even for his health and other important concerns. This is an example of *preyas*, or immediately beneficial activities. But there are also *śreyas*, or activities which are ultimately auspicious. According to Vedic civilization, a human being must be God conscious. He should understand what God is, what this material world is, who he is, and what their interrelationships are. This is called *śreyas*, or ultimately auspicious activity.

In this verse of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* it is said that one should be interested in *śreyas*. To achieve the ultimate goal of *śreyas*, or good fortune, one should engage everything, including his life, wealth and words, not only for himself but for others also. However, unless one is interested in *śreyas* in his own life, he cannot preach of *śreyas* for the benefit of others.

This verse cited by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu applies to human beings, not to animals. As indicated in the previous verse by the words *manuṣya-janma*, these injunctions are for human beings. Unfortunately, human

beings, although they have the bodies of men, are becoming less than animals in their behavior. This is the fault of modern education. Modern educators do not know the aim of human life; they are simply concerned with how to develop the economic condition of their countries or of human society. This is also necessary; the Vedic civilization considers all aspects of human life, including *dharma* (religion), *artha* (economic development), *kāma* (sense gratification) and *mokṣa* (liberation). But humanity's first concern should be religion. To be religious, one must abide by the orders of God, but unfortunately people in this age have rejected religion, and they are busy in economic development. Therefore they will adopt any means to get money. For economic development one does not need to get money by hook or by crook; one needs only sufficient money to maintain his body and soul. However, because modern economic development is going on with no religious background, people have become lusty, greedy and mad after money. They are simply developing the qualities of *rajas* (passion) and *tamas* (ignorance), neglecting the other quality of nature, *sattva* (goodness), and the brahminical qualifications. Therefore the entire society is in chaos.

The *Bhāgavatam* says that it is the duty of an advanced human being to act in such a way as to facilitate human society's attainment of the ultimate goal of life. There is a similar verse in the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*, Part Three, Chapter Twelve, verse 45, which is next quoted in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 43

prāṇinām upakārāya

yad eveha paratra ca

karmaṇā manasā vācā

tad eva mati-mān bhajet

SYNONYMS

prāṇinām—of all living entities; *upakārāya*—for the benefit; *yat*—whichever; *eva*—certainly; *iha*—in this world or in this life; *paratra*—in the next life; *ca*—and; *karmaṇā*—by work; *manasā*—by the mind; *vācā*—by words; *tat*—that; *eva*—certainly; *matī-mān*—an intelligent man; *bhajet*—must act.

TRANSLATION

“By his work, thoughts and words, an intelligent man must perform actions which will be beneficial for all living entities in this life and the next.’

PURPORT

Unfortunately, people in general do not know what is to take place in the next life. To prepare oneself for his next life is common sense, and it is a principle of the Vedic civilization, but presently people throughout the world do not believe in a next life. Even influential professors and other educators say that as soon as the body is finished, everything is finished. This atheistic philosophy is killing human civilization. People are irresponsibly performing all sorts of sinful activities, and thus the privilege of the human life is being taken away by the educational propaganda of the so-called leaders. Actually it is a fact that this life is meant for preparation for the next life; by evolution one has come through many species, or forms, and this human form of life is an opportunity to promote oneself to a better life. This is explained in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.25):

*yānti deva-vratā devān pitṛn yānti pitṛ-vratāḥ
bhūtāni yānti bhūtejyā yānti mad-yājino 'pi mām*

“Those who worship the demigods will take birth among the demigods; those who worship ghosts and spirits will take birth among such beings;

those who worship ancestors go to the ancestors; and those who worship Me will live with Me.” Therefore, one may promote himself to the higher planetary systems, which are the residence of the demigods, one can promote himself to Pitṛloka, one can remain on earth, or one can also go back home, back to Godhead. This is further confirmed elsewhere in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.9): *tyaktvā dehaṁ punar janma naiti mām eti so ’rjuna*. After giving up the body, one who knows Kṛṣṇa in truth does not come back again to this world to accept a material body, but he goes back home, back to Godhead. This knowledge is in the *śāstras*, and people should be given the opportunity to understand it. Even if one is not able to go back to Godhead in one life, the Vedic civilization at least gives one the opportunity to be promoted to the higher planetary systems, where the demigods live, and not glide down again to animal life. At present, people do not understand this knowledge, although it constitutes a great science, for they are uneducated and trained not to accept it. This is the horrible condition of modern human society. As such, the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is the only hope to direct the attention of intelligent men to a greater benefit in life.

TEXT 44

mālī manuṣya āmāra nāhi rājya-dhana

phala-phula diyā kari’ puṇya upārjana

SYNONYMS

mālī—gardener; *manuṣya*—man; *āmāra*—My; *nāhi*—there is none; *rājya*—kingdom; *dhana*—wealth; *phala*—fruit; *phula*—flowers; *diyā*—giving; *kari’*—do; *puṇya*—piety; *upārjana*—achievement.

TRANSLATION

“I am merely a gardener. I have neither a kingdom nor very great riches. I simply have some fruits and flowers that I wish to utilize to achieve

piety in My life.

PURPORT

In performing welfare activities for human society, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu presents Himself as being not very rich, thus indicating that a man need not be rich or opulent to act for the welfare of humanity. Sometimes rich men are very proud that they can perform beneficial activities for human society whereas others cannot. A practical example is that when there is a scarcity of food in India on account of meager rainfall, some members of the richer class very proudly distribute foodstuffs, making huge arrangements with the help of the government, as if merely by such activities people will be benefited. Suppose there were no food grain. How would the rich men distribute food? Production of grain is completely in the hands of God. If there were no rain, there would be no grain, and these so-called rich men would be unable to distribute grain to the people.

The real purpose of life, therefore, is to satisfy the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī describes in his *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* that devotional service is so exalted that it is beneficial and auspicious for every man. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu also declared that to propagate the *bhakti* cult of devotional service in human society, one does not need to be very rich. Anyone who knows the art can do it and thus render the highest benefit to humanity. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu takes the part of a gardener because although a gardener is naturally not a very rich man, he has some fruits and flowers. Any man can collect some fruits and flowers and satisfy the Supreme Personality of Godhead in devotional service, as the Lord recommends in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.26):

*patraṁ puṣpaṁ phalaṁ toyaṁ yo me bhaktyā prayacchati
tad ahaṁ bhakty-upahṛtam aśnāmi prayatātmanaḥ*

One cannot satisfy the Supreme Lord by his riches, wealth or opulent position, but anyone can collect a little fruit or a flower and offer it to the

Lord. The Lord says that if one brings such an offering in devotion, He will accept it and eat it. When Kṛṣṇa eats, the entire world becomes satisfied. There is a story in the *Mahābhārata* illustrating how by Kṛṣṇa's eating, the sixty thousand disciples of Durvāsā Muni were all satisfied. Therefore it is a fact that if by our life (*prāṇaiḥ*), by our wealth (*arthaiḥ*), by our intelligence (*dhiyā*) or by our words (*vācā*) we can satisfy the Supreme Personality of Godhead, naturally the entire world will become happy. Therefore our main duty is to satisfy the Supreme Godhead by our actions, our money and our words. This is very simple. Even if one does not have money, he can preach the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* to everyone. One can go everywhere, to every home, and request everyone to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*. Thus the entire world situation will become very happy and peaceful.

TEXT 45

mālī hañā vṛkṣa ha-ilān ei ta' icchāte

sarva-prāṇīra upakāra haya vṛkṣa haite

SYNONYMS

mālī hañā—although I am the gardener; *vṛkṣa ha-ilān*—I am also the tree; *ei ta'*—this is; *icchāte*—by My will; *sarva-prāṇīra*—of all living entities; *upakāra*—welfare; *haya*—there is; *vṛkṣa*—the tree; *haite*—from.

TRANSLATION

“Although I am acting as a gardener, I also want to be the tree, for thus I can bestow benefit upon all.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the most benevolent personality in human

society because His only desire is to make people happy. His *saṅkīrtana* movement is especially meant for the purpose of making people happy. He wanted to become the tree Himself because a tree is said to be the most benevolent living entity. In the following verse, which is from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.22.33), Kṛṣṇa Himself highly praises the existence of a tree.

TEXT 46

aho eṣāṁ varam janma

sarva-prāṇy-upajīvinām

su-janasyeva yeṣāṁ vai

vimukhā yānti nārthinaḥ

SYNONYMS

aho—oh, just see; *eṣāṁ*—of these trees; *varam*—superior; *janma*—birth; *sarva*—all; *prāṇi*—living entities; *upajīvinām*—one who provides maintenance; *su-janasya iva*—like the great personalities; *yeṣāṁ*—from whose; *vai*—certainly; *vimukhāḥ*—disappointed; *yānti*—goes away; *na*—never; *arthinaḥ*—one who is asking for something.

TRANSLATION

“Just see how these trees are maintaining every living entity! Their birth is successful. Their behavior is just like that of great personalities, for anyone who asks anything from a tree never goes away disappointed.”

PURPORT

According to Vedic civilization, *kṣatriyas* are considered to be great personalities because if anyone goes to a *kṣatriya* king to ask for charity,

the king will never refuse. The trees are compared to those noble *kṣatriyas* because everyone derives all kinds of benefits from them—some people take fruit, others take flowers, others take leaves, others take twigs, and others even cut the tree, and yet the tree gives to everyone without hesitation.

Unnecessarily cutting trees without consideration is another example of human debauchery. The paper industry cuts many hundreds and thousands of trees for its mills, and with the paper so much rubbish literature is published for the whimsical satisfaction of human society. Unfortunately, although these industrialists are now happy in this life by dint of their industrial development, they do not know that they will incur the responsibility for killing these living entities who are in the form of trees.

This verse, quoted from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, was spoken by Lord Kṛṣṇa to His friends when He was taking rest underneath a tree after His pastime of stealing the clothes of the *gopīs* (*vastra-haraṇa-līlā*). By quoting this verse, Caitanya Mahāprabhu teaches us that we should be tolerant like trees and also beneficial like trees, which give everything to the needy persons who come underneath them. A needy person may derive many advantages from trees and also from many animals, but in modern civilization people have become so ungrateful that they exploit the trees and animals and kill them. These are some of the sinful activities of modern civilization.

TEXT 47

ei ājñā kaila yadi caitanya-mālākāra

parama ānanda pāīla vṛkṣa-parivāra

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ājñā*—order; *kaila*—gave; *yadi*—when; *caitanya*—Śrī Caitanya

Mahāprabhu; *mālā-kāra*—as a gardener; *parama*—the greatest; *ānanda*—pleasure; *pāila*—got; *vṛkṣa*—of the tree; *parivāra*—descendants.

TRANSLATION

The descendants of the tree [the devotees of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu] were very glad to receive this order directly from the Lord.

PURPORT

It is the desire of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu that the benevolent activities of the *saṅkīrtana* movement, which was inaugurated five hundred years ago in Navadvīpa, be spread all over the world for the benefit of all human beings. Unfortunately, there are many so-called followers of Caitanya Mahāprabhu who are satisfied simply to construct a temple, make a show of the Deities, collect some funds and utilize them for eating and sleeping. There is no question of their preaching the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu all over the world. But even though they are unable to do so, if anyone else does it they become envious. This is the condition of the modern followers of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The Age of Kali is so strong that it affects even the so-called followers of Lord Caitanya. At least the followers of Caitanya Mahāprabhu must come out of India to preach His cult all over the world, for this is the mission of Lord Caitanya. The followers of Lord Caitanya must execute His will with heart and soul, being more tolerant than the trees and humbler than the straw in the street.

TEXT 48

yei yāhān tāhān dāna kare prema-phala

phalāsvāde matta loka ha-ila sakala

SYNONYMS

yei—anyone; *yāhān*—wherever; *tāhān*—anywhere; *dāna*—charity; *kare*—gives in; *prema-phala*—the fruit of love of Godhead; *phala*—fruit; *āsvāde*—by tasting; *matta*—intoxicated; *loka*—people; *ha-ila*—become; *sakala*—all.

TRANSLATION

The fruit of love of God is so delicious that wherever a devotee distributes it, those who relish the fruit, anywhere in the world, immediately become intoxicated.

PURPORT

Here the wonderful fruit of love of Godhead distributed by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is described. We have practical experience that anyone who accepts this fruit and sincerely tastes it immediately becomes mad after it and gives up all his bad habits, being intoxicated by Caitanya Mahāprabhu's gift, the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. The statements of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* are so practical that anyone can test them. As far as we are concerned, we are most confident of the success of the distribution of the great fruit of love of Godhead through the medium of chanting the *mahā-mantra*—Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare.

TEXT 49

mahā-mādaka prema-phala peṭa bhari' khāya

mātila sakala loka—hāse, nāce, gāya

SYNONYMS

mahā-mādaka—great intoxicant; *prema-phala*—this fruit of love of God; *peṭa*—belly; *bhari'*—filling; *khāya*—let them eat; *mātila*—became mad; *sakala loka*—all the people in general; *hāse*—laugh; *nāce*—dance; *gāya*—

chant.

TRANSLATION

The fruit of love of Godhead distributed by Caitanya Mahāprabhu is such a great intoxicant that anyone who eats it, filling his belly, immediately becomes maddened by it, and automatically he chants, dances, laughs and enjoys.

TEXT 50

keha gaḍāgaḍi yāya, keha ta' huṅkāra

dekhi' ānandita hañā hāse mālākāra

SYNONYMS

keha—some of them; *gaḍāgaḍi yāya*—roll on the floor; *keha*—some of them; *ta'*—certainly; *huṅkāra*—hum very loudly; *dekhi'*—seeing this; *ānandita*—gladdened; *hañā*—becoming so; *hāse*—smiles; *mālā-kāra*—the great gardener.

TRANSLATION

When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the great gardener, sees that people are chanting, dancing and laughing and that some of them are rolling on the floor and some are making loud humming sounds, He smiles with great pleasure.

PURPORT

This attitude of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is very important for persons engaged in the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement of Kṛṣṇa consciousness. In every center of our institution, ISKCON, we have arranged for a love feast every Sunday, and when we actually see people come to our center,

chant, dance, take *prasādam*, become jubilant and purchase books, we know that certainly Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is always present in such transcendental activities, and He is very pleased and satisfied. Therefore the members of ISKCON must increase this movement more and more, according to the principles that we are presently trying to execute. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, thus being pleased, will smilingly glance upon them, bestowing His favor, and the movement will be successful.

TEXT 51

ei mālākāra khāya ei prema-phala

niravadhi matta rahe, vivaśa-vihvala

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *mālā-kāra*—great gardener; *khāya*—eats; *ei*—this; *prema-phala*—fruit of love of Godhead; *niravadhi*—always; *matta*—maddened; *rahe*—remains; *vivaśa*—as if helpless; *vihvala*—as if bewildered.

TRANSLATION

The great gardener, Lord Caitanya, personally eats this fruit, and as a result He constantly remains mad, as if helpless and bewildered.

PURPORT

It is the mission of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu to act Himself and teach the people. He says, *āpani ācari' bhakti karila pracāra* (Cc. Ādi 4.41). One must first act himself and then teach. This is the function of a real teacher. Unless one is able to understand the philosophy that he speaks, it will not be effective. Therefore one should not only understand the philosophy of the Caitanya cult but also implement it practically in one's life.

While chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu sometimes fainted and remained unconscious for many hours. He prays in His *Śikṣāṣṭaka* (7):

*yugāyitaṁ nimeṣeṇa cakṣuṣā prāvṛṣāyitaṁ
śūnyāyitaṁ jagat sarvaṁ govinda-viraheṇa me*

“O Govinda! Feeling Your separation, I am considering a moment to be like twelve years or more. Tears are flowing from My eyes like torrents of rain, and I am feeling all vacant in the world in Your absence.” This is the perfectional stage of chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* and eating the fruit of love of Godhead, as exhibited by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. One should not artificially imitate this stage, but if one is serious and sincerely follows the regulative principles and chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, the time will come when these symptoms will appear. Tears will fill his eyes, he will be unable to chant the *mahā-mantra* distinctly, and his heart will throb in ecstasy. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu says that one should not imitate this, but a devotee should long for the day to come when such symptoms of trance will automatically appear in his body.

TEXT 52

sarva-loke matta kailā āpana-samāna

preme matta loka vinā nāhi dekhi āna

SYNONYMS

sarva-loke—all people; *matta*—maddened; *kailā*—He made; *āpana*—Himself; *samāna*—like; *preme*—in love of God; *matta*—maddened; *loka*—people in general; *vinā*—without; *nāhi*—do not; *dekhi*—we see; *āna*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

With His *saṅkīrtana* movement the Lord made everyone mad like Himself. We do not find anyone who was not intoxicated by His *saṅkīrtana* movement.

TEXT 53

ye ye pūrve nindā kaila, bali' mātoyāla

seho phala khāya, nāce, bale—bhāla bhāla

SYNONYMS

ye ye—persons who; *pūrve*—before; *nindā*—blasphemy; *kaila*—made; *bali'*—saying; *mātoyāla*—drunkard; *seho*—such persons; *phala*—fruit; *khāya*—takes; *nāce*—dance; *bale*—say; *bhāla bhāla*—very good, very good.

TRANSLATION

Persons who had formerly criticized Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, calling Him a drunkard, also ate the fruit and began to dance, saying, “Very good! Very good!”

PURPORT

When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu started the *saṅkīrtana* movement, even He was unnecessarily criticized by Māyāvādīs, atheists and fools. Naturally we are also criticized by such men. They will always remain and will always criticize anything that is actually good for human society. But the preachers of the *saṅkīrtana* movement should not be deterred by such criticism. Our method should be to convert such fools gradually by asking them to come and take *prasādam* and chant and dance with us. This should be our policy. Anyone who comes to join us, of course, must be sincere and serious regarding spiritual advancement in life; then such a person, simply by joining us, chanting with us, dancing with us and

taking *prasādam* with us, will gradually also come to say that this movement is very good. But one who joins with an ulterior purpose, to get material benefit or personal gratification, will never be able to grasp the philosophy of this movement.

TEXT 54

ei ta' kahiluṇi prema-phala-vitaraṇa

ebe śuna, phala-dātā ye ye śākhā-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ta'*—however; *kahiluṇi*—I have explained; *prema-phala*—the fruit of love of Godhead; *vitaraṇa*—distribution; *ebe*—now; *śuna*—hear; *phala-dātā*—the giver of the fruit; *ye ye*—who and who; *śākhā-gaṇa*—branches.

TRANSLATION

After describing the Lord's distribution of the fruit of love of Godhead, I now wish to describe the different branches of the tree of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 55

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—

describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Ninth Chapter, describing the desire tree of devotional service.

Chapter 10

The Trunk, Branches and Subbranches of the Caitanya Tree

This chapter describes the branches of the tree named Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 1

śrī-caitanya-padāmbhoja-

madhupebhyo namo namaḥ

kathañcid āśrayād yeṣāṁ

śvāpi tad-gandha-bhāg bhavet

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *pada-ambhoja*—the lotus feet; *madhu*—honey; *pebhyaḥ*—unto those who drink; *namaḥ*—respectful obeisances; *namaḥ*—respectful obeisances; *kathañcit*—a little of it; *āśrayāt*—taking shelter of; *yeṣāṁ*—of whom; *śvā*—dog; *api*—also;

tat-gandha—the aroma of the lotus flower; *bhāk*—shareholder; *bhavet*—may become.

TRANSLATION

Let me repeatedly offer my respectful obeisances unto the beelike devotees who always taste the honey of the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. If even a doggish nondevotee somehow takes shelter of such devotees, he enjoys the aroma of the lotus flower.

PURPORT

The example of a dog is very significant in this connection. A dog naturally does not become a devotee at any time, but still it is sometimes found that a dog of a devotee gradually becomes a devotee also. We have actually seen that a dog has no respect even for the *tulasī* plant. Indeed, a dog is especially inclined to pass urine on the *tulasī* plant. Therefore the dog is the number one nondevotee. But Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's *saṅkīrtana* movement is so strong that even a doglike nondevotee can gradually become a devotee by the association of a devotee of Lord Caitanya. Śrīla Śivānanda Sena, a great householder devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, attracted a dog on the street while going to Jagannātha Purī. The dog began to follow him and ultimately went to see Caitanya Mahāprabhu and was liberated. Similarly, cats and dogs in the household of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura were also liberated. Cats and dogs and other animals are not expected to become devotees, but in the association of a pure devotee they are also delivered.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-nityānanda

jayādvaitacandra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—to Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *jaya advaita-candra*—all glories to Advaita Prabhu; *jaya*—all glories; *gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—to the devotees of Lord Caitanya, headed by Śrīvāsa.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Lord Nityānanda! All glories to Advaita Prabhu, and all glories to the devotees of Lord Caitanya, headed by Śrīvāsa!

TEXT 3

ei mālira—*ei vṛkṣera akathya kathana*

ebe śuna mukhya-sākhāra nāma-vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

ei mālira—of this gardener; *ei vṛkṣera*—of this tree; *akathya kathana*—inconceivable description; *ebe*—now; *śuna*—hear; *mukhya*—chief; *sākhāra*—branches; *nāma*—of the names; *vivaraṇa*—description.

TRANSLATION

The description of Lord Caitanya as the gardener and the tree is inconceivable. Now hear with attention about the branches of this tree.

TEXT 4

caitanya-gosāñira yata pāriṣada-caya

guru-laghu-bhāva tāñra nā haya niścaya

SYNONYMS

caitanya—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gosāñīra*—of the supreme spiritual master; *yata*—all; *pāriṣada-caya*—groups of associates; *guru-laghu-bhāva*—conceptions of high and low; *tāñra*—of them; *nā*—never; *haya*—become; *niścaya*—ascertained.

TRANSLATION

The associates of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu were many, but none of them should be considered lower or higher. This cannot be ascertained.

TEXT 5

yata yata mahānta kailā tāñ-sabāra gaṇana

keha karibāre nāre jyeṣṭha-laghu-krama

SYNONYMS

yata yata—as many as there are; *mahānta*—great devotees; *kailā*—made; *tāñ-sabāra*—of all of them; *gaṇana*—counting; *keha*—all of them; *karibāre nāre*—can not do; *jyeṣṭha*—elder; *laghu*—younger; *krama*—chronology.

TRANSLATION

All the great personalities in the line of Lord Caitanya enumerated these devotees, but they could not distinguish between the greater and the lesser.

TEXT 6

ataeva tāñ-sabāre kari' namaskāra

nāma-mātra kari, doṣa nā labe āmāra

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *tān-sabāre*—to all of them; *kari'*—doing;
namaskāra—offer my obeisances; *nāma-mātra*—that is also a token;
kari—I do; *doṣa*—fault; *nā*—do not; *labe*—take; *āmāra*—of me.

TRANSLATION

I offer my obeisances unto them as a token of respect. I request them not to consider my offenses.

TEXT 7

vande śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-

premāmara-taroḥ priyān

śākhā-rūpān bhakta-gaṇān

kṛṣṇa-prema-phala-pradān

SYNONYMS

vande—I offer my obeisances; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *prema-amara-taroḥ*—of the eternal tree full of love of Godhead; *priyān*—those who are devotees; *śākhā-rūpān*—represented as branches; *bhakta-gaṇān*—all the devotees; *kṛṣṇa-prema*—of love of Kṛṣṇa; *phala*—of the fruit; *pradān*—the givers.

TRANSLATION

I offer my obeisances to all the dear devotees of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the eternal tree of love of Godhead. I offer my respects to all the branches of the tree, the devotees of the Lord who distribute the fruit of love of Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Śrī Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī sets the example of offering obeisances to all the preacher devotees of Lord Caitanya, without distinction as to higher and lower. Unfortunately, at present there are many foolish so-called devotees of Lord Caitanya who make such distinctions. For example, the title “Prabhupāda” is offered to a spiritual master, especially to a distinguished spiritual master such as Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhupāda, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhupāda or Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī Prabhupāda. When our disciples similarly wanted to address their spiritual master as Prabhupāda, some foolish people became envious. Not considering the propaganda work of the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement, simply because these disciples addressed their spiritual master as Prabhupāda they became so envious that they formed a faction along with other such envious persons just to minimize the value of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. To chastise such fools, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī very frankly says, *keha karibāre nāre jyeṣṭha-laghu-krama*. Anyone who is a bona fide preacher of the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu must be respectful to the real devotees of Lord Caitanya; one should not be envious, considering one preacher to be very great and another to be very lowly. This is a material distinction and has no place on the platform of spiritual activities. Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī therefore offers equal respect to all the preachers of the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who are compared to the branches of the tree. ISKCON is one of these branches, and it should therefore be respected by all sincere devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 8

śrīvāsa paṇḍita, āra śrī-rāma paṇḍita

dui bhāi—dui sākḥā, jagate vidita

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsa paṇḍita—Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita; *āra*—and; *śrī-rāma paṇḍita*—Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita; *dui bhāi*—two brothers; *dui śākhā*—two branches; *jagate*—in the world; *vidita*—well known.

TRANSLATION

The two brothers Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita and Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita started two branches that are well known in the world.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (90), Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita (Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura) is described as an incarnation of Nārada Muni, and Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita, his younger brother, is said to be an incarnation of Parvata Muni, a great friend of Nārada's. Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita's wife, Mālinī, is celebrated as an incarnation of the nurse Ambikā, who fed Lord Kṛṣṇa with her breast milk, and as already noted, his niece Nārāyaṇī, the mother of Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa, the author of *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*, was the sister of Ambikā in *kṛṣṇa-līlā*. We also understand from the description of *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata* that after Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's acceptance of the *sannyāsa* order, Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita left Navadvīpa, possibly because of feelings of separation, and domiciled at Kumārahaṭṭa.

TEXT 9

śrīpati, śrīnidhi——*tāira dui sahodara*

cāri bhāira dāsa-dāsī, gṛha-parikara

SYNONYMS

śrīpati—Śrīpati; *śrīnidhi*—Śrīnidhi; *tāira*—their; *dui*—two; *sahodara*—own brothers; *cāri*—four; *bhāira*—brothers; *dāsa-dāsī*—family members, menservants and maidservants; *gṛha-parikara*—all counted in one family.

TRANSLATION

Their two brothers were named Śrīpati and Śrīnidhi. These four brothers and their servants and maidservants are considered one big branch.

TEXT 10

dui śākhāra upaśākhāya tān-sabāra gaṇana

yāñra gr̥he mahāprabhura sadā sañkīrtana

SYNONYMS

dui śākhāra—of the two branches; *upaśākhāya*—on the subbranches; *tān-sabāra*—of all of them; *gaṇana*—counting; *yāñra gr̥he*—in whose house; *mahāprabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sadā*—always; *sañkīrtana*—congregational chanting.

TRANSLATION

There is no counting the subbranches of these two branches. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu held congregational chanting daily at the house of Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita.

TEXT 11

cāri bhāi sa-vamśe kare caitanyera sevā

gauracandra vinā nāhi jāne devī-devā

SYNONYMS

cāri bhāi—four brothers; *sa-vamśe*—with all family members; *kare*—do; *caitanyera*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sevā*—service; *gauracandra*—Gaurasundara (Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu); *vinā*—

except; *nāhi jāne*—they do not know; *devī*—goddess; *devā*—or god.

TRANSLATION

These four brothers and their family members fully engaged in the service of Lord Caitanya. They knew no other god or goddess.

PURPORT

Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura has said, *anya-devāśraya nāi, tomāre kahinu bhāi, ei bhakti parama-kāraṇa*: if one wants to become a pure, staunch devotee, one should not take shelter of any of the demigods or - goddesses. Foolish Māyāvādīs say that worshiping demigods is as good as worshiping the Supreme Personality of Godhead, but that is not a fact. This philosophy misleads people to atheism. One who has no idea what God actually is thinks that any form he imagines or any rascal he accepts can be God. This acceptance of cheap gods or incarnations of God is actually atheism. It is to be concluded, therefore, that those who worship demigods or self-proclaimed incarnations of God are all atheists. They have lost their knowledge, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.20): *kāmais tais tair hr̥ta-jñānāḥ prapadyante 'nya-devatāḥ*. “Those whose minds are distorted by material desires surrender unto demigods.” Unfortunately, those who do not cultivate Kṛṣṇa consciousness and do not properly understand the Vedic knowledge accept any rascal to be an incarnation of God, and they are of the opinion that one can become an incarnation simply by worshiping a demigod. This philosophical hodge-podge exists under the name of the Hindu religion, but the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement does not approve of it. Indeed, we strongly condemn it. Such worship of demigods and so-called incarnations of God should never be confused with the pure Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement.

TEXT 12

‘ācāryaratna’ nāma dhare baḍa eka sākḥā

tāñra parikara, tāñra śākhā-upasākhā

SYNONYMS

ācāryaratna—Ācāryaratna; *nāma*—name; *dhare*—he accepts; *baḍa*—big; *eka*—one; *śākhā*—branch; *tāñra*—his; *parikara*—associates; *tāñra*—his; *śākhā*—branch; *upasākhā*—subbranches.

TRANSLATION

Another big branch was Ācāryaratna, and his associates were subbranches.

TEXT 13

ācāryaratnera nāma ‘śrī-candraśekhara’—

yāñra ghare devī-bhāve nācilā īśvara

SYNONYMS

ācāryaratnera—of Ācāryaratna; *nāma*—name; *śrī-candraśekhara*—Śrī Candraśekhara; *yāñra*—of whom; *ghare*—in the home; *devī-bhāve*—as the goddess; *nācilā*—danced; *īśvara*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

Ācāryaratna was also named Śrī Candraśekhara Ācārya. In a drama in his house, Lord Caitanya played the goddess of fortune.

PURPORT

Dramatic performances were enacted during the presence of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, but the players who took part in such dramas were all pure devotees; no outsiders were allowed. The members of ISKCON should

follow this example. Whenever they stage dramatic performances about the lives of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu or Lord Kṛṣṇa, the players must be pure devotees. Professional players and dramatic actors have no sense of devotional service, and therefore although they can perform very artistically, there is no life in such performances. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura used to refer to such an actor as *yātrā-dale nārada*, which means “farcical Nārada.” Sometimes an actor in a drama plays the part of Nārada Muni, although in his private life he is not at all like Nārada Muni because he is not a devotee. Such actors are not needed in dramatic performances about the lives of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Lord Kṛṣṇa.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu used to perform dramas with Advaita Prabhu, Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura and other devotees in the house of Candrasekhara. The place where Candrasekhara’s house was situated is now known as Vrajapattana. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura established a branch of his Śrī Caitanya Maṭha at this place. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu decided to accept the renounced order of life, Candrasekhara Ācārya was informed of this by Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, and therefore he was present when Lord Caitanya accepted *sannyāsa* from Keśava Bhārati in Katwa. It is he who first spread the word in Navadvīpa of Lord Caitanya’s accepting *sannyāsa*. Śrī Candrasekhara Ācārya was present during many important incidents in the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He therefore forms the second branch of the tree of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 14

puṇḍarīka vidyānidhi—baḍa-sākhā jāni

yānira nāma lañā prabhu kāndilā āpani

SYNONYMS

puṇḍarīka vidyānidhi—Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi; *baḍa-sākhā*—another big

branch; *jāni*—I know; *yānira nāma*—whose name; *lañā*—taking; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kāndilā*—cried; *āpani*—Himself.

TRANSLATION

Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi, the third big branch, was so dear to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu that in his absence Lord Caitanya Himself would sometimes cry.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (54), Śrīla Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi is described as the father of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī in *kṛṣṇa-līlā*. Caitanya Mahāprabhu therefore treated him as His father. Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi's father was known as Bāṇeśvara or, according to another opinion, Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī, and his mother's name was Gaṅgādevī. According to one opinion, Bāṇeśvara was a descendent of Śrī Śivarāma Gaṅopādhyāya. The original home of Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi was in East Bengal (now Bangladesh), in a village near Dacca named Bāghiyā, which belonged to the Vārendra group of *brāhmaṇa* families. Sometimes these Vārendra *brāhmaṇas* were at odds with another group known as Rāḍhīya *brāhmaṇas*, and therefore Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi's family was ostracized and at that time was not living as a respectable family.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “One of the members of this family is living in Vṛndāvana and is named Sarojānanda Gosvāmī. One special characteristic of this family is that each of its members had only one son or no son at all, and therefore the family was not very expansive. There is a place in the district of Caṭṭagrāma in East Bengal that is known as Hāta-hājāri, and a short distance from this place is a village known as Mekhalā-grāma, in which Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi's forefathers lived. One can approach Mekhalā-grāma from Caṭṭagrāma either on horseback, by bullock cart or by steamer. The steamer station is known as Annapūrṇāra-ghāṭa. The birthplace of Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi is about two miles southwest of

Annapūrṇāra-ghāṭa. The temple constructed there by Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi is now very old and much in need of repair. Without repair, the temple may soon crumble. There are two inscriptions on the bricks of that temple, but they are so old that one cannot read them. There is another temple, however, about two hundred yards south of this one, and some people say that this is the old temple constructed by Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi.”

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu called Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi “father,” and He gave him the title Premanidhi. Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi later became the spiritual master of Gadādhara Paṇḍita and an intimate friend of Svarūpa Dāmodara’s. Gadādhara Paṇḍita at first misunderstood Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi to be an ordinary pounds-and-shillings man, but later, upon being corrected by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he became his disciple. Another incident in the life of Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi involves his criticizing the priest of the Jagannātha temple, for which Jagannātha Prabhu chastised him personally by slapping his cheeks. This is described in *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Seven. Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura informs us that during his time there were still two living descendants of the family of Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi, who were named Śrī Harakumāra Smṛtitīrtha and Śrī Kṛṣṇakiṅkara Vidyālaṅkāra. For further information one should refer to the dictionary known as *Vaiṣṇava-mañjuṣā*.

TEXT 15

baḍa śākhā,——gadādhara paṇḍita-gosāñi

teñho lakṣmī-rūpā, tāñra sama keha nāi

SYNONYMS

baḍa śākhā—big branch; *gadādhara paṇḍita-gosāñi*—the descendants or disciplic succession of Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *teñho*—Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *lakṣmī-rūpā*—incarnation of the pleasure potency of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tāñra*—

his; *sama*—equal; *keha*—anyone; *nāi*—there is none.

TRANSLATION

Gadādhara Paṇḍita, the fourth branch, is described as an incarnation of the pleasure potency of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. No one, therefore, can equal him.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (147–53) it is stated, “The pleasure potency of Śrī Kṛṣṇa formerly known as Vṛndāvaneśvarī is now personified in the form of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita in the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.” Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī has pointed out that in the shape of Lakṣmī, the pleasure potency of Kṛṣṇa, she was formerly very dear to the Lord as Śyāmasundara-vallabhā. The same Śyāmasundara-vallabhā was present in Lord Caitanya’s pastimes as Gadādhara Paṇḍita. Formerly, as Lalitā-sakhī, she was always devoted to Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. Thus Gadādhara Paṇḍita is simultaneously an incarnation of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī and Lalitā-sakhī. In the Twelfth Chapter of this part of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* there is a description of the descendants or disciplic succession of Gadādhara Paṇḍita.

TEXT 16

tānra śiṣya-upaśiṣya, — — tānra upasākhā

eimata saba sākḥā-upasākhāra lekhā

SYNONYMS

tānra—his; *śiṣya*—disciples; *upaśiṣya*—granddisciples and admirers; *tānra*—his; *upasākhā*—subbranches; *eimata*—in this way; *saba*—all; *sākḥā*—branches; *upasākhāra*—subbranches; *lekhā*—to describe by writing.

TRANSLATION

His disciples and granddisciples are his subbranches. To describe them all would be difficult.

TEXT 17

vakreśvara paṇḍita—prabhura baḍa priya bhṛtya

eka-bhāve cabbīśa prahara yāñra nṛtya

SYNONYMS

vakreśvara paṇḍita—Vakreśvara Paṇḍita; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *baḍa*—very; *priya*—dear; *bhṛtya*—servant; *eka-bhāve*—continuously in the same ecstasy; *cabbīśa*—twenty-four; *prahara*—a duration of time comprising three hours; *yāñra*—whose; *nṛtya*—dancing.

TRANSLATION

Vakreśvara Paṇḍita, the fifth branch of the tree, was a very dear servant of Lord Caitanya's. He could dance with constant ecstasy for seventy-two hours.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (71) it is stated that Vakreśvara Paṇḍita was an incarnation of Aniruddha, one of the quadruple expansions of Viṣṇu (Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Aniruddha and Pradyumna). He could dance wonderfully for seventy-two continuous hours. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu played in dramatic performances in the house of Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, Vakreśvara Paṇḍita was one of the chief dancers, and he danced continuously for that length of time. Śrī Govinda dāsa, an Oriyā devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, has described the life of Vakreśvara Paṇḍita in his book *Gaura-kṛṣṇodaya*. There are many

disciples of Vakreśvara Paṇḍita in Orissa, and they are known as Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas although they are Oriyās. Among these disciples are Śrī Gopālaguru and his disciple Śrī Dhyānacandra Gosvāmī.

TEXT 18

āpane mahāprabhu gāya yāñra nṛtya-kāle

prabhura caraṇa dhari’ vakreśvara bale

SYNONYMS

āpane—personally; *mahāprabhu*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gāya*—sang; *yāñra*—whose; *nṛtya-kāle*—at the time of dancing; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *caraṇa*—lotus feet; *dhari’*—embracing; *vakreśvara*—Vakreśvara Paṇḍita; *bale*—said.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu personally sang while Vakreśvara Paṇḍita danced, and thus Vakreśvara Paṇḍita fell at the lotus feet of the Lord and spoke as follows.

TEXT 19

“daśa-sahasra gandharva more deha’ candramukha

tārā gāya, muñi nācoṇ—tābe mora sukha”

SYNONYMS

daśa-sahasra—ten thousand; *gandharva*—residents of Gandharvaloka; *more*—unto me; *deha’*—please deliver; *candra-mukha*—O moon-faced one; *tārā gāya*—let them sing; *muñi nācoṇ*—let me dance; *tābe*—then; *mora*—my; *sukha*—happiness.

TRANSLATION

“O Candramukha! Please give me ten thousand Gandharvas. Let them sing as I dance, and then I will be greatly happy.”

PURPORT

The Gandharvas, who are residents of Gandharvaloka, are celebrated as celestial singers. Whenever singing is needed in the celestial planets, the Gandharvas are invited to sing. The Gandharvas can sing continuously for days, and therefore Vakreśvara Paṇḍita wanted to dance as they sang.

TEXT 20

prabhu bale——tumi mora pakṣa eka śākhā

ākāśe uḍitāma yadi pāñ āra pākhā

SYNONYMS

prabhu bale—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu replied; *tumi*—you; *mora*—My; *pakṣa*—wing; *eka*—one; *śākhā*—one-sided; *ākāśe*—in the sky; *uḍitāma*—I could fly; *yadi*—if; *pāñ*—I could get; *āra*—another; *pākhā*—wing.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya replied, “I have only one wing like you, but if I had another, certainly I would fly in the sky!”

TEXT 21

paṇḍita jagadānanda prabhura prāṇa-rūpa

loke khyāta yeñho satyabhāmāra svarūpa

SYNONYMS

paṇḍita jagadānanda—Paṇḍita Jagadānanda; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *prāṇa-rūpa*—life and soul; *loke*—in the world; *khyāta*—celebrated; *yeñho*—who; *satyabhāmāra*—of Satyabhāmā; *svarūpa*—personification.

TRANSLATION

Paṇḍita Jagadānanda, the sixth branch of the Caitanya tree, was celebrated as the life and soul of the Lord. He is known to have been an incarnation of Satyabhāmā [one of the chief queens of Lord Kṛṣṇa].

PURPORT

There are many dealings of Jagadānanda Paṇḍita with Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Most importantly, he was the Lord's constant companion and especially took part in all the pastimes of the Lord in the houses of Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita and Candrasekhara Ācārya.

TEXT 22

prītye karite cāhe prabhura lālana-pālana

vairāgya-loka-bhaye prabhu nā māne kakhana

SYNONYMS

prītye—in intimacy or affection; *karite*—to do; *cāhe*—wanted; *prabhura*—the Lord's; *lālana-pālana*—maintenance; *vairāgya*—renouncement; *loka-bhaye*—fearing the public; *prabhu*—the Lord; *nā*—did not; *māne*—accept; *kakhana*—any time.

TRANSLATION

Jagadānanda Paṇḍita [as an incarnation of Satyabhāmā] always wanted to

see to the comfort of Lord Caitanya, but since the Lord was a sannyāsī He did not accept the luxuries that Jagadānanda Paṇḍita offered.

TEXT 23

dui-jane khaṭmaṭi lāgāya kondala

tāñra prītyera kathā āge kahiba sakala

SYNONYMS

dui-jane—two persons; *khaṭmaṭi*—fighting over trifles; *lāgāya*—continued; *kondala*—quarrel; *tāñra*—his; *prītyera*—affection; *kathā*—narration; *āge*—ahead; *kahiba*—I shall speak; *sakala*—all.

TRANSLATION

They sometimes appeared to fight over trifles, but these quarrels were based on their affection, of which I shall speak later.

TEXT 24

rāghava-pañḍita—prabhura ādya-anucara

tāñra eka śākhā mukhya—makaradhvaja kara

SYNONYMS

rāghava pañḍita—Rāghava Paṇḍita; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *ādya*—original; *anucara*—follower; *tāñra*—his; *eka*—one; *śākhā*—branch; *mukhya*—chief; *makaradhvaja*—Makaradhvaja; *kara*—surname.

TRANSLATION

Rāghava Paṇḍita, Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's original follower, is

understood to have been the seventh branch. From him proceeded another subbranch, headed by Makaradhvaja Kara.

PURPORT

Kara was the surname of Makaradhvaja. At present this surname is generally found in the Kāyastha community. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (166) states:

*dhaniṣṭhā bhakṣya-sāmagrīm kṛṣṇāyādād vraje 'mitām
saiva sāmpratam gaurāṅga-priyo rāghava-pañḍitaḥ*

Rāghava Paṇḍita was formerly a confidential *gopī* in Vraja during the time of Lord Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, and his former name was Dhaniṣṭhā. This *gopī*, Dhaniṣṭhā, always engaged in preparing foods for Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 25

*tānhāra bhaginī damayantī prabhura priya dāsī
prabhura bhoga-sāmagrī ye kare vāra-māsi*

SYNONYMS

tānhāra—his; *bhaginī*—sister; *damayantī*—Damayantī; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *priya*—dear; *dāsī*—maidservant; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *bhoga-sāmagrī*—cooking materials; *ye*—who; *kare*—does; *vāra-māsi*—throughout the whole year.

TRANSLATION

Rāghava Paṇḍita's sister Damayantī was the dear maidservant of the Lord. She always collected various ingredients with which to cook for Lord Caitanya.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (167) it is mentioned, *guṇamālā vraje yāsīd damayantī tu tat-svasā*: The *gopī* named Guṇamālā appeared as Rāghava Paṇḍita’s sister Damayantī. On the East Bengal railway line beginning from the Sealdah station in Calcutta, there is a station named Sodapura, which is not very far from Calcutta. Within one mile of this station, toward the western side of the Ganges, is a village known as Pānihāṭi, in which the residential quarters of Rāghava Paṇḍita still exist. On Rāghava Paṇḍita’s tomb is a creeper on a concrete platform. There is also a Madana-mohana Deity in a broken-down temple nearby. This temple is managed by a local zamindar of the name Śrī Śivacandra Rāya Caudhurī. Makaradhvaja Kara was also an inhabitant of Pānihāṭi.”

TEXT 26

se saba sāmagrī yata jhālite bhariyā

rāghava la-iyā yā’na gupata kariyā

SYNONYMS

se saba—all those; *sāmagrī*—ingredients; *yata*—all of them; *jhālite bhariyā*—packing in bags; *rāghava*—Rāghava Paṇḍita; *la-iyā*—carried; *yā’na*—goes; *gupata kariyā*—very confidentially.

TRANSLATION

The foods Damayantī cooked for Lord Caitanya when He was at Purī were carried in bags by her brother Rāghava without the knowledge of others.

TEXT 27

vāra-māsa tāhā prabhu kareṇa aṅgikāra

‘rāghavera jhāli’ bali’ prasiddhi yāhāra

SYNONYMS

vāra-māsa—the whole year; *tāhā*—all those foods; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kareṇa*—did; *aṅgikāra*—accept; *rāghavera jhāli*—the bags of Rāghava Paṇḍita; *bali’*—so called; *prasiddhi*—celebrated; *yāhāra*—of which.

TRANSLATION

The Lord accepted these foods throughout the entire year. Those bags are still celebrated as *rāghavera jhāli* [“the bags of Rāghava Paṇḍita”].

TEXT 28

se-saba sāmagrī āge kariba vistāra

yāhāra śravaṇe bhaktera vahe aśrudhāra

SYNONYMS

se-saba—all these things; *sāmagrī*—ingredients of the foods; *āge*—further on; *kariba*—I shall describe; *vistāra*—vividly; *yāhāra*—of which; *śravaṇe*—by the hearing; *bhaktera*—of a devotee; *vahe*—flowing; *aśrudhāra*—tears.

TRANSLATION

I shall describe the contents of the bags of Rāghava Paṇḍita later in this book. Hearing this narration, devotees generally cry, and tears glide down from their eyes.

PURPORT

A vivid description of these *rāghavera jhālī* is to be found in Chapter Ten of the *Antya-līlā* portion of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 29

prabhura atyanta priya—paṇḍita gaṅgādāsa

yāñhāra smaraṇe haya sarva-bandha-nāśa

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *atyanta*—very; *priya*—dear; *paṇḍita gaṅgādāsa*—Paṇḍita Gaṅgādāsa; *yāñhāra*—who; *smaraṇe*—by remembering; *haya*—it becomes; *sarva-bandha-nāśa*—freedom from all kinds of bondage.

TRANSLATION

Paṇḍita Gaṅgādāsa was the eighth dear branch of the tree of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. One who remembers his activities attains freedom from all bondage.

TEXT 30

caitanya-pārṣada—śrī-ācārya purandara

pitā kari' yāñre bale gaurāṅga-sundara

SYNONYMS

caitanya-pārṣada—associate of Lord Caitanya; *śrī-ācārya purandara*—Śrī Ācārya Purandara; *pitā*—father; *kari'*—taking him; *yāñre*—whom; *bale*—says; *gaurāṅga-sundara*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Ācārya Purandara, the ninth branch, was a constant associate of Lord Caitanya's. The Lord accepted him as His father.

PURPORT

It is described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* that whenever Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu visited the house of Rāghava Paṇḍita, He also visited Purandara Ācārya immediately upon receiving an invitation. Purandara Ācārya is to be considered most fortunate because the Lord used to greet him by addressing him as His father and embracing him in great love.

TEXT 31

dāmodara-pañḍita śākhā premete pracaṇḍa

prabhura upare yeṇho kaila vākya-daṇḍa

SYNONYMS

dāmodara-pañḍita—Dāmodara Paṇḍita; *śākhā*—another branch (the tenth branch); *premete*—in affection; *pracaṇḍa*—very advanced; *prabhura*—the Lord; *upare*—upon; *yeṇho*—he who; *kaila*—did; *vākya-daṇḍa*—chastisement by speaking.

TRANSLATION

Dāmodara Paṇḍita, the tenth branch of the Caitanya tree, was so elevated in love of Lord Caitanya that he once unhesitatingly chastised the Lord with strong words.

TEXT 32

daṇḍa-kathā kahiba āge vistāra kariyā

daṇḍe tuṣṭa prabhu tāñre pāṭhāilā nadīyā

SYNONYMS

daṇḍa-kathā—the narration of such chastisement; *kahiḥa*—I shall speak; *āge*—ahead; *vistāra*—detailed description; *kariyā*—making; *daṇḍe*—in the matter of chastisement; *tuṣṭa prabhu*—the Lord is very much satisfied; *tāñre*—him; *pāṭhāilā*—sent back; *nadīyā*—Nadia (a district in Bengal).

TRANSLATION

Later in the Caitanya-caritāmṛta I shall describe this incident of chastisement in detail. The Lord, being very much satisfied by this chastisement, sent Dāmodara Paṇḍita to Navadvīpa.

PURPORT

Dāmodara Paṇḍita, who was formerly known as Śaibyā in Vraja-dhāma, used to carry messages from Lord Caitanya to Śacīmātā, and during the Ratha-yātrā festival he carried messages from Śacīmātā to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 33

tāñhāra anuja śākhā—śaṅkara-ṇḍita

‘prabhu-pāḍopādhāna’ yāñra nāma vidita

SYNONYMS

tāñhāra—his (Dāmodara Paṇḍita’s); *anuja*—younger brother; *śākhā*—the eleventh branch; *śaṅkara-ṇḍita*—Śaṅkara Paṇḍita; *prabhu*—the Lord’s; *pāḍa-upādhāna*—shoes; *yāñra*—whose; *nāma*—name; *vidita*—celebrated.

TRANSLATION

The eleventh branch, the younger brother of Dāmodara Paṇḍita, was known as Śaṅkara Paṇḍita. He was celebrated as the shoes of the Lord.

TEXT 34

sadāśīva-pañḍita yāñra prabhu-pade āśa

prathamei nityānandera yāñra ghare vāsa

SYNONYMS

sadāśīva-pañḍita—Sadāśīva Paṇḍita; *yāñra*—whose; *prabhu-pade*—unto the lotus feet of the Lord; *āśa*—constant desire; *prathamei*—in the beginning; *nityānandera*—of Lord Nityānanda; *yāñra*—of whom; *ghare*—in the home; *vāsa*—residence.

TRANSLATION

Sadāśīva Paṇḍita, the twelfth branch, was always eager to serve the lotus feet of the Lord. It was his good fortune that when Lord Nityānanda came to Navadvīpa He resided at his house.

PURPORT

It is mentioned in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Nine, that Sadāśīva Paṇḍita was a pure devotee and that Nityānanda Prabhu resided at his house.

TEXT 35

śrī-ṅṛsimha-upāsaka—pradyumna brahmacārī

prabhu tāñra nāma kailā ‘ṅṛsimhānanda’ kari’

SYNONYMS

śrī-nṛsimha-upāsaka—the worshiper of Lord Nṛsimhadeva; *pradyumna brahmacārī*—Pradyumna Brahmacārī; *prabhu*—the Lord; *tānra*—his; *nāma*—name; *kailā*—turned into; *nṛsimhānanda*—Nṛsimhānanda; *kari'*—by such a name.

TRANSLATION

The thirteenth branch was Pradyumna Brahmacārī. Since he was a worshiper of Lord Nṛsimhadeva, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu changed his name to Nṛsimhānanda Brahmacārī.

PURPORT

Pradyumna Brahmacārī is described in the *Antya-līlā*, Second Chapter, of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. He was a great devotee of Lord Caitanya, who changed his name to Nṛsimhānanda. While coming from the house of Rāghava Paṇḍita at Pānihāṭi to the house of Śivānanda, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared in the heart of Nṛsimhānanda Brahmacārī. To acknowledge this, Nṛsimhānanda Brahmacārī used to accept as eatables the food of three Deities, namely Jagannātha, Nṛsimhadeva and Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. This is stated in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, *Antya-līlā*, Second Chapter, verses 48 through 78. Upon receiving information that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was proceeding toward Vṛndāvana from Kuliyā, Nṛsimhānanda absorbed himself in meditation and by his mental activities began constructing a very nice road from Kuliyā to Vṛndāvana. All of a sudden, however, he broke his meditation and told the other devotees that this time Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu would not go to Vṛndāvana but would travel only as far as the place known as Kānāi Nāṭasālā. This is described in *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter One, verses 155 through 162. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (74) says, *āveśaś ca tathājñeyo miśre pradyumna-saṁjñake*: Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu changed the name of Pradyumna Miśra, or Pradyumna Brahmacārī, to Nṛsimhānanda Brahmacārī, for in his heart Lord Nṛsimhadeva was manifest. It is said

that Lord Nṛsimhadeva used to talk with him directly.

TEXT 36

nārāyaṇa-pañḍita eka baḍa-i udāra

caitanya-caraṇa vinu nāhi jāne āra

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇa-pañḍita—Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita; *eka*—one; *baḍai*—very; *udāra*—liberal; *caitanya-caraṇa*—the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya; *vinu*—except; *nāhi*—not; *jāne*—know; *āra*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita, the fourteenth branch, a great and liberal devotee, did not know any shelter but Lord Caitanya's lotus feet.

PURPORT

Nārāyaṇa Paṇḍita was one of the associates of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura. It is mentioned in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Eighth Chapter, verse 36, that he went to see Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī with the Ṭhākura's brother Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita.

TEXT 37

śrīmān-pañḍita śākhā—prabhura nija bhṛtya

deuṭi dharena, yabe prabhu karena nṛtya

SYNONYMS

śrīmān-pañḍita—Śrīmān Paṇḍita; *śākhā*—branch; *prabhura*—of the

Lord; *nija*—own; *bhṛtya*—servant; *deuṭi*—torch light; *dharena*—carries; *yabe*—while; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya; *karena*—does; *nṛtya*—dance.

TRANSLATION

The fifteenth branch was Śrīmān Paṇḍita, who was a constant servitor of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He used to carry a torch while the Lord danced.

PURPORT

Śrīmān Paṇḍita was among the companions of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu when the Lord performed *saṅkīrtana*. When Lord Caitanya dressed Himself in the form of the goddess Lakṣmī and danced in the streets of Navadvīpa, Śrīmān Paṇḍita carried a torch to light the way.

TEXT 38

śuklāmbara-brahmacārī baḍa bhāgyavān

yāñra anna māgi' kāḍi' khāilā bhagavān

SYNONYMS

śuklāmbara-brahmacārī—Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī; *baḍa*—very; *bhāgyavān*—fortunate; *yāñra*—whose; *anna*—food; *māgi'*—begging; *kāḍi'*—snatching; *khāilā*—ate; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

The sixteenth branch, Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī, was very fortunate because Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu jokingly or seriously begged food from him or sometimes snatched it from him forcibly and ate it.

PURPORT

It is stated that Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī, an inhabitant of Navadvīpa, was Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's first companion in the *saṅkīrtana* movement. When Lord Caitanya returned from Gayā after initiation, He stayed with Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī because He wanted to hear from this devotee about the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī collected alms of rice from the inhabitants of Navadvīpa, and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu took pleasure in eating the rice that he cooked. It is said that Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī was one of the wives of the yajñic *brāhmaṇas* during the time of Lord Kṛṣṇa's pastimes in Vṛndāvana. Lord Kṛṣṇa begged food from the wives of the *yajñic brāhmaṇas*, and Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu performed a similar pastime by begging rice from Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī.

TEXT 39

nandana-ācārya-sākhā jagate vidita

lukāiyā dui prabhura yāñra ghare sthita

SYNONYMS

nandana-ācārya—Nandana Ācārya; *sākhā*—the seventeenth branch; *jagate*—in the world; *vidita*—celebrated; *lukāiyā*—hiding; *dui*—two; *prabhura*—of the Lords; *yāñra*—of whom; *ghare*—in the house; *sthita*—situated.

TRANSLATION

Nandana Ācārya, the seventeenth branch of the Caitanya tree, is celebrated within the world because the two Prabhus [Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda] sometimes hid in his house.

PURPORT

Nandana Ācārya was another companion of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu during His *kīrtana* pastimes in Navadvīpa. Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu, as Avadhūta, traveled on many pilgrimages, and when He first came to Śrī Navadvīpa-dhāma He remained hidden in the house of Nandana Ācārya. It is there that He first met all the devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. When Caitanya Mahāprabhu exhibited His *mahā-prakāśa*, He asked Rāmāi Paṇḍita to call Advaita Prabhu, who was hiding in the home of Nandana Ācārya, for Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu could understand that He was hiding. Similarly, Lord Caitanya also sometimes hid in the home of Nandana Ācārya. In this connection one may refer to *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapters Six and Seventeen.

TEXT 40

śrī-mukunda-datta śākhā—prabhura samādhyaī

yāñhāra kīrtane nāce caitanya-gosāñi

SYNONYMS

śrī-mukunda-datta—Śrī Mukunda Datta; *śākhā*—another branch; *prabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *samādhyaī*—class friend; *yāñhāra*—whose; *kīrtane*—in *saṅkīrtana*; *nāce*—dances; *caitanya-gosāñi*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

Mukunda Datta, a class friend of Lord Caitanya's, was another branch of the Caitanya tree. Lord Caitanya danced while he sang.

PURPORT

Śrī Mukunda Datta was born in the Caṭṭagrāma district, in the village of Chanharā, which is under the jurisdiction of the police station named Paṭiyā. This village is situated ten *krośas*, or about twenty miles, from the

home of Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (140) it is said:

*vraje sthitau gāyakau yau madhukaṇṭha-madhuvratau
mukunda-vāsudevau tau dattau gaurāṅga-gāyakau*

“In Vraja there were two very nice singers named Madhukaṇṭha and Madhuvrata. They appeared in *caitanya-līlā* as Mukunda and Vāsudeva Datta, who were singers in the society of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.” When Lord Caitanya was a student, Mukunda Datta was His class friend, and they frequently engaged in logical arguments. Sometimes Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu would fight with Mukunda Datta, using tricks of logic. This is described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata, Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapters Eleven and Twelve. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu returned from Gayā, Mukunda Datta gave Him pleasure by reciting verses from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* about *kṛṣṇa-līlā*. It was by his endeavor that Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī became a disciple of Puṇḍarīka Vidyānidhi, as stated in *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata, Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Seven. When Mukunda Datta sang in the courtyard of Śrīvāsa Prabhu, Mahāprabhu danced with His singing, and when Lord Caitanya for twenty-one hours exhibited an ecstatic manifestation known as *sāta-prahariyā*, Mukunda Datta inaugurated the function by singing.

Sometimes Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu chastised Mukunda Datta by calling him *khaḍajāṭhiyā beṭā* because he attended many functions held by different classes of nondevotees. This is stated in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata, Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Ten. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu dressed Himself as the goddess of fortune to dance in the house of Candrasekhara, Mukunda Datta began the first song.

Before disclosing His desire to take the renounced order of life, Lord Caitanya first went to the house of Mukunda Datta, but at that time Mukunda Datta requested Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to continue His *saṅkīrtana* movement for a few days more before taking *sannyāsa*. This is stated in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata, Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Twenty-six.

The information of Lord Caitanya's accepting the renounced order was made known to Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Candraśekhara Ācārya and Mukunda Datta by Nityānanda Prabhu, and therefore all of them went to Katwa and arranged for *kīrtana* and all the paraphernalia for Lord Caitanya's acceptance of *sannyāsa*. After the Lord took *sannyāsa*, they all followed Him, especially Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, Gadādhara Prabhu and Govinda, who followed Him all the way to Puruṣottama-kṣetra. In this connection one may refer to *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Two. In the place known as Jaleśvara, Nityānanda Prabhu broke the *sannyāsa* rod of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Mukunda Datta was also present at that time. He went every year from Bengal to see Lord Caitanya at Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 41

vāsudeva datta—prabhura bhṛtya mahāśaya

sahasra-mukhe yāñra guṇa kahile nā haya

SYNONYMS

vāsudeva datta—Vāsudeva Datta; *prabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bhṛtya*—servant; *mahāśaya*—great personality; *sahasra-mukhe*—with thousands of mouths; *yāñra*—whose; *guṇa*—qualities; *kahile*—describing; *nā*—never; *haya*—becomes fulfilled.

TRANSLATION

Vāsudeva Datta, the nineteenth branch of the Śrī Caitanya tree, was a great personality and a most confidential devotee of the Lord. One could not describe his qualities even with thousands of mouths.

PURPORT

Vāsudeva Datta, the brother of Mukunda Datta, was also a resident of

Caṭṭagrāma. In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* it is said, *yāñra sthāne kṛṣṇa haya āpane vikraya*: Vāsudeva Datta was such a powerful devotee that Kṛṣṇa was purchased by him. Vāsudeva Datta stayed at Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita's house, and in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* it is described that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was so pleased with Vāsudeva Datta and so affectionate toward him that He used to say, "I am only Vāsudeva Datta's man. My body is only meant to please Vāsudeva Datta, and he can sell Me anywhere." Thrice He vowed that this was a fact and that no one should disbelieve these statements. "All My dear devotees," He said, "I tell you the truth. My body is especially meant for Vāsudeva Datta." Vāsudeva Datta initiated Śrī Yadunandana Ācārya, the spiritual master of Raghunātha dāsa, who later became Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. This will be found in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, *Antya-līlā*, Sixth Chapter, verse 161. Vāsudeva Datta spent money very liberally; therefore Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu asked Śivānanda Sena to become his *sarakhela*, or secretary, in order to control his extravagant expenses. Vāsudeva Datta was so kind to the living entities that he wanted to take all their sinful reactions so that they might be delivered by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. This is described in the Fifteenth Chapter of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta's Madhya-līlā*, verses 159 through 180.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, "There is a railway station named Pūrvasthalī near the Navadvīpa railway station, and about one mile away, in a village known as Māmagāchi, which is the birthplace of Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, there is presently a temple of Madana-gopāla that was established by Vāsudeva Datta." The Gauḍīya Maṭha devotees have now taken charge of this temple, and the *sevā-pūjā* is going on very nicely. Every year all the pilgrims on the *navadvīpa-parikrama* visit Māmagāchi. Since Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura inaugurated the *navadvīpa-parikrama* function, the temple has been very well managed.

TEXT 42

jagate yateka jīva, tāra pāpa lañā

naraka bhuñjite cāhe jīva chāḍāiyā

SYNONYMS

jagate—in the world; *yateka*—all; *jīva*—living entities; *tāra*—their; *pāpa*—sinful activities; *lañā*—taking; *naraka*—hell; *bhuñjite*—to suffer; *cāhe*—wanted; *jīva*—the living entities; *chāḍāiyā*—liberating them.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Vāsudeva Datta Ṭhākura wanted to suffer for the sinful activities of all the people of the world so that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu might deliver them.

TEXT 43

haridāsa-ṭhākura śākhāra adbhuta carita

tina lakṣa nāma teṇho layena apatita

SYNONYMS

haridāsa-ṭhākura—Haridāsa Ṭhākura; *śākhāra*—of the branch; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *carita*—characteristics; *tina*—three; *lakṣa*—hundred thousand; *nāma*—names; *teṇho*—he; *layena*—chanted; *apatita*—without fail.

TRANSLATION

The twentieth branch of the Caitanya tree was Haridāsa Ṭhākura. His character was wonderful. He used to chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa 300,000 times a day without fail.

PURPORT

Certainly the chanting of 300,000 holy names of the Lord is wonderful. No ordinary person can chant so many names, nor should one artificially imitate Haridāsa Ṭhākura's behavior. It is essential, however, that everyone fulfill a specific vow to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*. Therefore we have prescribed in our Society that all our students must chant at least sixteen rounds daily. Such chanting must be offenseless in order to be of high quality. Mechanical chanting is not as powerful as chanting of the holy name without offenses. It is stated in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata, Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Two, that Haridāsa Ṭhākura was born in a village known as Buḍhana but after some time came to live on the bank of the Ganges at Phuliyā, near Śāntipura. From the description of his chastisement by a Muslim magistrate, which is found in the Sixteenth Chapter of the *Ādi-khaṇḍa* of *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, we can understand how humble and meek Haridāsa Ṭhākura was and how he achieved the causeless mercy of the Lord. In the dramas performed by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Haridāsa Ṭhākura played the part of a police chief. While chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* in Benāpola, he was personally tested by Māyādevī herself. Haridāsa Ṭhākura's passing away is described in the *Antya-līlā* of *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Eleventh Chapter. It is not definitely certain whether Śrī Haridāsa Ṭhākura appeared in the village named Buḍhana that is in the district of Khulnā. Formerly this village was within a district of twenty-four *parganas* within the Sātakṣīrā division.

TEXT 44

tāñhāra ananta guṇa—kahi diñmātra

ācārya gosāñi yāñre bhuñjāya śrāddha-pātra

SYNONYMS

tāñhāra—Haridāsa Ṭhākura's; *ananta*—unlimited; *guṇa*—qualities; *kahi*—I speak; *diñ-mātra*—only a small part; *ācārya gosāñi*—Śrī Advaita Ācārya Prabhu; *yāñre*—to whom; *bhuñjāya*—offered to eat; *śrāddha-*

pātra—*prasādam* offered to Lord Viṣṇu.

TRANSLATION

There was no end to the transcendental qualities of Haridāsa Ṭhākura. Here I mention but a fraction of his qualities. He was so exalted that Advaita Gosvāmī, when performing the śrāddha ceremony of his father, offered him the first plate.

TEXT 45

prahlāda-samāna tāñra guṇera taraṅga

yavana-tāḍaneo yāñra nāhika bhrū-bhaṅga

SYNONYMS

prahlāda-samāna—exactly like Prahlaḍa Mahārāja; *tāñra*—his; *guṇera*—qualities; *taraṅga*—waves; *yavana*—of the Muslims; *tāḍaneo*—even by the persecution; *yāñra*—whose; *nāhika*—there was none; *bhrū-bhaṅga*—even the slightest agitation of an eyebrow.

TRANSLATION

The waves of his good qualities were like those of Prahlaḍa Mahārāja. He did not even slightly raise an eyebrow when persecuted by the Muslim ruler.

TEXT 46

teñho siddhi pāile tāñra deha lañā kole

nācila caitanya-prabhu mahā-kutūhale

SYNONYMS

teṇho—he; *siddhi*—perfection; *pāile*—after achieving; *tāṇra*—his; *deha*—body; *lañā*—taking; *kole*—on the lap; *nācila*—danced; *caitanya-prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mahā-kutūhale*—in great ecstasy.

TRANSLATION

After the passing away of Haridāsa Ṭhākura, the Lord Himself took his body on His lap and danced with it in great ecstasy.

TEXT 47

tāṇra līlā varṇiyāchena vṛndāvana-dāsa

yebā avasīṣṭa, āge kariba prakāśa

SYNONYMS

tāṇra—his; *līlā*—pastimes; *varṇiyāchena*—described; *vṛndāvana-dāsa*—Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *yebā*—whatever; *avasīṣṭa*—remained undescribed; *āge*—later in the book; *kariba*—I shall make; *prakāśa*—manifest.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has vividly described the pastimes of Haridāsa Ṭhākura in his Caitanya-bhāgavata. Whatever has remained undescribed I shall try to explain later in this book.

TEXT 48

tāṇra upasākhā—yata kulīna-grāmī jana

satyarāja-ādi—tāṇra kṛpāra bhājana

SYNONYMS

tānra upasākhā—his subbranch; *yata*—all; *kulīna-grāmī jana*—the inhabitants of Kulīna-grāma; *satyarāja*—Satyarāja; *ādi*—heading the list; *tānra*—his; *kṛpāra*—of mercy; *bhājana*—recipient.

TRANSLATION

One subbranch of Haridāsa Ṭhākura consisted of the residents of Kulīna-grāma. The most important among them was Satyarāja Khān, or Satyarāja Vasu, who was a recipient of all the mercy of Haridāsa Ṭhākura.

PURPORT

Satyarāja Khān was the son of Guṇarāja Khān and father of Rāmānanda Vasu. Haridāsa Ṭhākura lived for some time during the Cāturmāsya period in the village named Kulīna-grāma, where he chanted the holy name, the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, and distributed his mercy to the descendants of the Vasu family. Satyarāja Khān was allotted the service of supplying silk ropes for the Jagannātha Deity during the Ratha-yātrā festival. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s answers to his inquiries about the duty of householder devotees are vividly described in the *Madhya-līlā*, Chapters Fifteen and Sixteen.

The village of Kulīna-grāma is situated two miles from the railway station named Jaugrāma on the Newcord line from Howrah to Burdwan. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu very highly praised the people of Kulīna-grāma, and He stated that even a dog of Kulīna-grāma was very dear to Him.

TEXT 49

śrī-murāri gupta śākhā—premera bhāṇḍāra

prabhura hṛdaya drave śuni’ dainya yānra

SYNONYMS

śrī-murāri gupta—Śrī Murāri Gupta; *śākhā*—branch; *premera*—of love of Godhead; *bhāṇḍāra*—store; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *hṛdaya*—the heart; *drave*—melts; *śuni'*—hearing; *dainya*—humility; *yānra*—of whom.

TRANSLATION

Murāri Gupta, the twenty-first branch of the tree of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, was a storehouse of love of Godhead. His great humility and meekness melted the heart of Lord Caitanya.

PURPORT

Śrī Murāri Gupta wrote a book called *Śrī Caitanya-carita*. He belonged to a *vaidya* physician family of Śrīhaṭṭa, the paternal home of Lord Caitanya, and later became a resident of Navadvīpa. He was among the elders of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Lord Caitanya exhibited His Varāha form in the house of Murāri Gupta, as described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Third Chapter. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu exhibited His *mahā-prakāśa* form, He appeared before Murāri Gupta as Lord Rāmacandra. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu were sitting together in the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, Murāri Gupta first offered his respects to Lord Caitanya and then to Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. Nityānanda Prabhu, however, was older than Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and therefore Lord Caitanya remarked that Murāri Gupta had violated social etiquette, for he should have first shown respect to Nityānanda Prabhu and then to Him. In this way, by the grace of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Murāri Gupta was informed about the position of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, and the next day he offered obeisances first to Lord Nityānanda and then to Lord Caitanya. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu gave chewed pan, or betel nut, to Murāri Gupta. Once Śivānanda Sena offered food to Lord Caitanya that had been cooked with excessive ghee, and the next day the Lord became sick and went to Murāri Gupta for treatment. Lord

Caitanya accepted some water from the waterpot of Murāri Gupta, and thus He was cured. The natural remedy for indigestion is to drink a little water, and since Murāri Gupta was a physician, he gave the Lord some drinking water and cured Him.

When Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared in the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura in His Caturbhuja *mūrti*, Murāri Gupta became His carrier in the form of Garuḍa, and in these pastimes of ecstasy the Lord then got up on his back. It was the desire of Murāri Gupta to leave his body before the disappearance of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, but the Lord forbade him to do so. This is described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata, Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Twenty. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu one day appeared in ecstasy as the Varāha *mūrti*, Murāri Gupta offered Him prayers. He was a great devotee of Lord Rāmacandra, and his staunch devotion is vividly described in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Madhya-līlā*, Fifteenth Chapter, verses 137 through 157.

TEXT 50

pratigraha nāhi kare, nā laya kāra dhana

ātma-vṛtti kari' kare kuṭumba bharaṇa

SYNONYMS

pratigraha nāhi kare—he did not accept charity from anyone; *nā*—not; *laya*—take; *kāra*—anyone's; *dhana*—wealth; *ātma-vṛtti*—own profession; *kari'*—executing; *kare*—maintained; *kuṭumba*—family; *bharaṇa*—provision.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Murāri Gupta never accepted charity from friends, nor did he accept money from anyone. He practiced as a physician and maintained his family with his earnings.

PURPORT

It should be noted that a *grhastha* (householder) must not make his livelihood by begging from anyone. Every householder of the higher castes should engage himself in his own occupational duty as a *brāhmaṇa*, *kṣatriya* or *vaiśya*, but he should not engage in the service of others, for this is the duty of a *sūdra*. One should simply accept whatever he earns by his own profession. The engagements of a *brāhmaṇa* are *yajana*, *yājana*, *paṭhana*, *pāṭhana*, *dāna* and *pratigraha*. A *brāhmaṇa* should be a worshiper of Viṣṇu, and he should also instruct others how to worship Him. A *kṣatriya* can become a landholder and earn his livelihood by levying taxes or collecting rent from tenants. A *vaiśya* can accept agriculture or general trade as an occupational duty. Since Murāri Gupta was born in a physician's family (*vaidya-varṁśa*), he practiced as a physician, and with whatever income he earned he maintained his family. As stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, everyone should try to satisfy the Supreme Personality of Godhead through the execution of his occupational duty. That is the perfection of life. This system is called *daivī-varṇāśrama*. Murāri Gupta was an ideal *grhastha*, for he was a great devotee of Lord Rāmacandra and Caitanya Mahāprabhu. By practicing as a physician he maintained his family and at the same time satisfied Lord Caitanya to the best of his ability. This is the ideal of householder life.

TEXT 51

cikitsā karena yāre ha-iyā sadaya

deha-roga bhāva-roga,——dui tāra kṣaya

SYNONYMS

cikitsā—medical treatment; *karena*—did; *yāre*—upon whom; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *sadaya*—merciful; *deha-roga*—the disease of the body; *bhāva-roga*—the disease of material existence; *dui*—both; *tāra*—his; *kṣaya*—diminished.

TRANSLATION

As Murāri Gupta treated his patients, by his mercy both their bodily and spiritual diseases subsided.

PURPORT

Murāri Gupta could treat both bodily and spiritual disease because he was a physician by profession and a great devotee of the Lord in terms of spiritual advancement. This is an example of service to humanity. Everyone should know that there are two kinds of diseases in human society. One disease, which is called *adhyātmika*, or material disease, pertains to the body, but the main disease is spiritual. The living entity is eternal, but somehow or other, when in contact with the material energy, he is subjected to the repetition of birth, death, old age and disease. The physicians of the modern day should learn from Murāri Gupta. Although modern philanthropic physicians open gigantic hospitals, there are no hospitals to cure the material disease of the spirit soul. The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement has taken up the mission of curing this disease, but people are not very appreciative because they do not know what this disease is. A diseased person needs both proper medicine and a proper diet, and therefore the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement supplies materially stricken people with the medicine of the chanting of the holy name, or the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, and the diet of *prasādam*. There are many hospitals and medical clinics to cure bodily diseases, but there are no such hospitals to cure the material disease of the spirit soul. The centers of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement are the only established hospitals that can cure man of birth, death, old age and disease.

TEXT 52

śrīmān sena prabhura sevaka pradhāna

caitanya-caraṇa vinu nāhi jāne āna

SYNONYMS

śrīmān sena—Śrīmān Sena; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *sevaka*—servant; *pradhāna*—chief; *caitanya-carāṇa*—the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *vinu*—except; *nāhi*—does not; *jāne*—know; *āna*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

Śrīmān Sena, the twenty-second branch of the Caitanya tree, was a very faithful servant of Lord Caitanya. He knew nothing else but the lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

Śrīmān Sena was one of the inhabitants of Navadvīpa and was a constant companion of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 53

śrī-gadādhara dāsa śākhā sarvopari

kāñī-gaṇera mukhe yeṇha bolāila hari

SYNONYMS

śrī-gadādhara dāsa—Śrī Gadādhara dāsa; *śākhā*—another branch; *sarva-upari*—above all; *kāñī-gaṇera*—of the Kazis (Muslim magistrates); *mukhe*—in the mouth; *yeṇha*—one who; *bolāila*—caused to speak; *hari*—the holy name of Hari.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Gadādhara dāsa, the twenty-third branch, was understood to be the topmost, for he induced all the Muslim Kazis to chant the holy name of

Lord Hari.

PURPORT

About eight or ten miles from Calcutta, on the banks of the Ganges, is a village known as Eṇḍiyādaha-grāma. Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa was known as an inhabitant of this village (*eṇḍiyādaha-vāsī gadādhara dāsa*). The *Bhakti-ratnākara* (Seventh Wave), informs us that after the disappearance of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Gadādhara dāsa went from Navadvīpa to Katwa. Thereafter he came to Eṇḍiyādaha and resided there. He is stated to be the luster of the body of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, just as Śrīla Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī is an incarnation of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī Herself. Caitanya Mahāprabhu is sometimes explained to be *rādhā-bhāva-dyuti-suvalita*, or characterized by the emotions and bodily luster of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. Gadādhara dāsa is this *dyuti*, or luster. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (154) he is described to be an expansion of the potency of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. He counts among the associates of both Śrīla Gaurahari and Nityānanda Prabhu; as a devotee of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu he was one of the associates of Lord Kṛṣṇa in conjugal love, and as a devotee of Lord Nityānanda he is considered to have been one of the friends of Kṛṣṇa in pure devotional service. Even though he was an associate of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu, he was not among the cowherd boys but was situated in the transcendental mellow of conjugal love. He established a temple of Śrī Gaurasundara in Katwa.

In 1434 Śākābda (A.D. 1512), when Lord Nityānanda Prabhu was empowered by Lord Caitanya to preach the *saṅkīrtana* movement in Bengal, Śrī Gadādhara dāsa was one of Lord Nityānanda's chief assistants. He preached the *saṅkīrtana* movement by requesting everyone to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. This simple preaching method of Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa can be followed by anyone and everyone in any position of society. One must simply be a sincere and serious servant of Nityānanda Prabhu and preach this cult door to door.

When Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa Prabhu was preaching the cult of *hari-*

kīrtana, there was a magistrate who was very much against his *saṅkīrtana* movement. Following in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa one night went to the house of the Kazi and requested him to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. The Kazi replied, “All right, I shall chant Hare Kṛṣṇa tomorrow.” On hearing this, Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa Prabhu began to dance, and he said, “Why tomorrow? You have already chanted the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, so simply continue.”

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (verses 154–55) it is said:

*rādhā-vibhūti-rūpā yā candrakāntiḥ purā vraje
sa śrī-gaurāṅga-nikaṭe dāsa-vaṁśyo gadādharaḥ
pūrṇānandā vraje yāsīd baladeva-priyāgraṇī
sāpi kārya-vaśād eva prāviśat tam gadādharam*

Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa is considered to be a united form of Candrakānti, who is the effulgence of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, and Pūrṇānandā, who is the foremost of Lord Balarāma’s very dear girlfriends. Thus Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa Prabhu was one of the associates of both Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu.

Once while Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa Prabhu was returning to Bengal from Jagannātha Purī with Nityānanda Prabhu, he forgot himself and began talking very loudly as if he were a girl of Vrajabhūmi selling yogurt, and Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu noted this. Another time, while absorbed in the ecstasy of the *gopīs*, he carried a jug filled with Ganges water on his head as if he were selling milk. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared in the house of Rāghava Paṇḍita while going to Vṛndāvana, Gadādhara dāsa went to see Him, and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was so glad that He put His foot on his head. When Gadādhara dāsa Prabhu was present in Eṇḍiyādaha, he established a Bāla Gopāla *mūrti* for worship there. Śrī Mādhava Ghoṣa performed a drama known as *Dāna-khaṇḍa* with the help of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu and Śrī Gadādhara dāsa. This is explained in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (*Antya* 5.318–94).

The tomb of Gadādhara dāsa Prabhu, which is in the village of Eṇḍiyādaha, was under the control of the Saṁyogī Vaiṣṇavas and later under the direction of Siddha Bhagavān dāsa Bābājī of Kālnā. By his order, Śrī Madhusūdana Mullik, one of the members of the aristocratic Mullik family of the Nārikelaḍāṅgā in Calcutta, established a *pāṭavāṭī* (monastery) there in the Bengali year 1256 (A.D. 1849). He also arranged for the worship of a Deity named Śrī Rādhākānta. His son Balāicānda Mullik established Gaura-Nitāi Deities there in the Bengali year 1312 (A.D. 1905). Thus on the throne of the temple are both Gaura-Nityānanda Deities and Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa Deities. Below the throne is a tablet with an inscription written in Sanskrit. In that temple there is also a small Deity of Lord Śiva as Gopeśvara. This is all described on a stone by the side of the entrance door.

TEXT 54

śivānanda sena—prabhura bhṛtya antaraṅga

prabhu-sthāne yāite sabe layena yāñra saṅga

SYNONYMS

śivānanda sena—Śivānanda Sena; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *bhṛtya*—servant; *antaraṅga*—very confidential; *prabhu-sthāne*—in Jagannātha Purī, where the Lord was staying; *yāite*—while going; *sabe*—all; *layena*—took; *yāñra*—whose; *saṅga*—shelter.

TRANSLATION

Śivānanda Sena, the twenty-fourth branch of the tree, was an extremely confidential servant of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Everyone who went to Jagannātha Purī to visit Lord Caitanya took shelter and guidance from Śrī Śivānanda Sena.

TEXT 55

prativarṣe prabhu-gaṇa saṅgete lā-iyā

nīlācale calena pathe pālana kariyā

SYNONYMS

prati-varṣe—every year; *prabhu-gaṇa*—the devotees of Lord Caitanya; *saṅgete*—along with; *lā-iyā*—taking; *nīlācale*—to Jagannātha Purī; *calena*—goes; *pathe*—on the road; *pālana*—maintenance; *kariyā*—providing.

TRANSLATION

Every year he took a party of devotees from Bengal to Jagannātha Purī to visit Lord Caitanya. He maintained the entire party as they journeyed on the road.

TEXT 56

bhakte kṛpā karena prabhu e-tina svarūpe

‘sākṣāt,’ ‘āveśa’ āra ‘āvirbhāva’-rūpe

SYNONYMS

bhakte—unto devotees; *kṛpā*—mercy; *karena*—bestows; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya; *e*—these; *tina*—three; *svarūpe*—features; *sākṣāt*—directly; *āveśa*—empowered by the Lord; *āra*—and; *āvirbhāva*—appearance; *rūpe*—in the features.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu bestows His causeless mercy upon His devotees in three features: His own direct appearance [sākṣāt], His prowess within someone He empowers [āveśa], and His manifestation

[āvirbhāva].

PURPORT

The *sākṣāt* feature of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is His personal presence. *Āveśa* refers to invested power, like that invested in Nakula Brahmācārī. *Āvirbhāva* is a manifestation of the Lord that appears even though He is personally not present. For example, Śrī Śacīmātā offered food at home to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu although He was far away in Jagannātha Purī, and when she opened her eyes after offering the food, she saw that it had actually been eaten by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Similarly, when Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura performed *saṅkīrtana*, everyone felt the presence of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, even in His absence. This is another example of *āvirbhāva*.

TEXT 57

‘sākṣāte’ sakala bhakta dekhe nirviśeṣa

nakula brahmācārī-dehe prabhura ‘āveśa’

SYNONYMS

sākṣāte—directly; *sakala*—all; *bhakta*—devotees; *dekhe*—see; *nirviśeṣa*—nothing peculiar but as He is; *nakula brahmācārī*—Nakula Brahmācārī; *dehe*—in the body; *prabhura*—the Lord’s; *āveśa*—symptoms of power.

TRANSLATION

The appearance of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu in every devotee’s presence is called *sākṣāt*. His appearance in Nakula Brahmācārī as a symptom of special prowess is an example of *āveśa*.

TEXT 58

‘pradyumna brahmacārī’ tāñra āge nāma chila

‘nṛsimhānanda’ nāma prabhu pāche ta’ rākhila

SYNONYMS

pradyumna brahmacārī—Pradyumna Brahmacārī; *tāñra*—his; *āge*—previously; *nāma*—name; *chila*—was; *nṛsimhānanda*—Nṛsimhānanda; *nāma*—the name; *prabhu*—the Lord; *pāche*—afterward; *ta’*—certainly; *rākhila*—kept it.

TRANSLATION

The former Pradyumna Brahmacārī was given the name Nṛsimhānanda Brahmacārī by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 59

tāñhāte ha-ila caitanyera ‘āvirbhāva’

alaukika aiche prabhura aneka svabhāva

SYNONYMS

tāñhāte—in him; *ha-ila*—there was; *caitanyera*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *āvirbhāva*—appearance; *alaukika*—uncommon; *aiche*—like that; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *aneka*—various; *svabhāva*—features.

TRANSLATION

In his body there were symptoms of āvirbhāva. Such appearances are uncommon, but Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu displayed many such pastimes through His different features.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (73–74) it is said that Nakula Brahmācārī displayed the prowess (*āveśa*) and Pradyumna Brahmācārī the appearance (*āvirbhāva*) of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. There are many hundreds and thousands of devotees of Lord Caitanya among whom there are no special symptoms, but when a devotee of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu functions with specific prowess, he displays the feature called *āveśa*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu personally spread the *saṅkīrtana* movement, and He advised all the inhabitants of Bhāratavarṣa to take up His cult and preach it all over the world. The visible bodily symptoms of devotees who follow such instructions are called *āveśa*. Śrīla Śivānanda Sena observed such *āveśa* symptoms in Nakula Brahmācārī, who displayed symptoms exactly like those of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* states that in the Age of Kali the only spiritual function is to broadcast the holy name of the Lord, but this function can be performed only by one who is actually empowered by Lord Kṛṣṇa. The process by which a devotee is thus empowered is called *āveśa*, or sometimes it is called *śakty-āveśa*.

Pradyumna Brahmācārī was formerly a resident of a village known as Piyārīgāñja in Kālnā. There is a description of him in the *Antya-līlā* of Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Second Chapter, and in the *Antya-khaṇḍa* of Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata, chapters Three and Nine.

TEXT 60

āsvādila e saba rasa sena śivānanda

vistāri' kahiba āge esaba ānanda

SYNONYMS

āsvādila—tasted; *e*—these; *saba*—all; *rasa*—mellows; *sena śivānanda*—Śivānanda Sena; *vistāri'*—describing vividly; *kahiba*—I shall speak;

āge—later on; *esaba*—all this; *ānanda*—transcendental bliss.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Śivānanda Sena experienced the three features of *sākṣāt*, *āveśa* and *āvīrbhāva*. Later I shall vividly describe this transcendently blissful subject.

PURPORT

Śrīla Śivānanda Sena has been described by Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Mahārāja as follows: “Śivānanda Sena was a resident of Kumārahaṭṭa, which is also known as Hālisahara, and was a great devotee of the Lord. About one and a half miles from Kumārahaṭṭa is another village, known as Kāñcaḍāpāḍā, in which there are Gaura-Gopāla Deities installed by Śivānanda Sena, who also established a temple of Kṛṣṇarāya that is still existing. Śivānanda Sena was the father of Paramānanda Sena, who was also known as Purī dāsa or Kavi-karṇapūra. Paramānanda Sena wrote in his *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (176) that two of the *gopīs* of Vṛndāvana, whose former names were Vīrā and Dūtī, combined to become his father. Śrīla Śivānanda Sena guided all the devotees of Lord Caitanya who went from Bengal to Jagannātha Purī, and he personally bore all the expenses for their journey. This is described in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Sixteen, verses 19 through 27. Śrīla Śivānanda Sena had three sons, named Caitanya dāsa, Rāmadāsa and Paramānanda. As mentioned above, this last son later became Kavi-karṇapūra and wrote the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*. His spiritual master was Śrīnātha Paṇḍita, who was Śivānanda Sena’s priest. Due to Vāsudeva Datta’s lavish spending, Śivānanda Sena was engaged to supervise his expenditures.”

Śrī Śivānanda Sena actually experienced Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s features of *sākṣāt*, *āveśa* and *āvīrbhāva*. He once took along a dog while on his way to Jagannātha Purī, and it is described in the *Antya-līlā*, First Chapter, that this dog later attained salvation by his association. When

Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa, who later became Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, fled his paternal home to join Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, his father wrote a letter to Śivānanda Sena to get information about him. Śivānanda Sena supplied him the details for which he asked, and later Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī's father sent some servants and money to Śivānanda Sena to take care of Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. Once Śrī Śivānanda Sena invited Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to his home and fed Him so sumptuously that the Lord felt indigestion and was somewhat sick. This became known to Śivānanda Sena's eldest son, Caitanya dāsa, who gave the Lord the kinds of food that would help His digestion, and thus Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was very pleased. This is described in *Antya-līlā*, Tenth Chapter, verses 142 through 151.

Once while going to Jagannātha Purī, all the devotees had to stay underneath a tree, without the shelter of a house or even a shed, and Nityānanda Prabhu became very angry, as if He were greatly disturbed by hunger. Thus He cursed Śivānanda's sons to die. Śivānanda's wife was very much aggrieved at this, and she began to cry. She very seriously thought that since her sons had been cursed by Nityānanda Prabhu, certainly they would die. When Śivānanda later returned and saw his wife crying, he said, "Why are you crying? Let us all die if Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu desires." When Śivānanda Sena returned and Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu saw him, the Lord kicked him severely, complaining that He was very hungry, and asked why he had not arranged for His food. Such is the behavior of the Lord with His devotees. Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu behaved like an ordinary hungry man, as if completely dependent on the arrangements of Śivānanda Sena.

A nephew of Śivānanda Sena's named Śrīkānta left the company in protest of Nityānanda Prabhu's curse and went directly to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī, where the Lord pacified him. On that occasion, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu allowed His toe to be sucked by Purī dāsa, who was then a child. It is by the order of Caitanya Mahāprabhu that he could immediately compose Sanskrit verses. During the misunderstanding with Śivānanda's family, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

ordered His personal attendant, Govinda, to give them all the remnants of His food. This is described in *Antya-līlā*, Chapter Twelve, verse 53.

TEXT 61

śivānandera upasākhā, tāñra parikara

putra-bhṛty-ādi kari' caitanya-kiṅkara

SYNONYMS

śivānandera—of Śivānanda Sena; *upasākhā*—subbranch; *tāñra*—his; *parikara*—associates; *putra*—sons; *bhṛtya*—servants; *ādi*—all these; *kari'*—taking together; *caitanya-kiṅkara*—servants of Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

The sons, servants and family members of Śivānanda Sena constituted a subbranch. They were all sincere servants of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 62

caitanya-dāsa, rāmadāsa, āra karṇapūra

tina putra śivānandera prabhura bhakta-sūra

SYNONYMS

caitanya-dāsa—Caitanya dāsa; *rāmadāsa*—Rāmadāsa; *āra*—and; *karṇapūra*—Karṇapūra; *tina putra*—three sons; *śivānandera*—of Śivānanda Sena; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *bhakta-sūra*—of the heroic devotees.

TRANSLATION

The three sons of Śivānanda Sena, named Caitanya dāsa, Rāmadāsa and Karṇapūra, were all heroic devotees of Lord Caitanya.

PURPORT

Caitanya dāsa, the eldest son of Śivānanda Sena, wrote a commentary on *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta* that was later translated by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura in his paper *Sajjana-toṣaṇī*. According to expert opinion, Caitanya dāsa was the author of the book *Caitanya-carita* (also known as *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*), which was written in Sanskrit. The author was not Kavi-karṇapūra, as is generally supposed. This is the opinion of Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura. Śrī Rāmadāsa was the second son of Śivānanda Sena. It is stated in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (145) that the two famous parrots named Dakṣa and Vicakṣaṇa in *kṛṣṇa-līlā* became the elder brothers of Kavi-karṇapūra, namely Caitanya dāsa and Rāmadāsa. Karṇapūra, the third son, who was also known as Paramānanda dāsa or Purī dāsa, was initiated by Śrīnātha Paṇḍita, who was a disciple of Śrī Advaita Prabhu. Karṇapūra wrote many books that are important in Vaiṣṇava literature, such as the *Ānanda-vṛndāvana-campū*, *Alaṅkāra-kaustubha*, *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* and the great epic *Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka*. He was born in the year 1448 Śakābda (A.D. 1526). He continually wrote books for ten years, from 1488 until 1498.

TEXT 63

śrī-vallabhasena, āra sena śrīkānta

śivānanda-sambandhe prabhura bhakta ekānta

SYNONYMS

śrī-vallabha-sena—Śrīvallabha Sena; *āra*—and; *sena śrīkānta*—Śrīkānta Sena; *śivānanda*—Śivānanda Sena; *sambandhe*—in relationship;

prabhura—the Lord’s; *bhakta*—devotees; *ekānta*—unflinching.

TRANSLATION

Śrīvallabha Sena and Śrīkānta Sena were also subbranches of Śivānanda Sena, for they were not only his nephews but also unalloyed devotees of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

When Lord Nityānanda Prabhu rebuked Śivānanda Sena on the way to Purī, these two nephews of Śivānanda left the company as a protest and went to see Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī. The Lord could understand the feelings of the boys, and He asked His personal assistant, Govinda, to supply them *prasādam* until the party of Śivānanda arrived. During the Ratha-yātrā *saṅkīrtana* festival these two brothers were members of the party led by Mukunda. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (174) it is said that the *gopī* whose name was Kātyāyanī appeared as Śrīkānta Sena.

TEXT 64

prabhu-priya govindānanda mahābhāgavata

prabhura kīrtanīyā ādi śrī-govinda datta

SYNONYMS

prabhu-priya—the most dear to the Lord; *govindānanda*—Govindānanda; *mahā-bhāgavata*—great devotee; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *kīrtanīyā*—performer of *kīrtana*; *ādi*—originally; *śrī-govinda datta*—Śrī Govinda Datta.

TRANSLATION

Govindānanda and Govinda Datta, the twenty-fifth and twenty-sixth branches of the tree, were performers of kīrtana in the company of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Govinda Datta was the principal singer in Lord Caitanya's kīrtana party.

PURPORT

Govinda Datta appeared in the village of Sukhacara, near Khaḍadaha.

TEXT 65

śrī-vijaya-dāsa-nāma prabhura ākharīyā

prabhure aneka puṁthi diyāche likhiyā

SYNONYMS

śrī-vijaya-dāsa—Śrī Vijaya dāsa; *nāma*—name; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *ākharīyā*—chief singer; *prabhure*—unto the Lord; *aneka*—many; *puṁthi*—literatures; *diyāche*—has given; *likhiyā*—by writing.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Vijaya dāsa, the twenty-seventh branch, another of the Lord's chief singers, gave the Lord many books written by hand.

PURPORT

Formerly there were no printing presses or printed books. All books were handwritten. Precious books were kept in manuscript form in temples or other important places, and anyone who was interested in a book had to copy it by hand. Vijaya dāsa was a professional writer who copied many manuscripts and gave them to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 66

‘ratnabāhu’ bali’ prabhu thuila tāñra nāma

akiñcana prabhura priya kṛṣṇadāsa-nāma

SYNONYMS

ratnabāhu—the title Ratnabāhu; *bali’*—calling him; *prabhu*—the Lord; *thuila*—kept; *tāñra*—his; *nāma*—name; *akiñcana*—unalloyed; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *priya*—dear; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa; *nāma*—name.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu gave Vijaya dāsa the name Ratnabāhu [“jewel-handed”] because he copied many manuscripts for Him. The twenty-eighth branch was Kṛṣṇadāsa, who was very dear to the Lord. He was known as Akiñcana Kṛṣṇadāsa.

PURPORT

Akiñcana means “one who possesses nothing in this world.”

TEXT 67

kholā-vecā śrīdhara prabhura priya-dāsa

yāñhā-sane prabhu kare nitya parihāsa

SYNONYMS

kholā-vecā—a person who sells the bark of banana trees; *śrīdhara*—Śrīdhara Prabhu; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *priya-dāsa*—very dear servant; *yāñhā-sane*—with whom; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kare*—does; *nitya*—daily; *parihāsa*—joking.

TRANSLATION

The twenty-ninth branch was Śrīdhara, a trader in banana-tree bark. He was a very dear servant of the Lord. On many occasions, the Lord played jokes on him.

PURPORT

Śrīdhara was a poor *brāhmaṇa* who made a living by selling banana-tree bark to be made into cups. Most probably he had a banana-tree garden and collected the leaves, skin and pulp of the banana trees to sell daily in the market. He spent fifty percent of his income to worship the Ganges, and the balance he used for his subsistence. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu started His civil disobedience movement in defiance of the Kazi, Śrīdhara danced in jubilation. The Lord used to drink water from his water jug. Śrīdhara presented a squash to Śacīdevī to cook before Lord Caitanya took *sannyāsa*. Every year he went to see Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī. According to Kavi-karṇapūra, Śrīdhara was a cowherd boy of Vṛndāvana whose name was Kusumāsava. In his *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (133) it is stated:

*kholā-vecāṭayā khyātaḥ paṇḍitaḥ śrīdharo dvijaḥ
āsīd vraje hāsya-karo yo nāmnā kusumāsavaḥ*

“The cowherd boy known as Kusumāsava in *kṛṣṇa-līlā* later became Kholāvecā Śrīdhara during Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s *līlā* at Navadvīpa.”

TEXT 68

*prabhu yāñra nitya laya thoḍa-mocā-phala
yāñra phuṭā-lauhapātre prabhu pilā jala*

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *yāñra*—whose; *nitya*—daily; *laya*—takes; *thoḍa*—the pulp of the banana tree; *mocā*—the flowers of the banana tree; *phala*—the fruits of the banana tree; *yāñra*—whose; *phuṭā*—broken; *lauha-pātre*—in the iron pot; *prabhu*—the Lord; *pilā*—drank; *jala*—water.

TRANSLATION

Every day Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu jokingly snatched fruits, flowers and pulp from Śrīdhara and drank from his broken iron pot.

TEXT 69

prabhura atipriya dāsa bhagavān paṇḍita

yāñra dehe kṛṣṇa pūrve hailā adhiṣṭhita

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *atipriya*—very dear; *dāsa*—servant; *bhagavān paṇḍita*—Bhagavān Paṇḍita; *yāñra*—whose; *dehe*—in the body; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pūrve*—previously; *hailā*—became; *adhiṣṭhita*—established.

TRANSLATION

The thirtieth branch was Bhagavān Paṇḍita. He was an extremely dear servant of the Lord, but even previously he was a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa who always kept the Lord within his heart.

TEXT 70

jagadīśa paṇḍita, āra hiraṇya mahāśaya

yāre kṛpā kaila bālye prabhu dayāmaya

SYNONYMS

jagadīśa paṇḍita—Jagadīśa Paṇḍita; *āra*—and; *hiraṇya*—Hiraṇya; *mahāśaya*—great personality; *yāre*—unto whom; *kṛpā*—mercy; *kaila*—showed; *bālye*—in childhood; *prabhu*—the Lord; *dayāmaya*—merciful.

TRANSLATION

The thirty-first branch was Jagadīśa Paṇḍita, and the thirty-second was Hiraṇya Mahāśaya, unto whom Lord Caitanya in His childhood showed His causeless mercy.

PURPORT

Jagadīśa Paṇḍita was formerly a great dancer in *kṛṣṇa-līlā* and was known as Candrahāsa. Regarding Hiraṇya Paṇḍita, it is said that once when Lord Nityānanda, decorated with valuable jewels, was staying at his home, all night long a great thief attempted to plunder these jewels but was unsuccessful. Later he came to Nityānanda Prabhu and surrendered unto Him.

TEXT 71

ei dui-ghare prabhu ekādaśī dine

viṣṇura naivedya māgi' khāila āpane

SYNONYMS

ei dui-ghare—in these two houses; *prabhu*—the Lord; *ekādaśī dine*—on the Ekādaśī day; *viṣṇura*—of Lord Viṣṇu; *naivedya*—food offered to Lord Viṣṇu; *māgi'*—begging; *khāila*—ate; *āpane*—personally.

TRANSLATION

In their two houses Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu begged food on the Ekādaśī day and personally ate it.

PURPORT

The injunction to fast on Ekādaśī is especially meant for devotees; on Ekādaśī there are no restrictions regarding food that may be offered to the Lord. Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu took the food of Lord Viṣṇu in His ecstasy as *viṣṇu-tattva*.

TEXT 72

prabhura paḍuyā dui, — — puruṣottama, sañjaya

vyākaraṇe dui śiṣya — — dui mahāśaya

SYNONYMS

prabhura paḍuyā dui—the Lord’s two students; *puruṣottama*—Puruṣottama; *sañjaya*—Sañjaya; *vyākaraṇe*—studying grammar; *dui śiṣya*—two disciples; *dui mahāśaya*—very great personalities.

TRANSLATION

The thirty-third and thirty-fourth branches were the two students of Caitanya Mahāprabhu named Puruṣottama and Sañjaya, who were stalwart students in grammar. They were very great personalities.

PURPORT

These two students were inhabitants of Navadvīpa and were the Lord’s first companions in the *saṅkīrtana* movement. According to the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Puruṣottama Sañjaya was the son of Mukunda Sañjaya, but the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* has clarified that Puruṣottama and Sañjaya were two people, not one.

TEXT 73

vanamālī paṇḍita śākhā vikhyāta jagate

soṇāra muṣala hala dekhila prabhura hāte

SYNONYMS

vanamālī paṇḍita—Vanamālī Paṇḍita; *śākhā*—the next branch; *vikhyāta*—celebrated; *jagate*—in the world; *soṇāra*—made of gold; *muṣala*—club; *hala*—plow; *dekhila*—saw; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *hāte*—in the hand.

TRANSLATION

Vanamālī Paṇḍita, the thirty-fifth branch of the tree, was very much celebrated in this world. He saw a golden club and plow in the hands of the Lord.

PURPORT

Vanamālī Paṇḍita saw Lord Caitanya in the ecstasy of Balarāma. This is described vividly in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Nine.

TEXT 74

śrī-caitanyera ati priya buddhimanta khān

ājanma ājñākārī tenho sevaka-pradhāna

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanyera—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ati priya*—very dear; *buddhimanta khān*—Buddhimanta Khān; *ājanma*—from the very

beginning of his life; *ājñā-kārī*—follower of the orders; *teñho*—he; *sevaka*—servant; *pradhāna*—chief.

TRANSLATION

The thirty-sixth branch, Buddhimanta Khān, was extremely dear to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He was always prepared to carry out the Lord's orders, and therefore he was considered to be a chief servant of the Lord.

PURPORT

Śrī Buddhimanta Khān was one of the inhabitants of Navadvīpa. He was very rich, and it is he who arranged for the marriage of Lord Caitanya with Viṣṇupriyā, the daughter of Sanātana Miśra, who was the priest of the local zamindar. He personally defrayed all the expenditures for the marriage ceremony. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was attacked by *vāyu-vyādhi* (derangement of the air within the body) Buddhimanta Khān paid for all requisite medicines and treatments to cure the Lord. He was the Lord's constant companion in the *kīrtana* movement. He collected ornaments for the Lord when He played the part of the goddess of fortune in the house of Candraśekhara Ācārya. He also went to see Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu when He was staying at Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 75

garuḍa paṇḍita laya śrī-nāma-maṅgala

nāma-bale viṣa yāñre nā karila bala

SYNONYMS

garuḍa paṇḍita—Garuḍa Paṇḍita; *laya*—takes; *śrī-nāma-maṅgala*—the auspicious Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*; *nāma-bale*—by the strength of this chanting; *viṣa*—poison; *yāñre*—whom; *nā*—did not; *karila*—affect; *bala*—strength.

TRANSLATION

Garuḍa Paṇḍita, the thirty-seventh branch of the tree, always engaged in chanting the auspicious name of the Lord. Because of the strength of this chanting, even the effects of poison could not touch him.

PURPORT

Garuḍa Paṇḍita was once bitten by a poisonous snake, but the snake's poison could not affect him because of his chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

TEXT 76

gopīnātha śimha—eka caitanya dāsa

akrūra bali' prabhu yāñre kailā parihāsa

SYNONYMS

gopīnātha śimha—Gopīnātha Śimha; *eka*—one; *caitanya dāsa*—servant of Lord Caitanya; *akrūra bali'*—famous as Akrūra; *prabhu*—the Lord; *yāñre*—whom; *kailā*—did; *parihāsa*—joking.

TRANSLATION

Gopīnātha Śimha, the thirty-eighth branch of the tree, was a faithful servant of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The Lord jokingly addressed him as Akrūra.

PURPORT

Actually he was Akrūra, as stated in text 117 of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*.

TEXT 77

bhāgavatī devānanda vakreśvara-kṛpāte

bhāgavatera bhakti-artha pāila prabhu haite

SYNONYMS

bhāgavatī devānanda—Devānanda, who used to recite *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *vakreśvara-kṛpāte*—by the mercy of Vakreśvara; *bhāgavatera*—of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *bhakti-artha*—the *bhakti* interpretation; *pāila*—got; *prabhu haite*—from the Lord.

TRANSLATION

Devānanda Paṇḍita was a professional reciter of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, but by the mercy of Vakreśvara Paṇḍita and the grace of the Lord he understood the devotional interpretation of the *Bhāgavatam*.

PURPORT

In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata, Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Twenty-one, it is stated that Devānanda Paṇḍita and Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya's father, Viśārada, lived in the same village. Devānanda Paṇḍita was a professional reciter of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, but Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu did not like his interpretation of it. In the present town of Navadvīpa, which was formerly known as Kuliya, Lord Caitanya showed such mercy to him that he gave up the Māyāvādī interpretation of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and learned how to explain *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* in terms of *bhakti*. Formerly, when Devānanda was expounding the Māyāvādī interpretation, Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura was once present in his meeting, and when he began to cry, Devānanda's students drove him away. Some days later, Caitanya Mahāprabhu passed that way, and when He met Devānanda He chastised him severely because of his Māyāvāda interpretation of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. At that time Devānanda had little faith in Śrī Caitanya

Mahāprabhu as an incarnation of Lord Kṛṣṇa, but one night some time later Vakreśvara Paṇḍita was a guest in his house, and when he explained the science of Kṛṣṇa, Devānanda was convinced about the identity of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Thus he was induced to explain *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* according to the Vaiṣṇava understanding. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (106) it is described that he was formerly Bhāguri Muni, the *sabhā-paṇḍita* who recited Vedic literatures in the house of Nanda Mahārāja.

TEXTS 78–79

khaṇḍavāsī mukunda-dāsa, śrī-raghunandana

narahari-dāsa, cirañjīva, sulocana

ei saba mahāśākhā—caitanya-kṛpādhāma

prema-phala-phula kare yāhān tāhān dāna

SYNONYMS

khaṇḍa-vāsī mukunda-dāsa—Mukunda dāsa, a resident of Śrīkhaṇḍa; *śrī-raghunandana*—Raghunandana; *narahari-dāsa*—Narahari dāsa; *cirañjīva*—Cirañjīva; *sulocana*—Sulocana; *ei saba*—all of them; *mahā-śākhā*—great branches; *caitanya-kṛpā-dhāma*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the reservoir of mercy; *prema*—love of God; *phala*—fruit; *phula*—flower; *kare*—does; *yāhān*—anywhere; *tāhān*—everywhere; *dāna*—distribution.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Khaṇḍavāsī Mukunda and his son Raghunandana were the thirty-ninth branch of the tree, Narahari was the fortieth, Cirañjīva the forty-first and Sulocana the forty-second. They were all big branches of the all-merciful tree of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. They distributed the fruits and

flowers of love of Godhead anywhere and everywhere.

PURPORT

Śrī Mukunda dāsa was the son of Nārāyaṇa dāsa and eldest brother of Narahari Sarakāra. His second brother's name was Mādhava dāsa, and his son was named Raghunandana dāsa. Descendants of Raghunandana dāsa still live four miles west of Katwa in the village named Śrīkhaṇḍa, where Raghunandana dāsa used to live. Raghunandana had one son named Kānāi, who had two sons—Madana Rāya, who was a disciple of Narahari Ṭhākura, and Vamśīvadana. It is estimated that at least four hundred men descended in this dynasty. All their names are recorded in the village of Śrīkhaṇḍa. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (175) it is stated that the *gopī* whose name was Vṛndādevī became Mukunda dāsa, lived in Śrīkhaṇḍa village and was very dear to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. His wonderful devotion and love for Kṛṣṇa are described in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Fifteen. It is stated in the *Bhakti-ratnākara* (Eighth Wave) that Raghunandana used to serve a Deity of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Narahari dāsa Sarakāra was a very famous devotee. Locana dāsa Ṭhākura, the celebrated author of *Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala*, was his disciple. In the *Caitanya-maṅgala* it is stated that Śrī Gadādhara dāsa and Narahari Sarakāra were extremely dear to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, but there is no specific statement regarding the inhabitants of the village of Śrīkhaṇḍa.

Cirañjīva and Sulocana were both residents of Śrīkhaṇḍa, where their descendants are still living. Of Cirañjīva's two sons, the elder, Rāmacandra Kavirāja, was a disciple of Śrīnivāsa Acārya and an intimate associate of Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura. The younger son was Govinda dāsa Kavirāja, the famous Vaiṣṇava poet. Cirañjīva's wife was Sunandā, and his father-in-law was Dāmodara Sena Kavirāja. Cirañjīva previously lived on the bank of the Ganges River, in the village of Kumāranagara. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (207) states that he was formerly Candrikā in

Vṛndāvana.

TEXT 80

kulīnagrāma-vāsī satyarāja, rāmānanda

yadunātha, puruṣottama, śaṅkara, vidyānanda

SYNONYMS

kulīna-grāma-vāsī—the inhabitants of Kulīna-grāma; *satyarāja*—Satyarāja; *rāmānanda*—Rāmānanda; *yadunātha*—Yadunātha; *puruṣottama*—Puruṣottama; *śaṅkara*—Śaṅkara; *vidyānanda*—Vidyānanda.

TRANSLATION

Satyarāja, Rāmānanda, Yadunātha, Puruṣottama, Śaṅkara and Vidyānanda all belonged to the twentieth branch. They were inhabitants of the village known as Kulīna-grāma.

TEXT 81

vāṇīnātha vasu ādi yata grāmī jana

sabei caitanya-bhṛtya, — — caitanya-prāṇadhana

SYNONYMS

vāṇīnātha vasu—Vāṇīnātha Vasu; *ādi*—heading the list; *yata*—all; *grāmī*—of the village; *jana*—inhabitants; *sabei*—all of them; *caitanya-bhṛtya*—servants of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *caitanya-prāṇa-dhana*—their life and soul was Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

All the inhabitants of Kulīna-grāma village, headed by Vāṇinātha Vasu, were servants of Lord Caitanya, who was their only life and wealth.

TEXT 82

prabhu kahe, kulīnagrāmera ye haya kukkura

sei mora priya, anya jana rahu dūra

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *kahe*—says; *kulīna-grāmera*—of the village of Kulīna-grāma; *ye*—anyone who; *haya*—becomes; *kukkura*—even a dog; *sei*—he; *mora*—My; *priya*—dear; *anya*—others; *jana*—persons; *rahu*—let them remain; *dūra*—away.

TRANSLATION

The Lord said, “What to speak of others, even a dog in the village of Kulīna-grāma is My dear friend.

TEXT 83

kulīnagrāmīra bhāgya kahane nā yāya

sūkara carāya ḍoma, seha kṛṣṇa gāya

SYNONYMS

kulīna-grāmīra—the residents of Kulīna-grāma; *bhāgya*—fortune; *kahane*—to speak; *nā*—not; *yāya*—is possible; *sūkara*—hogs; *carāya*—tending; *ḍoma*—sweeper; *seha*—he also; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *gāya*—chants.

TRANSLATION

“No one can describe the fortunate position of Kulīna-grāma. It is so sublime that even sweepers who tend their hogs there also chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra.”

TEXT 84

anupama-vallabha, śrī-rūpa, sanātana

ei tina śākhā vṛkṣera paścime sarvottama

SYNONYMS

anupama-vallabha—Anupama, or Vallabha; *śrī-rūpa*—Śrī Rūpa; *sanātana*—Sanātana; *ei*—these; *tina*—three; *śākhā*—branches; *vṛkṣera*—of the tree; *paścime*—on the western side; *sarvottama*—very great.

TRANSLATION

On the western side were the forty-third, forty-fourth and forty-fifth branches—Śrī Sanātana, Śrī Rūpa and Anupama. They were the best of all.

PURPORT

Śrī Anupama was the father of Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī and younger brother of Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī and Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. His former name was Vallabha, but after Lord Caitanya met him He gave him the name Anupama. Because of working in the Muslim government, these three brothers were given the title Mullik. Our personal family is connected with the Mulliks of Mahatma Gandhi Road in Calcutta, and we often used to visit their Rādhā-Govinda temple. They belong to the same family as we do. Our family *gotra*, or original genealogical line, is the Gautama-gotra, or line of disciples of Gautama Muni, and our surname is De. But due to their accepting the posts of zamindars in the Muslim government,

they received the title Mullik. Similarly, Rūpa, Sanātana and Vallabha were also given the title Mullik. Mullik means “lord.” Just as the English government gives rich and respectable persons the title “lord,” so the Muslims give the title Mullik to rich, respectable families that have intimate connections with the government. Thus the title Mullik is found not only among the Muslims but also among the Hindu aristocracy. This title is not restricted to a particular family but is given to different families and castes. The qualifications for receiving it are wealth and respectability

Sanātana Gosvāmī and Rūpa Gosvāmī belonged to the Bharadvāja-gotra, which indicates that they belonged either to the family or disciplic succession of Bharadvāja Muni. As members of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement we belong to the family, or disciplic succession, of Sarasvatī Gosvāmī, and thus we are known as Sārasvatas. Obeisances are therefore offered to the spiritual master as *sārasvata-deva*, or a member of the Sārasvata family (*namas te sārasvate deve*), whose mission is to broadcast the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu (*gaura-vāṇī-pracāriṇe*) and to fight with impersonalists and voidists (*nirviśeṣa-sūnyavādi-pāścātya-deśa-tāriṇe*). This was also the occupational duty of Sanātana Gosvāmī, Rūpa Gosvāmī and Anupama Gosvāmī.

The genealogical table of Sanātana Gosvāmī, Rūpa Gosvāmī and Vallabha Gosvāmī can be traced back to the twelfth century Śakābda, when a gentleman of the name Sarvajña appeared in a very rich and opulent *brāhmaṇa* family in the province of Karṇāṭa. He had two sons, named Aniruddhera Rūpeśvara and Harihara, who were both bereft of their kingdoms and thus obliged to reside in the highlands. The son of Rūpeśvara, who was named Padmanābha, moved to a place in Bengal known as Naihātī, on the bank of the Ganges. There he had five sons, of whom the youngest, Mukunda, had a well-behaved son named Kumāradeva, who was the father of Rūpa, Sanātana and Vallabha. Kumāradeva lived in Phateyābād, an area bordering Bāklācandradvīpa in East Bengal (now Bangladesh). The present-day village of Prembagh, which lies near Ramshara in the Jessore district of Bangladesh, is said by

many to be the site of Kumāradeva's house. Of his many sons, three took to the path of Vaiṣṇavism. Later, Śrī Vallabha and his elder brothers Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana came from Candradvīpa to the village in the Maldah district of Bengal known as Rāmakeli. It is in this village that Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī took birth, accepting Vallabha as his father. Because of engaging in the service of the Muslim government, the three brothers received the title Mullik. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu visited the village of Rāmakeli, He met Vallabha there. Later, Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, after meeting Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, resigned from government service, and when he went to Vṛndāvana to meet Lord Caitanya, Vallabha accompanied him. The meeting of Rūpa Gosvāmī and Vallabha with Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Allahabad is described in the *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Nineteen.

Actually, it is to be understood from the statement of Sanātana Gosvāmī that Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī and Vallabha went to Vṛndāvana under the instructions of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. First they went to Mathurā, where they met a gentleman named Subuddhi Rāya, who maintained himself by selling dry fuel wood. He was very pleased to meet Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī and Anupama, and he showed them the twelve forests of Vṛndāvana. Thus they lived in Vṛndāvana for one month and then again went to search for Sanātana Gosvāmī. Following the course of the Ganges, they reached Allahabad, or Prayāga-tīrtha, but because Sanātana Gosvāmī had come there by a different road, they did not meet him there, and when Sanātana Gosvāmī came to Mathurā he was informed of the visit of Rūpa Gosvāmī and Anupama by Subuddhi Rāya. When Rūpa Gosvāmī and Anupama met Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Benares, they heard about Sanātana Gosvāmī's travels from Him, and thus they returned to Bengal, adjusted their affairs with the state and, on the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, went to see the Lord at Jagannātha Purī.

In the year 1436 Śakābda (A.D. 1514), the youngest brother, Anupama, died and went back home, back to Godhead. He went to the abode in the spiritual sky where Śrī Rāmacandra is situated. At Jagannātha Purī, Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī informed Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu of this incident.

Vallabha was a great devotee of Śrī Rāmacandra; therefore he could not seriously consider the worship of Rādhā-Govinda according to the instructions of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Yet he directly accepted Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as an incarnation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Rāmacandra. In the *Bhakti-ratnākara* there is the following statement: “Vallabha was given the name Anupama by Śrī Gaurasundara, but he was always absorbed in the devotional service of Lord Rāmacandra. He did not know anyone but Śrī Rāmacandra, but he knew that Caitanya Gosāñi was the same Lord Rāmacandra.”

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (180) Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī is described to be the *gopī* named Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī. In the *Bhakti-ratnākara* there is a list of the books Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī compiled. Of all his books, the following sixteen are very popular among Vaiṣṇavas: (1) *Haṁsadūta*, (2) *Uddhava-sandeśa*, (3) *Kṛṣṇa-janma-tithi-vidhi*, (4 and 5) *Rādhā-kṛṣṇa-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, *Bṛhat* (major) and *Laghu* (minor), (6) *Stavamālā*, (7) *Vidagdha-mādhava*, (8) *Lalita-mādhava*, (9) *Dāna-keli-kaumudī*, (10) *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (this is the most celebrated book by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī), (11) *Ujjvala-nīlamanī*, (12) *Ākhyāta-candrikā*, (13) *Mathurā-mahimā*, (14) *Padyāvalī*, (15) *Nāṭaka-candrikā* and (16) *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*. Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī gave up all family connections, joined the renounced order of life and divided his money, giving fifty percent to the *brāhmaṇas* and Vaiṣṇavas and twenty-five percent to his *kuṭumba* (family members), and keeping twenty-five percent for personal emergencies. He met Haridāsa Ṭhākura in Jagannātha Purī, where he also met Lord Caitanya and His other associates. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu used to praise the handwriting of Rūpa Gosvāmī. Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī could compose verses according to the desires of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and by His direction he wrote two books named *Lalita-mādhava* and *Vidagdha-mādhava*. Lord Caitanya desired the two brothers, Sanātana Gosvāmī and Rūpa Gosvāmī, to publish many books in support of the Vaiṣṇava religion. When Sanātana Gosvāmī met Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Lord advised him also to go to Vṛndāvana.

Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī is described in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (181).

He was formerly known as Rati-mañjarī or sometimes Lavaṅga-mañjarī. In the *Bhakti-ratnākara* it is stated that his spiritual master, Vidyā-vācaspati, sometimes stayed in the village of Rāmakeli, and Sanātana Gosvāmī studied all the Vedic literatures from him. He was so devoted to his spiritual master that this cannot be described. According to the Vedic system, if someone sees a Muslim he must perform rituals to atone for the meeting. Sanātana Gosvāmī always associated with Muslim kings. Not giving much attention to the Vedic injunctions, he used to visit the houses of Muslim kings, and thus he considered himself to have been converted into a Muslim. He was therefore always very humble and meek. When Sanātana Gosvāmī presented himself before Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he said, “I am always in association with lower-class people, and my behavior is therefore very abominable.” He actually belonged to a respectable *brāhmaṇa* family, but because he considered his behavior to be abominable, he did not try to place himself among the *brāhmaṇas* but always remained among people of the lower castes. He wrote the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* and *Vaiṣṇava-toṣaṇī*, which is a commentary on the Tenth Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. In the year 1476 Śakābda (A.D. 1554) he completed the *Bṛhad-vaiṣṇava-toṣaṇī* commentary on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. In the year 1504 Śakābda (A.D. 1582) he finished the *Laghu-toṣaṇī*.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu taught His principles through four chief followers. Among them, Rāmānanda Rāya is exceptional, for through him the Lord taught how a devotee can completely vanquish the power of Cupid. By Cupid’s power, as soon as one sees a beautiful woman he is conquered by her beauty. Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya, however, vanquished Cupid’s pride. Indeed, while rehearsing the *Jagannātha-vallabha-nāṭaka* he personally directed extremely beautiful young girls in dancing, but he was never affected by their youthful beauty. Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya personally bathed these girls, touching them and washing them with his own hands, yet he remained calm and passionless, as a great devotee should be. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu certified that this was possible only for Rāmānanda Rāya. Similarly, Dāmodara Paṇḍita was notable for his objectivity as a critic. He did not even spare Caitanya Mahāprabhu

from his criticism. This also cannot be imitated by anyone else. Haridāsa Ṭhākura is exceptional for his forbearance because although he was beaten with canes in twenty-two marketplaces, he was nevertheless tolerant. Similarly, Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī, although he belonged to a most respectable *brāhmaṇa* family, was exceptional for his humility and meekness.

In the *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Nineteen, the device adopted by Sanātana Gosvāmī to get free from government service is described. He served a notice of sickness to the Nawab, the Muslim governor, but actually he was studying *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* with *brāhmaṇas* at home. The Nawab received information of this through a royal physician, and he immediately went to see Sanātana Gosvāmī to discover his intentions. The Nawab requested Sanātana to accompany him on an expedition to Orissa, but when Sanātana Gosvāmī refused, the Nawab ordered that he be imprisoned. When Rūpa Gosvāmī left home, he wrote a note for Sanātana Gosvāmī informing him of some money that he had entrusted to a local grocer. Sanātana Gosvāmī took advantage of this money to bribe the jail keeper and get free from detention. Then he left for Benares to meet Caitanya Mahāprabhu, bringing with him only one servant, whose name was Īśāna. On the way they stopped at a *sarāī*, or hotel, and when the hotel keeper found out that Īśāna had some gold coins with him, he planned to kill both Sanātana Gosvāmī and Īśāna to take away the coins. Later Sanātana Gosvāmī saw that although the hotel keeper did not know them, he was being especially attentive to their comfort. Therefore he concluded that Īśāna was secretly carrying some money and that the hotel keeper was aware of this and therefore planned to kill them for it. Upon being questioned by Sanātana Gosvāmī, Īśāna admitted that he indeed had money with him, and immediately Sanātana Gosvāmī took the money and gave it to the hotel keeper, requesting him to help them get through the jungle. Thus with the help of the hotel keeper, who was also the chief of the thieves of that territory, Sanātana Gosvāmī crossed over the Hazipur mountains, which are presently known as the Hazaribags. He then met his brother-in-law Śrīkānta, who requested that he stay with him. Sanātana Gosvāmī refused, but before they parted Śrīkānta gave him a

valuable blanket.

Somehow or other Sanātana Gosvāmī reached Vārāṇasī and met Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu at the house of Candrasekhara. By the order of the Lord, Sanātana Gosvāmī was cleanly shaved and his dress changed to that of a mendicant, or *bābājī*. He put on old garments of Tapana Miśra's and took *prasādam* at the house of a Maharashtrian *brāhmaṇa*. Then, in discourses with Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Lord Himself explained everything about devotional service to Sanātana Gosvāmī. He advised Sanātana Gosvāmī to write books on devotional service, including a book of directions for Vaiṣṇava activities, and to excavate the lost places of pilgrimage in Vṛndāvana. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu gave him His blessings to do all this work and also explained to Sanātana Gosvāmī the import of the *ātmārāma* verse from sixty-one different angles of vision.

Sanātana Gosvāmī went to Vṛndāvana by the main road, and when he reached Mathurā he met Subuddhi Rāya. Then he returned to Jagannātha Purī through Jhārikhaṇḍa, the Madhya Pradesh jungle. At Jagannātha Purī he decided to give up his body by falling down beneath a wheel of the Jagannātha *ratha*, but Caitanya Mahāprabhu saved him. Then Sanātana Gosvāmī met Haridāsa Ṭhākura and heard about the disappearance of Anupama. Sanātana Gosvāmī later described the glories of Haridāsa Ṭhākura. Sanātana observed the etiquette of Jagannātha's temple by going along the beach to visit Lord Caitanya, although it was extremely hot due to the sun. He requested Jagadānanda Paṇḍita to give him permission to return to Vṛndāvana. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu praised the character of Sanātana Gosvāmī, and He embraced Sanātana, accepting his body as spiritual. Sanātana Gosvāmī was ordered by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu to live at Jagannātha Purī for one year. When he returned to Vṛndāvana after that time, he again met Rūpa Gosvāmī, and both brothers remained in Vṛndāvana to execute the orders of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

The place where Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī formerly lived has now become a place of pilgrimage. It is generally known as Gupta

Vṛndāvana, or hidden Vṛndāvana, and is situated about eight miles south of English Bazaar. There the following places are still visited: (1) the temple of the Śrī Madana-mohana Deity, (2) the Keli-kadamba tree, under which Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu met Sanātana Gosvāmī at night and (3) Rūpasāgara, a large pond excavated by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. A society named Rāmakeli-saṁskāra-samiti was established in 1924 to repair the temple and renovate the pond.

TEXT 85

tāñra madhye rūpa-sanātana—baḍa śākhā

anupama, jīva, rājendrādi upasākhā

SYNONYMS

tāñra—within that; *madhye*—in the midst of; *rūpa-sanātana*—the branch known as Rūpa-Sanātana; *baḍa śākhā*—the big branch; *anupama*—Anupama; *jīva*—Jīva; *rājendra-ādi*—and Rājendra and others; *upasākhā*—their subbranches.

TRANSLATION

Among these branches, Rūpa and Sanātana were principal. Anupama, Jīva Gosvāmī and others, headed by Rājendra, were their subbranches.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (195) it is said that Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī was formerly Vilāsa-mañjarī *gopī*. From his very childhood Jīva Gosvāmī was greatly fond of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. He later came to Navadvīpa to study Sanskrit, and, following in the footsteps of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, he circumambulated the entire Navadvīpa-dhāma. After visiting Navadvīpa-dhāma he went to Benares to study Sanskrit under Madhusūdana Vācaspati, and after finishing his studies in Benares he

went to Vṛndāvana and took shelter of his uncles, Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana. This is described in the *Bhakti-ratnākara*. As far as our information goes, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī composed and edited at least twenty-five books. They are all very much celebrated, and they are listed as follows: (1) *Hari-nāmāmṛta-vyākaraṇa*, (2) *Sūtra-mālikā*, (3) *Dhātu-saṅgraha*, (4) *Kṛṣṇārcā-dīpikā*, (5) *Gopāla-virudāvalī*, (6) *Rasāmṛta-śeṣa*, (7) *Śrī Mādhava-mahotsava*, (8) *Śrī Saṅkalpa-kalpavṛkṣa*, (9) *Bhāvārtha-sūcakā-campū*, (10) *Gopāla-tāpanī-ṭikā*, (11) a commentary on the *Brahma-saṁhitā*, (12) a commentary on the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, (13) a commentary on the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, (14) a commentary on the *Yogasāra-stava*, (15) a commentary on the *Gāyatrī-mantra*, as described in the *Agni Purāṇa*, (16) a description of the Lord's lotus feet derived from the *Padma Purāṇa*, (17) a description of the lotus feet of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, (18) *Gopāla-campū* (in two parts) and (19–25) seven *sandarbhās*: the *Krama-*, *Tattva-*, *Bhagavat-*, *Paramātmā-*, *Kṛṣṇa-*, *Bhakti-* and *Prīti-sandarbha*. After the disappearance of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī in Vṛndāvana, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī became the *ācārya* of all the Vaiṣṇavas in Bengal, Orissa and the rest of the world, and it is he who used to guide them in their devotional service. In Vṛndāvana he established the Rādhā-Dāmodara temple, where, after retirement, we had the opportunity to live from 1962 until 1965, when we decided to come to the United States of America. When Jīva Gosvāmī was still present, Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī compiled his famous *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. Later, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī inspired Śrīnivāsa Ācārya, Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura and Duḥkhī Kṛṣṇadāsa to preach Kṛṣṇa consciousness in Bengal. Jīva Gosvāmī was informed that all the manuscripts that had been collected from Vṛndāvana and sent to Bengal for preaching purposes were plundered near Viṣṇupura, in Bengal, but later he received the information that the books had been recovered. Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī awarded the designation Kavirāja to Rāmacandra Sena, a disciple of Śrīnivāsa Ācārya's, and to Rāmacandra's younger brother Govinda. While Jīva Gosvāmī was alive, Śrīmatī Jāhnavī-devī, the pleasure potency of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, went to Vṛndāvana with a few devotees. Jīva Gosvāmī was very kind to the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas, the Vaiṣṇavas from Bengal. Whoever went to Vṛndāvana he provided with a

residence and *prasādam*. His disciple Kṛṣṇadāsa Adhikārī listed all the books of the Gosvāmīs in his diary.

The *sahajiyās* level three accusations against Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī. This is certainly not congenial for the execution of devotional service. The first accusation concerns a materialist who was very proud of his reputation as a great Sanskrit scholar and approached Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana to argue with them about the revealed scriptures. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī, not wanting to waste their time, gave him a written statement that he had defeated them in a debate on the revealed scriptures. Taking this paper, the scholar approached Jīva Gosvāmī for a similar certificate of defeat, but Jīva Gosvāmī did not agree to give him one. On the contrary, he argued with him regarding the scriptures and defeated him. Certainly it was right for Jīva Gosvāmī to stop such a dishonest scholar from advertising that he had defeated Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī, but due to their illiteracy the *sahajiyā* class refer to this incident to accuse Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī of deviating from the principle of humility. They do not know, however, that humility and meekness are appropriate when one's own honor is insulted but not when Lord Viṣṇu or the *ācāryas* are blasphemed. In such cases one should not be humble and meek but must act. One should follow the example given by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Lord Caitanya says in His *Śikṣāṣṭaka* (3):

*trṇād api su-nīcena taror iva sahiṣṇunā
amāninā māna-dena kīrtanīyaḥ sadā hariḥ*

[Cc. adi 17.31]

“One can chant the holy name of the Lord in a humble state of mind, thinking himself lower than the straw in the street. One should be more tolerant than a tree, devoid of all sense of false prestige, and should be ready to offer all respect to others. In such a state of mind one can chant the holy name of the Lord constantly.” Nevertheless, when the Lord was informed that Nityānanda Prabhu was injured by Jagāi and Mādhāi, He immediately went to the spot, angry like fire, wanting to kill them. Thus Lord Caitanya has explained His verse by the example of His own

behavior. One should tolerate insults against oneself, but when there is blasphemy committed against superiors such as other Vaiṣṇavas, one should be neither humble nor meek: one must take proper steps to counteract such blasphemy. This is the duty of a servant of a *guru* and Vaiṣṇavas. Anyone who understands the principle of eternal servitude to the *guru* and Vaiṣṇavas will appreciate the action of Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī in connection with the so-called scholar's victory over his *gurus*, Śrīla Rūpa and Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī.

Another story fabricated to defame Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī states that when Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī showed him the newly-completed manuscript of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Jīva Gosvāmī thought it would hamper his reputation as a big scholar and therefore threw it into a well. Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī was greatly shocked, according to this story, and he died immediately. Fortunately a copy of the manuscript of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* had been kept by a person named Mukunda, and therefore later it was possible to publish the book. This story is another ignominious example of blasphemy against a *guru* and Vaiṣṇava. Such a story should never be accepted as authoritative.

According to another accusation, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī did not approve of the principles of the *parakīya-rasa* of Vraja-dhāma and therefore supported *svakīya-rasa*, showing that Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are eternally married. Actually, when Jīva Gosvāmī was alive, some of his followers disliked the *parakīya-rasa* of the *gopīs*. Therefore Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, for their spiritual benefit, supported *svakīya-rasa*, for he could understand that *sahajiyās* would otherwise exploit the *parakīya-rasa*, as they are actually doing at the present time. Unfortunately, in Vṛndāvana and Navadvīpa it has become fashionable among *sahajiyās*, in their debauchery, to find an unmarried sexual partner to live with to execute so-called devotional service in *parakīya-rasa*. Foreseeing this, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī supported *svakīya-rasa*, and later all the Vaiṣṇava *ācāryas* also approved of it. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī was never opposed to the transcendental *parakīya-rasa*, nor has any other Vaiṣṇava disapproved of it. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī strictly followed his predecessor *gurus* and

Vaiṣṇavas, Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī, and Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī accepted him as one of his instructor *gurus*.

TEXT 86

mālīra icchāya śākhā bahuta bāḍila

bāḍiyā paścima deśa saba ācchādila

SYNONYMS

mālīra icchāya—on the desire of the gardener; *śākhā*—branches; *bahuta*—many; *bāḍila*—expanded; *bāḍiyā*—so expanding; *paścima*—western; *deśa*—countries; *saba*—all; *ācchādila*—covered.

TRANSLATION

By the will of the supreme gardener, the branches of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī grew many times over, expanding throughout the western countries and covering the entire region.

TEXT 87

ā-sindhunadī-tīra āra himālaya

vṛndāvana-mathurādi yata tīrtha haya

SYNONYMS

ā-sindhu-nadī—to the border of the river Sindhu; *tīra*—border; *āra*—and; *himālaya*—the Himalayan Mountains; *vṛndāvana*—Vṛndāvana; *mathurā*—Mathurā; *ādi*—heading the list; *yata*—all; *tīrtha*—places of pilgrimage; *haya*—there are.

TRANSLATION

Extending to the borders of the river Sindhu and the Himalayan Mountain valleys, these two branches expanded throughout India, including all the places of pilgrimage, such as Vṛndāvana, Mathurā and Haridvāra.

TEXT 88

dui śākhāra prema-phale sakala bhāsila

prema-phalāsvāde loka unmatta ha-ila

SYNONYMS

dui śākhāra—of the two branches; *prema-phale*—by the fruit of love of Godhead; *sakala*—all; *bhāsila*—became overflowed; *prema-phala*—the fruit of love of Godhead; *āsvāde*—by tasting; *loka*—all people; *unmatta*—maddened; *ha-ila*—became.

TRANSLATION

The fruits of love of Godhead which fructified on these two branches were distributed in abundance. Tasting these fruits, everyone became mad after them.

TEXT 89

paścimera loka saba mūḍha anācāra

tāhān pracārila donhe bhakti-sadācāra

SYNONYMS

paścimera—on the western side; *loka*—people in general; *saba*—all; *mūḍha*—less intelligent; *anācāra*—not well behaved; *tāhān*—there; *pracārila*—preached; *donhe*—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana

Gosvāmī; *bhakti*—devotional service; *sad-ācāra*—good behavior.

TRANSLATION

The people in general on the western side of India were neither intelligent nor well behaved, but by the influence of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī they were trained in devotional service and good behavior.

PURPORT

Although it is not only in western India that people were contaminated by association with Muslims, it is a fact that the farther west one goes in India the more he will find the people to be fallen from the Vedic culture. Until five thousand years ago, when the entire planet was under the control of Mahārāja Parīkṣit, the Vedic culture was current everywhere. Gradually, however, people were influenced by non-Vedic culture, and they lost sight of how to behave in connection with devotional service. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī very kindly preached the *bhakti* cult in western India, and following in their footsteps the propagators of the Caitanya cult in the Western countries are spreading the *saṅkīrtana* movement and inculcating the principles of Vaiṣṇava behavior, thus purifying and reforming many persons who were previously accustomed to the culture of *mlecchas* and *yavanas*. All of our devotees in the Western countries give up their old habits of illicit sex, intoxication, meat-eating and gambling. Of course, five hundred years ago these practices were unknown in India—at least in eastern India—but unfortunately at present all of India has been victimized by these non-Vedic principles, which are sometimes even supported by the government.

TEXT 90

śāstra-dr̥ṣṭye kaila lupta-tīrthera uddhāra

vṛndāvane kaila śrīmūrti-sevāra pracāra

SYNONYMS

śāstra-dṛṣṭye—according to the directions of revealed scriptures; *kaila*—did; *lupta*—forgotten; *tīrthera*—places of pilgrimage; *uddhāra*—excavation; *vṛndāvane*—in Vṛndāvana; *kaila*—did; *śrī-mūrti*—Deity; *sevāra*—of worship; *pracāra*—propagation.

TRANSLATION

In accordance with the directions of the revealed scriptures, both Gosvāmīs excavated the lost places of pilgrimage and inaugurated the worship of Deities in Vṛndāvana.

PURPORT

The spot where we now find Śrī Rādhā-kuṇḍa was an agricultural field during the time of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. A small reservoir of water was there, and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu bathed in that water and pointed out that originally Rādhā-kuṇḍa existed in that location. Following His directions, Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī renovated Rādhā-kuṇḍa. This is one of the brilliant examples of how the Gosvāmīs excavated lost places of pilgrimage. Similarly, it is through the endeavor of the Gosvāmīs that all the important temples in Vṛndāvana were established. Originally there were seven important Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇava temples established in Vṛndāvana, namely the Madana-mohana temple, Govinda temple, Gopīnātha temple, Śrī Rādhāramaṇa temple, Rādhā-Śyāmasundara temple, Rādhā-Dāmodara temple and Gokulānanda temple.

TEXT 91

mahāprabhura priya bhṛtya—raghunātha-dāsa

sarva tyaji' kaila prabhura pada-tale vāsa

SYNONYMS

mahāprabhura—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *priya*—very dear; *bhṛtya*—servant; *raghunātha-dāsa*—Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *sarva tyaji'*—renouncing everything; *kaila*—did; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *pada-tale*—under the shelter of the lotus feet; *vāsa*—habitation.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, the forty-sixth branch of the tree, was one of the most dear servants of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He left all his material possessions to surrender completely unto the Lord and live at His lotus feet.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī was most probably born in the year 1416 Śakābda (A.D. 1494) in a *kāyastha* family as the son of Govardhana Majumadāra, who was the younger brother of the then zamindar, Hiraṇya Majumadāra. The village where he took birth is known as Śrī-kṛṣṇapura. On the railway line between Calcutta and Burdwan is a station named Triśābaghā [now known as Ādi-saptagrāma], and about one and a half miles away is the village of Śrī-kṛṣṇapura, where the parental home of Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī was situated. A temple of Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Govinda is still there. In front of the temple is a large open area but no large hall for devotees to assemble. A rich Calcutta gentleman named Haricaraṇa Ghoṣa, who resided in the Simlā quarter, recently repaired the temple. The entire temple compound is surrounded by walls, and in a small room just to the side of the temple is a small platform on which Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī used to worship the Deity. By the side of the temple is the dying river Sarasvatī.”

The forefathers of Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī were all Vaiṣṇavas and were very rich men. His spiritual master at home was Yadunandana

Ācārya. Although Raghunātha dāsa was a family man, he had no attachment for his estate and wife. Seeing his tendency to leave home, his father and uncle engaged special bodyguards to watch over him, but nevertheless he managed to escape their vigilance and went away to Jagannātha Purī to meet Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. This incident took place in the year 1439 Śakābda (A.D. 1517). Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī compiled three books, named *Stava-mālā* (or *Stavāvalī*), *Dāna-carita* and *Muktā-carita*. He lived a long time, residing for most of his life at Rādhā-kunḍa. The place where Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī performed his devotional service still exists by Rādhā-kunḍa. He almost completely gave up eating, and therefore he was very skinny and of weak health. His only concern was to chant the holy name of the Lord. He gradually reduced his sleeping until he was almost not sleeping at all. It is said that his eyes were always full of tears. When Śrīnivāsa Ācārya went to see Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, the Gosvāmī blessed him by embracing him. Śrīnivāsa Ācārya requested his blessings for preaching in Bengal, and Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī granted them. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (186) it is stated that Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī was formerly the *gopī* named Rasa-mañjarī. Sometimes it is said that he was Rati-mañjarī.

TEXT 92

prabhu samarpila tāñre svarūpera hāte

prabhura gupta-sevā kaila svarūpera sāthe

SYNONYMS

prabhu—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *samarpila*—handed over; *tāñre*—him; *svarūpera*—Svarūpa Dāmodara; *hāte*—to the hand; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *gupta-sevā*—confidential service; *kaila*—did; *svarūpera*—Svarūpa Dāmodara; *sāthe*—with.

TRANSLATION

When Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī approached Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī, the Lord entrusted him to the care of Svarūpa Dāmodara, His secretary. Thus they both engaged in the confidential service of the Lord.

PURPORT

This confidential service was the personal care of the Lord. Svarūpa Dāmodara, acting as His secretary, attended to the Lord's baths, meals, rest and massages, and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī assisted him. In effect, Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī acted as the assistant secretary of the Lord.

TEXT 93

ṣoḍaśa vatsara kaila antaraṅga-sevana

svarūpera antardhāne āilā vṛndāvana

SYNONYMS

ṣoḍaśa—sixteen; *vatsara*—years; *kaila*—did; *antaraṅga*—confidential; *sevana*—service; *svarūpera*—of Svarūpa Dāmodara; *antardhāne*—disappearance; *āilā*—came; *vṛndāvana*—to Vṛndāvana.

TRANSLATION

He rendered confidential service to the Lord for sixteen years at Jagannātha Purī, and after the disappearance of both the Lord and Svarūpa Dāmodara, he left Jagannātha Purī and went to Vṛndāvana.

TEXT 94

vṛndāvane dui bhāira caraṇa dekhiyā

govardhane tyajiba deha bhṛgupāta kariyā

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvane—at Vṛndāvana; *dui bhāira*—the two brothers (Rūpa and Sanātana); *caraṇa*—feet; *dekhiyā*—after seeing; *govardhane*—on the hill of Govardhana; *tyajiba*—will give up; *deha*—this body; *bhṛgupāta*—falling down; *kariyā*—doing so.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī intended to go to Vṛndāvana to see the lotus feet of Rūpa and Sanātana and then give up his life by jumping from Govardhana Hill.

PURPORT

Jumping from the top of Govardhana Hill is a system of suicide especially performed by saintly persons. After the disappearance of Lord Caitanya and Svarūpa Dāmodara, Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī keenly felt separation from these two exalted personalities and therefore decided to give up his life by jumping from Govardhana Hill in Vṛndāvana. Before doing so, however, he wanted to see the lotus feet of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī.

TEXT 95

ei ta' niścaya kari' āila vṛndāvane

āsi' rūpa-sanātanera vandila caraṇe

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—thus; *niścaya kari'*—having decided; *āila*—came; *vṛndāvane*—to Vṛndāvana; *āsi'*—coming there; *rūpa-sanātanera*—of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī; *vandila*—offered respects; *caraṇe*—at the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Thus Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī came to Vṛndāvana, visited Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī and offered them his obeisances.

TEXT 96

tabe dui bhāi tāñre marite nā dila

nija tṛtīya bhāi kari' nikaṭe rākhila

SYNONYMS

tabe—at that time; *dui bhāi*—the two brothers (Śrīla Rūpa and Sanātana); *tāñre*—him; *marite*—to die; *nā dila*—did not allow; *nija*—own; *tṛtīya*—third; *bhāi*—brother; *kari'*—accepting; *nikaṭe*—near; *rākhila*—kept him.

TRANSLATION

These two brothers, however, did not allow him to die. They accepted him as their third brother and kept him in their company.

TEXT 97

mahāprabhura līlā yata bāhira-antara

dui bhāi tāñra mukhe śune nirantara

SYNONYMS

mahāprabhura—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *līlā*—pastimes; *yata*—all; *bāhira*—external; *antara*—internal; *dui bhāi*—the two brothers; *tāñra*—his; *mukhe*—in the mouth; *śune*—hear; *nirantara*—always.

TRANSLATION

Because Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī was an assistant to Svarūpa Dāmodara, he knew much about the external and internal features of the pastimes of Lord Caitanya. Thus the two brothers Rūpa and Sanātana always used to hear of this from him.

TEXT 98

anna-jala tyāga kaila anya-kathana

pala dui-tina māṭhā karena bhakṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

anna-jala—food and drink; *tyāga*—renunciation; *kaila*—did; *anya-kathana*—talking of other things; *pala dui-tina*—a few drops of; *māṭhā*—sour milk; *karena*—does; *bhakṣaṇa*—eat.

TRANSLATION

Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī gradually gave up all food and drink but a few drops of buttermilk.

TEXT 99

sahasra daṇḍavat kare, laya lakṣa nāma

dui sahasra vaiṣṇavere nitya paraṇāma

SYNONYMS

sahasra—thousand; *daṇḍavat*—obeisances; *kare*—does; *laya*—takes; *lakṣa*—one hundred thousand; *nāma*—holy names; *dui*—two; *sahasra*—thousand; *vaiṣṇavere*—unto the devotees; *nitya*—daily; *paraṇāma*—

obeisances.

TRANSLATION

As a daily duty, he regularly offered one thousand obeisances to the Lord, chanted at least one hundred thousand holy names and offered obeisances to two thousand Vaiṣṇavas.

TEXT 100

rātri-dīne rādhā-kṛṣṇera mānasa sevana

prahareka mahāprabhura caritra-kathana

SYNONYMS

rātri-dīne—day and night; *rādhā-kṛṣṇera*—of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa; *mānasa*—within the mind; *sevana*—service; *prahareka*—about three hours; *mahāprabhura*—of Lord Caitanya; *caritra*—character; *kathana*—discussing.

TRANSLATION

Day and night he rendered service within his mind to Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, and for three hours a day he discoursed about the character of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

We have many things to learn about *bhajana*, or worship of the Lord, by following in the footsteps of Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. All the Gosvāmīs engaged in such transcendental activities, as described by Śrīnivāsa Ācārya in his poem about them (*kṛṣṇotkīrtana-gāna-nartana-parau premāmṛtāmbho-nidhī*). Following in the footsteps of Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī, one has to execute

devotional service very strictly, specifically by chanting the holy name of the Lord.

TEXT 101

tina sandhyā rādhā-kuṇḍe apatita snāna

vraja-vāsī vaiṣṇave kare ālīṅgana māna

SYNONYMS

tina sandhyā—three times, namely morning, evening and noon; *rādhā-kuṇḍe*—in the lake of Rādhā-kuṇḍa; *apatita*—without failure; *snāna*—taking bath; *vraja-vāsī*—inhabitants of Vrajabhūmi; *vaiṣṇave*—all devotees; *kare*—does; *ālīṅgana*—embracing; *māna*—and offering respect.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī took three baths daily in the Rādhā-kuṇḍa lake. As soon as he found a Vaiṣṇava residing in Vṛndāvana, he would embrace him and give him all respect.

TEXT 102

sārdha sapta-prahara kare bhaktira sādhanē

cāri daṇḍa nidrā, seha nahe kona-dine

SYNONYMS

sārdha—one and a half hours; *sapta-prahara*—seven *praharas* (twenty-one hours); *kare*—does; *bhaktira*—of devotional service; *sādhanē*—in execution; *cāri daṇḍa*—about two hours; *nidrā*—sleeping; *seha*—that also; *nahe*—not; *kona-dine*—some days.

TRANSLATION

He engaged himself in devotional service for more than twenty-two and a half hours a day, and for less than two hours he slept, although on some days that also was not possible.

TEXT 103

tāñhāra sādhana-rīti śunite camatkāra

sei rūpa-raghunātha prabhu ye āmāra

SYNONYMS

tāñhāra—his; *sādhana-rīti*—process of devotional service; *śunite*—to hear; *camatkāra*—wonderful; *sei*—that; *rūpa*—Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *prabhu*—lord; *ye*—that; *āmāra*—my.

TRANSLATION

I am struck with wonder when I hear about the devotional service he executed. I accept Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī as my guides.

PURPORT

Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī accepted Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī as his special guide. Therefore at the end of every chapter he says, *śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa*. Sometimes it is misunderstood that by using the word *raghunātha* he wanted to offer his respectful obeisances to Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, for it is sometimes stated that Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī was his initiating spiritual master. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī does not approve of this statement; he does not accept Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa

Gosvāmī as the spiritual master of Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TEXT 104

inhā-sabāra yaiche haila prabhura milana

āge vistāriyā tāhā kariba varṇana

SYNONYMS

inhā—of them; *sabāra*—all; *yaiche*—as; *haila*—became; *prabhura*—of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *milana*—meeting; *āge*—later on; *vistāriyā*—expanding; *tāhā*—that; *kariba*—I shall do; *varṇana*—description.

TRANSLATION

I shall later explain very elaborately how all these devotees met Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 105

śrī-gopāla bhaṭṭa eka śākhā sarvottama

rūpa-sanātana-saṅge yāñra prema-ālāpana

SYNONYMS

śrī-gopāla bhaṭṭa—Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa; *eka*—one; *śākhā*—branch; *sarva-uttama*—very exalted; *rūpa*—Rūpa; *sanātana*—Sanātana; *saṅge*—company; *yāñra*—whose; *prema*—love of Godhead; *ālāpana*—discussion.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, the forty-seventh branch, was one of the great and exalted branches of the tree. He always engaged in discourses

about love of Godhead in the company of Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī.

PURPORT

Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī was the son of Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa, a resident of Śrī Raṅgam. Gopāla Bhaṭṭa formerly belonged to the disciplic succession of the Rāmānuja-sampradāya but later became part of the Gauḍīya-sampradāya. In the year 1433 Śakābda (A.D. 1511), when Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was touring South India, He stayed for four months during the period of Cāturmāsya at the house of Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa, who then got the opportunity to serve the Lord to his heart's content. Gopāla Bhaṭṭa also got the opportunity to serve the Lord at this time. Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī was later initiated by his uncle, the great *sannyāsī* Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī. Both the father and the mother of Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī were extremely fortunate, for they dedicated their entire lives to the service of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. They allowed Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī to go to Vṛndāvana, and they gave up their lives thinking of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. When Lord Caitanya was later informed that Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī had gone to Vṛndāvana and met Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana Gosvāmī, He was very pleased, and He advised Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana to accept Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī as their younger brother and take care of him. Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī, out of his great affection for Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, compiled the Vaiṣṇava *smṛti* named *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* and published it under his name. Under the instruction of Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī installed one of the seven principal Deities of Vṛndāvana, the Rādhāramaṇa Deity. The *sevaits* (priests) of the Rādhāramaṇa temple belong to the Gauḍīya-sampradāya.

When Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī took permission from all the Vaiṣṇavas before writing *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī also gave him his blessings, but he requested him not to mention his name in the book. Therefore Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī has mentioned Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī only very cautiously in one or two passages of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī has written in the

beginning of his *Tattva-sandarbha*, “A devotee from southern India who was born of a *brāhmaṇa* family and was a very intimate friend of Rūpa Gosvāmī and Sanātana Gosvāmī has written a book that he has not compiled chronologically. Therefore I, a tiny living entity known as *jīva*, am trying to assort the events of the book chronologically, consulting the direction of great personalities like Madhvācārya, Śrīdhara Svāmī, Rāmānujācārya and other senior Vaiṣṇavas in the disciplic succession.” In the beginning of the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* there are similar statements by Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī. Śrīla Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī compiled a book called *Sat-kriyā-sāra-dīpikā*, edited the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, wrote a foreword to the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha* and a commentary on the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*, and installed the Rādhāramaṇa Deity in Vṛndāvana. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (184) it is mentioned that his previous name in the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa was Anaṅga-mañjarī. Sometimes he is also said to have been an incarnation of Guṇa-mañjarī. Śrīnivāsa Ācārya and Gopīnātha Pūjārī were two of his disciples.

TEXT 106

śaṅkarāraṇya—ācārya-vṛkṣera eka śākhā

mukunda, kāśīnātha, rudra—upaśākhā lekhā

SYNONYMS

śaṅkarāraṇya—Śaṅkarāraṇya; *ācārya-vṛkṣera*—of the tree of *ācāryas*; *eka*—one; *śākhā*—branch; *mukunda*—Mukunda; *kāśīnātha*—Kāśīnātha; *rudra*—Rudra; *upaśākhā lekhā*—they are known as subbranches.

TRANSLATION

The ācārya Śaṅkarāraṇya was considered the forty-eighth branch of the original tree. From him proceeded the subbranches known as Mukunda, Kāśīnātha and Rudra.

PURPORT

It is said that Śaṅkarāraṇya was the *sannyāsa* name of Śrīla Viśvarūpa, who was the elder brother of Viśvambhara (the original name of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu). Śaṅkarāraṇya expired in 1432 Śakābda (A.D. 1510) at Sholapur, where there is a place of pilgrimage known as Pāṇḍarapura. This is referred to in the *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Nine, verses 299 and 300.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu opened a primary school in the house of Mukunda, or Mukunda Sañjaya, and Mukunda’s son, whose name was Puruṣottama, became the Lord’s student. Kāśīnātha arranged the marriage of Lord Caitanya in His previous *āśrama*, when His name was Viśvambhara. Kāśīnātha induced the court *paṇḍita*, Sanātana, to offer Viśvambhara his daughter. In text 50 of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* it is mentioned that Kāśīnātha was an incarnation of the *brāhmaṇa* Kulaka, whom Satrājīta sent to arrange the marriage of Kṛṣṇa and Satyabhāmā, and in text 135 it is mentioned that Rudra, or Śrī Rudrarāma Paṇḍita, was formerly a friend of Lord Kṛṣṇa’s named Varūthapa. Śrī Rudrarāma Paṇḍita constructed a big temple at Vallabhapura, which is one mile north of Māheśa, for the Deities named Rādhāvallabha. The descendants of his brother, Yadunandana Vandyopādhyāya, are known as Cakravartī Ṭhākuras, and they are in charge of the maintenance of this temple as *sevaits*. Formerly the Jagannātha Deity used to come to the temple of Rādhāvallabha from Māheśa during the Ratha-yātrā festival, but in the Bengali year 1262 [A.D. 1855], due to a misunderstanding between the priests of the two temples, the Jagannātha Deity stopped coming.”

TEXT 107

śrīnātha paṇḍita—prabhura kṛpāra bhājana

yāñra kṛṣṇa-sevā dekhi’ vaśa tri-bhuvana

SYNONYMS

śrīnātha paṇḍita—Śrīnātha Paṇḍita; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *kṛpāra*—of mercy; *bhājana*—receiver; *yānira*—whose; *kṛṣṇa-sevā*—worship of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dekhi*—seeing; *vaśa*—subjugated; *tri-bhuvana*—all the three worlds.

TRANSLATION

Śrīnātha Paṇḍita, the forty-ninth branch, was the beloved recipient of all the mercy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Everyone in the three worlds was astonished to see how he worshiped Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “About one and a half miles away from Kumārahaṭṭa, or Kāmarhaṭṭa, which is a few miles from Calcutta, is a village known as Kāñcaḍāpāḍā, which was the home of Śrī Śivānanda Sena. There he constructed a temple of Śrī Gauragopāla. Śrīnātha Paṇḍita established another temple there with Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa *mūrtis*. The Deity of that temple is named Śrī Kṛṣṇa Rāya. The temple of Kṛṣṇa Rāya, which was constructed in the year 1708 Śakābda [A.D. 1786] by a prominent zamindar named Nimāi Mullik of Pāthuriyā-ghāṭa in Calcutta, is very large. There is a big courtyard in front of the temple, and there are residential quarters for visitors and good arrangements for cooking *prasādam*. The entire courtyard is surrounded by very high boundary walls, and the temple is almost as big as the Māheśa temple. Inscribed on a tablet are the names of Śrīnātha Paṇḍita and his father and grandfather and the date of construction of the temple. Śrīnātha Paṇḍita, one of the disciples of Advaita Prabhu, was the spiritual master of the third son of Śivānanda Sena, who was known as Paramānanda Kavi-karṇapūra. It is said that the Kṛṣṇa Rāya Deity was installed during the time of Kavi-karṇapūra. According to hearsay, Vīrabhadra Prabhu, the son of Nityānanda Prabhu, brought a big stone from Murśīdābād from which three Deities were

carved—namely, the Rādhāvallabha *vigraha* of Vallabhapura, the Śyāmasundara *vigraha* of Khaḍadaha and the Śrī Kṛṣṇa Rāya *vigraha* of Kāñcāḍāpāḍā. The home of Śivānanda Sena was situated on the bank of the Ganges near an almost ruined temple. It is said that the same Nimāi Mullik of Calcutta saw this broken-down temple of Kṛṣṇa Rāya while he was going to Benares and thereafter constructed the present temple.”

TEXT 108

jagannātha ācārya prabhura priya dāsa

prabhura ājñāte teṇho kaila gaṅgā-vāsa

SYNONYMS

jagannātha ācārya—Jagannātha Ācārya; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *priya dāsa*—very dear servant; *prabhura ājñāte*—by the order of the Lord; *teṇho*—he; *kaila*—agreed; *gaṅgā-vāsa*—living on the bank of the Ganges.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Ācārya, the fiftieth branch of the Caitanya tree, was an extremely dear servant of the Lord, by whose order he decided to live on the bank of the Ganges.

PURPORT

Jagannātha Ācārya is stated in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (111) to have formerly been Durvāsā of Nidhuvana.

TEXT 109

kṛṣṇadāsa vaidya, āra paṇḍita-śekhara

kavicandra, āra kīrtanīyā ṣaṣṭhīvara

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇadāsa vaidya—Kṛṣṇadāsa Vaidya; *āra*—and; *paṇḍita-śekhara*—Paṇḍita Śekhara; *kavicandra*—Kavicandra; *āra*—and; *kīrtanīyā*—*kīrtana* performer; *ṣaṣṭhīvara*—Ṣaṣṭhīvara.

TRANSLATION

The fifty-first branch of the Caitanya tree was Kṛṣṇadāsa Vaidya, the fifty-second was Paṇḍita Śekhara, the fifty-third was Kavicandra, and the fifty-fourth was Ṣaṣṭhīvara, who was a great saṅkīrtana performer.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (171) it is mentioned that Śrīnātha Miśra was Citrāṅgī and that Kavicandra was Manoharā-gopī.

TEXT 110

śrīnātha miśra, śubhānanda, śrīrāma, īśāna

śrīnidhi, śrīgopīkānta, miśra bhagavān

SYNONYMS

śrīnātha miśra—Śrīnātha Miśra; *śubhānanda*—Śubhānanda; *śrīrāma*—Śrīrāma; *īśāna*—Īśāna; *śrīnidhi*—Śrīnidhi; *śrī-gopīkānta*—Śrī Gopīkānta; *miśra bhagavān*—Miśra Bhagavān.

TRANSLATION

The fifty-fifth branch was Śrīnātha Miśra, the fifty-sixth was Śubhānanda, the fifty-seventh was Śrīrāma, the fifty-eighth was Īśāna,

the fifty-ninth was Śrīnidhi, the sixtieth was Śrī Gopikānta, and the sixty-first was Miśra Bhagavān.

PURPORT

Śubhānanda, who formerly lived in Vṛndāvana as Mālatī, was one of the *kīrtana* performers who danced in front of the Ratha-yātrā car during the Jagannātha festival. It is said that he ate the foam that came out of the mouth of the Lord while He danced before the Ratha-yātrā car. Īśāna was the personal servant of Śrīmatī Śacīdevī, who showered her great mercy upon him. He was also very dear to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 111

subuddhi miśra, hṛdayānanda, kamala-nayana

maheśa paṇḍita, śrīkara, śrī-madhusūdana

SYNONYMS

subuddhi miśra—Subuddhi Miśra; *hṛdayānanda*—Hṛdayānanda; *kamala-nayana*—Kamala-nayana; *maheśa paṇḍita*—Maheśa Paṇḍita; *śrīkara*—Śrīkara; *śrī-madhusūdana*—Śrī Madhusūdana.

TRANSLATION

The sixty-second branch of the tree was Subuddhi Miśra, the sixty-third was Hṛdayānanda, the sixty-fourth was Kamala-nayana, the sixty-fifth was Maheśa Paṇḍita, the sixty-sixth was Śrīkara, and the sixty-seventh was Śrī Madhusūdana.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Subuddhi Miśra, who was formerly Guṇacūḍā in Vṛndāvana, installed

Gaura-Nityānanda Deities in a temple in the village known as Belagān, which is about three miles away from Śrīkhaṇḍa. His present descendant is known as Govindacandra Gosvāmī.”

TEXT 112

puruṣottama, śrī-gālīma, jagannātha-dāsa

śrī-candraśekhara vaidya, dvija haridāsa

SYNONYMS

puruṣottama—Puruṣottama; *śrī-gālīma*—Śrī Gālīma; *jagannātha-dāsa*—Jagannātha dāsa; *śrī-candraśekhara vaidya*—Śrī Candraśekhara Vaidya; *dvija haridāsa*—Dvija Haridāsa.

TRANSLATION

The sixty-eighth branch of the original tree was Puruṣottama, the sixty-ninth was Śrī Gālīma, the seventieth was Jagannātha dāsa, the seventy-first was Śrī Candraśekhara Vaidya, and the seventy-second was Dvija Haridāsa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “There is some question about whether Dvija Haridāsa was the author of *Aṣṭottara-śata-nāma*. He had two sons, named Śrīdāma and Gokulānanda, who were disciples of Śrī Advaita Ācārya. Their village, Kāñcana-gaḍiyā, is situated within five miles of the Bājārasāu station, the fifth station from Ājīmagañja in the district of Mursīdābād [in West Bengal].”

TEXT 113

rāmadāsa, kavicandra, śrī-gopāladāsa

bhāgavatācārya, ṭhākura sāraṅgadāsa

SYNONYMS

rāmadāsa—Rāmadāsa; *kavicaṇḍra*—Kavicaṇḍra; *śrī gopāla-dāsa*—Śrī Gopāla dāsa; *bhāgavatācārya*—Bhāgavata Ācārya; *ṭhākura sāraṅga-dāsa*—Ṭhākura Sāraṅga dāsa.

TRANSLATION

The seventy-third branch of the original tree was Rāmadāsa, the seventy-fourth was Kavicaṇḍra, the seventy-fifth was Śrī Gopāla dāsa, the seventy-sixth was Bhāgavata Ācārya, and the seventy-seventh was Ṭhākura Sāraṅga dāsa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (203) it is said, ‘Bhāgavata Ācārya compiled a book entitled *Kṛṣṇa-prema-taraṅgiṇī*, and he was the most beloved devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.’ When Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu visited Varāhanagara, now a suburb of Calcutta, He stayed in the house of a most fortunate *brāhmaṇa* who was a very learned scholar in *Bhāgavata* literature. As soon as this *brāhmaṇa* saw Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he began to read *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. When Mahāprabhu heard his explanation, which expounded *bhakti-yoga*, He immediately became unconscious in ecstasy. Lord Caitanya later said, ‘I have never heard such a nice explanation of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. I therefore designate you Bhāgavata Ācārya. Your only duty is to recite *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. That is My injunction.’ His real name was Raghunātha. His monastery, which is situated in Varāhanagara, about three and a half miles north of Calcutta on the bank of the Ganges, still exists, and it is managed by the initiated disciples of the late Śrī Rāmadāsa Bābājī. Presently, however, it is not as well managed as in the presence of Bābājī Mahārāja.

“Another name of Ṭhākura Sāraṅga dāsa was Śārṅga Ṭhākura. Sometimes he was also called Śārṅgapāṇi or Śārṅgadhara. He was a resident of Navadvīpa in the neighborhood known as Modadruma-dvīpa, and he used to worship the Supreme Lord in a secluded place on the bank of the Ganges. He was not accepting disciples, but he was repeatedly being inspired from within by the Supreme Personality of Godhead to do so. Thus one morning he decided, ‘Whomever I see I shall make my disciple.’ When he went to the bank of the Ganges to take his bath, by chance he saw a dead body floating in the water, and he touched it with his feet. This immediately brought the body to life, and Ṭhākura Sāraṅga dāsa accepted him as his disciple. This disciple later became famous as Ṭhākura Murāri, and his name is always associated with that of Śrī Sāraṅga. His disciplic succession still inhabits the village of Śar. There is a temple at Māmagāchi that is said to have been started by Sāraṅga Ṭhākura. Not long ago, a new temple building was erected in front of a *bakula* tree there, and it is now being managed by the members of the Gauḍīya Maṭha. It is said that the management of the temple is now far better than before. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (172) it is stated that Sāraṅga Ṭhākura was formerly a *gopī* named Nāndīmukhī. Some devotees say that he was formerly Prahlāda Mahārāja, but Śrī Kavi-karṇapūra says that his father, Śivānanda Sena, does not accept this proposition.”

TEXT 114

jagannātha tīrtha, vipra śrī-jānakīnātha

gopāla ācārya, āra vipra vāṇīnātha

SYNONYMS

jagannātha tīrtha—Jagannātha Tīrtha; *vipra-śrī-jānakīnātha*—the *brāhmaṇa* of the name Śrī Jānakīnātha; *gopāla ācārya*—Gopāla Ācārya; *āra*—and; *vipra vāṇīnātha*—the *brāhmaṇa* of the name Vāṇīnātha.

TRANSLATION

The seventy-eighth branch of the original tree was Jagannātha Tīrtha, the seventy-ninth was the brāhmaṇa Śrī Jānakīnātha, the eightieth was Gopāla Ācārya, and the eighty-first was the brāhmaṇa Vāṇīnātha.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Jagannātha Tīrtha was one of the nine principal *sannyāsīs* who were Lord Caitanya’s associates. Vāṇīnātha Vipra was a resident of Cāṇpāhāṭi, a village in the district of Burdwan near the town of Navadvīpa, the police station of Pūrvasthalī and the post office of Samudragāḍa. The temple there was very much neglected, but it was renovated in the Bengali year 1328 [A.D. 1921] by Śrī Paramānanda Brahmācārī [one of Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura’s disciples], who reorganized the *sevā-pūjā* (worship in the temple) and placed the temple under the management of the Śrī Caitanya Maṭha of Śrī Māyāpur. In the temple as it now exists, the Deity of Śrī Gaura-Gadādhara is worshiped strictly according to the principles of the revealed scriptures. Cāṇpāhāṭi is two miles away from both Samudragarh and the Navadvīpa station of the eastern railway.”

TEXT 115

govinda, mādharma, vāsudeva—tina bhāi

yān-sabāra kīrtane nāce caitanya-nitāi

SYNONYMS

govinda—Govinda; *mādhava*—Mādhava; *vāsudeva*—Vāsudeva; *tina bhāi*—three brothers; *yān-sabāra*—all of whom; *kīrtane*—in the performance of *saṅkīrtana*; *nāce*—dance; *caitanya-nitāi*—Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

The three brothers Govinda, Mādhava and Vāsudeva were the eighty-second, eighty-third and eighty-fourth branches of the tree. Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda used to dance in their kīrtana performances.

PURPORT

The three brothers Govinda, Mādhava and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa all belonged to a *kāyastha* family. Govinda established the Gopīnātha temple in Agradvīpa, where he resided. Mādhava Ghoṣa was expert in performing *kīrtana*. No one within this world could compete with him. He was known as the singer of Vṛndāvana and was very dear to Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. It is said that when the three brothers performed *saṅkīrtana*, immediately Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda would dance in ecstasy. According to the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (188), the three brothers were formerly Kalāvātī, Rasollāsā and Guṇatuṅgā, who recited the songs composed by Śrī Viśākhā-gopī. The three brothers were among one of the seven parties that performed *kīrtana* when Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu attended the Ratha-yātrā festival at Jagannātha Purī. Vakreśvara Paṇḍita was the chief dancer in their party. This is vividly described in the *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Thirteen, verses 42 and 43.

TEXT 116

rāmadāsa abhirāma—sakhya-premarāśī

ṣolasāṅgera kāṣṭha tuli' ye karila vāñṣī

SYNONYMS

rāmadāsa abhirāma—Rāmadāsa Abhirāma; *sakhya-prema*—friendship; *rāśī*—great volume; *ṣolasa-aṅgera*—of sixteen knots; *kāṣṭha*—wood; *tuli'*—lifting; *ye*—one who; *karila*—made; *vāñṣī*—flute.

TRANSLATION

Rāmadāsa Abhirāma was fully absorbed in the mellow of friendship. He made a flute of a bamboo stick with sixteen knots.

PURPORT

Abhirāma was an inhabitant of Khānākula-kṛṣṇa-nagara.

TEXT 117

prabhura ājñāya nityānanda gauḍe calilā

tāñra sañge tina-jana prabhu-ājñāya āilā

SYNONYMS

prabhura ājñāya—under the order of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *gauḍe*—to Bengal; *calilā*—went back; *tāñra sañge*—in His company; *tina jana*—three men; *prabhu-ājñāya*—under the order of the Lord; *āilā*—went.

TRANSLATION

By the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, three devotees accompanied Lord Nityānanda Prabhu when He returned to Bengal to preach.

TEXT 118

rāmadāsa, mādhaba, āra vāsudeva ghoṣa

prabhu-saṅge rahe govinda pāiyā santoṣa

SYNONYMS

rāmadāsa—Rāmadāsa; *mādhaba*—Mādhava; *āra*—and; *vāsudeva ghoṣa*—Vāsudeva Ghoṣa; *prabhu-saṅge*—in the company of Lord Caitanya

Mahāprabhu; *rahe*—remained; *govinda*—Govinda; *pāiyā*—feeling; *santoṣa*—great satisfaction.

TRANSLATION

These three were Rāmadāsa, Mādhava Ghoṣa and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa. Govinda Ghoṣa, however, remained with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī and thus felt great satisfaction.

TEXT 119

bhāgavatācārya, cirañjīva śrī-raghunandana

mādhavācārya, kamalākānta, śrī-yadunandana

SYNONYMS

bhāgavatācārya—Bhāgavata Ācārya; *cirañjīva*—Cirañjīva; *śrī-raghunandana*—Śrī Raghunandana; *mādhavācārya*—Mādhavācārya; *kamalākānta*—Kamalākānta; *śrī-yadunandana*—Śrī Yadunandana.

TRANSLATION

Bhāgavata Ācārya, Cirañjīva, Śrī Raghunandana, Mādhavācārya, Kamalākānta and Śrī Yadunandana were all among the branches of the Caitanya tree.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Śrī Mādhavācārya was the husband of Lord Nityānanda’s daughter, Gaṅgādevī. He took initiation from Puruṣottama, a branch of Nityānanda Prabhu. It is said that when Nityānanda Prabhu’s daughter married Mādhavācārya, the Lord gave him the village named Pāñjinagara as a dowry. Mādhavācārya’s temple is situated near the Jīrāṭ railway station

on the eastern railway. According to the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (169), Śrī Mādhavācārya was formerly the *gopī* named Mādhavī. Kamalākānta belonged to the branch of Śrī Advaita Prabhu. His full name was Kamalākānta Viśvāsa.”

TEXT 120

mahā-kṛpā-pātra prabhura jagāi, mādhai

‘patita-pāvana’ nāmera sākṣī dui bhāi

SYNONYMS

mahā-kṛpā-pātra—object of very great mercy; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *jagāi mādhai*—the two brothers Jagāi and Mādhai; *patita-pāvana*—deliverer of the fallen; *nāmera*—of this name; *sākṣī*—witness; *dui bhāi*—these two brothers.

TRANSLATION

Jagāi and Mādhai, the eighty-ninth and ninetieth branches of the tree, were the greatest recipients of Lord Caitanya’s mercy. These two brothers were the witnesses who proved that Lord Caitanya was rightly named Patita-pāvana, “the deliverer of the fallen souls.”

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (115) it is said that the two brothers Jagāi and Mādhai were formerly the doorkeepers named Jaya and Vijaya, who later became Hiraṇyākṣa and Hiraṇyakaśipu. Jagāi and Mādhai were born in respectable *brāhmaṇa* families, but they adopted the professions of thieves and rogues and thus became implicated in all kinds of undesirable activities, especially woman-hunting, intoxication and gambling. Later, by the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, they were initiated, and they got the chance to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-*

mantra. As a result of chanting, both brothers became exalted devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The descendants of Mādhāi still exist, and they are respectable *brāhmaṇas*. The tombs of these two brothers, Jagāi and Mādhāi, are in a place known as Ghoṣahāṭa, or Mādhāitalā-grāma, which is situated about one mile south of Katwa. It is said that Śrī Gopīcaraṇa dāsa Bābājī established a temple of Nitāi-Gaura at this place about two hundred fifty years ago.

TEXT 121

gauḍa-deśa-bhaktera kaila saṅkṣepa kathana

ananta caitanya-bhakta nā yāya gaṇana

SYNONYMS

gauḍa-deśa—in Bengal; *bhaktera*—of the devotees; *kaila*—I have described; *saṅkṣepa*—in brief; *kathana*—narration; *ananta*—unlimited; *caitanya-bhakta*—devotees of Lord Caitanya; *nā*—not; *yāya*—can be; *gaṇana*—counted.

TRANSLATION

I have given a brief description of the devotees of Lord Caitanya in Bengal. Actually His devotees are innumerable.

TEXT 122

nīlācale ei saba bhakta prabhu-saṅge

dui sthāne prabhu-sevā kaila nānā-raṅge

SYNONYMS

nīlācale—at Jagannātha Purī; *ei*—these; *saba*—all; *bhakta*—devotees;

prabhu-saṅge—in the company of Lord Caitanya; *dui sthāne*—in two places; *prabhu-sevā*—service of the Lord; *kaila*—executed; *nānā-raṅge*—in different ways.

TRANSLATION

I have especially mentioned all these devotees because they accompanied Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in Bengal and Orissa and served Him in many ways.

PURPORT

Most of the devotees of Lord Caitanya lived in Bengal and Orissa. Thus they are celebrated as Gauḍīyas and Oriyās. At present, however, by the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, His cult is being propagated all over the world, and it is most probable that in the future history of Lord Caitanya's movement, Europeans, Americans, Canadians, Australians, South Americans, Asians and people from all over the world will be celebrated as devotees of Lord Caitanya. The International Society for Krishna Consciousness has already constructed a big temple at Māyāpur, Navadvīpa, which is being visited by devotees from all parts of the world, as foretold by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and anticipated by Śrī Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura.

TEXT 123

kevala nīlācale prabhura ye ye bhakta-gaṇa

saṅkṣepe kariye kichu se saba kathana

SYNONYMS

kevala—only; *nīlācale*—in Jagannātha Purī; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *ye ye*—all those; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *saṅkṣepe*—in brief; *kariye*—I do; *kichu*—some; *se saba*—all those; *kathana*—narration.

TRANSLATION

Let me briefly describe some of the devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in Jagannātha Purī.

TEXTS 124–126

nīlācale prabhu-saṅge yata bhakta-gaṇa

sabāra adhyakṣa prabhura marma dui-jana

paramānanda-purī, āra svarūpa-dāmodara

gadādhara, jagadānanda, śaṅkara, vakreśvara

dāmodara paṇḍita, ṭhākura haridāsa

raghunātha vaidya, āra raghunātha-dāsa

SYNONYMS

nīlācale—in Jagannātha Purī; *prabhu-saṅge*—in the company of Lord Caitanya; *yata*—all; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *sabāra*—of all of them; *adhyakṣa*—the chief; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *marma*—heart and soul; *dui jana*—two persons; *paramānanda-purī*—Paramānanda Purī; *āra*—and; *svarūpa-dāmodara*—Svarūpa Dāmodara; *gadādhara*—Gadādhara; *jagadānanda*—Jagadānanda; *śaṅkara*—Śaṅkara; *vakreśvara*—Vakreśvara; *dāmodara paṇḍita*—Dāmodara Paṇḍita; *ṭhākura haridāsa*—Ṭhākura Haridāsa; *raghunātha vaidya*—Raghunātha Vaidya; *āra*—and; *raghunātha-dāsa*—Raghunātha dāsa.

TRANSLATION

Among the devotees who accompanied the Lord in Jagannātha Purī, two of them—Paramānanda Purī and Svarūpa Dāmodara—were the heart

and soul of the Lord. Among the other devotees were Gadādhara, Jagadānanda, Śaṅkara, Vakreśvara, Dāmodara Paṇḍita, Ṭhākura Haridāsa, Raghunātha Vaidya and Raghunātha dāsa.

PURPORT

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Five, states that Raghunātha Vaidya came to see Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu when the Lord was staying at Pāṇihāṭī. He was a great devotee and had all good qualities. According to the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, he was formerly Revatī, the wife of Balarāma. Anyone he glanced upon would immediately attain Kṛṣṇa consciousness. He lived on the seashore at Jagannātha Purī and compiled a book of the name *Sthāna-nirūpaṇa*.

TEXT 127

ityādika pūrva-saṅgī baḍa bhakta-gaṇa

nīlācale rahi' kare prabhura sevana

SYNONYMS

iti-ādika—all these and others; *pūrva-saṅgī*—former associates; *baḍa*—very; *bhakta-gaṇa*—great devotees; *nīlācale*—at Jagannātha Purī; *rahi'*—remaining; *kare*—do; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *sevana*—service.

TRANSLATION

All these devotees were associates of the Lord from the very beginning, and when the Lord took up residence in Jagannātha Purī, they remained there to serve Him faithfully.

TEXT 128

āra yata bhakta-gaṇa gauḍa-deśa-vāsī

pratyabde prabhure dekhe nīlācale āśi'

SYNONYMS

āra—others; *yata*—all; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *gauḍa-deśa-vāsī*—residents of Bengal; *prati-abde*—each year; *prabhure*—the Lord; *dekhe*—see; *nīlācale*—in Jagannātha Purī; *āśi'*—coming there.

TRANSLATION

All the devotees who resided in Bengal used to visit Jagannātha Purī every year to see the Lord.

TEXT 129

nīlācale prabhu-saha prathama milana

sei bhakta-gaṇera ebe kariye gaṇana

SYNONYMS

nīlācale—at Jagannātha Purī; *prabhu-saha*—with the Lord; *prathama*—first; *milana*—meeting; *sei*—that; *bhakta-gaṇera*—of the devotees; *ebe*—now; *kariye*—I do; *gaṇana*—count.

TRANSLATION

Now let me enumerate the devotees of Bengal who first came to see the Lord at Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 130

baḍa-sākhā eka,——sārvabhauma bhāṭṭācārya

tānra bhagnī-pati śrī-gopīnāthācārya

SYNONYMS

baḍa-sākhā eka—one of the biggest branches; *sārvabhauma bhaṭṭācārya*—Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya; *tāñra bhagnī-patī*—his brother-in-law (the husband of Sārvabhauma's sister); *śrī-gopīnāthācārya*—Śrī Gopīnātha Ācārya.

TRANSLATION

There was Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya, one of the biggest branches of the tree of the Lord, and his sister's husband, Śrī Gopīnātha Ācārya.

PURPORT

The original name of Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya was Vāsudeva Bhaṭṭācārya. His place of birth, which is known as Vidyānagara, is about two and a half miles away from the Navadvīpa railway station, or Cāñpāhāṭi railway station. His father was a very much celebrated man of the name Maheśvara Viśārada. It is said that Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya was the greatest logician of his time in India. At Mithilā, in Bihar, he became a student of a great professor named Pakṣadhara Miśra, who did not allow any student to note down his explanations of logic. Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya was so talented, however, that he learned the explanations by heart, and when he later returned to Navadvīpa he established a school for the study of logic, thus diminishing the importance of Mithilā. Students from various parts of India still come to Navadvīpa to study logic. According to some authoritative opinions, the celebrated logician Raghunātha Śiromaṇi was also a student of Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya's. In effect, Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya became the leader of all students of logic. Although he was a *grhastha* (householder), he even taught many *sannyāsīs* in the knowledge of logic.

He started a school at Jagannātha Purī for the study of Vedānta philosophy, of which he was a great scholar. When Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya met Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he advised the Lord to learn

Vedānta philosophy from him, but later he became a student of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to understand the real meaning of Vedānta. Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya was so fortunate as to see the six-armed form of Lord Caitanya known as Ṣaḍbhuja. A Ṣaḍbhuja Deity is still situated at one end of the Jagannātha temple. Daily *saṅkīrtana* performances take place in this part of the temple. The meeting of Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya with Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is vividly described in *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Six. Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya wrote a book of one hundred verses named *Caitanya-śataka* or *Suśloka-śataka*. Two other verses he wrote, beginning with the words *vairāgya-vidyā-nija-bhakti-yoga* [Cc. Madya 6.254] and *kālān naṣṭam bhakti-yogam nijam yaḥ*, are very famous among Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (119) states that Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya was an incarnation of Bṛhaspati, the learned scholar from the celestial planets.

Gopīnātha Ācārya, who belonged to a respectable *brāhmaṇa* family, was also an inhabitant of Navadvīpa and a constant companion of the Lord. He was the husband of Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya's sister. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (178) it is described that he was formerly the *gopī* named Ratnāvalī. According to the opinion of others, he was an incarnation of Brahmā.

TEXT 131

kāśī-miśra, pradyumna-miśra, rāya bhavānanda

yāñhāra milane prabhu pāilā ānanda

SYNONYMS

kāśī-miśra—Kāśī Miśra; *pradyumna-miśra*—Pradyumna Miśra; *rāya bhavānanda*—Bhavānanda Rāya; *yāñhāra*—of whom; *milane*—meeting; *prabhu*—the Lord; *pāilā*—got; *ānanda*—great pleasure.

TRANSLATION

In the list of devotees at Jagannātha Purī [which begins with Paramānanda Purī, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya and Gopīnātha Ācārya], Kāśī Miśra was the fifth, Pradyumna Miśra the sixth and Bhavānanda Rāya the seventh. Lord Caitanya took great pleasure in meeting with them.

PURPORT

In Jagannātha Purī Lord Caitanya lived at the house of Kāśī Miśra, who was the priest of the King. Later this house was inherited by Vakreśvara Paṇḍita and then by his disciple Gopālaguru Gosvāmī, who established a Deity of Rādhākānta there. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (193) states that Kāśī Miśra was formerly Kubjā in Mathurā. Pradyumna Miśra, an inhabitant of Orissa, was a great devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Pradyumna Miśra was born of a *brāhmaṇa* family and Rāmānanda Rāya of a non-*brāhmaṇa* family, yet Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu advised Pradyumna Miśra to take instruction from Rāmānanda Rāya. This incident is described in the *Antya-līlā*, Chapter Five.

Bhavānanda Rāya was the father of Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya. His residence was in Ālalanātha (Brahmagiri), which is about twelve miles west of Jagannātha Purī. By caste he belonged to the *karāṇa* community of Orissa, whose members were sometimes known as *kāyasthas* and sometimes as *sūdras*, but he was the governor of Madras under the control of King Pratāparudra of Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 132

ālīṅgana kari' tāñire balila vacana

tumi pāṇḍu, pañca-pāṇḍava—tomāra nandana

SYNONYMS

ālīṅgana kari'—embracing; *tāñire*—unto him; *balila*—said; *vacana*—

those words; *tumī*—you; *pāṇḍu*—were Pāṇḍu; *pañca*—five; *pāṇḍava*—the Pāṇḍavas; *tomāra*—your; *nandana*—sons.

TRANSLATION

Embracing Rāya Bhavānanda, the Lord declared to him, “You formerly appeared as Pāṇḍu, and your five sons appeared as the five Pāṇḍavas.”

TEXT 133

rāmānanda rāya, paṭṭanāyaka gopīnātha

kalānidhi, sudhānidhi, nāyaka vāṇīnātha

SYNONYMS

rāmānanda rāya—Rāmānanda Rāya; *paṭṭanāyaka gopīnātha*—Paṭṭanāyaka Gopīnātha; *kalānidhi*—Kalānidhi; *sudhānidhi*—Sudhānidhi; *nāyaka vāṇīnātha*—Nāyaka Vāṇīnātha.

TRANSLATION

The five sons of Bhavānanda Rāya were Rāmānanda Rāya, Paṭṭanāyaka Gopīnātha, Kalānidhi, Sudhānidhi and Nāyaka Vāṇīnātha.

TEXT 134

ei pañca putra tomāra mora priyapātra

rāmānanda saha mora deha-bheda mātra

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *pañca*—five; *putra*—sons; *tomāra*—your; *mora*—Mine; *priya-pātra*—very dear; *rāmānanda saha*—with Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya;

mora—Mine; *deha-bheda*—bodily difference; *mātra*—only.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu told Bhavānanda Rāya, “Your five sons are all My dear devotees. Rāmānanda Rāya and I are one, although our bodies are different.”

PURPORT

The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (120–24) states that Rāmānanda Rāya was formerly Arjuna. He is also considered to have been an incarnation of the *gopī* Lalitā, although in the opinion of others he was an incarnation of Viśākhādevī. He was a most confidential devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu said, “Although I am a *sannyāsī*, My mind is sometimes perturbed when I see a woman. But Rāmānanda Rāya is greater than Me, for he is always undisturbed, even when he touches a woman.” Only Rāmānanda Rāya was endowed with the prerogative to touch a woman in this way; no one should imitate him. Unfortunately, there are rascals who imitate the activities of Rāmānanda Rāya. We need not discuss them further.

In Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s final pastimes, Rāmānanda Rāya and Svarūpa Dāmodara always engaged in reciting suitable verses from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* and other books to pacify the Lord’s ecstatic feelings of separation from Kṛṣṇa. When Lord Caitanya went to southern India, Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya advised Him to meet Rāmānanda Rāya, declaring that there was no devotee as advanced in understanding the conjugal love of Kṛṣṇa and the *gopīs*. While touring South India, Lord Caitanya met Rāmānanda Rāya by the bank of the Godāvarī, and in their long discourses the Lord took the position of a student, and Rāmānanda Rāya instructed Him. Caitanya Mahāprabhu concluded these discourses by saying, “My dear Rāmānanda Rāya, both you and I are madmen, and therefore we met intimately on an equal level.” Lord Caitanya advised Rāmānanda Rāya to resign from his government post and come back to

Jagannātha Purī to live with Him. Although Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu refused to see Mahārāja Pratāparudra because he was a king, Rāmānanda Rāya, by a Vaiṣṇava scheme, arranged a meeting between the Lord and the King. This is described in the *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Twelve, verses 41–57. Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya was present during the water sports of the Lord after the Ratha-yātrā festival.

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu considered Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya and Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī to be equal in their renunciation, for although Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya was a *grhastha* engaged in government service and Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī was in the renounced order of complete detachment from material activities, they were both servants of the Supreme Personality of Godhead who kept Kṛṣṇa in the center of all their activities. Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya was one of the three and a half personalities with whom Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu discussed the most confidential topics of Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu advised Pradyumna Miśra to learn the science of Kṛṣṇa from Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya. As Subala always assisted Kṛṣṇa in His dealings with Rādhārāṇī in *kṛṣṇa-līlā*, so Rāmānanda Rāya assisted Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in His feelings of separation from Kṛṣṇa. Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya was the author of the *Jagannātha-vallabha-nāṭaka*.

TEXTS 135–136

pratāparudra rājā, āra oḍhra kṛṣṇānanda

paramānanda mahāpātra, oḍhra śivānanda

bhagavān ācārya, brahmānandākhya bhārati

śrī-śikhi māhiti, āra murāri māhiti

SYNONYMS

pratāparudra rājā—King Pratāparudra of Orissa; *āra*—and; *oḍhra*

kṛṣṇānanda—Kṛṣṇānanda, an Oriyā devotee; *paramānanda mahāpātra*—Paramānanda Mahāpātra; *oḍhra śivānanda*—the Oriyā Śivānanda; *bhagavān ācārya*—Bhagavān Ācārya; *brahmānanda-ākhyā bhāratī*—the devotee of the name Brahmānanda Bhāratī; *śrī-śikhi māhiti*—Śrī Śikhi Māhiti; *āra*—and; *murāri māhiti*—Murāri Māhiti.

TRANSLATION

King Pratāparudra of Orissa, the Oriyā devotees Kṛṣṇānanda and Śivānanda, and Paramānanda Mahāpātra, Bhagavān Ācārya, Brahmānanda Bhāratī, Śrī Śikhi Māhiti and Murāri Māhiti constantly associated with Caitanya Mahāprabhu while He resided in Jagannātha Purī.

PURPORT

Pratāparudra Mahārāja, who belonged to the dynasty of the Gaṅgā kings and whose capital was in Cuttak, was the Emperor of Orissa and a great devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. It was by the arrangement of Rāmānanda Rāya and Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya that he was able to personally serve Lord Caitanya. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (118) it is said that King Indradyumna, who established the temple of Jagannātha thousands of years ago, later took birth again in his own family as Mahārāja Pratāparudra during the time of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Mahārāja Pratāparudra was as powerful as King Indra. The drama named *Caitanya-candrodaya* was written under his direction.

In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Five, Paramānanda Mahāpātra is described as follows: “Paramānanda Mahāpātra was among the devotees who took birth in Orissa and accepted Caitanya Mahāprabhu as their only asset. In the ecstasy of conjugal love, he always thought of Caitanya Mahāprabhu.” Bhagavān Ācārya, a very learned scholar, was formerly an inhabitant of Hālisahara, but he left everything to live with Caitanya Mahāprabhu in Jagannātha Purī. His relationship with Caitanya Mahāprabhu was friendly, like that of a cowherd boy. He was always

friendly to Svarūpa Gosāñi, but he was staunchly devoted to the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He sometimes invited Caitanya Mahāprabhu to his house.

Bhagavān Ācārya was very liberal and simple. His father, Śātānanda Khān, was completely materialistic, and his younger brother, Gopāla Bhaṭṭācārya, was a staunch Māyāvādī philosopher who had studied very elaborately. When his brother came to Jagannātha Purī, Bhagavān Ācārya wanted to hear from him about Māyāvāda philosophy, but Svarūpa Dāmodara forbade him to do so, and there the matter stopped. Once a friend of Bhagavān Ācārya's from Bengal wanted to recite a drama that he had written that was against the principles of devotional service, and although Bhagavān Ācārya wanted to recite this drama before Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Svarūpa Dāmodara, the Lord's secretary, did not allow him to do so. Later Svarūpa Dāmodara pointed out the drama's many mistakes and its disagreements with the conclusion of devotional service, and the author became aware of the faults in his writing and then surrendered to Svarūpa Dāmodara, begging his mercy. This is described in the *Antya-līlā*, Chapter Five, verses 91–158.

In the *Gaura-ṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (189) it is said that Śikhi Māhiti was formerly an assistant of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī named Rāgalekhā. His sister Mādhavī was also an assistant of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī and was named Kalākelī. Śikhi Māhiti, Mādhavī and their brother Murāri Māhiti were all unalloyed devotees of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu who could not forget Him for a moment of their lives. There is a book in the Oriyā language called *Caitanya-carita-mahākāvya*, in which there are many narrations about Śikhi Māhiti. One narration concerns his seeing an ecstatic dream. Śikhi Māhiti always engaged in serving the Lord in his mind. One night, while he was rendering such service, he fell asleep, and while he was asleep his brother and sister came to awaken him. At that time he was in full ecstasy because he was having a wonderful dream that Lord Caitanya, while visiting the temple of Jagannātha, was entering and again coming out of the body of Jagannātha and looking at the Jagannātha Deity. Thus as soon as he awakened he embraced his brother and sister and informed

them, “My dear brother and sister, I have had a wonderful dream that I shall now explain to you. The activities of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the son of Mother Śacī, are certainly most wonderful. I saw that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, while visiting the temple of Jagannātha, was entering the body of Jagannātha and again coming out of His body. I am still seeing the same dream. Do you think I have become deranged? I am still seeing the same dream! And the most wonderful thing is that as soon as I came near Caitanya Mahāprabhu, He embraced me with His long arms.” As Śikhi Māhiti spoke to his brother and sister in this way, his voice faltered and there were tears in his eyes. Thus the brothers and sister went to the temple of Jagannātha, and there they saw Lord Caitanya in the Jagamohana *kīrtana* hall, looking at the beauty of the Śrī Jagannātha Deity just as in Śikhi Māhiti’s dream. The Lord was so magnanimous that He immediately embraced Śikhi Māhiti, exclaiming, “You are the elder brother of Murāri!” Being thus embraced, Śikhi Māhiti felt ecstatic transcendental bliss. Thus he and his brother and sister always engaged in rendering service to the Lord. Murāri Māhiti, the younger brother of Śikhi Māhiti, is described in the *Madhya-līlā*, Chapter Ten, verse 44.

TEXT 137

mādhavī-devī—śikhi-māhitira bhaginī

śrī-rādhāra dāsī-madhye yāñra nāma gaṇi

SYNONYMS

mādhavī-devī—Mādhavīdevī; *śikhi-māhitira*—of Śikhi Māhiti; *bhaginī*—sister; *śrī-rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *dāsī-madhye*—amongst the maidservants; *yāñra*—whose; *nāma*—name; *gaṇi*—count.

TRANSLATION

Mādhavīdevī, the seventeenth of the prominent devotees, was the

younger sister of Śikhi Māhiti. She is considered to have formerly been a maidservant of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

PURPORT

In the *Antya-līlā* of *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Chapter Two, verses 104–106, there is a description of Mādhavīdevī. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu considered her one of the maidservants of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. Within this world, Caitanya Mahāprabhu had three and a half very confidential devotees. The three were Svarūpa Gosāṇi, Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya and Śikhi Māhiti, and Śikhi Māhiti's sister, Mādhavīdevī, being a woman, was considered the half. Thus it is known that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu had three and a half confidential devotees.

TEXT 138

īśvara-purīra śiṣya—brahmacārī kāśīśvara

śrī-govinda nāma tāñra priya anucara

SYNONYMS

īśvara-purīra śiṣya—disciple of Īśvara Purī; *brahmacārī kāśīśvara*—Brahmacārī Kāśīśvara; *śrī-govinda*—Śrī Govinda; *nāma*—name; *tāñra*—his; *priya*—very dear; *anucara*—follower.

TRANSLATION

Brahmacārī Kāśīśvara was a disciple of Īśvara Purī, and Śrī Govinda was another of his dear disciples.

PURPORT

Govinda was the personal servant of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (137) it is stated that the servants formerly

named Bhṛṅgāra and Bhaṅgura in Vṛndāvana became Kāśīśvara and Govinda in Caitanya Mahāprabhu's pastimes. Govinda always engaged in the service of the Lord, even at great risk.

TEXT 139

tāñra siddhi-kāle donhe tāñra ājñā pāñā

nīlācale prabhu-sthāne milila āsiyā

SYNONYMS

tāñra siddhi-kāle—at the time of Īśvara Purī's passing away; *donhe*—the two of them; *tāñra*—his; *ājñā*—order; *pāñā*—getting; *nīlācale*—at Jagannātha Purī; *prabhu-sthāne*—at the place of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *milila*—met; *āsiyā*—coming there.

TRANSLATION

In the list of prominent devotees at Nīlācala [Jagannātha Purī], Kāśīśvara was the eighteenth and Govinda the nineteenth. They both came to see Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī, being thus ordered by Īśvara Purī at the time of his passing away.

TEXT 140

gurura sambandhe mānya kaila duñhākāre

tāñra ājñā māni' sevā dilena donhāre

SYNONYMS

gurura sambandhe—in relationship with His spiritual master; *mānya*—honor; *kaila*—offered; *duñhākāre*—to both of them; *tāñra ājñā*—his order; *māni'*—accepting; *sevā*—service; *dilena*—gave them; *donhāre*—

the two of them.

TRANSLATION

Both Kāśīśvara and Govinda were Godbrothers of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and thus the Lord duly honored them as soon as they arrived. But because Īśvara Purī had ordered them to give Caitanya Mahāprabhu personal service, the Lord accepted their service.

TEXT 141

aṅga-sevā govindere dīlena īśvara

jagannātha dekhite calena āge kāśīśvara

SYNONYMS

aṅga-sevā—taking care of the body; *govindere*—unto Govinda; *dīlena*—He gave; *īśvara*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *jagannātha*—the Jagannātha Deity; *dekhite*—while going to visit; *calena*—goes; *āge*—in front; *kāśīśvara*—Kāśīśvara.

TRANSLATION

Govinda cared for the body of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, whereas Kāśīśvara went in front of the Lord when He went to see Jagannātha in the temple.

TEXT 142

aparaśa yāya gosāñi manuṣya-gahane

manuṣya ṭheli' patha kare kāśī balavāne

SYNONYMS

aparaśa—untouched; *yāya*—goes; *gosāñi*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *manuṣya-gahane*—in the crowd; *manuṣya theli'*—pushing the crowd of men; *patha kare*—clears the way; *kāśī*—Kāśīsvara; *balavāne*—very strong.

TRANSLATION

When Caitanya Mahāprabhu went to the temple of Jagannātha, Kāśīsvara, being very strong, cleared the crowds aside with his hands so that Caitanya Mahāprabhu could pass untouched.

TEXT 143

rāmāi-nandāi—*donhe prabhura kiṅkara*

govindera saṅge sevā kare nirantara

SYNONYMS

rāmāi-nandāi—of the names Rāmāi and Nandāi; *donhe*—both of them; *prabhura*—Lord Caitanya's; *kiṅkara*—servants; *govindera*—with Govinda; *saṅge*—with him; *sevā*—service; *kare*—rendered; *nirantara*—twenty-four hours a day.

TRANSLATION

Rāmāi and Nandāi, the twentieth and twenty-first among the important devotees in Jagannātha Purī, always assisted Govinda twenty-four hours a day in rendering service to the Lord.

TEXT 144

bāiśa ghaḍā jala dine bharena rāmāi

govinda-ājñāya sevā karena nandāi

SYNONYMS

bāīśa—twenty-two; *ghaḍā*—big waterpots; *jala*—water; *dine*—daily; *bharena*—fills; *rāmāī*—Rāmāi; *govinda-ājñāya*—by the order of Govinda; *sevā*—service; *karena*—renders; *nandāī*—Nandāi.

TRANSLATION

Every day Rāmāi filled twenty-two big waterpots, whereas Nandāi personally assisted Govinda.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (139) it is stated that two servants who formerly supplied milk and water to Lord Kṛṣṇa became Rāmāi and Nandāi in the pastimes of Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 145

kṛṣṇadāsa nāma śuddha kulīna brāhmaṇa

yāre saṅge laiyā kailā dakṣiṇa gamana

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇadāsa—Kṛṣṇadāsa; *nāma*—named; *śuddha*—pure; *kulīna*—respectable; *brāhmaṇa*—the *brāhmaṇa*; *yāre*—whom; *saṅge*—with; *laiyā*—taking; *kailā*—did; *dakṣiṇa*—southern India; *gamana*—touring.

TRANSLATION

The twenty-second devotee, Kṛṣṇadāsa, was born of a pure and respectable brāhmaṇa family. While touring southern India, Lord Caitanya took Kṛṣṇadāsa with Him.

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇadāsa is described in the *Madhya-līlā*, chapters Seven and Nine. He went with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu to carry His waterpot. In the Malabar state, members of the Bhaṭṭathāri cult tried to captivate Kṛṣṇadāsa by supplying a woman to seduce him, but although Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu saved him from being harmed, when they returned to Jagannātha Purī He ordered that Kṛṣṇadāsa remain separate from Him, for the Lord was never favorably disposed toward an associate who was attracted by a woman. Thus Kṛṣṇadāsa lost the personal association of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 146

balabhadra bhaṭṭācārya—bhakti adhikārī

mathurā-gamane prabhura yeñho brahmacārī

SYNONYMS

balabhadra bhaṭṭācārya—Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya; *bhakti adhikārī*—bona fide devotee; *mathurā-gamane*—while touring Mathurā; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *yeñho*—who; *brahmacārī*—acted as a *brahmacārī*.

TRANSLATION

As a bona fide devotee, Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya, the twenty-third principal associate, acted as the brahmacārī of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu when He toured Mathurā.

PURPORT

Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya acted as a *brahmacārī*, or personal assistant of a *sannyāsī*. A *sannyāsī* is not supposed to cook. Generally a *sannyāsī* takes *prasādam* at the house of a *gṛhastha*, and a *brahmacārī* helps in this

connection. A *sannyāsī* is supposed to be a spiritual master and a *brahmacārī* his disciple. Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya acted as a *brahmacārī* for Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu when the Lord toured Mathurā and Vṛndāvana.

TEXT 147

baḍa haridāsa, āra choṭa haridāsa

dui kīrtanīyā rahe mahāprabhura pāśa

SYNONYMS

baḍa haridāsa—Baḍa Haridāsa; *āra*—and; *choṭa haridāsa*—Choṭa Haridāsa; *dui kīrtanīyā*—both of them were good singers; *rahe*—stay; *mahā-prabhura*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *pāśa*—with.

TRANSLATION

Baḍa Haridāsa and Choṭa Haridāsa, the twenty-fourth and twenty-fifth devotees in Nīlācala, were good singers who always accompanied Lord Caitanya.

PURPORT

Choṭa Haridāsa was later banished from the company of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, as stated in the *Antya-līlā*, Chapter Two.

TEXT 148

rāmabhadra-cārya, āra oḍhra śimheśvara

tapana ācārya, āra raghu, nīlāmbara

SYNONYMS

rāmabhadra-ācārya—Rāmabhadra Ācārya; *āra*—and; *oḍhra*—resident of Orissa; *simheśvara*—Simheśvara; *tapana ācārya*—Tapana Ācārya; *āra raghu*—and another Raghunātha; *nīlāmbara*—Nīlāmbara.

TRANSLATION

Among the devotees who lived with Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī, Rāmabhadra Ācārya was the twenty-sixth, Simheśvara the twenty-seventh, Tapana Ācārya the twenty-eighth, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya the twenty-ninth and Nīlāmbara the thirtieth.

TEXT 149

siṅgābhaṭṭa, kāmābhaṭṭa, dantura śivānanda

gauḍe pūrva bhṛtya prabhura priya kamalānanda

SYNONYMS

siṅgābhaṭṭa—Siṅgābhaṭṭa; *kāmābhaṭṭa*—Kāmābhaṭṭa; *dantura śivānanda*—Dantura Śivānanda; *gauḍe*—in Bengal; *pūrva*—formerly; *bhṛtya*—servant; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *priya*—very dear; *kamalānanda*—Kamalānanda.

TRANSLATION

Siṅgābhaṭṭa was the thirty-first, Kāmābhaṭṭa the thirty-second, Śivānanda the thirty-third and Kamalānanda the thirty-fourth. They all formerly served Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu in Bengal, but later these servants left Bengal to live with the Lord in Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 150

acyutānanda— —advaita-ācārya-tanaya

nīlācale rahe prabhura caraṇa āśraya

SYNONYMS

acyutānanda—Acyutānanda; *advaita-ācārya-tanaya*—the son of Advaita Ācārya; *nīlācale*—at Jagannātha Purī; *rahe*—stays; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *caraṇa*—lotus feet; *āśraya*—taking shelter.

TRANSLATION

Acyutānanda, the thirty-fifth devotee, was the son of Advaita Ācārya. He also lived with Lord Caitanya, taking shelter of His lotus feet at Jagannātha Purī.

PURPORT

There is a statement about Acyutānanda in Chapter Twelve, verse 13, of the *Ādi-līlā*.

TEXT 151

nirloma gaṅgādāsa, āra viṣṇudāsa

ei sabera prabhu-saṅge nīlācale vāsa

SYNONYMS

nirloma gaṅgādāsa—Nirloma Gaṅgādāsa; *āra*—and; *viṣṇudāsa*—Viṣṇudāsa; *ei sabera*—of all of them; *prabhu-saṅge*—with Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nīlācale*—at Jagannātha Purī; *vāsa*—residence.

TRANSLATION

Nirloma Gaṅgādāsa and Viṣṇudāsa were the thirty-sixth and thirty-seventh among the devotees who lived at Jagannātha Purī as servants of

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXTS 152–154

vārāṇasī-madhye prabhura bhakta tina jana

candraśekhara vaidya, āra miśra tapana

raghunātha bhaṭṭācārya—miśrera nandana

prabhu yabe kāsī āilā dekhi’ vṛndāvana

candraśekhara-gr̥he kaila dui māsa vāsa

tapana-miśrera ghare bhikṣā dui māsa

SYNONYMS

vārāṇasī-madhye—at Vārāṇasī; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bhakta*—devotees; *tina jana*—three persons; *candraśekhara vaidya*—the clerk of the name Candraśekhara; *āra*—and; *miśra tapana*—Tapana Miśra; *raghunātha bhaṭṭācārya*—Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya; *miśrera nandana*—the son of Tapana Miśra; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yabe*—when; *kāsī*—Vārāṇasī; *āilā*—came; *dekhi’*—after visiting; *vṛndāvana*—the holy place known as Vṛndāvana; *candraśekhara gr̥he*—in the house of Candraśekhara Vaidya; *kaila*—did; *dui māsa*—for two months; *vāsa*—reside; *tapana-miśrera*—of Tapana Miśra; *ghare*—in the house; *bhikṣā*—accepted *prasādam*; *dui māsa*—for two months.

TRANSLATION

The prominent devotees at Vārāṇasī were the physician Candraśekhara, Tapana Miśra and Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya, Tapana Miśra’s son. When Lord Caitanya came to Vārāṇasī after seeing Vṛndāvana, for two months He lived at the residence of Candraśekhara Vaidya and accepted

prasādam at the house of Tapanā Miśra.

PURPORT

When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was in Bengal, Tapanā Miśra approached Him to discuss spiritual advancement. Thus he was favored by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and received *hari-nāma* initiation. After that, by the order of the Lord, Tapanā Miśra resided in Vārāṇasī, and when Lord Caitanya visited Vārāṇasī He stayed at the home of Tapanā Miśra.

TEXT 155

raghunātha bālye kaila prabhura sevana

ucchiṣṭa-mārjana āra pāda-saṁvāhana

SYNONYMS

raghunātha—Raghunātha, the son of Tapanā Miśra; *bālye*—in his boyhood; *kaila*—did; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya; *sevana*—rendering service; *ucchiṣṭa-mārjana*—washing the dishes; *āra*—and; *pāda-saṁvāhana*—massaging the feet.

TRANSLATION

When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu stayed at the house of Tapanā Miśra, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, who was then a boy, washed His dishes and massaged His legs.

TEXT 156

baḍa haile nīlācale gelā prabhura sthāne

aṣṭa-māsa rahila bhikṣā dena kona dine

SYNONYMS

baḍa haile—when he grew to be a young man; *nīlācale*—at Jagannātha Purī; *gelā*—went; *prabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sthāne*—at the place; *aṣṭa-māsa*—eight months; *rahila*—stayed; *bhikṣā*—*prasādam*; *dena*—gave; *kona dine*—some days.

TRANSLATION

When Raghunātha grew to be a young man, he visited Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī and stayed there for eight months. Sometimes he offered prasādam to the Lord.

TEXT 157

prabhura ājñā pāñā vṛndāvanere āilā

āsiyā śrī-rūpa-gosāñīra nikāṭe rahilā

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ājñā*—order; *pāñā*—receiving; *vṛndāvanere*—to Vṛndāvana; *ailā*—he came; *āsiyā*—coming there; *śrī-rūpa-gosāñīra*—of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *nikāṭe*—at his shelter; *rahilā*—remained.

TRANSLATION

Later, by the order of Lord Caitanya, Raghunātha went to Vṛndāvana and remained there under the shelter of Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 158

tānra sthāne rūpa-gosāñī śunena bhāgavata

prabhura kṛpāya teṇho kṛṣṇa-preme matta

SYNONYMS

tānra sthāne—in his place; *rūpa-gosāñi*—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *śunena*—heard; *bhāgavata*—the recitation of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *prabhura kṛpāya*—by the mercy of Lord Caitanya; *teṇho*—he; *kṛṣṇa-preme*—in love of Kṛṣṇa; *matta*—always maddened.

TRANSLATION

While he stayed with Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, his engagement was to recite Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam for him to hear. As a result of this Bhāgavatam recitation, he attained perfectional love of Kṛṣṇa, by which he remained always maddened.

PURPORT

Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya, or Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, one of the six Gosvāmīs, was the son of Tapana Miśra. Born in approximately 1425 Śakābda (A.D. 1503), he was expert in reciting *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and in *Antya-līlā*, Chapter Thirteen, it is stated that he was also expert in cooking; whatever he cooked would be nectarean. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was greatly pleased to accept the food that he cooked, and Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa used to take the remnants of food left by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya lived for eight months in Jagannātha Purī, after which Lord Caitanya ordered him to go to Vṛndāvana to join Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu asked Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya not to marry but to remain a *brahmacārī*, and He also ordered him to read *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* constantly. Thus he went to Vṛndāvana, where he engaged in reciting *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* to Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī. He was so expert in reciting *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* that he would recite each and every verse in three melodious tunes. While Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī was living with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Lord blessed him by offering him betel nuts offered to

the Jagannātha Deity and a garland of *tulasī* said to be as long as fourteen cubits. Under Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī's order, one of his disciples constructed the Govinda temple. Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī supplied all the ornaments of the Govinda Deity. He never talked of nonsense or worldly matters but always engaged in hearing about Kṛṣṇa twenty-four hours a day. He never cared to hear blasphemy of a Vaiṣṇava. Even when there were points to be criticized, he used to say that since all the Vaiṣṇavas were engaged in the service of the Lord, he did not mind their faults. Later Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī lived by Rādhā-kunḍa in a small cottage. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (185) it is said that Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī was formerly the *gopī* named Rāga-mañjarī.

TEXT 159

ei-mata saṅkhyātīta caitanya-bhakta-gaṇa

dinmātra likhi, samyak nā yāya kathana

SYNONYMS

ei-mata—in this way; *saṅkhyā-atīta*—innumerable; *caitanya-bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees of Lord Caitanya; *din-mātra*—only a fractional part; *likhi*—I write; *samyak*—full; *nā*—cannot; *yāya*—be possible; *kathana*—to explain.

TRANSLATION

I list in this way only a portion of the innumerable devotees of Lord Caitanya. To describe them all fully is not possible.

TEXT 160

ekaika-sākhāte lāge koṭi koṭi dāla

tāra śiṣya-upaśiṣya, tāra upaḍāla

SYNONYMS

eka-eka—in each; *sākhāte*—branch; *lāge*—grow; *koṭi koṭi*—hundreds and thousands; *ḍāla*—twigs; *tāra*—His; *śiṣya*—disciples; *upāśiṣya*—subdisciples; *tāra*—His; *upāḍāla*—subbranches.

TRANSLATION

From each branch of the tree have grown hundreds and thousands of subbranches of disciples and granddisciples.

PURPORT

It was the desire of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu that His cult be spread all over the world. Therefore there is a great necessity for many, many disciples of the branches of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's disciplic succession. His cult should be spread not only in a few villages, or in Bengal, or in India, but all over the world. It is very regrettable that complacent so-called devotees criticize the members of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness for accepting *sannyāsa* and spreading the cult of Lord Caitanya all over the world. It is not our business to criticize anyone, but because they try to find fault with this movement, the real truth must be stated. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted devotees all over the world, and Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura and Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura confirmed this. It is in pursuit of their will that the ISKCON movement is spreading all over the world. Genuine devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu must take pride in the spread of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement instead of viciously criticizing its propaganda work.

TEXT 161

sakala bhariyā āche prema-phula-phale

bhāsāila tri-jagat kṛṣṇa-prema-jale

SYNONYMS

sakala—all; *bhariyā*—filled; *āche*—there is; *prema*—love of Godhead; *phula*—flowers; *phale*—fruits; *bhāsāīla*—inundated; *tri-jagat*—the whole world; *kṛṣṇa-prema*—of love of Kṛṣṇa; *jale*—with water.

TRANSLATION

Every branch and subbranch of the tree is full of innumerable fruits and flowers. They inundate the world with the waters of love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 162

eka eka śākhāra śakti ananta mahimā

‘sahasra vadane’ yāra dite nāre sīmā

SYNONYMS

eka eka—of each and every; *śākhāra*—branch; *śakti*—power; *ananta*—unlimited; *mahimā*—glories; *sahasra vadane*—in thousands of mouths; *yāra*—of which; *dite*—to give; *nāre*—becomes unable; *sīmā*—limit.

TRANSLATION

Each and every branch of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s devotees has unlimited spiritual power and glory. Even if one had thousands of mouths, it would be impossible to describe the limits of their activities.

TEXT 163

saṅkṣepe kahila mahāprabhura bhakta-gaṇa

samagra balite nāre ‘sahasra-vadana’

SYNONYMS

saṅkṣepe—in brief; *kaḥila*—described; *mahāprabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees; *samagra*—all; *balite*—to speak; *nāre*—cannot; *sahasra-vadana*—Lord Śeṣa, who has thousands of mouths.

TRANSLATION

I have briefly described the devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in different places. Even Lord Śeṣa, who has thousands of mouths, could not list them all.

TEXT 164

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Tenth Chapter, in the matter of the main trunk of the Caitanya tree, its branches and its subbranches.

CHAPTER 11

The Expansions of Lord Nityānanda

As the branches and subbranches of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu were described in the Tenth Chapter, in this Eleventh Chapter the branches and subbranches of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu are similarly listed.

TEXT 1

nityānanda-padāmbhoja-

bhṛṅgān prema-madhūnmadān

natvākhilān teṣu mukhyā

likhyante katicin mayā

SYNONYMS

nityānanda—of Lord Śrī Nityānanda; *pada-ambhoja*—lotus feet; *bhṛṅgān*—the bumblebees; *prema*—of love of Godhead; *madhu*—by the honey; *unmadān*—maddened; *natvā*—offering obeisances; *akhilān*—to all of them; *teṣu*—out of them; *mukhyāḥ*—the chief; *likhyante*—being described; *katicit*—a few of them; *mayā*—by me.

TRANSLATION

After offering my obeisances unto all the devotees of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, who are like bumblebees collecting honey from His lotus feet, I shall try to describe those who are the most prominent.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya mahāprabhu śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

tāñhāra caraṇāśrita yei, sei dhanya

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *mahāprabhu*—unto Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—known as Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *tāñhāra caraṇa-āśrita*—all who have taken shelter at His lotus feet; *yei*—anyone; *sei*—he is; *dhanya*—glorious.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu! Anyone who has taken shelter at His lotus feet is glorious.

TEXT 3

jaya jaya śrī-advaita, jaya nityānanda

jaya jaya mahāprabhura sarva-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-advaita*—unto Śrī Advaita Ācārya; *jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—unto Lord Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu; *jaya jaya*—all glories; *mahāprabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sarva*—all; *bhakta-vṛnda*—devotees.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Śrī Advaita Prabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu and all the devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu!

TEXT 4

tasya śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-
sat-premāmara-śākhinaḥ
ūrdhva-skandhāvadhūtendoḥ
śākhā-rūpān gaṇān numaḥ

SYNONYMS

tasya—His; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sat-prema*—of eternal love of Godhead; *amara*—indestructible; *śākhinaḥ*—of the tree; *ūrdhva*—very high; *skandha*—branch; *avadhūta-indoḥ*—of Śrī Nityānanda; *śākhā-rūpān*—in the form of different branches; *gaṇān*—to the devotees; *numaḥ*—I offer my respects.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu is the topmost branch of the indestructible tree of eternal love of Godhead, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu. I offer my respectful obeisances to all the subbranches of that topmost branch.

TEXT 5

śrī-nityānanda-vṛkṣera skandha gurutara
tāhāte janmila śākhā-prasākhā vistara

SYNONYMS

śrī-nityānanda-vṛkṣera—of the tree known as Śrī Nityānanda; *skandha*—main branch; *gurutara*—extremely heavy; *tāhāte*—from that branch; *janmila*—grew; *śākhā*—branches; *prasākhā*—subbranches; *vistara*—expansively.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu is an extremely heavy branch of the Śrī Caitanya tree. From that branch grow many branches and subbranches.

TEXT 6

mālākarera icchā jale bāḍe śākhā-gaṇa

prema-phula-phale bhari' chāila bhuvana

SYNONYMS

mālā-kārera—of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *icchā-jale*—by the water of His wish; *bāḍe*—increase; *śākhā-gaṇa*—the branches; *prema*—love of Godhead; *phula-phale*—with flowers and fruits; *bhari'*—filling; *chāila*—covered; *bhuvana*—the whole world.

TRANSLATION

Watered by the desire of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, these branches and subbranches have grown unlimitedly and covered the entire world with fruits and flowers.

TEXT 7

asaṅkhyā ananta gaṇa ke karu gaṇana

āpanā śodhite kahi mukhya mukhya jana

SYNONYMS

asaṅkhyā—innumerable; *ananta*—unlimited; *gaṇa*—devotees; *ke*—who; *karu*—can; *gaṇana*—count; *āpanā*—the self; *śodhite*—to purify; *kahi*—I speak; *mukhya mukhya*—only the chief; *jana*—persons.

TRANSLATION

These branches and subbranches of devotees are innumerable and unlimited. Who could count them? For my personal purification I shall try to enumerate only the most prominent among them.

PURPORT

One should not write books or essays on transcendental subject matter for material name, fame or profit. Transcendental literature must be written under the direction of a superior authority because it is not meant for material purposes. If one tries to write under superior authority, he becomes purified. All Kṛṣṇa conscious activities should be undertaken for personal purification (*āpanā śodhite*), not for material gain.

TEXT 8

śrī-vīrabhadra gosāñi—skandha-mahāśākhā

tāñra upaśākhā yata, asaṅkhyā tāra lekhā

SYNONYMS

śrī-vīrabhadra gosāñi—Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi; *skandha*—of the trunk; *mahā-śākhā*—the biggest branch; *tāñra*—his; *upaśākhā*—subbranches; *yata*—all; *asaṅkhyā*—innumerable; *tāra*—of that; *lekhā*—the description.

TRANSLATION

After Nityānanda Prabhu, the greatest branch is Vīrabhadra Gosāñi, who also has innumerable branches and subbranches. It is not possible to describe them all.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Vīrabhadra Gosāṇi was the direct son of Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu and a disciple of Jāhnavā-devī. His real mother was Vasudhā. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (67) he is mentioned as an incarnation of Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. Therefore Vīrabhadra Gosāṇi is nondifferent from Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu. In a village of the name Jhāmaṭapura, in the district of Hugli, Vīrabhadra Gosāṇi had a disciple named Yadunāthācārya, who had two daughters—a real daughter named Śrīmatī and a foster daughter named Nārāyaṇī. Both these daughters married, and they are mentioned in the *Bhakti-ratnākara* (Thirteenth Wave). Vīrabhadra Gosāṇi had three disciples who are celebrated as his sons—Gopījana-vallabha, Rāmakṛṣṇa and Rāmacandra. The youngest, Rāmacandra, belonged to the Śāṇḍilya dynasty and had the surname Vaṭavyāla. He established his family at Khaḍadaha, and its members are known as the *gosvāmīs* of Khaḍadaha. The eldest disciple, Gopījana-vallabha, was a resident of a village known as Latā, near the Mānakara railway station in the district of Burdwan. The second, Rāmakṛṣṇa, lived near Māladaha, in a village named Gayeśapura.” Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura notes that since these three disciples belonged to different *gotras*, or dynasties, and also had different surnames and lived in different places, it is not possible to accept them as real sons of Vīrabhadra Gosāṇi. Rāmacandra had four sons, of whom the eldest was Rādhāmādhava, whose third son was named Yādavendra. Yādavendra’s son was Nandakiśora, his son was Nidhikṛṣṇa, his son was Caitanyacāṇḍa, his son was Kṛṣṇamohana, his son was Jaganmohana, his son was Vrajanātha, and his son was Śyāmalāla Gosvāmī. This is the genealogical table given by Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura for the descendants of Vīrabhadra Gosāṇi.

TEXT 9

īśvara ha-iyā kahāya mahā-bhāgavata

veda-dharmātīta hañā veda-dharme rata

SYNONYMS

īśvara—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *ha-iyā*—being; *kaḥāya*—calls Himself; *mahā-bhāgavata*—great devotee; *veda-dharma*—the principles of Vedic religion; *atīta*—transcendental; *hañā*—being; *veda-dharṁe*—in the Vedic system; *rata*—engaged.

TRANSLATION

Although Vīrabhadra Gosāṇi was the Supreme Personality of Godhead, He presented Himself as a great devotee. And although the Supreme Godhead is transcendental to all Vedic injunctions, He strictly followed the Vedic rituals.

TEXT 10

antare īśvara-ceṣṭā, bāhire nirdambha

caitanya-bhakti-maṇḍape teṇho mūla-stambha

SYNONYMS

antare—within Himself; *īśvara-ceṣṭā*—the activities of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *bāhire*—externally; *nirdambha*—without pride; *caitanya-bhakti-maṇḍape*—in the devotional hall of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *teṇho*—He is; *mūla-stambha*—the main pillar.

TRANSLATION

He is the main pillar in the hall of devotional service erected by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He knew within Himself that He acted as the Supreme Lord Viṣṇu, but externally He was prideless.

TEXT 11

adyāpi yāñhāra kṛpā-mahimā ha-ite

caitanya-nityānanda gāya sakala jagate

SYNONYMS

adyāpi—until today; *yāñhāra*—whose; *kṛpā*—mercy; *mahimā*—glorious; *ha-ite*—from; *caitanya-nityānanda*—Śrī Caitanya-Nityānanda; *gāya*—sing; *sakala*—all; *jagate*—in the world.

TRANSLATION

It is by the glorious mercy of Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi that people all over the world now have the chance to chant the names of Caitanya and Nityānanda.

TEXT 12

sei vīrabhadra-gosāñira la-inu śaraṇa

yāñhāra prasāde haya abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *vīrabhadra-gosāñira*—of Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi; *la-inu*—I take; *śaraṇa*—shelter; *yāñhāra*—whose; *prasāde*—by mercy; *haya*—it becomes so; *abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa*—fulfillment of desire.

TRANSLATION

I therefore take shelter of the lotus feet of Vīrabhadra Gosāñi, so that by His mercy my great desire to write Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta will be properly guided.

TEXT 13

śrī-rāmadāsa āra, gadādhara dāsa

caitanya-gosāñira bhakta rahe tāñira pāśa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rāmadāsa—Śrī Rāmadāsa; *āra*—and; *gadādhara dāsa*—Gadādhara dāsa; *caitanya-gosāñira*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bhakta*—devotees; *rahe*—stay; *tāñira pāśa*—with Him.

TRANSLATION

Two devotees of Lord Caitanya named Śrī Rāmadāsa and Gadādhara dāsa always lived with Śrī Vīrabhadra Gosāñi.

PURPORT

Śrī Rāmadāsa, later known as Abhirāma Ṭhākura, was one of the twelve *gopālas*, or cowherd boyfriends, of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (126) states that Śrī Rāmadāsa was formerly Śrīdāmā. In the *Bhakti-ratnākara* (Fourth Wave), there is a description of Śrīla Abhirāma Ṭhākura. By the order of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, Abhirāma Ṭhākura became a great *ācārya* and preacher of the Caitanya cult of devotional service. He was a very influential personality, and nondevotees were very much afraid of him. Empowered by Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, he was always in ecstasy and was extremely kind to all fallen souls. It is said that if he offered obeisances to any stone other than a *śālagrāma-sīlā*, it would immediately fracture.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Ten miles southwest of the Cānpāḍāṅgā railway station on the narrow-gauge railway line from Howrah, in Calcutta, to Āmtā, a village in the Hugli district, is a small town named Khānākūla-kṛṣṇanagara, where the temple in which Abhirāma Ṭhākura worshiped is situated. During the rainy season, when this area is inundated with water, people must go there by

another line, which is now called the southeastern railway. On this line there is a station named Kolāghāṭa, from which one has to go by steamer to Rāṇīcaka. Seven and a half miles north of Rāṇīcaka is Khānākūla. The temple where Abhirāma Ṭhākura worshiped is situated in Kṛṣṇanagara, which is near the *kūla* (bank) of the Khānā (Dvārakeśvara River); therefore this place is celebrated as Khānākūla-kṛṣṇanagara. Outside of the temple is a *bakula* tree. This place is known as Siddha-bakula-kuñja. It is said that when Abhirāma Ṭhākura came there, he sat down under this tree. In Khānākūla-kṛṣṇanagara there is a big fair held every year in the month of Caitra [March–April] on the Kṛṣṇa-saptamī, the seventh day of the dark moon. Many hundreds and thousands of people gather for this festival. The temple where Abhirāma Ṭhākura worshiped has a very old history. The Deity in the temple is known as Gopīnātha. There are many *sevaita* families living near the temple. It is said that Abhirāma Ṭhākura had a whip and that whoever he touched with it would immediately become an elevated devotee of Kṛṣṇa. Among his many disciples, Śrīmān Śrīnivāsa Ācārya was the most famous and the most dear, but it is doubtful that he was his initiated disciple.”

TEXTS 14–15

nityānande ājñā dila yabe gauḍe yāite

mahāprabhu ei dui dilā tānra sāthe

ataeva dui-gaṇe duñhāra gaṇana

mādhava-vāsudeva ghoṣerao ei vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

nityānande—unto Lord Nityānanda; *ājñā*—order; *dila*—gave; *yabe*—when; *gauḍe*—to Bengal; *yāite*—to go; *mahāprabhu*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ei dui*—these two; *dilā*—gave; *tānra sāthe*—with Him; *ataeva*—therefore; *dui-gaṇe*—in both the parties; *duñhāra*—two of

them; *gaṇana*—are counted; *mādhava*—Mādhava; *vāsudeva*—Vāsudeva; *ghoṣerao*—of the surname Ghoṣa; *ei*—this; *vivarāṇa*—description.

TRANSLATION

When Nityānanda Prabhu was ordered to go to Bengal to preach, these two devotees [Śrī Rāmadāsa and Gadādhara dāsa] were ordered to go with Him. Thus they are sometimes counted among the devotees of Lord Caitanya and sometimes among the devotees of Lord Nityānanda. Similarly, Mādhava Ghoṣa and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa belonged to both groups of devotees simultaneously.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “There is a place named Dānīhāṭa, near the Agradvīpa railway station and Pāṭuli in the district of Burdwan, where the Deity of Śrī Gopīnāthajī is still situated. This Deity accepted Govinda Ghoṣa as His father. Even until today, the Deity performs the *śrāddha* ceremony on the anniversary of the death of Govinda Ghoṣa. The temple of this Deity is managed by the *rāja-vamśa* family of Kṛṣṇanagara, whose members are descendants of Rājā Kṛṣṇacandra. Every year in the month of Vaiśākha, when there is a *bāradola* ceremony, this Gopīnātha Deity is taken to Kṛṣṇanagara. The ceremony is performed with eleven other Deities, and then Śrī Gopīnāthajī is brought back to the temple in Agradvīpa.”

TEXT 16

rāmadāsa— —mukhya-śākhā, sakhya-prema-rāśī

śolasāṅgera kāṣṭha yei tuli’ kaila vamśī

SYNONYMS

rāma-dāsa—Rāmadāsa; *mukhya-śākhā*—chief branch; *sakhya-prema-*

rāśī—full of fraternal love; *ṣolasa-aṅgera*—of sixteen knots; *kāṣṭha*—wood; *yei*—that; *tuli'*—raising; *kaila*—made; *vāṁśī*—flute.

TRANSLATION

Rāmadāsa, one of the chief branches, was full of fraternal love of Godhead. He made a flute from a stick with sixteen knots.

TEXT 17

gadādhara dāsa gopībhāve pūrṇānanda

yāñra ghare dānakeli kaila nityānanda

SYNONYMS

gadādhara dāsa—Gadādhara dāsa; *gopī-bhāve*—in the ecstasy of the *gopīs*; *pūrṇa-ānanda*—fully in transcendental bliss; *yāñra ghare*—in whose house; *dāna-keli*—performance of *dānakeli-līlā*; *kaila*—did; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Gadādhara dāsa was always fully absorbed in ecstasy as a gopī. In his house Lord Nityānanda enacted the drama Dāna-keli.

TEXT 18

śrī-mādhava ghoṣa—mukhya kīrtanīyā-gaṇe

nityānanda-prabhu nṛtya kare yāñra gāne

SYNONYMS

śrī-mādhava ghoṣa—Śrī Mādhava Ghoṣa; *mukhya*—chief; *kīrtanīyā-*

gaṇe—amongst the performers of *saṅkīrtana*; *nityānanda-prabhu*—Nityānanda Prabhu; *nṛtya*—dance; *kare*—does; *yāñra*—whose; *gāne*—in song.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Mādhava Ghoṣa was a principal performer of kīrtana. While he sang, Nityānanda Prabhu danced.

TEXT 19

vāsudeva gīte kare prabhura varṇane

kāṣṭha-pāṣāṇa drave yāhāra śravaṇe

SYNONYMS

vāsudeva—Vāsudeva; *gīte*—while singing; *kare*—does; *prabhura*—of Nityānanda Prabhu and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *varṇane*—in description; *kāṣṭha*—wood; *pāṣāṇa*—stone; *drave*—melt; *yāhāra*—whose; *śravaṇe*—by hearing.

TRANSLATION

When Vāsudeva Ghoṣa described Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda while performing kīrtana, even wood and stone would melt upon hearing it.

TEXT 20

murāri-caitanya-dāsera alaukika līlā

vyāghra-gāle caḍa māre, sarpa-sane khelā

SYNONYMS

murāri—Murāri; *caitanya-dāsera*—of the servant of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *alaukika*—uncommon; *līlā*—pastimes; *vyāghra*—tiger; *gāle*—on the cheek; *caḍa māre*—slaps; *sarpa*—a snake; *sane*—with; *khelā*—playing.

TRANSLATION

There were many extraordinary activities performed by Murāri, a great devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Sometimes in his ecstasy he would slap the cheek of a tiger, and sometimes he would play with a venomous snake.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Murāri Caitanya dāsa was born in the village of Sar-vṛndāvana-pura, which is situated about two miles from the Galaṣī station on the Burdwan line. When Murāri Caitanya dāsa came to Navadvīpa, he settled in the village of Modadruma, or Māmagāchi-grāma. At that time he became known as Śārṅga or Sāraṅga Murāri Caitanya dāsa. The descendants of his family still reside in Sarer Pāṭa. In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Five, there is the following statement: ‘Murāri Caitanya dāsa had no material bodily features, for he was completely spiritual. Thus he would sometimes chase after tigers in the jungle and treat them just like cats and dogs. He would slap the cheek of a tiger and take a venomous snake on his lap. He had no fear for his external body, of which he was completely forgetful. He could spend all twenty-four hours of the day chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* or speaking about Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda. Sometimes he would remain submerged in water for two or three days, but he would feel no bodily inconvenience. Thus he behaved almost like stone or wood, but he always used his energy in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. No one can describe his specific characteristics, but it is understood that wherever Murāri Caitanya dāsa passed, whoever was present would be enlightened in Kṛṣṇa consciousness simply by the atmosphere he created.’”

TEXT 21

nityānandera gaṇa yata—saba vraja-sakhā

śṛṅga-vetra-gopaveśa, śīre śikhi-pākhā

SYNONYMS

nityānandera—of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *gaṇa*—followers; *yata*—all; *saba*—all; *vraja-sakhā*—residents of Vṛndāvana; *śṛṅga*—horn; *vetra*—cane stick; *gopa-veśa*—dressed like a cowherd boy; *śīre*—on the head; *śikhi-pākhā*—the plume of a peacock.

TRANSLATION

All the associates of Lord Nityānanda were formerly cowherd boys in Vrajabhūmi. Their symbolic representations were the horns and sticks they carried, their cowherd dress and the peacock plumes on their heads.

PURPORT

Jāhnavā-mātā is also within the list of Lord Nityānanda's followers. She is described in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (66) as Anaṅga-mañjarī of Vṛndāvana. All the devotees who are followers of Jāhnavā-mātā are counted within the list of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu's devotees.

TEXT 22

raghunātha vaidya upādhyāya mahāśaya

yānhāra darśane kṛṣṇa-prema-bhakti haya

SYNONYMS

raghunātha vaidya—the physician Raghunātha; *upādhyāya mahāśaya*—a

great personality with the title Upādhyāya; *yāñhāra*—whose; *darśane*—by visiting; *kṛṣṇa-prema*—love of Kṛṣṇa; *bhakti*—devotional service; *haya*—awakened.

TRANSLATION

The physician Raghunātha, also known as Upādhyāya, was so great a devotee that simply by seeing him one would awaken his dormant love of Godhead.

TEXT 23

sundarānanda—nityānandera śākhā, bhṛtya marma

yāñra sañge nityānanda kare vraja-narma

SYNONYMS

sundarānanda—Sundarānanda; *nityānandera śākhā*—a branch of Nityānanda Prabhu; *bhṛtya marma*—very intimate servant; *yāñra sañge*—with whom; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *kare*—performs; *vraja-narma*—activities of Vṛndāvana.

TRANSLATION

Sundarānanda, another branch of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, was Lord Nityānanda’s most intimate servant. Lord Nityānanda Prabhu perceived the life of Vrajabhūmi in his company.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Five, it is stated that Sundarānanda was an ocean of love of Godhead and the chief associate of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (127) he is stated

to have been Sudāmā in *kṛṣṇa-līlā*. Thus he was one of the twelve cowherd boys who came down with Balarāma when He descended as Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. The holy place where Sundarānanda lived is situated in the village known as Maheśapura, which is about fourteen miles east of the Mājadiyā railway station of the eastern railway from Calcutta to Burdwan. This place is within the district of Jessore, [which is now in Bangladesh]. Among the relics of this village, only the old residential house of Sundarānanda still exists. At the end of the village resides a *bāula* [pseudo Vaiṣṇava], and all the buildings, both the temples and the house, appear to be newly constructed. In Maheśapura there are Deities of Śrī Rādhāvallabha and Śrī Śrī Rādhāramaṇa. Near the temple is a small river of the name Vetravatī.

“Sundarānanda Prabhu was a *naiṣṭhika-brahmacārī*: he never married in his life. Therefore he had no direct descendants except his disciples, but the descendants of his family still reside in the village known as Maṅgalaḍihi in the district of Birbhum. In that same village is a temple of Balarāma, and the Deity there is regularly worshiped. The original Deity of Maheśapura, Rādhāvallabha, was taken by the Saidābād Gosvāmīs of Berhampur, and since the present Deities were installed, a zamindar family of Maheśapura has looked after Their worship. On the full-moon day of the month of Māgha (January–February), the anniversary of Sundarānanda’s disappearance is regularly celebrated, and people from the neighboring areas gather together to observe this festival.”

TEXT 24

kamalākara pippalāi—alaukika rīta

alaukika prema tāñra bhuvane vidita

SYNONYMS

kamalākara pippalāi—Kamalākara Pippalāi; *alaukika*—uncommon; *rīta*—behavior or pastime; *alaukika*—uncommon; *prema*—love of Godhead;

tānira—his; *bhuvane*—in the world; *vidita*—celebrated.

TRANSLATION

Kamalākara Pippalāi is said to have been the third gopāla. His behavior and love of Godhead were uncommon, and thus he is celebrated all over the world.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (128) Kamalākara Pippalāi is described as the third *gopāla*. His former name was Mahābala. The Jagannātha Deity at Māheśa in Śrī Rāmapura was installed by Kamalākara Pippalāi. This village of Māheśa is situated about two and a half miles from the Śrī Rāmapura railway station. The genealogy of the family of Kamalākara Pippalāi is given as follows. Kamalākara Pippalāi had a son named Caturbhuja, who had two sons named Nārāyaṇa and Jagannātha. Nārāyaṇa had one son named Jagadānanda, and his son’s name was Rājīvalocana. During the time of Rājīvalocana, there was a scarcity of finances for the worship of the Jagannātha Deity, and it is said that the Nawab of Dacca, whose name was Shah Sujā, donated 1,185 *bighās* of land [about 395 acres] in the Bengali year 1060 [A.D. 1653]. The land being the possession of Jagannātha, the village was named Jagannāthapura. It is said that when Kamalākara Pippalāi left home his younger brother Nidhipati Pippalāi searched for him and in due course of time found him in the village of Māheśa. Nidhipati Pippalāi tried his best to bring his elder brother home, but he would not return. Under these circumstances, Nidhipati Pippalāi, with all his family members, came to Māheśa to reside. The members of this family still reside in the vicinity of the Māheśa village. Their family name is Adhikārī, and they are a *brāhmaṇa* family.

“The history of the Jagannātha temple in Māheśa is as follows. One devotee of the name Dhruvānanda went to see Lord Jagannātha, Balarāma

and Subhadrā at Jagannātha Purī, wanting to offer food to Jagannāthajī that he had cooked with his own hands. This being his desire, one night Jagannāthajī appeared to him in a dream and asked him to go to Māheśa on the bank of the Ganges and there start worship of Him in a temple. Thus Dhruvānanda went to Māheśa, where he saw the three deities—Jagannātha, Balarāma and Subhadrā—floating in the Ganges. He picked up all those deities and installed them in a small cottage, and with great satisfaction he executed the worship of Lord Jagannātha. When he became old, he was very anxious to hand over the worship to the charge of someone reliable, and in a dream he got permission from Jagannātha Prabhu to hand it over to a person whom he would meet the next morning. The next morning he met Kamalākara Pippalāi, who was formerly an inhabitant of the village Khālijuli in the Sundaravana forest area of Bengal and was a pure Vaiṣṇava, a great devotee of Lord Jagannātha; thus he immediately gave him charge of the worship. In this way, Kamalākara Pippalāi became the worshiper of Lord Jagannātha, and since then his family members have been designated as Adhikārī, which means ‘one who is empowered to worship the Lord.’ These Adhikārīs belong to a respectable *brāhmaṇa* family. Five types of upper-class *brāhmaṇas* are recognized by the surname Pippalāi.”

TEXT 25

sūryadāsa sarakhela, tānra bhāi kṛṣṇadāsa

nityānande dṛḍha viśvāsa, premera nivāsa

SYNONYMS

sūryadāsa sarakhela—Sūryadāsa Sarakhela; *tānra bhāi*—his brother; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa; *nityānande*—unto Lord Nityānanda; *dṛḍha viśvāsa*—firm faith; *premera nivāsa*—the reservoir of all love of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Sūryadāsa Sarakhela and his younger brother Kṛṣṇadāsa Sarakhela both possessed firm faith in Nityānanda Prabhu. They were a reservoir of love of Godhead.

PURPORT

In the *Bhakti-ratnākara* (Twelfth Wave), it is stated that a few miles from Navadvīpa is a place called Śāligrāma that was the residence of Sūryadāsa Sarakhela. He was employed as a secretary in the Muslim government of that time, and thus he amassed a good fortune. Sūryadāsa had four brothers, all of whom were pure Vaiṣṇavas. Vasudhā and Jāhnavā were two daughters of Sūryadāsa Sarakhela.

TEXT 26

gaurīdāsa paṇḍita yāñira premoddaṇḍa-bhakti

kṛṣṇa-premā dite, nite, dhare mahāśakti

SYNONYMS

gaurīdāsa paṇḍita—Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita; *yāñira*—whose; *prema-uddaṇḍa-bhakti*—the most elevated in love of Godhead and devotional service; *kṛṣṇa-premā*—love of Kṛṣṇa; *dite*—to deliver; *nite*—and to receive; *dhare*—empowered; *mahāśakti*—great potency.

TRANSLATION

Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita, the emblem of the most elevated devotional service in love of Godhead, had the greatest potency to receive and deliver such love.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “It is

said that Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita was always patronized by King Kṛṣṇadāsa, the son of Harihoḍa. Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita lived in the village of Śāligrāma, which is situated a few miles from the railway station Muḍāgāchā, and later he came to reside in Ambikā-kālanā. It is stated in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (128) that formerly he was Subala, one of the cowherd boyfriends of Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma in Vṛndāvana. Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita was the younger brother of Sūryadāsa Sarakhela, and with the permission of his elder brother he shifted his residence to the bank of the Ganges, living there in the town known as Ambikā-kālanā. Some of the names of the descendants of Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita are as follows: (1) Śrī Nṛsimha-caitanya, (2) Kṛṣṇadāsa, (3) Viṣṇudāsa, (4) Baḍa Balarāma dāsa, (5) Govinda, (6) Raghunātha, (7) Baḍu Gaṅgādāsa, (8) Āliyā Gaṅgārāma, (9) Yādavācārya, (10) Hṛdaya-caitanya, (11) Cānda Hāladāra, (12) Maheśa Paṇḍita, (13) Mukuṭa Rāya, (14) Bhātuyā Gaṅgārāma, (15) Āliyā Caitanya, (16) Kāliyā Kṛṣṇadāsa, (17) Pātuyā Gopāla, (18) Baḍa Jagannātha, (19) Nityānanda, (20) Bhāvi, (21) Jagadīśa, (22) Rāiyā Kṛṣṇadāsa and (22½) Annapūrṇā. The eldest son of Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita was known as big Balarāma, and the youngest was known as Raghunātha. The sons of Raghunātha were Maheśa Paṇḍita and Govinda. Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita's daughter was known as Annapūrṇā.

“The village Ambikā-kālanā, which is situated just across the river Ganges from Śāntipura, is two miles east of the Kālanā-korṭa railway station, on the eastern railway. In Ambikā-kālanā there is a temple constructed by the zamindar of Burdwan. In front of the temple there is a big tamarind tree, and it is said that Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita and Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu met underneath this tree. The place where the temple is situated is known as Ambikā, and because it is in the area of Kālanā, the village is known as Ambikā-kālanā. It is said that a copy of the *Bhagavad-gītā* written by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu still exists in this temple.”

TEXT 27

nityānande samarpila jāti-kula-pāṇti

śrī-caitanya-nityānande kari prāṇapati

SYNONYMS

nityānande—to Lord Nityānanda; *samarpila*—he offered; *jāti*—caste distinction; *kula*—family; *pāṇti*—fellowship; *śrī-caitanya*—Lord Caitanya; *nityānande*—in Lord Nityānanda; *kari*—making; *prāṇa-pati*—the Lords of his life.

TRANSLATION

Making Lord Caitanya and Lord Nityānanda the Lords of his life, Gaurīdāsa Paṇḍita sacrificed everything for the service of Lord Nityānanda, even the fellowship of his own family.

TEXT 28

nityānanda prabhura priya—paṇḍita purandara

premārṇava-madhye phire yaichana mandara

SYNONYMS

nityānanda—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *priya*—very dear; *paṇḍita purandara*—Paṇḍita Purandara; *prema-arṇava-madhye*—in the ocean of love of Godhead; *phire*—moved; *yaichana*—exactly like; *mandara*—the Mandara Hill.

TRANSLATION

The thirteenth important devotee of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu was Paṇḍita Purandara, who moved in the ocean of love of Godhead just like the Mandara Hill.

PURPORT

Paṇḍita Purandara met Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu at Khaḍadaha. When Nityānanda Prabhu visited this village, He danced very uncommonly, and His dancing captivated Purandara Paṇḍita. The *paṇḍita* was in the top of a tree, and upon seeing the dancing of Nityānanda he jumped down on the ground and proclaimed himself to be Aṅgada, one of the devotees in the camp of Hanumān during the pastimes of Lord Rāmacandra.

TEXT 29

parameśvara-dāsa—nityānandaika-śaraṇa

kṛṣṇa-bhakti pāya, tāñre ye kare smaraṇa

SYNONYMS

parameśvara-dāsa—Parameśvara dāsa; *nityānanda-eka-śaraṇa*—completely surrendered to the lotus feet of Nityānanda; *kṛṣṇa-bhakti pāya*—gets love of Kṛṣṇa; *tāñre*—him; *ye*—anyone; *kare*—does; *smaraṇa*—remembering.

TRANSLATION

Parameśvara dāsa, said to be the fifth gopāla of kṛṣṇa-līlā, completely surrendered to the lotus feet of Nityānanda. Anyone who remembers his name, Parameśvara dāsa, will get love of Kṛṣṇa very easily.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* states that Parameśvara dāsa, known sometimes as Parameśvarī dāsa, was the life and soul of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. The body of Parameśvara dāsa was the place of Lord Nityānanda’s pastimes. Parameśvara dāsa, who lived for some time at Khaḍadaha village, was always filled with the ecstasy of a cowherd boy. Formerly he was Arjuna, a friend of Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma. He was the fifth among the twelve

gopālas. He accompanied Śrīmatī Jāhnavā-devī when she performed the festival at Khetari. It is stated in the *Bhakti-ratnākara* that by the order of Śrīmatī Jāhnavā-mātā, he installed Rādhā-Gopīnātha in the temple at Āṭapura, in the district of Hugli. The Āṭapura station is on the narrow-gauge railway line between Howrah and Āmatā. Another temple in Āṭapura, established by the Mitra family, is known as the Rādhā-Govinda temple. In front of the temple, in a very attractive place among two *bakula* trees and a *kadamba* tree, is the tomb of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura, and above it is an altar with a *tulasī* bush. It is said that only one flower a year comes out of the *kadamba* tree. It is offered to the Deity.

“Parameśvarī Ṭhākura belonged, it is said, to a *vaidya* family. A descendant of his brother’s is at present a worshiper in the temple. Some of their family members still reside in the district of Hugli, near the post office of Caṇḍitalā. The descendants of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura took many disciples from *brāhmaṇa* families, but as these descendants gradually took to the profession of physicians, persons from *brāhmaṇa* families ceased becoming their disciples. The family titles of Parameśvarī’s descendants are Adhikārī and Gupta. Unfortunately, his family members do not worship the Deity directly; they have engaged paid *brāhmaṇas* to worship the Deity. In the temple, Baladeva and Śrī Śrī Rādhā-Gopīnātha are together on the throne. It is supposed that the Deity of Baladeva was installed later because according to transcendental mellow, Baladeva, Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā cannot stay on the same throne. On the full-moon day of Vaiśākha (April-May), the disappearance festival of Parameśvarī Ṭhākura is observed in this temple.”

TEXT 30

jagadīśa paṇḍita haya jagat-pāvana

kṛṣṇa-premāmṛta varṣe, yena varṣā ghana

SYNONYMS

jagadīśa paṇḍita—Jagadīśa Paṇḍita; *haya*—becomes; *jagat-pāvana*—the deliverer of the world; *kṛṣṇa-prema-amṛta varṣe*—he always pours torrents of devotional service; *yena*—like; *varṣā*—rainfall; *ghana*—heavy.

TRANSLATION

Jagadīśa Paṇḍita, the fifteenth branch of Lord Nityānanda’s followers, was the deliverer of the entire world. Devotional love of Kṛṣṇa showered from him like torrents of rain.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Descriptions of Jagadīśa Paṇḍita are available from the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Six, and the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, *Ādi-līlā*, Chapter Fourteen. He belonged to the village of Yaśaḍā-grāma, in the district of Nadia near the Cākadaha railway station. His father, the son of Bhaṭṭa Nārāyaṇa, was named Kamalākṣa. Both his father and mother were great devotees of Lord Viṣṇu, and after their death, Jagadīśa, with his wife Duḥkhiṇī and brother Maheśa, left his birthplace and came to Śrī Māyāpur to live in the company of Jagannātha Miśra and other Vaiṣṇavas. Lord Caitanya asked Jagadīśa to go to Jagannātha Purī to preach the *hari-nāma-saṅkīrtana* movement. After returning from Jagannātha Purī, on the order of Lord Jagannātha he established Deities of Jagannātha in the village of Yaśaḍā-grāma. It is said that when Jagadīśa Paṇḍita brought the Deity of Jagannātha to Yaśaḍā-grāma, he tied the heavy Deity to a stick and thus brought Him to the village. The priests of the temple still show the stick used by Jagadīśa Paṇḍita to carry the Jagannātha Deity.”

xxTEXT 31

nityānanda-priyabhṛtya paṇḍita dhanañjaya

atyanta virakta, sadā kṛṣṇa-premamaya

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-priya-bhṛtya—another dear servant of Nityānanda Prabhu;
paṇḍita dhanañjaya—Paṇḍita Dhanañjaya; *atyanta*—very much;
virakta—renounced; *sadā*—always; *kṛṣṇa-prema-maya*—merged in love
of Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

The sixteenth dear servant of Nityānanda Prabhu was Dhanañjaya Paṇḍita. He was very much renounced and always merged in love of Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Paṇḍita Dhanañjaya was a resident of the village in Katwa named Śītala. He was one of the twelve *gopālas*. His former name, according to the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (127), was Vasudāma. Śītala-grāma is situated near the Maṅgalakoṭa police station and Kaicara post office in the district of Burdwan. On the narrow railway from Burdwan to Katwa is a railway station about nine miles from Katwa known as Kaicara. One has to go about a mile northeast of this station to reach Śītala. The temple was a thatched house with walls made of dirt. Some time ago, the zamindars of Bājāravana Kābāśī, the Mulliks, constructed a big house for the purpose of a temple, but for the last sixty-five years the temple has been broken down and abandoned. The foundation of the old temple is still visible. There is a *tulasī* pillar near the temple, and every year during the month of Kārtika (October–November) the disappearance day of Dhanañjaya is observed. It is said that for some time Paṇḍita Dhanañjaya was in a *saṅkīrtana* party under the direction of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and then he went to Vṛndāvana. Before going to Vṛndāvana, he lived for some time in a village named Sāñcaḍāpāñcaḍā, which is six miles south of

the Memārī railway station. Sometimes this village is also known as ‘the place of Dhanañjaya’ (Dhanañjayera Pāṭa). After some time, he left the responsibility for worship with a disciple and went back to Vṛndāvana. After returning from Vṛndāvana to Śītala-grāma, he established a Deity of Gaurasundara in the temple. The descendants of Paṇḍita Dhanañjaya still live in Śītala-grāma and look after the temple worship.”

TEXT 32

maheśa paṇḍita—vrajera udāra gopāla

dhakkā-vādye nṛtya kare preme mātoyāla

SYNONYMS

maheśa paṇḍita—Maheśa Paṇḍita; *vrajera*—of Vṛndāvana; *udāra*—very liberal; *gopāla*—cowherd boy; *dhakkā-vādye*—with the beating of a kettledrum; *nṛtya kare*—used to dance; *preme*—in love; *mātoyāla*—as if a madman.

TRANSLATION

Maheśa Paṇḍita, the seventh of the twelve gopālas, was very liberal. In great love of Kṛṣṇa he danced to the beating of a kettledrum like a madman.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “The village of Maheśa Paṇḍita, which is known as Pālapāḍā, is situated in the district of Nadia within a forest about one mile south of the Cākadaha railway station. The Ganges flows nearby. It is said that formerly Maheśa Paṇḍita lived on the eastern side of Jirāṭ in the village known as Masipura or Yaśīpura, and when Masipura merged into the riverbed of the Ganges, the Deities there were brought to Pālapāḍā, which is situated in the midst

of various villages such as Beleḍāṅgā, Berigrāma, Sukhasāgara, Cānduḍe and Manasāpotā. (There are about fourteen villages, and the entire neighborhood is known as Pāñcanagara Paragaṇā.) It is mentioned that Maheśa Paṇḍita joined the festival performed by Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu at Pānihāṭi. Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura also joined in the festival, and Maheśa Paṇḍita saw him on that occasion. In the temple of Maheśa Paṇḍita there are Deities of Gaura-Nityānanda, Śrī Gopīnātha, Śrī Madana-mohana and Rādhā-Govinda, as well as a *śālagrāma-sīlā*.”

TEXT 33

navadvīpe puruṣottama paṇḍita mahāśaya

nityānanda-nāme yāñra mahonmāda haya

SYNONYMS

navadvīpe puruṣottama—Puruṣottama of Navadvīpa; *paṇḍita mahāśaya*—a very learned scholar; *nityānanda-nāme*—in the name of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *yāñra*—whose; *mahā-unmāda*—great ecstasy; *haya*—becomes.

TRANSLATION

Puruṣottama Paṇḍita, a resident of Navadvīpa, was the eighth gopāla. He would become almost mad as soon as he heard the holy name of Nityānanda Prabhu.

PURPORT

It is stated in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* that Puruṣottama Paṇḍita was born in Navadvīpa and was a great devotee of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu. As one of the twelve *gopālas*, his former name was Stokakṛṣṇa.

TEXT 34

balarāma dāsa—kr̥ṣṇa-prema-rasāsvādī

nityānanda-nāme haya parama unmādī

SYNONYMS

balarāma-dāsa—Balarāma dāsa; *kr̥ṣṇa-prema-rasa*—the nectar of always merging in love of Kṛṣṇa; *āsvādī*—fully tasting; *nityānanda-nāme*—in the name of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu; *haya*—becomes; *parama*—greatly; *unmādī*—maddened.

TRANSLATION

Balarāma dāsa always fully tasted the nectar of love of Kṛṣṇa. Upon hearing the name of Nityānanda Prabhu, he would become greatly maddened.

TEXT 35

mahā-bhāgavata yadunātha kavicandra

yānhāra hṛdaye nṛtya kare nityānanda

SYNONYMS

mahā-bhāgavata—a great devotee; *yadunātha kavicandra*—Yadunātha Kavicandra; *yānhāra*—whose; *hṛdaye*—in the heart; *nṛtya*—dancing; *kare*—does; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

Yadunātha Kavicandra was a great devotee. Lord Nityānanda Prabhu always danced in his heart.

PURPORT

In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter One, it is said that a gentleman known as Ratnagarbha Ācārya was a friend of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's father. They had been residents of the same village. Ratnagarbha Ācārya had three sons—Kṛṣṇānanda, Jīva and Yadunātha Kavicandra.

TEXT 36

rāḍhe yāñra janma kṛṣṇadāsa dvijavara

śrī-nityānandera teñho parama kiṅkara

SYNONYMS

rāḍhe—in West Bengal; *yāñra*—whose; *janma*—birth; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa; *dvija-vara*—the best *brāhmaṇa*; *śrī-nityānandera*—of Nityānanda Prabhu; *teñho*—he; *parama*—first-class; *kiṅkara*—servant.

TRANSLATION

The twenty-first devotee of Śrī Nityānanda in Bengal was Kṛṣṇadāsa Brāhmaṇa, who was a first-class servant of the Lord.

PURPORT

In this verse the word *rāḍhe* refers to Rāḍhadeśa, the part of Bengal where the Ganges does not flow.

TEXT 37

kālā-kṛṣṇadāsa baḍa vaiṣṇava-pradhāna

nityānanda-candra vinu nahi jāne āna

SYNONYMS

kālā-kṛṣṇadāsa—Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa; *baḍa*—great; *vaiṣṇava-pradhāna*—first-class Vaiṣṇava; *nityānanda-candra*—Lord Nityānanda; *vinu*—except; *nāhi jāne*—he did not know; *āna*—of anything else.

TRANSLATION

The twenty-second devotee of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu was Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa, who was the ninth cowherd boy. He was a first-class Vaiṣṇava and did not know anything beyond Nityānanda Prabhu.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (132) it is said that Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa, who was also known as Kāliyā Kṛṣṇadāsa, was formerly a *gopa* (cowherd boy) of the name Lavaṅga. He was one of the twelve cowherd boys.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Kāliyā Kṛṣṇadāsa had his headquarters in a village named Ākāihāṭa, which is situated in the district of Burdwan within the jurisdiction of the post office and police station of Katwa. It is situated on the road to Navadvīpa. To reach Ākāihāṭa, one has to go from the Byāṇḍel junction station to the Katwa railway station and then go about two miles, or one has to get off at the Dānihāṭa station and from there go one mile. The village of Ākāihāṭa is very small. In the month of Caitra, on the day of Vāruṇī, there is a festival commemorating the disappearance day of Kālā Kṛṣṇadāsa.”

TEXT 38

śrī-sadāśīva kavirāja—*baḍa mahāśāya*

śrī-puruṣottama-dāsa—*tānhāra tanaya*

SYNONYMS

śrī-sadāśīva kavirāja—Śrī Sadāśīva Kavirāja; *baḍa*—great; *mahāśāya*—respectable gentleman; *śrī-puruṣottama-dāsa*—Śrī Puruṣottama dāsa; *tānhāra tanaya*—his son.

TRANSLATION

The twenty-third and twenty-fourth prominent devotees of Nityānanda Prabhu were Sadāśīva Kavirāja and his son Puruṣottama dāsa, who was the tenth gopāla.

TEXT 39

ājanma nimagna nityānandera caraṇe

nirantara bālya-līlā kare kṛṣṇa-sane

SYNONYMS

ājanma—from birth; *nimagna*—merged; *nityānandera*—of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *caraṇe*—in the lotus feet; *nirantara*—always; *bālya-līlā*—childish play; *kare*—does; *kṛṣṇa-sane*—with Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

From birth, Puruṣottama dāsa was merged in the service of the lotus feet of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu, and he always engaged in childish play with Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Sadāśīva Kavirāja and Nāgara Puruṣottama, who were father and son, are described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* as *mahā-bhāgyavān*, greatly fortunate. They belonged to the *vaidya* caste of physicians. Text 156 of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* says that Candrāvalī, a most beloved *gopī* of

Kṛṣṇa's, later took birth as Sadāśiva Kavirāja. In texts 194 and 200 it is said that Kāmsāri Sena, the father of Sadāśiva Kavirāja, was formerly the *gopī* named Ratnāvalī in Kṛṣṇa's pastimes. All the family members of Sadāśiva Kavirāja were great devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Puruṣottama dāsa Ṭhākura sometimes lived at Sukhasāgara, near the Cākadaha and Śimurāli railway stations. All the Deities installed by Puruṣottama Ṭhākura were formerly situated in Beḍāṅgā-grāma, but when the temple was destroyed the Deities were brought to Sukhasāgara. When that temple merged into the bed of the Ganges, the Deities were brought with Jāhnavā-mātā's Deity to Sāhebaḍāṅgā Beḍigrāma. Since that place also has been destroyed, all the Deities are now situated in the village named Cānduḍe-grāma, which is situated one mile up from Pālapādā, as referred to above."

TEXT 40

tānra putra—mahāśaya śrī-kānu ṭhākura

yānra dehe rahe kṛṣṇa-premāmṛta-pūra

SYNONYMS

tānra putra—his son; *mahāśaya*—a respectable gentleman; *śrī-kānu ṭhākura*—Śrī Kānu Ṭhākura; *yānra*—whose; *dehe*—in the body; *rahe*—remained; *kṛṣṇa-prema-amṛta-pūra*—the nectar of devotional service to Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Kānu Ṭhākura, a very respectable gentleman, was the son of Puruṣottama dāsa Ṭhākura. He was such a great devotee that Lord Kṛṣṇa always lived in his body.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “To go to the headquarters of Kānu Ṭhākura, one has to proceed by boat from the Jhikaragāchā-ghāṭa station to the river known as Kapotākṣa. Otherwise, if one goes about two or two and a half miles from the Jhikaragāchā-ghāṭa station, he can see Bodhakhānā, the headquarters of Kānu Ṭhākura. The son of Sadāśiva was Puruṣottama Ṭhākura, and his son was Kānu Ṭhākura. The descendants of Kānu Ṭhākura know him as Nāgara Puruṣottama. He was the cowherd boy named Dāma during *kṛṣṇa-līlā*. It is said that just after the birth of Kānu Ṭhākura, his mother, Jāhnavā, died. When he was about twelve days old, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu took him to His home at Khāḍadaha. It is ascertained that Kānu Ṭhākura was born some time in the Bengali year 942 [A.D. 1535]. It is said that he took birth on the Ratha-yātrā day. Because he was a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa from the very beginning of his life, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu gave him the name Śīśu Kṛṣṇadāsa. When he was five years old he went to Vṛndāvana with Jāhnavā-mātā, and the Gosvāmīs, upon seeing the ecstatic symptoms of Kānu Ṭhākura, gave him the name Kānāi Ṭhākura.

“In the family of Kānu Ṭhākura there is a Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa Deity known as Prāṇavallabha. It is said that his family worshiped this Deity long before the appearance of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. When there was a Maharashtrian invasion of Bengal, the family of Kānu Ṭhākura was scattered, and after the invasion one Harikṛṣṇa Gosvāmī of that family came back to their original home, Bodhakhānā, and re-established the Prāṇavallabha Deity. The descendants of the family still engage in the service of Prāṇavallabha. Kānu Ṭhākura was present during the Kheṭari *utsava*, when Jāhnavā-devī and Vīrabhadra Gosvāmī were also present. One of Kānu Ṭhākura’s family members, Mādhavācārya, married the daughter of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, who was named Gaṅgādevī. Both Puruṣottama Ṭhākura and Kānu Ṭhākura had many disciples from *brāhmaṇa* families. Most of the disciplic descendants of Kānu Ṭhākura now reside in the village named Gaḍabetā, by the river Śilāvatī, in the Midnapore district.”

TEXT 41

mahā-bhāgavata-śreṣṭha datta uddhāraṇa

sarva-bhāve seve nityānandera caraṇa

SYNONYMS

mahā-bhāgavata—great devotee; *śreṣṭha*—chief; *datta*—the surname Datta; *uddhāraṇa*—Uddhāraṇa; *sarva-bhāve*—in all respects; *seve*—worships; *nityānandera*—of Lord Nityānanda; *caraṇa*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura, the eleventh among the twelve cowherd boys, was an exalted devotee of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu. He worshiped the lotus feet of Lord Nityānanda in all respects.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (129) states that Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura was formerly the cowherd boy of Vṛndāvana named Subāhu. Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura, previously known as Śrī Uddhāraṇa Datta, was a resident of Saptagrāma, which is situated on the bank of the Sarasvatī River near the Trisābighā railway station in the district of Hugli. At the time of Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura, Saptagrāma was a very big town, encompassing many other places such as Vāsudeva-pura, Bāṇśabeḍiyā, Kṛṣṇapura, Nityānanda-pura, Śivapura, Śaṅkhanagara and Saptagrāma.”

Calcutta was developed under British rule by the influential mercantile community, and especially by the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* community who came down from Saptagrāma to establish their businesses and homes all over Calcutta. They were known as the Saptagrāmī mercantile community of Calcutta, and most of them belonged to the Mullick and Sil families. More

than half of Calcutta belonged to this community, as did Śrīla Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura. Our paternal family also came from this district and belonged to the same community. The Mulliks of Calcutta are divided into two families, namely the Sil family and De family. All the Mulliks of the De family originally belong to the same family and *gotra*. We also formerly belonged to the branch of the De family whose members, intimately connected with the Muslim rulers, received the title Mullik.

In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Five, it is said that Uddhāraṇa Datta was an extremely elevated and liberal Vaiṣṇava. He was born with the right to worship Nityānanda Prabhu. It is also stated that Nityānanda Prabhu, after staying for some time in Khaḍadaha, came to Saptagrāma and stayed in the house of Uddhāraṇa Datta. The *suvarṇa-vaṇik* community to which Uddhāraṇa Datta belonged was actually a Vaiṣṇava community. Its members were bankers and gold merchants (*suvarṇa* means “gold,” and *vaṇik* means “merchant”). Long ago there was a misunderstanding between Ballāl Sena and the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* community because of the great banker Gaurī Sena. Ballāl Sena was taking loans from Gaurī Sena and spending money extravagantly, and therefore Gaurī Sena stopped supplying money. Ballāl Sena took revenge by instigating a social conspiracy to make the *suvarṇa-vaṇiks* outcastes, and since then they have been ostracized from the higher castes, namely the *brāhmaṇas*, *kṣatriyas* and *vaiśyas*. But by the grace of Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu, the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* community was again elevated. It is said in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *yateka vaṇik-kula uddhāraṇa haite pavitra ha-ila dvidhā nāhika ihāte*: there is no doubt that all the community members of the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* society were again purified by Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu.

In Saptagrāma there is still a temple with a six-armed Deity of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu that was personally worshiped by Śrīla Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura. On the right side of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is a Deity of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, and on the left side is Gadādhara Prabhu. There are also a Rādhā-Govinda *mūrti* and a *śālagrāma-śilā*, and below the throne is a picture of Śrī Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura. In front of the

temple there is now a big hall, and in front of the hall is a Mādhavī-latā plant. The temple is in a very shady, cool and nicely situated location. When we returned from America in 1967, the executive committee members of this temple invited us to visit it, and thus we had the opportunity to visit this temple with some American students. Formerly, in our childhood, we visited this temple with our parents because all the members of the *suvarṇa-vaṇik* community enthusiastically take interest in this temple of Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura.

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura adds in his *Anubhāṣya*: “In the Bengali year 1283 [A.D. 1876] a *bābājī* of the name Nitāi dāsa arranged for a donation of twelve *bighās* of land (about four acres) for the temple where Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura worshiped. The management of the temple later deteriorated, but then in 1306 (A.D. 1899), through the cooperation of the famous Balarāma Mullik of Hugli, who was a subjudge, and many rich *suvarṇa-vaṇik* community members, the management of the temple improved greatly. Not more than fifty years ago, one of the family members of Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura named Jagamohana Datta established a wooden *mūrti* [statue] of Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura in the temple, but that *mūrti* is no longer there; at present, a picture of Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura is worshiped. It is understood, however, that the wooden *mūrti* of Uddhāraṇa Ṭhākura was taken away by Śrī Madana-mohana Datta and is now being worshiped with a *sālagrāma-sīlā* by Śrīnātha Datta.

“Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura was the manager of the estate of a big zamindar in Naihātī, about one and a half miles north of Katwa. The relics of this royal family are still visible near the Dāināhāṭa station. Since Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura was the manager of the estate, it was also known as Uddhāraṇa-pura. Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura installed Nitāi-Gaura Deities that were later brought to the house of the zamindar, which was known as Vanaoyārībāda. Śrīla Uddhāraṇa Datta Ṭhākura remained a householder throughout his life. His father’s name was Śrīkara Datta, his mother’s name was Bhadrāvatī, and his son’s name was Śrīnivāsa Datta.”

TEXT 42

ācārya vaiṣṇavānanda bhakti-adhikārī

pūrve nāma chila yāñra ‘raghunātha purī’

SYNONYMS

ācārya—teacher; *vaiṣṇavānanda*—Vaiṣṇavānanda; *bhakti*—devotional service; *adhikārī*—fit candidate; *pūrve*—previously; *nāma*—name; *chila*—was; *yāñra*—whose; *raghunātha purī*—Raghunātha Purī.

TRANSLATION

The twenty-seventh prominent devotee of Nityānanda Prabhu was Ācārya Vaiṣṇavānanda, a great personality in devotional service. He was formerly known as Raghunātha Purī.

PURPORT

In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (97) it is said that Raghunātha Purī was previously very powerful in the eight mystic successes. He was an incarnation of one of the successes.

TEXT 43

viṣṇudāsa, nandana, gaṅgādāsa— —tina bhāi

pūrve yāñra ghare chilā ṭhākura nitāi

SYNONYMS

viṣṇudāsa—Viṣṇudāsa; *nandana*—Nandana; *gaṅgādāsa*—Gaṅgādāsa; *tina bhāi*—three brothers; *pūrve*—previously; *yāñra*—whose; *ghare*—in the house; *chilā*—stayed; *ṭhākura nitāi*—Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

Another important devotee of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu was Viṣṇudāsa, who had two brothers, Nandana and Gaṅgādāsa. Lord Nityānanda Prabhu sometimes stayed at their house.

PURPORT

The three brothers Viṣṇudāsa, Nandana and Gaṅgādāsa were residents of Navadvīpa and belonged to the Bhaṭṭācārya *brāhmaṇa* family. Both Viṣṇudāsa and Gaṅgādāsa stayed for some time with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī, and the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* states that formerly Nityānanda Prabhu stayed at their house.

TEXT 44

nityānanda-bhṛtya—paramānanda upādhyāya

śrī-jīva paṇḍita nityānanda-guṇa gāya

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-bhṛtya—servant of Nityānanda Prabhu; *paramānanda upādhyāya*—Paramānanda Upādhyāya; *śrī-jīva paṇḍita*—Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *guṇa*—qualities; *gāya*—glorified.

TRANSLATION

Paramānanda Upādhyāya was Nityānanda Prabhu's great servitor. Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita glorified the qualities of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu.

PURPORT

Śrī Paramānanda Upādhyāya was an advanced devotee. His name is

mentioned in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, where Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita is also mentioned as the second son of Ratnagarbha Ācārya and a childhood friend of Hāḍāi Ojhā, the father of Nityānanda Prabhu. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (169) it is said that Śrī Jīva Paṇḍita was formerly the *gopī* named Indirā.

TEXT 45

paramānanda gupta—kṛṣṇa-bhakta mahāmatī

pūrve yāñra ghare nityānandera vasatī

SYNONYMS

paramānanda gupta—Paramānanda Gupta; *kṛṣṇa-bhakta*—a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mahā-matī*—advanced in spiritual consciousness; *pūrve*—formerly; *yāñra*—whose; *ghare*—in the house; *nityānandera*—of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *vasatī*—residence.

TRANSLATION

The thirty-first devotee of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu was Paramānanda Gupta, who was greatly devoted to Lord Kṛṣṇa and highly advanced in spiritual consciousness. Formerly Nityānanda Prabhu also resided at his house for some time.

PURPORT

Paramānanda Gupta composed a prayer to Lord Kṛṣṇa known as *Kṛṣṇa-stavāvalī*. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (194 and 199) it is stated that he was formerly the *gopī* named Mañjumedhā.

TEXT 46

nārāyaṇa, kṛṣṇadāsa āra manohara

devānanda—*cāri bhāi nitāi-kiṅkara*

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇa—Nārāyaṇa; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa; *āra*—and; *manohara*—Manohara; *devānanda*—Devānanda; *cāri bhāi*—four brothers; *nitāi-kiṅkara*—servants of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

The thirty-second, thirty-third, thirty-fourth and thirty-fifth prominent devotees were Nārāyaṇa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, Manohara and Devānanda, who always engaged in the service of Lord Nityānanda.

TEXT 47

hoḍa kṛṣṇadāsa—*nityānanda-prabhu-prāṇa*

nityānanda-pada vinu nāhi jāne āna

SYNONYMS

hoḍa kṛṣṇadāsa—Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa; *nityānanda-prabhu*—of Lord Nityānanda; *prāṇa*—life and soul; *nityānanda-pada*—the lotus feet of Lord Nityānanda; *vinu*—except; *nāhi*—does not; *jāne*—know; *āna*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

The thirty-sixth devotee of Lord Nityānanda was Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa, whose life and soul was Nityānanda Prabhu. He was always dedicated to the lotus feet of Nityānanda, and he knew no one else but Him.

PURPORT

The residence of Kṛṣṇadāsa Hoḍa was Baḍagāchi, which is now in Bangladesh.

TEXT 48

nakaḍi, mukunda, sūrya, mādharma, śrīdhara

rāmānanda vasu, jagannātha, mahīdhara

SYNONYMS

nakaḍi—Nakaḍi; *mukunda*—Mukunda; *sūrya*—Sūrya; *mādharma*—Mādharma; *śrīdhara*—Śrīdhara; *rāmānanda vasu*—Rāmānanda Vasu; *jagannātha*—Jagannātha; *mahīdhara*—Mahīdhara.

TRANSLATION

Among Lord Nityānanda's devotees, Nakaḍi was the thirty-seventh, Mukunda the thirty-eighth, Sūrya the thirty-ninth, Mādharma the fortieth, Śrīdhara the forty-first, Rāmānanda the forty-second, Jagannātha the forty-third and Mahīdhara the forty-fourth.

PURPORT

Śrīdhara was the twelfth *gopāla*.

TEXT 49

śrīmanta, gokula-dāsa hariharānanda

śivāi, nandāi, avadhūta paramānanda

SYNONYMS

śrī-manta—Śrīmanta; *gokula-dāsa*—Gokula dāsa; *hariharānanda*—

Hariharānanda; *śivāi*—Śivāi; *nandāi*—Nandāi; *avadhūta paramānanda*—Avadhūta Paramānanda.

TRANSLATION

Śrīmanta was the forty-fifth, Gokula dāsa the forty-sixth, Hariharānanda the forty-seventh, Śivāi the forty-eighth, Nandāi the forty-ninth and Paramānanda the fiftieth.

TEXT 50

vasanta, navanī hoḍa, gopāla, sanātana

viṣṇāi hājarā, kṛṣṇānanda, sulocana

SYNONYMS

vasanta—Vasanta; *navanī hoḍa*—Navanī Hoḍa; *gopāla*—Gopāla; *sanātana*—Sanātana; *viṣṇāi hājarā*—Viṣṇāi Hājarā; *kṛṣṇānanda*—Kṛṣṇānanda; *sulocana*—Sulocana.

TRANSLATION

Vasanta was the fifty-first, Navanī Hoḍa the fifty-second, Gopāla the fifty-third, Sanātana the fifty-fourth, Viṣṇāi the fifty-fifth, Kṛṣṇānanda the fifty-sixth and Sulocana the fifty-seventh.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Navanī Hoḍa appears to have been the same person as Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa, the son of the King of Baḍagāchi. His father’s name was Hari Hoḍa. One can visit Baḍagāchi by taking the Lālagolā-ghāṭa railway line. Formerly the Ganges flowed by Baḍagāchi, but now it has become a canal known as the Kālśira Khāla. Near the Muḍāgāchā station is a village known as

Śaligrāma in which King Kṛṣṇadāsa arranged for the marriage of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, as described in the *Bhakti-ratnākara* (Twelfth Wave). It is sometimes said that Navanī Hoḍa was the son of Rāja Kṛṣṇadāsa. His descendants still live in Rukuṇapura, a village near Bahiragāchi. They belong to the *dakṣiṇa-rādhīya-kāyastha* community, but, having been reformed as *brāhmaṇas*, they still initiate all classes of men.”

TEXT 51

kaṁsāri sena, rāmasena, rāmacandra kavirāja

govinda, śrīraṅga, mukunda, tina kavirāja

SYNONYMS

kaṁsāri sena—Kaṁsāri Sena; *rāmasena*—Rāmasena; *rāmacandra kavirāja*—Rāmacandra Kavirāja; *govinda*—Govinda; *śrīraṅga*—Śrīraṅga; *mukunda*—Mukunda; *tina kavirāja*—all three are Kavirājas, or physicians.

TRANSLATION

The fifty-eighth great devotee of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu was Kaṁsāri Sena, the fifty-ninth was Rāmasena, the sixtieth was Rāmacandra Kavirāja, and the sixty-first, sixty-second and sixty-third were Govinda, Śrīraṅga and Mukunda, who were all physicians.

PURPORT

Śrī Rāmacandra Kavirāja, the son of Khaṇḍavāsī Cirañjīva and Sunanda, was a disciple of Śrīnivāsa Ācārya and the most intimate friend of Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura, who prayed several times for his association. His youngest brother was Govinda Kavirāja. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī very much appreciated Śrī Rāmacandra Kavirāja’s great devotion to Lord

Kṛṣṇa and therefore gave him the title Kavirāja. Śrī Rāmacandra Kavirāja, who was perpetually disinterested in family life, greatly assisted in the preaching work of Śrīnivāsa Ācārya and Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura. He resided at first in Śrīkhaṇḍa but later in the village of Kumāra-nagara, on the bank of the Ganges.

Govinda Kavirāja was the brother of Rāmacandra Kavirāja and youngest son of Cirañjīva of Śrīkhaṇḍa. Although at first a *śākta*, or worshiper of goddess Durgā, he was later initiated by Śrīnivāsa Ācārya Prabhu. Govinda Kavirāja also resided first in Śrīkhaṇḍa and then in Kumāra-nagara, but later he moved to the village known as Teliyā Budhari, on the southern bank of the river Padmā. Since Govinda Kavirāja, the author of two books, *Saṅgīta-mādhava* and *Gītāmṛta*, was a great Vaiṣṇava *kavi*, or poet, Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī gave him the title Kavirāja. He is described in the *Bhakti-ratnākara* (Ninth Wave).

Kaṁsāri Sena was formerly Ratnāvalī in Vraja, as described in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (194 and 200).

TEXT 52

pītāmbara, mādhavācārya, dāsa dāmodara

śaṅkara, mukunda, jñāna-dāsa, manohara

SYNONYMS

pītāmbara—Pītāmbara; *mādhavācārya*—Mādhavācārya; *dāsa dāmodara*—Dāmodara dāsa; *śaṅkara*—Śaṅkara; *mukunda*—Mukunda; *jñāna-dāsa*—Jñāna dāsa; *manohara*—Manohara.

TRANSLATION

Among the devotees of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu, Pītāmbara was the sixty-fourth, Mādhavācārya the sixty-fifth, Dāmodara dāsa the sixty-

sixth, Śaṅkara the sixty-seventh, Mukunda the sixty-eighth, Jñāna dāsa the sixty-ninth and Manohara the seventieth.

TEXT 53

nartaka gopāla, rāmabhadra, gaurāṅga-dāsa

nṛsimha-caitanya, mīnaketana rāmadāsa

SYNONYMS

nartaka gopāla—the dancer Gopāla; *rāmabhadra*—Rāmabhadra;
gaurāṅga-dāsa—Gaurāṅga dāsa; *nṛsimha-caitanya*—Nṛsimha-caitanya;
mīnaketana rāma-dāsa—Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.

TRANSLATION

The dancer Gopāla was the seventy-first, Rāmabhadra the seventy-second, Gaurāṅga dāsa the seventy-third, Nṛsimha-caitanya the seventy-fourth and Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa the seventy-fifth.

PURPORT

The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (68) describes Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa as an incarnation of Śaṅkarṣaṇa.

TEXT 54

vṛndāvana-dāsa—nārāyaṇīra nandana

‘caitanya-maṅgala’ yeṇho karila racana

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-dāsa—Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *nārāyaṇīra nandana*—

son of Nārāyaṇī; *caitanya-maṅgala*—the book of the name *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *yeṇho*—who; *karila*—did; *racana*—composition.

TRANSLATION

Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, the son of Śrīmatī Nārāyaṇī, composed Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala [later known as Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata].

TEXT 55

bhāgavate kṛṣṇa-līlā varṇilā vedavyāsa

caitanya-līlāte vyāsa—vṛndāvana dāsa

SYNONYMS

bhāgavate—in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *kṛṣṇa-līlā*—the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *varṇilā*—described; *veda-vyāsa*—Dvaipāyana Vyāsadeva; *caitanya-līlāte*—in the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *vyāsa*—Vedavyāsa; *vṛndāvana dāsa*—Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Vyāsadeva described the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. The Vyāsa of the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was Vṛndāvana dāsa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura was an incarnation of Vedavyāsa and also a friendly cowherd boy named Kusumāpīḍa in *kṛṣṇa-līlā*. In other words, the author of *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, the son of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura's niece Nārāyaṇī, was a combined incarnation of Vedavyāsa and the cowherd boy Kusumāpīḍa. There is a descriptive statement by Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura in his commentary

on *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata* giving the biographical details of the life of Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura.

TEXT 56

sarvaśākhā-śreṣṭha vīrabhadra gosāñi

tāñra upaśākhā yata, tāra anta nāi

SYNONYMS

sarva-śākhā-śreṣṭha—the best of all the branches; *vīrabhadra gosāñi*—Vīrabhadra Gosāñi; *tāñra upaśākhā*—His subbranches; *yata*—all; *tāra*—of them; *anta*—limit; *nāi*—there is not.

TRANSLATION

Among all the branches of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, Vīrabhadra Gosāñi was the topmost. His subbranches were unlimited.

TEXT 57

ananta nityānanda-gaṇa—ke karu gaṇana

ātma-pavitratā-hetu likhilān kata jana

SYNONYMS

ananta—unlimited; *nityānanda-gaṇa*—followers of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu; *ke karu*—who can; *gaṇana*—count; *ātma-pavitratā*—of self-purification; *hetu*—for the reason; *likhilān*—I have written; *kata jana*—some of them.

TRANSLATION

No one can count the unlimited followers of Nityānanda Prabhu. I have mentioned some of them just for my self-purification.

TEXT 58

ei sarva-śākhā pūrṇa—pakva prema-phale

yāre dekhe, tāre diyā bhāsāila sakale

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *sarva-śākhā*—all branches; *pūrṇa*—complete; *pakva prema-phale*—with ripened fruits of love of Godhead; *yāre dekhe*—whomever they see; *tāre diyā*—distributing to him; *bhāsāila*—overflowed; *sakale*—all of them.

TRANSLATION

All these branches, the devotees of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu, being full of ripened fruits of love of Kṛṣṇa, distributed these fruits to all they met, flooding them with love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 59

anargala prema sabāra, ceṣṭā anargala

prema dite, kṛṣṇa dite dhare mahābala

SYNONYMS

anargala—unchecked; *prema*—love of Kṛṣṇa; *sabāra*—of everyone of them; *ceṣṭā*—activity; *anargala*—unchecked; *prema dite*—to give love of Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṣṇa dite*—to deliver Kṛṣṇa; *dhare*—they possess; *mahābala*—great strength.

TRANSLATION

All these devotees had unlimited strength to deliver unobstructed, unceasing love of Kṛṣṇa. By their own strength they could offer anyone Kṛṣṇa and love of Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura has sung, *kṛṣṇa se tomāra, kṛṣṇa dite pāra, tomāra śakati āche*. In this song, Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura describes that a pure Vaiṣṇava, as the proprietor of Kṛṣṇa and love of Kṛṣṇa, can deliver both to anyone and everyone he likes. Therefore to get Kṛṣṇa and love of Kṛṣṇa one must seek the mercy of pure devotees. Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura also says, *yasya prasādād bhagavat-prasādo yasyāprasādān na gatiḥ kuto 'pi*: ** “By the mercy of the spiritual master one is blessed by the mercy of Kṛṣṇa. Without the grace of the spiritual master one cannot make any advancement.” By the grace of a Vaiṣṇava or bona fide spiritual master one can get both love of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa Himself.

TEXT 60

saṅkṣepe kahilān ei nityānanda-gaṇa

yānhāra avadhi nā pāya 'sahasra-vadana'

SYNONYMS

saṅkṣepe—in brief; *kahilān*—described; *ei*—these; *nityānanda-gaṇa*—devotees of Lord Nityānanda; *yānhāra*—of whom; *avadhi*—limitation; *nā*—does not; *pāya*—get; *sahasra-vadana*—the thousand-mouthed Śeṣa Nāga, on whom Lord Viṣṇu lies.

TRANSLATION

I have briefly described only some of the followers and devotees of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu. Even the thousand-mouthed Śeṣa Nāga cannot describe all of these unlimited devotees.

TEXT 61

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

With an ardent desire to serve the purpose of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Eleventh Chapter, in the matter of the expansions of Lord Nityānanda.

Chapter 12

The Expansions of Advaita Ācārya and Gadādhara Paṇḍita

Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura gives a summary of the Twelfth Chapter in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. The Twelfth Chapter describes the followers of

Advaita Prabhu, among whom the followers of Acyutānanda, the son of Advaita Ācārya, are understood to be the pure followers who received the cream of the philosophy Śrī Advaita Ācārya enunciated. Other so-called descendants and followers of Advaita Ācārya are not to be recognized. This chapter also includes narrations concerning the son of Advaita Ācārya named Gopāla Miśra and Advaita Ācārya's servant named Kamalākānta Viśvāsa. In his early life Gopāla fainted during the cleansing of the Guṇḍicā-mandira at Jagannātha Purī and thus became a recipient of the mercy of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The story of Kamalākānta Viśvāsa concerns his borrowing three hundred rupees from Pratāparudra Mahārāja to clear a debt of Advaita Ācārya's, for which Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu chastised him when He came to know of it. Kamalākānta Viśvāsa was then purified by the request of Śrī Advaita Ācārya. After describing the descendants of Advaita Ācārya, the chapter concludes by describing the followers of Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosvāmī.

TEXT 1

advaitāṅghry-abja-bhṛṅgāms tān

sārāsāra-bhṛto 'khilān

hitvāsārān sāra-bhṛto

naumi caitanya-jīvanān

SYNONYMS

advaita-aṅghri—the lotus feet of Advaita Ācārya; *abja*—lotus flower; *bhṛṅgān*—bumblebees; *tān*—all of them; *sāra-asāra*—real and not real; *bhṛtaḥ*—accepting; *akhilān*—all of them; *hitvā*—giving up; *asārān*—not real; *sāra-bhṛtaḥ*—those who are real; *naumi*—offer my obeisances; *caitanya-jīvanān*—whose life and soul was Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

The followers of Śrī Advaita Prabhu were of two kinds. Some were real followers, and the others were false. Rejecting the false followers, I offer my respectful obeisances to Śrī Advaita Ācārya's real followers, whose life and soul was Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya mahāprabhu śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

jaya jaya nityānanda jayādvaita dhanya

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *mahāprabhu*—Mahāprabhu; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; *jaya jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *jaya advaita*—all glories to Advaita Prabhu; *dhanya*—who are all very glorious.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu! All glories to Lord Nityānanda! All glories to Śrī Advaita Prabhu! All of Them are glorious.

TEXT 3

śrī-caitanyāmara-taror

dvitīya-skandha-rūpiṇaḥ

śrīmad-advaita-candrasya

śākhā-rūpān gaṇān numaḥ

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *amara*—eternal; *taroḥ*—of the tree; *dvitīya*—second; *skandha*—big branch; *rūpiṇaḥ*—in the form of; *śrīmat*—the all-glorious; *advaita-candrasya*—of Lord Advaitacandra; *śākhā-rūpān*—in the form of branches; *gaṇān*—to all the followers; *numaḥ*—I offer my respectful obeisances.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances to the all-glorious Advaita Prabhu, who forms the second branch of the eternal Caitanya tree, and to His followers, who form His subbranches.

TEXT 4

vṛkṣera dvitīya skandha—ācārya-gosāñi

tāñra yata śākhā ha-ila, tāra lekhā nāñi

SYNONYMS

vṛkṣera—of the tree; *dvitīya skandha*—the second big branch; *ācārya-gosāñi*—Śrī Advaita Ācārya Gosvāmī; *tāñra*—His; *yata*—all; *śākhā*—branches; *ha-ila*—became; *tāra*—of that; *lekhā*—description; *nāñi*—there is not.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Prabhu was the second big branch of the tree. There are many subbranches, but it is impossible to mention them all.

TEXT 5

caitanya-mālira kṛpā-jalera secane

sei jale puṣṭa skandha bāḍe dine dine

SYNONYMS

caitanya-mālira—of the gardener named Caitanya; *kṛpā-jalera*—of the water of His mercy; *secane*—by sprinkling; *sei jale*—by that water; *puṣṭa*—nourished; *skandha*—branches; *bāde*—increased; *dine dine*—day after day.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was also the gardener, and as He poured the water of His mercy on the tree, all the branches and subbranches grew, day after day.

TEXT 6

sei skandhe yata prema-phala upajila

sei kṛṣṇa-prema-phale jagat bharila

SYNONYMS

sei skandhe—on that branch; *yata*—all; *prema-phala*—fruits of love of Godhead; *upajila*—grew; *sei*—those; *kṛṣṇa-prema-phale*—fruits of love of Kṛṣṇa; *jagat*—the whole world; *bharila*—spread over.

TRANSLATION

The fruits of love of Godhead that grew on those branches of the Caitanya tree were so large that they flooded the entire world with love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 7

sei jala skandhe kare sākḥāte sañcāra

phale-phule bāḍe,——śākhā ha-īla vistāra

SYNONYMS

sei jala—that water; *skandhe*—on the branches; *kare*—does; *śākhāte*—on the subbranches; *sañcāra*—growing; *phale-phule*—in fruits and flowers; *bāḍe*—increases; *śākhā*—the branches; *ha-īla*—became; *vistāra*—widespread.

TRANSLATION

As the trunk and branches were watered, the branches and subbranches spread lavishly, and the tree grew full with fruits and flowers.

TEXT 8

prathame ta' eka-mata ācāryera gaṇa

pāche dui-mata haila daivera kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

prathame—in the beginning; *ta'*—however; *eka-mata*—one opinion; *ācāryera*—of Advaita Ācārya; *gaṇa*—followers; *pāche*—later; *dui-mata*—two opinions; *haila*—became; *daivera*—of providence; *kāraṇa*—the cause.

TRANSLATION

At first all the followers of Advaita Ācārya shared a single opinion. But later they followed two different opinions, as ordained by providence.

PURPORT

The words *daivera kāraṇa* indicate that by dint of providence, or by God's

will, the followers of Advaita Ācārya divided into two parties. Such disagreement among the disciples of one *ācārya* is also found among the members of the Gauḍīya Maṭha. In the beginning, during the presence of Om Viṣṇupāda Paramahaṁsa Parivrājakācārya Aṣṭottara-śata Śrī Śrīmad Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura Prabhupāda, all the disciples worked in agreement; but just after his disappearance, they disagreed. One party strictly followed the instructions of Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, but another group created their own concoction about executing his desires. Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, at the time of his departure, requested all his disciples to form a governing body and conduct missionary activities cooperatively. He did not instruct a particular man to become the next *ācārya*. But just after his passing away, his leading secretaries made plans, without authority, to occupy the post of *ācārya*, and they split into two factions over who the next *ācārya* would be. Consequently, both factions were *asāra*, or useless, because they had no authority, having disobeyed the order of the spiritual master. Despite the spiritual master's order to form a governing body and execute the missionary activities of the Gauḍīya Maṭha, the two unauthorized factions began litigation that is still going on after forty years with no decision.

Therefore, we do not belong to any faction. But because the two parties, busy dividing the material assets of the Gauḍīya Maṭha institution, stopped the preaching work, we took up the mission of Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura and Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura to preach the cult of Caitanya Mahāprabhu all over the world, under the protection of all the predecessor *ācāryas*, and we find that our humble attempt has been successful. We followed the principles especially explained by Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura in his commentary on the *Bhagavad-gītā* verse beginning *vyavasāyātmikā buddhir ekeha kuru-nandana*. According to this instruction of Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura, it is the duty of a disciple to follow strictly the orders of his spiritual master. The secret of success in advancement in spiritual life is the firm faith of the disciple in the orders of his spiritual master. The *Vedas* confirm this:

*yasya deve parā bhaktir yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāḥ prakāśante mahātmanaḥ*
[ŚU ^{viii}6.23]

“To one who has staunch faith in the words of the spiritual master and the words of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the secret of success in Vedic knowledge is revealed.” The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is being propagated according to this principle, and therefore our preaching work is going on successfully, in spite of the many impediments offered by antagonistic demons, because we are getting positive help from our previous *ācāryas*. One must judge every action by its result. The members of the self-appointed *ācārya*’s party who occupied the property of the Gauḍīya Maṭha are satisfied, but they could make no progress in preaching. Therefore by the result of their actions one should know that they are *asāra*, or useless, whereas the success of the ISKCON party, the International Society for Krishna Consciousness, which strictly follows *guru* and Gaurāṅga, is increasing daily all over the world. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura wanted to print as many books as possible and distribute them all over the world. We have tried our best in this connection, and we are getting results beyond our expectations.

TEXT 9

keha ta’ ācārya ājñāya, keha ta’ svatantra

sva-mata kalpanā kare daiva-paratantra

SYNONYMS

keha ta’—some; *ācārya*—the spiritual master; *ājñāya*—upon His order; *keha ta’*—some; *sva-tantra*—independently; *sva-mata*—their own opinions; *kalpanā kare*—they concoct; *daiva-paratantra*—under the spell of *māyā*.

TRANSLATION

Some of the disciples strictly accepted the orders of the ācārya, and others deviated, independently concocting their own opinions under the spell of daivī-māyā.

PURPORT

This verse describes the beginning of a schism. When disciples do not stick to the principle of accepting the order of their spiritual master, immediately there are two opinions. Any opinion different from the opinion of the spiritual master is useless. One cannot infiltrate materially concocted ideas into spiritual advancement. That is deviation. There is no scope for adjusting spiritual advancement to material ideas.

TEXT 10

ācāryera mata yei, sei mata sāra

tāñra ājñā lañghi' cale, sei ta' asāra

SYNONYMS

ācāryera—of the spiritual master (Advaita Prabhu); *mata*—opinion; *yei*—what is; *sei*—that; *mata*—opinion; *sāra*—active principle; *tāñra*—his; *ājñā*—order; *lañghi'*—transgressing; *cale*—becomes; *sei*—that; *ta'*—however; *asāra*—useless.

TRANSLATION

The order of the spiritual master is the active principle in spiritual life. Anyone who disobeys the order of the spiritual master immediately becomes useless.

PURPORT

Here is the opinion of Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī. Persons who

strictly follow the orders of the spiritual master are useful in executing the will of the Supreme, whereas persons who deviate from the strict order of the spiritual master are useless.

TEXT 11

asārera nāme ihāñ nāhi prayojana

bheda jānibāre kari ekatra gaṇana

SYNONYMS

asārera—of the useless persons; *nāme*—in their name; *ihāñ*—in this connection; *nāhi*—there is no; *prayojana*—use; *bheda*—differences; *jānibāre*—to know; *kari*—I do; *ekatra*—in one list; *gaṇana*—counting.

TRANSLATION

There is no need to name those who are useless. I have mentioned them only to distinguish them from the useful devotees.

TEXT 12

dhānya-rāsī māpe yaiche pātnā sahite

paścāte pātnā uḍāñā saṁskāra karite

SYNONYMS

dhānya-rāsī—heaps of paddy; *māpe*—measures; *yaiche*—as it is; *pātnā*—useless straw; *sahite*—with; *paścāte*—later; *pātnā*—useless straw; *uḍāñā*—fanning; *saṁskāra*—purification; *karite*—to do.

TRANSLATION

Paddy is mixed with straw at first, and one must fan it to separate the paddy from the straw.

PURPORT

This analogy given by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī is very appropriate. In the case of the Gauḍīya Maṭha members, one can apply a similar process. There are many disciples of Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, but to judge who is actually his disciple, to divide the useful from the useless, one must measure the activities of such disciples in executing the will of the spiritual master. Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura tried his best to spread the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu to countries outside India. When he was present he patronized the disciples to go outside India to preach the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, but they were unsuccessful because within their minds they were not actually serious about preaching His cult in foreign countries; they simply wanted to take credit for having gone to foreign lands and utilize this recognition in India by advertising themselves as repatriated preachers. Many *svāmīs* have adopted this hypocritical means of preaching for the last eighty years or more, but no one could preach the real cult of Kṛṣṇa consciousness all over the world. They merely came back to India falsely advertising that they had converted all the foreigners to the ideas of Vedānta or Kṛṣṇa consciousness, and then they collected funds in India and lived satisfied lives of material comfort. As one fans paddy to separate the real paddy from useless straw, by accepting the criterion recommended by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī one can very easily understand who is a genuine world-preacher and who is useless.

TEXT 13

acyutānanda— —baḍa śākhā, ācārya-nandana

ājanma sevilā teṇho caitanya-caraṇa

SYNONYMS

acyutānanda—Acyutānanda; *baḍa śākhā*—a big branch; *ācārya-nandana*—the son of Advaita Ācārya; *ājanma*—from the very beginning of life; *sevilā*—served; *teñho*—he; *caitanya-carana*—the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

A big branch of Advaita Ācārya was His son Acyutānanda. From the beginning of his life he engaged in the service of the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 14

caitanya-gosāñīra guru—keśava bhāratī

ei pitāra vākya śuni' duḥkha pāila ati

SYNONYMS

caitanya—Lord Caitanya; *gosāñīra*—the spiritual master; *guru*—His spiritual master; *keśava bhāratī*—Keśava Bhāratī; *ei*—these; *pitāra*—his father's; *vākya*—words; *śuni'*—hearing; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *pāila*—got; *ati*—very much.

TRANSLATION

When Acyutānanda heard from his father that Keśava Bhāratī was the spiritual master of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he was very unhappy.

TEXT 15

jagad-gurute tumi kara aiche upadeśa

tomāra ei upadeśe naṣṭa ha-ila deśa

SYNONYMS

jagat-gurute—on the spiritual master of the universe; *tumī*—You; *kara*—do; *aiche*—such; *upadeśa*—instruction; *tomāra*—Your; *ei upadeśe*—by this instruction; *naṣṭa*—spoiled; *ha-ila*—will become; *deśa*—the country.

TRANSLATION

He told his father, “Your instruction that Keśava Bhāratī is the spiritual master of Caitanya Mahāprabhu will spoil the entire country.

TEXT 16

caudda bhuvanera guru—caitanya-gosāñi

tāñra guru—anya, ei kona śāstre nāi

SYNONYMS

caudda—fourteen; *bhuvanera*—planetary systems; *guru*—master; *caitanya-gosāñi*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tāñra guru*—His spiritual master; *anya*—someone else; *ei*—this; *kona*—any; *śāstre*—in scripture; *nāi*—there is no mention.

TRANSLATION

“Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the spiritual master of the fourteen worlds, but You say that someone else is His spiritual master. This is not supported by any revealed scripture.”

TEXT 17

pañcama varṣera bālaka kahe siddhāntera sāra

śuniyā pāilā ācārya santoṣa apāra

SYNONYMS

pañcama—five; *varṣera*—years; *bālaka*—small boy; *kahe*—says; *siddhāntera*—conclusive; *sāra*—essence; *śuniyā*—hearing; *pāilā*—got; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *santoṣa*—satisfaction; *apāra*—very much.

TRANSLATION

When Advaita Ācārya heard this statement from His five-year-old son Acyutānanda, He felt great satisfaction because of his conclusive judgment.

PURPORT

Commenting on verses 13 through 17, Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura gives an extensive description of the descendants of Advaita Ācārya. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter One, states that Acyutānanda was the eldest son of Advaita Ācārya. The Sanskrit book *Advaita-carita* states, “Advaita Ācārya Prabhu had three sons who were devotees of Lord Caitanya. Their names were Acyuta, Kṛṣṇa Miśra and Gopāla dāsa, and they were all born of the womb of His wife, Sītādevī. Advaita Ācārya also had three more sons, whose names were Balarāma, Svarūpa and Jagadīśa. Thus there were six sons of Advaita Ācārya.” Among the six sons, three were strict followers of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and of these three, Acyutānanda was the eldest.

Advaita Prabhu married in the beginning of the fifteenth century Śakābda (late fifteenth century A.D.). When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted to visit the village of Rāmakeli while going from Jagannātha Purī to Vṛndāvana during the Śakābda years 1433 and 1434 (A.D. 1511 and 1512), Acyutānanda was only five years old. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata*,

Antya-khaṇḍa, Fourth Chapter, describes Acyutānanda at that time as *pañca-varṣa vayasa madhura digambara*, “only five years old and standing naked.” Therefore it is to be concluded that Acyutānanda was born sometime in the year 1428 (A.D. 1506). Before the birth of Acyutānanda, Advaita Prabhu’s wife, Sītādevī, came to see Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu at His birth. Thus it is not impossible that she had the other three sons by Advaita within the twenty-one years between 1407 and 1428 Śakābda (A.D. 1486 and 1507). In an unauthorized book of the name *Sītādvaita-carita*, published in Bengali in the unauthorized newspaper *Nityānanda-dāyini* in 1792 Śakābda (A.D. 1870), it is mentioned that Acyutānanda was a class friend of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. According to *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, this statement is not at all valid. When Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted the renounced order of *sannyāsa* in the year 1431 Śakābda (A.D. 1509), He came to the house of Advaita Prabhu at Śāntipura. At that time, as stated in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter One, Acyutānanda was only three years old. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* further states that the naked child, the son of Advaita Prabhu, immediately came and fell down at the lotus feet of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The Lord immediately took him on His lap, although he was not very clean, having dust all over his body. Lord Caitanya said, “My dear Acyuta, Advaita Ācārya is My father, and thus we are brothers.”

Before Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu exhibited His spiritual forms during His residence at Navadvīpa, He asked Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita, Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura’s brother, to go to Śāntipura and bring back Advaita Ācārya. Acyutānanda joined his father at that time. It is said, *advaitera tanaya ‘acyutānanda’ nāma/parama-bālaka, seho kānde avirāma*. Acyutānanda also joined in crying in transcendental bliss. Again, when Lord Caitanya beat Advaita Ācārya for explaining *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* from an impersonalist viewpoint opposed to the principles of *bhakti-yoga*, Acyutānanda was also present. Therefore all these incidents must have occurred only two or three years before Lord Caitanya accepted the *sannyāsa* order. As mentioned above, in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Antya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter One, it is stated that Acyutānanda, the son of Advaita Ācārya, offered his

obeisances to the Lord. Therefore it should be concluded that from the very beginning of his life Acyutānanda was a great devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

There is no information that Acyutānanda ever married, but he is described as the biggest branch of the Advaita Ācārya family. From a book named *Śākhā-nirṇayāmṛta* it is understood that Acyutānanda was a disciple of Gadādhara Paṇḍita and that he took shelter of Lord Caitanya in Jagannātha Purī and engaged in devotional service. The *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, *Ādi-līlā*, Chapter Ten, states that Acyutānanda, the son of Advaita Ācārya, lived in Jagannātha Purī, taking shelter of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Gadādhara Paṇḍita, in the last years of his life, also lived with Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī. There is no doubt, therefore, that Acyutānanda was a disciple of Paṇḍita Gadādhara. In the accounts of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's dancing in front of the car during the Ratha-yātrā festival, Acyutānanda's name is to be found many times. It is stated that in the party of Advaita Ācārya from Śāntipura, Acyutānanda was dancing and others were singing. At that time the boy was only six years old. Text 87 of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, compiled by Śrī Kavi-karṇapūra, describes Acyutānanda as a disciple of Gadādhara Paṇḍita and a great and dear devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. According to the opinion of some, he was an incarnation of Kārttikeya, the son of Lord Śiva, and according to others he was formerly the *gopī* named Acyutā. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (88) supports both these opinions. Another book, *Narottama-vilāsa*, compiled by Śrī Narahari dāsa, mentions Acyutānanda's presence during the festival at Khetari. According to Śrī Narahari dāsa, during the last days of his life Acyutānanda stayed in his house at Śāntipura, but during the presence of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu he lived at Jagannātha Purī with Gadādhara Paṇḍita.

Of the six sons of Advaita Ācārya, three, Acyutānanda, Kṛṣṇa Miśra and Gopāla dāsa, lived faithfully in the service of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Since Acyutānanda did not accept a wife, he had no issue. The second son of Advaita Ācārya, Kṛṣṇa Miśra, had two sons, Raghunātha

Cakravartī and Dola-govinda. The descendants of Raghunātha still live in Śāntipura, in the neighborhoods of Madana-gopāla-pāda, Gaṇakara, Mr̥jāpura and Kumārakhāli. Dola-govinda had three sons, namely Cānda, Kandarpa and Gopīnātha. The descendants of Kandarpa live in Maldah, in the village Jikābādī. Gopīnātha had three sons, Śrīvallabha, Prāṇavallabha and Keśava. The descendants of Śrīvallabha live in the villages known as Maśiyāḍārā (Mahiṣaḍerā), Dāmukadiyā and Caṇḍīpura. There is a genealogical table for the family of Śrī Vallabha beginning from his eldest son, Gaṅgā-nārāyaṇa. The descendants of Śrī Vallabha's youngest son, Rāmagopāla, still live in Dāmukadiyā, Caṇḍīpura, Śolamāri, and so on. The descendants of Prāṇavallabha and Keśava live in Uthalī. The son of Prāṇavallabha was Ratneśvara, and his son was Kṛṣṇarāma, whose youngest son was Lakṣmī-nārāyaṇa. His son was Navakiśora, and Navakiśora's second son was Rāmamohana, whose eldest son was Jagabandhu and whose third son, Vīracandra, accepted the *sannyāsa* order and established a Deity of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in Katwa. These two sons of Rāmamohana were known as Baḍa Prabhu and Choṭa Prabhu, and they inaugurated the circumambulation of Navadvīpa-dhāma. One may refer to the *Vaiṣṇava-maṇḍjuṣā* for the complete genealogical table of Advaita Prabhu in the line of Kṛṣṇa Miśra.

TEXT 18

kṛṣṇa-miśra-nāma āra ācārya-tanaya

caitanya-gosāñi baise yāñhāra hṛdaya

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-miśra—Kṛṣṇa Miśra; *nāma*—of the name; *āra*—and; *ācārya-tanaya*—the son of Advaita Ācārya; *caitanya-gosāñi*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *baise*—sits; *yāñhāra*—in whose; *hṛdaya*—heart.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa Mīśra was a son of Advaita Ācārya. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu always sat in his heart.

TEXT 19

śrī-gopāla-nāme āra ācāryera suta

tāñhāra caritra, śuna, atyanta adbhuta

SYNONYMS

śrī-gopāla—Śrī Gopāla; *nāme*—by the name; *āra*—another; *ācāryera*—of Advaita Ācārya; *suta*—son; *tāñhāra*—his; *caritra*—character; *śuna*—hear; *atyanta*—very; *adbhuta*—wonderful.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Gopāla was another son of Śrī Advaita Ācārya Prabhu. Now just hear about his characteristics, for they are all very wonderful.

PURPORT

As mentioned above, Śrī Gopāla was one of the three devoted sons of Advaita Ācārya. He is further described in the *Madhya-līlā* of *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Chapter Twelve, texts 143 through 149.

TEXT 20

guṇḍicā-mandire mahāprabhura sammukhe

kīrtane nartana kare baḍa prema-sukhe

SYNONYMS

guṇḍicā-mandire—in the Guṇḍicā-mandira in Jagannātha Purī;
mahāprabhura—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sammukhe*—in front;
kīrtane—in *saṅkīrtana*; *nartana*—dancing; *kare*—does; *baḍa*—very
much; *prema-sukhe*—in transcendental bliss.

TRANSLATION

When Lord Caitanya personally cleansed the Guṇḍicā-mandira in Jagannātha Purī, Gopāla danced in front of the Lord with great love and happiness.

PURPORT

The Guṇḍicā-mandira is situated in Jagannātha Purī, and every year Jagannātha, Balabhadra and Subhadrā come there from the Jagannātha temple to stay for eight days. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu lived at Jagannātha Purī, every year He personally cleansed this temple with His principal devotees. The *Guṇḍicā-māṛjana* chapter of *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* (Madhya 12) describes this vividly.

TEXT 21

nānā-bhāvodgama dehe adbhuta nartana

dui gosāñi 'hari' bale, ānandita mana

SYNONYMS

nānā—various; *bhāva-udgama*—ecstatic symptoms; *dehe*—in the body;
adbhuta—wonderful; *nartana*—dancing; *dui gosāñi*—the two *gosāñis*
(Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Advaita Prabhu); *hari bale*—chanted Hare
Kṛṣṇa; *ānandita*—pleased; *mana*—mind.

TRANSLATION

While Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Advaita Prabhu chanted the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra and danced, there were various ecstatic symptoms in Their bodies, and Their minds were very pleased.

TEXT 22

nācite nācite gopāla ha-ilā mūrcchita

bhūmete paḍila, dehe nāhika saṁvita

SYNONYMS

nācite—while dancing; *nācite*—while dancing; *gopāla*—the son of Advaita Prabhu; *ha-ilā*—became; *mūrcchita*—unconscious; *bhūmete*—on the ground; *paḍila*—fell down; *dehe*—in the body; *nāhika*—there was no; *saṁvita*—knowledge (consciousness).

TRANSLATION

While all of them danced, Gopāla, dancing and dancing, fainted and fell to the ground unconscious.

TEXT 23

duḥkhita ha-ilā ācārya putra kole lañā

rakṣā kare nṛsimhera mantra paḍiyā

SYNONYMS

duḥkhita—unhappy; *ha-ilā*—became; *ācārya*—Advaita Prabhu; *putra*—His son; *kole*—on the lap; *lañā*—taking; *rakṣā*—protection; *kare*—does; *nṛsimhera*—of Lord Nṛsimha; *mantra*—the hymn; *paḍiyā*—by chanting.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya Prabhu became very unhappy. Taking His son on His lap, He began to chant the Nṛsiṃha mantra for his protection.

TEXT 24

nānā mantra paḍena ācārya, nā haya cetana

ācāryera duḥkhe vaiṣṇava kareṇa krandana

SYNONYMS

nānā—various; *mantra*—hymns; *paḍena*—chants; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *nā*—not; *haya*—became; *cetana*—conscious; *ācāryera*—of Advaita Ācārya; *duḥkhe*—in unhappiness; *vaiṣṇava*—all the Vaiṣṇavas; *kareṇa*—do; *krandana*—cry.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya chanted various mantras, but Gopāla did not come to consciousness. Thus all the Vaiṣṇavas present cried in sorrow at His plight.

TEXT 25

tabe mahāprabhu, tāṇra hṛde hasta dhari'

'uṭhaha, gopāla,' kaila bala 'hari' 'hari'

SYNONYMS

tabe—at that time; *mahāprabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tāṇra*—His; *hṛde*—on the heart; *hasta*—hand; *dhari'*—keeping; *uṭhaha*—get up; *gopāla*—My dear Gopāla; *kaila*—did say; *bala*—chant; *hari hari*—

the holy name of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu then put His hand on the chest of Gopāla and told him, “My dear Gopāla, get up and chant the holy name of the Lord!”

TEXT 26

uṭhila gopāla prabhura sparsā-dhvani śuni’

ānandita hañā sabe kare hari-dhvani

SYNONYMS

uṭhila—got up; *gopāla*—Gopāla; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *sparsā*—touch; *dhvani*—sound; *śuni’*—hearing; *ānandita*—jubilant; *hañā*—becoming; *sabe*—all; *kare*—did; *hari-dhvani*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

TRANSLATION

When he heard this sound and felt the touch of the Lord, Gopāla immediately got up, and all the Vaiṣṇavas chanted the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra in jubilation.

TEXT 27

ācāryera āra putra—śrī-balarāma

āra putra—‘svarūpa’-śākhā, ‘jagadīśa’ nāma

SYNONYMS

ācāryera—of Śrīla Advaita Ācārya; *āra*—another; *putra*—son; *śrī-*

balarāma—Śrī Balarāma; *āra putra*—another son; *svarūpa*—Svarūpa; *śākhā*—branch; *jagadīśa nāma*—of the name Jagadīśa.

TRANSLATION

The other sons of Advaita Ācārya were Śrī Balarāma, Svarūpa and Jagadīśa.

PURPORT

The Sanskrit book *Advaita-carita* states that Balarāma, Svarūpa and Jagadīśa were the fourth, fifth and sixth sons of Advaita Ācārya. Therefore Śrī Advaita Ācārya had six sons. Balarāma, Svarūpa and Jagadīśa, being *smārtas*, or Māyāvādīs, were rejected by Vaiṣṇava society. Sometimes Māyāvādīs pose themselves as Vaiṣṇavas, or worshipers of Lord Viṣṇu, but actually they do not believe in Lord Viṣṇu as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, for they consider demigods like Lord Śiva, Durgā, the sun-god and Gaṇeśa equal to Him. They are generally known as *pañcopāsaka-smārtas*, and one should not count them among the Vaiṣṇavas.

Balarāma had three wives and nine sons. The youngest son of his first wife was known as Madhusūdana Gosvāmī. He took the title Bhaṭṭācārya and accepted the path of the *smārta* or Māyāvāda philosophy. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura notes that the son of Gosvāmī Bhaṭṭācārya, Śrī Rādhāramaṇa Gosvāmī Bhaṭṭācārya, refused the title *gosvāmī* because it is generally meant for *sannyāsīs*, those who have taken the renounced order of life. One who is still in family life should not misuse the title *gosvāmī*. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura did not recognize the caste *gosvāmīs* because they were not in the line of the six *gosvāmīs* in the renounced order who were direct disciples of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu—namely Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī, Śrīla Bhaṭṭa Raghunātha Gosvāmī, Śrī Gopāla Bhaṭṭa Gosvāmī, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī and Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura said that the *gṛhastha āśrama*, or the

status of family life, is a sort of concession for sense gratification. Therefore a *gṛhastha* should not falsely adopt the title *gosvāmī*. The ISKCON movement has never conferred the title *gosvāmī* upon a householder. Although all the *sannyāsīs* we have initiated in ISKCON are young, we have awarded them the titles of the renounced order of life, *svāmī* and *gosvāmī*, because they have completely dedicated their lives to preach the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura mentions that not only do the householder caste *gosvāmīs* disrespect the title *gosvāmī*, but also, following the principles of the *smārta* Raghunandana, they exhibit great foolishness by burning a straw image of Advaita Ācārya in a *śrāddha* ceremony, thus acting like Rākṣasas and disrespecting the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, which is the guide for Vaiṣṇavas. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura says that sometimes these *smārta* caste *gosvāmīs* write books on Vaiṣṇava philosophy or commentaries on the original scriptures, but a pure devotee should cautiously avoid reading them.

TEXT 28

‘kamaḷākānta viśvāsa’-nāma ācārya-kiṅkara

ācārya-vyavahāra saba—tāṇhāra gocara

SYNONYMS

kamaḷākānta viśvāsa—Kamaḷākānta Viśvāsa; *nāma*—of the name; *ācārya-kiṅkara*—servant of Advaita Ācārya; *ācārya-vyavahāra*—the dealings of Advaita Ācārya; *saba*—all; *tāṇhāra*—his; *gocara*—with in the knowledge.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya’s very confidential servant named Kamaḷākānta Viśvāsa knew all the dealings of Advaita Ācārya.

PURPORT

The name Kamalānanda mentioned in the *Ādi-līlā* (10.149) and the name Kamalākānta mentioned in the *Madhya-līlā* (10.94) both refer to the same man. Kamalākānta, a very confidential servant of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu born in a *brāhmaṇa* family, engaged in the service of Śrī Advaita Ācārya as His secretary. When Paramānanda Purī went from Navadvīpa to Jagannātha Purī, he took Kamalākānta Viśvāsa with him, and they both went to see Lord Caitanya at Jagannātha Purī. It is mentioned in the *Madhya-līlā* (10.94) that one of the devotees of Lord Caitanya, the *brāhmaṇa* Kamalākānta, went with Paramānanda Purī to Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 29

nīlācale teṇho eka patrikā likhiyā

pratāparudrera pāśa dila pāṭhāiyā

SYNONYMS

nīlācale—at Jagannātha Purī; *teṇho*—Kamalākānta; *eka*—one; *patrikā*—note; *likhiyā*—writing; *pratāparudrera*—Pratāparudra Mahārāja; *pāśa*—addressed to him; *dila pāṭhāiyā*—sent.

TRANSLATION

When Kamalākānta Viśvāsa was in Jagannātha Purī, he sent a note through someone to Mahārāja Pratāparudra.

TEXT 30

sei patrīra kathā ācārya nāhi jāne

kona pāke sei patrī āila prabhu-sthāne

SYNONYMS

sei patrīra—of that note; *kathā*—information; *ācārya*—Śrī Advaita Ācārya; *nāhi*—does not; *jāne*—know; *kona*—somehow or other; *pāke*—by means; *sei*—that; *patrī*—note; *āila*—came; *prabhu-sthāne*—in the hand of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

No one knew of that note, but somehow or other it reached the hands of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 31

se patrīte lekhā āche—ei ta' likhana

īśvaratve ācāryere kariyāche sthāpana

SYNONYMS

se—that; *patrīte*—in the note; *lekhā āche*—it is written; *ei ta'*—this; *likhana*—writing; *īśvaratve*—in the place of the Supreme Lord; *ācāryere*—unto Advaita Ācārya; *kariyāche*—established; *sthāpana*—situation.

TRANSLATION

That note established Advaita Ācārya as an incarnation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 32

kintu tānra daive kichu ha-iyāche ṛṇa

ṛṇa śodhibāre cāhi taṅkā śata-tina

SYNONYMS

kintu—but; *tāñra*—His; *daive*—in due course of time; *kichu*—some; *ha-iyāche*—there was; *ṛṇa*—debt; *ṛṇa*—debt; *śodhibāre*—to liquidate; *cāhi*—I want; *tañkā*—rupees; *śata-tina*—about three hundred.

TRANSLATION

But it also mentioned that Advaita Ācārya had recently incurred a debt of about three hundred rupees that Kamalākānta Viśvāsa wanted to liquidate.

TEXT 33

patra paḍiyā prabhura mane haila duḥkha

bāhire hāsiyā kichu bale candra-mukha

SYNONYMS

patra—note; *paḍiyā*—reading; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mane*—in the mind; *haila*—became; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *bāhire*—externally; *hāsiyā*—smiling; *kichu*—something; *bale*—says; *candra-mukha*—the moon-faced.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu became unhappy upon reading the note, although His face still shone as brightly as the moon. Thus, smiling, He spoke as follows.

TEXT 34

ācāryere sthāpiyāche kariyā īśvara

ithe doṣa nāhi, ācārya—daivata īśvara

SYNONYMS

ācāryere—unto Śrī Advaita Ācārya; *sthāpiyāche*—he established;
kariyā—mentioning; *īśvara*—as the Supreme Personality of Godhead;
ithe—in this; *doṣa*—fault; *nāhi*—there is not; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya;
daivata īśvara—He is actually the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

“He has established Advaita Ācārya as an incarnation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. There is nothing wrong in this, for He is indeed the Lord Himself.

TEXT 35

īśvarera dainya kari’ kariyāche bhikṣā

ataeva daṇḍa kari’ karāiba śikṣā

SYNONYMS

īśvarera—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *dainya*—poverty;
kari’—establishing; *kariyāche*—has done; *bhikṣā*—begging; *ataeva*—
therefore; *daṇḍa*—punishment; *kari’*—giving him; *karāiba*—shall cause;
śikṣā—instruction.

TRANSLATION

“But he has made the incarnation of Godhead a poverty-stricken beggar.
Therefore I shall punish him in order to correct him.”

PURPORT

To describe a man as an incarnation of God, or Nārāyaṇa, and at the same time present him as poverty-stricken is contradictory, and it is the greatest offense. The Māyāvādī philosophers, engaged in the missionary work of spoiling the Vedic culture by preaching that everyone is God, describe a poverty-stricken man as *daridra-nārāyaṇa*, or “poor Nārāyaṇa.” Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu never accepted such foolish and unauthorized ideas. He strictly warned, *māyāvādī-bhāṣya śunīle haya sarva-nāśa*: “Anyone who follows the principles of Māyāvāda philosophy is certainly doomed.” Such a fool needs to be reformed by punishment.

Although it is contradictory to say that the Supreme Personality of Godhead or His incarnation is poverty-stricken, we find in the revealed scriptures that when the Lord incarnated as Vāmana, He begged some land from Mahārāja Bali. Everyone knows, however, that Vāmanadeva was not at all poverty-stricken. His begging from Mahārāja Bali was a device to favor him. When Mahārāja Bali actually gave the land, Vāmanadeva exhibited His all-powerful position by covering the three worlds with three steps. One should not accept the so-called *daridra-nārāyaṇas* as incarnations, because they are completely unable to show the opulence of the genuine incarnations of God.

TEXT 36

govindere ājñā dila,— —“inhā āji haite

bāuliyā viśvāse ethā nā dibe āsite”

SYNONYMS

govindere—unto Govinda; *ājñā dila*—ordered; *inhā*—to this place; *āji*—today; *haite*—from; *bāuliyā*—the Māyāvādī; *viśvāse*—unto Kamalākānta Viśvāsa; *ethā*—here; *nā*—do not; *dibe*—allow; *āsite*—to come.

TRANSLATION

The Lord ordered Govinda, “From today on, do not allow that *bāuliyā* Kamalākānta Viśvāsa to come here.”

PURPORT

The *bāuliyās*, or *bāulas*, are one of thirteen unauthorized sects that pass as followers of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The Lord ordered Govinda, His personal assistant, not to allow Kamalākānta Viśvāsa to come into His presence because he had become a *bāuliyā*. Thus although the *bāula-sampradāya*, *āula-sampradāya* and *sahajiyā-sampradāya*, as well as the *smārtas*, *jāta-gosāñīs*, *ativādīs*, *cūḍādhārīs* and *gaurāṅga-nāgarīs*, claim to belong to the disciplic succession of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Lord actually rejected them.

TEXT 37

daṇḍa śuni’ ‘viśvāsa’ ha-ila parama duḥkhita

śuniyā prabhura daṇḍa ācārya harṣita

SYNONYMS

daṇḍa—punishment; *śuni’*—hearing; *viśvāsa*—Kamalākānta Viśvāsa; *ha-ila*—became; *parama*—very; *duḥkhita*—unhappy; *śuniyā*—hearing; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *daṇḍa*—punishment; *ācārya*—Śrī Advaita Ācārya Prabhu; *harṣita*—very pleased.

TRANSLATION

When Kamalākānta Viśvāsa heard about this punishment by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he was very unhappy, but when Advaita Prabhu heard about it, He was greatly pleased.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.29) the Lord says, *samo 'haṁ sarva-bhūteṣu na me dveṣyo 'sti na priyaḥ*: “I envy no one, nor am I partial to anyone. I am equal to all.” The Supreme Personality of Godhead being equal to everyone, no one can be His enemy, nor can anyone be His friend. Since everyone is a part or son of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the Lord cannot be partial and regard someone as a friend and someone as an enemy. Thus when Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu punished Kamalākānta Viśvāsa by no longer allowing him to come into His presence, although the punishment was actually very hard on him, Śrī Advaita Prabhu, understanding the inner meaning of such punishment, was happy because He appreciated that the Lord had actually favored Kamalākānta Viśvāsa. Therefore He was not at all unhappy. Devotees should always be happy with all the dealings of their master, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. A devotee may be put into difficulty or opulence, but he should accept both as gifts of the Supreme personality of Godhead and jubilantly engage in the service of the Lord in all circumstances.

TEXT 38

viśvāsere kahe,——tumi baḍa bhāgyavān

tomāre karila daṇḍa prabhu bhagavān

SYNONYMS

viśvāsere—unto Kamalākānta Viśvāsa; *kahe*—said; *tumi*—you; *baḍa*—very; *bhāgyavān*—fortunate; *tomāre*—unto you; *karila*—did; *daṇḍa*—punishment; *prabhu*—the Lord; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Seeing Kamalākānta Viśvāsa unhappy, Advaita Ācārya Prabhu told him, “You are greatly fortunate to have been punished by the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

This is an authoritative judgment by Śrī Advaita Prabhu. He clearly advises that one should not be unhappy when reverses come upon him by the order of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. A devotee should always be happy to receive the fortune awarded him by the Supreme Lord, which seems pleasant or unpleasant according to one's judgment.

TEXT 39

pūrve mahāprabhu more karena sammāna

duḥkha pāi' mane āmi kailuṇ anumāna

SYNONYMS

pūrve—previously; *mahāprabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *more*—unto Me; *karena*—does; *sammāna*—respect; *duḥkha*—unhappy; *pāi'*—becoming; *mane*—in the mind; *āmi*—I; *kailuṇ*—made; *anumāna*—a plan.

TRANSLATION

“Formerly Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu always respected Me as His senior, but I did not like such respect. Therefore, My mind being afflicted by unhappiness, I made a plan.

TEXT 40

mukti—śreṣṭha kari' kainu vāśiṣṭha vyākhyāna

kruddha hañā prabhu more kaila apamāna

SYNONYMS

mukti—liberation; *śreṣṭha*—the topmost; *kari'*—accepting; *kainu*—I did; *vāśiṣṭha*—the book known as *Yoga-vāśiṣṭha*; *vyākhyāna*—explanation; *kruddha*—angry; *hañā*—becoming; *prabhu*—the Lord; *more*—unto Me; *kaila*—did; *apamāna*—disrespect.

TRANSLATION

“Thus I expounded the *Yoga-vāśiṣṭha*, which considers liberation the ultimate goal of life. For this the Lord became angry at Me and treated Me with apparent disrespect.

PURPORT

There is a book of the name *Yoga-vāśiṣṭha* that Māyāvādīs greatly favor because it is full of impersonal misunderstandings regarding the Supreme Personality of Godhead, with no touch of Vaiṣṇavism. Factually, all Vaiṣṇavas should avoid such a book, but Advaita Ācārya Prabhu, wanting punishment from the Lord, began to support the impersonal statements of the *Yoga-vāśiṣṭha*. Thus Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu became extremely angry at Him and seemingly treated Him disrespectfully.

TEXT 41

daṇḍa pāñā haila mora parama ānanda

ye daṇḍa pāila bhāgyavān śrī-mukunda

SYNONYMS

daṇḍa pāñā—receiving the punishment; *haila*—became; *mora*—My; *parama*—very great; *ānanda*—happiness; *ye daṇḍa*—the punishment; *pāila*—got; *bhāgyavān*—the most fortunate; *śrī-mukunda*—Śrī Mukunda.

TRANSLATION

“When chastised by Lord Caitanya, I was very happy to receive a punishment similar to that awarded Śrī Mukunda.

PURPORT

Śrī Mukunda, a great friend and associate of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, used to visit many places where people were against the Vaiṣṇava cult. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu came to know of this, He punished Mukunda, forbidding him to see Him again. Although Caitanya Mahāprabhu was soft like a flower, He was also strict like a thunderbolt, and everyone was afraid to allow Mukunda to come again into the presence of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Mukunda, therefore, being very sorry, asked his friends whether he would one day be allowed to see Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. When the devotees brought this inquiry to Lord Caitanya, the Lord replied, “Mukunda will get permission to see Me after many millions of years.” When they gave this information to Mukunda, he danced with jubilation, and when Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu heard that Mukunda was so patiently waiting to meet Him after millions of years, He immediately asked him to return. There is a statement about this punishment of Mukunda in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Tenth Chapter.

TEXT 42

ye daṇḍa pāila śrī-śacī bhāgyavati

se daṇḍa prasāda anya loka pābe kati

SYNONYMS

ye daṇḍa—the punishment; *pāila*—got; *śrī-śacī bhāgyavati*—the most fortunate mother Śacīdevī; *se daṇḍa*—the same punishment; *prasāda*—favor; *anya*—other; *loka*—person; *pābe*—can get; *kati*—how.

TRANSLATION

“A similar punishment was awarded to mother Śacīdevī. Who could be more fortunate than she to receive such punishment?”

PURPORT

Mother Śacīdevī was similarly punished, as mentioned in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Twenty-two. Mother Śacīdevī, apparently showing her feminine nature, accused Advaita Prabhu of encouraging her son to become a *sannyāsī*. Caitanya Mahāprabhu, taking this accusation as an offense, asked Śacīdevī to touch the lotus feet of Advaita Ācārya to mitigate the offense she had supposedly committed.

TEXT 43

eta kahi' ācārya tāñre kariyā āśvāsa

ānandita ha-iyā āila mahāprabhu-pāśa

SYNONYMS

eta kahi'—speaking thus; *ācārya*—Śrī Advaita Ācārya Prabhu; *tāñre*—unto Kamalākānta Viśvāsa; *kariyā*—doing; *āśvāsa*—pacification; *ānandita*—happy; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *āila*—went; *mahāprabhu-pāśa*—to the place of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

After pacifying Kamalākānta Viśvāsa in this way, Śrī Advaita Ācārya Prabhu went to see Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 44

prabhuke kahena—tomāra nā bujhi e līlā

āmā haite prasāda-pātra karilā kamalā

SYNONYMS

prabhuke—unto the Lord; *kahena*—says; *tomāra*—Your; *nā*—do not; *bujhi*—I understand; *e*—these; *līlā*—pastimes; *āmā*—Myself; *haite*—more than; *prasāda-pātra*—object of favor; *karilā*—You did; *kamalā*—unto Kamalākānta Viśvāsa.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Advaita Ācārya told Lord Caitanya, “I cannot understand Your transcendental pastimes. You have shown more favor to Kamalākānta than You generally show to Me.

TEXT 45

āmāreha kabhu yei nā haya prasāda

tomāra caraṇe āmi ki kainu aparādha

SYNONYMS

āmāreha—even upon Me; *kabhu*—at any time; *yei*—that; *nā*—never; *haya*—becomes; *prasāda*—favor; *tomāra caraṇe*—at Your lotus feet; *āmi*—I; *ki*—what; *kainu*—have done; *aparādha*—offense.

TRANSLATION

“The favor You have shown Kamalākānta is so great that even to Me You have never shown such favor. What offense have I committed at Your lotus feet so as not to be shown such favor?”

PURPORT

This is a reference to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s former punishment of Advaita Ācārya. When Advaita Ācārya Prabhu was reading *Yoga-*

vāśiṣṭha, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu beat Him, but He never told Him not to come into His presence. But Kamalākānta was punished with the order never to come into the Lord's presence. Therefore Śrī Advaita Ācārya Prabhu wanted to impress upon Caitanya Mahāprabhu that He had shown more favor to Kamalākānta Viśvāsa because He had prohibited Kamalākānta from seeing Him, whereas He had not done so to Advaita Ācārya. Therefore the favor shown Kamalākānta Viśvāsa was greater than that shown Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 46

eta śuni' mahāprabhu hāsite lāgilā

bolāiyā kamalākānte prasanna ha-ilā

SYNONYMS

eta śuni'—thus hearing; *mahāprabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *hāsite*—to laugh; *lāgilā*—began; *bolāiyā*—calling; *kamalākānte*—unto Kamalākānta; *prasanna*—satisfied; *ha-ilā*—became.

TRANSLATION

Hearing this, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu laughed with satisfaction and immediately called Kamalākānta Viśvāsa.

TEXT 47

ācārya kahe, ihāke kene dile daraśana

dui prakārete kare more viḍambana

SYNONYMS

ācārya kahe—Śrī Advaita Ācārya said; *ihāke*—unto him; *kene*—why;

dile—You gave; *daraśana*—audience; *dui*—two; *prakārete*—in ways; *kare*—does; *more*—unto Me; *viḍambana*—cheating.

TRANSLATION

Advaita Ācārya then said to Caitanya Mahāprabhu, “Why have You called back this man and allowed him to see You? He has cheated Me in two ways.”

TEXT 48

śuniyā prabhura mana prasanna ha-ila

duñhāra antara-kathā duñhe se jānila

SYNONYMS

śuniyā—hearing this; *prabhura*—of Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mana*—mind; *prasanna*—satisfaction; *ha-ila*—felt; *duñhāra*—of both of Them; *antara-kathā*—confidential talks; *duñhe*—both of Them; *se*—that; *jānila*—could understand.

TRANSLATION

When Caitanya Mahāprabhu heard this, His mind was satisfied. Only They could understand each other’s minds.

TEXT 49

prabhu kahe—*bāuliyā, aiche kāhe kara*

ācāryera lajjā-dharma-hāni se ācara

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord said; *bāuliyā*—one who does not know what is right; *aiche*—in that way; *kāhe*—why; *kara*—do; *ācāryera*—of Śrī Advaita Ācārya; *lajjā*—privacy; *dharma*—religion; *hānī*—loss; *se*—that; *ācara*—you act.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu instructed Kamalākānta, “You are a *bāuliyā*, one who does not know things as they are. Why do you act in this way? Why do you invade the privacy of Advaita Ācārya and damage His religious principles?

PURPORT

Kamalākānta Viśvāsa, out of his ignorance, asked the King of Jagannātha Purī, Mahārāja Pratāparudra, to liquidate the three-hundred-rupee debt of Advaita Ācārya, but at the same time he established Advaita Ācārya as an incarnation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. This is contradictory. An incarnation of the Supreme Godhead cannot be indebted to anyone in this material world. Caitanya Mahāprabhu is never satisfied by such a contradiction, which is technically called *rasābhāsa*, or overlapping of one humor (*rasa*) with another. This is the same type of idea as the contradiction that Nārāyaṇa is poverty-stricken (*daridra-nārāyaṇa*).

TEXT 50

pratigraha kabhu nā karibe rāja-dhana

viṣayīra anna khāile duṣṭa haya mana

SYNONYMS

pratigraha—acceptance of alms; *kabhu*—at any time; *nā*—not; *karibe*—should do; *rāja-dhana*—charity by kings; *viṣayīra*—of men who are

materialistic; *anna*—food; *khāile*—by eating; *duṣṭa*—polluted; *haya*—becomes; *mana*—mind.

TRANSLATION

“Advaita Ācārya, My spiritual master, should never accept charity from rich men or kings, because if a spiritual master accepts money or grains from such materialists his mind becomes polluted.

PURPORT

It is very risky to accept money or food from materialistic persons, for such acceptance pollutes the mind of the charity’s recipient. According to the Vedic system, one should give charity to *sannyāsīs* and *brāhmaṇas* because one who thus gives charity becomes free from sinful activities. Formerly, therefore, *brāhmaṇas* would not accept charity from a person unless he were very pious. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu gave this instruction for all spiritual masters. Materialistic persons who are not inclined to give up their sinful activities like illicit sex, intoxication, gambling and meat-eating sometimes want to become our disciples, but, unlike professional spiritual masters who accept disciples regardless of their condition, Vaiṣṇavas do not accept such cheap disciples. One must at least agree to abide by the rules and regulations for a disciple before a Vaiṣṇava *ācārya* can accept him. In fact, a Vaiṣṇava should not even accept charity or food from persons who do not follow the rules and regulations of the Vaiṣṇava principles.

TEXT 51

mana duṣṭa ha-ile nahe kṛṣṇera smaraṇa

kṛṣṇa-smṛti vinu haya niṣphala jīvana

SYNONYMS

mana—mind; *duṣṭa*—polluted; *ha-ile*—becoming; *nahe*—is not possible; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *smaraṇa*—remembrance; *kṛṣṇa-smṛti*—remembrance of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vinu*—without; *haya*—becomes; *niṣphala*—without any result; *jīvana*—life.

TRANSLATION

“When one’s mind is polluted, it is very difficult to remember Kṛṣṇa, and when remembrance of Lord Kṛṣṇa is hampered, one’s life is unproductive.

PURPORT

A devotee should always be alert, keeping his mind in a sanguine state so that he can always remember Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa. The *sāstras* state, *smartavyaḥ satatam viṣṇuḥ*: in devotional life one should always remember Lord Viṣṇu. Śrīla Śukadeva Gosvāmī also advised Mahārāja Parīkṣit, *smartavyo nityaśaḥ*. In the Second Canto, First Chapter, of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Śukadeva Gosvāmī advised Parīkṣit Mahārāja:

*tasmād bhārata sarvātmā bhagavān īśvaro hariḥ
śrotavyaḥ kīrtitavyaś ca smartavyaś cecchatābhayaḥ*

“O descendant of King Bharata, one who desires to be free from all miseries must hear about, glorify and also remember the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is the Supersoul, the controller and the savior from all miseries.” (*Bhāg.* 2.1.5) This is the summary of all the activities of a Vaiṣṇava, and the same instruction is repeated here (*kṛṣṇa-smṛti vinu haya niṣphala jīvana*). Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī states in his *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, avyārtha-kālatvam*: [Cc.Madhya 23.18-19] A Vaiṣṇava must be very alert not to waste even a second of his valuable lifetime. This is a symptom of a Vaiṣṇava. But association with pounds-and-shillings men, or *viṣayīs*, materialists who are simply interested in sense gratification, pollutes one’s mind and hampers such continuous remembrance of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu therefore advised, *asat-saṅga-tyāga*—*—ei vaiṣṇava-ācāra*: a Vaiṣṇava should behave in such

a way as to never associate with nondevotees or materialists (Cc. *Madhya* 22.87). One can avoid such association simply by always remembering Kṛṣṇa within his heart.

TEXT 52

loka-lajjā haya, dharma-kīrti haya hāni

aiche karma nā kariha kabhu ihā jāni'

SYNONYMS

loka-lajjā—unpopularity; *haya*—becomes; *dharma*—religion; *kīrti*—reputation; *haya*—becomes; *hāni*—damaged; *aiche*—such; *karma*—work; *nā*—do not; *kariha*—execute; *kabhu*—ever; *ihā*—this; *jāni'*—knowing.

TRANSLATION

“Thus one becomes unpopular in the eyes of the people in general, for this damages his religiosity and fame. A Vaiṣṇava, especially one who acts as a spiritual master, must not act in such a way. One should always be conscious of this fact.”

TEXT 53

ei śikṣā sabākāre, sabe mane kaila

ācārya-gosāñi mane ānanda pāila

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *śikṣā*—instruction; *sabākāre*—for all; *sabe*—all present; *mane*—in the mind; *kaila*—took it; *ācārya-gosāñi*—Advaita Ācārya; *mane*—within the mind; *ānanda*—pleasure; *pāila*—felt.

TRANSLATION

When Caitanya Mahāprabhu gave this instruction to Kamalākānta, all present considered it to be meant for everyone. Thus Advaita Ācārya was greatly pleased.

TEXT 54

ācāryera abhiprāya prabhu-mātra bujhe

prabhura gambhīra vākya ācārya samujhe

SYNONYMS

ācāryera—of Advaita Ācārya; *abhiprāya*—intention; *prabhu-mātra*—only Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bujhe*—can understand; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gambhīra*—grave; *vākya*—instruction; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *samujhe*—can understand.

TRANSLATION

Only Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu could understand the intentions of Advaita Ācārya, and Advaita Ācārya appreciated the grave instruction of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 55

ei ta' prastāve āche bahuta vicāra

grantha-bāhulya-bhaye nāri likhibāra

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—in this; *prastāve*—statement; *āche*—there are; *bahuta*—many; *vicāra*—considerations; *grantha*—of the book; *bāhulya*—of the

expansion; *bhaye*—out of fear; *nāri*—I do not; *likhibāra*—write.

TRANSLATION

In this statement there are many confidential considerations. I do not write of them all, fearing an unnecessary increase in the volume of the book.

TEXT 56

śrī-yadunandanācārya— —advaitera śākhā

tāñra śākhā-upasākhāra nāhi haya lekhā

SYNONYMS

śrī-yadunandana-ācārya—Śrī Yadunandana Ācārya; *advaitera*—of Advaita Ācārya; *śākhā*—branch; *tāñra*—his; *śākhā*—branches; *upasākhāra*—subbranches; *nāhi*—not; *haya*—there is; *lekhā*—writing.

TRANSLATION

The fifth branch of Advaita Ācārya was Śrī Yadunandana Ācārya, who had so many branches and subbranches that it is impossible to write of them.

PURPORT

Yadunandana Ācārya was the official initiator spiritual master of Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī. In other words, when Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī was a householder, Yadunandana Ācārya initiated him at home. Later Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī took shelter of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu at Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 57

vāsudeva dattera teṇho kṛpāra bhājana

sarva-bhāve āśriyāche caitanya-carāṇa

SYNONYMS

vāsudeva dattera—of Vāsudeva Datta; *teṇho*—he was; *kṛpāra*—of the mercy; *bhājana*—competent to receive; *sarva-bhāve*—in all respects; *āśriyāche*—took shelter; *caitanya-carāṇa*—of the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Yadunandana Ācārya was a student of Vāsudeva Datta, and he received all his mercy. Therefore he could accept Lord Caitanya’s lotus feet, from all angles of vision, as the supreme shelter.

PURPORT

The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (140) describes that Vāsudeva Datta was formerly Madhuvrata, a singer in Vṛndāvana.

TEXT 58

bhāgavatācārya, āra viṣṇudāsācārya

cakrapāṇi ācārya, āra ananta ācārya

SYNONYMS

bhāgavata-ācārya—Bhāgavata Ācārya; *āra*—and; *viṣṇudāsa-ācārya*—Viṣṇudāsa Ācārya; *cakrapāṇi ācārya*—Cakrapāṇi Ācārya; *āra*—and; *ananta ācārya*—Ananta Ācārya.

TRANSLATION

Bhāgavata Ācārya, Viṣṇudāsa Ācārya, Cakrapāṇi Ācārya and Ananta Ācārya were the sixth, seventh, eighth and ninth branches of Advaita Ācārya.

PURPORT

In his *Anubhāṣya* Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Gosvāmī Prabhupāda says that Bhāgavata Ācārya was formerly among the followers of Advaita Ācārya but was later counted among the followers of Gadādhara Paṇḍita. The sixth verse of *Śākhā-nirṇayāmrta*, a book written by Yadunandana dāsa, states that Bhāgavata Ācārya compiled a famous book of the name *Prema-taraṅgiṇī*. According to the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (195), Bhāgavata Ācārya formerly lived in Vṛndāvana as Śveta-mañjarī. Viṣṇudāsa Ācārya was present during the Khetari-mahotsava. He went there with Acyutānanda, as stated in the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, Tenth *Taraṅga*. Ananta Ācārya was one of the eight principal *gopīs*. His former name was Sudevī. Although he was among Advaita Ācārya's followers, he later became an important devotee of Gadādhara Gosvāmī.

TEXT 59

nandinī, āra kāmadeva, caitanya-dāsa

durlabha viśvāsa, āra vanamāli-dāsa

SYNONYMS

nandinī—Nandinī; *āra*—and; *kāmadeva*—Kāmadeva; *caitanya-dāsa*—Caitanya dāsa; *durlabha viśvāsa*—Durlabha Viśvāsa; *āra*—and; *vanamāli-dāsa*—Vanamālī dāsa.

TRANSLATION

Nandinī, Kāmadeva, Caitanya dāsa, Durlabha Viśvāsa and Vanamālī dāsa were the tenth, eleventh, twelfth, thirteenth and fourteenth branches of Śrī Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 60

jagannātha kara, āra kara bhavanātha

hṛdayānanda sena, āra dāsa bholānātha

SYNONYMS

jagannātha kara—Jagannātha Kara; *āra*—and; *kara bhavanātha*—Bhavanātha Kara; *hṛdayānanda sena*—Hṛdayānanda Sena; *āra*—and; *dāsa bholānātha*—Bholānātha dāsa.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Kara, Bhavanātha Kara, Hṛdayānanda Sena and Bholānātha dāsa were the fifteenth, sixteenth, seventeenth and eighteenth branches of Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 61

yādava-dāsa, vijaya-dāsa, dāsa janārdana

ananta-dāsa, kānu-pañḍita, dāsa nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

yādava-dāsa—Yādava dāsa; *vijaya-dāsa*—Vijaya dāsa; *dāsa janārdana*—Janārdana dāsa; *ananta-dāsa*—Ananta dāsa; *kānu-pañḍita*—Kānu Pañḍita; *dāsa nārāyaṇa*—Nārāyaṇa dāsa.

TRANSLATION

Yādava dāsa, Vijaya dāsa, Janārdana dāsa, Ananta dāsa, Kānu Paṇḍita and Nārāyaṇa dāsa were the nineteenth, twentieth, twenty-first, twenty-second, twenty-third and twenty-fourth branches of Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 62

śrīvatsa paṇḍita, brahmacārī haridāsa

puruṣottama brahmacārī, āra kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrīvatsa paṇḍita—Śrīvatsa Paṇḍita; *brahmacārī haridāsa*—Haridāsa Brahmacārī; *puruṣottama brahmacārī*—Puruṣottama Brahmacārī; *āra*—and; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa.

TRANSLATION

Śrīvatsa Paṇḍita, Haridāsa Brahmacārī, Puruṣottama Brahmacārī and Kṛṣṇadāsa were the twenty-fifth, twenty-sixth, twenty-seventh and twenty-eighth branches of Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 63

puruṣottama paṇḍita, āra raghunātha

vanamālī kavicandra, āra vaidyanātha

SYNONYMS

puruṣottama paṇḍita—Puruṣottama Paṇḍita; *āra raghunātha*—and

Raghunātha; *vanamālī kavicandra*—Vanamālī Kavicandra; *āra*—and; *vaidyanātha*—Vaidyanātha.

TRANSLATION

Puruṣottama Paṇḍita, Raghunātha, Vanamālī Kavicandra and Vaidyanātha were the twenty-ninth, thirtieth, thirty-first and thirty-second branches of Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 64

lokanātha paṇḍita, āra murāri paṇḍita

śrī-haricaraṇa, āra mādharma paṇḍita

SYNONYMS

lokanātha paṇḍita—Lokanātha Paṇḍita; *āra*—and; *murāri paṇḍita*—Murāri Paṇḍita; *śrī-haricaraṇa*—Śrī Haricaraṇa; *āra*—and; *mādharma paṇḍita*—Mādhava Paṇḍita.

TRANSLATION

Lokanātha Paṇḍita, Murāri Paṇḍita, Śrī Haricaraṇa and Mādhava Paṇḍita were the thirty-third, thirty-fourth, thirty-fifth and thirty-sixth branches of Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 65

vijaya paṇḍita, āra paṇḍita śrīrāma

asaṅkha advaita-sākhā kata la-iba nāma

SYNONYMS

vijaya-pañḍita—Vijaya Paṇḍita; *āra*—and; *pañḍita śrīrāma*—Śrīrāma Paṇḍita; *asaṅkhyā*—innumerable; *advaita-sākhā*—branches of Advaita Ācārya; *kata*—how many; *la-iba*—shall I enumerate; *nāma*—their names.

TRANSLATION

Vijaya Paṇḍita and Śrīrāma Paṇḍita were two important branches of Advaita Ācārya. There are innumerable branches, but I am unable to mention them all.

PURPORT

Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita was an incarnation of Nārada Muni, and thus Śrīvāsa's younger brother, Śrīrāma Paṇḍita, is accepted as an incarnation of Parvata Muni, Nārada Muni's most intimate friend.

TEXT 66

māli-datta jala advaita-skandha yogāya

sei jale jīye sākhā, — — phula-phala pāya

SYNONYMS

māli-datta—given by the gardener; *jala*—water; *advaita-skandha*—the branch known as Advaita Ācārya; *yogāya*—supplies; *sei*—by that; *jale*—water; *jīye*—lives; *sākhā*—branches; *phula-phala*—fruits and flowers; *pāya*—grow.

TRANSLATION

The Advaita Ācārya branch received the water supplied by the original gardener, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. In this way, the subbranches were nourished, and their fruits and flowers grew luxuriantly.

PURPORT

The branches of Advaita Ācārya nourished by the water (*jala*) supplied by Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu are to be considered bona fide *ācāryas*. As we have discussed hereinbefore, the representatives of Advaita Ācārya later divided into two groups—the bona fide branches of the *ācārya*’s disciplic succession and the pretentious branches of Advaita Ācārya. Those who followed the principles of Caitanya Mahāprabhu flourished, whereas the others, who are mentioned below in the sixty-seventh verse, dried up.

TEXT 67

ihāra madhye mālī pāche kona śākhā-gaṇa

nā māne caitanya-mālī durdaiva kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

ihāra—of them; *madhye*—within; *mālī*—the gardener; *pāche*—later on; *kona*—some; *śākhā-gaṇa*—branches; *nā*—does not; *māne*—accept; *caitanya-mālī*—the gardener Lord Caitanya; *durdaiva*—unfortunate; *kāraṇa*—reason,

TRANSLATION

After the disappearance of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, some of the branches, for unfortunate reasons, deviated from His path.

TEXT 68

sṛjāila, jīyāila, tānre nā mānīla

kṛtaghna ha-ilā, tānre skandha kruddha ha-ila

SYNONYMS

srjāila—fructified; *jīyāila*—maintained; *tāñre*—Him; *nā*—not; *māñila*—accepted; *kṛtaghna*—ungrateful; *ha-ilā*—thus became; *tāñre*—to them; *skandha*—trunk; *kruddha*—angry; *ha-ila*—became.

TRANSLATION

Some branches did not accept the original trunk that vitalized and maintained the entire tree. When they thus became ungrateful, the original trunk was angry at them.

TEXT 69

kruddha hañā skandha tāre jala nā sañcāre

jalābhāve kṛśa śākhā śukāiyā mare

SYNONYMS

kruddha hañā—being angry; *skandha*—the trunk; *tāre*—onto them; *jala*—water; *nā*—did not; *sañcāre*—sprinkle; *jala-abhāve*—for want of water; *kṛśa*—thinner; *śākhā*—branch; *śukāiyā*—dried up; *mare*—died.

TRANSLATION

Thus Lord Caitanya did not sprinkle upon them the water of His mercy, and they gradually withered and died.

TEXT 70

caitanya-rahita deha—śuṣkakāṣṭha-sama

jīvitei mṛta sei, maile daṇḍe yama

SYNONYMS

caitanya-rahita—without consciousness; *deha*—body; *śuṣka-kāṣṭha-sama*—exactly like dry wood; *jīvitei*—while living; *mṛta*—dead; *sei*—that; *maile*—after death; *daṇḍe*—punishes; *yama*—Yamarāja.

TRANSLATION

A person without Kṛṣṇa consciousness is no better than dry wood or a dead body. He is understood to be dead while living, and after death he is punishable by Yamarāja.

PURPORT

In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Sixth Canto, Third Chapter, twenty-ninth verse, Yamarāja, the superintendent of death, tells his assistants what class of men they should bring before him. There he states, “A person whose tongue never describes the qualities and holy name of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, whose heart never throbs as he remembers Kṛṣṇa and His lotus feet, and whose head never bows in obeisances to the Supreme Lord must be brought before me for punishment.” In other words, nondevotees are brought before Yamarāja for punishment, and thus material nature awards them various types of bodies. After death, which is *dehāntara*, a change of body, nondevotees are brought before Yamarāja for justice. By the judgment of Yamarāja, material nature gives them bodies suitable for the reactions of their past activities. This is the process of *dehāntara*, or transmigration of the self from one body to another. Kṛṣṇa conscious devotees, however, are not subject to be judged by Yamarāja. For devotees there is an open road, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā*. After giving up the body (*tyaktvā deham*), a devotee never again has to accept another material body, for in a spiritual body he goes back home, back to Godhead. The punishments of Yamarāja are meant for persons who are not Kṛṣṇa conscious.

TEXT 71

kevala e gaṇa-prati nahe ei daṇḍa

caitanya-vimukha yei sei ta' pāṣaṇḍa

SYNONYMS

kevala—only; *e*—this; *gaṇa*—group; *prati*—unto them; *nahe*—it is not; *ei*—this; *daṇḍa*—punishment; *caitanya-vimukha*—against Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yei*—anyone; *sei*—he; *ta'*—but; *pāṣaṇḍa*—atheist.

TRANSLATION

Not only the misguided descendants of Advaita Ācārya but anyone who is against the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu should be considered an atheist subject to be punished by Yamarāja.

TEXT 72

ki paṇḍita, ki tapasvī, kibā gṛhī, yati

caitanya-vimukha yei, tāra ei gati

SYNONYMS

ki paṇḍita—whether a learned scholar; *ki tapasvī*—whether a great ascetic; *kibā*—or; *gṛhī*—householder; *yati*—or *sannyāsī*; *caitanya-vimukha*—one who is against the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yei*—anyone; *tāra*—his; *ei*—this; *gati*—destination.

TRANSLATION

Be he a learned scholar, a great ascetic, a successful householder or a famous sannyāsī, one who is against the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is destined to suffer the punishment meted out by Yamarāja.

TEXT 73

ye ye laila śrī-acyutānandera mata

sei ācāryera gaṇa—mahā-bhāgavata

SYNONYMS

ye ye—anyone who; *laila*—accepted; *śrī-acyutānandera*—of Śrī Acyutānanda; *mata*—the path; *sei*—those; *ācāryera gaṇa*—descendants of Advaita Ācārya; *mahā-bhāgavata*—are all great devotees.

TRANSLATION

The descendants of Advaita Ācārya who accepted the path of Śrī Acyutānanda were all great devotees.

PURPORT

In this connection, Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura, in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, gives this short note: “Śrī Advaita Ācārya is one of the important trunks of the *bhakti-kalpataru*, or desire tree of devotional service. Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, as a gardener, poured water on the root of the *bhakti* tree and thus nourished all its trunks and branches. But nevertheless, under the spell of *māyā*, the most unfortunate condition of a living entity, some of the branches, not accepting the gardener who poured water on them, considered the trunk the only cause of the great *bhakti-kalpataru*. In other words, the branches or descendants of Advaita Ācārya who considered Advaita Ācārya the original cause of the devotional creeper, and who thus neglected or disobeyed the instructions of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, deprived themselves of the effect of being watered and thus dried up and died. It is further to be understood that not only the misguided descendants of Advaita Ācārya but anyone who has no connection with Caitanya Mahāprabhu—even if he is independently a great *sannyāsī*, learned scholar or ascetic—is like a dead

branch of a tree.”

This analysis by Śrī Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura, supporting the statements of Śrī Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, depicts the position of the present so-called Hindu religion, which, being predominantly conducted by the Māyāvāda philosophy, has become a hodgepodge institution of various concocted ideas. Māyāvādīs greatly fear the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement and accuse it of spoiling the Hindu religion because it accepts people from all parts of the world and all religious sects and scientifically engages them in the *daiva-varṇāśrama-dharma*. As we have explained several times, however, we find no such word as “Hindu” in the Vedic literature. The word most probably came from Afghanistan, a predominantly Muslim country, and originally referred to a pass in Afghanistan known as Hindukush, which is still a part of a trade route between India and various Muslim countries.

The actual Vedic system of religion is called *varṇāśrama-dharma*, as confirmed in the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*:

*varṇāśramācāra-vatā puruṣeṇa paraḥ pumān
viṣṇur ārādhyate panthā nānyat tat-toṣa-kāraṇam*

(*Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 3.8.9)

The Vedic literature recommends that a human being follow the principles of *varṇāśrama-dharma*. Accepting the process of *varṇāśrama-dharma* will make a person’s life successful because this will connect him with the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is the goal of human life. Therefore the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is meant for all of humanity. Although human society has different sections or subdivisions, all human beings belong to one species, and therefore we accept that they all have the ability to understand their constitutional position in connection with the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Viṣṇu. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu confirms, *jīvera ‘svarūpa’ haya—kṛṣṇera nitya-dāsa*: [Cc. *Madhya* 20.108]. “Every living entity is an eternal part, an

eternal servant, of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.” Every living entity who attains the human form of life can understand the importance of his position and thus become eligible to become a devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa. We take it for granted, therefore, that all humanity should be educated in Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Indeed, in all parts of the world, in every country where we preach the *saṅkīrtana* movement, we find that people very easily accept the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* without hesitation. The visible effect of this chanting is that the members of the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement, regardless of their backgrounds, all give up the four principles of sinful life and come to an elevated standard of devotion.

Although posing as great scholars, ascetics, householders and *svāmīs*, the so-called followers of the Hindu religion are all useless, dried-up branches of the Vedic religion. They are impotent; they cannot do anything to spread the Vedic culture for the benefit of human society. The essence of the Vedic culture is the message of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Lord Caitanya instructed:

*yāre dekha, tāre kaha ‘kṛṣṇa’ upadeśa
āmāra ājñāya guru hañā tāra’ ei deśa*

(Cc. Madhya 7.128)

One should simply instruct everyone he meets regarding the principles of *kṛṣṇa-kathā*, as expressed in *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is* and *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. One who has no interest in *kṛṣṇa-kathā* or the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is like dry, useless wood with no living force. The ISKCON branch, being directly watered by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, is becoming undoubtedly successful, whereas the disconnected branches of the so-called Hindu religion that are envious of ISKCON are drying up and dying.

TEXT 74

sei sei,——ācāryera kṛpāra bhājana

anāyāse pāila sei caitanya-caraṇa

SYNONYMS

sei sei—whoever; *ācāryera*—of Advaita Ācārya; *kṛpāra*—of the mercy; *bhājana*—eligible candidate; *anāyāse*—without difficulty; *pāila*—got; *sei*—he; *caitanya-caraṇa*—the lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

By the mercy of Advaita Ācārya, the devotees who strictly followed the path of Caitanya Mahāprabhu attained the shelter of Lord Caitanya's lotus feet without difficulty.

TEXT 75

acyutera yei mata, sei mata sāra

āra yata mata saba haila chārakhāra

SYNONYMS

acyutera—of Acyutānanda; *yei*—which; *mata*—direction; *sei*—that; *mata*—direction; *sāra*—essential; *āra*—other; *yata*—all; *mata*—directions; *saba*—all; *haila*—became; *chārakhāra*—dismantled.

TRANSLATION

It should be concluded, therefore, that the path of Acyutānanda is the essence of spiritual life. Those who did not follow this path simply scattered.

TEXT 76

sei ācārya-gaṇe mora koṭi namaskāra

acyutānanda-prāya, caitanya—jīvana yāñhāra

SYNONYMS

sei—those; *ācārya-gaṇe*—unto the spiritual masters; *mora*—my; *koṭi*—millions; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *acyutānanda-prāya*—almost as good as Acyutānanda; *caitanya*—Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jīvana*—life; *yāñhāra*—whose.

TRANSLATION

I therefore offer my respectful obeisances millions of times to Acyutānanda's actual followers, whose life and soul was Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 77

ei ta' kahilāñ ācārya-gosāñhira gaṇa

tina skandha-sākhāra kaila sañkṣepa gaṇana

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—thus; *kahilāñ*—I have spoken; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *gosāñhira*—of the spiritual master; *gaṇa*—descendants; *tina*—three; *skandha*—of the trunk; *sākhāra*—of branches; *kaila*—was done; *sañkṣepa*—in brief; *gaṇana*—counting.

TRANSLATION

Thus I have briefly described the three branches [Acyutānanda, Kṛṣṇa Miśra and Gopāla] of Śrī Advaita Ācārya's descendants.

TEXT 78

śākhā-upasākhā, tāra nāhika gaṇana

kichu-mātra kahi' kari dig-daraśana

SYNONYMS

śākhā-upasākhā—branches and subbranches; *tāra*—of them; *nāhika*—there is no; *gaṇana*—counting; *kichu-mātra*—something about them; *kahi'*—describing; *kari*—I am simply giving; *dig-daraśana*—a glimpse of the direction.

TRANSLATION

There are multifarious branches and subbranches of Advaita Ācārya. It is very difficult to enumerate them fully. I have simply given a glimpse of the whole trunk and its branches and subbranches.

TEXT 79

śrī-gadādhara paṇḍita śākhāte mahottama

tānra upasākhā kichu kari ye gaṇana

SYNONYMS

śrī-gadādhara paṇḍita—Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *śākhāte*—of the branch; *mahottama*—very great; *tānra*—his; *upasākhā*—branches and subbranches; *kichu*—something; *kari*—let me do; *ye*—that; *gaṇana*—counting.

TRANSLATION

After describing the branches and subbranches of Advaita Ācārya, I shall now attempt to describe some of the descendants of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita, the most important among the branches.

TEXT 80

śākhā-śreṣṭha dhruvānanda, śrīdhara brahmacārī

bhāgavatācārya, haridāsa brahmacārī

SYNONYMS

śākhā-śreṣṭha—the chief branch; *dhruvānanda*—Dhruvānanda; *śrīdhara brahmacārī*—Śrīdhara Brahmacārī; *bhāgavatācārya*—Bhāgavata Ācārya; *haridāsa brahmacārī*—Haridāsa Brahmacārī.

TRANSLATION

The chief branches of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita were (1) Śrī Dhruvānanda, (2) Śrīdhara Brahmacārī, (3) Haridāsa Brahmacārī and (4) Raghunātha Bhāgavata Ācārya.

PURPORT

Text 152 of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* describes Śrī Dhruvānanda Brahmacārī as an incarnation of Lalitā, and texts 194 and 199 describe Śrīdhara Brahmacārī as the *gopī* known as Candralatikā.

TEXT 81

ananta ācārya, kavidatta, miśra-nayana

gaṅgāmantrī māmu ṭhākura, kaṇṭhābharaṇa

SYNONYMS

ananta ācārya—Ananta Ācārya; *kavi-datta*—Kavi Datta; *miśra-*

nayana—Nayana Miśra; *gaṅgāmantrī*—Gaṅgāmantrī; *māmu ṭhākura*—Māmu Ṭhākura; *kaṇṭhābharaṇa*—Kaṇṭhābharaṇa.

TRANSLATION

The fifth branch was Ananta Ācārya; the sixth, Kavi Datta; the seventh, Nayana Miśra; the eighth, Gaṅgāmantrī; the ninth, Māmu Ṭhākura; and the tenth, Kaṇṭhābharaṇa.

PURPORT

Texts 197 and 207 of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* describe Kavi Datta as the *gopī* named Kalakaṇṭhī, texts 196 and 207 describe Nayana Miśra as the *gopī* named Nitya-mañjarī, and texts 196 and 205 describe Gaṅgāmantrī as the *gopī* named Candrikā. Māmu Ṭhākura, whose real name was Jagannātha Cakravartī, was the nephew of Śrī Nīlāmbara Cakravartī, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's grandfather. In Bengal a maternal uncle is called *māmā*, and in East Bengal and Orissa, *māmu*. Thus Jagannātha Cakravartī was known as Māmā or Māmu Ṭhākura. Māmu Ṭhākura's residence was in the district of Faridpur, in the village known as Magḍobā. After the demise of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Māmu Ṭhākura became the priest in charge of the temple known as Ṭoṭā-gopīnātha, in Jagannātha Purī. According to the opinion of some Vaiṣṇavas, Māmu Ṭhākura was formerly known as Śrī Rūpa-mañjarī. The followers of Māmu Ṭhākura were Raghunātha Gosvāmī, Rāmacandra, Rādhāvallabha, Kṛṣṇajīvana, Śyāmasundara, Śāntāmaṇi, Harinātha, Navīnacandra, Matilāla, Dayāmayī and Kuṇjavihārī.

Kaṇṭhābharaṇa, whose original name was Śrī Ananta Caṭṭarāja, was the *gopī* named Gopālī in *kṛṣṇa-līlā*.

TEXT 82

bhūgarbha gosāñi, āra bhāgavata-dāsa

yei dui āsi' kaila vṛndāvane vāsa

SYNONYMS

bhūgarbha gosāñi—Bhūgarbha Gosāñi; *āra*—and; *bhāgavata-dāsa*—Bhāgavata dāsa; *yei dui*—both of them; *āsi'*—coming; *kaila*—did; *vṛndāvane vāsa*—residing in Vṛndāvana.

TRANSLATION

The eleventh branch of Gadādhara Gosvāmī was Bhūgarbha Gosāñi, and the twelfth was Bhāgavata dāsa. Both of them went to Vṛndāvana and resided there for life.

PURPORT

Bhūgarbha Gosāñi, formerly known as Prema-mañjarī, was a great friend of Lokanātha Gosvāmī, who constructed the temple of Gokulānanda, one of the seven important temples of Vṛndāvana—namely those of Govinda, Gopīnātha, Madana-mohana, Rādhāramaṇa, Śyāmasundara, Rādhā-Dāmodara and Gokulānanda—which are authorized institutions of Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas.

TEXT 83

vāñinātha brahmacārī—*baḍa mahāśaya*

vallabha-caitanya-dāsa—*kṛṣṇa-premamaya*

SYNONYMS

vāñinātha brahmacārī—Vāñinātha Brahmacārī; *baḍa mahāśaya*—very great personality; *vallabha-caitanya-dāsa*—Vallabha-caitanya dāsa; *kṛṣṇa-prema-maya*—always filled with love of Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

The thirteenth branch was Vāṇīnātha Brahmācārī, and the fourteenth was Vallabha-caitanya dāsa. Both of these great personalities were always filled with love of Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Śrī Vāṇīnātha Brahmācārī is described in the Tenth Chapter, verse 114, of the *Ādi-līlā*. A disciple of Vallabha-caitanya named Nalinī-mohana Gosvāmī established a temple of Madana-gopāla in Navadvīpa.

TEXT 84

śrīnātha cakravartī, āra uddhava dāsa

jitāmitra, kāṣṭhakāṭā-jagannātha-dāsa

SYNONYMS

śrīnātha cakravartī—Śrīnātha Cakravartī; *āra*—and; *uddhava dāsa*—Uddhava dāsa; *jitāmitra*—Jitāmitra; *kāṣṭhakāṭā jagannātha-dāsa*—Kāṣṭhakāṭā Jagannātha dāsa.

TRANSLATION

The fifteenth branch was Śrīnātha Cakravartī; the sixteenth, Uddhava; the seventeenth, Jitāmitra; and the eighteenth, Jagannātha dāsa.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “The *Śākhā-nirṇaya*, verse 13, mentions Śrīnātha Cakravartī as a reservoir of all good qualities and an expert in the service of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Similarly, verse 35 mentions Uddhava dāsa as being greatly qualified in distributing

love of Godhead to everyone. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (202) mentions Jitāmitra as the *gopī* named Śyāma-mañjarī. Jitāmitra wrote a book entitled *Kṛṣṇa-māyurya*. Jagannātha dāsa was a resident of Vikramapura, near Dacca. His birthplace was the village known as Kāṣṭhakāṭā or Kāṭhādiyā. His descendants now reside in villages known as Āḍiyala, Kāmārapāḍā and Pāikapāḍā. He established a temple of Yaśomādhava. The worshipers in this temple are the Gosvāmīs of Āḍiyala. As one of the sixty-four *sakhīs*, he was formerly an assistant of Citrādevī-gopī named Tilakinī. The following is a list of his descendants: Rāmanṛsimha, Rāmagopāla, Rāmacandra, Sanātana, Mukṭārāma, Gopīnātha, Goloka, Harimohana Śiromaṇi, Rākhālarāja, Mādhava and Lakṣmīkānta. The *Śākhā-nirṇaya* mentions that Jagannātha dāsa preached the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement in the district or state of Tripura.”

TEXT 85

śrī-hari ācārya, sādī-puriyā gopāla

kṛṣṇadāsa brahmacārī, puṣpa-gopāla

SYNONYMS

śrī-hari ācārya—Śrī Hari Ācārya; *sādī-puriyā gopāla*—Sādīpuriyā Gopāla; *kṛṣṇadāsa brahmacārī*—Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmacārī; *puṣpa-gopāla*—Puṣpagopāla.

TRANSLATION

The nineteenth branch was Śrī Hari Ācārya; the twentieth, Sādīpuriyā Gopāla; the twenty-first, Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmacārī; and the twenty-second, Puṣpagopāla.

PURPORT

The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (196 and 207) mentions that Hari Ācārya

was formerly the *gopī* named Kālākṣī. Sādipuriyā Gopāla is celebrated as a preacher of the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement in Vikramapura, in East Bengal (now Bangladesh). Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmācārī was formerly among the group of *sakhīs* known as the *aṣṭa-sakhīs*. His name was Indulekhā. Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmācārī lived in Vṛndāvana. There is a tomb in the Rādhā-Dāmodara temple known as Kṛṣṇadāsa's tomb. Some say that this is the tomb of Kṛṣṇadāsa Brahmācārī, and others say it is that of Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī. In either case we offer our respects because both of them were expert in distributing love of Godhead to the fallen souls of this age. The *Śākhā-nirṇaya* mentions that Puṣpagopāla was formerly known as Svarṇagrāmaka.

TEXT 86

śrīharṣa, raghu-miśra, paṇḍita lakṣmīnātha

baṅgavāṭī-caitanya-dāsa, śrī-raghunātha

SYNONYMS

śrīharṣa—Śrīharṣa; *raghu-miśra*—Raghu Miśra; *paṇḍita lakṣmīnātha*—Lakṣmīnātha Paṇḍita; *baṅgavāṭī-caitanya-dāsa*—Baṅgavāṭī Caitanya dāsa; *śrī-raghunātha*—Śrī Raghunātha.

TRANSLATION

The twenty-third branch was Śrīharṣa; the twenty-fourth, Raghu Miśra; the twenty-fifth, Lakṣmīnātha Paṇḍita; the twenty-sixth, Baṅgavāṭī Caitanya dāsa; and the twenty-seventh, Raghunātha.

PURPORT

Raghu Miśra is described in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (195 and 201) as

Karpūra-mañjarī. Similarly, Lakṣmīnātha Paṇḍita is mentioned as Rasonmādā, and Baṅgavāṭī Caitanya dāsa is mentioned as Kālī. The *Śākhā-nirṇaya* states that Baṅgavāṭī Caitanya dāsa was always seen with eyes full of tears. He also had a branch of descendants. Their names were Mathurāprasāda, Rukmiṇikānta, Jīvanakṛṣṇa, Yugalakīśora, Ratanakṛṣṇa, Rādhāmādhava, Ūṣāmaṇi, Vaikuṇṭhanātha and Lālamohana, or Lālamohana Śāhā Śāṅkhānidhi. Lālamohana was a great merchant in the city of Dacca. The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (194 and 200) mentions that Raghunātha was formerly Varāṅgadā.

TEXT 87

amogha paṇḍita, hasti-gopāla, caitanya-vallabha

yadu gāṅguli āra maṅgala vaiṣṇava

SYNONYMS

amogha paṇḍita—Amogha Paṇḍita; *hasti-gopāla*—Hastigopāla; *caitanya-vallabha*—Caitanya-vallabha; *yadu gāṅguli*—Yadu Gāṅguli; *āra*—and; *maṅgala vaiṣṇava*—Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava.

TRANSLATION

The twenty-eighth branch was Amogha Paṇḍita; the twenty-ninth, Hastigopāla; the thirtieth, Caitanya-vallabha; the thirty-first, Yadu Gāṅguli; and the thirty-second, Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Śrī Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava was a resident of the village Ṭṭakaṇā in the district of Murśidābād. His forefathers were *śāktas* who worshiped the goddess Kirīṭeśvarī. It is said that Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava, formerly a staunch *brahmacārī*, left home and later married the daughter of his disciple

Prāṇanātha Adhikārī in the village of Mayanāḍāla. The descendants of this family are known as the Ṭhākuras of Kāṇḍaḍā, which is a village in the district of Burdwan near Katwa. Scattered descendants of Maṅgala Vaiṣṇava, thirty-six families altogether, still live there. Among the celebrated disciples of Maṅgala Ṭhākura are Prāṇanātha Adhikārī, Puruṣottama Cakravartī of the village of Kāṇḍaḍā, and Nṛsimha-prasāda Mitra, whose family members are well-known *mṛdaṅga* players. Sudhākṛṣṇa Mitra and Nikuṅjavihārī Mitra are both especially famous *mṛdaṅga* players. In the family of Puruṣottama Cakravartī there are famous persons like Kuṅjavihārī Cakravartī and Rādhāvallabha Cakravartī, who now live in the district of Birbhum. They professionally recite songs from *Caitanya-maṅgala*. It is said that when Maṅgala Ṭhākura was constructing a road from Bengal to Jagannātha Purī, he found a Deity of Rādhāvallabha while digging a lake. At that time he was living in the locality of Kāṇḍaḍā, in the village named Rāṇīpura. The *śālagrāma-sīlā* personally worshiped by Maṅgala Ṭhākura still exists in the village of Kāṇḍaḍā. A temple has been constructed there for the worship of Vṛndāvana-candra. Maṅgala Ṭhākura had three sons—Rādhikāprasāda, Gopīramaṇa and Śyāmakīśora. The descendants of these three sons are still living.”

TEXT 88

cakravartī śivānanda sadā vrajavāsī

mahāśākhā-madhye teṇho sudṛḍha viśvāsī

SYNONYMS

cakravartī śivānanda—Śivānanda Cakravartī; *sadā*—always; *vraja-vāsī*—resident of Vṛndāvana; *mahā-śākhā-madhye*—amongst the great branches; *teṇho*—he is; *sudṛḍha viśvāsī*—possessing firm faith.

TRANSLATION

Śivānanda Cakravartī, the thirty-third branch, who always lived in Vṛndāvana with firm conviction, is considered an important branch of Gadādhara Paṇḍita.

PURPORT

The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (183) mentions that Śivānanda Cakravartī was formerly Lavaṅga-mañjarī. The *Śākhā-nirṇaya*, written by Yadunandana dāsa, also names other branches of Gadādhara Paṇḍita, as follows: (1) Mādhavācārya, (2) Gopāla dāsa, (3) Hṛdayānanda, (4) Vallabha Bhaṭṭa (the Vallabha-sampradāya, or Puṣṭimārga-sampradāya, is very famous), (5) Madhu Paṇḍita (this famous devotee lived near Khaḍadaha, in the village known as Sāṇibonā-grāma, about two miles east of the Khaḍadaha station, and constructed the temple of Gopīnāthajī in Vṛndāvana), (6) Acyutānanda, (7) Candrasēkhara, (8) Vakreśvara Paṇḍita, (9) Dāmodara, (10) Bhagavān Ācārya, (11) Ananta Ācāryavarya, (12) Kṛṣṇadāsa, (13) Paramānanda Bhaṭṭācārya, (14) Bhavānanda Gosvāmī, (15) Caitanya dāsa, (16) Lokanātha Bhaṭṭa (this devotee, who lived in the village of Tālakhāḍi in the district of Yaśohara [Jessore] and constructed the temple of Rādhāvinoda, was the spiritual master of Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura and a great friend of Bhūgarbha Gosvāmī), (17) Govinda Ācārya, (18) Akrūra Ṭhākura, (19) Saṅketa Ācārya, (20) Pratāpāditya, (21) Kamalākānta Ācārya, (22) Yādava Ācārya and (23) Nārāyaṇa Paḍihārī (a resident of Jagannātha Purī).

TEXT 89

ei ta' saṅkṣepe kahilān paṇḍitera gaṇa

aiche āra śākhā-upasākhāra gaṇana

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—thus; *saṅkṣepe*—in brief; *kahilān*—I have described; *paṇḍitera gaṇa*—the branches of Śrī Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *aiche*—similarly; *āra*—another; *śākhā-upaśākhāra gaṇana*—description of branches and subbranches.

TRANSLATION

Thus I have briefly described the branches and subbranches of Gadādhara Paṇḍita. There are still many more that I have not mentioned here.

TEXT 90

paṇḍitera gaṇa saba, — — bhāgavata dhanya

prāṇa-vallabha — — sabāra śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

SYNONYMS

paṇḍitera—of Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *gaṇa*—followers; *saba*—all; *bhāgavata dhanya*—glorious devotees; *prāṇa-vallabha*—the heart and soul; *sabāra*—of all of them; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

All the followers of Gadādhara Paṇḍita are considered great devotees because they have Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as their life and soul.

TEXT 91

ei tina skandhera kailuṇ śākhāra gaṇana

yān-sabā-smaraṇe bhava-bandha-vimocana

SYNONYMS

ei tina—of all these three; *skandhera*—trunks; *kailuṇ*—described; *śākhāra gaṇana*—enumeration of the branches; *yāñ-sabā*—all of them; *smaraṇe*—by remembering; *bhava-bandha*—from entanglement in the material world; *vimocana*—freedom.

TRANSLATION

Simply by remembering the names of all these branches and subbranches of the three trunks I have described [Nityānanda, Advaita and Gadādhara], one attains freedom from the entanglement of material existence.

TEXT 92

yāñ-sabā-smaraṇe pāi caitanya-caraṇa

yāñ-sabā-smaraṇe haya vāñchita pūraṇa

SYNONYMS

yāñ-sabā—all of them; *smaraṇe*—by remembering; *pāi*—I get; *caitanya-caraṇa*—the lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yāñ-sabā*—all of them; *smaraṇe*—by remembering; *haya*—becomes; *vāñchita pūraṇa*—fulfillment of all desires.

TRANSLATION

Simply by remembering the names of all these Vaiṣṇavas, one can attain the lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Indeed, simply by remembering their holy names, one achieves the fulfillment of all desires.

TEXT 93

ataeva tñi-sabāra vandiye caraṇa

caitanya-mālira kahi līlā-anukrama

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *tñi-sabāra*—of all of them; *vandiye*—I offer prayers; *caraṇa*—to the lotus feet; *caitanya-mālira*—of the gardener known as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kahi*—I speak; *līlā-anukrama*—the pastimes in chronological order.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, offering my obeisances at the lotus feet of them all, I shall describe the pastimes of the gardener, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, in chronological order.

TEXT 94

gaura-līlāmṛta-sindhu—apāra agādha

ke karite pāre tāhāṇi avagāha-sādha

SYNONYMS

gaura-līlāmṛta-sindhu—the ocean of the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *apāra*—immeasurable; *agādha*—unfathomable; *ke*—who; *karite*—to do; *pāre*—is able; *tāhāṇi*—in that ocean; *avagāha*—taking a dip; *sādha*—execution.

TRANSLATION

The ocean of the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is immeasurable and unfathomable. Who can have the courage to measure that great ocean?

TEXT 95

tāhāra mādhubya-gandhe lubdha haya mana

ataeva taṭe rahi' cāki eka kaṇa

SYNONYMS

tāhāra—His; *mādhubya*—sweet and mellow; *gandhe*—by the fragrance; *lubdha*—attracted; *haya*—becomes; *mana*—mind; *ataeva*—therefore; *taṭe*—on the beach; *rahi'*—standing; *cāki*—I taste; *eka*—one; *kaṇa*—particle.

TRANSLATION

It is not possible to dip into that great ocean, but its sweet mellow fragrance attracts my mind. I therefore stand on the shore of that ocean to try to taste but a drop of it.

TEXT 96

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at their lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring

their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Twelfth Chapter, describing the expansions of Advaita Ācārya and Gadādhara Paṇḍita.

Chapter 13

The Advent of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

The Thirteenth Chapter describes Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's appearance. The entire *Ādi-līlā* describes Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's household life, and similarly the *Antya-līlā* describes His life in the *sannyāsa* order. Within the Lord's *antya-līlā*, the first six years of His *sannyāsa* life are called the *madhya-līlā*. During this time, Caitanya Mahāprabhu toured southern India, went to Vṛndāvana, returned from Vṛndāvana and preached the *saṅkīrtana* movement.

A learned *brāhmaṇa* named Upendra Miśra, who resided in the district of Śrīhaṭṭa, was the father of Jagannātha Miśra, who came to Navadvīpa to study under the direction of Nīlāmbara Cakravartī and then settled there after marrying Nīlāmbara Cakravartī's daughter, Śacīdevī. Śrī Śacīdevī gave birth to eight children, all daughters, who died one after another immediately after birth. After her ninth pregnancy she gave birth to a son, who was named Viśvarūpa. Then, in 1407 Śaka Era (A.D. 1486), in the full-moon evening of the month of Phālguna, with the constellation of Simha (Leo) on the horizon, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared as the son of Śrī Śacīdevī and Jagannātha Miśra. After hearing of the birth of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, learned scholars and *brāhmaṇas*, bringing many gifts, came to see the newborn baby. Nīlāmbara Cakravartī, who was a great astrologer, immediately prepared a horoscope, and by astrological calculation he saw that the child was a great personality. This chapter describes the symptoms of this great personality.

TEXT 1

sa prasīdatu caitanya-

devo yasya prasādataḥ

tat-līlā-varṇane yogyaḥ

sadyaḥ syād adhamo 'py ayam

SYNONYMS

saḥ—He; *prasīdatu*—may bestow His blessings; *caitanya-devaḥ*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yasya*—of whom; *prasādataḥ*—by the grace; *tat-līlā*—His pastimes; *varṇane*—in the description; *yogyaḥ*—able; *sadyaḥ*—immediately; *syāt*—becomes possible; *adhamāḥ*—the most fallen; *api*—although; *ayam*—I am.

TRANSLATION

I wish the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by whose mercy even one who is fallen can describe the pastimes of the Lord.

PURPORT

To describe Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu or Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, one needs supernatural power, which is the grace and mercy of the Lord. Without this grace and mercy, one cannot compose transcendental literature. By dint of the grace of the Lord, however, even one who is unfit for a literary career can describe wonderful transcendental topics. Description of Kṛṣṇa is possible for one who is empowered. *Kṛṣṇa-śakti vinā nahe tāra pravartana* (Cc. *Antya* 7.11). Unless endowed with the mercy of the Lord, one cannot preach of the Lord's name, fame, qualities, form, entourage and so on. It should be concluded, therefore, that the writing of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī manifests specific

mercy bestowed upon the author, although he thought of himself as the most fallen. We should not consider him fallen because he describes himself as such. Rather, anyone who is able to compose such transcendental literature is our esteemed master.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gauracandra

jayādvaitacandra jaya jaya nityānanda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gaura-candra*—Lord Gauracandra; *jaya advaita-candra*—all glories to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya jaya*—all glories to; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu! All glories to Advaitacandra! All glories to Lord Nityānanda Prabhu!

TEXT 3

jaya jaya gadādhara jaya śrīnivāsa

jaya mukunda vāsudeva jaya haridāsa

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya gadādhara—all glories to Gadādhara Prabhu; *jaya śrīnivāsa*—all glories to Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *jaya mukunda*—all glories to Mukunda; *vāsudeva*—all glories to Vāsudeva; *jaya haridāsa*—all glories to Haridāsa Ṭhākura.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Gadādhara Prabhu! All glories to Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura! All glories to Mukunda Prabhu and Vāsudeva Prabhu! All glories to Haridāsa Ṭhākura!

TEXT 4

jaya dāmodara-svarūpa jaya murāri gupta

ei saba candrodaye tamaḥ kaila lupta

SYNONYMS

jaya—all glories; *dāmodara-svarūpa*—Svarūpa Dāmodara; *jaya*—all glories; *murāri gupta*—Murāri Gupta; *ei saba*—of all these; *candra-udaye*—such moons having arisen; *tamaḥ*—darkness; *kaila*—made; *lupta*—dissipated.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Svarūpa Dāmodara and Murāri Gupta! All these brilliant moons have together dissipated the darkness of this material world.

TEXT 5

jaya śrī-caitanyacandrera bhakta candra-gaṇa

sabāra prema jyotsnāya ujjala tri-bhuvana

SYNONYMS

jaya—all glories; *śrī-caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *candrera*—who is as bright as the moon; *bhakta*—devotees; *candra-gaṇa*—other moons; *sabāra*—of all of them; *prema-jyotsnāya*—by the full

light of love of Godhead; *ujjala*—bright; *tri-bhuvana*—all the three worlds.

TRANSLATION

All glories to the moons who are devotees of the principal moon, Lord Caitanyacandra! Their bright moonshine illuminates the entire universe.

PURPORT

In this verse we find the moon described as *candra-gaṇa*, which is plural in number. This indicates that there are many moons. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.21) the Lord says, *nakṣatrāṇām ahaṁ śasī*: “Among the stars, I am the moon.” All the stars are like the moon. Western astronomers consider the stars to be suns, but Vedic astronomers, following the Vedic scriptures, consider them moons. The sun has the ability to shine powerfully, and the moons reflect the sunshine and therefore look brilliant. In the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* Kṛṣṇa is described to be like the sun. The supreme powerful is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa, or Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and His devotees are also bright and illuminating because they reflect the supreme sun. The *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* (*Madhya* 22.31) states:

*kṛṣṇa—sūrya-sama; māyā haya andhakāra
yāhān kṛṣṇa, tāhān nāhi māyāra adhikāra*

“Kṛṣṇa is bright like the sun. As soon as the sun appears, there is no question of darkness or nescience.” Similarly, the present verse also describes that by the illumination of all the moons, brightened by the reflection of the Kṛṣṇa sun, or by the grace of all the devotees of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the entire world will be illuminated, despite the darkness of Kali-yuga. Only the devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu can dissipate the darkness of Kali-yuga, the ignorance of the population of this age. No one else can do so. We therefore wish that all the devotees of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement may reflect the supreme sun and thus dissipate

the darkness of the entire world.

TEXT 6

ei ta' kahila granthārambhe mukha-bandha

ebe kahi caitanya-līlā-krama-anubandha

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—thus; *kahila*—I have spoken; *grantha-ārambhe*—in the beginning of the book; *mukha-bandha*—preface; *ebe*—now; *kahi*—I speak; *caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *līlā-krama*—the chronological order of His pastimes; *anubandha*—as they are combined together.

TRANSLATION

Thus I have spoken the preface of the Caitanya-caritāmṛta. Now I shall describe Caitanya Mahāprabhu's pastimes in chronological order.

TEXT 7

prathame ta' sūtra-rūpe kariye gaṇana

pācīe tāhā vistāri kariba vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

prathame—in the beginning; *ta'*—however; *sūtra-rūpe*—in the form of a synopsis; *kariye*—do; *gaṇana*—counting; *pācīe*—thereafter; *tāhā*—that; *vistāri*—describing; *kariba*—I shall do; *vivaraṇa*—expansion.

TRANSLATION

First let me give a synopsis of the Lord's pastimes. Then I shall describe

them in detail.

TEXT 8

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya navadvīpe avatari

āṭa-calliśa vatsara prakāṣa vihari

SYNONYMS

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *navadvīpe*—at Navadvīpa; *avatari*—adventing Himself; *āṭa-calliśa*—forty-eight; *vatsara*—years; *prakāṣa*—visible; *vihari*—enjoying.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, adventing Himself in Navadvīpa, was visible for forty-eight years, enjoying His pastimes.

TEXT 9

caudda-śata sāta śake janmera pramāṇa

caudda-śata pañcāṇne ha-ila antardhāna

SYNONYMS

caudda-śata-sata—1407; *śake*—in the Śaka Era; *janmera*—of birth; *pramāṇa*—evidence; *caudda-śata pañcāṇne*—in the year 1455; *ha-ila*—became; *antardhāna*—disappearance.

TRANSLATION

In the year 1407 of the Śaka Era (A.D. 1486), Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared, and in the year 1455 (A.D. 1534) He disappeared

from this world.

TEXT 10

cabbiśa vatsara prabhu kaila gr̥ha-vāsa

nirantara kaila kṛṣṇa-kīrtana-vilāsa

SYNONYMS

cabbiśa—twenty-four; *vatsara*—years; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kaila*—did; *gr̥ha-vāsa*—residing at home; *nirantara*—always; *kaila*—did; *kṛṣṇa-kīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *vilāsa*—pastimes.

TRANSLATION

For twenty-four years Lord Caitanya lived in the gr̥hastha-āśrama [household life], always engaging in the pastimes of the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement.

TEXT 11

cabbiśa vatsara-śeṣe kariyā sannyāsa

āra cabbiśa vatsara kaila nīlācale vāsa

SYNONYMS

cabbiśa—twenty-four; *vatsara*—years; *śeṣe*—at the end of; *kariyā*—accepting; *sannyāsa*—renounced order; *āra*—another; *cabbiśa*—twenty-four; *vatsara*—years; *kaila*—did; *nīlācale*—at Jagannātha Purī; *vāsa*—reside.

TRANSLATION

After twenty-four years He accepted the renounced order of life, sannyāsa, and He resided for twenty-four years more at Jagannātha Purī.

TEXT 12

tāra madhye chaya vatsara—gamanāgamana

kabhu dakṣiṇa, kabhu gauḍa, kabhu vṛndāvana

SYNONYMS

tāra madhye—out of that; *chaya vatsara*—six years; *gamana-āgamana*—touring; *kabhu*—sometimes; *dakṣiṇa*—in South India; *kabhu*—sometimes; *gauḍa*—in Bengal; *kabhu*—sometimes; *vṛndāvana*—in Vṛndāvana.

TRANSLATION

Of these last twenty-four years, He spent the first six continuously touring India, sometimes in South India, sometimes in Bengal and sometimes in Vṛndāvana.

TEXT 13

aṣṭādaśa vatsara rahilā nīlācale

kṛṣṇa-prema-nāmāmṛte bhāsā'la sakale

SYNONYMS

aṣṭādaśa—eighteen; *vatsara*—years; *rahilā*—remained; *nīlācale*—at Jagannātha Purī; *kṛṣṇa-prema*—love of Godhead; *nāma-amṛte*—in the nectar of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *bhāsā'la*—inundated; *sakale*—everyone.

TRANSLATION

For the remaining eighteen years He continuously stayed in Jagannātha Purī. Chanting the nectarean Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra, He inundated everyone there in a flood of love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 14

gārhashtye prabhura līlā—‘ādi’-līlākhyāna

‘madhya’- ‘antya’-līlā—śeṣa-līlāra dui nāma

SYNONYMS

gārhashtye—in household life; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *līlā*—pastimes; *ādi*—the original; *līlā*—pastimes; *ākhyāna*—has the name of; *madhya*—middle; *antya*—last; *līlā*—pastimes; *śeṣa-līlāra*—the last part of the pastimes; *dui*—two; *nāma*—names.

TRANSLATION

The pastimes of His household life are known as the ādi-līlā, or the original pastimes. His later pastimes are known as the madhya-līlā and antya-līlā, or the middle and final pastimes.

TEXT 15

ādi-līlā-madhye prabhura yateka carita

sūtra-rūpe murāri gupta karilā grathita

SYNONYMS

ādi-līlā—the original pastimes; *madhye*—within; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *yateka*—whatever; *carita*—activities; *sūtra-rūpe*—in the form of notes;

murāri gupta—Murāri Gupta; *karilā*—has; *grathita*—recorded.

TRANSLATION

All the pastimes enacted by Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu in His ādi-līlā were recorded in summary form by Murāri Gupta.

TEXT 16

prabhura ye śeṣa-līlā svarūpa-dāmodara

sūtra kari' granthilena granthera bhitara

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *ye*—whatever; *śeṣa-līlā*—pastimes at the end; *svarūpa- dāmodara*—Svarūpa Dāmodara; *sūtra kari'*—in the form of notes; *granthilena*—recorded; *granthera*—a book; *bhitara*—within.

TRANSLATION

His later pastimes [the madhya-līlā and antya-līlā] were recorded in the form of notes by His secretary, Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī, and thus kept within a book.

TEXT 17

ei dui janera sūtra dekhiyā śuniyā

varṇanā karena vaiṣṇava krama ye kariyā

SYNONYMS

ei—of these; *dui*—two; *janera*—persons; *sūtra*—notes; *dekhiyā*—after looking at; *śuniyā*—and hearing; *varṇanā*—description; *karena*—does;

vaiṣṇava—the devotee; *krama*—chronological; *ye*—which; *kariyā*—making.

TRANSLATION

By seeing and hearing the notes recorded by these two great personalities, a Vaiṣṇava, a devotee of the Lord, can know these pastimes one after another.

TEXT 18

bālya, paugaṇḍa, kaiśora, yauvana, — — cāri bheda

ataeva ādi-khaṇḍe līlā cāri bheda

SYNONYMS

bālya—childhood; *paugaṇḍa*—early boyhood; *kaiśora*—later boyhood; *yauvana*—youth; *cāri*—four; *bheda*—divisions; *ataeva*—therefore; *ādi-khaṇḍe*—in the original part; *līlā*—of the pastimes; *cāri*—four; *bheda*—divisions.

TRANSLATION

In His original pastimes there are four divisions: *bālya*, *paugaṇḍa*, *kaiśora* and *yauvana* [childhood, early boyhood, later boyhood and youth].

TEXT 19

sarva-sad-guṇa-pūrṇām tām

vande phālguna-pūrṇimām

yasyām śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanyo

'vatīrṇaḥ kṛṣṇa-nāmaḥ

SYNONYMS

sarva—all; *sat*—auspicious; *guṇa*—qualities; *pūrṇām*—filled with; *tām*—that; *vande*—I offer obeisances; *phālguna*—of the month of Phālguna; *pūrṇimām*—the full-moon evening; *yasyām*—in which; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanyaḥ*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *avatīrṇaḥ*—advented; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa's; *nāmaḥ*—with the chanting of the holy names.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto the full-moon evening in the month of Phālguna, an auspicious time full of auspicious symptoms, when Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu advented Himself with the chanting of the holy name, Hare Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 20

phālguna-pūrṇimā-sandhyāya prabhura janmodaya

sei-kāle daiva-yoge candra-grahaṇa haya

SYNONYMS

phālguna-pūrṇimā—of the full moon of the month of Phālguna; *sandhyāya*—in the evening; *prabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *janma-udaya*—at the time of His birth; *sei-kāle*—at that moment; *daiva-yoge*—accidentally; *candra-grahaṇa*—lunar eclipse; *haya*—takes place.

TRANSLATION

On the full-moon evening of the month of Phālguna when the Lord took birth, coincidentally there was also a lunar eclipse.

TEXT 21

‘hari’ ‘hari’ bale loka haraṣita hañā

janmilā caitanya-prabhu ‘nāma’ janmāiyā

SYNONYMS

hari hari—the holy names of the Lord; *bale*—speak; *loka*—the people; *haraṣita*—jubilant; *hañā*—becoming; *janmilā*—took birth; *caitanya-prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nāma*—the holy name; *janmāiyā*—after causing to appear.

TRANSLATION

In jubilation everyone was chanting the holy name of the Lord—“Hari! Hari!”—and Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu then appeared, after first causing the appearance of the holy name.

TEXT 22

janma-bālya-paugaṇḍa-kaiśora-yuvā-kāle

hari-nāma laoyāilā prabhu nānā chale

SYNONYMS

janma—time of birth; *bālya*—childhood; *paugaṇḍa*—early boyhood; *kaiśora*—end of boyhood; *yuvā-kāle*—youth; *hari-nāma*—the holy name of the Lord; *laoyāilā*—caused to take; *prabhu*—the Lord; *nānā*—various; *chale*—under different pleas.

TRANSLATION

At His birth, in His childhood and in His early and later boyhood, as well

as in His youth, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, under different pleas, induced people to chant the holy name of Hari [the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra].

TEXT 23

bālya-bhāva chale prabhu karena krandana

‘kṛṣṇa’ ‘hari’ nāma śuni’ rahaye rodana

SYNONYMS

bālya-bhāva chale—as if in His childhood state; *prabhu*—the Lord; *karena*—does; *krandana*—crying; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *hari*—Lord Hari; *nāma*—names; *śuni’*—hearing; *rahaye*—stops; *rodana*—crying.

TRANSLATION

In His childhood, when the Lord was crying He would stop immediately upon hearing the holy names Kṛṣṇa and Hari.

TEXT 24

ataeva ‘hari’ ‘hari’ bale nārīgaṇa

dekhite āise yebā sarva bandhu jana

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *hari hari*—the holy name of the Lord; *bale*—chant; *nārīgaṇa*—all the ladies; *dekhite*—to see; *āise*—they come; *yebā*—whoever; *sarva*—all; *bandhu-jana*—friends.

TRANSLATION

All the friendly ladies who came to see the child would chant the holy names, “Hari, Hari!” as soon as the child would cry.

TEXT 25

‘gaurahari’ bali’ tāre hāse sarva nārī

ataeva haila tāñra nāma ‘gaurahari’

SYNONYMS

gaurahari—Gaurahari; *bali’*—addressing Him thus; *tāre*—unto the Lord; *hāse*—laugh; *sarva nārī*—all the ladies; *ataeva*—therefore; *haila*—became; *tāñra*—His; *nāma*—name; *gaurahari*—Gaurahari.

When all the ladies saw this fun, they enjoyed laughing and called the Lord “Gaurahari.” From then on, Gaurahari became another of His names.

TEXT 26

bālya vayasa—yāvat hāte khaḍi dila

paugaṇḍa vayasa—yāvat vivāha nā kaila

SYNONYMS

bālya vayasa—childhood age; *yāvat*—until the time; *hāte*—in His hand; *khaḍi*—chalk; *dila*—was given; *paugaṇḍa vayasa*—the part of boyhood known as *paugaṇḍa*; *yāvat*—until; *vivāha*—marriage; *nā*—not; *kaila*—did take place.

TRANSLATION

His childhood lasted until the date of *hāte khaḍi*, the beginning of His

education, and His age from the end of His childhood until He married is called paugaṇḍa.

TEXT 27

vivāha karile haila navīna yauvana

sarvatra laoyāila prabhu nāma-saṅkīrtana

SYNONYMS

vivāha karile—after getting married; *haila*—began; *navīna*—new; *yauvana*—youth; *sarvatra*—everywhere; *laoyāila*—caused to take; *prabhu*—the Lord; *nāma-saṅkīrtana*—the *saṅkīrtana* movement.

TRANSLATION

After His marriage His youth began, and in His youth He induced everyone to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra anywhere and everywhere.

TEXT 28

paugaṇḍa-vayase paḍena, paḍāna śiṣyagaṇe

sarvatra karena kṛṣṇa-nāmera vyākhyāne

SYNONYMS

paugaṇḍa-vayase—in the age of *paugaṇḍa*; *paḍena*—studies; *paḍāna*—teaches; *śiṣya-gaṇe*—disciples; *sarvatra*—everywhere; *karena*—does; *kṛṣṇa-nāmera*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vyākhyāne*—description.

TRANSLATION

During His paugaṇḍa age He became a serious student and also taught disciples. In this way He used to explain the holy name of Kṛṣṇa everywhere.

TEXT 29

sūtra-vṛtti-pāñji-ṭikā kṛṣṇete tātparya

śiṣyera pratīta haya, — — prabhāva āścarya

SYNONYMS

sūtra—aphorisms; *vṛtti*—explanation; *pāñji*—application; *ṭikā*—notes; *kṛṣṇete*—unto Kṛṣṇa; *tātparya*—culmination; *śiṣyera*—of the disciple; *pratīta*—realization; *haya*—becomes; *prabhāva*—influence; *āścarya*—wonderful.

TRANSLATION

When teaching a course in grammar [vyākaraṇa] and explaining it with notes, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu taught His disciples about the glories of Lord Kṛṣṇa. All explanations culminated in Kṛṣṇa, and His disciples would understand them very easily. Thus His influence was wonderful.

PURPORT

Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī compiled a grammar in two parts, named *Laghu-hari-nāmāmṛta-vyākaraṇa* and *Bṛhad-dhari-nāmāmṛta-vyākaraṇa*. If someone studies these two texts in *vyākaraṇa*, or grammar, he learns the grammatical rules of the Sanskrit language and simultaneously learns how to become a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, First Chapter, there is a statement about the method by which Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu taught grammar. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu explained the aphorisms of

grammar to be eternal, like the holy name of Kṛṣṇa. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.15), *vedaś ca sarvair aham eva vedyah*. The purport of all revealed scriptures is understanding of Kṛṣṇa. Therefore if a person explains anything that is not Kṛṣṇa, he simply wastes his time laboring hard without fulfilling the aim of his life. If one simply becomes a teacher or professor of education but does not understand Kṛṣṇa, it is to be understood that he is among the lowest of mankind, as stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.15): *narādhamā māyayāpahṛta-jñānāḥ*. If one does not know the essence of all revealed scriptures but still becomes a teacher, his teaching is like the disturbing braying of an ass.

TEXT 30

yāre dekhe, tāre kahe, — — kaha kṛṣṇa-nāma

kṛṣṇa-nāme bhāsāila navadvīpa-grāma

SYNONYMS

yāre—whomever; *dekhe*—He sees; *tāre*—to him; *kahe*—He says; *kaha*—speak; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṣṇa-nāme*—by the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhāsāila*—was inundated; *navadvīpa*—Navadvīpa; *grāma*—village.

TRANSLATION

When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was a student, He asked whomever He met to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra. In this way He inundated the whole town of Navadvīpa with the chanting of Hare Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The present Navadvīpa-dhāma is but a part of the whole of Navadvīpa. Navadvīpa means “nine islands.” These nine islands, which occupy an area of land estimated at thirty-two square miles, are surrounded by

different branches of the Ganges. In all nine of those islands of the Navadvīpa area there are different places for cultivating devotional service. It is stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (7.5.23) that there are *nava-vidha bhakti*, nine different activities of devotional service:

*śravaṇaṁ kīrtanaṁ viṣṇoḥ smaraṇaṁ pāda-sevanam
arcanaṁ vandanaṁ dāsyam sakhyam ātma-nivedanam*
[SB 7.5.23]

There are different islands in the Navadvīpa area for cultivation of these nine varieties of devotional service. They are as follows: (1) Antardvīpa, (2) Sīmantadvīpa, (3) Godrumadvīpa, (4) Madhyadvīpa, (5) Koladvīpa, (6) Ṛtadvīpa, (7) Jahnudvīpa, (8) Modadruma-dvīpa and (9) Rudradvīpa. According to the settlement map, our ISKCON Navadvīpa center is situated on the Rudradvīpa island. Below Rudradvīpa, in Antardvīpa, is Māyāpur. There Śrī Jagannātha Miśra, the father of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, used to reside. In all these different islands, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, as a young man, used to lead His *saṅkīrtana* party. He thus inundated the entire area with the waves of love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 31

kiśora vayase ārambhilā saṅkīrtana

rātra-dine preme nṛtya, saṅge bhakta-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

kiśora vayase—just before the beginning of His youthful life; *ārambhilā*—began; *saṅkīrtana*—the saṅkīrtana movement; *rātra-dine*—night and day; *preme*—in ecstasy; *nṛtya*—dancing; *saṅge*—along with; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees.

TRANSLATION

Just prior to His youthful life, He began the saṅkīrtana movement. Day and night He used to dance in ecstasy with His devotees.

TEXT 32

nagare nagare bhrame kīrtana kariyā

bhāsāila tri-bhuvana prema-bhakti diyā

SYNONYMS

nagare nagare—in different parts of the town; *bhrame*—wanders; *kīrtana*—chanting; *kariyā*—performing; *bhāsāila*—inundated; *tri-bhuvana*—all the three worlds; *prema-bhakti*—love of Godhead; *diyā*—distributing.

TRANSLATION

The saṅkīrtana movement went on from one part of the town to another, as the Lord wandered everywhere performing kīrtana. In this way He inundated the whole world by distributing love of Godhead.

PURPORT

One may raise the question how all three worlds became inundated with love of Kṛṣṇa, since Caitanya Mahāprabhu performed *kīrtana* only in the Navadvīpa area. The answer is that Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Kṛṣṇa Himself. The entire cosmic manifestation results from the Lord's first setting it in motion. Similarly, since the *saṅkīrtana* movement was first set in motion five hundred years ago by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's desire that it spread all over the universe, the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, in continuity of that same motion, is now spreading all over the world, and in this way it will gradually spread all over the universe. With the spread of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, everyone will merge in an ocean of love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 33

cabbiśa vatsara aiche navadvīpa-grāme

laoyāilā sarva-loke kṛṣṇa-prema-nāme

SYNONYMS

cabbiśa—twenty-four; *vatsara*—years; *aiche*—in that way; *navadvīpa*—Navadvīpa; *grāme*—in the village; *laoyāilā*—induced; *sarva-loke*—every man; *kṛṣṇa-prema*—love of Kṛṣṇa; *nāme*—in the holy name.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu lived in the Navadvīpa area for twenty-four years, and He induced every person to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra and thus merge in love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 34

cabbiśa vatsara chilā kariyā sannyāsa

bhakta-gaṇa lañā kailā nīlācale vāsa

SYNONYMS

cabbiśa—twenty-four; *vatsara*—years; *chilā*—remained; *kariyā*—accepting; *sannyāsa*—the renounced order; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *lañā*—taking with Him; *kailā*—did; *nīlācale*—in Jagannātha Purī; *vāsa*—reside.

TRANSLATION

For His remaining twenty-four years, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, after accepting the renounced order of life, stayed at Jagannātha Purī with His

devotees.

TEXT 35

tāra madhye nīlācale chaya vatsara

nṛtya, gīta, premabhakti-dāna nirantara

SYNONYMS

tāra madhye—out of those twenty-four years; *nīlācale*—while He was staying at Jagannātha Purī; *chaya vatsara*—continuously for six years; *nṛtya*—dancing; *gīta*—chanting; *prema-bhakti*—love of Kṛṣṇa; *dāna*—distribution; *nirantara*—always.

TRANSLATION

For six of these twenty-four years in Nīlācala [Jagannātha Purī], He distributed love of Godhead by always chanting and dancing.

TEXT 36

setubandha, āra gauḍa-vyāpi vṛndāvana

prema-nāma pracāriyā karilā bhramaṇa

SYNONYMS

setubandha—Cape Comorin; *āra*—and; *gauḍa*—Bengal; *vyāpi*—extending; *vṛndāvana*—to Vṛndāvana; *prema-nāma*—love of Kṛṣṇa and the holy name of Kṛṣṇa; *pracāriyā*—distributing; *karilā*—performed; *bhramaṇa*—touring.

TRANSLATION

Beginning from Cape Comorin and extending through Bengal to Vṛndāvana, during these six years He toured all of India, chanting, dancing and distributing love of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 37

ei ‘madhya-līlā’ nāma—līlā-mukhyadhāma

śeṣa aṣṭādaśa varṣa—‘antya-līlā’ nāma

SYNONYMS

ei—these; *madhya-līlā nāma*—named the middle pastimes; *līlā*—pastimes; *mukhya-dhāma*—principal place; *śeṣa*—last; *aṣṭādaśa*—eighteen; *varṣa*—years; *antya-līlā*—the final pastimes; *nāma*—named.

TRANSLATION

The activities of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in His travels after He accepted sannyāsa are His principal pastimes. His activities during His remaining eighteen years are called the antya-līlā, or the final portion of His pastimes.

TEXT 38

tāra madhye chaya vatsara bhakta-gaṇa-saṅge

prema-bhakti laoyāila nṛtya-gīta-raṅge

SYNONYMS

tāra madhye—out of that; *chaya vatsara*—six years; *bhakta-gaṇa-saṅge*—along with devotees; *prema-bhakti*—love of Kṛṣṇa; *laoyāila*—induced; *nṛtya*—dancing; *gīta*—chanting; *raṅge*—in transcendental bliss.

TRANSLATION

For six of the eighteen years He continuously stayed in Jagannātha Purī, He regularly performed kīrtana, inducing all the devotees to love Kṛṣṇa simply by chanting and dancing.

TEXT 39

dvādaśa vatsara śeṣa rahilā nīlācale

premāvasthā śikhāilā āsvādana-cchale

SYNONYMS

dvādaśa—twelve; *vatsara*—years; *śeṣa*—balance; *rahilā*—remained; *nīlācale*—at Jagannātha Purī; *prema-avasthā*—a state of ecstasy; *śikhāilā*—instructed everyone; *āsvādana-cchale*—under the plea of tasting it Himself.

TRANSLATION

For the remaining twelve years He stayed in Jagannātha Purī, He taught everyone how to taste the transcendental mellow ecstasy of love of Kṛṣṇa by tasting it Himself.

PURPORT

A person who is advanced in Kṛṣṇa consciousness always feels separation from Kṛṣṇa because such a feeling of separation excels the feeling of meeting Kṛṣṇa. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, in His last twelve years of existence within this world at Jagannātha Purī, taught the people of the world how, with a feeling of separation, one can develop His dormant love of Kṛṣṇa. Such feelings of separation or meeting with Kṛṣṇa are different stages of love of Godhead. These feelings develop in time when a person seriously engages in devotional service. The highest stage is

called *prema-bhakti*, but this stage is attained by executing *sādhana-bhakti*. One should not try to elevate himself artificially to the stage of *prema-bhakti* without seriously following the regulative principles of *sādhana-bhakti*. *Prema-bhakti* is the stage of relishing, whereas *sādhana-bhakti* is the stage of improving in devotional service. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu taught this cult of devotional service in full detail by practical application in His own life. It is said, therefore, *āpani ācari' bhakti śikhāimu sabāre*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Kṛṣṇa Himself, and in the role of a *kṛṣṇa-bhakta*, a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, He instructed the entire world how one can execute devotional service and thus go back home, back to Godhead, in due course of time.

TEXT 40

rātri-divase kṛṣṇa-viraha-sphuraṇa

unmādera ceṣṭā kare pralāpa-vacana

SYNONYMS

rātri-divase—day and night; *kṛṣṇa-viraha*—feelings of separation from Kṛṣṇa; *sphuraṇa*—awakening; *unmādera*—of a madman; *ceṣṭā*—activities; *kare*—performs; *pralāpa*—talking inconsistently; *vacana*—words.

TRANSLATION

Day and night Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu felt separation from Kṛṣṇa. Manifesting symptoms of this separation, He cried and talked very inconsistently, like a madman.

TEXT 41

śrī-rādhāra pralāpa yaiche uddhava-darśane

seimata unmāda-pralāpa kare rātri-dine

SYNONYMS

śrī-rādhāra—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *pralāpa*—talking; *yaiche*—as She did; *uddhava-darśane*—by meeting Uddhava; *sei-mata*—exactly like that; *unmāda*—madness; *pralāpa*—talking inconsistently; *kare*—does; *rātri-dine*—day and night.

TRANSLATION

As Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī talked inconsistently when She met Uddhava, so also Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu relished, both day and night, such ecstatic talk in the mood of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

PURPORT

In this connection one should refer to Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī's soliloquy after meeting Uddhava in Vṛndāvana. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu presented a similar picture of such ecstatic imaginary talking. Full of jealousy and madness symptomizing neglect by Kṛṣṇa, Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, criticizing a bumblebee, talked just like a madwoman. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, in the last days of His pastimes, exhibited all the symptoms of such ecstasy. In this connection one should refer to the Fourth Chapter of the *Ādi-līlā*, verses 107 and 108.

TEXT 42

vidyāpati, jayadeva, caṇḍīdāsera gīta

āsvādena rāmānanda-svarūpa-sahita

SYNONYMS

vidyāpati—the author of the name Vidyāpati; *jayadeva*—Jayadeva;

caṇḍīdāsera—Caṇḍīdāsa; *gīta*—their songs; *āsvādena*—tastes; *rāmānanda*—Rāmānanda; *svarūpa*—Svarūpa; *sahita*—along with.

TRANSLATION

The Lord used to read the books of Vidyāpati, Jayadeva and Caṇḍīdāsa, relishing their songs with His confidential associates like Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya and Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī.

PURPORT

Vidyāpati was a famous composer of songs about the pastimes of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa. He was an inhabitant of Mithilā, born in a *brāhmaṇa* family. It is calculated that he composed his songs during the reign of King Śivasimha and Queen Lachimādevī, in the beginning of the fourteenth century of the Śaka Era, almost one hundred years before the appearance of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The twelfth generation of Vidyāpati's descendants is still living. Vidyāpati's songs about the pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa express intense feelings of separation from Kṛṣṇa, and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu relished all those songs in His ecstasy of separation from Kṛṣṇa.

Jayadeva was born during the reign of Mahārāja Lakṣmaṇa Sena of Bengal, in the eleventh or twelfth century of the Śaka Era. His father was Bhojadeva, and his mother was Vāmādevī. For many years he lived in Navadvīpa, then the capital of Bengal. His birthplace was in the Birbhum district, in the village Kendubilva. In the opinion of some authorities, however, he was born in Orissa, and still others say that he was born in southern India. He passed the last days of his life in Jagannātha Purī. One of his famous books is *Gīta-govinda*, which is full of transcendental mellow feelings of separation from Kṛṣṇa. The *gopīs* felt separation from Kṛṣṇa before the *rāsa* dance, as mentioned in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and the *Gīta-govinda* expresses such feelings. There are many commentaries on the *Gīta-govinda* by many Vaiṣṇavas.

Caṇḍīdāsa was born in the village of Nānnura, which is also in the

Birbhum district of Bengal. He was born of a *brāhmaṇa* family, and it is said that he also took birth in the beginning of the fourteenth century, Śakābda Era. It has been suggested that Caṇḍīdāsa and Vidyāpati were great friends because the writings of both express the transcendental feelings of separation profusely. The feelings of ecstasy described by Caṇḍīdāsa and Vidyāpati were actually exhibited by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He relished all those feelings in the role of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, and His appropriate associates for this purpose were Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya and Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvāmī. These intimate associates of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu helped the Lord very much in the pastimes in which He felt like Rādhārāṇī.

Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura comments in this connection that such feelings of separation as Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu enjoyed from the books of Vidyāpati, Caṇḍīdāsa and Jayadeva are especially reserved for persons like Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya and Svarūpa Dāmodara, who were *paramahamsas*, men of the topmost perfection, because of their advanced spiritual consciousness. Such topics are not to be discussed by ordinary persons imitating the activities of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. For critical students of mundane poetry and literary men without God consciousness who are after bodily sense gratification, there is no need to read such a high standard of transcendental literature. Persons who are after sense gratification should not try to imitate *rāgānuga* devotional service. The songs of Caṇḍīdāsa, Vidyāpati and Jayadeva describe the transcendental activities of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Mundane reviewers of these songs simply help people in general become debauchees, and this leads only to social scandals and atheism in the world. One should not misunderstand the pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa to be the activities of a mundane young boy and girl. The mundane sexual activities of young boys and girls are most abominable. Therefore, those who are in bodily consciousness and who desire sense gratification are forbidden to indulge in discussions of the transcendental pastimes of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 43

kṛṣṇera viyoge yata prema-ceṣṭita

āsvādiyā pūrṇa kaila āpana vāñchita

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *viyoge*—in separation; *yata*—as many; *prema*—loving affairs; *ceṣṭita*—activities; *āsvādiyā*—tasting them; *pūrṇa*—fulfilled; *kaila*—made; *āpana*—own; *vāñchita*—desires.

TRANSLATION

In separation from Kṛṣṇa, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu relished all these ecstatic activities, and thus He fulfilled His own desires.

PURPORT

In the beginning of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* it is said that Lord Caitanya appeared in order to taste the feelings Rādhārāṇī felt upon seeing Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa Himself could not understand the ecstatic feelings of Rādhārāṇī toward Him, and therefore He desired to accept the role of Rādhārāṇī and thereby taste these feelings. Lord Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa with the feelings of Rādhārāṇī; in other words, He is a combination of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. It is therefore said, *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya rādhā-kṛṣṇa nahe anya*. By worshipping Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu alone, one can relish the loving affairs of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa together. One should therefore try to understand Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa not directly but through Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and through His devotees. Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura therefore says, *rūpa-raghunātha-pade haibe ākuti, kabe hāma bujhaba se yugala-pīriti*: “When shall I develop a mentality of service toward Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, Sanātana Gosvāmī, Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī and the other devotees of Lord Caitanya and thus become eligible to understand the pastimes of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa?”

TEXT 44

ananta caitanya-līlā kṣudra jīva hañā

ke varṇite pāre, tāhā vistāra kariyā

SYNONYMS

ananta—unlimited; *caitanya-līlā*—the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *kṣudra*—a small; *jīva*—living entity; *hañā*—being; *ke*—who; *varṇite*—describe; *pāre*—can; *tāhā*—that; *vistāra*—expanding; *kariyā*—doing so.

TRANSLATION

The pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu are unlimited. How much can a small living entity elaborate about those transcendental pastimes?

TEXT 45

sūtra kari' gaṇe yadi āpane ananta

sahasra-vadane teṇho nāhi pāya anta

SYNONYMS

sūtra—aphorisms; *kari'*—making; *gaṇe*—counts; *yadi*—if; *āpane*—personally; *ananta*—Śeṣa Nāga, the Personality of Godhead; *sahasra-vadane*—by thousands of mouths; *teṇho*—He also; *nāhi*—does not; *pāya*—get; *anta*—the limit.

TRANSLATION

If Śeṣa Nāga Ananta personally were to make the pastimes of Lord Caitanya into sūtras, even with His thousands of mouths there is no possibility that He could find their limit.

TEXT 46

dāmodara-svarūpa, āra gupta murāri

mukhya-mukhya-līlā sūtre likhiyāche vicāri'

SYNONYMS

dāmodara-svarūpa—Svarūpa Dāmodara; *āra*—and; *gupta murāri*—Murāri Gupta; *mukhya-mukhya*—most important; *līlā*—pastimes; *sūtre*—in notes; *likhiyāche*—have written; *vicāri'*—by mature deliberation.

TRANSLATION

Devotees like Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara and Murāri Gupta have recorded all the principal pastimes of Lord Caitanya in the form of notes, after deliberate consideration.

TEXT 47

sei, anusāre likhi līlā-sūtragaṇa

vistāri' varṇiyāchena tāhā dāsa-vṛndāvana

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *anusāre*—following; *likhi*—I write; *līlā*—pastimes; *sūtragaṇa*—notes; *vistāri'*—very explicitly; *varṇiyāchena*—has described; *tāhā*—that; *dāsa-vṛndāvana*—Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura.

TRANSLATION

The notes kept by Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara and Murāri Gupta are the basis of this book. Following those notes, I write of all the pastimes of the Lord. The notes have been described elaborately by Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura.

TEXT 48

caitanya-līlāra vyāsa, — — dāsa vṛndāvana

madhura kariyā līlā karilā racana

SYNONYMS

caitanya-līlāra—of the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *vyāsa*—the authorized writer Vyāsadeva; *dāsa vṛndāvana*—Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *madhura*—sweet; *kariyā*—making it; *līlā*—pastimes; *karilā*—did; *racana*—compilation.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, the authorized writer of the pastimes of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, is as good as Śrīla Vyāsadeva. He has described the pastimes in such a way as to make them sweeter and sweeter.

TEXT 49

grantha-vistāra-bhaye chāḍilā ye ye sthāna

sei sei sthāne kichu kariba vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

grantha—of the book; *vistāra*—of expansion; *bhaye*—being afraid; *chāḍilā*—gave up; *ye ye sthāna*—which different places; *sei sei sthāne*—in those places; *kichu*—something; *kariba*—I shall make; *vyākhyāna*—description.

TRANSLATION

Being afraid of his book's becoming too voluminous, he left some places

without vivid descriptions. I shall try to fill those places as far as possible.

TEXT 50

prabhura līlāmṛta teñho kaila āsvādana

tāñra bhukta-śeṣa kichu kariye carvaṇa

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *līlāmṛta*—the nectar of the pastimes; *teñho*—he (Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura); *kaila*—did; *āsvādana*—taste; *tāñra*—his; *bhukta*—of food; *śeṣa*—remnants; *kichu*—something; *kariye*—I do; *carvaṇa*—chew.

TRANSLATION

The transcendental pastimes of Lord Caitanya have actually been relished by Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura. I am simply trying to chew the remnants of food left by him.

TEXT 51

ādi-līlā-sūtra likhi, śuna, bhakta-gaṇa

saṅkṣepe likhiye samyak nā yāya likhana

SYNONYMS

ādi-līlā—the first part of His pastimes; *sūtra likhi*—I write a synopsis; *śuna*—hear; *bhakta-gaṇa*—all you devotees; *saṅkṣepe*—in brief; *likhiye*—I write; *samyak*—full; *nā*—not; *yāya*—possible; *likhana*—to write.

TRANSLATION

My dear devotees of Lord Caitanya, let me now write a synopsis of the ādi-līlā; I write of these pastimes in brief because it is not possible to describe them in full.

TEXT 52

kona vāñchā pūraṇa lāgi' vrajendra-kumāra

avatīrṇa haite mane karilā vicāra

SYNONYMS

kona—some; *vāñchā*—desire; *pūraṇa*—fulfillment; *lāgi'*—for the matter of; *vrajendra-kumāra*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatīrṇa haite*—to descend as an incarnation; *mane*—in the mind; *karilā*—did; *vicāra*—consideration.

TRANSLATION

To fulfill a particular desire within His mind, Lord Kṛṣṇa, Vrajendra-kumāra, decided to descend to this planet after mature contemplation.

TEXT 53

āge avatārilā ye ye guru-parivāra

saṅkṣepe kahiye, kahā nā yāya vistāra

SYNONYMS

āge—first of all; *avatārilā*—allowed to descend; *ye ye*—all those; *guru-parivāra*—family of spiritual masters; *saṅkṣepe*—in brief; *kahiye*—I describe; *kahā*—to describe; *nā*—not; *yāya*—possible; *vistāra*—expansively.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa therefore first allowed His family of superiors to descend to the earth. I shall try to describe them in brief because it is not possible to describe them fully.

TEXTS 54–55

śrī-śacī-jagannātha, śrī-mādhava-purī

keśava bhāratī, āra śrī-īśvara purī

advaita ācārya, āra paṇḍita śrīvāsa

ācāryaratna, vidyānidhi, ṭhākura haridāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-śacī-jagannātha—Śrīmatī Śacīdevī and Jagannātha Miśra; *śrī-mādhava purī*—Śrī Mādhavendra Purī; *keśava bhāratī*—Keśava Bhāratī; *āra*—and; *śrī-īśvara purī*—Śrī Īśvara Purī; *advaita ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *āra*—and; *paṇḍita śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita; *ācārya-ratna*—Ācāryaratna; *vidyānidhi*—Vidyānidhi; *ṭhākura haridāsa*—Ṭhākura Haridāsa.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, before appearing as Lord Caitanya, requested these devotees to precede Him: Śrī Śacīdevī, Jagannātha Miśra, Mādhavendra Purī, Keśava Bhāratī, Īśvara Purī, Advaita Ācārya, Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita, Ācāryaratna, Vidyānidhi and Ṭhākura Haridāsa.

TEXT 56

śrīhaṭṭa-nivāsī śrī-upendra-miśra-nāma

vaiṣṇava, paṇḍita, dhanī, sad-guṇa-pradhāna

SYNONYMS

śrī-haṭṭa-nivāsī—a resident of Śrīhaṭṭa; *śrī-upendra-miśra-nāma*—by the name of Upendra Miśra; *vaiṣṇava*—a devotee of Lord Viṣṇu; *paṇḍita*—learned; *dhanī*—rich; *sat-guṇa-pradhāna*—qualified with all good qualities.

TRANSLATION

There was also Śrī Upendra Miśra, a resident of the district of Śrīhaṭṭa. He was a great devotee of Lord Viṣṇu, a learned scholar, a rich man and a reservoir of all good qualities.

PURPORT

Upendra Miśra is described in the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (35) as the *gopāla* named Parjanya. The same personality who was formerly the grandfather of Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared as Upendra Miśra at Śrīhaṭṭa and begot seven sons. He was a resident of Dhākā-dakṣiṇa-grāma, in the district of Śrīhaṭṭa. There are still many residents of that part of the country who introduce themselves as belonging to the Miśra family of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXTS 57–58

sapta miśra tāṇra putra—*sapta ṛṣiśvara*

kāmsāri, paramānanda, padmanābha, sarveśvara

jagannātha, janārdana, trailokyanātha

nadīyāte gaṅgā-vāsa kaila jagannātha

SYNONYMS

sapta miśra—seven Miśras; *tāñra*—his; *putra*—sons; *sapta*—seven; *ṛṣi*—great saintly persons; *īśvara*—most influential; *kañsāri*—Kaṁsāri; *paramānanda*—Paramānanda; *padmanābha*—Padmanābha; *sarveśvara*—Sarveśvara; *jagannātha*—Jagannātha; *janārdana*—Janārdana; *trailokyanātha*—Trailokyanātha; *nadīyāte*—at Navadvīpa; *gaṅgā-vāsa*—living on the bank of the Ganges; *kaila*—did; *jagannātha*—the fifth son of Upendra Miśra.

TRANSLATION

Upendra Miśra had seven sons, who were all saintly and most influential: (1) Kaṁsāri, (2) Paramānanda, (3) Padmanābha, (4) Sarveśvara, (5) Jagannātha, (6) Janārdana and (7) Trailokyanātha. Jagannātha Miśra, the fifth son, decided to reside on the bank of the Ganges at Nadia.

TEXT 59

jagannātha miśravara—*padavī* ‘*purandara*’

nanda-vasudeva-rūpa sadguṇa-sāgara

SYNONYMS

jagannātha miśra-vara—Jagannātha Miśra, who was the chief among the seven; *padavī*—designation; *purandara*—another name of Vasudeva; *nanda*—Nanda, the father of Kṛṣṇa; *vasudeva*—the father of Kṛṣṇa; *rūpa*—like; *sat-guṇa*—good qualities; *sāgara*—ocean.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra was designated as Purandara. Exactly like Nanda Mahārāja and Vasudeva, he was an ocean of all good qualities.

TEXT 60

tāñra patnī ‘śacī’-nāma, pativratā satī

yāñra pitā ‘nīlāmbara’ nāma cakravartī

SYNONYMS

tāñra patnī—his wife; *śacī*—Śacī; *nāma*—named; *pati-vratā*—devoted to her husband; *satī*—chaste; *yāñra*—whose; *pitā*—father; *nīlāmbara*—Nīlāmbara; *nāma*—named; *cakravartī*—with the title Cakravartī.

TRANSLATION

His wife, Śrīmatī Śacīdevī, was a chaste woman highly devoted to her husband. Śacīdevī’s father’s name was Nīlāmbara, and his surname was Cakravartī.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (104) it is mentioned that Nīlāmbara Cakravartī was formerly Garga Muni. Some of the family descendants of Nīlāmbara Cakravartī still live in the village of the name Magḍobā, in the district of Faridpur, in Bangladesh. His nephew was Jagannātha Cakravartī, also known as Māmu Ṭhākura, who became a disciple of Paṇḍita Gosvāmī and stayed at Jagannātha Purī as the priest of Ṭoṭā-gopīnātha. Nīlāmbara Cakravartī lived at Navadvīpa, in the neighborhood of Belapukuriyā. This fact is mentioned in the book *Prema-vilāsa*. Because he lived near the house of the Kazi, the Kazi was also considered one of the maternal uncles of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The Kazi used to address Nīlāmbara Cakravartī as *kākā*, or ‘uncle.’ One cannot separate the residence of the Kazi from Vāmanapukura because the tomb of the Kazi is still existing there. Formerly the place was known as Belapukuriyā, and now it is called Vāmanapukura. This has been ascertained by archeological evidence.”

TEXT 61

rāḍhadeśe janmilā ṭhākura nityānanda

gaṅgādāsa paṇḍita, gupta murāri, mukunda

SYNONYMS

rāḍha-deśe—the place where there is no Ganges; *janmilā*—took birth; *ṭhākura nityānanda*—Nityānanda Prabhu; *gaṅgādāsa paṇḍita*—Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita; *gupta murāri*—Murāri Gupta; *mukunda*—Mukunda.

TRANSLATION

In Rāḍhadeśa, the part of Bengal where the Ganges is not visible, Nityānanda Prabhu, Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, Murāri Gupta and Mukunda took birth.

PURPORT

Here *rāḍha-deśe* refers to the village of the name Ekacakrā, in the district of Birbhum, next to Burdwan. After the Burdwan railway station there is another branch line, which is called the Loop Line of the eastern railway, and there is a railway station of the name Mallārapura. Eight miles east of this railway station, Ekacakrā village is still situated. Ekacakrā village extends north and south for an area of about eight miles. Other villages, namely Vīracandra-pura and Vīrabhadra-pura, are situated within the area of the village of Ekacakrā. In honor of the holy name of Vīrabhadra Gosvāmī, these places are renowned as Vīracandra-pura and Vīrabhadra-pura.

In the Bengali year 1331 (A.D. 1924) a thunderbolt struck the temple of Ekacakrā-grāma. Therefore the temple is now in a broken state. Before this, there were no such accidents in that quarter. Within the temple there is a Deity of Śrī Kṛṣṇa established by Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. The

name of the Deity is Baṅkima Rāya or Bāṅkā Rāya.

On Baṅkima Rāya's right side is a deity of Jāhnavā, and on His left side is Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. The priests of the temple describe that Lord Nityānanda Prabhu entered within the body of Baṅkima Rāya and that the deity of Jāhnavā-mātā was therefore later placed on the right side of Baṅkima Rāya. Afterwards, many other Deities were installed within the temple. On another throne within the temple are Deities of Muralīdhara and Rādhā-Mādhava. On another throne are Deities of Manomohana, Vṛndāvana-candra and Gaura-Nitāi. But Baṅkima Rāya is the Deity originally installed by Nityānanda Prabhu.

On the eastern side of the temple is a *ghāṭa* known as Kadamba-khaṇḍī on the bank of a river called the Yamunā, and it is said that the Deity of Baṅkima Rāya was floating in the water and Lord Nityānanda Prabhu picked Him up and then installed Him in the temple. Thereafter, in a place known as Bhaḍḍāpura, in the village of Vīracandra-pura, about half a mile west, in a place underneath a *nīma* tree, Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī was found. For this reason, the Rādhārāṇī of Baṅkima Rāya was known as Bhaḍḍāpurera Ṭhākurāṇī, the mistress of Bhaḍḍāpura. On another throne, on the right side of Baṅkima Rāya, is a Deity of Yogamāyā.

Now the temple and temple corridor rest on a high plinth, and on a concrete structure in front of the temple is a *kīrtana* hall. It is also said that on the northern side of the temple there was a Deity of Lord Śiva named Bhāṇḍīśvara and that the father of Nityānanda Prabhu, Hāḍāi Paṇḍita, used to worship that Deity. At present, however, the Bhāṇḍīśvara Deity is missing, and in his place a Jagannātha Svāmī Deity has been installed. Lord Nityānanda Prabhu did not factually construct any temples. The temple was constructed at the time of Vīrabhadra Prabhu. In the Bengali year 1298 (A.D. 1891), a *brahmacārī* of the name Śivānanda Svāmī repaired the temple, for it had become dilapidated.

In this temple there is an arrangement to offer food to the Deity on the basis of seventeen seers (about thirty-four pounds) of rice and necessary

vegetables. The present priestly order of the temple belongs to the family of Gopijana-vallabhānanda, one of the branches of Nityānanda Prabhu. There is a land settlement in the name of the temple, and income from this land finances the expenditures for the temple. There are three parties of priestly *gosvāmīs* who take charge of the temple management, one after another. A few steps from the temple is a place known as Viśrāmatalā, where it is said that Nityānanda Prabhu in His childhood used to enjoy sporting with His boyfriends by enacting the *rāsa-līlā* and various other pastimes of Vṛndāvana.

Near the temple is a place named Āmalītalā (Imlitala), which is so named because of a big tamarind tree there. According to a party named the Neḍādi-sampradāya, Vīrabhadra Prabhu, with the assistance of twelve hundred Neḍās (Buddhist monks), dug a great lake of the name Śvetagaṅgā. Outside of the temple are tombs of the Gosvāmīs, and there is a small river known as the Maudeśvara, which is called the water of Yamunā. Within half a mile from this small river is the birthplace of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. It appears that there was a big *kīrtana* hall in front of the temple, but later it became dilapidated. It is now covered by banyan trees. Later on, a temple was constructed within which Gaura-Nityānanda Deities are existing. The temple was constructed by the late Prasannakumāra Kārapharmā. A tablet was installed in his memory in the Bengali year 1323 (A.D. 1916), in the month of Vaiśākha (April–May).

The place where Nityānanda Prabhu appeared is called Garbhavāsa. There is an allotment of about forty-three *bighās* (fourteen acres) of land to continue the worship in a temple there. The Mahārāja of Dinājapura donated twenty *bighās* of land (about six and a half acres) in this connection. It is said that near the place known as Garbhavāsa, Hāḍāi Paṇḍita conducted a primary school. The priests of this place, listed in a genealogical table, were as follows: (1) Śrī Rāghavacandra, (2) Jagadānanda dāsa, (3) Kṛṣṇadāsa, (4) Nityānanda dāsa, (5) Rāmadāsa, (6) Vrajamohana dāsa, (7) Kānāi dāsa, (8) Gauradāsa, (9) Śivānanda dāsa and (10) Haridāsa. Kṛṣṇadāsa belonged to the Cīḍiyā-kuñja at Vṛndāvana. The date of his disappearance is Kṛṣṇa-janmāṣṭamī. Cīḍiyā-kuñja is a

place now managed by the *gosvāmīs* of Śṛṅgāra-ghāṭa in Vṛndāvana. They are also known as belonging to the Nityānanda family, most probably on the basis of their relationship with Kṛṣṇadāsa.

Near Garbhavāsa is a place called Bakulatalā, where Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu and His boyfriends used to take part in sporting activities known as *jhāla-jhapeṭā*. There is a *bakula* tree there that is wonderful because all its branches and subbranches look like the hoods of serpents. It has been suggested that by the desire of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, Anantadeva manifested Himself in that way. The tree is very old. It is said that formerly it had two trunks, but later on, when the playmates of Nityānanda Prabhu felt inconvenience in jumping from the branches of one trunk to those of the other, Nityānanda Prabhu, by His mercy, merged the two trunks into one.

Another place nearby is named Hāṇṭugāḍā. It is said that Lord Nityānanda Prabhu brought all the holy places there. Therefore the people in the surrounding villages go there instead of to the Ganges to take bath. It is named Hāṇṭugāḍā because Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu used to perform the *dadhi-ciḍā* festival of distributing chipped rice with yogurt *prasādam* there and He took the *prasādam* kneeling down. A sanctified lake in this place is always full of water throughout the year. A great fair is held there during Goṣṭhāṣṭamī, and there is another big fair on the birthday of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. In the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (58–63) it is described that Halāyudha, Baladeva, Viśvarūpa and Saṅkarṣaṇa appeared as Nityānanda Avadhūta.

TEXT 62

asaṅkha bhaktera karāilā avatāra

śeṣe avatīrṇa hailā vrajendra-kumāra

SYNONYMS

asaṅkhyā—unlimited; *bhaktera*—of devotees; *karāilā*—made into being; *avatāra*—incarnation; *śeṣe*—at last; *avatīrṇa*—descended; *hailā*—became; *vrajendra-kumāra*—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the son of Nanda Mahārāja.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa, Vrajendra-kumāra, first caused countless devotees to appear, and at last He appeared Himself.

TEXT 63

prabhura āvirbhāva-pūrve yata vaiṣṇava-gaṇa

advaita-ācāryera sthāne kareṇa gamana

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *āvirbhāva*—appearance; *pūrve*—before; *yata*—all; *vaiṣṇava-gaṇa*—devotees; *advaita-ācāryera*—of Advaita Ācārya; *sthāne*—place; *kareṇa*—do; *gamana*—go.

TRANSLATION

Before the appearance of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, all the devotees of Navadvīpa used to gather in the house of Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 64

gītā-bhāgavata kahe ācārya-gosāñi

jñāna-karma nindī' kare bhaktira baḍāi

SYNONYMS

gītā—the *Bhagavad-gītā*; *bhāgavata*—*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *kahe*—

recites; *ācārya-gosāñī*—Advaita Ācārya; *jñāna*—the path of philosophical speculation; *karma*—fruitive activity; *nindī'*—decrying; *kare*—establishes; *bhaktira*—of devotional service; *baḍāi*—excellence.

TRANSLATION

In these meetings of the Vaiṣṇavas, Advaita Ācārya used to recite the Bhagavad-gītā and Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, decrying the paths of philosophical speculation and fruitive activity and establishing the superexcellence of devotional service.

TEXT 65

sarva-śāstre kahe kṛṣṇa-bhaktira vyākhyāna

jñāna, yoga, tapo-dharma nāhi māne āna

SYNONYMS

sarva-śāstre—in all revealed scriptures; *kahe*—says; *kṛṣṇa-bhaktira*—of devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vyākhyāna*—explanation; *jñāna*—philosophical speculation; *yoga*—mystic *haṭha-yoga*; *tapas*—austerities; *dharma*—religious procedures; *nāhi*—does not; *māne*—accept; *āna*—other.

TRANSLATION

In all the revealed scriptures of Vedic culture, devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa is explained throughout. Therefore devotees of Lord Kṛṣṇa do not recognize the processes of philosophical speculation, mystic yoga, unnecessary austerity and so-called religious rituals. They do not accept any process but devotional service.

PURPORT

Our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement follows this principle. We do not recognize any method for spiritual realization other than Kṛṣṇa consciousness, devotional service. Sometimes we are criticized by groups following *jñāna*, *yoga*, *tapas* or *dharma*, but fortunately we are unable to make any compromises with them. We simply stand on the platform of devotional service and preach the same principles all over the world.

TEXT 66

tāñra sañge ānanda kare vaiṣṇavera gaṇa

kṛṣṇa-kathā, kṛṣṇa-pūjā, nāma-saṅkīrtana

SYNONYMS

tāñra sañge—with Him (Advaita Ācārya); *ānanda*—pleasure; *kare*—takes; *vaiṣṇavera*—of the devotees; *gaṇa*—assembly; *kṛṣṇa-kathā*—topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kṛṣṇa-pūjā*—worship of Kṛṣṇa; *nāma-saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

TRANSLATION

In the house of Advaita Ācārya, all the Vaiṣṇavas took pleasure in always talking of Kṛṣṇa, always worshiping Kṛṣṇa and always chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

PURPORT

On these principles only does the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement go on. We have no business other than to talk of Kṛṣṇa, worship Kṛṣṇa and chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

TEXT 67

kintu sarva-loka dekhi' kṛṣṇa-bahirmukha

viṣaye nimagna loka dekhi' pāya duḥkha

SYNONYMS

kintu—but; *sarva-loka*—all people; *dekhi'*—seeing; *kṛṣṇa-bahirmukha*—without Kṛṣṇa consciousness; *viṣaye*—material enjoyment; *nimagna*—merged; *loka*—all people; *dekhi'*—seeing; *pāya duḥkha*—felt pained.

TRANSLATION

But Śrī Advaita Ācārya Prabhu felt pained to see all the people without Kṛṣṇa consciousness simply merging in material sense enjoyment.

PURPORT

A bona fide devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa is always pained to see the fallen condition of the whole world. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura used to say, “There is no scarcity of anything within this world. The only scarcity is of Kṛṣṇa consciousness.” That is the vision of all pure devotees. Because of this lack of Kṛṣṇa consciousness in human society, people are suffering terribly, being merged in an ocean of nescience and sense gratification. A devotee onlooker is very much aggrieved to see such a situation in the world.

TEXT 68

lokerā nistāra-hetu kareṇa cintana

kemate e saba lokera ha-ibe tārāṇa

SYNONYMS

lokerā—of all people; *nistāra-hetu*—for the matter of deliverance; *kareṇa*—does; *cintana*—contemplation; *kemate*—how; *e*—these; *saba*—

all; *lokerā*—of people in general; *ha-ibe*—will become; *tāraṇa*—liberation.

TRANSLATION

Seeing the condition of the world, He began to think seriously of how all these people could be delivered from the clutches of *māyā*.

TEXT 69

kṛṣṇa avatari'arena bhaktira vistāra

tabe ta' sakala lokerā ha-ibe nistāra

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatari'*—descending; *arena*—does; *bhaktira*—of devotional service; *vistāra*—expansion; *tabe*—then; *ta'*—certainly; *sakala*—all; *lokerā*—of the people; *ha-ibe*—there will be; *nistāra*—liberation.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Advaita Ācārya Prabhu thought, “If Kṛṣṇa Himself appears in order to distribute the cult of devotional service, then only will liberation be possible for all people.”

PURPORT

Just as a condemned person can be relieved by a special favor of the chief executive head, the president or king, so the condemned people of this Kali-yuga can be delivered only by the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself or a person especially empowered for this purpose. Śrīla Advaita Ācārya Prabhu desired that the Supreme Personality of Godhead advent Himself to deliver the fallen souls of this age.

TEXT 70

kṛṣṇa avatārite ācārya pratijñā kariyā

kṛṣṇa-pūjā kare tulasī-gaṅgājala diyā

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatārite*—to cause His advent; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *pratijñā*—promise; *kariyā*—making; *kṛṣṇa-pūjā*—worship of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kare*—does; *tulasī*—*tulasī* leaves; *gaṅgā-jala diyā*—with the water of the Ganges .

TRANSLATION

With this consideration, Advaita Ācārya Prabhu, promising to cause Lord Kṛṣṇa to descend, began to worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, with *tulasī* leaves and water of the Ganges.

PURPORT

Tulasī leaves and Ganges water, with, if possible, a little pulp of sandalwood, is sufficient paraphernalia to worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Lord says in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.26):

*patraṁ puṣpaṁ phalaṁ toyam yo me bhaktyā prayacchati
tad ahaṁ bhakty-upahṛtam aśnāmi prayatātmanaḥ*

“If one offers Me with love and devotion a leaf, a flower, a fruit or water, I will accept it.” Following this principle, Advaita Prabhu pleased the Supreme personality of Godhead with *tulasī* leaves and water of the Ganges.

TEXT 71

kṛṣṇera āhvāna kare saghana huṅkāra

huṅkāre ākṛṣṭa hailā vrajendra-kumāra

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *āhvāna*—invitation; *kare*—does; *saghana*—with great gravity; *huṅkāra*—vibration; *huṅkāre*—and by such loud cries; *ākṛṣṭa*—attracted; *hailā*—became; *vrajendra-kumāra*—the son of Vrajendra, Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

By loud cries He invited Kṛṣṇa to appear, and this repeated invitation attracted Lord Kṛṣṇa to descend.

TEXT 72

jagannāthamīśra-patnī śacīra udare

aṣṭa kanyā krame haila, janmi' janmi' mare

SYNONYMS

jagannātha-mīśra—Jagannātha Mīśra; *patnī*—his wife; *śacīra*—of Śacīmātā; *udare*—within the womb; *aṣṭa*—eight; *kanyā*—daughters; *krame*—one after another; *haila*—appeared; *janmi'*—after taking birth; *janmi'*—after taking birth; *mare*—all died.

TRANSLATION

Before the birth of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, eight daughters took birth one after another from the womb of Śacīmātā, the wife of Jagannātha Mīśra. But just after their birth, they all died.

TEXT 73

apatya-virahe miśrera duḥkhī haila mana

putra lāgi' ārādhila viṣṇura caraṇa

SYNONYMS

apatya—of children; *virahe*—in separation; *miśrera*—of Jagannātha Miśra; *duḥkhī*—unhappy; *haila*—became; *mana*—mind; *putra*—son; *lāgi'*—for the matter of; *ārādhila*—worshiped; *viṣṇura*—of Lord Viṣṇu; *caraṇa*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra was very unhappy at the death of his children one after another. Therefore, desiring a son, he worshiped the lotus feet of Lord Viṣṇu.

TEXT 74

tabe putra janamilā 'viśvarūpa' nāma

mahā-guṇavān tenha—'baladeva'-dhāma

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *putra*—son; *janamilā*—took birth; *viśvarūpa*—Viśvarūpa; *nāma*—named; *mahā-guṇavān*—highly qualified; *tenha*—He; *baladeva*—of Lord Baladeva; *dhāma*—incarnation.

TRANSLATION

After this, Jagannātha Miśra got a son of the name Viśvarūpa, who was most powerful and highly qualified because He was an incarnation of

Baladeva.

PURPORT

Viśvarūpa was the elder brother of Gaurahari, Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. When arrangements were being made for the marriage of Viśvarūpa, He took *sannyāsa* and left home. He took the *sannyāsa* name of Śaṅkarāraṇya. In 1431 Śakābda Era (A.D. 1509), He disappeared in Pāṇḍarapura, in the district of Sholapur. As an incarnation of Saṅkarṣaṇa, He is both the ingredient and immediate cause of the creation of this material world. He is nondifferent from Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, for the *aṁśa* and the *aṁśī*, or the part and the whole, are not different. As an incarnation of Saṅkarṣaṇa, Viśvarūpa belongs to the quadruple manifestation of *catur-vyūha*. In the *Gaura-candrodaya* it is said that Viśvarūpa, after His so-called demise, remained mixed within Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu.

TEXT 75

baladeva-prakāśa—parama-vyome ‘saṅkarṣaṇa’

tenha—viśvera upādāna-nimitta-kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

baladeva-prakāśa—manifestation of Baladeva; *parama-vyome*—in the spiritual sky; *saṅkarṣaṇa*—Saṅkarṣaṇa; *tenha*—He; *viśvera*—the cosmic manifestation; *upādāna*—ingredient; *nimitta-kāraṇa*—immediate cause.

TRANSLATION

The expansion of Baladeva known as Saṅkarṣaṇa in the spiritual world is the ingredient and immediate cause of this material cosmic manifestation.

TEXT 76

tāñhā ba-i viśve kichu nāhi dekhi āra

ataeva 'viśvarūpa' nāma ye tāñhāra

SYNONYMS

tāñhā ba-i—except Him; *viśve*—within this cosmic manifestation; *kichu*—something; *nāhi*—there is none; *dekhi*—I see; *āra*—further; *ataeva*—therefore; *viśvarūpa*—universal form; *nāma*—name; *ye*—that; *tāñhāra*—His.

TRANSLATION

The gigantic universal form is called the Viśvarūpa incarnation of Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa. Thus we do not find anything within this cosmic manifestation except the Lord Himself.

TEXT 77

naitac citraṁ bhagavati

hy anante jagad-īśvare

otaṁ protaṁ idaṁ yasmin

tantuṣv aṅga yathā paṭaḥ

SYNONYMS

na—not; *etat*—this; *citraṁ*—wonderful; *bhagavati*—in the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *hi*—certainly; *anante*—in the unlimited; *jagad-īśvare*—the master of the universe; *otaṁ*—lengthwise; *protam*—breadthwise; *idaṁ*—this universe; *yasmin*—in whom; *tantuṣu*—in the threads; *aṅga*—O King; *yathā*—as much as; *paṭaḥ*—a cloth.

TRANSLATION

“As the threads in a cloth spread both lengthwise and breadthwise, so the Supreme Personality of Godhead exists directly and indirectly within everything we see in this cosmic manifestation. This is not very wonderful for Him.”

PURPORT

This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.15.35).

TEXT 78

ataeva prabhu tāñre bale, ‘baḍa bhāi’

kṛṣṇa, balarāma dui—caitanya, nitāi

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya; *tāñre*—unto Viśvarūpa; *bale*—says; *baḍa bhāi*—elder brother; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *balarāma*—and Baladeva; *dui*—two; *caitanya*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nitāi*—and Lord Nityānanda Prabhu.

TRANSLATION

Because Mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa is the ingredient and efficient cause of the cosmic manifestation, He is present in every detail of it. Lord Caitanya therefore called Him His elder brother. The two brothers are known as Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma in the spiritual world, but at the present moment they are Caitanya and Nitāi. Therefore the conclusion is that Nityānanda Prabhu is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa, Baladeva.

TEXT 79

putra pāñā dampati hailā ānandita mana

viśeṣe sevana kare govinda-caraṇa

SYNONYMS

putra—son; *pāñā*—having gotten; *dampati*—husband and wife; *hailā*—became; *ānandita*—pleased; *mana*—mind; *viśeṣe*—specifically; *sevana*—service; *kare*—render; *govinda-caraṇa*—the lotus feet of Lord Govinda.

TRANSLATION

The husband and wife [Jagannātha Miśra and Śacīmātā], having gotten Viśvarūpa as their son, were very pleased within their minds. Because of their pleasure, they specifically began to serve the lotus feet of Govinda.

PURPORT

There is a common saying in India that everyone goes to worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead when he is in distress, but when a person is in an opulent position, he forgets God. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.16) this is confirmed:

catur-vidhā bhajante mām janāḥ sukṛtino 'rjuna
ārto jijñāsura arthārthī jñānī ca bharataṣabha

“If backed by pious activities in the past, four kinds of men—namely those who are distressed, those in need of money, those searching after knowledge and those who are inquisitive—become interested in devotional service.” The husband and wife, Jagannātha Miśra and Śacīmātā, were very unhappy because their eight daughters had passed away. Now, when they got Viśvarūpa as their son, certainly they became extremely happy. They knew that it was by the grace of the Lord that they were endowed with such happiness and opulence. Therefore instead of forgetting the Lord, they became more and more adherent in rendering

service to the lotus feet of Govinda. When a common man becomes opulent, he forgets God; but the more opulent a devotee becomes by the grace of the Lord, the more he becomes attached to the service of the Lord.

TEXT 80

caudda-śata chaya śake śeṣa māgha māse

jagannātha-śacīra dehe kṛṣṇera praveśe

SYNONYMS

caudda-śata—1400; *chaya*—6; *śake*—in the year of the Śaka Era; *śeṣa*—last; *māgha*—Māgha; *māse*—in the month; *jagannātha*—of Jagannātha Miśra; *śacīra*—and of Śacīdevī; *dehe*—in the bodies; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *praveśe*—by the entrance.

TRANSLATION

In the month of January in the year 1406 of the Śaka Era (A.D. 1485), Lord Kṛṣṇa entered the bodies of both Jagannātha Miśra and Śacī.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu took His birth in the year 1407 Śaka Era (A.D. 1486), in the month of Phālguna. But here we see that He entered the bodies of His parents in the year 1406, in the month of Māgha. Therefore, the Lord entered the bodies of His parents thirteen full months before His birth. Generally a common child remains within the womb of his mother for ten lunar months, but here we see that the Lord remained within the body of His mother for thirteen months.

TEXT 81

miśra kahe śacī-sthāne,——dekhi āna rīta

jyotirmaya deha, geha lakṣmī-adhiṣṭhita

SYNONYMS

miśra kahe—Jagannātha Miśra began to speak; *śacī-sthāne*—in the presence of Śacīdevī-mātā; *dekhi*—I see; *āna*—extraordinary; *rīta*—behavior; *jyotir-maya*—effulgent; *deha*—body; *geha*—home; *lakṣmī*—the goddess of fortune; *adhiṣṭhita*—situated.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra said to Śacīmātā, “I see wonderful things! Your body is effulgent, and it appears as if the goddess of fortune were now staying personally in my home.

TEXT 82

yāhān tāhān sarva-loka karaye sammāna

ghare pāṭhāiyā deya dhana, vastra, dhāna

SYNONYMS

yāhān—wherever; *tāhān*—anywhere; *sarva-loka*—all people; *karaye*—show; *sammāna*—respect; *ghare*—at home; *pāṭhāiyā*—sending; *deya*—give; *dhana*—riches; *vastra*—cloth; *dhāna*—paddy.

TRANSLATION

“Anywhere and everywhere I go, all people offer me respect. Even without my asking, they voluntarily give me riches, clothing and paddy.”

PURPORT

A *brāhmaṇa* does not become anyone's servant. To render service to someone else is the business of the *sūdras*. A *brāhmaṇa* is always independent because he is a teacher, spiritual master and advisor to society. The members of society provide him with all the necessities of life. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* the Lord says He has divided society into four divisions—*brāhmaṇa*, *kṣatriya*, *vaiśya* and *sūdra*. A society cannot run smoothly without this scientific division. A *brāhmaṇa* should give good advice to all the members of society, a *kṣatriya* should look after the administration, maintaining law and order in society, *vaiśyas* should produce and trade to meet all the needs of society, whereas *sūdras* should render service to the higher sections of society (the *brāhmaṇas*, *kṣatriyas* and *vaiśyas*).

Jagannātha Miśra was a *brāhmaṇa*; therefore people would send him all bodily necessities—money, cloth, grain and so on. While Lord Caitanya was in the womb of Śacīmātā, Jagannātha Miśra received all these necessities of life without asking for them. Because of the presence of the Lord in his family, everyone offered him due respect as a *brāhmaṇa*. In other words, if a *brāhmaṇa* or Vaiṣṇava sticks to his position as an eternal servant of the Lord and executes the will of the Lord, there is no question of scarcity for his personal maintenance or the needs of his family.

TEXT 83

śacī kahe, — — muñi dekhoṅ ākāśa-upare

divya-mūrti loka saba yena stuti kare

SYNONYMS

śacī kahe—mother Śacīdevī replied; *muñi*—I; *dekhoṅ*—see; *ākāśa-upare*—in outer space; *divya-mūrti*—brilliant forms; *loka*—people; *saba*—all; *yena*—as if; *stuti*—prayers; *kare*—offering.

TRANSLATION

Śacīmātā told her husband, “I see wonderfully brilliant human beings appearing in outer space, as if offering prayers.”

PURPORT

Jagannātha Miśra was honored by everyone on the earth and was supplied with all necessities. Similarly, mother Śacī saw many demigods in outer space offering prayers to her because of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s presence in her womb.

TEXT 84

jagannātha miśra kahe,——svapna ye dekhila

jyotirmaya-dhāma mora hṛdaye paśila

SYNONYMS

jagannātha miśra kahe—Jagannātha Miśra replied; *svapna*—dream; *ye*—that; *dekhila*—I have seen; *jyotir-maya*—with a brilliant effulgence; *dhāma*—abode; *mora*—my; *hṛdaye*—in the heart; *paśila*—entered.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra then replied, “In a dream I saw the effulgent abode of the Lord enter my heart.

TEXT 85

āmāra hṛdaya haite gelā tomāra hṛdaye

hena bujhi, janmibena kona mahāśaye

SYNONYMS

āmāra hṛdaya haite—from my heart; *gelā*—transferred; *tomāra hṛdaye*—into your heart; *hena*—like this; *bujhi*—I understand; *janmibena*—will take birth; *kona*—some; *mahāśaye*—very great personality.

TRANSLATION

“From my heart it entered your heart. I therefore understand that a great personality will soon take birth.”

TEXT 86

eta bali’ duñhe rahe haraṣita hañā

śālagrāma sevā kare viśeṣa kariyā

SYNONYMS

eta bali’—after this conversation; *duñhe*—both of them; *rahe*—remained; *haraṣita*—jubilant; *hañā*—becoming; *śālagrāma*—*śālagrāma-nārāyaṇa-śilā*; *sevā*—service; *kare*—rendered; *viśeṣa*—with special attention; *kariyā*—giving it.

TRANSLATION

After this conversation, both husband and wife were very jubilant, and together they rendered service to the household *śālagrāma-śilā*.

PURPORT

Especially in every *brāhmaṇa*’s house there must be a *śālagrāma-śilā* to be worshiped by the *brāhmaṇa* family. This system is still current. People who are *brāhmaṇas* by caste, who are born in a *brāhmaṇa* family, must worship the *śālagrāma-śilā*. Unfortunately, with the progress of Kali-yuga, the so-called *brāhmaṇas*, although very proud of taking birth in *brāhmaṇa* families, no longer worship the *śālagrāma-śilā*. But actually it

has been a custom since time immemorial that a person born in a *brāhmaṇa* family must worship the *śālagrāma-śīlā* in all circumstances. In our Kṛṣṇa consciousness society, some of the members are very anxious to introduce worship of the *śālagrāma-śīlā*, but we have purposely refrained from introducing it because most of the members of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement do not originally come from families of the *brāhmaṇa* caste. After some time, when we find that they are actually situated strictly in the line of brahminical behavior, *śālagrāma-śīlā* worship will be introduced.

In this age, the worship of the *śālagrāma-śīlā* is not as important as the chanting of the holy name of the Lord. That is the injunction of the *śāstra*: *harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam/ kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva nāsty eva gatiḥ anyathā* [Adi 17.21]. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī's opinion is that by chanting the holy name offenselessly one becomes completely perfect. Nevertheless, just to purify the situation of the mind, worship of the Deity in the temple is also necessary. Therefore when one is advanced in spiritual consciousness or is perfectly situated on a spiritual platform, he may take to the worship of the *śālagrāma-śīlā*.

The transference of the Lord from the heart of Jagannātha Miśra to the heart of Śacīmātā is explained by Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura as follows: "It is to be concluded that Jagannātha Miśra and Śacīmātā are *nitya-siddhas*, ever-pure associates of the Lord. Their hearts are always uncontaminated, and therefore they never forget the Supreme Personality of Godhead. A common man in this material world has a contaminated heart. He must therefore first purify his heart to come to the transcendental position. But Jagannātha Miśra and Śacīmātā were not a common man and woman with contaminated hearts. When the heart is uncontaminated, it is said to be in the existential position of Vasudeva. Vasudeva can beget Vāsudeva, or Kṛṣṇa, who is transcendently situated."

It is to be understood that Śacīdevī did not become pregnant as an ordinary woman becomes pregnant because of sense indulgence. One

should not think the pregnancy of Śacīmātā to be that of an ordinary woman, because that is an offense. One can understand the pregnancy of Śacīmātā when one is actually advanced in spiritual consciousness and fully engaged in the devotional service of the Lord.

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.2.16) it is stated:

*bhagavān api viśvātmā bhaktānām abhayaṁ-karaḥ
āviveśāṁśa-bhāgena mana ānakadundubheḥ*

This is a statement regarding the birth of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The incarnation of the Lord entered the mind of Vasudeva and was then transferred to the mind of Devakī. Śrīla Śrīdhara Svāmī gives the following annotation in this connection: ‘*mana āviveśa’ manasy āvirbabhūva; jīvānām iva na dhātu-sambandha ity arthaḥ*. There was no question of the seminal discharge necessary for the birth of an ordinary human being. Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī also comments in this connection that Lord Kṛṣṇa first appeared in the mind of Ānakadundubhi, Vasudeva, and was then transferred to the mind of Devakī-devī. Thus the spiritual bliss in the mind of Devakī-devī gradually increased, just as the moon increases every night until it becomes a full moon. At the time of His appearance, Lord Kṛṣṇa came out of the mind of Devakī and appeared within the prison house of Kāṁsa, by the side of Devakī’s bed. At that time, by the spell of *yogamāyā*, Devakī thought that her child had now been born. In this connection, even the demigods from the celestial kingdom were also bewildered. As it is stated, *muhyanti yat sūrayaḥ* (*Bhāg.* 1.1.1). They came to offer their prayers to Devakī, thinking that the Supreme Lord was within her womb. The demigods came to Mathurā from their celestial kingdom. This indicates that Mathurā is still more important than the celestial kingdom of the upper planetary system.

Lord Kṛṣṇa, as the eternal son of Yaśodāmayī, is always present in Vṛndāvana. The pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa are continuously going on within both this material world and the spiritual world. In such pastimes, the Lord always thinks Himself the eternal son of mother Yaśodā and father

Nanda Mahārāja. In the Tenth Canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Chapter Six, verse 43, it is stated, “When magnanimous, broad-hearted Nanda Mahārāja came back from a tour, he immediately took his son Kṛṣṇa on his lap and experienced transcendental bliss by smelling His head.” Similarly, in the Tenth Canto, Ninth Chapter, verse 21, it is said, “This Personality of Godhead, appearing as the son of a cowherd damsel, is easily available and understandable to devotees, whereas those who are under the concept of bodily life, even though they are very much advanced in austerity and penance, or even though they are great philosophers, are unable to understand Him.”

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura next quotes Śrīpāda Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa, who refers to the prayers offered by the demigods to Lord Kṛṣṇa in the womb of Devakī and summarizes the birth of Kṛṣṇa as follows: “As the rising moon manifests light in the east, so Devakī, who was always situated on the transcendental platform, having been initiated in the Kṛṣṇa *mantra* by Vasudeva, the son of Śūrasena, kept Kṛṣṇa within her heart.” From this statement of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.2.18) it is understood that the Supreme Personality of Godhead, having been transferred from the heart of Ānakadundubhi, or Vasudeva, manifested Himself in the heart of Devakī. According to Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa, “the heart of Devakī” means the womb of Devakī because in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.2.41 the demigods say, *diṣṭyāmba te kukṣi-gataḥ paraḥ pumān*: “Mother Devakī, the Lord is already within your womb.” Therefore, that the Lord was transferred from the heart of Vasudeva to the heart of Devakī means that He was transferred to the womb of Devakī.

Similarly, in regard to the appearance of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu as described in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, the words *viśeṣe sevana kare govinda-carāṇa*, “they specifically began to worship the lotus feet of Govinda,” indicate that exactly as Kṛṣṇa appeared in the heart of Devakī through the heart of Vasudeva, so Lord Caitanya appeared in the heart of Śacīdevī through the heart of Jagannātha Miśra. This is the mystery of the appearance of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Consequently, one should

not think of Lord Caitanya's appearance as that of a common man or living entity. This subject matter is a little difficult to understand, but for devotees of the Lord it will not at all be difficult to realize the statements given by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TEXT 87

haite haite haila garbha trayodaśa māsa

tathāpi bhūmiṣṭha nahe,——miśrera haila trāsa

SYNONYMS

haite haite—thus becoming; *haila*—it so became; *garbha*—pregnancy; *trayodaśa*—thirteenth; *māsa*—month; *tathāpi*—still; *bhūmiṣṭha*—delivery; *nahe*—there was no sign; *miśrera*—of Jagannātha Miśra; *haila*—became; *trāsa*—apprehension.

TRANSLATION

In this way the pregnancy approached its thirteenth month, but still there was no sign of the delivery of the child. Thus Jagannātha Miśra became greatly apprehensive.

TEXT 88

nīlāmbara cakravartī kahila gaṇiyā

ei māse putra habe śubha-kṣaṇa pāñā

SYNONYMS

nīlāmbara cakravartī—Nīlāmbara Cakravartī; *kahila*—said; *gaṇiyā*—by astrological calculation; *ei māse*—in this month; *putra*—son; *habe*—will take birth; *śubha-kṣaṇa*—auspicious moment; *pāñā*—taking advantage

of.

TRANSLATION

Nīlāmbara Cakravartī [the grandfather of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu] then did an astrological calculation and said that in that very month, taking advantage of an auspicious moment, the child would take birth.

TEXT 89

caudda-śata sāta-śake māsa ye phālguna

paurṇamāsīra sandhyā-kāle haile śubha-kṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

caudda-śata sāta-śake—in 1407 of the Śaka Era (A.D. 1486); *māsa*—month; *ye*—which; *phālguna*—Phālguna; *paurṇamāsīra*—of the full-moon day; *sandhyā-kāle*—in the evening; *haile*—there was; *śubha-kṣaṇa*—an auspicious moment.

TRANSLATION

Thus in the year 1407 of the Śaka Era [A.D. 1486], in the month of Phālguna [February–March], in the evening of the full-moon day, the desired auspicious moment arrived.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura, in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, has presented the horoscope of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as follows:

^{ix}śaka 1407/10/22/28/45

dīnam

7 11 8

15 54 38

40 37 40

13 6 23

The explanation of the horoscope given by Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura is that at the time of the birth of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu the planets were situated as follows: Śukra (Venus) was in Meṣa-rāśi (Aries) and the *nakṣatra* (lunar mansion) of Aśvinī; Ketu (the ninth planet) was in Simha-rāśi (Leo) and Uttaraphalgunī; Candra (the moon) was in Pūrvaphalgunī (the eleventh lunar mansion); Śani (Saturn) was in Vṛścika-rāśi (Scorpio) and Jyeṣṭhā; Bṛhaspati (Jupiter) was in Dhanu-rāśi (Sagittarius) and Pūrvāṣāḍhā; Maṅgala (Mars) was in Makara-rāśi (Capricorn) and Śravaṇā; Ravi (the sun) was in Kumbha-rāśi (Aquarius) and Pūrvabhādrapāda; Rāhu was in Pūrvabhādrapāda; and Budha (Mercury) was in Mīna-rāśi (Pisces) and Uttarabhādrapāda. The *lagna* was Simha.

TEXT 90

simha-rāśi, simha-lagna, ucca graha-gaṇa

ṣaḍ-varga, aṣṭa-varga, sarva sulakṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

simha—the lion; *rāśi*—sign of the zodiac; *simha*—the lion; *lagna*—birth moment; *ucca*—high; *graha-gaṇa*—all planets; *ṣaḍ-varga*—six divisions; *aṣṭa-varga*—eight divisions; *sarva*—all; *su-lakṣaṇa*—symptoms of auspiciousness.

TRANSLATION

[According to the Jyotir-veda, or Vedic astrology, the auspicious birth moment is described as follows:] The moon was in Leo [the figure of the lion in the zodiac], Leo was the ascendant, several planets were strongly positioned, and the *ṣaḍ-varga* and *aṣṭa-varga* showed all-auspicious influences.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, who was previously a great astrologer, explains this verse as follows: The *ṣaḍ-varga* (six divisions) are technically called *kṣetra*, *horā*, *drekkāṇa*, *navāṁśa*, *dvādaśāṁśa* and *triṁśāṁśa*. According to Jyotir-vedic astrology, when the relationship between the planets and the rulers of these six divisions is determined, the auspiciousness of the moment of birth can be calculated. In the book named *Brhaj-jātaka* and other books there are directions for interpreting the movements of the stars and planets. One who knows the process of calculating the *aṣṭa-varga* (eight divisions) can predict auspicious and inauspicious events. This science is known especially by persons who are called *horā-śāstra-vit*, or those who know the astrological scriptures. On the strength of astrological calculations from the *horā* scriptures, Nīlāmbara Cakravartī, the grandfather of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, had ascertained the auspicious moment when the Lord would appear.

TEXT 91

a-kalaṅka gauracandra dilā daraśana

sa-kalaṅka candre āra kon prayojana

SYNONYMS

a-kalaṅka—without contamination; *gauracandra*—the moon of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dilā*—gave; *daraśana*—audience; *sa-kalaṅka*—with contamination; *candre*—for a moon; *āra*—also; *kon*—what; *prayojana*—necessity.

TRANSLATION

When the spotless moon of Caitanya Mahāprabhu became visible, what would be the need for a moon full of black marks on its body?

TEXT 92

eta jāni' rāhu kaila candrera grahaṇa

'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' 'hari' nāme bhāse tri-bhuvana

SYNONYMS

eta jāni'—knowing all this; *rāhu*—the zodiac figure Rāhu; *kaila*—attempted; *candrera*—of the moon; *grahaṇa*—eclipse; *kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa*—the holy name of Kṛṣṇa; *hari*—the holy name of Hari; *nāme*—the names; *bhāse*—inundated; *tri-bhuvana*—the three worlds.

TRANSLATION

Considering this, Rāhu, the black planet, covered the full moon, and immediately vibrations of “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa! Hari!” inundated the three worlds.

PURPORT

According to the *Jyotir-veda*, a lunar eclipse takes place when the Rāhu planet comes in front of the full moon. It is customary in India that all the followers of the Vedic scriptures bathe in the Ganges or the sea as soon as there is a lunar or solar eclipse. All strict followers of the Vedic religion stand up in the water throughout the whole period of the eclipse and chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. At the time of the birth of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, such a lunar eclipse took place, and naturally all the people standing in the water were chanting Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare

Hare.

TEXT 93

jaya jaya dhvani haila sakala bhuvana

camatkāra haiyā loka bhāve mane mana

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *dhvani*—vibration; *haila*—there was; *sakala*—all; *bhuvana*—worlds; *camatkāra*—wonderful; *haiyā*—becoming; *loka*—all the people; *bhāve*—state; *mane mana*—within their minds.

TRANSLATION

All people thus chanted the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra during the lunar eclipse, and their minds were struck with wonder.

TEXT 94

jagat bhariyā loka bale—‘hari’ ‘hari’

sei-kṣaṇe gaurakṛṣṇa bhūme avatari

SYNONYMS

jagat—the whole world; *bhariyā*—fulfilling; *loka*—people; *bale*—said; *hari hari*—the holy name of the Lord; *sei-kṣaṇe*—at that time; *gaurakṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa in the form of Gaurahari; *bhūme*—on the earth; *avatari*—advented.

TRANSLATION

When the whole world was thus chanting the holy name of the Supreme

Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa in the form of Gaurahari advented Himself on the earth.

TEXT 95

prasanna ha-īla saba jagatera mana

‘hari’ bali’ hinduke hāsyā karaye yavana

SYNONYMS

prasanna—joyful; *ha-īla*—became; *saba*—all; *jagatera*—of the whole world; *mana*—the mind; *hari*—the holy name of the Lord; *bali’*—saying; *hinduke*—unto the Hindus; *hāsyā*—laughing; *karaye*—do so; *yavana*—the Muslims.

TRANSLATION

The whole world was pleased. While the Hindus chanted the holy name of the Lord, the non-Hindus, especially the Muslims, jokingly imitated the words.

PURPORT

Although Muslims, or non-Hindus, have no interest in chanting the holy name of the Lord, the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, the Muslims in Navadvīpa imitated the Hindus as they chanted during the lunar eclipse. Thus the Hindus and Muslims joined together in chanting the holy name of the Lord when Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu advented Himself.

TEXT 96

‘hari’ bali’ nārīgaṇa dei hulāhuli

svarge vādya-nṛtya kare deva kutūhalī

SYNONYMS

hari bali'—by saying the word Hari; *nārī-gaṇa*—all the ladies; *dei*—chanting; *hulāhuli*—the sound of *hulāhuli*; *svarge*—in the heavenly planets; *vādyā-nṛtya*—music and dance; *kare*—do; *deva*—demigods; *kutūhalī*—curious.

TRANSLATION

While all the ladies vibrated the holy name of Hari on earth, in the heavenly planets dancing and music were going on, for the demigods were very curious.

TEXT 97

prasanna haila daśa dik, prasanna nadījala

sthāvara-jaṅgama haila ānande vihvala

SYNONYMS

prasanna—jubilant; *haila*—became; *daśa*—ten; *dik*—directions; *prasanna*—satisfied; *nadī-jala*—the water of the rivers; *sthāvara*—immovable; *jaṅgama*—movable; *haila*—became; *ānande*—in joy; *vihvala*—overwhelmed.

TRANSLATION

In this atmosphere, all the ten directions became jubilant, as did the waves of the rivers. Moreover, all beings, moving and nonmoving, were overwhelmed with transcendental bliss.

TEXT 98

nadīyā-udayagiri, pūrṇacandra gauraharī,

kṛpā kari' ha-ila udaya

pāpa-tamaḥ haila nāśa, tri-jagatera ullāsa,

jagabhari' hari-dhvani haya

SYNONYMS

nadīyā—the place known as Nadia; *udayagiri*—is the appearing place; *pūrṇa-candra*—the full moon; *gaurahari*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kṛpā*—by mercy; *kari'*—doing so; *ha-ila*—became; *udaya*—risen; *pāpa*—sinful; *tamaḥ*—darkness; *haila*—became; *nāśa*—dissipated; *tri-jagatera*—of the three worlds; *ullāsa*—happiness; *jagabhari'*—filling the whole world; *hari-dhvani*—the transcendental vibration of Hari; *haya*—resounded.

TRANSLATION

Thus by His causeless mercy the full moon, Gaurahari, rose in the district of Nadia, which is compared to Udayagiri, where the sun first becomes visible. His rising in the sky dissipated the darkness of sinful life, and thus the three worlds became joyful and chanted the holy name of the Lord.

TEXT 99

sei-kāle nijālaya, uṭhiyā advaita rāya,

nṛtya kare ānandita-mane

haridāse lañā saṅge, huṅkāra-kīrtana-raṅge

kene nāce, keha nāhi jāne

SYNONYMS

sei-kāle—at that time; *nīja-ālaya*—in His own house; *uṭhiyā*—standing; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *rāya*—the rich man; *nṛtya*—dancing; *kare*—performs; *ānandita*—with joyful; *mane*—mind; *haridāse*—Ṭhākura Haridāsa; *lañā*—taking; *saṅge*—with Him; *huṅkāra*—loudly; *kīrtana*—*saṅkīrtana*; *raṅge*—performing; *kene*—why; *nāce*—dances; *keha nāhi*—no one; *jāne*—knows.

TRANSLATION

At that time Śrī Advaita Ācārya Prabhu, in His own house at Śāntipura, was dancing in a pleasing mood. Taking Haridāsa Ṭhākura with Him, He danced and loudly chanted Hare Kṛṣṇa. But why they were dancing, no one could understand.

PURPORT

It is understood that Advaita Prabhu, at that time, was in His own paternal house at Śāntipura. Haridāsa Ṭhākura frequently used to meet Him. Coincidentally, therefore, he was also there, and upon the birth of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu both of them immediately began to dance. But no one in Śāntipura could understand why those two saintly persons were dancing.

TEXT 100

dekhi' uparāga hāsi', śīghra gaṅgā-ghāṭe āsi'

ānande karila gaṅgā-snāna

pāñā uparāga-chale, āpanāra mano-bale,

brāhmaṇere dīla nānā dāna

SYNONYMS

dekhi'—seeing; *uparāga*—the eclipse; *hāsi'*—laughing; *śighra*—very soon; *gaṅga-ghāṭe*—on the bank of the Ganges; *āsi'*—coming; *ānande*—in jubilation; *karīla*—took; *gaṅgā-snāna*—bath in the Ganges; *pāñā*—taking advantage of; *uparāga-chale*—on the event of the lunar eclipse; *āpanāra*—His own; *manaḥ-bale*—by the strength of mind; *brāhmaṇere*—unto the *brāhmaṇas*; *dīla*—gave; *nānā*—various; *dāna*—charities.

TRANSLATION

Seeing the lunar eclipse and laughing, Advaita Ācārya and Haridāsa Ṭhākura immediately went to the bank of the Ganges and bathed in the river in great jubilation. Taking advantage of the occasion of the lunar eclipse, Advaita Ācārya, by His mental strength, distributed various types of charity to the *brāhmaṇas*.

PURPORT

It is the custom of Hindus to give in charity to the poor as much as possible during the time of a lunar or solar eclipse. Advaita Ācārya, therefore, taking advantage of this eclipse, distributed many varieties of charity to the *brāhmaṇas*. In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.3.11) there is a statement that when Kṛṣṇa took His birth, Vasudeva immediately took advantage of this moment and distributed ten thousand cows to the *brāhmaṇas*. It is customary among Hindus that at the time a child is born, especially a male child, the parents distribute great charity in jubilation. Advaita Ācārya was actually interested in distributing charity because of Lord Caitanya's birth at the time of the lunar eclipse. People could not understand, however, why Advaita Ācārya was giving such a great variety of things in charity. He did so not because of the lunar eclipse but because of the Lord's taking birth at that moment. He distributed charity exactly as Vasudeva did at the time of Lord Kṛṣṇa's appearance.

TEXT 101

jagat ānandamaya, dekhi' mane sa-vismaya,

ṭhāreṭhore kahe haridāsa

tomāra aichana raṅga, mora mana parasanna,

dekhi—kichu kārye āche bhāsa

SYNONYMS

jagat—the whole world; *ānanda-maya*—full of pleasure; *dekhi'*—seeing; *mane*—within the mind; *sa-vismaya*—with amazement; *ṭhāreṭhore*—by direct and indirect indications; *kahe*—says; *haridāsa*—Haridāsa Ṭhākura; *tomāra*—Your; *aichana*—that kind of; *raṅga*—performance; *mora*—my; *mana*—mind; *parasanna*—very pleased; *dekhi*—I can understand; *kichu*—something; *kārye*—in work; *āche*—there is; *bhāsa*—indication.

TRANSLATION

When he saw that the whole world was jubilant, Haridāsa Ṭhākura, his mind astonished, directly and indirectly expressed himself to Advaita Ācārya: “Your dancing and distributing charity are very pleasing to me. I can understand that there is some special purpose in these actions.”

TEXT 102

ācāryaratna, śrīvāsa, haila mane sukhollāsa

yāi' snāna kaila gaṅgā-jale

ānande vihvala mana, kare hari-saṅkīrtana

nānā dāna kaila mano-bale

SYNONYMS

ācāryaratna—Ācāryaratna; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa; *haila*—became; *mane*—in the mind; *sukha-ullāsa*—happy; *yāi'*—going; *snāna*—bathing; *kaila*—executed; *gaṅgā-jale*—in the water of the Ganges; *ānande*—in jubilation; *vihvala*—overwhelmed; *mana*—mind; *kare*—does; *hari-saṅkīrtana*—performance of *saṅkīrtana*; *nānā*—various; *dāna*—charities; *kaila*—did; *manaḥ-bale*—by the strength of the mind.

TRANSLATION

Ācāryaratna [Candraśekhara] and Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura were overwhelmed with joy, and immediately they went to the bank of the Ganges to bathe in her waters. Their minds full of happiness, they chanted the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra and gave charity by mental strength.

TEXT 103

ei mata bhakta-tati, yāira yei deśe sthiti,

tāhān tāhān pāñā mano-bale

nāce, kare saṅkīrtana, ānande vihvala mana,

dāna kare grahaṇera chale

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *bhakta-tati*—all the devotees there; *yāira*—whose; *yei*—whichever; *deśe*—in the country; *sthiti*—resident; *tāhān tāhān*—there and there; *pāñā*—taking advantage; *manaḥ-bale*—by the strength of the mind; *nāce*—dance; *kare saṅkīrtana*—perform *saṅkīrtana*; *ānande*—in joyfulness; *vihvala*—overwhelmed; *mana*—mind; *dāna*—in charity; *kare*—give; *grahaṇera*—of the lunar eclipse; *chale*—on the pretense.

TRANSLATION

In this way all the devotees, wherever they were situated, in every city and every country, danced, performed saṅkīrtana and gave charity by mental strength on the plea of the lunar eclipse, their minds overwhelmed with joy.

TEXT 104

brāhmaṇa-sajjana-nārī, nānā-dravye thālī bhari'

āilā sabe yautuka la-iyā

yena kāñcā-ṣoṇā-dyuti, dekhi' bālakera mūrti,

āśīrvāda kare sukha pāñā

SYNONYMS

brāhmaṇa—the respectable *brāhmaṇas*; *sat-jana*—gentlemen; *nārī*—ladies; *nānā*—varieties; *dravye*—with gifts; *thālī*—plates; *bhari'*—filled up; *āilā*—came; *sabe*—all; *yautuka*—presentations; *la-iyā*—taking; *yena*—like; *kāñcā*—raw; *ṣoṇā*—gold; *dyuti*—glaring; *dekhi'*—seeing; *bālakera*—of the child; *mūrti*—form; *āśīrvāda*—blessings; *kare*—offered; *sukha*—happiness; *pāñā*—achieving.

TRANSLATION

All sorts of respectable brāhmaṇa gentlemen and ladies, carrying plates filled with various gifts, came with their presentations. Seeing the newborn child, whose form resembled natural glaring gold, all of them happily offered their blessings.

TEXT 105

sāvitrī, gaurī, sarasvatī, śacī, rambhā, arundhatī

āra yata deva-nārīgaṇa

nānā-dravye pātra bhari', brāhmaṇīra veśa dhari',

āsi' sabe kare daraśana

SYNONYMS

sāvitrī—the wife of Lord Brahmā; *gaurī*—the wife of Lord Śiva; *sarasvatī*—the wife of Lord Nṛsimhadeva; *śacī*—the wife of King Indra; *rambhā*—a dancing girl of heaven; *arundhatī*—the wife of Vasiṣṭha; *āra*—and; *yata*—all; *deva*—celestial; *nārī-gaṇa*—women; *nānā*—varieties; *dravye*—with gifts; *pātra bhari'*—filling up the baskets; *brāhmaṇīra*—in the forms of *brāhmaṇa* ladies; *veśa dhari'*—dressing like that; *āsi'*—coming there; *sabe*—all; *kare*—do; *daraśana*—visit.

TRANSLATION

Dressing themselves as the wives of brāhmaṇas, all the celestial ladies, including the wives of Lord Brahmā, Lord Śiva, Lord Nṛsimhadeva, King Indra and Vasiṣṭha Ṛṣi, along with Rambhā, a dancing girl of heaven, came there with varieties of gifts.

PURPORT

When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was a newborn baby, He was visited by the neighboring ladies, most of whom were the wives of respectable *brāhmaṇas*. In the dress of *brāhmaṇas'* wives, celestial ladies like the wives of Lord Brahmā and Lord Śiva also came to see the newborn child. Ordinary people saw them as respectable *brāhmaṇa* ladies of the neighborhood, but actually they were all celestial ladies dressed in that way.

TEXT 106

antarīkṣe deva-gaṇa, gandharva, siddha, cāraṇa,

stuti-nṛtya kare vādyā-gīta

nartaka, vādaka, bhāṭa, navadvīpe yāra nāṭa,

sabe āsi' nāce pāñā prīta

SYNONYMS

antarīkṣe—in outer space; *deva-gaṇa*—the demigods; *gandharva*—the inhabitants of Gandharvaloka; *siddha*—the inhabitants of Siddhaloka; *cāraṇa*—the professional singers of the heavenly planets; *stuti*—prayers; *nṛtya*—dancing; *kare*—do; *vādyā*—music; *gīta*—song; *nartaka*—dancers; *vādaka*—professional drummers; *bhāṭa*—professional blessers; *navadvīpe*—in the city of Navadvīpa; *yāra*—of whom; *nāṭa*—stage; *sabe*—all of them; *āsi'*—coming; *nāce*—began to dance; *pāñā*—achieving; *prīta*—happiness.

TRANSLATION

In outer space all the demigods, including the inhabitants of Gandharvaloka, Siddhaloka and Cāraṇaloka, offered their prayers and danced to the accompaniment of music, songs and the beating of drums. Similarly, in Navadvīpa city all the professional dancers, musicians and blessers gathered together, dancing in great jubilation.

PURPORT

As there are professional singers, dancers and reciters of prayers in the heavenly planets, so in India still there are professional dancers, blessers and singers, all of whom assemble together during householder ceremonies, especially marriages and birth ceremonies. These professional men earn their livelihood by taking charity on such occasions from the homes of the Hindus. Eunuchs also take advantage of such ceremonies to

receive charity. That is their means of livelihood. Such men never become servants or engage themselves in agriculture or business occupations; they simply take charity from neighborhood friends to maintain themselves peacefully. The *bhāṭas* are a class of *brāhmaṇas* who go to such ceremonies to offer blessings by composing poems with references to the Vedic scriptures.

TEXT 107

kebā āse kebā yāya, kebā nāce kebā gāya,

sambhālite nāre kāra bola

khaṇḍileka duḥkha-śoka, pramoda-pūrīta loka,

miśra hailā ānande vihvala

SYNONYMS

kebā—who; *āse*—is coming; *kebā*—who; *yāya*—is going; *kebā*—who; *nāce*—is dancing; *kebā*—who; *gāya*—is singing; *sambhālite*—to understand; *nāre*—cannot; *kāra*—others; *bola*—language; *khaṇḍileka*—dissipated; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *śoka*—lamentation; *pramoda*—jubilation; *pūrīta*—full of; *loka*—all people; *miśra*—Jagannātha Miśra; *hailā*—became; *ānande*—in happiness; *vihvala*—overwhelmed.

TRANSLATION

No one could understand who was coming and who was going, who was dancing and who was singing. Nor could they understand one another's language. Yet all unhappiness and lamentation were immediately dissipated, and people became all-jubilant. Thus Jagannātha Miśra was also overwhelmed with joy.

TEXT 108

ācāryaratna, śrīvāsa, jagannātha-miśra-pāśa,

āsi' tāñre kare sāvadhāna

karāila jātakarma, ye āchila vidhi-dharma,

tabe miśra kare nānā dāna

SYNONYMS

ācāryaratna—Candraśekhara Ācārya; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *jagannātha-miśra pāśa*—at the house of Jagannātha Miśra; *āsi'*—coming; *tāñre*—unto him; *kare*—do; *sāvadhāna*—attention; *karāila*—executed; *jāta-karma*—the auspicious ceremony at the time of birth; *ye*—whatever; *āchila*—there was; *vidhi-dharma*—regulative principles of religion; *tabe*—at that time; *miśra*—Jagannātha Miśra; *kare*—does; *nānā*—varieties; *dāna*—charities.

TRANSLATION

Candraśekhara Ācārya and Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura both came to Jagannātha Miśra and drew his attention in various ways. They performed the ritualistic ceremonies prescribed at the time of birth according to religious principles. Jagannātha Miśra also gave varieties of charity.

TEXT 109

yautuka pāila yata, ghare vā āchila kata,

saba dhana vipre dila dāna

yata nartaka, gāyana, bhāṭa, akiñcana jana,

dhana diyā kaila sabāra māna

SYNONYMS

yautuka—presentation; *pāila*—received; *yata*—as much as; *ghare*—in the house; *vā*—or; *āchila*—there was; *kata*—whatever; *saba dhana*—all riches; *vipre*—unto the *brāhmaṇas*; *dila*—gave; *dāna*—in charity; *yata*—all; *nartaka*—dancers; *gāyana*—singers; *bhāṭa*—blessers; *akiñcana jana*—poor men; *dhana diyā*—giving them riches; *kaila*—did; *sabāra*—everyone’s; *māna*—honor.

TRANSLATION

Whatever riches Jagannātha Miśra collected in the form of gifts and presentations, and whatever he had in his house, he distributed among the *brāhmaṇas*, professional singers, dancers, *bhāṭas* and the poor. He honored them all by giving them riches in charity.

TEXT 110

śrīvāsera brāhmaṇī, nāma tānra ‘mālinī’,

ācāryaratnera patnī-saṅge

sindūra, haridrā, taila, kha-i, kalā, nārikela,

diyā pūje nārīgaṇa raṅge

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsera brāhmaṇī—the wife of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *nāma*—name; *tānra*—her; *mālinī*—Mālinī; *ācāryaratnera*—of Candrasekhara (Ācāryaratna); *patnī*—wife; *saṅge*—along with; *sindūra*—vermilion; *haridrā*—turmeric; *taila*—oil; *kha-i*—fused rice; *kalā*—banana; *nārikela*—coconut; *diyā*—giving; *pūje*—worship; *nārīgaṇa*—ladies; *raṅge*—in a happy mood.

TRANSLATION

The wife of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, whose name was Mālinī, accompanied by the wife of Candrasēkhara [Ācāryaratna] and other ladies, came there in great happiness to worship the baby with paraphernalia such as vermilion, turmeric, oil, fused rice, bananas and coconuts.

PURPORT

Vermilion, *kha-i* (fused rice), bananas, coconuts and turmeric mixed with oil are all auspicious gifts for such a ceremony. As there is puffed rice, so there is another preparation of rice called *kha-i*, or fused rice, which, along with bananas, is taken as a very auspicious presentation. Also, turmeric mixed with oil and vermilion makes an auspicious ointment that is smeared over the body of a newborn baby or a person who is going to marry. These are all auspicious activities in family affairs. We see that five hundred years ago at the birth of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu all these ceremonies were performed rigidly, but at present such ritualistic performances hardly ever take place. Generally a pregnant mother is sent to the hospital, and as soon as her child is born he is washed with an antiseptic, and this concludes everything.

TEXT 111

advaita-ācārya-bhāryā, jagat-pūjitā āryā,

nāma tānra 'sītā ṭhākurāṇī'

ācāryera ājñā pāñā, gela upahāra lañā,

dekhite bālaka-sīromaṇi

SYNONYMS

advaita-ācārya-bhāryā—the wife of Advaita Ācārya; *jagat-pūjitā*—worshiped by the whole world; *āryā*—the most advanced cultured lady; *nāma*—name; *tānra*—her; *sītā ṭhākurāṇī*—mother Sītā; *ācāryera ājñā*

pāñā—taking the order of Advaita Ācārya; *gela*—went; *upahāra*—presentation; *lañā*—taking; *dekhite*—to see; *bālaka*—the child; *śiromaṇi*—topmost.

TRANSLATION

One day shortly after Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was born, Advaita Ācārya's wife, Sītādevī, who is worshipable by the whole world, took her husband's permission and went to see that topmost child with all kinds of gifts and presentations

PURPORT

It appears that Advaita Ācārya had two different houses, one at Śāntipura and one at Navadvīpa. When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was born, Advaita Ācārya was residing not at His Navadvīpa house but at His Śāntipura house. Therefore, as formerly explained (text 99), from Advaita's old paternal house (*nijālaya*) in Śāntipura, Sītā came to Navadvīpa to present gifts to the newborn child, Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 112

suvarṇera kaḍi-ba-uli, rajatamudrā-pāśuli,

suvarṇera aṅgada, kaṅkaṇa

du-bāhute divya śaṅkha, rajatera malabaṅka,

svarṇa-mudrā nānā hāraṇa

SYNONYMS

suvarṇera—made of gold; *kaḍi-ba-uli*—bangles worn on the hand; *rajata-mudrā*—gold coins; *pāśuli*—a kind of ornament covering the foot; *suvarṇera*—made of gold; *aṅgada*—a kind of ornament; *kaṅkaṇa*—

another kind of ornament for the hand; *du-bāhute*—in two arms; *divya*—celestial; *śaṅkha*—conchshell; *rajatera*—made of gold; *malabaṅka*—bangles for the foot; *svaṛṇa-mudrāra*—made of gold; *nānā*—varieties; *hāra-gaṇa*—necklaces.

TRANSLATION

She brought different kinds of golden ornaments, including armlets, necklaces, anklets and bangles for the hands.

TEXT 113

vyāghra-nakha hema-jaḍi, kaṭi-paṭṭasūtra-ḍorī

hasta-padera yata ābharaṇa

citra-varṇa paṭṭa-sāḍī, buni photo paṭṭapāḍī,

svaṛṇa-raupya-mudrā bahu-dhana

SYNONYMS

vyāghra-nakha—tiger nails; *hema-jaḍi*—set in gold; *kaṭi-paṭṭasūtra-ḍorī*—silken thread for the waist; *hasta-padera*—of the hands and legs; *yata*—all kinds of; *ābharaṇa*—ornaments; *citra-varṇa*—printed with varieties of colors; *paṭṭa-sāḍī*—silken saris; *buni*—woven; *photo*—small jackets for children; *paṭṭa-pāḍī*—with embroidery of silk; *svaṛṇa*—gold; *raupya*—silver; *mudrā*—coins; *bahu-dhana*—all kinds of riches.

TRANSLATION

There were also tiger nails set in gold, waist decorations of silk and lace, ornaments for the hands and legs, nicely printed silken saris, and a child's garment, also made of silk. Many other riches, including gold and silver coins, were also presented to the child.

PURPORT

From the gifts presented by Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī, Advaita Ācārya's wife, it appears that Advaita Ācārya was at that time a very rich man. Although *brāhmaṇas* are not the rich men of society, Advaita Ācārya, being the leader of the *brāhmaṇas* in Śāntipura, was considerably well-to-do. Therefore He presented many ornaments to the baby, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. But Kamalākānta Viśvāsa's asking for three hundred rupees from the King of Jagannātha Purī, Mahārāja Pratāparudra, on the plea that Advaita Ācārya was in debt for that amount, indicates that such a rich man, who could present many valuable ornaments, saris, etc., thought it difficult to repay three hundred rupees. Therefore the value of a rupee at that time was many thousands of times what it is now. At present, no one feels difficulty over a debt of three hundred rupees, nor can an ordinary man accumulate such valuable ornaments to present to a friend's son. Probably the value of three hundred rupees at that time was equal to the present value of thirty thousand rupees.

TEXT 114

durvā, dhānya, gorocana, haridrā, kuṅkuma, candana,

maṅgala-dravya pātra bhariyā

vastra-gupta dolā caḍi' saṅge lañā dāsī ceḍi,

vastrāṅkāra peṭāri bhariyā

SYNONYMS

durvā—fresh grass; *dhānya*—rice paddy; *gorocana*—a yellow patch for the head of a cow; *haridrā*—turmeric; *kuṅkuma*—a kind of scent produced in Kashmir; *candana*—sandalwood; *maṅgala-dravya*—auspicious things; *pātra bhariyā*—filling up a dish; *vastra-gupta*—covered by cloth; *dolā*—palanquin; *caḍi'*—riding; *saṅge*—along with; *lañā*—

taking; *dāsī*—maidservant; *ceḍī*—female attendants; *vastra-alaṅkāra*—ornaments and clothes; *peṭāri*—basket; *bhariyā*—filled up.

TRANSLATION

Riding in a palanquin covered with cloth and accompanied by maidservants, Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī came to the house of Jagannātha Miśra, bringing with her many auspicious articles such as fresh grass, paddy, gorocana, turmeric, kuṅkuma and sandalwood. All these presentations filled a large basket.

PURPORT

The words *vastra-gupta dolā* are very significant in this verse. Even fifty or sixty years ago in Calcutta, all respectable ladies would go to a neighboring place riding on a palanquin carried by four men. The palanquin was covered with soft cotton, and in that way there was no chance of seeing a respectable lady traveling in public. Ladies, especially those coming from respectable families, could not be seen by ordinary men. This system is still current in remote places. The Sanskrit word *asūrya-paśyā* indicates that a respectable lady could not be seen even by the sun. In the oriental culture this system was very prevalent and was strictly observed by respectable ladies, both Hindu and Muslim. We have actual experience in our childhood that our mother would not walk even next door to observe an invitation; rather, she would go in either a carriage or a palanquin carried by four men. This custom was also strictly followed five hundred years ago, and the wife of Advaita Ācārya, being a very respectable lady, observed the customary rules current in that social environment.

TEXT 115

bhakṣya, bhojya, upahāra, saṅge la-ila bahu bhāra,

śacī-grhe haila upanīta

dekhiyā bālaka-ṭhāma, sākṣāt gokula-kāna,

varṇa-mātra dekhi viparīta

SYNONYMS

bhakṣya—foods; *bhojya*—fried foods; *upahāra*—presentation; *saṅge*—along with her; *la-ila*—took; *bahu bhāra*—many packages; *śacī-gr̥he*—in the house of mother Śacī; *haila*—was; *upanīta*—carried; *dekhiyā*—seeing; *bālaka-ṭhāma*—the feature of the child; *sākṣāt*—directly; *gokula-kāna*—Lord Kṛṣṇa of Gokula; *varṇa-mātra*—only the color; *dekhi*—seeing; *viparīta*—opposite.

TRANSLATION

When Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī came to the house of Śacīdevī, bringing with her many kinds of eatables, dresses and other gifts, she was astonished to see the newborn child, for she appreciated that except for a difference in color, the child was directly Kṛṣṇa of Gokula Himself.

PURPORT

A *peṭāri* is a kind of big basket that is carried in pairs on the ends of a rod balanced over the shoulders. The man who carries such a load is called a *bhārī*. This system of carrying luggage and packages is still current in India and other oriental countries, and we have seen that the same system is still current even in Jakarta, Indonesia.

TEXT 116

sarva aṅga—*—sunīrmāṇa, suvarṇa-pratimā-bhāna,*

sarva aṅga—*—sulakṣaṇamaya*

bālakera divya jyoti, dekhi' pāila bahu prīti,

vātsalyete dravila hṛdaya

SYNONYMS

sarva aṅga—all different parts of the body; *sunirmāṇa*—well constructed; *suvarṇa*—gold; *pratimā*—form; *bhāna*—like; *sarva*—all; *aṅga*—parts of the body; *sulakṣaṇa-maya*—full of auspicious signs; *bālakera*—of the child; *divya*—transcendental; *jyoti*—effulgence; *dekhi'*—seeing; *pāila*—got; *bahu*—much; *prīti*—satisfaction; *vātsalyete*—by parental affection; *dravila*—melted; *hṛdaya*—her heart.

TRANSLATION

Seeing the transcendental bodily effulgence of the child, each of His nicely constructed limbs full of auspicious signs and resembling a form of gold, Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī was very pleased, and because of her maternal affection, she felt as if her heart were melting.

TEXT 117

durvā, dhānya, dila śīrṣe, kaila bahu āśīṣe,

cirajīvī hao dui bhāi

ḍākinī-śāṅkhinī haite, śāṅkā upajila cite,

ḍare nāma thuila 'nimāi'

SYNONYMS

durvā—fresh grass; *dhānya*—paddy; *dila*—gave; *śīrṣe*—on the head; *kaila*—did; *bahu*—with much; *āśīṣe*—blessing; *cira-jīvī*—live long; *hao*—become; *dui bhāi*—two brothers; *ḍākinī-śāṅkhinī*—ghosts and witches; *haite*—from; *śāṅkā*—doubt; *upajila*—grew; *cite*—in the heart; *ḍare*—out of fear; *nāma*—name; *thuila*—kept; *nimāi*—Lord Caitanya's

childhood name, derived from the *nima* (*nimba*) tree.

TRANSLATION

She blessed the newborn child by placing fresh grass and paddy on His head and saying, “May You be blessed with a long duration of life.” But being afraid of ghosts and witches, she gave the child the name Nimāi.

PURPORT

Dākinī and Śāṅkhinī are two companions of Lord Śiva and his wife who are supposed to be extremely inauspicious, having been born of ghostly life. It is believed that such inauspicious living creatures cannot go near a *nima* tree. At least medically it is accepted that *nima* wood is extremely antiseptic, and formerly it was customary to have a *nima* tree in front of one’s house. On very large roads in India, especially in Uttar Pradesh, there are hundreds and thousands of *nima* trees. *Nima* wood is so antiseptic that the Āyurvedic science uses it to cure leprosy. Medical scientists have extracted the active principle of the *nima* tree, which is called margosic acid. *Nima* is used for many purposes, especially to brush the teeth. In Indian villages ninety percent of the people use *nima* twigs for this purpose. Because of all the antiseptic effects of the *nima* tree and because Lord Caitanya was born beneath a *nima* tree, Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī gave the Lord the name Nimāi. Later in His youth He was celebrated as Nimāi Paṇḍita, and in the neighborhood villages He was called by that name, although His real name was Viśvambhara.

TEXT 118

putramātā-snānadine, dila vastra vibhūṣaṇe,

putra-saha miśrere sammāni’

śacī-miśrera pūjā lañā, manete hariṣa hañā,

ghare āilā sītā ṭhākuraṇī

SYNONYMS

putra-mātā—of the mother and child; *snāna-dīne*—on the day of bathing; *dila*—gave; *vastra*—cloth; *vibhūṣaṇe*—ornaments; *putra-saha*—with the child; *miśrere*—unto Jagannātha Miśra; *sammāni'*—congratulating; *śacī*—Śacīdevī; *miśrera*—Jagannātha Miśra; *pūjā*—honor; *lañā*—receiving; *manete*—within the mind; *hariṣa*—pleased; *hañā*—becoming; *ghare*—home; *āilā*—returned; *sītā ṭhākuraṇī*—mother Sītā, wife of Advaita Ācārya.

TRANSLATION

On the day the mother and son bathed and left the maternity home, Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī gave them all kinds of ornaments and garments and then also honored Jagannātha Miśra. Then Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī, being honored by mother Śacīdevī and Jagannātha Miśra, was greatly happy within her mind, and thus she returned home.

PURPORT

On the fifth day from the birth of a child, as also on the ninth day, the mother bathes either in the Ganges or in another sacred place. This is called *niṣkrāmaṇa*, or the ceremony of coming out of the maternity home. Nowadays the maternity home is a hospital, but formerly in every respectable house one room was set aside as a maternity home where children would take birth, and on the ninth day after the birth of a child the mother would come into the regular rooms in the ceremony called *niṣkrāmaṇa*. Of the ten purificatory processes, *niṣkrāmaṇa* is one. Formerly, especially in Bengal, the higher castes observed four months after the birth of a child as a quarantine. At the end of the fourth month, the mother could see the sun rise. Later the higher castes, namely the *brāhmaṇas*, *kṣatriyas* and *vaiśyas*, observed only twenty-one days as a quarantine, whereas the *sūdras* had to observe thirty days. For the

sections of society known as *kartābhajā* and *satīmā*, the mother of the child was immediately purified after the quarantine by the throwing of *hari-nuṭa*, small pieces of sweetmeat, in *saṅkīrtana*. Śacīdevī and Jagannātha Miśra, with the newborn child, were honored by Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī. Similarly, while Sītā Ṭhākuraṇī was returning home, she was also honored by Śacīdevī and Jagannātha Miśra. That was the system in respectable families of Bengal.

TEXT 119

aiche śacī-jagannātha, putra pāñā lakṣmīnātha,

pūrṇa ha-ila sakala vāñchita

dhana-dhānye bhare ghara, lokamānya kalevara,

dine dine haya ānandita

SYNONYMS

aiche—in that way; *śacī-jagannātha*—mother Śacīdevī and Jagannātha Miśra; *putra*—son; *pāñā*—having obtained; *lakṣmī-nātha*—personally the husband of the goddess of fortune; *pūrṇa*—fulfilled; *ha-ila*—became; *sakala*—all; *vāñchita*—desires; *dhana-dhānye*—with riches and grains; *bhare ghara*—the house filled up; *loka-mānya kalevara*—the body beloved by the people in general; *dine dine*—day after day; *haya*—becomes; *ānandita*—pleased.

TRANSLATION

In this way mother Śacīdevī and Jagannātha Miśra, having obtained a son who was the husband of the goddess of fortune, had all their desires fulfilled. Their house was always filled with riches and grains. As they saw the beloved body of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, day after day their pleasure increased.

PURPORT

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore everyone offered respects to Him. Even the denizens of heaven used to come in the dress of ordinary men to offer their respect to the Lord. His father and mother, Jagannātha Miśra and Śacīdevī, seeing the honor of their transcendental son, also became very pleased within their hearts.

TEXT 120

miśra—vaiṣṇava, śānta, alampaṭa, śuddha, dānta,

dhana-bhoge nāhi abhimāna

putrera prabhāve yata, dhana āsi' mile, tata,

viṣṇu-prīte dvije dena dāna

SYNONYMS

miśra—Jagannātha Miśra; *vaiṣṇava*—a great devotee; *śānta*—peaceful; *alampaṭa*—very regular; *śuddha*—purified; *dānta*—controlled; *dhana-bhoge*—in the matter of enjoying material happiness; *nāhi*—there is no; *abhimāna*—desire; *putrera*—of their son; *prabhāve*—by the influence; *yata*—all; *dhana*—riches; *āsi'*—coming; *mile*—gets; *tata*—so much so; *viṣṇu-prīte*—for the satisfaction of Lord Viṣṇu; *dvije*—to the *brāhmaṇas*; *dena*—gives; *dāna*—charity.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra was an ideal Vaiṣṇava. He was peaceful, restrained in sense gratification, pure and controlled. Therefore he had no desire to enjoy material opulence. Whatever money came because of the influence of his transcendental son, he gave it in charity to the brāhmaṇas for the

satisfaction of Viṣṇu.

TEXT 121

lagna gaṇi' harṣamati, nīlāmbara cakravartī,

gupte kichu kahila miśrere

mahāpuruṣera cihna, lagne aṅge bhinna bhinna,

dekhi, — — ei tāribe saṁsāre

SYNONYMS

lagna gaṇi'—by astrological calculation of the birth moment; *harṣamati*—very pleased; *nīlāmbara cakravartī*—Nīlāmbara Cakravartī; *gupte*—in private; *kichu*—something; *kahila*—said; *miśrere*—unto Jagannātha Miśra; *mahā-puruṣera cihna*—all the symptoms of a great personality; *lagne*—in the birth moment; *aṅge*—on the body; *bhinna bhinna*—different; *dekhi*—I see; *ei*—this child; *tāribe*—shall deliver; *saṁsāre*—all the three worlds.

TRANSLATION

After calculating the birth moment of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nīlāmbara Cakravartī privately said to Jagannātha Miśra that he saw all the different symptoms of a great personality in both the body and birth moment of the child. Thus he understood that in the future this child would deliver all the three worlds.

TEXT 122

aiche prabhu śacī-ghare, kṛpāya kaila avatāre,

yei ihā karaye śravaṇa

gaura-prabhu dayāmaya, tāñre hayena sadaya,

sei pāya tāñhāra caraṇa

SYNONYMS

aiche—in this way; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *śacī-ghare*—in the home of Śacīdevī; *kṛpāya*—by His causeless mercy; *kaila*—made; *avatāre*—advent; *yei*—anyone who; *ihā*—this; *karaye*—does; *śravaṇa*—hear; *gaura-prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *dayā-maya*—being very merciful; *tāñre*—upon him; *hayena*—becomes; *sadaya*—merciful; *sei*—that person; *pāya*—gets; *tāñhāra*—His; *caraṇa*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

In this way Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, out of His causeless mercy, made His advent in the house of Śacīdevī. Lord Caitanya is very merciful to anyone who hears this narration of His birth, and thus such a person attains the lotus feet of the Lord.

TEXT 123

pāiyā mānuṣa janma, ye nā śune gaura-guṇa,

hena janma tāra vyartha haila

pāiyā amṛtadhunī, piye viṣa-garta-pānī,

janmiyā se kene nāhi maila

SYNONYMS

pāiyā mānuṣa janma—anyone who has gotten the form of a human body; *ye*—who; *nā*—does not; *śune*—hear; *gaura-guṇa*—the qualities of Lord

Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *hena janma*—such a birth; *tāra*—his; *vyartha haila*—becomes useless; *pāiyā*—getting the opportunity; *amṛtadhunī*—of the river of nectar; *piye*—drinks; *viṣa-garta-pānī*—water in a poison pit of material happiness; *janmīyā*—taking birth as a human being; *se*—he; *kene*—why; *nāhi*—did not; *maila*—die.

TRANSLATION

Anyone who attains a human body but does not take to the cult of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is baffled in his opportunity. Amṛtadhunī is a flowing river of the nectar of devotional service. If after getting a human body one drinks the water in a poison pit of material happiness instead of the water of such a river, it would be better for him not to have lived, but to have died long ago.

PURPORT

In this connection Śrīmat Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī has composed the following verses in his *Caitanya-candrāmṛta* (37, 36, 34):

*acaitanyam idaṁ viśvaṁ yadī caitanyam īśvaram
na viduḥ sarva-śāstra-jñā hy api bhrāmyanti te janāḥ*

“This material world is without Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is Kṛṣṇa consciousness personified. Therefore if a very learned scholar or scientist does not understand Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, certainly he is wandering uselessly in this world.”

*prasārita-mahā-prema-pīyūṣa-rasa-sāgare
caitanya-candre prakāṣe yo dīno dīna eva saḥ*

“A person who does not take advantage of the nectar of devotional service overflowing during the presence of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s cult is certainly the poorest of the poor.”

*avatīrṇe gaura-candre vistīrṇe prema-sāgare
suprakāśita-ratnaughe yo dīno dīna eva saḥ*

“The advent of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is just like an expanding ocean of nectar. One who does not collect the valuable jewels within this ocean is certainly the poorest of the poor.”

Similarly, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (2.3.19, 20, 23) states:

*śva-vid-varāhoṣṭra-kharaiḥ saṁstutaḥ puruṣaḥ paśuḥ
na yat-karṇa-pathopeto jātu nāma gadāgrajaḥ*

*bile batorukrama-vikramān ye
na śṛṇvataḥ karṇa-puṭe narasya*

*jihvāsati dārdurikeva sūta
na copagāyaty urugāya-gāthāḥ*

*jīvañ chavo bhāgavatāṅghri-reṇuṁ
na jātu martyo 'bhilabheta yas tu*

*śrī-viṣṇu-padyā manujas tulasyāḥ
śvasaṁ chavo yas tu na veda gandham*

“A person who has no connection with Kṛṣṇa consciousness may be a very great personality in so-called human society, but actually he is no better than a great animal. Such big animals are generally praised by other animals like dogs, hogs camels and asses. A person who does not lend his aural reception to hearing about the Supreme Personality of Godhead must be considered to have earholes like holes in a field. Although that person has a tongue, it is like the tongue of a frog, which unnecessarily creates a disturbance by croaking, inviting the snake of death. Similarly, a person who neither takes advantage of the dust of the lotus feet of great devotees nor smells the *tulasī* leaves offered to the lotus feet of the Lord must be considered dead even though he is supposedly working.”

Similarly, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.1.4 states:

*nivṛtta-tarṣair upagīyamānād
bhavauśadhāc chrotra-mano-'bhirāmāt
ka uttamaśloka-guṇānuvādāt
pumān virajyeta vinā paśu-ghnāt*

“Who but the animal-killer or the killer of the soul will not care to hear glorification of the Supreme Personality of Godhead? Such glorification is enjoyed by persons liberated from the contamination of this material world.”

Similarly, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.23.56 says, *na tīrtha-pada-sevāyai jīvann api mṛto hi saḥ*: “Although a person is apparently living, if he does not serve the lotus feet of great devotees he is to be considered a dead body.”

TEXT 124

*śrī-caitanya-nityānanda, ācārya advaitacandra,
svarūpa-rūpa-raghunāthadāsa
inhā-sabāra śrī-caraṇa, śīre vandi nija-dhana,
janma-līlā gāila kṛṣṇadāsa*

SYNONYMS

śrī-caitanya-nityānanda—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu; *ācārya advaitacandra*—Ācārya Śrī Advaitacandra; *svarūpa-rūpa-raghunāthadāsa*—Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rūpa Gosvāmī and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *inhā-sabāra*—of all of them; *śrī-caraṇa*—the lotus feet; *śīre*—on the head; *vandi*—offering respect; *nija-dhana*—personal property; *janma-līlā*—narration of the birth; *gāila*—sang; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Taking on my head as my own property the lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu, Ācārya Advaitacandra, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rūpa Gosvāmī and Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, have thus described the advent of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda, Advaita Prabhu, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rūpa Gosvāmī, Raghunātha dāsa and their followers are all accepted by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī. Anyone who follows in the footsteps of Kavirāja Gosvāmī also accepts the lotus feet of the above-mentioned lords as his personal property. For a materialistic person, material wealth and opulence are only illusory. Actually they are not possessions but entanglements because by enjoying the material world a conditioned soul becomes more and more entangled by incurring debts for his present enjoyment. Unfortunately, a conditioned soul considers property for which he is in debt to be his own, and he is very busy acquiring such property. But a devotee considers such property not real property but simply an entanglement in the material world. If Lord Kṛṣṇa is very pleased with a devotee, He takes away his material property, as He states in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.88.8): *yasyāham anugṛhṇāmi hariṣye tad-dhanam śanaiḥ*. “To show special favor to a devotee, I take away all his material property.” Similarly, Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura says:

*dhana mora nityānanda, rādhā-kṛṣṇa-śrīcaraṇa
sei mora prāṇadhana*

“My real riches are Nityānanda Prabhu and the lotus feet of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.” He further prays, “O Lord, kindly give me this opulence. I do not want anything but Your lotus feet as my property.” Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura has sung in many places that his real property is the lotus feet of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. Unfortunately, we are interested in

unreal property and are neglecting our real property (*adhane yatana kari' dhana teyāginu*).

Sometimes *smārtas* consider Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī a *śūdra*. But Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī here especially mentions *svarūpa-rūpa-raghunāthadāsa*. Therefore one who considers the lotus feet of Raghunātha dāsa to be transcendental to all divisions of the caste system enjoys the riches of actual spiritual bliss.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Thirteenth Chapter, describing the advent of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Chapter 14

Lord Caitanya's Childhood Pastimes

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura has given a summary of this chapter in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “In the Fourteenth Chapter there is a description of how Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu enjoyed His childhood pastimes—crawling, crying, eating dirt and giving intelligence to His mother, favoring a *brāhmaṇa* guest, riding on the shoulders of two thieves and misleading them to His own house, and, on the plea of being diseased, taking *prasādam* in the house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa on the Ekādaśī day. The chapter further describes how He displayed Himself as a naughty boy, how when His mother fainted He brought a coconut to her on His head, how He joked with girls of the same age on the banks of the Ganges, how He accepted worshipful paraphernalia from Śrīmatī Lakṣmīdevī, how He sat down in a garbage pit and instructed His mother in transcendental knowledge, how He left the pit on the order of His mother, and how He dealt with His father with full affection.”

TEXT 1

kathañcana smṛte yasmin

duṣkaram sukaram bhavet

vismṛte viparītam syāt

śrī-caitanyam namāmi tam

SYNONYMS

kathañcana—somehow or other; *smṛte*—by remembering; *yasmin*—whom; *duṣkaram*—difficult things; *sukaram*—easy; *bhavet*—become; *vismṛte*—by forgetting Him; *viparītam*—just the opposite; *syāt*—become; *śrī-caitanyam*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *namāmi*—I offer my respectful obeisances; *tam*—unto Him.

TRANSLATION

Things that are very difficult to do become easy to execute if one somehow or other simply remembers Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. But if one does not remember Him, even easy things become very difficult. To this Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu I offer my respectful obeisances.

PURPORT

In his book *Caitanya-candrāmṛta*, Śrīla Prabodhānanda Sarasvatī says, “One who receives a little favor from the Lord becomes so exalted that he does not care even for liberation, which is sought after by many great scholars and philosophers. Similarly, a devotee of Lord Caitanya considers residence in the heavenly planets a will-o’-the-wisp. He surpasses the perfection of mystic *yoga* power because for him the senses are like snakes with broken fangs.” A snake is a very fearful and dangerous animal because of his poison fangs, but if these fangs are broken, the appearance of a snake is no cause for fear. The *yoga* principles are meant to control the senses, but there is no scope for the senses of one engaged

in the service of the Lord to be dangerous like snakes. These are the gifts of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

The *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* confirms that difficult things become easy to understand if one remembers Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and easy things become very difficult to understand if one forgets Him. We actually see that even those who are very great scientists in the eyes of the general public cannot understand the very simple idea that life comes from life, because they do not have the mercy of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. They defend the false understanding that life comes from matter, although they cannot prove that this is a fact. Modern civilization, therefore, progressing on the basis of this false scientific theory, is simply creating problems to be solved by the so-called scientists.

The author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* takes shelter of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to describe the pastimes of His appearance as a child because one cannot write such transcendental literature by mental speculation. One who writes about the Supreme Personality of Godhead must be especially favored by the Lord. Simply by academic qualifications it is not possible to write such literature.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya, jaya nityānanda

jayādvaitacandra, jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-caitanya*—to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Nityānanda Prabhu; *jaya advaitacandra*—all glories to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya*—all glories; *gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—to all the devotees of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu, Advaita Prabhu and all the devotees of Lord Caitanya!

TEXT 3

prabhura kahila ei janmalilā-sūtra

yaśodā-nandana yaiche haila śacī-putra

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *kahila*—I have spoken; *ei*—thus; *janma-lilā*—pastimes of the birth; *sūtra*—in summary; *yaśodā-nandana*—the son of mother Yaśodā; *yaiche*—as much as; *haila*—became; *śacī-putra*—the son of mother Śacī.

TRANSLATION

I have thus described in brief the advent of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who appeared as the son of mother Śacī exactly as Kṛṣṇa appeared as the son of mother Yaśodā.

PURPORT

Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura confirms this statement that now Lord Kṛṣṇa, the son of mother Yaśodā, has appeared again as Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, becoming the son of mother Śacī:

vrajendra-nandana yei, śacī-suta haila sei
balarāma ha-ila nitāi

“The son of Śacī is none other than the son of mother Yaśodā and Nanda Mahārāja, and Nityānanda Prabhu is the same Balarāma.”

TEXT 4

saṅkṣepe kahila janmalīlā-anukrama

ebe kahi bālyalīlā-sūtrera gaṇana

SYNONYMS

saṅkṣepe—in brief; *kahila*—I have spoken; *janma-līlā*—the pastimes of birth; *anukrama*—chronological order; *ebe*—now; *kahi*—I shall speak; *bālyalīlā*—of the pastimes of childhood; *sūtrera*—of the *sūtras*; *gaṇana*—enumeration.

TRANSLATION

I have already briefly spoken about the pastimes of His birth in chronological order. Now I shall give a synopsis of His childhood pastimes.

TEXT 5

vande caitanya-kṛṣṇasya

bālyalīlām mano-harām

laukikīm api tām īśa-

ceṣṭayā valitāntarām

SYNONYMS

vande—I worship; *caitanya-kṛṣṇasya*—of Lord Caitanya, who is Kṛṣṇa Himself; *bālyalīlā*—pastimes of childhood; *manoharām*—which are so beautiful; *laukikīm*—appearing ordinary; *api*—although; *tām*—those; *īśa-ceṣṭayā*—by manifestation of supreme authority; *valita-antarām*—quite fit although appearing differently.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the childhood pastimes of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself. Although such pastimes appear exactly like those of an ordinary child, they should be understood as various pastimes of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.11) this statement is confirmed as follows:

*avajānanti mām mūḍhā mānuṣīm tanum āśritam
param bhāvam ajānanto mama bhūta-maheśvaram*

“Fools deride Me when I descend in the human form. They do not know My transcendental nature and My supreme dominion over all that be.” To execute His pastimes, the Supreme Personality of Godhead appears on this planet or within this universe like an ordinary human being or human child, yet He maintains His superiority as the Supreme Lord. Lord Kṛṣṇa appeared as a human child, but His uncommon activities, even in His childhood—like the killing of the demon Pūtana or the lifting of Govardhana Hill—were not the engagements of an ordinary child. Similarly, although the pastimes of Lord Caitanya, as they will be described in this chapter, appear like the activities of a small boy, they are uncommon pastimes impossible for an ordinary human child to execute.

TEXT 6

bālya-līlāya āge prabhura uttāna śayana

pitā-mātāya dekhāila cihna caraṇa

SYNONYMS

bālya-līlāya—in His pastimes as a child; *āge*—first of all; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *uttāna*—turning the body; *śayana*—lying down; *pitā-mātāya*—unto the parents; *dekhāila*—showed; *cihna*—marks; *caraṇa*—of the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

In His first childhood pastimes the Lord turned upside down while lying on His bed, and thus He showed His parents the marks of His lotus feet.

PURPORT

The word *uttāna* is also used to mean “lying down on the bed face upwards” or “lying down flat on the bed.” In some readings the word is *utthāna*, which means “standing up.” In His childhood pastimes the Lord tried to catch the wall and stand up, but as an ordinary child falls down, so the Lord also fell down and again took to lying on His bed.

TEXT 7

gr̥he dui jana dekhi laghupada-cihna

tāhe śobhe dhvaja, vajra, śaṅkha, cakra, mīna

SYNONYMS

gr̥he—at home; *dui jana*—the father and mother; *dekhi*—seeing; *laghupada-cihna*—the marks of the lotus feet, which were very small at that time; *tāhe*—in those; *śobhe*—which were beautifully visible; *dhvaja*—flag; *vajra*—thunderbolts; *śaṅkha*—conchshell; *cakra*—disc; *mīna*—fish.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord tried to walk, in His small footprints the specific marks of Lord Viṣṇu were visible, namely the flag, thunderbolt, conchshell, disc

and fish.

TEXT 8

dekhiyā doñhāra citte janmila vismaya

kāra pada-cihna ghare, nā pāya niścaya

SYNONYMS

dekhiyā—seeing all these marks; *doñhāra*—of the parents, Śacīmātā and Jagannātha Miśra; *citte*—in their hearts; *janmila*—there was; *vismaya*—wonder; *kāra*—whose; *pada-cihna*—footprints; *ghare*—at home; *nā*—does not; *pāya*—get; *niścaya*—certainty.

TRANSLATION

Seeing all these marks, neither His father nor His mother could understand whose footprints they were. Thus struck with wonder, they could not understand how those marks could be possible in their home.

TEXT 9

miśra kahe, — — bālagopāla āche śilā-saṅge

tenho mūrti hañā ghare khele, jāni, raṅge

SYNONYMS

miśra kahe—Jagannātha Miśra said; *bāla-gopāla*—Lord Kṛṣṇa as a child; *āche*—there is; *śilā-saṅge*—along with the *śālagrāma-śilā*; *tenho*—He; *mūrti hañā*—taking His transcendental form; *ghare*—within the room; *khele*—plays; *jāni*—I understand; *raṅge*—in curiosity.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra said, “Certainly child Kṛṣṇa is with the śālagrāma-śilā. Taking His childhood form, He is playing within the room.”

PURPORT

When the form of the Lord is carved from wood, stone or any other element, it is to be understood that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is there. Even logically we can understand that all material elements are expansions of the energy of the Lord. Since the energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is nondifferent from His personal body, the Lord is always present in His energy, and He manifests Himself on account of the ardent desire of a devotee. Since the Lord is supremely powerful, it is logical that He can manifest Himself in His energy. Deity worship or worship of the *śālagrāma-śilā* is not idol worship. The Deity of the Lord in the house of a pure devotee can act exactly as He can in His original transcendental personality.

TEXT 10

sei kṣaṇe jāgi’ nimāi karaye krandana

aṅke lañā śacī tāṅre piyāila stana

SYNONYMS

sei kṣaṇe—immediately; *jāgi’*—awakening; *nimāi*—the Lord of the name Nimāi; *karaye*—does; *krandana*—crying; *aṅke*—on the lap; *lañā*—taking; *śacī*—mother Śacī; *tāṅre*—Him; *piyāila*—caused to suck; *stana*—breast.

TRANSLATION

While mother Śacī and Jagannātha Miśra were talking, child Nimāi woke up and began to cry, and mother Śacī took Him on her lap and allowed Him to suck her breast.

TEXT 11

stana piyāite putrera caraṇa dekhila

sei cihna pāye dekhi' miśre bolāila

SYNONYMS

stana—her breast; *piyāite*—while letting Him suck; *putrera*—of her son; *caraṇa*—lotus feet; *dekhila*—observed; *sei*—those very; *cihna*—marks; *pāye*—on the sole; *dekhi'*—seeing; *miśre*—Jagannātha Miśra; *bolāila*—called for.

TRANSLATION

While mother Śacī was feeding the child from her breast, she saw on His lotus feet all the marks that were visible on the floor of the room, and she called for Jagannātha Miśra.

TEXT 12

dekhiyā miśrera ha-ila ānandita mati

gupte bolāila nīlāmbara cakravartī

SYNONYMS

dekhiyā—by seeing; *miśrera*—of Jagannātha Miśra; *ha-ila*—became; *ānandita*—satisfied; *mati*—intelligence; *gupte*—privately; *bolāila*—called for; *nīlāmbara cakravartī*—Nīlāmbara Cakravartī.

TRANSLATION

When Jagannātha Miśra saw the wonderful marks on the sole of his son, he became very joyful and privately called for Nīlāmbara Cakravartī.

TEXT 13

cihna dekhi' cakravartī balena hāsiyā

lagna gaṇi' pūrve āmi rākhiyāchi likhiyā

SYNONYMS

cihna dekhi'—by seeing the marks; *cakravartī*—Nīlāmbara Cakravartī; *balena*—says; *hāsiyā*—smiling; *lagna gaṇi'*—by astrological calculation of the birth moment; *pūrve*—formerly; *āmi*—I; *rākhiyāchi*—have kept; *likhiyā*—after writing all these things.

TRANSLATION

When Nīlāmbara Cakravartī saw those marks, he smilingly said,
“Formerly I ascertained all this by astrological calculation and noted it in writing.

TEXT 14

batrīśa lakṣaṇa—mahāpuruṣa-bhūṣaṇa

ei śīśu aṅge dekhi se saba lakṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

batrīśa—thirty-two; *lakṣaṇa*—symptoms; *mahā-puruṣa*—great personality; *bhūṣaṇa*—ornament; *ei śīśu*—this child; *aṅge*—on the body; *dekhi*—I see; *se*—those; *saba*—all; *lakṣaṇa*—symptoms.

TRANSLATION

“There are thirty-two bodily marks that symptomize a great personality,
and I see all those marks on the body of this child.

TEXT 15

pañca-dīrghaḥ pañca-sūkṣmaḥ

sapta-raktaḥ ṣaḍ-unnataḥ

tri-hrasva-prthu-gambhīro

dvātrimśal-lakṣaṇo mahān

SYNONYMS

pañca-dīrghaḥ—five large; *pañca-sūkṣmaḥ*—five fine; *sapta-raktaḥ*—seven reddish; *ṣaḍ-unnataḥ*—six raised; *tri-hrasva*—three small; *prthu*—three broad; *gambhīraḥ*—three grave; *dvā-trimśat*—in this way thirty-two; *lakṣaṇaḥ*—symptoms; *mahān*—of a great personality.

TRANSLATION

“There are thirty-two bodily symptoms of a great personality: five of his bodily parts are large, five fine, seven reddish, six raised, three small, three broad and three grave.”

PURPORT

The five large parts are the nose, arms, chin, eyes and knees. The five fine parts are the skin, fingertips, teeth, hair on the body and hair on the head. The seven reddish parts are the eyes, soles, palms, palate, nails and upper and lower lips. The six raised parts are the chest, shoulders, nails, nose, waist and mouth. The three small parts are the neck, thighs and male organ. The three broad parts are the waist, forehead and chest. The three grave parts are the navel, voice and existence. Altogether these are the thirty-two symptoms of a great personality. This is a quotation from the *Sāmudrika*.

TEXT 16

nārāyaṇera cihna-yukta śrī-hasta caraṇa

ei śīśu sarva loka karibe tāraṇa

SYNONYMS

nārāyaṇera—of Lord Nārāyaṇa; *cihna-yukta*—with positive marks; *śrī-hasta caraṇa*—the palm and the sole; *ei*—this; *śīśu*—baby; *sarva loka*—all the three worlds; *karibe*—will; *tāraṇa*—deliver.

TRANSLATION

“This baby has all the symptoms of Lord Nārāyaṇa on His palms and soles. He will be able to deliver all the three worlds.

TEXT 17

ei ta' karibe vaiṣṇava-dharmera pracāra

ihā haite habe dui kulera nistāra

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—this child; *karibe*—will do; *vaiṣṇava*—of Vaiṣṇavism, or devotional service; *dharmera*—of the religion; *pracāra*—preaching; *ihā haite*—from this; *habe*—there will be; *dui*—two; *kulera*—dynasties; *nistāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

“This child will preach the Vaiṣṇava cult and deliver both His maternal and paternal families.

PURPORT

Only Nārāyaṇa Himself or His bona fide representative can preach the cult of Vaiṣṇavism, or devotional service. When a Vaiṣṇava is born, he delivers both his maternal and paternal families simultaneously.

TEXT 18

mahotsava kara, saba bolāha brāhmaṇa

āji dina bhāla, — — kariba nāma-karaṇa

SYNONYMS

mahotsava—a festival; *kara*—observe; *saba*—all; *bolāha*—call; *brāhmaṇa*—the *brāhmaṇas*; *āji*—today; *dina*—day; *bhāla*—auspicious; *kariba*—I shall perform; *nāma-karaṇa*—the name-giving ceremony.

TRANSLATION

“I propose to perform a name-giving ceremony. We should observe a festival and call for the *brāhmaṇas* because today is very auspicious.

PURPORT

It is a Vedic principle to observe a festival in connection with Nārāyaṇa and *brāhmaṇas*. Giving a child a particular name is among the purificatory processes known as *daśa-vidha-saṁskāra*, and on the day of such a ceremony one should observe a festival by worshiping Nārāyaṇa and distributing *prasādam*, chiefly among the *brāhmaṇas*.

When Nīlāmbara Cakravartī, Śacīmātā and Jagannātha Miśra understood from the marks on the Lord’s lotus feet that child Nimāi was not an ordinary child but an incarnation of Nārāyaṇa, they decided that on that very same day, which was very auspicious, they should observe a festival

for His name-giving ceremony. In this connection we can particularly see how an incarnation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is ascertained by His bodily symptoms, His activities and the prediction of the *śāstras*. By factual evidence a person can be accepted as an incarnation of God, not whimsically or by the votes of rascals and fools. There have been many imitation incarnations in Bengal since the appearance of Lord Caitanya, but any impartial devotee or learned man can understand that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was accepted as an incarnation of Kṛṣṇa not on the basis of popular votes but by evidence from the *śāstras* and bona fide scholars. It was not ordinary men who accepted Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. In the beginning His identity was ascertained by learned scholars like Nīlāmbara Cakravartī, and later all His activities were confirmed by the six Gosvāmīs, especially Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī and Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī, and many other learned scholars, with evidence from the *śāstra*. An incarnation of God is such from the very beginning of His life. It is not that by performing meditation one can become an incarnation of God all of a sudden. Such false incarnations are meant for fools and rascals, not sane men.

TEXT 19

sarva-lokera karibe ihañ dhāraṇa, poṣaṇa

‘viśvambhara’ nāma ihāra,——ei ta’ kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

sarva-lokera—of all people; *karibe*—will do; *ihañ*—this child; *dhāraṇa*—protection; *poṣaṇa*—maintenance; *viśvambhara*—the name Viśvambhara; *nāma*—name; *ihāra*—His; *ei*—this; *ta’*—certainly; *kāraṇa*—the reason.

TRANSLATION

“In the future this child will protect and maintain all the world. For this

reason He is to be called Viśvambhara.”

PURPORT

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* confirms that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by His birth, has made the whole world peaceful, as in the past Nārāyaṇa protected this earth in His incarnation as Varāha. Because of His protecting and maintaining this world in the present Kali-yuga, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is known as Viśvambhara, which refers to one who feeds the entire world. The movement inaugurated by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu when He was present five hundred years ago is again being propagated all over the world, and factually we are seeing its practical results. People are being saved, protected and maintained by this Hare Kṛṣṇa movement. Thousands of followers, especially Western youths, are taking part in this Hare Kṛṣṇa movement, and how safe and happy they feel can be understood from the expressions of gratitude in their hundreds and thousands of letters. The name Viśvambhara is also mentioned in the *Atharva-veda-saṁhitā* (3.3.16.5): *viśvambhara viśvena mā bharasā pāhi svāhā*.

TEXT 20

śuni’ śacī-miśrera mane ānanda bāḍila

brāhmaṇa-brāhmaṇī āni’ mahotsava kaila

SYNONYMS

śuni’—hearing this; *śacī*—of mother Śacī; *miśrera*—and of Jagannātha Miśra; *mane*—within the minds; *ānanda*—pleasure; *bāḍila*—increased; *brāhmaṇa*—the *brāhmaṇas*; *brāhmaṇī*—and their wives; *āni’*—inviting them; *mahotsava*—a festival; *kaila*—observed.

TRANSLATION

After hearing Nīlāmbara Cakravartī's prediction, Śacīmātā and Jagannātha Mīśra observed the name-giving festival in great joy, inviting all the brāhmaṇas and their wives.

PURPORT

It is the Vedic system to observe all kinds of festivals, including birthday festivals, marriage festivals, name-giving festivals and festivals marking the beginning of education, by especially inviting *brāhmaṇas*. In every festival the *brāhmaṇas* are to be fed first, and when the *brāhmaṇas* are pleased they bless the festival by chanting Vedic *mantras* or the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*.

TEXT 21

tabe kata dine prabhura jānu-caṅkramaṇa

nānā camatkāra tathā karāila darśana

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *kata*—some; *dine*—days; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *jānu*—knees; *caṅkramaṇa*—the crawling; *nānā*—various; *camatkāra*—wonderful; *tathā*—also; *karāila*—caused; *darśana*—the sight.

TRANSLATION

After some days the Lord began to crawl on His knees, and He caused various wonderful things to be seen.

PURPORT

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* describes that one day while the Lord was crawling upon His knees, the bells on His waist ringing very sweetly, a snake came out to crawl in the yard of the Lord, who captured the snake

like a curious child. Immediately the snake coiled over Him. The Lord as a child then rested on the snake, and after some time the snake went away, leaving the Lord aside.

TEXT 22

krandanera chale balāila hari-nāma

nārī saba ‘hari’ bale, — — hāse gaura-dhāma

SYNONYMS

krandanera—of crying; *chale*—on the pretense of; *balāila*—caused to speak; *hari-nāma*—the holy name of the Lord; *nārī*—ladies; *saba*—all; *‘hari’ bale*—chant the holy name of the Lord; *hāse*—laughs; *gaura-dhāma*—Lord Śrī Caitanya as a child.

TRANSLATION

The Lord caused all the ladies to chant the holy names of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra on the plea of His crying, and while they chanted the Lord would smile.

PURPORT

In the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* this pastime is described as follows: “The Lord, with His beautiful eyes, would cry, but He would stop immediately upon hearing the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. When the ladies, understanding the fun of the Lord, discovered that He would cry and then stop upon hearing the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, they all took it as a clue to chant Hare Kṛṣṇa as soon as the Lord cried. Thus it became a regular function. The Lord would cry, and the ladies would begin chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, clapping their hands. In this way all the ladies of the neighboring houses would assemble in the home of Śacīmātā to join in the *saṅkīrtana* movement twenty-four hours

a day. As long as the ladies continued to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, the Lord would not cry but would very pleasingly smile upon them.”

TEXT 23

tabe kata dine kaila pada-caṅkramaṇa

śīśu-gaṇe mili’ kaila vividha khelana

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *kata dine*—in a few days; *kaila*—did; *pada*—legs; *caṅkramaṇa*—movement; *śīśu-gaṇe*—all the children; *mili’*—mingling together; *kaila*—executed; *vividha*—varieties; *khelana*—sporting.

TRANSLATION

After some days the Lord began to move His legs and walk. He mixed with other children and exhibited various sports.

TEXT 24

ekadina śacī kha-i-sandeśa āniyā

bāṭā bhari’ diyā baila,——khāo ta’ basiyā

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *śacī*—mother Śacī; *kha-i*—fused rice; *sandeśa*—sweetmeat; *āniyā*—bringing; *bāṭā*—tiffin dish; *bhari’*—filling; *diyā*—delivering; *baila*—said; *khāo*—eat; *ta’*—now; *basiyā*—sitting down.

TRANSLATION

One day while the Lord was enjoying His playful sports with the other little children, mother Śacī brought a dish filled with fused rice and sweetmeats and asked the child to sit down and eat them.

TEXT 25

eta bali' gelā śacī gr̥he karma karite

lukāññā lāgilā śīśu mṛttikā khāite

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *gelā*—returned; *śacī*—mother Śacī; *gr̥he*—in the house; *karma*—duties; *karite*—to execute; *lukāññā*—hiding; *lāgilā*—began; *śīśu*—the child; *mṛttikā*—dirt; *khāite*—to eat.

TRANSLATION

But when she returned to her household duties, the child hid from His mother and began to eat dirt.

TEXT 26

dekhi' śacī dhāññā āilā kari' 'hāya, hāya'

māṭi kāḍi' laññā kahe 'māṭi kene khāya'

SYNONYMS

dekhi'—seeing this; *śacī*—mother Śacī; *dhāññā*—rushing; *āilā*—came back; *kari'*—making a noise; *hāya, hāya*—“What is this! What is this!”; *māṭi*—dirt; *kāḍi'*—snatching; *laññā*—taking; *kahe*—she said; *'māṭi kene khāya'*—why is the child eating dirt?

TRANSLATION

Seeing this, mother Śacī hastily returned and exclaimed, “What is this! What is this!” She snatched the dirt from the hands of the Lord and inquired why He was eating it.

TEXT 27

kāndiyā balena śīśu,——kene kara roṣa

tumi māṭi khāite dile, mora kibā doṣa

SYNONYMS

kāndiyā—while crying; *balena*—says; *śīśu*—the child; *kene*—why; *kara*—you become; *roṣa*—angry; *tumi*—you; *māṭi*—dirt; *khāite*—to eat; *dile*—gave Me; *mora*—My; *kibā*—what is; *doṣa*—fault.

TRANSLATION

Crying, the child inquired from His mother, “Why are you angry? You have already given Me dirt to eat. What is My fault?”

TEXT 28

kha-i-sandesa-anna yateka,——māṭira vikāra

eho māṭi, seha māṭi, ki bheda-vicāra

SYNONYMS

kha-i—fused rice; *sandesa*—sweetmeat; *anna*—eatables; *yateka*—all; *māṭira*—of dirt; *vikāra*—transformations; *eho*—this is also; *māṭi*—dirt; *seha*—that; *māṭi*—dirt; *ki*—what; *bheda*—of difference; *vicāra*—consideration.

TRANSLATION

“Fused rice, sweetmeats and all other eatables are but transformations of dirt. This is dirt, that is dirt. Please consider. What is the difference between them?

TEXT 29

māṭi—deha, māṭi—bhakṣya, dekhaha vicāri’

avicāre deha doṣa, ki balite pāri

SYNONYMS

māṭi—dirt; *deha*—this body; *māṭi*—dirt; *bhakṣya*—eatable; *dekhaha*—just try to see; *vicāri’*—by consideration; *avicāre*—without considering; *deha*—you put; *doṣa*—fault upon Me; *ki*—what; *balite*—to say; *pāri*—I am able.

TRANSLATION

“This body is a transformation of dirt, and the eatables are also a transformation of dirt. Please reflect upon this. You are blaming Me without consideration. What can I say?”

PURPORT

This is an explanation of the Māyāvāda philosophy, which takes everything to be one. The necessities of the body, namely eating, sleeping, mating and defending, are all unnecessary in spiritual life. When one is elevated to the spiritual platform, there are no more bodily necessities, and in activities pertaining to the bodily necessities there are no spiritual considerations. In other words, the more we eat, sleep, have sex and try to defend ourselves, the more we engage in material activities. Unfortunately, Māyāvādī philosophers consider devotional activities to be bodily activities. They cannot understand the simple explanation in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (14.26):

*mām ca yo 'vyabhicāreṇa bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guṇān samatītyaitān brahma-bhūyāya kalpate*

“Anyone who engages in spiritual devotional service without motivation, rendering such service for the satisfaction of the Lord, is elevated immediately to the spiritual platform, and all his activities are spiritual.”

Brahma-bhūyāya refers to Brahman (spiritual) activities. Although Māyāvādī philosophers are very eager to merge into the Brahman effulgence, they have no Brahman activities. To a certain extent they recommend Brahman activities, which for them means engagement in studying the Vedānta and Sāṅkhya philosophies, but their interpretations are but dry speculation. Lacking the varieties of spiritual activity, they cannot stay for long on that platform of simply studying Vedānta or Sāṅkhya philosophy.

Life is meant for varieties of enjoyment. The living entity is by nature full of an enjoying spirit, as stated in the *Vedānta-sūtra* (1.1.12): *ānanda-mayo 'bhyāsāt*. In devotional service the activities are variegated and full of enjoyment. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.2), all devotional activities are easy to perform (*su-sukhaṁ kartum*) and are eternal and spiritual (*avyayam*). Since Māyāvādī philosophers cannot understand this, they take it for granted that a devotee's activities (*śravaṇam kīrtanam viṣṇoḥ smaraṇam pāda-sevanam*, etc. [SB 7.5.23]) are all material and are therefore *māyā*. They also consider Kṛṣṇa's advent in this universe and His activities to be *māyā*. Therefore, because they consider everything *māyā*, they are known as Māyāvādīs.

Actually, any activities performed favorably for the satisfaction of the Lord, under the direction of the spiritual master, are spiritual. But for a person to disregard the order of the spiritual master and act by concoction, accepting his nonsensical activities to be spiritual, is *māyā*. One must achieve the favor of the Supreme Personality of Godhead through the mercy of the spiritual master. Therefore one must first please the spiritual master, and if he is pleased, then we should understand that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is also pleased. But if the spiritual

master is displeased by our actions, they are not spiritual. Śrīla Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura confirms this: *yasya prasādād bhagavat-prasādo yasyāprasādān na gatiḥ kuto 'pi ***. Activities that please the spiritual master must be considered spiritual, and they should be accepted as satisfying to the Lord.

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, as the supreme spiritual master, instructed His mother about the Māyāvāda philosophy. By saying that the body is dirt and eatables are also dirt, He implied that everything is *māyā*. This is Māyāvāda philosophy. The philosophy of the Māyāvādīs is defective because it maintains that everything is *māyā* but the nonsense they speak. While saying that everything is *māyā*, the Māyāvādī philosopher loses the opportunity of devotional service, and therefore his life is doomed. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu therefore advised, *māyāvādi-bhāṣya śunile haya sarva-nāśa* (Cc. *Madhya* 6.169). If one accepts the Māyāvāda philosophy, his advancement is doomed forever.

TEXT 30

antare vismita śacī balila tāhāre

“māṭi khāite jñāna-yoga ke śikhāla tore

SYNONYMS

antare—within herself; *vismita*—surprised; *śacī*—mother Śacī; *balila*—replied; *tāhāre*—unto Him; *māṭi*—dirt; *khāite*—to eat; *jñāna-yoga*—philosophical speculation; *ke*—who; *śikhāla*—taught; *tore*—You.

TRANSLATION

Astonished that the child was speaking Māyāvāda philosophy, mother Śacī replied, “Who has taught You this philosophical speculation that justifies eating dirt?”

PURPORT

In the philosophical discourse between the mother and the son, when the son said that everything is one, as impersonalists say, the mother replied, “If everything is one, why do people in general not eat dirt but eat the food grains produced from the dirt?”

TEXT 31

māṭira vikāra anna khāile deha-puṣṭi haya

māṭi khāile roga haya, deha yāya kṣaya

SYNONYMS

māṭira—of the dirt; *vikāra*—transformation; *anna*—food grains; *khāile*—by eating; *deha*—of the body; *puṣṭi*—nourishment; *haya*—becomes; *māṭi*—the dirt; *khāile*—by eating; *roga*—disease; *haya*—becomes; *deha*—the body; *yāya*—goes; *kṣaya*—to destruction.

TRANSLATION

Replying to the Māyāvāda idea of the child philosopher, mother Śacī said, “My dear boy, if we eat earth transformed into grain, our body is nourished, and it becomes strong. But if we eat dirt in its crude state, the body becomes diseased instead of nourished, and thus it is destroyed.

TEXT 32

māṭira vikāra ghaṭe pāni bhari’ āni

māṭi-piṇḍe dhari yabe, śoṣi’ yāya pāni”

SYNONYMS

māṭira—of the dirt; *vikāra*—transformation; *ghaṭe*—in the waterpot; *pāni*—water; *bhari'*—filling; *āni*—I can bring; *māṭi*—of dirt; *piṇḍe*—on the lump; *dhari*—I hold; *yabe*—when; *śoṣi'*—soaking; *yāya*—goes; *pāni*—the water.

TRANSLATION

“In a waterpot, which is a transformation of dirt, I can bring water very easily. But if I poured water on a lump of dirt, the lump would soak up the water, and my labor would be useless.”

PURPORT

This simple philosophy propounded by Śacīmātā, even though she is a woman, can defeat the Māyāvādī philosophers who speculate on oneness. The defect of Māyāvāda philosophy is that it does not accept the variety that is useful for practical purposes. Śacīmātā gave the example that although an earthen pot and a lump of dirt are basically one, for practical purposes the waterpot is useful whereas the lump of dirt is useless. Sometimes scientists argue that matter and spirit are one, with no difference between them. Factually, in a higher sense, there is no difference between matter and spirit, but one should have the practical knowledge that matter, being an inferior state of existence, is useless for our spiritual, blissful life, whereas spirit, being a finer state, is full of bliss. In this connection the *Bhāgavatam* gives the example that dirt and fire are practically one and the same. From the earth grow trees, and from their wood come fire and smoke. Nevertheless, for heat we can utilize the fire but not the earth, smoke or wood. Therefore, for the ultimate realization of the goal of life, we are concerned with the fire of the spirit, not the dull wood or earth of matter.

TEXT 33

ātma lukāite prabhu balilā tāñhāre

“āge kena ihā, mātā, nā śikhāle more

SYNONYMS

ātma—Himself; *lukāite*—to hide; *prabhu*—the Lord; *balilā*—replied; *tānhāre*—unto Śacīmātā; *āge*—in the beginning; *kena*—why; *ihā*—this; *mātā*—My dear mother; *nā śikhāle*—you didn’t teach; *more*—unto Me.

TRANSLATION

The Lord replied to His mother, “Why did you conceal self-realization by not teaching Me this practical philosophy in the beginning?”

PURPORT

If from the beginning of life one is taught the Vaiṣṇava philosophy of duality or variety, the monistic philosophy will not bother him very much. In reality, everything is an emanation from the supreme source (*janmādy asya yataḥ* [SB 1.1.1]). The original energy is exhibited in varieties, exactly as the sunshine, the original energy emanating from the sun, exhibits itself in variety as light and heat. One cannot say that light is heat or that heat is light, yet one cannot separate one from the other. Therefore Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s philosophy is *acintya-bhedābheda*, inconceivable nonseparation and distinction. Although there is an affinity between the two physical manifestations light and heat, there is also a difference between them. Similarly, although the whole cosmic manifestation is the Lord’s energy, the energy is nevertheless exhibited in varieties of manifestations.

TEXT 34

ebe se jānīlān, āra māṭi nā khāiba

kṣudhā lāge yabe, tabe tomāra stana piba”

SYNONYMS

ebe—now; *se*—that; *jānīlānī*—I understand; *āra*—more; *māṭi*—dirt; *nā*—not; *khāiba*—I shall eat; *kṣudhā*—hunger; *lāge*—arises; *yabe*—when; *tabe*—at that time; *tomāra*—your; *stana*—breast; *piba*—I shall suck.

TRANSLATION

“Now that I can understand this philosophy, no more shall I eat dirt. Whenever I am hungry I shall suck your breast and drink your breast milk.”

TEXT 35

eta bali’ jananīra kolete caḍiyā

stana pāna kare prabhu īṣat hāsiyā

SYNONYMS

eta bali’—saying this; *jananīra*—of the mother; *kolete*—on the lap; *caḍiyā*—rising; *stana pāna*—sucking the nipple; *kare*—does; *prabhu*—the Lord; *īṣat*—slightly; *hāsiyā*—smiling.

TRANSLATION

After saying this, the Lord, smiling slightly, climbed on the lap of His mother and sucked her breast.

TEXT 36

eimate nānā-chale aiśvarya dekhāya

bālya-bhāva prakāṣiyā paścāt lukāya

SYNONYMS

eimate—in this way; *nānā-chale*—under different excuses; *aiśvarya*—opulence; *dekhāya*—exhibits; *bālya-bhāva*—the status of a child; *prakaṭiyā*—manifesting; *paścāt*—thereafter; *lukāya*—hides Himself.

TRANSLATION

Thus under various excuses the Lord exhibited His opulences as much as possible in His childhood, and later, after exhibiting such opulences, He hid Himself.

TEXT 37

atithi-viprera anna khāila tina-bāra

pāche gupte sei vipre karila nistāra

SYNONYMS

atithi—guest; *viprera*—of a *brāhmaṇa*; *anna*—food; *khāila*—ate; *tina-bāra*—thrice; *pāche*—afterwards; *gupte*—in privacy; *sei*—that; *vipre*—unto the *brāhmaṇa*; *karila*—made; *nistāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

On one occasion the Lord ate the food of a *brāhmaṇa* guest three times, and later, in confidence, the Lord delivered that *brāhmaṇa* from material engagement.

PURPORT

The story of the deliverance of this *brāhmaṇa* is as follows. A *brāhmaṇa* who was touring all over the country, traveling from one place of pilgrimage to another, reached Navadvīpa and became a guest in the

house of Jagannātha Miśra. Jagannātha Miśra gave him all ingredients for cooking, and the *brāhmaṇa* prepared his food. When the *brāhmaṇa* was offering the food to Lord Viṣṇu in meditation, child Nimāi came before him and began to eat it, and because of this the *brāhmaṇa* thought the whole offering had been spoiled. Therefore by the request of Jagannātha Miśra he cooked for a second time, but when he was meditating the child again came before him and began to eat the food, again spoiling the offering. By the request of Jagannātha Miśra the *brāhmaṇa* cooked for a third time, but for a third time the Lord came before him and began to eat the food, although the child had been locked within a room and everyone was sleeping because it was late at night. Thus, thinking that on that day Lord Viṣṇu was not willing to accept his food and that he was therefore ordained to fast, the *brāhmaṇa* became greatly agitated and cried aloud, *hāya hāya*: “What has been done! What has been done!” When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu saw the *brāhmaṇa* in that agitated state, He told him, “Formerly I was the son of mother Yaśodā. At that time also you became a guest in the house of Nanda Mahārāja, and I disturbed you in this way. I am very much pleased by your devotion. Therefore I am eating the food you have prepared.” Understanding the favor offered to him by the Lord, the *brāhmaṇa* was greatly pleased, and he was overwhelmed with love of Kṛṣṇa. He was thankful to the Lord, for he felt himself greatly fortunate. Then the Lord asked the *brāhmaṇa* not to disclose the incident to anyone else. This pastime is very elaborately explained in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Three.

TEXT 38

core lañā gela prabhuke bāhire pāiyā

tāra skandhe caḍi’ āilā tāre bhulāiyā

SYNONYMS

core—two thieves; *lañā*—taking; *gela*—went; *prabhuke*—the Lord; *bāhire*—outside; *pāiyā*—finding Him; *tāra*—their; *skandhe*—on the

shoulders; *caḍi'*—rising; *āilā*—came back; *tāre*—them; *bhulāiyā*—misleading.

TRANSLATION

In His childhood the Lord was taken away by two thieves outside His home. The Lord, however, got up on the shoulders of the thieves, and while they were thinking they were safely carrying the child to rob His ornaments, the Lord misled them, and thus instead of going to their own home the thieves came back to the home of Jagannātha Miśra.

PURPORT

In His childhood the Lord was profusely decorated with gold ornaments. Once upon a time, when the Lord was playing outside His house, two thieves passing on the street saw the opportunity to rob Him. Therefore they took Him on their shoulders, pleasing Him by offering Him some sweetmeats. The thieves thought they would carry the child to the forest and then kill Him and take away the ornaments. The Lord, however, expanded His illusory energy upon the thieves, so much so that instead of carrying Him to the forest they came right back in front of His house. When they came before His house they became afraid because everyone from the house of Jagannātha Miśra and all the inhabitants of that quarter were busy searching for the child. Therefore the thieves, thinking it dangerous to remain, went away and left Him. The child was brought within the house and given to mother Śacī, who was in great anxiety, and she became satisfied. This incident is also very elaborately explained in the *Ādi-khaṇḍaof Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Third Chapter.

TEXT 39

vyādhi-chale jagadīśa-hiraṇya-sadane

viṣṇu-naivedya khāila ekādaśī-dine

SYNONYMS

vyādhi-chale—on the plea of being diseased; *jagadīśa-hiraṇya*—of the names Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya; *sadane*—in the house of; *viṣṇu-naivedya*—food offered to Lord Viṣṇu; *khāila*—ate; *ekādaśī*—of Ekādaśī; *dine*—on the day.

TRANSLATION

Pretending to be sick, the Lord asked some food from the house of Hiraṇya and Jagadīśa on the Ekādaśī day.

PURPORT

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Six, fully describes the Lord's accepting *viṣṇu-prasādam* on the Ekādaśī day at the house of Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya. Regular *prasādam* is offered to Lord Viṣṇu on Ekādaśī because although fasting is recommended for devotees on Ekādaśī, it is not recommended for Lord Viṣṇu. Once on Ekādaśī in the house of Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya Paṇḍita there were arrangements for preparing special *prasādam* for Lord Viṣṇu, and Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu asked His father to go there to ask for the *viṣṇu-prasādam* because He was feeling sick. The house of Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya Paṇḍita was situated about two miles from the house of Jagannātha Miśra. Therefore when Jagannātha Miśra, on the request of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, came to ask Jagadīśa and Hiraṇya for the *prasādam*, they were a little astonished. How could the boy understand that special *prasādam* was being prepared for Lord Viṣṇu? They immediately concluded that Nimāi must have supernatural mystic power. Otherwise how could He understand that they were preparing special *prasādam*? Therefore they immediately sent the food to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu through His father, Jagannātha Miśra. Nimāi was feeling sick, but immediately after eating the *viṣṇu-prasādam* He was cured, and He also distributed the *prasādam* among His playmates.

TEXT 40

śíśu saba laye pāḍā-paḍasīra ghare

curi kari' dravya khāya māre bālakere

SYNONYMS

śíśu—children; *saba*—all; *laye*—taking with Him; *pāḍā-paḍasīra*—neighboring; *ghare*—in the houses; *curi kari'*—stealing; *dravya*—eatables; *khāya*—eats; *māre*—fights; *bālakere*—with other children.

TRANSLATION

As usual for small children, He learned to play, and with His playmates He went to the houses of neighboring friends, stealing their eatables and eating them. Sometimes the children fought among themselves.

TEXT 41

śíśu saba śacī-sthāne kaila nivedana

śuni' śacī putre kichu dilā olāhana

SYNONYMS

śíśu saba—all the children; *śacī-sthāne*—in the presence of mother Śacī; *kaila*—made; *nivedana*—petition; *śuni'*—hearing that; *śacī*—mother Śacī; *putre*—unto her son; *kichu*—some; *dilā*—gave; *olāhana*—chastisement or rebuke.

TRANSLATION

All the children lodged complaints with Śacīmātā about the Lord's fighting with them and stealing from the neighbors' houses. Therefore

sometimes she used to chastise or rebuke her son.

TEXT 42

“kene curi kara, kene mārāha śísūre

kene para-ghare yāha, kibā nāhi ghare”

SYNONYMS

kene curi kara—why do You steal; *kene mārāha śísūre*—why do You beat other children; *kene*—why; *para-ghare*—in others’ houses; *yāha*—You go; *kibā*—what; *nāhi*—is not there; *ghare*—in Your own house.

TRANSLATION

Śacīmātā said, “Why do You steal others’ things? Why do You beat the other children? And why do You go inside others’ houses? What do You not have in Your own house?”

PURPORT

According to the *Vedānta-sūtra* (*janmādy asya yataḥ* [SB 1.1.1]), since creation, maintenance and annihilation exist in the Supreme Absolute, whatever we find within this material world is already in the spiritual world. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa Himself. How is He stealing, and how is He fighting? It is not as a thief or an enemy but as a friend in a loving condition. He steals as a child not because He is in want but out of a natural instinct. In this material world also, small children, without enmity or bad will, sometimes go to a neighboring house and steal, and sometimes they fight. Kṛṣṇa also, like other children, did all these things in His childhood. Without the existence of the stealing propensity and fighting propensity in the spiritual world, they cannot exist here in this material world. The difference between the material and spiritual worlds is that stealing in the

spiritual world is done in friendship and love, whereas fighting and stealing within this material world are executed on the basis of enmity and envy. Therefore we should understand that in the spiritual world all these activities exist, but there is no inebriety, whereas in the material world all activities are full of miserable conditions.

TEXT 43

śuni' kruddha hañā prabhu ghara-bhitara yāñā

ghare yata bhāṇḍa chila, phelila bhāṅgiyā

SYNONYMS

śuni'—hearing; *kruddha*—angry; *hañā*—becoming; *prabhu*—the Lord; *ghara-bhitara*—within the room; *yāñā*—going; *ghare*—in the room; *yata*—all; *bhāṇḍa*—pots; *chila*—there were; *phelila*—He threw them; *bhāṅgiyā*—breaking.

TRANSLATION

Thus rebuked by His mother, he Lord would go in anger to a room and break all the pots within it.

TEXT 44

tabe śacī kole kari' karāila santoṣa

lajjita ha-ilā prabhu jāni' nija-doṣa

SYNONYMS

tabe—at that time; *śacī*—mother Śacīdevī; *kole*—on the lap; *kari'*—taking; *karāila*—made; *santoṣa*—pacified; *lajjita*—ashamed; *ha-ilā*—became; *prabhu*—the Lord; *jāni'*—knowing; *nija*—His own; *doṣa*—

fault.

TRANSLATION

Then Śacīmātā would take her son on her lap and pacify Him, and the Lord would be very much ashamed, admitting His faults.

PURPORT

There is a nice description of the faults of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu in His childhood in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Three, where it is said that as a child the Lord used to steal all kinds of eatables from the houses of neighboring friends. In some houses He would steal milk and drink it, and in others He would steal and eat prepared rice. Sometimes He would break cooking pots. If there were nothing to eat but there were small babies, the Lord would tease the babies and make them cry. Sometimes a neighbor would complain to Śacīmātā, “My child is very small, but your child puts water in his ears and makes him cry.”

TEXT 45

kabhu mṛdu-haste kaila mātāke tāḍana

mātāke mūrcchitā dekhi’ karaye krandana

SYNONYMS

kabhu—sometimes; *mṛdu-haste*—by His soft hand; *kaila*—did; *mātāke*—His mother; *tāḍana*—chastise; *mātāke*—His mother; *mūrcchitā*—fainted; *dekhi’*—seeing; *karaye*—was; *krandana*—crying.

TRANSLATION

Once the child, Caitanya Mahāprabhu, chastised His mother with His soft hand, and His mother pretended to faint. Seeing this, the Lord began

to cry.

TEXT 46

nārīgaṇa kahe,——“nārikela deha āni’

tabe sustha ha-ibena tomāra janani’

SYNONYMS

nārī-gaṇa—all the ladies; *kahe*—say; *nārikela*—coconut; *deha*—give; *āni’*—bringing from somewhere; *tabe*—then; *sustha ha-ibena*—will be cured; *tomāra*—Your; *janani*—mother.

TRANSLATION

The neighboring ladies told Him, “Dear child, please bring a coconut from somewhere, and then Your mother will be cured.”

TEXT 47

bāhire yāñā ānilena dui nārikela

dekhiyā apūrva haila vismita sakala

SYNONYMS

bāhire—outside; *yāñā*—going; *ānilena*—He immediately brought; *dui*—two; *nārikela*—coconuts; *dekhiyā*—seeing; *apūrva*—this wonder; *haila*—became; *vismita*—astonished; *sakala*—all.

TRANSLATION

He then went outside the house and immediately brought two coconuts. All the ladies were astonished to see such wonderful activities.

TEXT 48

kabhū śíśu-saṅge snāna karīla gaṅgāte

kanyāgaṇa āilā tāhāñ devatā pūjite

SYNONYMS

kabhū—sometimes; *śíśu-saṅge*—along with other children; *snāna*—bathing; *karīla*—did; *gaṅgāte*—in the Ganges; *kanyā-gaṇa*—the girls; *āilā*—came there; *tāhāñ*—on the bank of the Ganges; *devatā*—demigods; *pūjite*—to worship.

TRANSLATION

Sometimes the Lord would go with other children to bathe in the Ganges, and the neighboring girls would also come there to worship various demigods.

PURPORT

According to the Vedic system, when small girls ten or twelve years old would go to the bank of the Ganges to take their bath, they would especially worship Lord Śiva with prayers to get good husbands in the future. They especially wanted to get a husband like Lord Śiva because Lord Śiva is very peaceful and at the same time most powerful. Formerly, therefore, small girls in Hindu families would worship Lord Śiva, especially in the month of Vaiśākha (April–May). To take a bath in the Ganges is a great pleasure for everyone, not only for adults but for children also.

TEXT 49

gaṅgā-snāna kari' pūjā karite lāgilā

kanyāgaṇa-madhye prabhu āsiyā basilā

SYNONYMS

gaṅgā-snāna—bath in the Ganges; *kari'*—having taken; *pūjā*—worship; *karite*—to do; *lāgilā*—began; *kanyā-gaṇa*—the girls; *madhye*—in the midst of; *prabhu*—the Lord; *āsiyā*—coming there; *basilā*—sat down.

TRANSLATION

When the girls engaged in worshipping the different demigods after bathing in the Ganges, the young Lord would come there and sit down among them.

TEXT 50

kanyāre kahe,——āmā pūja, āmi diba vara

gaṅgā-durgā,——dāsī mora, maheśa,——kiṅkara

SYNONYMS

kanyāre kahe—addressing the girls, the Lord would say; *āmā pūja*—“Worship Me”; *āmi*—I; *diba*—shall give; *vara*—nice husband; *gaṅgā*—the Ganges; *durgā*—goddess Durgā; *dāsī*—maidservants; *mora*—My; *maheśa*—Lord Śiva; *kiṅkara*—servant.

TRANSLATION

Addressing the girls, the Lord would say, “Worship Me, and I shall give you good husbands or good benedictions. The Ganges and goddess Durgā are My maidservants. What to speak of other demigods, even Lord Śiva is My servant.”

PURPORT

There is a misconception about the Hindu religion among people who profess other religions, such as Christians and Muslims, who say that in the Hindu religion there are many Gods. Actually that is not a fact. God is one, but there are many other powerful living entities who are in charge of different departments of administration. They are called demigods. All the demigods are servants who carry out the orders of the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu disclosed this fact in His childhood. Out of ignorance, sometimes people worship the demigods to receive some particular boon, but actually, one who becomes a devotee and worshiper of the Supreme Personality of Godhead does not need to go to the demigods for any benediction because he obtains everything by the grace of the Supreme Lord. The *Bhagavad-gītā* (7.20, 28) therefore condemns such demigod worship:

*kāmais tais tair hṛta-jñānāḥ prapadyante 'nya-devatāḥ
taṁ taṁ niyamam āsthāya prakṛtyā niyatāḥ svayā*

“Only persons whose intelligence is lost and who are mad with lusty desires worship the demigods and follow the particular rules and regulations of worship according to their own natures.”

*yeṣāṁ tv anta-gataṁ pāpaṁ janānāṁ puṇya-karmaṇām
te dvandva-moha-nirmuktā bhajante mām dṛḍha-vratāḥ*

“But persons who are freed from all sinful activities and the duality of delusion engage themselves in the worship of the Supreme Personality of Godhead with determination.” Only the less intelligent worship the demigods for their various purposes. The most intelligent worship only the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa.

Sometimes we, the members of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, are accused of not approving of the worship of demigods. But how can we approve of this when it is condemned by Lord Caitanya and Lord Kṛṣṇa? How can we allow people to become foolish and *hṛta-jñāna*, bereft of intelligence? Our propaganda is simply meant to enable intelligent people

to understand the distinction between matter and spirit and understand the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is the whole spiritual identity. That is our mission. How could we mislead people into worshipping so-called gods in material bodies within this material world?

Our position of not allowing worship of the many hundreds of demigods was confirmed by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu even in His childhood. Śrīla Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura has sung in this connection:

*anya devāśraya nāi tomāre kahinu bhāi
ei bhakti parama-kāraṇa*

“To become a staunch, pure devotee of the Supreme Personality of Godhead without deviation [*ananya-bhāṅk*], one should not divert his attention to the worship of the demigods. Such control is a symptom of pure devotional service.”

TEXT 51

*āpani candana pari' parena phula-mālā
naivedya kāḍiyā khā'na—sandeśa, cāla, kalā*

SYNONYMS

āpani—Himself; *candana*—pulp of sandalwood; *pari'*—smearing over the body; *parena*—takes; *phula-mālā*—the flower garlands; *naivedya*—offering of food; *kāḍiyā*—snatching; *khā'na*—begins to eat; *sandeśa*—the sweetmeats; *cāla*—rice; *kalā*—bananas.

TRANSLATION

Without the permission of the girls, the Lord would take the sandalwood pulp and smear it on His own body, put the flower garlands on His neck, and snatch and eat all the offerings of sweetmeats, rice and bananas.

PURPORT

According to the system of worship, when something is offered to deities outside one's home, it is generally not cooked food but raw rice, bananas and sweetmeats. Out of His causeless mercy, the Lord would snatch the offerings from the girls and eat them, admonishing the girls not to worship the demigods but to worship Him. This worship of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is recommended in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*:

*kṛṣṇa-varṇam tviṣākṛṣṇam sāṅgopāṅgāstra-pārṣadam
yajñaiḥ saṅkīrtana-prāyair yajanti hi su-medhasaḥ*
[SB 11.5.32]

“One should worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead who appears in this Age of Kali with His associates as the Pañca-tattva: the Lord Himself and His associates Nityānanda Prabhu, Śrī Advaita Prabhu, Śrī Gadādhara Prabhu and Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura. In this age an intelligent person worships the Pañca-tattva by the method of chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* and, if possible, distributing *prasādam*.” Our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is introducing this bona fide method of worship in the Western world. Its members are going from village to village and town to town with Deities of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, teaching people how to worship the Lord by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, offering *prasādam* and distributing *prasādam* to people in general.

TEXT 52

*krodhe kanyāgaṇa kahe—śuna, he nimāñi
grāma-sambandhe hao tumi āmā sabāra bhāi*

SYNONYMS

krodhe—in anger; *kanyā-gaṇa*—all the girls; *kahe*—said; *śuna*—hear; *he*—O; *nimāñi*—Nimāi; *grāma*—village; *sambandhe*—in relationship;

hao—are; *tumi*—You; *āmā*—of us; *sabāra*—everyone; *bhāi*—the brother.

TRANSLATION

All the girls became very angry at the Lord for this behavior. “Dear Nimāi,” they told Him, “You are just like our brother in our village relationship.

TEXT 53

āmā sabākāra pakṣe ihā karite nā yuyāya

nā laha devatā sajja, nā kara anyāya

SYNONYMS

āmā sabākāra—of all of us; *pakṣe*—on the behalf; *ihā*—this; *karite*—to do; *nā*—not; *yuyāya*—is suitable; *nā*—don’t; *laha*—take; *devatā*—demigods; *sajja*—worshipable paraphernalia; *nā*—don’t; *kara*—do; *anyāya*—mischief.

TRANSLATION

“Therefore it does not behoove You to act like this. Don’t take our paraphernalia for worship of the demigods. Don’t create a disturbance in this way.”

TEXT 54

prabhu kahe, — — “tomā sabāke dila ei vara

tomā sabāra bhartā habe parama sundara

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord replied; *tomā*—you; *sabāke*—to all; *dila*—I give; *ei*—this; *vara*—benediction; *tomā sabāra*—of all of you; *bhartā*—the husbands; *habe*—will be; *parama*—very; *sundara*—beautiful.

TRANSLATION

The Lord replied, “My dear sisters, I give you the benediction that your husbands will be very handsome.

TEXT 55

paṇḍita, vidagdha, yuvā, dhana-dhānyavān

sāta sāta putra habe—cirāyu, matimān”

SYNONYMS

paṇḍita—learned; *vidagdha*—expert and humorous; *yuvā*—young man; *dhana-dhānyavān*—very rich, possessing wealth and rice; *sāta sāta*—seven each; *putra*—sons; *habe*—you will have; *cirāyu*—born with a long life; *matimān*—and intelligent.

TRANSLATION

“They will be learned, clever and young and possess abundant wealth and rice. Not only that, but you will each have seven sons, who will all live long lives and be very intelligent.”

PURPORT

Generally it is the ambition of a young girl to have a very handsome husband who is learned, clever, young and rich. According to the Vedic culture, one is rich if he possesses a large stock of food grain and a very large number of animals. *Dhānyena dhanavān gavayā dhanavān*: one is rich if he possesses food grain, cows and bulls. A girl also desires to have

many children, especially sons (*putra*) who are very intelligent and long-lived. Now because society has deteriorated there is propaganda to have one or two children and kill the rest by contraceptive methods. But the natural ambition of a girl is to possess not only more than one child but at least half a dozen.

In exchange for the paraphernalia of worship He usurped for Himself, Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted to bless the girls to fulfill all their ambitions and desires. One can easily become happy and obtain the material benefits of a good husband, wealth, food grain and a number of nice children by worshiping Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Although Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted *sannyāsa* at an early age, it is not necessary for His devotees to follow Him by also taking *sannyāsa*. One can stay a householder, but one must be a devotee of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Then one will be happy, with all the material opulences of a good home, good children, good mate, good wealth and everything he desires. Therefore the *śāstras* advise, *yajñaiḥ saṅkīrtana-prāyair yajanti hi su-medhasaḥ* [SB 11.5.32]. Every householder, therefore, who is actually intelligent should introduce the *saṅkīrtana* movement home to home and live peacefully in this life and go back to Godhead in the next.

TEXT 56

vara śuni' kanyā-gaṇera antare santoṣa

bāhire bhartsana kare kari' mithyā roṣa

SYNONYMS

vara śuni'—hearing the benediction; *kanyā-gaṇera*—of the girls; *antare*—within; *santoṣa*—very much satisfaction; *bāhire*—externally; *bhartsana*—rebuking; *kare*—they do; *kari'*—making; *mithyā*—false; *roṣa*—anger.

TRANSLATION

Hearing this benediction from Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, all the girls were inwardly very happy, but externally, as is natural for girls, they rebuked the Lord under the pretense of anger.

PURPORT

This double-dealing is natural for girls. When they are satisfied within, they externally show dissatisfaction. Such feminine dealings are very palatable to boys who try to make friendships with them.

TEXT 57

kona kanyā palāila naivedya la-iyā

tāre ḍāki' kahe prabhu sakrodha ha-iyā

SYNONYMS

kona kanyā—some of the girls; *palāila*—fled; *naivedya*—the plate of worshipable things; *la-iyā*—taking away; *tāre*—unto them; *ḍāki'*—calling; *kahe*—says; *prabhu*—the Lord; *sakrodha*—angry; *ha-iyā*—becoming.

TRANSLATION

When some of the girls fled, the Lord called them in anger and advised them as follows:

TEXT 58

yadi naivedya nā deha ha-iyā kṛpaṇī

buḍā bhartā habe, āra cāri cāri satinī

SYNONYMS

yadi—if; *naivedya*—offering; *nā*—do not; *deha*—give Me; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *kṛpaṇī*—miser; *buḍā*—old; *bhartā*—husband; *habe*—will have; *āra*—and; *cāri*—four; *cāri*—four; *satinī*—co-wives.

TRANSLATION

“If you are miserly and do not give Me the offerings, every one of you will have an old husband with at least four co-wives.”

PURPORT

In India in those days and even until fifty years ago, polygamy was freely allowed. Any man, especially of the higher castes—the *brāhmaṇas*, the *vaiśyas* and particularly the *kṣatriyas*—could marry more than one wife. In the *Mahābhārata*, or the old history of India, we see that *kṣatriya* kings especially used to marry many wives. According to Vedic civilization there was no restriction against this, and even a man more than fifty years old could marry. But to be married to a man who had many wives was not a very pleasing situation because the husband’s love would be divided among his many wives. To punish the girls unwilling to offer Him the *naivedya*, Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu apparently wanted to curse them to be married to men who had at least four wives.

The social structure allowing a man to marry more than one wife can be supported in this way. Generally in every society the female population is greater in number than the male population. Therefore if it is a principle in the society that all girls should be married, unless polygamy is allowed it will not be possible. If all the girls are not married there is a good chance of adultery, and a society in which adultery is allowed cannot be very peaceful or pure. In our Kṛṣṇa consciousness society we have restricted illicit sex. The practical difficulty is to find a husband for each and every girl. We are therefore in favor of polygamy, provided, of course, that the husband is able to maintain more than one wife.

TEXT 59

ihā śuni' tā-sabāra mane ha-ila bhaya

kona kichu jāne, kibā devāviṣṭa haya

SYNONYMS

ihā śuni'—hearing this; *tā-sabāra*—of all the girls; *mane*—in the minds; *ha-ila*—became; *bhaya*—fear; *kona kichu*—something uncommon; *jāne*—He knows; *kibā*—what if; *deva-āviṣṭa*—empowered by demigods; *haya*—He is.

TRANSLATION

Hearing this supposed curse by Lord Caitanya, the girls, considering that He might know something uncommon or be empowered by demigods, were afraid that His curse might be effective.

TEXT 60

āniyā naivedya tārā sammukhe dharila

khāiyā naivedya tāre iṣṭa-vara dila

SYNONYMS

āniyā—bringing; *naivedya*—offering; *tārā*—all of them; *sammukhe*—in front; *dharila*—held; *khāiyā*—eating; *naivedya*—offering; *tāre*—them; *iṣṭa-vara*—desired benediction; *dila*—gave.

TRANSLATION

The girls then brought the offerings before the Lord, who ate them all and blessed the girls to their satisfaction.

TEXT 61

ei mata cāpalya saba lokere dekhāya

duḥkha kāro mane nahe, sabe sukha pāya

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *cāpalya*—cunning behavior; *saba lokere*—unto the people in general; *dekhāya*—exhibits; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *kāro*—distress; *mane*—in the mind; *nahe*—there is no such thing; *sabe*—everyone; *sukha*—happiness; *pāya*—enjoys.

TRANSLATION

When this cunning behavior of the Lord with the girls became known to the people in general, it did not create misunderstandings among them. Rather, they enjoyed happiness in these dealings.

TEXT 62

eka-dina vallabhācārya-kanyā 'lakṣmī' nāma

devatā pūjite āila kari gaṅgā-snāna

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *vallabhācārya-kanyā*—the daughter of Vallabhācārya; *lakṣmī*—Lakṣmī; *nāma*—named; *devatā*—demigods; *pūjite*—to worship; *āila*—came; *kari*—taking; *gaṅgā-snāna*—bath in the Ganges.

TRANSLATION

One day a girl of the name Lakṣmī, the daughter of Vallabhācārya, came to the bank of the Ganges to take a bath in the river and worship the demigods.

PURPORT

According to the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (45), Lakṣmī was formerly Jānakī, the wife of Lord Rāmacandra, and Rukmiṇī, the wife of Lord Kṛṣṇa in Dvārakā. The same goddess of fortune descended as Lakṣmī to become the wife of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 63

tāñre dekhi' prabhura ha-ila sābhilāṣa mana

lakṣmī citte prīta pāila prabhura darśana

SYNONYMS

tāñre dekhi'—seeing her; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *ha-ila*—there was; *sa*—her; *abhilāṣa*—attachment; *mana*—mind; *lakṣmī*—Lakṣmī also; *citte*—in the heart; *prīta*—satisfaction; *pāila*—attained; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *darśana*—meeting.

TRANSLATION

Seeing Lakṣmīdevī, the Lord became attached to her, and Lakṣmī, upon seeing the Lord, felt great satisfaction within her mind.

TEXT 64

sāhajika prīti duñhāra karila udaya

bālya-bhāvācchanna tabhu ha-ila niścaya

SYNONYMS

sāhajika—natural; *prīti*—affection; *duñhāra*—both of them; *karila*—made; *udaya*—appearance; *bālya*—childhood; *bhāva-ācchanna*—covered

by emotion; *tabhu*—still; *ha-ila*—it so became; *nīścaya*—fixed up.

TRANSLATION

Their natural love for each other awakened, and although it was covered by childhood emotions, it became apparent that they were mutually attracted.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Lakṣmīdevī are eternal husband and wife. Therefore it was quite natural for their dormant love to awaken when they saw each other. Their natural feelings were immediately awakened by their meeting.

TEXT 65

duñhā dekhi' duñhāra citte ha-ila ullāsa

deva-pūjā chale kaila duñhe parakāśa

SYNONYMS

duñhā—both of them; *dekhi'*—seeing; *duñhāra*—of both of them; *citte*—in the minds; *ha-ila*—there was; *ullāsa*—pleasure; *deva-pūjā*—worshiping the demigods; *chale*—on the plea of; *kaila*—there was; *duñhe*—both of them; *parakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

They both enjoyed natural pleasure in seeing each other, and under the pretext of demigod worship they manifested their feelings.

TEXT 66

prabhu kahe, ‘āmā’ pūja, āmi maheśvara

āmāre pūjile pābe abhīpsita vara’

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord said; *āmā’ pūja*—just worship Me; *āmi*—I am; *maheśvara*—the Supreme Lord; *āmāre*—unto Me; *pūjile*—if you worship; *pābe*—you will get; *abhīpsita*—desired; *vara*—benediction.

TRANSLATION

The Lord told Lakṣmī, “Just worship Me, for I am the Supreme Lord. If you worship Me, certainly you will get the benediction you desire.”

PURPORT

This is the same philosophy declared by Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself:

*sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja
ahaṁ tvāṁ sarva-pāpebhyo mokṣayiṣyāmi mā śucaḥ*

“Abandon all varieties of religion and just surrender unto Me. I shall deliver you from all sinful reaction. Do not fear.” (Bg. 18.66) People do not understand this. They are accustomed to flattering or worshiping many demigods, human beings, or even cats and dogs, but when requested to worship the Supreme Lord, they refuse. This is called illusion. Factually, if one worships the Supreme Lord there is no need to worship anyone else. For example, in a village of a limited area one may use different wells for different purposes, but when one goes to a river where there is water constantly flowing in waves, that water can serve all his purposes. When there is a river, one can take drinking water, wash his clothes, bathe and so on, for that water will serve all purposes. Similarly, if one worships the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, all his goals will be achieved. *Kāmais tais tair hr̥ta-jñānāḥ prapadyante ’nya-devatāḥ:*

only men who have lost their intelligence worship the various demigods to fulfill their desires (Bg. 7.20).

TEXT 67

lakṣmī tāñra aṅge dila puṣpa-candana

mallikāra mālā diyā karila vandana

SYNONYMS

lakṣmī—Lakṣmīdevī; *tāñra*—His; *aṅge*—on the body; *dila*—gave; *puṣpa*—flowers; *candana*—sandalwood pulp; *mallikāra*—of the flower of the name *mallikā*; *mālā*—garland; *diyā*—giving; *karila*—offered; *vandana*—prayers.

TRANSLATION

On hearing the order of the Supreme Lord, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Lakṣmī immediately worshiped Him, offering sandalwood pulp and flowers for His body, garlanding Him with mallikā flowers, and offering prayers.

TEXT 68

prabhu tāñra pūjā pāñā hāsite lāgilā

śloka paḍi' tāñra bhāva aṅgikāra kailā

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *tāñra*—her; *pūjā*—worship; *pāñā*—receiving; *hāsite*—to smile; *lāgilā*—began; *śloka paḍi'*—reciting one verse; *tāñra*—her; *bhāva*—emotion; *aṅgikāra kailā*—accepted.

TRANSLATION

Being worshiped by Lakṣmī, the Lord began to smile. He recited a verse from Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam and thus accepted the emotion she expressed.

PURPORT

The verse quoted in this connection is the twenty-fifth verse of the Twenty-second Chapter, Tenth Canto, of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. The *gopīs* worshiped goddess Durgā, or Kātyāyanī, but their inner desire was to get Lord Kṛṣṇa as their husband. Kṛṣṇa, as Paramātmā, could realize the ardent desire of the *gopīs*, and therefore He enjoyed the pastime of *vastra-haraṇa*. When the *gopīs* went to bathe in the river Yamunā, they left their garments on the land and dipped into the water completely naked. Taking this opportunity, Kṛṣṇa stole all their garments and sat down in the top of a tree with them, desiring to see the girls naked just to become their husband. The *gopīs* desired to have Kṛṣṇa as their husband, and since it is only before her husband that a woman can be naked, to fulfill their desire Lord Kṛṣṇa accepted their prayers by this pastime of stealing their garments. When the *gopīs* received their garments back from Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa recited this verse.

TEXT 69

saṅkalpo viditaḥ sādhyo

bhavatīnām mad-arcanam

mayānumoditaḥ so 'sau

satyo bhavitum arhati

SYNONYMS

saṅkalpaḥ—desire; *viditaḥ*—has been understood; *sādhyaḥ*—O all of

you chaste ladies; *bhavatīnām*—of all of you; *mat-arcanam*—for worshiping Me; *mayā*—by Me; *anumoditaḥ*—accepted; *saḥ*—that; *asau*—that determination or desire; *satyaḥ*—successful; *bhavitum*—to become; *arhati*—deserves.

TRANSLATION

“My dear gopīs, I accept your desire to have Me as your husband and thus worship Me. I wish your desire to be fulfilled because it deserves to be so.”

PURPORT

The *gopīs*, the girlfriends of Kṛṣṇa, were almost of the same age as He. Within their minds they desired that Kṛṣṇa be their husband, but because of feminine bashfulness they could not express their desire. Therefore later on, after stealing their garments, Kṛṣṇa informed them, “I immediately understood your desire and approved of it. Because I have now stolen your garments, you have presented yourselves before Me completely naked, which means that I have accepted all of you as My wives.” Sometimes foolish rascals, not knowing the purpose of the Lord or the purpose of the *gopīs*, unnecessarily criticize from their own angle of vision, but the real purpose of *vastra-haraṇa* is expressed by the Lord in this verse.

TEXT 70

ei-mata līlā kari’ duṁhe gelā ghare

gambhīra caitanya-līlā ke bujhite pāre

SYNONYMS

ei-mata—in this way; *līlā*—pastimes; *kari’*—executing; *duṁhe*—both of them; *gelā*—returned; *ghare*—home; *gambhīra*—very grave; *caitanya-*

līlā—the pastimes of Lord Caitanya; *ke*—who; *bujhite*—to understand; *pāre*—is able.

TRANSLATION

After thus expressing their feelings to each other, Lord Caitanya and Lakṣmī returned home. Who can understand the grave pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu?

TEXT 71

caitanya-cāpalya dekhi' preme sarva jana

śacī-jagannāthe dekhi' dena olāhana

SYNONYMS

caitanya—Lord Caitanya; *cāpalya*—naughtiness; *dekhi'*—seeing; *preme*—out of love; *sarva jana*—all people; *śacī*—before Śacīmātā; *jagannāthe*—and Jagannātha Miśra; *dekhi'*—seeing them; *dena*—gave; *olāhana*—a little rebuke.

TRANSLATION

When the neighboring people saw the naughty behavior of Lord Caitanya, out of love for Him they lodged complaints with Śacīmātā and Jagannātha Miśra.

TEXT 72

ekadina śacī-devī putrere bhartsiyā

dharibāre gelā, putra gelā palāiyā

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *śacī-devī*—mother Śacī; *putrere*—unto the son; *bhartsiyā*—rebuking; *dharibāre*—to catch Him; *gelā*—went; *putra*—the son; *gelā*—went; *palāiyā*—running away.

TRANSLATION

One day mother Śacī went to catch her son, wanting to rebuke Him, but He fled from the spot.

TEXT 73

ucchiṣṭa-garte tyakta-hāṇḍīra upara

basiyāchena sukhe prabhu deva-viśvambhara

SYNONYMS

ucchiṣṭa-garte—in the pit where the remnants of food were thrown; *tyakta*—rejected; *hāṇḍīra*—pots; *upara*—upon; *basiyāchena*—sat down; *sukhe*—very pleasingly; *prabhu*—the Lord; *deva*—the Supreme God; *viśvambhara*—the maintainer of the universe.

TRANSLATION

Although He is the maintainer of the entire universe, once the Lord sat upon some rejected pots in the pit where the remnants of food were thrown, after the pots had been used for cooking.

PURPORT

Formerly it was the custom of *brāhmaṇas* to worship Lord Viṣṇu daily at home and cook food in new pots. This system is still going on in Jagannātha Purī. The food would be cooked in earthen pots, all fresh and new, and after cooking, the pots would be thrown away. By the side of the house there was generally a big pit where such pots were thrown.

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu sat down on the pots very pleasingly, just to give His mother a lesson.

TEXT 74

śacī āśi' kahe,——kene āsuci chuñilā

gaṅgā-snāna kara yāi'——apavitra ha-ilā

SYNONYMS

śacī āśi'—mother Śacī, coming there; *kahe*—said; *kene*—why; *āsuci*—untouchable; *chuñilā*—You have touched; *gaṅgā-snāna*—bathing in the Ganges; *kara*—do; *yāi'*—going there; *apavitra ha-ilā*—You have become impure.

TRANSLATION

When mother Śacī saw her boy sitting on the rejected pots, she protested, “Why have You touched these untouchable pots? You have now become impure. Go and bathe in the Ganges.”

TEXT 75

ihā śuni' mātāke kahila brahma-jñāna

vismitā ha-iyā mātā karāila snāna

SYNONYMS

ihā śuni'—hearing this; *mātāke*—unto His mother; *kahila*—explained; *brahma-jñāna*—absolute knowledge; *vismitā*—amazed; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *mātā*—the mother; *karāila*—forced; *snāna*—bathing.

TRANSLATION

Hearing this, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu taught His mother about absolute knowledge. Although amazed by this, His mother forced Him to take a bath.

PURPORT

The absolute knowledge explained by the Lord to His mother is described by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* as follows: “The Lord said, ‘Mother, that this is pure and that is impure is surely a worldly sentiment with no basis in fact. You have cooked food for Lord Viṣṇu within these pots and offered the food to Him. How then can these pots be untouchable? Everything in relationship with Viṣṇu is to be considered an expansion of Viṣṇu’s energy. Viṣṇu, the Supersoul, is eternal and uncontaminated. How then may these pots be considered pure or impure?’ Hearing this discourse on absolute knowledge, His mother was very much astonished and forced Him to take a bath.”

TEXT 76

kabhu putra-saṅge śacī karilā śayana

dekhe, divyaloka āsi’ bharila bhavana

SYNONYMS

kabhu—sometimes; *putra-saṅge*—taking the boy; *śacī*—mother Śacī; *karilā śayana*—took rest; *dekhe*—sees; *divya-loka*—celestial denizens; *āsi’*—coming there; *bharila*—filled up; *bhavana*—the whole house.

TRANSLATION

Sometimes, taking her son with her, mother Śacī would lie down on her bed, and she would see that denizens of the celestial world had come there, filling the entire house.

TEXT 77

śacī bale, — — yāha, putra, bolāha bāpere

māṭṛ-ājñā paīyā prabhu calilā bāhire

SYNONYMS

śacī bale—mother Śacī said; *yāha*—go; *putra*—my dear son; *bolāha*—call; *bāpere*—Your father; *māṭṛ-ājñā*—the order of His mother; *paīyā*—getting; *prabhu*—the Lord; *calilā*—went; *bāhire*—out.

TRANSLATION

Once mother Śacī told the Lord, “Please go call Your father.” Receiving this order from His mother, the Lord went out to call him.

TEXT 78

calite caraṇe nūpura bāje jhanjhan

śuni’ camakita haila pitā-mātāra mana

SYNONYMS

calite—while going; *caraṇe*—on the lotus feet; *nūpura*—ankle bells; *bāje*—sounded; *jhanjhan*—tinkling; *śuni’*—hearing; *camakita*—struck with wonder; *haila*—became; *pitā*—of His father; *mātāra*—and mother; *mana*—the minds.

TRANSLATION

When the child was going out, there was a tinkling of ankle bells from His lotus feet. Hearing this, His father and mother were struck with wonder.

TEXT 79

miśra kahe, — — ei baḍa adbhuta kāhinī

śīśura śūnya-pade kene nūpurera dhvani

SYNONYMS

miśra kahe—Jagannātha Miśra said; *ei baḍa*—this is very; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *kāhinī*—incident; *śīśura*—of the child; *śūnya-pade*—on the naked legs; *kene*—why; *nūpurera*—of the ankle bells; *dhvani*—sound.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra said, “This is a very wonderful incident. Why is there a sound of ankle bells from the bare feet of my child?”

TEXT 80

śacī kahe, — — āra eka adbhuta dekhila

divya divya loka āsi’ aṅgana bharila

SYNONYMS

śacī kahe—mother Śacī said; *āra*—another; *eka*—one; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *dekhila*—I saw; *divya*—celestial; *divya*—celestial; *loka*—people; *āsi’*—coming there; *aṅgana*—courtyard; *bharila*—filled up.

TRANSLATION

Mother Śacī said, “I also saw another wonder. People were coming down from the celestial kingdom and crowding the entire courtyard.

TEXT 81

kibā kolāhala kare, bujhite nā pāri

kāhāke vā stuti kare——anumāna kari

SYNONYMS

kibā—what; *kolāhala*—rowdy sounds; *kare*—they make; *bujhite*—to understand; *nā*—not; *pāri*—I am able; *kāhāke*—to whom; *vā*—or; *stuti*—prayer; *kare*—they offer; *anumāna*—guess; *kari*—I do.

TRANSLATION

“They made noisy sounds I could not understand. I guess they were offering prayers to someone.”

TEXT 82

miśra bale,——kichu ha-uk, cintā kichu nāi

viśvambharera kuśala ha-uk,——ei mātra cāi

SYNONYMS

miśra bale—Jagannātha Miśra replied; *kichu ha-uk*—whatever it may be; *cintā kichu nāi*—don’t be worried; *viśvambharera*—of Viśvambhara; *kuśala*—auspiciousness; *ha-uk*—let there be; *ei*—this; *mātra*—only; *cāi*—I want.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra replied, “Never mind what it is. There is no need to worry. Let there always be good fortune for Viśvambhara. This is all I want.”

TEXT 83

eka-dina miśra putrera cāpalya dekhiyā

dharma-sīkṣā dila bahu bhartsanā kariyā

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *miśra*—Jagannātha Miśra; *putrera*—of his son; *cāpalya*—the mischievous behavior; *dekhiyā*—seeing; *dharma-sīkṣā*—religious teaching; *dila*—gave; *bahu*—much; *bhartsanā*—rebuking; *kariyā*—doing.

TRANSLATION

On another occasion, Jagannātha Miśra, seeing the mischievous acts of his son, gave Him lessons in morality after rebuking Him greatly.

TEXT 84

rātre svapna dekhe, — —eka āsi' brāhmaṇa

miśrere kahaye kichu sa-roṣa vacana

SYNONYMS

rātre—at night; *svapna dekhe*—he dreamt; *eka*—one; *āsi'*—coming; *brāhmaṇa*—*brāhmaṇa*; *miśrere*—unto Jagannātha Miśra; *kahaye*—spoke; *kichu*—something; *sa-roṣa*—with anger; *vacana*—words.

TRANSLATION

On that very night, Jagannātha Miśra dreamt that a brāhmaṇa had come before him speaking these words in great anger:

TEXT 85

“mísra, tumi putrera tattva kichui nā jāna

bhartsana-tāḍana kara,——putra kari’ māna”

SYNONYMS

mísra—my dear Jagannātha Mísra; *tumi*—you; *putrera*—of your son; *tattva*—truth; *kichui*—something; *nā*—do not; *jāna*—know; *bhartsana*—rebuking; *tāḍana*—chastisement; *kara*—you do; *putra*—son; *kari’*—making Him; *māna*—you regard.

TRANSLATION

“My dear Mísra, you do not know anything about your son. You think Him your son, and therefore you rebuke and chastise Him.”

TEXT 86

mísra kahe,——deva, siddha, muni kene naya

ye se baḍa ha-uk mātra āmāra tanaya

SYNONYMS

mísra kahe—Jagannātha Mísra replied; *deva*—demigod; *siddha*—mystic yogī; *muni*—great saintly person; *kene naya*—may be so or not; *ye se*—whatever; *baḍa*—great; *ha-uk*—He may be; *mātra*—only; *āmāra*—my; *tanaya*—son.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Mísra replied, “This boy may be a demigod, a mystic yogī or a great saintly person. It doesn’t matter what He is, for I think He is only my son.

TEXT 87

putrera lālana-sīkṣā—pitāra sva-dharma

āmi nā śikhāle kaiche janibe dharma-marma

SYNONYMS

putrera—of the son; *lālana*—maintenance; *sīkṣā*—education; *pitara*—of the father; *sva-dharma*—duty; *āmi*—if I; *nā*—do not; *śikhāle*—give education; *kaiche*—how; *janibe*—He will know; *dharma-marma*—religion and morality.

TRANSLATION

“It is the duty of a father to educate his son in both religion and morality. If I do not give Him this education, how will He know of it?”

TEXT 88

vipra kahe,—putra yadi daiva-siddha haya

svataḥ-siddha-jñāna, tabe sīkṣā vyartha haya

SYNONYMS

vipra kahe—the *brāhmaṇa* replied; *putra*—son; *yadi*—if; *daiva*—transcendental; *siddha*—mystic; *haya*—were; *svataḥ-siddha-jñāna*—self-illuminated perfect knowledge; *tabe*—at that time; *sīkṣā*—education; *vyartha*—futile; *haya*—becomes.

TRANSLATION

The *brāhmaṇa* replied, “If your son is a transcendental mystic boy with self-effulgent perfect knowledge, what is the use of your education?”

PURPORT

The *brāhmaṇa* Jagannātha Miśra saw in his dream told him that his son was not an ordinary human being. If He were a transcendental person, He would have self-effulgent knowledge, and thus there would be no need to educate Him.

TEXT 89

miśra kahe, — — “putra kene nahe nārāyaṇa

tathāpi pitāra dharma — — putrera śikṣaṇa”

SYNONYMS

miśra kahe—Jagannātha Miśra replied; *putra*—my son; *kene*—may be; *nahe*—why not; *nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *tathāpi*—still; *pitāra*—of a father; *dharma*—the duty; *putrera*—of the son; *śikṣaṇa*—instruction.

TRANSLATION

Jagannātha Miśra replied, “Even if my son is not a common man but Nārāyaṇa, still it is the duty of a father to instruct his son.”

TEXT 90

ei-mate duihe karena dharmera vicāra

viśuddha-vātsalya miśrera, nāhi jāne āra

SYNONYMS

ei-mate—in this way; *duihe*—both of them; *karena*—do; *dharmera*—of religion; *vicāra*—consideration; *viśuddha*—unalloyed; *vātsalya*—parental

affection; *miśrera*—of Jagannātha Miśra; *nāhi*—there is not; *jāne*—he knew; *āra*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

In this way Jagannātha Miśra and the brāhmaṇa discussed the principles of religion in the dream, yet Jagannātha Miśra was absorbed in unalloyed parental mellow and did not want to know anything else.

PURPORT

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.8.45) it is said, “Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is worshiped with exalted hymns by all the *Vedas* and *Upaniṣads* and by great personalities through *sāṅkhya-yoga* in the mode of goodness, was considered by mother Yaśodā and Nanda to be their own little son.” Similarly, Jagannātha Miśra also considered Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu his beloved little boy, although He is worshiped with all veneration by learned *brāhmaṇas* and saintly persons.

TEXT 91

eta śuni’ dvija gelā hañā ānandita

miśra jāgiyā ha-ilā parama vismita

SYNONYMS

eta śuni’—after hearing so much; *dvija*—the *brāhmaṇa*; *gelā*—returned; *hañā*—becoming; *ānandita*—very pleased; *miśra*—Jagannātha Miśra; *jāgiyā*—being awakened; *ha-ilā*—became; *parama*—highly; *vismita*—astonished.

TRANSLATION

Being very pleased, the brāhmaṇa left after talking with Jagannātha

Miśra, and when Jagannātha Miśra awakened from his dream, he was very much astonished.

TEXT 92

bandhu-bāndhava-sthāne svapna kahila

śuniyā sakala loka vismita ha-ila

SYNONYMS

bandhu-bāndhava—of friends and relatives; *sthāne*—in the presence; *svapna*—dream; *kahila*—explained; *śuniyā*—after hearing; *sakala*—all; *loka*—the people; *vismita*—astonished; *ha-ila*—became.

TRANSLATION

He related the dream to his friends and relatives, and every one of them was very much astonished to hear of it.

TEXT 93

ei mata śīśu-līlā kare gauracandra

dine dine pitā-mātāra bāḍāya ānanda

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *mata*—like; *śīśu-līlā*—childhood pastimes; *kare*—does; *gauracandra*—Śrī Gaurahari; *dine dine*—day after day; *pitā-mātāra*—of His parents; *bāḍāya*—He increases; *ānanda*—the pleasure.

TRANSLATION

In this way Gaurahari performed His childhood pastimes and day after

day increased the pleasure of His parents.

TEXT 94

kata dine miśra putrera hāte khaḍi dila

alpa dine dvādaśa-phalā akṣara śikhila

SYNONYMS

kata dine—after some days; *miśra*—Jagannātha Miśra; *putrera*—of his son; *hāte*—in the hand; *khaḍi*—chalk; *dila*—gave; *alpa*—within a very few; *dine*—days; *dvādaśa-phalā*—twelve combinations of letters; *akṣara*—letters; *śikhila*—learned.

TRANSLATION

After some days Jagannātha Miśra inaugurated the primary education of his son by performing the hāte khaḍi ceremony. Within a very few days the Lord learned all the letters and combinations of letters.

PURPORT

The twelve *phalā*, or combinations of letters, are called *repha*, *mūrdhanya* (cerebral), *ṇa*, *dāntavya* (dental), *na*, *ma*, *ya*, *ra*, *la*, *va*, *ṛ*, *ṝ*, *ḷ* and *ḻ*. *Hāte khaḍi* is the primary educational beginning. At the age of four or five years, on an auspicious day called *vidyārambha* marking the beginning of primary education, there is a ceremony worshiping Lord Viṣṇu, and after that the teacher gives the child a long chalk pencil. Then, guiding the hand of the student, he instructs him how to write the letters of the alphabet (*a*, *ā*, *i*, etc.) by writing big letters on the floor. When the child is a little advanced in writing, he is given a slate for his primary education, which ends when he learns the two-letter combinations, which are called *phalā*, as mentioned above.

TEXT 95

bālyalīlā-sūtra ei kaila anukrama

ihā vistāriyāchena dāsa-vṛndāvana

SYNONYMS

bālyalīlā-sūtra—synopsis of the pastimes of childhood; *ei*—this; *kaila*—did; *anukrama*—in chronological order; *ihā*—this; *vistāriyāchena*—has elaborately explained; *dāsa-vṛndāvana*—Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura.

TRANSLATION

This is a synopsis of the childhood pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, placed herewith in chronological order. Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has already elaborately explained these pastimes in his book Caitanya-bhāgavata.

TEXT 96

ataeva ei-līlā saṅkṣepe sūtra kaila

punarukti-bhaye vistāriyā nā kahila

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *ei-līlā*—these pastimes; *saṅkṣepe*—in brief; *sūtra*—synopsis; *kaila*—made; *punar-ukti*—repetition; *bhaye*—being afraid of; *vistāriyā*—elaborate explanation; *nā*—did not; *kahila*—say.

TRANSLATION

I have therefore made only a brief summary. Being afraid of repetition, I have not elaborated upon this subject matter.

TEXT 97

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇa-dāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Fourteenth Chapter, describing Lord Caitanya's childhood pastimes.

Chapter 15

The Lord's Pugaṇḍa-līlā

A synopsis of the Fifteenth Chapter is as follows. The Lord took lessons in grammar from Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita and became very expert in commenting upon grammar. He forbade His mother to take grains on the Ekādaśī day. He narrated a story that Viśvarūpa, after accepting the *sannyāsa* order, invited Him in a dream to accept *sannyāsa* also, but the Lord refused and was therefore sent back home. When Jagannātha Miśra passed away, the Lord married the daughter of Vallabhācārya, whose name was Lakṣmī. All these events are summarized in this chapter.

TEXT 1

ku-manāḥ su-manastvam hi

yāti yasya padābjayoḥ

su-mano-'rpaṇa-mātreṇa

taṁ caitanya-prabhum bhaje

SYNONYMS

ku-manāḥ—a person interested in activities of material sense enjoyment; *su-manastvam*—the position of a devotee without material desires; *hi*—certainly; *yāti*—gets; *yasya*—whose; *pada-abjayoḥ*—at the lotus feet; *su-manaḥ*—a flower; *arpaṇa*—offering; *mātreṇa*—simply by doing so; *taṁ*—Him; *caitanya-prabhum*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bhaje*—I worship.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya because simply by offering a flower at His lotus feet even the most ardent materialist becomes a devotee.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaitacandra, jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-caitanya*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *jaya-advaitacandra*—

all glories to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—all glories to the devotees of Lord Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu! All glories to Lord Nityānanda Prabhu! All glories to Advaita Ācārya! And all glories to all the devotees of Lord Caitanya!

TEXT 3

paugaṇḍa-līlāra sūtra kariye gaṇana

paugaṇḍa-vayase prabhura mukhya adhyayana

SYNONYMS

paugaṇḍa—of the age from five years to ten years; *līlāra*—of the pastimes; *sūtra*—synopsis; *kariye*—I do; *gaṇana*—enumerate; *paugaṇḍa-vayase*—in that age between five and ten years; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *mukhya*—chief; *adhyayana*—studying.

TRANSLATION

Let me now enumerate the activities of the Lord between the ages of five and ten. His chief occupation during this period was to engage Himself in study.

TEXT 4

paugaṇḍa-līlā caitanya-

kṛṣṇasyāti-suvistṛtā

vidyārambha-mukhā pāṇi-

grahaṇāntā mano-harā

SYNONYMS

pauganḍa-līlā—the pastimes of the *pauganḍa* age; *caitanya-kṛṣṇasya*—of Lord Caitanya, who is Kṛṣṇa Himself; *ati-suvistṛtā*—very much expanded; *vidyā-ārambha*—the beginning of education; *mukhā*—chief business; *pāṇi-grahaṇa*—marriage; *antā*—at the end; *manaḥ-harā*—very beautiful.

TRANSLATION

The pastimes of the Lord during His *pauganḍa* age were very extensive. His education was His chief occupation, and after that His very beautiful marriage took place.

TEXT 5

gaṅgādāsa paṇḍita-sthāne paḍena vyākaraṇa

śravaṇa-mātre kaṇṭhe kaila sūtra-vṛtti-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

gaṅgādāsa—Gaṅgādāsa; *paṇḍita-sthāne*—at the place of the teacher; *paḍena*—studies; *vyākaraṇa*—grammar; *śravaṇa-mātre*—simply by hearing; *kaṇṭhe*—between the neck and the heart; *kaila*—did; *sūtra-vṛtti-gaṇa*—the aphorisms and their definitions.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord was studying grammar at the place of Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, He would immediately learn grammatical rules and definitions by heart simply by hearing them once.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura says that the Lord was given lessons by a teacher named Viṣṇu and another teacher named Sudarśana. Later on, when He was a little grown up, He was under the care of Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, who taught Him grammar of a higher standard. Anyone serious about studying the Sanskrit language should first learn grammar. It is said that simply to finish studying Sanskrit grammar takes at least twelve years, but once one learns the grammatical rules and regulations very nicely, all other scriptures or subject matters in Sanskrit are extremely easy to understand, for Sanskrit grammar is the gateway to education.

TEXT 6

alpa-kāle hailā pañjī-ṭikāte pravīṇa

cira-kālera paḍuyā jine ha-iyā navīna

SYNONYMS

alpa-kāle—within a very short time; *hailā*—became; *pañjī-ṭikāte*—in the commentary on grammar named *Pañjī-ṭikā*; *pravīṇa*—very expert; *cira-kālera*—all older; *paḍuyā*—students; *jine*—conquers; *ha-iyā*—being; *navīna*—their junior.

TRANSLATION

He soon became so expert in commenting on the *Pañjī-ṭikā* that He could win victory over all the other students, although He was a neophyte.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura says there was a commentary on grammar named *Pañjī-ṭikā* that was later explained very lucidly by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 7

adhyayana-līlā prabhura dāsa-vṛndāvana

‘caitanya-maṅgale’ kaila vistāri varṇana

SYNONYMS

adhyayana-līlā—pastimes of studying; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *dāsa-vṛndāvana*—Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *caitanya-maṅgale*—in his book *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *kaila*—has done; *vistāri*—elaborately; *varṇana*—explanation.

TRANSLATION

In his book *Caitanya-maṅgala* [which later became *Caitanya-bhāgavata*], Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has very elaborately described the Lord’s pastimes of study.

PURPORT

The *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Ādi-khaṇḍa*, chapters Four, Six, Seven, Eight, Nine and Ten, are a good reference for the studious pastimes of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 8

eka dina mātāra pade kariyā praṇāma

prabhu kahe,——mātā, more deha eka dāna

SYNONYMS

eka dina—one day; *mātāra*—of the mother; *pade*—on the feet; *kariyā*—doing; *praṇāma*—obeisances; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kahe*—said; *mātā*—My

dear mother; *more*—unto Me; *deha*—give; *eka*—one; *dāna*—gift.

TRANSLATION

One day Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu fell down at the feet of His mother and requested her to give Him one thing in charity.

TEXT 9

mātā bale, — — tāi diba, yā tumi māgibe

prabhu kahe, — — ekādaśīte anna nā khāibe

SYNONYMS

mātā bale—His mother said; *tāi diba*—I shall give that; *yā*—whatever; *tumi*—You; *māgibe*—should ask me; *prabhu kahe*—the Lord said; *ekādaśīte*—on the Ekādaśī day; *anna*—grains; *nā*—don't; *khāibe*—eat.

TRANSLATION

His mother replied, “My dear son, I will give You whatever You ask.” Then the Lord said, “My dear mother, please do not eat grains on the Ekādaśī day.”

PURPORT

From the very beginning of His childhood life Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu introduced the system of observing a fast on the Ekādaśī day. In the *Bhakti-sandarbha*, by Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī, there is a quotation from the *Skanda Purāṇa* admonishing that a person who eats grains on Ekādaśī becomes a murderer of his mother, father, brother and spiritual master, and even if he is elevated to a Vaikuṇṭha planet, he falls down. On Ekādaśī, everything is cooked for Viṣṇu, including regular grains and dhal, but it is enjoined that a Vaiṣṇava should not even take *viṣṇu-*

prasādam on Ekādaśī. It is said that a Vaiṣṇava does not accept anything eatable that is not offered to Lord Viṣṇu, but on Ekādaśī a Vaiṣṇava should not touch even *mahā-prasādam* offered to Viṣṇu, although such *prasādam* may be kept for being eaten the next day. It is strictly forbidden for one to accept any kind of grain on Ekādaśī, even if it is offered to Lord Viṣṇu.

TEXT 10

śacī kahe, — — nā khāiba, bhāla-i kahilā

sei haite ekādaśī karite lāgilā

SYNONYMS

śacī kahe—mother Śacī said; *nā khāiba*—I shall not take; *bhāla-i kahilā*—You have said very nicely; *sei haite*—from that day; *ekādaśī*—Ekādaśī day; *karite lāgilā*—began to observe.

TRANSLATION

Mother Śacī said, “You have spoken very nicely. I shall not eat grains on Ekādaśī.” From that day, she began to observe fasting on Ekādaśī.

PURPORT

It is a prejudice among *smārta-brāhmaṇas* that a widow must observe fasting on Ekādaśī but a woman who is *sa-dhava*—who has her husband—should not. It appears that before Lord Caitanya’s request, Śacīmātā, being *sa-dhava*, was not observing Ekādaśī. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, however, introduced the system that a woman, even if not a widow, must observe the Ekādaśī day and must not touch any kind of grains, even those offered to the Deity of Viṣṇu.

TEXT 11

tabe miśra viśvarūpera dekhiyā yauvana

kanyā cāhi' vivāha dite karilena mana

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *miśra*—Jagannātha Miśra; *viśvarūpera*—of Viśvarūpa, his elder son; *dekhiyā*—seeing; *yauvana*—youthfulness; *kanyā cāhi'*—wanting to find a girl; *vivāha*—marriage; *dite*—to give; *karilena*—made up; *mana*—his mind.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, seeing that Viśvarūpa was a grown-up youth, Jagannātha Miśra wanted to find a girl and arrange a marriage ceremony for Him.

TEXT 12

viśvarūpa śuni' ghara chāḍi palāilā

sannyāsa kariyā tīrtha karibāre gelā

SYNONYMS

viśvarūpa—Viśvarūpa; *śuni'*—hearing this; *ghara*—home; *chāḍi*—giving up; *palāilā*—went away; *sannyāsa*—the renounced order; *kariyā*—accepting; *tīrtha*—the holy places; *karibāre*—for touring; *gelā*—went away.

TRANSLATION

Hearing of this, Viśvarūpa immediately left home and went away to accept sannyāsa and travel from one place of pilgrimage to another.

TEXT 13

śuni, śacī-miśrera duḥkhī haila mana

tabe prabhu mātā-pitāra kaila āśvāsana

SYNONYMS

śuni'—hearing this; *śacī*—of mother Śacī; *miśrera*—and of Jagannātha Miśra; *duḥkhī*—very unhappy; *haila*—became; *mana*—minds; *tabe*—at that time; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mātā-pitāra*—of the parents; *kaila*—did; *āśvāsana*—pacification.

TRANSLATION

When Śacīmātā and Jagannātha Miśra heard of the departure of their elder son, Viśvarūpa, they were very unhappy, but Lord Caitanya tried to console them.

TEXT 14

bhāla haila, — — viśvarūpa sannyāsa karila

pitṛ-kula, mātṛ-kula, — — dui uddhārila

SYNONYMS

bhāla haila—it is very good; *viśvarūpa*—Viśvarūpa; *sannyāsa*—the renounced order of life; *karila*—has accepted; *pitṛ-kula*—father's family; *mātṛ-kula*—mother's family; *dui*—both of them; *uddhārila*—delivered.

TRANSLATION

“My dear mother and father,” the Lord said, “it is very good that Viśvarūpa has accepted the sannyāsa order, for thus He has delivered both His father's family and His mother's family.”

PURPORT

It is sometimes said that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu disapproved of the acceptance of the *sannyāsa* order in this Kali-yuga because in the *śāstra* it is said:

*aśvamedham gavāmbham sannyāsam pala-paitṛkam
devareṇa sutotpattiṁ kalau pañca vivarjayet*
[Cc. Ādi 17.164]

“In this Age of Kali, five acts are forbidden: the offering of a horse in sacrifice, the offering of a cow in sacrifice, the acceptance of the order of *sannyāsa*, the offering of oblations of flesh to the forefathers, and a man’s begetting children in his brother’s wife.” (*Brahma-vaivarta Purāṇa*, *Kṛṣṇa-janma-khaṇḍa* 185.180)

Nevertheless, we see that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu Himself accepted *sannyāsa* and approved of the *sannyāsa* of His elder brother, Viśvarūpa. It is clearly said here, *bhāla haila*, — — *viśvarūpa sannyāsa karila pitr-kula, mātr-kula*, — — *dui uddhārila*. Therefore, should it be thought that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu made statements that are contradictory? No, actually He did not. It is recommended that one accept *sannyāsa* to dedicate his life for the service of the Lord, and everyone must take that kind of *sannyāsa*, for by accepting such *sannyāsa* one renders the best service to both his paternal and maternal families. But one should not accept the *sannyāsa* order of the Māyāvāda school, which has practically no meaning. We find many Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* simply loitering in the street thinking themselves Brahman or Nārāyaṇa and spending all day and night begging so they can fill their hungry bellies. Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* have become so degraded that there is a section of them who eat everything, just like hogs and dogs. It is such degraded *sannyāsa* that is prohibited in this age. Actually, Śrīla Śaṅkarācārya’s principles for the acceptance of *sannyāsa* were very strict, but later the so-called Māyāvādī *sannyāsīs* became degraded because of their false philosophy, which propounds that by accepting *sannyāsa* one becomes Nārāyaṇa. Śrī

Caitanya Mahāprabhu rejected that kind of *sannyāsa*. But the acceptance of *sannyāsa* is one of the items of the *varṇāśrama-dharma*. How then can it be rejected?

TEXT 15

āmi ta' kariba tomā' duñhāra sevana

śuniyā santuṣṭa haila pitā-mātāra mana

SYNONYMS

āmi ta'—I; *kariba*—shall do; *tomā*—for you; *duñhāra*—both; *sevana*—service; *śuniyā*—after hearing; *santuṣṭa*—pleased; *haila*—became; *pitā-mātāra mana*—the parents' minds.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu assured His parents that He would serve them, and thus the minds of His father and mother were satisfied.

TEXT 16

eka-dina naivedya-tāmbūla khāiyā

bhūmite paḍilā prabhu acetana hañā

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *naivedya*—food offered to the Deity; *tāmbūla*—betel nut; *khāiyā*—after eating; *bhūmite*—on the ground; *paḍilā*—fell; *prabhu*—the Lord; *acetana*—unconscious; *hañā*—becoming.

TRANSLATION

One day Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu ate betel nuts offered to the Deity, but they acted as an intoxicant, and He fell down on the ground unconscious.

PURPORT

Betel nuts are an intoxicant, and therefore the regulative principles prohibit eating them. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's pastime of fainting after eating betel nuts is a solid instruction to all of us that one should not touch betel nuts, even those offered to Viṣṇu, just as one should not touch grains on the Ekādaśī day. Of course, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's fainting had a particular purpose. As the Supreme Personality of Godhead, He can do whatever He likes and eat whatever He wants, but we should not imitate His pastimes.

TEXT 17

āste-vyaste pitā-mātā mukhe dila pāni

sustha hañā kahe prabhu apūrva kāhinī

SYNONYMS

āste-vyaste—with great haste; *pitā-mātā*—both the parents; *mukhe*—on the mouth; *dila*—gave; *pāni*—water; *sustha hañā*—being revived; *kahe*—says; *prabhu*—the Lord; *apūrva*—something astonishing; *kāhinī*—narration.

TRANSLATION

After His father and mother sprinkled water on His mouth with great haste, the Lord revived and said something wonderful they had never heard before.

TEXT 18

ethā haite viśvarūpa more lañā gelā

sannyāsa karaha tumi, āmāre kahilā

SYNONYMS

ethā—here; *haite*—from; *viśvarūpa*—Viśvarūpa; *more*—Me; *lañā*—taking with Him; *gelā*—went; *sannyāsa*—the renounced order of life; *karaha*—accept; *tumi*—You also; *āmāre*—unto Me; *kahilā*—He said.

TRANSLATION

The Lord said, “Viśvarūpa took Me away from here, and He requested Me to accept the sannyāsa order.

TEXT 19

āmi kahi, — — āmāra anātha pitā-mātā

āmi bālaka, — — sannyāsera kibā jāni kathā

SYNONYMS

āmi kahi—I said; *āmāra*—My; *anātha*—helpless; *pitā-mātā*—father and mother; *āmi*—I am; *bālaka*—only a child; *sannyāsera*—of the renounced order of life; *kibā*—what; *jāni*—I know; *kathā*—words.

TRANSLATION

“I replied to Viśvarūpa, ‘I have My helpless father and mother, and also I am but a child. What do I know about the sannyāsa order of life?

TEXT 20

gṛhastha ha-iyā kariba pitā-mātāra sevana

ihāte-i tuṣṭa habena lakṣmī-nārāyaṇa

SYNONYMS

gṛhastha—a householder; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *kariba*—I shall do; *pitā-mātāra*—of the parents; *sevana*—service; *ihāte-i*—in this; *tuṣṭa*—satisfied; *habena*—will become; *lakṣmī-nārāyaṇa*—the goddess of fortune and Nārāyaṇa.

TRANSLATION

“Later I shall become a householder and thus serve My parents, for this action will very much satisfy Lord Nārāyaṇa and His wife, the goddess of fortune.’

TEXT 21

tabe viśvarūpa ihāṇ pāṭhāila more

mātāke kahio koṭi koṭi namaskāre

SYNONYMS

tabe—then; *viśvarūpa*—Viśvarūpa; *ihāṇ*—here; *pāṭhāila*—sent; *more*—Me; *mātāke kahio*—speak to My mother; *koṭi koṭi*—hundreds and thousands; *namaskāre*—obeisances.

TRANSLATION

“Then Viśvarūpa returned Me home and requested, ‘Offer thousands and thousands of obeisances unto My mother, Śacīdevī.’”

TEXT 22

ei mata nānā līlā kare gaurahari

ki kāraṇe līlā, — — ihā bujhite nā pāri

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *nānā*—various; *līlā*—pastimes; *kare*—does; *gaurahari*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ki kāraṇe*—what is the reason; *līlā*—pastimes; *ihā*—this; *bujhite*—to understand; *nā*—not; *pāri*—I am able.

TRANSLATION

In this way Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu performed various pastimes, but why He did so I cannot understand.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead and His devotees who come to this world are executing a mission, and therefore sometimes they act in a way that is very difficult to understand. It is said, therefore, *vaiṣṇavera kriyā-mudrā vijñeha nā bujhaya*: even if one is a very learned and intelligent scholar, he cannot understand the activities of a Vaiṣṇava. A Vaiṣṇava accepts anything favorable for executing his mission. But foolish persons, not knowing the purpose of such exalted Vaiṣṇavas, indulge in criticizing them. That is forbidden. Since no one can understand what a Vaiṣṇava does for the purpose of executing his mission, to criticize such a Vaiṣṇava is the offense called *sādhū-nindā*.

TEXT 23

kata dina rahi' miśra gelā para-loka

mātā-putra duñhāra bādila hṛdi śoka

SYNONYMS

kata dina—some days; *rahi'*—remaining; *miśra*—Jagannātha Miśra; *gelā*—passed away; *para-loka*—for the transcendental world; *mātā*—mother; *putra*—son; *duñhāra*—of both of them; *bāḍila*—increased; *hṛdi*—in the hearts; *śoka*—lamentation.

TRANSLATION

After some days, Jagannātha Miśra passed away from this world to the transcendental world, and both mother and son were very much aggrieved in their hearts.

TEXT 24

bandhu-bāndhava asi' duñhā prabodhila

pitṛ-kriyā vidhi-mate īśvara karila

SYNONYMS

bandhu—friends; *bāndhava*—relatives; *āsi'*—coming there; *duñhā*—both of them; *prabodhila*—pacified; *pitṛ-kriyā*—rituals performed after the death of the father; *vidhi-mate*—according to the Vedic system; *īśvara*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *karila*—executed.

TRANSLATION

Friends and relatives came there to pacify Lord Caitanya and His mother. Then Lord Caitanya, even though He was the Supreme Personality of Godhead, executed the rituals for His dead father according to the Vedic system.

TEXT 25

kata dine prabhu citte karilā cintana

gr̥hastha ha-ilāma, ebe cāhi gr̥ha-dharma

SYNONYMS

kata dine—after some days; *prabhu*—the Lord; *citte*—within His mind; *karilā*—made; *cintana*—consideration; *gr̥hastha ha-ilāma*—I remained in householder life; *ebe*—now; *cāhi*—I want; *gr̥ha-dharma*—activities of family life.

TRANSLATION

After some days the Lord thought, “I did not take sannyāsa, and since I am remaining at home it is My duty to act as a gr̥hastha.

TEXT 26

gr̥hiṇī vinā gr̥ha-dharma nā haya śobhana

eta cinti’ vivāha karite haila mana

SYNONYMS

gr̥hiṇī—wife; *vinā*—without; *gr̥ha-dharma*—duties of family life; *nā*—not; *haya*—become; *śobhana*—beautiful; *eta cinti’*—thinking thus; *vivāha*—marriage; *karite*—to execute; *haila*—became; *mana*—mind.

TRANSLATION

“Without a wife,” Lord Caitanya considered, “there is no meaning to householder life.” Thus the Lord decided to marry.

TEXT 27

na gr̥ham gr̥ham ity āhur

gr̥hiṇī gr̥ham ucyate

tayā hi sahitaḥ sarvān

puruṣārthān samaśnute

SYNONYMS

na—not; *gr̥ham*—the home; *gr̥ham*—the house; *iti*—thus; *āhuḥ*—said; *gr̥hiṇī*—the wife; *gr̥ham*—home; *ucyate*—it is said; *tayā*—with her; *hi*—certainly; *sahitaḥ*—together; *sarvān*—all; *puruṣa-arthān*—goals of human life; *samaśnute*—perfects.

TRANSLATION

“Merely a house is not a home, for it is a wife who gives a home its meaning. If one lives at home with his wife, together they can fulfill all the interests of human life.”

TEXT 28

daive eka dina prabhu paḍiyā āsite

vallabhācāryera kanyā dekhe gaṅgā-pathe

SYNONYMS

daive—accidentally; *eka dina*—one day; *prabhu*—the Lord; *paḍiyā*—after studying; *āsite*—while He was coming back; *vallabhācāryera*—of Vallabhācārya; *kanyā*—daughter; *dekhe*—sees; *gaṅgā-pathe*—on the way to the Ganges.

TRANSLATION

One day when the Lord was coming back from school He accidentally saw

the daughter of Vallabhācārya on the way to the Ganges.

TEXT 29

pūrva-siddha bhāva duñhāra udaya karila

daive vanamālī ghaṭaka śacī-sthāne āila

SYNONYMS

pūrva-siddha—as it is already settled; *bhāva*—ecstasy; *duñhāra*—of both of them; *udaya*—awakened; *karila*—was made; *daive*—also accidentally; *vanamālī*—Vanamālī; *ghaṭaka*—the marriage-maker; *śacī-sthāne*—at the place of Śacīmātā; *āila*—came.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord and Lakṣmīdevī met, their relationship awakened, having already been settled, and coincidentally the marriage-maker Vanamālī came to see Śacīmātā.

PURPORT

Vanamālī Ghaṭaka, a resident of Navadvīpa and a *brāhmaṇa* by caste, arranged the marriage of the Lord to Lakṣmīdevī. He was formerly Viśvāmitra, who negotiated the marriage of Lord Rāmacandra, and later he was the *brāhmaṇa* who negotiated the marriage of Lord Kṛṣṇa with Rukmiṇī. That same *brāhmaṇa* acted as the marriage-maker of the Lord in *caitanya-līlā*.

TEXT 30

śacīra ingite sambandha karila ghaṭana

lakṣmīke vivāha kaila śacīra nandana

SYNONYMS

śacīra īṅgite—by the indication of mother Śacī; *sambandha*—the relationship; *karīla*—made; *ghaṭana*—possible; *lakṣmīke*—unto Lakṣmīdevī; *vivāha*—marriage; *kaila*—executed; *śacīra nandana*—the son of mother Śacī.

TRANSLATION

Following the indications of Śacīdevī, Vanamālī Ghaṭaka arranged the marriage, and thus in due course the Lord married Lakṣmīdevī.

TEXT 31

vistāriyā varṇilā tāhā vṛndāvana-dāsa

ei ta' paugaṇḍa-līlāra sūtra-prakāśa

SYNONYMS

vistāriyā—having elaborated; *varṇilā*—has described; *tāhā*—that; *vṛndāvana-dāsa*—Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa; *ei ta'*—this is; *paugaṇḍa-līlāra*—of the pastimes of His early age; *sūtra-prakāśa*—manifestation of the synopsis.

TRANSLATION

Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has elaborately described all these pastimes of the Lord's early age. What I have given is but a condensed presentation of the same pastimes.

TEXT 32

paugaṇḍa vayase līlā bahuta prakāra

vṛndāvana-dāsa ihā kariyāchena vistāra

SYNONYMS

pauganḍa vayase—in His early age; *līlā*—pastimes; *bahuta prakāra*—of various kinds; *vṛndāvana-dāsa*—Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *ihā*—this; *kariyāchena*—has done; *vistāra*—the elaborate explanation.

TRANSLATION

The Lord performed many varieties of pastimes in His early age, and Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has described them elaborately.

TEXT 33

ataeva diṁmātra ihāṇi dekhāila

‘caitanya-maṅgale’ sarva-loke khyāta haila

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *diṁ-mātra*—only in the matter of indication; *ihāṇi*—here; *dekhāila*—I have exhibited; *caitanya-maṅgale*—in the book of the name *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *sarva-loke*—all over the world; *khyāta*—famous; *haila*—became.

TRANSLATION

I have given but a single hint of these pastimes, for Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, in his book *Caitanya-maṅgala* [now *Caitanya-bhāgavata*], has described them all vividly.

TEXT 34

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Fifteenth Chapter, describing the Lord's paugāṇḍa-līlā.

Chapter 16

The Pastimes of the Lord in His Childhood and Youth

This chapter fully describes Lord Caitanya's *kaiśora-līlā*, or the activities He performed just before attaining youth. During this time He studied deeply and was victorious over greatly learned scholars. During His *kaiśora-līlā* the Lord also sported in the water. He went to East Bengal to secure financial assistance, cultivate knowledge and introduce the *saṅkīrtana* movement, and there He met Tapanā Mīśra, whom He instructed about spiritual advancement and ordered to go to Vārāṇasī. While Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was touring East Bengal, His wife, Lakṣmīdevī, was bitten by a serpent or by the serpent of separation, and thus she left this world. When the Lord returned home, He saw that His mother was overwhelmed with grief because of Lakṣmīdevī's death. Therefore at her request He later married His second wife, Viṣṇupriyā-

devī. This chapter also describes the Lord's argument with Keśava Kāśmīrī, the celebrated scholar, and the Lord's criticism of his prayer glorifying mother Ganges. In this prayer the Lord found five kinds of literary ornaments and five kinds of literary faults, thus defeating the *paṇḍita*. Later the Kāśmīrī Paṇḍita, who was known to have been victorious all over the country, submitted himself to the goddess of learning, and by her order he met Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu on the morning of the next day and surrendered unto Him.

TEXT 1

kṛpā-sudhā-sarid yasya

viśvam āplāvayanty api

nīca-gaīva sadā bhāti

tam caitanya-prabhum bhaje

SYNONYMS

kṛpā-sudhā—of the nectar of the mercy; *sarit*—river; *yasya*—whose; *viśvam*—the whole universe; *āplāvayantī*—inundating; *api*—although; *nīca-gā eva*—more inclined to the poor and fallen; *sadā*—always; *bhāti*—is manifest; *tam*—Him; *caitanya-prabhum*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bhaje*—I worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, whose nectarean mercy flows like a great river, inundating the entire universe. Just as a river flows downstream, Lord Caitanya especially extends Himself to the fallen.

PURPORT

Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura has sung, *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu dayā kara more*. He prays for Lord Caitanya's mercy because He is the mercy incarnation, having appeared especially to reclaim the fallen souls. The more fallen one is, the greater one's claim to the favor of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. One must only be very sincere and serious. Despite being contaminated by all the bad qualities of this Kali-yuga, if one surrenders unto the lotus feet of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Lord will surely and certainly deliver him. The best example is Jagāi and Mādhāi. In this Age of Kali practically everyone is like Jagāi and Mādhāi, but the *saṅkīrtana* movement inaugurated by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is still flowing like a great river, inundating the entire world, and thus the International Society for Krishna Consciousness is successfully claiming all fallen souls to free them from contamination.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaitacandra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya—all glories to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *jaya advaitacandra*—all glories to Advaitacandra; *jaya*—all glories; *gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—to all the devotees of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu! All glories to Lord Nityānanda! All glories to Advaitacandra! And all glories to all the devotees of the Lord!

TEXT 3

jīyāt kaiśora-caitanya

mūrti-matyā grhāśramāt

lakṣmyārcito 'tha vāg-devyā

disām jayi-jaya-cchalāt

SYNONYMS

jīyāt—long live; *kaiśora*—situated in the *kaiśora* age; *caitanyaḥ*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *mūrti-matyā*—having accepted such a body; *grhā-śramāt*—from a householder's life; *lakṣmyā*—by Lakṣmī; *arcitaḥ*—being worshiped; *atha*—then; *vāg-devyā*—by the goddess of learning; *disām*—of all directions; *jayi*—the conqueror; *jaya-chalāt*—on the plea of conquering.

TRANSLATION

Long live Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in His *kaiśora* age! Both the goddess of fortune and the goddess of learning worshiped Him. The goddess of learning, Sarasvatī, worshiped Him in His victory over the scholar who had conquered all the world, and the goddess of fortune, Lakṣmīdevī, worshiped Him at home. Since He is therefore the husband or Lord of both goddesses, I offer my obeisances unto Him.

TEXT 4

ei ta' kaiśora-līlāra sūtra-anubandha

śiṣya-gaṇa paḍāite karilā ārambha

SYNONYMS

ei ta'—thus; *kaiśora*—the age of *kaiśora* (the age between the eleventh

and fifteenth years); *līlāra*—of the pastimes; *sūtra-anubandha*—chronological synopsis; *śiṣya-gaṇa*—students; *paḍāite*—to teach; *karilā*—did; *ārambha*—begin.

TRANSLATION

At the age of eleven Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu began to teach students. This marks the beginning of His kaisora age.

TEXT 5

śata śata śiṣya saṅge sadā adhyāpana

vyākhyā śuni sarva-lokera camakita mana

SYNONYMS

śata śata—very many; *śiṣya*—disciples; *saṅge*—along with Him; *sadā*—always; *adhyāpana*—studying; *vyākhyā*—explanation; *śuni*—hearing; *sarva-lokera*—of all people; *camakita*—astonished; *mana*—minds.

TRANSLATION

As soon as the Lord became a teacher, many, many students came to Him, every one of them astonished to hear His mode of explanation.

TEXT 6

sarva-śāstre sarva paṇḍita pāya parājaya

vinaya-bhaṅgīte kāro duḥkha nāhi haya

SYNONYMS

sarva-śāstre—in all scriptures; *sarva*—all; *paṇḍita*—learned scholars;

pāya—obtain; *parājaya*—defeat; *vinaya*—gentle; *bhaṅgīte*—by behavior; *kāro*—anyone’s; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *nāhi*—does not; *haya*—become.

TRANSLATION

The Lord defeated all kinds of scholars in discourses about all the scriptures, yet because of His gentle behavior, none of them were unhappy.

TEXT 7

vividha auddhatya kare śiṣya-gaṇa-saṅge

jahnavite jala-keli kare nānā range

SYNONYMS

vividha—various; *auddhatya*—impudences; *kare*—does; *śiṣya-gaṇa*—His disciples; *saṅge*—with; *jāhnavīte*—in the water of the Ganges; *jala-keli*—sporting in the water; *kare*—does; *nānā*—in various; *range*—jokes.

TRANSLATION

The Lord, as a teacher, performed various kinds of pranks in His sporting pastimes in the water of the Ganges.

TEXT 8

kata dine kaila prabhu baṅgete gamana

yāhān yāya, tāhān laoyāya nāma-saṅkīrtana

SYNONYMS

kata dine—after a few days; *kaila*—did; *prabhu*—the Lord; *baṅgete*—in East Bengal; *gamana*—touring; *yāhān yāya*—wherever He goes; *tāhān*—there; *laoyāya*—induces; *nāma-saṅkīrtana*—the *saṅkīrtana* movement.

TRANSLATION

After some days the Lord went to East Bengal, and wherever He went He introduced the *saṅkīrtana* movement.

PURPORT

Although Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His devotees in disciplic succession can defeat all kinds of learned scholars, scientists and philosophers in arguments, thus establishing the supremacy of the Personality of Godhead, their main business as preachers is to introduce *saṅkīrtana* everywhere. Simply to defeat scholars and philosophers is not the occupation of a preacher. Preachers must simultaneously introduce the *saṅkīrtana* movement, for that is the mission of the Caitanya cult.

TEXT 9

vidyāra prabhāva dekhi camatkāra cite

śata śata paḍuyā āsi lāgilā paḍite

SYNONYMS

vidyāra—of His learning; *prabhāva*—the influence; *dekhi*—seeing; *camatkāra*—wonder; *cite*—within the heart; *śata śata*—many hundreds; *paḍuyā*—disciples or students; *āsi*—coming there; *lāgilā*—began; *paḍite*—to study.

TRANSLATION

Struck with wonder by the influence of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's

intellectual prowess, many hundreds of students came to the Lord and began studying under His direction.

TEXT 10

sei deśe vipra, nāma— —mīśra tapana

niścaya karite nāre sādhyā-sādhana

SYNONYMS

sei deśe—in that region of East Bengal; *vipra*—a *brāhmaṇa*; *nāma*—named; *mīśra tapana*—Tapana Mīśra; *niścaya karite*—to ascertain; *nāre*—not able; *sādhyā*—objective; *sādhana*—process.

TRANSLATION

In East Bengal there was a *brāhmaṇa* named Tapana Mīśra, who could not ascertain the objective of life or how to attain it.

PURPORT

One must first ascertain the object of life and then understand how to attain it. The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is pointing out to everyone that the object of life is to understand Kṛṣṇa, and to attain that goal of life one must practice Kṛṣṇa consciousness, following the methods prescribed by the Gosvāmīs with reference to the authoritative *śāstras* and *Vedas*.

TEXT 11

bahu-śāstre bahu-vākye citte bhrama haya

sādhya-sādhana śreṣṭha nā haya niścaya

SYNONYMS

bahu-sāstre—by many books or scriptures; *bahu-vākye*—by many versions of many persons; *citte*—within the heart; *bhrama*—doubt; *haya*—there is; *sādhya-sādhana*—objective and means; *śreṣṭha*—about the best; *nā*—not; *haya*—there is; *niścaya*—certainty.

TRANSLATION

If one becomes a bookworm, reading many books and scriptures and hearing many commentaries and the instructions of many men, this will produce doubt within his heart. One cannot in this way ascertain the real goal of life.

PURPORT

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (7.13.8) it is said, *granthān naivābhyased bahūn na vyākhyām upayuñjīta*: “One should not read many books, nor should one try to make a profession of reciting many books, especially if one is a devotee.” One must give up the ambition to be a learned scholar and in this way earn a worldly reputation and financial facilities. If one diverts his attention to studying many books, he cannot fix his mind in devotional service, nor can he understand many scriptures, for they are full of grave statements and meanings. In this connection Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura gives his opinion that those who are attracted to studying many kinds of literature concerning various subject matters, especially fruitive activities and philosophical speculation, are deprived of unalloyed devotional service because of their splayed attention.

Man has a general tendency toward fruitive activities, religious ritualistic ceremonies and philosophical speculation. A living entity thus bewildered since time immemorial does not understand the real goal of life, and thus his activities in life are wasted. Innocent persons misled in this way are deprived of unalloyed *kṛṣṇa-bhakti*, devotional service to the Lord.

Tapana Miśra is a vivid example of such a person. He was a learned scholar, but he could not ascertain what the goal of life is. Therefore he was given a chance to hear Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu instructing Sanātana Gosvāmī. Lord Caitanya's instruction to Tapana Miśra is especially significant for persons who loiter here and there collecting books and reading none of them, thus becoming bewildered regarding the aim of life.

TEXT 12

svapne eka vipra kahe, — — śunaha tapana

nimāñi-paṇḍita pāśe karaha gamana

SYNONYMS

svapne—in a dream; *eka*—one; *vipra*—*brāhmaṇa*; *kahe*—says; *śunaha*—just hear; *tapana*—Tapana Miśra; *nimāñi-paṇḍita*—Nimāi Paṇḍita; *pāśe*—unto Him; *karaha gamana*—go.

TRANSLATION

Tapana Miśra, being thus bewildered, was directed by a *brāhmaṇa* in a dream to go to Nimāi Paṇḍita [Caitanya Mahāprabhu].

TEXT 13

teṇho tomāra sādhya-sādhana karibe niścaya

sākṣāt īśvara teṇho, — — nāhika saṁśaya

SYNONYMS

teṇho—He; *tomāra*—your; *sādhya*—objective of life; *sādhana*—process; *karibe*—will do; *niścaya*—ascertain; *sākṣāt*—direct; *īśvara*—the Lord;

tenho—He is; *nāhika*—there is no; *saṁśaya*—doubt.

TRANSLATION

“Because He is the Lord [īśvara],” the brāhmaṇa told him, “undoubtedly He can give you proper direction.”

TEXT 14

svapna dekhi’ miśra āsi’ prabhura caraṇe

svapnera vṛttānta saba kaila nivedane

SYNONYMS

svapna dekhi’—by seeing the dream; *miśra*—Tapana Miśra; *āsi’*—coming; *prabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *caraṇe*—at the shelter of the lotus feet; *svapnera*—of the dream; *vṛttānta*—details; *saba*—all; *kaila*—did; *nivedane*—inform Him.

TRANSLATION

After seeing the dream, Tapana Miśra came to the shelter of Lord Caitanya’s lotus feet, and he described all the details of the dream to the Lord.

TEXT 15

prabhu tuṣṭa hañā sādhya-sādhana kahila

nāma-saṅkīrtana kara,——upadeśa kaila

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *tuṣṭa*—satisfied; *hañā*—becoming; *sādhya-sādhana*—

the objective and the process; *kahila*—described; *nāma-saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *kara*—practice; *upadeśa kaila*—gave him the instruction.

TRANSLATION

The Lord, being satisfied, instructed him about the object of life and the process for attaining it. He instructed him that the basic principle of success is to chant the holy name of the Lord [the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra].

PURPORT

The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is based upon this instruction of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu that one must chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* regularly and according to the prescribed principles. We simply ask our Western students to chant at least sixteen rounds a day, but sometimes we find that they fail to chant even these sixteen rounds, and instead they bring many austere books and a worshiping method that diverts their attention in so many ways. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's cult is based upon the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*. Lord Caitanya first advised Tapana Miśra to fix his mind on this chanting. We, the members of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, must strictly follow this advice of Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 16

tānra icchā,——prabhu-saṅge navadvīpe vasi

prabhu ājñā dila,——tumi yāo vārāṇasī

SYNONYMS

tānra icchā—his desire; *prabhu-saṅge*—with the Lord; *navadvīpe*—in Navadvīpa; *vasi*—I live there; *prabhu ājñā dila*—but the Lord advised

him; *tumí*—you; *yāo*—go; *vārāṇasī*—to Benares.

TRANSLATION

Tapana Miśra desired to live with the Lord in Navadvīpa, but the Lord asked him to go to Vārāṇasī [Benares].

TEXT 17

tāhāñ āmā-saṅge tomāra habe daraśana

ājñā pāñā miśra kaila kāsīte gamana

SYNONYMS

tāhāñ—there; *āmā-saṅge*—with Me; *tomāra*—your; *habe*—there will be; *daraśana*—meeting; *ājñā pāñā*—receiving this order; *miśra*—Tapana Miśra; *kaila*—did; *kāsīte*—to Benares; *gamana*—going.

TRANSLATION

The Lord assured Tapana Miśra that they would meet again in Vārāṇasī. Receiving this order, Tapana Miśra went there.

TEXT 18

prabhura atarkya-līlā bujhite nā pāri

sva-saṅga chāḍhāñā kene pāṭhāya kāsīpurī

SYNONYMS

prabhura—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's; *atarkya-līlā*—inconceivable pastimes; *bujhite*—to understand; *nā*—not; *pāri*—able; *sva-saṅga*—personal association; *chāḍhāñā*—avoiding; *kene*—why; *pāṭhāya*—sends;

kāśī-purī—to Benares.

TRANSLATION

I cannot understand the inconceivable pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, for although Tapana Miśra wanted to live with Him in Navadvīpa, the Lord advised him to go to Vārāṇasī.

PURPORT

When Tapana Miśra met Him, Caitanya Mahāprabhu was living in household life, and there was no indication that in the future He would accept the *sannyāsa* order. But by asking Tapana Miśra to go to Vārāṇasī, He indicated that in the future He would accept *sannyāsa* and that when He would teach Sanātana Gosvāmī, Tapana Miśra would take advantage of the opportunity to learn the object of life and the real process for attaining it.

TEXT 19

ei mata baṅgera lokera kailā mahā hita

‘nāma’ diyā bhakta kaila, paḍāññā paṇḍita

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *baṅgera*—of East Bengal; *lokera*—of the people; *kailā*—contributed; *mahā*—great; *hita*—benefit; *nāma*—the holy name of the Lord; *diyā*—giving them; *bhakta*—devotees; *kaila*—made them; *paḍāññā*—by educating them; *paṇḍita*—learned scholars.

TRANSLATION

In this way Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu contributed the greatest benefit to the people of East Bengal by initiating them into hari-nāma, the chanting

of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra, and making them learned scholars by educating them.

PURPORT

Following in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is distributing the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* and inducing people all over the world to chant. We are giving people an immense treasury of transcendental literature, translated into all the important languages of the world, and by the grace of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu this literature is selling profusely and people are chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* with great delight. This is the preaching process of the Caitanya cult. Since the Lord wanted this cult preached all over the world, the International Society for Krishna Consciousness is acting in a humble way so that the vision of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu may be fulfilled all over the world, especially in the Western countries.

TEXT 20

ei mata baṅge prabhu kare nānā līlā

ethā navadvīpe lakṣmī virahe duḥkhī hailā

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *baṅge*—in East Bengal; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kare*—does; *nānā*—various; *līlā*—pastimes; *ethā*—here; *navadvīpe*—in Navadvīpa; *lakṣmī*—the wife of Nimāi Paṇḍita; *virahe*—in separation; *duḥkhī*—unhappy; *hailā*—became.

TRANSLATION

Because the Lord was engaged in various ways in preaching work in East Bengal, His wife, Lakṣmīdevī, was very unhappy at home in separation from her husband.

TEXT 21

prabhura viraha-sarpa lakṣmīre daṁśīla

viraha-sarpa-viṣe tāñra paraloka haila

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *viraha-sarpa*—the separation snake; *lakṣmīre*—Lakṣmīdevī; *daṁśīla*—bit; *viraha-sarpa*—of the separation snake; *viṣe*—by the poison; *tāñra*—her; *para-loka*—next world; *haila*—it so happened.

TRANSLATION

The snake of separation bit Lakṣmīdevī, and its poison caused her death. Thus she passed to the next world. She went back home, back to Godhead.

PURPORT

As stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (8.6), *yaṁ yaṁ vāpi smaran bhāvaṁ tyajaty ante kalevaram*: one's practice in thinking throughout his entire life determines the quality of his thoughts at death, and thus at death one obtains a suitable body. According to this principle, Lakṣmīdevī, the goddess of fortune from Vaikuṇṭha, who was absorbed in thought of the Lord in separation from Him, certainly went back home to Vaikuṇṭhaloka after death.

TEXT 22

antare jānīlā prabhu, yāte antaryāmī

deśere āilā prabhu śacī-duḥkha jānī'

SYNONYMS

antare—within Himself; *jānilā*—knew; *prabhu*—the Lord; *yāte*—because; *antaryāmī*—He is the Supersoul; *deśere*—to the country; *āilā*—returned; *prabhu*—the Lord; *śacī*—of mother Śacīdevī; *duḥkha*—the unhappiness; *jāni'*—knowing.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya knew about the disappearance of Lakṣmīdevī because He is the Supersoul Himself. Thus He returned home to solace His mother, Śacīdevī, who was greatly unhappy about the death of her daughter-in-law.

TEXT 23

ghare āilā prabhu bahu lañā dhana-jana

tattva-jñāne kailā śacīra duḥkha vimocana

SYNONYMS

ghare—home; *āilā*—returned; *prabhu*—the Lord; *bahu*—much; *lañā*—bringing; *dhana*—riches; *jana*—followers; *tattva-jñāne*—by transcendental knowledge; *kailā*—did; *śacīra*—of Śacīmātā; *duḥkha*—the unhappiness; *vimocana*—relieving.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord returned home, bringing with Him great wealth and many followers, He spoke to Śacīdevī about transcendental knowledge to relieve her of the grief she was suffering.

PURPORT

It is stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (2.13):

*dehino 'smin yathā dehe kaumāraṁ yauvanaṁ jarā
tathā dehāntara-prāptir dhīras tatra na muhyati*

“As the embodied soul continuously passes, in this body, from boyhood to youth to old age, the soul similarly passes into another body at death. The self-realized soul is not bewildered by such a change.” Such verses from the *Bhagavad-gītā* or any other Vedic literature give valuable instructions on the occasion of someone’s passing away. By discussing such instructions from the *Bhagavad-gītā* or *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, a sober man can certainly understand that the soul never dies but rather passes from one body to another. This is called transmigration of the soul. A soul comes into this material world and creates bodily relationships with a father, a mother, sisters, brothers, a wife and children, but all these relationships pertain to the body, not the soul. Therefore, as described in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, *dhīras tatra na muhyati*: one who is sober is not disturbed by such phenomenal changes within this material world. Such instructions are called *tattva-kathā*, or real truth.

TEXT 24

śiṣya-gaṇa lañā punaḥ vidyāra vilāsa

vidyā-bale sabā jini’ auddhatya prakāśa

SYNONYMS

śiṣya-gaṇa—disciples; *lañā*—taking; *punaḥ*—again; *vidyāra*—of education; *vilāsa*—pastime; *vidyā-bale*—by the strength of education; *sabā*—everyone; *jini’*—conquering; *auddhatya*—of pride; *prakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

After coming back from East Bengal, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu again began educating others. By the strength of His education He conquered

everyone, and thus He was greatly proud.

TEXT 25

tabe viṣṇupriyā-ṭhākurāṇīra pariṇaya

tabe ta' karila prabhu digvijayī jaya

SYNONYMS

tabe—after this; *viṣṇupriyā*—Viṣṇupriyā; *ṭhākurāṇīra*—of the goddess of fortune; *pariṇaya*—marriage; *tabe ta'*—thereafter; *karila*—did; *prabhu*—the Lord; *dig-vijayī*—the champion; *jaya*—conquer.

TRANSLATION

Then Lord Caitanya married Viṣṇupriyā, the goddess of fortune, and thereafter He conquered a champion of learning named Keśava Kāśmīrī.

PURPORT

As in the modern day there are many champions in sports, so in bygone days there were many learned scholars in India who were champions in learning. One such person was Keśava Kāśmīrī, who came from the state of Kashmir. He traveled all over India and at last came to Navadvīpa to challenge the learned scholars there. Unfortunately he could not conquer the learned scholars in Navadvīpa, for he was defeated by the boy scholar Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Later he understood that Caitanya Mahāprabhu is none other than the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Thus he surrendered unto Him and later became a pure Vaiṣṇava in the *sampradāya* of Nimbārka. He wrote *Kaustubha-prabhā*, a commentary on the *Vedānta* commentary of the Nimbārka-sampradāya, which is known as the *Pārijāta-bhāṣya*.

The *Bhakti-ratnākara* mentions Keśava Kāśmīrī and lists his predecessors

in the disciplic succession of the Nimbārka-sampradāya: (1) Śrīnivāsa Ācārya, (2) Viśva Ācārya, (3) Puruṣottama, (4) Vilāsa, (5) Svarūpa, (6) Mādhava, (7) Balabhadra, (8) Padma, (9) Śyāma, (10) Gopāla, (11) Kṛpā, (12) Deva Ācārya, (13) Sundara Bhaṭṭa, (14) Padmanābha, (15) Upendra, (16) Rāmacandra, (17) Vāmana, (18) Kṛṣṇa, (19) Padmākara, (20) Śravaṇa, (21) Bhūri, (22) Mādhava, (23) Śyāma, (24) Gopāla, (25) Balabhadra, (26) Gopīnātha, (27) Keśava, (28) Gokula and (29) Keśava Kāśmīrī. It is stated in the *Bhakti-ratnākara* that Keśava Kāśmīrī was a favorite devotee of mother Sarasvatī, the goddess of learning. By her grace he was an extremely influential scholar, and he was the greatest champion among all the scholars in the four corners of the country. Therefore he got the title *dig-vijayī*, which means “one who has conquered everyone in all directions.” He belonged to a very respectable *brāhmaṇa* family of Kashmir. Later, by the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he gave up the profession of winning championships and became a great devotee. He joined the Nimbārka-sampradāya, one of the Vaiṣṇava communities of the Vedic culture.

TEXT 26

vṛndāvana-dāsa ihā kariyāchena vistāra

sphuṭa nāhi kare doṣa-guṇera vicāra

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-dāsa—Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *ihā*—this; *kariyāchena*—has made; *vistāra*—elaborate description ; *sphuṭa*—what was clear; *nāhi*—not; *kare*—does; *doṣa-guṇera*—of both the faults and the virtues; *vicāra*—analysis.

TRANSLATION

Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has previously elaborately described this. That which is clear need not be scrutinized for good qualities and faults.

TEXT 27

sei amśa kahi, tāñre kari' namaskāra

yā' śuni' digvijayī kaila āpanā dhik-kāra

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *amśa*—portion; *kahi*—I mention; *tāñre*—unto Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *kari'*—making; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *yā'*—of which; *śuni*—hearing; *dig-vijayī*—the conquering *paṇḍita*; *kaila*—did; *āpanā*—his own; *dhik-kāra*—condemnation.

TRANSLATION

Offering my obeisances to Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, I shall try to describe that portion of the Lord's analysis which, when he heard it, made the Digvijayī feel himself condemned.

TEXT 28

jyotsnāvatī rātri, prabhu śiṣya-gaṇa saṅge

vasiyāchena gaṅgātīre vidyāra prasaṅge

SYNONYMS

jyotsnāvatī—full moon; *rātri*—night; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *śiṣya-gaṇa*—disciples; *saṅge*—along with; *vasiyāchena*—was sitting; *gaṅgā-tīre*—on the bank of the Ganges; *vidyāra*—educational; *prasaṅge*—in discussion.

TRANSLATION

Once on a full moon night the Lord was sitting on the bank of the Ganges

with His many disciples and discussing literary topics.

TEXT 29

hena-kāle digvijayī tāhāñi āilā
gaṅgāre vandana kari' prabhure mililā

SYNONYMS

hena-kāle—at this time; *dig-vijayī*—Keśava Kāśmīrī; *tāhāñi*—there; *āilā*—reached; *gaṅgāre*—to mother Ganges; *vandana*—prayers; *kari'*—offering; *prabhure*—the Lord; *mililā*—met.

TRANSLATION

Coincidentally, Keśava Kāśmīrī Paṇḍita came there. While offering his prayers to mother Ganges, he met Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 30

vasāilā tāre prabhu ādara kariyā
digvijayī kahe mane avajñā kariyā

SYNONYMS

vasāilā—made seated; *tāre*—him; *prabhu*—the Lord; *ādara*—adoration; *kariyā*—offering him; *dig-vijayī*—Keśava Kāśmīrī; *kahe*—says; *mane*—within his mind; *avajñā*—disregard; *kariyā*—doing.

TRANSLATION

The Lord received him with adoration, but because Keśava Kāśmīrī was very proud, he talked to the Lord very inconsiderately.

TEXT 31

vyākaraṇa paḍāha, nimāñi paṇḍita tomāra nāma

bālya-śāstre loke tomāra kahe guṇa-grāma

SYNONYMS

vyākaraṇa—grammar; *paḍāha*—You teach; *nimāñi paṇḍita*—Nimāi Paṇḍita; *tomāra*—Your; *nāma*—name; *bālya-śāstre*—in grammar, which is considered a study for boys; *loke*—the people in general; *tomāra*—of You; *kahe*—declare; *guṇa-grāma*—very much qualified.

TRANSLATION

“I understand that You are a teacher of grammar,” he said, “and that Your name is Nimāi Paṇḍita. People speak very highly of Your teaching of beginners’ grammar.

PURPORT

Formerly Sanskrit schools first taught grammar very thoroughly, and this system continues even now. A student was supposed to study grammar carefully for twelve years in the beginning of his life, because if one is expert in the grammar of the Sanskrit language, all the *śāstras* are open to him. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was famous for teaching grammar to students, and therefore Keśava Kāśmīrī first referred to His position as a teacher of grammar. Keśava Kāśmīrī was very proud of his literary career; he was far above the first lessons of grammar, and so he thought the position of Nimāi Paṇḍita not at all comparable to his own.

TEXT 32

vyākaraṇa-madhye, jāni, paḍāha kalāpa

śuniluṅ phāṅkite tomāra śiṣyera saṁlāpa

SYNONYMS

vyākaraṇa-madhye—among grammars; *jāni*—I understand; *paḍāha*—You teach; *kalāpa*—the *Kalāpa-vyākaraṇa*; *śuniluṅ*—I have heard; *phāṅkite*—in deceitful word jugglery; *tomāra*—Your; *śiṣyera*—of the disciples; *saṁlāpa*—the specific knowledge.

TRANSLATION

“I understand that You teach *Kalāpa-vyākaraṇa*. I have heard that Your students are very expert in the word jugglery of this grammar.”

PURPORT

There are many schools of grammar in the Sanskrit language, the most famous of which are the systems of Pāṇini and the *Kalāpa* and *Kaumudī* grammars. There were different branches of grammatical knowledge, and a student of grammar was supposed to study them all in twelve years. Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who was famous as Nimāi Paṇḍita, taught grammar to His students, who became expert in dealing with the word jugglery of complicated grammar. Almost anyone expert in studying grammar interprets the *śāstras* in many ways by changing the root meanings of their words. A student of grammar can sometimes completely change the meaning of a sentence by juggling grammatical rules. Keśava Kāśmīrī indirectly taunted Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu by implying that although He was a great teacher of grammar, such grammatical jugglery of root meanings did not require great expertise. This was a challenge to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Because it was prearranged that Keśava Kāśmīrī would have to discuss the *śāstras* with Nimāi Paṇḍita, from the very beginning he wanted to bluff the Lord. Thus the Lord replied as follows.

TEXT 33

prabhu kahe, vyākaraṇa paḍāi—abhimāna kari

śiṣyete nā bujhe, āmi bujhāite nāri

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord replied; *vyākaraṇa paḍāi*—yes, I teach grammar; *abhimāna kari*—I am supposed to do so; *śiṣyete*—amongst My disciples; *nā*—do not; *bujhe*—understand; *āmi*—I also; *bujhāite*—to make them understand; *nāri*—am not able.

TRANSLATION

The Lord said, “Yes, I am known as a teacher of grammar, but factually I cannot impress My students with grammatical knowledge, nor can they understand Me very well.

PURPORT

Since Keśava Kāśmīrī was a little puffed up, the Lord increased his artificial pride by presenting Himself as subordinate to him. Thus He flattered him as follows.

TEXT 34

kāhān tumi sarva-śāstre kavīte pravīṇa

kāhān āmi sabe śīśu—paḍuyā navīna

SYNONYMS

kāhān—whereas; *tumi*—your good self; *sarva-śāstre*—in all scriptures; *kavīte*—in a literary career; *pravīṇa*—very much experienced; *kāhān*—whereas; *āmi*—I; *sabe*—just; *śīśu*—a boy; *paḍuyā*—student; *navīna*—new.

TRANSLATION

“My dear sir, whereas you are a very learned scholar in all sorts of scriptures and are very much experienced in composing poetry, I am only a boy—a new student and nothing more.

TEXT 35

tomāra kavitva kichu śunite haya mana

kṛpā kari’ kara yadi gaṅgāra varṇana

SYNONYMS

tomāra—your; *kavitva*—poetic integrity; *kichu*—something; *śunite*—to hear; *haya*—becomes; *mana*—mind; *kṛpā*—mercy; *kari’*—showing Me; *kara*—you do; *yadi*—if; *gaṅgāra*—of mother Ganges; *varṇana*—description.

TRANSLATION

“Therefore I desire to hear your skill in composing poetry. We could hear this if you would mercifully describe the glory of mother Ganges.”

TEXT 36

śuniyā brāhmaṇa garve varṇite lāgilā

ghaṭī eke śata śloka gaṅgāra varṇilā

SYNONYMS

śuniyā—hearing this; *brāhmaṇa*—the *paṇḍita*, Keśava Kāśmīrī; *garve*—in pride; *varṇite*—to describe; *lāgilā*—began; *ghaṭī*—hour; *eke*—one; *śata*—hundred; *śloka*—verses; *gaṅgāra*—of the Ganges; *varṇilā*—

described.

TRANSLATION

When the brāhmaṇa, Keśava Kāśmīrī, heard this, he became still more puffed up, and within one hour he composed one hundred verses describing mother Ganges.

TEXT 37

śuniyā karila prabhu bahuta satkāra

tomā sama prṥthivīte kavi nāhi āra

SYNONYMS

śuniyā—hearing this; *karila*—did; *prabhu*—the Lord; *bahuta*—very much; *satkāra*—high praise; *tomā*—you; *sama*—like; *prṥthivīte*—in the world; *kavi*—poet; *nāhi*—there is not; *āra*—anyone else.

TRANSLATION

The Lord praised him, saying, “Sir, there is no greater poet than you in the entire world.

TEXT 38

tomāra kavita śloka bujhite kāra śakti

tumi bhāla jāna artha kimvā sarasvatī

SYNONYMS

tomāra—your; *kavita*—poetry; *śloka*—verses; *bujhite*—to understand; *kāra*—whose; *śakti*—power; *tumi*—you; *bhāla*—well; *jāna*—know;

artha—meaning; *kimvā*—or; *sarasvatī*—the goddess of learning.

TRANSLATION

“Your poetry is so difficult that no one can understand it but you and mother Sarasvatī, the goddess of learning.

PURPORT

Replying to Keśava Kāśmīrī sarcastically, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu indirectly minimized the value of his poetry by saying, “Yes, your compositions are so nice that no one but you and your worshipable mother, the goddess of learning, can understand them.” Keśava Kāśmīrī was a favorite devotee of mother Sarasvatī, the goddess of learning, but Caitanya Mahāprabhu, as the master of the goddess of learning, has the right to speak sarcastically of her devotees. In other words, although Keśava Kāśmīrī was proud of being favored by the goddess of learning, he did not know that she is controlled by Caitanya Mahāprabhu Himself because He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 39

eka ślokerā artha yadi kara nija-mukhe

śuni’ saba loka tabe pāiba baḍa-sukhe

SYNONYMS

eka—one; *ślokerā*—of a verse; *artha*—the meaning; *yadi*—if; *kara*—you do; *nija-mukhe*—by your own mouth; *śuni’*—hearing; *saba*—all; *loka*—persons; *tabe*—thereafter; *pāiba*—we shall get; *baḍa-sukhe*—with great happiness.

TRANSLATION

“But if you explain the meaning of one verse, we can all hear it from your own mouth and thus be very happy.”

TEXT 40

tabe digvijayī vyākhyāra śloka puchila

śata ślokerā eka śloka prabhu ta’ paḍila

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *dig-vijayī*—Keśava Kāśmīrī; *vyākhyāra*—for explanation; *śloka*—a verse; *puchila*—inquired about; *śata*—one hundred; *ślokerā*—of the verses; *eka*—one; *śloka*—verse; *prabhu*—the Lord; *ta’*—then; *paḍila*—recited.

TRANSLATION

The Digvijayī, Keśava Kāśmīrī, inquired which verse He wanted explained. The Lord then recited one of the one hundred verses Keśava Kāśmīrī had composed.

TEXT 41

mahattvam gaṅgāyāḥ satatam idam ābhāti nītarām

yad eṣā śrī-viṣṇoś caraṇa-kamalotpatti-subhagā

dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr iva sura-narair arcya-caraṇā

bhavānī-bhartur yā śīrasi vibhavaty adbhuta-guṇā

SYNONYMS

mahattvam—greatness; *gaṅgāyāḥ*—of mother Ganges; *satatam*—always;

idam—this; *ābhāti*—shines; *nitarām*—without comparison; *yat*—because; *eṣā*—she; *śrī-viṣṇoḥ*—of Lord Viṣṇu; *caraṇa*—feet; *kamala*—lotus flower; *utpatti*—generation; *subhagā*—fortunate; *dvitīya*—second; *śrī*—beautiful; *lakṣmīḥ*—goddess of fortune; *iva*—like; *sura-naraiḥ*—by demigods and human beings; *arcyā*—worshipable; *caraṇā*—feet; *bhavānī*—of goddess Durgā; *bhartuḥ*—of the husband; *yā*—she; *śīrasi*—on the head; *vibhavati*—flourishes; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *guṇā*—qualities.

TRANSLATION

“The greatness of mother Ganges always brilliantly exists. She is the most fortunate because she emanated from the lotus feet of Śrī Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead. She is a second goddess of fortune, and therefore she is always worshiped both by demigods and by humanity. Endowed with all wonderful qualities, she flourishes on the head of Lord Śiva.”

TEXT 42

‘ei ślokerā artha kara’—prabhu yadi baila

vismita hañā digvijayī prabhure puchila

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *artha*—explanation; *kara*—kindly do; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya; *yadi*—when; *baila*—said; *vismita*—struck with wonder; *hañā*—being; *dig-vijayī*—the champion; *prabhure*—unto the Lord; *puchila*—inquired.

TRANSLATION

When Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu asked him to explain the meaning of this verse, the champion, very much astonished, inquired from Him as follows.

TEXT 43

jhañjhāvāta-prāya āmi śloka paḍila

tāra madhye śloka tumi kaiche kaṇṭhe kaila

SYNONYMS

jhañjhā-vāta—the strong wind of a storm; *prāya*—like; *āmi*—I; *śloka*—verses; *paḍila*—recited; *tāra*—of them; *madhye*—in the midst; *śloka*—one verse; *tumi*—You; *kaiche*—how; *kaṇṭhe*—within the heart; *kaila*—have taken.

TRANSLATION

“I recited all the verses like the blowing wind. How could You completely learn by heart even one among those verses?”

TEXT 44

prabhu kahe, devera vare tumi—‘kavi-vara’

aiche devera vare keho haya ‘śrutidhara’

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *kahe*—replied; *devera*—of a superior power; *vare*—by benediction; *tumi*—you; *kavi-vara*—the most elevated poet; *aiche*—similarly; *devera*—of the Lord; *vare*—by the benediction; *keho*—someone; *haya*—becomes; *śruti-dhara*—one who can immediately remember.

TRANSLATION

The Lord replied, “By the grace of the Lord someone may become a great

poet, and similarly by His grace someone else may become a great śruti-dhara who can memorize anything immediately.”

PURPORT

In this connection, *śruti-dhara* is a very important word. *Śruti* means “hearing,” and *dhara* means “one who can capture.” Formerly, before the beginning of Kali-yuga, almost everyone, especially among the intelligent men, the *brāhmaṇas*, was a *śruti-dhara*. As soon as a student heard any of the Vedic wisdom from his master, he would remember it forever. There was no need to refer to books, and therefore there were no written books in those days. The spiritual master delivered the Vedic hymns and their explanations to the student, who would then remember them forever, without consulting books.

To become a *śruti-dhara*, one who can remember simply by hearing, is a great achievement for a student. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.41) the Lord says:

*yad yad vibhūtimat sattvaṁ śrīmad ūrjitam eva vā
tat tad evāvagaccha tvam mama tejo-’mśa-sambhavam*

“Know that all opulent, beautiful and glorious creations spring from but a spark of My splendor.”

As soon as we find anything extraordinary, we should understand that such an extraordinary manifestation is the special grace of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu replied to the champion, Keśava Kāśmīrī, that just as he was greatly proud of being a favorite devotee of mother Sarasvatī, so someone else, like Caitanya Mahāprabhu Himself, being favored by the Supreme Personality of Godhead, could become a *śruti-dhara* and thus memorize anything immediately simply by hearing it.

TEXT 45

ślokerā artha kaila vipra pāiyā santoṣa

prabhu kahe—kaha ślokerā kibā guṇa-doṣa

SYNONYMS

ślokerā—of the verse; *artha*—explanation; *kaila*—made; *vipra*—the *brāhmaṇa*; *pāiyā*—obtaining; *santoṣa*—satisfaction; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kahe*—said; *kaha*—kindly speak; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *kibā*—what are; *guṇa*—qualities; *doṣa*—faults.

TRANSLATION

Satisfied by the statement of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the *brāhmaṇa* [Keśava Kāśmīrī] explained the quoted verse. Then the Lord said, “Now kindly explain the special qualities and faults in the verse.”

PURPORT

Not only did Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu pick out this one among the one hundred verses and remember it although the *brāhmaṇa* had recited them like the blowing wind, but He also analyzed its qualities and faults. Not only did He hear the verse, but He immediately made a critical study of it.

TEXT 46

vipra kahe śloke nāhi doṣera ābhāsa

upamālaṅkāra guṇa, kichu anuprāsa

SYNONYMS

vipra kahe—the *brāhmaṇa* replied; *śloke*—in that verse; *nāhi*—there is not; *doṣera*—of fault; *ābhāsa*—even a tinge; *upamā-alaṅkāra*—simile or

metaphor; *guṇa*—quality; *kichu*—something; *anuprāsa*—alliteration.

TRANSLATION

The brāhmaṇa replied, “There is not a tinge of fault in that verse. Rather, it has the good qualities of similes and alliteration.”

PURPORT

In the last line of the verse quoted by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the letter *bha* is repeated many times, as in the words *bhavānī*, *bhartur*, *vibhavati* and *adbhuta*. Such repetition is called *anuprāsa*, or alliteration. The words *lakṣmīr iva* and *viṣṇoś caraṇa-kamalotpatti* are instances of *upamā-alaṅkāra*, for they exhibit metaphorical beauty. The Ganges is water, and Lakṣmī is the goddess of fortune. Since water and a person are not actually similar, the comparison is metaphorical.

TEXT 47

prabhu kahena,——kahi, yadi na karaha roṣa

kaha tomāra ei śloke kibā āche doṣa

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahena—the Lord replied; *kahi*—let Me say; *yadi*—if; *nā*—do not; *karaha*—you become; *roṣa*—angry; *kaha*—please tell Me; *tomāra*—your; *ei śloke*—in this verse; *kibā*—what; *āche*—there is; *doṣa*—fault.

TRANSLATION

The Lord said, “My dear sir, I may say something to you if you will not become angry. Can you explain the faults in this verse?”

TEXT 48

pratibhāra kāvya tomāra devatā santoṣe

bhāla-mate vicāṛile jāni guṇa-doṣe

SYNONYMS

pratibhāra—of ingenuity; *kāvya*—poetry; *tomāra*—your; *devatā*—the Lord; *santoṣe*—satisfies; *bhāla-mate*—scrutinizingly; *vicāṛile*—on analyzing; *jāni*—I know; *guṇa-doṣe*—there are faults and good qualities also.

TRANSLATION

“There is no doubt that your poetry is full of ingenuity, and certainly it has satisfied the Supreme Lord. Yet if we scrutinizingly consider it we can find both good qualities and faults.”

TEXT 49

tāte bhāla kari’ śloka karaha vicāra

kavi kahe,—ye kahile sei veda-sāra

SYNONYMS

tāte—therefore; *bhāla*—very carefully; *kari’*—doing it; *śloka*—the verse; *karaha*—do; *vicāra*—judgment; *kavi kahe*—the poet said; *ye kahile*—what You have said; *sei*—that is; *veda-sāra*—exactly right.

TRANSLATION

The Lord concluded, “Now, therefore, let us carefully scrutinize this verse.”

The poet replied, “Yes, the verse You have recited is perfectly correct.

TEXT 50

vyākaraṇiyā tumi nāhi paḍa alaṅkāra

tumi ki jānibe ei kavīvera sāra

SYNONYMS

vyākaraṇiyā—a student of grammar; *tumi*—You are; *nāhi*—do not; *paḍa*—study; *alaṅkāra*—poetic ornaments; *tumi*—You; *ki*—what; *jānibe*—will know; *ei*—this; *kavīvera*—of poetic quality; *sāra*—review.

TRANSLATION

“You are an ordinary student of grammar. What do You know about literary embellishments? You cannot review this poetry because You do not know anything about it.”

PURPORT

Keśava Kāśmīrī first wanted to bluff Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu by saying that since He was not an advanced student in literary style, He could not review a verse full of metaphors and literary ornaments. This argument has some basis in fact. Unless one is a medical man he cannot criticize a medical man, and unless one is a lawyer he cannot criticize a lawyer. Therefore Keśava Kāśmīrī first depreciated the Lord’s position. Because Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was to the champion a student of grammar, how could He dare criticize a great poet like him? Lord Caitanya, therefore, criticized the poet in a different way. He said that although He was certainly not advanced in a literary career, He had heard from others how to criticize such poetry, and as a *śruti-dhara*, possessing a complete memory, He could understand the process for such a review.

TEXT 51

prabhu kahena—ataeva puchiye tomāre

vicāriyā guṇa-doṣa bujhāha āmāre

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahena—the Lord said; *ataeva*—therefore; *puchiye*—I am asking; *tomāre*—you; *vicāriyā*—completely reviewing; *guṇa*—qualities; *doṣa*—faults; *bujhāha*—teach; *āmāre*—Me.

TRANSLATION

Taking a humble position, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu said, “Because I am not on your level, I have asked you to teach Me by explaining the faults and good qualities in your poetry.

TEXT 52

nāhi paḍi alaṅkāra, kariyāchi śravaṇa

tāte ei śloke dekhi bahu doṣa-guṇa

SYNONYMS

nāhi paḍi—I do not study; *alaṅkāra*—the art of literary embellishment; *kariyāchi*—I have done; *śravaṇa*—hearing; *tāte*—by that; *ei śloke*—in this verse; *dekhi*—I see; *bahu*—many; *doṣa*—faults; *guṇa*—good qualities.

TRANSLATION

“Certainly I have not studied the art of literary embellishments. But I have heard about it from higher circles, and thus I can review this verse and find in it many faults and many good qualities.”

PURPORT

The statement *kariyāchi śravaṇa* (“I have heard it”) is very important in the sense that hearing is more important than directly studying or perceiving. If one is expert in hearing and hears from the right source, his knowledge is immediately perfect. This process is called *śrauta-panthā*, or the acquisition of knowledge by hearing from authorities. All Vedic knowledge is based on the principle that one must approach a bona fide spiritual master and hear from him the authoritative statements of the *Vedas*. It is not necessary for one to be a highly polished literary man to receive knowledge; to receive perfect knowledge from a perfect person, one must be expert in hearing. This is called the descending process of deductive knowledge, or *avaroha-panthā*.

TEXT 53

kavi kahe,——kaha dekhi, kon guṇa-doṣa

prabhu kahena,——kahi, śuna, nā kariha roṣa

SYNONYMS

kavi kahe—the poet said; *kaha dekhi*—you say “I see”; *kon*—what; *guṇa*—good qualities; *doṣa*—faults; *prabhu kahena*—the Lord replied; *kahi*—let Me say; *śuna*—please hear; *nā*—do not; *kariha*—become; *roṣa*—angry.

TRANSLATION

The poet said, “All right, let me see what good qualities and faults You have found.”

The Lord replied, “Let Me speak, and please hear Me without becoming angry.

TEXT 54

pañca doṣa ei śloke pañca alaṅkāra

krame āmi kahi, śuna, karaha vicāra

SYNONYMS

pañca—five; *doṣa*—faults; *ei śloke*—in this verse; *pañca*—five; *alaṅkāra*—literary embellishments; *krame*—one after another; *āmi*—I; *kahi*—say; *śuna*—kindly hear; *karaha*—give; *vicāra*—judgment.

TRANSLATION

“My dear sir, in this verse there are five faults and five literary ornaments. I shall state them one after another. Kindly hear Me and then give your judgment.

PURPORT

In the verse beginning with *mahattvaṁ gaṅgāyāḥ* there are five literary ornaments and five examples of faulty composition. There are two examples of the fault called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* and one example each of the faults *viruddha-mati*, *punar-ukti* and *bhagna-krama*.

Vimṛṣṭa means “clean,” and *vidheyāṁśa* means “predicate.” It is a general rule of composition to establish a subject first and then give its predicate. For example, according to Sanskrit grammar if one says, “This man is learned,” his composition is in order. But if one says, “Learned is this man,” the composition is not in order. Such a flaw is called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa-doṣa*, or the fault of unclean composition. The subject matter to be known of the verse is the glorification of the Ganges, and therefore the word *idam* (“this”), or what is known, should have been placed before instead of after the glorification. The subject matter already known should be placed before the unknown so that its meaning will not be

misconstrued.

The second instance of *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa-doṣa* occurs in the words *dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr iva*. In this composition the word *dvitīya* (“second”) is *vidheya*, or unknown. Placing the unknown first to make the compound word *dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr* is another fault. The words *dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmīr iva* were intended to compare the Ganges to the goddess of fortune, but because of this fault the meaning of the compound word was bewildering.

The third fault is that of *viruddha-mati*, or contradictory conception, in the words *bhavānī-bhartuḥ*. The word *bhavānī* refers to the wife of Bhava, Lord Śiva. But since Bhavānī is already known as the wife of Lord Śiva, to add the word *bhartā*, “husband,” thus forming a compound meaning “the husband of the wife of Lord Śiva,” is contradictory, for thus it appears as if the wife of Lord Śiva had another husband.

The fourth fault is *punar-ukti*, or redundancy, which occurs when the verb *vibhavati* (“flourishes”), which should have ended the composition, is further qualified by the unnecessary adjective *adbhuta-guṇā* (“endowed with wonderful qualities”). The fifth fault is *bhagna-krama*, which means “broken order.” In the first, third and fourth lines there is *anuprāsa*, or alliteration, created by the sounds *ta*, *ra* and *bha*, but in the second line there is no such *anuprāsa*, and therefore the order is broken.

TEXT 55

‘*avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*’——*dui ṭhāñi cihna*

‘*viruddha-mati*’, ‘*bhagna-krama*’, ‘*punar-āṭṭa*’,——*doṣa tina*

SYNONYMS

avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa—unclean composition; *dui ṭhāñi*—in two places; *cihna*—symptoms; *viruddha-mati*—a contradictory conception; *bhagna-krama*—broken order; *punar-āṭṭa*—redundancy (also called *punar-ukti*);

doṣa—faults; *tina*—three.

TRANSLATION

“In this verse the fault of avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa occurs twice, and the faults of viruddha-mati, bhagna-krama and punar-ātta occur once each.

TEXT 56

‘gaṅgāra mahattva’——śloke mūla ‘vidheya’

idam śabde ‘anuvāda’——pāche avidheya

SYNONYMS

gaṅgāra mahattva—glorification of mother Ganges; *śloke*—in the verse; *mūla*—chief; *vidheya*—unknown; *idam śabde*—by the word *idam* (“this”); *anuvāda*—the known; *pāche*—at the end; *avidheya*—improper.

TRANSLATION

“The glorification of the Ganges [mahattvaṁ gaṅgāyāḥ] is the principal unknown subject matter in this verse, and the known subject matter is indicated by the word ‘idam,’ which has been placed after the unknown.

TEXT 57

‘vidheya’ āge kahi’ pāche kahile ‘anuvāda’

ei lāgi’ ślokerā artha kariyāche bādha

SYNONYMS

vidheya—what is unknown; *āge*—first; *kahi’*—after speaking; *pāche*—at the end; *kahile*—if one speaks; *anuvāda*—known things; *ei lāgi’*—for

this reason; *ślokerā*—of the verse; *ārtha*—meaning; *kariyāche*—has been made; *bādhā*—objectionable.

TRANSLATION

“Because you have placed the known subject at the end and that which is unknown at the beginning, the composition is faulty, and the meaning of the words has become doubtful.

TEXT 58

anuvādam anuktvaiva

na vidheyam udīrayet

na hy alabdhāspadam kiñcit

kuṭracit pratītiṣṭhati

SYNONYMS

anuvādam—things already known; *anuktvā*—without mentioning; *eva*—certainly; *na*—not; *vidheyam*—unknown subject matters; *udīrayet*—one should mention; *na*—not; *hi*—certainly; *alabdhā-āspadam*—without having achieved a proper place; *kiñcit*—something; *kuṭracit*—anywhere; *pratītiṣṭhati*—has a position.

TRANSLATION

“‘Without first mentioning what is known, one should not introduce the unknown, for that which has no solid basis can never be established anywhere.’

PURPORT

This is a verse from the *Ekādaśī-tattva*.

TEXT 59

‘dvitīya śrī-lakṣmī’—ihān ‘dvitīyatva’ vidheya

samāse gauṇa haila, śabdārtha gela kṣaya

SYNONYMS

dvitīya śrī-lakṣmī—the word *dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmī* (“a second all-opulent goddess of fortune”); *ihān*—this; *dvitīyatva*—the quality of being a second; *vidheya*—the unknown, which is to be explained; *samāse*—in the compound word; *gauṇa*—secondary; *haila*—became; *śabda-artha*—the word’s intended meaning; *gela*—became; *kṣaya*—lost.

TRANSLATION

“In the word ‘*dvitīya-śrī-lakṣmī*’ [‘a second all-opulent goddess of fortune’], the quality of being a second Lakṣmī is the unknown. In making this compound word, the meaning became secondary and the originally intended meaning was lost.

TEXT 60

‘dvitīya’ śabda—vidheya tāhā paḍila samāse

‘lakṣmīra samatā’ artha karila vināśe

SYNONYMS

dvitīya śabda—the word *dvitīya* (“second”); *vidheya*—the unknown; *tāhā*—that; *paḍila*—joined; *samāse*—in the compound word; *lakṣmīra*—with Lakṣmī; *samatā*—equality; *artha*—meaning; *karila*—became; *vināśe*—lost.

TRANSLATION

“Because the word ‘dvitīya’ [‘second’] is the unknown, in its combination in this compound word the intended meaning of equality with Lakṣmī is lost.

TEXT 61

‘avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa’——ei doṣera nāma

āra eka doṣa āche, śuna sāvadhāna

SYNONYMS

avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa—avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa; ei—this; doṣera—of the fault; nāma—the name; āra—another; eka—one; doṣa—fault; āche—there is; śuna—hear; sāvadhāna—carefully.

TRANSLATION

“Not only is there the fault avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa, but there is also another fault, which I shall point out to you. Kindly hear Me with great attention.

TEXT 62

‘bhavānī-bharṭṛ’-śabda dile pāiyā santoṣa

‘viruddha-mati-kṛt’ nāma ei mahā doṣa

SYNONYMS

bhavānī-bharṭṛ śabda—the word bhavānī-bharṭṛ (“the husband of Bhavānī”); dile—you have placed; pāiyā—getting; santoṣa—very much satisfaction; viruddha-mati-kṛt—a statement of opposing elements;

nāma—named; *ei*—this; *mahā*—great; *doṣa*—fault.

TRANSLATION

“Here is another great fault. You have arranged the word ‘bhavānī-bhartr̥’ to your great satisfaction, but this betrays the fault of contradiction.

TEXT 63

bhavānī-śabde kahe mahādevera gṛhiṇī

tāñra bhartā kahile dvitīya bhartā jāni

SYNONYMS

bhavānī śabde—by the word *bhavānī*; *kahe*—is mentioned; *mahādevera*—of Lord Śiva; *gṛhiṇī*—the wife; *tāñra*—her; *bhartā*—husband; *kahile*—if we say; *dvitīya*—second; *bhartā*—husband; *jāni*—we understand.

TRANSLATION

“The word ‘bhavānī’ means ‘the wife of Lord Śiva.’ But when we mention her husband, one might conclude that she has another husband.

TEXT 64

‘śiva-patnīra bhartā’ ihā śūnite viruddha

‘viruddha-mati-kṛt’ śabda śāstre nahe śuddha

SYNONYMS

śiva-patnīra—of the wife of Lord Śiva; *bhartā*—husband; *ihā*—this;

śunite—to hear; *viruddha*—contradiction; *viruddha-mati-kṛt*—that which creates a contradiction; *śabda*—such a word; *śāstre*—in the scriptures; *nahe*—is not; *śuddha*—pure.

TRANSLATION

“It is contradictory to hear that Lord Śiva’s wife has another husband. The use of such words in literature creates the fault called *viruddha-mati-kṛt*.

TEXT 65

‘brāhmaṇa-patnīra bhartāra haste deha dāna’

śabda śunitei haya dvitīya-bhartā jñāna

SYNONYMS

brāhmaṇa-patnīra—of the wife of a *brāhmaṇa*; *bhartāra*—of the husband; *haste*—in the hand; *deha*—give; *dāna*—charity; *śabda*—these words; *śunitei*—hearing; *haya*—there is; *dvitīya-bhartā*—another husband; *jñāna*—knowledge.

TRANSLATION

“If someone says, ‘Place this charity in the hand of the husband of the wife of the *brāhmaṇa*,’ when we hear these contradictory words we immediately understand that the *brāhmaṇa*’s wife has another husband.

TEXT 66

‘vibhavati’ kriyāya vākya—sāṅga, punaḥ viśeṣaṇa

‘adbhuta-guṇā’—ei punar-ātta dūṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

vibhavati kriyāya—by the verb *vibhavati* (“flourishes”); *vākya*—statement; *sāṅga*—complete; *punaḥ*—again; *viśeṣaṇa adbhuta-guṇa*—the adjective *adbhuta-guṇa* (“wonderful qualities”); *ei*—this; *punar-ātta*—repetition of the same word; *dūṣaṇa*—fault.

TRANSLATION

“The statement by the word ‘vibhavati’ [‘flourishes’] is complete. Qualifying it with the adjective ‘adbhuta-guṇa’ [‘wonderful qualities’] creates the fault of redundancy.

TEXT 67

tina pāde anuprāsa dekhi anupama

eka pāde nāhi, ei doṣa ‘bhagna-krama’

SYNONYMS

tina pāde—in three lines; *anuprāsa*—alliteration; *dekhi*—I see; *anupama*—extraordinary; *eka pāde*—in one line; *nāhi*—there is not (alliteration); *ei doṣa*—this fault; *bhagna-krama*—deviation.

TRANSLATION

“There is extraordinary alliteration in three lines of the verse, but in one line there is no such alliteration. This is the fault of deviation.

TEXT 68

yadyapi ei śloke āche pañca alaṅkāra

ei pañca-doṣe śloka kaila chārakhāra

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *ei śloke*—in this verse; *āche*—there are; *pañca*—five; *alañkāra*—literary embellishments; *ei pañca-doṣe*—by the above-mentioned five faults; *śloka*—the verse; *kaila*—has been made; *chārakhāra*—spoiled.

TRANSLATION

“Although there are five literary ornaments decorating this verse, the entire verse has been spoiled by these five most faulty presentations.

TEXT 69

daśa alaṅkāre yadi eka śloka haya

eka doṣe saba alaṅkāra haya kṣaya

SYNONYMS

daśa alaṅkāre—with ten instances of literary ornamentation; *yadi*—if; *eka*—one; *śloka*—verse; *haya*—there is; *eka doṣe*—by one fault; *saba*—all; *alaṅkāra*—ornaments; *haya kṣaya*—become null and void.

TRANSLATION

“If there are ten literary ornaments in a verse but even one faulty expression, the entire verse is nullified.

TEXT 70

sundara śarīra yaiche bhūṣaṇe bhūṣita

eka śveta-kuṣṭhe yaiche karaye vigīta

SYNONYMS

sundara—beautiful; *śarīra*—body; *yaiche*—as; *bhūṣaṇe*—with ornaments; *bhūṣita*—decorated; *eka*—one; *śveta-kuṣṭhe*—with a white spot of leprosy; *yaiche*—as; *karaye*—is made; *vigīta*—abominable.

TRANSLATION

“One’s beautiful body may be decorated with jewels, but one spot of white leprosy makes the entire body abominable.

PURPORT

The great sage Bharata Muni, an authority on poetic metaphor, has given his opinion in this connection as follows.

TEXT 71

rasālaṅkāra-vat kāvyaṁ

doṣa-yuk cet vibhūṣitam

syād vapuḥ sundaram api

śvitreṇaikena durbhagam

SYNONYMS

rasa—with humors; *alaṅkāra-vat*—with ornaments (metaphors, similes, etc.); *kāvyaṁ*—poetry; *doṣa-yuk*—faulty; *cet*—if; *vibhūṣitam*—very nicely decorated; *syāt*—it becomes so; *vapuḥ*—the body; *sundaram*—beautiful; *api*—even though; *śvitreṇa*—by a white spot of leprosy; *ekena*—one; *durbhagam*—unfortunate.

TRANSLATION

“As one’s body, although well-decorated with ornaments, is made unfortunate by even one spot of white leprosy, so an entire poem is made useless by a fault, despite alliteration, similes and metaphors.’

TEXT 72

pañca alaṅkāreṇa ebe śunaha vicāra

dui śabdālaṅkāra, tina artha-alaṅkāra

SYNONYMS

pañca—five; *alaṅkāreṇa*—of the literary embellishments; *ebe*—now; *śunaha*—just hear; *vicāra*—description; *dui*—two; *śabda-alaṅkāra*—ornaments of sound or ornaments of words; *tina*—three; *artha-alaṅkāra*—ornaments of meaning.

TRANSLATION

“Now hear the description of the five literary embellishments. There are two ornaments of sound and three ornaments of meaning.

TEXT 73

śabdālaṅkāra—tina-pāde āche anuprāsa

‘śrī-lakṣmī’ śabde ‘punar-uktavad-ābhāsa’

SYNONYMS

śabda-alaṅkāra—ornamentation of sound; *tina-pāde*—in three lines; *āche*—there is; *anuprāsa*—alliteration; *śrī-lakṣmī-śabde*—in the words *śrī-lakṣmī*; *punar-ukta-vat*—of repetition of the same word; *ābhāsa*—there is a tinge.

TRANSLATION

“There is a sound ornament of alliteration in three lines. And in the combination of the words ‘śrī’ and ‘lakṣmī’ there is the ornament of a tinge of redundancy.

TEXT 74

prathama-carāṇe pañca ‘ta’-kārera pāṇti

tṛtīya-carāṇe haya pañca ‘repha’-sthiti

SYNONYMS

prathama-carāṇe—in the first line; *pañca*—five; *ta-kārera*—of the letter *ta*; *pāṇti*—very nice composition; *tṛtīya-carāṇe*—in the third line; *haya*—there is; *pañca*—five; *repha*—of the letter *ra*; *sthiti*—composition.

TRANSLATION

“In the arrangement of the first line the letter ‘ta’ occurs five times, and the arrangement of the third line repeats the letter ‘ra’ five times.

TEXT 75

caturtha-carāṇe cāri ‘bha’-kāra-prakāśa

ataeva śabdālaṅkāra anuprāsa

SYNONYMS

caturtha-carāṇe—in the fourth line; *cāri*—four; *bha-kāra*—of the letter *bha*; *prakāśa*—manifestations; *ataeva*—therefore; *śabda-alaṅkāra*—ornamental use of different sounds; *anuprāsa*—alliteration.

TRANSLATION

“In the fourth line the letter ‘bha’ occurs four times. This arrangement of alliteration is a pleasing ornamental use of sounds.

TEXT 76

‘śrī’-śabde, ‘lakṣmī’-śabde—eka vastu ukta

punar-ukta-prāya bhāse, nahe punar-ukta

SYNONYMS

śrī-śabde—by the word *śrī*; *lakṣmī-śabde*—by the word *lakṣmī*; *eka vastu*—one thing; *ukta*—is indicated; *punar-ukta-prāya*—almost repetition; *bhāse*—appears; *nahe*—but actually it is not; *punar-ukta*—repetition.

TRANSLATION

“Although the words ‘śrī’ and ‘lakṣmī’ convey the same meaning and are therefore almost redundant, they are nevertheless not redundant.

TEXT 77

‘śrī-yukta lakṣmī’ arthe arthera vibheda

punar-uktavad-ābhāsa, śabdālaṅkāra-bheda

SYNONYMS

śrī-yukta lakṣmī—Lakṣmī, possessed of opulence; *arthe*—in the sense; *arthera*—of the meaning; *vibheda*—difference; *punar-ukta-vad-ābhāsa*—tinge of *punar-ukta-vat*; *śabda-alaṅkāra*—ornamental use of words; *bheda*—different.

TRANSLATION

“Describing Lakṣmī as possessed of śrī [opulence] offers a difference in meaning with a tinge of repetition. This is the second ornamental use of words.

TEXT 78

‘lakṣmīr iva’ arthālaṅkāra—upamā-prakāśa

āra arthālaṅkāra āche, nāma—‘virodhābhāsa’

SYNONYMS

lakṣmīr iva—the words *lakṣmīr iva* (“like Lakṣmī”); *artha-alaṅkāra*—ornamental use of the meaning; *upamā*—analogy; *prakāśa*—manifestation; *āra*—also; *artha-alaṅkāra*—ornamental use of meaning; *āche*—there is; *nāma*—which is named; *virodha-ābhāsa*—possibility of contradiction.

TRANSLATION

“The use of the words ‘lakṣmīr iva’ [‘like Lakṣmī’] manifests the ornament of meaning called upamā [analogy]. There is also the further ornament of meaning called virodhābhāsa, or a contradictory indication.

TEXT 79

‘gaṅgāte kamala janme’—sabāra subodha

‘kamale gaṅgāra janma’—atyanta virodha

SYNONYMS

gaṅgāte—in the river Ganges; *kamala*—lotus flower; *janme*—grows;

sabāra—of everyone; *subodha*—understanding; *kamale*—in the lotus flower; *gaṅgāra*—of the Ganges; *janma*—birth; *atyanta*—very much; *virodha*—contradiction.

TRANSLATION

“Everyone knows that lotus flowers grow in the water of the Ganges. But to say that the Ganges takes birth from a lotus flower seems extremely contradictory.

TEXT 80

‘ihāṇ viṣṇu-pāda-padme gaṅgāra utpatti’

virodhālaṅkāra ihā mahā-camatkṛti

SYNONYMS

ihāṇ—in this connection; *viṣṇu-pāda-padme*—in the lotus feet of Lord Viṣṇu; *gaṅgāra*—of mother Ganges; *utpatti*—beginning; *virodha*—contradiction; *alaṅkāra*—literary decoration; *ihā*—it; *mahā*—very great; *camatkṛti*—wonder.

TRANSLATION

“The existence of mother Ganges begins from the lotus feet of the Lord. Although this statement that water comes from a lotus flower is a contradiction, in connection with Lord Viṣṇu it is a great wonder.

TEXT 81

īśvara-acintya-śaktye gaṅgāra prakāśa

ihāte virodha nāhi, virodha-ābhāsa

SYNONYMS

īśvara-acintya-śaktye—by the inconceivable potency of the Supreme Lord; *gaṅgāra*—of the Ganges; *prakāśa*—emanation; *ihāte*—in this; *virodha nāhi*—there is no contradiction; *virodha-ābhāsa*—appears to be a contradiction.

TRANSLATION

“In this birth of the Ganges by the inconceivable potency of the Lord, there is no contradiction although it appears contradictory.

PURPORT

The central point of all Vaiṣṇava philosophy is to accept the inconceivable potency of Lord Viṣṇu. What sometimes appears contradictory from a material viewpoint is understandable in connection with the Supreme Personality of Godhead because He can perform contradictory activities by dint of His inconceivable potencies. Modern scientists are puzzled. They cannot even explain how such a large quantity of chemicals has formed the atmosphere. Scientists explain that water is a combination of hydrogen and oxygen, but when asked where such a large quantity of hydrogen and oxygen came from and how they combined to manufacture the great oceans and seas, they cannot answer because they are atheists who will not accept that everything comes from life. Their thesis is that life comes from matter.

Where do all these chemicals come from? The answer is that they are produced by the inconceivable energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Living entities are part of the Supreme Godhead, and from their bodies come many chemicals. For example, the lemon tree is a living entity that produces many lemons, and within each lemon is a great deal of citric acid. Therefore, if even an insignificant living entity who is but a part of the Supreme Lord can produce so much of a chemical, how much potency there must be in the body of the Supreme Personality of

Godhead.

Scientists cannot perfectly explain where the chemicals of the world are manufactured, but one can explain this perfectly by accepting the inconceivable energy of the Supreme Lord. There is no reason for denying this argument. Since there are potencies in the living entities who are samples of the Personality of Godhead, how much potency there must be in the Supreme Godhead Himself. As described in the *Vedas*, *nityo nityānām cetanaś cetanānām*: “He is the chief eternal of all eternal and the chief living entity among all living entities.” (*Kaṭha Upaniṣad*, 2.2.13)

Unfortunately, atheistic science will not accept that matter comes from life. Scientists insist upon their most illogical and foolish theory that life comes from matter, although this is quite impossible. They cannot prove in their laboratories that matter can produce life, yet there are thousands and thousands of examples illustrating that matter comes from life. Therefore in *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī says that as soon as one accepts the inconceivable potency of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, no great philosopher or scientist can put forward any thesis to contradict the Lord’s power. This is expressed in the following Sanskrit verse.

TEXT 82

ambujam ambuni jātām

kvacid api na jātam ambujād ambu

mura-bhidi tad-viparītām

pādāmbhojān mahā-nadī jātā

SYNONYMS

ambujam—lotus flower; *ambuni*—in the water; *jātam*—is grown; *kvacit*—at any time; *api*—certainly; *na*—not; *jātam*—grown; *ambujāt*—from a lotus flower; *ambu*—water; *mura-bhidi*—in Kṛṣṇa, the killer of Murāsura; *tat-viparītam*—just the opposite of that; *pāda-ambhojāt*—from the lotus flower of His feet; *mahā-nadī*—the great river; *jātā*—has grown.

TRANSLATION

“Everyone knows that lotus flowers grow in the water but water never grows from a lotus. All such contradictions, however, are wonderfully possible in Kṛṣṇa: the great river Ganges has grown from His lotus feet.’

TEXT 83

gaṅgāra mahattva—*sādhya, sādhana tāhāra*

viṣṇu-pādotpatti—*‘anumāna’ alaṅkāra*

SYNONYMS

gaṅgāra—of the Ganges; *mahattva*—opulences; *sādhya*—subject matter; *sādhana*—means; *tāhāra*—of that; *viṣṇu-pāda-utpatti*—her origin from the lotus feet of the Lord; *anumāna*—called *anumāna* (hypothesis); *alaṅkāra*—an ornament.

TRANSLATION

“The real glory of mother Ganges is that she has grown from the lotus feet of Lord Viṣṇu. Such a hypothesis is another ornament, called *anumāna*.

TEXT 84

sthūla ei pañca doṣa, pañca alaṅkāra

sūkṣma vicāriye yadī āchaye apāra

SYNONYMS

sthūla—gross; *ei*—these; *pañca*—five; *doṣa*—faults; *pañca*—five; *alaṅkāra*—literary ornaments; *sūkṣma*—in detail; *vicāriye*—we consider; *yadī*—if; *āchaye*—there are; *apāra*—unlimited.

TRANSLATION

“I have simply discussed the five gross faults and five literary embellishments of this verse, but if we consider it in fine detail we will find unlimited faults.

TEXT 85

pratibhā, kavitva tomāra devatā-prasāde

avicāra kāvye avaśya paḍe doṣa-bādhe

SYNONYMS

pratibhā—ingenuity; *kavitva*—poetic imagination; *tomāra*—your; *devatā*—of a demigod; *prasāde*—by the grace; *avicāra*—without good judgment; *kāvye*—in the poetry; *avaśya*—certainly; *paḍe*—there is; *doṣa*—fault; *bādhe*—obstruction.

TRANSLATION

“You have achieved poetic imagination and ingenuity by the grace of your worshipable demigod. But poetry not well reviewed is certainly subject to criticism.

TEXT 86

vicāri' kavitva kaile haya sunirmala

sālaṅkāra haile artha kare jhalamala

SYNONYMS

vicāri'—with proper consideration; *kavitva*—poetic explanation; *kaile*—if done; *haya*—it becomes; *sunirmala*—very pure; *sa-alaṅkāra*—with metaphorical use of words; *haile*—if it is; *artha*—meaning; *kare*—does; *jhalamala*—dazzle.

TRANSLATION

“Poetic skill used with due consideration is very pure, and with metaphors and analogies it is dazzling.”

TEXT 87

śuniyā prabhura vyākhyā digvijayī vismita

mukhe nā niḥsare vākya, pratibhā stambhita

SYNONYMS

śuniyā—hearing; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *vyākhyā*—explanation; *digvijayī*—the champion; *vismita*—struck with wonder; *mukhe*—in the mouth; *nā*—did not; *niḥsare*—come out; *vākya*—words; *pratibhā*—ingenuity; *stambhita*—choked up.

TRANSLATION

After hearing the explanation of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the champion poet was struck with wonder. His cleverness stunned, he could not say anything.

TEXT 88

kahite cāhaye kichu, nā āise uttara

tabe vicāraye mane ha-iyā phāṇphara

SYNONYMS

kahite—to speak; *cāhaye*—wants; *kichu*—something; *nā*—not; *āise*—comes; *uttara*—any reply; *tabe*—thereafter; *vicāraye*—considers; *mane*—within the mind; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *phāṇphara*—puzzled.

TRANSLATION

He wanted to say something, but no reply would come from his mouth.
He then began to consider this puzzle within his mind.

TEXT 89

paḍuyā bālaka kaila mora buddhi lopa

jāni——*sarasvatī more kariyāchena kopa*

SYNONYMS

paḍuyā—student; *bālaka*—a boy; *kaila*—made; *mora*—my; *buddhi*—intelligence; *lopa*—lost; *jāni*—I can understand; *sarasvatī*—mother Sarasvatī; *more*—with me; *kariyāchena*—must have been; *kopa*—angry.

TRANSLATION

“This mere boy has blocked my intelligence. I can therefore understand that mother Sarasvatī has become angry with me.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is clearly said that all intelligence comes from the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is situated in everyone's heart as the Paramātmā. The Paramātmā gave the *paṇḍita* the intelligence to understand that because he was proud of his learning and wanted to defeat even the Supreme Lord, by the will of the Lord and through the agency of mother Sarasvatī he had been defeated. One should not, therefore, be too proud of one's position. Even if one is a greatly learned scholar, if he commits an offense to the lotus feet of the Lord he will not be able to speak properly, in spite of his learning. In every respect, we are controlled. Our only duty, therefore, is to surrender always to the lotus feet of the Lord and not be falsely proud. Mother Sarasvatī created this situation to favor the champion *paṇḍita* so that he might surrender unto Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 90

ye vyākhyā karila, se manuṣyera nahe śakti

nimāñi-mukhe rahi' bale āpane sarasvatī

SYNONYMS

ye vyākhyā—which explanation; *karila*—He has made; *se*—that; *manuṣyera*—of any human being; *nahe*—there is not; *śakti*—power; *nimāñi-mukhe*—in the mouth of this boy Nimāi; *rahi'*—remaining; *bale*—speaks; *āpane*—personally; *sarasvatī*—mother Sarasvatī.

TRANSLATION

“The wonderful explanation the boy has given could not have been possible for a human being. Therefore mother Sarasvatī must have spoken personally through His mouth.”

TEXT 91

eta bhāvi' kahe—śuna, nimāñi paṇḍita

tava vyākhyā śuni' āmi ha-ilāñ vismita

SYNONYMS

eta bhāvi—thinking like this; *kahe*—the *paṇḍita* says; *śuna*—hear; *nimāñi paṇḍita*—O Nimāi Paṇḍita; *tava*—Your; *vyākhyā*—explanations; *śuni'*—hearing; *āmi*—I; *ha-ilāñ*—have become; *vismita*—struck with wonder.

TRANSLATION

Thinking thus, the paṇḍita said, “My dear Nimāi Paṇḍita, please hear me. Hearing Your explanation, I am simply struck with wonder.

TEXT 92

alaṅkāra nāhi paḍa, nāhi śāstrābhyāsa

kemane e saba artha karile prakāśa

SYNONYMS

alaṅkāra—the literary use of words; *nāhi paḍa*—You never read; *nāhi*—nor is there; *śāstra-abhyāsa*—long practice in the discussion of the *śāstras*; *kemane*—by which method; *e saba*—all these; *artha*—explanations; *karile*—You have made; *prakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

“I am surprised. You are not a literary student and do not have long experience in studying the śāstras. How have You been able to explain all these critical points?”

TEXT 93

ihā śuni' mahāprabhu ati baḍa raṅgī

tāṅhāra hṛdaya jāni' kahe kari' bhaṅgī

SYNONYMS

ihā śuni'—hearing this; *mahāprabhu*—Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ati*—very; *baḍa*—much; *raṅgī*—funny; *tāṅhāra*—his; *hṛdaya*—heart; *jāni'*—understanding; *kahe*—says; *kari'*—doing; *bhaṅgī*—indication.

TRANSLATION

Hearing this and understanding the paṇḍita's heart, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu replied in a humorous way.

TEXT 94

śāstrera vicāra bhāla-manda nāhi jāni

sarasvatī ye balāya, sei bali vāṇī

SYNONYMS

śāstrera vicāra—discussion of *śāstra*; *bhāla-manda*—good or bad; *nāhi jāni*—do not know; *sarasvatī*—mother Sarasvatī; *ye balāya*—whatever she speaks; *sei*—those; *bali*—I say; *vāṇī*—words.

TRANSLATION

“My dear sir, I do not know what is good composition and what is bad. But whatever I have spoken must be understood to have been spoken by mother Sarasvatī.”

TEXT 95

ihā śuni' digvijayī karila niścaya

śīśu-dvāre devī more kaila parājaya

SYNONYMS

ihā śuni'—hearing this; *dig-vijayī*—the champion; *karila*—admitted; *niścaya*—decision; *śīśu-dvāre*—through this boy; *devī*—mother Sarasvatī; *more*—unto me; *kaila*—has done; *parājaya*—defeat.

TRANSLATION

When he heard this judgment from Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the paṇḍita sorrowfully wondered why mother Sarasvatī wanted to defeat him through a small boy.

TEXT 96

āji tāñre nivediba, kari' japa-dhyāna

śīśu-dvāre kaila more eta apamāna

SYNONYMS

āji—today; *tāñre*—unto her; *nivediba*—I shall offer my prayers; *kari'*—performing; *japa*—chanting; *dhyāna*—meditation; *śīśu-dvāre*—through a boy; *kaila*—has done; *more*—unto me; *eta*—so much; *apamāna*—insult.

TRANSLATION

“I shall offer prayers and meditation to the goddess of learning,” the champion concluded, “and ask her why she has insulted me so greatly through this boy.”

TEXT 97

vastutaḥ sarasvatī asuddha śloka karāila

vicāra-samaya tāñra buddhi ācchādila

SYNONYMS

vastutaḥ—in fact; *sarasvatī*—mother Sarasvatī; *asuddha*—impure; *śloka*—verse; *karāila*—caused him to compose; *vicāra-samaya*—at the time of reviewing; *tāñra*—his; *buddhi*—intelligence; *ācchādila*—covered.

TRANSLATION

Sarasvatī had in fact induced the champion to compose his verse in an impure way. Furthermore, when it was discussed she covered his intelligence, and thus the Lord’s intelligence was triumphant.

TEXT 98

tabe śiṣya-gaṇa saba hāsite lāgila

tā’-sabā niṣedhi’ prabhu kavire kahila

SYNONYMS

tabe—at that time; *śiṣya-gaṇa*—the disciples; *saba*—all; *hāsite*—to laugh; *lāgila*—began; *tā’-sabā*—all of them; *niṣedhi’*—forbidding; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kavire*—unto the poet; *kahila*—addressed.

TRANSLATION

When the poetic champion was thus defeated, all the Lord’s disciples sitting there began to laugh loudly. But Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu asked them not to do so, and He addressed the poet as follows.

TEXT 99

tumi baḍa paṇḍita, mahākavi-sīromaṇi

yāñra mukhe bāhirāya aiche kavya-vāṇī

SYNONYMS

tumi—you; *baḍa paṇḍita*—greatly learned scholar; *mahā-kavi*—of all great poets; *sīromaṇi*—the topmost; *yāñra*—of whom; *mukhe*—in the mouth; *bāhirāya*—emanates; *aiche*—such; *kāvya-vāṇī*—poetic language.

TRANSLATION

“You are the most learned scholar and the topmost of all great poets, for otherwise how could such fine poetry come from your mouth?”

TEXT 100

tomāra kavitva yena gaṅgā-jala-dhāra

tomā-sama kavi kothā nāhi dekhi āra

SYNONYMS

tomāra—your; *kavitva*—poetic ingenuity; *yena*—like; *gaṅgā-jala-dhāra*—the flowing of the waters of the Ganges; *tomā-sama*—like you; *kavi*—poet; *kothā*—anywhere; *nāhi*—not; *dekhi*—I see; *āra*—anyone else.

TRANSLATION

“Your poetic skill is like the constant flow of the waters of the Ganges. I find no one in the world who can compete with you.”

TEXT 101

bhavabhūti, jayadeva, āra kālīdāsa

tān-sabāra kavīte āche doṣera prakāśa

SYNONYMS

bhavabhūti—Bhavabhūti; *jayadeva*—Jayadeva; *āra*—and; *kālīdāsa*—Kālīdāsa; *tān-sabāra*—of all of them; *kavīte*—in the poetic power; *āche*—there is; *doṣera*—of faults; *prakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

“Even in the poetic compositions of such great poets as Bhavabhūti, Jayadeva and Kālīdāsa there are many examples of faults.

TEXT 102

doṣa-guṇa-vicāra—ei alpa kari’ māni

kavīta-karaṇe śakti, tānhā se vākhāni

SYNONYMS

doṣa-guṇa-vicāra—therefore to criticize one’s poetry as good or bad; *ei*—this; *alpa*—negligible; *kari’*—making; *māni*—I consider; *kavīta*—poetic ingenuity; *karaṇe*—in performing; *śakti*—power; *tānhā*—that; *se*—we; *vākhāni*—describe.

TRANSLATION

“Such mistakes should be considered negligible. One should see only how such poets have displayed their poetic power.

PURPORT

In *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.5.11) it is said:

*tad-vāg-visargo janatāgha-viplavo
yasmin prati-ślokaṁ abaddhavyaty api
nāmāny anantasya yaśo 'ñkitāni yat
śṛṇvanti gāyanti gṛṇanti sādhaḥ*

“In explaining the glories of the Lord, inexperienced men may compose poetry with many faults, but because it contains glorification of the Lord, great personalities read it, hear it and chant it.” Despite its minute literary discrepancies, one must study poetry on the merit of its subject matter. According to Vaiṣṇava philosophy, any literature that glorifies the Lord, whether properly written or not, is first class. There need be no other considerations. The poetic compositions of Bhavabhūti, or Śrīkaṇṭha, include *Mālatī-mādhava*, *Uttara-carita*, *Vīra-carita* and many similar Sanskrit dramas. This great poet was born during the time of Bhojarāja as the son of Nīlakaṇṭha, a *brāhmaṇa*. Kālidāsa flourished during the time of Mahārāja Vikramāditya, and he became the state poet. He composed some thirty or forty Sanskrit dramas, including *Kumāra-sambhava*, *Abhijñāna-śakuntalā* and *Megha-dūta*. His drama *Raghu-varṁśa* is especially famous. We have already described Jayadeva in Chapter Thirteen of the *Ādi-līlā*.

TEXT 103

śaiśava-cāpalya kichu nā labe āmāra

śiṣyera samāna muñi nā hañ tomāra

SYNONYMS

śaiśava—childish; *cāpalya*—impudence; *kichu*—anything; *nā*—do not; *labe*—please take; *āmāra*—My; *śiṣyera*—of disciples; *samāna*—the

equal; *muñi*—I; *na*—not; *hañ*—am; *tomāra*—your.

TRANSLATION

“I am not even fit to be your disciple. Therefore kindly do not take seriously whatever childish impudence I have shown.

TEXT 104

āji vāsā' yāha, kāli miliba ābāra

śuniba tomāra mukhe śāstrera vicāra

SYNONYMS

āji—today; *vāsā'*—resting place; *yāha*—go back; *kāli*—tomorrow; *miliba*—we will meet; *ābāra*—again; *śuniba*—I shall hear; *tomāra mukhe*—from your mouth; *śāstrera*—on the *śāstras*; *vicāra*—discussion.

TRANSLATION

“Please go back home, and tomorrow we may meet again so that I may hear discourses on the *śāstras* from your mouth.”

TEXT 105

ei-mate nija ghare gelā dui jana

kavi rātre kaila sarasvatī-ārādhana

SYNONYMS

ei-mate—in this way; *nija ghare*—to their respective homes; *gelā*—went back; *dui jana*—both of them; *kavi*—poet; *rātre*—at night; *kaila*—performed; *sarasvatī*—of mother Sarasvatī; *ārādhana*—worship.

TRANSLATION

In this way both the poet and Caitanya Mahāprabhu went back to their homes, and at night the poet worshiped mother Sarasvatī.

TEXT 106

sarasvatī swapne tāñre upadeśa kaila

sākṣāt īśvara kari' prabhuke jāñila

SYNONYMS

sarasvatī—mother Sarasvatī; *swapne*—in a dream; *tāñre*—unto him; *upadeśa*—advice; *kaila*—gave; *sākṣāt*—directly; *īśvara*—the Supreme Person; *kari'*—accepting; *prabhuke*—the Lord; *jāñila*—he understood.

TRANSLATION

In a dream the goddess informed him of the Lord's position, and the poetic champion could understand that Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the Supreme Personality of Godhead Himself.

TEXT 107

prāte āsi' prabhu-pade la-ila śaraṇa

prabhu kṛpā kaila, tāñra khaṇḍila bandhana

SYNONYMS

prāte—in the morning; *āsi'*—coming back; *prabhu-pade*—at the lotus feet of the Lord; *la-ila*—took; *śaraṇa*—shelter; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kṛpā*—mercy; *kaila*—showed; *tāñra*—his; *khaṇḍila*—cut off; *bandhana*—all bondage.

TRANSLATION

The next morning the poet came to Lord Caitanya and surrendered unto His lotus feet. The Lord bestowed His mercy upon him and cut off all his bondage to material attachment.

PURPORT

The same process advocated by Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa in His teachings of the *Bhagavad-gītā* as it is—“Surrender unto Me in all instances”—was advocated by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The champion surrendered unto the Lord, and the Lord favored him. One who is favored by the Lord is freed from material bondage, as stated in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.9):
tyaktvā dehaṁ punar janma naiti mām eti so 'rjuna.

TEXT 108

bhāgyavanta digvijayī saphala-jīvana

vidyā-bale pāila mahāprabhura caraṇa

SYNONYMS

bhāgyavanta—very fortunate; *dig-vijayī*—the poetic champion; *saphala*—successful; *jīvana*—life; *vidyā-bale*—by the strength of learning; *pāila*—got; *mahā-prabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *caraṇa*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

The poetic champion was certainly most fortunate. His life was successful by dint of his vast learning and erudite scholarship, and thus he attained the shelter of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

Śrī Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura has sung that the best qualification for taking shelter of the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya is to be the most fallen because the Lord came specifically to deliver the fallen souls. In this age there are very few scholars. Almost everyone is a fallen meat-eater, drunkard, woman-hunter or gambler. Such persons are never considered learned scholars, even if they pose as such. Because these so-called scholars superficially see that Caitanya Mahāprabhu associates with the fallen souls, they think that He is meant for a lower class of men but that they do not need Him. Thus such scholars do not take to the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. To be puffed up with false learning, therefore, is a disqualification for accepting the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. But here is a special example, for although the poetic champion was a greatly learned scholar, the Lord also favored him because of his humble submission.

TEXT 109

e-saba līlā varṇiyāchena vṛndāvana-dāsa

ye kichu viśeṣa ihān karila prakāśa

SYNONYMS

e-saba—all these; *līlā*—pastimes; *varṇiyāchena*—has described; *vṛndāvana-dāsa*—Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *ye kichu*—whatever; *viśeṣa*—specifics; *ihān*—in this connection; *karila*—I have made; *prakāśa*—presentation.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has described all these incidents elaborately. I have only presented the specific incidents he has not described.

TEXT 110

caitanya-gosāñīra līlā—amṛtera dhāra

sarvendriya tṛpta haya śravaṇe yāhāra

SYNONYMS

caitanya-gosāñīra līlā—the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *amṛtera dhāra*—drops of nectar; *sarva-indriya*—all senses; *tṛpta*—satisfied; *haya*—become; *śravaṇe*—by hearing; *yāhāra*—of them all.

TRANSLATION

The nectarean drops of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s pastimes can satisfy the senses of everyone who hears them.

TEXT 111

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-rūpa—Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī; *raghunātha*—Śrīla Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *pade*—at the lotus feet; *yāra*—whose; *āśa*—expectation; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-

līlā, Sixteenth Chapter, describing the pastimes of the Lord in His childhood and youth.

Chapter 17

The Pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in His Youth

The Seventeenth Chapter, as summarized by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, describes Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's pastimes from His sixteenth year until the time He accepted the renounced order of life. Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has already vividly described these pastimes in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*; therefore Kṛṣṇa dāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī describes them only briefly. Vivid descriptions of some portions of His pastimes are seen in this chapter, however, because Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has not elaborately described them.

In this chapter we shall find descriptions of the mango distribution festival and Lord Caitanya's discourses with Chand Kazi. Finally, the chapter shows that the same son of mother Yaśodā, Lord Kṛṣṇa, tasted four transcendental mellows of devotional service in His form of Śacīnandana, the son of mother Śacī. To understand Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī's ecstatic love for Him, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa assumed the form of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The attitude of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī is considered the superexcellent devotional mentality. As Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Kṛṣṇa Himself assumed the position of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī to taste Her ecstatic situation. No one else could do this.

When Śrī Kṛṣṇa assumed the form of the four-armed Nārāyaṇa, the *gopīs* showed their respect, but they were not very interested in Him. In the ecstatic love of the *gopīs*, all worshipable forms but Kṛṣṇa are rejected. Among all the *gopīs*, Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī has the highest ecstatic love. When Kṛṣṇa in His form of Nārāyaṇa saw Rādhārāṇī, He could not keep His position as Nārāyaṇa, and again He assumed the form of Kṛṣṇa.

The King of Vrajabhūmi is Nanda Mahārāja, and the same person in Navadvīpa is Jagannātha Miśra, the father of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Similarly, mother Yaśodā is the Queen of Vrajabhūmi, and in the pastimes of Lord Caitanya she is Śacīmātā. Therefore the son of Śacī is the son of Yaśodā. Śrī Nityānanda occupies an ecstatic position of parental love in servitude and fraternal attraction. Śrī Advaita Prabhu exhibits the ecstasy of both fraternity and servitude. All the Lord's other associates, situated in their original love, engage in the service of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

The same Absolute Truth who enjoys as Kṛṣṇa, Śyāmasundara, who plays His flute and dances with the *gopīs*, sometimes takes birth in a *brāhmaṇa* family and plays the part of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, accepting the renounced order of life. It appears contradictory that the same Kṛṣṇa accepted the ecstasy of the *gopīs*, and of course this is very difficult for an ordinary person to understand. But if we accept the inconceivable energy of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, we can understand that everything is possible. There is no need of mundane arguments in this connection, because mundane arguments are meaningless in regard to inconceivable potency.

At the end of the Seventeenth Chapter, Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, following in the footsteps of Śrīla Vyāsadeva, has summarized all the *ādi-līlā* pastimes separately.

TEXT 1

vande svairādbhutehaṁ taṁ

caitanyaṁ yat-prasādataḥ

yavanāḥ sumanāyante

kṛṣṇa-nāma-prajalpakāḥ

SYNONYMS

vande—let me offer my obeisances; *svaira*—completely independent; *adbhuta*—and uncommon; *īham*—whose activities; *tam*—unto Him; *caitanyam*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yat*—of whom; *prasādataḥ*—by the mercy; *yavanāḥ*—even the unclean; *sumanāyante*—are transformed into gentlemen; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—of the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prajalpakāḥ*—taking to the chanting.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, by whose mercy even unclean yavanas become perfectly well bred gentlemen by chanting the holy name of the Lord. Such is the power of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

PURPORT

There is a persistent misunderstanding between caste *brāhmaṇas* and advanced Vaiṣṇavas, or *gosvāmīs*, because caste *brāhmaṇas*, or *smārtas*, are of the opinion that one cannot become a *brāhmaṇa* unless he changes his body. As we have discussed several times, it is to be understood that by the supremely powerful potency of the Lord, as described by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, everything is possible. Caitanya Mahāprabhu is as fully independent as Kṛṣṇa. Therefore no one can interfere with His activities. If He wants, by His mercy He can convert even a *yavana*, an unclean follower of non-Vedic principles, into a perfectly well behaved gentleman. This is actually happening in our propagation of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement. The members of the present Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement were not born in India, nor do they belong to the Vedic culture, but within the short time of four or five years they have become such wonderful devotees simply by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* that even in India they are well received as perfectly well behaved Vaiṣṇavas wherever they go.

Although less intelligent men cannot understand it, this is the special power of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Actually, the body of a Kṛṣṇa conscious person changes in many ways. Even in the United States, when our devotees chant on the street, American ladies and gentlemen inquire from them whether they are actually Americans because no one could expect Americans to become such nice devotees all of a sudden. Even Christian priests are greatly surprised that all these boys from Jewish and Christian families have joined this Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement; before joining, they never regarded any principles of religion seriously, but now they have become sincere devotees of the Lord. Everywhere people express this astonishment, and we take great pride in the transcendental behavior of our students. Such wonders are possible, however, only by the mercy of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. They are not ordinary or mundane.

TEXT 2

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda

jayādvaitacandra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

jaya jaya—all glories; *śrī-caitanya*—to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jaya*—all glories; *nityānanda*—to Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *jaya advaita-candra*—all glories to Advaita Ācārya; *jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*—all glories to the devotees of Lord Caitanya.

TRANSLATION

All glories to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu! All glories to Lord Nityānanda Prabhu! All glories to Advaita Ācārya! And all glories to all the devotees of Lord Caitanya!

TEXT 3

kaiśora-līlāra sūtra karīla gaṇana

yauvana-līlāra sūtra kari anukrama

SYNONYMS

kaiśora-līlāra—of the activities before His youth; *sūtra*—synopsis; *karīla*—I have done; *gaṇana*—an enumeration; *yauvana-līlāra*—of the pastimes of youth; *sūtra*—synopsis; *kari*—I enumerate; *anukrama*—in chronological order.

TRANSLATION

I have already given a synopsis of the *kaiśora-līlā* of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Now let me enumerate His youthful pastimes in chronological order.

TEXT 4

vidyā-saundarya-sat-veśa-

sambhoga-nṛtya-kīrtanaiḥ

prema-nāma-pradānaiś ca

gauro dīvyati yauvane

SYNONYMS

vidyā—education; *saundarya*—beauty; *sat-veśa*—nice dress; *sambhoga*—enjoyment; *nṛtya*—dancing; *kīrtanaiḥ*—by chanting; *prema-nāma*—the holy name of the Lord, which induces one to become a devotee; *pradānaiḥ*—by distributing; *ca*—and; *gauro*—Lord Śrī Gaurasundara; *dīvyati*—illuminated; *yauvane*—in His youth.

TRANSLATION

Exhibiting His scholarship, beauty and fine dress, Lord Caitanya danced and chanted as He distributed the holy name of the Lord to awaken dormant love of Kṛṣṇa. Thus Lord Śrī Gaurasundara shone in His youthful pastimes.

TEXT 5

yauvana-praveśe aṅgera aṅga vibhūṣaṇa

divya vastra, divya veśa, mālya-candana

SYNONYMS

yauvana-praveśe—on the entrance of His youth; *aṅgera*—of the body; *aṅga*—limbs; *vibhūṣaṇa*—ornaments; *divya*—transcendental; *vastra*—garments; *divya*—transcendental; *veśa*—dress; *mālya*—garland; *candana*—(smeared with) sandalwood pulp.

TRANSLATION

As He entered His youth, the Lord decorated Himself with ornaments, dressed Himself in fine cloth, garlanded Himself with flowers and smeared Himself with sandalwood.

TEXT 6

vidyāra auddhatye kāhoṇ nā kare gaṇana

sakala paṇḍita jini' kare adhyāpana

SYNONYMS

vidyāra auddhatye—because of pride in education; *kāhoṇ*—anyone; *nā*—

does not; *kare*—do; *gaṇana*—care; *sakala*—all; *paṇḍita*—learned scholars; *jini'*—conquering; *kare*—does; *adhyāpana*—studies.

TRANSLATION

By dint of pride in His education, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, not caring for anyone else, defeated all kinds of learned scholars while executing His studies.

TEXT 7

vāyu-vyādhi-cchale kaila prema parakāśa

bhakta-gaṇa lañā kaila vividha vilāsa

SYNONYMS

vāyu-vyādhi—disease caused by disturbance of the air in the body; *cchale*—on the plea of; *kaila*—made; *prema*—love of Godhead; *parakāśa*—manifestation; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees; *lañā*—taking with Him; *kaila*—did; *vividha*—varieties of; *vilāsa*—pastimes.

TRANSLATION

In His youth the Lord exhibited His ecstatic love of Kṛṣṇa on the plea of disturbances of the bodily airs. Accompanied by His confidential devotees, He enjoyed various pastimes in this way.

PURPORT

According to Āyur-vedic treatment, the entire physiological system is conducted by three elements, namely *vāyu*, *pitta* and *kapha* (air, bile and mucus). Secretions within the body transform into other secretions like blood, urine and stool, but if there are disturbances in the metabolism, the secretions turn into *kapha* (mucus) by the influence of the air within

the body. According to the Āyur-vedic system, when the secretion of bile and formation of mucus disturb the air circulating within the body, fifty-nine varieties of diseases may occur. One such disease is craziness.

On the plea of disturbance of the bodily air and metabolism, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu acted as if crazy. Thus in His school He began to explain the grammar of verbs through Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Explaining everything in grammar in relationship to Kṛṣṇa, the Lord induced His students to refrain from worldly education, for it is better to become Kṛṣṇa conscious and in this way attain the highest perfectional platform of education. On these grounds, Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī later compiled the grammar entitled *Hari-nāmāmṛta-vyākaraṇa*. People in general consider such explanations crazy. Therefore the Lord's purpose in His attitude of craziness was to explain that there is nothing within our experience but Kṛṣṇa consciousness, for everything may be dovetailed with Kṛṣṇa consciousness. These pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu have been very vividly described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya-līlā, Chapter One.

TEXT 8

tabeta karilā prabhu gayāte gamana

īśvara-purīra saṅge tathāi milana

SYNONYMS

tabeta—thereafter; *karilā*—did; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *gayāte*—to Gayā; *gamana*—travel; *īśvara-purīra saṅge*—with Īśvara Purī; *tathāi*—there; *milana*—meeting.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter the Lord went to Gayā. There He met Śrīla Īśvara Purī.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu went to Gayā to offer respectful oblations to His forefathers. This process is called *piṇḍa-dāna*. In Vedic society, after the death of a relative, especially one's father or mother, one must go to Gayā and there offer oblations to the lotus feet of Lord Viṣṇu. Therefore hundreds and thousands of men gather in Gayā daily to offer such oblations, or *śrāddha*. Following this principle, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu also went there to offer *piṇḍa* to His dead father. Fortunately He met Īśvara Purī there.

TEXT 9

dīkṣā-anantare haila, premera prakāśa

deśe āgamana punaḥ premera vilāsa

SYNONYMS

dīkṣā—initiation; *anantare*—immediately after; *haila*—became; *premera*—of love of Godhead; *prakāśa*—exhibition; *deśe*—in His home country; *āgamana*—coming back; *punaḥ*—again; *premera*—of love of God; *vilāsa*—enjoyment.

TRANSLATION

In Gayā, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was initiated by Īśvara Purī, and immediately afterwards He exhibited signs of love of Godhead. He again displayed such symptoms after returning home.

PURPORT

When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu went to Gayā, accompanied by many of His disciples, He became sick on the way. He had such a high fever that He asked His students to bring water that had washed the feet of

brāhmaṇas, and when they brought it the Lord drank it and was cured. Therefore everyone should respect the position of a *brāhmaṇa*, as indicated by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Neither the Lord nor His followers displayed any disrespect to *brāhmaṇas*.

The followers of the Lord must be prepared to offer *brāhmaṇas* all due respect. But preachers of Lord Caitanya's cult object if someone presents himself as a *brāhmaṇa* without having the necessary qualifications. The followers of Lord Caitanya cannot blindly accept that everyone born in a *brāhmaṇa* family is a *brāhmaṇa*. Therefore one should not indiscriminately follow the Lord's example of showing respect to *brāhmaṇas* by drinking water that has washed their feet. Gradually the *brāhmaṇa* families have become degraded because of the contamination of Kali-yuga. Thus they misguide people by exploiting their sentiments.

TEXT 10

śacīke prema-dāna, tabe advaita-milana

advaita pāīla viśvarūpa-daraśana

SYNONYMS

śacīke—unto mother Śacīdevī; *prema-dāna*—giving love of Godhead; *tabe*—thereafter; *advaita*—with Advaita Ācārya; *milana*—meeting; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya; *pāīla*—received; *viśva-rūpa*—of the universal form of the Lord; *daraśana*—vision.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter the Lord delivered love of Kṛṣṇa to His mother, Śacīdevī, nullifying her offense at the feet of Advaita Ācārya. Thus there was a meeting with Advaita Ācārya, who later had a vision of the Lord's universal form.

PURPORT

One day Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was sitting on the throne of Viṣṇu in the house of Śrīvāsa Prabhu, and in a mood of His own He said, “My mother has offended the lotus feet of Advaita Ācārya. Unless she nullifies this offense at the lotus feet of a Vaiṣṇava, it will not be possible for her to achieve love of Kṛṣṇa.” Hearing this, all the devotees went to bring Advaita Ācārya there. While coming to see the Lord, Advaita Ācārya was glorifying the characteristics of mother Śacīdevī, and thus upon arriving He fell down on the ground in ecstasy. Then, under the instruction of Lord Caitanya, Śacīdevī took advantage of this situation to touch Advaita Ācārya’s lotus feet. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was very much pleased by His mother’s action, and He said, “Now My mother’s offense at the lotus feet of Advaita Ācārya has been rectified, and she may have love of Kṛṣṇa without difficulty.” By this example Lord Caitanya taught everyone that although one may be very much advanced in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, if one offends the lotus feet of a Vaiṣṇava his advancement will not bear fruit. We should therefore be very cautious not to offend a Vaiṣṇava. Śrī *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* has described such an offense as follows:

*yadī vaiṣṇava-aparādha uṭhe hātī mātā
upāḍe vā chiṇḍe, tāra śukhi’ yāya pātā*

(Cc. Madhya 19.156)

As a mad elephant may trample all the plants in a garden, so by committing one offense at the lotus feet of a Vaiṣṇava one may spoil all the devotional service he has accumulated in his life.

After this incident, one day Advaita Ācārya Prabhu requested Caitanya Mahāprabhu to display the universal form He had very kindly shown Arjuna. Lord Caitanya agreed to this proposal, and Advaita Prabhu was fortunate enough to see the universal form of the Lord.

TEXT 11

prabhura abhiṣeka tabe karila śrīvāsa

khāṭe vasi' prabhu kailā aiśvarya prakāśa

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *abhiṣeka*—worship; *tabe*—after that; *karila*—did; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa; *khāṭe*—on the cot; *vasi'*—sitting; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *kailā*—did; *aiśvarya*—opulence; *prakāśa*—manifestation.

TRANSLATION

Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura then worshiped Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu by the process of abhiṣeka. Sitting on a cot, the Lord exhibited transcendental opulence.

PURPORT

Abhiṣeka is a special function for the installation of the Deity. In this ceremony the Deity is bathed with milk and water and then worshiped and given a change of dress. This *abhiṣeka* function was especially observed at the house of Śrīvāsa. All the devotees, according to their means, worshiped the Lord with all kinds of paraphernalia, and the Lord gave benedictions to each devotee according to his desire.

TEXT 12

tabe nityānanda-svarūpera āgamana

prabhuke miliyā pāila ṣaḍ-bhuja-darśana

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *nityānanda-svarūpera*—of the Personality of Godhead

Nityānanda; *āgamana*—appearance; *prabhuke*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *miliyā*—meeting; *pāila*—obtained; *ṣaṭ-bhuja-darśana*—a vision of the six-armed Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

After this function at the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, Nityānanda Prabhu appeared, and when He met with Lord Caitanya He got the opportunity to see Him in His six-armed form.

PURPORT

The form of Ṣaḍ-bhuja, the six-armed Lord Gaurasundara, is a representation of three incarnations. The form of Śrī Rāmacandra is symbolized by a bow in one hand and an arrow in another, the form of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa is symbolized by a stick and a flute like those generally held by a cowherd boy, and Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is symbolized by a *sannyāsa-daṇḍa* and a *kamaṇḍalu*, or waterpot.

Śrīla Nityānanda Prabhu was born in the village of Ekacakrā, in the district of Birbhum, as the son of Padmāvatī and Hāḍāi Paṇḍita. In His childhood He played like Balarāma. When He was growing up, a *sannyāsī* came to the house of Hāḍāi Paṇḍita and begged to have the *paṇḍita's* son as his *brahmacārī* assistant. Hāḍāi Paṇḍita immediately agreed and delivered his son to him, although the separation was greatly shocking, so much so that Hāḍāi lost his life after the separation. Nityānanda Prabhu traveled on many pilgrimages with the *sannyāsī*. It is said that for many days He lived at Mathurā with him, and at that time He heard about Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu's pastimes in Navadvīpa. Therefore He came down to Bengal to see the Lord. When Lord Nityānanda came to Navadvīpa, He was a guest at the house of Nandana Ācārya. Understanding that Nityānanda Prabhu had arrived, Lord Caitanya sent His devotees to Him, and thus there was a meeting between Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu.

TEXT 13

prathame ṣaṭ-bhuja tāñre dekhāila īśvara

śaṅkha-cakra-gadā-padma-śārṅga-veṇu-dhara

SYNONYMS

prathame—at first; *ṣaṭ-bhuja*—six-armed; *tāñre*—unto Him; *dekhāila*—showed; *īśvara*—the Lord; *śaṅkha*—conchshell; *cakra*—disc; *gadā*—club; *padma*—lotus flower; *śārṅga*—bow; *veṇu*—flute; *dhara*—carrying.

TRANSLATION

One day Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu exhibited to Lord Nityānanda Prabhu a six-armed form bearing a conchshell, disc, club, lotus flower, bow and flute.

TEXT 14

tabe catur-bhuja hailā, tina aṅga vakra

dui haste veṇu bājāya, duye śaṅkha-cakra

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *catur-bhuja*—four-armed; *hailā*—became; *tina*—three; *aṅga*—body; *vakra*—curved; *dui haste*—in two hands; *veṇu bājāya*—blowing the flute; *duye*—in two (hands); *śaṅkha-cakra*—conchshell and disc.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter the Lord showed Him His four-armed form, standing in a three-curved posture. With two hands He played upon a flute, and in the

other two He carried a conchshell and disc.

TEXT 15

tabe ta' dvi-bhuja kevala vaṁśī-vadana

śyāma-aṅga pīta-vastra vrajendra-nandana

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *ta'*—certainly; *dvi-bhuja*—two-handed; *kevala*—only; *vaṁśī*—flute; *vadana*—on the mouth; *śyāma*—bluish; *aṅga*—body; *pīta-vastra*—yellow dress; *vrajendra-nandana*—the son of Nanda Mahārāja.

TRANSLATION

Finally the Lord showed Nityānanda Prabhu His two-armed form of Kṛṣṇa, the son of Mahārāja Nanda, simply playing on His flute, His bluish body dressed in yellow garments.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya-maṅgala vividly elaborates upon this description.

TEXT 16

tabe nityānanda-gosāñīra vyāsa-pūjana

nityānandāveśe kaila muṣala dhāraṇa

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda; *gosāñīra*—of the Lord; *vyāsa-pūjana*—worshiping Vyāsadeva or the spiritual master; *nityānanda-āveśe*—in the ecstasy of becoming Nityānanda; *kaila*—did; *muṣala*

dhāraṇa—carrying a plowlike weapon called a *muṣala*.

TRANSLATION

Nityānanda Prabhu then arranged to offer Vyāsa-pūjā, or worship of the spiritual master, to Lord Śrī Gaurasundara. But Lord Caitanya carried the plowlike weapon called *muṣala* in the ecstasy of being Nityānanda Prabhu.

PURPORT

By the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Nityānanda Prabhu arranged for the Vyāsa-pūjā of the Lord on the night of the full moon. He arranged for the Vyāsa-pūjā, or *guru-pūjā*, through the agency of Vyāsadeva. Since Vyāsadeva is the original *guru* (spiritual master) of all who follow the Vedic principles, worship of the spiritual master is called Vyāsa-pūjā. Nityānanda Prabhu arranged for the Vyāsa-pūjā, and *saṅkīrtana* was going on, but when He tried to put a garland on the shoulder of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, He saw Himself in Lord Caitanya. There is no difference between the spiritual positions of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu, or Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma. All of Them are but different manifestations of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. During this special ceremony, all the devotees of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu could understand that there is no difference between Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda Prabhu.

TEXT 17

tabe śacī dekhila, rāma-kṛṣṇa——dui bhāi

tabe nistārila prabhu jagāi-mādhāi

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *śacī*—mother Śacīdevī; *dekhila*—saw; *rāma-kṛṣṇa*—

Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Balarāma; *dui bhāi*—two brothers; *tabe*—thereafter; *nistārila*—delivered; *prabhu*—the Lord; *jagāi-mādhāi*—the two brothers Jagāi and Mādhāi.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter mother Śacīdevī saw the brothers Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma in Their manifestation of Lord Caitanya and Nityānanda. Then the Lord delivered the two brothers Jagāi and Mādhāi.

PURPORT

One night Śacīdevī dreamt that the Deities in her house, Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, had taken the forms of Caitanya and Nityānanda and were fighting one another, as children do, to eat the *naivedya*, or offering to the Deities. The next day, by the will of Lord Caitanya, Śacīdevī invited Nityānanda to take *prasādam* at her house. Thus Viśvambhara (Lord Caitanya) and Nityānanda were eating together, and Śacīdevī realized that They were none other than Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma. Seeing this, she fainted.

Jagāi and Mādhāi were two brothers born in Navadvīpa in a respectable *brāhmaṇa* family who later became addicted to all kinds of sinful activities. By the order of Lord Caitanya, both Nityānanda Prabhu and Haridāsa Ṭhākura used to preach the cult of Kṛṣṇa consciousness door to door. In the course of such preaching they found Jagāi and Mādhāi, two maddened drunken brothers, who, upon seeing them, began to chase them. On the next day, Mādhāi struck Nityānanda Prabhu on the head with a piece of earthen pot, thus drawing blood. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu heard of this, He immediately came to the spot, ready to punish both brothers, but when the all-merciful Lord Gaurāṅga saw Jagāi's repentant behavior, He immediately embraced him. By seeing the Supreme Personality of Godhead face to face and embracing Him, both the sinful brothers were at once cleansed. Thus they received initiation into the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* from the Lord and

were delivered.

TEXT 18

tabe sapta-prahara chilā prabhu bhāvāveśe

yathā tathā bhakta-gaṇa dekhila viśeṣe

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *sapta-prahara*—twenty-one hours; *chilā*—remained; *prabhu*—the Lord; *bhāva-āveśe*—in ecstasy; *yathā*—anywhere; *tathā*—everywhere; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees; *dekhila*—saw; *viśeṣe*—specifically.

TRANSLATION

After this incident, the Lord remained in an ecstatic position for twenty-one hours, and all the devotees saw His specific pastimes.

PURPORT

In the Deity's room there must be a bed for the Deity behind the His throne. (This system should immediately be introduced in all our centers. It does not matter whether the bed is big or small; it should be of a size the Deity room can conveniently accommodate, but there must be at least a small bed.) One day in the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu sat down on the bed of Viṣṇu, and all the devotees worshiped Him with the Vedic *mantras* of the *Puruṣa-sūkta*, beginning with *sahasra-śīrṣā puruṣaḥ sahasrākṣaḥ sahasra-pāt*. This *veda-stuti* should also be introduced, if possible, for installations of Deities. While bathing the Deity, all the priests and devotees must chant this *Puruṣa-sūkta* and offer the appropriate paraphernalia for worshiping the Deity, such as flowers, fruits, incense, *ārati* paraphernalia, *naivedya*, *vastra* and ornaments. All the devotees worshiped Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in

this way, and the Lord remained in ecstasy for seven *praharas*, or twenty-one hours. He took this opportunity to show the devotees that He is the original Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, who is the source of all other incarnations, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.8): *aham sarvasya prabhavo mattaḥ sarvaṁ pravartate*. All the different forms of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, or *viṣṇu-tattva*, emanate from the body of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu exposed all the private desires of the devotees, and thus all of them became fully confident that Lord Caitanya is the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Some devotees call this exhibition of ecstasy by the Lord *sāta-prahariyā bhāva*, or “the ecstasy of twenty-one hours,” and others call it *mahābhāva-prakāśa* or *mahā-prakāśa*. There is a description of this *sāta-prahariyā bhāva* in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Nine, which mentions that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu blessed a maidservant named Duḥkhī with the name Sukhī. He called for Kholāvecā Śrīdhara and showed him His *mahā-prakāśa*. Then He called for Murāri Gupta and showed him His feature as Lord Rāmacandra. He offered His blessings to Haridāsa Ṭhākura, and at this time He also asked Advaita Prabhu to explain the *Bhagavad-gītā* as it is (*gītāra satya-pāṭha*) and showed special favor to Mukunda.

TEXT 19

varāha-āveśa hailā murāri-bhavane

tānra skandhe caḍi’ prabhu nācīlā aṅgane

SYNONYMS

varāha-āveśa—the ecstasy of becoming Varāhadeva; *hailā*—became; *murāri-bhavane*—in the house of Murāri Gupta; *tānra skandhe*—on the shoulders of Murāri Gupta; *caḍi’*—riding; *prabhu*—the Lord; *nācīlā*—danced; *aṅgane*—in the yard.

TRANSLATION

One day Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu felt the ecstasy of the boar incarnation and got up on the shoulders of Murāri Gupta. Thus they both danced in Murāri Gupta’s courtyard.

PURPORT

One day Caitanya Mahāprabhu began to cry out, “Śūkara! Śūkara!” Thus crying out for the boar incarnation of the Lord, He assumed His form as the boar incarnation and got up on the shoulders of Murāri Gupta. He carried a small *gāḍu*, a small waterpot with a nozzle, and thus He symbolically picked up the earth from the depths of the ocean, for this is the pastime of Lord Varāha.

TEXT 20

tabe śuklāmbarera kaila taṇḍula-bhakṣaṇa

‘harer nāma’ ślokerā kaila artha vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *śuklāmbarera*—of Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī; *kaila*—did; *taṇḍula*—raw rice; *bhakṣaṇa*—eating; *harer nāma ślokerā*—of the verse celebrated as such; *kaila*—did; *artha*—of the meaning; *vivaraṇa*—explanation.

TRANSLATION

After this incident the Lord ate raw rice given by Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī and explained very elaborately the import of the “harer nāma” śloka mentioned in the Bṛhan-nāradya Purāṇa.

PURPORT

Śuklāmbara Brahmācārī resided in Navadvīpa on the bank of the Ganges. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was dancing in ecstasy, he approached the Lord with a begging bag containing rice. The Lord was so pleased with His devotee that He immediately snatched the bag and began to eat the raw rice. No one forbade Him, and thus He finished the entire supply of rice.

TEXT 21

harer nāma harer nāma

harer nāmaiva kevalam

kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva

nāsty eva gatiḥ anyathā

SYNONYMS

hareḥ nāma—the holy name of the Lord; *hareḥ nāma*—the holy name of the Lord; *eva*—certainly; *kevalam*—only; *kalau*—in the Age of Kali; *na asti*—there is none; *eva*—certainly; *na asti*—there is none; *eva*—certainly; *na asti*—there is none; *eva*—certainly; *gatiḥ*—destination; *anyathā*—otherwise.

TRANSLATION

“In this Age of Kali there is no other means, no other means, no other means for self-realization than chanting the holy name, chanting the holy name, chanting the holy name of Lord Hari.’

TEXT 22

kali-kāle nāma-rūpe kṛṣṇa-avatāra

nāma haite haya sarva-jagat-nistāra

SYNONYMS

kali-kāle—in this Age of Kali; *nāma-rūpe*—in the form of the holy name; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *avatāra*—incarnation; *nāma*—holy name; *haite*—from; *haya*—becomes; *sarva*—all; *jagat*—of the world; *nistāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

“In this Age of Kali, the holy name of the Lord, the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra, is the incarnation of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Simply by chanting the holy name, one associates with the Lord directly. Anyone who does this is certainly delivered.

TEXT 23

dārdhya lāgi ‘*harer nāma*’-*ukti tina-vāra*

jaḍa loka bujhāite punaḥ ‘*eva*’-*kāra*

SYNONYMS

dārdhya lāgi—in the matter of emphasizing; *harer nāma*—of the holy name of Lord Hari; *ukti*—there is utterance; *tina-vāra*—three times; *jaḍa loka*—ordinary common people; *bujhāite*—just to make them understand; *punaḥ*—again; *eva-kāra*—the word *eva*, or “certainly.”

TRANSLATION

“This verse repeats the word ‘eva’ [‘certainly’] three times for emphasis, and it also three times repeats ‘harer nāma’ [‘the holy name of the Lord’], just to make common people understand.

PURPORT

To emphasize something to an ordinary person, one may repeat it three times, just as one might say, “You must do this! You must do this! You must do this!” Thus the *Bṛhan-nāradya Purāṇa* repeatedly emphasizes the chanting of the holy name so that people may take it seriously and thus free themselves from the clutches of *māyā*. It is our practical experience in the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement all over the world that many millions of people are factually coming to the spiritual stage of life simply by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* regularly, according to the prescribed principles. Therefore our request to all our students is that they daily chant at least sixteen rounds of this *harer nāma mahā-mantra* [Adi 17.21] offenselessly, following the regulative principles. Thus their success will be assured without a doubt.

TEXT 24

‘kevala’-śabde punarapi niścaya-karaṇa

jñāna-yoga-tapa-karma-ādi nivāraṇa

SYNONYMS

‘kevala’-śabde—by the word *kevala*, or “only”; *punarapi*—again; *niścaya-karaṇa*—final decision; *jñāna*—cultivation of knowledge; *yoga*—practice of the mystic *yoga* system; *tapa*—austerity; *karma*—fruitive activities; *ādi*—and so on; *nivāraṇa*—prohibition.

TRANSLATION

“The use of the word ‘kevala’ [‘only’] prohibits all other processes, such as the cultivation of knowledge, practice of mystic yoga, or performance of austerities and fruitive activities.

PURPORT

Our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement stresses the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* only, whereas those who do not know the secret of success for this Age of Kali unnecessarily indulge in the cultivation of knowledge, the practice of mystic *yoga* or the performance of fruitive activities or useless austerities. They are simply wasting their time and misleading their followers. When we point this out very plainly to an audience, members of opposing groups become angry at us. But according to the injunctions of the *śāstras*, we cannot make compromises with these so-called *jñānīs*, *yogīs*, *karmīs* and *tapasvīs*. When they say they are as good as we are, we must say that only we are good and that they are not good. This is not our obstinacy; it is the injunction of the *śāstras*. We must not deviate from the injunctions of the *śāstras*. This is confirmed in the next verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 25

anyathā ye māne, tāra nāhika nistāra

nāhi, nāhi, nāhi—e tina ‘eva’-kāra

SYNONYMS

anyathā—otherwise; *ye*—anyone who; *māne*—accepts; *tāra*—of him; *nāhika*—there is no; *nistāra*—deliverance; *nāhi nāhi nāhi*—there is nothing else, nothing else, nothing else; *e*—in this; *tina*—three; *eva-kāra*—bearing the meaning of emphasis.

TRANSLATION

“This verse clearly states that anyone who accepts any other path cannot be delivered. This is the reason for the triple repetition ‘nothing else, nothing else, nothing else,’ which emphasizes the real process of self-realization.

TEXT 26

tr̥ṇa haite nīca hañā sadā labe nāma

āpani nirabhimānī, anye dibe māna

SYNONYMS

tr̥ṇa—grass; *haite*—than; *nīca*—lower; *hañā*—becoming; *sadā*—always; *labe*—chant; *nāma*—the holy name; *āpani*—personally; *nirabhimānī*—without honor; *anye*—unto others; *dibe*—you should give; *māna*—all respect.

TRANSLATION

“To chant the holy name always, one should be humbler than the grass in the street and devoid of all desire for personal honor, but one should offer others all respectful obeisances.

TEXT 27

taru-sama sahiṣṇutā vaiṣṇava karibe

bhartsana-tāḍane kāke kichu nā balibe

SYNONYMS

taru-sama—like a tree; *sahiṣṇutā*—forbearance; *vaiṣṇava*—devotee; *karibe*—should practice; *bhartsana*—rebuking; *tāḍane*—chastising; *kāke*—unto anyone; *kichu*—something; *nā*—not; *balibe*—will utter.

TRANSLATION

“A devotee engaged in chanting the holy name of the Lord should practice forbearance like that of a tree. Even if rebuked or chastised, he should not say anything to others to retaliate.

TEXT 28

kāṭileha taru yena kichu nā bolaya

śukāiyā mare, tabu jala nā māgaya

SYNONYMS

kāṭileha—even being cut; *taru*—the tree; *yena*—as; *kichu*—something; *nā*—not; *bolaya*—says; *śukāiyā*—drying up; *mare*—dies; *tabu*—still; *jala*—water; *nā*—does not; *māgaya*—ask for.

TRANSLATION

“For even if one cuts a tree, it never protests, and even if it is drying up and dying, it does not ask anyone for water.

PURPORT

This practice of forbearance (*taror iva sahiṣṇunā*) is very difficult, but when one actually engages in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, the quality of forbearance automatically develops. A person advanced in spiritual consciousness through the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* need not practice to develop it separately, for a devotee develops all good qualities simply by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra* regularly.

TEXT 29

ei-mata vaiṣṇava kāre kichu nā māgiba

ayācīta-vṛtti, kimvā sāka-phala khāiba

SYNONYMS

ei-mata—in this way; *vaiṣṇava*—a devotee; *kāre*—from anyone; *kichu*—

anything; *nā*—not; *māgiba*—shall ask for; *ayācita-vṛtti*—the profession of not asking for anything; *kiṁvā*—or; *śāka*—vegetables; *phala*—fruits; *khāiba*—shall eat.

TRANSLATION

“Thus a Vaiṣṇava should not ask anything from anyone else. If someone gives him something without being asked, he should accept it, but if nothing comes, a Vaiṣṇava should be satisfied to eat whatever vegetables and fruits are easily available.

TEXT 30

sadā nāma la-iba, yathā-lābhetē santoṣa

eita ācāra kare bhakti-dharma-poṣa

SYNONYMS

sadā—always; *nāma*—the holy name; *la-iba*—one should chant; *yathā*—inasmuch as; *lābhetē*—gains; *santoṣa*—satisfaction; *eita*—this; *ācāra*—behavior; *kare*—does; *bhakti-dharma*—of devotional service; *poṣa*—maintenance.

TRANSLATION

“One should strictly follow the principle of always chanting the holy name, and one should be satisfied with whatever he gets easily. Such devotional behavior solidly maintains one’s devotional service.

TEXT 31

trṇād apī su-nīcena

taror iva sahiṣṇunā

amāninā māna-dena

kīrtanīyaḥ sadā hariḥ

SYNONYMS

trṇāt api—than downtrodden grass; *su-nīcena*—being lower; *taroh*—than a tree; *iva*—like; *sahīṣṇunā*—with tolerance; *amāninā*—without being puffed up by false pride; *māna-dena*—giving respect to all; *kīrtanīyaḥ*—to be chanted; *sadā*—always; *hariḥ*—the holy name of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

“One who thinks himself lower than the grass, who is more tolerant than a tree, and who does not expect personal honor yet is always prepared to give all respect to others can very easily always chant the holy name of the Lord.”

PURPORT

The grass is specifically mentioned in this verse because everyone tramples upon it yet the grass never protests. This example indicates that a spiritual master or leader should not be proud of his position; being always humbler than an ordinary common man, he should go on preaching the cult of Caitanya Mahāprabhu by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*.

TEXT 32

ūrdhva-bāhu kari’ kahoṇ, śuna, sarva-loka

nāma-sūtre gānthi’ para kaṇṭhe ei śloka

SYNONYMS

ūrdhva-bāhu—raising my hands; *kari'*—doing so; *kahoñ*—I declare; *śuna*—please hear; *sarva-loka*—all persons; *nāma*—of the holy name; *sūtre*—on the thread; *gāñthi*—stringing; *para*—get it; *kañthe*—on the neck; *ei*—this; *śloka*—verse.

TRANSLATION

Raising my hands, I declare, “Everyone please hear me! String this verse on the thread of the holy name and wear it on your neck for continuous remembrance.”

PURPORT

When chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, in the beginning one may commit many offenses, which are called *nāmābhāsa* and *nāma-aparādha*. In this stage there is no possibility of achieving perfect love of Kṛṣṇa by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. Therefore one must chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* according to the principles of the above verse, *tr̥ṇād api su-nīcena taror iva sahiṣṇunā*. One should note in this connection that chanting involves the activities of the upper and lower lips as well as the tongue. All three must be engaged in chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. The words “Hare Kṛṣṇa” should be very distinctly pronounced and heard. Sometimes one mechanically produces a hissing sound instead of chanting with the proper pronunciation with the help of the lips and tongue. Chanting is very simple, but one must practice it seriously. Therefore the author of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī, advises everyone to keep this verse always strung about his neck.

TEXT 33

prabhu-ājñāya kara ei śloka ācaraṇa

avaśya pāibe tabe śrī-kṛṣṇa-caraṇa

SYNONYMS

prabhu—of the Lord; *ājñāya*—on the order; *kara*—do; *ei śloka*—of this verse; *ācaraṇa*—practice; *avaśya*—certainly; *pāibe*—he will get; *tabe*—afterwards; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caraṇa*—the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

One must strictly follow the principles given by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in this verse. If one simply follows in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya and the Gosvāmīs, certainly he will achieve the ultimate goal of life, the lotus feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 34

tabe prabhu śrīvāsera gr̥he nirantara

rātre saṅkīrtana kaila eka saṁvatsara

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *prabhu*—the Lord, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *śrīvāsera*—of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *gr̥he*—in the home; *nirantara*—always; *rātre*—at night; *saṅkīrtana*—congregational chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*; *kaila*—performed; *eka saṁvatsara*—one full year.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu regularly led congregational chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* in the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura every night for one full year.

TEXT 35

kapāṭa diyā kīrtana kare parama āveśe

pāṣaṇḍī hāsite āise, nā pāya praveśe

SYNONYMS

kapāṭa—door; *diyā*—closing; *kīrtana*—chanting; *kare*—performed; *parama*—very high; *āveśe*—in an ecstatic condition; *pāṣaṇḍī*—nonbelievers; *hāsite*—to laugh; *āise*—come; *nā*—does not; *pāya*—get; *praveśe*—entrance.

TRANSLATION

This ecstatic chanting was performed with the doors closed so that nonbelievers who came to make fun could not gain entrance.

PURPORT

Chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* is open to everyone, but sometimes nonbelievers come to disturb the ceremony of chanting. It is indicated herein that under such circumstances the temple doors should be closed. Only bona fide chanters should be admitted; others should not. But when there is large-scale congregational chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, we keep our temples open for everyone to join, and by the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu this policy has given good results.

TEXT 36

kīrtana śuni' bāhire tārā jvali' puḍi' mare

śrīvāsere duḥkha dite nānā yukti kare

SYNONYMS

kīrtana śuni'—after hearing the chanting; *bāhire*—outside; *tārā*—the nonbelievers; *jvali'*—burned; *puḍi'*—to ashes; *mare*—die; *śrīvāsere*—unto Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *duḥkha*—troubles; *dite*—to give; *nānā*—various;

yukti—plans; *kare*—do.

TRANSLATION

Thus the nonbelievers almost burned to ashes and died out of envy. To retaliate, they planned various ways to give trouble to Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura.

TEXTS 37–38

eka-dina vipra, nāma——‘*gopāla cāpāla*’

pāṣaṇḍi-pradhāna sei durmukha, vācāla

bhavānī-pūjāra saba sāmagrī lañā

rātre śrīvāsera dvāre sthāna lepāñā

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *vipra*—one *brāhmaṇa*; *nāma*—named; *gopāla cāpāla*—Gopāla Cāpāla; *pāṣaṇḍi-pradhāna*—the chief of the nonbelievers; *sei*—he; *durmukha*—ferocious, using strong words; *vācāla*—talkative; *bhavānī-pūjāra*—for worshiping the goddess Bhavānī; *saba*—all; *sāmagrī*—ingredients, paraphernalia; *lañā*—taking; *rātre*—at night; *śrīvāsera*—of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *dvāre*—on the door; *sthāna*—the place; *lepāñā*—smearing.

TRANSLATION

One night while kīrtana was going on inside Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura’s house, a *brāhmaṇa* named Gopāla Cāpāla, the chief of the nonbelievers, who was talkative and very rough in his speech, placed all the paraphernalia for worshiping the goddess Durgā outside Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura’s door.

PURPORT

This *brāhmaṇa*, Gopāla Cāpāla, wanted to defame Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura by proving that he was actually a *śākta*, or a worshiper of Bhavānī, the goddess Durgā, but was externally posing as a Vaiṣṇava. In Bengal there is perpetual competition between the devotees of goddess Kālī and the devotees of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Generally Bengalis, especially those who are meat-eaters and drunkards, are very much attached to worshiping the goddesses Durgā, Kālī, Śitalā and Caṇḍī. Such devotees, who are known as *śāktas*, or worshipers of the *śakti-tattva*, are always envious of Vaiṣṇavas. Since Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura was a well-known and respected Vaiṣṇava in Navadvīpa, Gopāla Cāpāla wanted to reduce his prestige by bringing him down to the platform of the *śāktas*. Therefore outside Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura's door he placed various paraphernalia for worshiping Bhavānī, the wife of Lord Śiva, such as a red flower, a plantain leaf, a pot of wine, and reddish sandalwood paste. In the morning, when Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura saw all this paraphernalia in front of his door, he called for the respectable gentlemen of the neighborhood and showed them that at night he was worshiping Bhavānī. Very sorry, these gentlemen called for a sweeper to cleanse the place and purify it by sprinkling water and cow dung there. This incident concerning Gopāla Cāpāla is not mentioned in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

TEXT 39

kalāra pāta upare thuila oḍa-phula

haridrā, sindūra āra rakta-candana, taṇḍula

SYNONYMS

kalāra pāta—a banana leaf; *upare*—upon it; *thuila*—placed; *oḍa-phula*—a particular type of flower; *haridrā*—turmeric; *sindūra*—vermilion; *āra*—and; *rakta-candana*—red sandalwood; *taṇḍula*—rice.

TRANSLATION

On the upper portion of a plantain leaf he placed such paraphernalia for worship as oḍa-phula, turmeric, vermilion, red sandalwood and rice.

TEXT 40

madya-bhāṇḍa-pāśe dhari' nija-ghare gela

prātaḥ-kāle śrīvāsa tāhā ta' dekhila

SYNONYMS

madya-bhāṇḍa—a pot of wine; *pāśe*—by the side of; *dhari'*—placing; *nija-ghare*—to his own home; *gela*—went; *prātaḥ-kāle*—in the morning; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *tāhā*—all those things; *ta'*—certainly; *dekhila*—saw.

TRANSLATION

He placed a pot of wine beside all this, and in the morning when Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura opened his door he saw this paraphernalia.

TEXT 41

baḍa baḍa loka saba ānila bolāiyā

sabāre kahe śrīvāsa hāsiyā hāsiyā

SYNONYMS

baḍa baḍa—respectable; *loka*—persons; *saba*—all; *ānila*—brought them; *bolāiyā*—causing to be called; *sabāre*—to everyone; *kahe*—addresses; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *hāsiyā hāsiyā*—while smiling.

TRANSLATION

Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura called for all the respectable gentlemen of the neighborhood and smilingly addressed them as follows.

TEXT 42

nitya rātre kari āmi bhavānī-pūjana

āmāra mahimā dekha, brāhmaṇa-sajjana

SYNONYMS

nitya rātre—every night; *kari*—I do; *āmi*—I; *bhavānī-pūjana*—worship of Bhavānī, the wife of Lord Śiva; *āmāra*—my; *mahimā*—glories; *dekha*—you see; *brāhmaṇa-sat-jana*—all respectable *brāhmaṇas*.

TRANSLATION

“Gentlemen, every night I worship the goddess Bhavānī. Since the paraphernalia for the worship is present here, now all you respectable *brāhmaṇas* and members of the higher castes can understand my position.”

PURPORT

According to the Vedic system there are four castes—the *brāhmaṇas*, *kṣatriyas*, *vaiśyas* and *sūdras*—and below them are the *pañcamas* (literally, “members of the fifth group”), who are lower than the *sūdras*. The higher castes—the *brāhmaṇas*, the *kṣatriyas* and even the *vaiśyas*—were known as *brāhmaṇa-saj-jana*. The *brāhmaṇas* especially were known as *saj-jana*, or respectable gentlemen who guided the entire society. If there were disputes in the village, people would approach these respectable *brāhmaṇas* to settle them. Now it is very difficult to find such *brāhmaṇas* and *saj-janas*, and thus every village and town is so disrupted that there is no peace and happiness anywhere. To revive a fully cultured civilization, the scientific division of society into *brāhmaṇas*, *kṣatriyas*,

vaiśyas and *sūdras* must be introduced all over the world. Unless some people are trained as *brāhmaṇas*, there cannot be peace in human society.

TEXT 43

tabe saba śiṣṭa-loka kare hāhākāra

aiche karma hethā kaila kon durācāra

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *saba*—all; *śiṣṭa-loka*—gentlemen; *kare*—exclaimed; *hāhā-kāra*—alas, alas; *aiche*—such; *karma*—activities; *hethā*—here; *kaila*—did; *kon*—who; *durācāra*—sinful person.

TRANSLATION

Then all the assembled gentlemen exclaimed, “What is this? What is this? Who has performed such mischievous activities? Who is that sinful man?”

TEXT 44

hāḍike āniyā saba dūra karāila

jala-gomaya diyā sei sthāna lepāila

SYNONYMS

hāḍike—a sweeper; *āniyā*—calling; *saba*—all; *dūra karāila*—caused to be thrown far; *jala*—water; *gomaya*—cow dung; *diyā*—mixing; *sei*—that; *sthāna*—place; *lepāila*—caused to be smeared over.

TRANSLATION

They called for a sweeper [hāḍi], who threw all the items of worship far away and cleansed the place by mopping it with a mixture of water and cow dung.

PURPORT

The men in Vedic society who engage in public sanitary activities like picking up stool and sweeping the street are called *hāḍis*. Sometimes they are untouchable, especially when engaged in their profession, yet such *hāḍis* also have the right to become devotees. This is established by *Śrī Bhagavad-gītā* (9.32), where the Lord declares:

*mām hi pārtha vyapāśritya ye 'pi syuḥ pāpa-yonayaḥ
striyo vaiśyās tathā śūdrās te 'pi yānti parām gatim*

“O son of Pṛthā, those who take shelter in Me, though they be of lower birth—women, *vaiśyas* [merchants], and *śūdras* [workers]—can attain the supreme destination.”

There are many untouchables of the lower caste in India, but according to Vaiṣṇava principles everyone is welcome to accept this Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement on the spiritual platform of life and thus be freed from trouble. Neither equality nor fraternity is possible on the material platform.

When Lord Caitanya declares *tṛṇād api su-nīcena taror iva sahiṣṇunā*, He indicates that one must be above the material conception of life. When one thoroughly understands that he is not the material body but a spiritual soul, he is even humbler than a man of the lower castes, for he is spiritually elevated. Such humility, in which one thinks himself lower than the grass, is called *su-nīcatva*, and being more tolerant than a tree is called *sahiṣṇutva*, forbearance. Being situated in devotional service, not caring for the material conception of life, is called *amānītva*, indifference to material respect; yet a devotee thus situated is called *māna-da*, for he is prepared to give honor to others without hesitation.

Mahatma Gandhi started the *hari-jana* movement to purify the untouchables, but he was a failure because he thought that one could become a *hari-jana*, a personal associate of the Lord, through some kind of material adjustment. That is not possible. Unless one fully realizes that he is not the body but is a spiritual soul, there is no question of his becoming a *hari-jana*. Those who do not follow in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His disciplic succession cannot distinguish between matter and spirit, and therefore all their ideas are but a mixed-up hodgepodge of problems. They are virtually lost in the bewildering network of Māyādevī.

TEXT 45

tina dina rahi' sei gopāla-cāpāla

sarvāṅge ha-ila kuṣṭha, vahe rakta-dhāra

SYNONYMS

tina dina—three days; *rahi'*—remaining in that way; *sei*—that; *gopāla-cāpāla*—Gopāla Cāpāla; *sarva-āṅge*—all over the body; *ha-ila*—became visible; *kuṣṭha*—leprosy; *vahe*—discharging; *rakta-dhāra*—a flow of blood.

TRANSLATION

After three days, leprosy attacked Gopāla Cāpāla, and blood oozed from sores all over his body.

TEXT 46

sarvāṅga beḍila kīṭe, kāṭe nirantara

asahya vedanā, duḥkhe jvalaye antara

SYNONYMS

sarva-aṅga—all over the body; *beḍila*—became covered; *kīṭe*—by insects; *kāṭe*—biting; *nirantara*—always; *asahya*—unbearable; *vedanā*—pain; *duḥkhe*—in unhappiness; *jvalaye*—burns; *antara*—without cessation.

TRANSLATION

Incessantly covered with germs and insects biting him all over his body, Gopāla Cāpāla felt unbearable pain. His entire body burned in distress.

TEXT 47

gaṅgā-ghāṭe vṛkṣa-tale rahe ta' vasiyā

eka dina bale kichu prabhuke dekhiyā

SYNONYMS

gaṅgā-ghāṭe—on the bank of the Ganges; *vṛkṣa-tale*—underneath a tree; *rahe*—remains; *ta'*—certainly; *vasiyā*—sitting; *eka dina*—one day; *bale*—says; *kichu*—something; *prabhuke*—the Lord; *dekhiyā*—seeing.

TRANSLATION

Since leprosy is an infectious disease, Gopāla Cāpāla left the village to sit down on the bank of the Ganges underneath a tree. One day, however, he saw Caitanya Mahāprabhu passing by and spoke to Him as follows.

TEXT 48

grāma-sambandhe āmi tomāra mātula

bhāginā, mui kuṣṭha-vyādhite hañāchi vyākula

SYNONYMS

grāma-sambandhe—in a village relationship; *āmi*—I (am); *tomāra*—Your; *mātula*—maternal uncle; *bhāgīna*—nephew; *mui*—I; *kuṣṭha-vyādhite*—by the disease of leprosy; *hañāchi*—have become; *vyākula*—too much afflicted.

TRANSLATION

“My dear nephew, I am Your maternal uncle in our village relationship. Please see how greatly this attack of leprosy has afflicted me.

TEXT 49

loka saba uddhārite tomāra avatāra

muñi baḍa dukhī, more karaha uddhāra

SYNONYMS

loka—people; *saba*—all; *uddhārite*—to deliver; *tomāra*—Your; *avatāra*—incarnation; *muñi*—I (am); *baḍa*—very; *dukhī*—unhappy; *more*—unto me; *karaha*—please do; *uddhāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

“As an incarnation of God, You are delivering so many fallen souls. I am also a greatly unhappy fallen soul. Kindly deliver me by Your mercy.”

PURPORT

It appears that although Gopāla Cāpāla was sinful, talkative and insulting, he nevertheless had the qualification of simplicity. Thus he believed Caitanya Mahāprabhu to be the incarnation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead who had come to deliver all fallen souls, and he appealed for

his own deliverance, seeking the mercy of the Lord. He did not know, however, that the deliverance of the fallen does not consist of curing their bodily diseases, although it is also a fact that when a man is delivered from the material clutches his material bodily diseases are automatically cured. Gopāla Cāpāla simply wanted to be delivered from the bodily sufferings of leprosy, but Śrī Caitanya, although accepting his sincere appeal, wanted to inform him of the real cause of suffering.

TEXT 50

eta śuni' mahāprabhura ha-ila kruddha mana

krodhāveśe bale tāre tarjana-vacana

SYNONYMS

eta—thus; *śuni'*—hearing; *mahāprabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *ha-ila*—there was; *kruddha*—angry; *mana*—mind; *krodhā-āveśe*—out of intense anger; *bale*—says; *tāre*—unto him; *tarjana*—chastising; *vacana*—words.

TRANSLATION

Hearing this, Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared greatly angry, and in that angry mood He spoke some words chastising him.

TEXT 51

āre pāpi, bhakta-dveṣi, tore na uddhārimu

koṭi-janma ei mate kīḍāya khāoyāimu

SYNONYMS

āre—O; *pāpi*—you sinful person; *bhakta-dveṣi*—envious of devotees;

tore—you; *nā uddhārimu*—I shall not deliver; *koṭi-janma*—for ten million births; *ei mate*—in this way; *kīḍāya*—by the germs; *khāoyāimu*—I shall cause you to be bitten.

TRANSLATION

“O sinful person, envious of pure devotees, I shall not deliver you! Rather, I shall have you bitten by these germs for many millions of years.

PURPORT

We should note herein that all our sufferings in this material world, especially from disease, are due to our past sinful activities. And of all sinful activities, actions directed against a pure devotee out of sheer envy are considered extremely severe. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted Gopāla Cāpāla to understand the cause of his suffering. Any person who disturbs a pure devotee engaged in broadcasting the holy name of the Lord is certainly punished like Gopāla Cāpāla. This is the instruction of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. As we shall see, one who offends a pure devotee can never satisfy Caitanya Mahāprabhu unless and until he sincerely regrets his offense and thus rectifies it.

TEXT 52

śrīvāse karāili tui bhavānī-pūjana

koṭi janma habe tora raurave patana

SYNONYMS

śrīvāse—unto Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *karāili*—you have caused to do; *tui*—you; *bhavānī-pūjana*—worshiping the goddess Bhavānī; *koṭi janma*—for ten million births; *habe*—there will be; *tora*—your; *raurave*—in hell; *patana*—fall down.

TRANSLATION

“You have made Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura appear to have been worshiping the goddess Bhavānī. Simply for this offense, you will have to fall down into hellish life for ten million births.

PURPORT

There are many tantric followers who, wishing to eat meat and drink wine, practice the black art of worshiping the goddess Bhavānī in a crematorium. Such fools also consider this *bhavānī-pūjā* to be as good as worship of Lord Kṛṣṇa in devotional service. But such abominable tantric activities performed by so-called *svāmīs* and *yogīs* are herein condemned by Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He declares that such *bhavānī-pūjā* for drinking wine and eating meat quickly plunges one into hellish life. The method of worship itself is already hellish, and its results must also be hellish and nothing more.

Many rascals say that whatever way one accepts, one will ultimately reach Brahman. Yet we can see from this verse how such persons reach Brahman. Brahman spreads everywhere, but appreciation of Brahman in different objects leads to different results. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.11) the Lord says, *ye yathā mām prapadyante tāṁs tathaiva bhajāmy aham*: “I reward everyone according to his surrender unto Me.” Māyāvādīs certainly realize Brahman in certain aspects, but realization of Brahman in the aspects of wine, women and meat is not the same realization of Brahman that devotees achieve by chanting, dancing and eating *prasādam*. Māyāvādī philosophers, being educated in paltry knowledge, think all sorts of Brahman realization one and the same and do not consider varieties. But although Kṛṣṇa is everywhere, by His inconceivable potency He is simultaneously not everywhere. Thus the Brahman realization of the tantric cult is not the same Brahman realization as that of pure devotees. Unless one reaches the highest point of Brahman realization, Kṛṣṇa consciousness, he is punishable. All people except Kṛṣṇa conscious devotees are to some proportion *pāṣaṇḍīs*, or demons,

and thus they are punishable by the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, as stated below.

TEXT 53

pāṣaṇḍī saṁhārite mora ei avatāra

pāṣaṇḍī saṁhāri' bhakti karimu pracāra

SYNONYMS

pāṣaṇḍī—demons, atheists; *saṁhārite*—to kill; *mora*—My; *ei*—this; *avatāra*—incarnation; *pāṣaṇḍī*—atheist; *saṁhāri'*—killing; *bhakti*—devotional service; *karimu*—I shall do; *pracāra*—preaching.

TRANSLATION

“I have appeared in this incarnation to kill the demons [pāṣaṇḍīs] and, after killing them, to preach the cult of devotional service.”

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya's mission is the same as that of Lord Kṛṣṇa, which He states in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.7–8):

*yadā yadā hi dharmasya glānir bhavati bhārata
abhyutthānam adharmasya tadātmānam sṛjāmy aham
paritrāṇāya sādhūnām vināśāya ca duṣkṛtām
dharma-saṁsthāpanārthāya sambhavāmi yuge yuge*

“Whenever and wherever there is a decline in religious practice, O descendant of Bharata, and a predominant rise of irreligion—at that time I descend Myself. In order to deliver the pious and to annihilate the miscreants, as well as to reestablish the principles of religion, I advent Myself millennium after millennium”

As explained here, the real purpose of an incarnation of Godhead is to kill the atheists and maintain the devotees. He does not say, like so many rascal incarnations, that atheists and devotees are on the same platform. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, or Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the real Personality of Godhead, does not advocate such an idea.

Atheists are punishable, whereas devotees are to be protected. To maintain this principle is the mission of all *avatāras*, or incarnations. One must therefore identify an incarnation by His activities, not by popular votes or mental concoctions. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu gave protection to devotees and killed many demons in the course of His preaching work. He specifically mentioned that the Māyāvādī philosophers are the greatest demons. Therefore He warned all others not to hear the Māyāvāda philosophy: *māyāvādī-bhāṣya śunile haya sarva-nāśa*. Simply by hearing the Māyāvāda interpretation of the *sāstras*, one is doomed (Cc. *Madhya* 6.169).

TEXT 54

eta bali' gelā prabhu karite gaṅgā-snāna

sei pāpī duḥkha bhoge, nā yāya parāṇa

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *gelā*—went away; *prabhu*—the Lord; *karite*—to take; *gaṅgā-snāna*—a bath in the Ganges; *sei*—that; *pāpī*—sinful man; *duḥkha*—pains; *bhoge*—suffers; *nā*—not; *yāya*—go away; *parāṇa*—the life.

TRANSLATION

After saying this, the Lord left to take His bath in the Ganges, and that sinful man did not give up his life but continued to suffer.

PURPORT

It appears that an offender to a Vaiṣṇava continues to suffer and does not give up his life. We have actually seen that a great *vaiṣṇava-aparādhī* continuously suffered so much that it was difficult for him to move, and yet he did not die.

TEXTS 55–56

sannyāsa kariyā yabe prabhu nīlācale gelā

tathā haite yabe kuliyā grāme āilā

tabe sei pāpī prabhura la-ila śaraṇa

hita upadeśa kaila ha-iyā karuṇa

SYNONYMS

sannyāsa kariyā—after accepting the renounced order of life; *yabe*—when; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nīlācale*—to Jagannātha Purī; *gelā*—went; *tathā haite*—from there; *yabe*—when; *kuliyā*—of the name Kuliya; *grāme*—to the village; *āilā*—came back; *tabe*—at that time; *sei*—that; *pāpī*—sinful man; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *la-ila*—took; *śaraṇa*—shelter; *hita*—beneficial; *upadeśa*—advice; *kaila*—gave; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *karuṇa*—merciful.

TRANSLATION

When Śrī Caitanya, after accepting the renounced order of life, went to Jagannātha Purī and then came back to the village of Kuliya, upon His return that sinful man took shelter at the Lord's lotus feet. The Lord, being merciful to him, gave him instructions for his benefit.

PURPORT

Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura, in his *Anubhāṣya*, has given the following note in connection with the village Kuliya. The village originally known as Kuliya has developed into what is now the city of Navadvīpa. In various authorized books like the *Bhakti-ratnākara*, *Caitanya-carita-mahākāvya*, *Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka* and *Caitanya-bhāgavata* it is mentioned that the village of Kuliya is on the western side of the Ganges. Even now, within the area known as Koladvīpa, there is a place known as *kuliāra gañja* and a place called *kuliāra daha*, both within the jurisdiction of the present municipality of Navadvīpa. In the time of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the two villages on the western side of the Ganges named Kuliya and Pāhāḍapura both belonged to the jurisdiction of Bāhiradvīpa. At that time the place on the eastern side of the Ganges now known as Antardvīpa was known as Navadvīpa. At that time the place on the eastern side of the Ganges now known as Antardvīpa was known as Navadvīpa. At Śrī Māyāpur that place is still known as Dvīpera Māṭha. There is another place of the name Kuliya near Kāñcaḍāpāḍā, but it is not the same Kuliya mentioned here. It cannot be accepted as *aparādha-bhañjanera pāṭa*, or the place where the offense was excused, for that occurred in the above-mentioned Kuliya on the western side of the Ganges. For business reasons many envious persons oppose excavation of the real place, and sometimes they advertise unauthorized places as the authorized one.

TEXTS 57–58

śrīvāsa paṇḍītera sthāne āche aparādha

tathā yāha, teñho yadi karena prasāda

tabe tora habe ei pāpa-vimocana

yadi punaḥ aiche nāhi kara ācaraṇa

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsa paṇḍitera—of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *sthāne*—at the lotus feet; *āche*—there is; *aparādha*—offense; *tathā*—there; *yāha*—go; *teñho*—he; *yadi*—if; *karena*—does; *prasāda*—blessings; *tabe*—then; *tora*—your; *habe*—there will be; *ei*—this; *pāpa-vimocana*—immunity from sinful reaction; *yadi*—if; *punaḥ*—again; *aiche*—such; *nāhi kara*—you do not commit; *ācaraṇa*—behavior.

TRANSLATION

“You have committed an offense at the lotus feet of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura,” the Lord said. “First you must go there and beg for his mercy, and then if he gives you his blessings and you do not commit such sins again, you will be freed from these reactions.”

TEXT 59

tabe vipra la-ila āsi śrīvāsa śaraṇa

tānhāra kṛpāya haila pāpa-vimocana

SYNONYMS

tabe—after that; *vipra*—the *brāhmaṇa* (Gopāla Cāpāla); *la-ila*—took shelter; *āsi*—coming; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *śaraṇa*—shelter of his lotus feet; *tānhāra kṛpāya*—by his mercy; *haila*—became; *pāpa-vimocana*—free from all sinful reaction.

TRANSLATION

Then the *brāhmaṇa*, Gopāla Cāpāla, went to Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura and took shelter of his lotus feet, and by Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura’s mercy he was freed from all sinful reactions.

TEXT 60

āra eka vipra āila kīrtana dekhite

dvāre kapāṭa, — — nā pāila bhitare yāite

SYNONYMS

āra—another; *eka*—one; *vipra*—*brāhmaṇa*; *āila*—came; *kīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *dekhite*—to see; *dvāre*—in the gateway; *kapāṭa*—the door (being closed); *nā pāila*—did not get; *bhitare*—inside; *yāite*—to go.

TRANSLATION

Another *brāhmaṇa* came to see the *kīrtana* performance, but the door was closed, and he could not enter the hall.

TEXT 61

phiri' gela vipra ghare mane duḥkha pāñā

āra dina prabhuke kahe gaṅgāya lāga pāñā

SYNONYMS

phiri' gela—went back; *vipra*—the *brāhmaṇa*; *ghare*—to his home; *mane*—within his mind; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *pāñā*—getting; *āra dina*—the next day; *prabhuke*—unto the Lord; *kahe*—says; *gaṅgāya*—on the bank of the Ganges; *lāga*—touch; *pāñā*—getting.

TRANSLATION

He returned home with an unhappy mind, but on the next day he met Lord Caitanya on the bank of the Ganges and spoke to Him.

TEXT 62

śāpiba tomāre muñi, pāñāchi mano-duḥkha

paitā chiṇḍiyā śāpe pracaṇḍa durmukha

SYNONYMS

śāpiba—I shall curse; *tomāre*—You; *muñi*—I; *pāñāchi*—I have; *manaḥ-duḥkha*—mentally very much aggrieved; *paitā*—sacred thread; *chiṇḍiyā*—breaking; *śāpe*—cursing; *pracaṇḍa*—fiercely; *durmukha*—one who speaks harshly.

TRANSLATION

That brāhmaṇa was expert in talking harshly and cursing others. Thus he broke his sacred thread and declared, “I shall now curse You, for Your behavior has greatly aggrieved me.”

TEXT 63

saṁsāra-sukha tomāra ha-uka vināśa

śāpa śuni’ prabhura citte ha-ila ullāsa

SYNONYMS

saṁsāra-sukha—material happiness; *tomāra*—Your; *ha-uka*—may it become; *vināśa*—all vanquished; *śāpa śuni’*—hearing this curse; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *citte*—within His mind; *ha-ila*—there was; *ullāsa*—jubilation.

TRANSLATION

The brāhmaṇa cursed the Lord, “You shall be bereft of all material happiness!” When the Lord heard this, He felt great jubilation within Himself.

TEXT 64

prabhura śāpa-vārtā yei śune śraddhāvān

brahma-śāpa haite tāra haya paritrāṇa

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *śāpa-vārtā*—the incident of the curse; *yei*—anyone who; *śune*—hears; *śraddhāvān*—with affection; *brahma-śāpa*—cursing by a *brāhmaṇa*; *haite*—from; *tāra*—his; *haya*—becomes; *paritrāṇa*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

Any faithful person who hears of this brāhmaṇa's cursing Lord Caitanya is delivered from all brahminical curses.

PURPORT

One should know with firm conviction that the Lord, being transcendental, is never subject to any curse or benediction. Only ordinary living entities are subjected to curses and the punishments of Yamarāja. As the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is beyond such punishments and benedictions. When one understands this fact with faith and love, he personally becomes free from all curses uttered by *brāhmaṇas* or anyone else. This incident is not mentioned in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*.

TEXT 65

mukunda-dattere kaila daṇḍa-parasāda

khaṇḍila tāhāra cittera saba avasāda

SYNONYMS

mukunda-dattere—unto Mukunda Datta; *kaila*—did; *daṇḍa*—punishment; *parasāda*—benediction; *khaṇḍila*—vanquished; *tāhāra*—his; *cittera*—of the mind; *saba*—all kinds of; *avasāda*—depressions.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu blessed Mukunda Datta with punishment and in that way vanquished all his mental depression.

PURPORT

Mukunda Datta was once forbidden to enter the association of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu because of his mixing with the Māyāvādī impersonalists. When Lord Caitanya manifested His *mahā-prakāśa*, He called all the devotees one after another and blessed them, while Mukunda Datta stood outside the door. The devotees informed the Lord that Mukunda Datta was waiting outside, but the Lord replied, “I shall not soon be pleased with Mukunda Datta, for though he explains devotional service among devotees, he then goes to Māyāvādīs to hear from them the *Yoga-vāśiṣṭha-rāmāyaṇa*, which is full of Māyāvāda philosophy. For this I am greatly displeased with him.” Hearing the Lord speak in that way, Mukunda Datta, standing outside, was exceedingly glad that the Lord would at some time be pleased with him, although He was not pleased at that moment. But when the Lord understood that Mukunda Datta was going to give up the association of the Māyāvādīs for good, He was pleased, and He at once called to see Mukunda. Thus He delivered him from the association of the Māyāvādīs and gave him the association of pure devotees.

TEXT 66

ācārya-gosāñire prabhu kare guru-bhakti

tāhāte ācārya baḍa haya duḥkha-matī

SYNONYMS

ācārya-gosāñire—unto Advaita Ācārya; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kare*—does; *guru-bhakti*—offering respects like a spiritual master; *tāhāte*—in that way; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *baḍa*—very much; *haya*—becomes; *duḥkha-matī*—aggrieved.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya respected Advaita Ācārya as His spiritual master, but Advaita Ācārya Prabhu was greatly aggrieved by such behavior.

TEXT 67

bhaṅgī kari' jñāna-mārga karila vyākhyāna

krodhāveśe prabhu tāre kaila avajñāna

SYNONYMS

bhaṅgī kari'—doing it in fun; *jñāna-mārga*—the path of philosophical speculation; *karila*—did; *vyākhyāna*—explanation; *krodha-āveśe*—in the mood of anger; *prabhu*—the Lord; *tāre*—to Him; *kaila*—did; *avajñāna*—disrespect.

TRANSLATION

Thus He whimsically began to explain the path of philosophical speculation, and the Lord, in His anger, seemingly disrespected Him.

TEXT 68

tabe ācārya-gosāñira ānanda ha-ila

lajjita ha-iyā prabhu prasāda karila

SYNONYMS

tabe—at that time; *ācārya-gosāñīra*—of Advaita Ācārya; *ānanda*—pleasure; *ha-ila*—aroused; *lajjita*—ashamed; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *prabhu*—the Lord; *prasāda*—benediction; *karila*—offered.

TRANSLATION

At that time Advaita Ācārya was greatly pleased. The Lord understood this, and He was somewhat ashamed, but He offered Advaita Ācārya His benediction.

PURPORT

Advaita Ācārya was a disciple of Mādhavendra Purī, Īśvara Purī's spiritual master. Therefore Īśvara Purī, the spiritual master of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, was Advaita Ācārya's Godbrother. In view of this, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu treated Advaita Ācārya as His spiritual master, but Śrī Advaita Ācārya did not like this behavior of Lord Caitanya, for He wanted to be treated as His eternal servant. Advaita Prabhu's aspiration was to be a servant of the Lord, not His spiritual master. He therefore devised a plan to antagonize the Lord. He began to explain the path of philosophical speculation in the midst of some unfortunate Māyāvādīs, and when Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu heard about this, He immediately went there and in a very angry mood began to beat Advaita Ācārya. At that time, Advaita Ācārya, greatly pleased, began to dance, saying, "Just see how My desire has now been fulfilled! Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu used to treat Me honorably for so long, but now He is treating Me neglectfully. This is My reward. His affection for Me is so great that He wanted to save Me from the hands of the Māyāvādīs." Hearing this statement, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu was somewhat ashamed, but He was very pleased with Advaita Ācārya.

TEXT 69

murāri-gupta-mukhe śuni' rāma-guṇa-grāma

lalāṭe likhila tāñra 'rāmadāsa' nāma

SYNONYMS

murāri-gupta—of Murāri Gupta; *mukhe*—from the mouth; *śuni'*—hearing; *rāma*—of Lord Rāmacandra; *guṇa-grāma*—glories; *lalāṭe*—on the forehead; *likhila*—wrote; *tāñra*—of Murāri Gupta; *rāma-dāsa*—the eternal servant of Lord Rāmacandra; *nāma*—the name .

TRANSLATION

Murāri Gupta was a great devotee of Lord Rāmacandra. When Lord Caitanya heard Lord Rāmacandra's glories from his mouth, He immediately wrote on his forehead "rāmadāsa" [the eternal servant of Lord Rāmacandra].

TEXT 70

śrīdharera lauha-pātre kaila jala-pāna

samasta bhaktere dila iṣṭa vara-dāna

SYNONYMS

śrīdharera—of Śrīdhara; *lauha-pātre*—from the iron pot; *kaila*—did; *jala-pāna*—drinking of water; *samasta*—all; *bhaktere*—to the devotees; *dila*—gave; *iṣṭa*—desired; *vara-dāna*—benediction.

TRANSLATION

Once Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu went to the house of Śrīdhara after

kīrtana and drank water from his damaged iron pot. Then He bestowed His benediction upon all the devotees according to their desires.

PURPORT

After the mass *nagara-saṅkīrtana* in protest against the magistrate Chand Kazi, the Kazi was converted to a devotee. Then Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu returned with His *saṅkīrtana* party to the house of Śrīdhara, and Chand Kazi followed Him. All the devotees rested there for some time and drank water from Śrīdhara's damaged iron pot. The Lord accepted the water because the pot belonged to a devotee. Chand Kazi then returned home. The place where they rested is still situated on the northeastern side of Māyāpur, and it is known as *kīrtana-viśrāma-sthāna*, “the resting place of the *kīrtana* party.”

TEXT 71

haridāsa ṭhākurere karila prasāda

ācārya-sthāne mātāra khaṇḍāila aparādha

SYNONYMS

haridāsa ṭhākurere—unto Haridāsa Ṭhākura; *karila*—did; *prasāda*—benediction; *ācārya-sthāne*—in the home of Advaita Ācārya; *mātāra*—of Śacīmātā; *khaṇḍāila*—vanquished; *aparādha*—the offense.

TRANSLATION

After this incident the Lord blessed Haridāsa Ṭhākura and vanquished the offense of His mother at the home of Advaita Ācārya.

PURPORT

On the *mahā-prakāśa* day, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu embraced Haridāsa

Ṭhākura and informed him that he was none other than an incarnation of Prahlāda Mahārāja. When Viśvarūpa took *sannyāsa*, Śacīmātā thought that Advaita Ācārya had persuaded Him to do so. Therefore she accused Advaita Ācārya of this, which was an offense at His lotus feet. Later Lord Caitanya induced His mother to take the dust of Advaita Ācārya's lotus feet, and thus her *vaiṣṇava-aparādhā* was nullified.

TEXT 72

bhakta-gaṇe prabhu nāma-mahimā kahila

śuniyā paḍuyā tāhān artha-vāda kaila

SYNONYMS

bhakta-gaṇe—unto the devotees; *prabhu*—the Lord; *nāma-mahimā*—glories of the holy name; *kahila*—explained; *śuniyā*—hearing; *paḍuyā*—the students; *tāhān*—there; *artha-vāda*—interpretation; *kaila*—did.

TRANSLATION

Once when the Lord explained the glories of the holy name to the devotees, some ordinary students who heard Him fashioned their own interpretation.

TEXT 73

nāme stuti-vāda śuni' prabhura haila duḥkha

sabāre niṣedhila,—ihāra nā dekhiha mukha

SYNONYMS

nāme—in the holy name of the Lord; *stuti-vāda*—exaggeration; *śuni'*—hearing; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *haila*—became; *duḥkha*—aggrieved;

sabāre—unto everyone; *niṣedhila*—warned; *ihāra*—of him; *nā*—do not; *dekhiha*—see; *mukha*—face.

TRANSLATION

When a student interpreted the glories of the holy name as a prayer of exaggeration, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, greatly unhappy, immediately warned everyone not to see the student's face henceforward.

PURPORT

Once when Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu explained the glories of the transcendental potency of the Lord's holy name, the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, one unfortunate student said that such glorification of the holy name was an exaggeration in the *śāstras* to induce people to take to it. In this way the student interpreted the glories of the holy name. This is called *artha-vāda*, and it is one of the ten offenses at the lotus feet of the holy name of the Lord. There are many kinds of offenses, but the offense known as *nāma-aparādha*, an offense at the lotus feet of the holy name, is extremely dangerous. The Lord therefore warned everyone not to see the face of the offender. The Lord immediately took a bath in the Ganges with all His clothes on to teach everyone to avoid such a *nāma-aparādha*. The holy name is identical with the Supreme Personality of Godhead. There is no difference between the person God and His holy name. This is the absolute position of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore one who distinguishes between the Lord and His name is called a *pāṣaṇḍī*, or nonbeliever, an atheistic demon. Glorification of the holy name is glorification of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. One should never attempt to distinguish between the Lord and His name or interpret the glories of the holy name as mere exaggerations.

TEXT 74

sagaṇe sacele giyā kaila gaṅgā-snāna

bhaktira mahimā tāhāñ karila vyākhyāna

SYNONYMS

sa-gaṇe—with His followers; *sa-cele*—without leaving the clothes;
giyā—going; *kaila*—did; *gaṅgā-snāna*—bathing in the Ganges;
bhaktira—of devotional service; *mahimā*—glories; *tāhāñ*—there;
karila—did; *vyākhyāna*—explanation.

TRANSLATION

Without even removing His garments, Lord Caitanya took a bath in the Ganges with His companions. There He explained the glories of devotional service.

TEXT 75

jñāna-karma-yoga-dharme nahe kṛṣṇa vaśa

kṛṣṇa-vaśa-hetu eka—prema-bhakti-rasa

SYNONYMS

jñāna—the path of speculative knowledge; *karma*—fruitive activities;
yoga—the process of controlling the senses; *dharme*—in the activities, in such an occupation; *nahe*—is not; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vaśa*—pleased;
kṛṣṇa—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vaśa*—for the pleasure; *hetu*—reason; *eka*—one;
prema—love; *bhakti*—devotional service; *rasa*—such a mellow.

TRANSLATION

“By following the paths of speculative philosophical knowledge, fruitive activity or mystic yoga to control the senses, one cannot satisfy Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Lord. Unalloyed devotional love for Kṛṣṇa is the only cause for the Lord’s satisfaction.

TEXT 76

na sādhayati mām yogo

na sāṅkhyam dharma uddhava

na svādhyāyas tapas tyāgo

yathā bhaktir mamorjitā

SYNONYMS

na—never; *sādhayati*—causes to remain satisfied; *mām*—Me; *yogaḥ*—the process of control; *na*—nor; *sāṅkhyam*—the process of gaining philosophical knowledge about the Absolute Truth; *dharmaḥ*—such an occupation; *uddhava*—My dear Uddhava; *na*—nor; *svādhyāyaḥ*—study of the *Vedas*; *tapas*—austerities; *tyāgaḥ*—renunciation, acceptance of *sannyāsa*, or charity; *yathā*—as much as; *bhaktiḥ*—devotional service; *mama*—unto Me; *ūrjitā*—developed.

TRANSLATION

“[The Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, said:] ‘My dear Uddhava, neither through aṣṭāṅga-yoga [the mystic yoga system to control the senses], nor through impersonal monism or an analytical study of the Absolute Truth, nor through study of the Vedas, nor through austerities, charity or acceptance of sannyāsa can one satisfy Me as much as by developing unalloyed devotional service unto Me.’”

PURPORT

Karmīs, jñānīs, yogīs, tapasvīs and students of Vedic literature who do not have Kṛṣṇa consciousness simply beat around the bush and do not get any final profit because they have no clear knowledge of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Nor do they have faith in approaching Him by

discharging devotional service, although everywhere such service is repeatedly emphasized, as it is in this verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.14.20). The *Bhagavad-gītā* (18.55) also declares, *bhaktyā mām abhijānāti yāvān yaś cāsmi tattvataḥ*: “One can understand the Supreme Personality as He is only by devotional service.” If one wants to understand the Supreme Personality factually, he must take to the path of devotional service and not waste time in profitless philosophical speculation, fruitive activity, mystic yogic practice or severe austerity and penance. Elsewhere in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (12.5) the Lord confirms, *kleśo ’dhikataras teṣām avyaktāsakta-cetasām*: “For those whose minds are attached to the unmanifested, impersonal feature of the Supreme, advancement is very troublesome.” People who are attached to the impersonal feature of the Lord are obliged to take great trouble, yet nevertheless they cannot understand the Absolute Truth. As explained in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (1.2.11), *brahmeti paramātmetye bhagavān iti śabdyate*. Unless one understands the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the original source of both Brahman and Paramātmā, one is still in darkness about the Absolute Truth.

TEXT 77

murārike kahe tumi kṛṣṇa vaśa kailā

śuniyā murāri śloka kahite lāgilā

SYNONYMS

murārike—unto Murāri; *kahe*—says; *tumi*—you; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *vaśa*—satisfied; *kailā*—made; *śuniyā*—hearing; *murāri*—Murāri; *śloka*—verse; *kahite*—to speak; *lāgilā*—began.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya then praised Murāri Gupta, saying, “You have satisfied Lord Kṛṣṇa.” Hearing this, Murāri Gupta quoted a verse from *Śrīmad-*

Bhāgavatam.

TEXT 78

kvāhaṁ daridraḥ pāpīyān

kva kṛṣṇaḥ śrī-niketaṇaḥ

brahma-bandhur iti smāhaṁ

bāhubhyāṁ parirambhitaḥ

SYNONYMS

kva—whereas; *ahaṁ*—I (am); *daridraḥ*—very poor; *pāpīyān*—sinful; *kva*—whereas; *kṛṣṇaḥ*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *śrī-niketaṇaḥ*—the shelter of the goddess of fortune; *brahma-bandhuḥ*—a caste *brāhmaṇa* without brahminical qualifications; *iti*—thus; *smā*—certainly; *ahaṁ*—I (am); *bāhubhyāṁ*—by the arms; *parirambhitaḥ*—embraced.

TRANSLATION

“‘Since I am but a poor, sinful brahma-bandhu, not brahminically qualified although born in a brāhmaṇa family, and You, Lord Kṛṣṇa, are the shelter of the goddess of fortune, it is simply wonderful, my dear Lord Kṛṣṇa, that You have embraced me with Your arms.’”

PURPORT

This is a verse from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.81.16) spoken by Sudāmā Vipra in the presence of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa. This and the previous verse quoted from *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* clearly indicate that although Kṛṣṇa is so great that it is not possible for anyone to satisfy Him, He exhibits His greatness by being personally satisfied even with one who is unqualified

from so many angles of vision. Sudāmā Vipra was born in a family of *brāhmaṇas*, and he was a learned scholar and a class friend of Kṛṣṇa's, yet he considered himself unfit to be strictly called a *brāhmaṇa*. He called himself a *brahma-bandhu*, meaning “one born in a *brāhmaṇa* family but not brahminically qualified.” Because of His great respect for *brāhmaṇas*, however, Kṛṣṇa embraced Sudāmā Vipra, although he was not a regular *brāhmaṇa* but a *brahma-bandhu*, or friend of a *brāhmaṇa* family. Murāri Gupta could not be called even a *brahma-bandhu* because he was born of a *vaidya* family and according to the social structure was therefore considered a *sūdra*. But Kṛṣṇa bestowed special mercy upon Murāri Gupta because he was a beloved devotee of the Lord, as stated by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The purport of Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura's elaborate discussion of this subject is that no qualification in this material world can satisfy the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, yet everything becomes successful simply through development of devotional service to the Lord.

The members of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness cannot even call themselves *brahma-bandhus*. Therefore our only means for satisfying Kṛṣṇa is to pursue the injunctions of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who says:

*yāre dekha, tāre kaha 'kṛṣṇa'-upadeśa
āmāra ājñāya guru hañā tāra' ei deśa*

“Whomever you meet, instruct him on the teachings of Kṛṣṇa. In this way, on My order, become a spiritual master and deliver the people of this country.” (Cc. *Madhya* 7.128) Simply trying to follow the orders of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, we speak to the people of the world about *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is*. This will make us qualified to satisfy the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 79

eka-dina prabhu saba bhakta-gaṇa lañā

saṅkīrtana kari' vaise śrama-yukta hañā

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *prabhu*—the Lord; *saba*—all; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *lañā*—taking into company; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *kari'*—doing so; *vaise*—sat; *śrama-yukta*—feeling fatigued; *hañā*—thus being.

TRANSLATION

One day the Lord performed saṅkīrtana with all His devotees, and when they were greatly fatigued they sat down.

TEXT 80

eka āmra-bīja prabhu aṅgane ropila

tat-kṣaṇe janmila vṛkṣa bāḍite lāgila

SYNONYMS

eka—one; *āmra-bīja*—seed of a mango; *prabhu*—the Lord; *aṅgane*—in the yard; *ropila*—sowed; *tat-kṣaṇe*—immediately; *janmila*—fructified; *vṛkṣa*—a tree; *bāḍite*—to grow; *lāgila*—began.

TRANSLATION

The Lord then sowed a mango seed in the yard, and immediately the seed fructified into a tree and began to grow.

TEXT 81

dekhite dekhite vṛkṣa ha-ila phalita

pākila aneka phala, sakei vismita

SYNONYMS

dekhite dekhite—as people were seeing; *vrkṣa*—the tree; *ha-ila*—became; *phalita*—fully grown with fruits; *pākila*—ripened; *aneka*—many; *phala*—fruits; *sakei*—every one of them; *vismita*—struck with wonder.

TRANSLATION

As people looked on, the tree became fully grown, with fruits that fully ripened. Thus everyone was struck with wonder.

TEXT 82

śata dui phala prabhu śīghra pādāila

prakṣālana kari' kṛṣṇe bhoga lāgāila

SYNONYMS

śata—hundred; *dui*—two; *phala*—fruits; *prabhu*—the Lord; *śīghra*—very soon; *pādāila*—caused to be picked up; *prakṣālana*—washing; *kari'*—doing; *kṛṣṇe*—to Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhoga*—offering; *lāgāila*—made it so.

TRANSLATION

The Lord immediately picked about two hundred fruits, and after washing them He offered them to Kṛṣṇa to eat.

TEXT 83

rakta-pīta-varṇa, — — nāhi aṣṭhi-valkala

eka janera peṭa bhare khāile eka phala

SYNONYMS

rakta-pīta-varṇa—the mangoes were red and yellow in color; *nāhi*—there was none; *aṣṭhi*—seed; *valkala*—or skin; *eka*—one; *janera*—man's; *peṭa*—belly; *bhare*—filled up; *khāile*—if he would eat; *eka*—one; *phala*—fruit.

TRANSLATION

The fruits were all red and yellow, with no seed inside and no skin outside, and eating one fruit would immediately fill a man's belly.

PURPORT

In India a mango is considered best when it is red and yellow, its seed is very small, its skin is very thin, and it is so palatable that if a person eats one fruit he will be satisfied. The mango is considered the king of all fruits.

TEXT 84

dekhiyā santuṣṭa hailā śacīra nandana

sabāke khāoyāla āge kariyā bhakṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

dekhiyā—seeing this; *santuṣṭa*—satisfied; *hailā*—became; *śacīra*—of mother Śacī; *nandana*—son; *sabāke*—everyone; *khāoyāla*—made to eat; *āge*—in the beginning; *kariyā*—doing; *bhakṣaṇa*—eating Himself.

TRANSLATION

Seeing the quality of the mangoes, the Lord was greatly satisfied, and thus after eating first, He fed all the other devotees.

TEXT 85

aṣṭhi-vaḥkala nāhi,——amṛta-rasamaya

eka phala khāile rase udara pūraya

SYNONYMS

aṣṭhi—seed; *vaḥkala*—skin; *nāhi*—there is none; *amṛta*—nectar; *rasa-maya*—full of juice; *eka*—one; *phala*—fruit; *khāile*—if one eats; *rase*—with the juice; *udara*—belly; *pūraya*—fulfilled.

TRANSLATION

The fruits had no seeds or skins. They were full of nectarean juice and were so sweet that a man would be fully satisfied by eating only one.

TEXT 86

ei-mata pratidina phale bāra māsa

vaiṣṇava khāyena phala,——prabhura ullāsa

SYNONYMS

ei-mata—in this way; *prati-dina*—every day; *phale*—fruit grew; *bāra*—twelve; *māsa*—months; *vaiṣṇava*—the Vaiṣṇavas; *khāyena*—eat; *phala*—the fruits; *prabhura*—the Lord's; *ullāsa*—satisfaction.

TRANSLATION

In this way, fruits grew on the tree every day throughout the twelve

months of the year, and the Vaiṣṇavas used to eat them, to the Lord's great satisfaction.

TEXT 87

ei saba līlā kare śacīra nandana

anya loka nāhi jāne vinā bhakta-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

ei saba—all these; *līlā*—pastimes; *kare*—performed; *śacīra*—of mother Śacī; *nandana*—son; *anya loka*—other people; *nāhi*—do not; *jāne*—know; *vinā*—except; *bhakta-gaṇa*—the devotees.

TRANSLATION

These are confidential pastimes of the son of Śacī. Other than devotees, no one knows of this incident.

PURPORT

Nondevotees cannot believe this incident, yet the place where the tree grew still exists in Māyāpur. It is called Āmra-ghaṭṭa or Āma-ghāṭā.

TEXT 88

ei mata bāra-māsa kīrtana-avasāne

āmra-mahotsava prabhu kare dine dine

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *bāra-māsa*—for twelve months; *kīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *avasāne*—at the end; *āmra-mahā-utsava*—

festival of eating mangoes; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kare*—performs; *dine dine*—every day.

TRANSLATION

In this way the Lord performed saṅkīrtana every day, and at the end of saṅkīrtana there was a mango-eating festival every day for twelve months.

PURPORT

On principle, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu would distribute *prasādam* at the end of *kīrtana* performances. Similarly, the members of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement must distribute some *prasādam* to the audience after performing *kīrtana*.

TEXT 89

kīrtana karite prabhu āila megha-gaṇa

āpana-icchāya kaila megha nivāraṇa

SYNONYMS

kīrtana—saṅkīrtana; *karite*—performing; *prabhu*—the Lord; *āila*—there was; *megha-gaṇa*—bunches of clouds; *āpana-icchāya*—by self-will; *kaila*—made; *megha*—of the clouds; *nivāraṇa*—stopping.

TRANSLATION

Once while Caitanya Mahāprabhu was performing kīrtana, clouds assembled in the sky, and the Lord, by His own will, immediately stopped them from pouring rain.

PURPORT

In this connection Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura says that once when Lord Caitanya was performing *saṅkīrtana* a short way from the village, some clouds appeared overhead. By the supreme will of the Lord, the clouds were asked to disperse, and they did. Because of this incident, that place is still known as Meghera-cara. Since the course of the Ganges has now changed, the village of the name Belapukhuriyā, which was formerly situated in a different place, called Tāraṇavāsa, has now become known as Meghera-cara. The *Madhya-khaṇḍa* of Śrīla Locana dāsa Ṭhākura 's *Caitanya-maṅgala* also relates that once at the end of the day, when evening clouds assembled overhead and thundered threateningly, all the Vaiṣṇavas were very much afraid. But the Lord took His karatālas in His hands and personally began chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra, looking up toward the sky as if to direct the demigods in the higher planets. Thus all the assembled clouds dispersed, and as the sky became clear, with the moon rising, the Lord began dancing very happily with His jubilant and satisfied devotees.

TEXT 90

eka-dina prabhu śrīvāsere ājñā dila

‘bṛhat sahasra-nāma’ paḍa, śūnite mana haila

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *prabhu*—the Lord; *śrīvāsere*—unto Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *ājñā*—order; *dila*—gave; *bṛhat*—great; *sahasra-nāma*—one thousand names; *paḍa*—read; *śūnite*—to hear; *mana*—mind; *haila*—wanted.

TRANSLATION

One day the Lord ordered Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura to read the Bṛhat-sahasra-nāma [the thousand names of Lord Viṣṇu], for He wanted to hear them at that time.

TEXT 91

paḍite āilā stave nṛsimhera nāma

śuniyā āviṣṭa hailā prabhu gauradhāma

SYNONYMS

paḍite—while reading; *āilā*—came; *stave*—in the prayer; *nṛsimhera*—of Lord Nṛsimha; *nāma*—the holy name; *śuniyā*—hearing; *āviṣṭa*—absorbed; *hailā*—became; *prabhu*—Lord; *gaura-dhāma*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

As he read the thousand names of the Lord, in due course the holy name of Lord Nṛsimha appeared. When Caitanya Mahāprabhu heard the holy name of Lord Nṛsimha, He became fully absorbed in thought.

PURPORT

The *Caitanya-maṅgala*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, describes this incident as follows: Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita was performing the *śrāddha* ceremony for his father, and as is customary, he was hearing the thousand names of Lord Viṣṇu. At that time Gaurahari (Lord Caitanya) appeared on the scene, and He also began to hear the thousand names of Viṣṇu with full satisfaction. When He thus heard the holy name of Lord Nṛsimha, Lord Caitanya became absorbed in thought, and He became angry like Nṛsimha Prabhu in His angry mood. His eyes became red, His bodily hairs stood on end, all the parts of His body trembled, and He made a thundering sound. All of a sudden He took up a club, and people became greatly afraid, thinking, “We do not know what kind of offense we have now committed!” But then Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu adjusted His thoughts and sat down on His seat.

TEXT 92

nṛsimha-āveśe prabhu hāte gadā lañā

pāṣaṇḍī mārīte yāya nagare dhāiyā

SYNONYMS

nṛsimha-āveśe—in the ecstatic mood of Lord Nṛsimha; *prabhu*—the Lord; *hāte*—in His hand; *gadā*—club; *lañā*—taking; *pāṣaṇḍī*—the atheists; *mārīte*—to kill; *yāya*—goes; *nagare*—in the city; *dhāiyā*—running.

TRANSLATION

In the mood of Lord Nṛsimhadeva, Lord Caitanya ran through the city streets, club in hand, ready to kill all the atheists.

TEXT 93

nṛsimha-āveśa dekhi' mahā-tejomaya

patha chāḍi' bhāge loka pāñā baḍa bhaya

SYNONYMS

nṛsimha-āveśa—the ecstasy of Lord Nṛsimhadeva; *dekhi'*—seeing; *mahā-tejo-maya*—very fierce; *patha chāḍi'*—giving up the road; *bhāge*—run away; *loka*—all people; *pāñā*—getting; *baḍa*—very much; *bhaya*—afraid.

TRANSLATION

Seeing Him appearing very fierce in the ecstasy of Lord Nṛsimha, people ran from the street and fled here and there, afraid of His anger.

TEXT 94

loka-bhaya dekhi' prabhura bāhya ha-ila

śrīvāsa-grhete giyā gadā phelāila

SYNONYMS

loka-bhaya—the fearful people; *dekhi'*—seeing this; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *bāhya*—external sense; *ha-ila*—appeared; *śrīvāsa-grhete*—in the house of Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita; *giyā*—going there; *gadā*—the club; *phelāila*—threw away.

TRANSLATION

Seeing the people so afraid, the Lord came to His external senses and thus returned to the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura and threw away the club.

TEXT 95

śrīvāse kahena prabhu kariyā viṣāda

loka bhaya pāya,——mora haya aparādha

SYNONYMS

śrīvāse—unto Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *kahena*—says; *prabhu*—the Lord; *kariyā*—becoming; *viṣāda*—morose; *loka*—people; *bhaya pāya*—become afraid; *mora*—My; *haya*—there is; *aparādha*—offense.

TRANSLATION

The Lord became morose and said to Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, “When I adopted the mood of Lord Nṛsimhadeva, people were greatly afraid. Therefore I stopped, since causing fear among people is an offense.”

TEXT 96

śrīvāsa balena,—ye tomāra nāma laya

tāra koṭi aparādha saba haya kṣaya

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsa balena—Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita said; *ye*—anyone who; *tomara*—Your; *nāma*—holy name; *laya*—takes; *tāra*—his; *koṭi*—ten million; *aparādha*—offenses; *saba*—all; *haya*—become; *kṣaya*—vanquished.

TRANSLATION

Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura replied, “Anyone who takes Your holy name vanquishes ten million of his offenses immediately.

TEXT 97

aparādha nāhi, kaile lokera nistāra

ye tomā’ dekhila, tāra chuṭila saṁsāra

SYNONYMS

aparādha—offense; *nāhi*—did not; *kaile*—committed; *lokera*—of the people; *nistāra*—liberation; *ye*—anyone who; *tomā’*—You; *dekhila*—saw; *tāra*—his; *chuṭila*—became free; *saṁsāra*—material bondage.

TRANSLATION

“There was no offense in Your appearing as Nṛsimhadeva. Rather, any man who saw You in that mood was immediately liberated from the bondage of material existence.”

TEXT 98

eta bali' śrīvāsa karila sevana

tuṣṭa hañā prabhu āilā āpana-bhavana

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *karila*—did; *sevana*—worship; *tuṣṭa*—satisfied; *hañā*—becoming; *prabhu*—the Lord; *āilā*—came back; *āpana-bhavana*—to His own home.

TRANSLATION

After saying this, Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura worshiped the Lord, who was then greatly satisfied and returned to His own home.

TEXT 99

āra dina śiva-bhakta śiva-guṇa gāya

prabhura aṅgane nāce, ḍamaru bājāya

SYNONYMS

āra dina—another day; *śiva-bhakta*—a devotee of Lord Śiva; *śiva-guṇa*—the qualities of Lord Śiva; *gāya*—chants; *prabhura*—of Lord Caitanya; *aṅgane*—in the courtyard; *nāce*—dances; *ḍamaru*—a kind of musical instrument; *bājāya*—plays on it.

TRANSLATION

On another day a great devotee of Lord Śiva, chanting of Lord Śiva's qualities, came to Lord Caitanya's house, where he began dancing in the courtyard and playing his ḍamaru [a musical instrument].

TEXT 100

maheśa-āveśa hailā śacīra nandana

tāra skandhe caḍi nṛtya kaila bahu-kṣaṇa

SYNONYMS

maheśa-āveśa—in the mood of Lord Śiva; *hailā*—became; *śacīra*—of mother Śacī; *nandana*—son; *tāra skandhe*—on his shoulder; *caḍi*—getting on; *nṛtya*—dance; *kaila*—did; *bahu-kṣaṇa*—for a long time.

TRANSLATION

Then Lord Caitanya, adopting the mood of Lord Śiva, got on the man's shoulders, and thus they danced together for a long time.

PURPORT

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu adopted the mood of Lord Śiva, for He is Śiva also. According to the philosophy of *acintya-bhedābheda-tattva*, Lord Śiva is not different from Lord Viṣṇu, but still Lord Śiva is not Lord Viṣṇu, just as yogurt is nothing but milk and yet is not milk nevertheless. One cannot get the benefit of milk by drinking yogurt. Similarly, one cannot get salvation by worshiping Lord Śiva. If one wants salvation, one must worship Lord Viṣṇu. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (9.4): *mat-sthāni sarva-bhūtāni na cāham teṣv avasthitaḥ*. Everything is resting on the Lord, for everything is His energy, yet He is not everywhere. Lord Caitanya's adopting the mood of Lord Śiva is not extraordinary, but one should not therefore think that by worshiping Lord Śiva one is worshiping Lord Caitanya. That would be a mistake.

TEXT 101

āra dina eka bhikṣuka āilā māgite

prabhura nṛtya dekhi nṛtya lāgila karite

SYNONYMS

āra—another; *dina*—day; *eka*—one; *bhikṣuka*—beggar; *āilā*—came; *māgite*—to beg; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *nṛtya*—dancing; *dekhi*—seeing; *nṛtya*—dancing; *lāgila*—began; *karite*—to perform.

TRANSLATION

On another day a mendicant came to beg alms from the Lord's house, but when he saw the Lord dancing, he also began to dance.

TEXT 102

prabhu-saṅge nṛtya kare parama ullāse

prabhu tāre prema dila, prema-rase bhāse

SYNONYMS

prabhu-saṅge—along with the Lord; *nṛtya kare*—was dancing; *parama*—very much; *ullāse*—in satisfaction; *prabhu*—the Lord; *tāre*—him; *prema*—love of Godhead; *dila*—delivered; *prema-rase*—in the mellows of love of God; *bhāse*—began to float.

TRANSLATION

He danced with the Lord because he was favored by love of Kṛṣṇa. Thus he flowed in the mellows of love of Godhead.

TEXT 103

āra dine jyotiṣa sarva-jña eka āila

tāhāre sammāna kari' prabhu praśna kaila

SYNONYMS

āra dine—some other day; *jyotiṣa*—an astrologer; *sarva-jña*—who knows everything; *eka*—one; *āila*—came there; *tāhāre*—unto him; *sammāna kari'*—giving all honor; *prabhu*—the Lord; *praśna*—question; *kaila*—put.

TRANSLATION

On another day an astrologer came who was said to know everything—past, present and future. Thus Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu received him with all honor and put this question before him.

PURPORT

Brāhmaṇas generally used to become astrologers, Āyur-vedic physicians, teachers and priests. Although highly learned and respectable, such *brāhmaṇas* went from door to door to distribute their knowledge. A *brāhmaṇa* would first go to a householder's home to give information about the functions to be performed on a particular *tithi*, or date, but if there were sickness in the family, the family members would consult the *brāhmaṇa* as a physician, and the *brāhmaṇa* would give instruction and some medicine. Often, since the *brāhmaṇas* were expert in astrology, people would also be greatly inquisitive about their past, present and future.

Although the *brāhmaṇa* appeared at Lord Caitanya's house as a beggar, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu received him with great respect because he was a qualified *brāhmaṇa* who knew the astrological science perfectly. Although *brāhmaṇas* would go door to door just like beggars, they were honored as very respectable guests. This was the system in Hindu society five hundred years ago, during the time of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. This system was current even one hundred years ago; even fifty or sixty years

ago, when we were children, such *brāhmaṇas* would visit householders like humble beggars, and people would derive great benefit from the mercy of such *brāhmaṇas*. The greatest benefit was that a householder could save a great deal of money from being spent on doctor bills because the *brāhmaṇas*, aside from explaining the past, present and future, could ordinarily cure all kinds of diseases simply by giving instructions and some medicine. Thus no one was bereft of the benefit of a first-class physician, astrologer and priest. The important members of ISKCON should give careful attention to our Dallas school, where children are being taught Sanskrit and English to become perfect *brāhmaṇas*. If they are actually trained as perfect *brāhmaṇas*, they can save society from rogues and ruffians; indeed, people can live happily under the protection of qualified *brāhmaṇas*. Therefore the *Bhagavad-gītā* (4.13) gives special stress to the division of society (*cātur-varṇyam mayā sṛṣṭam guṇa-karma-vibhāgaśaḥ*). Unfortunately some people are now claiming to be *brāhmaṇas* simply by birthright, with no qualifications. Therefore the entire society is in chaos.

TEXT 104

ke āchilun āmi pūrva janme kaha gaṇi'

gaṇite lāgilā sarva-jñā prabhu-vākya śuni'

SYNONYMS

ke āchilun āmi—who I was; *pūrva janme*—in My previous birth; *kaha*—please say; *gaṇi'*—by your astrological calculation; *gaṇite*—to calculate; *lāgilā*—began; *sarva-jñā*—a man who knows past, present and future; *prabhu-vākya*—the words of Lord Caitanya; *śuni'*—hearing.

TRANSLATION

“Please tell Me who I was in My previous birth,” the Lord said. “Please tell Me by your astrological computations.” Hearing the words of the

Lord, the astrologer immediately began to calculate.

PURPORT

Through astrology one can know past, present and future. Modern Western astrologers have no knowledge of the past or future, nor can they perfectly say anything about the present. Herein we find, however, that after hearing Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's order, the astrologer immediately began his calculations. This was not a facade: he actually knew how to ascertain one's past life through astrology. A still-existing treatise called the *Bhṛgu-saṁhitā* describes a system by which anyone can immediately get information about what he was in the past and what he is going to be in the future. The *brāhmaṇas* who went door to door as if beggars had perfect command of such vast knowledge. Thus the highest knowledge was easily available even to the poorest man in society. The poorest man could inquire from an astrologer about his past, present and future, with no need for business agreements or exorbitant payments. The *brāhmaṇa* would give him all the benefit of his knowledge without asking remuneration, and the poor man, in return, would offer a handful of rice, or anything he had in his possession, to satisfy the *brāhmaṇa*. In a perfect human society, perfect knowledge in any science—medical, astrological, ecclesiastical and so on—is available even to the poorest man, with no anxiety over payment. In the present day, however, no one can get justice, medical treatment, astrological help or ecclesiastical enlightenment without money, and since people are generally poor, they are bereft of the benefits of all these great sciences.

TEXT 105

gaṇi' dhyāne dekhe sarva-jña,—mahā-jyotirmaya

ananta vaikuṇṭha-brahmāṇḍa—sabāra āśraya

SYNONYMS

gaṇi'—by calculation; *dhyāne*—by meditation; *dekhe*—sees; *sarva-jñā*—knower of everything; *mahā-jyotir-maya*—highly effulgent body; *ananta*—unlimited; *vaikuṇṭha*—spiritual world; *brahmāṇḍa*—planets; *sabāra*—of all of them; *āśraya*—shelter.

TRANSLATION

Through calculation and meditation, the all-knowing astrologer saw the greatly effulgent body of the Lord, which is the resting place of all the unlimited Vaikuṇṭha planets.

PURPORT

Here we get some information of the Vaikuṇṭha world, or spiritual world. *Vaikuṇṭha* means “without anxiety.” In the material world, everyone is full of anxiety, but another world, where there is no anxiety, is described in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (8.20):

*paras tasmāt tu bhāvo 'nyo 'vyakto 'vyaktāt sanātanaḥ
yaḥ sa sarveṣu bhūteṣu naśyatsu na vinaśyati*

“Yet there is another unmanifest nature, which is eternal and is transcendental to this manifested and unmanifested matter. It is supreme and is never annihilated. When all in this world is annihilated, that part remains as it is.”

As there are many planets within the material world, there are many millions of planets, called Vaikuṇṭhalokas, in the spiritual world. All these Vaikuṇṭhalokas, or superior planets, rest on the effulgence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. As stated in the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (*yasya prabhā prabhavato jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-* [Bs. 5.40]), the Brahman effulgence emanating from the body of the Supreme Lord creates innumerable planets in both the spiritual and material worlds; thus these planets are creations of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The astrologer saw Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu to be the very same Personality of Godhead. We

can just imagine how learned he was, yet he was traveling door to door, just like an ordinary beggar, for the highest benefit of human society.

TEXT 106

parama-tattva, para-brahma, parama-īśvara

dekhi' prabhura mūrti sarva-jñā ha-ila phāñphara

SYNONYMS

parama-tattva—the Supreme Truth; *para-brahma*—the Supreme Brahman; *parama-īśvara*—the Supreme Lord; *dekhi'*—seeing; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *mūrti*—form; *sarva-jñā*—the all-knowing astrologer; *ha-ila*—became; *phāñphara*—confused.

TRANSLATION

Seeing Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to be the same Absolute Truth, the Supreme Brahman, the Personality of Godhead, the astrologer was confused.

PURPORT

Herein it is clearly indicated that the Absolute Truth, the Supreme Brahman, is, in the ultimate issue, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Therefore a person is the beginning of all things. As confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (10.8), *mattaḥ sarvaṁ pravartate*: everything begins from the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Supreme Lord is the supreme living entity. Therefore whatever exists, whether matter or spirit, is all but an emanation from the Supreme Person, or supreme life. The modern scientists' theory that life begins from matter is nonsense. Both matter and life begin from life. Unfortunately the scientists do not know this scientific fact; they are drifting in the darkness of their so-called knowledge.

TEXT 107

balite nā pāre kichu, mauna ha-ila

prabhu punaḥ praśna kaila, kahite lāgila

SYNONYMS

balite—to say; *nā pāre*—is not able; *kichu*—anything; *mauna*—silent; *ha-ila*—became; *prabhu*—the Lord; *punaḥ*—again; *praśna*—question; *kaila*—put; *kahite*—to speak; *lāgila*—began.

TRANSLATION

Struck with wonder, the astrologer remained silent, unable to speak. But when the Lord again put the question before him, he replied as follows.

TEXT 108

pūrva janme chilā tumi jagat-āśraya

paripūrṇa bhagavān—sarvaiśvaramaya

SYNONYMS

pūrva janme—in the previous birth; *chilā*—were; *tumi*—You; *jagat*—universe; *āśraya*—shelter; *paripūrṇa*—with full potencies; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *sarva-aiśvarya-maya*—full of all opulences.

TRANSLATION

“My dear sir, in Your previous birth You were the shelter of all creation, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, full of all opulences.

TEXT 109

pūrve yaiche chilā tumi ebeha se-rūpa

durvijñeya nityānanda—tomāra svarūpa

SYNONYMS

pūrve—in the past; *yaiche*—as much as; *chilā*—You were; *tumi*—You; *ebeha*—now also; *se-rūpa*—the same thing; *durvijñeya*—inconceivable; *nityānanda*—eternal happiness; *tomāra*—Your; *svarūpa*—identity.

TRANSLATION

“You are now the same Personality of Godhead that You were in Your previous birth. Your identity is inconceivable eternal happiness.”

PURPORT

By the power of astrological science one can even ascertain the position of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Everything is to be identified by its symptoms. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is identified by the symptoms mentioned in the *śāstras*. It is not that anyone and everyone can become God without proof from *śāstras*.

TEXT 110

prabhu hāsi' kailā,—tumi kichu nā jānilā

pūrve āmi āchilān jātite goyālā

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *hāsi'*—smiling; *kailā*—said; *tumi*—you; *kichu*—anything; *nā*—not; *jānilā*—know; *pūrve*—in the past; *āmi*—I;

āchilān—was; *jātite*—by caste; *goyālā*—cowherd.

TRANSLATION

When the astrologer was speaking so highly of Him, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu stopped him and began to smile. “My dear sir,” He said, “I think you do not know very clearly what I was, for I know that in My previous birth I was a cowherd boy.

TEXT 111

gopa-gr̥he janma chila, gābhīra rākhāla

sei puṇye hailān ebe brāhmaṇa-chāoyāla

SYNONYMS

gopa-gr̥he—in the house of a cowherd; *janma*—birth; *chila*—there was; *gābhīra*—of the cows; *rākhāla*—protector; *sei puṇye*—by those pious activities; *hailān*—became; *ebe*—now; *brāhmaṇa*—of a *brāhmaṇa*; *chāoyāla*—son.

TRANSLATION

“In My last birth I was born in the family of cowherd men, and I gave protection to the calves and cows. Because of such pious activities, I have now become the son of a *brāhmaṇa*.”

PURPORT

The words of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the greatest authority, herein clearly indicate that one becomes pious simply by keeping cows and protecting them. Unfortunately, people have become such rascals that they do not even care about the words of an authority. People generally consider cowherd men lowly members of society, but herein Caitanya

Mahāprabhu confirms that they are so pious that in their next lives they are going to be *brāhmaṇas*. The caste system has a specific purpose. If this scientific system is followed, human society will get the greatest benefit. Heeding this instruction by the Lord, people should serve cows and calves and in return get ample quantities of milk. There is no loss in serving the cows and calves, but modern human society has become so degraded that instead of giving protection to the cows and serving them, people are killing them. How can they expect peace and prosperity in human society while committing such sinful activities? It is impossible.

TEXT 112

sarva-jña kahe āmi tāhā dhyāne dekhilān

tāhāte aiśvarya dekhi' phāṇphara ha-ilān

SYNONYMS

sarva-jña—the all-knowing astrologer; *kahe*—says; *āmi*—I; *tāhā*—that; *dhyāne*—in meditation; *dekhilān*—saw; *tāhāte*—there; *aiśvarya*—opulence; *dekhi'*—by seeing; *phāṇphara*—confused; *ha-ilān*—became.

TRANSLATION

The astrologer said, “What I saw in meditation was full of opulence, and therefore I was confused.

PURPORT

It appears that the astrologer not only was a knower of past, present and future through astrological calculation, but was a great meditator as well. Therefore he was a great devotee and could see Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu to be the same personality as Kṛṣṇa. He was puzzled, however, about whether Kṛṣṇa and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu were actually the same person.

TEXT 113

sei-rūpe ei-rūpe dekhi ekākāra

kabhu bheda dekhi, ei māyāya tomāra

SYNONYMS

sei-rūpe—in that form; *ei-rūpe*—in this form; *dekhi*—I see; *eka-ākāra*—one form; *kabhu*—sometimes; *bheda*—difference; *dekhi*—I see; *ei*—this; *māyāya tomāra*—Your *māyā*.

TRANSLATION

“I am certain that Your form and the form I saw in my meditation are one and the same. If I see any difference, this is an act of Your illusory energy.”

PURPORT

Śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya rādhā-kṛṣṇa nahe anya: in the vision of a perfect devotee, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu is a combination of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. One who sees Lord Caitanya to be different from Kṛṣṇa is under the illusory energy of the Lord. It appears that the astrologer was already an advanced devotee, and when he came into the presence of the Supreme Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he became perfectly self-realized and could see that the Supreme Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu are one and the same Supreme Person.

TEXT 114

ye hao, se hao tumi, tomāke namaskāra

prabhu tāre prema diyā kaila puraskāra

SYNONYMS

ye hao—whatever You are; *se hao tumi*—whatever You may be;
tomāke—unto You; *namaskāra*—my obeisances; *prabhu*—the Lord;
tāre—unto him; *prema*—love of Godhead; *diyā*—delivered; *kaila*—did;
puraskāra—honor.

TRANSLATION

The all-knowing astrologer concluded, “Whatever You may be or whoever You may be, I offer my respectful obeisances unto You!” By His causeless mercy, the Lord then gave him love of Godhead, thus rewarding him for his service.

PURPORT

The incident of Lord Caitanya’s meeting the all-knowing astrologer is not mentioned in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, but we cannot therefore say that it did not take place. On the contrary, we must accept the statement of Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī that whatever the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* did not mention he has especially mentioned in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

TEXT 115

eka dina prabhu viṣṇu-maṇḍape vasiyā

‘madhu āna’, ‘madhu āna’ balena ḍākiyā

SYNONYMS

eka dina—one day; *prabhu*—the Lord; *viṣṇu-maṇḍape*—in the corridor of a Viṣṇu temple; *vasiyā*—sitting; *madhu āna*—bring honey; *madhu āna*—bring honey; *balena*—says; *ḍākiyā*—calling loudly.

TRANSLATION

One day the Lord sat down in the corridor of a Viṣṇu temple and began calling very loudly, “Bring some honey! Bring some honey!”

TEXT 116

nityānanda-gosāñi prabhura āveśa jānīla

gaṅgā-jala-pātra āni’ sammukhe dharīla

SYNONYMS

nityānanda-gosāñi—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *āveśa*—ecstasy; *jānīla*—could understand; *gaṅgā-jala*—Ganges water; *pātra*—pot; *āni’*—bringing; *sammukhe*—in front; *dharīla*—placed it.

TRANSLATION

Nityānanda Prabhu Gosāñi, understanding the ecstatic mood of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, brought a pot of Ganges water as a token and put it before Him.

TEXT 117

jala pāna kariyā nāce hañā vihvala

yamunākarṣaṇa-līlā dekhaye sakala

SYNONYMS

jala—water; *pāna kariyā*—after drinking; *nāce*—dances; *hañā*—becoming; *vihvala*—ecstatic; *yamunā-ākarṣaṇa*—attracting the river Yamunā; *līlā*—pastimes; *dekhaye*—sees; *sakala*—everyone.

TRANSLATION

After drinking the water, Lord Caitanya became so ecstatic that He began to dance. Thus everyone saw the pastime of attracting the river Yamunā.

PURPORT

Yamunākarṣaṇa-līlā is the pastime of attracting the Yamunā. One day, Śrī Baladeva wanted the Yamunā River to come before Him, and when the river Yamunā refused, He took His plow, wanting to dig a canal so that the Yamunā would be obliged to come there. Since Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the original form of Baladeva, in His ecstasy He asked everyone to bring honey. In this way, all the devotees standing there saw the *yamunākarṣaṇa-līlā*. In this *līlā*, Baladeva was accompanied by His girlfriends. After drinking a honey beverage called Vāruṇī, He wanted to jump into the Yamunā and swim with the girls. It is stated in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.65.25–30, 33) that Lord Baladeva asked the Yamunā to come near, and when the river disobeyed the order of the Lord, He became angry and thus wanted to snatch her near to Him with His plow. The Yamunā, however, very much afraid of Lord Balarāma's anger, immediately came and surrendered unto Him, praying to the Lord, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and admitting her fault. She was then excused. This is the sum and substance of the *yamunākarṣaṇa-līlā*. The incident is also described in the prayer of Jayadeva Gosvāmī concerning the ten incarnations:

*vahasi vapuṣi viśade vasaṇaṁ jaladābhaṁ
halahati-bhīti-milita-yamunābhaṁ
keśava dhṛta-haladhara-rūpa jaya jagad-īśa hare*

TEXT 118

*mada-matta-gati baladeva-anukāra
ācārya śekhara tāñre dekhe rāmākāra*

SYNONYMS

mada-matta—being intoxicated by drinking Vāruṇī; *gati*—movement; *baladeva*—Lord Baladeva; *anukāra*—imitating; *ācārya*—Advaita Ācārya; *śekhara*—at the head; *tāñre*—Him; *dekhe*—sees; *rāma-ākāra*—in the form of Balarāma.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord, in His ecstasy of Baladeva, was moving as if intoxicated by the beverage, Advaita Ācārya, the chief of the ācāryas [ācārya śekhara], saw Him in the form of Balarāma.

TEXT 119

vanamālī ācārya dekhe soṇāra lāṅgala

sabe mili' nṛtya kare āveśe vihvala

SYNONYMS

vanamālī ācārya—Vanamālī Ācārya; *dekhe*—sees; *soṇāra*—made of gold; *lāṅgala*—plow; *sabe*—all; *mili'*—meeting together; *nṛtya*—dance; *kare*—perform; *āveśe*—in ecstasy; *vihvala*—overwhelmed.

TRANSLATION

Vanamālī Ācārya saw a golden plow in the hand of Balarāma, and the devotees all assembled together and danced, overwhelmed by ecstasy.

TEXT 120

ei-mata nṛtya ha-ila cāri prahara

sandhyāya gaṅgā-snāna kari' sabe gelā ghara

SYNONYMS

ei-mata—in this way; *nṛtya*—dancing; *ha-ila*—was performed; *cāri*—four; *prahara*—a period of time lasting three hours; *sandhyāya*—in the evening; *gaṅgā-snāna*—taking bath in the Ganges; *kari'*—finishing; *sabe*—all; *gelā*—returned; *ghara*—home.

TRANSLATION

In this way they danced continuously for twelve hours, and in the evening they all took a bath in the Ganges and then returned to their homes.

TEXT 121

nagariyā loke prabhu yabe ājñā dilā

ghare ghare saṅkīrtana karite lāgilā

SYNONYMS

nagariyā—citizens; *loke*—all the people; *prabhu*—the Lord; *yabe*—when; *ājñā*—order; *dilā*—gave; *ghare ghare*—in each and every home; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *karite*—to perform; *lāgilā*—began.

TRANSLATION

The Lord ordered all the citizens of Navadvīpa to chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra, and in each and every home they began performing saṅkīrtana regularly.

TEXT 122

'haraye namaḥ, kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ

gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana'

SYNONYMS

haraye namaḥ—I offer my respectful obeisances to Lord Hari; *kṛṣṇa*—O Kṛṣṇa; *yādavāya*—unto the descendant of the Yadu dynasty; *namaḥ*—all obeisances; *gopāla*—Gopāla; *govinda*—Govinda; *rāma*—Rāma; *śrī-madhusūdana*—Śrī Madhusūdana.

TRANSLATION

[All the devotees sang this popular song along with the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra.] “Haraye namaḥ, kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ/ gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana.”

TEXT 123

mṛdaṅga-karatāla saṅkīrtana-mahādhvani

‘hari’ ‘hari’—dhvani vinā anya nāhi śuni

SYNONYMS

mṛdaṅga—drum; *karatāla*—hand bells; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the holy name of the Lord; *mahā-dhvani*—great vibration; *hari*—the Lord; *hari*—the Lord; *dhvani*—sound; *vinā*—except; *anya*—another; *nāhi*—not; *śuni*—one can hear.

TRANSLATION

When the saṅkīrtana movement thus started, no one in Navadvīpa could hear any sound other than the words “Hari! Hari!” and the beating of the mṛdaṅga and clashing of hand bells.

PURPORT

The International Society for Krishna Consciousness now has its world

center in Navadvīpa, Māyāpur. The managers of this center should see that twenty-four hours a day there is chanting of the holy names of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, with the addition of *haraye namaḥ*, *kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ*, for this song was a favorite of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's. But all such *saṅkīrtana* must be preceded by the chanting of the holy names of the five *tattvas*—*śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda*. We are already accustomed to chant these two *mantras*—*śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu-nityānanda śrī-advaita gadādhara śrīvāsādi-gaura-bhakta-vṛnda* and Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare. Now, after these, the other two lines—namely *haraye namaḥ*, *kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ/ gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana*—should be added, especially in Māyāpur. Chanting of these six lines should go on so perfectly well that no one there hears any vibration other than the chanting of the holy names of the Lord. That will make the center spiritually all-perfect.

TEXT 124

śuniyā ye kruddha haila sakala yavana

kājī-pāśe āsi' sabe kaila nivedana

SYNONYMS

śuniyā—by hearing; *ye*—that; *kruddha*—angry; *haila*—became; *sakala*—all; *yavana*—Muslims; *kājī-pāśe*—in the court of the Kazi, or magistrate; *āsi'*—coming; *sabe*—all; *kaila*—made; *nivedana*—petition.

TRANSLATION

Hearing the resounding vibration of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra, the local Muslims, greatly angry, submitted a complaint to the Kazi.

PURPORT

The *phaujadarā*, or city magistrate, was called the *kājī* (Kazi). The *jamidāras* (zamindars), or landholders (*maṇḍalerās*), levied taxes on the land, but keeping law and order and punishing criminals was the duty entrusted to the Kazi. Both the Kazi and the landholders were under the control of the governor of Bengal, which at that time was known as Subā-bāṅgālā. The districts of Nadia, Islāmpura and Bāgoyāna were all under the zamindar named Hari Hoḍa or his descendant known as Hoḍa Kṛṣṇadāsa. It is said that Chand Kazi was the spiritual master of Nawab Hussain Shah. According to one opinion his name was Maulānā Sirājuddina, and according to another his name was Habibara Rahamāna. Descendants of Chand Kazi are still living in the vicinity of Māyāpur. People still go to see the tomb of Chand Kazi, which is underneath a *campaka* tree and is known as Chand Kazi's *samādhi*.

TEXT 125

krodhe sandhyā-kāle kājī eka ghare āila

mṛdaṅga bhāṅgiyā loke kahite lāgila

SYNONYMS

krodhe—in anger; *sandhyā-kāle*—in the evening; *kājī*—the Chand Kazi; *eka ghare*—in one home; *āila*—came; *mṛdaṅga*—drum; *bhāṅgiyā*—breaking; *loke*—unto the people; *kahite*—to speak; *lāgila*—began.

TRANSLATION

Chand Kazi angrily came to one home in the evening, and when he saw kīrtana going on, he broke a mṛdaṅga and spoke as follows.

TEXT 126

eta-kāla keha nāhi kaila hinduyāni

ebe ye udyama cālāo kāra bala jāni'

SYNONYMS

eta-kāla—so long; *keha*—anyone; *nāhi*—not; *kaila*—performed; *hinduyāni*—regulative principles of the Hindus; *ebe*—now; *ye*—that; *udyama*—endeavor; *cālāo*—you propagate; *kāra*—whose; *bala*—strength; *jāni'*—I want to know.

TRANSLATION

“For so long you did not follow the regulative principles of the Hindu religion, but now you are following them with great enthusiasm. May I know by whose strength you are doing so?

PURPORT

It appears that from the aggression of Baktiyār Khiliji in Bengal until the time of Chand Kazi, Hindus, or the followers of the Vedic principles, were greatly suppressed. Like the Hindus in present-day Pakistan, practically no one could execute the Hindu religious principles freely. Chand Kazi referred to this condition of Hindu society. Formerly the Hindus had not been straightforward in executing their Hindu principles, but now they were freely chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. Therefore it must have been by the strength of someone else that they were so daring.

Actually, that was the fact. Although the members of the so-called Hindu society had followed the social customs and formulas, they had practically forgotten to execute their religious principles strictly. But with the presence of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu they actually began following the regulative principles according to His order. That order is still existing, and anywhere and everywhere, in all parts of the world, one can execute it. That order is to become a spiritual master under the direction of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu by following the regulative principles, chanting

daily at least sixteen rounds of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, and preaching the cult of Kṛṣṇa consciousness all over the world. If we adhere to the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, we shall get spiritual strength without a doubt, and we shall be free to preach this cult of the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement and not be hampered by anyone.

TEXT 127

keha kīrtana nā kariha sakala nagare

āji āmi kṣamā kari' yāitechoṇ ghare

SYNONYMS

keha—anyone; *kīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*; *nā*—do not; *kariha*—perform; *sakala nagare*—in the whole town; *āji*—today; *āmi*—I; *kṣamā kari'*—excusing; *yāitechoṇ*—am returning; *ghare*—home.

TRANSLATION

“No one should perform saṅkīrtana on the streets of the city. Today I am excusing the offense and returning home.

PURPORT

Such orders stopping *saṅkīrtana* in the streets of the world's great cities have been imposed upon members of the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement. We have hundreds of centers all over the world, and we have been specifically persecuted in Australia. In most cities of the Western world we have been arrested many times by the police, but we are nevertheless executing the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu by chanting on the streets of all the important cities, such as New York, London, Chicago, Sydney, Melbourne, Paris and Hamburg. We must remember that such incidents took place in the past, five hundred years ago, and the fact that they are still going on indicates that our *saṅkīrtana* movement is really authorized,

for if *saṅkīrtana* were an insignificant material affair, demons would not object to it. The demons of the time tried to obstruct the *saṅkīrtana* movement started by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Similar demons are trying to obstruct the *saṅkīrtana* movement we are executing all over the world, and this proves that our *saṅkīrtana* movement is still pure and genuine, following in the footsteps of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 128

āra yadi kīrtana karite lāga pāimu

sarvasva daṇḍiyā tāra jāti ye la-imu

SYNONYMS

āra—again; *yadi*—if; *kīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*; *karite*—to do; *lāga*—contact; *pāimu*—I shall take; *sarva-sva*—all possessions; *daṇḍiyā*—chastising; *tāra*—his; *jāti*—caste; *ye*—that; *la-imu*—I shall take.

TRANSLATION

“The next time I see someone performing such *saṅkīrtana*, I shall certainly chastise him by not only confiscating all his property but also converting him into a Muslim.”

PURPORT

To convert a Hindu into a Muslim was an easy affair in those days. If a Muslim simply sprinkled water on the body of a Hindu, it was supposed that the Hindu had already become a Muslim. During the transition of the British in Bangladesh during the last Hindu-Muslim riots, many Hindus were converted into Muslims by having cows’ flesh forcibly pushed into their mouths. Hindu society was so rigid at the time of Lord Caitanya that if a Hindu were converted into a Muslim, there was no

chance of his being reformed. In this way the Muslim population in India increased. None of the Muslims came from outside; social customs somehow or other forced Hindus to become Muslims, with no chance of returning to Hindu society. Emperor Aurangzeb also inaugurated a tax that Hindus had to pay because of their being Hindus. Thus all the poor Hindus of the lower class voluntarily became Muslims to avoid the tax. In this way the Muslim population in India increased. Chand Kazi threatened to convert the people into Muslims by the simple process of sprinkling water on their bodies.

TEXT 129

eta bali' kājī gela, — — nagariyā loka

prabhu-sthāne nivedila pāñā baḍa śoka

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—thus saying; *kājī*—the magistrate; *gela*—returned; *nagariyā loka*—the citizens in general; *prabhu-sthāne*—before the Lord; *nivedila*—submitted; *pāñā*—getting; *baḍa*—very much; *śoka*—shock.

TRANSLATION

After saying this, the Kazi returned home, and the devotees, greatly shocked that they were forbidden to chant Hare Kṛṣṇa, submitted their grief to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 130

prabhu ājñā dila — — yāha karaha kīrtana

muñi saṁhārimu āji sakala yavana

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *ājñā dila*—ordered; *yāha*—go; *karaha*—and perform; *kīrtana*—*saṅkīrtana*, chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*; *muñi*—I; *saṁhārimu*—shall kill; *āji*—today; *sakala*—all; *yavana*—the Muslims.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya ordered, “Go perform saṅkīrtana! Today I shall kill all the Muslims!”

PURPORT

Gandhi is known for having started the movement of nonviolent civil disobedience in India, but about five hundred years before him, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu started His movement of nonviolent civil disobedience to the order of Chand Kazi. It is not necessary to commit violence to stop the opposition from hindering a movement, for one can kill their demoniac behavior with reason and argument. Following in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, whenever there are obstacles the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement should kill the opposition with reason and argument and thus stop their demoniac behavior. If we became violent in every case, it would be difficult for us to manage our affairs. We should therefore follow in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who disobeyed the order of Chand Kazi but subdued him with reason and argument.

TEXT 131

ghare giyā saba loka karaye kīrtana

kājīra bhaye svacchanda nahe, camakita mana

SYNONYMS

ghare giyā—returning home; *saba*—all; *loka*—citizens; *karaye*—performed; *kīrtana*—*saṅkīrtana*; *kājīra*—of the Kazi; *bhaye*—from fear;

svacchanda—carefree; *nahe*—not; *camakita*—always full of anxieties; *mana*—the mind.

TRANSLATION

Returning home, all the citizens began performing saṅkīrtana, but because of the order of the Kazi, they were not carefree but always full of anxiety.

TEXT 132

tā-sabhāra antare bhaya prabhu mane jāni

kahite lāgilā loke śīghra ḍāki' āni'

SYNONYMS

tā-sabhāra—of all of them; *antare*—in the mind; *bhaya*—fear; *prabhu*—the Lord; *mane*—in the mind; *jāni*—understanding; *kahite*—to speak; *lāgilā*—began; *loke*—to the people; *śīghra*—very soon; *ḍāki'*—calling; *āni'*—bringing them.

TRANSLATION

Understanding the anxiety within the people's minds, the Lord called them together and spoke to them as follows.

TEXT 133

nagare nagare āji karimu kīrtana

sandhyā-kāle kara sabhe nagara-maṇḍana

SYNONYMS

nagare—from town; *nagare*—to town; *ājī*—today; *karimu*—I shall perform; *kīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*; *sandhyā-kāle*—in the evening; *kara*—do; *sabhe*—all; *nagara*—of the city; *maṇḍana*—decoration.

TRANSLATION

“In the evening I shall perform saṅkīrtana in each and every town. Therefore you should all decorate the city in the evening.

PURPORT

At that time, Navadvīpa was composed of nine small cities, so the words *nagare nagare* are significant. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted to perform *kīrtana* in each of these neighboring towns. He ordered the city decorated for the function.

TEXT 134

sandhyāte deuṭi sabe jvāla ghare ghare

dekha, kona kājī āsi' more mānā kare

SYNONYMS

sandhyāte—in the evening; *deuṭi*—lamps; *sabe*—everyone; *jvāla*—light up; *ghare ghare*—in each and every home; *dekha*—just wait and see; *kona*—which kind; *kājī*—magistrate; *āsi'*—coming; *more*—unto Me; *mānā kare*—orders Me to stop.

TRANSLATION

“In the evening, burn torchlights in every home. I shall give protection to everyone. Let us see what kind of Kazi comes to stop our kīrtana.”

TEXT 135

eta kahi' sandhyā-kāle cāle gaurarāya

kīrtanera kaila prabhu tina sampradāya

SYNONYMS

eta kahi'—saying this; *sandhyā-kāle*—in the evening; *cāle*—went out; *gaura-rāya*—Gaurasundara; *kīrtanera*—of performing *saṅkīrtana*; *kaila*—made; *prabhu*—the Lord; *tina*—three; *sampradāya*—parties.

TRANSLATION

In the evening Lord Gaurasundara went out and formed three parties to perform kīrtana.

PURPORT

This is a scheme for performing *kīrtana* in a procession. During Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's time, one party was composed of twenty-one men: four people playing *mṛdaṅgas*, one leading the chanting, and sixteen others striking *karatālas*, responding to the leading chanter. If many men join the *saṅkīrtana* movement, they may follow in the footsteps of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and form different parties according to the time and the number of men available.

TEXT 136

āge sampradāye nṛtya kare haridāsa

madhye nāce ācārya-gosāñi parama ullāsa

SYNONYMS

āge—in front; *sampradāye*—in the party; *nṛtya*—dancing; *kare*—does; *haridāsa*—Ṭhākura Haridāsa; *madhye*—in the middle; *nāce*—dances; *ācārya-gosāñi*—Śrī Advaita Ācārya; *parama*—very; *ullāsa*—happy.

TRANSLATION

In the front party danced Ṭhākura Haridāsa, and in the middle party danced Advaita Ācārya with great jubilation.

TEXT 137

pāche sampradāye nṛtya kare gauracandra

tāñra sañge nāci' bule prabhu nityānanda

SYNONYMS

pāche—at the rear; *sampradāye*—in the party; *nṛtya*—dancing; *kare*—does; *gauracandra*—Lord Gaurāṅga; *tāñra*—His; *sañge*—along with; *nāci'*—dancing; *bule*—moves; *prabhu*—Lord; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda.

TRANSLATION

Lord Gaurasundara Himself danced in the rear party, and Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu moved with Lord Caitanya's dancing.

TEXT 138

vṛndāvana-dāsa ihā 'caitanya-maṅgale'

vistāri' varṇiyāchena, prabhu-kṛpā-bale

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-dāsa—Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura; *ihā*—this; *caitanya-*

maṅgale—in his book named *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *vistāri'*—elaborately; *varṇiyāchena*—has described; *prabhu*—of the Lord; *kṛpā-bale*—by the strength of mercy.

TRANSLATION

By the grace of the Lord, Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has elaborately described this incident in his Caitanya-maṅgala [now Caitanya-bhāgavata].

TEXT 139

ei mata kīrtana kari' nagare bhramilā

bhramite bhramite sabhe kājī-dvāre gelā

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *kīrtana*—congregational chanting; *kari'*—executing; *nagare*—in the city; *bhramilā*—circumambulated; *bhramite bhramite*—while thus moving; *sabhe*—all of them; *kājī-dvāre*—at the door of the Kazi; *gelā*—reached.

TRANSLATION

Performing kīrtana in this way, circumambulating through every nook and corner of the city, they finally reached the door of the Kazi.

TEXT 140

tarja-garja kare loka, kare kolāhala

gauracandra-bale loka praśraya-pāgala

SYNONYMS

tarja-garja—murmuring in anger; *kare*—do; *loka*—the people; *kare*—do; *kolāhala*—roaring; *gauracandra*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bale*—by the power; *loka*—people; *praśraya-pāgala*—became mad by such indulgence.

TRANSLATION

Murmuring in anger and making a roaring sound, the people, under the protection of Lord Caitanya, became mad through such indulgence.

PURPORT

The Kazi had issued an order not to perform *kīrtana*, congregational chanting of the holy name of the Lord. But when this was brought up to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, He ordered civil disobedience to the Kazi's order. Lord Caitanya and all His devotees, naturally enthusiastic although agitated, must have made a great noise with their loud cries.

TEXT 141

kīrtanera dhvanite kājī lukāila ghare

tarjana garjana śuni' nā haya bāhire

SYNONYMS

kīrtanera—of the *saṅkīrtana* movement; *dhvanite*—by the sound; *kājī*—the Chand Kazi; *lukāila*—hid himself; *ghare*—in the room; *tarjana*—murmuring; *garjana*—protesting; *śuni'*—hearing; *nā*—does not; *haya*—come out; *bāhire*—outside.

TRANSLATION

The loud sound of the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra certainly made the Kazi very much afraid, and he hid himself within his room. Hearing

the people thus protesting, murmuring in great anger, the Kazi would not come out of his home.

PURPORT

The Kazi's order not to perform *saṅkīrtana* could stand only as long as there was no civil disobedience. Under the leadership of the Supreme Lord, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the chanters, increasing in number, disobeyed the order of the Kazi. Thousands assembled together and formed parties, chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* and making a tumultuous sound of protest. Thus the Kazi was very much afraid, as naturally one should be under such circumstances.

In the present day also, people all over the world may join together in the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement and protest against the present degraded governments of the world's godless societies, which are based on all kinds of sinful activities. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* states that in the Age of Kali, thieves, rogues and fourth-class people who have neither education nor culture capture the seats of governments to exploit the citizens. This is a symptom of Kali-yuga that has already appeared. People cannot feel secure about their lives and property, yet the so-called governments continue, and government ministers get fat salaries, although they are unable to do anything good for society. The only remedy for such conditions is to enhance the *saṅkīrtana* movement under the banner of Kṛṣṇa consciousness and protest against the sinful activities of all the world's governments.

The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement is not a sentimental religious movement; it is a movement for the reformation of all the anomalies of human society. If people take to it seriously, discharging this duty scientifically, as ordered by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the world will see peace and prosperity instead of being confused and hopeless under useless governments. There are always rogues and thieves in human society, and as soon as a weak government is unable to execute its duties, these rogues and thieves come out to do their business. Thus the entire society

becomes a hell unfit for gentlemen to live in. There is an immediate need for a good government—a government by the people, with Kṛṣṇa consciousness. Unless the masses of people become Kṛṣṇa conscious, they cannot be good men. The Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement that Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu started by chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra* still has its potency. Therefore people should understand it seriously and scientifically and spread it all over the world.

The *saṅkīrtana* movement started by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, *Madhya-khaṇḍa*, Twenty-third Chapter, beginning with verse 241, which states, “My dear Lord, let my mind be fixed at Your lotus feet.” Following Lord Caitanya’s chanting, all the devotees reproduced the same sound He chanted. In this way the Lord proceeded, leading the entire party on the strand roads by the bank of the Ganges. When the Lord came to His own *ghāṭa*, or bathing place, He danced more and more. Then He proceeded to Mādhāi’s *ghāṭa*. In this way Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Supreme Lord, who was known as Viśvambhara, danced all over the banks of the Ganges. Then He proceeded to Bārakoṇā-ghāṭa, then Nāgariyā-ghāṭa, and, traveling through Gaṅgānagara, reached Simuliyā, a quarter at one end of the town. All these places surround Śrī Māyāpur. After reaching Simuliyā, the Lord proceeded toward the Kazi’s house, and in this way He reached the door of Chand Kazi.

TEXT 142

uddhata loka bhāṅge kājira ghara-puṣpavana

vistāri’ varṇilā ihā dāsa-vṛndāvana

SYNONYMS

uddhata—agitated; *loka*—persons; *bhāṅge*—break; *kājira*—of the Kazi; *ghara*—house; *puṣpa-vana*—flower garden; *vistāri’*—elaborately; *varṇilā*—described; *ihā*—this; *dāsa-vṛndāvana*—Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa

Ṭhākura.

TRANSLATION

Naturally some of the people who were very much agitated began to retaliate the Kazi's actions by wrecking his house and flower garden. Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has elaborately described this incident.

TEXT 143

tabe mahāprabhu tāra dvārete vasilā

bhavya-loka pāṭhāiyā kājire bolāilā

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *mahāprabhu*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tāra dvārete*—at the Kazi's door; *vasilā*—sat down; *bhavya-loka*—respectable persons; *pāṭhāiyā*—sending; *kājire*—unto the Kazi; *bolāilā*—had them call.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, when Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu reached the Kazi's house, He sat down by the doorway and sent some respectable persons to call for the Kazi.

TEXT 144

dūra ha-ite āilā kājī māthā noyāiyā

kājire vasāilā prabhu sammāna kariyā

SYNONYMS

dūra ha-ite—from a distant place; *āilā*—came; *kājī*—the Kazi; *māthā*—head; *noyāiyā*—bowed down; *kājire*—unto the Kazi; *vasāilā*—gave a seat; *prabhu*—the Lord; *sammāna*—respect; *kariyā*—offering.

TRANSLATION

When the Kazi came, his head bowed down, the Lord gave him proper respect and a seat.

PURPORT

Some of the men in Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s civil disobedience movement were agitated because they could not control their minds. But the Lord was thoroughly peaceful, sober and unagitated. Therefore when the Kazi came down to see Him, the Lord offered him proper respect and a seat because he was a respectable government officer. Thus the Lord taught us by His personal behavior. In pushing on our *saṅkīrtana* movement of Kṛṣṇa consciousness, we might have to face difficult days, but we should always follow in the footsteps of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and do the needful according to the time and circumstances.

TEXT 145

prabhu balena,——āmi tomāra āilāma abhyāgata

āmi dekhi’ lukāilā,——e-dharma kemata

SYNONYMS

prabhu balena—the Lord said; *āmi*—I; *tomāra*—your; *āilāma*—have come; *abhyāgata*—guest; *āmi*—Me; *dekhi’*—seeing; *lukāilā*—you disappeared; *e-dharma kemata*—what kind of etiquette is this.

TRANSLATION

In a friendly way, the Lord said, “Sir, I have come to your house as your guest, but upon seeing Me you hid yourself in your room. What kind of etiquette is this?”

TEXT 146

kājī kahe—tumi āisa kruddha ha-iyā

tomā śānta karāite rahinu lukāiyā

SYNONYMS

kājī kahe—the Kazi replied; *tumi*—You; *āisa*—have come; *kruddha*—angry; *ha-iyā*—being; *tomā*—You; *śānta*—pacified; *karāite*—to make; *rahinu*—I remained; *lukāiyā*—hiding out of sight.

TRANSLATION

The Kazi replied, “You have come to my house in a very angry mood. To pacify You, I did not come before You immediately but kept myself hidden.

TEXT 147

ebe tumi śāntā haile, āsi, mililān

bhāgya mora,—tomā hena atithi pāilān

SYNONYMS

ebe—now; *tumi*—You; *śānta*—pacified; *haile*—have become; *āsi’*—coming; *mililān*—I have met (You); *bhāgya mora*—it is my great fortune; *toma*—You; *hena*—like; *atithi*—guest; *pāilān*—I have received.

TRANSLATION

“Now that You have become pacified, I have come to You. It is my good fortune to receive a guest like Your Honor.

TEXT 148

grāma-sambandhe ‘cakravartī’ haya mora cācā

deha-sambandhe haite haya grāma-sambandha sāñcā

SYNONYMS

grāma-sambandhe—in our neighborhood relationship; *cakravartī*—Your grandfather Nīlāmbara Cakravartī; *haya*—becomes; *mora*—my; *cācā*—uncle; *deha-sambandhe*—in a bodily relationship; *haite*—than; *haya*—becomes; *grāma-sambandha*—neighborhood relationship; *sāñcā*—more powerful.

TRANSLATION

“In our village relationship, Nīlāmbara Cakravartī Ṭhākura was my uncle. Such a relationship is stronger than a bodily relationship.

PURPORT

In India, even in the interior villages, all the Hindu and Muslim communities used to live very peacefully by establishing a relationship between them. The young men called the elderly members of the village by the name *cācā* or *kākā*, “uncle,” and men of the same age called each other *dādā*, “brother.” The relationship was very friendly. There were even invitations from Muslim houses to Hindu houses and from Hindu houses to Muslim houses. Both the Hindus and the Muslims accepted the invitations to go to one another’s houses to attend ceremonial functions. Even until fifty or sixty years ago, the relationship between Hindus and Muslims was very friendly, and there were no disturbances. We do not find any Hindu-Muslim riots in the history of India, even during the days

of the Muslims' rule over the country. Conflict between Hindus and Muslims was created by polluted politicians, especially foreign rulers, and thus the situation gradually became so degraded that India was divided into Hindustan and Pakistan. Fortunately, the remedy to unite not only the Hindus and Muslims but all communities and all nations can still be implemented by the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement on the strong basic platform of love of Godhead.

TEXT 149

nīlāmbara cakravartī haya tomāra nānā

se-sambandhe hao tumi āmāra bhāginā

SYNONYMS

nīlāmbara cakravartī—Nīlāmbara Cakravartī; *haya*—becomes; *tomāra*—Your; *nānā*—maternal grandfather; *se-sambandhe*—by such a relationship; *hao*—become; *tumi*—You; *āmāra*—my; *bhāginā*—nephew (the son of my sister).

TRANSLATION

“Nīlāmbara Cakravartī is Your maternal grandfather, and by this relationship You are thus my nephew.

TEXT 150

bhāgināra krodha māmā avaśya sahaya

mātulera aparādha bhāginā nā laya

SYNONYMS

bhāgināra—of the nephew; *krodha*—anger; *māmā*—maternal uncle;

avaśya—certainly; *sahaya*—tolerates; *mātulera*—of the maternal uncle; *aparādha*—offense; *bhāginā*—the nephew; *nā*—does not; *laya*—accept.

TRANSLATION

“When a nephew is very angry, his maternal uncle is tolerant, and when the maternal uncle commits an offense, the nephew does not take it very seriously.”

TEXT 151

ei mata duñhāra kathā haya ṭhāre-ṭhore

bhitarera artha keha bujhite nā pāre

SYNONYMS

ei mata—in this way; *duñhāra*—of both of them; *kathā*—conversation; *haya*—took place; *ṭhāre-ṭhore*—with different indications; *bhitarera*—inner; *artha*—meaning; *keha*—anyone; *bujhite*—to understand; *nā pāre*—is not able.

TRANSLATION

In this way the Kazi and the Lord talked with each other with various indications, but no outsider could understand the inner meaning of their conversation.

TEXT 152

prabhu kahe,——praśna lāgi’ āilāma tomāra sthāne

kājī kahe,——ājñā kara, ye tomāra mane

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord said; *praśna lāgi'*—just to inquire from you; *āilāma*—I have come; *tomāra sthāne*—at your place; *kājī kahe*—the Kazi replied; *ājñā kara*—just order me; *ye*—whatever; *tomāra mane*—(is) in Your mind.

TRANSLATION

The Lord said, “My dear uncle, I have come to your home just to ask you some questions.”

“Yes,” the Kazi replied, “You are welcome. Just tell me what is in Your mind.”

TEXT 153

prabhu kahe, — — go-dugdha khāo, gābhī tomāra mātā

vṛṣa anna upajāya, tāte teṇho pitā

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord said; *go-dugdha khāo*—you drink cows’ milk; *gābhī*—the cow (is); *tomāra*—your; *mātā*—mother; *vṛṣa*—the bull; *anna*—grains; *upajāya*—produces; *tāte*—therefore; *teṇho*—he; *pitā*—(is) your father.

TRANSLATION

The Lord said, “You drink cows’ milk; therefore the cow is your mother. And the bull produces grains for your maintenance; therefore he is your father.

TEXT 154

pitā-mātā mārī' khāo — — ebā kon dharma

kon bale kara tumi e-mata vikarma

SYNONYMS

pitā-mātā—father and mother; *māri'*—killing; *khāo*—you eat; *ebā*—this; *kon*—what kind of; *dharma*—religion; *kon bale*—on what strength; *kara*—do; *tumi*—you; *e-mata*—such; *vikarma*—sinful activities.

TRANSLATION

“Since the bull and cow are your father and mother, how can you kill and eat them? What kind of religious principle is this? On what strength are you so daring that you commit such sinful activities?”

PURPORT

Everyone can understand that we drink the milk of cows and take the help of bulls in producing agricultural products. Therefore, since our real father gives us food grains and our mother gives us milk with which to live, the cow and bull are considered our father and mother. According to Vedic civilization, there are seven mothers, of which the cow is one. Therefore Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu challenged the Muslim Kazi, “What kind of religious principle do you follow by killing your father and mother to eat them?” In any civilized human society, no one would dare kill his father and mother for the purpose of eating them. Therefore Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu challenged the system of Muslim religion as patricide and matricide. In the Christian religion also, a principal commandment is “Thou shalt not kill.” Nevertheless, Christians violate this rule; they are very expert in killing and in opening slaughterhouses. In our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, our first provision is that no one should be allowed to eat any kind of flesh. It does not matter whether it is cows’ flesh or goats’ flesh, but we especially stress the prohibition against cows’ flesh because according to *śāstra* the cow is our mother. Thus the Muslims’ cow-killing was challenged by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 155

kājī kahe, — — tomāra yaiche veda-purāṇa

taiche āmāra śāstra — — ketāva ‘korāṇa’

SYNONYMS

kājī kahe—the Kazi replied; *tomāra*—Your; *yaiche*—as much as; *veda-purāṇa*—the *Vedas* and *Purāṇas*; *taiche*—similarly; *āmāra*—our; *śāstra*—scripture; *ketāva*—the holy book; *korāṇa*—the Koran.

TRANSLATION

The Kazi replied, “As You have Your scriptures called the Vedas and Purāṇas, we have our scripture, known as the holy Koran.

PURPORT

Chand Kazi agreed to talk with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu on the strength of the scriptures. According to the Vedic scripture, if one can support his position by quoting from the *Vedas*, his argument is perfect. Similarly, when the Muslims support their position with quotations from the Koran, their arguments are also authorized. When Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu raised the question of the Muslims’ cow-killing and bull-killing, Chand Kazi came to the standard of understanding from his scriptures.

TEXT 156

sei śāstre kahe, — — pravṛtti-nivṛtti-mārga-bheda

nivṛtti-mārga jīva-mātra-vadhera niṣedha

SYNONYMS

sei śāstre—in the scripture (the Koran); *kahe*—it is ordered; *pravṛtti*—of attachment; *nivṛtti*—of detachment; *mārga*—ways; *bheda*—difference; *nivṛtti*—of detachment; *mārga*—on the path; *jīva-mātra*—of any living entity; *vadhera*—of killing; *niṣedha*—prohibition.

TRANSLATION

“According to the Koran, there are two ways of advancement—through increasing the propensity to enjoy, and through decreasing the propensity to enjoy. On the path of decreasing attachment [nivṛtti-mārga], the killing of animals is prohibited.

TEXT 157

pravṛtti-mārga go-vadha karite vidhi haya

śāstra-ājñāya vadha kaile nāhi pāpa-bhaya

SYNONYMS

pravṛtti-mārga—on the path of attachment; *go-vadha*—the killing of cows; *karite*—to execute; *vidhi*—regulative principles; *haya*—there are; *śāstra-ājñāya*—on the order of the scripture; *vadha*—killing; *kaile*—if one commits; *nāhi*—there is no; *pāpa-bhaya*—fear of sinful activities.

TRANSLATION

“On the path of material activities, there is regulation for killing cows. If such killing is done under the guidance of scripture, there is no sin.”

PURPORT

The word *śāstra* is derived from the *dhātu*, or verbal root, *śas*. *Śas-dhātu* pertains to controlling or ruling. A government’s ruling through force or weapons is called *śāstra*. Thus whenever there is ruling, either by

weapons or by injunctions, the *śas-dhātu* is the basic principle. Between *śāstra* (ruling through weapons) and *śāstra* (ruling through the injunctions of the scriptures), the better is *śāstra*. Our Vedic scriptures are not ordinary lawbooks of human common sense; they are the statements of factually liberated persons unaffected by the imperfectness of the senses.

Śāstra must be correct always, not sometimes correct and sometimes incorrect. In the Vedic scriptures, the cow is described as a mother. Therefore she is a mother for all time; it is not, as some rascals say, that in the Vedic age she was a mother but she is not in this age. If *śāstra* is an authority, the cow is a mother always; she was a mother in the Vedic age, and she is a mother in this age also.

If one acts according to the injunctions of *śāstra*, he is freed from the reactions of sinful activity. For example, the propensities for eating flesh, drinking wine and enjoying sex are all natural to the conditioned soul. The path of such enjoyment is called *pravṛtti-marga*. The *śāstra* says, *pravṛttir eṣāṁ bhūtānāṁ nivṛttis tu mahā-phalā*: one should not be carried away by the propensities of defective conditioned life; one should be guided by the principles of the *śāstras*. A child's propensity is to play all day long, but it is the injunction of the *śāstras* that the parents should take care to educate him. The *śāstras* are there just to guide the activities of human society. But because people do not refer to the instructions of *śāstras*, which are free from defects and imperfections, they are therefore misguided by so-called educated teachers and leaders who are full of the deficiencies of conditioned life.

TEXT 158

tomāra vedete āche go-vadhera vāṇī

ataeva go-vadha kare baḍa baḍa muni

SYNONYMS

tomāra vedete—in Your Vedic literatures; *āche*—there is; *go-vadhera*—for cow-killing; *vāṇī*—injunction; *ataeva*—therefore; *go-vadha*—cow-killing; *kare*—does; *baḍa baḍa*—very, very great; *muni*—sages.

TRANSLATION

As a learned scholar, the Kazi challenged Caitanya Mahāprabhu, “In Your Vedic scriptures there is an injunction for killing a cow. On the strength of this injunction, great sages performed sacrifices involving cow-killing.”

TEXT 159

prabhu kahe, — — vede kahe go-vadha niṣedha

ataeva hindu-mātra nā kare go-vadha

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord replied; *vede*—in the *Vedas*; *kahe*—is enjoined; *go-vadha*—cow-killing; *niṣedha*—prohibition; *ataeva*—therefore; *hindu*—Hindu; *mātra*—any; *nā*—does not; *kare*—execute; *go-vadha*—cow-killing.

TRANSLATION

Refuting the Kazi’s statement, the Lord immediately replied, “The Vedas clearly enjoin that cows should not be killed. Therefore every Hindu, whoever he may be, avoids indulging in cow-killing.

PURPORT

In the Vedic scriptures there are concessions for meat-eaters. It is said that if one wants to eat meat, he should kill a goat before the goddess Kālī and then eat its meat. Meat-eaters are not allowed to purchase meat or

flesh from a market or slaughterhouse. There are no sanctions for maintaining regular slaughterhouses to satisfy the tongues of meat-eaters. As far as cow-killing is concerned, it is completely forbidden. Since the cow is considered a mother, how could the *Vedas* allow cow-killing? Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu pointed out that the Kazi's statement was faulty. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (18.44) there is a clear injunction that cows should be protected: *kṛṣi-gorakṣya-vāṇijyaṁ vaiśya-karma svabhāva-jam*. "The duty of *vaiśyas* is to produce agricultural products, trade and give protection to cows." Therefore it is a false statement that the Vedic scriptures contain injunctions permitting cow-killing.

TEXT 160

jīyāite pāre yadi, tabe māre prāṇī

veda-purāṇe āche hena ājñā-vāṇī

SYNONYMS

jīyāite—to rejuvenate; *pāre*—one is able; *yadi*—if; *tabe*—then; *māre*—can kill; *prāṇī*—living being; *veda-purāṇe*—in the *Vedas* and *Purāṇas*; *āche*—there are; *hena*—such; *ājñā-vāṇī*—orders and injunctions.

TRANSLATION

"In the *Vedas* and *Purāṇas* there are injunctions declaring that if one can revive a living being, one can kill it for experimental purposes.

TEXT 161

ataeva jarad-gava māre muni-gaṇa

veda-mantre siddha kare tāhāra jīvana

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *jarad-gava*—old cows; *māre*—killed; *muni-gaṇa*—sages; *veda-mantre*—by the power of Vedic hymns; *siddha*—rejuvenated; *kare*—makes; *tāhāra*—his; *jīvana*—life.

TRANSLATION

“Therefore the great sages sometimes killed old cows, and by chanting Vedic hymns they brought them back to life for perfection.

TEXT 162

jarad-gava hañā yuvā haya āra-vāra

tāte tāra vadha nahe, haya upakāra

SYNONYMS

jarad-gava—old, invalid cows; *hañā*—becoming; *yuvā*—young; *haya*—become; *āra-vāra*—again; *tāte*—in that action; *tāra*—his; *vadha*—killing; *nahe*—is not; *haya*—there is; *upakāra*—benefit.

TRANSLATION

“The killing and rejuvenation of such old and invalid cows was not truly killing but an act of great benefit.

TEXT 163

kali-kāle taiche śakti nāhika brāhmaṇe

ataeva go-vadha keha nā kare ekhane

SYNONYMS

kali-kāle—in the Age of Kali; *taiche*—such; *śakti*—power; *nāhika*—

there is none; *brāhmaṇe*—in the *brāhmaṇas*; *ataeva*—therefore; *go-vadha*—killing of cows; *keha*—anyone; *nā*—does not; *kare*—execute; *ekhane*—at the present.

TRANSLATION

“Formerly there were powerful *brāhmaṇas* who could make such experiments using Vedic hymns, but now, because of the Kali-yuga, *brāhmaṇas* are not so powerful. Therefore the killing of cows and bulls for rejuvenation is forbidden.

TEXT 164

aśvamedham gavālbham

sannyāsam pala-paitṛkam

devareṇa sutotpattim

kalau pañca vivarjayet

SYNONYMS

aśva-medham—a sacrifice offering a horse; *gava-ālbham*—a sacrifice of cows; *sannyāsam*—the renounced order of life; *pala-paitṛkam*—an offering of oblations of flesh to the forefathers; *devareṇa*—by a husband’s brother; *suta-utpattim*—begetting children; *kalau*—in the Age of Kali; *pañca*—five; *vivarjayet*—one must give up.

TRANSLATION

“In this Age of Kali, five acts are forbidden: the offering of a horse in sacrifice, the offering of a cow in sacrifice, the acceptance of the order of *sannyāsa*, the offering of oblations of flesh to the forefathers, and a man’s begetting children in his brother’s wife.’

PURPORT

This is a quotation from the *Brahma-vaivarta Purāṇa* (*Kṛṣṇa-janma-khaṇḍa* 185.180).

TEXT 165

tomarā jīyāite nāra, — — vadha-mātra sāra

naraka ha-ite tomāra nāhika nistāra

SYNONYMS

tomarā—you Muslims; *jīyāite*—bring to life; *nāra*—cannot; *vadha-mātra*—killing only; *sāra*—the essence; *naraka ha-ite*—from hell; *tomāra*—your; *nāhika*—there is not; *nistāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

“Since you Muslims cannot bring killed cows back to life, you are responsible for killing them. Therefore you are going to hell; there is no way for your deliverance.

TEXT 166

go-aṅge yata loma, tata sahasra vatsara

go-vadhī raurava-madhye pace nirantara

SYNONYMS

go-aṅge—on the body of the cow; *yata*—as many; *loma*—hairs; *tata*—so many; *sahasra*—a thousand; *vatsara*—years; *go-vadhī*—the killer of a cow; *raurava-madhye*—in a hellish condition of life; *pace*—decomposes; *nirantara*—always.

TRANSLATION

“Cow-killers are condemned to rot in hellish life for as many thousands of years as there are hairs on the body of the cow.

TEXT 167

tomā-sabāra śāstra-kartā—seha bhrānta haila

nā jāni’ śāstrera marma aiche ājñā dila

SYNONYMS

tomā-sabāra—of all of you; *śāstra-kartā*—compilers of scripture; *seha*—they also; *bhrānta*—mistaken; *haila*—became; *nā jāni’*—without knowing; *śāstrera marma*—the essence of scriptures; *aiche*—such; *ājñā*—order; *dila*—gave.

TRANSLATION

“There are many mistakes and illusions in your scriptures. Their compilers, not knowing the essence of knowledge, gave orders that were against reason and argument.”

TEXT 168

śuni’ stabdha haila kājī, nāhi sphure vāñī

vicāriyā kahe kājī parābhava māni’

SYNONYMS

śuni’—by hearing; *stabdha*—stunned; *haila*—became; *kājī*—the Kazi; *nāhi*—does not; *sphure*—utter; *vāñī*—words; *vicāriyā*—after due consideration; *kahe*—said; *kājī*—the Kazi; *parābhava*—defeat; *māni’*—

accepting.

TRANSLATION

After hearing these statements by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Kazi, his arguments stunned, could not put forward any more words. Thus, after due consideration, the Kazi accepted defeat and spoke as follows.

PURPORT

In our practical preaching work we meet many Christians who talk about statements of the Bible. When we question whether God is limited or unlimited, Christian priests say that God is unlimited. But when we question why the unlimited God should have only one son and not unlimited sons, they are unable to answer. Similarly, from a scientific point of view, the answers of the Old Testament, New Testament and Koran to many questions have changed. But a *śāstra* cannot change at a person's whim. All *śāstras* must be free from the four defects of human nature. The statements of *śāstras* must be correct for all time.

TEXT 169

tumi ye kahile, paṇḍita, sei satya haya

ādhunika āmāra śāstra, vicāra-saha naya

SYNONYMS

tumi—You; *ye*—whatever; *kahile*—have said; *paṇḍita*—O Nimāi Paṇḍita; *sei*—that; *satya*—truth; *haya*—is certainly; *ādhunika*—of modern days; *āmāra*—our; *śāstra*—scripture; *vicāra*—logic; *saha*—with; *naya*—they are not.

TRANSLATION

“My dear Nimāi Paṇḍita, what You have said is all true. Our scriptures have developed only recently, and they are certainly not logical and philosophical.

PURPORT

The *śāstras* of the *yavanas*, or meat-eaters, are not eternal scriptures. They have been fashioned recently, and sometimes they contradict one another. The scriptures of the *yavanas* are three: the Old Testament, the New Testament and the Koran. Their compilation has a history; they are not eternal like the Vedic knowledge. Therefore although they have their arguments and reasonings, they are not very sound and transcendental. As such, modern people advanced in science and philosophy deem these scriptures unacceptable.

Sometimes Christian priests come to us inquiring, “Why are our followers neglecting our scriptures and accepting yours?” But when we ask them, “Your Bible says, ‘Do not kill.’ Why then are you killing so many animals daily?” they cannot answer. Some of them imperfectly answer that the animals have no souls. But then we ask them, “How do you know that animals have no souls? Animals and children are of the same nature. Does this mean that the children of human society also have no souls?” According to the Vedic scriptures, within the body is the owner of the body, the soul. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* (2.13) it is said:

*dehino 'smin yathā dehe kaumāraṁ yauvanaṁ jarā
tathā dehāntara-prāptir dhīras tatra na muhyati*

“As the embodied soul continuously passes, in this body, from boyhood to youth to old age, the soul similarly passes into another body at death. The self-realized soul is not bewildered by such a change.”

Because the soul is within the body, the body changes through so many forms. There is a soul within the body of every living creature, whether animal, tree, bird or human being, and the soul is transmigrating from

one type of body to another. When the scriptures of the *yavanas*—namely the Old Testament, New Testament and Koran—cannot properly answer inquisitive followers, naturally those advanced in scientific knowledge and philosophy lose faith in such scriptures. The Kazi admitted this while talking with Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The Kazi was a very intelligent person. He had full knowledge of his position, as stated in the following verse.

TEXT 170

kalpita āmāra śāstra,——āmi saba jāni

jāti-anurodhe tabu sei śāstra māni

SYNONYMS

kalpita—imagined; *āmāra*—our; *śāstra*—scripture; *āmi*—I; *saba*—everything; *jāni*—know; *jāti*—by community; *anurodhe*—being obliged; *tabu*—still; *sei*—that; *śāstra*—scripture; *māni*—I accept.

TRANSLATION

“I know that our scriptures are full of imagination and mistaken ideas, yet because I am a Muslim I accept them for the sake of my community, despite their insufficient support.

TEXT 171

sahaje yavana-śāstre adṛḍha vicāra

hāsi’ tāhe mahāprabhu puchena āra-vāra

SYNONYMS

sahaje—naturally; *yavana-śāstre*—in the scriptures of the meat-eaters;

adṛḍha—unsound; *vicāra*—judgment; *hāsi'*—smiling; *tāhe*—from him; *mahāprabhu*—Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *puchena*—inquired; *āra-vāra*—again.

TRANSLATION

“The reasoning and arguments in the scriptures of the meat-eaters are not very sound,” the Kazi concluded. Upon hearing this statement, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu smiled and inquired from him as follows.

TEXT 172

āra eka praśna kari, śuna, tumi māmā

yathārtha kahibe, chale nā vañchibe āmā'

SYNONYMS

āra eka—one more; *praśna*—inquiry; *kari*—am putting; *śuna*—hear; *tumi*—you; *māmā*—maternal uncle; *yathā-ārtha*—as it is true; *kahibe*—you should speak; *chale*—by tricks; *nā vañchibe*—you should not cheat; *āmā'*—Me.

TRANSLATION

“My dear maternal uncle, I wish to ask you another question. Please tell Me the truth. Do not try to cheat Me with tricks.

TEXT 173

tomāra nagare haya sadā saṅkīrtana

vādyā-gīta-kolāhala, saṅgīta, nartana

SYNONYMS

tomāra nagare—in your city; *haya*—there is; *sadā*—always; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the holy name of the Lord; *vādyā*—musical sounds; *gīta*—song; *kolāhala*—tumultuous roaring; *saṅgīta*—singing; *nartana*—dancing.

TRANSLATION

“In your city there is always congregational chanting of the holy name. A tumultuous uproar of music, singing and dancing is always going on.

TEXT 174

tumi kājī— —hindu-dharma-virodhe adhikārī

ebe ye nā kara mānā bujhite nā pāri

SYNONYMS

tumi—you; *kājī*—the magistrate; *hindu-dharma*—the religious principles of the Hindus; *virodhe*—in opposing; *adhikārī*—have the right; *ebe*—now; *ye*—that; *nā kara mānā*—you do not forbid; *bujhite*—to understand; *nā pāri*—I am not able.

TRANSLATION

“As a Muslim magistrate, you have the right to oppose the performance of Hindu ceremonies, but now you do not forbid them. I cannot understand the reason why.”

TEXT 175

kājī bale— —sabhe tomāya bale ‘gaurahari’

sei nāme āmi tomāya sambodhana kari

SYNONYMS

kājī bale—the Kazi said; *sabhe*—all; *tomāya*—You; *bale*—address; *gaurahari*—by the name Gaurahari; *sei nāme*—by that name; *āmi*—I; *tomāya*—You; *sambodhana*—address; *kari*—do.

TRANSLATION

The Kazi said, “Everyone calls You Gaurahari. Please let me address You by that name.

TEXT 176

śuna, gaurahari, ei praśnera kāraṇa

nibhṛta hao yadi, tabe kari nivedana

SYNONYMS

śuna—kindly hear; *gaurahari*—O Gaurahari; *ei praśnera*—of this question; *kāraṇa*—reason; *nibhṛta*—solitary; *hao*—You become; *yadi*—if; *tabe*—then; *kari*—I shall make; *nivedana*—submission.

TRANSLATION

“Kindly listen, O Gaurahari! If You come to a private place, I shall then explain the reason.”

TEXT 177

prabhu bale, —e loka āmāra antaraṅga haya

spuṭa kari’ kaha tumi, nā kariha bhaya

SYNONYMS

prabhu bale—the Lord said; *e loka*—all these men; *āmāra*—My; *antaraṅga*—confidential associates; *haya*—are; *sphuṭa kari*’—making it clear; *kaha*—speak; *tumī*—you; *nā*—do not; *kariha bhaya*—be afraid.

TRANSLATION

The Lord replied, “All these men are My confidential associates. You may speak frankly. There is no reason to be afraid of them.”

TEXTS 178–179

kājī kahe, — — yabe āmi hindura ghare giyā

kīrtana kariluṁ mānā mṛdaṅga bhāṅgiyā

sei rātre eka simha mahā-bhayaṅkara

nara-deha, simha-mukha, garjaye vistara

SYNONYMS

kājī kahe—the Kazi replied; *yabe*—when; *āmi*—I; *hindura*—of a Hindu; *ghare*—in the house; *giyā*—going there; *kīrtana*—chanting of the holy name; *kariluṁ*—made; *mānā*—prohibition; *mṛdaṅga*—the drum; *bhāṅgiyā*—breaking; *sei rātre*—on that night; *eka*—one; *simha*—lion; *mahā-bhayaṅkara*—very fearful; *nara-deha*—having a body like a human being’s; *simha-mukha*—having a face like a lion’s; *garjaye*—was roaring; *vistara*—very loudly.

TRANSLATION

The Kazi said, “When I went to the Hindu’s house, broke the drum and forbade the performance of congregational chanting, in my dreams that very night I saw a greatly fearful lion, roaring very loudly, His body like a human being’s and His face like a lion’s.

TEXT 180

śayane āmāra upara lāpha diyā caḍi'

aṭṭa aṭṭa hāse, kare danta-kaḍamaḍi

SYNONYMS

śayane—in a sleeping condition; *āmāra*—me; *upara*—upon; *lāpha diyā*—jumping; *caḍi'*—mounting; *aṭṭa aṭṭa*—rough and hard; *hāse*—laughs; *kare*—does; *danta*—teeth; *kaḍamaḍi*—gnashing.

TRANSLATION

“While I was asleep, the lion jumped on my chest, laughing fiercely and gnashing His teeth.

TEXT 181

mora buke nakha diyā ghora-svare bale

phāḍimu tomāra buka mṛdaṅga badale

SYNONYMS

mora—my; *buke*—on the chest; *nakha*—nails; *diyā*—placing; *ghora*—roaring; *svare*—in a voice; *bale*—says; *phāḍimu*—I shall bifurcate; *tomāra*—your; *buka*—chest; *mṛdaṅga*—for the drum; *badale*—in exchange.

TRANSLATION

“Placing its nails on my chest, the lion said in a grave voice, ‘I shall immediately bifurcate your chest as you broke the mṛdaṅga drum!’

TEXT 182

mora kīrtana mānā karis, karimu tora kṣaya

āṅkhi mudi' kāṇpi āmi pāñā baḍa bhaya

SYNONYMS

mora—My; *kīrtana*—congregational chanting; *mānā karis*—you are forbidding; *karimu*—I shall do; *tora*—your; *kṣaya*—destruction; *āṅkhi*—eyes; *mudi'*—closing; *kāṇpi*—I was trembling; *āmi*—I; *pāñā*—getting; *baḍa*—very great; *bhaya*—fear.

TRANSLATION

“You have forbidden the performance of My congregational chanting. Therefore I must destroy you!’ Being very much afraid of Him, I closed my eyes and trembled.

TEXT 183

bhīta dekhi' simha bale ha-iyā sadaya

tore śikṣā dite kailu tora parājaya

SYNONYMS

bhīta dekhi'—seeing me so afraid; *simha*—the lion; *bale*—says; *ha-iyā*—becoming; *sa-daya*—merciful; *tore*—unto you; *śikṣā*—lesson; *dite*—to give; *kailu*—I have done; *tora*—your; *parājaya*—defeat.

TRANSLATION

“Seeing me so afraid, the lion said, ‘I have defeated you just to teach you a lesson, but I must be merciful to you.

TEXT 184

se dina bahuta nāhi kaili utpāta

teñi kṣamā kari' nā karinu prāṇāghāta

SYNONYMS

se dina—on that day; *bahuta*—very much; *nāhi*—not; *kaili*—you did; *utpāta*—disturbance; *teñi*—therefore; *kṣamā kari'*—forgiving; *nā karinu*—I did not execute; *prāṇa-āghāta*—the taking of your life.

TRANSLATION

“On that day you did not create a very great disturbance. Therefore I have excused you and not taken your life.

TEXT 185

aiche yadi punaḥ kara, tabe nā sahimu

savaṁśe tomāre mārī yavana nāśīmu

SYNONYMS

aiche—similarly; *yadi*—if; *punaḥ*—again; *kara*—you do; *tabe*—then; *nā sahimu*—I shall not tolerate; *sa-vaṁśe*—along with your family; *tomāre*—you; *mārī*—killing; *yavana*—the meat-eaters; *nāśīmu*—I shall vanquish.

TRANSLATION

“But if you perform such activities again, I shall not be tolerant. At that time I shall kill you, your entire family and all the meat-eaters.’

TEXT 186

eta kahi' simha gela, āmāra haila bhaya

ei dekha, nakha-cihna amora hṛdaya

SYNONYMS

eta—thus; *kahi'*—saying; *simha*—the lion; *gela*—returned; *āmāra*—my; *haila*—there was; *bhaya*—fear; *ei dekha*—just see this; *nakha-cihna*—the nail marks; *amora hṛdaya*—on my heart.

TRANSLATION

“After saying this, the lion left, but I was very much afraid of Him. Just see the marks of His nails on my heart!”

TEXT 187

eta bali' kājī nija-buka dekhāila

śuni' dekhi' sarva-loka āścarya mānila

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *kājī*—the Kazi; *nija-buka*—his chest; *dekhāila*—showed; *śuni'*—hearing; *dekhi'*—seeing; *sarva-loka*—everyone; *āścarya*—wonderful incident; *mānila*—accepted.

TRANSLATION

After this description, the Kazi showed his chest. Having heard him and seen the marks, all the people there accepted the wonderful incident.

TEXT 188

kājī kahe, — — ihā āmī kāre nā kahila

sei dina āmāra eka piyādā āila

SYNONYMS

kājī kahe—the Kazi said; *ihā*—this; *āmī*—I; *kāre*—to others; *nā kahila*—did not tell; *sei dina*—on that day; *āmāra*—my; *eka*—one; *piyādā*—orderly; *āila*—came to see me.

TRANSLATION

The Kazi continued, “I did not speak to anyone about this incident, but on that very day one of my orderlies came to see me.

TEXT 189

āsi’ kahe, — — geluñ muñi kīrtana niṣedhite

agni ulkā mora mukhe lāge ācambite

SYNONYMS

āsi’—coming to me; *kahe*—he said; *geluñ*—went; *muñi*—I; *kīrtana*—congregational chanting; *niṣedhite*—to stop; *agni ulkā*—flames of fire; *mora*—my; *mukhe*—in the face; *lāge*—come in contact; *ācambite*—all of a sudden.

TRANSLATION

“After coming to me, the orderly said, ‘When I went to stop the congregational chanting, suddenly flames struck my face.

TEXT 190

puḍila sakala dāḍi, mukhe haila vraṇa

yei peyādā yāya, tāra ei vivaraṇa

SYNONYMS

puḍila—burned; *sakala*—all; *dāḍi*—beard; *mukhe*—on the face; *haila*—there was; *vraṇa*—blisters; *yei*—any; *peyādā*—orderly; *yāya*—goes; *tāra*—his; *ei*—this; *vivaraṇa*—description.

TRANSLATION

“My beard was burned, and there were blisters on my cheeks.’ Every orderly who went gave the same description.

TEXT 191

tāhā dekhi’ rahinu muñi mahā-bhaya pāñā

kīrtana nā varjiha, ghare rahoñ ta’ vasiyā

SYNONYMS

tāhā dekhi’—seeing that; *rahinu*—remained; *muñi*—I; *mahā-bhaya*—great fear; *pāñā*—getting; *kīrtana*—the congregational chanting; *nā*—not; *varjiha*—stop; *ghare*—at home; *rahoñ*—remain; *ta’*—certainly; *vasiyā*—sitting.

TRANSLATION

“After seeing this, I was very much afraid. I asked them not to stop the congregational chanting but to go sit down at home.

TEXT 192

tabe ta' nagare ha-ibe svacchande kīrtana

śuni' saba mleccha āsi' kaila nivedana

SYNONYMS

tabe ta'—thereafter; *nagare*—in the city; *ha-ibe*—there would be; *svacchande*—without disturbance or anxiety; *kīrtana*—congregational chanting; *śuni'*—hearing this; *saba*—all; *mleccha*—meat-eaters; *āsi'*—coming; *kaila*—submitted; *nivedana*—petition.

TRANSLATION

“Then all the meat-eaters, hearing that there would be unrestricted congregational chanting in the city, came to submit a petition.

TEXT 193

nagare hindura dharma bādīla apāra

'hari' 'hari' dhvani ba-i nāhi śuni āra

SYNONYMS

nagare—in the city; *hindura*—of the Hindus; *dharma*—religion; *bādīla*—has increased; *apāra*—unlimitedly; *hari hari*—of the Lord's name, Hari, Hari; *dhvani*—the vibration; *ba-i*—except; *nāhi*—do not; *śuni*—we hear; *āra*—anything else.

TRANSLATION

“The religion of the Hindus has increased unlimitedly. There are always vibrations of “Hari! Hari!” We do not hear anything but this.’

TEXT 194

āra mleccha kahe, — — hindu ‘kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa’ bali’

hāse, kānde, nāce, gāya, gaḍi yāya dhūli

SYNONYMS

āra—another; *mleccha*—meat-eater; *kahe*—said; *hindu*—Hindus; *kṛṣṇa kṛṣṇa bali’*—saying “Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa”; *hāse*—laugh; *kānde*—cry; *nāce*—dance; *gāya*—chant; *gaḍi yāya dhūli*—roll in the dust.

TRANSLATION

“One meat-eater said, ‘The Hindus say, “Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa,” and they laugh, cry, dance, chant and fall on the ground, smearing their bodies with dirt.

TEXT 195

‘hari’ ‘hari’ kari’ hindu kare kolāhala

pātasāha śunile tomāra karibeka phala

SYNONYMS

hari hari kari’—saying “Hari, Hari”; *hindu*—the Hindus; *kare*—make; *kolāhala*—tumultuous sound; *pātasāha*—the king; *śunile*—if hearing; *tomāra*—your; *karibeka*—will do; *phala*—punishment.

TRANSLATION

“‘Vibrating “Hari, Hari,” the Hindus make a tumultuous sound. If the king [pātasāha] hears it, certainly he will punish you.’

PURPORT

Pātasāha refers to the king. Nawab Hussain Shah, whose full name was

Ālā Uddīn Saiyad Husen Sā, was at that time (A.D. 1498–1521) the independent King of Bengal. Formerly he was the servant of the cruel Nawab of the Hābsī dynasty named Mujahphara Khān, but somehow or other he assassinated his master and became the King. After gaining the throne of Bengal (technically called Masnada), he declared himself Saiyad Husen Ālā Uddīn Seriph Mukkā. There is a book called *Riyāja Us-salātina*, whose author, Golām Husen, says that Nawab Hussain Shah belonged to the family of Mukkā Seriph. To keep his family’s glory, he took the name Seriph Mukkā. Generally, however, he is known as Nawab Hussain Shah. After his death, his eldest son, Nasaratsā, became King of Bengal (A.D. 1521–1533). This King also was very cruel. He committed many atrocities against the Vaiṣṇavas. As a result of his sinful activities, one of his servants from the Khojā group killed him while he was praying in the mosque.

TEXT 196

tabe sei yavanere āmi ta’ puchila

hindu ‘hari’ bale, tāra svabhāva jānila

SYNONYMS

tabe—then; *sei*—that; *yavanere*—from the meat-eaters; *āmi*—I; *ta’*—certainly; *puchila*—inquired; *hindu*—the Hindu; *hari bale*—says Hari; *tara*—his; *svabhāva*—nature; *jānila*—I know.

TRANSLATION

“I then inquired from these yavanas, ‘I know that these Hindus by nature chant “Hari, Hari.”

TEXT 197

tumita yavana hañā kene anukṣaṇa

hindura devatāra nāma laha ki kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

tumita—but you; *yavana*—meat-eaters; *hañā*—being; *kene*—why; *anukṣaṇa*—always; *hindura*—of the Hindus; *devatāra*—of the God; *nāma*—the name; *lahe*—you take; *ki*—what; *kāraṇa*—the reason.

TRANSLATION

“The Hindus chant the name Hari because that is the name of their God. But you are Muslim meat-eaters. Why do you chant the name of the Hindus’ God?”

TEXT 198

mleccha kahe, — hindure āmi kari parihāsa

keha keha — kṛṣṇadāsa, keha — rāmadāsa

SYNONYMS

mleccha—the meat-eater; *kahe*—says; *hindure*—unto a Hindu; *āmi*—I; *kari*—do; *parihāsa*—joking; *keha keha*—some of them; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Kṛṣṇadāsa; *keha*—some of them; *rāmadāsa*—Rāmadāsa.

TRANSLATION

“The meat-eater replied, ‘Sometimes I joke with the Hindus. Some of them are called Kṛṣṇadāsa, and some are called Rāmadāsa.’

TEXT 199

keha — haridāsa, sadā bale ‘hari’ ‘hari’

jāni kāra ghare dhana karibeka curi

SYNONYMS

keha—some of them; *haridāsa*—Haridāsa; *sadā*—always; *bale*—says; *hari hari*—the name of the Lord, “Hari, Hari”; *jāni*—I understand; *kāra*—someone’s; *ghare*—at home; *dhana*—wealth; *karibeka*—will do; *curi*—theft.

TRANSLATION

“Some of them are called Haridāsa. They always chant “Hari, Hari,” and thus I thought they would steal the riches from someone’s house.

PURPORT

Another meaning of “Hari, Hari” is “I am stealing. I am stealing.”

TEXT 200

sei haite jihvā mora bale ‘hari’ ‘hari’

icchā nāhi, tabu bale,——ki upāya kari

SYNONYMS

sei haite—from that time; *jihvā*—tongue; *mora*—my; *bale*—says; *hari hari*—the vibration “Hari, Hari”; *icchā*—desire; *nāhi*—there is none; *tabu*—still; *bale*—says; *ki*—what; *upāya*—means; *kari*—I may do.

TRANSLATION

“Since that time, my tongue also always vibrates the sound “Hari, Hari.” I have no desire to say it, but still my tongue says it. I do not know what to do.’

PURPORT

Sometimes demoniac nonbelievers, not understanding the potency of the holy name, make fun of the Vaiṣṇavas when the Vaiṣṇavas chant the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*. This joking is also beneficial for such persons. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Sixth Canto, Second Chapter, verse 14, indicates that the chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mahā-mantra*, even in joking, in the course of ordinary discussion, in indicating something extraneous, or in negligence, is called *nāmābhāsa*, which is chanting that is almost on the transcendental stage. This *nāmābhāsa* stage is better than *nāmāparādhā*. *Nāmābhāsa* awakens the supreme remembrance of Lord Viṣṇu. When one remembers Lord Viṣṇu, he becomes free from material enjoyment. Thus he gradually comes forward toward the transcendental service of the Lord and becomes eligible to chant the holy name of the Lord in the transcendental position.

TEXTS 201–202

āra mleccha kahe, śuna—āmi ta' ei-mate

hinduke parihāsa kainu se dina ha-ite

jihvā kṛṣṇa-nāma kare, nā māne varjana

nā jāni, ki mantrauṣadhi jāne hindu-gaṇa

SYNONYMS

āra—another; *mleccha*—meat-eater; *kahe*—said; *śuna*—please hear; *āmi*—I; *ta'*—certainly; *ei-mate*—in this way; *hinduke*—to a Hindu; *parihāsa*—joking; *kainu*—did; *se*—that; *dina*—day; *ha-ite*—from; *jihvā*—the tongue; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kare*—chants; *nā*—does not; *māne*—accept; *varjana*—renunciation; *nā*—not; *jāni*—I know; *ki*—what; *mantra-uṣadhi*—hymns and herbs; *jāne*—know; *hindu-gaṇa*—the Hindus.

TRANSLATION

“Another meat-eater said, ‘Sir, please hear me. Since the day I joked with some Hindus in this way, my tongue chants the Hare Kṛṣṇa hymn and cannot give it up. I do not know what mystic hymns and herbal potions these Hindus know.’

TEXT 203

eta śuni’ tā’-sabhāre ghare pāṭhāila

hena-kāle pāṣaṇḍī hindu pāñca-sāta āila

SYNONYMS

eta śuni’—after hearing all this; *tā’-sabhāre*—all of them; *ghare*—back home; *pāṭhāila*—sent; *hena-kāle*—at that time; *pāṣaṇḍī*—nonbeliever; *hindu*—Hindus; *pāñca-sāta*—five or seven; *āila*—came.

TRANSLATION

“After hearing all this, I sent all the mlecchas back to their homes. Five or seven nonbelieving Hindus then approached me.

PURPORT

The word *pāṣaṇḍī* refers to nonbelievers engaged in fruitive activities and to idolatrous worshipers of many demigods. *Pāṣaṇḍīs* do not believe in one God, the Supreme Personality, Lord Viṣṇu; they think that all the demigods have the same potency as He. The definition of a *pāṣaṇḍī* is given in the *tantra-śāstra*:

*yas tu nārāyaṇaṁ devaṁ brahma-rudrādi-daivataiḥ
samatvenaiva vīkṣeta sa pāṣaṇḍī bhaved dhruvam*

“A *pāṣaṇḍī* is one who considers the great demigods such as Lord Brahmā and Lord Śiva equal to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Nārāyaṇa.”
(*Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, 1.17)

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is *asamaurdhva*; in other words, no one can be equal to or greater than Him. But *pāṣaṇḍīs* do not believe this. They worship any kind of demigod, thinking it all right to accept whomever they please as the Supreme Lord. The *pāṣaṇḍīs* were against the Hare Kṛṣṇa movement of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and now we see practically that they also do not like our humble attempts to spread Kṛṣṇa consciousness all over the world. On the contrary, these *pāṣaṇḍīs* say that we are spoiling the Hindu religion because people all over the world are accepting Lord Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead according to the version of *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is*. The *pāṣaṇḍīs* condemn this movement, and sometimes they accuse Vaiṣṇavas from foreign countries of being not bona fide. Even so-called Vaiṣṇavas—pseudo followers of the Vaiṣṇava cult—do not agree with our activities in making Vaiṣṇavas in the Western countries. Such *pāṣaṇḍīs* existed even during the time of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and they continue to exist. Despite all the activities of these *pāṣaṇḍīs*, however, the prediction of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu will triumph: *pr̥thivīte āche yata nagarāḍi grāma/ sarvatra pracāra haibe mora nāma*. “In every town and village, the chanting of My name will be heard.” No one can check the spread of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement because upon this movement is the benediction of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 204

āsi’ kahe,——hindura dharma bhāṅgila nimāi

ye kīrtana pravartāila, kabhu śuni nāi

SYNONYMS

āsi'—coming there; *kahe*—they said; *hindura*—of the Hindus; *dharma*—religious principles; *bhāṅgila*—has broken; *nimāi*—Nimāi Paṇḍita; *ye*—that; *kīrtana*—congregational chanting; *pravartāila*—has introduced; *kabhu*—at any time; *śuni*—we heard; *nāi*—never.

TRANSLATION

“Coming to me, the Hindus complained, ‘Nimāi Paṇḍita has broken the Hindu religious principles. He has introduced the saṅkīrtana system, which we never heard from any scripture.

TEXT 205

maṅgalacaṇḍī viṣahari kari' jāgaraṇa

tā'te vādya, nṛtya, gīta, — — yogya ācaraṇa

SYNONYMS

maṅgala-caṇḍī—of the religious performance for worship of Maṅgalacaṇḍī; *viṣahari*—of the religious performance for worship of Viṣahari; *kari'*—observing; *jāgaraṇa*—night vigil; *tā'te*—in that ceremony; *vādya*—musical performance; *nṛtya*—dancing; *gīta*—chanting; *yogya*—suitable; *ācaraṇa*—custom.

TRANSLATION

“When we keep a night-long vigil to observe religious performances for the worship of Maṅgalacaṇḍī and Viṣahari, playing on musical instruments, dancing and chanting are certainly fitting customs.

TEXT 206

pūrve bhāla chila ei nimāi paṇḍita

gayā haite āsiyā cālāya viparīta

SYNONYMS

pūrve—before this; *bhāla*—very good; *chila*—was; *ei*—this; *nimāi paṇḍita*—Nimāi Paṇḍita; *gayā*—Gayā (a place of pilgrimage); *haite*—from; *āsiyā*—coming; *cālāya*—conducts; *viparīta*—just the opposite.

TRANSLATION

“Nimāi Paṇḍita was previously a very good boy, but since He has returned from Gayā He conducts Himself differently.

TEXT 207

ucca kari’ gāya gīta, deya karatāli

mṛdaṅga-karatāla-śabde karṇe lāge tāli

SYNONYMS

ucca—loud; *kari’*—making; *gāya*—sings; *gīta*—songs; *deya*—practices; *karatāli*—clapping; *mṛdaṅga*—*mṛdaṅga* drum; *karatāla*—hand cymbals; *śabde*—by sounds; *karṇe*—in the ear; *lāge*—there is; *tāli*—blocking.

TRANSLATION

“Now He loudly sings all kinds of songs, claps, and plays drums and hand cymbals, making a tumultuous sound that deafens our ears.

TEXT 208

nā jāni,——ki khāñā matta hañā nāce, gāya

hāse, kānde, paḍe, uṭhe, gaḍāgaḍi yāya

SYNONYMS

nā jāni—we do not know; *ki*—what; *khāñā*—eating; *matta*—mad; *hañā*—becoming; *nāce*—He dances; *gāya*—chants; *hāse*—laughs; *kānde*—cries; *paḍe*—falls down; *uṭhe*—gets up; *gaḍāgaḍi yāya*—goes rolling on the ground.

TRANSLATION

“We do not know what He eats that makes Him become mad, dancing, singing, sometimes laughing, crying, falling down, jumping up and rolling on the ground.

TEXT 209

nagariyāke pāgala kaila sadā saṅkīrtana

rātre nidrā nāhi yāi, kari jāgaraṇa

SYNONYMS

nagariyāke—all the citizens; *pāgala*—mad; *kaila*—He has made; *sadā*—always; *saṅkīrtana*—congregational chanting; *rātre*—at night; *nidrā*—sleep; *nāhi yāi*—we do not get; *kari*—observe; *jāgaraṇa*—wakefulness.

TRANSLATION

“He has made all the people practically mad by always performing congregational chanting. At night we cannot get any sleep; we are always kept awake.

TEXT 210

‘nimāñi’ nāma chāḍi’ ebe bolāya ‘gaurahari’

hindura dharma naṣṭa kaila pāṣaṇḍa sañcāri'

SYNONYMS

nimāñi—Nimāi; *nāma*—the name; *chāḍi'*—giving up; *ebe*—now; *bolāya*—calls; *gaurahari*—Gaurahari; *hindura*—of the Hindus; *dharma*—the religious principles; *naṣṭa kaila*—spoiled; *pāṣaṇḍa*—irreligion; *sañcāri'*—introducing.

TRANSLATION

“Now He has given up His own name Nimāi and introduced Himself by the name Gaurahari. He has spoiled the Hindu religious principles and introduced the irreligion of nonbelievers.

TEXT 211

kṛṣṇera kīrtana kare nīca bāḍa bāḍa

ei pāpe navadvīpa ha-ibe ujāḍa

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇera—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kīrtana*—chanting; *kare*—does; *nīca*—lower class; *bāḍa bāḍa*—again and again; *ei pāpe*—by this sin; *navadvīpa*—the whole city of Navadvīpa; *ha-ibe*—will become; *ujāḍa*—deserted.

TRANSLATION

“Now the lower classes are chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa mahā-mantra again and again. For this sinful activity, the entire city of Navadvīpa will become deserted.

TEXT 212

hindu-śāstre 'īśvara' nāma—mahā-mantra jāni

sarva-loka śunile mantrera vīrya haya hāni

SYNONYMS

hindu-śāstre—in the scriptures of the Hindus; *īśvara*—God; *nāma*—the holy name; *mahā-mantra*—topmost hymn; *jāni*—we know; *sarva-loka*—everyone; *śunile*—if they hear; *mantrera*—of the *mantra*; *vīrya*—potency; *haya*—becomes; *hāni*—finished.

TRANSLATION

“According to Hindu scripture, God’s name is the most powerful hymn. If everyone hears the chanting of the name, the potency of the hymn will be lost.

PURPORT

In the list of offenses in the chanting of the holy name of the Lord, it is said, *dharma-vrata-tyāga-hutādi-sarva-śubha-kriyā-sāmyam api pramādaḥ*: to consider the chanting of the holy name of the Lord equal to the execution of some auspicious religious ceremony is an offense. According to the materialistic point of view, observing a religious ceremony invokes an auspicious atmosphere for the material benefit of the entire world. Materialists therefore manufacture religious principles to live comfortably and without disturbance in executing their material activities. Since they do not believe in the existence of God, they have manufactured the idea that God is impersonal and that to have some conception of God one may imagine any form. Thus they respect the many forms of the demigods as different representations or manifestations of the Lord. They are called *bahv-īśvara-vādīs*, or followers of thousands and thousands of gods. They consider the chanting of the names of the demigods an auspicious activity. Great so-called *svāmīs* have written books saying that one may chant any name—Durgā, Kālī, Śiva, Kṛṣṇa, Rāma, and so on—because any name is

all right for invoking an auspicious atmosphere in society. Thus they are called *pāṣaṇḍīs*—unbelievers or faithless demons.

Such *pāṣaṇḍīs* do not know the actual value of the chanting of the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Foolishly proud of their material birth as *brāhmaṇas* and their consequently higher position in the social order, they think of the other classes—namely the *kṣatriyas*, *vaiśyas* and *sūdras*—as lower classes. According to them, no one but the *brāhmaṇas* can chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa, for if others chanted the holy name, its potency would be reduced. They are unaware of the potency of Lord Kṛṣṇa’s name. The *Bṛhan-nāradya Purāṇa* recommends:

*harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam
kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva nāsty eva gatir anyathā*
[Adi 17.21]

“For spiritual progress in this Age of Kali, there is no alternative, no alternative, no alternative to the holy name, the holy name, the holy name of the Lord.” The *pāṣaṇḍīs* do not accept that the potency of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa is so great that one can be delivered simply by chanting the holy name, although this is confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (12.3.51): *kīrtanād eva kṛṣṇasya mukta-saṅgaḥ param vrajet*. Any man from any part of the world who practices chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa can be liberated and after death go back home, back to Godhead. The rascal *pāṣaṇḍīs* think that if anyone but a *brāhmaṇa* chants the holy name, the potency of the holy name is vanquished. According to their judgment, instead of delivering the fallen souls, the potency of the holy name is reduced. Believing in the existence of many gods and considering the chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa no better than other hymns, these *pāṣaṇḍīs* do not believe in the words of the *sāstra* (*harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam*). But Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu confirms in His *Śikṣāṣṭaka*, *kīrtanīyaḥ sadā hariḥ*: [Cc. adi 17.31] one must chant the holy name of the Lord always, twenty-four hours a day. The *pāṣaṇḍīs*, however, are so fallen and falsely proud of having taken birth in *brāhmaṇa* families that they think that instead of delivering all

the fallen souls, the holy name becomes impotent when constantly chanted by lower-class men.

Significant in verse 211 are the words *kṛṣṇera kīrtana kare nīca bāḍa bāḍa*, indicating that anyone can join in the *saṅkīrtana* movement. This is confirmed in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (2.4.18): *kirāta-hūṇāndhra-pulinda-pulkaśā ābhīra-śumbhā yavanāḥ khasādayaḥ*. This is a list of the names of *caṇḍālas*. The *pāṣaṇḍīs* say that when these lower-class men are allowed to chant, their influence is enhanced. They do not like the idea that others should also develop spiritual qualities, because this would curb their false pride in having taken birth in families of the elevated *brāhmaṇa* caste, with a monopoly on spiritual activities. But despite all protests from so-called Hindus and members of the *brāhmaṇa* caste, we are propagating the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement all over the world, according to the injunctions of the *śāstras* and the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Thus we are sure that we are delivering many fallen souls, making them bona fide candidates for going back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 213

grāmera ṭhākura tumi, saba tomāra jana

nimāi bolāiyā tāre karaha varjana

SYNONYMS

grāmera—of this town; *ṭhākura*—the ruler; *tumi*—you; *saba*—all; *tomāra*—your; *jana*—people; *nimāi*—Nimāi Paṇḍita; *bolāiyā*—calling; *tāre*—unto Him; *karaha*—do; *varjana*—the punishment of making Him leave the town.

TRANSLATION

“Sir, you are the ruler of this town. Whether Hindu or Muslim, everyone is under your protection. Therefore please call Nimāi Paṇḍita

and make Him leave the town.'

PURPORT

The word *ṭhākura* has two meanings. One meaning is “God” or “a godly person,” and another meaning is *kṣatriya*. Here the *pāṣaṇḍī brāhmaṇas* address the Kazi as *ṭhākura*, considering him the ruler of the town. There are different names by which to address the members of different castes. The *brāhmaṇas* are addressed as *mahārāja*, the *kṣatriyas* as *ṭhākura*, the *vaiśyas* as *śeṭha* or *mahājana*, and the *sūdras* as *caudhurī*. This etiquette is still followed in northern India, where the *kṣatriyas* are addressed as Ṭhākura Sāhab. The *pāṣaṇḍīs* went so far as to request the magistrate, or Kazi, to have Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu expelled from the town because of His introducing *hari-nāma-saṅkīrtana*. Fortunately our Hare Kṛṣṇa movement all over the world, especially in the civilized world of Europe and America, has become very popular. Generally no one complains against us to have us removed from a city. Although such an attempt was indeed made in Melbourne, Australia, the attempt failed. Thus we are now introducing this Hare Kṛṣṇa movement in great cities of the world like New York, London, Paris, Tokyo, Sydney, Melbourne and Auckland, and by the grace of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu everything is going on nicely. People are happy to accept the principle of chanting the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*, and the result is most satisfactory.

TEXT 214

tabe āmi prīti-vākya kahila sabāre

sabe ghare yāha, āmi niṣedhiba tāre

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *āmi*—I; *prīti-vākya*—sweet words; *kahila*—said; *sabāre*—unto all of them; *sabe*—all of you; *ghare*—back home; *yāha*—go; *āmi*—I; *niṣedhiba*—shall prohibit; *tāre*—Him (Nimāi Paṇḍita).

TRANSLATION

“After hearing their complaints, in sweet words I told them, ‘Please go back home. I shall certainly prohibit Nimāi Paṇḍita from continuing His Hare Kṛṣṇa movement.’

TEXT 215

hindura īśvara baḍa yei nārāyaṇa

sei tumi hao,——hena laya mora mana

SYNONYMS

hindura—of the Hindus; *īśvara*—God; *baḍa*—the topmost; *yei*—who; *nārāyaṇa*—Lord Nārāyaṇa; *sei*—He; *tumi*—You; *hao*—are; *hena*—such; *laya*—takes; *mora*—my; *mana*—mind.

TRANSLATION

“I know that Nārāyaṇa is the Supreme God of the Hindus, and I think that You are the same Nārāyaṇa. This I feel within my mind.”

TEXT 216

eta śuni’ mahāprabhu hāsiyā hāsiyā

kahite lāgilā kichu kājire chuñiyā

SYNONYMS

eta—this; *śuni’*—hearing; *mahāprabhu*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *hāsiyā hāsiyā*—smiling; *kahite*—to speak; *lāgilā*—began; *kichu*—something; *kājire*—unto the Kazi; *chuñiyā*—touching.

TRANSLATION

After hearing the Kazi speak so nicely, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu touched him and smilingly spoke as follows.

TEXT 217

tomāra mukhe kṛṣṇa-nāma,——e baḍa vicitra

pāpa-kṣaya gela, hailā parama pavitra

SYNONYMS

tomāra mukhe—in your mouth; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa; *e*—this; *baḍa*—very; *vicitra*—wonderful; *pāpa-kṣaya*—nullifying of sinful activities; *gela*—has become a fact; *hailā*—have become; *parama*—topmost; *pavitra*—purified.

TRANSLATION

“The chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa from your mouth has performed a wonder—it has nullified the reactions of all your sinful activities. Now you have become supremely pure.

PURPORT

Confirming the potency of the *saṅkīrtana* movement, these words from the very mouth of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu express how people can be purified simply by chanting the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The Kazi was a Muslim *mleccha*, or meat-eater, but because he several times uttered the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa, automatically the reactions of his sinful life were vanquished and he was fully purified of all material contamination. We do not know why the *pāṣaṇḍīs* of the present day protest that we are deteriorating the Hindu religion by spreading Kṛṣṇa consciousness all over the world and claiming all classes of men to the highest standard of

Vaiṣṇavism. But these rascals disagree with us so vehemently that some of them do not allow European and American Vaiṣṇavas to enter the temples of Viṣṇu. Thinking religion to be meant for material benefit, these so-called Hindus have actually become vicious by worshiping the numerous forms of the demigods. In the next verse Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu confirms the Kazi's purification.

TEXT 218

'hari' 'kṛṣṇa' 'nārāyaṇa' — — laile tina nāma

baḍa bhāgyavān tumi, baḍa puṇyavān

SYNONYMS

hari kṛṣṇa nārāyaṇa—the holy names of Lord Hari, Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Nārāyaṇa; *laile*—you have taken; *tina*—three; *nāma*—holy names; *baḍa*—very; *bhāgyavān*—fortunate; *tumi*—you are; *baḍa*—very; *puṇyavān*—pious.

TRANSLATION

“Because you have chanted three holy names of the Lord—Hari, Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa—you are undoubtedly the most fortunate and pious.”

PURPORT

Here the Supreme Lord, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, confirms that anyone who chants the holy names Hari, Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa without offense is certainly extremely fortunate, and whether Indian or non-Indian, Hindu or non-Hindu, he immediately comes to the level of the most pious personality. We therefore do not care about the statements of *pāṣaṇḍīs* who protest against our movement's making the members of other cities or countries into Vaiṣṇavas. We have to follow in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, executing our mission peacefully, or, if necessary,

kicking the heads of such protesters.

TEXT 219

eta śuni' kājīra dui cakṣe paḍe pāni

prabhura caraṇa chuṇi' bale priya-vāṇī

SYNONYMS

eta—this; *śuni'*—hearing; *kājīra*—of the Kazi; *dui*—two; *cakṣe*—in the eyes; *paḍe*—flow down; *pāni*—tears; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *caraṇa*—lotus feet; *chuṇi'*—touching; *bale*—says; *priya-vāṇī*—pleasing words.

TRANSLATION

After the Kazi heard this, tears flowed down from his eyes. He immediately touched the lotus feet of the Lord and spoke the following sweet words.

TEXT 220

tomāra prasāde mora ghucila kumati

ei kṛpā kara, —yena tomāte rahu bhakti

SYNONYMS

tomāra prasāde—by Your mercy; *mora*—my; *ghucila*—have gone away; *kumati*—bad intentions; *ei*—this; *kṛpā*—mercy; *kara*—please do unto me; *yena*—so that; *tomāte*—in You; *rahu*—may stay; *bhakti*—devotion.

TRANSLATION

“Only by Your mercy have my bad intentions vanished. Kindly favor me

so that my devotion may always be fixed upon You.”

TEXT 221

prabhu kahe, — — eka dāna māgiye tomāya

saṅkīrtana vāda yaiche nahe nadīyāya

SYNONYMS

prabhu kahe—the Lord said; *eka*—one; *dāna*—charity; *māgiye*—I beg; *tomāya*—from you; *saṅkīrtana*—chanting of the Hare Kṛṣṇa *mantra*; *vāda*—opposition; *yaiche*—as it may be; *nahe*—not be; *nadīyāya*—in the district of Nadia.

TRANSLATION

The Lord said, “I wish to beg you for one favor in charity. You must pledge that this saṅkīrtana movement will not be checked, at least in the district of Nadia.”

TEXT 222

kājī kahe, — — mora vaṁśe yata upajibe

tāhāke ‘tālāka’ diba, — — kīrtana nā bādhibe

SYNONYMS

kājī kahe—the Kazi said; *mora*—my; *vaṁśe*—in the dynasty; *yata*—all (descendants); *upajibe*—who will take birth; *tāhāke*—unto them; *tālāka*—grave admonition; *diba*—I shall give; *kīrtana*—the *saṅkīrtana* movement; *nā*—never; *bādhibe*—they will oppose.

TRANSLATION

The Kazi said, “To as many descendants as take birth in my dynasty in the future, I give this grave admonition: No one should check the *saṅkīrtana* movement.”

PURPORT

As a result of this grave injunction by the Kazi, even at present the descendants of the Kazi’s family do not oppose the *saṅkīrtana* movement under any circumstances. Even during the great Hindu-Muslim riots in neighboring places, the descendants of the Kazi honestly preserved the assurance given by their forefather.

TEXT 223

śuni’ prabhu ‘hari’ bali’ uṭhilā āpani

uṭhila vaiṣṇava saba kari’ hari-dhvani

SYNONYMS

śuni’—hearing; *prabhu*—the Lord; *hari*—the holy name of the Lord; *bali’*—chanting; *uṭhilā*—got up; *āpani*—personally; *uṭhila*—got up; *vaiṣṇava*—other devotees; *saba*—all; *kari’*—making; *hari-dhvani*—vibration of the holy name, “Hari Hari.”

TRANSLATION

Hearing this, the Lord got up, chanting “Hari! Hari!” Following Him, all the other Vaiṣṇavas also got up, chanting the vibration of the holy name.

TEXT 224

kīrtana karite prabhu karilā gamana

saṅge calī’ āise kājī ullasita mana

SYNONYMS

kīrtana—chanting; *karite*—to perform; *prabhu*—the Lord; *karilā*—made; *gamana*—departure; *saṅge*—accompanying Him; *cali'*—walking; *āise*—comes; *kājī*—the Kazi; *ullasita*—jubilant; *mana*—mind.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu went back to perform kīrtana, and the Kazi, his mind jubilant, went with Him.

TEXT 225

kājīre vidāya dila śacīra nandana

nācite nācite āilā āpana bhavana

SYNONYMS

kājīre—unto the Kazi; *vidāya*—farewell; *dila*—gave; *śacīra*—of mother Śacī; *nandana*—the son; *nācite nācite*—dancing and dancing; *āilā*—came back; *āpana*—own; *bhavana*—house.

TRANSLATION

The Lord asked the Kazi to go back home. Then the son of mother Śacī came back to His own home, dancing and dancing.

TEXT 226

ei mate kājīre prabhu karilā prasāda

ihā yei śune tāra khaṇḍe aparādha

SYNONYMS

ei mate—in this way; *kājīre*—unto the Kazi; *prabhu*—the Lord; *karilā*—did; *prasāda*—mercy; *ihā*—this; *yei*—anyone who; *śune*—hears; *tāra*—his; *khaṇḍe*—vanquishes; *aparādha*—offenses.

TRANSLATION

This is the incident concerning the Kazi and the Lord's mercy upon him. Anyone who hears this is also freed from all offenses.

TEXT 227

eka dina śrīvāsera mandire gosāñi

nityānanda-saṅge nṛtya kare dui bhāi

SYNONYMS

eka dina—one day; *śrīvāsera*—of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *mandire*—in the house; *gosāñi*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *saṅge*—accompanied by; *nṛtya*—dancing; *kare*—performed; *dui*—two; *bhāi*—brothers.

TRANSLATION

One day the two brothers Lord Nityānanda Prabhu and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu were dancing in the holy house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura.

TEXT 228

śrīvāsa-putrera tāhān haila paraloka

tabu śrīvāsera citte nā janmila śoka

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsa—of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *putrera*—of the son; *tāhāñ*—there; *haila*—took place; *paraloka*—death; *tabu*—still; *śrīvāsera*—of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *citte*—in the mind; *nā*—not; *janmila*—there was; *śoka*—lamentation.

TRANSLATION

At that time a calamity took place—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura's son died. Yet Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura was not at all sorry.

TEXT 229

mṛta-putra-mukhe kaila jñānera kathana

āpane dui bhāi hailā śrīvāsa-nandana

SYNONYMS

mṛta-putra—of the dead son; *mukhe*—in the mouth; *kaila*—did; *jñānera*—of knowledge; *kathana*—conversation; *āpane*—personally; *dui*—the two; *bhāi*—brothers; *hailā*—became; *śrīvāsa-nandana*—sons of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu caused the dead son to speak about knowledge, and then the two brothers personally became the sons of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura.

PURPORT

This incident is described as follows by Śrīla Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura in his *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. One night while Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was dancing with His devotees at the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, one of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura's sons, who was suffering from some disease, died. Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura was so patient, however, that he did not allow anyone to express sorrow by crying, for he did not want the *kīrtana* going on at his

house to be disturbed. Thus *kīrtana* continued without a sound of lamentation. But when the *kīrtana* was over, Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who could understand the incident, declared, “There must have been some calamity in this house.” When He was then informed about the death of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura’s son, He expressed His regret, saying, “Why was this news not given to Me before?” He went to the place where the son was lying dead and asked him, “My dear boy, why are you leaving the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura?” The dead son immediately replied, “I was living in this house as long as I was destined to live here. Now that the time is over, I am going elsewhere, according to Your direction. I am Your eternal servant, a dependent living being. I must act only according to Your desire. Beyond Your desire, I cannot do anything. I have no such power.” Hearing these words of the dead son, all the members of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura’s family received transcendental knowledge. Thus there was no cause for lamentation. This transcendental knowledge is described in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (2.13): *tathā dehāntara-prāptir dhīras tatra na muhyati*. When someone dies, he accepts another body; therefore sober persons do not lament. After the discourse between the dead boy and Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, funeral ceremonies were performed, and Lord Caitanya assured Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, “You have lost one son, but Nityānanda Prabhu and I are your eternal sons. We shall never be able to give up your company.” This is an instance of a transcendental relationship with Kṛṣṇa. We have eternal transcendental relationships with Kṛṣṇa as His servants, friends, fathers, sons or conjugal lovers. When the same relationships are pervertedly reflected in this material world, we have relationships as the sons, fathers, friends, lovers, masters or servants of others, but all these relationships are subject to termination within a definite period. If we revive our relationship with Kṛṣṇa, however, by the grace of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu our eternal relationship will never break to cause our lamentation.

TEXT 230

tabe ta’ karilā saba bhakte vara dāna

ucchiṣṭa diyā nārāyaṇīra karila sammāna

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *ta'*—certainly; *karilā*—did; *saba bhakte*—unto all devotees; *vara*—benediction; *dāna*—charity; *ucchiṣṭa*—food remnants; *diyā*—giving; *nārāyaṇīra*—of Nārāyaṇī; *karila*—did; *sammāna*—respect.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter the Lord charitably bestowed His benediction upon all His devotees. He gave the remnants of His food to Nārāyaṇī, showing her special respect.

PURPORT

Nārāyaṇī was a niece of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, and later she became the mother of Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura. In this connection the *sahajiyās* cite a malicious story that after eating the remnants of Lord Caitanya's food Nārāyaṇī became pregnant and gave birth to Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura. The rascal *sahajiyās* may manufacture such false statements, but no one should believe them because they are motivated by enmity against the Vaiṣṇavas.

TEXT 231

śrīvāsera vastra sinye darajī yavana

prabhu tāre nija-rūpa karāila darśana

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsera—of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *vastra*—cloth; *sinye*—sewing; *darajī*—tailor; *yavana*—meat-eater; *prabhu*—the Lord; *tāre*—unto him; *nija-rūpa*—His own form; *karāila*—caused; *darśana*—vision.

TRANSLATION

There was a tailor who was a meat-eater but was sewing garments for Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura. The Lord, being merciful to him, showed him His own form.

TEXT 232

‘dekhinu’ ‘dekhinu’ bali’ ha-ila pāgala

preme nṛtya kare, haila vaiṣṇava āgala

SYNONYMS

dekhinu—I have seen; *dekhinu*—I have seen; *bali’*—saying; *ha-ila*—became; *pāgala*—mad; *preme*—in the ecstasy of love; *nṛtya*—dancing; *kare*—does; *haila*—became; *vaiṣṇava*—devotee; *āgala*—first class.

TRANSLATION

Saying “I have seen! I have seen!” and dancing in ecstatic love as though mad, he became a first-class Vaiṣṇava.

PURPORT

There was a Muslim tailor near the house of Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura who used to sew the garments of the family. One day he was very pleased with the dancing of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; indeed, he was enchanted. The Lord, understanding his attitude, showed him His original form as Kṛṣṇa. The tailor then began to dance, saying, “I have seen! I have seen!” He became absorbed in ecstatic love and began to dance with Lord Caitanya. Thus he became one of the foremost Vaiṣṇava adherents of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 233

āveśete śrīvāse prabhu vaṁśī ta' māgila

śrīvāsa kahe, — — vaṁśī tomāra gopī hari' nila

SYNONYMS

āveśete—in ecstasy; *śrīvāse*—unto Śrīvāsa; *prabhu*—the Lord; *vaṁśī*—a flute; *ta'*—certainly; *māgila*—asked; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *kahe*—replied; *vaṁśī*—flute; *tomāra*—Your; *gopī*—the *gopīs*; *hari*—stealing; *nila*—took away.

TRANSLATION

In ecstasy the Lord asked Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura to deliver His flute, but Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura replied, “Your flute has been stolen away by the *gopīs*.”

TEXT 234

śuni' prabhu 'bala' 'bala' balena āveśe

śrīvāsa varṇena vṛndāvana-līlā-rase

SYNONYMS

śuni'—hearing; *prabhu*—the Lord; *bala bala*—go on speaking, go on speaking; *balena*—He says; *āveśe*—in ecstasy; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *varṇena*—describes; *vṛndāvana*—of Vṛndāvana; *līlā-rase*—the transcendental mellows of the pastimes.

TRANSLATION

Hearing this reply, the Lord said in ecstasy, “Go on talking! Go on talking!” Thus Śrīvāsa described the transcendental mellows of the pastimes of Śrī Vṛndāvana.

TEXT 235

prathamete vṛndāvana-mādhurya varṇila

śuniyā prabhura citte ānanda bāḍila

SYNONYMS

prathamete—in the beginning; *vṛndāvana-mādhurya*—sweet pastimes of Vṛndāvana; *varṇila*—described; *śuniyā*—hearing; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *citte*—in the heart; *ānanda*—jubilation; *bāḍila*—increased.

TRANSLATION

In the beginning Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura described the transcendental sweetness of Vṛndāvana’s pastimes. Hearing this, the Lord felt great and increasing jubilation in His heart.

TEXT 236

tabe ‘bala’ ‘bala’ prabhu bale vāra-vāra

punaḥ punaḥ kahe śrīvāsa kariyā vistāra

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *bala bala*—go on speaking, go on speaking; *prabhu*—the Lord; *bale*—says; *vāra-vāra*—again, again; *punaḥ punaḥ*—again, again; *kahe*—speaks; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *kariyā*—making; *vistāra*—expansion.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter the Lord again and again asked him, “Speak on! Speak on!” Thus Śrīvāsa again and again described the pastimes of Vṛndāvana,

vividly expanding them.

TEXT 237

vaṁśī-vādye gopī-gaṇera vane ākarṣaṇa

tāñ-sabāra saṅge yaiche vana-viharaṇa

SYNONYMS

vaṁśī-vādye—on hearing the sound of the flute; *gopī-gaṇera*—of all the gopīs; *vane*—in the forest; *ākarṣaṇa*—the attraction; *tāñ-sabāra*—of all of them; *saṅge*—in the company; *yaiche*—in what way; *vana*—in the forest; *viharaṇa*—wandering.

TRANSLATION

Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura extensively explained how the gopīs were attracted to the forests of Vṛndāvana by the vibration of Kṛṣṇa's flute and how they wandered together in the forest.

TEXT 238

tāhi madhye chaya-ṛtu līlāra varṇana

madhu-pāna, rāsotsava, jala-keli kathana

SYNONYMS

tāhi madhye—during that; *chaya-ṛtu*—the six seasons; *līlāra*—of the pastimes; *varṇana*—description; *madhu-pāna*—drinking of the honey; *rāsa-utsava*—dancing the *rāsa-līlā*; *jala-keli*—swimming in the Yamunā; *kathana*—narrations.

TRANSLATION

Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita narrated all the pastimes enacted during the six changing seasons. He described the drinking of honey, the celebration of the rāsa dance, the swimming in the Yamunā and other such incidents.

TEXT 239

‘bala’ ‘bala’ bale prabhu śunite ullāsa

śrīvāsa kahena tabe rāsa rasera vilāsa

SYNONYMS

bala bala—go on speaking, go on speaking; *bale*—says; *prabhu*—the Lord; *śunite*—hearing; *ullāsa*—very jubilantly; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *kahena*—says; *tabe*—then; *rāsa*—*rāsa* dance; *rasera*—filled with transcendental humors; *vilāsa*—pastimes.

TRANSLATION

When the Lord, hearing with great pleasure, said, “Go on speaking! Go on speaking!” Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura described the rāsa-līlā dance, which is filled with transcendental mellows.

TEXT 240

kahite, śunite aiche prātaḥ-kāla haila

prabhu śrīvāsere toṣi’ ālīngana kaila

SYNONYMS

kahite—speaking; *śunite*—hearing; *aiche*—in that way; *prātaḥ-kāla*—morning; *haila*—appeared; *prabhu*—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *śrīvāsere*—unto Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *toṣi’*—satisfying; *ālīngana*—embracing; *kaila*—did.

TRANSLATION

As the Lord thus requested and Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura spoke, the morning appeared, and the Lord embraced Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura and satisfied him.

TEXT 241

tabe ācāryera ghare kaila kṛṣṇa-līlā

rukmiṇī-svarūpa prabhu āpane ha-ilā

SYNONYMS

tabe—thereafter; *ācāryera*—of Śrī Candrasēkhara Ācārya; *ghare*—in the house; *kaila*—performed; *kṛṣṇa-līlā*—pastimes of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *rukmiṇī*—of Rukmiṇī; *svarūpa*—form; *prabhu*—the Lord; *āpane*—personally; *ha-ilā*—became.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter a dramatization of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes was performed in the house of Śrī Candrasēkhara Ācārya. The Lord personally took the part of Rukmiṇī, the foremost of Kṛṣṇa's queens.

TEXT 242

kabhu durgā, lakṣmī haya, kabhu vā cic-chakti

khāṭe vasi' bhakta-gaṇe dilā prema-bhakti

SYNONYMS

kabhu—sometimes; *durgā*—the part of Goddess Durgā; *lakṣmī*—the goddess of fortune; *haya*—is; *kabhu*—sometimes; *vā*—or; *cit-śakti*—the spiritual potency; *khāṭe*—on a cot; *vasi'*—sitting; *bhakta-gaṇe*—unto the

devotees; *dilā*—gave; *prema-bhakti*—love of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

The Lord sometimes took the part of Goddess Durgā, Lakṣmī [the goddess of fortune] or the chief potency, Yogamāyā. Sitting on a cot, He delivered love of Godhead to all the devotees present.

TEXT 243

eka-dina mahāprabhura nṛtya-avasāne

eka brāhmaṇī āsi' dharila caraṇe

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *mahāprabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *nṛtya-avasāne*—at the end of the dancing; *eka*—one; *brāhmaṇī*—wife of a *brāhmaṇa*; *āsi'*—coming; *dharila*—caught hold; *caraṇe*—of His lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

One day when Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu had finished His dancing, a woman, the wife of a brāhmaṇa, came there and caught hold of His lotus feet.

TEXT 244

caraṇera dhūli sei laya vāra vāra

dekhiyā prabhura duḥkha ha-ila apāra

SYNONYMS

caraṇera—of His lotus feet; *dhūli*—the dust; *sei*—that woman; *laya*—takes; *vāra vāra*—again and again; *dekhiyā*—seeing this; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *duḥkha*—unhappiness; *ha-ila*—there was; *apāra*—unlimited.

TRANSLATION

As she took the dust of His lotus feet again and again, the Lord became unlimitedly unhappy.

PURPORT

This holding of a great personality's lotus feet is certainly very good for the person who takes the dust, but this example of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu's unhappiness indicates that a Vaiṣṇava should not allow anyone to take dust from his feet.

One who takes the dust of a great personality's lotus feet transfers his sinful activities to that great personality. Unless the person whose dust is taken is very strong, he must suffer the sinful activities of the person who takes the dust. Therefore ordinarily it should not be allowed. Sometimes in big meetings people come to take the same advantage by touching our feet. On account of this, sometimes we have to suffer from some disease. As far as possible, no outsider should be allowed to touch one's feet to take dust from them. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu personally showed this by His example, as explained in the next verse.

TEXT 245

sei-kṣaṇe dhāñā prabhu gaṅgāte paḍila

nityānanda-haridāsa dhari' uṭhāila

SYNONYMS

sei-kṣaṇe—immediately; *dhāñā*—running; *prabhu*—the Lord; *gaṅgāte*—

in the water of the Ganges; *paḍila*—plunged; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda; *haridāsa*—Haridāsa Ṭhākura; *dhari'*—catching Him; *uṭhāila*—raised Him.

TRANSLATION

Immediately He ran to the river Ganges and jumped in to counteract the sinful activities of that woman. Lord Nityānanda and Haridāsa Ṭhākura caught Him and raised Him from the river.

PURPORT

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu is God Himself, but He was playing the part of a preacher. Every preacher should know that being allowed to touch a Vaiṣṇava's feet and take dust may be good for the person who takes it, but it is not good for the person who allows it to be taken. As far as possible, this practice should ordinarily be avoided. Only initiated disciples should be allowed to take this advantage, not others. Those who are full of sinful activities should generally be avoided.

TEXT 246

vijaya ācāryera ghare se rātre rahilā

prātaḥ-kāle bhakta sabe ghare lañā gelā

SYNONYMS

vijaya—named Vijaya; *ācāryera*—of the teacher; *ghare*—at the home; *se*—that; *rātre*—on the night; *rahilā*—remained; *prātaḥ-kāle*—in the morning; *bhakta*—the devotees; *sabe*—all; *ghare*—home; *lañā*—taking them; *gelā*—went.

TRANSLATION

That night the Lord stayed at the house of Vijaya Ācārya. In the morning the Lord took all His devotees and returned home.

TEXT 247

eka-dina gopī-bhāve grhete vasiyā

‘gopī’ ‘gopī’ nāma laya viṣaṇṇa hañā

SYNONYMS

eka-dina—one day; *gopī-bhāve*—in the ecstasy of the *gopīs*; *grhete*—at home; *vasiyā*—sitting; *gopī gopī*—*gopī gopī*; *nāma*—the name; *laya*—chants; *viṣaṇṇa*—morose; *hañā*—becoming.

TRANSLATION

One day the Lord, in the ecstasy of the *gopīs*, was sitting in His house. Very morose in separation, He was calling, “Gopī! Gopī!”

TEXT 248

eka paḍuyā āila prabhuke dekhite

‘gopī’ ‘gopī’ nāma śuni’ lāgila balite

SYNONYMS

eka paḍuyā—one student; *āila*—came there; *prabhuke*—the Lord; *dekhite*—to see; *gopī gopī*—*gopī gopī*; *nāma*—the name; *śuni’*—hearing; *lāgila*—began; *balite*—to say.

TRANSLATION

A student who came to see the Lord was astonished that the Lord was

chanting “Gopī! Gopī!” Thus he spoke as follows.

TEXT 249

kṛṣṇa-nāma nā lao kene, kṛṣṇa-nāma—dhanya

‘gopī’ ‘gopī’ balile vā kibā haya puṇya

SYNONYMS

kṛṣṇa-nāma—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nā*—not; *lao*—You take; *kene*—why; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dhanya*—glorious; *gopī gopī*—the names *gopī gopī*; *balile*—on saying; *vā*—or; *kibā*—what; *haya*—there is; *puṇya*—piety.

TRANSLATION

“Why are You chanting the names ‘gopī gopī’ instead of the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa, which is so glorious? What pious result will You achieve by such chanting?”

PURPORT

It is said, *vaiṣṇavera kṛiyā-mudrā vijñeha nā bujhaya*: no one can understand the activities of a pure devotee. A student or neophyte devotee could not possibly understand why Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was chanting the name of the *gopīs*, nor should the student have asked the Lord about the potency of chanting *gopī gopī*. The neophyte student was certainly convinced of the piety in the chanting of Kṛṣṇa’s holy name, but this sort of attitude is also offensive. *Dharma-vrata-tyāga-hutādi-sarva-śubha-kṛiyā-sāmyam apī pramādaḥ*: to chant the holy name of Kṛṣṇa in exchange for the achievement of piety is an offense. This, of course, was unknown to the student. Thus he innocently asked, “What piety is there in the chanting of the name *gopī*?” He did not know that there is no question of piety or impiety. The chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa or

the holy name *gopī* is on the transcendental platform of loving affairs. Since he was not expert in understanding such transcendental activities, his question was merely impudent. Thus Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, apparently greatly angry at him, reacted as follows.

TEXT 250

śuni' prabhu krodhe kaila kṛṣṇe doṣodgāra

theṅgā lañā uṭhilā prabhu paḍuyā māribāra

SYNONYMS

śuni'—hearing; *prabhu*—the Lord; *krodhe*—in anger; *kaila*—did; *kṛṣṇe*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *doṣa-udgāra*—many accusations; *theṅgā*—stick; *lañā*—taking; *uṭhilā*—got up; *prabhu*—the Lord; *paḍuyā*—the student; *māribāra*—to strike.

TRANSLATION

Hearing the foolish student, the Lord became greatly angry and rebuked Lord Kṛṣṇa in various ways. Taking up a stick, He rose to strike the student.

PURPORT

It is mentioned in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* that when Uddhava came from Lord Kṛṣṇa with a message for the *gopīs*, all the *gopīs*, especially Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, denounced Kṛṣṇa in various ways. Such denunciations, however, reflect an exuberant loving attitude that an ordinary man cannot understand. When the foolish student questioned Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Lord Caitanya similarly rebuked Lord Kṛṣṇa in loving exuberance. When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu was in the mood of the *gopīs* and the student advocated the cause of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Lord Caitanya was greatly angry. Seeing His anger, the foolish student, who

was an ordinary atheistic *smārta-brāhmaṇa*, foolishly misjudged Him. Thus he and a party of students were ready to strike the Lord in retaliation. After this incident, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu decided to take *sannyāsa* so that people would not commit offenses against Him, considering Him an ordinary householder, for in India even now a *sannyāsī* is naturally offered respect.

TEXT 251

bhaye palāya paḍuyā, prabhu pāche pāche dhāya

āste vyaste bhakta-gaṇa prabhure rahāya

SYNONYMS

bhaye—out of fear; *palāya*—runs away; *paḍuyā*—the student; *prabhu*—the Lord; *pāche pāche*—after him; *dhāya*—runs; *āste vyaste*—somehow or other; *bhakta-gaṇa*—all the devotees; *prabhure*—the Lord; *rahāya*—checked.

TRANSLATION

The student ran away in fear, and the Lord followed him. But somehow or other the devotees checked the Lord.

TEXT 252

prabhure śānta kari' ānila nija ghare

paḍuyā palāyā gela paḍuyā-sabhāre

SYNONYMS

prabhure—the Lord; *śānta kari'*—pacifying; *ānila*—brought; *nija*—His own; *ghare*—to the house; *paḍuyā*—the student; *palāyā*—running away;

gela—went; *paḍuyā*—of students; *sabhāre*—to the assembly.

TRANSLATION

The devotees pacified the Lord and brought Him home, and the student ran away to an assembly of other students.

TEXT 253

paḍuyā sahasra yāhān paḍe eka-ṭhāñi

prabhura vṛttānta dvija kahe tāhān yāi

SYNONYMS

paḍuyā—students; *sahasra*—a thousand; *yāhān*—where; *paḍe*—they study; *eka-ṭhāñi*—in one place; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *vṛttānta*—incident; *dvija*—the *brāhmaṇa*; *kahe*—says; *tāhān*—there; *yāi*—he goes.

TRANSLATION

The *brāhmaṇa* student ran to a place where a thousand students were studying together. There he described the incident to them.

PURPORT

In this verse we find the word *dvija*, indicating that the student was a *brāhmaṇa*. Actually, in those days, only members of the *brāhmaṇa* class became students of Vedic literature. Schooling is meant especially for *brāhmaṇas*; previously there was no question of schooling for *kṣatriyas*, *vaiśyas* or *sūdras*. *Kṣatriyas* used to learn the technology of warfare, and *vaiśyas* learned business from their fathers or other businessmen; they were not meant to study the *Vedas*. At present, however, everyone goes to school, and everyone is given the same type of education, although no one knows what the result will be. The result, however, is most

unsatisfactory, as we have seen in the Western countries especially. The United States has vast educational institutions where everyone is allowed to receive an education, but the result is that most students become like hippies.

Higher education is not meant for everyone. Only selected individuals trained in brahminical culture should be allowed to pursue a higher education. Educational institutions should not aim to teach technology, for a technologist cannot properly be called educated. A technologist is a *śūdra*; only one who studies the *Vedas* may properly be called a learned man (*paṇḍita*). The duty of a *brāhmaṇa* is to become learned in the Vedic literature and teach the Vedic knowledge to other *brāhmaṇas*. In our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement we are simply teaching our students to become fit *brāhmaṇas* and Vaiṣṇavas. In our school at Dallas, the students are learning English and Sanskrit, and through these two languages they are studying all our books, such as *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, *Bhagavad-gītā As It Is* and *The Nectar of Devotion*. It is a mistake to educate every student as a technologist. There must be a group of students who become *brāhmaṇas*. Without *brāhmaṇas* who study the Vedic literature, human society will be entirely chaotic.

TEXT 254

śuni' krodha kaila saba paḍuyāra gaṇa

sabe meli' kare tabe prabhura nindana

SYNONYMS

śuni'—hearing; *krodha*—angry; *kaila*—became; *saba*—all; *paḍuyāra*—of students; *gaṇa*—the groups; *sabe*—all; *meli'*—joining together; *kare*—do; *tabe*—then; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *nindana*—accusation.

TRANSLATION

Hearing of the incident, all the students became greatly angry and joined together in criticizing the Lord.

TEXT 255

saba deśa bhraṣṭa kaila ekalā nimāñi

brāhmaṇa mārīte cāhe, dharma-bhaya nāi

SYNONYMS

saba—all; *deśa*—countries; *bhraṣṭa*—spoiled; *kaila*—has; *ekalā*—alone; *nimāñi*—Nimāi Paṇḍita; *brāhmaṇa*—a caste *brāhmaṇa*; *mārīte*—to strike; *cāhe*—He wants; *dharma*—of religious principles; *bhaya*—fear; *nāi*—there is not.

TRANSLATION

“Nimāi Paṇḍita alone has spoiled the entire country,” they accused. “He wants to strike a caste *brāhmaṇa*. He has no fear of religious principles.

PURPORT

In those days also, the caste *brāhmaṇas* were very proud. They were not prepared to accept chastisement even from a teacher or spiritual master.

TEXT 256

punaḥ yadi aiche kare māriba tāhare

kon vā mānuṣa haya, ki karite pāre

SYNONYMS

punaḥ—again; *yadi*—if; *aiche*—like that; *kare*—He does; *māriba*—we

shall strike; *tāhare*—Him; *kon*—who; *vā*—or; *mānuṣa*—the man; *haya*—is; *ki*—what; *karite*—to do; *pāre*—He is able.

TRANSLATION

“If He again performs such an atrocious act, certainly we shall retaliate and strike Him in turn. What kind of important person is He, that He can check us in this way?”

TEXT 257

prabhura nindāya sabāra buddhi haila nāśa

supaṭhita vidyā kārao nā haya prakāśa

SYNONYMS

prabhura—of the Lord; *nindāya*—in accusation; *sabāra*—of everyone; *buddhi*—the intelligence; *haila*—became; *nāśa*—spoiled; *su-paṭhita*—well-studied; *vidyā*—knowledge; *kārao*—everyone’s; *nā*—does not; *haya*—become; *prakāśa*—manifest.

TRANSLATION

When all the students thus resolved, criticizing Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, their intelligence was spoiled. Thus although they were learned scholars, because of this offense the essence of knowledge was not manifested in them.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is said, *māyayāpahṛta-jñānā āsuram bhāvam āśritāḥ*: when one becomes inimical to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, adopting an atheistic attitude (*āsuram bhāvam*), even if one is a learned scholar the essence of knowledge does not become manifested in

him; in other words, the essence of his knowledge is stolen by the illusory energy of the Lord. In this connection Śrī Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura quotes a *mantra* from the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* (6.23):

*yasya deve parā bhaktir yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāḥ prakāśante mahātmanaḥ*
[ŚU ^x6.23]

The purport of this verse is that one who is unflinchingly devoted to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Viṣṇu, and similarly devoted to the spiritual master, with no ulterior motive, becomes a master of all knowledge. In the heart of such a devotee, the real essence of the Vedic knowledge becomes manifested. This essence is nothing but surrender unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead (*vedaiś ca sarvair aham eva vedyah* [Bg. 15.15]). Only unto one who fully surrenders to the spiritual master and the Supreme Lord does the essence of Vedic knowledge become manifested, not to anyone else. This same principle is emphasized by Śrī Prahlāda Mahārāja in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (7.5.24):

*iti puṁsārpitā viṣṇau bhaktiś cen nava-lakṣaṇā
kriyate bhagavat addhā tan manye 'dhītam uttamam*

“A person who directly applies these nine principles [hearing, chanting, remembering, etc.] in the service of the Lord is to be understood as a greatly learned man who has assimilated the Vedic literatures very well, for the goal of studying the Vedic literature is to understand the supremacy of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa.” Śrīdhara Svāmī confirms in his commentary that first one must surrender to the spiritual master; then the process of devotional service will develop. It is not a fact that only one who diligently pursues an academic career can become a devotee. Even with no academic career, if one has full faith in the spiritual master and the Supreme Personality of Godhead, he develops in spiritual life and real knowledge of the *Vedas*. The example of Mahārāja Khaṭvāṅga confirms this. One who surrenders is understood to have learned the subject matter of the *Vedas* very nicely. One who adopts this Vedic process of

surrender learns devotional service and is certainly successful. One who is very proud, however, is unable to surrender either to the spiritual master or to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Thus he cannot understand the essence of any Vedic literature. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (*Bhāg.* 11.11.18) declares:

*śabda-brahmaṇi niṣṇāto na niṣṇāyāt pare yadi
śramas tasya śrama-phalo hy adhenum iva rakṣataḥ*

“If one is learned in the Vedic literature but is not a devotee of Lord Viṣṇu, his work is a useless waste of labor, just like the keeping of a cow that does not give milk.”

Anyone who does not follow the surrendering process but is simply interested in an academic career cannot make any advancement. His profit is only his labor for nothing. If one is expert in the study of the *Vedas* but does not surrender to a spiritual master or Viṣṇu, all his cultivation of knowledge is but a waste of time and labor.

TEXT 258

tathāpi dāmbhika paḍuyā namra nāhi haya

yāhān tāhān prabhura nindā hāsi’ se karaya

SYNONYMS

tathāpi—still; *dāmbhika*—proud; *paḍuyā*—students; *namra*—submissive; *nāhi*—not; *haya*—become; *yāhān*—any where; *tāhān*—everywhere; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *nindā*—accusation; *hāsi’*—laughing; *se*—they; *karaya*—do.

TRANSLATION

But the proud student community did not become submissive. On the

contrary, the students spoke of the incident anywhere and everywhere. In a laughing manner they criticized the Lord.

TEXT 259

sarva-jña gosāñi jāni' sabāra durgati

ghare vasi' cinte tā'-sabāra avyāhati

SYNONYMS

sarva-jña—all-knowing; *gosāñi*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *jāni'*—knowing; *sabāra*—of all of them; *durgati*—degradation; *ghare*—at home; *vasi'*—sitting; *cinte*—contemplates; *tā'*—of them; *sabāra*—of all; *avyāhati*—the rescue.

TRANSLATION

Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, being omniscient, could understand the degradation of these students. Thus He sat at home, contemplating how to rescue them.

TEXT 260

yata adhyāpaka, āra tānra śiṣya-gaṇa

dharmī, karmī, tapo-niṣṭha, nindaka, durjana

SYNONYMS

yata—all; *adhyāpaka*—professors; *āra*—and; *tānra*—their; *śiṣya-gaṇa*—students; *dharmī*—followers of religious ritualistic ceremonies; *karmī*—performers of fruitive activities; *tapo-niṣṭha*—performers of austerities; *nindaka*—blasphemers; *durjana*—rogues.

TRANSLATION

“All the so-called professors and scientists and their students generally follow the regulative principles of religion, fruitive activities and austerities,” the Lord thought, “yet at the same time they are blasphemers and rogues.

PURPORT

Here is a depiction of materialists who have no knowledge of devotional service. They may be very religious and may work very systematically or perform austerities and penances, but if they blaspheme the Supreme Personality of Godhead they are nothing but rogues. This is confirmed in the *Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya* (3.11):

*bhagavad-bhakti-hīnasya jātiḥ śāstraṁ japas tapaḥ
aprāṇasyaiva dehasya maṇḍanaṁ loka-rañjanam*

If they are without knowledge of devotional service to the Lord, then great nationalism, fruitive, political or social work, science or philosophy are all simply like costly garments decorating a dead body. The only offense of persons adhering to these principles is that they are not devotees; they are always blasphemous toward the Supreme Personality of Godhead and His devotees.

TEXT 261

ei saba mora nindā-aparādha haite

āmi nā laoyāile bhakti, nā pāre la-ite

SYNONYMS

ei saba—all of them; *mora*—of Me; *nindā*—blasphemy; *aparādha*—offense; *haite*—from; *āmi*—I; *nā*—not; *laoyāile*—if causing them to

take; *bhakti*—devotional service; *nā*—not; *pāre*—able; *la-ite*—to take.

TRANSLATION

“If I do not induce them to take to devotional service, because of committing the offense of blasphemy none of these people will be able to take to it.

TEXT 262

nistārite āilāma āmi, haila viparīta

e-saba durjanera kaiche ha-ibeka hita

SYNONYMS

nistārite—to deliver; *āilāma*—have come; *āmi*—I; *haila*—it has become; *viparīta*—just the opposite; *e-saba*—all these; *durjanera*—of the rogues; *kaiche*—how; *ha-ibeka*—it will be; *hita*—the benefit.

TRANSLATION

“I have come to deliver all the fallen souls, but now just the opposite has happened. How can these rogues be delivered? How may they be benefited?

TEXT 263

āmāke praṇati kare, haya pāpa-kṣaya

tabe se ihāre bhakti laoyāile laya

SYNONYMS

āmāke—unto Me; *praṇati*—obeisances; *kare*—they offer; *haya*—

becomes; *pāpa-kṣaya*—destruction of sinful reactions; *tabe*—then; *se*—they; *ihāre*—unto them; *bhakti*—devotional service; *laoyāile*—if causing to take; *laya*—will take.

TRANSLATION

“If these rogues offer Me obeisances, the reactions of their sinful activities will be nullified. Then, if I induce them, they will take to devotional service.

TEXT 264

more nindā kare ye, nā kare namaskāra

e-saba jīvere avaśya kariba uddhāra

SYNONYMS

more—Me; *nindā kare*—blasphemes; *ye*—anyone who; *nā*—does not; *kare*—offer; *namaskāra*—obeisances; *e-saba*—all these; *jīvere*—living entities; *avaśya*—certainly; *kariba*—I shall do; *uddhāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

“I must certainly deliver all these fallen souls who blaspheme Me and do not offer Me obeisances.

TEXT 265

ataeva avaśya āmi sannyāsa kariba

sannyāsi-buddhye more praṇata ha-iba

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *avaśya*—certainly; *āmi*—I; *sannyāsa*—the renounced order of life; *kariba*—shall accept; *sannyāsi-buddhye*—by thinking of Me as a *sannyāsī*; *more*—unto Me; *praṇata*—bow down; *ha-iba*—they shall do.

TRANSLATION

“I shall accept the *sannyāsa* order of life, for thus people will offer Me their obeisances, thinking of Me as a member of the renounced order.

PURPORT

Among the members of the *varṇāśrama* institution’s social orders (*brāhmaṇa*, *kṣatriya*, *vaiśya* and *sūdra*), the *brāhmaṇa* is considered the foremost, for he is the teacher and spiritual master of all the other *varṇas*. Similarly, among the spiritual orders (*brahmacarya*, *gṛhastha*, *vānaprastha* and *sannyāsa*), the *sannyāsa* order is the most elevated. Therefore a *sannyāsī* is the spiritual master of all the *varṇas* and *āśramas*, and a *brāhmaṇa* is also expected to offer obeisances to a *sannyāsī*. Unfortunately, however, caste *brāhmaṇas* do not offer obeisances to a Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsī*. They are so proud that they do not offer obeisances even to Indian *sannyāsīs*, what to speak of European and American *sannyāsīs*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, however, expected that even the caste *brāhmaṇas* would offer respectful obeisances to a *sannyāsī* because five hundred years ago the social custom was to offer obeisances immediately to any *sannyāsī*, known or unknown.

The *sannyāsīs* of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement are bona fide. All the students of the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement have undergone the regular process of initiation. As enjoined in the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* by Sanātana Gosvāmī, *tathā dīkṣā-vidhānena dvijatvaṁ jāyate nṛṇām*: by the regular process of initiation, any man can become a *brāhmaṇa*. Thus in the beginning the students of our Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement agree to live with devotees, and gradually, having given up four prohibited activities—illicit sex, gambling, meat-eating and intoxication—they

become advanced in the activities of spiritual life. When one is found to be regularly following these principles, he is given the first initiation (*hari-nāma*), and he regularly chants at least sixteen rounds a day. Then, after six months or a year, he is initiated for the second time and given the sacred thread with the regular sacrifice and rituals. After some time, when he advances still further and is willing to give up this material world, he is given the *sannyāsa* order. At that time he receives the title *svāmī* or *gosvāmī*, both of which mean “master of the senses.”

Unfortunately, debauched so-called *brāhmaṇas* in India neither offer them respect nor accept them as bona fide *sannyāsīs*. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu expected the so-called *brāhmaṇas* to offer respect to such Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsīs*. Nevertheless, it does not matter whether they offer respect, nor whether they accept these *sannyāsīs* as bona fide, for the *śāstra* describes punishment for such disobedient so-called *brāhmaṇas*. The *śāstric* injunction declares:

*devatā-pratimām dṛṣṭvā yatim caiva tridaṇḍinam
namaskāraṁ na kuryād yaḥ prāyaścittīyate naraḥ*

“One who does not offer respect to the Supreme Personality of Godhead, to His Deity in the temple or to a *tridaṇḍī sannyāsī* must undergo *prāyaścitta* [atonement].” If one does not offer obeisances to such a *sannyāsī*, the prescribed *prāyaścitta* is to fast for one day.

TEXT 266

praṇatite ha’be ihāra aparādha kṣaya

nirmala hṛdaye bhakti karāiba udaya

SYNONYMS

praṇatite—by offering obeisances; *ha’be*—there will be; *ihāra*—of such offenders; *aparādha*—the offenses; *kṣaya*—destruction; *nirmala*—pure; *hṛdaye*—in the heart; *bhakti*—devotional service; *karāiba*—I shall cause;

udaya—the rising.

TRANSLATION

“Offering obeisances will relieve them of all the reactions to their offenses. Then, by My grace, devotional service [bhakti] will awaken in their pure hearts.

PURPORT

According to the Vedic injunctions, only a *brāhmaṇa* may be offered *sannyāsa*. The Śāṅkara-sampradāya (*ekadaṇḍa-sannyāsa-sampradāya*) awards the *sannyāsa* order only to caste *brāhmaṇas*, or born *brāhmaṇas*, but in the Vaiṣṇava system even one not born in a *brāhmaṇa* family may be made a *brāhmaṇa* according to the direction of the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* (*tathā dīkṣā-vidhānena dvijatvaṁ jāyate nṛṇām*). Any person from any part of the world may be made a *brāhmaṇa* by the regular process of initiation, and when he follows brahminical behavior, observing the principle of abstaining from intoxication, illicit sex, meat-eating and gambling, he may be offered *sannyāsa*. All the *sannyāsīs* in the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement, who are preaching all over the world, are regular *brāhmaṇa-sannyāsīs*. Thus the so-called caste *brāhmaṇas* should not object to offering them respectful obeisances. By offering such obeisances, as recommended by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, they will diminish their offenses and automatically awaken to their natural position of devotional service. As it is said, *nitya-siddha kṛṣṇa-prema sādhyā kabhu naya*: [Cc. madhya 22.107] *kṛṣṇa-prema* can be awakened in a purified heart. The more we offer obeisances to *sannyāsīs*, especially Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsīs*, the more we diminish our offenses and purify our hearts. Only in a purified heart can *kṛṣṇa-prema* awaken. This is the process of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s cult, the Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement.

TEXT 267

e-saba pāṣaṇḍīra tabe ha-ibe nistāra

āra kona upāya nāhi, ei yukti sāra

SYNONYMS

e-saba—all these; *pāṣaṇḍīra*—of the demons; *tabe*—then; *ha-ibe*—there will be; *nistāra*—deliverance; *āra*—alternative; *kona*—some; *upāya*—means; *nāhi*—there is not; *ei*—this; *yukti*—of the argument; *sāra*—essence.

TRANSLATION

“All the unfaithful rogues of this world can be delivered by this process. There is no alternative. This is the essence of the argument.”

TEXT 268

ei dṛḍha yukti kari' prabhu āche ghare

keśava bhāratī āilā nadīyā-nagare

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *dṛḍha*—firm; *yukti*—consideration; *kari'*—making; *prabhu*—the Lord; *āche*—was; *ghare*—in His home; *keśava bhāratī*—Keśava Bhāratī; *āilā*—came; *nadīyā-nagare*—to the town of Nadia.

TRANSLATION

After coming to this firm conclusion, the Lord continued to stay at home. In the meantime Keśava Bhāratī came to the town of Nadia.

TEXT 269

prabhu tāñre namaskari' kaila nimantraṇa

bhikṣā karāiyā tāñre kaila nivedana

SYNONYMS

prabhu—the Lord; *tāñre*—to him; *namaskari'*—offering obeisances; *kaila*—did; *nimantraṇa*—invitation; *bhikṣā*—alms; *karāiyā*—giving; *tāñre*—to him; *kaila*—submitted; *nivedana*—His prayer.

TRANSLATION

The Lord offered him respectful obeisances and invited him to His house. After feeding him sumptuously, He submitted to him His petition.

PURPORT

According to the system of Vedic society, whenever an unknown *sannyāsī* comes to a village or town, someone must invite him to take *prasādam* in his home. *Sannyāsīs* generally take *prasādam* in the house of a *brāhmaṇa* because the *brāhmaṇa* worships the Lord Nārāyaṇa *śilā*, or *śālagrāma-śilā*, and therefore there is *prasādam* that the *sannyāsī* may take. Keśava Bhāratī accepted the invitation of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. Thus the Lord had a good opportunity to explain His desire to take *sannyāsa* from him.

TEXT 270

tumi ta' īśvara baṭa,——sākṣāt nārāyaṇa

kṛpā kari' kara mora saṁsāra mocana

SYNONYMS

tumi—you; *ta'*—certainly; *īśvara*—the Lord; *baṭa*—are; *sākṣāt*—

directly; *nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Lord, Nārāyaṇa; *kṛpā kari'*—showing mercy; *kara*—please do; *mora*—My; *saṁsāra*—material life; *mocana*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

“Sir, you are directly Nārāyaṇa. Therefore please be merciful unto Me. Deliver Me from this material bondage.”

TEXT 271

bhāratī kahena, — — tumi īśvara, antaryāmi

ye karāha, se kariba, — — svatantra nahi āmi

SYNONYMS

bhāratī kahena—Keśava Bhāratī replied; *tumi*—You; *īśvara*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *antaryāmi*—You know everything from within; *ye*—whatever; *karāha*—You cause to do; *se*—that; *kariba*—I must do; *svatantra*—independent; *nahi*—not; *āmi*—I.

TRANSLATION

Keśava Bhāratī replied to the Lord, “You are the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the Supersoul. I must do whatever You cause me to do. I am not independent of You.”

TEXT 272

eta bali' bhāratī gosāñi kāṭoyāte gelā

mahāprabhu tāhā yāi' sannyāsa karilā

SYNONYMS

eta bali'—saying this; *bhāratī*—Keśava Bhāratī; *gosāñī*—the spiritual master; *kāṭoyāte*—to Katwa; *gelā*—went; *mahāprabhu*—Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *tahā*—there; *yai'*—going; *sannyāsa*—the renounced order of life; *karilā*—accepted.

TRANSLATION

After saying this, Keśava Bhāratī, the spiritual master, went back to his village, Katwa. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu went there and accepted the renounced order of life [sannyāsa].

PURPORT

At the end of His twenty-fourth year, at the end of the fortnight of the waxing moon, Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu left Navadvīpa and crossed the river Ganges at a place known as Nidayāra-ghāṭa. Then He reached Kaṇṭaka-nagara, or Kāṭoyā (Katwa), where He accepted *ekadaṇḍa-sannyāsa* according to the Śāṅkarite system. Since Keśava Bhāratī belonged to the Śāṅkarite sect, he could not initiate Caitanya Mahāprabhu into the Vaiṣṇava *sannyāsa* order, whose members carry the *tridaṇḍa*.

Candraśekhara Ācārya assisted in the routine ceremonial work of the Lord's acceptance of *sannyāsa*. By the order of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, *kīrtana* was performed for the entire day, and at the end of the day the Lord shaved off His hair. On the next day He became a regular *sannyāsī*, with one rod (*ekadaṇḍa*). From that day on, His name was Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Before that, He was known as Nimāi Paṇḍita. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, in the *sannyāsa* order, traveled all over Rāḍhadeśa, the region where the Ganges River cannot be seen. Keśava Bhāratī accompanied Him for some distance.

TEXT 273

saṅge nityānanda, candraśekhara ācārya

mukunda-datta,—ei tina kaila sarva kārya

SYNONYMS

saṅge—in His company; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda Prabhu; *candraśekhara ācārya*—Candraśekhara Ācārya; *mukunda-datta*—Mukunda Datta; *ei tina*—these three; *kaila*—performed; *sarva*—all; *kārya*—necessary activities.

TRANSLATION

When Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted sannyāsa, three personalities were with Him to perform all the necessary activities. They were Nityānanda Prabhu, Candraśekhara Ācārya and Mukunda Datta.

TEXT 274

ei ādi-līlāra kaila sūtra gaṇana

vistāri varṇilā ihā dāsa vṛndāvana

SYNONYMS

ei—this; *ādi-līlāra*—of the *ādi-līlā* (the first portion of Lord Caitanya's pastimes); *kaila*—made; *sūtra*—synopsis; *gaṇana*—enumeration; *vistāri*—elaborately; *varṇilā*—described; *ihā*—this; *dāsa vṛndāvana*—Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura.

TRANSLATION

Thus I have summarized the incidents of the ādi-līlā. Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has described them elaborately [in his Caitanya-bhāgavata].

TEXT 275

yaśodā-nandana hailā śacīra nandana

catur-vidha bhakta-bhāva kare āsvādana

SYNONYMS

yaśodā-nandana—the son of mother Yaśodā; *hailā*—became; *śacīra*—of mother Śacī; *nandana*—the son; *catur-vidha*—four kinds of; *bhakta-bhāva*—devotional humors; *kare*—does; *āsvādana*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

The same Supreme Personality of Godhead who appeared as the son of mother Yaśodā has now appeared as the son of mother Śacī, relishing four kinds of devotional activities.

PURPORT

Servitude, friendship, parental affection and conjugal love for the Supreme Personality of Godhead are the basis of the four kinds of devotional activities. In *śānta*, the marginal stage of devotional service, there is no activity. But above the *śānta* humor are servitude, friendship, parental affection and conjugal love, which represent the gradual growth of devotional service to higher and higher platforms.

TEXT 276

sva-mādhurya rādhā-prema-rasa āsvādite

rādhā-bhāva aṅgī kariyāche bhāla-mate

SYNONYMS

sva-mādhurya—His own conjugal love; *rādhā-prema-rasa*—the mellow of the loving affairs between Rādhārāṇī and Kṛṣṇa; *āsvādite*—to taste;

rādhā-bhāva—the mood of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *aṅgī kariyāche*—He accepted; *bhāla-mate*—very well.

TRANSLATION

To taste the mellows of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī's loving affairs in Her relationship with Kṛṣṇa, and to understand the reservoir of pleasure in Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Himself, as Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, accepted the mood of Rādhārāṇī.

PURPORT

In this connection Śrīla Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvatī Ṭhākura writes in his *Anubhāṣya*, “Śrī Gaurasundara is Kṛṣṇa Himself with the attitude of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu never gave up the attitude of the *gopīs*. He remained everlastingly predominated by Kṛṣṇa and never accepted the part of the predominator by imitating conjugal love with an ordinary woman, as *sahajiyās* generally do. He never placed Himself in the position of a debauchee. Lusty materialists like the members of the *sahajiyā-sampradāya* hanker after women, even others' wives. But when they try to ascribe the responsibility for their lusty activities to Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, they become offenders to Svarūpa Dāmodara and Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura. In *Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata, Ādi-khaṇḍa*, Chapter Fifteen, it is said:

*sabe para-strīra prati nāhi parihāsa
strī dekhi' dūre prabhu hayena eka-pāśa*

‘Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu never even joked with others' wives. As soon as He saw a woman coming, He would immediately give her ample room to pass without talking.’ He was extremely strict regarding the association of women. The *sahajiyās*, however, pose as followers of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu although they indulge in lusty affairs with women. In His youth Lord Caitanya was very humorous with everyone, but He never joked with any woman, nor in this incarnation did He talk about women.

The *gaurāṅga-nāgarī* party is not approved by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu or Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura. Even though one may offer all kinds of prayers to Caitanya Mahāprabhu, one should strictly avoid worshiping Him as the Gaurāṅga Nāgara. The personal behavior of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu and the verses written by Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura have completely repudiated the lusty desires of the *gaurāṅga-nāgarīs*.”

TEXT 277

gopī-bhāva yāte prabhu dhariyāche ekānta

vrajendra-nandane māne āpanāra kānta

SYNONYMS

gopī-bhāva—the mood of the *gopīs*; *yāte*—in which; *prabhu*—the Lord; *dhariyāche*—accepted; *ekānta*—positively; *vrajendra-nandane*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *māne*—they accept; *āpanāra*—own; *kānta*—lover.

TRANSLATION

Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu accepted the mood of the *gopīs*, who accept Vrajendranandana, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, as their lover.

TEXT 278

gopikā-bhāvera ei sudṛḍha niścaya

vrajendra-nandana vinā anyatra nā haya

SYNONYMS

gopikā-bhāvera—of the ecstasy of the *gopīs*; *ei*—this; *sudṛḍha*—firm; *niścaya*—confirmation; *vrajendra-nandana*—Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa; *vinā*—without; *anyatra*—anyone else; *nā*—not; *haya*—is possible.

TRANSLATION

It is firmly concluded that the ecstatic mood of the gopīs is possible only before Kṛṣṇa, and no one else.

TEXT 279

śyāmasundara, śikhipiccha-guñjā-vibhūṣaṇa

gopa-veśa, tri-bhaṅgima, muralī-vadana

SYNONYMS

śyāma-sundara—Lord Kṛṣṇa, who has a bluish color; *śikhi-piccha*—with a peacock feather on the head; *guñjā*—a garland of *guñjā* (small berries or conchshells); *vibhūṣaṇa*—decorations; *gopa-veśa*—with the dress of a cowherd boy; *tri-bhaṅgima*—curved in three places; *muralī-vadana*—holding a flute to His mouth.

TRANSLATION

He has a bluish complexion, a peacock feather on His head, a guñjā garland and the decorations of a cowherd boy. His body is curved in three places, and He holds a flute to His mouth.

TEXT 280

ihā chāḍi' kṛṣṇa yadi haya anyākāra

gopikāra bhāva nāhi yāya nikaṭa tāhāra

SYNONYMS

ihā—this; *chāḍi'*—giving up; *kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa; *yadi*—if; *haya*—takes; *anya-ākāra*—another form; *gopikāra*—of the *gopīs*; *bhāva*—the ecstasy;

nāhi—does not; *yāya*—arise; *nikaṭa*—near; *tāhāra*—that (form).

TRANSLATION

If Lord Kṛṣṇa gives up this original form and assumes another Viṣṇu form, nearness to Him cannot invoke the ecstatic mood of the gopīs.

TEXT 281

gopīnām paśupendra-nandana-juṣo bhāvasya kaś tām kṛtī

vijñātum kṣamate durūha-padavī-saṅcārīṇaḥ prakriyām

āviṣkurvati vaiṣṇavīm api tanum tasmin bhujair jiṣṇubhir

yāsām hanta caturbhir adbhuta-ruciṁ rāgoḍayaḥ kuñcati

SYNONYMS

gopīnām—of the *gopīs*; *paśupa-indra-nandana-juṣaḥ*—of the service of the son of Vraja’s King, Mahārāja Nanda; *bhāvasya*—ecstatic; *kaḥ*—what; *tām*—that; *kṛtī*—learned man; *vijñātum*—to understand; *kṣamate*—is able; *durūha*—very difficult to understand; *padavī*—the position; *saṅcārīṇaḥ*—which provokes; *prakriyām*—activity; *āviṣkurvati*—He manifests; *vaiṣṇavīm*—of Viṣṇu; *api*—certainly; *tanum*—the body; *tasmin*—in that; *bhujaiḥ*—with arms; *jiṣṇubhiḥ*—very beautiful; *yāsām*—of whom (the *gopīs*); *hanta*—alas; *caturbhiḥ*—four; *adbhuta*—wonderfully; *ruciṁ*—beautiful; *rāgoḍayaḥ*—the evoking of ecstatic feelings; *kuñcati*—cripples.

TRANSLATION

“Once Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa playfully manifested Himself as Nārāyaṇa, with four victorious hands and a very beautiful form. When the gopīs saw this exalted form, however, their ecstatic feelings were crippled. Even a

learned scholar, therefore, cannot understand the gopīs' ecstatic feelings, which are firmly fixed upon the original form of Lord Kṛṣṇa as the son of Nanda Mahārāja. The wonderful feelings of the gopīs in ecstatic parama-rasa with Kṛṣṇa constitute the greatest mystery in spiritual life."

PURPORT

This is a quotation from the *Lalita-mādhava* (6.54), by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 282

vasanta-kāle rāsa-līlā kare govardhane

antardhāna kailā saṅketa kari' rādhā-sane

SYNONYMS

vasanta-kāle—during the season of spring; *rāsa-līlā*—the *rāsa* dance; *kare*—does; *govardhane*—near the Govardhana Hill; *antardhāna*—disappearance; *kailā*—did; *saṅketa*—indication; *kari'*—making; *rādhā-sane*—with Rādhārāṇī.

TRANSLATION

During the season of springtime, when the *rāsa* dance was going on, suddenly Kṛṣṇa disappeared from the scene, indicating that He wanted to be alone with Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī.

TEXT 283

nibhṛta-nikuñje vasi' dekhe rādhāra bāṭa

anveṣite āilā tāhān gopikāra ṭhāṭa

SYNONYMS

nibhṛta—solitary; *nikuñje*—in a bush; *vasi'*—sitting; *dekhe*—waiting to see; *rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *bāṭa*—the passing; *anveṣite*—while searching; *āilā*—came; *tāhān*—there; *gopikāra*—of the *gopīs*; *thāṭa*—the phalanx.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa was sitting in a solitary bush, waiting for Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī to pass by. But while He was searching, the *gopīs* arrived there, like a phalanx of soldiers.

TEXT 284

dūra haite kṛṣṇe dekhi' bale gopī-gaṇa

“*ei dekha kuñjera bhitara vrajendra-nandana*”

SYNONYMS

dūra haite—from a distance; *kṛṣṇe*—unto Kṛṣṇa; *dekhi'*—seeing; *bale*—said; *gopī-gaṇa*—all the *gopīs*; *ei dekha*—just see here; *kuñjera*—the bush; *bhitara*—within; *vrajendra-nandana*—the son of Nanda Mahārāja.

TRANSLATION

“Just see!” the *gopīs* said, seeing Kṛṣṇa from a distant place. “Here within a bush is Kṛṣṇa, the son of Nanda Mahārāja.”

TEXT 285

gopī-gaṇa dekhi' kṛṣṇera ha-ila sādharma

lukāite nārila, bhave hailā vibaśa

SYNONYMS

gopī-gaṇa—all the *gopīs* combined together; *dekhi’*—seeing; *kṛṣṇera*—of Kṛṣṇa; *ha-īla*—there were; *sādhvasa*—some emotional feelings; *lukāite*—to hide; *nārīla*—was unable; *bhaye*—out of fear; *hailā*—became; *vibaśa*—motionless.

TRANSLATION

As soon as Kṛṣṇa saw all the *gopīs*, He was struck with emotion. Thus He could not hide Himself, and out of fear He became motionless.

TEXT 286

catur-bhuja mūrti dhari’ āchena vasiyā

kṛṣṇa dekhi’ gopī kahe nikaṭe āsiyā

SYNONYMS

catur-bhuja—four-armed; *mūrti*—form; *dhari’*—accepting; *āchena*—was; *vasiyā*—sitting; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dekhi’*—seeing; *gopī*—the *gopīs*; *kahe*—say; *nikaṭe*—nearby; *āsiyā*—coming there.

TRANSLATION

Kṛṣṇa assumed His four-armed Nārāyaṇa form and sat there. When all the *gopīs* came, they looked at Him and spoke as follows.

TEXT 287

‘ihon kṛṣṇa nahe, ihon nārāyaṇa mūrti’

eta bali’ tāñre sabhe kare nati-stuti

SYNONYMS

ihorī—this; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nahe*—is not; *ihorī*—this is; *nārāyaṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *mūrti*—the form; *eta bali'*—saying this; *tāñre*—unto Him; *sabhe*—all the gopīs; *kare*—make; *nati-stuti*—obeisances and prayers.

TRANSLATION

“He is not Kṛṣṇa! He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Nārāyaṇa.” After saying this, they offered obeisances and the following respectful prayers.

TEXT 288

“namo nārāyaṇa, deva karaha prasāda

kṛṣṇa-saṅga deha' mora ghucāha viśāda”

SYNONYMS

namaḥ nārāyaṇa—all respects to Nārāyaṇa; *deva*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *karaha*—kindly give; *prasāda*—Your mercy; *kṛṣṇa-saṅga*—association with Kṛṣṇa; *deha'*—giving; *mora*—our; *ghucāha*—please diminish; *viśāda*—lamentation.

TRANSLATION

“O Lord Nārāyaṇa, we offer our respectful obeisances unto You. Kindly be merciful to us. Give us the association of Kṛṣṇa and thus vanquish our lamentation.”

PURPORT

The *gopīs* were not made happy even by seeing the four-armed form of

Nārāyaṇa. Yet they offered their respects to the Supreme Personality of Godhead and begged from Him the benediction of achieving the association of Kṛṣṇa. Such is the ecstatic feeling of the *gopīs*.

TEXT 289

eta bali namaskari' gelā gopī-gaṇa

hena-kāle rādhā āsi' dilā daraśana

SYNONYMS

eta bali—saying this; *namaskari'*—offering obeisances; *gelā*—went away; *gopī-gaṇa*—all the *gopīs*; *hena-kāle*—at this time; *rādhā*—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *āsi'*—coming there; *dilā*—gave; *daraśana*—audience.

TRANSLATION

After saying this and offering obeisances, all the *gopīs* dispersed. Then Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī came and appeared before Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 290

rādhā dekhi' kṛṣṇa tānre hāsyā karite

sei catur-bhuja mūrti cāhena rākhite

SYNONYMS

rādhā—Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *dekhi'*—seeing; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tānre*—unto Her; *hāsyā*—joking; *karite*—to do; *sei*—that; *catur-bhuja*—four-armed; *mūrti*—form; *cāhena*—wanted; *rākhite*—to keep.

TRANSLATION

When Lord Kṛṣṇa saw Rādhārāṇī, He wanted to maintain the four-armed form to joke with Her.

TEXT 291

lukāilā dui bhuja rādhāra agrete

bahu yatna kailā kṛṣṇa, nārila rākhite

SYNONYMS

lukāilā—He hid; *dui*—two; *bhuja*—arms; *rādhāra*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *agrete*—in front; *bahu*—much; *yatna*—endeavor; *kailā*—did; *kṛṣṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *nārila*—was unable; *rākhite*—to keep.

TRANSLATION

In front of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī, Śrī Kṛṣṇa had to hide the two extra arms. He tried His best to keep four arms before Her, but He was completely unable to do so.

TEXT 292

rādhāra viśuddha-bhāvera acintya prabhāva

ye kṛṣṇere karāilā dvi-bhuja-svabhāva

SYNONYMS

rādhāra—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *viśuddha*—purified; *bhāvera*—of the ecstasy; *acintya*—inconceivable; *prabhāva*—influence; *ye*—which; *kṛṣṇere*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *karāilā*—forced; *dvi-bhuja*—two-armed; *svabhāva*—original form.

TRANSLATION

The influence of Rādhārāṇī's pure ecstasy is so inconceivably great that it forced Kṛṣṇa to come to His original two-armed form.

TEXT 293

rāsārambha-vidhau nilīya vasatā kuñje mṛgākṣī-gaṇair

dṛṣṭam gopayitum svam uddhura-dhiyā yā suṣṭhu sandarśitā

rādhāyāḥ praṇayasya hanta mahimā yasya śriyā rakṣitum

sā śakyā prabhaviṣṇunāpi hariṇā nāsīc catur-bāhutā

SYNONYMS

rāsa-ārambha-vidhau—in the matter of beginning the *rāsa* dance; *nilīya*—having hidden; *vasatā*—sitting; *kuñje*—in a grove; *mṛga-akṣī-gaṇaiḥ*—by the *gopīs*, who had eyes resembling those of deer; *dṛṣṭam*—being seen; *gopayitum*—to hide; *svam*—Himself; *uddhura-dhiyā*—by first-class intelligence; *yā*—which; *suṣṭhu*—perfectly; *sandarśitā*—exhibited; *rādhāyāḥ*—of Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī; *praṇayasya*—of the love; *hanta*—just see; *mahimā*—the glory; *yasya*—of which; *śriyā*—the opulence; *rakṣitum*—to protect that; *sā*—that; *śakyā*—able; *prabhaviṣṇunā*—by Kṛṣṇa; *api*—even; *hariṇā*—by the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *na*—not; *āsīt*—was; *catur-bāhutā*—four-armed form.

TRANSLATION

“Prior to the *rāsa* dance, Lord Kṛṣṇa hid Himself in a grove just to have fun. When the *gopīs* came, their eyes resembling those of deer, by His sharp intelligence He exhibited His beautiful four-armed form to hide Himself. But when Śrīmatī Rādhārāṇī came there, Kṛṣṇa could not maintain His four arms in Her presence. This is the wonderful glory of Her love.”

PURPORT

This is a quotation from the *Ujjvala-nīlamanī*, by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 294

sei vrajeśvara—ihaṇ jagannātha pitā

sei vrajeśvarī—ihaṇ śacīdevī mātā

SYNONYMS

sei—that; *vrajeśvara*—the King of Vraja; *ihaṇ*—now; *jagannātha*—Jagannātha Miśra; *pitā*—the father of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sei*—that; *vrajeśvarī*—Queen of Vraja; *ihaṇ*—now; *śacīdevī*—Śacīdevī; *mātā*—the mother of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

Father Nanda, the King of Vrajabhūmi, is now Jagannātha Miśra, the father of Caitanya Mahāprabhu. And mother Yaśodā, the Queen of Vrajabhūmi, is now Śacīdevī, Lord Caitanya's mother.

TEXT 295

sei nanda-suta—ihaṇ caitanya-gosāñi

sei baladeva—ihaṇ nityānanda bhāi

SYNONYMS

sei nanda-suta—the same son of Nanda Mahārāja; *ihaṇ*—now; *caitanya-gosāñi*—Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sei baladeva*—the selfsame Baladeva; *ihaṇ*—now; *nityānanda bhāi*—Nityānanda Prabhu, the brother of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

The former son of Nanda Mahārāja is now Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and the former Baladeva, Kṛṣṇa's brother, is now Nityānanda Prabhu, the brother of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 296

vātsalya, dāsya, sakhya—tina bhāvamaya

sei nityānanda—kṛṣṇa-caitanya-sahāya

SYNONYMS

vātsalya—paternity; *dāsya*—servitude; *sakhya*—fraternity; *tina*—three; *bhāva-maya*—emotional ecstasies; *sei*—that; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda Prabhu; *kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *sahāya*—the assistant.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu always feels the ecstatic emotions of paternity, servitude and friendship. He always assists Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu in that way.

TEXT 297

prema-bhakti diyā teṇho bhāsā'la jagate

tānra caritra loke nā pāre bujhite

SYNONYMS

prema-bhakti—devotional service; *diyā*—giving; *teṇho*—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *bhāsā'la*—overflowed; *jagate*—in the world;

tānra—His; *caritra*—character; *loke*—people; *nā*—not; *pāre*—able; *bujhite*—to understand.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu overflowed the entire world by distributing transcendental loving service. No one can understand His character and activities.

TEXT 298

advaita-ācārya-gosāñi bhakta-avatāra

kṛṣṇa avatāriyā kailā bhaktira pracāra

SYNONYMS

advaita-ācārya—Śrī Advaita Prabhu; *gosāñi*—spiritual master; *bhakta-avatāra*—the incarnation of a devotee; *kṛṣṇa*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *avatāriyā*—descending; *kailā*—did; *bhaktira*—of devotional service; *pracāra*—propagation.

TRANSLATION

Śrīla Advaita Ācārya Prabhu appeared as an incarnation of a devotee. He is in the category of Kṛṣṇa, but He descended to this earth to propagate devotional service.

TEXT 299

sakhya, dāsyā,——dui bhāva sahaja tānhāra

kabhu prabhu karena tānre guru-vyavahāra

SYNONYMS

sakhya—fraternity; *dāsyā*—servitude; *dui*—two; *bhāva*—ecstasies; *sahaja*—natural; *tāñhāra*—His; *kabhū*—sometimes; *prabhu*—Lord Caitanya; *karena*—does; *tāñre*—to Him; *guru*—of spiritual master; *vyavahāra*—treatment.

TRANSLATION

His natural emotions were always on the platform of fraternity and servitude, but the Lord sometimes treated Him as His spiritual master.

TEXT 300

śrīvāsādi yata mahāprabhura bhakta-gaṇa

nija nija bhāve karena caitanya-sevana

SYNONYMS

śrīvāsa-ādi—headed by Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *yata*—all; *mahāprabhura*—of Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *nija nija*—in their own respective; *bhāve*—emotions; *karena*—do; *caitanya-sevana*—service to Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

All the devotees of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, headed by Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura, have their own emotional humors in which they render service unto Him.

TEXT 301

paṇḍita-gosāñi ādi yāñra yei rasa

sei sei rase prabhu hana tāñra vaśa

SYNONYMS

paṇḍita-gosāñi—Gadādhara Paṇḍita; *ādi*—headed by; *yāñra*—whose; *yei*—whatever; *rasa*—transcendental mellow; *sei sei*—that respective; *rase*—by the mellow; *prabhu*—the Lord; *hana*—is; *tāñra*—his; *vaśa*—under control.

TRANSLATION

Personal associates like Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Rāmānanda Rāya, and the six Gosvāmīs (headed by Rūpa Gosvāmī) are all situated in their respective transcendental humors. Thus the Lord submits to various positions in various transcendental mellows.

PURPORT

In verses 296 through 301 the emotional devoted service of Śrī Nityānanda, Śrī Advaita Prabhu and others has been fully described. Describing such individual service, the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (11–16) declares that although Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu appeared as a devotee, He is none other than the son of Nanda Mahārāja. Similarly, although Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu appeared as Lord Caitanya’s assistant, He is none other than Baladeva, the carrier of the plow. Advaita Ācārya is the incarnation of Sadāśiva from the spiritual world. All the devotees headed by Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura are His marginal energy, whereas the devotees headed by Gadādhara Paṇḍita are manifestations of His internal potency.

Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Advaita Prabhu and Nityānanda Prabhu all belong to the *viṣṇu-tattva* category. Because Lord Caitanya is an ocean of mercy, He is addressed as *mahāprabhu*, whereas Nityānanda and Advaita, being two great personalities who assist Lord Caitanya, are addressed as *prabhu*. Thus there are two *prabhus* and one *mahāprabhu*. Gadādhara Gosvāmī is a representative of a perfect *brāhmaṇa* spiritual master. Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura represents a perfect *brāhmaṇa* devotee. These five are known as the Pañca-tattva.

TEXT 302

tihan śyāma,——vaṁśī-mukha, gopa-vilāsī

ihañ gaura,——kabhu dvija, kabhu ta' sannyāsī

SYNONYMS

tihan—in *kṛṣṇa-līlā*; *śyāma*—blackish color; *vaṁśī-mukha*—a flute in the mouth; *gopa-vilāsī*—an enjoyer as a cowherd boy; *ihañ*—now; *gaura*—fair complexion; *kabhu*—sometimes; *dvija*—*brāhmaṇa*; *kabhu*—sometimes; *ta'*—certainly; *sannyāsī*—in the renounced order of life.

TRANSLATION

In *kṛṣṇa-līlā* the Lord's complexion is blackish. Holding a flute to His mouth, He enjoys as a cowherd boy. Now the selfsame person has appeared with a fair complexion, sometimes acting as a *brāhmaṇa* and sometimes accepting the renounced order of life.

TEXT 303

ataeva āpane prabhu gopī-bhāva dhari'

vrajendra-nandane kahe 'prāṇa-nātha' kari'

SYNONYMS

ataeva—therefore; *āpane*—personally; *prabhu*—the Lord; *gopī-bhāva*—the ecstasy of the *gopīs*; *dhari'*—accepting; *vrajendra-nandane*—the son of Nanda Mahārāja; *kahe*—addresses; *prāṇa-nātha*—O Lord of My life (husband); *kari'*—accepting.

TRANSLATION

Therefore the Lord Himself, accepting the emotional ecstasy of the gopīs, now addresses the son of Nanda Mahārāja, “O master of My life! O My dear husband!”

TEXT 304

sei kṛṣṇa, sei gopī, —parama virodha

acintya caritra prabhura ati sudurbodha

SYNONYMS

sei kṛṣṇa—that Kṛṣṇa; *sei gopī*—that *gopī*; *parama virodha*—very contradictory; *acintya*—inconceivable; *caritra*—character; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *ati*—very; *sudurbodha*—difficult to understand.

TRANSLATION

He is Kṛṣṇa, yet He has accepted the mood of the gopīs. How is it so? It is the inconceivable character of the Lord, which is very difficult to understand.

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇa’s accepting the part of the *gopīs* is certainly contradictory according to any mundane calculations, but the Lord, by His inconceivable character, may act like the *gopīs* and feel separation from Kṛṣṇa, although He is Kṛṣṇa Himself. Such a contradiction can be reconciled only in the Supreme Personality of Godhead because He has energy that is inconceivable (*acintya*), which can make possible that which is impossible to do (*aghaṭa-ghaṭana-patīyasī*). Such contradictions are very difficult to understand unless a devotee strictly follows the Vaiṣṇava philosophy under the direction of the Gosvāmīs. Therefore Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī ends every chapter with this verse:

*śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa*

“Praying at the lotus feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, always desiring their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, following in their footsteps.”

In a song by Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura it is stated:

*rūpa-raghunātha-pade ha-ibe ākuti
kabe hāma bujhaba se yugala-pīriti*

The conjugal love between Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, which is called *yugala-pīriti*, is not understandable by mundane scholars, artists or poets. It is simply to be understood by devotees who strictly follow in the footsteps of the six Gosvāmīs. Sometimes so-called artists and poets try to understand the love affairs of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, and they publish cheap books of poetry and pictures on the subject. Unfortunately, however, they do not understand the transcendental affairs of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa even to the smallest degree. They are simply meddling in a matter in which they are not fit even to enter.

TEXT 305

ithe tarka kari’ keha nā kara saṁśaya

kṛṣṇera acintya-śakti ei mata haya

SYNONYMS

ithe—in this matter; *tarka kari’*—making arguments; *keha*—someone; *nā*—do not; *kara*—make; *saṁśaya*—doubts; *kṛṣṇera*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *acintya-śakti*—inconceivable potency; *ei*—this; *mata*—the verdict; *haya*—is.

TRANSLATION

One cannot understand the contradictions in Lord Caitanya's character by putting forward mundane logic and arguments. Consequently one should not maintain doubts in this connection. One should simply try to understand the inconceivable energy of Kṛṣṇa; otherwise one cannot understand how such contradictions are possible.

TEXT 306

acintya, adbhuta kṛṣṇa-caitanya-vihāra

citra bhāva, citra guṇa, citra vyavahāra

SYNONYMS

acintya—inconceivable; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *viḥāra*—pastimes; *citra*—wonderful; *bhāva*—ecstasy; *citra*—wonderful; *guṇa*—qualities; *citra*—wonderful; *vyavahāra*—behavior.

TRANSLATION

The pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu are inconceivable and wonderful. His ecstasy is wonderful, His qualities are wonderful, and His behavior is wonderful.

TEXT 307

tarke ihā nāhi māne yei durācāra

kumbhīpāke pace, tāra nāhika nistāra

SYNONYMS

tarke—by arguments; *ihā*—this; *nāhi*—not; *māne*—accepts; *yei*—anyone who; *durācāra*—debauchee; *kumbhī-pāke*—in the boiling oil of hell; *pace*—boils; *tāra*—his; *nāhika*—there is not; *nistāra*—deliverance.

TRANSLATION

If one simply adheres to mundane arguments and therefore does not accept this, he will boil in the hell of Kumbhīpāka. For him there is no deliverance.

PURPORT

Kumbhīpāka, a type of hellish condition, is described in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (5.26.13), wherein it is said that a person who cooks living birds and beasts to satisfy his tongue is brought before Yamarāja after death and punished in the Kumbhīpāka hell. There he is put into boiling oil called *kumbhī-pāka*, from which there is no deliverance. Kumbhīpāka is meant for persons who are unnecessarily envious. Those who are envious of the activities of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu are punished in that hellish condition.

TEXT 308

acintyāḥ khalu ye bhāvā

na tāms tarkeṇa yojayet

prakṛtibhyaḥ param yac ca

tad acintyasya lakṣaṇam

SYNONYMS

acintyāḥ—inconceivable; *khalu*—certainly; *ye*—those; *bhāvāḥ*—subject matters; *na*—not; *tān*—them; *tarkeṇa*—by argument; *yojayet*—one may

understand; *prakṛtibhyaḥ*—to material nature; *param*—transcendental; *yat*—that which; *ca*—and; *tat*—that; *acintyasya*—of the inconceivable; *lakṣaṇam*—a symptom.

TRANSLATION

“Anything transcendental to material nature is called inconceivable, whereas arguments are all mundane. Since mundane arguments cannot touch transcendental subject matters, one should not try to understand transcendental subjects through mundane arguments.”

PURPORT

This verse from the *Mahābhārata* (*Bhīṣma-parva* 5.22) is also quoted in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (2.5.93), by Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī.

TEXT 309

adbhuta caitanya-līlāya yāhāra viśvāsa

sei jana yāya caitanyera pada pāśa

SYNONYMS

adbhuta—wonderful; *caitanya-līlāya*—in the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *yāhāra*—anyone whose; *viśvāsa*—faith; *sei*—that; *jana*—person; *yāya*—makes progress; *caitanyera*—of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *pada*—the lotus feet; *pāśa*—near.

TRANSLATION

Only a person who has firm faith in the wonderful pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu can approach His lotus feet.

TEXT 310

prasaṅge kahila ei siddhāntera sāra

ihā yei śune, śuddha-bhakti haya tāra

SYNONYMS

prasaṅge—in the course of discussion; *kahila*—it was said; *ei*—this; *siddhāntera*—of the conclusion; *sāra*—the essence; *ihā*—this; *yei*—anyone who; *śune*—hears; *śuddha-bhakti*—unalloyed devotional service; *haya*—becomes; *tāra*—his.

TRANSLATION

In this discourse I have explained the essence of the devotional conclusion. Anyone who hears this develops unalloyed devotional service to the Lord.

TEXT 311

likhita granthera yadi kari anuvāda

tabe se granthera artha pāiye āsvāda

SYNONYMS

likhita—written; *granthera*—of the scripture; *yadi*—if; *kari*—I do; *anuvāda*—repetition; *tabe*—then; *se granthera*—of that scripture; *artha*—the meaning; *pāiye*—I can get; *āsvāda*—taste.

TRANSLATION

If I repeat what is already written, I may thus relish the purpose of this scripture.

TEXT 312

dekhi granthe bhāgavate vyāsera ācāra

kathā kahi’ anuvāda kare vāra vāra

SYNONYMS

dekhi—I see; *granthē*—in the scripture; *bhāgavate*—in *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*; *vyāsera*—of Śrī Vyāsadeva; *ācāra*—behavior; *kathā*—narration; *kahi’*—describing; *anuvāda*—repetition; *kare*—he does; *vāra vāra*—again and again.

TRANSLATION

We can see in the scripture *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* the conduct of its author, Śrī Vyāsadeva. After speaking the narration, he repeats it again and again.

PURPORT

At the end of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, in the Twelfth Canto, the Twelfth Chapter contains forty-three verses in which Śrī Kṛṣṇa-dvaipāyana Vedavyāsa recapitulates *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*’s entire subject matter. Śrī Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī wants to follow in the footsteps of Śrī Vyāsadeva by recapitulating the seventeen chapters of *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*’s *Ādi-līlā*.

TEXT 313

tāte ādi-līlāra kari pariccheda gaṇana

prathama paricchede kailuṇ ‘maṅgalācaraṇa’

SYNONYMS

tāte—therefore; *ādi-līlāra*—of the First Canto, known as *Ādi-līlā*; *kari*—

I do; *pariccheda*—chapter; *gaṇana*—enumeration; *prathama paricchede*—in the First Chapter; *kailuṇ*—I have done; *maṅgala-ācaraṇa*—invocation of auspiciousness.

TRANSLATION

Therefore I shall enumerate the chapters of the Ādi-līlā. In the First Chapter I offer obeisances to the spiritual master, for this is the beginning of auspicious writing.

TEXT 314

dvitīya paricchede ‘caitanya-tattva-nirūpaṇa’

svayaṁ bhagavān yei vrajendra-nandana

SYNONYMS

dvitīya paricchede—in the Second Chapter; *caitanya-tattva-nirūpaṇa*—description of the truth of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *svayaṁ*—personally; *bhagavān*—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *yei*—who; *vrajendra-nandana*—the son of Nanda Mahārāja.

TRANSLATION

The Second Chapter explains the truth of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa, the son of Mahārāja Nanda.

TEXT 315

teṁho ta’ caitanya-kṛṣṇa—śācīra nandana

tr̥tīya paricchede janmera ‘sāmānya’ kāraṇa

SYNONYMS

tenho—He; *ta'*—certainly; *caitanya-kṛṣṇa*—Kṛṣṇa with the name of Śrī Caitanya; *śacīra nandana*—the son of Śacīmātā; *tṛtīya paricchede*—in the Third Chapter; *janmera*—of His birth; *sāmānya*—general; *kāraṇa*—reason.

TRANSLATION

Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu, who is Kṛṣṇa Himself, has now appeared as the son of mother Śacī. The Third Chapter describes the general cause of His appearance.

TEXT 316

tahin madhye prema-dāna——‘*viśeṣa*’ *kāraṇa*

yuga-dharma——*kṛṣṇa-nāma-prema-pracāraṇa*

SYNONYMS

tahin madhye—in that chapter; *prema-dāna*—distribution of love of Godhead; *viśeṣa*—specific; *kāraṇa*—reason; *yuga-dharma*—the religion of the millennium; *kṛṣṇa-nāma*—the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prema*—love of Godhead; *pracāraṇa*—propagating.

TRANSLATION

The Third Chapter specifically describes the distribution of love of Godhead. It also describes the religion of the age, which is simply to distribute the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa and propagate the process of loving Him.

TEXT 317

caturthe kahiluṅ janmera ‘mūla’ prayojana

sva-mādhurya-premānanda-rasa-āsvādana

SYNONYMS

caturthe—in the Fourth Chapter; *kahiluṅ*—I have described; *janmera*—of His birth; *mūla*—the real; *prayojana*—necessity; *sva-mādhurya*—His own transcendental sweetness; *prema-ānanda*—of ecstatic joy from love; *rasa*—the mellows; *āsvādana*—tasting.

TRANSLATION

The Fourth Chapter describes the main reason for His appearance, which is to taste the mellows of His own transcendental loving service and His own sweetness.

TEXT 318

pañcame ‘śrī-nityānanda’-tattva nirūpaṇa

nityānanda hailā rāma rohiṇī-nandana

SYNONYMS

pañcame—in the Fifth Chapter; *śrī-nityānanda*—of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *tattva*—the truth; *nirūpaṇa*—description; *nityānanda*—Lord Nityānanda Prabhu; *hailā*—was; *rāma*—Balarāma; *rohiṇī-nandana*—the son of Rohiṇī.

TRANSLATION

The Fifth Chapter describes the truth of Lord Nityānanda Prabhu, who is none other than Balarāma, the son of Rohiṇī.

TEXT 319

ṣaṣṭha paricchede ‘advaita-tattve’ra vicāra

advaita-ācārya—mahā-viṣṇu-avatāra

SYNONYMS

ṣaṣṭha paricchede—in the Sixth Chapter; *advaita*—of Advaita Ācārya; *tattvera*—of the truth; *vicāra*—consideration; *advaita-ācārya*—Advaita Prabhu; *mahā-viṣṇu-avatāra*—incarnation of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

TRANSLATION

The Sixth Chapter considers the truth of Advaita Ācārya. He is an incarnation of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

TEXT 320

saptama paricchede ‘pañca-tattve’ra ākhyāna

pañca-tattva mili’ yaiche kailā prema-dāna

SYNONYMS

saptama paricchede—in the Seventh Chapter; *pañca-tattvera*—of the five *tattvas* (truths); *ākhyāna*—the elaboration; *pañca-tattva*—the five *tattvas*; *mili’*—combining together; *yaiche*—in what way; *kailā*—did; *prema-dāna*—distribution of love of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

The Seventh Chapter describes the Pañca-tattva—Śrī Caitanya, Prabhu Nityānanda, Śrī Advaita, Gadādhara and Śrīvāsa. They all combined together to distribute love of Godhead everywhere.

TEXT 321

aṣṭame 'caitanya-līlā-varṇana'-kāraṇa

eka kṛṣṇa-nāmera mahā-mahimā-kathana

SYNONYMS

aṣṭame—in the Eighth Chapter; *caitanya-līlā-varṇana-kāraṇa*—the reason for describing Caitanya Mahāprabhu's pastimes; *eka*—one; *kṛṣṇa-nāmera*—of the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mahā-mahimā-kathana*—description of great glories.

TRANSLATION

The Eighth Chapter gives the reason for describing Lord Caitanya's pastimes. It also describes the greatness of Lord Kṛṣṇa's holy name.

TEXT 322

navamete 'bhakti-kalpa-vṛkṣera varṇana'

śrī-caitanya-mālī kailā vṛkṣa āropaṇa

SYNONYMS

navamete—in the Ninth Chapter; *bhakti-kalpa-vṛkṣera*—of the desire tree of devotional service; *varṇana*—the description; *śrī-caitanya-mālī*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu as the gardener; *kailā*—did; *vṛkṣa*—the tree; *āropaṇa*—implantation.

TRANSLATION

The Ninth Chapter describes the desire tree of devotional service. Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu Himself is the gardener who planted it.

TEXT 323

daśamete mūla-skandhera 'śākhādi-gaṇana'

sarva-śākhā-gaṇera yaiche phala-vītarāṇa

SYNONYMS

daśamete—in the Tenth Chapter; *mūla-skandhera*—of the main trunk; *śākhā-ādi*—of the branches, etc.; *gaṇana*—enumeration; *sarva-śākhā-gaṇera*—of all branches; *yaiche*—in what way; *phala-vītarāṇa*—distribution of the fruits.

TRANSLATION

The Tenth Chapter describes the branches and subbranches of the main trunk and the distribution of their fruits.

TEXT 324

ekādaśe 'nityānanda-śākhā-vivaraṇa'

dvādaśe 'advaita-skandha śākhāra varṇana'

SYNONYMS

ekādaśe—in the Eleventh Chapter; *nityānanda-śākhā*—of the branches of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu; *vivaraṇa*—description; *dvādaśe*—in the Twelfth Chapter; *advaita-skandha*—the trunk known as Advaita Prabhu; *śākhāra*—of the branch; *varṇana*—description.

TRANSLATION

The Eleventh Chapter describes the branch called Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu. The Twelfth Chapter describes the branch called Śrī Advaita

Prabhu.

TEXT 325

trayodaśe mahāprabhura ‘janma-vivaraṇa’

kṛṣṇa-nāma-saha yaiche prabhura janama

SYNONYMS

trayodaśe—in the Thirteenth Chapter; *mahāprabhura*—of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *janma*—of the birth; *vivaraṇa*—the description; *kṛṣṇa-nāma-saha*—along with the holy name of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *yaiche*—in what way; *prabhura*—of the Lord; *janama*—the birth.

TRANSLATION

The Thirteenth Chapter describes the birth of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, which took place with the chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 326

caturdaśe ‘bālya-līlā’ra kichu vivaraṇa

pañcadaśe ‘paugaṇḍa-līlā’ra saṅkṣepe kathana

SYNONYMS

caturdaśe—in the Fourteenth Chapter; *bālya-līlā’ra*—of the Lord’s childhood pastimes; *kichu*—some; *vivaraṇa*—description; *pañcadaśe*—in the Fifteenth Chapter; *paugaṇḍa-līlāra*—of the pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* (boyhood) age; *saṅkṣepe*—in brief; *kathana*—the telling.

TRANSLATION

The Fourteenth Chapter gives some description of the Lord's childhood pastimes. The Fifteenth briefly describes the Lord's boyhood pastimes.

TEXT 327

ṣoḍaśa paricchede 'kaiśora-līlā' ra uddeśa

saptadaśe 'yauvana-līlā' kahiluṁ viśeṣa

SYNONYMS

ṣoḍaśa—sixteenth; *paricchede*—in the chapter; *kaiśora-līlā*—of pastimes prior to youth; *uddeśa*—indication; *saptadaśe*—in the Seventeenth Chapter; *yauvana-līlā*—the pastimes of youth; *kahiluṁ*—I have stated; *viśeṣa*—specifically.

TRANSLATION

In the Sixteenth Chapter I have indicated the pastimes of the *kaiśora* age [the age prior to youth]. In the Seventeenth Chapter I have specifically described His youthful pastimes.

TEXT 328

ei saptadaśa prakāra ādi-līlāra prabandha

dvādaśa prabandha tāte grantha-mukhabandha

SYNONYMS

ei saptadaśa—these seventeen; *prakāra*—varieties; *ādi-līlāra*—of the *Ādi-līlā* (first canto); *prabandha*—subject matter; *dvādaśa*—twelve; *prabandha*—subject matters; *tāte*—among those; *grantha*—of the book; *mukha-bandha*—prefaces.

TRANSLATION

Thus there are seventeen varieties of subjects in the first canto, which is known as the Ādi-līlā. Twelve of these constitute the preface of this scripture.

TEXT 329

pañca-prabandhe pañca-rasera carita

saṅkṣepe kahiluṁ ati,——nā kailuṁ vistṛta

SYNONYMS

pañca-prabandhe—in five chapters; *pañca-rasera*—of five transcendental mellows; *carita*—the character; *saṅkṣepe*—in brief; *kahiluṁ*—I stated; *ati*—greatly; *nā kailuṁ*—I did not make; *vistṛta*—expanded.

TRANSLATION

After the chapters of the preface, I have described five transcendental mellows in five chapters. I have described them very briefly rather than expansively.

TEXT 330

vṛndāvana-dāsa ihā 'caitanya-maṅgale'

vistāri' varṇilā nityānanda-ājñā-bale

SYNONYMS

vṛndāvana-dāsa—Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana dāsa; *ihā*—this; *caitanya-maṅgale*—in his book *Caitanya-maṅgala*; *vistāri'*—expanding; *varṇilā*—described; *nityānanda*—of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu; *ājñā*—of the order;

bale—on the strength.

TRANSLATION

By the order and strength of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, Śrīla Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura has elaborately described in his Caitanya-maṅgala all that I have not.

TEXT 331

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-līlā——adbhuta, ananta

brahmā-śiva-śeṣa yāñra nāhi pāya anta

SYNONYMS

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-līlā—the pastimes of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *ananta*—unlimited; *brahmā*—Lord Brahmā; *śiva*—Lord Śiva; *śeṣa*—Lord Śeṣa Nāga; *yāñra*—of which; *nāhi*—not; *pāya*—get; *anta*—end.

TRANSLATION

The pastimes of Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu are wonderful and unlimited. Even personalities like Lord Brahmā, Lord Śiva and Śeṣa Nāga cannot find their end.

TEXT 332

ye yei amśa kahe, śune sei dhanya

acire milibe tāre śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya

SYNONYMS

ye yei aṁśa—any part of this; *kahe*—anyone who describes; *śune*—anyone who hears; *sei*—that person; *dhanya*—glorious; *acire*—very soon; *milibe*—will meet; *tāre*—Him; *śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya*—Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TRANSLATION

Anyone who describes or hears any part of this elaborate subject will very soon receive the causeless mercy of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 333

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya, advaita, nityānanda

śrīvāsa-gadādharaḍi yata bhakta-vṛnda

SYNONYMS

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya—Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu; *advaita*—Advaita Ācārya Prabhu; *nityānanda*—Nityānanda Prabhu; *śrīvāsa*—Śrīvāsa Ṭhākura; *gadādhara-ādi*—and others like Gadādhara; *yata*—all; *bhakta-vṛnda*—all devotees.

TRANSLATION

[Herein the author again describes the Pañca-tattva.] Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, Prabhu Nityānanda, Śrī Advaita, Gadādhara, Śrīvāsa and all the devotees of Lord Caitanya.

TEXT 334

yata yata bhakta-gaṇa vaise vṛndāvane

namra hañā śīre dharaṇ sabāra caraṇe

SYNONYMS

yata yata—each and every one; *bhakta-gaṇa*—devotees; *vaise*—reside; *vṛndāvane*—at Vṛndāvana; *namra hañā*—becoming humble; *śire*—on my head; *dharoṇ*—I place; *sabāra*—of all; *caraṇe*—the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

I offer my respectful obeisances to all the residents of Vṛndāvana. I wish to place their lotus feet on my head in great humbleness.

TEXTS 335–336

śrī-svarūpa-śrī-rūpa-śrī-sanātana

śrī-raghunātha-dāsa, āra śrī-jīva-caraṇa

śire dhari vandoṇ, nitya karoṇ tāṇra āśa

caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa

SYNONYMS

śrī-svarūpa—Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara; *śrī-rūpa*—Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī; *śrī-sanātana*—Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī; *śrī-raghunātha-dāsa*—Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī; *āra*—and; *śrī-jīva-caraṇa*—the lotus feet of Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī; *śire*—on the head; *dhari*—placing; *vandoṇ*—I worship; *nitya*—always; *karoṇ*—I do; *tāṇra*—their; *āśa*—hope to serve; *caitanya-caritāmṛta*—the book named *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*; *kahe*—describes; *kṛṣṇadāsa*—Śrīla Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvāmī.

TRANSLATION

I wish to place the lotus feet of the Gosvāmīs on my head. Their names are Śrī Svarūpa Dāmodara, Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī, Śrī

Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī and Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī. Placing their lotus feet on my head, always hoping to serve them, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, following in their footsteps.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Ādi-līlā, Seventeenth Chapter, describing the pastimes of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu in His youth.

END OF THE ĀDI-LĪLĀ

ⁱA foolish farmer once thought he would save money by cutting off his hen's head, which he had to feed, and leaving its tail, which produced the eggs. Hence the term *ardha-kukkuṭi-nyāya*, literally "half-hen logic."

“yasya deve parā bhaktir
yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāḥ
prakāśante mahātmanāḥ

“Unto those great souls who have implicit faith in both the Lord and the spiritual master, all the imports of Vedic knowledge are automatically revealed.” (*Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23)

ataḥ śrī-kṛṣṇa-nāmādi
na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiḥ
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau
svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ

“No one can understand Kṛṣṇa as He is by the blunt material senses. But He reveals Himself to the devotees, being pleased with them for their transcendental loving service unto Him.” (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.234)

bhaktyā mām abhijānāti
yāvān yaś cāsmi tattvataḥ
tato mām tattvato jñātvā
viśate tad-anantaram

“One can understand the Supreme Personality as He is only by devotional service. And when one is in full consciousness of the Supreme Lord by such devotion, he can enter into the kingdom of God.” (Bg. 18.55)

These are Vedic instructions. One must have full faith in the words of the spiritual master and similar faith in the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Then the real knowledge of *ātmā* and Paramātmā and the distinction between matter and spirit will be automatically revealed. This *ātmā-tattva*, or spiritual knowledge, will be revealed within the core of a devotee’s heart because of his having taken shelter of the lotus feet of a *mahājana* such as Prahlāda Mahārāja.

*iii*yasya deve parā bhaktir
yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāḥ
prakāśante mahātmanaḥ

“Unto those great souls who have implicit faith in both the Lord and the spiritual master, all the imports of Vedic knowledge are automatically revealed.” (*Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23)

*ataḥ śrī-kṛṣṇa-nāmādi
na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiḥ
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau
svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ*

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These are Vedic instructions. One must have full faith in the words of the spiritual master and similar faith in the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Then the real knowledge of *ātmā* and Paramātmā and the distinction between matter and spirit will be automatically revealed. This *ātmā-tattva*, or spiritual knowledge, will be revealed within the core of a devotee’s heart because of his having taken shelter of the lotus feet of a *mahājana* such as Prahāda Mahārāja.

*iv*śruti-smṛti-purāṇādi-
pañcarātra-vidhiṁ vinā
aikāntikī harer bhaktir
utpātāyaiva kalpate

“Devotional service of the Lord that ignores the authorized Vedic literatures like the Upaniṣads, Purāṇas and Nārada-pañcarātra is simply an unnecessary disturbance in society.” Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 1.2.101

*v*ataḥ śrī-kṛṣṇa-nāmādi
na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiḥ
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau
svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ

“No one can understand the transcendental nature of the name, form, quality and pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa through his materially contaminated senses. Only when one becomes spiritually saturated by transcendental service to the Lord are the transcendental name, form, quality and pastimes of the Lord revealed to him.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 1.2.234)

*vi*anyābhilāṣitā-sūnyam
jñāna-karmādy-anāvṛtam
ānukūlyena kṛṣṇānu-
śīlanam bhaktir uttamā

“One should render transcendental loving service to the Supreme Lord

Kṛṣṇa favorably and without desire for material profit or gain through fruitive activities or philosophical speculation. That is called pure devotional service.” *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.1.11

^{vii}śruti-smṛti-purāṇādi-
pañcarātra-vidhiṁ vinā
aikāntikī harer bhaktir
utpātāyaiva kalpate

“Devotional service of the Lord that ignores the authorized Vedic literatures like the Upaniṣads, Purāṇas and Nārada-pañcarātra is simply an unnecessary disturbance in society.” *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.101

^{viii}yasya deve parā bhaktir
yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāḥ
prakāśante mahātmanāḥ

“Unto those great souls who have implicit faith in both the Lord and the spiritual master, all the imports of Vedic knowledge are automatically revealed.” (*Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23)

*ataḥ śrī-kṛṣṇa-nāmādi
na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiḥ
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau
svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ*

“No one can understand Kṛṣṇa as He is by the blunt material senses. But He reveals Himself to the devotees, being pleased with them for their transcendental loving service unto Him.” (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.234)

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tato mām tattvato jñātvā
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devotional service. And when one is in full consciousness of the Supreme Lord by such devotion, he can enter into the kingdom of God.” (Bg. 18.55)

These are Vedic instructions. One must have full faith in the words of the spiritual master and similar faith in the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Then the real knowledge of *ātmā* and Paramātmā and the distinction between matter and spirit will be automatically revealed. This *ātmā-tattva*, or spiritual knowledge, will be revealed within the core of a devotee’s heart because of his having taken shelter of the lotus feet of a *mahājana* such as Prahāda Mahārāja.

^{ix} *The line of numbers labeled śāka* defines the time of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu’s appearance. One thousand four hundred seven years of the Śāka era had passed: it was the 1408th year. Ten months of that year had passed: it was the eleventh month (Phālguna). Twenty-two days of Phālguna had passed: it was the 23rd day. Twenty-eight *ghaṭīs* (11 hours, 12 minutes) and 45 *palas* (18 minutes) had passed since sunrise: it was just after sunset. The square of numbers gives further astrological information concerning the time of the Lord’s birth.

*yasya deve parā bhaktir
yathā deve tathā gurau
tasyaite kathitā hy arthāḥ
prakāśante mahātmanāḥ

“Unto those great souls who have implicit faith in both the Lord and the spiritual master, all the imports of Vedic knowledge are automatically revealed.” (*Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.23)

ataḥ śrī-kṛṣṇa-nāmādi
na bhaved grāhyam indriyaiḥ
sevonmukhe hi jihvādau
svayam eva sphuraty adaḥ

“No one can understand Kṛṣṇa as He is by the blunt material senses. But He reveals Himself to the devotees, being pleased with them for their transcendental loving service unto Him.” (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*

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*bhaktyā mām abhijānāti
yāvān yaś cāsmi tattvataḥ
tato mām tattvato jñātvā
viśate tad-anantaram*

“One can understand the Supreme Personality as He is only by devotional service. And when one is in full consciousness of the Supreme Lord by such devotion, he can enter into the kingdom of God.” (Bg. 18.55)

These are Vedic instructions. One must have full faith in the words of the spiritual master and similar faith in the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Then the real knowledge of *ātmā* and Paramātmā and the distinction between matter and spirit will be automatically revealed. This *ātma-tattva*, or spiritual knowledge, will be revealed within the core of a devotee’s heart because of his having taken shelter of the lotus feet of a *mahājana* such as Prahlāda Mahārāja.